

THE STORY OF SALVATION

an abridged reading of the whole arc in order

The Full Account track

357 readings

Douay-Rheims (Challoner)

This track

The full spine at about a chapter to a reading: 357 readings, 13,867 verses, 38.7 per cent of the Bible, touching 454 chapters in 31 books. Adds to the narrative tier the three remaining gospels where they give what St. Luke does not; the narrative deuterocanon - Daniel, Esther, Tobias, Judith and 2 Machabees 6-7; and the non-narrative passages the story is unintelligible without: the messianic prophecies of Isaias, the new covenant of Jeremias, the shepherd and the dry bones of Ezechiel, and sixteen psalms. At roughly a reading a day it runs a year with eight days to spare.

Extent. 357 readings, 454 chapters and 13867 verses of this edition.

What this plan does not read

This account belongs at the front and not in a footnote. An abridgement is defined by what it drops.

This plan is an abridgement, and the honest account of an abridgement is what it leaves out. All figures below are verse counts taken from the Douay-Rheims (Challoner) text indexed in this repository, whose 73 books hold 35,804 verses. Percentages computed on a 66-book canon run higher for every class named here, because the denominator is smaller; the commonly quoted figures of about 19.8 per cent for the prophets, 14.4 per cent for wisdom and poetry and 8.1 per cent for the epistles are of that kind.

At its fullest tier this plan reads 13,867 verses, 38.7 per cent of the Bible. The story tier reads 3,675 verses, 10.3 per cent. The landmarks tier reads 1,210 verses, 3.4 per cent.

The reduction does not come from cutting genealogies and law codes. Those are small: every genealogy and register dropped here comes to 297 verses, 0.8 per cent of the Bible, and the whole of Leviticus, Exodus 25-31 and 35-40, Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 and Deuteronomy 12-26 together come to 2,217 verses, 6.2 per cent. Seven per cent, between them. The reduction comes from dropping three whole classes of book that are not narrative, which come to 15,519 verses, 43.3 per cent of the Bible.

Not read at any tier:

The prophets, 5,875 verses, 16.4 per cent of the Bible (counting Lamentations, Baruch and Daniel among them). What survives is fifteen passages in thirteen readings, and the narrative chapters of Daniel: Isaias 7:1-17, 9:1-7, 11:1-10, 52:13-53:12, 54:5-14 and 55:1-11; Jeremias 31:31-40, 36 and 38:1-13; Baruch 3:9-15 with 3:32-4:4; Ezechiel 34, 36:16-28 and 37:1-14; Lamentations 3:19-33; Daniel 1-6, 13 and 14. Everything else is absent - the whole of Osee through Malachias, all but six passages of Isaias, all but three of Jeremias, Daniel's visions, and every oracle against the nations. A reader who finishes this plan has not read the prophets.

The wisdom and poetical books, 6,881 verses, 19.2 per cent. Job, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, the Canticle of Canticles, Wisdom and Ecclesiasticus are not read at all. Of the 150 psalms, sixteen are read, each because a narrative moment demands it.

The epistles, 2,763 verses, 7.7 per cent. All twenty-one, and Hebrews with them. The plan follows the Church's expansion through the Acts and stops; it does not read what the apostles wrote to the churches they founded. That is the largest gap in its New Testament coverage, and no narrative plan can close it, because the epistles are not narrative.

The Apocalypse, but for 21:1-22:5, read as the close of the arc opened in Genesis 1.

Also not read, being narrative or historical but doubled, legal, or list: Leviticus entire; Exodus 25-31 and 35-40; Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 apart from chapter 27; Deuteronomy 12-26; Josue 12-22; Judges 17-21; 1 and 2 Paralipomenon entire, as a second telling of reigns already read in Samuel and Kings; Aggeus, Zacharias and Malachias, though they belong to the Return; and 2 Machabees but for chapters 6 and 7.

Genealogies and registers dropped: Genesis 5, 10, 22:20-24, 25:12-18 and 36; Exodus 6:14-30; Esdras 2; Nehemias 3 and 7. Genesis 11:10-32 and St. Matthew 1 are kept, because they are the two genealogies that carry the plot.

The consensus narrative spine within the twelve periods is 334 chapters. This plan reads 331 of them, holding back only Esdras 2, Nehemias 3 and Nehemias 7, and adds the material listed at the year tier. It touches 454 chapters in 31 of the 73 books.

The cost is stated here because every abridgement that concealed it has been attacked for concealing it. A reader who wants the Bible should read the Bible. What this offers is the story in order, at three depths, with the seams visible.

The readings of this track

PRIMEVAL HISTORY

1	Creation	10
	<i>Genesis 1:1-2:2</i>	
2	The seventh day and the garden	10
	<i>Genesis 2:3-25</i>	
3	The fall	11
	<i>Genesis 3:1-24</i>	
4	Cain and Abel	11
	<i>Genesis 4:1-16</i>	
5	The sons of Cain, and calling on the name of the Lord . . .	12
	<i>Genesis 4:17-26</i>	
6	The sons of God and the daughters of men	12
	<i>Genesis 6:1-4</i>	
7	The flood	12
	<i>Genesis 6:5-8:22</i>	
8	The covenant with Noe	13
	<i>Genesis 9:1-29</i>	
9	Babel	14
	<i>Genesis 11:1-9</i>	
10	From Sem to Abram	14
	<i>Genesis 11:10-32</i>	
11	Psalms 8	14
	<i>Psalms 8:1-10</i>	
12	Psalms 103, the hymn of creation	14
	<i>Psalms 103:1-35</i>	

PATRIARCHS

13	The call of Abram	15
	<i>Genesis 12:1-9</i>	
14	Abram in Egypt	15
	<i>Genesis 12:10-20</i>	
15	Abram and Lot part	15
	<i>Genesis 13:1-18</i>	
16	Melchisedech, and the rescue of Lot	16
	<i>Genesis 14:1-24</i>	
17	The covenant of the divided victims	16
	<i>Genesis 15:1-21</i>	
18	Agar and Ismael	17
	<i>Genesis 16:1-16</i>	
19	Circumcision, and the new names	17
	<i>Genesis 17:1-27</i>	
20	The three at Mambre, and the plea for Sodom	18
	<i>Genesis 18:1-33</i>	
21	Sodom destroyed; Abraham and Abimelech	18
	<i>Genesis 19:1-20:18</i>	
22	The birth of Isaac; Agar cast out	19
	<i>Genesis 21:1-34</i>	
23	The binding of Isaac	20
	<i>Genesis 22:1-18</i>	
24	The death of Sara, and the cave of Machpelah	20
	<i>Genesis 23:1-20</i>	
25	A wife for Isaac	21
	<i>Genesis 24:1-67</i>	

26	The death of Abraham	22
	<i>Genesis 25:1-11</i>	
27	Esau and Jacob; the birthright sold	22
	<i>Genesis 25:19-34</i>	
28	Isaac at Gerara, and the wells	22
	<i>Genesis 26:1-35</i>	
29	The stolen blessing	23
	<i>Genesis 27:1-46</i>	
30	Jacob sent into Mesopotamia	24
	<i>Genesis 28:1-9</i>	
31	Jacob's ladder at Bethel	24
	<i>Genesis 28:10-22</i>	
32	Lia and Rachel	25
	<i>Genesis 29:1-35</i>	
33	The sons of Jacob, and the flight from Laban	25
	<i>Genesis 30:1-31:55</i>	
34	Jacob wrestles until daybreak	27
	<i>Genesis 32:1-32</i>	
35	Reconciliation, and the men of Sichem	28
	<i>Genesis 33:1-34:31</i>	
36	Bethel confirmed; the death of Rachel	28
	<i>Genesis 35:1-29</i>	
37	Joseph sold by his brethren	29
	<i>Genesis 37:1-36</i>	
38	Juda and Tamar	30
	<i>Genesis 38:1-30</i>	
39	Joseph and the wife of Putiphar	30
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40	The dreams of the butler and the baker	31
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44	Pharao invites Jacob	34
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45	Jacob goes down into Egypt	35
	<i>Genesis 46:1-47:31</i>	
46	Ephraim set before Manasses	36
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47	The blessing of Jacob	36
	<i>Genesis 49:1-32</i>	
48	The death of Jacob and of Joseph	37
	<i>Genesis 50:1-25</i>	

EGYPT AND EXODUS

49	Israel in bondage	38
	<i>Exodus 1:1-22</i>	
50	The birth of Moses, and his flight	38
	<i>Exodus 2:1-25</i>	
51	The burning bush	39
	<i>Exodus 3:1-4:17</i>	
52	Moses returns into Egypt	39
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55 The rod, the blood, the frogs and the flies	40	82 "A star shall rise out of Jacob"	61
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56 Murrain, hail, locusts and darkness	42	83 Beelphegor, and the zeal of Phinees	61
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57 The last plague foretold	43	84 The daughters of Salphaad; Josue appointed	61
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58 The passover, and the going out	43	85 Madian, the land beyond Jordan, and the stations of the journey	62
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62 The canticle of Moses, and the bitter waters	46	89 "Hear, O Israel"	68
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64 Water from the rock; Amalec	47	91 "Not in bread alone"	69
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70 The golden calf	51	97 The canticle of Moses	73
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PRIMEVAL HISTORY

From the creation to the scattering at Babel: the world God made, the fault that broke it, and the first covenant made with a remnant. Genesis 5 and 10, which are genealogies, are passed over; Genesis 11:10-32 is kept because it is the bridge to Abram.

1. Creation

Genesis 1:1-2:2

The first lesson of the Easter Vigil. The Vigil's own abridgement of salvation history governs this plan: every one of its lessons is read at some tier.

1 ¹ In the beginning God created heaven, and earth. ² And the earth was void and empty, and darkness was upon the face of the deep; and the spirit of God moved over the waters.

³ And God said: Be light made. And light was made. ⁴ And God saw the light that it was good; and he divided the light from the darkness. ⁵ And he called the light Day, and the darkness Night; and there was evening and morning one day.

⁶ And God said: Let there be a firmament made amidst the waters: and let it divide the waters from the waters. ⁷ And God made a firmament, and divided the waters that were under the firmament, from those that were above the firmament, and it was so. ⁸ And God called the firmament, Heaven; and the evening and morning were the second day.

⁹ God also said; Let the waters that are under the heaven, be gathered together into one place: and let the dry land appear. And it was so done. ¹⁰ And God called the dry land, Earth; and the gathering together of the waters, he called Seas. And God saw that it was good. ¹¹ And he said: let the earth bring forth green herb, and such as may seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after its kind, which may have seed in itself upon the earth. And it was so done. ¹² And the earth brought forth the green herb, and such as yieldeth seed according to its kind, and the tree that beareth fruit, having seed each one according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. ¹³ And the evening and the morning were the third day.

¹⁴ And God said: Let there be lights made in the firmament of heaven, to divide the day and the night, and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days and years: ¹⁵ To shine in the firmament of heaven, and to give light upon the earth, and it was so done. ¹⁶ And God made two great lights: a greater light to rule the day; and a lesser light to rule the night: and the stars. ¹⁷ And he set them in the firmament of heaven to shine upon the earth. ¹⁸ And to rule the day and the night, and to divide the light and the darkness. And God saw that it was good. ¹⁹ And the evening and morning were the fourth day.

²⁰ God also said: let the waters bring forth the creeping creature having life, and the fowl that may fly over the earth under the firmament of heaven. ²¹ And God created the great whales, and every living and moving creature, which the waters brought forth, according to their kinds, and every winged fowl according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. ²² And he blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the waters of the sea: and let the birds be multiplied upon the earth. ²³ And the evening and morning were the fifth day.

²⁴ And God said: Let the earth bring forth the living creature in its kind, cattle and creeping things, and beasts of the earth,

according to their kinds. And it was so done. ²⁵ And God made the beasts of the earth according to their kinds, and cattle, and every thing that creepeth on the earth after its kind. And God saw that it was good.

²⁶ And he said: Let us make man to our image and likeness: and let him have dominion over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and the beasts, and the whole earth, and every creeping creature that moveth upon the earth. ²⁷ And God created man to his own image: to the image of God he created him: male and female he created them. ²⁸ And God blessed them, saying: Increase and multiply, and fill the earth, and subdue it, and rule over the fishes of the sea, and the fowls of the air, and all living creatures that move upon the earth. ²⁹ And God said: Behold I have given you every herb bearing seed upon the earth, and all trees that have in themselves seed of their own kind, to be your meat: ³⁰ And to all beasts of the earth, and to every fowl of the air, and to all that move upon the earth, and wherein there is life, that they may have to feed upon. And it was so done. ³¹ And God saw all the things that he had made, and they were very good. And the evening and morning were the sixth day.

2 ¹ So the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the furniture of them. ² And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made: and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had done.

2. The seventh day and the garden

Genesis 2:3-25

The sabbath blessing, and the second account, in which man is placed in the garden and given the woman.

2 ³ And he blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.

⁴ These are the generations of the heaven and the earth, when they were created, in the day that the Lord God made the heaven and the earth: ⁵ And every plant of the field before it sprung up in the earth, and every herb of the ground before it grew: for the Lord God had not rained upon the earth; and there was not a man to till the earth. ⁶ But a spring rose out of the earth, watering all the surface of the earth. ⁷ And the Lord God formed man of the slime of the earth: and breathed into his face the breath of life, and man became a living soul. ⁸ And the Lord God had planted a paradise of pleasure from the beginning: wherein he placed man whom he had formed. ⁹ And the Lord God brought forth of the ground all manner of trees, fair to behold, and pleasant to eat of: the tree of life also in the midst of paradise: and the tree of knowledge of good and evil. ¹⁰ And a river went out of the place of pleasure to water paradise, which from thence is divided into four heads. ¹¹ The name of the one is Phison: that is it which compasseth all the land of Hevilath, where gold groweth. ¹² And the gold of that land is very good: there is found bdellium, and the onyx stone. ¹³ And the name of the second river is Gehon: the same is it that compasseth all the land of Ethiopia. ¹⁴ And the name of the third river is Tigris: the same passeth along by the Assyrians. And the fourth river is Euphrates. ¹⁵ And the Lord God took man, and put him into the paradise of pleasure, to dress it, and to keep it. ¹⁶ And he commanded him, saying: Of every tree of paradise thou shalt eat: ¹⁷ But of the tree of

knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat. For in what day soever thou shalt eat of it, thou shalt die the death.

¹⁸ And the Lord God said: It is not good for man to be alone: let us make him a help like unto himself. ¹⁹ And the Lord God having formed out of the ground all the beasts of the earth, and all the fowls of the air, brought them to Adam to see what he would call them: for whatsoever Adam called any living creature the same is its name. ²⁰ And Adam called all the beasts by their names, and all the fowls of the air, and all the cattle of the field: but for Adam there was not found a helper like himself. ²¹ Then the Lord God cast a deep sleep upon Adam: and when he was fast asleep, he took one of his ribs, and filled up flesh for it. ²² And the Lord God built the rib which he took from Adam into a woman: and brought her to Adam. ²³ And Adam said: This now is bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called woman, because she was taken out of man. ²⁴ Wherefore a man shall leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife: and they shall be two in one flesh. ²⁵ And they were both naked: to wit, Adam and his wife: and were not ashamed.

3. The fall

Genesis 3:1-24

The protoevangelium at 3:15 is the seed of everything the plan afterwards follows.

3 ¹ Now the serpent was more subtle than any of the beasts of the earth which the Lord God had made. And he said to the woman: Why hath God commanded you, that you should not eat of every tree of paradise? ² And the woman answered him, saying: Of the fruit of the trees that are in paradise we do eat: ³ But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of paradise, God hath commanded us that we should not eat; and that we should not touch it, lest perhaps we die. ⁴ And the serpent said to the woman: No, you shall not die the death. ⁵ For God doth know that in what day soever you shall eat thereof, your eyes shall be opened: and you shall be as Gods, knowing good and evil.

⁶ And the woman saw that the tree was good to eat, and fair to the eyes, and delightful to behold: and she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave to her husband, who did eat. ⁷ And the eyes of them both were opened: and when they perceived themselves to be naked, they sewed together fig leaves, and made themselves aprons. ⁸ And when they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in paradise at the afternoon air, Adam and his wife hid themselves from the face of the Lord God, amidst the trees of paradise.

⁹ And the Lord God called Adam, and said to him: Where art thou? ¹⁰ And he said: I heard thy voice in paradise; and I was afraid, because I was naked, and I hid myself.

¹¹ And he said to him: And who hath told thee that thou wast naked, but that thou hast eaten of the tree whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat? ¹² And Adam said: The woman, whom thou gavest me to be my companion, gave me of the tree, and I did eat. ¹³ And the Lord God said to the woman: Why hast thou done this? And she answered: The serpent deceived me, and I did eat.

¹⁴ And the Lord God said to the serpent: Because thou hast done this thing, thou art cursed among all cattle, and beasts of

the earth: upon thy breast shalt thou go, and earth shalt thou eat all the days of thy life. ¹⁵ I will put enmities between thee and the woman, and thy seed and her seed: she shall crush thy head, and thou shalt lie in wait for her heel. ¹⁶ To the woman also he said: I will multiply thy sorrows, and thy conceptions: in sorrow shalt thou bring forth children, and thou shalt be under thy husband's power, and he shall have dominion over thee.

¹⁷ And to Adam he said: Because thou hast hearkened to the voice of thy wife, and hast eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee, that thou shouldst not eat, cursed is the earth in thy work: with labour and toil shalt thou eat thereof all the days of thy life. ¹⁸ Thorns and thistles shall it bring forth to thee, and thou shalt eat the herbs of the earth. ¹⁹ In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread till thou return to the earth out of which thou wast taken: for dust thou art, and into dust thou shalt return. ²⁰ And Adam called the name of his wife Eve: because she was the mother of all the living. ²¹ And the Lord God made for Adam and his wife garments of skins, and clothed them.

²² And he said: Behold Adam is become as one of us, knowing good and evil: now therefore lest perhaps he put forth his hand and take also of the tree of life, and eat, and live for ever. ²³ And the Lord God sent him out of the paradise of pleasure, to till the earth from which he was taken. ²⁴ And he cast out Adam: and placed before the paradise of pleasure Cherubims, and a flaming sword, turning every way, to keep the way of the tree of life.

4. Cain and Abel

Genesis 4:1-16

4 ¹ And Adam knew Eve his wife; who conceived and brought forth Cain, saying: I have gotten a man through God. ² And again she brought forth his brother Abel. And Abel was a shepherd, and Cain a husbandman. ³ And it came to pass after many days, that Cain offered, of the fruits of the earth, gifts to the Lord. ⁴ Abel also offered of the firstlings of his flock, and of their fat: and the Lord had respect to Abel, and to his offerings. ⁵ But to Cain and his offerings he had no respect: and Cain was exceeding angry, and his countenance fell. ⁶ And the Lord said to him: Why art thou angry? and why is thy countenance fallen? ⁷ If thou do well, shalt thou not receive? but if ill, shall not sin forthwith be present at the door? but the lust thereof shall be under thee, and thou shalt have dominion over it. ⁸ And Cain said to Abel his brother: Let us go forth abroad. And when they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel, and slew him.

⁹ And the Lord said to Cain: Where is thy brother Abel? And he answered: I know not: am I my brother's keeper? ¹⁰ And he said to him: What hast thou done? the voice of thy brother's blood crieth to me from the earth. ¹¹ Now, therefore, cursed shalt thou be upon the earth, which hath opened her mouth and received the blood of thy brother at thy hand. ¹² When thou shalt till it, it shall not yield to thee its fruit: a fugitive and a vagabond shalt thou be upon the earth.

¹³ And Cain said to the Lord: My iniquity is greater than that I may deserve pardon. ¹⁴ Behold thou dost cast me out this day from the face of the earth, and from thy face I shall be hid, and I shall be a vagabond and a fugitive on the earth: every one, therefore, that findeth me, shall kill me. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: No, it shall not so be: but whosoever shall kill Cain, shall

be punished sevenfold. And the Lord set a mark upon Cain, that whosoever found him should not kill him.

¹⁶ And Cain went out from the face of the Lord, and dwelt as a fugitive on the earth at the east side of Eden.

5. The sons of Cain, and calling on the name of the Lord

Genesis 4:17-26

Kept, against the general omission of genealogies, because it divides the two lines from which the flood narrative proceeds.

4 ¹⁷ And Cain knew his wife, and she conceived, and brought forth Henoch: and he built a city, and called the name thereof by the name of his son Henoch. ¹⁸ And Henoch begot Irad, and Irad begot Maviael, and Maviael begot Mathusael, and Mathusael begot Lamech, ¹⁹ Who took two wives: the name of the one was Ada, and the name of the other Sella. ²⁰ And Ada brought forth Jabel: who was the father of such as dwell in tents, and of herdsmen. ²¹ And his brother's name was Jubal: he was the father of them that play upon the harp and the organs. ²² Sella also brought forth Tubalcain, who was a hammerer and artificer in every work of brass and iron. And the sister of Tubalcain was Noema. ²³ And Lamech said to his wives Ada and Sella: Hear my voice, ye wives of Lamech, hearken to my speech: for I have slain a man to the wounding of myself, and a stripling to my own bruising. ²⁴ Sevenfold vengeance shall be taken for Cain: but for Lamech seventy times sevenfold.

²⁵ Adam also knew his wife again: and she brought forth a son, and called his name Seth, saying: God hath given me another seed for Abel, whom Cain slew. ²⁶ But to Seth also was born a son, whom he called Enos: this man began to call upon the name of the Lord.

6. The sons of God and the daughters of men

Genesis 6:1-4

6 ¹ And after that men began to be multiplied upon the earth, and daughters were born to them, ² The sons of God seeing the daughters of men, that they were fair, took to themselves wives of all which they chose. ³ And God said: My spirit shall not remain in man for ever, because he is flesh, and his days shall be a hundred and twenty years. ⁴ Now giants were upon the earth in those days. For after the sons of God went in to the daughters of men, and they brought forth children, these are the mighty men of old, men of renown.

7. The flood

Genesis 6:5-8:22

Read as one unit: the corruption, the ark, the deluge and its abating.

6 ⁵ And God seeing that the wickedness of men was great on the earth, and that all the thought of their heart was bent upon evil at all times, ⁶ It repented him that he had made man on the earth. And being touched inwardly with sorrow of heart, ⁷ He said: I will destroy man, whom I have created, from the face of the earth, from man even to beasts, from the creeping thing even to the fowls of the air, for it repenteth me that I have made them. ⁸ But Noe found grace before the Lord.

⁹ These are the generations of Noe: Noe was a just and perfect man in his generations, he walked with God. ¹⁰ And he begot

three sons, Sem, Cham, and Japheth. ¹¹ And the earth was corrupted before God, and was filled with iniquity. ¹² And when God had seen that the earth was corrupted (for all flesh had corrupted its way upon the earth),

¹³ He said to Noe: The end of all flesh is come before me, the earth is filled with iniquity through them, and I will destroy them with the earth. ¹⁴ Make thee an ark of timber planks: thou shalt make little rooms in the ark, and thou shalt pitch it within and without. ¹⁵ And thus shalt thou make it. The length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits: the breadth of it fifty cubits, and the height of it thirty cubits. ¹⁶ Thou shalt make a window in the ark, and in a cubit shalt thou finish the top of it: and the door of the ark thou shalt set in the side: with lower, middle chambers, and third stories shalt thou make it. ¹⁷ Behold, I will bring the waters of a great flood upon the earth, to destroy all flesh, wherein is the breath of life under heaven. All things that are in the earth shall be consumed. ¹⁸ And I will establish my covenant with thee, and thou shalt enter into the ark, thou and thy sons, and thy wife, and the wives of thy sons with thee. ¹⁹ And of every living creature of all flesh, thou shalt bring two of a sort into the ark, that they may live with thee: of the male sex, and the female. ²⁰ Of fowls according to their kind, and of beasts in their kind, and of every thing that creepeth on the earth according to its kind: two of every sort shall go in with thee, that they may live. ²¹ Thou shalt take unto thee of all food that may be eaten, and thou shalt lay it up with thee: and it shall be food for thee and them. ²² And Noe did all things which God commanded him.

7 ¹ And the Lord said to him: Go in, thou and all thy house, into the ark: for thee I have seen just before me in this generation. ² Of all clean beasts take seven and seven, the male and the female. ³ But of the beasts that are unclean two and two, the male and the female. Of the fowls also of the air seven and seven, the male and the female: that seed may be saved upon the face of the whole earth. ⁴ For yet a while, and after seven days, I will rain upon the earth forty days and forty nights: and I will destroy every substance that I have made, from the face of the earth.

⁵ And Noe did all things which the Lord had commanded him. ⁶ And he was six hundred years old, when the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. ⁷ And Noe went in and his sons, his wife and the wives of his sons with him into the ark, because of the waters of the flood. ⁸ And of beasts clean and unclean, and of fowls, and of every thing that moveth upon the earth, ⁹ Two and two went in to Noe into the ark, male and female, as the Lord had commanded Noe. ¹⁰ And after the seven days were passed, the waters of the flood overflowed the earth. ¹¹ In the six hundredth year of the life of Noe, in the second month, in the seventeenth day of the month, all the fountains of the great deep were broken up, and the floodgates of heaven were opened: ¹² And the rain fell upon the earth forty days and forty nights.

¹³ In the selfsame day Noe, and Sem, and Cham, and Japheth, his sons: his wife, and the three wives of his sons with them, went into the ark. ¹⁴ They and every beast according to its kind, and all the cattle in their kind, and every thing that moveth upon the earth, according to its kind, and every fowl according to its kind, all birds, and all that fly, ¹⁵ Went in to Noe into the

ark, two and two of all flesh, wherein was the breath of life. ¹⁶ And they that went in, went in male and female of all flesh, as God had commanded him: and the Lord shut him in on the outside. ¹⁷ And the flood was forty days upon the earth: and the waters increased, and lifted up the ark on high from the earth. ¹⁸ For they overflowed exceedingly: and filled all on the face of the earth: and the ark was carried upon the waters. ¹⁹ And the waters prevailed beyond measure upon the earth: and all the high mountains under the whole heaven were covered. ²⁰ The water was fifteen cubits higher than the mountains which it covered. ²¹ And all flesh was destroyed that moved upon the earth, both of fowl and of cattle, and of beasts, and of all creeping things that creep upon the earth: and all men. ²² And all things wherein there is the breath of life on the earth, died. ²³ And he destroyed all the substance that was upon the earth, from man even to beast, and the creeping things and fowls of the air: and they were destroyed from the earth: and Noe only remained, and they that were with him in the ark. ²⁴ And the waters prevailed upon the earth a hundred and fifty days.

8 ¹ And God remembered Noe, and all the living creatures, and all the cattle which were with him in the ark, and brought a wind upon the earth, and the waters were abated: ² The fountains also of the deep, and the floodgates of heaven, were shut up, and the rain from heaven was restrained. ³ And the waters returned from off the earth going and coming: and they began to be abated after a hundred and fifty days. ⁴ And the ark rested in the seventh month, the seven and twentieth day of the month, upon the mountains of Armenia. ⁵ And the waters were going and decreasing until the tenth month: for in the tenth month, the first day of the month, the tops of the mountains appeared.

⁶ And after that forty days were passed, Noe opening the window of the ark, which he had made, sent forth a raven: ⁷ Which went forth and did not return, till the waters were dried up upon the earth. ⁸ He sent forth also a dove after him, to see if the waters had now ceased upon the face of the earth. ⁹ But she not finding where her foot might rest, returned to him into the ark: for the waters were upon the whole earth: and he put forth his hand, and caught her, and brought her into the ark. ¹⁰ And having waited yet seven other days, he again sent forth the dove out of the ark. ¹¹ And she came to him in the evening carrying a bough of an olive tree, with green leaves, in her mouth. Noe therefore understood that the waters were ceased upon the earth. ¹² And he stayed yet other seven days: and he sent forth the dove, which returned not any more unto him.

¹³ Therefore in the six hundredth and first year, the first month, the first day of the month, the waters were lessened upon the earth, and Noe opening the covering of the ark, looked, and saw that the face of the earth was dried. ¹⁴ In the second month, the seven and twentieth day of the month, the earth was dried.

¹⁵ And God spoke to Noe, saying: ¹⁶ Go out of the ark, thou and thy wife, thy sons and the wives of thy sons with thee. ¹⁷ All living things that are with thee of all flesh, as well in fowls as in beasts, and all creeping things that creep upon the earth, bring out with thee, and go ye upon the earth: increase and multiply upon it. ¹⁸ So Noe went out, he and his sons: his wife, and the wives of his sons with him. ¹⁹ And all living things, and cattle,

and creeping things that creep upon the earth, according to their kinds went out of the ark.

²⁰ And Noe built an altar unto the Lord: and taking of all cattle and fowls that were clean, offered holocausts upon the altar. ²¹ And the Lord smelled a sweet savour, and said: I will no more curse the earth for the sake of man: for the imagination and thought of man's heart are prone to evil from his youth: therefore I will no more destroy every living soul as I have done. ²² All the days of the earth, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, night and day, shall not cease.

8. The covenant with Noe

Genesis 9:1-29

The first covenant of the plan; the bow set in the cloud.

9 ¹ And God blessed Noe and his sons. And he said to them: Increase, and multiply, and fill the earth. ² And let the fear and dread of you be upon all the beasts of the earth, and upon all the fowls of the air, and all that move upon the earth: all the fishes of the sea are delivered into your hand. ³ And every thing that moveth, and liveth shall be meat for you: even as the green herbs have I delivered them all to you: ⁴ Saving that flesh with blood you shall not eat. ⁵ For I will require the blood of your lives at the hand of every beast, and at the hand of man, at the hand of every man, and of his brother, will I require the life of man. ⁶ Whosoever shall shed man's blood, his blood shall be shed: for man was made to the image of God. ⁷ But increase you and multiply, and go upon the earth and fill it.

⁸ Thus also said God to Noe, and to his sons with him: ⁹ Behold I will establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you: ¹⁰ And with every living soul that is with you, as well in all birds, as in cattle and beasts of the earth, that are come forth out of the ark, and in all the beasts of the earth. ¹¹ I will establish my covenant with you, and all flesh shall be no more destroyed with the waters of a flood, neither shall there be from henceforth a flood to waste the earth. ¹² And God said: This is the sign of the covenant which I give between me and you, and to every living soul that is with you, for perpetual generations. ¹³ I will set my bow in the clouds, and it shall be the sign of a covenant between me and between the earth. ¹⁴ And when I shall cover the sky with clouds, my bow shall appear in the clouds: ¹⁵ And I will remember my covenant with you, and with every living soul that beareth flesh: and there shall no more be waters of a flood to destroy all flesh. ¹⁶ And the bow shall be in the clouds, and I shall see it, and shall remember the everlasting covenant, that was made between God and every living soul of all flesh which is upon the earth. ¹⁷ And God said to Noe: This shall be the sign of the covenant, which I have established, between me and all flesh upon the earth.

¹⁸ And the sons of Noe, who came out of the ark, were Sem, Cham, and Japheth: and Cham is the father of Chanaan. ¹⁹ These three are the sons of Noe: and from these was all mankind spread over the whole earth. ²⁰ And Noe a husbandman began to till the ground, and planted a vineyard. ²¹ And drinking of the wine was made drunk, and was uncovered in his tent. ²² Which when Cham the father of Chanaan had seen, to wit, that his father's nakedness was uncovered, he told it to his two brethren without. ²³ But Sem and Japheth put a cloak upon their shoulders,

and going backward, covered the nakedness of their father: and their faces were turned away, and they saw not their father's nakedness. ²⁴ And Noe awaking from the wine, when he had learned what his younger son had done to him, ²⁵ He said: Cursed be Chanaan, a servant of servants shall he be unto his brethren. ²⁶ And he said: Blessed be the Lord God of Sem, be Chanaan his servant. ²⁷ May God enlarge Japheth, and may he dwell in the tents of Sem, and Chanaan be his servant.

²⁸ And Noe lived after the flood three hundred and fifty years. ²⁹ And all his days were in the whole nine hundred and fifty years: and he died.

9. Babel

Genesis 11:1-9

11 ¹ And the earth was of one tongue, and of the same speech. ² And when they removed from the east, they found a plain in the land of Sennaar, and dwelt in it. ³ And each one said to his neighbour: Come let us make brick, and bake them with fire. And they had brick instead of stones, and slime instead of mortar: ⁴ And they said: Come, let us make a city and a tower, the top whereof may reach to heaven; and let us make our name famous before we be scattered abroad into all lands.

⁵ And the Lord came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of Adam were building. ⁶ And he said: Behold, it is one people, and all have one tongue: and they have begun to do this, neither will they leave off from their designs, till they accomplish them in deed. ⁷ Come ye, therefore, let us go down, and there confound their tongue, that they may not understand one another's speech. ⁸ And so the Lord scattered them from that place into all lands, and they ceased to build the city. ⁹ And therefore the name thereof was called Babel, because there the language of the whole earth was confounded: and from thence the Lord scattered them abroad upon the face of all countries.

10. From Sem to Abram

Genesis 11:10-32

The one genealogy retained in this period, because without it the call of Abram has no ancestry.

11 ¹⁰ These are the generations of Sem: Sem was a hundred years old when he begot Arphaxad, two years after the flood. ¹¹ And Sem lived after he begot Arphaxad, five hundred years, and begot sons and daughters. ¹² And Arphaxad lived thirty-five years, and begot Sale. ¹³ And Arphaxad lived after he begot Sale, three hundred and three years, and begot sons and daughters. ¹⁴ Sale also lived thirty years, and begot Heber. ¹⁵ And Sale lived after he begot Heber, four hundred and three years: and begot sons and daughters. ¹⁶ And Heber lived thirty-four years, and begot Phaleg. ¹⁷ And Heber lived after he begot Phaleg, four hundred and thirty years: and begot sons and daughters. ¹⁸ Phaleg also lived thirty years, and begot Reu. ¹⁹ And Phaleg lived after he begot Reu, two hundred and nine years, and begot sons and daughters. ²⁰ And Reu lived thirty-two years, and begot Sarug. ²¹ And Reu lived after he begot Sarug, two hundred and seven years, and begot sons and daughters. ²² And Sarug lived thirty years, and begot Nachor. ²³ And Sarug lived after he begot Nachor, two hundred years, and begot sons and daughters. ²⁴ And Nachor lived nine and twenty years, and begot Thare. ²⁵ And

Nachor lived after he begot Thare, a hundred and nineteen years, and begot sons and daughters. ²⁶ And Thare lived seventy years, and begot Abram, and Nachor, and Aran.

²⁷ And these are the generations of Thare: Thare begot Abram, Nachor, and Aran. And Aran begot Lot. ²⁸ And Aran died before Thare his father, in the land of his nativity in Ur of the Chaldees. ²⁹ And Abram and Nachor married wives: the name of Abram's wife was Sarai: and the name of Nachor's wife, Melcha, the daughter of Aran, father of Melcha and father of Jescha. ³⁰ And Sarai was barren, and had no children. ³¹ And Thare took Abram his son, and Lot the son of Aran, his son's son, and Sarai his daughter in law, the wife of Abram his son, and brought them out of Ur of the Chaldees, to go into the land of Chanaan: and they came as far as Haran, and dwelt there. ³² And the days of Thare were two hundred and five years, and he died in Haran.

11. Psalm 8

Psalms 8:1-10

Vulgate numbering, which is this plan's throughout; here the Vulgate and the Hebrew agree.

8 ¹ Unto the end, for the presses: a psalm for David. ² O Lord, our Lord, how admirable is thy name in the whole earth! For thy magnificence is elevated above the heavens. ³ Out of the mouth of infants and of sucklings thou hast perfected praise, because of thy enemies, that thou mayst destroy the enemy and the avenger. ⁴ For I will behold thy heavens, the works of thy fingers: the moon and the stars which thou hast founded. ⁵ What is man, that thou art mindful of him? or the son of man, that thou visitest him? ⁶ Thou hast made him a little less than the angels, thou hast crowned him with glory and honour: ⁷ And hast set him over the works of thy hands. ⁸ Thou hast subjected all things under his feet, all sheep and oxen: moreover, the beasts also of the fields. ⁹ The birds of the air, and the fishes of the sea, that pass through the paths of the sea. ¹⁰ O Lord, our Lord, how admirable is thy name in the whole earth!

12. Psalm 103, the hymn of creation

Psalms 103:1-35

Vulgate 103 = Hebrew 104.

103 ¹ For David himself. Bless the Lord, O my soul: O Lord my God, thou art exceedingly great. Thou hast put on praise and beauty: ² And art clothed with light as with a garment. Who stretchest out the heaven like a pavilion: ³ Who coverest the higher rooms thereof with water. Who makest the clouds thy chariot: who walkest upon the wings of the winds. ⁴ Who makest thy angels spirits: and thy ministers a burning fire. ⁵ Who hast founded the earth upon its own bases: it shall not be moved for ever and ever. ⁶ The deep like a garment is its clothing: above the mountains shall the waters stand. ⁷ At thy rebuke they shall flee: at the voice of thy thunder they shall fear. ⁸ The mountains ascend, and the plains descend into the place which thou hast founded for them. ⁹ Thou hast set a bound which they shall not pass over; neither shall they return to cover the earth. ¹⁰ Thou sendest forth springs in the vales: between the midst of the hills the waters shall pass. ¹¹ All the beasts of the field shall drink: the wild asses shall expect in their thirst. ¹² Over them the birds of the air shall dwell: from the midst of the rocks they

shall give forth their voices. ¹³ Thou waterest the hills from thy upper rooms: the earth shall be filled with the fruit of thy works: ¹⁴ Bringing forth grass for cattle, and herb for the service of men. That thou mayst bring bread out of the earth: ¹⁵ And that wine may cheer the heart of man. That he may make the face cheerful with oil: and that bread may strengthen man's heart. ¹⁶ The trees of the field shall be filled, and the cedars of Libanus which he hath planted: ¹⁷ There the sparrows shall make their nests. The highest of them is the house of the heron. ¹⁸ The high hills are a refuge for the harts, the rock for the irchins. ¹⁹ He hath made the moon for seasons: the sun knoweth his going down. ²⁰ Thou hast appointed darkness, and it is night: in it shall all the beasts of the woods go about: ²¹ The young lions roaring after their prey, and seeking their meat from God. ²² The sun ariseth, and they are gathered together: and they shall lie down in their dens. ²³ Man shall go forth to his work, and to his labour until the evening. ²⁴ How great are thy works, O Lord? thou hast made all things in wisdom: the earth is filled with thy riches. ²⁵ So is this great sea, which stretcheth wide its arms: there are creeping things without number: Creatures little and great. ²⁶ There the ships shall go. This sea dragon which thou hast formed to play therein. ²⁷ All expect of thee that thou give them food in season. ²⁸ What thou givest to them they shall gather up: when thou openest thy hand, they shall all be filled with good. ²⁹ But if thou turnest away thy face, they shall be troubled: thou shalt take away their breath, and they shall fail, and shall return to their dust. ³⁰ Thou shalt send forth thy spirit, and they shall be created: and thou shalt renew the face of the earth. ³¹ May the glory of the Lord endure for ever: the Lord shall rejoice in his works. ³² He looketh upon the earth, and maketh it tremble: he toucheth the mountains, and they smoke. ³³ I will sing to the Lord as long as I live: I will sing praise to my God while I have my being. ³⁴ Let my speech be acceptable to him: but I will take delight in the Lord. ³⁵ Let sinners be consumed out of the earth, and the unjust, so that they be no more: O my soul, bless thou the Lord.

PATRIARCHS

Genesis 12-50, less chapter 36: the promise given to Abraham, carried through Isaac and Jacob, and preserved in Egypt through Joseph. The genealogy of Esau (36), the genealogy of Nachor (22:20-24) and the generations of Ismael (25:12-18) are passed over.

13. The call of Abram

Genesis 12:1-9

The promise on which the rest of the Old Testament depends.

12 ¹ And the Lord said to Abram: Go forth out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and out of thy father's house, and come into the land which I shall shew thee. ² And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and magnify thy name, and thou shalt be blessed. ³ I will bless them that bless thee, and curse them that curse thee, and IN THEE shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed.

⁴ So Abram went out as the Lord had commanded him, and Lot went with him: Abram was seventy-five years old when he went forth from Haran. ⁵ And he took Sarai his wife, and Lot his

brother's son, and all the substance which they had gathered, and the souls which they had gotten in Haran: and they went out to go into the land of Chanaan. And when they were come into it, ⁶ Abram passed through the country unto the place of Sichem, as far as the noble vale: now the Chanaanite was at that time in the land. ⁷ And the Lord appeared to Abram, and said to him: To thy seed will I give this land. And he built there an altar to the Lord, who had appeared to him. ⁸ And passing on from thence to a mountain, that was on the east side of Bethel, he there pitched his tent, having Bethel on the west, and Hai on the east: he built there also an altar to the Lord, and called upon his name. ⁹ And Abram went forward, going and proceeding on to the south.

14. Abram in Egypt

Genesis 12:10-20

12 ¹⁰ And there came a famine in the country: and Abram went down into Egypt, to sojourn there: for the famine was very grievous in the land. ¹¹ And when he was near to enter into Egypt, he said to Sarai his wife: I know that thou art a beautiful woman: ¹² And that when the Egyptians shall see thee, they will say: She is his wife: and they will kill me, and keep thee. ¹³ Say, therefore, I pray thee, that thou art my sister: that I may be well used for thee, and that my soul may live for thy sake.

¹⁴ And when Abram was come into Egypt, the Egyptians saw the woman that she was very beautiful. ¹⁵ And the princes told Pharao, and praised her before him: and the woman was taken into the house of Pharao. ¹⁶ And they used Abram well for her sake. And he had sheep and oxen and he asses, and men servants, and maid servants, and she asses, and camels. ¹⁷ But the Lord scourged Pharao and his house with most grievous stripes for Sarai, Abram's wife. ¹⁸ And Pharao called Abram, and said to him: What is this that thou hast done to me? Why didst thou not tell me that she was thy wife? ¹⁹ For what cause didst thou say, she was thy sister, that I might take her to my wife? Now therefore there is thy wife, take her, and go thy way. ²⁰ And Pharao gave his men orders concerning Abram: and they led him away and his wife, and all that he had.

15. Abram and Lot part

Genesis 13:1-18

13 ¹ And Abram went up out of Egypt, he and his wife, and all that he had, and Lot with him into the south. ² And he was very rich in possession of gold and silver. ³ And he returned by the way, that he came, from the south to Bethel, to the place where before he had pitched his tent between Bethel and Hai, ⁴ In the place of the altar which he had made before, and there he called upon the name of the Lord. ⁵ But Lot also, who was with Abram, had flocks of sheep, and herds of beasts, and tents. ⁶ Neither was the land able to bear them, that they might dwell together: for their substance was great, and they could not dwell together. ⁷ Whereupon also there arose a strife between the herdsmen of Abram and of Lot. And at that time the Chanaanite and the Pherezite dwelled in that country. ⁸ Abram therefore said to Lot: Let there be no quarrel, I beseech thee, between me and thee, and between my herdsmen and thy herdsmen: for we are brethren. ⁹ Behold the whole land is before thee: depart from me, I pray

thee: if thou wilt go to the left hand, I will take the right: if thou choose the right hand, I will pass to the left.

¹⁰ And Lot lifting up his eyes, saw all the country about the Jordan, which was watered throughout, before the Lord destroyed Sodom and Gomorrha, as the paradise of the Lord, and like Egypt as one comes to Segor. ¹¹ And Lot chose to himself the country about the Jordan, and he departed from the east: and they were separated one brother from the other. ¹² Abram dwelt in the land of Chanaan: and Lot abode in the towns, that were about the Jordan, and dwelt in Sodom. ¹³ And the men of Sodom were very wicked, and sinners before the face of the Lord beyond measure.

¹⁴ And the Lord said to Abram, after Lot was separated from him: Lift up thy eyes, and look from the place wherein thou now art, to the north and to the south, to the east and to the west. ¹⁵ All the land which thou seest, I will give to thee, and to thy seed for ever. ¹⁶ And I will make thy seed as the dust of the earth: if any man be able to number the dust of the earth, he shall be able to number thy seed also. ¹⁷ Arise and walk through the land in the length, and the breadth thereof: for I will give it to thee. ¹⁸ So Abram removing his tent, came, and dwelt by the vale of Mambre, which is in Hebron: and he built there an altar to the Lord.

16. Melchisedech, and the rescue of Lot

Genesis 14:1-24

Melchisedech's bread and wine is read again in the Canon of the Mass and in Hebrews; the epistle is not in this plan.

14 ¹ And it came to pass at that time, that Amraphel, king of Sennaar, and Arioch, king of Pontus, and Chodorlahomor, king of the Elamites, and Thadal, king of nations, ² Made war against Bara, king of Sodom, and against Bersa, king of Gomorrha, and against Sennaab, king of Adama, and against Semeber, king of Seboim, and against the king of Bala, which is Segor. ³ All these came together into the woodland vale, which now is the salt sea. ⁴ For they had served Chodorlahomor twelve years, and in the thirteenth year they revolted from him. ⁵ And in the fourteenth year came Chodorlahomor, and the kings that were with him: and they smote the Raphaim in Astarothcarnaim, and the Zuzim with them, and the Emim in Save of Cariathaim. ⁶ And the Chorreans in the mountains of Seir, even to the plains of Pharan, which is in the wilderness. ⁷ And they returned, and came to the fountain of Misphat, the same is Cades: and they smote all the country of the Amalecites, and the Amorrian that dwelt in Asasonthamar. ⁸ And the king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorrha, and the king of Adama, and the king of Seboim, and the king of Bala, which is Segor, went out: and they set themselves against them in battle array, in the woodland vale: ⁹ To wit, against Chodorlahomor king of the Elamites, and Thadal king of nations, and Amraphel king of Sennaar, and Arioch king of Pontus: four kings against five. ¹⁰ Now the woodland vale had many pits of slime. And the king of Sodom, and the king of Gomorrha turned their backs, and were overthrown there: and they that remained, fled to the mountain. ¹¹ And they took all the substance of the Sodomites, and Gomorrhites, and all their victuals, and went their way: ¹² And Lot also, the son of Abram's brother, who dwelt in Sodom, and his substance.

¹³ And behold one, that had escaped, told Abram the Hebrew, who dwelt in the vale of Mambre the Amorrhite, the brother of Escol, and the brother of Aner: for these had made a league with Abram. ¹⁴ Which when Abram had heard, to wit, that his brother Lot was taken, he numbered of the servants born in his house, three hundred and eighteen, well appointed: and pursued them to Dan. ¹⁵ And dividing his company, he rushed upon them in the night, and defeated them: and pursued them as far as Hoba, which is on the left hand of Damascus. ¹⁶ And he brought back all the substance, and Lot his brother, with his substance, the women also, and the people.

¹⁷ And the king of Sodom went out to meet him, after he returned from the slaughter of Chodorlahomor, and of the kings that were with him in the vale of Save, which is the king's vale. ¹⁸ But Melchisedech, the king of Salem, bringing forth bread and wine, for he was the priest of the most high God, ¹⁹ Blessed him, and said: Blessed be Abram by the most high God, who created heaven and earth. ²⁰ And blessed be the most high God, by whose protection, the enemies are in thy hands. And he gave him the tithes of all.

²¹ And the king of Sodom said to Abram: Give me the persons, and the rest take to thyself. ²² And he answered him: I lift up my hand to the Lord God the most high, the possessor of heaven and earth, ²³ That from the very woof thread unto the shoe latchet, I will not take of any things that are thine, lest thou say: I have enriched Abram. ²⁴ Except such things as the young men have eaten, and the shares of the men that came with me, Aner, Escol, and Mambre: these shall take their shares.

17. The covenant of the divided victims

Genesis 15:1-21

"He believed God, and it was reputed to him unto justice."

15 ¹ Now when these things were done, the word of the Lord came to Abram by a vision, saying: Fear not, Abram, I am thy protector, and thy reward exceeding great.

² And Abram said: Lord God, what wilt thou give me? I shall go without children: and the son of the steward of my house is this Damascus Eliezer. ³ And Abram added: But to me thou hast not given seed: and lo my servant born in my house, shall be my heir. ⁴ And immediately the word of the Lord came to him, saying: He shall not be thy heir: but he that shall come out of thy bowels, him shalt thou have for thy heir. ⁵ And he brought him forth abroad, and said to him: Look up to heaven and number the stars if thou canst. And he said to him: So shall thy seed be. ⁶ Abram believed God, and it was reputed to him unto justice. ⁷ And he said to him: I am the Lord who brought thee out from Ur of the Chaldees, to give thee this land, and that thou mightest possess it. ⁸ But he said: Lord God, whereby may I know that I shall possess it? ⁹ And the Lord answered, and said: Take me a cow of three years old, and a she-goat of three years, and a ram of three years, a turtle also, and a pigeon. ¹⁰ And he took all these, and divided them in the midst, and laid the two pieces of each one against the other: but the birds he divided not. ¹¹ And the fowls came down upon the carcasses, and Abram drove them away.

¹² And when the sun was setting, a deep sleep fell upon Abram, and a great and darksome horror seized upon him. ¹³ And it was

said unto him: Know thou beforehand that thy seed shall be a stranger in a land not their own, and they shall bring them under bondage, and afflict them four hundred years. ¹⁴ But I will judge the nation which they shall serve, and after this they shall come out with great substance. ¹⁵ And thou shalt go to thy fathers in peace, and be buried in a good old age. ¹⁶ But in the fourth generation they shall return hither: for as yet the iniquities of the Amorrites are not at the full until this present time. ¹⁷ And when the sun was set, there arose a dark mist, and there appeared a smoking furnace, and a lamp of fire passing between those divisions. ¹⁸ That day God made a covenant with Abram, saying: To thy seed will I give this land, from the river to Egypt even to the great river Euphrates. ¹⁹ The Cineans, and Cenezites, the Cedmonites, ²⁰ And the Hethites, and the Pherezites, the Raphaim also, ²¹ And the Amorrites, and the Chanaanites, and the Gergesites, and the Jebusites.

18. Agar and Ismael

Genesis 16:1-16

16 ¹ Now Sarai, the wife of Abram, had brought forth no children: but having a handmaid, an Egyptian, named Agar, ² She said to her husband: Behold, the Lord hath restrained me from bearing: go in unto my handmaid, it may be I may have children of her at least. And when he agreed to her request, ³ She took Agar the Egyptian her handmaid, ten years after they first dwelt in the land of Chanaan, and gave her to her husband to wife. ⁴ And he went in to her. But she perceiving that she was with child, despised her mistress. ⁵ And Sarai said to Abram: Thou dost unjustly with me: I gave my handmaid into thy bosom, and she perceiving herself to be with child, despiseth me. The Lord judge between me and thee. ⁶ And Abram made answer, and said to her: Behold thy handmaid is in thy own hand, use her as it pleaseth thee. And when Sarai afflicted her, she ran away.

⁷ And the angel of the Lord having found her, by a fountain of water in the wilderness, which is in the way to Sur in the desert, ⁸ He said to her: Agar, handmaid of Sarai, whence comest thou? and whither goest thou? And she answered: I flee from the face of Sarai, my mistress. ⁹ And the angel of the Lord said to her: Return to thy mistress, and humble thyself under her hand. ¹⁰ And again he said: I will multiply thy seed exceedingly, and it shall not be numbered for multitude. ¹¹ And again: Behold, said he, thou art with child, and thou shalt bring forth a son: and thou shalt call his name Ismael, because the Lord hath heard thy affliction. ¹² He shall be a wild man: his hand will be against all men, and all men's hands against him: and he shall pitch his tents over against all his brethren. ¹³ And she called the name of the Lord that spoke unto her: Thou the God who hast seen me. For she said: Verily, here have I seen the hinder parts of him that seeth me. ¹⁴ Therefore she called that well, the well of him that liveth and seeth me. The same is between Cades and Barad.

¹⁵ And Agar brought forth a son to Abram: who called his name Ismael. ¹⁶ Abram was four score and six years old when Agar brought him forth Ismael.

19. Circumcision, and the new names

Genesis 17:1-27

17 ¹ And after he began to be ninety and nine years old, the Lord appeared to him: and said unto him: I am the Almighty God: walk before me, and be perfect. ² And I will make my covenant between me and thee: and I will multiply thee exceedingly. ³ Abram fell flat on his face. ⁴ And God said to him: I am, and my covenant is with thee, and thou shalt be a father of many nations. ⁵ Neither shall thy name be called any more Abram: but thou shalt be called Abraham: because I have made thee a father of many nations. ⁶ And I will make thee increase exceedingly, and I will make nations of thee, and kings shall come out of thee. ⁷ And I will establish my covenant between me and thee, and between thy seed after thee in their generations, by a perpetual covenant: to be a God to thee, and to thy seed after thee. ⁸ And I will give to thee, and to thy seed, the land of thy sojournment, all the land of Chanaan, for a perpetual possession, and I will be their God.

⁹ Again God said to Abraham: And thou therefore shalt keep my covenant, and thy seed after thee in their generations. ¹⁰ This is my covenant which you shall observe between me and you, and thy seed after thee: All the male-kind of you shall be circumcised. ¹¹ And you shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin, that it may be for a sign of the covenant between me and you. ¹² An infant of eight days old shall be circumcised among you, every manchild in your generations: he that is born in the house, as well as the bought servant, shall be circumcised, and whosoever is not of your stock: ¹³ And my covenant shall be in your flesh for a perpetual covenant. ¹⁴ The male whose flesh of his foreskin shall not be circumcised, that soul shall be destroyed out of his people: because he hath broken my covenant.

¹⁵ God said also to Abraham: Sarai thy wife thou shalt not call Sarai, but Sara. ¹⁶ And I will bless her, and of her I will give thee a son, whom I will bless, and he shall become nations, and kings of people shall spring from him. ¹⁷ Abraham fell upon his face, and laughed, saying in his heart: Shall a son, thinkest thou, be born to him that is a hundred years old? and shall Sara that is ninety years old bring forth? ¹⁸ And he said to God: O that Ismael may live before thee. ¹⁹ And God said to Abraham: Sara thy wife shall bear thee a son, and thou shalt call his name Isaac, and I will establish my covenant with him for a perpetual covenant, and with his seed after him. ²⁰ And as for Ismael I have also heard thee. Behold, I will bless him, and increase, and multiply him exceedingly: he shall beget twelve chiefs, and I will make him a great nation. ²¹ But my covenant I will establish with Isaac, whom Sara shall bring forth to thee at this time in the next year. ²² And when he had left off speaking with him, God went up from Abraham. ²³ And Abraham took Ismael his son, and all that were born in his house: and all whom he had bought, every male among the men of his house: and he circumcised the flesh of their foreskin forthwith the very same day, as God had commanded him. ²⁴ Abraham was ninety and nine years old, when he circumcised the flesh of his foreskin. ²⁵ And Ismael his son was full thirteen years old at the time of his circumcision. ²⁶ The self-same day was Abraham circumcised and Ismael his son. ²⁷ And all the men of his house, as well they that were

born in his house, as the bought servants and strangers, were circumcised with him.

20. The three at Mambre, and the plea for Sodom

Genesis 18:1-33

18 ¹ And the Lord appeared to him in the vale of Mambre as he was sitting at the door of his tent, in the very heat of the day. ² And when he had lifted up his eyes, there appeared to him three men standing near to him: and as soon as he saw them, he ran to meet them from the door of his tent, and adored down to the ground. ³ And he said: Lord, if I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away from thy servant. ⁴ But I will fetch a little water, and wash ye your feet, and rest ye under the tree. ⁵ And I will set a morsel of bread, and strengthen ye your heart, afterwards you shall pass on: for therefore are you come aside to your servant. And they said: Do as thou hast spoken. ⁶ Abraham made haste into the tent to Sara, and said to her: Make haste, temper together three measures of flour, and make cakes upon the hearth. ⁷ And he himself ran to the herd, and took from thence a calf, very tender and very good, and gave it to a young man, who made haste and boiled it. ⁸ He took also butter and milk, and the calf which he had boiled, and set before them: but he stood by them under the tree.

⁹ And when they had eaten, they said to him: Where is Sara thy wife? He answered: Lo she is in the tent. ¹⁰ And he said to him: I will return and come to thee at this time, life accompanying, and Sara, thy wife, shall have a son. Which when Sara heard, she laughed behind the door of the tent. ¹¹ Now they were both old, and far advanced in years, and it had ceased to be with Sara after the manner of women. ¹² And she laughed secretly, saying: After I am grown old, and my lord is an old man, shall I give myself to pleasure? ¹³ And the Lord said to Abraham: Why did Sara laugh, saying: Shall I, who am an old woman, bear a child indeed? ¹⁴ Is there any thing hard to God? According to appointment I will return to thee at this same time, life accompanying, and Sara shall have a son. ¹⁵ Sara denied, saying: I did not laugh: for she was afraid. But the Lord said: Nay; but thou didst laugh.

¹⁶ And when the men rose up from thence, they turned their eyes towards Sodom: and Abraham walked with them, bringing them on the way. ¹⁷ And the Lord said: Can I hide from Abraham what I am about to do: ¹⁸ Seeing he shall become a great and mighty nation, and in him all the nations of the earth shall be blessed? ¹⁹ For I know that he will command his children, and his household after him, to keep the way of the Lord, and do judgment and justice: that for Abraham's sake, the Lord may bring to effect all the things he hath spoken unto him. ²⁰ And the Lord said: The cry of Sodom and Gomorrha is multiplied, and their sin is become exceedingly grievous. ²¹ I will go down and see whether they have done according to the cry that is come to me; or whether it be not so, that I may know. ²² And they turned themselves from thence, and went their way to Sodom: but Abraham as yet stood before the Lord. ²³ And drawing nigh, he said: Wilt thou destroy the just with the wicked? ²⁴ If there be fifty just men in the city, shall they perish withal? and wilt thou not spare that place for the sake of the fifty just, if they be therein? ²⁵ Far be it from thee to do this thing, and to slay the just with the wicked, and for the just to be in like case as the wicked; this is not beseeeming thee: thou who judgest all

the earth, wilt not make this judgment. ²⁶ And the Lord said to him: If I find in Sodom fifty just within the city, I will spare the whole place for their sake. ²⁷ And Abraham answered, and said: Seeing I have once begun, I will speak to my Lord, whereas I am dust and ashes. ²⁸ What if there be five less than fifty just persons? wilt thou for five and forty destroy the whole city: And he said: I will not destroy it, if I find five and forty. ²⁹ And again he said to him: But if forty be found there, what wilt thou do? He said: I will not destroy it for the sake of forty. ³⁰ Lord, saith he, be not angry, I beseech thee, if I speak: What if thirty shall be found there? He answered: I will not do it, if I find thirty there. ³¹ Seeing, saith he, I have once begun, I will speak to my Lord: What if twenty be found there? He said: I will not destroy it for the sake of twenty. ³² I beseech thee, saith he, be not angry, Lord, if I speak yet once more: What if ten shall be found there? And he said: I will not destroy it for the sake of ten. ³³ And the Lord departed, after he had left speaking to Abraham: and Abraham returned to his place.

21. Sodom destroyed; Abraham and Abimelech

Genesis 19:1-20:18

19 ¹ And the two angels came to Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting in the gate of the city. And seeing them, he rose up and went to meet them: and worshipped prostrate to the ground. ² And said: I beseech you, my lords, turn in to the house of your servant, and lodge there: wash your feet, and in the morning you shall go on your way. And they said: No, but we will abide in the street. ³ He pressed them very much to turn in unto him: and when they were come into his house, he made them a feast, and baked unleavened bread, and they ate: ⁴ But before they went to bed, the men of the city beset the house, both young and old, all the people together. ⁵ And they called Lot, and said to him: Where are the men that came in to thee at night? bring them out hither, that we may know them: ⁶ Lot went out to them, and shut the door after him, and said: ⁷ Do not so, I beseech you, my brethren, do not commit this evil. ⁸ I have two daughters who, as yet, have not known man; I will bring them out to you, and abuse you them as it shall please you, so that you do no evil to these men, because they are come in under the shadow of my roof. ⁹ But they said: Get thee back thither. And again: Thou camest in, said they, as a stranger, was it to be a judge? therefore we will afflict thee more than them. And they pressed very violently upon Lot: and they were even at the point of breaking open the doors. ¹⁰ And behold the men put out their hand, and drew in Lot unto them, and shut the door. ¹¹ And them, that were without, they struck with blindness from the least to the greatest, so that they could not find the door.

¹² And they said to Lot: Hast thou here any of thine? son in law, or sons, or daughters, all that are thine bring them out of this city: ¹³ For we will destroy this place, because their cry is grown loud before the Lord, who hath sent us to destroy them. ¹⁴ So Lot went out, and spoke to his sons in law that were to have his daughters, and said: Arise: get you out of this place, because the Lord will destroy this city. And he seemed to them to speak as it were in jest.

¹⁵ And when it was morning, the angels pressed him, saying: Arise, take thy wife, and the two daughters that thou hast: lest thou also perish in the wickedness of the city. ¹⁶ And as he

lingered, they took his hand, and the hand of his wife, and of his two daughters, because the Lord spared him. ¹⁷ And they brought him forth, and set him without the city: and there they spoke to him, saying: Save thy life: look not back, neither stay thou in all the country about: but save thy self in the mountain, lest thou be also consumed. ¹⁸ And Lot said to them: I beseech thee, my Lord, ¹⁹ Because thy servant hath found grace before thee, and thou hast magnified thy mercy, which thou hast shewn to me, in saving my life, and I cannot escape to the mountain, lest some evil seize me, and I die. ²⁰ There is this city here at hand, to which I may flee, it is a little one, and I shall be saved in it: is it not a little one, and my soul shall live? ²¹ And he said to him: Behold also in this, I have heard thy prayers, not to destroy the city for which thou hast spoken. ²² Make haste, and be saved there: because I cannot do any thing till thou go in thither. Therefore the name of that city was called Segor.

²³ The sun was risen upon the earth, and Lot entered into Segor. ²⁴ And the Lord rained upon Sodom and Gomorrha brimstone and fire from the Lord out of heaven. ²⁵ And he destroyed these cities, and all the country about, all the inhabitants of the cities, and all things that spring from the earth. ²⁶ And his wife looking behind her, was turned into a statue of salt.

²⁷ And Abraham got up early in the morning, and in the place where he had stood before with the Lord: ²⁸ He looked towards Sodom and Gomorrha, and the whole land of that country: and he saw the ashes rise up from the earth as the smoke of a furnace.

²⁹ Now when God destroyed the cities of that country, remembering Abraham, he delivered Lot out of the destruction of the cities wherein he had dwelt.

³⁰ And Lot went up out of Segor, and abode in the mountain, and his two daughters with him (for he was afraid to stay in Segor) and he dwelt in a cave, he and his two daughters with him. ³¹ And the elder said to the younger: Our father is old, and there is no man left on the earth, to come in unto us after the manner of the whole earth. ³² Come, let us make him drunk with wine, and let us lie with him, that we may preserve seed of our father. ³³ And they made their father drink wine that night: and the elder went in, and lay with her father: but he perceived not, neither when his daughter lay down, nor when she rose up. ³⁴ And the next day the elder said to the younger: Behold I lay last night with my father, let us make him drink wine also to night, and thou shalt lie with him, that we may save seed of our father. ³⁵ They made their father drink wine that night also, and the younger daughter went in, and lay with him: and neither then did he perceive when she lay down, nor when she rose up. ³⁶ So the two daughters of Lot were with child by their father. ³⁷ And the elder bore a son, and she called his name Moab: he is the father of the Moabites unto this day. ³⁸ The younger also bore a son, and she called his name Ammon; that is, the son of my people: he is the father of the Ammonites unto this day.

20 ¹ Abraham removed from thence to the south country, and dwelt between Cades and Sur, and sojourned in Gerara. ² And he said of Sara his wife: She is my sister. So Abimelech the king of Gerara sent, and took her. ³ And God came to Abimelech in a dream by night, and he said to him: Lo thou shalt die for the woman that thou hast taken: for she hath a husband. ⁴ Now Abimelech had not touched her, and he said: Lord, wilt thou slay

a nation that is ignorant and just? ⁵ Did not he say to me: She is my sister: and she say, He is my brother? in the simplicity of my heart, and cleanness of my hands have I done this. ⁶ And God said to him: And I know that thou didst it with a sincere heart: and therefore I withheld thee from sinning against me, and I suffered thee not to touch her. ⁷ Now therefore restore the man his wife, for he is a prophet: and he shall pray for thee, and thou shalt live: but if thou wilt not restore her, know that thou shalt surely die, thou and all that are thine.

⁸ And Abimelech forthwith rising up in the night, called all his servants: and spoke all these words in their hearing, and all the men were exceedingly afraid. ⁹ And Abimelech called also for Abraham, and said to him: What hast thou done to us? what have we offended thee in, that thou hast brought upon me and upon my kingdom a great sin? thou hast done to us what thou oughtest not to do. ¹⁰ And again he expostulated with him, and said: What sawest thou, that thou hast done this? ¹¹ Abraham answered: I thought with myself, saying: Perhaps there is not the fear of God in this place: and they will kill me for the sake of my wife: ¹² Howbeit, otherwise also she is truly my sister, the daughter of my father, and not the daughter of my mother, and I took her to wife. ¹³ And after God brought me out of my father's house, I said to her: Thou shalt do me this kindness: In every place, to which we shall come, thou shalt say that I am thy brother.

¹⁴ And Abimelech took sheep and oxen, and servants and handmaids, and gave to Abraham: and restored to him Sara his wife, ¹⁵ And said: The land is before you, dwell wheresoever it shall please thee. ¹⁶ And to Sara he said: Behold I have given thy brother a thousand pieces of silver, this shall serve thee for a covering of thy eyes to all that are with thee, and whithersoever thou shalt go: and remember thou wast taken.

¹⁷ And when Abraham prayed, God healed Abimelech and his wife, and his handmaids, and they bore children: ¹⁸ For the Lord had closed up every womb of the house of Abimelech, on account of Sara, Abraham's wife.

22. The birth of Isaac; Agar cast out

Genesis 21:1-34

21 ¹ And the Lord visited Sara, as he had promised: and fulfilled what he had spoken. ² And she conceived and bore a son in her old age, at the time that God had foretold her. ³ And Abraham called the name of his son, whom Sara bore him, Isaac. ⁴ And he circumcised him the eighth day, as God had commanded him, ⁵ When he was a hundred years old: for at this age of his father, was Isaac born. ⁶ And Sara said: God hath made a laughter for me: whosoever shall hear of it will laugh with me. ⁷ And again she said: Who would believe that Abraham should hear that Sara gave suck to a son, whom she bore to him in his old age? ⁸ And the child grew, and was weaned: and Abraham made a great feast on the day of his weaning. ⁹ And when Sara had seen the son of Agar, the Egyptian, playing with Isaac, her son, she said to Abraham: ¹⁰ Cast out this bondwoman and her son; for the son of the bondwoman shall not be heir with my son Isaac. ¹¹ Abraham took this grievously for his son. ¹² And God said to him: Let it not seem grievous to thee for the boy, and for thy bondwoman: in all that Sara hath said to thee, hearken to her voice: for in Isaac shall thy seed be called. ¹³ But I will make the

son also of the bondwoman a great nation, because he is thy seed. ¹⁴ So Abraham rose up in the morning, and taking bread and a bottle of water, put it upon her shoulder, and delivered the boy, and sent her away. And she departed, and wandered in the wilderness of Bersabee. ¹⁵ And when the water in the bottle was spent, she cast the boy under one of the trees that were there. ¹⁶ And she went her way, and sat over against him a great way off, as far as a bow can carry, for she said: I will not see the boy die: and sitting over against, she lifted up her voice and wept. ¹⁷ And God heard the voice of the boy: and an angel of God called to Agar from heaven, saying: What art thou doing, Agar? fear not; for God hath heard the voice of the boy, from the place wherein he is. ¹⁸ Arise, take up the boy, and hold him by the hand, for I will make him a great nation. ¹⁹ And God opened her eyes: and she saw a well of water, and went and filled the bottle, and gave the boy to drink. ²⁰ And God was with him: and he grew, and dwelt in the wilderness, and became a young man, an archer. ²¹ And he dwelt in the wilderness of Pharan, and his mother took a wife for him out of the land of Egypt.

²² At the same time Abimelech, and Phicol the general of his army, said to Abraham: God is with thee in all that thou dost. ²³ Swear therefore by God, that thou wilt not hurt me, nor my posterity, nor my stock: but according to the kindness that I have done to thee, thou shalt do to me, and to the land wherein thou hast lived a stranger. ²⁴ And Abraham said: I will swear. ²⁵ And he reproveth Abimelech for a well of water, which his servants had taken away by force. ²⁶ And Abimelech answered: I knew not who did this thing: and thou didst not tell me, and I heard not of it till today. ²⁷ Then Abraham took sheep and oxen, and gave them to Abimelech: and both of them made a league. ²⁸ And Abraham set apart seven ewelambs of the flock. ²⁹ And Abimelech said to him: What mean these seven ewelambs which thou hast set apart? ³⁰ But he said: Thou shalt take seven ewelambs at my hand: that they may be a testimony for me, that I dug this well. ³¹ Therefore that place was called Bersabee; because there both of them did swear. ³² And they made a league for the well of oath. ³³ And Abimelech and Phicol, the general of his army, arose and returned to the land of the Palestines. But Abraham planted a grove in Bersabee, and there called upon the name of the Lord God eternal. ³⁴ And he was a sojourner in the land of the Palestines many days.

23. The binding of Isaac

Genesis 22:1-18

The second lesson of the Easter Vigil, read to its Vigil terminus at verse 18; the genealogy of Nachor that follows is omitted.

22 ¹ After these things, God tempted Abraham, and said to him: Abraham, Abraham. And he answered: Here I am. ² He said to him: Take thy only begotten son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and go into the land of vision; and there thou shalt offer him for an holocaust upon one of the mountains which I will shew thee.

³ So Abraham rising up in the night, saddled his ass, and took with him two young men, and Isaac his son: and when he had cut wood for the holocaust, he went his way to the place which God had commanded him. ⁴ And on the third day, lifting up his eyes, he saw the place afar off. ⁵ And he said to his young men: Stay you here with the ass; I and the boy will go with speed as far as

yonder, and after we have worshipped, will return to you. ⁶ And he took the wood for the holocaust, and laid it upon Isaac his son; and he himself carried in his hands fire and a sword. And as they two went on together, ⁷ Isaac said to his father: My father. And he answered: What wilt thou, son? Behold, saith he, fire and wood: where is the victim for the holocaust? ⁸ And Abraham said: God will provide himself a victim for an holocaust, my son. So they went on together. ⁹ And they came to the place which God had shewn him, where he built an altar, and laid the wood in order upon it; and when he had bound Isaac his son, he laid him on the altar upon the pile of wood. ¹⁰ And he put forth his hand, and took the sword, to sacrifice his son.

¹¹ And behold, an angel of the Lord from heaven called to him, saying: Abraham, Abraham. And he answered: Here I am. ¹² And he said to him: Lay not thy hand upon the boy, neither do thou any thing to him: now I know that thou fearest God, and hast not spared thy only begotten son for my sake. ¹³ Abraham lifted up his eyes, and saw behind his back a ram, amongst the briers, sticking fast by the horns, which he took and offered for a holocaust instead of his son. ¹⁴ And he called the name of that place, The Lord seeth. Whereupon, even to this day, it is said: In the mountain the Lord will see.

¹⁵ And the angel of the Lord called to Abraham a second time from heaven, saying: ¹⁶ By my own self have I sworn, saith the Lord: because thou hast done this thing, and hast not spared thy only begotten son for my sake: ¹⁷ I will bless thee, and I will multiply thy seed as the stars of heaven, and as the sand that is by the sea shore; thy seed shall possess the gates of their enemies. ¹⁸ And in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed, because thou hast obeyed my voice.

24. The death of Sara, and the cave of Machpelah

Genesis 23:1-20

The only land Abraham ever owns in the country promised to him is a grave.

23 ¹ And Sara lived a hundred and twenty-seven years. ² And she died in the city of Arbee which is Hebron, in the land of Chanaan: and Abraham came to mourn and weep for her. ³ And after he rose up from the funeral obsequies, he spoke to the children of Heth, saying: ⁴ I am a stranger and sojourner among you: give me the right of a burying place with you, that I may bury my dead. ⁵ The children of Heth answered, saying: ⁶ My lord, hear us, thou art a prince of God among us: bury thy dead in our principal sepulchres: and no man shall have power to hinder thee from burying thy dead in his sepulchre. ⁷ Abraham rose up, and bowed down to the people of the land, to wit, the children of Heth: ⁸ And said to them: If it please your soul that I should bury my dead, hear me, and intercede for me to Ephron the son of Seor. ⁹ That he may give me the double cave, which he hath in the end of his field: For as much money as it is worth he shall give it me before you, for a possession of a burying place. ¹⁰ Now Ephron dwelt in the midst of the children of Heth. And Ephron made answer to Abraham in the hearing of all that went in at the gate of the city, saying: ¹¹ Let it not be so, my lord, but do thou rather hearken to what I say: The field I deliver to thee, and the cave that is therein; in the presence of the children of my people, bury thy dead. ¹² Abraham bowed down before the

people of the land. ¹³ And he spoke to Ephron, in the presence of the people: I beseech thee to hear me: I will give money for the field; take it, and so will I bury my dead in it. ¹⁴ And Ephron answered: ¹⁵ My lord, hear me. The ground which thou desirest, is worth four hundred sicles of silver: this is the price between me and thee: but what is this? bury thy dead.

¹⁶ And when Abraham had heard this, he weighed out the money that Ephron had asked, in the hearing of the children of Heth, four hundred sicles of silver, of common current money.

¹⁷ And the field that before was Ephron's, wherein was the double cave, looking towards Mambre, both it and the cave, and all the trees thereof, in all its limits round about, ¹⁸ Was made sure to Abraham for a possession, in the sight of the children of Heth, and of all that went in at the gate of his city. ¹⁹ And so Abraham buried Sara, his wife, in the double cave of the field, that looked towards Mambre, this is Hebron in the land of Chanaan. ²⁰ And the field was made sure to Abraham, and the cave that was in it, for a possession to bury in, by the children of Heth.

25. A wife for Isaac

Genesis 24:1-67

24 ¹ Now Abraham was old, and advanced in age; and the Lord had blessed him in all things. ² And he said to the elder servant of his house, who was ruler over all he had: Put thy hand under my thigh, ³ That I may make thee swear by the Lord, the God of heaven and earth, that thou take not a wife for my son, of the daughters of the Chanaanites, among whom I dwell: ⁴ But that thou go to my own country and kindred, and take a wife from thence for my son Isaac. ⁵ The servant answered: If the woman will not come with me into this land, must I bring thy son back again to the place from whence thou camest out? ⁶ And Abraham said: Beware thou never bring my son back again thither. ⁷ The Lord God of heaven, who took me out of my father's house, and out of my native country, who spoke to me, and swore to me, saying: To thy seed will I give this land: he will send his angel before thee, and thou shalt take from thence a wife for my son. ⁸ But if the woman will not follow thee, thou shalt not be bound by the oath: only bring not my son back thither again. ⁹ The servant, therefore, put his hand under the thigh of Abraham, his lord, and swore to him upon his word. ¹⁰ And he took ten camels of his master's herd, and departed, carrying something of all his goods with him, and he set forward and went on to Mesopotamia, to the city of Nachor. ¹¹ And when he had made the camels lie down without the town, near a well of water, in the evening, at the time when women are wont to come out to draw water, he said: ¹² O Lord, the God of my master, Abraham, meet me today, I beseech thee, and shew kindness to my master, Abraham. ¹³ Behold, I stand nigh the spring of water, and the daughters of the inhabitants of this city will come out to draw water: ¹⁴ Now, therefore, the maid to whom I shall say: Let down thy pitcher that I may drink: and she shall answer, Drink, and I will give thy camels drink also: let it be the same whom thou hast provided for thy servant Isaac: and by this, I shall understand that thou hast shewn kindness to my master.

¹⁵ He had not yet ended these words within himself, and behold Rebecca came out, the daughter of Bathuel, son of Melcha, wife to Nachor the brother of Abraham, having a pitcher on her

shoulder: ¹⁶ An exceeding comely maid, and a most beautiful virgin, and not known to man: and she went down to the spring, and filled her pitcher, and was coming back. ¹⁷ And the servant ran to meet her, and said: Give me a little water to drink of thy pitcher. ¹⁸ And she answered: Drink, my lord. And quickly she let down the pitcher upon her arm, and gave him drink. ¹⁹ And when he had drunk, she said: I will draw water for thy camels also, till they all drink. ²⁰ And pouring out the pitcher into the troughs, she ran back to the well to draw water; and having drawn, she gave to all the camels. ²¹ But he musing, beheld her with silence, desirous to know whether the Lord had made his journey prosperous or not. ²² And after that the camels had drunk, the man took out golden earrings, weighing two sicles; and as many bracelets, of ten sicles weight. ²³ And he said to her: Whose daughter art thou? tell me: is there any place in thy father's house to lodge? ²⁴ And she answered: I am the daughter of Bathuel, the son of Melcha, whom she bore to Nachor. ²⁵ And she said, moreover, to him: We have good store of both straw and hay, and a large place to lodge in. ²⁶ The man bowed himself down, and adored the Lord, ²⁷ Saying: Blessed be the Lord God of my master Abraham, who hath not taken away his mercy and truth from my master, and hath brought me the straight way into the house of my master's brother. ²⁸ Then the maid ran, and told in her mother's house all that she had heard. ²⁹ And Rebecca had a brother, named Laban, who went out in haste to the man, to the well. ³⁰ And when he had seen the earrings and bracelets in his sister's hands, and had heard all that she related, saying, Thus and thus the man spoke to me: he came to the man who stood by the camels, and near to the spring of water, ³¹ And said to him: Come in, thou blessed of the Lord; why standest thou without? I have prepared the house, and a place for the camels.

³² And he brought him into his lodging; and he unharnessed the camels, and gave straw and hay, and water to wash his feet, and the feet of the men that were come with him. ³³ And bread was set before him. But he said: I will not eat, till I tell my message. He answered him: Speak. ³⁴ And he said: I am the servant of Abraham: ³⁵ And the Lord hath blessed my master wonderfully, and he is become great: and he hath given him sheep and oxen, silver and gold, men servants and women servants, camels and asses. ³⁶ And Sara, my master's wife, hath borne my master a son in her old age, and he hath given him all that he had. ³⁷ And my master made me swear, saying: Thou shalt not take a wife for my son of the Chanaanites, in whose land I dwell: ³⁸ But thou shalt go to my father's house, and shalt take a wife of my own kindred for my son: ³⁹ But I answered my master: What if the woman will not come with me? ⁴⁰ The Lord, said he, in whose sight I walk, will send his angel with thee, and will direct thy way: and thou shalt take a wife for my son of my own kindred, and of my father's house. ⁴¹ But thou shalt be clear from my curse, when thou shalt come to my kindred, if they will not give thee one. ⁴² And I came today to the well of water, and said: O Lord God of my master, Abraham, if thou hast prospered my way, wherein I now walk, ⁴³ Behold, I stand by the well of water, and the virgin, that shall come out to draw water, who shall hear me say: Give me a little water to drink of thy pitcher: ⁴⁴ And shall say to me: Both drink thou, and I will also draw for thy camels:

let the same be the woman, whom the Lord hath prepared for my master's son. ⁴⁵ And whilst I pondered these things secretly with myself, Rebecca appeared, coming with a pitcher, which she carried on her shoulder: and she went down to the well and drew water. And I said to her: Give me a little to drink. ⁴⁶ And she speedily let down the pitcher from her shoulder, and said to me: Both drink thou, and to thy camels I will give drink. I drank, and she watered the camels. ⁴⁷ And I asked her, and said: Whose daughter art thou? And she answered: I am the daughter of Bathuel, the son of Nachor, whom Melcha bore to him. So I put earrings on her to adorn her face, and I put bracelets on her hands. ⁴⁸ And falling down, I adored the Lord, blessing the Lord God of my master, Abraham, who hath brought me the straight way to take the daughter of my master's brother for his son. ⁴⁹ Wherefore, if you do according to mercy and truth with my master, tell me: but if it please you otherwise, tell me that also, that I may go to the right hand, or to the left. ⁵⁰ And Laban and Bathuel answered: The word hath proceeded from the Lord: we cannot speak any other thing to thee but his pleasure. ⁵¹ Behold, Rebecca is before thee, take her and go thy way, and let her be the wife of thy master's son, as the Lord hath spoken. ⁵² Which when Abraham's servant heard, falling down to the ground, he adored the Lord. ⁵³ And bringing forth vessels of silver and gold, and garments, he gave them to Rebecca, for a present. He offered gifts also to her brothers, and to her mother. ⁵⁴ And a banquet was made, and they ate and drank together, and lodged there. And in the morning, the servant arose, and said: Let me depart, that I may go to my master. ⁵⁵ And her brother and mother answered: Let the maid stay, at least, ten days with us, and afterwards she shall depart. ⁵⁶ Stay me not, said he, because the Lord hath prospered my way: send me away, that I may go to my master. ⁵⁷ And they said: Let us call the maid, and ask her will. ⁵⁸ And they called her, and when she was come, they asked: Wilt thou go with this man? She said: I will go. ⁵⁹ So they sent her away, and her nurse, and Abraham's servant, and his company. ⁶⁰ Wishing prosperity to their sister, and saying: Thou art our sister, mayst thou increase to thousands of thousands; and may thy seed possess the gates of their enemies.

⁶¹ So Rebecca and her maids, being set upon camels, followed the man: who with speed returned to his master. ⁶² At the same time, Isaac was walking along the way to the well which is called Of the living and the seeing: for he dwelt in the south country: ⁶³ And he was gone forth to meditate in the field, the day being now well spent: and when he had lifted up his eyes, he saw camels coming afar off. ⁶⁴ Rebecca also, when she saw Isaac, lighted off the camel, ⁶⁵ And said to the servant: Who is that man who cometh towards us along the field? And he said to her: That man is my master. But she quickly took her cloak, and covered herself. ⁶⁶ And the servant told Isaac all that he had done. ⁶⁷ Who brought her into the tent of Sara his mother, and took her to wife: and he loved her so much, that it moderated the sorrow which was occasioned by his mother's death.

26. The death of Abraham

Genesis 25:1-11

25:12-18, the generations of Ismael, is omitted.

²⁵ ¹ And Abraham married another wife named Cetura: ² Who bore him Zamram, and Jecsan, and Madan, and Madian, and Jesboc, and Sue. ³ Jecsan also begot Saba, and Dadan. The children of Dadan were Assurim, and Latusim, and Loomim. ⁴ But of Madian was born Ephra, and Opher, and Henoah, and Abida, and Eldaa: all these were the children of Cetura. ⁵ And Abraham gave all his possessions to Isaac: ⁶ And to the children of the concubines he gave gifts, and separated them from Isaac his son, while he yet lived, to the east country. ⁷ And the days of Abraham's life were a hundred and seventy-five years. ⁸ And decaying he died in a good old age, and having lived a long time, and being full of days: and was gathered to his people. ⁹ And Isaac and Ismael his sons buried him in the double cave, which was situated in the field of Ephron the son of Seor the Hethite, over against Mambre, ¹⁰ Which he had bought of the children of Heth: there was he buried, and Sara his wife. ¹¹ And after his death, God blessed Isaac his son, who dwelt by the well named Of the living and seeing.

27. Esau and Jacob; the birthright sold

Genesis 25:19-34

²⁵ ¹⁹ These also are the generations of Isaac the son of Abraham: Abraham begot Isaac: ²⁰ Who when he was forty years old, took to wife Rebecca the daughter of Bathuel the Syrian of Mesopotamia, sister to Laban. ²¹ And Isaac besought the Lord for his wife, because she was barren: and he heard him, and made Rebecca to conceive. ²² But the children struggled in her womb, and she said: If it were to be so with me, what need was there to conceive? And she went to consult the Lord. ²³ And he answering, said: Two nations are in thy womb, and two peoples shall be divided out of thy womb, and one people shall overcome the other, and the elder shall serve the younger.

²⁴ And when her time was come to be delivered, behold twins were found in her womb. ²⁵ He that came forth first was red, and hairy like a skin: and his name was called Esau. Immediately the other coming forth, held his brother's foot in his hand: and therefore he was called Jacob. ²⁶ Isaac was threescore years old when the children were born unto him. ²⁷ And when they were grown up, Esau became a skilful hunter, and a husbandman: but Jacob, a plain man, dwelt in tents. ²⁸ Isaac loved Esau, because he ate of his hunting: and Rebecca loved Jacob. ²⁹ And Jacob boiled pottage: to whom Esau, coming faint out of the field, ³⁰ Said: Give me of this red pottage, for I am exceeding faint. For which reason his name was called Edom. ³¹ And Jacob said to him: Sell me thy first birthright. ³² He answered: Lo I die, what will the first birthright avail me? ³³ Jacob said: Swear therefore to me. Esau swore to him, and sold his first birthright. ³⁴ And so taking bread and the pottage of lentils, he ate, and drank, and went on his way; making little account of having sold his first birthright.

28. Isaac at Gerara, and the wells

Genesis 26:1-35

²⁶ ¹ And when a famine came in the land, after that barrenness which had happened in the days of Abraham, Isaac went to Abimelech, king of the Palestines, to Gerara. ² And the Lord appeared to him, and said: Go not down into Egypt, but stay in the land that I shall tell thee. ³ And sojourn in it, and I will

be with thee, and will bless thee: for to thee and to thy seed I will give all these countries, to fulfil the oath which I swore to Abraham thy father. ⁴ And I will multiply thy seed like the stars of heaven: and I will give to thy posterity all these countries: and in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed. ⁵ Because Abraham obeyed my voice, and kept my precepts and commandments, and observed my ceremonies and laws.

⁶ So Isaac abode in Gerara. ⁷ And when he was asked by the men of that place, concerning his wife, he answered: She is my sister: for he was afraid to confess that she was his wife, thinking lest perhaps they would kill him because of her beauty. ⁸ And when very many days were passed, and he abode there, Abimelech, king of the Palestines, looking out through a window, saw him playing with Rebecca, his wife. ⁹ And calling for him, he said: It is evident she is thy wife: why didst thou feign her to be thy sister? He answered: I feared lest I should die for her sake. ¹⁰ And Abimelech said: Why hast thou deceived us? Some man of the people might have lain with thy wife, and thou hadst brought upon us a great sin. And he commanded all the people, saying: ¹¹ He that shall touch this man's wife, shall surely be put to death.

¹² And Isaac sowed in that land, and he found that same year a hundredfold: and the Lord blessed him. ¹³ And the man was enriched, and he went on prospering and increasing, till he became exceeding great. ¹⁴ And he had possessions of sheep and of herds, and a very great family. Wherefore the Palestines envying him, ¹⁵ Stopped up at that time all the wells, that the servants of his father, Abraham, had digged, filling them up with earth: ¹⁶ Insomuch that Abimelech himself said to Isaac: Depart from us, for thou art become much mightier than we.

¹⁷ So he departed, and came to the torrent of Gerara, to dwell there: ¹⁸ And he digged again other wells, which the servants of his father, Abraham, had digged, and which, after his death, the Philistines had of old stopped up: and he called them by the same names, by which his father before had called them. ¹⁹ And they digged in the torrent, and found living water: ²⁰ But there also the herdsmen of Gerara strove against the herdsmen of Isaac, saying: It is our water. Wherefore he called the name of the well, on occasion of that which had happened, Calumny. ²¹ And they digged also another; and for that they quarrelled likewise, and he called the name of it, Enmity. ²² Going forward from thence, he digged another well, for which they contended not; therefore he called the name thereof, Latitude, saying: Now hath the Lord given us room, and made us to increase upon the earth. ²³ And he went up from that place to Bersabee, ²⁴ Where the Lord appeared to him that same night, saying: I am the God of Abraham thy father, do not fear, for I am with thee: I will bless thee, and multiply thy seed for my servant Abraham's sake. ²⁵ And he built there an altar: and called upon the name of the Lord, and pitched his tent; and commanded his servants to dig a well.

²⁶ To which place when Abimelech, and Ochozath his friend, and Phicol chief captain of his soldiers, came from Gerara, ²⁷ Isaac said to them: Why are ye come to me, a man whom you hate, and have thrust out from you? ²⁸ And they answered: We saw that the Lord is with thee, and therefore we said: Let there be an oath between us, and let us make a covenant, ²⁹ That

thou do us no harm, as we on our part have touched nothing of thine, nor have done any thing to hurt thee; but with peace have sent thee away, increased with the blessing of the Lord. ³⁰ And he made them a feast, and after they had eaten and drunk: ³¹ Arising in the morning, they swore one to another: and Isaac sent them away peaceably to their own home. ³² And behold, the same day the servants of Isaac came, telling him of a well which they had digged, and saying: We have found water. ³³ Whereupon he called it Abundance: and the name of the city was called Bersabee, even to this day.

³⁴ And Esau being forty years old, married wives, Judith, the daughter of Beer, the Hethite, and Basemath, the daughter of Elon, of the same place. ³⁵ And they both offended the mind of Isaac and Rebecca.

29. The stolen blessing

Genesis 27:1-46

27 ¹ Now Isaac was old, and his eyes were dim, and he could not see: and he called Esau, his elder son, and said to him: My son? And he answered: Here I am. ² And his father said to him, Thou seest that I am old, and know not the day of my death. ³ Take thy arms, thy quiver, and bow, and go abroad; and when thou hast taken something by hunting, ⁴ Make me a savoury meat thereof, as thou knowest I like, and bring it that I may eat: and my soul may bless thee, before I die. ⁵ And when Rebecca had heard this, and he was gone into the field to fulfil his father's commandment, ⁶ She said to her son Jacob: I heard thy father talking with Esau, thy brother, and saying to him: ⁷ Bring me of thy hunting, and make me meats that I may eat, and bless thee in the sight of the Lord, before I die. ⁸ Now therefore, my son, follow my counsel: ⁹ And go thy way to the flock, bring me two kids of the best, that I may make of them meat for thy father, such as he gladly eateth. ¹⁰ Which when thou hast brought in, and he hath eaten, he may bless thee before he die. ¹¹ And he answered her: Thou knowest that Esau, my brother, is a hairy man, and I am smooth: ¹² If my father should feel me, and perceive it, I fear lest he will think I would have mocked him, and I shall bring upon me a curse instead of a blessing. ¹³ And his mother said to him: Upon me be this curse, my son: only hear thou my voice, and go, fetch me the things which I have said. ¹⁴ He went, and brought, and gave them to his mother. She dressed meats, such as she knew his father liked. ¹⁵ And she put on him very good garments of Esau, which she had at home with her: ¹⁶ And the little skins of the kids she put about his hands, and covered the bare of his neck. ¹⁷ And she gave him the savoury meat, and delivered him bread that she had baked.

¹⁸ Which when he had carried in, he said: My father? But he answered: I hear. Who art thou, my son? ¹⁹ And Jacob said: I am Esau, thy firstborn: I have done as thou didst command me: arise, sit and eat of my venison, that thy soul may bless me. ²⁰ And Isaac said to his son: How couldst thou find it so quickly, my son? He answered: It was the will of God, that what I sought came quickly in my way: ²¹ And Isaac said: Come hither, that I may feel thee, my son, and may prove whether thou be my son Esau, or no. ²² He came near to his father, and when he had felt him, Isaac said: The voice indeed is the voice of Jacob; but the hands, are the hands of Esau. ²³ And he knew him not, because his hairy hands made him like to the elder. Then blessing him,

²⁴ He said: Art thou my son Esau? He answered: I am. ²⁵ Then he said: Bring me the meats of thy hunting, my son, that my soul may bless thee. And when they were brought, and he had eaten, he offered him wine also, which after he had drunk, ²⁶ He said to him: Come near me, and give me a kiss, my son. ²⁷ He came near, and kissed him. And immediately as he smelled the fragrant smell of his garments, blessing him, he said: Behold, the smell of my son is as the smell of a plentiful field, which the Lord hath blessed. ²⁸ God give thee of the dew of heaven, and of the fatness of the earth, abundance of corn and wine. ²⁹ And let peoples serve thee, and tribes worship thee: be thou lord of thy brethren, and let thy mother's children bow down before thee. Cursed be he that curseth thee: and let him that blesseth thee be filled with blessings.

³⁰ Isaac had scarce ended his words, when, Jacob being now gone out abroad, Esau came, ³¹ And brought in to his father meats, made of what he had taken in hunting, saying: Arise, my father, and eat of thy son's venison; that thy soul may bless me. ³² And Isaac said to him: Why! who art thou? He answered: I am thy firstborn son, Esau. ³³ Isaac was struck with fear, and astonished exceedingly; and wondering beyond what can be believed, said: Who is he then that even now brought me venison that he had taken, and I ate of all before thou camest? and I have blessed him, and he shall be blessed. ³⁴ Esau having heard his father's words, roared out with a great cry; and, being in a consternation, said: Bless me also, my father. ³⁵ And he said: Thy brother came deceitfully and got thy blessing. ³⁶ But he said again: Rightly is his name called Jacob; for he hath supplanted me lo this second time: My birthright he took away before, and now this second time he hath stolen away my blessing. And again he said to his father: Hast thou not reserved me also a blessing? ³⁷ Isaac answered: I have appointed him thy lord, and have made all his brethren his servants: I have established him with corn and wine, and after this, what shall I do more for thee, my son? ³⁸ And Esau said to him: Hast thou only one blessing, father? I beseech thee bless me also. And when he wept with a loud cry, ³⁹ Isaac being moved, said to him: In the fat of the earth, and in the dew of heaven from above, ⁴⁰ Shall thy blessing be. Thou shalt live by the sword, and shalt serve thy brother: and the time shall come, when thou shalt shake off and loose his yoke from thy neck.

⁴¹ Esau therefore always hated Jacob, for the blessing where-with his father had blessed him; and he said in his heart: The days will come of the mourning for my father, and I will kill my brother Jacob. ⁴² These things were told to Rebecca: and she sent and called Jacob, her son, and said to him: Behold Esau, thy brother, threateneth to kill thee. ⁴³ Now therefore, my son, hear my voice, arise and flee to Laban, my brother, to Haran: ⁴⁴ And thou shalt dwell with him a few days, till the wrath of thy brother be assuaged, ⁴⁵ And his indignation cease, and he forget the things thou hast done to him: afterwards I will send, and bring thee from thence hither. Why shall I be deprived of both my sons in one day? ⁴⁶ And Rebecca said to Isaac: I am weary of my life, because of the daughters of Heth: if Jacob take a wife of the stock of this land, I choose not to live.

30. *Jacob sent into Mesopotamia*

Genesis 28:1-9

28 ¹ And Isaac called Jacob, and blessed him, and charged him, saying: Take not a wife of the stock of Chanaan: ² But go, and take a journey to Mesopotamia of Syria, to the house of Bathuel, thy mother's father, and take thee a wife thence of the daughters of Laban, thy uncle. ³ And God almighty bless thee, and make thee to increase and multiply thee: that thou mayst be a multitude of people. ⁴ And give the blessings of Araham to thee, and to thy seed after thee: that thou mayst possess the land of thy sojournment, which he promised to thy grandfather. ⁵ And when Isaac had sent him away, he took his journey and went to Mesopotamia of Syria, to Laban, the son of Bathuel, the Syrian, brother to Rebecca, his mother.

⁶ And Esau seeing that his father had blessed Jacob, and had sent him into Mesopotamia of Syria, to marry a wife thence; and that after the blessing he had charged him, saying: Thou shalt not take a wife of the daughters of Chanaan: ⁷ And that Jacob obeying his parents, was gone into Syria: ⁸ Experiencing also, that his father was not well pleased with the daughters of Chanaan: ⁹ He went to Ismael, and took to wife, besides them he had before, Maheleth, the daughter of Ismael, Abraham's son, the sister of Nabajoth.

31. *Jacob's ladder at Bethel*

Genesis 28:10-22

28 ¹⁰ But Jacob being departed from Bersabee, went on to Haran. ¹¹ And when he was come to a certain place, and would rest in it after sunset, he took of the stones that lay there, and putting under his head, slept in the same place. ¹² And he saw in his sleep a ladder standing upon the earth, and the top thereof touching heaven: the angels also of God ascending and descending by it. ¹³ And the Lord leaning upon the ladder saying to him: I am the Lord God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: The land, wherein thou sleepest, I will give to thee and to thy seed. ¹⁴ And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth: thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and IN THEE and thy seed, all the tribes of the earth SHALL BE BLESSED. ¹⁵ And I will be thy keeper whithersoever thou goest, and will bring thee back into this land: neither will I leave thee, till I shall have accomplished all that I have said.

¹⁶ And when Jacob awaked out of sleep, he said: Indeed the Lord is in this place, and I knew it not. ¹⁷ And trembling, he said: How terrible is this place? this is no other but the house of God, and the gate of heaven. ¹⁸ And Jacob arising in the morning, took the stone which he had laid under his head, and set it up for a title, pouring oil upon the top of it. ¹⁹ And he called the name of the city Bethel, which before was called Luza. ²⁰ And he made a vow, saying: If God shall be with me, and shall keep me in the way, by which I walk, and shall give me bread to eat, and raiment to put on, ²¹ And I shall return prosperously to my father's house: the Lord shall be my God: ²² And this stone, which I have set up for a title, shall be called the house of God: and of all things that thou shalt give to me, I will offer tithes to thee.

32. Lia and Rachel*Genesis 29:1-35*

29 ¹ Then Jacob went on in his journey, and came into the east country. ² And he saw a well in the field, and three flocks of sheep lying by it: for the beasts were watered out of it, and the mouth thereof was closed with a great stone. ³ And the custom was, when all the sheep were gathered together, to roll away the stone, and after the sheep were watered, to put it on the mouth of the well again. ⁴ And he said to the shepherds: Brethren, whence are you? They answered: Of Haran. ⁵ And he asked them, saying: Know you Laban, the son of Nachor? They said: We know him. ⁶ He said: Is he in health? He is in health, say they: and behold, Rachel, his daughter, cometh with his flock. ⁷ And Jacob said: There is yet much day remaining, neither is it time to bring the flocks into the folds again: first give the sheep drink, and so lead them back to feed. ⁸ They answered: We cannot, till all the cattle be gathered together, and we remove the stone from the well's mouth, that we may water the flocks.

⁹ They were yet speaking, and behold Rachel came with her father's sheep; for she fed the flock. ¹⁰ And when Jacob saw her, and knew her to be his cousin german, and that they were the sheep of Laban, his uncle: he removed the stone wherewith the well was closed. ¹¹ And having watered the flock, he kissed her: and lifting up his voice wept. ¹² And he told her that he was her father's brother, and the son of Rebecca: but she went in haste and told her father. ¹³ Who, when he heard that Jacob his sister's son was come, ran forth to meet him: and embracing him, and heartily kissing him, brought him into his house. And when he had heard the causes of his journey, ¹⁴ He answered: Thou art my bone and my flesh. And after the days of one month were expired, ¹⁵ He said to him: Because thou art my brother, shalt thou serve me without wages? Tell me what wages thou wilt have. ¹⁶ Now he had two daughters, the name of the elder was Lia; and the younger was called Rachel. ¹⁷ But Lia was bleary-eyed: Rachel was well favoured, and of a beautiful countenance. ¹⁸ And Jacob being in love with her, said: I will serve thee seven years for Rachel, thy younger daughter. ¹⁹ Laban answered: It is better that I give her to thee than to another man; stay with me. ²⁰ So Jacob served seven years for Rachel: and they seemed but a few days, because of the greatness of his love.

²¹ And he said to Laban: Give me my wife; for now the time is fulfilled, that I may go in unto her. ²² And he, having invited a great number of his friends to the feast, made the marriage. ²³ And at night he brought in Lia, his daughter, to him, ²⁴ Giving his daughter a handmaid, named Zelpha. Now when Jacob had gone in to her according to custom, when morning was come he saw it was Lia. ²⁵ And he said to his father-in-law: What is it that thou didst mean to do? did not I serve thee for Rachel? why hast thou deceived me? ²⁶ Laban answered: It is not the custom in this place, to give the younger in marriage first. ²⁷ Make up the week of days of this match: and I will give thee her also, for the service that thou shalt render me other seven years. ²⁸ He yielded to his pleasure: and after the week was past, he married Rachel. ²⁹ To whom her father gave Bala, for her servant. ³⁰ And having at length obtained the marriage he wished for, he preferred the love of the latter before the former, and served with him other seven years.

³¹ And the Lord seeing that he despised Lia, opened her womb, but her sister remained barren. ³² And she conceived and bore a son, and called his name Ruben, saying: The Lord saw my affliction: now my husband will love me. ³³ And again she conceived and bore a son, and said: Because the Lord heard that I was despised, he hath given this also to me: and she called his name Simeon. ³⁴ And she conceived the third time, and bore another son, and said: Now also my husband will be joined to me, because I have borne him three sons: and therefore she called his name Levi. ³⁵ The fourth time she conceived and bore a son, and said: Now will I praise the Lord: and for this she called him Juda. And she left bearing.

33. The sons of Jacob, and the flight from Laban*Genesis 30:1-31:55*

30 ¹ And Rachel seeing herself without children, envied her sister, and said to her husband: Give me children, otherwise I shall die. ² And Jacob being angry with her, answered: Am I as God, who hath deprived thee of the fruit of thy womb? ³ But she said: I have here my servant Bala: go in unto her, that she may bear upon my knees, and I may have children by her. ⁴ And she gave him Bala in marriage: who, ⁵ When her husband had gone in unto her, conceived and bore a son. ⁶ And Rachel said: The Lord hath judged for me, and hath heard my voice, giving me a son; and therefore she called his name Dan. ⁷ And again Bala conceived, and bore another, ⁸ For whom Rachel said: God hath compared me with my sister, and I have prevailed: and she called him Nephthali. ⁹ Lia perceiving that she had left of bearing, gave Zelpha, her handmaid, to her husband. ¹⁰ And when she had conceived, and brought forth a son, ¹¹ She said: Happily. And therefore called his name Gad. ¹² Zelpha also bore another. ¹³ And Lia said: This is for my happiness: for women will call me blessed. Therefore she called him Aser.

¹⁴ And Ruben going out in the time of the wheat harvest into the field, found mandrakes: which he brought to his mother Lia. And Rachel said: Give me part of thy son's mandrakes. ¹⁵ She answered: Dost thou think it a small matter, that thou hast taken my husband from me, unless thou take also my son's mandrakes? Rachel said: He shall sleep with thee this night, for thy son's mandrakes. ¹⁶ And when Jacob returned at even from the field, Lia went out to meet him, and said: Thou shalt come in unto me, because I have hired thee for my son's mandrakes. And he slept with her that night. ¹⁷ And God heard her prayers; and she conceived: and bore a fifth son: ¹⁸ And said: God hath given me a reward, because I gave my handmaid to my husband. And she called his name Issachar. ¹⁹ And Lia conceived again, and bore the sixth son, ²⁰ And said: God hath endowed me with a good dowry; this turn also my husband will be with me, because I have borne him six sons: and therefore she called his name Zabulon. ²¹ After whom she bore a daughter, named Dina.

²² The Lord also remembering Rachel, heard her, and opened her womb. ²³ And she conceived, and bore a son, saying: God hath taken away my reproach. ²⁴ And she called his name Joseph: saying: The Lord give me also another son.

²⁵ And when Joseph was born, Jacob said to his father-in-law: Send me away, that I may return into my country, and to my land.

²⁶ Give me my wives, and my children, for whom I have served thee, that I may depart: thou knowest the service that I have

rendered thee. ²⁷ Laban said to him: Let me find favour in thy sight: I have learned, by experience, that God hath blessed me for thy sake. ²⁸ Appoint thy wages which I shall give thee. ²⁹ But he answered: Thou knowest how I have served thee, and how great thy possession hath been in my hands. ³⁰ Thou hadst but little before I came to thee, and now thou art become rich: and the Lord hath blessed thee at my coming. It is reasonable, therefore, that I should now provide also for my own house. ³¹ And Laban said: What shall I give thee? But he said: I require nothing; but if thou wilt do what I demand, I will feed and keep thy sheep again. ³² Go round through all thy flocks, and separate all the sheep of divers colours, and speckled; and all that is brown and spotted, and of divers colours, as well among the sheep as among the goats, shall be my wages. ³³ And my justice shall answer for me tomorrow before thee, when the time of the bargain shall come; and all that is not of divers colours, and spotted, and brown, as well among the sheep as among the goats, shall accuse me of theft. ³⁴ And Laban said: I like well what thou demandest. ³⁵ And he separated the same day the she-goats, and the sheep, and the he-goats, and the rams of divers colours, and spotted; and all the flock of one colour, that is, of white and black fleece, he delivered into the hands of his sons. ³⁶ And he set the space of three days journey betwixt himself and his son-in-law, who fed the rest of his flock.

³⁷ And Jacob took green rods of poplar, and of almond, and of plane-trees, and pilled them in part: so when the bark was taken off, in the parts that were pilled, there appeared whiteness: but the parts that were whole, remained green: and by this means the colour was divers. ³⁸ And he put them in the troughs, where the water was poured out; that when the flocks should come to drink, they might have the rods before their eyes, and in the sight of them might conceive. ³⁹ And it came to pass, that in the very heat of coition, the sheep beheld the rods, and brought forth spotted, and of divers colours, and speckled. ⁴⁰ And Jacob separated the flock, and put the rods in the troughs before the eyes of the rams; and all the white and the black were Laban's, and the rest were Jacob's, when the flocks were separated one from the other. ⁴¹ So when the ewes went first to ram, Jacob put the rods in the troughs of water before the eyes of the rams, and of the ewes, that they might conceive while they were looking upon them. ⁴² But when the later coming was, and the last conceiving, he did not put them. And those that were lateward, became Laban's; and they of the first time, Jacob's. ⁴³ And the man was enriched exceedingly, and he had many flocks, maid-servants and men-servants, camels and asses.

31 ¹ But after that he had heard the words of the sons of Laban, saying: Jacob hath taken away all that was our father's, and being enriched by his substance is become great. ² And perceiving also, that Laban's countenance was not towards him as yesterday and the other day. ³ Especially the Lord saying to him: Return into the land of thy fathers and to thy kindred, and I will be with thee. ⁴ He sent, and called Rachel and Lia into the field, where he fed the flocks, ⁵ And said to them: I see your father's countenance is not towards me as yesterday and the other day: but the God of my father hath been with me. ⁶ And you know that I have served your father to the uttermost of my power. ⁷ Yea your father hath also overreached me, and hath changed my wages ten times:

and yet God hath not suffered him to hurt me. ⁸ If at any time, he said: The speckled shall be thy wages: all the sheep brought forth speckled: but when he said on the contrary: Thou shalt take all the white one for thy wages: all the flocks brought forth white ones. ⁹ And God hath taken your father's substance, and given it to me. ¹⁰ For after the time came of the ewes conceiving, I lifted up my eyes, and saw in my sleep, that the males which leaped upon the females were of divers colours, and spotted, and speckled. ¹¹ And the angel of God said to me in my sleep: Jacob. And I answered: Here I am. ¹² And he said: Lift up thy eyes, and see that all the males leaping upon the females, are of divers colours, spotted and speckled. For I have seen all that Laban hath done to thee. ¹³ I am the God of Bethel, where thou didst anoint the stone, and make a vow to me. Now therefore arise, and go out of this land, and return into thy native country. ¹⁴ And Rachel and Lia answered: Have we any thing left among the goods and inheritance of our father's house? ¹⁵ Hath he not counted us as strangers, and sold us, and eaten up the price of us? ¹⁶ But God hath taken our father's riches, and delivered them to us, and to our children: wherefore, do all that God hath commanded thee.

¹⁷ Then Jacob rose up, and having set his children and wives upon camels, went his way. ¹⁸ And he took all his substance, and flocks, and whatsoever he had gotten in Mesopotamia, and went forward to Isaac, his father, to the land of Chanaan. ¹⁹ At that time Laban was gone to shear his sheep, and Rachel stole away her father's idols. ²⁰ And Jacob would not confess to his father-in-law that he was flying away. ²¹ And when he was gone, together with all that belonged to him, and having passed the river, was going on towards mount Galaad, ²² It was told Laban on the third day, that Jacob fled. ²³ And he took his brethren with him, and pursued after him seven days; and overtook him in the mount of Galaad. ²⁴ And he saw in a dream God, saying to him: Take heed thou speak not any thing harshly against Jacob.

²⁵ Now Jacob had pitched his tent in the mountain: and when he, with his brethren, had overtaken him, he pitched his tent in the same mount of Galaad. ²⁶ And he said to Jacob: Why hast thou done thus, to carry away, without my knowledge, my daughters as captives taken with the sword? ²⁷ Why wouldst thou run away privately, and not acquaint me, that I might have brought thee on the way with joy, and with songs, and with timbrels, and with harps? ²⁸ Thou hast not suffered me to kiss my sons and daughters; thou hast done foolishly; and now indeed, ²⁹ It is in my power to return thee evil; but the God of your father said to me yesterday: Take heed thou speak not any thing harshly against Jacob. ³⁰ Suppose thou didst desire to go to thy friends, and hadst a longing after thy father's house: why hast thou stolen away my gods? ³¹ Jacob answered: That I departed unknown to thee, it was for fear lest thou wouldst take away thy daughters by force. ³² But, whereas, thou chargest me with theft: with whomsoever thou shalt find thy gods, let him be slain before our brethren. Search, and if thou find any of thy things with me, take them away. Now when he said this, he knew not that Rachel had stolen the idols. ³³ So Laban went into the tent of Jacob, and of Lia, and of both the handmaids, and found them not. And when he was entered into Rachel's tent, ³⁴ She, in haste, hid the idols under the camel's furniture, and sat upon them:

and when he had searched all the tent, and found nothing, ³⁵ She said: Let not my lord be angry that I cannot rise up before thee, because it has now happened to me according to the custom of women. So his careful search was in vain.

³⁶ And Jacob being angry, said in a chiding manner: For what fault of mine, and for what offence on my part hast thou so hotly pursued me, ³⁷ And searched all my household stuff? What hast thou found of all the substance of thy house? lay it here before my brethren, and thy brethren, and let them judge between me and thee. ³⁸ Have I, therefore, been with thee twenty years? thy ewes and goats were not barren, the rams of thy flocks I did not eat: ³⁹ Neither did I shew thee that which the beast had torn; I made good all the damage: whatsoever was lost by theft, thou didst exact it of me: ⁴⁰ Day and night was I parched with heat, and with frost, and sleep departed from my eyes. ⁴¹ And in this manner have I served thee in thy house twenty years, fourteen for thy daughters, and six for thy flocks: thou hast changed also my wages ten times. ⁴² Unless the God of my father, Abraham, and the fear of Isaac, had stood by me, peradventure now thou hadst sent me away naked: God beheld my affliction and the labour of my hands, and rebuked thee yesterday.

⁴³ Laban answered him: The daughters are mine, and the children, and thy flocks, and all things that thou seest are mine: what can I do to my children, and grandchildren? ⁴⁴ Come, therefore, let us enter into a league; that it may be for a testimony between me and thee. ⁴⁵ And Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a title. ⁴⁶ And he said to his brethren: Bring hither stones. And they, gathering stones together, made a heap, and they ate upon it. ⁴⁷ And Laban called it, The witness heap; and Jacob, The hillock of testimony: each of them according to the propriety of his language. ⁴⁸ And Laban said: This heap shall be a witness between me and thee this day, and therefore the name thereof was called Galaad, that is, The witness heap. ⁴⁹ The Lord behold and judge between us, when we shall be gone one from the other. ⁵⁰ If thou afflict my daughters, and if thou bring in other wives over them: none is witness of our speech but God, who is present and beholdeth. ⁵¹ And he said again to Jacob: Behold this heap, and the stone which I have set up between me and thee, ⁵² Shall be a witness: this heap, I say, and the stone, be they for a testimony, if either I shall pass beyond it going towards thee, or thou shalt pass beyond it thinking harm to me. ⁵³ The God of Abraham, and the God of Nachor, the God of their father, judge between us. And Jacob swore by the fear of his father Isaac: ⁵⁴ And after he had offered sacrifices in the mountain, he called his brethren to eat bread. And when they had eaten, they lodged there: ⁵⁵ But Laban arose in the night, and kissed his sons and daughters, and blessed them: and returned to his place.

34. Jacob wrestles until daybreak

Genesis 32:1-32

The name Israel is given here.

32 ¹ Jacob also went on the journey he had begun: and the angels of God met him. ² And when he saw them, he said: These are the camps of God, and he called the name of that place Mahanaim, that is, Camps.

³ And he sent messengers before him to Esau, his brother, to the land of Seir, to the country of Edom: ⁴ And he commanded

them, saying: Thus shall ye speak to my lord Esau: Thus saith thy brother Jacob: I have sojourned with Laban, and have been with him until this day: ⁵ I have oxen, and asses, and sheep, and menservants, and womenservants: and now I send a message to my lord, that I may find favour in thy sight. ⁶ And the messengers returned to Jacob, saying: We came to Esau, thy brother, and behold he cometh with speed to meet thee with four hundred men. ⁷ Then Jacob was greatly afraid; and in his fear divided the people that was with him, and the flocks, and the sheep, and the oxen, and the camels, into two companies, ⁸ Saying: If Esau come to one company, and destroy it, the other company that is left, shall escape. ⁹ And Jacob said: O God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac: O Lord who saidst to me, Return to thy land, and to the place of thy birth, and I will do well for thee. ¹⁰ I am not worthy of the least of all thy mercies, and of thy truth which thou hast fulfilled to thy servant. With my staff I passed over this Jordan; and now I return with two companies. ¹¹ Deliver me from the hand of my brother Esau, for I am greatly afraid of him; lest perhaps he come, and kill the mother with the children. ¹² Thou didst say, that thou wouldst do well by me, and multiply my seed like the sand of the sea, which cannot be numbered for multitude.

¹³ And when he had slept there that night, he set apart, of the things which he had, presents for his brother Esau, ¹⁴ Two hundred she-goats, twenty he-goats, two hundred ewes, and twenty rams, ¹⁵ Thirty milch camels with their colts, forty kine, and twenty bulls, twenty she-asses, and ten of their foals. ¹⁶ And he sent them by the hands of his servants, every drove by itself, and he said to his servants: Go before me, and let there be a space between drove and drove. ¹⁷ And he commanded the first, saying: If thou meet my brother Esau, and he ask thee: Whose art thou? or whither goest thou? or whose are these before thee? ¹⁸ Thou shalt answer: Thy servant Jacob's: he hath sent them as a present to my lord Esau; and he cometh after us. ¹⁹ In like manner he commanded the second, and the third, and all that followed the droves, saying: Speak ye the same words to Esau, when ye find him. ²⁰ And ye shall add: Thy servant Jacob himself also followeth after us; for he said: I will appease him with the presents that go before, and afterwards I will see him, perhaps he will be gracious to me. ²¹ So the presents went before him, but himself lodged that night in the camp. ²² And rising early, he took his two wives and his two handmaids, with his eleven sons, and passed over the ford of Jaboc. ²³ And when all things were brought over that belonged to him, ²⁴ He remained alone; and behold, a man wrestled with him till morning. ²⁵ And when he saw that he could not overcome him, he touched the sinew of his thigh, and forthwith it shrank. ²⁶ And he said to him: Let me go, for it is break of day. He answered: I will not let thee go, except thou bless me. ²⁷ And he said: What is thy name? He answered: Jacob. ²⁸ But he said: Thy name shall not be called Jacob, but Israel; for if thou hast been strong against God, how much more shalt thou prevail against men? ²⁹ Jacob asked him: Tell me by what name art thou called? He answered: Why dost thou ask my name? And he blessed him in the same place. ³⁰ And Jacob called the name of the place Phaniel, saying: I have seen God face to face, and my soul has been saved. ³¹ And immediately the sun rose upon him, after he was past Phaniel; but he halted

on his foot. ³² Therefore the children of Israel, unto this day, eat not the sinew, that shrank in Jacob's thigh: because he touched the sinew of his thigh and it shrank.

35. Reconciliation, and the men of Sichem

Genesis 33:1-34:31

33 ¹ And Jacob lifting up his eyes, saw Esau coming, and with him four hundred men: and he divided the children of Lia and of Rachel, and of the two handmaids. ² And he put both the handmaids and their children foremost: and Lia and her children in the second place: and Rachel and Joseph last. ³ And he went forward and bowed down with his face to the ground seven times, until his brother came near. ⁴ Then Esau ran to meet his brother, and embraced him: and clasping him fast about the neck, and kissing him, wept. ⁵ And lifting up his eyes, he saw the women and their children, and said: What mean these? And do they belong to thee? He answered: They are the children which God hath given to me, thy servant. ⁶ Then the handmaids and their children came near and bowed themselves. ⁷ Lia also, with her children, came near and bowed down in like manner; and last of all, Joseph and Rachel bowed down. ⁸ And Esau said: What are the droves that I met? He answered: That I might find favour before my lord. ⁹ But he said: I have plenty, my brother, keep what is thine for thyself. ¹⁰ And Jacob said: Do not so I beseech thee, but if I have found favour in thy eyes, receive a little present at my hands: for I have seen thy face, as if I should have seen the countenance of God: be gracious to me, ¹¹ And take the blessing which I have brought thee, and which God hath given me, who giveth all things. He took it with much ado at his brother's earnest pressing him, ¹² And said: Let us go on together, and I will accompany thee in thy journey. ¹³ And Jacob said: My lord, thou knowest that I have with me tender children, and sheep, and kine with young: which if I should cause to be overdriven, in one day all the flocks will die. ¹⁴ May it please my lord to go before his servant: and I will follow softly after him, as I shall see my children to be able, until I come to my lord in Seir. ¹⁵ Esau answered: I beseech thee, that some of the people, at least, who are with me, may stay to accompany thee in the way. And he said: There is no necessity: I want nothing else but only to find favour, my lord, in thy sight.

¹⁶ So Esau returned that day, the way that he came, to Seir. ¹⁷ And Jacob came to Socoth: where having built a house, and pitched tents, he called the name of the place Socoth, that is, Tents.

¹⁸ And he passed over to Salem, a city of the Sichemites, which is in the land of Chanaan, after he returned from Mesopotamia of Syria: and he dwelt by the town. ¹⁹ And he bought that part of the field, in which he pitched his tents, of the children of Hemor, the father of Sichem, for a hundred lambs. ²⁰ And raising an altar there, he invoked upon it the most mighty God of Israel.

34 ¹ And Dina the daughter of Lia went out to see the women of that country. ² And when Sichem the son of Hemor the Hevite, the prince of that land, saw her, he was in love with her: and took her away, and lay with her, ravishing the virgin. ³ And his soul was fast knit unto her; and whereas she was sad, he comforted her with sweet words. ⁴ And going to Hemor his father, he said: Get me this damsel to wife. ⁵ But when Jacob had heard this,

his sons being absent, and employed in feeding the cattle, he held his peace till they came back. ⁶ And when Hemor the father of Sichem was come out to speak to Jacob, ⁷ Behold his sons came from the field: and hearing what had passed, they were exceeding angry, because he had done a foul thing in Israel, and committed an unlawful act, in ravishing Jacob's daughter. ⁸ And Hemor spoke to them: The soul of my son Sichem has a longing for your daughter: give her him to wife: ⁹ And let us contract marriages one with another: give us your daughters, and take you our daughters. ¹⁰ And dwell with us: the land is at your command, till, trade, and possess it. ¹¹ Sichem also said to her father and to her brethren: Let me find favour in your sight, and whatsoever you shall appoint I will give: ¹² Raise the dowry, and ask gifts, and I will gladly give what you shall demand: only give me this damsel to wife. ¹³ The sons of Jacob answered Sichem and his father deceitfully, being enraged at the deflowering of their sister: ¹⁴ We cannot do what you demand, nor give our sister to one that is uncircumcised; which with us is unlawful and abominable. ¹⁵ But in this we may be allied with you, if you will be like us, and all the male sex among you be circumcised: ¹⁶ Then will we mutually give and take your daughters, and ours; and we will dwell with you, and will be one people: ¹⁷ But if you will not be circumcised, we will take our daughter and depart.

¹⁸ Their offer pleased Hemor, and Sichem, his son: ¹⁹ And the young man made no delay, but forthwith fulfilled what was required: for he loved the damsel exceedingly, and he was the greatest man in all his father's house. ²⁰ And going into the gate of the city, they spoke to the people: ²¹ These men are peaceable, and are willing to dwell with us: let them trade in the land, and till it, which being large and wide wanteth men to till it: we shall take their daughters for wives, and we will give them ours. ²² One thing there is for which so great a good is deferred: We must circumcise every male among us, following the manner of the nation. ²³ And their substance, and cattle, and all that they possess, shall be ours; only in this let us condescend, and by dwelling together, we shall make one people. ²⁴ And they all agreed, and circumcised all the males. ²⁵ And behold the third day, when the pain of the wound was greatest: two of the sons of Jacob, Simeon and Levi, the brothers of Dina, taking their swords, entered boldly into the city and slew all the men. ²⁶ And they killed also Hemor and Sichem, and took away their sister Dina out of Sichem's house. ²⁷ And when they were gone out, the other sons of Jacob came upon the slain; and plundered the city in revenge of the rape. ²⁸ And they took their sheep, and their herds, and their asses, wasting all they had in their houses and in their fields. ²⁹ And their children and wives they took captive. ³⁰ And when they had boldly perpetrated these things, Jacob said to Simeon and Levi: You have troubled me, and made me hateful to the Chanaanites and Pherezites, the inhabitants of this land. We are few: they will gather themselves together and kill me; and both I, and my house shall be destroyed. ³¹ They answered: Should they abuse our sister as a strumpet?

36. Bethel confirmed; the death of Rachel

Genesis 35:1-29

Genesis 36, the generations of Esau, is omitted.

35 ¹ In the mean time God said to Jacob: Arise and go up to Bethel, and dwell there, and make there an altar to God, who appeared to thee when thou didst flee from Esau, thy brother. ² And Jacob having called together all his household, said: Cast away the strange gods that are among you, and be cleansed, and change your garments. ³ Arise, and let us go up to Bethel, that we may make there an altar to God; who heard me in the day of my affliction, and accompanied me in my journey. ⁴ So they gave him all the strange gods they had, and the earrings which were in their ears: and he buried them under the turpentine tree, that is behind the city of Sichem. ⁵ And when they were departed, the terror of God fell upon all the cities round about, and they durst not pursue after them as they went away. ⁶ And Jacob came to Luza, which is in the land of Chanaan, surnamed Bethel: he and all the people that were with him. ⁷ And he built there an altar, and called the name of that place, The house of God: for there God appeared to him when he fled from his brother. ⁸ At the same time Debora, the nurse of Rebecca, died, and was buried at the foot of Bethel, under an oak, and the name of that place was called, The oak of weeping.

⁹ And God appeared again to Jacob, after he returned from Mesopotamia of Syria, and he blessed him, ¹⁰ Saying: Thou shalt not be called any more Jacob, but Israel shall be thy name. And he called him Israel. ¹¹ And said to him: I am God almighty, increase thou and be multiplied. Nations and peoples of nations shall be from thee, and kings shall come out of thy loins. ¹² And the land which I gave to Abraham and Isaac, I will give to thee, and to thy seed after thee. ¹³ And he departed from him. ¹⁴ But he set up a monument of stone, in the place where God had spoken to him: pouring drink-offerings upon it, and pouring oil thereon: ¹⁵ And calling the name of that place Bethel.

¹⁶ And going forth from thence, he came in the spring time to the land which leadeth to Ephrata: wherein when Rachel was in travail, ¹⁷ By reason of her hard labour, she began to be in danger, and the midwife said to her: Fear not, for thou shalt have this son also. ¹⁸ And when her soul was departing for pain, and death was now at hand, she called the name of her son Benoni, that is, the son of my pain: but his father called him Benjamin, that is, the son of the right hand. ¹⁹ So Rachel died, and was buried in the highway that leadeth to Ephrata, this is Bethlehem. ²⁰ And Jacob erected a pillar over her sepulchre: this is the pillar of Rachel's monument, to this day. ²¹ Departing thence, he pitched his tent beyond the Flock tower. ²² And when he dwelt in that country, Ruben went, and slept with Bala the concubine of his father: which he was not ignorant of. Now the sons of Jacob were twelve. ²³ The sons of Lia: Ruben the first born, and Simeon, and Levi, and Juda, and Issachar, and Zabulon. ²⁴ The sons of Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin. ²⁵ The sons of Bala, Rachel's handmaid: Dan and Nephthali. ²⁶ The sons of Zelpha, Lia's handmaid: Gad and Aser: these are the sons of Jacob, that were born to him in Mesopotamia of Syria. ²⁷ And he came to Isaac his father in Mambre, the city of Arbee, this is Hebron: wherein Abraham and Isaac sojourned. ²⁸ And the days of Isaac were a hundred and eighty years. ²⁹ And being spent with age he died, and was gathered to his people, being old and full of days: and his sons Esau and Jacob buried him.

37. Joseph sold by his brethren

Genesis 37:1-36

37 ¹ And Jacob dwelt in the land of Chanaan, wherein his father sojourned. ² And these are his generations: Joseph, when he was sixteen years old, was feeding the flock with his brethren, being but a boy: and he was with the sons of Bala and of Zelpha his father's wives: and he accused his brethren to his father of a most wicked crime. ³ Now Israel loved Joseph above all his sons, because he had him in his old age: and he made him a coat of divers colours. ⁴ And his brethren seeing that he was loved by his father, more than all his sons, hated him, and could not speak peaceably to him.

⁵ Now it fell out also that he told his brethren a dream, that he had dreamed: which occasioned them to hate him the more. ⁶ And he said to them: Hear my dream which I dreamed. ⁷ I thought we were binding sheaves in the field: and my sheaf arose as it were, and stood, and your sheaves standing about bowed down before my sheaf. ⁸ His brethren answered: Shalt thou be our king? or shall we be subject to thy dominion? Therefore this matter of his dreams and words ministered nourishment to their envy and hatred. ⁹ He dreamed also another dream, which he told his brethren, saying: I saw in a dream, as it were the sun, and the moon, and eleven stars worshipping me. ¹⁰ And when he had told this to his father, and brethren, his father rebuked him and said: What meaneth this dream that thou hast dreamed? shall I and thy mother, and thy brethren worship thee upon the earth? ¹¹ His brethren therefore envied him: but his father considered the thing with himself.

¹² And when his brethren abode in Sechem, feeding their father's flocks, ¹³ Israel said to him: Thy brethren feed the sheep in Sichem: come, I will send thee to them. And when he answered: ¹⁴ I am ready: he said to him: Go, and see if all things be well with thy brethren, and the cattle: and bring me word again what is doing. So being sent from the vale of Hebron, he came to Sichem: ¹⁵ And a man found him there wandering in the field, and asked what he sought. ¹⁶ But he answered: I seek my brethren, tell me where they feed the flocks. ¹⁷ And the man said to him: They are departed from this place: for I heard them say: Let us go to Dothain. And Joseph went forward after his brethren, and found them in Dothain. ¹⁸ And when they saw him afar off, before he came nigh them, they thought to kill him: ¹⁹ And said one to another: Behold the dreamer cometh. ²⁰ Come, let us kill him, and cast him into some old pit: and we will say: Some evil beast hath devoured him: and then it shall appear what his dreams avail him: ²¹ And Ruben hearing this, endeavoured to deliver him out of their hands, and said: ²² Do not take away his life, nor shed his blood: but cast him into this pit, that is in the wilderness, and keep your hands harmless: now he said this, being desirous to deliver him out of their hands and to restore him to his father. ²³ And as soon as he came to his brethren, they forthwith stript him of his outside coat, that was of divers colours: ²⁴ And cast him into an old pit where there was not water. ²⁵ And sitting down to eat bread, they saw some Ismaelites on their way coming from Galaad, with their camels, carrying spices, and balm, and myrrh to Egypt. ²⁶ And Juda said to his brethren: What will it profit us to kill our brother, and conceal his blood? ²⁷ It is better that he be sold to the Ismaelites,

and that our hands be not defiled: for he is our brother and our flesh. His brethren agreed to his words. ²⁸ And when the Madianite merchants passed by, they drew him out of the pit, and sold him to the Ismaelites, for twenty pieces of silver: and they led him into Egypt.

²⁹ And Ruben returning to the pit, found not the boy: ³⁰ And rending his garments he went to his brethren, and said: The boy doth not appear, and whither shall I go? ³¹ And they took his coat, and dipped it in the blood of a kid, which they had killed: ³² Sending some to carry it to their father, and to say: This we have found: see whether it be thy son's coat, or not. ³³ And the father acknowledging it, said: It is my son's coat, an evil wild beast hath eaten him, a beast hath devoured Joseph. ³⁴ And tearing his garments, he put on sackcloth, mourning for his son a long time. ³⁵ And all his children being gathered together to comfort their father in his sorrow, he would not receive comfort, but said: I will go down to my son into hell, mourning. And whilst he continued weeping, ³⁶ The Madianites sold Joseph in Egypt to Putiphar, an eunuch of Pharaoh, captain of the soldiers.

38. *Juda and Tamar*

Genesis 38:1-30

Retained because Phares stands in the genealogy of Christ that closes the book of Ruth and opens St. Matthew.

38 ¹ At that time Juda went down from his brethren, and turned in to a certain Odollamite, named Hiras. ² And he saw there the daughter of a man of Chanaan, called Sue: and taking her to wife, he went in unto her. ³ And she conceived, and bore a son, and called his name Her. ⁴ And conceiving again, she bore a son, and called him Onan. ⁵ She bore also a third: whom she called Sela. After whose birth, she ceased to bear any more. ⁶ And Juda took a wife for Her, his first born, whose name was Tamar. ⁷ And Her, the first born of Juda, was wicked in the sight of the Lord: and was slain by him. ⁸ Juda, therefore, said to Onan his son: Go in to thy brother's wife and marry her, that thou mayst raise seed to thy brother. ⁹ He knowing that the children should not be his, when he went in to his brother's wife, he spilled his seed upon the ground, lest children should be born in his brother's name. ¹⁰ And therefore the Lord slew him, because he did a detestable thing: ¹¹ Wherefore Juda said to Tamar his daughter-in-law: Remain a widow in thy father's house, till Sela my son grow up: for he was afraid lest he also might die, as his brethren did. She went her way, and dwelt in her father's house.

¹² And after many days were past: the daughter of Sue the wife of Juda died: and when he had taken comfort after his mourning, he went up to Thamnas, to the shearers of his sheep, he and Hiras the Odollamite, the shepherd of his flock. ¹³ And it was told Tamar that her father-in-law was come up to Thamnas to shear his sheep. ¹⁴ And she put off the garments of her widowhood, and took a veil: and changing her dress, sat in the cross way, that leadeth to Thamnas: because Sela was grown up, and she had not been married to him. ¹⁵ When Juda saw her, he thought she was a harlot: for she had covered her face, lest she should be known. ¹⁶ And going to her, he said: Suffer me to lie with thee: for he knew her not to be his daughter-in-law. And she answered: What wilt thou give me to enjoy my company? ¹⁷ He said: I will send thee a kid out of the flock. And when she said again: I

will suffer what thou wilt, if thou give me a pledge, till thou send what thou promisest. ¹⁸ Juda said: What wilt thou have for a pledge? She answered: Thy ring and bracelet, and the staff which thou holdest in thy hand. The woman therefore at one copulation conceived. ¹⁹ And she arose and went her way: and putting off the apparel which she had taken, put on the garments of her widowhood. ²⁰ And Juda sent a kid by his shepherd, the Odollamite, that he might receive the pledge again, which he had given to the woman: but he, not finding her, ²¹ Asked the men of that place: Where is the woman that sat in the cross way? And when they all made answer: There was no harlot in this place, ²² He returned to Juda, and said to him: I have not found her; moreover, the men of that place said to me, that there never sat a harlot there. ²³ Juda said: Let her take it to herself, surely she cannot charge us with a lie, I sent the kid which I promised: and thou didst not find her.

²⁴ And behold, after three months, they told Juda, saying: Tamar, thy daughter-in-law, hath played the harlot, and she appeareth to have a big belly. And Juda said: Bring her out that she may be burnt. ²⁵ But when she was led to execution, she sent to her father in law, saying: By the man, to whom these things belong, I am with child. See whose ring, and bracelet, and staff this is. ²⁶ But he acknowledging the gifts, said: She is juster than I: because I did not give her to Sela, my son. However he knew her no more.

²⁷ And when she was ready to be brought to bed, there appeared twins in her womb: and in the very delivery of the infants, one put forth a hand, whereon the midwife tied a scarlet thread, saying: ²⁸ This shall come forth the first. ²⁹ But he drawing back his hand, the other came forth: and the woman said: Why is the partition divided for thee? and therefore called his name Phares. ³⁰ Afterwards his brother came out, on whose hand was the scarlet thread: and she called his name Zara.

39. *Joseph and the wife of Putiphar*

Genesis 39:1-23

39 ¹ And Joseph was brought into Egypt, and Putiphar, an eunuch of Pharaoh, chief captain of the army, an Egyptian, bought him of the Ismaelites, by whom he was brought. ² And the Lord was with him, and he was a prosperous man in all things: and he dwelt in his master's house: ³ Who knew very well that the Lord was with him, and made all that he did to prosper in his hand. ⁴ And Joseph found favour in the sight of his master, and ministered to him: and being set over all by him, he governed the house committed to him, and all things that were delivered to him: ⁵ And the Lord blessed the house of the Egyptian for Joseph's sake, and multiplied all his substance, both at home and in the fields. ⁶ Neither knew he any other thing, but the bread which he ate. And Joseph was of a beautiful countenance, and comely to behold.

⁷ And after many days, his mistress cast her eyes on Joseph, and said: Lie with me. ⁸ But he in no wise consenting to that wicked act said to her: Behold, my master hath delivered all things to me, and knoweth not what he hath in his own house: ⁹ Neither is there any thing which is not in my power, or that he hath not delivered to me, but thee, who art his wife; how then can I do this wicked thing, and sin against my God? ¹⁰ With such words as these day by day, both the woman was importunate

with the young man, and he refused the adultery. ¹¹ Now it happened on a certain day, that Joseph went into the house, and was doing some business, without any man with him: ¹² And she catching the skirt of his garment, said: Lie with me. But he leaving the garment in her hand, fled, and went out.

¹³ And when the woman saw the garment in her hands, and herself disregarded, ¹⁴ She called to her the men of her house, and said to them: See, he hath brought in a Hebrew, to abuse us: he came in to me, to lie with me; and when I cried out, ¹⁵ And he heard my voice, he left the garment that I held, and got him out. ¹⁶ For a proof therefore of her fidelity, she kept the garment, and shewed it to her husband when he returned home: ¹⁷ And said: The Hebrew servant, whom thou hast brought, came to me to abuse me. ¹⁸ And when he heard me cry, he left the garment which I held, and fled out.

¹⁹ His master hearing these things, and giving too much credit to his wife's words, was very angry, ²⁰ And cast Joseph into the prison, where the king's prisoners were kept, and he was there shut up. ²¹ But the Lord was with Joseph, and having mercy upon him gave him favour in the sight of the chief keeper of the prison: ²² Who delivered into his hand all the prisoners that were kept in custody: and whatsoever was done, was under him. ²³ Neither did he himself know any thing, having committed all things to him: for the Lord was with him, and made all that he did to prosper.

40. The dreams of the butler and the baker

Genesis 40:1-23

40 ¹ After this, it came to pass, that two eunuchs, the butler and the baker of the king of Egypt, offended their lord. ² And Pharaoh being angry with them, (now the one was chief butler, the other chief baker,) ³ He sent them to the prison of the commander of the soldiers, in which Joseph also was prisoner. ⁴ But the keeper of the prison delivered them to Joseph, and he served them. Some little time passed, and they were kept in custody. ⁵ And they both dreamed a dream the same night, according to the interpretation agreeing to themselves: ⁶ And when Joseph was come into them in the morning, and saw them sad, ⁷ He asked them, saying: Why is your countenance sadder today than usual? ⁸ They answered: We have dreamed a dream, and there is nobody to interpret it to us. And Joseph said to them: Doth not interpretation belong to God? Tell me what you have dreamed: ⁹ The chief butler first told his dream: I saw before me a vine, ¹⁰ On which were three branches, which by little and little sent out buds, and after the blossoms brought forth ripe grapes: ¹¹ And the cup of Pharaoh was in my hand: and I took the grapes, and pressed them into the cup which I held, and I gave the cup to Pharaoh. ¹² Joseph answered: This is the interpretation of the dream: The three branches, are yet three days: ¹³ After which Pharaoh will remember thy service, and will restore thee to thy former place: and thou shalt present him the cup according to thy office, as before thou was wont to do. ¹⁴ Only remember me when it shall be well with thee, and do me this kindness: to put Pharaoh in mind to take me out of this prison: ¹⁵ For I was stolen away out of the land of the Hebrews, and here without any fault was cast into the dungeon. ¹⁶ The chief baker seeing that he had wisely interpreted the dream, said: I also dreamed a dream, That I had three baskets of meal upon my head: ¹⁷ And

that in one basket which was uppermost, I carried all meats that are made by the art of baking, and that the birds ate out of it. ¹⁸ Joseph answered: This is the interpretation of the dream: The three baskets, are yet three days: ¹⁹ After which Pharaoh will take thy head from thee, and hang thee on a cross, and the birds shall tear thy flesh. ²⁰ The third day after this was the birthday of Pharaoh: and he made a great feast for his servants, and at the banquet remembered the chief butler, and the chief baker. ²¹ And he restored the one to his place, to present him the cup: ²² The other he hanged on a gibbet, that the truth of the interpreter might be shewn. ²³ But the chief butler, when things prospered with him, forgot his interpreter.

41. Pharaoh's dreams; Joseph exalted

Genesis 41:1-57

41 ¹ After two years Pharaoh had a dream. He thought he stood by the river, ² Out of which came up seven kine, very beautiful and fat: and they fed in marshy places. ³ Other seven also came up out of the river, ill-favoured, and lean fleshed: and they fed on the very bank of the river, in green places: ⁴ And they devoured them, whose bodies were very beautiful and well conditioned. So Pharaoh awoke. ⁵ He slept again, and dreamed another dream: Seven ears of corn came up upon one stalk full and fair: ⁶ Then seven other ears sprung up thin and blasted, ⁷ And devoured all the beauty of the former. Pharaoh awaked after his rest: ⁸ And when morning was come, being struck with fear, he sent to all the interpreters of Egypt, and to all the wise men: and they being called for, he told them his dream, and there was not any one that could interpret it.

⁹ Then at length the chief butler remembering, said: I confess my sin: ¹⁰ The king being angry with his servants, commanded me and the chief baker to be cast into the prison of the captain of the soldiers. ¹¹ Where in one night both of us dreamed a dream foreboding things to come. ¹² There was there a young man a Hebrew, servant to the same captain of the soldiers: to whom we told our dreams, ¹³ And we heard what afterwards the event of the thing proved to be so. For I was restored to my office: and he was hanged upon a gibbet.

¹⁴ Forthwith at the king's command Joseph was brought out of the prison, and they shaved him: and changing his apparel brought him in to him. ¹⁵ And he said to him: I have dreamed dreams, and there is no one that can expound them: Now I have heard that thou art very wise at interpreting them: ¹⁶ Joseph answered: Without me, God shall give Pharaoh a prosperous answer.

¹⁷ So Pharaoh told what he had dreamed: Methought I stood upon the bank of the river, ¹⁸ And seven kine came up out of the river, exceeding beautiful and full of flesh: and they grazed on green places in a marshy pasture. ¹⁹ And behold, there followed these, other seven kine, so very ill-favoured and lean, that I never saw the like in the land of Egypt: ²⁰ And they devoured and consumed the former, ²¹ And yet gave no mark of their being full: but were as lean and ill-favoured as before. I awoke, and then fell asleep again, ²² And dreamed a dream: Seven ears of corn grew up upon one stalk, full and very fair. ²³ Other seven also thin and blasted, sprung of the stalk: ²⁴ And they devoured the beauty of the former: I told this dream to the conjecturers, and there is no man that can expound it.

²⁵ Joseph answered: The king's dream is one: God hath shewn to Pharao what he is about to do. ²⁶ The seven beautiful kine, and the seven full ears, are seven years of plenty: and both contain the same meaning of the dream. ²⁷ And the seven lean and thin kine that came up after them, and the seven thin ears that were blasted with the burning wind, are seven years of famine to come: ²⁸ Which shall be fulfilled in this order. ²⁹ Behold, there shall come seven years of great plenty in the whole land of Egypt: ³⁰ After which shall follow other seven years of so great scarcity, that all the abundance before shall be forgotten: for the famine shall consume all the land, ³¹ And the greatness of the scarcity shall destroy the greatness of the plenty. ³² And for that thou didst see the second time a dream pertaining to the same thing: it is a token of the certainty, and that the word of God cometh to pass, and is fulfilled speedily.

³³ Now therefore let the king provide a wise and industrious man, and make him ruler over the land of Egypt: ³⁴ That he may appoint overseers over all the countries: and gather into barns the fifth part of the fruits, during the seven fruitful years, ³⁵ That shall now presently ensue: and let all the corn be laid up, under Pharao's hands, and be reserved in the cities. ³⁶ And let it be in readiness, against the famine of seven years to come, which shall oppress Egypt, and the land shall not be consumed with scarcity.

³⁷ The counsel pleased Pharao, and all his servants. ³⁸ And he said to them: Can we find such another man, that is full of the spirit of God? ³⁹ He said therefore to Joseph: Seeing God hath shewn thee all that thou hast said, can I find one wiser and one like unto thee? ⁴⁰ Thou shalt be over my house, and at the commandment of thy mouth all the people shall obey: only in the kingly throne will I be above thee. ⁴¹ And again Pharao said to Joseph: Behold, I have appointed thee over the whole land of Egypt. ⁴² And he took his ring from his own hand, and gave it into his hand: and he put upon him a robe of silk, and put a chain of gold about his neck. ⁴³ And he made him go up into his second chariot, the crier proclaiming that all should bow their knee before him, and that they should know he was made governor over the whole land of Egypt. ⁴⁴ And the king said to Joseph: I am Pharao: without thy commandment no man shall move hand or foot in all the land of Egypt. ⁴⁵ And he turned his name, and called him in the Egyptian tongue the saviour of the world. And he gave him to wife Aseneth, the daughter of Putiphare, priest of Heliopolis. Then Joseph went out to the land of Egypt.

⁴⁶ (Now he was thirty years old when he stood before king Pharao), and he went round all the countries of Egypt. ⁴⁷ And the fruitfulness of the seven years came: and the corn being bound up into sheaves, was gathered together into the barns of Egypt. ⁴⁸ And all the abundance of grain was laid up in every city. ⁴⁹ And there was so great abundance of wheat, that it was equal to the sand of the sea, and the plenty exceeded measure. ⁵⁰ And before the famine came, Joseph had two sons born: whom Aseneth, the daughter of Putiphare, priest of Heliopolis, bore unto him. ⁵¹ And he called the name of the firstborn Manasses, saying: God hath made me to forget all my labours, and my father's house. ⁵² And he named the second Ephraim, saying: God hath made me to grow in the land of my poverty.

⁵³ Now when the seven years of plenty that had been in Egypt were passed: ⁵⁴ The seven years of scarcity, which Joseph had foretold, began to come: and the famine prevailed in the whole world, but there was bread in all the land of Egypt. ⁵⁵ And when there also they began to be famished, the people cried to Pharao, for food. And he said to them: Go to Joseph: and do all that he shall say to you. ⁵⁶ And the famine increased daily in all the land: and Joseph opened all the barns, and sold to the Egyptians: for the famine had oppressed them also. ⁵⁷ And all provinces came into Egypt, to buy food, and to seek some relief of their want.

42. The brethren come down into Egypt

Genesis 42:1-44:34

Three journeys read as one: the first descent, Benjamin, and the cup in the sack.

42 ¹ And Jacob hearing that food was sold in Egypt, said to his sons: Why are ye careless? ² I have heard that wheat is sold in Egypt: Go ye down, and buy us necessities, that we may live, and not be consumed with want. ³ So the ten brethren of Joseph went down, to buy corn in Egypt: ⁴ Whilst Benjamin was kept at home by Jacob, who said to his brethren: Lest perhaps he take any harm in the journey. ⁵ And they entered into the land of Egypt with others that went to buy. For the famine was in the land of Chanaan. ⁶ And Joseph was governor in the land of Egypt, and corn was sold by his direction to the people. And when his brethren had bowed down to him, ⁷ And he knew them, he spoke as it were to strangers, somewhat roughly, asking them: Whence came you? They answered: From the land of Chanaan, to buy necessities of life. ⁸ And though he knew his brethren, he was not known by them. ⁹ And remembering the dreams, which formerly he had dreamed, he said to them: You are spies. You are come to view the weaker parts of the land. ¹⁰ But they said: It is not so, my lord; but thy servants are come to buy food. ¹¹ We are all the sons of one man: we are come as peaceable men, neither do thy servants go about any evil. ¹² And he answered them: It is otherwise: you are come to consider the unfenced parts of this land. ¹³ But they said: We thy servants are twelve brethren, the sons of one man in the land of Chanaan: the youngest is with our father, the other is not living. ¹⁴ He saith, This is it that I said: You are spies. ¹⁵ I shall now presently try what you are: by the health of Pharao, you shall not depart hence, until your youngest brother come. ¹⁶ Send one of you to fetch him: and you shall be in prison, till what you have said be proved, whether it be true or false: or else by the health of Pharao you are spies. ¹⁷ So he put them in prison three days. ¹⁸ And the third day he brought them out of prison, and said: Do as I have said, and you shall live: for I fear God. ¹⁹ If you be peaceable men, let one of your brethren be bound in prison: and go ye your ways, and carry the corn that you have bought, unto your houses. ²⁰ And bring your youngest brother to me, that I may find your words to be true, and you may not die. They did as he had said.

²¹ And they talked one to another: We deserve to suffer these things, because we have sinned against our brother, seeing the anguish of his soul, when he besought us, and we would not hear: therefore is this affliction come upon us. ²² And Ruben, one of them, said: Did not I say to you: Do not sin against the boy; and you would not hear me? Behold his blood is required.

²³ And they knew not that Joseph understood, because he spoke to them by an interpreter. ²⁴ And he turned himself away a little while, and wept: and returning, he spoke to them. ²⁵ And taking Simeon, and binding him in their presence, he commanded his servants to fill their sacks with wheat, and to put every man's money again in their sacks, and to give them besides provisions for the way: and they did so. ²⁶ But they having loaded their asses with the corn went their way. ²⁷ And one of them opening his sack, to give his beast provender in the inn, saw the money in the sack's mouth, ²⁸ And said to his brethren: My money is given me again; behold it is in the sack. And they were astonished, and troubled, and said to one another: What is this that God hath done unto us? ²⁹ And they came to Jacob their father in the land of Chanaan, and they told him all things that had befallen them, saying: ³⁰ The lord of the land spoke roughly to us, and took us to be spies of the country. ³¹ And we answered him: We are peaceable men, and we mean no plot. ³² We are twelve brethren born of one father: one is not living, the youngest is with our father in the land of Chanaan. ³³ And he said to us: Hereby shall I know that you are peaceable men: Leave one of your brethren with me, and take ye necessary provision for your houses, and go your ways, ³⁴ And bring your youngest brother to me, that I may know you are not spies: and you may receive this man again, that is kept in prison: and afterwards may have leave to buy what you will.

³⁵ When they had told this, they poured out their corn, and every man found his money tied in the mouth of his sack: and all being astonished together, ³⁶ Their father Jacob said: You have made me to be without children: Joseph is not living, Simeon is kept in bonds, and Benjamin you will take away: all these evils are fallen upon me. ³⁷ And Ruben answered him: Kill my two sons, if I bring him not again to thee: deliver him into my hand, and I will restore him to thee. ³⁸ But he said: My son shall not go down with you: his brother is dead, and he is left alone: if any mischief befall him in the land to which you go, you will bring down my grey hairs with sorrow to hell.

43 ¹ In the mean time the famine was heavy upon all the land. ² And when they had eaten up all the corn, which they had brought out of Egypt, Jacob said to his sons: Go again, and buy us a little food. ³ Juda answered: The man declared unto us with the attestation of an oath, saying: You shall not see my face, unless you bring your youngest brother with you. ⁴ If therefore thou wilt send him with us, we will set out together, and will buy necessities for thee. ⁵ But if thou wilt not, we will not go: for the man, as we have often said, declared unto us, saying: You shall not see my face without your youngest brother. ⁶ Israel said to them: You have done this for my misery, in that you told him you had also another brother. ⁷ But they answered: The man asked us in order concerning our kindred: if our father lived: if we had a brother: and we answered him regularly, according to what he demanded: could we know that he would say: Bring hither your brother with you? ⁸ And Juda said to his father: Send the boy with me, that we may set forward, and may live: lest both we and our children perish. ⁹ I take the boy upon me, require him at my hand: unless I bring him again, and restore him to thee, I will be guilty of sin against thee for ever. ¹⁰ If delay had not been made, we had been here again the second time.

¹¹ Then Israel said to them: If it must needs be so, do what you will: take of the best fruits of the land in your vessels, and carry down presents to the man, a little balm, and honey, and storax, myrrh, turpentine, and almonds. ¹² And take with you double money, and carry back what you found in your sacks, lest perhaps it was done by mistake. ¹³ And take also your brother, and go to the man. ¹⁴ And may my almighty God make him favourable to you: and send back with you your brother, whom he keepeth, and this Benjamin: and as for me I shall be desolate without children.

¹⁵ So the men took the presents, and double money, and Benjamin: and went down into Egypt, and stood before Joseph. ¹⁶ And when he had seen them, and Benjamin with them, he commanded the steward of his house, saying: Bring in the men into the house, and kill victims, and prepare a feast: because they shall eat with me at noon. ¹⁷ He did as he was commanded, and brought the men into the house. ¹⁸ And they being much afraid, said there one to another: Because of the money, which we carried back the first time in our sacks, we are brought in: that he may bring upon us a false accusation, and by violence make slaves of us and our asses. ¹⁹ Wherefore, going up to the steward of the house, at the door, ²⁰ They said: Sir, we desire thee to hear us. We came down once before to buy food: ²¹ And when we had bought, and were come to the inn, we opened our sacks, and found our money in the mouths of the sacks: which we have now brought again in the same weight. ²² And we have brought other money besides, to buy what we want: we cannot tell who put it in our bags. ²³ But he answered: Peace be with you, fear not: your God, and the God of your father, hath given you treasure in your sacks. For the money, which you gave me, I have for good. And he brought Simeon out to them. ²⁴ And having brought them into the house, he fetched water, and they washed their feet, and he gave provender to their asses. ²⁵ But they made ready the presents, against Joseph came at noon: for they had heard that they should eat bread there.

²⁶ Then Joseph came in to his house, and they offered him the presents, holding them in their hands; and they bowed down with their face to the ground. ²⁷ But he courteously saluting them again, asked them, saying: Is the old man your father in health, of whom you told me? Is he yet living? ²⁸ And they answered: Thy servant our father, is in health; he is yet living. And bowing themselves, they made obeisance to him. ²⁹ And Joseph lifting up his eyes, saw Benjamin, his brother by the same mother, and said: Is this your young brother, of whom you told me? And he said: God be gracious to thee, my son. ³⁰ And he made haste, because his heart was moved upon his brother, and tears gushed out: and going into his chamber, he wept. ³¹ And when he had washed his face, coming out again, he refrained himself, and said: Set bread on the table. ³² And when it was set on, for Joseph apart, and for his brethren apart, for the Egyptians also that ate with him apart, (for it is unlawful for the Egyptians to eat with the Hebrews, and they think such a feast profane): ³³ They sat before him, the firstborn according to his birthright, and the youngest according to his age. And they wondered very much; ³⁴ Taking the messes which they received of him: and the greater mess came to Benjamin, so that it exceeded by five parts. And they drank, and were merry with him.

44 ¹ And Joseph commanded the steward of his house, saying: Fill their sacks with corn, as much as they can hold: and put the money of every one in the top of his sack. ² And in the mouth of the younger's sack put my silver cup, and the price which he gave for the wheat. And it was so done. ³ And when the morning arose, they were sent away with their asses. ⁴ And when they were now departed out of the city, and had gone forward a little way: Joseph sending for the steward of his house, said: Arise, and pursue after the men: and when thou hast overtaken them, say to them: Why have you returned evil for good? ⁵ The cup which you have stolen, is that in which my lord drinketh, and in which he is wont to divine: you have done a very evil thing. ⁶ He did as he had commanded him. And having overtaken them, he spoke to them the same words. ⁷ And they answered: Why doth our lord speak so, as though thy servants had committed so heinous a fact? ⁸ The money, that we found in the top of our sacks, we brought back to thee from the land of Chanaan: how then should it be that we should steal out of thy lord's house, gold or silver? ⁹ With whomsoever of thy servants shall be found that which thou seekest, let him die, and we will be the bondmen of my lord. ¹⁰ And he said to them: Let it be according to your sentence: with whomsoever it shall be found, let him be my servant, and you shall be blameless. ¹¹ Then they speedily took down their sacks to the ground, and every man opened his sack. ¹² Which when he had searched, beginning at the eldest, and ending at the youngest, he found the cup in Benjamin's sack. ¹³ Then they rent their garments, and loading their asses again, returned into the town.

¹⁴ And Juda at the head of his brethren went in to Joseph (for he was not yet gone out of the place) and they all together fell down before him on the ground. ¹⁵ And he said to them: Why would you do so? know you not that there is no one like me in the science of divining. ¹⁶ And Juda said to him: What shall we answer my lord? or what shall we say, or be able justly to allege? God hath found out the iniquity of thy servants: behold, we are all bondmen to my lord, both we, and he with whom the cup was found. ¹⁷ Joseph answered: God forbid that I should do so: he that stole the cup, he shall be my bondman: and go you away free to your father.

¹⁸ Then Juda coming nearer, said boldly: I beseech thee, my lord, let thy servant speak a word in thy ears, and be not angry with thy servant: for after Pharaoh thou art. ¹⁹ My lord. Thou didst ask thy servants the first time: Have you a father or a brother. ²⁰ And we answered thee, my lord: We have a father an old man, and a young boy, that was born in his old age; whose brother by the mother is dead; and he alone is left of his mother, and his father loveth him tenderly. ²¹ And thou saidst to thy servants: Bring him hither to me, and I will set my eyes on him. ²² We suggested to my lord: The boy cannot leave his father: for if he leave him, he will die. ²³ And thou saidst to thy servants: Except your youngest brother come with you, you shall see my face no more. ²⁴ Therefore when we were gone up to thy servant our father, we told him all that my lord had said. ²⁵ And our father said: Go again, and buy us a little wheat. ²⁶ And we said to him: We cannot go: if our youngest brother go down with us, we will set out together: otherwise, without him we dare not see the man's face. ²⁷ Whereunto he answered: You know that

my wife bore me two. ²⁸ One went out, and you said: A beast devoured him; and hitherto he appeareth not. ²⁹ If you take this also, and any thing befall him in the way, you will bring down my grey hairs with sorrow unto hell. ³⁰ Therefore, if I shall go to thy servant, our father, and the boy be wanting, (whereas his life dependeth upon the life of him,) ³¹ And he shall see that he is not with us, he will die, and thy servants shall bring down his grey hairs with sorrow unto hell. ³² Let me be thy proper servant, who took him into my trust, and promised, saying: If I bring him not again, I will be guilty of sin against my father for ever. ³³ Therefore I, thy servant, will stay instead of the boy in the service of my lord, and let the boy go up with his brethren. ³⁴ For I cannot return to my father without the boy, lest I be a witness of the calamity that will oppress my father.

43. Joseph makes himself known

Genesis 45:1-15

45 ¹ Joseph could no longer refrain himself before many that stood by: whereupon he commanded that all should go out, and no stranger be present at their knowing one another. ² And he lifted up his voice with weeping, which the Egyptians, and all the house of Pharaoh heard. ³ And he said to his brethren: I am Joseph: Is my father yet living? His brethren could not answer him, being struck with exceeding great fear. ⁴ And he said mildly to them: Come nearer to me. And when they were come near him, he said: I am Joseph, your brother, whom you sold into Egypt. ⁵ Be not afraid, and let it not seem to you a hard case that you sold me into these countries: for God sent me before you into Egypt for your preservation. ⁶ For it is two years since the famine began to be upon the land, and five years more remain, wherein there can be neither ploughing nor reaping. ⁷ And God sent me before, that you may be preserved upon the earth, and may have food to live. ⁸ Not by your counsel was I sent hither, but by the will of God: who hath made me as it were a father to Pharaoh, and lord of his whole house, and governor in all the land of Egypt. ⁹ Make haste, and go ye up to my father, and say to him: Thus saith thy son Joseph: God hath made me lord of the whole land of Egypt; come down to me, linger not. ¹⁰ And thou shalt dwell in the land of Gessen: and thou shalt be near me, thou and thy sons, and thy sons' sons, thy sheep, and thy herds, and all things that thou hast. ¹¹ And there I will feed thee, (for there are yet five years of famine remaining) lest both thou perish, and thy house, and all things that thou hast. ¹² Behold, your eyes, and the eyes of my brother Benjamin, see that it is my mouth that speaketh to you. ¹³ You shall tell my father of all my glory, and all things that you have seen in Egypt: make haste and bring him to me. ¹⁴ And falling upon the neck of his brother Benjamin, he embraced him and wept: and Benjamin in like manner wept also on his neck. ¹⁵ And Joseph kissed all his brethren, and wept upon every one of them: after which they were emboldened to speak to him.

44. Pharaoh invites Jacob

Genesis 45:16-28

45 ¹⁶ And it was heard, and the fame was spread abroad in the king's court: The brethren of Joseph are come; and Pharaoh with all his family was glad. ¹⁷ And he spoke to Joseph that he should

give orders to his brethren, saying: Load your beasts, and go into the land of Chanaan, ¹⁸ And bring away from thence your father and kindred, and come to me; and I will give you all the good things of Egypt, that you may eat the marrow of the land. ¹⁹ Give orders also that they take wagons out of the land of Egypt, for the carriage of their children and their wives; and say: Take up your father, and make haste to come with all speed: ²⁰ And leave nothing of your household stuff; for all the riches of Egypt shall be yours. ²¹ And the sons of Israel did as they were bid. And Joseph gave them wagons according to Pharaoh's commandment: and provisions for the way. ²² He ordered also to be brought out for every one of them two robes: but to Benjamin he gave three hundred pieces of silver, with five robes of the best: ²³ Sending to his father as much money and raiment; adding besides, ten he-asses, to carry off all the riches of Egypt, and as many she-asses, carrying wheat and bread for the journey. ²⁴ So he sent away his brethren, and at their departing said to them: Be not angry in the way.

²⁵ And they went up out of Egypt, and came into the land of Chanaan, to their father Jacob. ²⁶ And they told him, saying: Joseph, thy son, is living; and he is ruler in all the land of Egypt. Which when Jacob heard, he awaked as it were out of a deep sleep, yet did not believe them. ²⁷ They, on the other side, told the whole order of the thing. And when he saw the wagons, and all that he had sent, his spirit revived, ²⁸ And he said: It is enough for me if Joseph, my son, be yet living: I will go and see him before I die.

45. *Jacob goes down into Egypt*

Genesis 46:1-47:31

46 ¹ And Israel taking his journey, with all that he had, came to the well of the oath, and killing victims there to the God of his father Isaac, ² He heard him, by a vision in the night, calling him, and saying to him: Jacob, Jacob. And he answered him: Lo, here I am. ³ God said to him: I am the most mighty God of thy father; fear not, go down into Egypt, for I will make a great nation of thee there. ⁴ I will go down with thee thither, and will bring thee back again from thence: Joseph also shall put his hands upon thy eyes.

⁵ And Jacob rose up from the well of the oath: and his sons took him up, with their children and wives in the wagons, which Pharaoh had sent to carry the old man, ⁶ And all that he had in the land of Chanaan: and he came into Egypt with all his seed; ⁷ His sons, and grandsons, daughters, and all his offspring together.

⁸ And these are the names of the children of Israel, that entered into Egypt, he and his children. His firstborn Ruben, ⁹ The sons of Ruben: Henoch and Phallu, and Hesron and Charmi. ¹⁰ The sons of Simeon: Jamuel and Jamin and Ahod, and Jachin and Sohar, and Saul, the son of a woman of Chanaan. ¹¹ The sons of Levi: Gerson and Caath, and Merari. ¹² The sons of Juda: Her and Onan, and Sela, and Phares and Zara. And Her and Onan died in the land of Chanaan. And sons were born to Phares: Hesron and Hamul. ¹³ The sons of Issachar: Thola and Phua, and Job and Semron. ¹⁴ The sons of Zabulon: Sared, and Elon, and Jafelel. ¹⁵ These are the sons of Lia, whom she bore in Mesopotamia of Syria, with Dina, his daughter. All the souls of her sons and daughters, thirty-three. ¹⁶ The sons of Gad: Sephion and Haggi, and Suni and Esebon, and Heri and Arodi, and Areli. ¹⁷ The sons

of Aser: Jamne and Jesua, and Jessuri and Beria, and Sara their sister. The sons of Beria: Heber and Melchiel. ¹⁸ These are the sons of Zelpha, whom Laban gave to Lia, his daughter. And these she bore to Jacob, sixteen souls. ¹⁹ The sons of Rachel, Jacob's wife: Joseph and Benjamin. ²⁰ And sons were born to Joseph, in the land of Egypt, whom Aseneth, the daughter of Putiphare, priest of Heliopolis, bore him: Manasses and Ephraim. ²¹ The sons of Benjamin: Bela and Bechor, and Asbel and Gera, and Naaman and Echi, and Ross and Mophim, and Ophim and Ared. ²² These are the sons of Rachel, whom she bore to Jacob: all the souls, fourteen. ²³ The sons of Dan: Husim. ²⁴ The sons of Nephthali: Jaziel and Guni, and Jeser and Sallem. ²⁵ These are the sons of Bala, whom Laban gave to Rachel, his daughter: and these she bore to Jacob: all the souls, seven. ²⁶ All the souls that went with Jacob into Egypt, and that came out of his thigh, besides his sons' wives, sixty-six. ²⁷ And the sons of Joseph, that were born to him in the land of Egypt, two souls. All the souls of the house of Jacob, that entered into Egypt, were seventy.

²⁸ And he sent Juda before him to Joseph, to tell him; and that he should meet him in Gessen. ²⁹ And when he was come thither, Joseph made ready his chariot, and went up to meet his father in the same place: and seeing him, he fell upon his neck, and embracing him, wept. ³⁰ And the father said to Joseph: Now shall I die with joy, because I have seen thy face, and leave thee alive. ³¹ And Joseph said to his brethren, and to all his father's house: I will go up, and will tell Pharaoh, and will say to him: My brethren, and my father's house, that were in the land of Chanaan, are come to me: ³² And the men are shepherds, and their occupation is to feed cattle; their flocks, and herds, and all they have, they have brought with them. ³³ And when he shall call you, and shall say: What is your occupation? ³⁴ You shall answer: We, thy servants, are shepherds, from our infancy until now, both we and our fathers. And this you shall say, that you may dwell in the land of Gessen, because the Egyptians have all shepherds in abomination.

47 ¹ Then Joseph went in and told Pharaoh, saying: My father and brethren, their sheep and their herds, and all that they possess, are come out of the land of Chanaan: and behold they stay in the land of Gessen. ² Five men also, the last of his brethren, he presented before the king: ³ And he asked them: What is your occupation? They answered: We, thy servants, are shepherds, both we and our fathers. ⁴ We are come to sojourn in thy land, because there is no grass for the flocks of thy servants, the famine being very grievous in the land of Chanaan: and we pray thee to give orders that we thy servants may be in the land of Gessen. ⁵ The king therefore said to Joseph: Thy father and thy brethren are come to thee. ⁶ The land of Egypt is before thee: and make them dwell in the best place, and give them the land of Gessen. And if thou knowest that there are industrious men among them, make them rulers over my cattle. ⁷ After this Joseph brought in his father to the king, and presented him before him: and he blessed him. ⁸ And being asked by him: How many are the days of the years of thy life? ⁹ He answered: The days of my pilgrimage are a hundred and thirty years, few, and evil, and they are not come up to the days of the pilgrimage of my fathers. ¹⁰ And blessing the king, he went out.

¹¹ But Joseph gave a possession to his father and his brethren in Egypt, in the best place of the land, in Ramesses, as Pharaoh had commanded. ¹² And he nourished them, and all his father's house, allowing food to every one.

¹³ For in the whole world there was want of bread, and a famine had oppressed the land, more especially of Egypt and Chanaan; ¹⁴ Out of which he gathered up all the money for the corn which they bought, and brought it in to the king's treasure. ¹⁵ And when the buyers wanted money, all Egypt came to Joseph, saying: Give us bread: why should we die in thy presence, having now no money? ¹⁶ And he answered them: Bring me your cattle, and for them I will give you food, if you have no money. ¹⁷ And when they had brought them, he gave them food in exchange for their horses, and sheep, and oxen, and asses: and he maintained them that year for the exchange of their cattle. ¹⁸ And they came the second year, and said to him: We will not hide from our lord, how that our money is spent, and our cattle also are gone: neither art thou ignorant that we have nothing now left but our bodies and our lands. ¹⁹ Why therefore shall we die before thy eyes? we will be thine, both we and our lands: buy us to be the king's servants, and give us seed, lest for want of tillers the land be turned into a wilderness. ²⁰ So Joseph bought all the land of Egypt, every man selling his possessions, because of the greatness of the famine. And he brought it into Pharaoh's hands: ²¹ And all its people from one end of the borders of Egypt, even to the other end thereof, ²² Except the land of the priests, which had been given them by the king: to whom also a certain allowance of food was given out of the public stores, and therefore they were not forced to sell their possessions. ²³ Then Joseph said to the people: Behold, as you see, both you and your lands belong to Pharaoh; take seed and sow the fields, ²⁴ That you may have corn. The fifth part you shall give to the king; the other four you shall have for seed, and for food for your families and children. ²⁵ And they answered: our life is in thy hand; only let my lord look favourably upon us, and we will gladly serve the king. ²⁶ From that time unto this day, in the whole land of Egypt, the fifth part is paid to the kings, and it is become as a law, except the land of the priests, which was free from this covenant.

²⁷ So Israel dwelt in Egypt, that is, in the land of Gessen, and possessed it; and grew, and was multiplied exceedingly. ²⁸ And he lived in it seventeen years: and all the days of his life came to a hundred and forty-seven years. ²⁹ And when he saw that the day of his death drew nigh, he called his son Joseph, and said to him: If I have found favour in thy sight, put thy hand under my thigh; and thou shalt shew me this kindness and truth, not to bury me in Egypt. ³⁰ But I will sleep with my fathers, and thou shalt take me away out of this land, and bury me in the burying place of my ancestors. And Joseph answered him: I will do what thou hast commanded. ³¹ And he said: Swear then to me. And as he was swearing, Israel adored God, turning to the bed's head.

46. Ephraim set before Manasses

Genesis 48:1-22

48 ¹ After these things, it was told Joseph that his father was sick; and he set out to go to him, taking his two sons Manasses and Ephraim. ² And it was told the old man: Behold thy son Joseph cometh to thee. And being strengthened, he sat on his bed.

³ And when Joseph was come in to him, he said: God almighty appeared to me at Luza, which is in the land of Chanaan, and he blessed me, ⁴ And said: I will cause thee to increase and multiply, and I will make of thee a multitude of people: and I will give this land to thee, and to thy seed after thee for an everlasting possession. ⁵ So thy two sons, who were born to thee in the land of Egypt before I came hither to thee, shall be mine: Ephraim and Manasses shall be reputed to me as Ruben and Simeon. ⁶ But the rest whom thou shalt have after them, shall be thine, and shall be called by the name of their brethren in their possessions. ⁷ For, when I came out of Mesopotamia, Rachel died from me in the land of Chanaan in the very journey, and it was spring time: and I was going to Ephrata, and I buried her near the way of Ephrata, which by another name is called Bethlehem.

⁸ Then seeing his sons, he said to him: Who are these? ⁹ He answered: They are my sons, whom God hath given me in this place. And he said: Bring them to me, that I may bless them. ¹⁰ For Israel's eyes were dim by reason of his great age, and he could not see clearly. And when they were brought to him, he kissed and embraced them, ¹¹ And said to his son: I am not deprived of seeing thee; moreover God hath shewn me thy seed. ¹² And when Joseph had taken them from his father's lap, he bowed down with his face to the ground. ¹³ And he set Ephraim on his right hand, that is, towards the left hand of Israel; but Manasses on his left hand, to wit, towards his father's right hand, and brought them near to him. ¹⁴ But he, stretching forth his right hand, put it upon the head of Ephraim, the younger brother; and the left upon the head of Manasses, who was the elder, changing his hands. ¹⁵ And Jacob blessed the sons of Joseph, and said: God, in whose sight my fathers Abraham and Isaac walked, God that feedeth me from my youth until this day: ¹⁶ The angel that delivereth me from all evils, bless these boys: and let my name be called upon them, and the names of my fathers Abraham and Isaac; and may they grow into a multitude upon the earth. ¹⁷ And Joseph seeing that his father had put his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, was much displeased: and taking his father's hand, he tried to lift it from Ephraim's head, and to remove it to the head of Manasses. ¹⁸ And he said to his father: It should not be so, my father; for this is the firstborn, put thy right hand upon his head. ¹⁹ But he refusing, said: I know, my son, I know: and this also shall become a people, and shall be multiplied; but his younger brother shall be greater than he; and his seed shall grow into nations. ²⁰ And he blessed them at that time, saying: In thee shall Israel be blessed, and it shall be said: God do to thee as to Ephraim, and as to Manasses. And he set Ephraim before Manasses. ²¹ And he said to Joseph, his son: Behold I die, and God will be with you, and will bring you back into the land of your fathers. ²² I give thee a portion above thy brethren, which I took out of the hand of the Amorrite with my sword and bow.

47. The blessing of Jacob

Genesis 49:1-32

"The sceptre shall not be taken away from Juda" (49:10).

49 ¹ And Jacob called his sons, and said to them: Gather yourselves together, that I may tell you the things that shall befall you in the last days. ² Gather yourselves together, and hear, O ye sons

of Jacob, hearken to Israel, your father: ³ Ruben, my firstborn, thou art my strength, and the beginning of my sorrow; excelling in gifts, greater in command. ⁴ Thou art poured out as water, grow thou not; because thou wentest up to thy father's bed, and didst defile his couch. ⁵ Simeon and Levi brethren: vessels of iniquity waging war. ⁶ Let not my soul go into their counsel, nor my glory be in their assembly: because in their fury they slew a man, and in their self-will they undermined a wall. ⁷ Cursed be their fury, because it was stubborn: and their wrath, because it was cruel: I will divide them in Jacob, and will scatter them in Israel. ⁸ Juda, thee shall thy brethren praise: thy hand shall be on the necks of thy enemies; the sons of thy father shall bow down to thee. ⁹ Juda is a lion's whelp: to the prey, my son, thou art gone up: resting thou hast couched as a lion, and as a lioness, who shall rouse him? ¹⁰ The sceptre shall not be taken away from Juda, nor a ruler from his thigh, till he come that is to be sent, and he shall be the expectation of nations. ¹¹ Tying his foal to the vineyard, and his ass, O my son, to the vine. He shall wash his robe in wine, and his garment in the blood of the grape. ¹² His eyes are more beautiful than wine, and his teeth whiter than milk. ¹³ Zabulon shall dwell on the seashore, and in the road of ships, reaching as far as Sidon. ¹⁴ Issachar shall be a strong ass, lying down between the borders. ¹⁵ He saw rest that it was good: and the land that it was excellent: and he bowed his shoulder to carry, and became a servant under tribute. ¹⁶ Dan shall judge his people like another tribe in Israel. ¹⁷ Let Dan be a snake in the way, a serpent in the path, that biteth the horse's heels, that his rider may fall backward. ¹⁸ I will look for thy salvation, O Lord. ¹⁹ Gad, being girded, shall fight before him: and he himself shall be girded backward. ²⁰ Aser, his bread shall be fat, and he shall yield dainties to kings. ²¹ Nephthali, a hart let loose, and giving words of beauty. ²² Joseph is a growing son, a growing son and comely to behold: the daughters run to and fro upon the wall; ²³ But they that held darts, provoked him, and quarrelled with him, and envied him. ²⁴ His bow rested upon the strong, and the bands of his arms and his hands were loosed, by the hands of the mighty one of Jacob: thence he came forth a pastor, the stone of Israel. ²⁵ The God of thy father shall be thy helper, and the Almighty shall bless thee with the blessings of heaven above, with the blessings of the deep that lieth beneath, with the blessings of the breasts and of the womb. ²⁶ The blessings of thy father are strengthened with the blessings of his fathers: until the desire of the everlasting hills should come: may they be upon the head of Joseph, and upon the crown of the Nazarite among his brethren. ²⁷ Benjamin a ravenous wolf, in the morning shall eat the prey, and in the evening shall divide the spoil.

²⁸ All these are the twelve tribes of Israel: these things their father spoke to them, and he blessed every one with their proper blessings. ²⁹ And he charged them, saying: I am now going to be gathered to my people: bury me with my fathers in the double cave, which is in the field of Ephron the Hethite, ³⁰ Over against Mambre, in the land of Chanaan, which Abraham bought together with the field, of Ephron the Hethite, for a possession to bury in. ³¹ There they buried him, and Sara his wife: there was Isaac buried with Rebecca, his wife: there also Lia doth lie buried.

³² And when he had ended the commandments, wherewith he

instructed his sons, he drew up his feet upon the bed, and died: and he was gathered to his people.

48. The death of Jacob and of Joseph

Genesis 50:1-25

"You thought evil against me: but God turned it into good" (50:20) is the hinge of the whole patriarchal narrative.

50 ¹ And when Joseph saw this, he fell upon his father's face, weeping and kissing him. ² And he commanded his servants, the physicians, to embalm his father. ³ And while they were fulfilling his commands, there passed forty days: for this was the manner with bodies that were embalmed, and Egypt mourned for him seventy days. ⁴ And the time of the mourning being expired, Joseph spoke to the family of Pharaoh: If I have found favour in your sight, speak in the ears of Pharaoh: ⁵ For my father made me swear to him, saying: Behold I die; thou shalt bury me in my sepulchre which I have digged for myself in the land of Chanaan. So I will go up and bury my father, and return. ⁶ And Pharaoh said to him: Go up and bury thy father according as he made thee swear.

⁷ So he went up, and there went with him all the ancients of Pharaoh's house, and all the elders of the land of Egypt. ⁸ And the house of Joseph with his brethren, except their children, and their flocks and herds, which they left in the land of Gessen. ⁹ He had also in his train chariots and horsemen: and it was a great company. ¹⁰ And they came to the threshing floor of Atad, which is situated beyond the Jordan: where celebrating the exequies with a great and vehement lamentation, they spent full seven days. ¹¹ And when the inhabitants of Chanaan saw this, they said: This is a great mourning to the Egyptians. And therefore the name of that place was called, The mourning of Egypt. ¹² So the sons of Jacob did as he had commanded them. ¹³ And carrying him into the land of Chanaan, they buried him in the double cave, which Abraham had bought together with the field for a possession of a burying place, of Ephron, the Hethite, over against Mambre. ¹⁴ And Joseph returned into Egypt with his brethren, and all that were in his company, after he had buried his father.

¹⁵ Now he being dead, his brethren were afraid, and talked one with another: Lest perhaps he should remember the wrong he suffered, and requite us all the evil that we did to him. ¹⁶ And they sent a message to him, saying: Thy father commanded us before he died, ¹⁷ That we should say thus much to thee from him: I beseech thee to forget the wickedness of thy brethren, and the sin and malice they practised against thee: we also pray thee, to forgive the servants of the God of thy father this wickedness. And when Joseph heard this, he wept. ¹⁸ And his brethren came to him; and worshipping prostrate on the ground, they said: We are thy servants. ¹⁹ And he answered them: Fear not: can we resist the will of God? ²⁰ You thought evil against me: but God turned it into good, that he might exalt me, as at present you see, and might save many people. ²¹ Fear not: I will feed you and your children. And he comforted them, and spoke gently and mildly.

²² And he dwelt in Egypt with all his father's house; and lived a hundred and ten years. And he saw the children of Ephraim to the third generation. The children also of Machir, the sons

of Manasses, were born on Joseph's knees. ²³ After which he told his brethren: God will visit you after my death, and will make you go up out of this land, to the land which he swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ²⁴ And he made them swear to him, saying: God will visit you, carry my bones with you out of this place: ²⁵ And he died, being a hundred and ten years old. And being embalmed, he was laid in a coffin in Egypt.

EGYPT AND EXODUS

Exodus 1-24 and 32-34: bondage, the passover, the sea, and the covenant at Sinai. The tabernacle specifications (25-31) and their execution (35-40) are passed over; they are description, not narrative, and the second is largely a repetition of the first.

49. Israel in bondage

Exodus 1:1-22

¹ ¹ These are the names of the children of Israel, that went into Egypt with Jacob: they went in every man with his household: ² Ruben, Simeon, Levi, Juda, ³ Issachar, Zabulon, and Benjamin, ⁴ Dan, and Nephthali, Gad and Aser. ⁵ And all the souls that came out of Jacob's thigh, were seventy: but Joseph was in Egypt. ⁶ After he was dead, and all his brethren, and all that generation, ⁷ The children of Israel increased, and sprung up into multitudes, and growing exceedingly strong they filled the land.

⁸ In the mean time there arose a new king over Egypt, that knew not Joseph: ⁹ And he said to his people: Behold the people of the children of Israel are numerous and stronger than we. ¹⁰ Come let us wisely oppress them, lest they multiply: and if any war shall rise against us, join with our enemies, and having overcome us, depart out of the land. ¹¹ Therefore he set over them masters of the works, to afflict them with burdens: and they built for Pharaoh cities of tabernacles, Phithom, and Ramesses. ¹² But the more they oppressed them, the more they were multiplied and increased. ¹³ And the Egyptians hated the children of Israel, and afflicted them and mocked them: ¹⁴ And they made their life bitter with hard works in clay and brick, and with all manner of service, wherewith they were overcharged in the works of the earth.

¹⁵ And the king of Egypt spoke to the midwives of the Hebrews: of whom one was called Sephora, the other Phua, ¹⁶ Commanding them: When you shall do the office of midwives to the Hebrew women, and the time of delivery is come: if it be a man child, kill it: if a woman, keep it alive. ¹⁷ But the midwives feared God, and did not do as the king of Egypt had commanded, but saved the men children. ¹⁸ And the king called for them and said: What is it that you meant to do, that you would save the men children? ¹⁹ They answered: The Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women: for they themselves are skilful in the office of a midwife; and they are delivered before we come to them. ²⁰ Therefore God dealt well with the midwives: and the people multiplied and grew exceedingly strong. ²¹ And because the midwives feared God, he built them houses. ²² Pharaoh therefore charged all his people, saying: Whatsoever shall be born of the male sex, ye shall cast into the river: whatsoever of the female, ye shall save alive.

50. The birth of Moses, and his flight

Exodus 2:1-25

² ¹ After this there went a man of the house of Levi; and took a wife of his own kindred. ² And she conceived, and bore a son: and seeing him a goodly child, hid him three months. ³ And when she could hide him no longer, she took a basket made of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and pitch: and put the little babe therein, and laid him in the sedges by the river's brink, ⁴ His sister standing afar off, and taking notice what would be done. ⁵ And behold the daughter of Pharaoh came down to wash herself in the river: and her maids walked by the river's brink. And when she saw the basket in the sedges she sent one of her maids for it: and when it was brought, ⁶ She opened it, and seeing within it an infant crying, having compassion on it, she said: This is one of the babes of the Hebrews. ⁷ And the child's sister said to her: Shall I go, and call to thee a Hebrew woman, to nurse the babe? ⁸ She answered: Go. The maid went and called her mother. ⁹ And Pharaoh's daughter said to her: Take this child, and nurse him for me: I will give thee thy wages. The woman took and nursed the child: and when he was grown up, she delivered him to Pharaoh's daughter. ¹⁰ And she adopted him for a son, and called him Moses, saying: Because I took him out of the water.

¹¹ In those days, after Moses was grown up, he went out to his brethren: and saw their affliction, and an Egyptian striking one of the Hebrews, his brethren. ¹² And when he had looked about this way and that way, and saw no one there, he slew the Egyptian and hid him in the sand. ¹³ And going out the next day, he saw two Hebrews quarrelling: and he said to him that did the wrong: Why strikest thou thy neighbour? ¹⁴ But he answered: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge over us? wilt thou kill me, as thou didst yesterday kill the Egyptian? Moses feared, and said: How is this come to be known? ¹⁵ And Pharaoh heard of this word, and sought to kill Moses: but he fled from his sight, and abode in the land of Madian, and he sat down by a well.

¹⁶ And the priest of Madian had seven daughters, who came to draw water: and when the troughs were filled, desired to water their father's flocks. ¹⁷ And the shepherds came and drove them away: and Moses arose, and defending the maids, watered their sheep. ¹⁸ And when they returned to Raguel their father, he said to them: Why are ye come sooner than usual? ¹⁹ They answered: A man of Egypt delivered us from the hands of the shepherds: and he drew water also with us, and gave the sheep to drink. ²⁰ But he said: Where is he? why have you let the man go? call him that he may eat bread. ²¹ And Moses swore that he would dwell with him. And he took Sephora his daughter to wife: ²² And she bore him a son, whom he called Gersam, saying: I have been a stranger in a foreign country. And she bore another, whom he called Eliezer, saying: For the God of my father, my helper, hath delivered me out of the hand of Pharaoh.

²³ Now after a long time the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel groaning, cried out because of the works: and their cry went up unto God from the works. ²⁴ And he heard their groaning, and remembered the covenant which he made with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ²⁵ And the Lord looked upon the children of Israel, and he knew them.

51. The burning bush*Exodus 3:1-4:17*

"I AM WHO AM." The divine name is given here.

3 ¹ Now Moses fed the sheep of Jethro, his father in law, the priest of Madian: and he drove the flock to the inner parts of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, Horeb. ² And the Lord appeared to him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he saw that the bush was on fire, and was not burnt. ³ And Moses said: I will go, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt. ⁴ And when the Lord saw that he went forward to see, he called to him out of the midst of the bush. and said: Moses, Moses. And he answered: Here I am. ⁵ And he said: Come not nigh hither, put off the shoes from thy feet; for the place, whereon thou standest, is holy ground. ⁶ And he said: I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. Moses hid his face: for he durst not look at God.

⁷ And the Lord said to him: I have seen the affliction of my people in Egypt, and I have heard their cry because of the rigour of them that are over the works; ⁸ And knowing their sorrow, I am come down to deliver them out of the hands of the Egyptians, and to bring them out of that land into a good and spacious land, into a land that floweth with milk and honey, to the places of the Chanaanite, and Hethite, and Amorrrhite, and Pherezite, and Hevite, and Jebusite. ⁹ For the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have seen their affliction, wherewith they are oppressed by the Egyptians. ¹⁰ But come, and I will send thee to Pharaο, that thou mayst bring forth my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt.

¹¹ And Moses said to God: Who am I that I should go to Pharaο, and should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt? ¹² And he said to him: I will be with thee; and this thou shalt have for a sign that I have sent thee: When thou shalt have brought my people out of Egypt, thou shalt offer sacrifice to God upon this mountain. ¹³ Moses said to God: Lo, I shall go to the children of Israel, and say to them: The God of your fathers hath sent me to you. If they shall say to me: What is his name? What shall I say to them? ¹⁴ God said to Moses: I AM WHO AM. He said: Thus shalt thou say to the children of Israel: HE WHO IS, hath sent me to you. ¹⁵ And God said again to Moses: Thus shalt thou say to the children of Israel: The Lord God of your fathers the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob hath sent me to you; this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations. ¹⁶ Go and gather together the ancients of Israel, and thou shalt say to them: The Lord God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared to me, saying: Visiting I have visited you; and I have seen all that hath befallen you in Egypt. ¹⁷ And I have said the word to bring you forth out of the affliction of Egypt, into the land of the Chanaanite, and Hethite, and Amorrrhite, and Pherezite, and Hevite, and Jebusite, to a land that floweth with milk and honey. ¹⁸ And they shall hear thy voice; and thou shalt go in, thou and the ancients of Israel, to the king of Egypt, and thou shalt say to him: The Lord God of the Hebrews hath called us; we will go three days' journey into the wilderness, to sacrifice unto the Lord our God. ¹⁹ But I know that the king of Egypt will not let you go, but by a mighty hand. ²⁰ For I will

stretch forth my hand, and will strike Egypt with all my wonders which I will do in the midst of them: after these he will let you go. ²¹ And I will give favour to this people, in the sight of the Egyptians: and when you go forth, you shall not depart empty: ²² But every woman shall ask of her neighbour, and of her that is in her house, vessels of silver and of gold, and raiment: and you shall put them on your sons and daughters, and shall spoil Egypt.

4 ¹ Moses answered, and said: They will not believe me, nor hear my voice, but they will say: The Lord hath not appeared to thee. ² Then he said to him: What is that thou holdest in thy hand? He answered: A rod. ³ And the Lord said: Cast it down upon the ground. He cast it down, and it was turned into a serpent, so that Moses fled from it. ⁴ And the Lord said: Put out thy hand, and take it by the tail. He put forth his hand, and took hold of it, and it was turned into a rod. ⁵ That they may believe, saith he, that the Lord God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath appeared to thee. ⁶ And the Lord said again: Put thy hand into thy bosom. And when he had put it into his bosom, he brought it forth leprous as snow. ⁷ And he said: Put back thy hand into thy bosom. He put it back, and brought it out again, and it was like the other flesh. ⁸ If they will not believe thee, saith he, nor hear the voice of the former sign, they will believe the word of the latter sign. ⁹ But if they will not even believe these two signs, nor hear thy voice: take of the river water, and pour it out upon the dry land, and whatsoever thou drawest out of the river, shall be turned into blood.

¹⁰ Moses said: I beseech thee, Lord, I am not eloquent from yesterday and the day before; and since thou hast spoken to thy servant, I have more impediment and slowness of tongue. ¹¹ The Lord said to him: Who made man's mouth? or who made the dumb and the deaf, the seeing and the blind? did not I? ¹² Go therefore, and I will be in thy mouth; and I will teach thee what thou shalt speak. ¹³ But he said: I beseech thee, Lord, send whom thou wilt send. ¹⁴ The Lord being angry at Moses, said: Aaron the Levite is thy brother, I know that he is eloquent: behold he cometh forth to meet thee, and seeing thee, shall be glad at heart. ¹⁵ Speak to him, and put my words in his mouth: and I will be in thy mouth, and in his mouth, and will shew you what you must do. ¹⁶ He shall speak in thy stead to the people, and shall be thy mouth: but thou shalt be to him in those things that pertain to God. ¹⁷ And take this rod in thy hand, wherewith thou shalt do the signs.

52. Moses returns into Egypt*Exodus 4:18-31*

4 ¹⁸ Moses went his way, and returned to Jethro his father in law, and said to him; I will go and return to my brethren into Egypt, that I may see if they be yet alive. And Jethro said to him: Go in peace. ¹⁹ And the Lord said to Moses, in Madian: Go, and return into Egypt; for they are all dead that sought thy life. ²⁰ Moses therefore took his wife, and his sons, and set them upon an ass; and returned into Egypt, carrying the rod of God in his hand. ²¹ And the Lord said to him as he was returning into Egypt: See that thou do all the wonders before Pharaο, which I have put in thy hand: I shall harden his heart, and he will not let the people go. ²² And thou shalt say to him: Thus saith the

Lord: Israel is my son, my firstborn. ²³ I have said to thee: Let my son go, that he may serve me, and thou wouldst not let him go: behold I will kill thy son, thy firstborn.

²⁴ And when he was in his journey, in the inn, the Lord met him, and would have killed him. ²⁵ Immediately Sephora took a very sharp stone, and circumcised the foreskin of her son, and touched his feet, and said: A bloody spouse art thou to me. ²⁶ And he let him go after she had said: A bloody spouse art thou to me, because of the circumcision.

²⁷ And the Lord said to Aaron: Go into the desert to meet Moses. And he went forth to meet him in the mountain of God, and kissed him. ²⁸ And Moses told Aaron all the words of the Lord, by which he had sent him, and the signs that he had commanded. ²⁹ And they came together, and they assembled all the ancients of the children of Israel. ³⁰ And Aaron spoke all the words which the Lord had said to Moses: and he wrought the signs before the people. ³¹ And the people believed. And they heard that the Lord had visited the children of Israel, and that he had looked upon their affliction: and falling down they adored.

53. Bricks without straw

Exodus 5:1-23

5 ¹ After these things, Moses and Aaron went in, and said to Pharaoh: Thus saith the Lord God of Israel: Let my people go, that they may sacrifice to me in the desert. ² But he answered: Who is the Lord, that I should hear his voice, and let Israel go? I know not the Lord, neither will I let Israel go.

³ And they said: The God of the Hebrews hath called us, to go three days' journey into the wilderness, and to sacrifice to the Lord our God; lest a pestilence or the sword fall upon us. ⁴ The king of Egypt said to them: Why do you Moses and Aaron draw off the people from their works? Get you gone to your burdens. ⁵ And Pharaoh said: The people of the land are numerous; you see that the multitude is increased; how much more if you give them rest from their works? ⁶ Therefore he commanded the same day the overseers of the works, and the task-masters of the people, saying: ⁷ You shall give straw no more to the people to make brick, as before; but let them go and gather straw. ⁸ And you shall lay upon them the task of bricks, which they did before; neither shall you diminish any thing thereof, for they are idle, and therefore they cry, saying: Let us go and sacrifice to our God. ⁹ Let them be oppressed with works, and let them fulfil them; that they may not regard lying words.

¹⁰ And the overseers of the works, and the taskmasters, went out and said to the people: Thus saith Pharaoh: I allow you no straw; ¹¹ Go, and gather it where you can find it; neither shall any thing of your work be diminished. ¹² And the people was scattered through all the land of Egypt to gather straw. ¹³ And the overseers of the works pressed them, saying: Fulfil your work every day, as before ye were wont to do, when straw was given you. ¹⁴ And they that were over the works of the children of Israel, were scourged by Pharaoh's taskmasters, saying: Why have you not made up the task of bricks, both yesterday and to day, as before?

¹⁵ And the officers of the children of Israel came, and cried out to Pharaoh, saying: Why dealest thou so with thy servants? ¹⁶ Straw is not given us, and bricks are required of us as before; behold we, thy servants, are beaten with whips, and thy people is

unjustly dealt withal. ¹⁷ And he said: You are idle, and therefore you say: Let us go and sacrifice to the Lord. ¹⁸ Go therefore and work: straw shall not be given you, and you shall deliver the accustomed number of bricks. ¹⁹ And the officers of the children of Israel saw that they were in evil case, because it was said to them: There shall not a whit be diminished of the bricks for every day.

²⁰ And they met Moses and Aaron, who stood over against them as they came out from Pharaoh: ²¹ And they said to them: The Lord see and judge, because you have, made our savour to stink before Pharaoh and his servants, and you have given him a sword, to kill us. ²² And Moses returned to the Lord, and said: Lord, why hast thou afflicted this people? wherefore hast thou sent me? ²³ For since the time that I went in to Pharaoh to speak in thy name, he hath afflicted thy people: and thou hast not delivered them.

54. The promise renewed

Exodus 6:1-13

6:14-30, the genealogy of Levi, is omitted.

6 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Now thou shalt see what I will do to Pharaoh: for by a mighty hand shall he let them go, and with a strong hand shall he cast them out of his land. ² And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: I am the Lord ³ That appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, by the name of God Almighty: and my name ADONAI I did not shew them. ⁴ And I made a covenant with them, to give them the land of Chanaan, the land of their pilgrimage wherein they were strangers. ⁵ I have heard the groaning of the children of Israel, wherewith the Egyptians have oppressed them: and I have remembered my covenant. ⁶ Therefore say to the children of Israel: I am the Lord who will bring you out from the work-prison of the Egyptians, and will deliver you from bondage: and redeem you with a high arm, and great judgments. ⁷ And I will take you to myself for my people, I will be your God: and you shall know that I am the Lord your God, who brought you out from the work-prison of the Egyptians: ⁸ And brought you into the land, concerning which I lifted up my hand to give it to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: and I will give it you to possess: I am the Lord.

⁹ And Moses told all this to the children of Israel: but they did not hearken to him, for anguish of spirit, and most painful work.

¹⁰ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ¹¹ Go in, and speak to Pharaoh king of Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land. ¹² Moses answered before the Lord: Behold the children of Israel do not hearken to me: and how will Pharaoh hear me, especially as I am of uncircumcised lips? ¹³ And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, and he gave them a charge unto the children of Israel, and unto Pharaoh the king of Egypt, that they should bring forth the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt.

55. The rod, the blood, the frogs and the flies

Exodus 7:1-8:32

7 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Behold, I have appointed thee the god of Pharaoh; and Aaron, thy brother, shall be thy prophet.

² Thou shalt speak to him all that I command thee; and he shall

speaking to Pharaoh, that he let the children of Israel go out of his land.³ But I shall harden his heart, and shall multiply my signs and wonders in the land of Egypt.⁴ And he will not hear you: and I will lay my hand upon Egypt, and will bring forth my army and my people, the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt, by very great judgments.⁵ And the Egyptians shall know that I am the Lord, who have stretched forth my hand upon Egypt, and have brought forth the children of Israel out of the midst of them.⁶ And Moses and Aaron did as the Lord had commanded; so did they.⁷ And Moses was eighty years old, and Aaron eighty-three, when they spoke to Pharaoh.

⁸ And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: ⁹ When Pharaoh shall say to you, Shew signs; thou shalt say to Aaron: Take thy rod, and cast it down before Pharaoh, and it shall be turned into a serpent.

¹⁰ So Moses and Aaron went in unto Pharaoh, and did as the Lord had commanded. And Aaron took the rod before Pharaoh and his servants, and it was turned into a serpent.¹¹ And Pharaoh called the wise men and the magicians; and they also by Egyptian enchantments and certain secrets, did in like manner.¹² And they every one cast down their rods, and they were turned into serpents: but Aaron's rod devoured their rods.¹³ And Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he did not hearken to them, as the Lord had commanded.

¹⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Pharaoh's heart is hardened, he will not let the people go.¹⁵ Go to him in the morning, behold he will go out to the waters: and thou shalt stand to meet him on the bank of the river: and thou shalt take in thy hand the rod that was turned into a serpent.¹⁶ And thou shalt say to him: The Lord God of the Hebrews sent me to thee, saying: Let my people go to sacrifice to me in the desert: and hitherto thou wouldst not hear.¹⁷ Thus therefore saith the Lord: In this thou shalt know that I am the Lord: behold I will strike with the rod, that is in my hand, the water of the river, and it shall be turned into blood.¹⁸ And the fishes that are in the river, shall die, and the waters shall be corrupted, and the Egyptians shall be afflicted when they drink the water of the river.¹⁹ The Lord also said to Moses: Say to Aaron, Take thy rod; and stretch forth thy hand upon the waters of Egypt, and upon their rivers, and streams and pools, and all the ponds of waters, that they may be turned into blood: and let blood be in all the land of Egypt, both in vessels of wood and of stone.²⁰ And Moses and Aaron did as the Lord had commanded: and lifting up the rod, he struck the water of the river before Pharaoh and his servants: and it was turned into blood.²¹ And the fishes that were in the river died; and the river corrupted, and the Egyptians could not drink the water of the river, and there was blood in all the land of Egypt.²² And the magicians of the Egyptians with their enchantments did in like manner; and Pharaoh's heart was hardened, neither did he hear them, as the Lord had commanded.²³ And he turned himself away, and went into his house, neither did he set his heart to it this time also.²⁴ And all the Egyptians dug round about the river for water to drink; for they could not drink of the water of the river.²⁵ And seven days were fully ended, after that the Lord struck the river.

8 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Go in to Pharaoh, and thou shalt say to him: Thus saith the Lord: Let my people go to sacrifice to

me.² But if thou wilt not let them go, behold I will strike all thy coasts with frogs.³ And the river shall bring forth an abundance of frogs; which shall come up and enter into thy house, and thy bedchamber, and upon thy bed, and into the houses of thy servants, and to thy people, and into thy ovens, and into the remains of thy meats:⁴ And the frogs shall come in to thee, and to thy people, and to all thy servants.⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: Say to Aaron: Stretch forth thy hand upon the streams, and upon the rivers and the pools, and bring forth frogs upon the land of Egypt.⁶ And Aaron stretched forth his hand upon the waters of Egypt, and the frogs came up, and covered the land of Egypt.⁷ And the magicians also, by their enchantments, did in like manner, and they brought forth frogs upon the land of Egypt.

⁸ But Pharaoh called Moses and Aaron, and said to them: Pray ye to the Lord to take away the frogs from me and from my people; and I will let the people go to sacrifice to the Lord.⁹ And Moses said to Pharaoh: Set me a time when I shall pray for thee, and for thy servants, and for thy people, that the frogs may be driven away from thee and from thy house, and from thy servants, and from thy people; and may remain only in the river.¹⁰ And he answered: To morrow. But he said: I will do according to thy word; that thou mayest know that there is none like to the Lord our God.¹¹ And the frogs shall depart from thee, and from thy house, and from thy servants, and from thy people; and shall remain only in the river.¹² And Moses and Aaron went forth from Pharaoh: and Moses cried to the Lord for the promise, which he had made to Pharaoh concerning the frogs.¹³ And the Lord did according to the word of Moses: and the frogs died out of the houses, and out of the villages, and out of the fields:¹⁴ And they gathered them together into immense heaps, and the land was corrupted.¹⁵ And Pharaoh seeing that rest was given, hardened his own heart, and did not hear them, as the Lord had commanded.

¹⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Say to Aaron: Stretch forth thy rod, and strike the dust of the earth; and may there be sciniphs in all the land of Egypt.¹⁷ And they did so. And Aaron stretched forth his hand, holding the rod; and he struck the dust of the earth, and there came sciniphs on men and on beasts: all the dust of the earth was turned into sciniphs through all the land of Egypt.¹⁸ And the magicians with their enchantments practised in like manner, to bring forth sciniphs, and they could not: and there were sciniphs as well on men as on beasts.¹⁹ And the magicians said to Pharaoh: This is the finger of God. And Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he hearkened not unto them, as the Lord had commanded.

²⁰ The Lord also said to Moses: Arise early, and stand before Pharaoh; for he will go forth to the waters: and thou shalt say to him: Thus saith the Lord: Let my people go to sacrifice to me.²¹ But if thou wilt not let them go, behold I will send in upon thee, and upon thy servants, and upon thy houses, all kind of flies: and the houses of the Egyptians shall be filled with flies of divers kinds, and the whole land wherein they shall be.²² And I will make the land of Gessen wherein my people is, wonderful in that day, so that flies shall not be there: and thou shalt know that I am the Lord in the midst of the earth.²³ And I will put a division between my people and thy people: to morrow shall this

sign be. ²⁴ And the Lord did so. And there came a very grievous swarm of flies into the houses of Pharaoh and of his servants, and into all the land of Egypt: and the land was corrupted by this kind of flies.

²⁵ And Pharaoh called Moses and Aaron, and said to them: Go and sacrifice to your God in this land. ²⁶ And Moses said: It cannot be so: for we shall sacrifice the abominations of the Egyptians to the Lord our God: now if we kill those things which the Egyptians worship, in their presence, they will stone us. ²⁷ We will go three days' journey into the wilderness; and we will sacrifice to the Lord our God, as he hath commanded us. ²⁸ And Pharaoh said: I will let you go to sacrifice to the Lord your God in the wilderness, but go no farther: pray for me. ²⁹ And Moses said: I will go out from thee, and will pray to the Lord: and the flies shall depart from Pharaoh, and from his servants, and from his people to morrow: but do not deceive any more, in not letting the people go to sacrifice to the Lord. ³⁰ So Moses went out from Pharaoh, and prayed to the Lord. ³¹ And he did according to his word: and he took away the flies from Pharaoh, and from his servants, and from his people: there was not left so much as one. ³² And Pharaoh's heart was hardened, so that neither this time would he let the people go.

56. Murrain, hail, locusts and darkness

Exodus 9:1-10:29

9 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Go in to Pharaoh, and speak to him: Thus saith the Lord God of the Hebrews: Let my people go to sacrifice to me. ² But if thou refuse, and withhold them still: ³ Behold my hand shall be upon thy fields; and a very grievous murrain upon thy horses, and asses, and camels, and oxen, and sheep. ⁴ And the Lord will make a wonderful difference between the possessions of Israel and the possessions of the Egyptians, that nothing at all shall die of those things that belong to the children of Israel. ⁵ And the Lord appointed a time, saying: To morrow will the Lord do this thing in the land. ⁶ The Lord therefore did this thing the next day: and all the beasts of the Egyptians died, but of the beasts of the children of Israel there died not one. ⁷ And Pharaoh sent to see; and there was not any thing dead of that which Israel possessed. And Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he did not let the people go.

⁸ And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: Take to you handfuls of ashes out of the chimney, and let Moses sprinkle it in the air in the presence of Pharaoh. ⁹ And be there dust upon all the land of Egypt: for there shall be boils and swelling blains both in men and beasts, in the whole land of Egypt. ¹⁰ And they took ashes out of the chimney, and stood before Pharaoh, and Moses sprinkled it in the air; and there came boils with swelling blains in men and beasts. ¹¹ Neither could the magicians stand before Moses, for the boils that were upon them, and in all the land of Egypt. ¹² And the Lord hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he hearkened not unto them, as the Lord had spoken to Moses.

¹³ And the Lord said to Moses: Arise in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh, and thou shalt say to him: Thus saith the Lord, the God of the Hebrews: Let my people go to sacrifice to me. ¹⁴ For I will at this time send all my plagues upon thy heart, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people; that thou mayst know that there is none like me in all the earth. ¹⁵ For now I will stretch out my hand to strike thee, and thy people,

with pestilence, and thou shalt perish from the earth. ¹⁶ And therefore have I raised thee, that I may shew my power in thee, and my name may be spoken of throughout all the earth. ¹⁷ Dost thou yet hold back my people; and wilt thou not let them go? ¹⁸ Behold I will cause it to rain to morrow at this same hour, an exceeding great hail; such as hath not been in Egypt from the day that it was founded, until this present time. ¹⁹ Send therefore now presently, and gather together thy cattle, and all that thou hast in the field; for men and beasts, and all things that shall be found abroad, and not gathered together out of the fields which the hail shall fall upon, shall die. ²⁰ He that feared the word of the Lord among Pharaoh's servants, made his servants and his cattle flee into houses: ²¹ But he that regarded not the word of the Lord, left his servants, and his cattle in the fields.

²² And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch forth thy hand towards heaven, that there may be hail in the whole land of Egypt upon men, and upon beasts, and upon every herb of the field in the land of Egypt. ²³ And Moses stretched forth his rod towards heaven, and the Lord sent thunder and hail, and lightnings running along the ground: and the Lord rained hail upon the land of Egypt. ²⁴ And the hail and fire mixt with it drove on together: and it was of so great bigness, as never before was seen in the whole land of Egypt since that nation was founded. ²⁵ And the hail destroyed through all the land of Egypt all things that were in the fields, both man and beast: and the hail smote every herb of the field, and it broke every tree of the country. ²⁶ Only in the land of Gessen, where the children of Israel were, the hail fell not.

²⁷ And Pharaoh sent and called Moses and Aaron, saying to them: I have sinned this time also, the Lord is just: I and my people, are wicked. ²⁸ Pray ye to the Lord that the thunderings of God and the hail may cease: that I may let you go, and that ye may stay here no longer. ²⁹ Moses said: As soon as I am gone out of the city, I will stretch forth my hands to the Lord, and the thunders shall cease, and the hail shall be no more: that thou mayst know that the earth is the Lord's: ³⁰ But I know that neither thou, nor thy servants do yet fear the Lord God. ³¹ The flax therefore, and the barley were hurt, because the barley was green, and the flax was now balled; ³² But the wheat, and other winter corn were not hurt, because they were lateward. ³³ And when Moses was gone from Pharaoh out of the city, he stretched forth his hands to the Lord: and the thunders and the hail ceased, neither did there drop any more rain upon the earth. ³⁴ And Pharaoh seeing that the rain, and the hail, and the thunders were ceased, increased his sin: ³⁵ And his heart was hardened, and the heart of his servants, and it was made exceeding hard: neither did he let the children of Israel go, as the Lord had commanded by the hand of Moses.

10 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Go in to Pharaoh; for I have hardened his heart, and the heart of his servants: that I may work these my signs in him, ² And thou mayst tell in the ears of thy sons, and of thy grandsons, how often I have plagued the Egyptians, and wrought my signs amongst them: and you may know that I am the Lord. ³ Therefore Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh, and said to him: Thus saith the Lord God of the Hebrews: How long refusest thou to submit to me? let my people go, to sacrifice to me. ⁴ But if thou resist, and wilt not let

them go, behold I will bring in to-morrow the locusts into thy coasts; ⁵ To cover the face of the earth, that nothing thereof may appear, but that which the hail hath left may be eaten: for they shall feed upon all the trees that spring in the fields. ⁶ And they shall fill thy houses, and the houses of thy servants, and of all the Egyptians: such a number as thy fathers have not seen, nor thy grandfathers, from the time they were first upon the earth, until this present day. And he turned himself away, and went forth from Pharaoh. ⁷ And Pharaoh's servants said to him: How long shall we endure this scandal? Let the men go to sacrifice to the Lord their God. Dost thou not see that Egypt is undone? ⁸ And they called back Moses, and Aaron, to Pharaoh; and he said to them: Go, sacrifice to the Lord your God: who are they that shall go? ⁹ Moses said: We will go with our young and old, with our sons and daughters, with our sheep and herds: for it is the solemnity of the Lord our God. ¹⁰ And Pharaoh answered: So be the Lord with you, as I shall let you and your children go: who can doubt but that you intend some great evil? ¹¹ It shall not be so, but go ye men only, and sacrifice to the Lord: for this yourselves also desired. And immediately they were cast out from Pharaoh's presence.

¹² And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch forth thy hand upon the land of Egypt unto the locust, that it come upon it, and devour every herb that is left after the hail. ¹³ And Moses stretched forth his rod upon the land of Egypt: and the Lord brought a burning wind all that day, and night; and when it was morning, the burning wind raised the locusts. ¹⁴ And they came up over the whole land of Egypt; and rested in all the coasts of the Egyptians, innumerable, the like as had not been before that time, nor shall be hereafter. ¹⁵ And they covered the whole face of the earth, wasting all things. And the grass of the earth was devoured, and what fruits soever were on the trees, which the hail had left; and there remained not any thing that was green on the trees, or in the herbs of the earth, in all Egypt. ¹⁶ Wherefore Pharaoh in haste called Moses and Aaron, and said to them: I have sinned against the Lord your God, and against you. ¹⁷ But now forgive me my sin this time also, and pray to the Lord your God, that he take away from me this death. ¹⁸ And Moses going forth from the presence of Pharaoh, prayed to the Lord: ¹⁹ And he made a very strong wind to blow from the west, and it took the locusts and cast them into the Red Sea: there remained not so much as one in all the coasts of Egypt. ²⁰ And the Lord hardened Pharaoh's heart, neither did he let the children of Israel go.

²¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out thy hand towards heaven: and may there be darkness upon the land of Egypt so thick that it may be felt. ²² And Moses stretched forth his hand towards heaven: and there came horrible darkness in all the land of Egypt for three days. ²³ No man saw his brother, nor moved himself out of the place where he was: but wheresoever the children of Israel dwelt, there was light.

²⁴ And Pharaoh called Moses and Aaron, and said to them: Go, sacrifice to the Lord: let your sheep only, and herds remain, let your children go with you. ²⁵ Moses said: Thou shalt give us also sacrifices and burnt-offerings, to the Lord our God. ²⁶ All the flocks shall go with us; there shall not a hoof remain of them: for they are necessary for the service of the Lord our God: especially

as we know not what must be offered, till we come to the very place.

²⁷ And the Lord hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let them go. ²⁸ And Pharaoh said to Moses: Get thee from me, and beware thou see not my face any more: in what day soever thou shalt come in my sight, thou shalt die. ²⁹ Moses answered: So shall it be as thou hast spoken, I will not see thy face anymore.

57. The last plague foretold

Exodus 11:1-10

11 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses: Yet one plague more will I bring upon Pharaoh and Egypt, and after that he shall let you go, and thrust you out. ² Therefore thou shalt tell all the people, that every man ask of his friend, and every woman of her neighbour, vessels of silver and of gold. ³ And the Lord will give favour to his people in the sight of the Egyptians. And Moses was a very great man in the land of Egypt, in the sight of Pharaoh's servants, and of all the people.

⁴ And he said: Thus saith the Lord: At midnight I will enter into Egypt: ⁵ And every firstborn in the land of the Egyptians shall die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sitteth on his throne, even to the firstborn of the handmaid that is at the mill, and all the firstborn of beasts. ⁶ And there shall be a great cry in all the land of Egypt, such as neither hath been before, nor shall be hereafter. ⁷ But with all the children of Israel there shall not a dog make the least noise, from man even to beast; that you may know how wonderful a difference the Lord maketh between the Egyptians and Israel. ⁸ And all these thy servants shall come down to me, and shall worship me, saying: Go forth thou, and all the people that is under thee: after that we will go out. ⁹ And he went out from Pharaoh exceeding angry. But the Lord said to Moses: Pharaoh will not hear you, that many signs may be done in the land of Egypt. ¹⁰ And Moses and Aaron did all the wonders that are written, before Pharaoh. And the Lord hardened Pharaoh's heart, neither did he let the children of Israel go out of his land.

58. The passover, and the going out

Exodus 12:1-42

12 ¹ And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt: ² This month shall be to you the beginning of months; it shall be the first in the months of the year. ³ Speak ye to the whole assembly of the children of Israel, and say to them: On the tenth day of this month let every man take a lamb by their families and houses. ⁴ But if the number be less than may suffice to eat the lamb, he shall take unto him his neighbour that joineth to his house, according to the number of souls which may be enough to eat the lamb. ⁵ And it shall be a lamb without blemish, a male, of one year; according to which rite also you shall take a kid. ⁶ And you shall keep it until the fourteenth day of this month; and the whole multitude of the children of Israel shall sacrifice it in the evening. ⁷ And they shall take of the blood thereof, and put it upon both the side posts, and on the upper door posts of the houses, wherein they shall eat it. ⁸ And they shall eat the flesh that night roasted at the fire, and unleavened bread with wild lettuce. ⁹ You shall not eat thereof any thing raw, nor boiled in water, but only roasted at the fire; you shall eat the head with

the feet and entrails thereof. ¹⁰ Neither shall there remain any thing of it until morning. If there be any thing left, you shall burn it with fire. ¹¹ And thus you shall eat it: you shall gird your reins, and you shall have shoes on your feet, holding staves in your hands, and you shall eat in haste; for it is the Phase (that is the Passage) of the Lord. ¹² And I will pass through the land of Egypt that night, and will kill every firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast: and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgments; I am the Lord. ¹³ And the blood shall be unto you for a sign in the houses where you shall be; and I shall see the blood, and shall pass over you; and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I shall strike the land of Egypt. ¹⁴ And this day shall be for a memorial to you; and you shall keep it a feast to the Lord in your generations, with an everlasting observance. ¹⁵ Seven days shall you eat unleavened bread: in the first day there shall be no leaven in your houses; whosoever shall eat any thing leavened, from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall perish out of Israel. ¹⁶ The first day shall be holy and solemn, and the seventh day shall be kept with the like solemnity: you shall do no work in them, except those things that belong to eating. ¹⁷ And you shall observe the feast of the unleavened bread: for in this same day I will bring forth your army out of the land of Egypt, and you shall keep this day in your generations by a perpetual observance. ¹⁸ The first month, the fourteenth day of the month, in the evening, you shall eat unleavened bread, until the one and twentieth day of the same month, in the evening. ¹⁹ Seven days there shall not be found any leaven in your houses: he that shall eat leavened bread, his soul shall perish out of the assembly of Israel, whether he be a stranger or born in the land. ²⁰ You shall not eat any thing leavened: in all your habitations you shall eat unleavened bread.

²¹ And Moses called all the ancients of the children of Israel, and said to them: Go take a lamb by your families, and sacrifice the Phase. ²² And dip a bunch of hyssop in the blood that is at the door, and sprinkle the transom of the door therewith, and both the door cheeks: let none of you go out of the door of his house till morning. ²³ For the Lord will pass through striking the Egyptians: and when he shall see the blood on the transom, and on both the posts, he will pass over the door of the house, and not suffer the destroyer to come into your houses and to hurt you. ²⁴ Thou shalt keep this thing as a law for thee and thy children for ever. ²⁵ And when you have entered into the land which the Lord will give you, as he hath promised, you shall observe these ceremonies. ²⁶ And when your children shall say to you: What is the meaning of this service? ²⁷ You shall say to them: It is the victim of the passage of the Lord, when he passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, striking the Egyptians, and saving our houses. And the people bowing themselves, adored. ²⁸ And the children of Israel going forth, did as the Lord had commanded Moses and Aaron.

²⁹ And it came to pass at midnight, the Lord slew every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat on his throne, unto the firstborn of the captive woman that was in the prison, and all the firstborn of cattle. ³⁰ And Pharaoh arose in the night, and all his servants, and all Egypt: and there arose a great cry in Egypt; for there was not a house wherein there

lay not one dead. ³¹ And Pharaoh calling Moses and Aaron, in the night, said: Arise and go forth from among my people, you and the children of Israel: go, sacrifice to the Lord as you say. ³² Your sheep and herds take along with you, as you demanded, and departing bless me. ³³ And the Egyptians pressed the people to go forth out of the land speedily, saying: We shall all die. ³⁴ The people therefore took dough before it was leavened; and tying it in their cloaks, put it on their shoulders. ³⁵ And the children of Israel did as Moses had commanded: and they asked of the Egyptians vessels of silver and gold, and very much raiment. ³⁶ And the Lord gave favour to the people in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they lent unto them: and they stripped the Egyptians.

³⁷ And the children of Israel set forward from Ramesse to Socoth, being about six hundred thousand men on foot, beside children. ³⁸ And a mixed multitude, without number, went up also with them, sheep and herds, and beasts of divers kinds, exceeding many. ³⁹ And they baked the meal, which a little before they had brought out of Egypt in dough: and they made hearth cakes unleavened: for it could not be leavened, the Egyptians pressing them to depart, and not suffering them to make any stay; neither did they think of preparing any meat. ⁴⁰ And the abode of the children of Israel that they made in Egypt, was four hundred and thirty years. ⁴¹ Which being expired, the same day all the army of the Lord went forth out of the land of Egypt. ⁴² This is the observable night of the Lord, when he brought them forth out of the land of Egypt: this night all the children of Israel must observe in their generations.

59. The law of the passover and of the firstborn

Exodus 12:43-13:16

12 ⁴³ And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: This is the service of the Phase; no foreigner shall eat of it. ⁴⁴ But every bought servant shall be circumcised, and so shall eat. ⁴⁵ The stranger and the hireling shall not eat thereof. ⁴⁶ In one house shall it be eaten, neither shall you carry forth of the flesh thereof out of the house, neither shall you break a bone thereof. ⁴⁷ All the assembly of the children of Israel shall keep it. ⁴⁸ And if any stranger be willing to dwell among you, and to keep the Phase of the Lord, all his males shall first be circumcised, and then shall he celebrate it according to the manner: and he shall be as he that is born in the land: but if any man be uncircumcised, he shall not eat thereof. ⁴⁹ The same law shall be to him that is born in the land, and to the proselyte that sojourneth with you. ⁵⁰ And all the children of Israel did as the Lord had commanded Moses and Aaron. ⁵¹ And the same day the Lord brought forth the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their companies.

13 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ² Sanctify unto me every firstborn that openeth the womb among the children of Israel, as well of men as of beasts: for they are all mine.

³ And Moses said to the people: Remember this day in which you came forth out of Egypt, and out of the house of bondage, for with a strong hand hath the Lord brought you forth out of this place: that you eat no leavened bread. ⁴ This day you go forth in the month of new corn. ⁵ And when the Lord shall have brought thee into the land of the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Amorrite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite, which he swore to

thy fathers that he would give thee, a land that floweth with milk and honey, thou shalt celebrate this manner of sacred rites in this month. ⁶ Seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread: and on the seventh day shall be the solemnity of the Lord. ⁷ Unleavened bread shall you eat seven days: there shall not be seen any thing leavened with thee, nor in all thy coasts. ⁸ And thou shalt tell thy son in that day, saying: This is what the Lord did to me when I came forth out of Egypt. ⁹ And it shall be as a sign in thy hand, and as a memorial before thy eyes; and that the law of the Lord be always in thy mouth, for with a strong hand the Lord hath brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁰ Thou shalt keep this observance at the set time from days to days.

¹¹ And when the Lord shall have brought thee into the land of the Chanaanite, as he swore to thee and thy fathers, and shall give it thee: ¹² Thou shalt set apart all that openeth the womb for the Lord, and all that is first brought forth of thy cattle: whatsoever thou shalt have of the male sex, thou shalt consecrate to the Lord. ¹³ The firstborn of an ass thou shalt change for a sheep: and if thou do not redeem it, thou shalt kill it. And every firstborn of men thou shalt redeem with a price. ¹⁴ And when thy son shall ask thee to morrow, saying: What is this? thou shalt answer him: With a strong hand did the Lord bring us forth out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ¹⁵ For when Pharaoh was hardened, and would not let us go, the Lord slew every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of man to the firstborn of beasts: therefore I sacrifice to the Lord all that openeth the womb of the male sex, and all the firstborn of my sons I redeem. ¹⁶ And it shall be as a sign in thy hand, and as a thing hung between thy eyes, for a remembrance: because the Lord hath brought us forth out of Egypt by a strong hand.

60. The pillar of cloud; Israel at the sea

Exodus 13:17-14:14

13 ¹⁷ And when Pharaoh had sent out the people, the Lord led them not by the way of the land of the Philistines, which is near; thinking lest perhaps they would repent, if they should see wars arise against them, and would return into Egypt. ¹⁸ But he led them about by the way of the desert, which is by the Red Sea: and the children of Israel went up armed out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁹ And Moses took Joseph's bones with him: because he had adjured the children of Israel, saying: God shall visit you, carry out my bones from hence with you. ²⁰ And marching from Socoth, they encamped in Etham, in the utmost coasts of the wilderness. ²¹ And the Lord went before them to shew the way, by day in a pillar of a cloud, and by night in a pillar of fire; that he might be the guide of their journey at both times. ²² There never failed the pillar of the cloud by day, nor the pillar of fire by night, before the people.

14 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ² Speak to the children of Israel: Let them turn and encamp over against Pihahiroth, which is between Magdal and the sea over against Beelsephon: you shall encamp before it upon the sea. ³ And Pharaoh will say of the children of Israel: They are straitened in the land, the desert hath shut them in. ⁴ And I shall harden his heart and he will pursue you: and I shall be glorified in Pharaoh, and in all his army: and the Egyptians shall know that I am the Lord. And they did so.

⁵ And it was told the king of the Egyptians that the people was fled: and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was changed with regard to the people, and they said: What meant we to do, that we let Israel go from serving us? ⁶ So he made ready his chariot, and took all his people with him. ⁷ And he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots that were in Egypt: and the captains of the whole army. ⁸ And the Lord hardened the heart of Pharaoh, king of Egypt, and he pursued the children of Israel; but they were gone forth in a mighty hand. ⁹ And when the Egyptians followed the steps of them who were gone before, they found them encamped at the sea side: all Pharaoh's horse and chariots and the whole army were in Pihahiroth, before Beelsephon.

¹⁰ And when Pharaoh drew near, the children of Israel lifting up their eyes, saw the Egyptians behind them: and they feared exceedingly, and cried to the Lord. ¹¹ And they said to Moses: Perhaps there were no graves in Egypt, therefore thou hast brought us to die in the wilderness: why wouldst thou do this, to lead us out of Egypt? ¹² Is not this the word that we spoke to thee in Egypt, saying: Depart from us, that we may serve the Egyptians? for it was much better to serve them, than to die in the wilderness.

¹³ And Moses said to the people: Fear not: stand, and see the great wonders of the Lord, which he will do this day; for the Egyptians, whom you see now, you shall see no more for ever.

¹⁴ The Lord will fight for you, and you shall hold your peace.

61. The crossing of the sea

Exodus 14:15-15:1

The third lesson of the Easter Vigil, whose range this reading reproduces exactly, ending as the Vigil does at the opening of the canticle.

14 ¹⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: Why criest thou to me? Speak to the children of Israel to go forward. ¹⁶ But lift thou up thy rod, and stretch forth thy hand over the sea, and divide it: that the children of Israel may go through the midst of the sea on dry ground. ¹⁷ And I will harden the heart of the Egyptians to pursue you: and I will be glorified in Pharaoh, and in all his host, and in his chariots and in his horsemen. ¹⁸ And the Egyptians shall know that I am the Lord, when I shall be glorified in Pharaoh, and in his chariots, and in his horsemen. ¹⁹ And the angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, removing, went behind them: and together with him the pillar of the cloud, leaving the forepart, ²⁰ Stood behind, between the Egyptians' camp and the camp of Israel: and it was a dark cloud, and enlightening the night, so that they could not come at one another all the night.

²¹ And when Moses had stretched forth his hand over the sea, the Lord took it away by a strong and burning wind blowing all the night, and turned it into dry ground: and the water was divided. ²² And the children of Israel went in through the midst of the sea dried up; for the water was as a wall on their right hand and on their left. ²³ And the Egyptians pursuing went in after them, and all Pharaoh's horses, his chariots and horsemen, through the midst of the sea. ²⁴ And now the morning watch was come, and behold the Lord looking upon the Egyptian army through the pillar of fire and of the cloud, slew their host. ²⁵ And overthrew the wheels of the chariots, and they were carried into

the deep. And the Egyptians said: Let us flee from Israel; for the Lord fighteth for them against us.

²⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch forth thy hand over the sea, that the waters may come again upon the Egyptians, upon their chariots and horsemen. ²⁷ And when Moses had stretched forth his hand towards the sea, it returned at the first break of day to the former place: and as the Egyptians were fleeing away, the waters came upon them, and the Lord shut them up in the middle of the waves. ²⁸ And the waters returned, and covered the chariots and the horsemen of all the army of Pharaoh, who had come into the sea after them, neither did there so much as one of them remain. ²⁹ But the children of Israel marched through the midst of the sea upon dry land, and the waters were to them as a wall on the right hand and on the left: ³⁰ And the Lord delivered Israel in that day out of the hands of the Egyptians. ³¹ And they saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore, and the mighty hand that the Lord had used against them: and the people feared the Lord, and they believed the Lord, and Moses his servant.

15 ¹ Then Moses and the children of Israel sung this canticle to the Lord, and said: Let us sing to the Lord: for he is gloriously magnified, the horse and the rider he hath thrown into the sea.

62. The canticle of Moses, and the bitter waters

Exodus 15:2-27

15 ² The Lord is my strength and my praise, and he is become salvation to me: he is my God, and I will glorify him: the God of my father, and I will exalt him. ³ The Lord is as a man of war, Almighty is his name. ⁴ Pharaoh's chariots and his army he hath cast into the sea: his chosen captains are drowned in the Red Sea. ⁵ The depths have covered them, they are sunk to the bottom like a stone. ⁶ Thy right hand, O Lord, is magnified in strength: thy right hand, O Lord, hath slain the enemy. ⁷ And in the multitude of thy glory thou hast put down thy adversaries: thou hast sent thy wrath, which hath devoured them like stubble. ⁸ And with the blast of thy anger the waters were gathered together: the flowing water stood, the depths were gathered together in the midst of the sea. ⁹ The enemy said: I will pursue and overtake, I will divide the spoils, my soul shall have its fill: I will draw my sword, my hand shall slay them. ¹⁰ Thy wind blew and the sea covered them: they sunk as lead in the mighty waters. ¹¹ Who is like to thee, among the strong, O Lord? who is like to thee, glorious in holiness, terrible and praise-worthy, doing wonders? ¹² Thou stretchedst forth thy hand, and the earth swallowed them. ¹³ In thy mercy thou hast been a leader to the people which thou hast redeemed: and in thy strength thou hast carried them to thy holy habitation. ¹⁴ Nations rose up, and were angry: sorrows took hold on the inhabitants of Philisthiim. ¹⁵ Then were the princes of Edom troubled, trembling seized on the stout men of Moab: all the inhabitants of Chanaan became stiff. ¹⁶ Let fear and dread fall upon them, in the greatness of thy arm: let them become immovable as a stone, until thy people, O Lord, pass by: until this thy people pass by, which thou hast possessed. ¹⁷ Thou shalt bring them in, and plant them in the mountain of thy inheritance, in thy most firm habitation, which thou hast made, O Lord; thy sanctuary, O Lord, which thy hands have established. ¹⁸ The Lord shall reign for ever and ever. ¹⁹ For Pharaoh went in on horseback with his chariots and horsemen

into the sea: and the Lord brought back upon them the waters of the sea: but the children of Israel walked on dry ground in the midst thereof. ²⁰ So Mary the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a timbrel in her hand: and all the women went forth after her with timbrels and with dances. ²¹ And she began the song to them, saying: Let us sing to the Lord, for he is gloriously magnified, the horse and his rider he hath thrown into the sea.

²² And Moses brought Israel from the Red Sea, and they went forth into the wilderness of Sur: and they marched three days through the wilderness, and found no water. ²³ And they came into Mara, and they could not drink the waters of Mara because they were bitter: whereupon he gave a name also agreeable to the place, calling it Mara, that is, bitterness. ²⁴ And the people murmured against Moses, saying: What shall we drink? ²⁵ But he cried to the Lord, and he shewed him a tree, which when he had cast into the waters, they were turned into sweetness. There he appointed him ordinances, and judgments, and there he proved him, ²⁶ Saying: If thou wilt hear the voice of the Lord thy God, and do what is right before him, and obey his commandments, and keep all his precepts, none of the evils that I laid upon Egypt, will I bring upon thee: for I am the Lord thy healer.

²⁷ And the children of Israel came into Elim, where there were twelve fountains of water, and seventy palm trees: and they encamped by the waters.

63. The manna and the quails

Exodus 16:1-36

16 ¹ And they set forward from Elim, and all the multitude of the children of Israel came into the desert of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai: the fifteenth day of the second month, after they came out of the land of Egypt. ² And all the congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron in the wilderness. ³ And the children of Israel said to them: Would to God we had died by the hand of the Lord in the land of Egypt, when we sat over the fleshpots, and ate bread to the full: Why have you brought us into this desert, that you might destroy all the multitude with famine?

⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Behold I will rain bread from heaven for you; let the people go forth, and gather what is sufficient for every day: that I may prove them whether they will walk in my law, or not. ⁵ But the sixth day let them provide for to bring in: and let it be double to that they were wont to gather every day. ⁶ And Moses and Aaron said to the children of Israel In the evening you shall know that the Lord hath brought you forth out of the land of Egypt: ⁷ And in the morning you shall see the glory of the Lord: for he hath heard your murmuring against the Lord: but as for us, what are we, that you mutter against us? ⁸ And Moses said: In the evening the Lord will give you flesh to eat, and in the morning bread to the full: for he hath heard your murmurings, with which you have murmured against him, for what are we? your murmuring is not against us, but against the Lord. ⁹ Moses also said to Aaron: Say to the whole congregation of the children of Israel: Come before the Lord; for he hath heard your murmuring. ¹⁰ And when Aaron spoke to all the assembly of the children of Israel, they looked towards the wilderness; and behold the glory of the Lord appeared in a cloud. ¹¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ¹² I have heard the murmuring of the children of Israel, say to them: In the evening you shall eat

flesh, and in the morning you shall have your fill of bread; and you shall know that I am the Lord your God.

¹³ So it came to pass in the evening, that quails coming up, covered the camp: and in the morning a dew lay round about the camp. ¹⁴ And when it had covered the face of the earth, it appeared in the wilderness small, and as it were beaten with a pestle, like unto the hoar frost on the ground. ¹⁵ And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another: Manhu! which signifieth: What is this! for they knew not what it was. And Moses said to them: This is the bread which the Lord hath given you to eat. ¹⁶ This is the word that the Lord hath commanded: Let every one gather of it as much as is enough to eat; a gomor for every man, according to the number of your souls that dwell in a tent, so shall you take of it. ¹⁷ And the children of Israel did so: and they gathered, one more, another less. ¹⁸ And they measured by the measure of a gomor: neither had he more that had gathered more; nor did he find less that had provided less: but every one had gathered, according to what they were able to eat. ¹⁹ And Moses said to them: Let no man leave thereof till the morning. ²⁰ And they hearkened not to him, but some of them left until the morning, and it began to be full of worms, and it putrified, and Moses was angry with them. ²¹ Now every one of them gathered in the morning, as much as might suffice to eat: and after the sun grew hot, it melted. ²² But on the sixth day they gathered twice as much, that is, two gomors every man: and all the rulers of the multitude came, and told Moses. ²³ And he said to them: This is what the Lord hath spoken: To morrow is the rest of the sabbath sanctified to the Lord. Whatsoever work is to be done, do it; and the meats that are to be dressed, dress them; and whatsoever shall remain, lay it up until the morning. ²⁴ And they did so as Moses had commanded, and it did not putrify, neither was there worm found in it. ²⁵ And Moses said: Eat it to day, because it is the sabbath of the Lord: to day it shall not be found in the field. ²⁶ Gather it six days; but on the seventh day is the sabbath of the Lord, therefore it shall not be found. ²⁷ And the seventh day came; and some of the people going forth to gather, found none. ²⁸ And the Lord said to Moses: How long will you refuse to keep my commandments, and my law? ²⁹ See that the Lord hath given you the sabbath, and for this reason on the sixth day he giveth you a double provision: let each man stay at home, and let none go forth out of his place the seventh day. ³⁰ And the people kept the sabbath on the seventh day. ³¹ And the house of Israel called the name thereof Manna: and it was like coriander seed, white, and the taste thereof like to flour with honey. ³² And Moses said: This is the word which the Lord hath commanded: Fill a gomor of it, and let it be kept unto generations to come hereafter; that they may know the bread, wherewith I fed you in the wilderness when you were brought forth out of the land of Egypt. ³³ And Moses said to Aaron: Take a vessel, and put manna into it, as much as a gomor can hold; and lay it up before the Lord, to keep unto your generations. ³⁴ As the Lord commanded Moses. And Aaron put it in the tabernacle to be kept. ³⁵ And the children of Israel ate manna forty years, till they came to a habitable land: with this meat were they fed, until they reached the borders of the land of Chanaan. ³⁶ Now a gomor is the tenth part of an ephi.

64. *Water from the rock; Amalec*

Exodus 17:1-16

17 ¹ Then all the multitude of the children of Israel setting forward from the desert of Sin, by their mansions, according to the word of the Lord, encamped in Raphidim, where there was no water for the people to drink. ² And they chode with Moses, and said: Give us water, that we may drink. And Moses answered them: Why chide you with me? Wherefore do you tempt the Lord? ³ So the people were thirsty there for want of water, and murmured against Moses, saying: Why didst thou make us go forth out of Egypt, to kill us and our children, and our beasts with thirst? ⁴ And Moses cried to the Lord, saying: What shall I do to this people? Yet a little more and they will stone me. ⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: Go before the people, and take with thee of the ancients of Israel: and take in thy hand the rod wherewith thou didst strike the river, and go. ⁶ Behold I will stand there before thee, upon the rock Horeb, and thou shalt strike the rock, and water shall come out of it that the people may drink. Moses did so before the ancients of Israel: ⁷ And he called the name of that place Temptation, because of the chiding of the children of Israel, and for that they tempted the Lord, saying: Is the Lord amongst us or not?

⁸ And Amalec came, and fought against Israel in Raphidim. ⁹ And Moses said to Josue: Choose out men; and go out and fight against Amalec: tomorrow I will stand on the top of the hill, having the rod of God in my hand. ¹⁰ Josue did as Moses had spoken, and he fought against Amalec; but Moses, and Aaron, and Hur, went up upon the top of the hill. ¹¹ And when Moses lifted up his hands, Israel overcame; but if he let them down a little, Amalec overcame. ¹² And Moses's hands were heavy: so they took a stone, and put under him, and he sat on it: and Aaron and Hur stayed up his hands on both sides. And it came to pass, that his hands were not weary until sunset. ¹³ And Josue put Amalec and his people to flight, by the edge of the sword. ¹⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Write this for a memorial in a book, and deliver it to the ears of Josue; for I will destroy the memory of Amalec from under heaven. ¹⁵ And Moses built an altar; and called the name thereof, The Lord, my exaltation, saying: ¹⁶ Because the hand of the throne of the Lord, and the war of the Lord shall be against Amalec, from generation to generation.

65. *The counsel of Jethro*

Exodus 18:1-27

18 ¹ And when Jethro the priest of Madian, the kinsman of Moses, had heard all the things that God had done to Moses, and to Israel his people, and that the Lord had brought forth Israel out of Egypt: ² He took Sephora, the wife of Moses, whom he had sent back: ³ And her two sons, of whom one was called Gersam: his father saying, I have been a stranger in a foreign country. ⁴ And the other Eliezer: For the God of my father, said he, is my helper, and hath delivered me from the sword of Pharaoh. ⁵ And Jethro, the kinsman of Moses, came with his sons, and his wife to Moses into the desert, where he was camped by the mountain of God. ⁶ And he sent word to Moses, saying: I Jethro, thy kinsman, come to thee, and thy wife, and thy two sons with her.

⁷ And he went out to meet his kinsman, and worshipped and kissed him: and they saluted one another with words of peace. And when he was come into the tent, ⁸ Moses told his kinsman all that the Lord had done to Pharaoh, and the Egyptians in favour of Israel: and all the labour which had befallen them in the journey, and that the Lord had delivered them. ⁹ And Jethro rejoiced for all the good things that the Lord had done to Israel, because he had delivered them out of the hands of the Egyptians. ¹⁰ And he said: Blessed is the Lord, who hath delivered you out of the hand of Pharaoh, and out of the hand of Egypt. ¹¹ Now I know, that the Lord is great above all gods; because he hath delivered his people out of the hand of the Egyptians, who dealt proudly against them. ¹² So Jethro, the kinsman of Moses, offered holocausts and sacrifices to God: and Aaron and all the ancients of Israel came, to eat bread with him before God.

¹³ And the next day Moses sat to judge the people, who stood by Moses from morning until night. ¹⁴ And when his kinsman had seen all things that he did among the people, he said: What is it that thou dost among the people? Why sittest thou alone, and all the people wait from morning till night? ¹⁵ And Moses answered him: The people come to me to seek the judgment of God? ¹⁶ And when any controversy falleth out among them, they come to me to judge between them, and to shew the precepts of God, and his laws. ¹⁷ But he said: The thing thou dost is not good. ¹⁸ Thou art spent with foolish labour, both thou, and this people that is with thee; the business is above thy strength, thou alone canst not bear it. ¹⁹ But hear my words and counsels, and God shall be with thee. Be thou to the people in those things that pertain to God, to bring their words to him: ²⁰ And to shew the people the ceremonies, and the manner of worshipping; and the way wherein they ought to walk, and the work that they ought to do. ²¹ And provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, in whom there is truth, and that hate avarice, and appoint of them rulers of thousands, and of hundreds, and of fifties, and of tens, ²² Who may judge the people at all times: and when any great matter soever shall fall out, let them refer it to thee, and let them judge the lesser matters only: that so it may be lighter for thee, the burden being shared out unto others. ²³ If thou dost this, thou shalt fulfil the commandment of God, and shalt be able to bear his precepts: and all this people shall return to their places with peace. ²⁴ And when Moses heard this, he did all things that he had suggested unto him. ²⁵ And choosing able men out of all Israel, he appointed them rulers of the people, rulers over thousands, and over hundreds, and over fifties, and over tens. ²⁶ And they judged the people at all times: and whatsoever was of greater difficulty they referred to him, and they judged the easier cases only. ²⁷ And he let his kinsman depart: and he returned and went into his own country.

66. Israel at the mountain

Exodus 19:1-25

19 ¹ In the third month of the departure of Israel out of the land of Egypt, on this day they came into the wilderness of Sinai: ² For departing out of Raphidim, and coming to the desert of Sinai, they camped in the same place, and there Israel pitched their tents over against the mountain. ³ And Moses went up to God; and the Lord called unto him from the mountain, and said: Thus shalt thou say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of

Israel: ⁴ You have seen what I have done to the Egyptians, how I have carried you upon the wings of eagles, and have taken you to myself. ⁵ If therefore you will hear my voice, and keep my covenant, you shall be my peculiar possession above all people: for all the earth is mine. ⁶ And you shall be to me a priestly kingdom, and a holy nation. These are the words thou shalt speak to the children of Israel.

⁷ Moses came; and calling together the elders of the people, he declared all the words which the Lord had commanded. ⁸ And all the people answered together: All that the Lord hath spoken, we will do. And when Moses had related the people's words to the Lord,

⁹ The Lord said to him: Lo, now will I come to thee in the darkness of a cloud, that the people may hear me speaking to thee, and may believe thee for ever. And Moses told the words of the people to the Lord. ¹⁰ And he said to him: Go to the people, and sanctify them to day, and to morrow, and let them wash their garments. ¹¹ And let them be ready against the third day; for on the third day the Lord will come down in the sight of all the people, upon Mount Sinai. ¹² And thou shalt appoint certain limits to the people round about, and thou shalt say to them: Take heed ye go not up into the mount, and that ye touch not the borders thereof: every one that toucheth the mount, dying he shall die. ¹³ No hands shall touch him, but he shall be stoned to death, or he shall be shot through with arrows: whether it be beast, or man, he shall not live. When the trumpet shall begin to sound, then let them go up into the mount.

¹⁴ And Moses came down from the mount to the people, and sanctified them. And when they had washed their garments, ¹⁵ He said to them: Be ready against the third day, and come not near your wives.

¹⁶ And now the third day was come, and the morning appeared: and behold thunders began to be heard, and lightning to flash, and a very thick cloud to cover the mount, and the noise of the trumpet sounded exceeding loud; and the people that was in the camp, feared. ¹⁷ And when Moses had brought them forth to meet God, from the place of the camp, they stood at the bottom of the mount. ¹⁸ And all Mount Sinai was on a smoke: because the Lord was come down upon it in fire, and the smoke arose from it as out of a furnace: and all the mount was terrible. ¹⁹ And the sound of the trumpet grew by degrees louder and louder, and was drawn out to a greater length: Moses spoke, and God answered him. ²⁰ And the Lord came down upon Mount Sinai, in the very top of the mount, and he called Moses unto the top thereof. And when he was gone up thither, ²¹ He said unto him: Go down, and charge the people; lest they should have a mind to pass the limits to see the Lord, and a very great multitude of them should perish. ²² The priests also that come to the Lord, let them be sanctified, lest he strike them. ²³ And Moses said to the Lord: The people cannot come up to Mount Sinai: for thou didst charge, and command, saying: Set limits about the mount, and sanctify it. ²⁴ And the Lord said to him: Go, get thee down; and thou shalt come up, thou and Aaron with thee: but let not the priests and the people pass the limits, nor come up to the Lord, lest he kill them. ²⁵ And Moses went down to the people and told them all.

67. The Decalogue*Exodus 20:1-21*

Kept at the highest tier although it is law and not narrative: the covenant it states is the standard against which every later collapse in this plan is measured.

20 ¹ And the Lord spoke all these words: ² I am the Lord thy God, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ³ Thou shalt not have strange gods before me. ⁴ Thou shalt not make to thyself a graven thing, nor the likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or in the earth beneath, nor of those things that are in the waters under the earth. ⁵ Thou shalt not adore them, nor serve them: I am the Lord thy God, mighty, jealous, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children, unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me: ⁶ And shewing mercy unto thousands to them that love me, and keep my commandments. ⁷ Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain: for the Lord will not hold him guiltless that shall take the name of the Lord his God in vain. ⁸ Remember that thou keep holy the sabbath day. ⁹ Six days shalt thou labour, and shalt do all thy works. ¹⁰ But on the seventh day is the sabbath of the Lord thy God: thou shalt do no work on it, thou nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy beast, nor the stranger that is within thy gates. ¹¹ For in six days the Lord made heaven and earth, and the sea, and all things that are in them, and rested on the seventh day: therefore the Lord blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it.

¹² Honour thy father and thy mother, that thou mayst be longlived upon the land which the Lord thy God will give thee. ¹³ Thou shalt not kill. ¹⁴ Thou shalt not commit adultery. ¹⁵ Thou shalt not steal. ¹⁶ Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house; neither shalt thou desire his wife, nor his servant, nor his handmaid, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is his.

¹⁸ And all the people saw the voices and the flames, and the sound of the trumpet, and the mount smoking; and being terrified and struck with fear, they stood afar off, ¹⁹ Saying to Moses: Speak thou to us, and we will hear: let not the Lord speak to us, lest we die. ²⁰ And Moses said to the people: Fear not; for God is come to prove you, and that the dread of him might be in you, and you should not sin. ²¹ And the people stood afar off. But Moses went to the dark cloud wherein God was.

68. The book of the covenant*Exodus 20:22-23:33*

The one law code this plan reads, and only because it stands inside the Sinai narrative.

20 ²² And the Lord said to Moses: Thus shalt thou say to the children of Israel: You have seen that I have spoken to you from heaven. ²³ You shall not make gods of silver, nor shall you make to yourselves gods of gold. ²⁴ You shall make an altar of earth unto me, and you shall offer upon it your holocausts and peace offerings, your sheep and oxen, in every place where the memory of my name shall be: I will come to thee, and will bless thee. ²⁵ And if thou make an altar of stone unto me, thou shalt not build it of hewn stones; for if thou lift up a tool upon it, it shall be defiled. ²⁶ Thou shalt not go up by steps unto my altar, lest thy nakedness be discovered.

²¹ ¹ These are the judgments which thou shalt set before them. ² If thou buy a Hebrew servant, six years shall he serve thee; in the seventh he shall go out free for nothing. ³ With what raiment he came in, with the like let him go out: if having a wife, his wife also shall go out with him. ⁴ But if his master gave him a wife, and she hath borne sons and daughters; the woman and her children shall be her master's: but he himself shall go out with his raiment. ⁵ And if the servant shall say: I love my master and my wife and children, I will not go out free: ⁶ His master shall bring him to the gods, and he shall be set to the door and the posts, and he shall bore his ear through with an awl: and he shall be his servant for ever.

⁷ If any man sell his daughter to be a servant, she shall not go out as bondwomen are wont to go out. ⁸ If she displease the eyes of her master to whom she was delivered, he shall let her go: but he shall have no power to sell her to a foreign nation, if he despise her. ⁹ But if he have betrothed her to his son, he shall deal with her after the manner of daughters. ¹⁰ And if he take another wife for him, he shall provide her a marriage, and raiment, neither shall he refuse the price of her chastity. ¹¹ If he do not these three things, she shall go out free without money.

¹² He that striketh a man with a will to kill him, shall be put to death. ¹³ But he that did not lie in wait for him, but God delivered him into his hands: I will appoint thee a place to which he must flee. ¹⁴ If a man kill his neighbour on set purpose, and by lying in wait for him: thou shalt take him away from my altar that he may die.

¹⁵ He that striketh his father or mother, shall be put to death.

¹⁶ He that shall steal a man, and sell him, being convicted of the guilt, shall be put to death.

¹⁷ He that curseth his father or mother, shall die the death.

¹⁸ If men quarrel, and the one strike his neighbour with a stone, or with his fist, and he die not, but keepeth his bed: ¹⁹ If he rise again and walk abroad upon his staff, he that struck him shall be quit, yet so that he make restitution for his work, and for his expenses upon the physicians.

²⁰ He that striketh his bondman, or bondwoman, with a rod, and they die under his hands, shall be guilty of the crime. ²¹ But if the party remain alive a day or two, he shall not be subject to the punishment, because it is his money.

²² If men quarrel, and one strike a woman with child and she miscarry indeed, but live herself: he shall be answerable for so much damage as the woman's husband shall require, and as arbiters shall award. ²³ But if her death ensue thereupon, he shall render life for life, ²⁴ Eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot, ²⁵ Burning for burning, wound for wound, stripe for stripe.

²⁶ If any man strike the eye of his manservant or maidservant, and leave them but one eye, he shall let them go free for the eye which he put out. ²⁷ Also if he strike out a tooth of his manservant or maidservant, he shall in like manner make them free.

²⁸ If an ox gore a man or a woman, and they die, he shall be stoned: and his flesh shall not be eaten, but the owner of the ox shall be quit. ²⁹ But if the ox was wont to push with his horn yesterday, and the day before, and they warned his master, and he did not shut him up, and he shall kill a man or a woman:

then the ox shall be stoned, and his owner also shall be put to death. ³⁰ And if they set a price upon him, he shall give for his life whatsoever is laid upon him. ³¹ If he have gored a son, or a daughter, he shall fall under the like sentence. ³² If he assault a bondman or bondwoman, he shall give thirty sicles of silver to their master, and the ox shall be stoned.

³³ If a man open a pit, and dig one, and cover it not, and an ox or an ass fall into it, ³⁴ The owner of the pit shall pay the price of the beasts: and that which is dead shall be his own.

³⁵ If one man's ox gore another man's ox, and he die: they shall sell the live ox, and shall divide the price, and the carcass of that which died they shall part between them: ³⁶ But if he knew that his ox was wont to push yesterday, and the day before, and his master did not keep him in; he shall pay ox for ox, and shall take the whole carcass.

22 ¹ If any man steal an ox or a sheep, and kill or sell it: he shall restore five oxen for one ox, and four sheep for one sheep.

² If a thief be found breaking open a house or undermining it, and be wounded so as to die: he that slew him shall not be guilty of blood. ³ But if he did this when the sun is risen, he hath committed murder, and he shall die. If he have not wherewith to make restitution for the theft, he shall be sold. ⁴ If that which he stole be found with him, alive, either ox, or ass, or sheep: he shall restore double.

⁵ If any man hurt a field or a vineyard, and put in his beast to feed upon that which is other men's: he shall restore the best of whatsoever he hath in his own field, or in his vineyard, according to the estimation of the damage.

⁶ If a fire breaking out light upon thorns, and catch stacks of corn, or corn standing in the fields, he that kindled the fire shall make good the loss.

⁷ If a man deliver money, or any vessel unto his friend to keep, and they be stolen away from him that received them: if the thief be found, he shall restore double: ⁸ If the thief be not known, the master of the house shall be brought to the gods, and shall swear that he did not lay his hand upon his neighbour's goods, ⁹ To do any fraud, either in ox, or in ass, or sheep, or raiment, or any thing that may bring damage: the cause of both parties shall come to the gods: and if they give judgment, he shall restore double to his neighbour. ¹⁰ If a man deliver ass, ox, sheep, or any beast, to his neighbour's custody, and it die, or be hurt, or be taken by enemies, and no man saw it: ¹¹ There shall be an oath between them, that he did not put forth his hand to his neighbour's goods: and the owner shall accept of the oath, and he shall not be compelled to make restitution. ¹² But if it were taken away by stealth, he shall make the loss good to the owner. ¹³ If it were eaten by a beast, let him bring to him that which was slain, and he shall not make restitution.

¹⁴ If a man borrow of his neighbour any of these things, and it be hurt or die, the owner not being present, he shall be obliged to make restitution. ¹⁵ But if the owner be present, he shall not make restitution, especially if it were hired, and came for the hire of his work.

¹⁶ If a man seduce a virgin not yet espoused, and lie with her: he shall endow her, and have her to wife. ¹⁷ If the maid's father will not give her to him, he shall give money according to the dowry, which virgins are wont to receive.

¹⁸ Wizards thou shalt not suffer to live.

¹⁹ Whosoever copulateth with a beast; shall be put to death.

²⁰ He that sacrificeth to gods, shall be put to death, save only to the Lord.

²¹ Thou shalt not molest a stranger, nor afflict him: for yourselves also were strangers in the land of Egypt.

²² You shall not hurt a widow or an orphan. ²³ If you hurt them, they will cry out to me, and I will hear their cry: ²⁴ And my rage shall be enkindled, and I will strike you with the sword, and your wives shall be widows, and your children fatherless.

²⁵ If thou lend money to any of my people that is poor, that dwelleth with thee, thou shalt not be hard upon them as an extortioner, nor oppress them with usuries. ²⁶ If thou take of thy neighbour a garment in pledge, thou shalt give it him again before sunset. ²⁷ For that same is the only thing, wherewith he is covered, the clothing of his body, neither hath he any other to sleep in: if he cry to me, I will hear him, because I am compassionate.

²⁸ Thou shalt not speak ill of the gods, and the prince of thy people thou shalt not curse.

²⁹ Thou shalt not delay to pay thy tithes and thy firstfruits: thou shalt give the firstborn of thy sons to me. ³⁰ Thou shalt do the same with the firstborn of thy oxen also and sheep: seven days let it be with its dam: the eighth day thou shalt give it to me.

³¹ You shall be holy men to me: the flesh that beasts have tasted of before, you shall not eat, but shall cast it to the dogs.

23 ¹ Thou shalt not receive the voice of a lie: neither shalt thou join thy hand to bear false witness for a wicked person.

² Thou shalt not follow the multitude to do evil: neither shalt thou yield in judgment, to the opinion of the most part, to stray from the truth. ³ Neither shalt thou favour a poor man in judgment.

⁴ If thou meet thy enemy's ox or ass going astray, bring it back to him. ⁵ If thou see the ass of him that hateth thee lie underneath his burden, thou shalt not pass by, but shalt lift him up with him. ⁶ Thou shalt not go aside in the poor man's judgment. ⁷ Thou shalt fly lying. The innocent and just person thou shalt not put to death: because I abhor the wicked.

⁸ Neither shalt thou take bribes, which even blind the wise, and pervert the words of the just.

⁹ Thou shalt not molest a stranger, for you know the hearts of strangers: for you also were strangers in the land of Egypt.

¹⁰ Six years thou shalt sow thy ground, and shalt gather the corn thereof. ¹¹ But the seventh year thou shalt let it alone, and suffer it to rest, that the poor of thy people may eat, and whatsoever shall be left, let the beasts of the field eat it: so shalt thou do with thy vineyard and thy oliveyard. ¹² Six days thou shalt work: the seventh day thou shalt cease, that thy ox and thy ass may rest: and the son of thy handmaid and the stranger may be refreshed. ¹³ Keep all things that I have said to you. And by the name of strange gods you shall not swear, neither shall it be heard out of your mouth.

¹⁴ Three times every year you shall celebrate feasts to me.

¹⁵ Thou shalt keep the feast of unleavened bread. Seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread, as I commanded thee, in the time of the month of new corn, when thou didst come forth out

of Egypt: thou shalt not appear empty before me. ¹⁶ And the feast of the harvest of the firstfruits of thy work, whatsoever thou hast sown in the field. The feast also in the end of the year, when thou hast gathered in all thy corn out of the field. ¹⁷ Thrice a year shall all thy males appear before the Lord thy God. ¹⁸ Thou shalt not sacrifice the blood of my victim upon leaven, neither shall the fat of my solemnity remain until the morning. ¹⁹ Thou shalt carry the first-fruits of the corn of thy ground to the house of the Lord thy God. Thou shalt not boil a kid in the milk of his dam.

²⁰ Behold I will send my angel, who shall go before thee, and keep thee in thy journey, and bring thee into the place that I have prepared. ²¹ Take notice of him, and hear his voice, and do not think him one to be contemned: for he will not forgive when thou hast sinned, and my name is in him. ²² But if thou wilt hear his voice, and do all that I speak, I will be an enemy to thy enemies, and will afflict them that afflict thee. ²³ And my angel shall go before thee, and shall bring thee in unto the Amorrite, and the Hethite, and the Pherezite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite, whom I will destroy. ²⁴ Thou shalt not adore their gods, nor serve them. Thou shalt not do their works, but shalt destroy them, and break their statues. ²⁵ And you shall serve the Lord your God, that I may bless your bread and your waters, and may take away sickness from the midst of thee. ²⁶ There shall not be one fruitless nor barren in thy land: I will fill the number of thy days. ²⁷ I will send my fear before thee, and will destroy all the people to whom thou shalt come: and will turn the backs of all thy enemies before thee: ²⁸ Sending out hornets before, that shall drive away the Hevite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, before thou come in. ²⁹ I will not cast them out from thy face in one year; lest the land be brought into a wilderness, and the beasts multiply against thee. ³⁰ By little and little I will drive them out from before thee, till thou be increased, and dost possess the land. ³¹ And I will set thy bounds from the Red Sea to the sea of the Palestines, and from the desert to the river: I will deliver the inhabitants of the land into your hands, and will drive them out from before you. ³² Thou shalt not enter into league with them, nor with their gods. ³³ Let them not dwell in thy land, lest perhaps they make thee sin against me, if thou serve their gods; which, undoubtedly, will be a scandal to thee.

69. The blood of the covenant

Exodus 24:1-18

Exodus 25-31, the tabernacle specifications, are omitted here.

24 ¹ And he said to Moses: Come up to the Lord, thou, and Aaron, Nadab and Abiu, and seventy of the ancients of Israel, and you shall adore afar off. ² And Moses alone shall come up to the Lord, but they shall not come nigh; neither shall the people come up with him.

³ So Moses came and told the people all the words of the Lord, and all the judgments: and all the people answered with one voice: We will do all the words of the Lord, which he hath spoken. ⁴ And Moses wrote all the words of the Lord: and rising in the morning, he built an altar at the foot of the mount, and twelve titles according to the twelve tribes of Israel. ⁵ And he sent young men of the children of Israel, and they offered holocausts, and

sacrificed pacific victims of calves to the Lord. ⁶ Then Moses took half of the blood, and put it into bowls; and the rest he poured upon the altar. ⁷ And taking the book of the covenant, he read it in the hearing of the people: and they said: All things that the Lord hath spoken, we will do, we will be obedient. ⁸ And he took the blood and sprinkled it upon the people, and he said: This is the blood of the covenant, which the Lord hath made with you concerning all these words.

⁹ Then Moses and Aaron, Nadab and Abiu, and seventy of the ancients of Israel went up: ¹⁰ And they saw the God of Israel: and under his feet as it were a work of sapphire stone, and as the heaven, when clear. ¹¹ Neither did he lay his hand upon those of the children of Israel, that retired afar off, and they saw God, and they did eat and drink.

¹² And the Lord said to Moses: Come up to me into the mount, and be there; and I will give thee tables of stone, and the law, and the commandments which I have written; that thou mayest teach them. ¹³ Moses rose up, and his minister Josue: and Moses going up into the mount of God, ¹⁴ Said to the ancients: Wait ye here till we return to you. You have Aaron and Hur with you: if any question shall arise, you shall refer it to them. ¹⁵ And when Moses was gone up, a cloud covered the mount. ¹⁶ And the glory of the Lord dwelt upon Sinai, covering it with a cloud six days: and the seventh day he called him out of the midst of the cloud. ¹⁷ And the sight of the glory of the Lord, was like a burning fire upon the top of the mount, in the eyes of the children of Israel. ¹⁸ And Moses entering into the midst of the cloud, went up into the mountain: And he was there forty days and forty nights.

70. The golden calf

Exodus 32:1-35

32 ¹ And the people seeing that Moses delayed to come down from the mount, gathering together against Aaron, said: Arise, make us gods, that may go before us: For as to this Moses, the man that brought us out of the land of Egypt, we know not what has befallen him. ² And Aaron said to them: Take the golden earrings from the ears of your wives, and your sons and daughters, and bring them to me. ³ And the people did what he had commanded, bringing the earrings to Aaron. ⁴ And when he had received them, he fashioned them by founders' work, and made of them a molten calf. And they said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ⁵ And when Aaron saw this, he built an altar before it, and made proclamation by a crier's voice, saying To morrow is the solemnity of the Lord. ⁶ And rising in the morning, they offered holocausts, and peace victims, and the people sat down to eat and drink, and they rose up to play.

⁷ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Go, get thee down: thy people, which thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, hath sinned. ⁸ They have quickly strayed from the way which thou didst shew them: and they have made to themselves a molten calf, and have adored it, and sacrificing victims to it, have said: These are thy gods, O Israel, that have brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ⁹ And again the Lord said to Moses: I see that this people is stiffnecked: ¹⁰ Let me alone, that my wrath may be kindled against them, and that I may destroy them, and I will make of thee a great nation. ¹¹ But Moses besought the Lord his God, saying: Why, O Lord, is thy indignation enkindled against thy

people, whom thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, with great power, and with a mighty hand? ¹² Let not the Egyptians say, I beseech thee: He craftily brought them out, that he might kill them in the mountains, and destroy them from the earth: let thy anger cease, and be appeased upon the wickedness of thy people. ¹³ Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, thy servants, to whom thou sworest by thy own self, saying: I will multiply your seed as the stars of heaven: and this whole land that I have spoken of, I will give to your seed, and you shall possess it for ever: ¹⁴ And the Lord was appeased from doing the evil which he had spoken against his people.

¹⁵ And Moses returned from the mount, carrying the two tables of the testimony in his hand, written on both sides, ¹⁶ And made by the work of God; the writing also of God was graven in the tables. ¹⁷ And Josue hearing the noise of the people shouting, said to Moses: The noise of battle is heard in the camp. ¹⁸ But he answered: It is not the cry of men encouraging to fight, nor the shout of men compelling to flee: but I hear the voice of singers. ¹⁹ And when he came nigh to the camp, he saw the calf, and the dances: and being very angry, he threw the tables out of his hand, and broke them at the foot of the mount: ²⁰ And laying hold of the calf which they had made, he burnt it, and beat it to powder, which he strewed into water, and gave thereof to the children of Israel to drink.

²¹ And he said to Aaron: What has this people done to thee, that thou shouldst bring upon them a most heinous sin? ²² And he answered him: Let not my lord be offended; for thou knowest this people, that they are prone to evil. ²³ They said to me: make us gods, that may go before us; for as to this Moses, who brought us forth out of the land of Egypt, we know not what is befallen him. ²⁴ And I said to them: Which of you hath any gold? and they took and brought it to me; and I cast it into the fire, and this calf came out.

²⁵ And when Moses saw that the people were naked, (for Aaron had stripped them by occasion of the shame of the filth, and had set them naked among their enemies) ²⁶ Then standing in the gate of the camp, he said: If any man be on the Lord's side, let him join with me. And all the sons of Levi gathered themselves together unto him: ²⁷ And he said to them: Thus saith the Lord God of Israel: Put every man his sword upon his thigh: go, and return from gate to gate through the midst of the camp, and let every man kill his brother, and friend, and neighbour. ²⁸ And the sons of Levi did according to the words of Moses, and there were slain that day about three and twenty thousand men. ²⁹ And Moses said: You have consecrated your hands this day to the Lord, every man in his son and in his brother, that a blessing may be given to you.

³⁰ And when the next day was come, Moses spoke to the people: You have sinned a very great sin: I will go up to the Lord, if by any means I may be able to entreat him for your crime. ³¹ And returning to the Lord, he said: I beseech thee: this people hath sinned a heinous sin, and they have made to themselves gods of gold: either forgive them this trespass, ³² Or if thou do not, strike me out of the book that thou hast written. ³³ And the Lord answered him: He that hath sinned against me, him will I strike out of my book: ³⁴ But go thou, and lead this people whither I have told thee: my angel shall go before thee. And I in

the day of revenge will visit this sin also of theirs. ³⁵ The Lord therefore struck the people for the guilt, on occasion of the calf which Aaron had made.

71. "Shew me thy glory"

Exodus 33:1-23

33 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Go, get thee up from this place, thou and thy people which thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, into the land concerning which I swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying: To thy seed I will give it: ² And I will send an angel before thee, that I may cast out the Chanaanite, and the Amorrhite, and the Hethite, and the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite, ³ That thou mayst enter into the land that floweth with milk and honey. For I will not go up with thee, because thou art a stiffnecked people; lest I destroy thee in the way.

⁴ And the people hearing these very bad tidings, mourned: and no man put on his ornaments according to custom. ⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: Say to the children of Israel: Thou art a stiffnecked people, once I shall come up in the midst of thee, and shall destroy thee. Now presently lay aside thy ornaments, that I may know what to do to thee. ⁶ So the children of Israel laid aside their ornaments by Mount Horeb.

⁷ Moses also taking the tabernacle, pitched it without the camp afar off, and called the name thereof, The tabernacle of the covenant. And all the people, that had any question, went forth to the tabernacle of the covenant, without the camp. ⁸ And when Moses went forth to the tabernacle, all the people rose up, and every one stood in the door of his pavilion, and they beheld the back of Moses, till he went into the tabernacle. ⁹ And when he was gone into the tabernacle of the covenant, the pillar of the cloud came down, and stood at the door, and he spoke with Moses. ¹⁰ And all saw that the pillar of the cloud stood at the door of the tabernacle. And they stood and worshipped at the doors of their tent. ¹¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses face to face, as a man is wont to speak to his friend. And when he returned into the camp, his servant Josue, the son of Nun, a young man, departed not from the tabernacle.

¹² And Moses said to the Lord: Thou commandest me to lead forth this people; and thou dost not let me know whom thou wilt send with me, especially whereas thou hast said: I know thee by name, and thou hast found favour in my sight. ¹³ If therefore I have found favour in thy sight, shew me thy face, that I may know thee, and may find grace before thy eyes: look upon thy people this nation. ¹⁴ And the Lord said: My face shall go before thee, and I will give thee rest. ¹⁵ And Moses said: If thou thyself dost not go before, bring us not out of this place. ¹⁶ For how shall we be able to know, I and thy people, that we have found grace in thy sight, unless thou walk with us, that we may be glorified by all people that dwell upon the earth? ¹⁷ And the Lord said to Moses: This word also, which thou hast spoken, will I do; for thou hast found grace before me, and thee I have known by name. ¹⁸ And he said: Shew me thy glory. ¹⁹ He answered: I will shew thee all good, and I will proclaim in the name of the Lord before thee: and I will have mercy on whom I will, and I will be merciful to whom it shall please me. ²⁰ And again he said: Thou canst not see my face: for man shall not see me, and live. ²¹ And again he said: Behold there is a place with me, and thou shalt

stand upon the rock. ²² And when my glory shall pass, I will set thee in a hole of the rock, and protect thee with my right hand till I pass: ²³ And I will take away my hand, and thou shalt see my back parts: but my face thou canst not see.

72. The covenant renewed; the shining face

Exodus 34:1-35

Exodus 35-40, the making of the tabernacle, are omitted; they repeat chapters 25-31 in the past tense.

34 ¹ And after this he said: Hew thee two tables of stone like unto the former, and I will write upon them the words, which were in the tables, which thou brokest. ² Be ready in the morning, that thou mayst forthwith go up into Mount Sinai, and thou shalt stand with me upon the top of the mount. ³ Let no man go up with thee, and let not any man be seen throughout all the mount; neither let the oxen nor the sheep feed over against it.

⁴ Then he cut out two tables of stone, such as had been before; and rising very early he went up into the Mount Sinai, as the Lord had commanded him, carrying with him the tables. ⁵ And when the Lord was come down in a cloud, Moses stood with him, calling upon the name of the Lord. ⁶ And when he passed before him, he said: O the Lord, the Lord God, merciful and gracious, patient and of much compassion, and true, ⁷ Who keepest mercy unto thousands: who takest away iniquity, and wickedness, and sin, and no man of himself is innocent before thee. Who renderest the iniquity of the fathers to the children, and to the grandchildren unto the third and fourth generation. ⁸ And Moses making haste, bowed down prostrate unto the earth, and adoring, ⁹ Said: If I have found grace in thy sight, O Lord, I beseech thee that thou wilt go with us, (for it is a stiffnecked people) and take away our iniquities and sin, and possess us.

¹⁰ The Lord answered: I will make a covenant in the sight of all, I will do signs such as were never seen upon the earth, nor in any nations; that this people, in the midst of whom thou art, may see the terrible work of the Lord which I will do. ¹¹ Observe all things which this day I command thee: I myself will drive out before thy face the Amorrite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite. ¹² Beware thou never join in friendship with the inhabitants of that land, which may be thy ruin: ¹³ But destroy their altars, break their statues and cut down their groves: ¹⁴ Adore not any strange god. The Lord his name is jealous, he is a jealous God. ¹⁵ Make no covenant with the men of those countries; lest, when they have committed fornication with their gods, and have adored their idols, some one call thee to eat of the things sacrificed. ¹⁶ Neither shalt thou take of their daughters a wife for thy son, lest after they themselves have committed fornication, they make thy sons also to commit fornication with their gods. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not make to thyself any molten gods.

¹⁸ Thou shalt keep the feast of the unleavened bread. Seven days shalt thou eat unleavened bread, as I commanded thee in the time of the month of the new corn: for in the month of the spring time thou camest out from Egypt. ¹⁹ All of the male kind that openeth the womb, shall be mine. Of all beasts; both of oxen and of sheep, it shall be mine. ²⁰ The firstling of an ass thou shalt redeem with a sheep: but if thou wilt not give a price for it,

it shall be slain. The firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem: neither shalt thou appear before me empty.

²¹ Six days shalt thou work, the seventh day thou shalt cease to plough and to reap.

²² Thou shalt keep the feast of weeks with the firstfruits of the corn of thy wheat harvest, and the feast when the time of the year returneth that all things are laid in. ²³ Three times in the year all thy males shall appear in the sight of the almighty Lord the God of Israel. ²⁴ For when I shall have taken away the nations from thy face, and shall have enlarged thy borders, no man shall lie in wait against thy land when thou shalt go up, and appear in the sight of the Lord thy God thrice in a year. ²⁵ Thou shalt not offer the blood of my sacrifice upon leaven; neither shall there remain in the morning any thing of the victim of the solemnity of the Phase. ²⁶ The first of the fruits of thy ground thou shalt offer in the house of the Lord thy God. Thou shalt not boil a kid in the milk of his dam. ²⁷ And the Lord said to Moses: Write thee these words, by which I have made a covenant both with thee and with Israel.

²⁸ And he was there with the Lord forty days and forty nights: he neither ate bread nor drank water, and he wrote upon the tables the ten words of the covenant.

²⁹ And when Moses came down from the Mount Sinai, he held the two tables of the testimony, and he knew not that his face was horned from the conversation of the Lord. ³⁰ And Aaron and the children of Israel seeing the face of Moses horned, were afraid to come near. ³¹ And being called by him, they returned, both Aaron and the rulers of the congregation. And after that he spoke to them, ³² And all the children of Israel came to him: and he gave them in commandment all that he had heard of the Lord on Mount Sinai. ³³ And having done speaking, he put a veil upon his face. ³⁴ But when he went in to the Lord, and spoke with him, he took it away until he came forth, and then he spoke to the children of Israel all things that had been commanded him. ³⁵ And they saw that the face of Moses when he came out was horned, but he covered his face again, if at any time he spoke to them.

THE WILDERNESS

Numbers 10-14, 16-17, 20-25, 27 and 31-33, with Deuteronomy 1-11 and 29-34. The Deuteronomic law code (12-26) is passed over, as is Leviticus entire and Numbers 1-9 and 26-30 apart from chapter 27: censuses, offerings and cultic ordinance.

73. The cloud lifts

Numbers 10:1-36

10 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ² Make thee two trumpets of beaten silver, wherewith thou mayest call together the multitude when the camp is to be removed. ³ And when thou shalt sound the trumpets, all the multitude shall gather unto thee to the door of the tabernacle of the covenant. ⁴ If thou sound but once, the princes and the heads of the multitude of Israel shall come to thee. ⁵ But if the sound of the trumpets be longer, and with interruptions, they that are on the east side, shall first go forward. ⁶ And at the second sounding and like noise of the trumpet, they who lie on the south side shall take up their tents. And after this manner shall the rest do, when the

trumpets shall sound for a march. ⁷ But when the people is to be gathered together, the sound of the trumpets shall be plain, and they shall not make a broken sound. ⁸ And the sons of Aaron the priest shall sound the trumpets: and this shall be an ordinance for ever in your generations. ⁹ If you go forth to war out of your land against the enemies that fight against you, you shall sound aloud with the trumpets, and there shall be a remembrance of you before the Lord your God, that you may be delivered out of the hands of your enemies. ¹⁰ If at any time you shall have a banquet, and on your festival days, and on the first days of your months, you shall sound the trumpets over the holocausts, and the sacrifices of peace offerings, that they may be to you for a remembrance of your God. I am the Lord your God.

¹¹ The second year, in the second month, the twentieth day of the month, the cloud was taken up from the tabernacle of the covenant. ¹² And the children of Israel marched by their troops from the desert of Sinai, and the cloud rested in the wilderness of Pharan. ¹³ And the first went forward according to the commandment of the Lord by the hand of Moses.

¹⁴ The sons of Juda by their troops: whose prince was Nahasson the son of Aminadab. ¹⁵ In the tribe of the sons of Issachar, the prince was Nathanael the son of Suar. ¹⁶ In the tribe of Zabulon, the prince was Eliab the son of Helon. ¹⁷ And the tabernacle was taken down, and the sons of Gerson and Merari set forward, bearing it. ¹⁸ And the sons of Ruben also marched, by their troops and ranks, whose prince was Helisur the son of Sedeur. ¹⁹ And in the tribe of Simeon, the prince was Salamiel the son of Surisaddai. ²⁰ And in the tribe of Gad, the prince was Eliasaph the son of Duel. ²¹ Then the Caathites also marched carrying the sanctuary. So long was the tabernacle carried, till they came to the place of setting it up.

²² The sons of Ephraim also moved their camp by their troops, in whose army the prince was Elisama the son of Ammiud. ²³ And in the tribe of the sons of Manasses, the prince was Gamaliel the son of Phadassur. ²⁴ And in the tribe of Benjamin, the prince was Abidan the son of Gedeon.

²⁵ The last of all the camp marched the sons of Dan by their troops, in whose army the prince was Ahiezer the son of Amisaddai. ²⁶ And in the tribe of the sons of Aser, the prince was Phlegiel the son of Ochran. ²⁷ And in the tribe of the sons of Nephtali, the prince was Ahira the son of Enan. ²⁸ This was the order of the camps, and marches of the children of Israel by their troops, when they set forward.

²⁹ And Moses said to Hobab the son of Raguel the Madianite, his kinsman: We are going towards the place which the Lord will give us: come with us, that we may do thee good: for the Lord hath promised good things to Israel. ³⁰ But he answered him: I will not go with thee, but I will return to my country, wherein I was born. ³¹ And he said: Do not leave us: for thou knowest in what places we should encamp in the wilderness, and thou shalt be our guide. ³² And if thou comest with us, we will give thee what is the best of the riches which the Lord shall deliver to us.

³³ So they marched from the mount of the Lord three days' journey, and the ark of the covenant of the Lord went before them, for three days providing a place for the camp. ³⁴ The cloud also of the Lord was over them by day when they marched.

³⁵ And when the ark was lifted up, Moses said: Arise, O Lord, and let thy enemies be scattered, and let them that hate thee, flee from before thy face. ³⁶ And when it was set down, he said: Return, O Lord, to the multitude of the host of Israel.

74. *The quails, and the seventy elders*

Numbers 11:1-34

11 ¹ In the mean time there arose a murmuring of the people against the Lord, as it were repining at their fatigue. And when the Lord heard it he was angry. And the fire of the Lord being kindled against them, devoured them that were at the uttermost part of the camp. ² And when the people cried to Moses, Moses prayed to the Lord, and the fire was swallowed up. ³ And he called the name of that place, The burning: for that the fire of the Lord had been kindled against them.

⁴ For a mixt multitude of people, that came up with them, burned with desire, sitting and weeping, the children of Israel also being joined with them, and said: Who shall give us flesh to eat? ⁵ We remember the fish that we ate in Egypt free cost: the cucumbers come into our mind, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlic. ⁶ Our soul is dry, our eyes behold nothing else but manna. ⁷ Now the manna was like coriander seed, of the colour of bdellium. ⁸ And the people went about, and gathering it, ground it in a mill, or beat it in a mortar, and boiled it in a pot, and made cakes thereof of the taste of bread tempered with oil. ⁹ And when the dew fell in the night upon the camp, the manna also fell with it.

¹⁰ Now Moses heard the people weeping by their families, every one at the door of his tent. And the wrath of the Lord was exceedingly enkindled: to Moses also the thing seemed insupportable. ¹¹ And he said to the Lord: Why hast thou afflicted thy servant? Wherefore do I not find favour before thee? And why hast thou laid the weight of all this people upon me? ¹² Have I conceived all this multitude, or begotten them, that thou shouldst say to me: Carry them in thy bosom as the nurse is wont to carry the little infant, and bear them into the land, for which thou hast sworn to their fathers? ¹³ Whence should I have flesh to give to so great a multitude? They weep against me, saying: Give us flesh that we may eat. ¹⁴ I am not able alone to bear all this people, because it is too heavy for me. ¹⁵ But if it seem unto thee otherwise, I beseech thee to kill me, and let me find grace in thy eyes, that I be not afflicted with so great evils.

¹⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Gather unto me seventy men of the ancients of Israel, whom thou knowest to be ancients and masters of the people: and thou shalt bring them to the door of the tabernacle of the covenant, and shalt make them stand there with thee, ¹⁷ That I may come down and speak with thee: and I will take of thy spirit, and will give to them, that they may bear with thee the burden of the people, and thou mayest not be burthened alone. ¹⁸ And thou shalt say to the people: Be ye sanctified: to morrow you shall eat flesh: for I have heard you say: Who will give us flesh to eat? It was well with us in Egypt. That the Lord may give you flesh, and you may eat: ¹⁹ Not for one day, nor two, nor five, nor ten, nor for twenty. ²⁰ But even for a month of days, till it come out at your nostrils, and become loathsome to you, because you have cast off the Lord, who is in the midst of you, and have wept before him, saying: Why came we out of Egypt? ²¹ And Moses said: There are six

hundred thousand footmen of this people, and sayest thou: I will give them flesh to eat a whole month? ²² Shall then a multitude of sheep and oxen be killed, that it may suffice for their food? or shall the fishes of the sea be gathered together to fill them? ²³ And the Lord answered him: Is the hand of the Lord unable? Thou shalt presently see whether my word shall come to pass or no.

²⁴ Moses therefore came, and told the people the words of the Lord, and assembled seventy men of the ancients of Israel, and made them to stand about the tabernacle. ²⁵ And the Lord came down in a cloud, and spoke to him, taking away of the spirit that was in Moses, and giving to the seventy men. And when the spirit had rested on them they prophesied, nor did they cease afterwards. ²⁶ Now there remained in the camp two of the men, of whom one was called Eldad, and the other Medad, upon whom the spirit rested; for they also had been enrolled, but were not gone forth to the tabernacle. ²⁷ And when they prophesied in the camp, there ran a young man, and told Moses, saying: Eldad and Medad prophesy in the camp. ²⁸ Forthwith Josue the son of Nun, the minister of Moses, and chosen out of many, said: My lord Moses forbid them. ²⁹ But he said: Why hast thou emulation for me? O that all the people might prophesy, and that the Lord would give them his spirit! ³⁰ And Moses returned, with the ancients of Israel, into the camp. ³¹ And a wind going out from the Lord, taking quails up beyond the sea brought them, and cast them into the camp for the space of one day's journey, on every side of the camp round about, and they flew in the air two cubits high above the ground. ³² The people therefore rising up all that day, and night, and the next day, gathered together of quails, he that did least, ten cores: and they dried them round about the camp. ³³ As yet the flesh was between their teeth, neither had that kind of meat failed: when behold the wrath of the Lord being provoked against the people, struck them with an exceeding great plague. ³⁴ And that place was called, The graves of lust: for there they buried the people that had lusted. And departing from the graves of lust, they came unto Haseroth, and abode there.

75. Mary and Aaron murmur

Numbers 12:1-15

12 ¹ And Mary and Aaron spoke against Moses, because of his wife the Ethiopian, ² And they said: Hath the Lord spoken by Moses only? Hath he not also spoken to us in like manner? And when the Lord heard this, ³ (For Moses was a man exceeding meek above all men that dwelt upon earth) ⁴ Immediately he spoke to him, and to Aaron and Mary: Come out you three only to the tabernacle of the covenant. And when they were come out, ⁵ The Lord came down in a pillar of the cloud, and stood in the entry of the tabernacle calling to Aaron and Mary. And when they were come, ⁶ He said to them: Hear my words: if there be among you a prophet of the Lord, I will appear to him in a vision, or I will speak to him in a dream. ⁷ But it is not so with my servant Moses who is most faithful in all my house: ⁸ For I speak to him mouth to mouth: and plainly, and not by riddles and figures doth he see the Lord. Why then were you not afraid to speak ill of my servant Moses? ⁹ And being angry with them he went away:

¹⁰ The cloud also that was over the tabernacle departed: and behold Mary appeared white as snow with a leprosy. And when Aaron had looked on her, and saw her all covered with leprosy, ¹¹ He said to Moses: I beseech thee, my lord, lay not upon us this sin, which we have foolishly committed: ¹² Let her not be as one dead, and as an abortive that is cast forth from the mother's womb. Lo, now one half of her flesh is consumed with the leprosy. ¹³ And Moses cried to the Lord, saying O God, I beseech thee heal her.

¹⁴ And the Lord answered him: If her father had spitten upon her face, ought she not to have been ashamed for seven days at least? Let her be separated seven days without the camp, and afterwards she shall be called again. ¹⁵ Mary therefore was put out of the camp seven days: and the people moved not from that place until Mary was called again.

76. The spies, and the refusal of the land

Numbers 13:1-14:45

The forty years in the desert begin here; every later reading in this period is its consequence.

13 ¹ And the people marched from Haseroth, and pitched their tents in the desert of Pharan. ² And there the Lord spoke to Moses, saying. ³ Send men to view the land of Chanaan, which I will give to the children of Israel, one of every tribe, of the rulers. ⁴ Moses did what the Lord had commanded, sending from the desert of Pharan, principal men, whose names are these: ⁵ Of the tribe of Ruben, Sammua the son of Zechur. ⁶ Of the tribe of Simeon, Saphat the son of Huri. ⁷ Of the tribe of Juda, Caleb the son of Jephone. ⁸ Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of Joseph. ⁹ Of the tribe of Ephraim, Osee the son of Nun. ¹⁰ Of the tribe of Benjamin, Phalti the son of Raphu. ¹¹ Of the tribe of Zabulon, Geddiel the son of Sodi. ¹² Of the tribe of Joseph, of the sceptre of Manasses, Gaddi the son of Susi. ¹³ Of the tribe of Dan, Ammiel the son of Gemalli. ¹⁴ Of the tribe of Aser, Sthur the son of Michael. ¹⁵ Of the tribe of Nephtali, Nahabi the son of Vapsi. ¹⁶ Of the tribe of Gad, Guel the son of Machi. ¹⁷ These are the names of the men, whom Moses sent to view the land: and he called Osee the son of Nun, Josue. ¹⁸ And Moses sent them to view the land of Chanaan, and said to them: Go you up by the south side. And when you shall come to the mountains, ¹⁹ View the land, of what sort it is, and the people that are the inhabitants thereof, whether they be strong or weak: few in number or many: ²⁰ The land itself, whether it be good or bad: what manner of cities, walled or without walls:

²¹ The ground, fat or barren, woody or without trees. Be of good courage, and bring us of the fruits of the land. Now it was the time when the firstripe grapes are fit to be eaten. ²² And when they were gone up, they viewed the land from the desert of Sin, unto Rohob as you enter into Emath. ²³ And they went up at the south side, and came to Hebron, where were Achiman and Sisai and Tholmai the sons of Enac. For Hebron was built seven years before Tanis the city of Egypt. ²⁴ And going forward as far as the torrent of the cluster of grapes, they cut off a branch with its cluster of grapes, which two men carried upon a lever. They took also of the pomegranates and of the figs of that place: ²⁵ Which was called Nehelescol, that is to say, the torrent of the cluster of grapes, because from thence the children of Israel had

carried a cluster of grapes. ²⁶ And they that went to spy out the land returned after forty days, having gone round all the country, ²⁷ And came to Moses and Aaron and to all the assembly of the children of Israel to the desert of Pharan, which is in Cades. And speaking to them and to all the multitude, they shewed them the fruits of the land: ²⁸ And they related and said: We came into the land to which thou sentest us, which in very deed floweth with milk and honey as may be known by these fruits: ²⁹ But it hath very strong inhabitants, and the cities are great and walled. We saw there the race of Enac. ³⁰ Amalec dwelleth in the south, the Hethite and the Jebusite and the Amorhite in the mountains: but the Chanaanite abideth by the sea and near the streams of the Jordan. ³¹ In the mean time Caleb, to still the murmuring of the people that rose against Moses, said: Let us go up and possess the land, for we shall be able to conquer it. ³² But the others, that had been with him, said: No, we are not able to go up to this people, because they are stronger than we. ³³ And they spoke ill of the land, which they had viewed, before the children of Israel, saying: The land which we have viewed, devoureth its inhabitants: the people, that we beheld are of a tall stature. ³⁴ There we saw certain monsters of the sons of Enac, of the giant kind: in comparison of whom, we seemed like locusts.

14 ¹ Therefore the whole multitude crying wept that night. ² And all the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, saying: ³ Would God that we had died in Egypt: and would God we may die in this vast wilderness, and that the Lord may not bring us into this land, lest we fall by the sword, and our wives and children be led away captives. Is it not better to return into Egypt? ⁴ And they said one to another: Let us appoint a captain, and let us return into Egypt.

⁵ And when Moses and Aaron heard this, they fell down flat upon the ground before the multitude of the children of Israel.

⁶ But Josue the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephone, who themselves also had viewed the land, rent their garments, ⁷ And said to all the multitude of the children of Israel: The land which we have gone round is very good: ⁸ If the Lord be favourable, he will bring us into it, and give us a land flowing with milk and honey. ⁹ Be not rebellious against the Lord: and fear ye not the people of this land, for we are able to eat them up as bread. All aid is gone from them: the Lord is with us, fear ye not. ¹⁰ And when all the multitude cried out, and would have stoned them, the glory of the Lord appeared over the tabernacle of the covenant to all the children of Israel.

¹¹ And the Lord said to Moses: How long will this people detract me? how long will they not believe me for all the signs that I have wrought before them? ¹² I will strike them therefore with pestilence, and will consume them: but thee I will make a ruler over a great nation, and a mightier than this is.

¹³ And Moses said to the Lord: That the Egyptians, from the midst of whom thou hast brought forth this people, ¹⁴ And the inhabitants of this land, (who have heard that thou, O Lord, art among this people, and art seen face to face, and thy cloud protecteth them, and thou goest before them in a pillar of a cloud by day, and in a pillar of fire by night,) ¹⁵ May hear that thou hast killed so great a multitude as it were one man and may say: ¹⁶ He could not bring the people into the land for which he had sworn, therefore did he kill them in the wilderness. ¹⁷ Let

then the strength of the Lord be magnified, as thou hast sworn, saying: ¹⁸ The Lord is patient and full of mercy, by taking away iniquity and wickedness, and leaving no man clear, who visiteth the sins of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation. ¹⁹ Forgive, I beseech thee, the sins of this people, according to the greatness of thy mercy, as thou hast been merciful to them from their going out of Egypt unto this place.

²⁰ And the Lord said: I have forgiven according to thy word. ²¹ As I live: and the whole earth shall be filled with the glory of the Lord. ²² But yet all the men that have seen my majesty, and the signs that I have done in Egypt, and in the wilderness, and have tempted me now ten times, and have not obeyed my voice, ²³ Shall not see the land for which I swore to their fathers, neither shall any one of them that hath detracted me behold it. ²⁴ My servant Caleb, who being full of another spirit hath followed me, I will bring into this land which he hath gone round: and his seed shall possess it. ²⁵ For the Amalecite and the Chanaanite dwell in the valleys. To morrow remove the camp, and return into the wilderness by the way of the Red Sea. ²⁶ And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying: ²⁷ How long doth this wicked multitude murmur against me? I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel. ²⁸ Say therefore to them: As I live, saith the Lord: According as you have spoken in my hearing, so will I do to you. ²⁹ In the wilderness shall your carcasses lie. All you that were numbered from twenty years old and upward, and have murmured against me, ³⁰ Shall not enter into the land, over which I lifted up my hand to make you dwell therein, except Caleb the son of Jephone, and Josue the son of Nun. ³¹ But your children, of whom you said, that they should be a prey to the enemies, will I bring in: that they may see the land which you have despised. ³² Your carcasses shall lie in the wilderness. ³³ Your children shall wander in the desert forty years, and shall bear your fornication, until the carcasses of their fathers be consumed in the desert, ³⁴ According to the number of the forty days, wherein you viewed the land: a year shall be counted for a day. And forty years you shall receive your iniquities, and shall know my revenge: ³⁵ For as I have spoken, so will I do to all this wicked multitude, that hath risen up together against me: in this wilderness shall it faint away and die.

³⁶ Therefore all the men, whom Moses had sent to view the land, and who at their return had made the whole multitude to murmur against him, speaking ill of the land that it was naught, ³⁷ Died and were struck in the sight of the Lord. ³⁸ But Josue the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephone lived, of all them that had gone to view the land. ³⁹ And Moses spoke all these words to all the children of Israel, and the people mourned exceedingly. ⁴⁰ And behold rising up very early in the morning, they went up to the top of the mountain, and said: We are ready to go up to the place, of which the Lord hath spoken: for we have sinned. ⁴¹ And Moses said to them: Why transgress you the word of the Lord, which shall not succeed prosperously with you? ⁴² Go not up, for the Lord is not with you: lest you fall before your enemies. ⁴³ The Amalecite and the Chanaanite are before you, and by their sword you shall fall, because you would not consent to the Lord, neither will the Lord be with you. ⁴⁴ But they being

blinded went up to the top of the mountain. But the ark of the testament of the Lord and Moses departed not from the camp. ⁴⁵ And the Amalecite came down, and the Chanaanite that dwelt in the mountain: and smiting and slaying them pursued them as far as Horma.

77. The rebellion of Core

Numbers 16:1-50

16 ¹ And behold Core the son of Isaar, the son of Caath, the son of Levi, and Dathan and Abiron the sons of Eliab, and Hon the son of Pheleth of the children of Ruben, ² Rose up against Moses, and with them two hundred and fifty others of the children of Israel, leading men of the synagogue, and who in the time of assembly were called by name. ³ And when they had stood up against Moses and Aaron, they said: Let it be enough for you, that all the multitude consisteth of holy ones, and the Lord is among them: Why lift you up yourselves above the people of the Lord? ⁴ When Moses heard this, he fell flat on his face: ⁵ And speaking to Core and all the multitude, he said: In the morning the Lord will make known who belong to him, and the holy he will join to himself: and whom he shall choose, they shall approach to him. ⁶ Do this therefore: Take every man of you your censers, thou Core, and all thy company. ⁷ And putting fire in them to morrow, put incense upon it before the Lord: and whomsoever he shall choose, the same shall be holy: you take too much upon you, ye sons of Levi. ⁸ And he said again to Core: Hear ye sons of Levi. ⁹ Is it a small thing unto you, that the God of Israel hath spared you from all the people, and joined you to himself, that you should serve him in the service of the tabernacle, and should stand before the congregation of the people, and should minister to him? ¹⁰ Did he therefore make thee and all thy brethren the sons of Levi to approach unto him, that you should challenge to yourselves the priesthood also, ¹¹ And that all thy company should stand against the Lord? for what is Aaron that you murmur against him?

¹² Then Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiron the sons of Eliab. But they answered: We will not come. ¹³ Is it a small matter to thee, that thou hast brought us out of a land that flowed with milk and honey, to kill us in the desert, except thou rule also like a lord over us? ¹⁴ Thou hast brought us indeed into a land that floweth with rivers of milk and honey, and hast given us possessions of fields and vineyards; wilt thou also pull out our eyes? We will not come. ¹⁵ Moses therefore being very angry, said to the Lord: Respect not their sacrifices: thou knowest that I have not taken of them so much as a young ass at any time, nor have injured any of them. ¹⁶ And he said to Core: Do thou and thy congregation stand apart before the Lord to morrow, and Aaron apart. ¹⁷ Take every one of you censers, and put incense upon them, offering to the Lord two hundred and fifty censers: let Aaron also hold his censer. ¹⁸ When they had done this, Moses and Aaron standing, ¹⁹ And had drawn up all the multitude against them to the door of the tabernacle, the glory of the Lord appeared to them all. ²⁰ And the Lord speaking to Moses and Aaron, said: ²¹ Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may presently destroy them. ²² They fell flat on their face, and said: O most mighty, the God of the spirits of all flesh, for one man's sin shall thy wrath rage against all?

²³ And the Lord said to Moses: ²⁴ Command the whole people to separate themselves from the tents of Core and Dathan and Abiron. ²⁵ And Moses arose, and went to Dathan and Abiron: and the ancients of Israel following him, ²⁶ He said to the multitude: Depart from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest you be involved in their sins. ²⁷ And when they were departed from their tents round about, Dathan and Abiron coming out stood in the entry of their pavilions with their wives and children, and all the people. ²⁸ And Moses said: By this you shall know that the Lord hath sent me to do all things that you see, and that I have not forged them of my own head: ²⁹ If these men die the common death of men, and if they be visited with a plague, wherewith others also are wont to be visited, the Lord did not send me. ³⁰ But if the Lord do a new thing, and the earth opening her mouth swallow them down, and all things that belong to them, and they go down alive into hell, you shall know that they have blasphemed the Lord.

³¹ And immediately as he had made an end of speaking, the earth broke asunder under their feet: ³² And opening her mouth, devoured them with their tents and all their substance. ³³ And they went down alive into hell, the ground closing upon them, and they perished from among the people. ³⁴ But all Israel, that was standing round about, fled at the cry of them that were perishing: saying: Lest perhaps the earth swallow us up also. ³⁵ And a fire coming out from the Lord, destroyed the two hundred and fifty men that offered the incense.

³⁶ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ³⁷ Command Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest to take up the censers that lie in the burning, and to scatter the fire of one side and the other: because they are sanctified ³⁸ In the deaths of the sinners: and let him beat them into plates, and fasten them to the altar, because incense hath been offered in them to the Lord, and they are sanctified, that the children of Israel may see them for a sign and a memorial. ³⁹ Then Eleazar the priest took the brazen censers, wherein they had offered, whom the burning fire had devoured, and beat them into plates, fastening them to the altar: ⁴⁰ That the children of Israel might have for the time to come wherewith they should be admonished, that no stranger or any one that is not of the seed of Aaron should come near to offer incense to the Lord, lest he should suffer as Core suffered, and all his congregation, according as the Lord spoke to Moses.

⁴¹ The following day all the multitude of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, saying: You have killed the people of the Lord. ⁴² And when there arose a sedition, and the tumult increased, ⁴³ Moses and Aaron fled to the tabernacle of the covenant. And when they were gone into it, the cloud covered it, and the glory of the Lord appeared. ⁴⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: ⁴⁵ Get you out from the midst of this multitude, this moment will I destroy them. And as they were lying on the ground,

⁴⁶ Moses said to Aaron: Take the censer, and putting fire in it from the altar, put incense upon it, and go quickly to the people to pray for them: for already wrath is gone out from the Lord, and the plague rageth. ⁴⁷ When Aaron had done this, and had run to the midst of the multitude which the burning fire was now destroying, he offered the incense: ⁴⁸ And standing between the dead and the living, he prayed for the people, and

the plague ceased. ⁴⁹ And the number of them that were slain was fourteen thousand and seven hundred men, besides them that had perished in the sedition of Core. ⁵⁰ And Aaron returned to Moses to the door of the tabernacle of the covenant after the destruction was over.

78. The rod of Aaron that blossomed

Numbers 17:1-13

17 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ² Speak to the children of Israel, and take of every one of them a rod by their kindreds, of all the princes of the tribes, twelve rods, and write the name of every man upon his rod. ³ And the name of Aaron shall be for the tribe of Levi, and one rod shall contain all their families: ⁴ And thou shalt lay them up in the tabernacle of the covenant before the testimony, where I will speak to thee. ⁵ Whomsoever of these I shall choose, his rod shall blossom: and I will make to cease from me the murmurings of the children of Israel, wherewith they murmur against you.

⁶ And Moses spoke to the children of Israel: and all the princes gave him rods one for every tribe: and there were twelve rods besides the rod of Aaron. ⁷ And when Moses had Laid them up before the Lord in the tabernacle of the testimony:

⁸ He returned on the following day, and found that the rod of Aaron for the house of Levi, was budded: and that the buds swelling it had bloomed blossoms, which spreading the leaves, were formed into almonds. ⁹ Moses therefore brought out all the rods from before the Lord to all the children of Israel: and they saw, and every one received their rods.

¹⁰ And the Lord said to Moses: Carry back the rod of Aaron into the tabernacle of the testimony, that it may be kept there for a token of the rebellious children of Israel, and that their complaints may cease from me lest they die. ¹¹ And Moses did as the Lord had commanded. ¹² And the children of Israel said to Moses: Behold we are consumed, we all perish. ¹³ Whosoever approacheth to the tabernacle of the Lord, he dieth. Are we all to a man to be utterly destroyed?

79. Meriba; the death of Aaron

Numbers 20:1-30

20 ¹ And the children of Israel, and all the multitude came into the desert of Sin, in the first month: and the people abode in Cades. And Mary died there, and was buried in the same place. ² And the people wanting water, came together against Moses and Aaron: ³ And making a sedition, they said: Would God we had perished among our brethren before the Lord. ⁴ Why have you brought out the church of the Lord into the wilderness, that both we and our cattle should die? ⁵ Why have you made us come up out of Egypt, and have brought us into this wretched place which cannot be sowed, nor bringeth forth figs, nor vines, nor pomegranates, neither is there any water to drink? ⁶ And Moses and Aaron leaving the multitude, went into the tabernacle of the covenant, and fell flat upon the ground, and cried to the Lord, and said. O Lord God, hear the cry of this people, and open to them thy treasure, a fountain of living water, that being satisfied, they may cease to murmur. And the glory of the Lord appeared over them. ⁷ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ⁸ Take the rod, and assemble the people together, thou and Aaron thy brother,

and speak to the rock before them, and it shall yield waters. And when thou hast brought forth water out of the rock, all the multitude and their cattle shall drink. ⁹ Moses therefore took the rod, which was before the Lord, as he had commanded him, ¹⁰ And having gathered together the multitude before the rock, he said to them: Hear, ye rebellious and incredulous: Can we bring you forth water out of this rock? ¹¹ And when Moses had lifted up his hand, and struck the rock twice with the rod, there came forth water in great abundance, so that the people and their cattle drank,

¹² And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: Because you have not believed me, to sanctify me before the children of Israel, you shall not bring these people into the land, which I will give them. ¹³ This is the Water of contradiction, where the children of Israel strove with words against the Lord, and he was sanctified in them.

¹⁴ In the mean time Moses sent messengers from Cades to the king of Edom, to say: Thus saith thy brother Israel: Thou knowest all the labour that hath come upon us: ¹⁵ In what manner our fathers went down into Egypt, and there we dwelt a long time, and the Egyptians afflicted us and our fathers. ¹⁶ And how we cried to the Lord, and he heard us, and sent an angel, who hath brought us out of Egypt. Lo, we are now in the city of Cades, which is in the uttermost of thy borders, ¹⁷ And we beseech thee that we may have leave to pass through thy country. We will not go through the fields, nor through the vineyards, we will not drink the waters of thy wells, but we will go by the common highway, neither turning aside to the right hand, nor to the left, till we are past thy borders. ¹⁸ And Edom answered them: Thou shalt not pass by me: if thou dost I will come out armed against thee. ¹⁹ And the children of Israel said: We will go by the beaten way: and if we and our cattle drink of thy waters, we will give thee what is just: there shall be no difficulty in the price, only let us pass speedily. ²⁰ But he answered: Thou shalt not pass. And immediately he came forth to meet them with an infinite multitude, and a strong hand, ²¹ Neither would he condescend to their desire to grant them passage through his borders. Wherefore Israel turned another way from him.

²² And when they had removed the camp from Cades, they came to mount Hor, which is in the borders of the land of Edom: ²³ Where the Lord spoke to Moses: ²⁴ Let Aaron, saith he, go to his people: for he shall not go into the land which I have given the children of Israel, because he was incredulous to my words, at the waters of contradiction. ²⁵ Take Aaron and his son with him, and bring them up into mount Hor: ²⁶ And when thou hast stripped the father of his vesture, thou shalt vest therewith Eleazar his son: Aaron shall be gathered to his people, and die there. ²⁷ Moses did as the Lord had commanded: and they went up into mount Hor before all the multitude. ²⁸ And when he had stripped Aaron of his vestments, he vested Eleazar his son with them. ²⁹ And Aaron being dead in the top of the mountain, he came down with Eleazar. ³⁰ And all the multitude seeing that Aaron was dead, mourned for him thirty days throughout all their families.

80. The brazen serpent*Numbers 21:1-35*

Read again in St. John 3:14, which this plan also reads.

21 ¹ And when king Arad the Chanaanite, who dwelt towards the south, had heard this, to wit, that Israel was come by the way of the spies, he fought against them, and overcoming them carried off their spoils. ² But Israel binding himself by vow to the Lord, said: If thou wilt deliver this people into my hand, I will utterly destroy their cities. ³ And the Lord heard the prayers of Israel, and delivered up the Chanaanite, and they cut them off and destroyed their cities: and they called the name of that place Horma, that is to say, Anathema.

⁴ And they marched from mount Hor, by the way that leadeth to the Red Sea, to compass the land of Edom. And the people began to be weary of their journey and labour: ⁵ And speaking against God and Moses, they said: Why didst thou bring us out of Egypt, to die in the wilderness? There is no bread, nor have we any waters: our soul now loatheth this very light food. ⁶ Wherefore the Lord sent among the people fiery serpents, which bit them and killed many of them. ⁷ Upon which they came to Moses, and said; We have sinned, because we have spoken against the Lord and thee: pray that he may take away these serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people. ⁸ And the Lord said to him: Make a brazen serpent, and set it up for a sign: whosoever being struck shall look on it, shall live. ⁹ Moses therefore made a brazen serpent, and set it up for a sign: which when they that were bitten looked upon, they were healed.

¹⁰ And the children of Israel setting forwards camped in Oboth. ¹¹ And departing thence they pitched their tents in Jeabarim, in the wilderness, that faceth Moab toward the east. ¹² And removing from thence, they came to the torrent Zared: ¹³ Which they left and encamped over against Arnon, which is in the desert and standeth out on the borders of the Amorrite. For Arnon is the border of Moab, dividing the Moabites and the Amorrites. ¹⁴ Wherefore it is said in the book of the wars of the Lord: As he did in the Red Sea, so will he do in the streams of Arnon. ¹⁵ The rocks of the torrents were bowed down that they might rest in Ar, and lie down in the borders of the Moabites. ¹⁶ When they went from that place, the well appeared whereof the Lord said to Moses: Gather the people together, and I will give them water.

¹⁷ Then Israel sung this song: Let the well spring up. They sung thereto: ¹⁸ The well, which the princes dug, and the chiefs of the people prepared by the direction of the lawgiver, and with their staves. And they marched from the wilderness to Mathana.

¹⁹ From Mathana unto Nahaliel: from Nahaliel unto Bamoth.

²⁰ From Bamoth, is a valley in the country of Moab, to the top of Phasga, which looked towards the desert. ²¹ And Israel sent messengers to Sehon king of the Amorrites, saying: ²² I beseech thee that I may have leave to pass through thy land: we will not go aside into the fields or the vineyards, we will not drink waters of the wells, we will go the king's highway, till we be past thy borders. ²³ And he would not grant that Israel should pass by his borders: but rather gathering an army, went forth to meet them in the desert, and came to Jasa and fought against them. ²⁴ And he was slain by them with the edge of the sword, and they possessed his land from the Arnon unto the Jeboc, and to the confines of the children of Ammon: for the borders of the

Ammonites, were kept with a strong garrison. ²⁵ So Israel took all his cities, and dwelt in the cities of the Amorrite, to wit, in Hesebon, and in the villages thereof. ²⁶ Hesebon was the city of Sehon the king of the Amorrites, who fought against the king of Moab: and took all the land, that had been of his dominion, as far as the Arnon. ²⁷ Therefore it is said in the proverb: Come into Hesebon, let the city of Sehon be built and set up: ²⁸ A fire is gone out of Hesebon, a flame from the city of Sehon, and hath consumed Ar of the Moabites, and the inhabitants of the high places of the Arnon. ²⁹ Woe to thee Moab: thou art undone, O people of Chamos. He hath given his sons to flight, and his daughters into captivity to Sehon the king of the Amorrites. ³⁰ Their yoke is perished from Hesebon unto Dibon, they came weary to Nophe, and unto Medaba.

³¹ So Israel dwelt in the land of the Amorrite. ³² And Moses sent some to take a view of Jazer: and they took the villages of it, and conquered the inhabitants. ³³ And they turned themselves, and went up by the way of Basan, and Og the king of Basan came against them with all his people, to fight in Edrai. ³⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Fear him not, for I have delivered him and all his people, and his country into thy hand: and thou shalt do to him as thou didst to Sehon the king of the Amorrites, the inhabitant of Hesebon. ³⁵ So they slew him also with his sons, and all his people, not letting any one escape, and they possessed his land.

81. Balaam*Numbers 22:1-23:30*

22 ¹ And they went forward and encamped in the plains of Moab, over against where Jericho is situate beyond the Jordan.

² And Balac the son of Sephor, seeing all that Israel had done to the Amorrite, ³ And that the Moabites were in great fear of him, and were not able to sustain his assault, ⁴ He said to the elders of Madian: So will this people destroy all that dwell in our borders, as the ox is wont to eat the grass to the very roots. Now he was at that time king in Moab. ⁵ He sent therefore messengers to Balaam the son of Beor, a soothsayer, who dwelt by the river of the land of the children of Ammon, to call him, and to say: Behold a people is come out of Egypt, that hath covered the face of the earth, sitting over against me. ⁶ Come therefore, and curse this people, because it is mightier than I: if by any means I may beat them and drive them out of my land: for I know that he whom thou shalt bless is blessed, and he whom thou shalt curse is cursed. ⁷ And the ancients of Moab, and the elders of Madian, went with the price of divination in their hands. And where they were come to Balaam, and had told him all the words of Balac: ⁸ He answered: Tarry here this night and I will answer whatsoever the Lord shall say to me. And while they stayed with Balaam, God came and said to him: ⁹ What mean these men that are with thee? ¹⁰ He answered: Balac the son of Sephor king of the Moabites hath sent to me, ¹¹ Saying: Behold a people that is come out of Egypt, hath covered the face of the land: come and curse them, if by any means I may fight with them and drive them away. ¹² And God said to Balaam: Thou shalt not go with them, nor shalt thou curse the people: because it is blessed. ¹³ And he rose in the morning and said to the princes: Go into your country, because the Lord hath forbid me to come with

you. ¹⁴ The princes returning, said to Balac: Balaam would not come with us.

¹⁵ Then he sent many more and more noble than he had sent before: ¹⁶ Who, when they were come to Balaam, said: Thus saith Balac the son of Sephor, Delay not to come to me: ¹⁷ For I am ready to honour thee, and will give thee whatsoever thou wilt: come and curse this people. ¹⁸ Balaam answered: If Balac would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot alter the word of the Lord my God, to speak either more or less. ¹⁹ I pray you to stay here this night also, that I may know what the Lord will answer me once more. ²⁰ God therefore came to Balaam in the night, and said to him: If these men be come to call thee, arise and go with them: yet so, that thou do what I shall command thee. ²¹ Balaam arose in the morning, and saddling his ass went with them. ²² And God was angry. And an angel of the Lord stood in the way against Balaam, who sat on the ass, and had two servants with him. ²³ The ass seeing the angel standing in the way, with a drawn sword, turned herself out of the way, and went into the field. And when Balaam beat her, and had a mind to bring her again to the way, ²⁴ The angel stood in a narrow place between two walls, wherewith the vineyards were enclosed. ²⁵ And the ass seeing him, thrust herself close to the wall, and bruised the foot of the rider. But he beat her again: ²⁶ And nevertheless the angel going on to a narrow place, where there was no way to turn aside either to the right hand or to the left, stood to meet him. ²⁷ And when the ass saw the angel standing, she fell under the feet of the rider: who being angry beat her sides more vehemently with a staff. ²⁸ And the Lord opened the mouth of the ass, and she said: What have I done to thee? Why strikest thou me, lo, now this third time? ²⁹ Balaam answered: Because thou hast deserved it, and hast served me ill: I would I had a sword that I might kill thee. ³⁰ The ass said: Am not I thy beast, on which thou hast been always accustomed to ride until this present day? tell me if I ever did the like thing to thee. But he said: Never. ³¹ Forthwith the Lord opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the angel standing in the way with a drawn sword, and he worshipped him falling flat on the ground. ³² And the angel said to him: Why beatest thou thy ass these three times? I am come to withstand thee, because thy way is perverse, and contrary to me: ³³ And unless the ass had turned out of the way, giving place to me who stood against thee, I had slain thee, and she should have lived. ³⁴ Balaam said: I have sinned, not knowing that thou didst stand against me: and now if it displease thee that I go, I will return. ³⁵ The angel said: Go with these men, and see thou speak no other thing than what I shall command thee. He went therefore with the princes.

³⁶ And when Balac heard it he came forth to meet him in a town of the Moabites, that is situate in the uttermost borders of Arnon. ³⁷ And he said to Balaam: I sent messengers to call thee, why didst thou not come immediately to me? was it because I am not able to reward thy coming? ³⁸ He answered him: Lo, here I am: shall I have power to speak any other thing but that which God shall put in my mouth? ³⁹ So they went on together, and came into a city, that was in the uttermost borders of his kingdom. ⁴⁰ And when Balac had killed oxen and sheep, he sent presents to Balaam, and to the princes that were with him. ⁴¹ And

when morning was come, he brought him to the high places of Baal, and he beheld the uttermost part of the people.

23 ¹ And Balaam said to Balac: Build me here seven altars, and prepare as many calves, and the same number of rams. ² And when he had done according to the word of Balaam, they laid together a calf and a ram upon every altar. ³ And Balaam said to Balac: Stand a while by thy burnt offering, until I go, to see if perhaps the Lord will meet me, and whatsoever he shall command, I will speak to thee. ⁴ And when he was gone with speed, God met him. And Balaam speaking to him, said: I have erected seven altars, and have laid on everyone a calf and a ram. ⁵ And the Lord put the word in his mouth, and said: Return to Balac, and thus shalt thou speak. ⁶ Returning he found Balac standing by his burnt offering, with all the princes of the Moabites: ⁷ And taking up his parable, he said: Balac king of the Moabites hath brought me from Aram, from the mountains of the east: Come, said he, and curse Jacob: make haste and detest Israel. ⁸ How shall I curse him, whom God hath not cursed? By what means should I detest him, whom the Lord detesteth not? ⁹ I shall see him from the tops of the rocks, and shall consider him from the hills. This people shall dwell alone, and shall not be reckoned among the nations. ¹⁰ Who can count the dust of Jacob, and know the number of the stock of Israel? Let my soul die the death of the just, and my last end be like to them. ¹¹ And Balac said to Balaam: What is this that thou dost? I sent for thee to curse my enemies: and thou contrariwise blessest them. ¹² He answered him: Can I speak any thing else but what the Lord commandeth?

¹³ Balac therefore said: Come with me to another place from whence thou mayest see part of Israel, and canst not see them all: curse them from thence.

¹⁴ And when he had brought him to a high place, upon the top of mount Phasga, Balaam built seven altars, and laying on every one a calf and a ram, ¹⁵ He said to Balac: Stand here by thy burnt offering while I go to meet him. ¹⁶ And when the Lord had met him, and had put the word in his mouth, he said: Return to Balac, and thus shalt thou say to him. ¹⁷ Returning he found him standing by his burnt sacrifice, and the princes of the Moabites with him. And Balac said to him: What hath the Lord spoken? ¹⁸ But he taking up his parable, said: Stand, O Balac, and give ear: hear, thou son of Sephor: ¹⁹ God is not a man, that he should lie, nor is the son of man, that he should be changed. Hath he said then, and will he not do? hath he spoken, and will he not fulfil? ²⁰ I was brought to bless, the blessing I am not able to hinder. ²¹ There is no idol in Jacob, neither is there an image god to be seen in Israel. The Lord his God is with him, and the sound of the victory of the king in him. ²² God hath brought him out of Egypt, whose strength is like to the rhinoceros. ²³ There is no soothsaying in Jacob, nor divination in Israel. In their times it shall be told to Jacob and to Israel what God hath wrought. ²⁴ Behold the people shall rise up as a lioness, and shall lift itself up as a lion: it shall not lie down till it devour the prey, and drink the blood of the slain.

²⁵ And Balac said to Balaam: Neither curse, nor bless him. ²⁶ And he said: Did I not tell thee, that whatsoever God should command me, that I would do?

²⁷ And Balac said to him: Come and I will bring thee to another place; if peradventure it please God that thou mayest curse them from thence. ²⁸ And when he had brought him upon the top of mount Phogor, which looketh towards the wilderness, ²⁹ Balaam said to him: Build me here seven altars, and prepare as many calves, and the same number of rams. ³⁰ Balac did as Balaam had said: and he laid on every altar, a calf and a ram.

82. "A star shall rise out of Jacob"

Numbers 24:1-25

24 ¹ And when Balaam saw that it pleased the Lord that he should bless Israel, he went not as he had gone before, to seek divination: but setting his face towards the desert, ² And lifting up his eyes, he saw Israel abiding in their tents by their tribes: and the spirit of God rushing upon him, ³ He took up his parable and said: Balaam the son of Beor hath said: The man hath said, whose eye is stopped up: ⁴ The hearer of the words of God hath said, he that hath beheld the vision of the Almighty, he that falleth, and so his eyes are opened: ⁵ How beautiful are thy tabernacles O Jacob, and thy tents, O Israel! ⁶ As woody valleys, as watered gardens near the rivers, as tabernacles which the Lord hath pitched, as cedars by the waterside. ⁷ Water shall flow out of his bucket, and his seed shall be in many waters. For Agag his king shall be removed, and his kingdom shall be taken away. ⁸ God hath brought him out of Egypt, whose strength is like to the rhinoceros. They shall devour the nations that are his enemies, and break their bones, and pierce them with arrows. ⁹ Lying down he hath slept as a lion, and as a lioness, whom none shall dare to rouse. He that blesseth thee, shall also himself be blessed: he that curseth thee shall be reckoned accursed.

¹⁰ And Balac being angry against Balaam, clapped his hands together and said: I called thee to curse my enemies, and thou on the contrary hast blessed them three times. ¹¹ Return to thy place. I had determined indeed greatly to honour thee, but the Lord hath deprived thee of the honour designed for thee. ¹² Balaam made answer to Balac: Did I not say to thy messengers, whom thou sentest to me: ¹³ If Balac would give me his house full of silver and gold, I cannot go beyond the word of the Lord my God, to utter any thing of my own head either good or evil: but whatsoever the Lord shall say, that I will speak? ¹⁴ But yet going to my people, I will give thee counsel, what this people shall do to thy people in the latter days.

¹⁵ Therefore taking up his parable, again he said: Balaam the son of Beor hath said: The man whose eye is stopped up, hath said: ¹⁶ The hearer of the words of God hath said, who knoweth the doctrine of the Highest, and seeth the visions of the Almighty, who falling hath his eyes opened: ¹⁷ I shall see him, but not now: I shall behold him, but not near. A STAR SHALL RISE out of Jacob and a sceptre shall spring up from Israel: and shall strike the chiefs of Moab, and shall waste all the children of Seth ¹⁸ And he shall possess Idumea: the inheritance of Seir shall come to their enemies, but Israel shall do manfully. ¹⁹ Out of Jacob shall he come that shall rule, and shall destroy the remains of the city.

²⁰ And when he saw Amalec, he took up his parable, and said: Amalec the beginning of nations, whose latter ends shall be destroyed. ²¹ He saw also the Cinite: and took up his parable, and said: Thy habitation indeed is strong: but though thou build thy nest in a rock, ²² And thou be chosen of the stock of Cin,

how long shalt thou be able to continue? For Assur shall take thee captive. ²³ And taking up his parable, again he said: Alas, who shall live when God shall do these things? ²⁴ They shall come in galleys from Italy, they shall overcome the Assyrians, and shall waste the Hebrews, and at the last they themselves also shall perish. ²⁵ And Balaam rose, and returned to his place: Balac also returned the way that he came.

83. Beelphegor, and the zeal of Phinees

Numbers 25:1-18

25 ¹ And Israel at that time abode in Settim, and the people committed fornication with the daughters of Moab, ² Who called them to their sacrifices. And they ate of them, and adored their gods. ³ And Israel was initiated to Beelphegor: upon which the Lord being angry, ⁴ Said to Moses: Take all the princes of the people, and hang them up on gibbets against the sun: that my fury may be turned away from Israel. ⁵ And Moses said to the judges of Israel: Let every man kill his neighbours, that have been initiated to Beelphegor.

⁶ And behold one of the children of Israel went in before his brethren to a harlot of Madian, in the sight of Moses and of all the children of Israel, who were weeping before the door of the tabernacle. ⁷ And when Phinees the son of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest saw it, he rose up from the midst of the multitude, and taking a dagger, ⁸ Went in after the Israelite into the brothel house, and thrust both of them through together, to wit, the man and the woman in the genital parts. And the scourge ceased from the children of Israel. ⁹ And there were slain four and twenty thousand men.

¹⁰ And the Lord said to Moses: ¹¹ Phinees the son of Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, hath turned away my wrath from the children of Israel: because he was moved with my zeal against them, that I myself might not destroy the children of Israel in my zeal. ¹² Therefore say to him: behold I give him the peace of my covenant, ¹³ And the covenant of the priesthood for ever shall be both to him and his seed, because he hath been zealous for his God, and hath made atonement for the wickedness of the children of Israel. ¹⁴ And the name of the Israelite, that was slain with the woman of Madian, was Zambri the son of Salu, a prince of the kindred and tribe of Simeon. ¹⁵ And the Madianite woman, that was slain with him, was called Cozbi the daughter of Sur, a most noble prince among the Madianites.

¹⁶ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ¹⁷ Let the Madianites find you their enemies, and slay you them: ¹⁸ Because they also have acted like enemies against you, and have guilefully deceived you by the idol Phogor, and Cozbi their sister, a daughter of a prince of Madian, who was slain in the day of the plague for the sacrilege of Phogor.

84. The daughters of Salphaad; Josue appointed

Numbers 27:1-23

27 ¹ Then came the daughters of Salphaad, the son of Hopher, the son of Galaad, the son of Machir, the son of Manasses, who was the son of Joseph: and their names are Maala, and Noa, and Hegla, and Melcha, and Thersa. ² And they stood before Moses and Eleazar the priest, and all the princes of the people at the door of the tabernacle of the covenant, and said: ³ Our father died

in the desert, and was not in the sedition, that was raised against the Lord under Core, but he died in his own sin: and he had no male children. Why is his name taken away out of his family, because he had no son? Give us a possession among the kinsmen of our father. ⁴ And Moses referred their cause to the judgment of the Lord. ⁵ And the Lord said to him: ⁶ The daughters of Salphaad demand a just thing: Give them a possession among their father's kindred, and let them succeed him in his inheritance. ⁷ And to the children of Israel thou shalt speak these things: ⁸ When a man dieth without a son, his inheritance shall pass to his daughter. ⁹ If he have no daughter, his brethren shall succeed him. ¹⁰ And if he have no brethren, you shall give the inheritance to his father's brethren. ¹¹ But if he have no uncles by the father, the inheritance shall be given to them that are the next akin. And this shall be to the children of Israel sacred by a perpetual law, as the Lord hath commanded Moses.

¹² The Lord also said to Moses: Go up into this mountain Abarim, and view from thence the land which I will give to the children of Israel. ¹³ And when thou shalt have seen it, thou also shalt go to thy people, as thy brother Aaron is gone: ¹⁴ Because you offended me in the desert of Sin in the contradiction of the multitude, neither would you sanctify me before them at the waters. These are the waters of contradiction in Cades of the desert of Sin.

¹⁵ And Moses answered him: ¹⁶ May the Lord the God of the spirits of all flesh provide a man, that may be over this multitude: ¹⁷ And may go out and in before them, and may lead them out, or bring them in: lest the people of the Lord be as sheep without a shepherd.

¹⁸ And the Lord said to him: take Josue the son of Nun, a man in whom is the Spirit, and put thy hand upon him. ¹⁹ And he shall stand before Eleazar the priest and all the multitude: ²⁰ And thou shalt give him precepts in the sight of all, and part of thy glory, that all the congregation of the children of Israel may hear him. ²¹ If any thing be to be done, Eleazar the priest shall consult the Lord for him. He and all the children of Israel with him, and the rest of the multitude shall go out and go in at his word. ²² Moses did as the Lord had commanded. And, when he had taken Josue, he set him before Eleazar the priest, and all the assembly of the people, ²³ And laying his hands on his head, he repeated all things that the Lord had commanded.

85. *Madian, the land beyond Jordan, and the stations of the journey*

Numbers 31:1-33:56

Chapter 33 is an itinerary rather than a narrative, kept because it is the desert generation's whole record.

31 ¹ And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: ² Revenge first the children of Israel on the Madianites, and so thou shalt be gathered to thy people. ³ And Moses forthwith said: Arm of you men to fight, who may take the revenge of the Lord on the Madianites. ⁴ Let a thousand men be chosen out of every tribe of Israel to be sent to the war. ⁵ And they gave a thousand of every tribe, that is to say, twelve thousand men well appointed for battle. ⁶ And Moses sent them with Phinees the son of Eleazar the priest, and he delivered to him the holy vessels, and the trumpets to sound. ⁷ And when they had fought against the Madianites and had

overcome them, they slew all the men. ⁸ And their kings Evi, and Recem, and Sur, and Hur, and Rebe, five princes of the nation: Balaam also the son of Beor they killed with the sword. ⁹ And they took their women, and their children captives, and all their cattle, and all their goods: and all their possessions they plundered: ¹⁰ And all their cities, and their villages, and castles, they burned. ¹¹ And they carried away the booty, and all that they had taken both of men and of beasts. ¹² And they brought them to Moses, and Eleazar the priest, and to all the multitude of the children of Israel. But the rest of the things for use they carried to the camp on the plains of Moab, beside the Jordan over against Jericho. ¹³ And Moses and Eleazar the priest and all the princes of the synagogue went forth to meet them without the camp. ¹⁴ And Moses being angry with the chief officers of the army, the tribunes, and the centurions that were come from the battle, ¹⁵ Said: Why have you saved the women? ¹⁶ Are not these they, that deceived the children of Israel by the counsel of Balaam, and made you transgress against the Lord by the sin of Phogor, for which also the people was punished? ¹⁷ Therefore kill all that are of the male sex, even of the children: and put to death the women, that have carnally known men. ¹⁸ But the girls, and all the women that are virgins save for yourselves: ¹⁹ And stay without the camp seven days. He that hath killed a man, or touched one that is killed, shall be purified the third day and the seventh day. ²⁰ And of all the spoil, every garment, or vessel, or any thing made for use, of the skins, or hair of goats, or of wood, shall be purified.

²¹ Eleazar also the priest spoke to the men of the army, that had fought, in this manner: This is the ordinance of the law, which the Lord hath commanded Moses: ²² Gold, and silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin, ²³ And all that may pass through the fire, shall be purified by fire, but whatsoever cannot abide the fire, shall be sanctified with the water of expiation: ²⁴ And you shall wash your garments the seventh day, and being purified, you shall afterwards enter into the camp.

²⁵ And the Lord said to Moses: ²⁶ Take the sum of the things that were taken both of man and beast, thou and Eleazar the priest and the princes of the multitude: ²⁷ And thou shalt divide the spoil equally, between them that fought and went out to the war, and between the rest of the multitude. ²⁸ And thou shalt separate a portion to the Lord from them that fought and were in the battle, one soul of five hundred as well of persons as of oxen and asses and sheep. ²⁹ And thou shalt give it to Eleazar the priest, because they are the firstfruits of the Lord. ³⁰ Out of the moiety also of the children of Israel thou shalt take the fiftieth head of persons, and of oxen, and asses, and sheep, and of all beasts, and thou shalt give them to the Levites that watch in the charge of the tabernacle of the Lord. ³¹ And Moses and Eleazar did as the Lord had commanded. ³² And the spoil which the army had taken, was six hundred seventy-five thousand sheep, ³³ Seventy-two thousand oxen, ³⁴ Sixty-one thousand asses: ³⁵ And thirty-two thousand persons of the female sex, that had not known men. ³⁶ And one half was given to them that had been in the battle, to wit, three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep: ³⁷ Out of which, for the portion of the Lord, were reckoned six hundred seventy five sheep. ³⁸ And out of the thirty-six thousand oxen, seventy-two oxen: ³⁹ Out of

the thirty thousand five hundred asses, sixty-one asses: ⁴⁰ Out of the sixteen thousand persons, there fell to the portion of the Lord, thirty-two souls. ⁴¹ And Moses delivered the number of the firstfruits of the Lord to Eleazar the priest, as had been commanded him, ⁴² Out of the half of the children of Israel, which he had separated for them that had been in the battle. ⁴³ But out of the half that fell to the rest of the multitude, that is to say, out of the three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep, ⁴⁴ And out of the thirty-six thousand oxen, ⁴⁵ And out of the thirty thousand five hundred asses, ⁴⁶ And out of the sixteen thousand persons, ⁴⁷ Moses took the fiftieth head, and gave it to the Levites that watched in the tabernacle of the Lord, as the Lord had commanded.

⁴⁸ And when the commanders of the army, and the tribunes and centurions were come to Moses, they said: ⁴⁹ We thy servants have reckoned up the number of the fighting men, whom we had under our hand, and not so much as one was wanting. ⁵⁰ Therefore we offer as gifts to the Lord what gold every one of us could find in the booty, in garters and tablets, rings and bracelets, and chains, that thou mayst pray to the Lord for us. ⁵¹ And Moses and Eleazar the priest received all the gold in divers kinds, ⁵² In weight sixteen thousand seven hundred and fifty sicles, from the tribunes and from the centurions. ⁵³ For that which every one had taken in the booty was his own. ⁵⁴ And that which was received they brought into the tabernacle of the testimony, for a memorial of the children of Israel before the Lord.

32 ¹ And the sons of Ruben and Gad had many flocks of cattle, and their substance in beasts was infinite. And when they saw the lands of Jazer and Galaad fit for feeding cattle, ² They came to Moses and Eleazar the priest, and the princes of the multitude, and said: ³ Ataroth, and Dibon, and Jazer, and Nemra, Hesebon, and Eleale, and Saban, and Nebo, and Beon, ⁴ The land, which the Lord hath conquered in the sight of the children of Israel, is a very fertile soil for the feeding of beasts: and we thy servants have very much cattle: ⁵ And we pray thee, if we have found favour in thy sight, that thou give it to us thy servants in possession, and make us not pass over the Jordan.

⁶ And Moses answered them: What, shall your brethren go to fight, and will you sit here? ⁷ Why do ye overturn the minds of the children of Israel, that they may not dare to pass into the place which the Lord hath given them? ⁸ Was it not thus your fathers did, when I sent from Cadesbarne to view the land? ⁹ And when they were come as far as the valley of the cluster, having viewed all the country, they overturned the hearts of the children of Israel, that they should not enter into the coasts, which the Lord gave them. ¹⁰ And he swore in his anger, saying: ¹¹ If these men, that came up out of Egypt, from twenty years old and upward, shall see the land, which I promised with an oath to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: because they would not follow me, ¹² Except Caleb the son of Jephone the Cenezite, and Josue the son of Nun: these have fulfilled my will. ¹³ And the Lord being angry against Israel, led them about through the desert forty years, until the whole generation, that had done evil in his sight, was consumed. ¹⁴ And behold, said he, you are risen up instead of your fathers, the increase and offspring of sinful men, to augment the fury of the Lord against Israel. ¹⁵ For if you will

not follow him, he will leave the people in the wilderness, and you shall be the cause of the destruction of all.

¹⁶ But they coming near, said: We will make sheepfolds, and stalls for our cattle, and strong cities for our children: ¹⁷ And we ourselves will go armed and ready for battle before the children of Israel, until we bring them in unto their places. Our little ones, and all we have, shall be in walled cities, for fear of the ambushes of the inhabitants. ¹⁸ We will not return into our houses until the children of Israel possess their inheritance: ¹⁹ Neither will we seek any thing beyond the Jordan, because we have already our possession on the east side thereof,

²⁰ And Moses said to them: If you do what you promise, go on well appointed for war before the Lord: ²¹ And let every fighting man pass over the Jordan, until the Lord overthrow his enemies: ²² And all the land be brought under him, then shall you be blameless before the Lord and before Israel, and you shall obtain the countries that you desire, before the Lord. ²³ But if you do not what you say, no man can doubt but you sin against God: and know ye, that your sin shall overtake you. ²⁴ Build therefore cities for your children, and folds and stalls for your sheep and beasts, and accomplish what you have promised. ²⁵ And the children of Gad and Ruben said to Moses: We are thy servants, we will do what my lord commandeth. ²⁶ We will leave our children, and our wives and sheep and cattle, in the cities of Galaad: ²⁷ And we thy servants all well appointed will march on to the war, as thou, my lord, speakest.

²⁸ Moses therefore commanded Eleazar the priest, and Josue the son of Nun, and the princes of the families of all the tribes of Israel, and said to them: ²⁹ If the children of Gad, and the children of Ruben pass with you over the Jordan, all armed for war before the Lord, and the land be made subject to you: give them Galaad in possession. ³⁰ But if they will not pass armed with you into the land of Chanaan, let them receive places to dwell in among you. ³¹ And the children of Gad, and the children of Ruben answered: As the Lord hath spoken to his servants, so will we do: ³² We will go armed before the Lord into the land of Chanaan, and we confess that we have already received our possession beyond the Jordan. ³³ Moses therefore gave to the children of Gad and of Ruben, and to the half tribe of Manasses the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sehon king of the Amorrites, and the kingdom of Og king of Basan, and their land and the cities thereof round about. ³⁴ And the sons of Gad built Dibon, and Ataroth, and Aroer, ³⁵ And Etroth, and Sophan, and Jazer, and Jegbaa, ³⁶ And Bethnemra, and Betharan, fenced cities, and folds for their cattle. ³⁷ But the children of Ruben built Hesebon, and Eleale, and Cariathaim, ³⁸ And Nabo, and Baalmeon (their names being changed) and Sabama: giving names to the cities which they had built. ³⁹ Moreover the children of Machir, the son of Manasses, went into Galaad, and wasted it, cutting off the Amorrites, the inhabitants thereof. ⁴⁰ And Moses gave the land of Galaad to Machir the son of Manasses, and he dwelt in it. ⁴¹ And Jair the son of Manasses went, and took the villages thereof, and he called them Havoth Jair, that is to say, the villages of Jair. ⁴² Nobe also went, and took Canath with the villages thereof: and he called it by his own name, Nobe.

33 ¹ These are the mansions of the children of Israel, who went out of Egypt by their troops under the conduct of Moses and

Aaron, ² Which Moses wrote down according to the places of their encamping, which they changed by the commandment of the Lord. ³ Now the children of Israel departed from Ramesses the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month, the day after the phase, with a mighty hand, in the sight of all the Egyptians, ⁴ Who were burying their firstborn, whom the Lord had slain (upon their gods also he had executed vengeance,) ⁵ And they camped in Soccoth. ⁶ And from Soccoth they came into Etham, which is in the uttermost borders of the wilderness. ⁷ Departing from thence they came over against Phihahiroth, which looketh towards Beelsephon, and they camped before Magdalum. ⁸ And departing from Phihahiroth, they passed through the midst of the sea into the wilderness: and having marched three days through the desert of Etham, they camped in Mara. ⁹ And departing from Mara, they came into Elim, where there were twelve fountains of waters, and seventy palm trees: and there they camped. ¹⁰ But departing from thence also, they pitched their tents by the Red Sea. And departing from the Red Sea, ¹¹ They camped in the desert of Sin. ¹² And they removed from thence, and came to Daphca. ¹³ And departing from Daphca, they camped in Alus. ¹⁴ And departing from Alus, they pitched their tents in Raphidim, where the people wanted water to drink. ¹⁵ And departing from Raphidim, they camped in the desert of Sinai. ¹⁶ But departing also from the desert of Sinai, they came to the graves of lust. ¹⁷ And departing from the graves of lust, they camped in Haseroth. ¹⁸ And from Haseroth they came to Rethma. ¹⁹ And departing from Rethma, they camped in Remmomphares. ²⁰ And they departed from thence and came to Lebna. ²¹ Removing from Lebna they camped in Ressa. ²² And departing from Ressa, they came to Ceelatha. ²³ And they removed from thence and camped in the mountain Sepher. ²⁴ Departing from the mountain Sepher, they came to Arada. ²⁵ From thence they went and camped in Maceloth. ²⁶ And departing from Maceloth, they came to Thahath. ²⁷ Removing from Thahath they camped in Thare. ²⁸ And they departed from thence, and pitched their tents in Methca. ²⁹ And removing from Methca, they camped in Hesmona. ³⁰ And departing from Hesmona, they came to Moseroth. ³¹ And removing from Moseroth, they camped in Benejaacan. ³² And departing from Benejaacan, they came to mount Gadgad. ³³ From thence they went and camped in Jetebatha. ³⁴ And from Jetebatha they came to Hebrona. ³⁵ And departing from Hebrona, they camped in Asiongaber. ³⁶ They removed from thence and came into the desert of Sin, which is Cades. ³⁷ And departing from Cades, they camped in mount Hor, in the uttermost borders of the land of Edom. ³⁸ And Aaron the priest went up into mount Hor at the commandment of the Lord: and there he died in the fortieth year of the coming forth of the children of Israel out of Egypt, the fifth month, the first day of the month, ³⁹ When he was a hundred and twenty-three years old. ⁴⁰ And king Arad the Chanaanite, who dwelt towards the south, heard that the children of Israel were come to the land of Chanaan. ⁴¹ And they departed from mount Hor, and camped in Salmona. ⁴² From whence they removed and came to Phunon. ⁴³ And departing from Phunon, they camped in Oboth. ⁴⁴ And from Oboth they came to Ijeabarim, which is in the borders of the Moabites. ⁴⁵ And departing from Ijeabarim they pitched their tents in Dibongab. ⁴⁶ From thence they went and camped in Helmonde-

blathaim. ⁴⁷ And departing from Helmondeblathaim, they came to the mountains of Abarim over against Nabo. ⁴⁸ And departing from the mountains of Abarim, they passed to the plains of Moab, by the Jordan, over against Jericho. ⁴⁹ And there they camped from Bethsimoth even to Ablesatim in the plains of the Moabites, ⁵⁰ Where the Lord said to Moses: ⁵¹ Command the children of Israel, and say to them: When you shall have passed over the Jordan, entering into the land of Chanaan, ⁵² Destroy all the inhabitants of that land: Beat down their pillars, and break in pieces their statues, and waste all their high places, ⁵³ Cleansing the land, and dwelling in it. For I have given it you for a possession. ⁵⁴ And you shall divide it among you by lot. To the more you shall give a larger part, and to the fewer a lesser. To every one as the lot shall fall, so shall the inheritance be given. The possession shall be divided by the tribes and the families. ⁵⁵ But if you will not kill the inhabitants of the land: they that remain, shall be unto you as nails in your eyes, and spears in your sides, and they shall be your adversaries in the land of your habitation. ⁵⁶ And whatsoever I had thought to do to them, I will do to you.

86. Moses recalls the way from Horeb

Deuteronomy 1:1-3:29

1 ¹ These are the words, which Moses spoke to all Israel beyond the Jordan, in the plain wilderness, over against the Red Sea, between Pharan and Thophel and Laban and Haseroth, where there is very much gold. ² Eleven days' journey from Horeb by the way of mount Seir to Cadesbarne. ³ In the fortieth year, the eleventh month, the first day of the month, Moses spoke to the children of Israel all that the Lord had commanded him to say to them: ⁴ After that he had slain Sehon king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Hesebon: and Og king of Basan who abode in Astaroth, and in Edrai, ⁵ Beyond the Jordan in the land of Moab. And Moses began to expound the law, and to say: ⁶ The Lord our God spoke to us in Horeb, saying: You have stayed long enough in this mountain: ⁷ Turn you, and come to the mountain of the Amorrites, and to the other places that are next to it, the plains and the hills and the vales towards the south, and by the sea shore, the land of the Chanaanites, and of Libanus, as far as the great river Euphrates. ⁸ Behold, said he, I have delivered it to you: go in and possess it, concerning which the Lord swore to your fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, that he would give it to them, and to their seed after them.

⁹ And I said to you at that time: ¹⁰ I alone am not able to bear you: for the Lord your God hath multiplied you, and you are this day as the stars of heaven, for multitude. ¹¹ (The Lord God of your fathers add to this number many thousands, and bless you as he hath spoken.) ¹² I alone am not able to bear your business, and the charge of you and your differences. ¹³ Let me have from among you wise and understanding men, and such whose conversation is approved among your tribes, that I may appoint them your rulers. ¹⁴ Then you answered me: The thing is good which thou meanest to do. ¹⁵ And I took out of your tribes men wise and honourable, and appointed them rulers, tribunes, and centurions, and officers over fifties, and over tens, who might teach you all things. ¹⁶ And I commanded them, saying: Hear them, and judge that which is just: whether he be one of your country, or a stranger. ¹⁷ There shall be no difference of persons, you shall hear the little as well as the great: neither shall you

respect any man's person, because it is the judgment of God. And if any thing seem hard to you, refer it to me, and I will hear it. ¹⁸ And I commanded you all things that you were to do. ¹⁹ And departing from Horeb, we passed through the terrible and vast wilderness, which you saw, by the way of the mountain of the Amorrite, as the Lord our God had commanded us. And when we were come into Cadesbarne, ²⁰ I said to you: You are come to the mountain of the Amorrite, which the Lord our God will give to us. ²¹ See the land which the Lord thy God giveth thee: go up and possess it, as the Lord our God hath spoken to thy fathers: fear not, nor be any way discouraged.

²² And you came all to me, and said: Let us send men who may view the land, and bring us word what way we shall go up, and to what cities we shall go. ²³ And because the saying pleased me, I sent of you twelve men, one of every tribe: ²⁴ Who, when they had set forward and had gone up to the mountains, came as far as the valley of the cluster: and having viewed the land, ²⁵ Taking of the fruits thereof, to shew its fertility, they brought them to us, and said: The land is good, which the Lord our God will give us. ²⁶ And you would not go up, but being incredulous to the word of the Lord our God, ²⁷ You murmured in your tents, and said: The Lord hateth us, and therefore he hath brought us out of the land of Egypt, that he might deliver us into the hand of the Amorrite, and destroy us. ²⁸ Whither shall we go up? the messengers have terrified our hearts, saying: The multitude is very great, and taller than we: the cities are great, and walled up to the sky, we have seen the sons of the Enacims there. ²⁹ And I said to you: Fear not, neither be ye afraid of them: ³⁰ The Lord God, who is your leader, himself will fight for you, as he did in Egypt in the sight of all. ³¹ And in the wilderness (as thou hast seen) the Lord thy God hath carried thee, as a man is wont to carry his little son, all the way that you have come, until you came to this place. ³² And yet for all this you did not believe the Lord your God, ³³ Who went before you in the way, and marked out the place, wherein you should pitch your tents, in the night shewing you the way by fire, and in the day by the pillar of a cloud. ³⁴ And when the Lord had heard the voice of your words, he was angry and swore, and said: ³⁵ Not one of the men of this wicked generation shall see the good land, which I promised with an oath to your fathers: ³⁶ Except Caleb the son of Jephone: for he shall see it, and to him I will give the land that he hath trodden upon, and to his children, because he hath followed the Lord. ³⁷ Neither is his indignation against the people to be wondered at, since the Lord was angry with me also on your account, and said: Neither shalt thou go in thither. ³⁸ But Josue the son of Nun, thy minister, he shall go in for thee: exhort and encourage him, and he shall divide the land by lot to Israel. ³⁹ Your children, of whom you said that they should be led away captives, and your sons who know not this day the difference of good and evil, they shall go in: and to them I will give the land, and they shall possess it. ⁴⁰ But return you and go into the wilderness by the way of the Red Sea. ⁴¹ And you answered me: We have sinned against the Lord: we will go up and fight, as the Lord our God hath commanded. And when you went ready armed unto the mountain, ⁴² The Lord said to me: Say to them: Go not up, and fight not, for I am not with you: lest you fall before your enemies. ⁴³ I spoke, and you hearkened not:

but resisting the commandment of the Lord, and swelling with pride, you went up into the mountain. ⁴⁴ And the Amorrite that dwelt in the mountains coming out, and meeting you, chased you, as bees do: and made slaughter of you from Seir as far as Horma. ⁴⁵ And when you returned and wept before the Lord, he heard you not, neither would he yield to your voice. ⁴⁶ So you abode in Cadesbarne a long time.

2 ¹ And departing from thence we came into the wilderness that leadeth to the Red Sea, as the Lord had spoken to me: and we compassed mount Seir a long time. ² And the Lord said to me: ³ You have compassed this mountain long enough: go toward the north: ⁴ And command thou the people, saying: You shall pass by the borders of your brethren the children of Esau, who dwell in Seir, and they will be afraid of you. ⁵ Take ye then good heed that you stir not against them. For I will not give you of their land so much as the step of one foot can tread upon, because I have given mount Seir to Esau, for a possession. ⁶ You shall buy meats of them for money and shall eat: you shall draw waters for money, and shall drink. ⁷ The Lord thy God hath blessed thee in every work of thy hands: the Lord thy God dwelling with thee, knoweth thy journey, how thou hast passed through this great wilderness, for forty years, and thou hast wanted nothing.

⁸ And when we had passed by our brethren the children of Esau, that dwelt in Seir, by the way of the plain from Elath and from Asiongaber, we came to the way that leadeth to the desert of Moab. ⁹ And the Lord said to me: Fight not against the Moabites, neither go to battle against them: for I will not give thee any of their land, because I have given Ar to the children of Lot in possession. ¹⁰ The Emims first were the inhabitants thereof, a people great, and strong, and so tall, that like the race of the Enacims, ¹¹ They were esteemed as giants, and were like the sons of the Enacims. But the Moabites call them Emims. ¹² The Horrites also formerly dwelt in Seir: who being driven out and destroyed, the children of Esau dwelt there, as Israel did in the land of his possession, which the Lord gave him. ¹³ Then rising up to pass the torrent Zared, we came to it. ¹⁴ And the time that we journeyed from Cadesbarne till we passed over the torrent Zared, was thirty-eight years: until all the generation of the men that were fit for war was consumed out of the camp, as the Lord had sworn: ¹⁵ For his hand was against them, that they should perish from the midst of the camp. ¹⁶ And after all the fighting men were dead, ¹⁷ The Lord spoke to me, saying: ¹⁸ Thou shalt pass this day the borders of Moab, the city named Ar: ¹⁹ And when thou comest nigh the frontiers of the children of Ammon, take heed thou fight not against them, nor once move to battle: for I will not give thee of the land of the children of Ammon, because I have given it to the children of Lot for a possession. ²⁰ It was accounted a land of giants: and giants formerly dwelt in it, whom the Ammonites call Zomzommims, ²¹ A people great and many, and of tall stature, like the Enacims whom the Lord destroyed before their face: and he made them to dwell in their stead, ²² As he had done in favour of the children of Esau, that dwell in Seir, destroying the Horrites, and delivering their land to them, which they possess to this day. ²³ The Hevites also, that dwelt in Haserim as far as Gaza, were expelled by the Cappadocians: who came out of Cappadocia, and destroyed them and dwelt in their stead.

²⁴ Arise ye, and pass the torrent Arnon: Behold I have delivered into thy hand Sehon king of Hesebon the Amorrrhite, and begin thou to possess his land and make war against him. ²⁵ This day will I begin to send the dread and fear of thee upon the nations that dwell under the whole heaven: that when they hear thy name they may fear and tremble, and be in pain like women in travail.

²⁶ So I sent messengers from the wilderness of Cademoth to Sehon the king of Hesebon with peaceable words, saying: ²⁷ We will pass through thy land, we will go along by the highway: we will not turn aside neither to the right hand nor to the left. ²⁸ Sell us meat for money, that we may eat: give us water for money and so we will drink. We only ask that thou wilt let us pass through, ²⁹ As the children of Esau have done, that dwell in Seir, and the Moabites, that abide in Ar: until we come to the Jordan, and pass to the land which the Lord our God will give us. ³⁰ And Sehon the king of Hesebon would not let us pass: because the Lord thy God had hardened his spirit, and fixed his heart, that he might be delivered into thy hands, as now thou seest. ³¹ And the Lord said to me: Behold I have begun to deliver unto thee Sehon and his land, begin to possess it. ³² And Sehon came out to meet us with all his people to fight at Jasa. ³³ And the Lord our God delivered him to us: and we slew him with his sons and all his people. ³⁴ And we took all his cities at that time, killing the inhabitants of them, men and women and children. We left nothing of them: ³⁵ Except the cattle which came to the share of them that took them: and the spoils of the cities, which we took: ³⁶ From Aroer, which is upon the bank of the torrent Arnon, a town that is situate in a valley, as far as Galaad. There was not a village or city, that escaped our hands: the Lord our God delivered all unto us: ³⁷ Except the land of the children of Ammon, to which we approached not: and all that border upon the torrent Jeboc, and the cities in the mountains, and all the places which the Lord our God forbade us.

3 ¹ Then we turned and went by the way of Basan: and Og the king of Basan came out to meet us with his people to fight in Edrai. ² And the Lord said to me: Fear him not: because he is delivered into thy hand, with all his people and his land: and thou shalt do to him as thou hast done to Sehon king of the Amorrrhites, that dwelt in Hesebon. ³ So the Lord our God delivered into our hands, Og also, the king of Basan, and all his people: and we utterly destroyed them, ⁴ Wasting all his cities at one time, there was not a town that escaped us: sixty cities, all the country of Argob the kingdom of Og in Basan. ⁵ All the cities were fenced with very high walls, and with gates and bars, besides innumerable towns that had no walls. ⁶ And we utterly destroyed them, as we had done to Sehon the king of Hesebon, destroying every city, men and women and children: ⁷ But the cattle and the spoils of the cities we took for our prey. ⁸ And we took at that time the land out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorrrhites, that were beyond the Jordan: from the torrent Arnon unto the mount Hermon, ⁹ Which the Sidonians call Sarrion, and the Amorrrhites Sanir: ¹⁰ All the cities that are situate in the plain, and all the land of Galaad and Basan as far as Selcha and Edrai, cities of the kingdom of Og in Basan. ¹¹ For only Og king of Basan remained of the race of the giants. His bed of iron is shewn, which is in Rabbath of the children of Ammon, being

nine cubits long, and four broad after the measure of the cubit of a man's hand. ¹² And we possessed the land at that time from Aroer, which is upon the bank of the torrent Arnon, unto the half of mount Galaad: and I gave the cities thereof to Ruben and Gad. ¹³ And I delivered the other part of Galaad, and all Basan the kingdom of Og to the half tribe of Manasses, all the country of Argob: and all Basan is called the Land of giants. ¹⁴ Jair the son of Manasses possessed all the country of Argob unto the borders of Gessuri, and Machati. And he called Basan by his own name, Havoth Jair, that is to say, the towns of Jair, until this present day. ¹⁵ To Machir also I gave Galaad. ¹⁶ And to the tribes of Ruben and Gad I gave of the land of Galaad as far as the torrent Arnon, half the torrent, and the confines even unto the torrent Jeboc, which is the border of the children of Ammon: ¹⁷ And the plain of the wilderness, and the Jordan, and the borders of Cenereth unto the sea of the desert, which is the most salt sea, to the foot of mount Phasga eastward.

¹⁸ And I commanded you at that time, saying: The Lord your God giveth you this land for an inheritance, go ye well appointed before your brethren the children of Israel, all the strong men of you. ¹⁹ Leaving your wives and children and cattle. For I know you have much cattle, and they must remain in the cities, which I have delivered to you. ²⁰ Until the Lord give rest to your brethren, as he hath given to you: and they also possess the land, which he will give them beyond the Jordan: then shall every man return to his possession, which I have given you.

²¹ I commanded Josue also at that time, saying: Thy eyes have seen what the Lord your God hath done to these two kings: so will he do to all the kingdoms to which thou shalt pass. ²² Fear them not: for the Lord your God will fight for you. ²³ And I besought the Lord at that time, saying: ²⁴ Lord God, thou hast begun to shew unto thy servant thy greatness, and most mighty hand, for there is no other God either in heaven or earth, that is able to do thy works, or to be compared to thy strength. ²⁵ I will pass over therefore, and will see this excellent land beyond the Jordan, and this goodly mountain, and Libanus. ²⁶ And the Lord was angry with me on your account and heard me not, but said to me: It is enough: speak no more to me of this matter. ²⁷ Go up to the top of Phasga, and cast thy eyes round about to the west, and to the north, and to the south, and to the east, and behold it, for thou shalt not pass this Jordan. ²⁸ Command Josue, and encourage and strengthen him: for he shall go before this people, and shall divide unto them the land which thou shalt see. ²⁹ And we abode in the valley over against the temple of Phogor.

87. "Ask of the days of old"

Deuteronomy 4:1-49

4 ¹ And now, O Israel, hear the commandments and judgments which I teach thee: that doing them, thou mayst live, and entering in mayst possess the land which the Lord the God of your fathers will give you. ² You shall not add to the word that I speak to you, neither shall you take away from it: keep the commandments of the Lord your God which I command you. ³ Your eyes have seen all that the Lord hath done against Beelphegor, how he hath destroyed all his worshippers from among you. ⁴ But you that adhere to the Lord your God, are all alive until this present day. ⁵ You know that I have taught you statutes and justices, as the

Lord my God hath commanded me: so shall you do them in the land which you shall possess: ⁶ And you shall observe, and fulfil them in practice. For this is your wisdom, and understanding in the sight of nations, that hearing all these precepts, they may say: Behold a wise and understanding people, a great nation. ⁷ Neither is there any other nation so great, that hath gods so nigh them, as our God is present to all our petitions. ⁸ For what other nation is there so renowned that hath ceremonies, and just judgments, and all the law, which I will set forth this day before our eyes? ⁹ Keep thyself therefore, and thy soul carefully. Forget not the words that thy eyes have seen, and let them not go out of thy heart all the days of thy life. Thou shalt teach them to thy sons and to thy grandsons, ¹⁰ From the day in which thou didst stand before the Lord thy God in Horeb, when the Lord spoke to me, saying: Call together the people unto me, that they may hear my words, and may learn to fear me all the time that they live on the earth, and may teach their children. ¹¹ And you came to the foot of the mount, which burned even unto heaven: and there was darkness, and a cloud and obscurity in it. ¹² And the Lord spoke to you from the midst of the fire. You heard the voice of his words, but you saw not any form at all. ¹³ And he shewed you his covenant, which he commanded you to do, and the ten words that he wrote in two tables of stone. ¹⁴ And he commanded me at that time that I should teach you the ceremonies and judgments which you shall do in the land, that you shall possess. ¹⁵ Keep therefore your souls carefully. You saw not any similitude in the day that the Lord God spoke to you in Horeb from the midst of the fire: ¹⁶ Lest perhaps being deceived you might make you a graven similitude, or image of male or female, ¹⁷ The similitude of any beasts, that are upon the earth, or of birds, that fly under heaven, ¹⁸ Or of creeping things, that move on the earth, or of fishes, that abide in the waters under the earth: ¹⁹ Lest perhaps lifting up thy eyes to heaven, thou see the sun and the moon, and all the stars of heaven, and being deceived by error thou adore and serve them, which the Lord thy God created for the service of all the nations, that are under heaven. ²⁰ But the Lord hath taken you and brought you out of the iron furnaces of Egypt, to make you his people of inheritance, as it is this present day. ²¹ And the Lord was angry with me for your words, and he swore that I should not pass over the Jordan, nor enter into the excellent land, which he will give you. ²² Behold I die in this land, I shall not pass over the Jordan: you shall pass, and possess the goodly land. ²³ Beware lest thou ever forget the covenant of the Lord thy God, which he hath made with thee: and make to thyself a graven likeness of those things which the Lord hath forbid to be made: ²⁴ Because the Lord thy God is a consuming fire, a jealous God. ²⁵ If you shall beget sons and grandsons, and abide in the land, and being deceived, make to yourselves any similitude, committing evil before the Lord your God, to provoke him to wrath: ²⁶ I call this day heaven and earth to witness, that you shall quickly perish out of the land, which, when you have passed over the Jordan, you shall possess. You shall not dwell therein long, but the Lord will destroy you, ²⁷ And scatter you among all nations, and you shall remain a few among the nations, to which the Lord shall lead you. ²⁸ And there you shall serve gods, that were framed with men's hands: wood and stone, that neither see, nor hear,

nor eat, nor smell. ²⁹ And when thou shalt seek there the Lord thy God, thou shalt find him: yet so, if thou seek him with all thy heart, and all the affliction of thy soul. ³⁰ After all the things aforesaid shall find thee, in the latter time thou shalt return to the Lord thy God, and shalt hear his voice. ³¹ Because the Lord thy God is a merciful God: he will not leave thee, nor altogether destroy thee, nor forget the covenant, by which he swore to thy fathers. ³² Ask of the days of old, that have been before thy time from the day that God created man upon the earth, from one end of heaven to the other end thereof, if ever there was done the like thing, or it hath been known at any time, ³³ That a people should hear the voice of God speaking out of the midst of fire, as thou hast heard, and lived: ³⁴ If God ever did so as to go, and take to himself a nation out of the midst of nations by temptations, signs, and wonders, by fight, and a strong hand, and stretched out arm, and horrible visions according to all the things that the Lord your God did for you in Egypt, before thy eyes. ³⁵ That thou mightest know that the Lord he is God, and there is no other besides him. ³⁶ From heaven he made thee to hear his voice, that he might teach thee. And upon earth he shewed thee his exceeding great fire, and thou didst hear his words out of the midst of the fire, ³⁷ Because he loved thy fathers, and chose their seed after them. And he brought thee out of Egypt, going before thee with his great power, ³⁸ To destroy at thy coming very great nations, and stronger than thou art, and to bring thee in, and give thee their land for a possession, as thou seest at this present day. ³⁹ Know therefore this day, and think in thy heart that the Lord he is God in heaven above, and in the earth beneath, and there is no other. ⁴⁰ Keep his precepts and commandments, which I command thee: that it may be well with thee, and thy children after thee, and thou mayst remain a long time upon the land, which the Lord thy God will give thee.

⁴¹ Then Moses set aside three cities beyond the Jordan at the east side, ⁴² That any one might flee to them who should kill his neighbour unwillingly, and was not his enemy a day or two before, and that he might escape to some one of these cities: ⁴³ Bosor in the wilderness, which is situate in the plains of the tribe of Ruben: and Ramoth in Galaad, which is in the tribe of Gad: and Golan in Basan, which is in the tribe of Manasses.

⁴⁴ This is the law, that Moses set before the children of Israel, ⁴⁵ And these are the testimonies and ceremonies and judgments, which he spoke to the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt, ⁴⁶ Beyond the Jordan in the valley over against the temple of Phogor, in the land of Sehon king of the Amorrites, that dwelt in Hesebon, whom Moses slew. And the children of Israel coming out of Egypt, ⁴⁷ Possessed his land, and the land of Og king of Basan, of the two kings of the Amorrites, who were beyond the Jordan towards the rising of the sun: ⁴⁸ From Aroer, which is situate upon the bank of the torrent Arnon, unto mount Sion, which is also called Hermon, ⁴⁹ All the plain beyond the Jordan at the east side, unto the sea of the wilderness, and unto the foot of mount Phasga.

88. The Decalogue rehearsed

Deuteronomy 5:1-33

The second of the two statements of the Decalogue this plan reads.

⁵ ¹ And Moses called all Israel, and said to them: Hear, O Israel, the ceremonies and judgments, which I speak in your ears this day: learn them, and fulfil them in work. ² The Lord our God made a covenant with us in Horeb. ³ He made not the covenant with our fathers, but with us, who are now present and living. ⁴ He spoke to us face to face in the mount out of the midst of fire. ⁵ I was the mediator and stood between the Lord and you at that time, to shew you his words, for you feared the fire, and went not up into the mountain, and he said:

⁶ I am the Lord thy God, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. ⁷ Thou shalt not have strange gods in my sight. ⁸ Thou shalt not make to thy self a graven thing, nor the likeness of any things, that are in heaven above, or that are in the earth beneath, or that abide in the waters under the earth. ⁹ Thou shalt not adore them, and thou shalt not serve them. For I am the Lord thy God, a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon their children unto the third and fourth generation, to them that hate me, ¹⁰ And shewing mercy unto many thousands, to them that love me, and keep my commandments. ¹¹ Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain: for he shall not be unpunished that taketh his name upon a vain thing. ¹² Observe the day of the sabbath, to sanctify it, as the Lord thy God hath commanded thee. ¹³ Six days shalt thou labour, and shalt do all thy works. ¹⁴ The seventh is the day of the sabbath, that is, the rest of the Lord thy God. Thou shalt not do any work therein, thou nor thy son nor thy daughter, nor thy manservant nor thy maidservant, nor thy ox, nor thy ass, nor any of thy beasts, nor the stranger that is within thy gates: that thy manservant and thy maidservant may rest, even as thyself. ¹⁵ Remember that thou also didst serve in Egypt, and the Lord thy God brought thee out from thence with a strong hand, and a stretched out arm. Therefore hath he commanded thee that thou shouldst observe the sabbath day.

¹⁶ Honour thy father and mother, as the Lord thy God hath commanded thee, that thou mayst live a long time, and it may be well with thee in the land, which the Lord thy God will give thee. ¹⁷ Thou shalt not kill. ¹⁸ Neither shalt thou commit adultery. ¹⁹ And thou shalt not steal. ²⁰ Neither shalt thou bear false witness against thy neighbour. ²¹ Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife: nor his house, nor his field, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is his.

²² These words the Lord spoke to all the multitude of you in the mountain, out of the midst of the fire and the cloud, and the darkness, with a loud voice, adding nothing more: and he wrote them in two tables of stone, which he delivered unto me. ²³ But you, after you heard the voice out of the midst of the darkness, and saw the mountain burn, came to me, all the princes of the tribes and the elders, and you said: ²⁴ Behold the Lord our God hath shewn us his majesty and his greatness, we have heard his voice out of the midst of the fire, and have proved this day that God speaking with man, man hath lived. ²⁵ Why shall we die therefore, and why shall this exceeding great fire consume us: for if we hear the voice of the Lord our God any more, we shall die. ²⁶ What is all flesh, that it should hear the voice of the living God, who speaketh out of the midst of the fire, as we have heard, and be able to live? ²⁷ Approach thou rather: and hear all

things that the Lord our God shall say to thee, and thou shalt speak to us, and we will hear and will do them. ²⁸ And when the Lord had heard this, he said to me: I have heard the voice of the words of this people, which they spoke to thee: they have spoken all things well. ²⁹ Who shall give them to have such a mind, to fear me, and to keep all my commandments at all times, that it may be well with them and with their children for ever? ³⁰ Go and say to them: Return into your tents. ³¹ But stand thou here with me, and I will speak to thee all my commandments, and ceremonies and judgments: which thou shalt teach them, that they may do them in the land, which I will give them for a possession. ³² Keep therefore and do the things which the Lord God hath commanded you: you shall not go aside neither to the right hand, nor to the left. ³³ But you shall walk in the way that the Lord your God hath commanded, that you may live, and it may be well with you, and your days may be long in the land of your possession.

89. "Hear, O Israel"

Deuteronomy 6:1-25

The Shema, and the first commandment as Christ cites it. Deuteronomy 12-26, the law code, is omitted after chapter 11.

⁶ ¹ These are the precepts, and ceremonies, and judgments, which the Lord your God commanded that I should teach you, and that you should do them in the land into which you pass over to possess it: ² That thou mayst fear the Lord thy God, and keep all his commandments and precepts, which I command thee, and thy sons, and thy grandsons, all the days of thy life, that thy days may be prolonged. ³ Hear, O Israel, and observe to do the things which the Lord hath commanded thee, that it may be well with thee, and thou mayst be greatly multiplied, as the Lord the God of thy fathers hath promised thee a land flowing with milk and honey.

⁴ Hear, O Israel, the Lord our God is one Lord. ⁵ Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with thy whole heart, and with thy whole soul, and with thy whole strength. ⁶ And these words which I command thee this day, shall be in thy heart: ⁷ And thou shalt tell them to thy children, and thou shalt meditate upon them sitting in thy house, and walking on thy journey, sleeping and rising. ⁸ And thou shalt bind them as a sign on thy hand, and they shall be and shall move between thy eyes. ⁹ And thou shalt write them in the entry, and on the doors of thy house. ¹⁰ And when the Lord thy God shall have brought thee into the land, for which he swore to thy fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: and shall have given thee great and goodly cities, which thou didst not build, ¹¹ Houses full of riches, which thou didst not set up, cisterns which thou didst not dig, vineyards and oliveyards, which thou didst not plant, ¹² And thou shalt have eaten and be full: ¹³ Take heed diligently lest thou forget the Lord, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. Thou shalt fear the Lord thy God, and shalt serve him only, and thou shalt swear by his name. ¹⁴ You shall not go after the strange gods of all the nations, that are round about you: ¹⁵ Because the Lord thy God is a jealous God in the midst of thee: lest at any time the wrath of the Lord thy God be kindled against thee, and take thee away from the face of the earth. ¹⁶ Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God, as thou temptedst him in the place of temptation.

¹⁷ Keep the precepts of the Lord thy God, and the testimonies and ceremonies which he hath commanded thee. ¹⁸ And do that which is pleasing and good in the sight of the Lord, that it may be well with thee: and going in thou mayst possess the goodly land, concerning which the Lord swore to thy fathers, ¹⁹ That he would destroy all thy enemies before thee, as he hath spoken. ²⁰ And when thy son shall ask thee to morrow, saying: What mean these testimonies, and ceremonies and judgments, which the Lord our God hath commanded us? ²¹ Thou shalt say to him: We were bondmen of Pharaoh in Egypt, and the Lord brought us out of Egypt with a strong hand. ²² And he wrought signs and wonders great and very grievous in Egypt against Pharaoh, and all his house, in our sight, ²³ And he brought us out from thence, that he might bring us in and give us the land, concerning which he swore to our fathers. ²⁴ And the Lord commanded that we should do all these ordinances, and should fear the Lord our God, that it might be well with us all the days of our life, as it is at this day. ²⁵ And he will be merciful to us, if we keep and do all his precepts before the Lord our God, as he hath commanded us.

90. A people chosen and holy

Deuteronomy 7:1-26

7 ¹ When the Lord thy God shall have brought thee into the land, which thou art going in to possess, and shall have destroyed many nations before thee, the Hethite, and the Gergezite, and the Amorrite, and the Chanaanite, and the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite, seven nations much more numerous than thou art, and stronger than thou: ² And the Lord thy God shall have delivered them to thee, thou shalt utterly destroy them. Thou shalt make no league with them, nor shew mercy to them: ³ Neither shalt thou make marriages with them. Thou shalt not give thy daughter to his son, nor take his daughter for thy son: ⁴ For she will turn away thy son from following me, that he may rather serve strange gods, and the wrath of the Lord will be kindled, and will quickly destroy thee. ⁵ But thus rather shall you deal with them: Destroy their altars, and break their statues, and cut down their groves, and burn their graven things. ⁶ Because thou art a holy people to the Lord thy God. The Lord thy God hath chosen thee, to be his peculiar people of all peoples that are upon the earth. ⁷ Not because you surpass all nations in number, is the Lord joined unto you, and hath chosen you, for you are the fewest of any people: ⁸ But because the Lord hath loved you, and hath kept his oath, which he swore to your fathers: and hath brought you out with a strong hand, and redeemed you from the house of bondage, out of the hand of Pharaoh the king of Egypt. ⁹ And thou shalt know that the Lord thy God, he is a strong and faithful God, keeping his covenant and mercy to them that love him, and to them that keep his commandments, unto a thousand generations: ¹⁰ And repaying forthwith them that hate him, so as to destroy them, without further delay immediately rendering to them what they deserve. ¹¹ Keep therefore the precepts and ceremonies and judgments, which I command thee this day to do. ¹² If after thou hast heard these judgments, thou keep and do them, the Lord thy God will also keep his covenant to thee, and the mercy which he swore to thy fathers: ¹³ And he will love thee and multiply thee, and will bless the fruit of thy womb, and the fruit of thy land, thy corn,

and thy vintage, thy oil, and thy herds, and the flocks of thy sheep upon the land, for which he swore to thy fathers that he would give it thee. ¹⁴ Blessed shalt thou be among all people. No one shall be barren among you of either sex, neither of men nor cattle. ¹⁵ The Lord will take away from thee all sickness: and the grievous infirmities of Egypt, which thou knowest, he will not bring upon thee, but upon thy enemies. ¹⁶ Thou shalt consume all the people, which the Lord thy God will deliver to thee. Thy eye shall not spare them, neither shalt thou serve their gods, lest they be thy ruin. ¹⁷ If thou say in thy heart: These nations are more than I, how shall I be able to destroy them? ¹⁸ Fear not, but remember what the Lord thy God did to Pharaoh and to all the Egyptians, ¹⁹ The exceeding great plagues, which thy eyes saw, and the signs and wonders, and the strong hand, and the stretched out arm, with which the Lord thy God brought thee out: so will he do to all the people, whom thou fearest. ²⁰ Moreover the Lord thy God will send also hornets among them, until he destroy and consume all that have escaped thee, and could hide themselves. ²¹ Thou shalt not fear them, because the Lord thy God is in the midst of thee, a God mighty and terrible: ²² He will consume these nations in thy sight by little and little and by degrees. Thou wilt not be able to destroy them altogether: lest perhaps the beasts of the earth should increase upon thee. ²³ But the Lord thy God shall deliver them in thy sight: and shall slay them until they be utterly destroyed. ²⁴ And he shall deliver their kings into thy hands, and thou shalt destroy their names from under Heaven: no man shall be able to resist thee, until thou destroy them. ²⁵ Their graven things thou shalt burn with fire: thou shalt not covet the silver and gold of which they are made, neither shalt thou take to thee any thing thereof, lest thou offend, because it is an abomination to the Lord thy God. ²⁶ Neither shalt thou bring any thing of the idol into thy house, lest thou become an anathema, like it. Thou shalt detest it as dung, and shalt utterly abhor it as uncleanness and filth, because it is an anathema.

91. "Not in bread alone"

Deuteronomy 8:1-20

Cited in the temptation of Christ, read later in this plan.

8 ¹ All the commandments, that I command thee this day, take great care to observe: that you may live, and be multiplied, and going in may possess the land, for which the Lord swore to your fathers. ² And thou shalt remember all the way through which the Lord thy God hath brought thee for forty years through the desert, to afflict thee and to prove thee, and that the things that were in thy heart might be made known, whether thou wouldst keep his commandments or no. ³ He afflicted thee with want, and gave thee manna for thy food, which neither thou nor thy fathers knew: to shew that not in bread alone doth man live, but in every word that proceedeth from the mouth of God. ⁴ Thy raiment, with which thou wast covered, hath not decayed for age, and thy foot is not worn, lo this is the fortieth year, ⁵ That thou mayst consider in thy heart, that as a man traineth up his son, so the Lord thy God hath trained thee up. ⁶ That thou shouldst keep the commandments of the Lord thy God, and walk in his ways, and fear him. ⁷ For the Lord thy God will bring thee into a good land, of brooks and of waters, and of fountains: in the plains of

which and the hills deep rivers break out: ⁸ A land of wheat, and barley, and vineyards, wherein fig trees and pomegranates, and oliveyards grow: a land of oil and honey. ⁹ Where without any want thou shalt eat thy bread, and enjoy abundance of all things: where the stones are iron, and out of its hills are dug mines of brass: ¹⁰ That when thou hast eaten, and art full, thou mayst bless the Lord thy God for the excellent land which he hath given thee. ¹¹ Take heed, and beware lest at any time thou forget the Lord thy God, and neglect his commandments and judgments and ceremonies, which I command thee this day: ¹² Lest after thou hast eaten and art filled, hast built goodly houses, and dwelt in them, ¹³ And shalt have herds of oxen and flocks of sheep, and plenty of gold and of silver, and of all things, ¹⁴ Thy heart be lifted up, and thou remember not the Lord thy God, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage: ¹⁵ And was thy leader in the great and terrible wilderness, wherein there was the serpent burning with his breath, and the scorpion and the dipsas, and no waters at all: who brought forth streams out of the hardest rock, ¹⁶ And fed thee in the wilderness with manna which thy fathers knew not. And after he had afflicted and proved thee, at the last he had mercy on thee, ¹⁷ Lest thou shouldst say in thy heart: My own might, and the strength of my own hand have achieved all these things for me. ¹⁸ But remember the Lord thy God, that he hath given thee strength, that he might fulfil his covenant, concerning which he swore to thy fathers, as this present day sheweth. ¹⁹ But if thou forget the Lord thy God, and follow strange gods, and serve and adore them: behold now I foretell thee that thou shalt utterly perish. ²⁰ As the nations, which the Lord destroyed at thy entrance, so shall you also perish, if you be disobedient to the voice of the Lord your God.

92. "Not for thy justices"; the circumcision of the heart

Deuteronomy 9:1-10:22

9 ¹ Hear, O Israel: Thou shalt go over the Jordan this day; to possess nations very great, and stronger than thyself, cities great, and walled up to the sky, ² A people great and tall, the sons of the Enacims, whom thou hast seen, and heard of, against whom no man is able to stand. ³ Thou shalt know therefore this day that the Lord thy God himself will pass over before thee, a devouring and consuming fire, to destroy and extirpate and bring them to nothing before thy face quickly, as he hath spoken to thee. ⁴ Say not in thy heart, when the Lord thy God shall have destroyed them in thy sight: For my justice hath the Lord brought me in to possess this land, whereas these nations are destroyed for their wickedness. ⁵ For it is not for thy justices, and the uprightness of thy heart that thou shalt go in to possess their lands: but because they have done wickedly, they are destroyed at thy coming in: and that the Lord might accomplish his word, which he promised by oath to thy fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ⁶ Know therefore that the Lord thy God giveth thee not this excellent land in possession for thy justices, for thou art a very stiffnecked people. ⁷ Remember, and forget not how thou provokedst the Lord thy God to wrath in the wilderness. From the day that thou camest out of Egypt unto this place, thou hast always strove against the Lord. ⁸ For in Horeb, also thou didst provoke him, and he was angry, and would have destroyed thee, ⁹ When I went up into the mount to receive the tables of stone, the tables of the covenant which the Lord made with you: and

I continued in the mount forty days and nights, neither eating bread, nor drinking water. ¹⁰ And the Lord gave me two tables of stone written with the finger of God, and containing all the words that he spoke to you in the mount from the midst of the fire, when the people were assembled together. ¹¹ And when forty days were passed, and as many nights, the Lord gave me the two tables of stone, the tables of the covenant, ¹² And said to me: Arise, and go down from hence quickly: for thy people, which thou hast brought out of Egypt, have quickly forsaken the way that thou hast shewn them, and have made to themselves a molten idol. ¹³ And again the Lord said to me: I see that this people is stiffnecked: ¹⁴ Let me alone that I may destroy them, and abolish their name from under heaven, and set thee over a nation, that is greater and stronger than this. ¹⁵ And when I came down from the burning mount, and held the two tables of the covenant with both hands, ¹⁶ And saw that you had sinned against the Lord your God, and had made to yourselves a molten calf, and had quickly forsaken his way, which he had shewn you: ¹⁷ I cast the tables out of my hands, and broke them in your sight. ¹⁸ And I fell down before the Lord as before, forty days and nights neither eating bread, nor drinking water, for all your sins, which you had committed against the Lord, and had provoked him to wrath: ¹⁹ For I feared his indignation and anger, wherewith being moved against you, he would have destroyed you. And the Lord heard me this time also. ²⁰ And he was exceeding angry against Aaron also, and would have destroyed him, and I prayed in like manner for him. ²¹ And your sin that you had committed, that is, the calf, I took, and burned it with fire, and breaking it into pieces, until it was as small as dust, I threw it into the torrent, which cometh down from the mountain. ²² At the burning also, and at the place of temptation, and at the graves of lust you provoked the Lord: ²³ And when he sent you from Cadesbarne, saying: Go up, and possess the land that I have given you, and you slighted the commandment of the Lord your God, and did not believe him, neither would you hearken to his voice: ²⁴ But were always rebellious from the day that I began to know you. ²⁵ And I lay prostrate before the Lord forty days and nights, in which I humbly besought him, that he would not destroy you as he had threatened: ²⁶ And praying, I said: O Lord God, destroy not thy people, and thy inheritance, which thou hast redeemed in thy greatness, whom thou hast brought out of Egypt with a strong hand. ²⁷ Remember thy servants Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob: look not on the stubbornness of this people, nor on their wickedness and sin: ²⁸ Lest perhaps the inhabitants of the land, out of which thou hast brought us, say: The Lord could not bring them into the land that he promised them, and he hated them: therefore he brought them out, that he might kill them in the wilderness, ²⁹ Who are thy people and thy inheritance, whom thou hast brought out by thy great strength, and in thy stretched out arm.

10 ¹ At that time the Lord said to me: Hew thee two tables of stone like the former, and come up to me into the mount: and thou shalt make an ark of wood, ² And I will write on the tables the words that were in them, which thou brokest before, and thou shalt put them in the ark. ³ And I made an ark of setim wood. And when I had hewn two tables of stone like the former, I went up into the mount, having them in my hands. ⁴ And he

wrote in the tables, according as he had written before, the ten words, which the Lord spoke to you in the mount from the midst of the fire, when the people were assembled: and he gave them to me. ⁵ And returning from the mount, I came down, and put the tables into the ark, that I had made, and they are there till this present, as the Lord commanded me.

⁶ And the children of Israel removed their camp from Beroth, of the children of Jacan into Mosera, where Aaron died and was buried, and Eleazar his son succeeded him in the priestly office. ⁷ From thence they came to Gadgad, from which place they departed, and camped in Jetebatha, in a land of waters and torrents. ⁸ At that time he separated the tribe of Levi, to carry the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and to stand before him in the ministry, and to bless in his name until this present day. ⁹ Wherefore Levi hath no part nor possession with his brethren: because the Lord himself is his possession, as the Lord thy God promised him. ¹⁰ And I stood in the mount, as before, forty days and nights: and the Lord heard me this time also, and would not destroy thee. ¹¹ And he said to me: Go, and walk before the people, that they may enter, and possess the land, which I swore to their fathers that I would give them.

¹² And now, Israel, what doth the Lord thy God require of thee, but that thou fear the Lord thy God, and walk in his ways, and love him, and serve the Lord thy God, with all thy heart, and with all thy soul: ¹³ And keep the commandments of the Lord, and his ceremonies, which I command thee this day, that it may be well with thee? ¹⁴ Behold heaven is the Lord's thy God, and the heaven of heaven, the earth and all things that are therein. ¹⁵ And yet the Lord hath been closely joined to thy fathers, and loved them and chose their seed after them, that is to say, you, out of all nations, as this day it is proved. ¹⁶ Circumcise therefore the foreskin of your heart, and stiffen your neck no more. ¹⁷ Because the Lord your God he is the God of gods, and the Lord of lords, a great God and mighty and terrible, who accepteth no person nor taketh bribes. ¹⁸ He doth judgment to the fatherless and the widow, loveth the stranger, and giveth him food and raiment. ¹⁹ And do you therefore love strangers, because you also were strangers in the land of Egypt. ²⁰ Thou shalt fear the Lord thy God, and serve him only: to him thou shalt adhere, and shalt swear by his name. ²¹ He is thy praise, and thy God, that hath done for thee these great and terrible things, which thy eyes have seen. ²² In seventy souls thy fathers went down into Egypt: and behold now the Lord thy God hath multiplied thee as the stars of heaven.

93. The blessing and the curse

Deuteronomy 11:1-32

11 ¹ Therefore love the Lord thy God and observe his precepts and ceremonies, his judgments and commandments at all times. ² Know this day the things that your children know not, who saw not the chastisements of the Lord your God, his great doings and strong hand, and stretched out arm, ³ The signs and works which he did in the midst of Egypt to king Pharaoh, and to all his land, ⁴ And to all the host of the Egyptians, and to their horses and chariots: how the waters of the Red Sea covered them, when they pursued you, and how the Lord destroyed them until this present day: ⁵ And what he hath done to you in the wilderness, til you came to this place: ⁶ And to Dathan and Abiron the sons

of Eliab, who was the son of Ruben: whom the earth, opening her mouth swallowed up with their households and tents, and all their substance, which they had in the midst of Israel. ⁷ Your eyes have seen all the great works of the Lord, that he hath done,

⁸ That you may keep all his commandments, which I command you this day, and may go in, and possess the land, to which you are entering, ⁹ And may live in it a long time: which the Lord promised by oath to your fathers, and to their seed, a land which floweth with milk and honey. ¹⁰ For the land, which thou goest to possess, is not like the land of Egypt, from whence thou camest out, where, when the seed is sown, waters are brought in to water it after the manner of gardens. ¹¹ But it is a land of hills and plains, expecting rain from heaven. ¹² And the Lord thy God doth always visit it, and his eyes are on it from the beginning of the year unto the end thereof. ¹³ If then you obey my commandments, which I command you this day, that you love the Lord your God, and serve him with all your heart, and with all your soul: ¹⁴ He will give to your land the early rain and the latter rain, that you may gather in your corn, and your wine, and your oil, ¹⁵ And your hay out of the fields to feed your cattle, and that you may eat and be filled. ¹⁶ Beware lest perhaps your heart be deceived, and you depart from the Lord, and serve strange gods, and adore them: ¹⁷ And the Lord being angry shut up heaven, that the rain come not down, nor the earth yield her fruit, and you perish quickly from the excellent land, which the Lord will give you. ¹⁸ Lay up these words in your hearts and minds, and hang them for a sign on your hands, and place them between your eyes. ¹⁹ Teach your children that they meditate on them, when thou sittest in thy house, and when thou walkest on the way, and when thou liest down and risest up. ²⁰ Thou shalt write them upon the posts and the doors of thy house: ²¹ That thy days may be multiplied, and the days of thy children in the land which the Lord swore to thy fathers, that he would give them as long as the heaven hangeth over the earth. ²² For if you keep the commandments which I command you, and do them, to love the Lord your God, and walk in all his ways, cleaving unto him, ²³ The Lord will destroy all these nations before your face, and you shall possess them, which are greater and stronger than you. ²⁴ Every place, that your foot shall tread upon, shall be yours. From the desert, and from Libanus, from the great river Euphrates unto the western sea shall be your borders. ²⁵ None shall stand against you: the Lord your God shall lay the dread and fear of you upon all the land that you shall tread upon, as he hath spoken to you. ²⁶ Behold I set forth in your sight this day a blessing and a curse: ²⁷ A blessing, if you obey the commandments of the Lord your God, which I command you this day: ²⁸ A curse, if you obey not the commandments of the Lord your God, but revolt from the way which now I shew you, and walk after strange gods which you know not. ²⁹ And when the Lord thy God shall have brought thee into the land, whither thou goest to dwell, thou shalt put the blessing upon mount Garizim, the curse upon mount Hebal: ³⁰ Which are beyond the Jordan, behind the way that goeth to the setting of the sun, in the land of the Chanaanite who dwelleth in the plain country over against Galgala, which is near the valley that reacheth and entereth far. ³¹ For you shall pass over the Jordan, to possess the land, which the Lord your God will give you, that you may have

it and possess it. ³² See therefore that you fulfil the ceremonies and judgments, which I shall set this day before you.

94. **The covenant in the land of Moab**

Deuteronomy 29:1-29

29 ¹ These are the words of the covenant which the Lord commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the land of Moab: beside that covenant which he made with them in Horeb. ² And Moses called all Israel, and said to them: You have seen all the things that the Lord did before you in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to his whole land. ³ The great temptations, which thy eyes have seen, those mighty signs and wonders, ⁴ And the Lord hath not given you a heart to understand, and eyes to see, and ears that may hear, unto this present day. ⁵ He hath brought you forty years through the desert: your garments are not worn out, neither are the shoes of your feet consumed with age. ⁶ You have not eaten bread, nor have you drunk wine or strong drink: that you might know that I am the Lord your God. ⁷ And you came to this place: and Sehon king of Hesebon, and Og king of Basan, came out against us to fight. And we slew them. ⁸ And took their land, and delivered it for a possession to Ruben and Gad, and the half tribe of Manasses. ⁹ Keep therefore the words of this covenant, and fulfil them: that you may understand all that you do. ¹⁰ You all stand this day before the Lord your God, your princes, and tribes, and ancients, and doctors, all the people of Israel, ¹¹ Your children and your wives, and the stranger that abideth with thee in the camp, besides the hewers of wood, and them that bring water: ¹² That thou mayst pass in the covenant of the Lord thy God, and in the oath which this day the Lord thy God maketh with thee. ¹³ That he may raise thee up a people to himself, and he may be thy God as he hath spoken to thee, and as he swore to thy fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. ¹⁴ Neither with you only do I make this covenant, and confirm these oaths, ¹⁵ But with all that are present and that are absent. ¹⁶ For you know how we dwelt in the land of Egypt, and how we have passed through the midst of nations, and passing through them, ¹⁷ You have seen their abominations and filth, that is to say, their idols, wood and stone, silver and gold, which they worshipped. ¹⁸ Lest perhaps there should be among you a man or a woman, a family or a tribe, whose heart is turned away this day from the Lord our God, to go and serve the gods of those nations: and there should be among you a root bringing forth gall and bitterness. ¹⁹ And when he shall hear the words of this oath, he should bless himself in his heart saying: I shall have peace, and will walk on in the naughtiness of my heart: and the drunken may consume the thirsty, ²⁰ And the Lord should not forgive him: but his wrath and jealousy against that man should be exceedingly enkindled at that time, and all the curses that are written in this volume should light upon him: and the Lord should blot out his name from under heaven, ²¹ And utterly destroy him out of all the tribes of Israel, according to the curses that are contained in the book of this law and covenant: ²² And the following generation shall say, and the children that shall be born hereafter, and the strangers that shall come from afar, seeing the plagues of that land and the evils wherewith the Lord hath afflicted it, ²³ Burning it with brimstone, and the heat of salt, so that it cannot be sown any more, nor any green thing grow therein, after the example of

the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrhah, Adama and Seboim, which the Lord destroyed in his wrath and indignation: ²⁴ And all the nations shall say: Why hath the Lord done thus to this land? what meaneth this exceeding great heat of his wrath? ²⁵ And they shall answer: Because they forsook the covenant of the Lord, which he made with their fathers, when he brought them out of the land of Egypt: ²⁶ And they have served strange gods, and adored them, whom they knew not, and for whom they had not been assigned: ²⁷ Therefore the wrath of the Lord was kindled against this land, to bring upon it all the curses that are written in this volume: ²⁸ And he hath cast them out of their land, in anger and in wrath, and in very great indignation, and hath thrown them into a strange land, as it is seen this day. ²⁹ Secret things to the Lord our God: things that are manifest, to us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.

95. **"Life and death, blessing and cursing"**

Deuteronomy 30:1-20

30 ¹ Now when all these things shall be come upon thee, the blessing or the curse, which I have set forth before thee, and thou shalt be touched with repentance of thy heart among all the nations, into which the Lord thy God shall have scattered thee, ² And shalt return to him, and obey his commandments, as I command thee this day, thou and thy children, with all thy heart, and with all thy soul: ³ The Lord thy God will bring back again thy captivity, and will have mercy on thee, and gather thee again out of all the nations, into which he scattered thee before. ⁴ If thou be driven as far as the poles of heaven, the Lord thy God will fetch thee back from hence, ⁵ And will take thee to himself, and bring thee into the land which thy fathers possessed, and thou shalt possess it: and blessing thee, he will make thee more numerous than were thy fathers. ⁶ The Lord thy God will circumcise thy heart, and the heart of thy seed: that thou mayst love the Lord thy God with all thy heart and with all thy soul, that thou mayst live. ⁷ And he will turn all these curses upon thy enemies, and upon them that hate and persecute thee. ⁸ But thou shalt return, and hear the voice of the Lord thy God, and shalt do all the commandments which I command thee this day: ⁹ And the Lord thy God will make thee abound in all the works of thy hands, in the fruit of thy womb, and in the fruit of thy cattle, in the fruitfulness of thy land, and in the plenty of all things. For the Lord will return to rejoice over thee in all good things, as he rejoiced in thy fathers: ¹⁰ Yet so if thou hear the voice of the Lord thy God, and keep his precepts and ceremonies, which are written in this law: and return to the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul.

¹¹ This commandment, that I command thee this day is not above thee, nor far off from thee: ¹² Nor is it in heaven, that thou shouldst say: Which of us can go up to heaven to bring it unto us, and we may hear and fulfil it in work? ¹³ Nor is it beyond the sea: that thou mayst excuse thyself, and say: Which of us can cross the sea, and bring it unto us: that we may hear, and do that which is commanded? ¹⁴ But the word is very nigh unto thee, in thy mouth and in thy heart, that thou mayst do it. ¹⁵ Consider that I have set before thee this day life and good, and on the other hand death and evil: ¹⁶ That thou mayst love the Lord thy God, and walk in his ways, and keep his commandments and

ceremonies and judgments, and thou mayst live, and he may multiply thee, and bless thee in the land, which thou shalt go in to possess. ¹⁷ But if thy heart be turned away, so that thou wilt not hear, and being deceived with error thou adore strange gods, and serve them: ¹⁸ I foretell thee this day that thou shalt perish, and shalt remain but a short time in the land, to which thou shalt pass over the Jordan, and shalt go in to possess it. ¹⁹ I call heaven and earth to witness this day, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing. Choose therefore life, that both thou and thy seed may live: ²⁰ And that thou mayst love the Lord thy God, and obey his voice, and adhere to him (for he is thy life, and the length of thy days,) that thou mayst dwell in the land, for which the Lord swore to thy fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob that he would give it them.

96. Josue commissioned; the law entrusted

Deuteronomy 31:1-30

31 ¹ And Moses went, and spoke all these words to all Israel, ² And he said to them: I am this day a hundred and twenty years old, I can no longer go out and come in, especially as the Lord also hath said to me: Thou shalt not pass over this Jordan. ³ The Lord thy God then will pass over before thee: he will destroy all these nations in thy sight, and thou shalt possess them: and this Josue shall go over before thee, as the Lord hath spoken. ⁴ And the Lord shall do to them as he did to Sehon and Og the kings of the Amorrites, and to their land, and shall destroy them. ⁵ Therefore when the Lord shall have delivered these also to you, you shall do in like manner to them as I have commanded you. ⁶ Do manfully and be of good heart: fear not, nor be ye dismayed at their sight: for the Lord thy God he himself is thy leader, and will not leave thee nor forsake thee.

⁷ And Moses called Josue, and said to him before all Israel: Take courage, and be valiant: for thou shalt bring this people into the land which the Lord swore he would give to their fathers, and thou shalt divide it by lot. ⁸ And the Lord who is your leader, he himself will be with thee: he will not leave thee, nor forsake thee: fear not, neither be dismayed.

⁹ And Moses wrote this law, and delivered it to the priests the sons of Levi, who carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and to all the ancients of Israel. ¹⁰ And he commanded them, saying: After seven years, in the year of remission, in the feast of tabernacles, ¹¹ When all Israel come together, to appear in the sight of the Lord thy God in the place which the Lord shall choose, thou shalt read the words of this law before all Israel, in their hearing. ¹² And the people being all assembled together, both men and women, children and strangers, that are within thy gates: that hearing they may learn, and fear the Lord your God, and keep, and fulfil all the words of this law: ¹³ That their children also, who now are ignorant, may hear, and fear the Lord their God, all the days that they live in the land whither you are going over the Jordan to possess it.

¹⁴ And the Lord said to Moses: Behold the days of thy death are nigh: call Josue, and stand ye in the tabernacle of the testimony, that I may give him a charge. So Moses and Josue went and stood in the tabernacle of the testimony: ¹⁵ And the Lord appeared there in the pillar of a cloud, which stood in the entry of the tabernacle. ¹⁶ And the Lord said to Moses: Behold thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, and this people rising up will go

a fornicating after strange gods in the land, to which it goeth in to dwell: there will they forsake me, and will make void the covenant, which I have made with them, ¹⁷ And my wrath shall be kindled against them in that day: and I will forsake them, and will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured: all evils and afflictions shall find them, so that they shall say in that day: In truth it is because God is not with me, that these evils have found me. ¹⁸ But I will hide, and cover my face in that day, for all the evils which they have done, because they have followed strange gods. ¹⁹ Now therefore write you this canticle, and teach the children of Israel: that they may know it by heart, and sing it by mouth, and this song may be unto me for a testimony among the children of Israel. ²⁰ For I will bring them into the land, for which I swore to their fathers, that floweth with milk and honey. And when they have eaten, and are full and fat, they will turn away after strange gods, and will serve them: and will despise me, and make void my covenant. ²¹ And after many evils and afflictions shall have come upon them, this canticle shall answer them for a testimony, which no oblivion shall take away out of the mouth of their seed. For I know their thoughts, and what they are about to do this day, before that I bring them into the land which I have promised them.

²² Moses therefore wrote the canticle, and taught it to the children of Israel. ²³ And the Lord commanded Josue the son of Nun, and said: Take courage, and be valiant: for thou shalt bring the children of Israel into the land which I have promised, and I will be with thee.

²⁴ Therefore after Moses had wrote the words of this law in a volume, and finished it: ²⁵ He commanded the Levites, who carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, saying: ²⁶ Take this book, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the Lord your God: that it may be there for a testimony against thee. ²⁷ For I know thy obstinacy, and thy most stiff neck. While I am yet living, and going in with you, you have always been rebellious against the Lord: how much more when I shall be dead? ²⁸ Gather unto me all the ancients of your tribes, and your doctors, and I will speak these words in their hearing, and will call heaven and earth to witness against them. ²⁹ For I know that, after my death, you will do wickedly, and will quickly turn aside from the way that I have commanded you: and evils shall come upon you in the latter times, when you shall do evil in the sight of the Lord, to provoke him by the works of your hands. ³⁰ Moses therefore spoke, in the hearing of the whole assembly of Israel, the words of this canticle, and finished it even to the end.

97. The canticle of Moses

Deuteronomy 32:1-52

32 ¹ Hear, O ye heavens, the things I speak, let the earth give ear to the words of my mouth. ² Let my doctrine gather as the rain, let my speech distil as the dew, as a shower upon the herb, and as drops upon the grass. ³ Because I will invoke the name of the Lord: give ye magnificence to our God. ⁴ The works of God are perfect, and all his ways are judgments: God is faithful and without any iniquity, he is just and right. ⁵ They have sinned against him, and are none of his children in their filth: they are a wicked and perverse generation. ⁶ Is this the return thou makest to the Lord, O foolish and senseless people? Is not he

thy father, that hath possessed thee, and made thee, and created thee? ⁷ Remember the days of old, think upon every generation: ask thy father, and he will declare to thee: thy elders and they will tell thee. ⁸ When the Most High divided the nations: when he separated the sons of Adam, he appointed the bounds of people according to the number of the children of Israel. ⁹ But the Lord's portion is his people: Jacob the lot of his inheritance. ¹⁰ He found him in a desert land, in a place of horror, and of vast wilderness: he led him about, and taught him: and he kept him as the apple of his eye. ¹¹ As the eagle enticing her young to fly, and hovering over them, he spread his wings, and hath taken him and carried him on his shoulders. ¹² The Lord alone was his leader: and there was no strange god with him. ¹³ He set him upon high land: that he might eat the fruits of the fields, that he might suck honey out of the rock, and oil out of the hardest stone, ¹⁴ Butter of the herd, and milk of the sheep with the fat of lambs, and of the rams of the breed of Basan: and goats with the marrow of wheat, and might drink the purest blood of the grape. ¹⁵ The beloved grew fat, and kicked: he grew fat, and thick and gross, he forsook God who made him, and departed from God his saviour. ¹⁶ They provoked him by strange gods, and stirred him up to anger, with their abominations. ¹⁷ They sacrificed to devils and not to God: to gods whom they knew not: that were newly come up, whom their fathers worshipped not. ¹⁸ Thou hast forsaken the God that begot thee, and hast forgotten the Lord that created thee. ¹⁹ The Lord saw, and was moved to wrath: because his own sons and daughters provoked him. ²⁰ And he said: I will hide my face from them, and will consider what their last end shall be: for it is a perverse generation, and unfaithful children. ²¹ They have provoked me with that which was no god, and have angered me with their vanities: and I will provoke them with that which is no people, and will vex them with a foolish nation. ²² A fire is kindled in my wrath, and shall burn even to the lowest hell: and shall devour the earth with her increase, and shall burn the foundations of the mountains. ²³ I will heap evils upon them, and will spend my arrows among them. ²⁴ They shall be consumed with famine, and birds shall devour them with a most bitter bite: I will send the teeth of beasts upon them, with the fury of creatures that trail upon the ground, and of serpents. ²⁵ Without, the sword shall lay them waste, and terror within, both the young man and the virgin, the sucking child with the man in years. ²⁶ I said: Where are they? I will make the memory of them to cease from among men. ²⁷ But for the wrath of the enemies I have deferred it: lest perhaps their enemies might be proud, and should say: Our mighty hand, and not the Lord, hath done all these things. ²⁸ They are a nation without counsel, and without wisdom. ²⁹ O that they would be wise and would understand, and would provide for their last end. ³⁰ How should one pursue after a thousand, and two chase ten thousand? Was it not, because their God had sold them, and the Lord had shut them up? ³¹ For our God is not as their gods: our enemies themselves are judges. ³² Their vines are of the vineyard of Sodom, and of the suburbs of Gomorrha: their grapes are grapes of gall, and their clusters most bitter. ³³ Their wine is the gall of dragons, and the venom of asps, which is incurable. ³⁴ Are not these things stored up with me, and sealed up in my treasures? ³⁵ Revenge is mine, and I will repay them in due time, that their foot may slide: the

day of destruction is at hand, and the time makes haste to come. ³⁶ The Lord will judge his people, and will have mercy on his servants: he shall see that their hand is weakened, and that they who were shut up have also failed, and they that remained are consumed. ³⁷ And he shall say: Where are their gods, in whom they trusted? ³⁸ Of whose victims they ate the fat, and drank the wine of their drink offerings: let them arise and help you, and protect you in your distress. ³⁹ See ye that I alone am, and there is no other God besides me: I will kill and I will make to live: I will strike, and I will heal, and there is none that can deliver out of my hand. ⁴⁰ I will lift up my hand to heaven, and I will say: I live for ever. ⁴¹ If I shall whet my sword as the lightning, and my hand take hold on judgment: I will render vengeance to my enemies, and repay them that hate me. ⁴² I will make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh, of the blood of the slain and of the captivity, of the bare head of the enemies. ⁴³ Praise his people, ye nations, for he will revenge the blood of his servants: and will render vengeance to their enemies, and he will be merciful to the land of his people.

⁴⁴ So Moses came and spoke all the words of this canticle in the ears of the people, and Josue the son of Nun. ⁴⁵ And he ended all these words, speaking to all Israel. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Set your hearts on all the words, which I testify to you this day: which you shall command your children to observe and to do, and to fulfil all that is written in this law: ⁴⁷ For they are not commanded you in vain, but that every one should live in them, and that doing them you may continue a long time in the land whither you are going over the Jordan to possess it. ⁴⁸ And the Lord spoke to Moses the same day, saying: ⁴⁹ Go up into this mountain Abarim, (that is to say, of passages,) unto mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab over against Jericho: and see the land of Chanaan, which I will deliver to the children of Israel to possess, and die thou in the mountain. ⁵⁰ When thou art gone up into it thou shalt be gathered to thy people, as Aaron thy brother died in mount Hor, and was gathered to his people: ⁵¹ Because you trespassed against me in the midst of the children of Israel, at the waters of contradiction, in Cades of the desert of Sin: and you did not sanctify me among the children of Israel. ⁵² Thou shalt see the land before thee, which I will give to the children of Israel, but thou shalt not enter into it.

98. The blessing of the tribes

Deuteronomy 33:1-29

33 ¹ This is the blessing, wherewith the man of God, Moses, blessed the children of Israel, before his death. ² And he said: The Lord came from Sinai, and from Seir he rose up to us: he hath appeared from mount Pharan, and with him thousands of saints. In his right hand a fiery law. ³ He hath loved the people, all the saints are in his hand: and they that approach to his feet, shall receive of his doctrine. ⁴ Moses commanded us a law, the inheritance of the multitude of Jacob. ⁵ He shall be king with the most right, the princes of the people, being assembled with the tribes of Israel. ⁶ Let Ruben live, and not die, and be he small in number.

⁷ This is the blessing of Juda. Hear, O Lord, the voice of Juda, and bring him in unto his people: his hands shall fight for him, and he shall be his helper against his enemies.

⁸ To Levi also he said: Thy perfection, and thy doctrine be to thy holy man, whom thou hast proved in the temptation, and judged at the waters of contradiction: ⁹ Who hath said to his father, and to his mother: I do not know you; and to his brethren: I know you not: and their own children they have not known. These have kept thy word, and observed thy covenant, ¹⁰ Thy judgments, O Jacob, and thy law, O Israel: they shall put incense in thy wrath and holocaust upon thy altar. ¹¹ Bless, O Lord, his strength, and receive the works of his hands. Strike the backs of his enemies, and let not them that hate him rise.

¹² And to Benjamin he said: The best beloved of the Lord shall dwell confidently in him: as in a bride chamber shall he abide all the day long, and between his shoulders shall be rest.

¹³ To Joseph also he said: Of the blessing of the Lord be his land, of the fruits of heaven, and of the dew, and of the deep that lieth beneath. ¹⁴ Of the fruits brought forth by the sun and by the moon. ¹⁵ Of the tops of the ancient mountains, of the fruits of the everlasting hills: ¹⁶ And of the fruits of the earth, and of the fulness thereof. The blessing of him that appeared in the bush, come upon the head of Joseph, and upon the crown of the Nazarite among his brethren. ¹⁷ His beauty as of the firstling of a bullock, his horns as the horns of a rhinoceros: with them shall he push the nations even to the ends of the earth. These are the multitudes of Ephraim and these the thousands of Manasses.

¹⁸ And to Zabulon he said: Rejoice, O Zabulon, in thy going out; and Issachar in thy tabernacles. ¹⁹ They shall call the people to the mountain: there shall they sacrifice the victims of justice. Who shall suck as milk the abundance of the sea, and the hidden treasures of the sands.

²⁰ And to Gad he said: Blessed be Gad in his breadth: he hath rested as a lion, and hath seized upon the arm and the top of the head. ²¹ And he saw his pre-eminence, that in his portion the teacher was laid up: who was with the princes of the people, and did the justices of the Lord, and his judgment with Israel.

²² To Dan also he said: Dan is a young lion, he shall flow plentifully from Basan.

²³ And To Nephtali he said: Nephtali shall enjoy abundance, and shall be full of the blessings of the Lord: he shall possess the sea and the south.

²⁴ To Aser also he said: Let Aser be blessed with children, let him be acceptable to his brethren, and let him dip his foot in oil. ²⁵ His shoe shall be iron and brass. As the days of thy youth, so also shall thy old age be. ²⁶ There is no other god like the God of the rightest: he that is mounted upon the heaven is thy helper. By his magnificence the clouds run hither and thither. ²⁷ His dwelling is above, and underneath are the everlasting arms: he shall cast out the enemy from before thee, and shall say: Be thou brought to nought. ²⁸ Israel shall dwell in safety, and alone. The eye of Jacob in a land of corn and wine, and the heavens shall be misty with dew. ²⁹ Blessed art thou, Israel: who is like to thee, O people, that art saved by the Lord? the shield of thy help, and the sword of thy glory: thy enemies shall deny thee, and thou shalt tread upon their necks.

99. The death of Moses

Deuteronomy 34:1-12

34 ¹ Then Moses went up from the plains of Moab upon mount Nebo, to the top of Phasga over against Jericho: and the Lord shewed him all the land of Galaad as far as Dan. ² And all Nephtali, and the land of Ephraim and Manasses, and all the land of Juda unto the furthestmost sea, ³ And the south part, and the breadth of the plain of Jericho the city of palm trees as far as Segor. ⁴ And the Lord said to him: This is the land, for which I swore to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying: I will give it to thy seed. Thou hast seen it with thy eyes, and shalt not pass over to it.

⁵ And Moses the servant of the Lord died there, in the land of Moab, by the commandment of the Lord: ⁶ And he buried him in the valley of the land of Moab over against Phogor: and no man hath known of his sepulchre until this present day. ⁷ Moses was a hundred and twenty years old when he died: his eye was not dim, neither were his teeth moved. ⁸ And the children of Israel mourned for him in the plains of Moab thirty days: and the days of their mourning in which they mourned Moses were ended. ⁹ And Josue the son of Nun was filled with the spirit of wisdom, because Moses had laid his hands upon him. And the children of Israel obeyed him, and did as the Lord commanded Moses. ¹⁰ And there arose no more a prophet in Israel like unto Moses, whom the Lord knew face to face, ¹¹ In all the signs and wonders, which he sent by him, to do in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to his whole land, ¹² And all the mighty hand, and great miracles, which Moses did before all Israel.

100. Psalm 94

Psalms 94:1-11

Vulgate 94 = Hebrew 95: "Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation." The desert generation judged in a psalm.

94 ¹ Come let us praise the Lord with joy: let us joyfully sing to God our saviour. ² Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving; and make a joyful noise to him with psalms. ³ For the Lord is a great God, and a great King above all gods. ⁴ For in his hand are all the ends of the earth: and the heights of the mountains are his. ⁵ For the sea is his, and he made it: and his hands formed the dry land. ⁶ Come let us adore and fall down: and weep before the Lord that made us. ⁷ For he is the Lord our God: and we are the people of his pasture and the sheep of his hand. ⁸ To day if you shall hear his voice, harden not your hearts: ⁹ As in the provocation, according to the day of temptation in the wilderness: where your fathers tempted me, they proved me, and saw my works. ¹⁰ Forty years long was I offended with that generation, and I said: These always err in heart. ¹¹ And these men have not known my ways: so I swore in my wrath that they shall not enter into my rest.

101. Psalm 105

Psalms 105:1-48

Vulgate 105 = Hebrew 106: Israel's own confession of the rebellions read in this period.

105 ¹ Give glory to the Lord, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever. ² Who shall declare the powers of the Lord? who

shall set forth all his praises? ³ Blessed are they that keep judgment, and do justice at all times. ⁴ Remember us, O Lord, in the favour of thy people: visit us with thy salvation. ⁵ That we may see the good of thy chosen, that we may rejoice in the joy of thy nation: that thou mayst be praised with thy inheritance. ⁶ We have sinned with our fathers: we have acted unjustly, we have wrought iniquity. ⁷ Our fathers understood not thy wonders in Egypt: they remembered not the multitude of thy mercies: And they provoked to wrath going up to the sea, even the Red Sea. ⁸ And he saved them for his own name's sake: that he might make his power known. ⁹ And he rebuked the Red Sea and it was dried up: and he led them through the depths, as in a wilderness. ¹⁰ And he saved them from the hand of them that hated them: and he redeemed them from the hand of the enemy. ¹¹ And the water covered them that afflicted them: there was not one of them left. ¹² And they believed his words: and they sang his praises. ¹³ They had quickly done, they forgot his works: and they waited not for his counsel. ¹⁴ And they coveted their desire in the desert: and they tempted God in the place without water. ¹⁵ And he gave them their request: and sent fulness into their souls. ¹⁶ And they provoked Moses in the camp, Aaron the holy one of the Lord. ¹⁷ The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan: and covered the congregation of Abiron. ¹⁸ And a fire was kindled in their congregation: the flame burned the wicked. ¹⁹ They made also a calf in Horeb: and they adored the graven thing. ²⁰ And they changed their glory into the likeness of a calf that eateth grass. ²¹ They forgot God, who saved them, who had done great things in Egypt, ²² Wondrous works in the land of Cham: terrible things in the Red Sea. ²³ And he said that he would destroy them: had not Moses his chosen stood before him in the breach: To turn away his wrath, lest he should destroy them. ²⁴ And they set at nought the desirable land. They believed not his word, ²⁵ And they murmured in their tents: they hearkened not to the voice of the Lord. ²⁶ And he lifted up his hand over them: to overthrow them in the desert; ²⁷ And to cast down their seed among the nations, and to scatter them in the countries. ²⁸ They also were initiated to Beelphegor: and ate the sacrifices of the dead. ²⁹ And they provoked him with their inventions: and destruction was multiplied among them. ³⁰ Then Phinees stood up, and pacified him: and the slaughter ceased. ³¹ And it was reputed to him unto justice, to generation and generation for evermore. ³² They provoked him also at the waters of contradiction: and Moses was afflicted for their sakes: ³³ Because they exasperated his spirit. And he distinguished with his lips. ³⁴ They did not destroy the nations of which the Lord spoke unto them. ³⁵ And they were mingled among the heathens, and learned their works: ³⁶ And served their idols, and it became a stumblingblock to them. ³⁷ And they sacrificed their sons, and their daughters to devils. ³⁸ And they shed innocent blood: the blood of their sons and of their daughters which they sacrificed to the idols of Chanaan. And the land was polluted with blood, ³⁹ And was defiled with their works: and they went aside after their own inventions. ⁴⁰ And the Lord was exceedingly angry with his people: and he abhorred his inheritance. ⁴¹ And he delivered them into the hands of the nations: and they that hated them had dominion over them. ⁴² And their enemies afflicted them: and they were humbled under their hands: ⁴³ Many times

did he deliver them. But they provoked him with their counsel: and they were brought low by their iniquities. ⁴⁴ And he saw when they were in tribulation: and he heard their prayer. ⁴⁵ And he was mindful of his covenant: and repented according to the multitude of his mercies. ⁴⁶ And he gave them unto mercies, in the sight of all those that had made them captives. ⁴⁷ Save us, O Lord, our God: and gather us from among the nations: That we may give thanks to thy holy name, and may glory in thy praise. ⁴⁸ Blessed be the Lord the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting: and let all the people say: So be it, so be it.

CONQUEST AND JUDGES

Josue 1-11 and 23-24, Judges 1-16, and Ruth. The allotment of the tribal territories (Josue 12-22) is passed over as a survey document, and Judges 17-21, the appendix, is left aside as outside the line of the story.

102. The commission of Josue

Joshua 1:1-18

1 ¹ Now it came to pass after the death of Moses, the servant of the Lord, that the Lord spoke to Josue, the son of Nun, the minister of Moses, and said to him: ² Moses my servant is dead: arise, and pass over this Jordan, thou and thy people with thee, into the land which I will give to the children of Israel. ³ I will deliver to you every place that the sole of your foot shall tread upon, as I have said to Moses. ⁴ From the desert, and from Libanus unto the great river Euphrates, all the land of the Hethites, unto the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your border. ⁵ No man shall be able to resist you all the days of thy life: as I have been with Moses, so will I be with thee: I will not leave thee, nor forsake thee. ⁶ Take courage, and be strong: for thou shalt divide by lot to this people the land for which I swore to their fathers, that I would deliver it to them. ⁷ Take courage therefore, and be very valiant: that thou mayst observe and do all the law, which Moses my servant hath commanded thee: turn not from it to the right hand or to the left, that thou mayst understand all things which thou dost. ⁸ Let not the book of this law depart from thy mouth: but thou shalt meditate on it day and night, that thou mayst observe and do all things that are written in it: then shalt thou direct thy way, and understand it. ⁹ Behold I command thee, take courage, and be strong. Fear not, and be not dismayed: because the Lord thy God is with thee in all things whatsoever thou shalt go to.

¹⁰ And Josue commanded the princes of the people, saying: Pass through the midst of the camp, and command the people, and say: ¹¹ Prepare your victuals: for after the third day you shall pass over the Jordan, and shall go in to possess the land, which the Lord your God will give you.

¹² And he said to the Rubenites, and the Gadites, and the half tribe of Manasses: ¹³ Remember the word, which Moses the servant of the Lord commanded you, saying: The Lord your God hath given you rest, and all this land. ¹⁴ Your wives, and children; and cattle, shall remain in the land which Moses gave you on this side of the Jordan: but pass you over armed before your brethren all of you that are strong of hand, and fight for them, ¹⁵ Until the Lord give rest to your brethren, as he hath given you, and they also possess the land which the Lord your God

will give them: and so you shall return into the land of your possession, and you shall dwell in it, which Moses the servant of the Lord gave you beyond the Jordan, toward the rising of the sun.

¹⁶ And they made answer to Josue, and said: All that thou hast commanded us, we will do: and whither soever thou shalt send us, we will go. ¹⁷ As we obeyed Moses in all things, so will we obey thee also: only be the Lord thy God with thee, as he was with Moses. ¹⁸ He that shall gainsay thy mouth, and not obey all thy words, that thou shalt command him, let him die: only take thou courage, and do manfully.

103. Rahab and the spies

Joshua 2:1-24

Rahab stands in the genealogy of Christ; the plan reads her here and there only.

2 ¹ And Josue, the son of Nun, sent from Setim two men, to spy secretly: and said to them: Go, and view the land, and the city of Jericho. They went, and entered into the house of a woman that was a harlot, named Rahab, and lodged with her. ² And it was told the king of Jericho, and was said: Behold there are men come in hither, by night, of the children of Israel, to spy the land. ³ And the king of Jericho sent to Rahab, saying: Bring forth the men that came to thee, and are entered into thy house: for they are spies, and are come to view all the land. ⁴ And the woman taking the men, hid them, and said: I confess they came to me, but I knew not whence they were: ⁵ And at the time of shutting the gate in the dark, they also went out together. I know not whither they are gone: pursue after them quickly, and you will overtake them. ⁶ But she made the men go up to the top of her house, and covered them with the stalks of flax, which was there. ⁷ Now they that were sent, pursued after them, by the way that leadeth to the fords of the Jordan: and as soon as they were gone out, the gate was presently shut. ⁸ The men that were hid were not yet asleep, when behold the woman went up to them, and said: ⁹ I know that the Lord hath given this land to you: for the dread of you is fallen upon us, and all the inhabitants of the land have lost all strength. ¹⁰ We have heard that the Lord dried up the water of the Red Sea, at your going in, when you came out of Egypt: and what things you did to the two kings of the Amorrites, that were beyond the Jordan, Sehon and Og whom you slew. ¹¹ And at the hearing these things, we were affrighted, and our heart fainted away, neither did there remain any spirit in us, at your coming in: for the Lord your God he is God in heaven above, and in the earth beneath. ¹² Now, therefore, swear ye to me by the Lord, that as I have shewed mercy to you, so you also will shew mercy to my father's house: and give me a true token. ¹³ That you will save my father and mother, my brethren and sisters, and all things that are theirs, and deliver our souls from death. ¹⁴ They answered her: Be our lives for you unto death, only if thou betray us not. And when the Lord shall have delivered us the land, we will shew thee mercy and truth. ¹⁵ Then she let them down with a cord out of a window: for her house joined close to the wall. ¹⁶ And she said to them: Get ye up to the mountains, lest perhaps they meet you as they return: and there lie ye hid three days, till they come back, and so you shall go on your way. ¹⁷ And they said to her: We shall

be blameless of this oath, which thou hast made us swear, ¹⁸ If, when we come into the land, this scarlet cord be a sign, and thou tie it in the window, by which thou hast let us down: and gather together thy father and mother, and brethren, and all thy kindred into thy house. ¹⁹ Whosoever shall go out of the door of thy house, his blood shall be upon his own head, and we shall be quit. But the blood of all that shall be with thee in the house, shall light upon our head, if any man touch them. ²⁰ But if thou wilt betray us, and utter this word abroad, we shall be quit of this oath, which thou hast made us swear. ²¹ And she answered: As you have spoken, so be it done: and sending them on their way, she hung the scarlet cord in the window.

²² But they went and came to the mountains, and stayed there three days, till they that pursued them were returned. For having sought them through all the way, they found them not. ²³ And when they were gone back into the city, the spies returned, and came down from the mountain: and passing over the Jordan, they came to Josue, the son of Nun, and told him all that befel them, ²⁴ And said: the Lord hath delivered all this land into our hands, and all the inhabitants thereof are overthrown with fear.

104. The crossing of the Jordan

Joshua 3:1-17

3 ¹ And Josue rose before daylight, and removed the camp: and they departed from Setim, and came to the Jordan: he, and all the children of Israel, and they abode there for three days. ² After which, the heralds went through the midst of the camp. ³ And began to proclaim: When you shall see the ark of the covenant of the Lord your God, and the priests of the race of Levi carrying it, rise you up also, and follow them as they go before: ⁴ And let there be between you and the ark the space of two thousand cubits: that you may see it afar off, and know which way you must go: for you have not gone this way before: and take care you come not near the ark. ⁵ And Josue said to the people: Be ye sanctified: for tomorrow the Lord will do wonders among you. ⁶ And he said to the priests: Take up the ark of the covenant, and go before the people. And they obeyed his commands, and took it up, and walked before them.

⁷ And the Lord said to Josue: This day will I begin to exalt thee before Israel: that they may know that as I was with Moses, so I am with thee also. ⁸ And do thou command the priests, that carry the ark of the covenant, and say to them: When you shall have entered into part of the water of the Jordan, stand in it.

⁹ And Josue said to the children of Israel: Come hither, and hear the word of the Lord your God. ¹⁰ And again he said: By this you shall know, that the Lord, the living God, is in the midst of you, and that he shall destroy, before your sight, the Chanaanite and the Hethite, the Hevite and the Pherezite, the Gergesite also, and the Jebusite, and the Amorrite. ¹¹ Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth shall go before you into the Jordan. ¹² Prepare ye twelve men of the tribes of Israel, one of every tribe. ¹³ And when the priests, that carry the ark of the Lord the God of the whole earth, shall set the soles of their feet in the waters of the Jordan, the waters that are beneath shall run down and go off: and those that come from above, shall stand together upon a heap.

¹⁴ So the people went out of their tents, to pass over the Jordan: and the priests that carried the ark of the covenant, went on

before them. ¹⁵ And as soon as they came into the Jordan, and their feet were dipped in part of the water, (now the Jordan, it being harvest time, had filled the banks of its channel,) ¹⁶ The waters that came down from above stood in one place, and swelling up like a mountain, were seen afar off, from the city that is called Adom, to the place of Sarthan: but those that were beneath, ran down into the sea of the wilderness, (which now is called the Dead Sea) until they wholly failed. ¹⁷ And the people marched over against Jericho: and the priests that carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, stood girded upon the dry ground in the midst of the Jordan, and all the people passed over, through the channel that was dried up.

105. The twelve stones; the pasch at Galgal

Joshua 4:1-5:16

4 ¹ And when they were passed over, the Lord said to Josue: ² Choose twelve men, one of every tribe: ³ And command them to take out of the midst of the Jordan, where the feet of the priests stood, twelve very hard stones, which you shall set in the place of the camp, where you shall pitch your tents this night. ⁴ And Josue called twelve men, whom he had chosen out of the children of Israel, one out of every tribe, ⁵ And he said to them: Go before the ark of the Lord your God to the midst of the Jordan, and carry from thence every man a stone on your shoulders, according to the number of the children of Israel, ⁶ That it may be a sign among you: and when your children shall ask you tomorrow, saying: What means these stones? ⁷ You shall answer them: The waters of the Jordan ran off before the ark of the covenant of the Lord when it passed over the same: therefore were these stones set for a monument of the children of Israel forever. ⁸ The children of Israel therefore did as Josue commanded them, carrying out of the channel of the Jordan twelve stones, as the Lord had commanded him according to the number of the children of Israel unto the place wherein they camped, and there they set them. ⁹ And Josue put other twelve stones in the midst of the channel of the Jordan, where the priests stood that carried the ark of the covenant: and they are there until this present day. ¹⁰ Now the priests that carried the ark, stood in the midst of the Jordan, till all things were accomplished, which the Lord had commanded Josue to speak to the people, and Moses had said to him. And the people made haste, and passed over. ¹¹ And when they had all passed over, the ark also of the Lord passed over, and the priests went before the people. ¹² The children of Ruben also, and Gad, and half the tribe of Manasses, went armed before the children of Israel, as Moses had commanded them. ¹³ And forty thousand fighting men by their troops and bands, marched through the plains and fields of the city of Jericho. ¹⁴ In that day the Lord magnified Josue in the sight of all Israel, that they should fear him, as they had feared Moses, while he lived. ¹⁵ And he said to him: ¹⁶ Command the priests, that carry the ark of the covenant, to come up out of the Jordan. ¹⁷ And he commanded them, saying: Come ye up out of the Jordan. ¹⁸ And when they that carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, were come up, and began to tread on the dry ground, the waters returned into their channel, and ran as they were wont before. ¹⁹ And the people came up out of the Jordan, the tenth day of the first month, and camped in Galgal, over against the east side of the city of Jericho.

²⁰ And the twelve stones, which they had taken out of the channel of the Jordan, Josue pitched in Galgal, ²¹ And said to the children of Israel: When your children shall ask their fathers tomorrow, and shall say to them: What mean these stones? ²² You shall teach them, and say: Israel passed over this Jordan through the dry channel, ²³ The Lord your God drying up the waters thereof in your sight, until you passed over: ²⁴ As he had done before in the Red Sea, which he dried up till we passed through: ²⁵ That all the people of the earth may learn the most mighty hand of the Lord, that you also may fear the Lord your God for ever.

5 ¹ Now when all the kings of the Amorrites, who dwelt beyond the Jordan, westward, and all the kings of Chanaan, who possessed the places near the great sea, had heard that the Lord had dried up the waters of the Jordan before the children of Israel, till they passed over, their heart failed them, and there remained no spirit in them, fearing the coming in of the children of Israel. ² At that time the Lord said to Josue: Make thee knives of stone, and circumcise the second time the children of Israel. ³ He did what the Lord had commanded, and he circumcised the children of Israel in the hill of the foreskins. ⁴ Now this is the cause of the second circumcision: All the people that came out of Egypt that were males, all the men fit for war, died in the desert, during the time of the long going about in the way: ⁵ Now these were all circumcised. But the people that were born in the desert, ⁶ During the forty years of the journey in the wide wilderness, were uncircumcised: till all they were consumed that had not heard the voice of the Lord, and to whom he had sworn before, that he would not shew them the land flowing with milk and honey. ⁷ The children of these succeeded in the place of their fathers, and were circumcised by Josue: for they were uncircumcised even as they were born, and no one had circumcised them in the way. ⁸ Now after they were all circumcised, they remained in the same place of the camp, until they were healed. ⁹ And the Lord said to Josue: This day have I taken away from you the reproach of Egypt. And the name of that place was called Galgal, until this present day. ¹⁰ And the children of Israel abode in Galgal, and they kept the phase, on the fourteenth day of the month at evening, in the plains of Jericho: ¹¹ And they ate on the next day unleavened bread of the corn of the land, and frumenty of the same year. ¹² And the manna ceased after they ate of the corn of the land, neither did the children of Israel use that food any more, but they ate of the corn of the present year of the land of Chanaan.

¹³ And when Josue was in the field of the city of Jericho, he lifted up his eyes, and saw a man standing over against him, holding a drawn sword, and he went to him, and said: Art thou one of ours, or of our adversaries? ¹⁴ And he answered: No: but I am prince of the host of the Lord, and now I am come. ¹⁵ Josue fell on his face to the ground. And worshipping, said: What saith my lord to his servant? ¹⁶ Loose, saith he, thy shoes from off thy feet: for the place whereon thou standest is holy. And Josue did as was commanded him.

106. The fall of Jericho*Joshua 6:1-27*

6 ¹ Now Jericho was close shut up and fenced, for fear of the children of Israel, and no man durst go out or come in. ² And the Lord said to Josue: Behold I have given into thy hands Jericho, and the king thereof, and all the valiant men. ³ Go round about the city all ye fighting men once a day: so shall ye do for six days. ⁴ And on the seventh day the priests shall take the seven trumpets, which are used in the jubilee, and shall go before the ark of the covenant: and you shall go about the city seven times, and the priests shall sound the trumpets. ⁵ And when the voice of the trumpet shall give a longer and broken tune, and shall sound in your ears, all the people shall shout together with a very great shout, and the walls of the city shall fall to the ground, and they shall enter in every one at the place against which they shall stand.

⁶ Then Josue, the son of Nun, called the priests, and said to them: Take the ark of the covenant: and let seven other priests take the seven trumpets of the jubilee, and march before the ark of the Lord. ⁷ And he said to the people: Go, and compass the city, armed, marching before the ark of the Lord.

⁸ And when Josue had ended his words, and the seven priests blew the seven trumpets before the ark of the covenant of the Lord, ⁹ And all the armed men went before, the rest of the common people followed the ark, and the sound of the trumpets was heard on all sides. ¹⁰ But Josue had commanded the people, saying: You shall not shout, nor shall your voice be heard, nor any word go out of your mouth: until the day come wherein I shall say to you: Cry, and shout. ¹¹ So the ark of the Lord went about the city once a day, and returning into the camp, abode there. ¹² And Josue rising before day, the priests took the ark of the Lord, ¹³ And seven of them seven trumpets, which are used in the jubilee: and they went before the ark of the Lord, walking and sounding the trumpets: and the armed men went before them, and the rest of the common people followed the ark, and they blew the trumpets. ¹⁴ And they went round about the city the second day once, and returned into the camp. So they did six days. ¹⁵ But the seventh day, rising up early, they went about the city, as it was ordered, seven times. ¹⁶ And when in the seventh going about the priests sounded with the trumpets, Josue said to all Israel: Shout: for the Lord hath delivered the city to you: ¹⁷ And let this city be an anathema, and all things that are in it, to the Lord. Let only Rahab, the harlot, live, with all that are with her in the house: for she hid the messengers whom we sent. ¹⁸ But beware ye lest you touch ought of those things that are forbidden, and you be guilty of transgression, and all the camp of Israel be under sin, and be troubled. ¹⁹ But whatsoever gold or silver there shall be, or vessels of brass and iron, let it be consecrated to the Lord, laid up in his treasures. ²⁰ So all the people making a shout, and the trumpets sounding, when the voice and the sound thundered in the ears of the multitude, the walls forthwith fell down: and every man went up by the place that was over against him: and they took the city, ²¹ And killed all that were in it, man and woman, young and old. The oxen also, and the sheep, and the asses, they slew with the edge of the sword. ²² But Josue said to the two men that had been sent for spies: Go into the harlot's house, and bring her out, and

all things that are hers, as you assured her by oath. ²³ And the young men went in, and brought out Rahab, and her parents, her brethren also, and all her goods, and her kindred, and made them to stay without the camp. ²⁴ But they burned the city, and all things that were therein; except the gold and silver, and vessels of brass and iron, which they consecrated unto the treasury of the Lord. ²⁵ But Josue saved Rahab the harlot, and her father's house, and all she had, and they dwelt in the midst of Israel until this present day: because she hid the messengers whom he had sent to spy out Jericho. At that time, Josue made an imprecation, saying:

²⁶ Cursed be the man before the Lord, that shall raise up and build the city of Jericho. In his firstborn may he lay the foundation thereof, and in the last of his children set up its gates. ²⁷ And the Lord was with Josue, and his name was noised throughout all the land.

107. Achan's theft, and the defeat at Hai*Joshua 7:1-26*

7 ¹ But the children of Israel transgressed the commandment, and took to their own use of that which was accursed. For Achan, the son of Charmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zare, of the tribe of Juda, took something of the anathema: and the Lord was angry against the children of Israel. ² And when Josue sent men from Jericho against Hai, which is beside Bethaven, on the east side of the town of Bethel, he said to them: Go up, and view the country: and they fulfilled his command, and viewed Hai. ³ And returning, they said to him: Let not all the people go up, but let two or three thousand men go, and destroy the city: why should all the people be troubled in vain, against enemies that are very few? ⁴ There went up therefore three thousand fighting men: who immediately turned their backs, ⁵ And were defeated by the men of the city of Hai, and there fell of them six and thirty men: and the enemies pursued them from the gate as far as Sabarim, and they slew them as they fled by the descent: and the heart of the people was struck with fear, and melted like water. ⁶ But Josue rent his garments, and fell flat on the ground, before the ark of the Lord, until the evening, both he and all the ancients of Israel: and they put dust upon their heads. ⁷ And Josue said: Alas, O Lord God, why wouldst thou bring this people over the river Jordan, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorrite, and to destroy us? would God we had stayed beyond the Jordan, as we began. ⁸ My Lord God, what shall I say, seeing Israel turning their backs to their enemies? ⁹ The Chanaanites, and all the inhabitants of the land, will hear of it, and being gathered together will surround us, and cut off our name from the earth: and what wilt thou do to thy great name?

¹⁰ And the Lord said to Josue: Arise, why liest thou flat on the ground? ¹¹ Israel hath sinned, and transgressed my covenant: and they have taken of the anathema, and have stolen and lied, and have hid it among their goods. ¹² Neither can Israel stand before his enemies, but he shall flee from them: because he is defiled with the anathema. I will be no more with you, till you destroy him that is guilty of this wickedness. ¹³ Arise, sanctify the people, and say to them: Be ye sanctified against tomorrow: for thus saith the Lord God of Israel: The curse is in the midst of thee, O Israel: thou canst not stand before thy enemies, till he be destroyed out of thee, that is defiled with this wickedness.

¹⁴ And you shall come in the morning, every one by your tribes: and what tribe soever the lot shall find, it shall come by its kindreds, and the kindred by its houses and the house by the men. ¹⁵ And whosoever he be that shall be found guilty of this fact, he shall be burnt with fire, with all his substance, because he hath transgressed the covenant of the Lord, and hath done wickedness in Israel.

¹⁶ Josue, therefore, when he rose in the morning, made Israel to come by their tribes, and the tribe of Juda was found. ¹⁷ Which being brought by in families, it was found to be the family of Zare. Bringing that also by the houses, he found it to be Zabdi: ¹⁸ And bringing his house man by man, he found Achan, the son of Charmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zare, of the tribe of Juda. ¹⁹ And Josue said to Achan: My son, give glory to the Lord God of Israel, and confess, and tell me what thou hast done, hide it not. ²⁰ And Achan answered Josue, and said to him: Indeed I have sinned against the Lord, the God of Israel, and thus and thus have I done. ²¹ For I saw among the spoils a scarlet garment, exceeding good, and two hundred sicles of silver, and a golden rule of fifty sicles: and I coveted them, and I took them away, and hid them in the ground in the midst of my tent, and the silver I covered with the earth that I dug up.

²² Josue therefore sent ministers: who running to his tent, found all hid in the same place, together with the silver. ²³ And taking them away out of the tent, they brought them to Josue, and to all the children of Israel, and threw them down before the Lord. ²⁴ Then Josue, and all Israel with him, took Achan, the son of Zare, and the silver, and the garment, and the golden rule, his sons also, and his daughters, his oxen, and asses, and sheep, the tent also, and all the goods: and brought them to the valley of Achor: ²⁵ Where Josue said: Because thou hast troubled us, the Lord trouble thee this day. And all Israel stoned him: and all things that were his, were consumed with fire. ²⁶ And they gathered together upon him a great heap of stones, which remaineth until this present day And the wrath of the Lord was turned away from them. And the name of that place was called the Valley of Achor, until this day.

108. Hai taken; the stratagem of the Gabaonites

Joshua 8:1-9:27

8 ¹ And the Lord said to Josue: Fear not, nor be thou dismayed: take with thee all the multitude of fighting men, arise, and go up to the town of Hai: Behold I have delivered into thy hand the king thereof, and the people, and the city, and the land. ² And thou shalt do to the city of Hai, and to the king thereof, as thou hast done to Jericho, and to the king thereof: but the spoils, and all the cattle, you shall take for a prey to yourselves: lay an ambush for the city behind it.

³ And Josue arose, and all the army of the fighting men with him, to go up against Hai: and he sent thirty thousand chosen valiant men in the night, ⁴ And commanded them, saying: Lay an ambush behind the city: and go not very far from it: and be ye all ready. ⁵ But I, and the rest of the multitude which is with me, will approach on the contrary side against the city. And when they shall come out against us, we will flee, and turn our backs, as we did before: ⁶ Till they pursuing us be drawn farther from the city: for they will think that we flee as before. ⁷ And whilst we are fleeing, and they pursuing, you shall rise out of the

ambush, and shall destroy the city: and the Lord your God will deliver it into your hands. ⁸ And when you shall have taken it, set it on fire, and you shall do all things so as I have commanded.

⁹ And he sent them away, and they went on to the place of the ambush, and abode between Bethel and Hai, on the west side of the city of Hai. But Josue staid that night in the midst of the people, ¹⁰ And rising early in the morning, he mustered his soldiers, and went up with the ancients in the front of the army, environed with the aid of the fighting men. ¹¹ And when they were come, and were gone up over against the city, they stood on the north side of the city, between which and them there was a valley in the midst. ¹² And he had chosen five thousand men, and set them to lie in ambush between Bethel and Hai, on the west side of the same city: ¹³ But all the rest of the army went in battle array on the north side, so that the last of that multitude reached to the west side of the city. So Josue went that night, and stood in the midst of the valley. ¹⁴ And when the king of Hai saw this, he made haste in the morning, and went out with all the army of the city, and set it in battle array, toward the desert, not knowing that there lay an ambush behind his back. ¹⁵ But Josue, and all Israel gave back, making as if they were afraid, and fleeing by the way of the wilderness. ¹⁶ But they shouting together, and encouraging one another, pursued them. And when they were come from the city, ¹⁷ And not one remained in the city of Hai and of Bethel, that did not pursue after Israel, leaving the towns open as they had rushed out, ¹⁸ The Lord said to Josue: Lift up the shield that is in thy hand, towards the city of Hai, for I will deliver it to thee. ¹⁹ And when he had lifted up his shield towards the city, the ambush, that lay hid, rose up immediately: and going to the city, took it, and set it on fire. ²⁰ And the men of the city, that pursued after Josue, looking back, and seeing the smoke of the city rise up to heaven, had no more power to flee this way or that way: especially as they that had counterfeited flight, and were going toward the wilderness, turned back most valiantly against them that pursued. ²¹ So Josue, and all Israel, seeing that the city was taken, and that the smoke of the city rose up, returned, and slew the men of Hai. ²² And they also that had taken and set the city on fire, issuing out of the city to meet their own men, began to cut off the enemies who were surrounded by them. So that the enemies being cut off on both sides, not one of so great a multitude was saved. ²³ And they took the king of the city of Hai alive and brought him to Josue. ²⁴ So all being slain that had pursued after Israel, in his flight to the wilderness, and falling by the sword in the same place, the children of Israel returned and laid waste the city. ²⁵ And the number of them that fell that day, both of men and women, was twelve thousand persons, all of the city of Hai. ²⁶ But Josue drew not back his hand, which he had stretched out on high, holding the shield, till all the inhabitants of Hai were slain. ²⁷ And the children of Israel divided among them, the cattle and the prey of the city, as the Lord had commanded Josue. ²⁸ And he burnt the city, and made it a heap forever: ²⁹ And he hung the king thereof on a gibbet, until the evening and the going down of the sun. Then Josue commanded, and they took down his carcass from the gibbet: and threw it in the very entrance of the city, heaping upon it a great heap of stones, which remaineth until this present day.

³⁰ Then Josue built an altar to the Lord, the God of Israel, in Mount Hebal, ³¹ As Moses, the servant of the Lord, had commanded the children of Israel, and it is written in the book of the law of Moses: an altar of unhewn stones, which iron had not touched: and he offered upon it holocausts to the Lord, and immolated victims of peace offerings. ³² And he wrote upon stones, the Deuteronomy of the law of Moses, which he had ordered before the children of Israel. ³³ And all the people, and the ancients, and the princes, and judges, stood on both sides of the ark, before the priests that carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord, both the stranger and he that was born among them, half of them by Mount Garizim, and half by Mount Hebal, as Moses the servant of the Lord, had commanded. And first he blessed the people of Israel. ³⁴ After this, he read all the words of the blessing and the cursing, and all things that were written in the book of the law. ³⁵ He left out nothing of those things which Moses had commanded, but he repeated all before all the people of Israel, with the women and children, and strangers, that dwelt among them.

9 ¹ Now when these things were heard of, all the kings beyond the Jordan, that dwelt in the mountains, and in the plains, in the places near the sea, and on the coasts of the great sea, they also that dwell by Libanus, the Hethite, and the Amorrite, the Chanaanite, the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite, ² Gathered themselves together, to fight against Josue and Israel with one mind, and one resolution. ³ But they that dwelt in Gabaon, hearing all that Josue had done to Jericho and Hai: ⁴ Cunningly devising took for themselves provisions, laying old sacks upon their asses, and wine bottles rent and sewed up again, ⁵ And very old shoes, which for a show of age were clouted with patches, and old garments upon them: the loaves also, which they carried for provisions by the way, were hard, and broken into pieces: ⁶ And they went to Josue, who then abode in the camp at Galgal, and said to him, and to all Israel with him: We are come from a far country, desiring to make peace with you. And the children of Israel answered them, and said: ⁷ Perhaps you dwell in the land which falls to our lot; if so, we can make no league with you. ⁸ But they said to Josue: We are thy servants. Josue said to them: Who are you? and whence came you? ⁹ They answered: From a very far country thy servants are come in the name of the Lord thy God. For we have heard the fame of his power, all the things that he did in Egypt. ¹⁰ And to the two kings of the Amorrites, that were beyond the Jordan, Sehon, king of Hesebon, and Og, king of Basan, that was in Astaroth: ¹¹ And our ancients, and all the inhabitants of our country, said to us: Take with you victuals for a long way, and go meet them, and say: We are your servants, make ye a league with us. ¹² Behold, these loaves we took hot, when we set out from our houses to come to you, now they are become dry, and broken in pieces by being exceeding old. ¹³ These bottles of wine when we filled them were new, now they are rent and burst. These garments we have on, and the shoes we have on our feet, by reason of the very long journey, are worn out, and almost consumed. ¹⁴ They took therefore of their victuals, and consulted not the mouth of the Lord. ¹⁵ And Josue made peace with them, and entering into a league, promised that they should not be slain: the princes also of the multitude swore to them. ¹⁶ Now three days after

the league was made, they heard that they dwelt nigh, and they should be among them. ¹⁷ And the children of Israel removed the camp, and came into their cities on the third day, the names of which are, Gabaon, and Caphira, and Beroth, and Cariathiarim. ¹⁸ And they slew them not, because the princes of the multitude had sworn in the name of the Lord, the God of Israel. Then all the common people murmured against the princes. ¹⁹ And they answered them: We have sworn to them in the name of the Lord, the God of Israel, and therefore we may not touch them. ²⁰ But this we will do to them: Let their lives be saved, lest the wrath of the Lord be stirred up against us, if we should be forsworn: ²¹ But so let them live, as to serve the whole multitude in hewing wood, and bringing in water. As they were speaking these things,

²² Josue called the Gabaonites, and said to them: Why would you impose upon us, saying: We dwell very far off from you, whereas you are in the midst of us? ²³ Therefore you shall be under a curse, and your race shall always be hewers of wood, and carriers of water, into the house of my God. ²⁴ They answered: It was told us, thy servants, that the Lord thy God had promised his servant Moses, to give you all the land, and to destroy all the inhabitants thereof. Therefore we feared exceedingly and provided for our lives, compelled by the dread we had of you, and we took this counsel. ²⁵ And now we are in thy hand: deal with us as it seemeth good and right unto thee. ²⁶ So Josue did as he had said, and delivered them from the hand of the children of Israel, that they should not be slain. ²⁷ And he gave orders in that day, that they should be in the service of all the people, and of the altar of the Lord, hewing wood, and carrying water, until this present time, in the place which the Lord hath chosen.

109. The five kings; the sun stayed

Joshua 10:1-43

10 ¹ When Adonisedec, king of Jerusalem, had heard these things, to wit, that Josue had taken Hai, and had destroyed it, (for as he had done to Jericho and the king thereof, so did he to Hai and its king) and that the Gabaonites were gone over to Israel, and were their confederates, ² He was exceedingly afraid. For Gabaon was a great city, and one of the royal cities, and greater than the town of Hai, and all its fighting men were most valiant. ³ Therefore Adonisedec, king of Jerusalem, sent to Oham, king of Hebron, and to Pharam, king of Jerimoth, and to Japhia, king of Lachis, and to Dabir, king of Eglon, saying: ⁴ Come up to me, and bring help, that we may take Gabaon, because it hath gone over to Josue, and to the children of Israel. ⁵ So the five kings of the Amorrites being assembled together, went up: the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jerimoth, the king of Lachis, the king of Eglon, they and their armies, and camped about Gabaon, laying siege to it. ⁶ But the inhabitants of the city of Gabaon, which was besieged, sent to Josue, who then abode in the camp at Galgal, and said to him: Withdraw not thy hands from helping thy servants: come up quickly, and save us, and bring us succour: for all the kings of the Amorrites, who dwell in the mountains, are gathered together against us.

⁷ And Josue went up from Galgal, and all the army of the warriors with him, most valiant men. ⁸ But the Lord said to Josue: Fear them not: for I have delivered them into thy hands: none of them shall be able to stand against thee. ⁹ So Josue going

up from Galgal all the night, came upon them suddenly. ¹⁰ And the Lord troubled them, at the sight of Israel: and he slew them with a great slaughter, in Gabaon, and pursued them by the way of the ascent to Bethoron, and cut them off all the way to Azeca and Maceda. ¹¹ And when they were fleeing from the children of Israel, and were in the descent of Bethoron, the Lord cast down upon them great stones from heaven, as far as Azeca: and many more were killed with the hailstones, than were slain by the swords of the children of Israel,

¹² Then Josue spoke to the Lord, in the day that he delivered the Amorrite in the sight of the children of Israel, and he said before them: Move not, O sun, toward Gabaon, nor thou, O moon, toward the valley of Ajalon. ¹³ And the sun and the moon stood still, till the people revenged themselves of their enemies. Is not this written in the book of the just? So the sun stood still in the midst of heaven, and hasted not to go down the space of one day. ¹⁴ There was not before, nor after, so long a day, the Lord obeying the voice of a man, and fighting for Israel.

¹⁵ And Josue returned, with all Israel, into the camp of Galgal. ¹⁶ For the five kings were fled, and had hid themselves in a cave of the city of Maceda. ¹⁷ And it was told Josue, that the five kings were found hid in a cave of the city of Maceda. ¹⁸ And he commanded them that were with him, saying: Roll great stones to the mouth of the cave, and set careful men to keep them shut up: ¹⁹ And stay you not, but pursue after the enemies, and kill all the hindermost of them as they flee, and do not suffer them whom the Lord God hath delivered into your hands, to shelter themselves in their cities. ²⁰ So the enemies being slain with a great slaughter, and almost utterly consumed, they that were able to escape from Israel, entered into fenced cities. ²¹ And all the army returned to Josue, in Maceda, where the camp then was, in good health, and without the loss of any one: and no man durst move his tongue against the children of Israel. ²² And Josue gave orders, saying: Open the mouth of the cave, and bring forth to me the five kings that lie hid therein. ²³ And the ministers did as they were commanded: and they brought out to him the five kings out of the cave: the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jerimoth, the king of Lachis, the king of Eglon. ²⁴ And when they were brought out to him, he called all the men of Israel, and said to the chiefs of the army that were with him: Go, and set your feet on the necks of these kings. And when they had gone, and put their feet upon the necks of them lying under them, ²⁵ He said again to them: Fear not, neither be ye dismayed, take courage, and be strong: for so will the Lord do to all your enemies, against whom you fight. ²⁶ And Josue struck, and slew them, and hanged them upon five gibbets; and they hung until the evening. ²⁷ And when the sun was down, he commanded the soldiers to take them down from the gibbets. And after they were taken down, they cast them into the cave, where they had lain hid, and put great stones at the mouth thereof, which remain until this day.

²⁸ The same day Josue took Maceda, and destroyed it with the edge of the sword, and killed the king and all the inhabitants thereof: he left not in it the least remains. And he did to the king of Maceda, as he had done to the king of Jericho. ²⁹ And he passed from Maceda with all Israel to Lebna, and fought against it: ³⁰ And the Lord delivered it with the king thereof into the

hands of Israel: and they destroyed the city with the edge of the sword, and all the inhabitants thereof. They left not in it any remains. And they did to the king of Lebna, as they had done to the king of Jericho.

³¹ From Lebna he passed unto Lachis, with all Israel: and investing it with his army, besieged it. ³² And the Lord delivered Lachis into the hands of Israel, and he took it the following day, and put it to the sword, and every soul that was in it, as he had done to Lebna. ³³ At that time Horam, king of Gazer, came up to succour Lachis: and Josue slew him with all his people so as to leave none alive.

³⁴ And he passed from Lachis to Eglon, and surrounded it, ³⁵ And took it the same day: and put to the sword all the souls that were in it, according to all that he had done to Lachis. ³⁶ He went up also with all Israel from Eglon to Hebron, and fought against it: ³⁷ Took it, and destroyed it with the edge of the sword: the king also thereof, and all the towns of that country, and all the souls that dwelt in it: he left not therein any remains: as he had done to Eglon, so did he also to Hebron, putting to the sword all that he found in it.

³⁸ Returning from thence to Dabir, ³⁹ He took it, and destroyed it: the king also thereof, and all the towns round about, he destroyed with the edge of the sword: he left not in it any remains: as he had done to Hebron and Lebna, and to their kings, so did he to Dabir, and to the king thereof. ⁴⁰ So Josue conquered all the country of the hills, and of the south, and of the plain, and of Asedoth, with their kings: he left not any remains therein, but slew all that breathed, as the Lord, the God of Israel, had commanded him. ⁴¹ From Cadesbarne even to Gaza. All the land of Gosen even to Gabaon, ⁴² And all their kings, and their lands he took and wasted at one onset: for the Lord the God of Israel fought for him. ⁴³ And he returned with all Israel to the place of the camp in Galgal.

110. The northern kings

Joshua 11:1-23

Josue 12-22, the lists of conquered kings and the tribal allotments, are omitted here.

11 ¹ And when Jabin king of Asor had heard these things, he sent to Jobab king of Madon, and to the king of Semeron, and to the king of Achsaph: ² And to the kings of the north, that dwelt in the mountains and in the plains over against the south side of Ceneroth, and in the levels and the countries of Dor by the sea side: ³ To the Chanaanites also on the east and on the west, and the Amorrite, and the Hethite, and the Pherezite, and the Jebusite in the mountains: to the Hevite also who dwelt at the foot of Hermon in the land of Maspha. ⁴ And they all came out with their troops, a people exceeding numerous as the sand that is on the sea shore, their horses also and chariots a very great multitude, ⁵ And all these kings assembled together at the waters of Merom, to fight against Israel.

⁶ And the Lord said to Josue: Fear them not: for to morrow at this same hour I will deliver all these to be slain in the sight of Israel: thou shalt hamstring their horses, and thou shalt burn their chariots with fire. ⁷ And Josue came, and all the army with him, against them to the waters of Merom on a sudden, and fell upon them. ⁸ And the Lord delivered them into the hands

of Israel. And they defeated them, and chased them as far as the great Sidon and the waters of Maserophot, and the field of Masphe, which is on the east thereof. He slew them all, so as to leave no remains of them: ⁹ And he did as the Lord had commanded him, he hamstringed their horses and burned their chariots. ¹⁰ And presently turning back he took Asor: and slew the king thereof with the sword. Now Asor of old was the head of all these kingdoms. ¹¹ And he cut off all the souls that abode there: he left not in it any remains, but utterly destroyed all, and burned the city itself with fire. ¹² And he took and put to the sword and destroyed all the cities round about, and their kings, as Moses the servant of God had commanded him. ¹³ Except the cities that were on hills and high places, the rest Israel burned: only Asor that was very strong he consumed with fire. ¹⁴ And the children of Israel divided among themselves all the spoil of these cities and the cattle, killing all the men.

¹⁵ As the Lord had commanded Moses his servant, so did Moses command Josue, and he accomplished all: he left not one thing undone of all the commandments which the Lord had commanded Moses. ¹⁶ So Josue took all the country of the hills, and of the south, and the land of Gosen, and the plains and the west country, and the mountain of Israel, and the plains thereof: ¹⁷ And part of the mountain that goeth up to Seir as far as Baalgad, by the plain of Libanus under mount Hermon: all their kings he took, smote and slew. ¹⁸ Josue made war a long time against these kings. ¹⁹ There was not a city that delivered itself to the children of Israel, except the Hevite, who dwelt in Gabaon: for he took all by fight. ²⁰ For it was the sentence of the Lord, that their hearts should be hardened, and they should fight against Israel, and fall, and should not deserve any clemency, and should be destroyed as the Lord had commanded Moses. ²¹ At that time Josue came and cut off the Enacims from the mountains, from Hebron, and Dabir, and Anab, and from all the mountain of Juda and Israel, and destroyed their cities. ²² He left not any of the stock of the Enacims, in the land of the children of Israel: except the cities of Gaza, and Geth, and Azotus, in which alone they were left. ²³ So Josue took all the land, as the Lord spoke to Moses, and delivered it in possession to the children of Israel, according to their divisions and tribes. And the land rested from wars.

111. The last charge of Josue

Joshua 23:1-16

23 ¹ And when a long time was passed, after that the Lord had given peace to Israel, all the nations round about being subdued, and Josue being now old, and far advanced in years: ² Josue called for all Israel, and for the elders, and for the princes, and for the judges, and for the masters, and said to them: I am old, and far advanced in years, ³ And you see all that the Lord your God hath done to all the nations round about, how he himself hath fought for you: ⁴ And now since he hath divided to you by lot all the land, from the east of the Jordan unto the great sea, and many nations yet remain: ⁵ The Lord your God will destroy them, and take them away from before your face, and you shall possess the land as he hath promised you. ⁶ Only take courage, and be careful to observe all things that are written in the book of the law of Moses: and turn not aside from them neither to the right hand nor to the left: ⁷ Lest after that you are come in

among the Gentiles, who will remain among you, you should swear by the name of their gods, and serve them, and adore them: ⁸ But cleave ye unto the Lord your God, as you have done until this day. ⁹ And then the Lord God will take away before your eyes nations that are great and very strong, and no man shall be able to resist you. ¹⁰ One of you shall chase a thousand men of the enemies: because the Lord your God himself will fight for you, as he hath promised. ¹¹ This only take care of with all diligence, that you love the Lord your God. ¹² But if you will embrace the errors of these nations that dwell among you, and make marriages with them, and join friendships: ¹³ Know ye for a certainty that the Lord your God will not destroy them before your face, but they shall be a pit and a snare in your way, and a stumbling-block at your side, and stakes in your eyes, till he take you away and destroy you from off this excellent land, which he hath given you. ¹⁴ Behold this day I am going into the way of all the earth, and you shall know with all your mind that of all the words which the Lord promised to perform for you, not one hath failed, ¹⁵ Therefore as he hath fulfilled in deed, what he promised, and all things prosperous have come: so will he bring upon you all the evils he hath threatened, till he take you away and destroy you from off this excellent land, which he hath given you, ¹⁶ When you shall have transgressed the covenant of the Lord your God, which he hath made with you, and shall have served strange gods, and adored them: then shall the indignation of the Lord rise up quickly and speedily against you, and you shall be taken away from this excellent land, which he hath delivered to you.

112. The covenant at Sichem

Joshua 24:1-33

24 ¹ And Josue gathered together all the tribes of Israel in Sichem, and called for the ancients, and the princes and the judges, and the masters: and they stood in the sight of the Lord: ² And he spoke thus to the people: Thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: Your fathers dwelt of old on the other side of the river, Thare the father of Abraham, and Nachor: and they served strange gods. ³ And I took your father Abraham from the borders of Mesopotamia: and brought him into the land of Chanaan: and I multiplied his seed, ⁴ And gave him Isaac: and to him again I gave Jacob and Esau. And I gave to Esau mount Seir for his possession: but Jacob and his children went down into Egypt. ⁵ And I sent Moses and Aaron, and I struck Egypt with many signs and wonders. ⁶ And I brought you and your fathers out of Egypt, and you came to the sea: and the Egyptians pursued your fathers with chariots and horsemen, as far as the Red Sea. ⁷ And the children of Israel cried to the Lord: and he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea upon them, and covered them. Your eyes saw all that I did in Egypt, and you dwelt in the wilderness a long time. ⁸ And I brought you into the land of the Amorrite, who dwelt beyond the Jordan. And when they fought against you, I delivered them into your hands, and you possessed their land, and slew them. ⁹ And Balac son of Sephor king of Moab arose and fought against Israel. And he sent and called for Balaam son of Beor, to curse you: ¹⁰ And I would not hear him, but on the contrary I blessed you by him, and I delivered you out of his hand. ¹¹ And you passed over the Jordan, and you came to Jericho. And the men

of that city fought against you, the Amorrite, and the Pherezite, and the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Gergesite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite: and I delivered them into your hands. ¹² And I sent before you hornets: and I drove them out from their places, the two kings of the Amorrites, not with thy sword nor with thy bow, ¹³ And I gave you a land, in which you had not laboured, and cities to dwell in which you built not, vineyards and oliveyards, which you planted not.

¹⁴ Now therefore fear the Lord, and serve him with a perfect and most sincere heart: and put away the gods which your fathers served in Mesopotamia and in Egypt, and serve the Lord. ¹⁵ But if it seem evil to you to serve the Lord, you have your choice: choose this day that which pleaseth you, whom you would rather serve, whether the gods which your fathers served in Mesopotamia, or the gods of the Amorrites, in whose land you dwell: but as for me and my house we will serve the Lord, ¹⁶ And the people answered, and said, God forbid we should leave the Lord, and serve strange gods. ¹⁷ The Lord our God he brought us and our fathers out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage: and did very great signs in our sight, and preserved us in all the way by which we journeyed, and among all the people through whom we passed. ¹⁸ And he hath cast out all the nations, the Amorrite the inhabitant of the land into which we are come. Therefore we will serve the Lord, for he is our God. ¹⁹ And Josue said to the people: You will not be able to serve the Lord: for he is a holy God, and mighty and jealous, and will not forgive your wickedness and sins. ²⁰ If you leave the Lord, and serve strange gods, he will turn, and will afflict you, and will destroy you after all the good he hath done you. ²¹ And the people said to Josue: No, it shall not be so as thou sayest, but we will serve the Lord. ²² And Josue said to the people, You are witnesses, that you yourselves have chosen you the Lord to serve him. And they answered: We are witnesses. ²³ Now therefore, said he, put away strange gods from among you, and incline your hearts to the Lord the God of Israel. ²⁴ And the people said to Josue: We will serve the Lord our God, and we will be obedient to his commandments. ²⁵ Josue therefore on that day made a covenant, and set before the people commandments and judgments in Sichem. ²⁶ And he wrote all these things in the volume of the law of the Lord: and he took a great stone, and set it under the oak that was in the sanctuary of the Lord. ²⁷ And he said to all the people: Behold this stone shall be a testimony unto you, that it hath heard all the words of the Lord, which he hath spoken to you: lest perhaps hereafter you will deny it, and lie to the Lord your God. ²⁸ And he sent the people away every one to their own possession,

²⁹ And after these things Josue the son of Nun the servant of the Lord died, being a hundred and ten years old: ³⁰ And they buried him in the border of his possession in Thamnathare, which is situate in mount Ephraim, on the north side of mount Gaas. ³¹ And Israel served the Lord all the days of Josue, and of the ancients that lived a long time after Josue, and that had known all the works of the Lord which he had done in Israel. ³² And the bones of Joseph which the children of Israel had taken out of Egypt, they buried in Sichem, in that part of the field which Jacob had bought of the sons of Hemor the father of Sichem, for a hundred young ewes, and it was in the possession

of the sons of Joseph. ³³ Eleazar also the son of Aaron died: and they buried him in Gabaath that belongeth to Phinees his son, which was given him in mount Ephraim.

113. What the tribes failed to drive out

Judges 1:1-36

1 ¹ After the death of Josue, the children of Israel consulted the Lord, saying: Who shall go up before us against the Chanaanite, and shall be the leader of the war? ² And the Lord said: Juda shall go up: behold I have delivered the land into his hands. ³ And Juda said to Simeon, his brother: Come up with me into my lot, and fight against the Chanaanite, that I also may go along with thee into thy lot. And Simeon went with him. ⁴ And Juda went up, and the Lord delivered the Chanaanite, and the Pherezite into their hands: and they slew of them in Bezek ten thousand men. ⁵ And they found Adonibezec in Bezek, and fought against him, and they defeated the Chanaanite, and the Pherezite. ⁶ And Adonibezec fled: and they pursued after him and took him, and cut off his fingers and toes. ⁷ And Adonibezec said: Seventy kings, having their fingers and toes cut off, gathered up the leavings of the meat under my table: as I have done, so hath God requited me. And they brought him to Jerusalem, and he died there. ⁸ And the children of Juda besieging Jerusalem, took it, and put it to the sword, and set the whole city on fire.

⁹ And afterwards they went down and fought against the Chanaanite, who dwelt in the mountains, and in the south, and in the plains. ¹⁰ And Juda going forward against the Chanaanite, that dwelt in Hebron, (the name whereof was in former times Cariath-Arbe) slew Sesai, and Ahiman, and Tholmai: ¹¹ And departing from thence, he went to the inhabitants of Dabir, the ancient name of which was Cariath-Sepher, that is, the city of letters. ¹² And Caleb said: He that shall take Cariath-Sepher, and lay it waste, to him will I give my daughter Axa to wife. ¹³ And Othoniel, the son of Cenez, the younger brother of Caleb, having taken it, he gave him Axa his daughter to wife. ¹⁴ And as she was going on her way, her husband admonished her to ask a field of her father. And as she sighed sitting on her ass, Caleb said to her: What aileth thee? ¹⁵ But she answered: Give me a blessing, for thou hast given me a dry land: give me also a watery land So Caleb gave her the upper and the nether watery ground. ¹⁶ And the children of the Cinite, the kinsman of Moses, went up from the city of palms, with the children of Juda, into the wilderness of his lot, which is at the south side of Arad, and they dwelt with him. ¹⁷ And Juda went with Simeon, his brother, and they together defeated the Chanaanites that dwelt in Sephaath, and slew them. And the name of the city was called Horma, that is, Anathema. ¹⁸ And Juda took Gaza, with its confines, and Ascalon, and Accaron, with their confines. ¹⁹ And the Lord was with Juda, and he possessed the hill country: but was not able to destroy the inhabitants of the valley, because they had many chariots armed with scythes. ²⁰ And they gave Hebron to Caleb, as Moses had said, who destroyed out of it the three sons of Enac. ²¹ But the sons of Benjamin did not destroy the Jebusites that inhabited Jerusalem: and the Jebusite hath dwelt with the sons of Benjamin in Jerusalem until this present day.

²² The house of Joseph also went up against Bethel, and the Lord was with them. ²³ For when they were besieging the city, which before was called Luza, ²⁴ They saw a man coming out

of the city, and they said to him: Shew us the entrance into the city, and we will shew thee mercy. ²⁵ And when he had shewed them, they smote the city with the edge of the sword: but that man, and all his kindred, they let go: ²⁶ Who being sent away, went into the land of Hetthim, and built there a city, and called it Luza: which is so called until this day.

²⁷ Manasses also did not destroy Bethsan, and Thanac, with their villages; nor the inhabitants of Dor, and Jeblaam, and Mageddo, with their villages. And the Chanaanite began to dwell with them. ²⁸ But after Israel was grown strong, he made them tributaries, and would not destroy them. ²⁹ Ephraim also did not slay the Chanaanite that dwelt in Gazer, but dwelt with him. ³⁰ Zabulon destroyed not the inhabitants of Cetron, and Naalol: but the Chanaanite dwelt among them, and became their tributary. ³¹ Aser also destroyed not the inhabitants of Accho, and of Sidon, of Ahalab, and of Achazib, and of Helba, and of Aphec, and of Rohob: ³² And he dwelt in the midst of the Chanaanites, the inhabitants of that land, and did not slay them. ³³ Nephthali also destroyed not the inhabitants of Bethsames, and of Bethanath: and he dwelt in the midst of the Chanaanites, the inhabitants of the land, and the Bethsamites and Bethanites were tributaries to him. ³⁴ And the Amorrhite straitened the children of Dan in the mountain, and gave them not a place to go down to the plain: ³⁵ And he dwelt in the mountain Hares, that is, of potsherds, in Aialon and Salebim. And the hand of the house of Joseph was heavy upon him, and he became tributary to him. ³⁶ And the border of the Amorrhite was from the ascent of the scorpion, the rock, and the higher places.

114. The pattern of the judges

Judges 2:1-23

The interpretative key to the whole book: they forsook the Lord, he delivered them up, they cried, he raised a judge.

2 ¹ And an angel of the Lord went up from Galgal to the place of weepers, and said: I made you go out of Egypt, and have brought you into the land for which I swore to your fathers: and I promised that I would not make void my covenant with you for ever: ² On condition that you should not make a league with the inhabitants of this land, but should throw down their altars: and you would not hear my voice: why have you done this? ³ Wherefore I would not destroy them from before your face; that you may have enemies, and their gods may be your ruin. ⁴ And when the angel of the Lord spoke these words to all the children of Israel: they lifted up their voice, and wept. ⁵ And the name of that place was called, The place of weepers, or of tears: and there they offered sacrifices to the Lord. ⁶ And Josue sent away the people, and the children of Israel went every one to his own possession to hold it: ⁷ And they served the Lord all his days, and the days of the ancients, that lived a long time after him, and who knew all the works of the Lord, which he had done for Israel. ⁸ And Josue, the son of Nun, the servant of the Lord, died, being a hundred and ten years old; ⁹ And they buried him in the borders of his possession in Thamnathsare, in Mount Ephraim, on the north side of Mount Gaas. ¹⁰ And all that generation was gathered to their fathers: and there arose others that knew not the Lord and the works which he had done for Israel. ¹¹ And the children of Israel did evil in the sight

of the Lord, and they served Baalim, ¹² And they left the Lord, the God of their fathers, who had brought them out of the land of Egypt: and they followed strange gods, and the gods of the people that dwelt round about them, and they adored them: and they provoked the Lord to anger, ¹³ Forsaking him, and serving Baal and Astaroth ¹⁴ And the Lord being angry against Israel, delivered them into the hands of plunderers: who took them and sold them to their enemies, that dwelt round about: neither could they stand against their enemies: ¹⁵ But whithersoever they meant to go, the hand of the Lord was upon them, as he had said, and as he had sworn to them: and they were greatly distressed. ¹⁶ And the Lord raised up judges, to deliver them from the hands of those that oppressed them: but they would not hearken to them, ¹⁷ Committing fornication with strange gods, and adoring them. They quickly forsook the way, in which their fathers had walked: and hearing the commandments of the Lord, they did all things contrary. ¹⁸ And when the Lord raised them up judges, in their days, he was moved to mercy, and heard the groanings of the afflicted, and delivered them from the slaughter of the oppressors. ¹⁹ But after the judge was dead, they returned, and did much worse things than their fathers had done, following strange gods, serving them, and adoring them. They left not their own inventions, and the stubborn way, by which they were accustomed to walk. ²⁰ And the wrath of the Lord was kindled against Israel, and he said: Behold this nation hath made void my covenant, which I had made with their fathers, and hath despised to hearken to my voice: ²¹ I also will not destroy the nations which Josue left when he died: ²² That through them I may try Israel, whether they will keep the way of the Lord, and walk in it, as their fathers kept it, or not. ²³ The Lord therefore left all these nations, and would not quickly destroy them, neither did he deliver them into the hands of Josue.

115. Othoniel, Aod and Samgar

Judges 3:1-31

3 ¹ These are the nations which the Lord left, that by them he might instruct Israel, and all that had not known the wars of the Chanaanites: ² That afterwards their children might learn to fight with their enemies, and to be trained up to war: ³ The five princes of the Philistines, and all the Chanaanites, and the Sidonians, and the Hevites that dwelt in Mount Libanus, from Mount Baal Hermon to the entering into Emath. ⁴ And he left them, that he might try Israel by them, whether they would hear the commandments of the Lord, which he had commanded their fathers, by the hand of Moses, or not. ⁵ So the children of Israel dwelt in the midst of the Chanaanite, and the Hethite, and the Amorrhite, and the Pherezite, and the Hevite, and the Jebusite: ⁶ And they took their daughters to wives, and they gave their own daughters to their sons, and they served their gods. ⁷ And they did evil in the sight of the Lord, and they forgot their God, and served Baalim and Astaroth. ⁸ And the Lord being angry with Israel, delivered them into the hands of Chusan Rasathaim, king of Mesopotamia, and they served him eight years. ⁹ And they cried to the Lord, who raised them up a saviour, and delivered them; to wit, Othoniel, the son of Cenez, the younger brother of Caleb: ¹⁰ And the spirit of the Lord was in him, and he judged Israel. And he went out to fight, and the Lord deliv-

ered into his hands Chusan Rasathaim, king of Syria, and he overthrew him: ¹¹ And the land rested forty years, and Othoniel, the son of Cenez, died.

¹² And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the Lord: who strengthened against them Eglon, king of Moab: because they did evil in his sight. ¹³ And he joined to him the children of Ammon, and Amalec: and he went and overthrew Israel, and possessed the city of palm trees. ¹⁴ And the children of Israel served Eglon, king of Moab, eighteen years. ¹⁵ And afterwards they cried to the Lord, who raised them up a saviour, called Aod, the son of Gera, the son of Jemini, who used the left hand as well as the right. And the children of Israel sent presents to Eglon, king of Moab, by him. ¹⁶ And he made himself a two-edged sword, with a haft in the midst of the length of the palm of the hand, and was girded therewith, under his garment, on the right thigh. ¹⁷ And he presented the gifts to Eglon, king of Moab Now Eglon was exceeding fat. ¹⁸ And when he had presented the gifts unto him he followed his companions that came along with him. ¹⁹ Then returning from Galgal, where the idols were, he said to the king: I have a secret message to thee, O king. And he commanded silence: and all being gone out that were about him, ²⁰ Aod went in to him: now he was sitting in a summer parlour alone, and he said: I have a word from God to thee. And he forthwith rose up from his throne. ²¹ And Aod put forth his left hand, and took the dagger from his right thigh, and thrust it into his belly, ²² With such force that the haft went in after the blade into the wound, and was closed up with the abundance of fat. So that he did not draw out the dagger, but left it in the body as he had struck it in: and forthwith, by the secret parts of nature, the excrements of the belly came out. ²³ And Aod carefully shutting the doors of the parlour, and locking them, ²⁴ Went out by a postern door. And the king's servants going in, saw the doors of the parlour shut, and they said: Perhaps he is easing nature in his summer parlour. ²⁵ And waiting a long time, till they were ashamed, and seeing that no man opened the door, they took a key: and opening, they found their lord lying dead on the ground. ²⁶ But Aod, while they were in confusion, escaped, and passed by the place of the idols from whence he had returned. And he came to Seirath: ²⁷ And forthwith he sounded the trumpet in Mount Ephraim: and the children of Israel went down with him, he himself going in the front. ²⁸ And he said to them: Follow me: for the Lord hath delivered our enemies, the Moabites, into our hands. And they went down after him, and seized upon the fords of the Jordan, which are in the way to Moab: and they suffered no man to pass over: ²⁹ But they slew of the Moabites at that time, about ten thousand, all strong and valiant men: none of them could escape. ³⁰ And Moab was humbled that day under the hand of Israel: and the land rested eighty years.

³¹ After him was Samgar, the son of Anath, who slew of the Philistines six hundred men with a ploughshare: and he also defended Israel.

116. *Debbora and Barac*

Judges 4:1-24

4 ¹ And the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the Lord after the death of Aod: ² And the Lord delivered them up into the hands of Jabin, king of Chanaan, who reigned in Asor:

and he had a general of his army named Sisara, and he dwelt in Haroseth of the Gentiles. ³ And the children of Israel cried to the Lord: for he had nine hundred chariots set with scythes and for twenty years had grievously oppressed them. ⁴ And there was at that time Debbora, a prophetess, the wife of Lapidoth, who judged the people. ⁵ And she sat under a palm tree, which was called by her name, between Rama and Bethel, in Mount Ephraim: and the children of Israel came up to her for all judgment. ⁶ And she sent and called Barac, the Son of Abinoem, out of Cedec, in Nephthali: and she said to him: The Lord God of Israel hath commanded thee: Go, and lead an army to Mount Tabor, and thou shalt take with thee ten thousand fighting men of the children of Nephthali, and of the children of Zabulon: ⁷ And I will bring unto thee in the place of the torrent Cison, Sisara, the general of Jabin's army, and his chariots, and all his multitude, and will deliver them into thy hand. ⁸ And Barac said to her: If thou wilt come with me, I will go: if thou wilt not come with me, I will not go. ⁹ She said to him: I will go, indeed, with thee, but at this time the victory shall not be attributed to thee, because Sisara shall be delivered into the hand of a woman. Debbora therefore arose, and went with Barac to Cedec.

¹⁰ And he called unto him Zabulon and Nephthali, and went up with ten thousand fighting men, having Debbora in his company. ¹¹ Now Haber, the Cinite, had some time before departed from the rest of the Cinites, his brethren, the sons of Hobab, the kinsman of Moses: and had pitched his tents unto the valley, which is called Sennim, and was near Cedec. ¹² And it was told Sisara, that Barac, the son of Abinoem, was gone up to Mount Tabor: ¹³ And he gathered together his nine hundred chariots armed with scythes, and all his army, from Haroseth of the Gentiles, to the torrent Cison. ¹⁴ And Debbora said to Barac: Arise, for this is the day wherein the Lord hath delivered Sisara into thy hands: behold, he is thy leader. And Barac went down from Mount Tabor, and ten thousand fighting men with him. ¹⁵ And the Lord struck a terror into Sisara, and all his chariots, and all his multitude, with the edge of the sword, at the sight of Barac: insomuch, that Sisara leaping down from off his chariot, fled away on foot, ¹⁶ And Barac pursued after the fleeing chariots, and the army, unto Haroseth of the Gentiles; and all the multitude of the enemies was utterly destroyed.

¹⁷ But Sisara fleeing, came to the tent of Jahel, the wife of Haber, the Cinite, for there was peace between Jabin, the king of Asor, and the house of Haber, the Cinite. ¹⁸ And Jahel went forth to meet Sisara, and said to him: Come in to me, my lord; come in, fear not. He went into her tent, and being covered by her with a cloak, ¹⁹ Said to her: Give me, I beseech thee, a little water, for I am very thirsty. She opened a bottle of milk, and gave him to drink, and covered him. ²⁰ And Sisara said to her: Stand before the door of the tent, and when any shall come and inquire of thee, saying: Is there any man here? thou shalt say: There is none. ²¹ So Jahel, Haber's wife, took a nail of the tent, and taking also a hammer: and going in softly, and with silence, she put the nail upon the temples of his head, and striking it with the hammer, drove it through his brain fast into the ground: and so passing from deep sleep to death, he fainted away and died. ²² And behold, Barac came pursuing after Sisara: and Jahel went out to meet him, and said to him: Come, and I will shew thee

the man whom thou seekest. And when he came into her tent, he saw Sisara lying dead, and the nail fastened in his temples. ²³ So God that day humbled Jabin, the king of Chanaan, before the children of Israel: ²⁴ Who grew daily stronger, and with a mighty hand overpowered Jabin, king of Chanaan, till they quite destroyed him.

117. The canticle of Debbora

Judges 5:1-32

⁵ ¹ In that day Debbora and Barac, son of Abinoem, sung, and said: ² O you of Israel, that have willingly offered your lives to danger, bless the Lord. ³ Hear, O ye kings, give ear, O ye princes: It is I, it is I, that will sing to the Lord, I will sing to the Lord, the God of Israel. ⁴ O Lord, when thou wentest out of Seir, and passedst by the regions of Edom, the earth trembled, and the heavens and clouds dropped water. ⁵ The mountains melted before the face of the Lord, and Sinai before the face of the Lord the God of Israel. ⁶ In the days of Samgar, the son of Anath, in the days of Jahel, the paths rested: and they that went by them, walked through bye-ways. ⁷ The valiant men ceased, and rested in Israel: until Debbora arose, a mother arose in Israel. ⁸ The Lord chose new wars, and he himself overthrew the gates of the enemies: a shield and spear was not seen among forty thousand of Israel. ⁹ My heart loveth the princes of Israel: O you, that of your own good will offered yourselves to danger, bless the Lord. ¹⁰ Speak, you that ride upon fair asses, and you that sit in judgment, and walk in the way. ¹¹ Where the chariots were dashed together, and the army of the enemies was choked, there let the justices of the Lord be rehearsed, and his clemency towards the brave men of Israel: then the people of the Lord went down to the gates, and obtained the sovereignty. ¹² Arise, arise, O Debbora, arise, arise, and utter a canticle. Arise, Barac, and take hold of thy captives, O son of Abinoem. ¹³ The remnants of the people are saved, the Lord hath fought among the valiant ones. ¹⁴ Out of Ephraim he destroyed them into Amalec, and after him out of Benjamin into thy people, O Amalec: Out of Machir there came down princes, and out of Zabulon they that led the army to fight. ¹⁵ The captains of Issachar were with Debbora, and followed the steps of Barac, who exposed himself to danger, as one going headlong, and into a pit. Ruben being divided against himself, there was found a strife of courageous men. ¹⁶ Why dwellest thou between two borders, that thou mayst hear the bleatings of the flocks? Ruben being divided against himself, there was found a strife of courageous men. ¹⁷ Galaad rested beyond the Jordan, and Dan applied himself to ships: Aser dwelt on the sea shore, and abode in the havens. ¹⁸ But Zabulon and Nephthali offered their lives to death in the region of Merome. ¹⁹ The kings came and fought, the kings of Chanaan fought in Thanac, by the waters of Mageddo and yet they took no spoils. ²⁰ There was war made against them from heaven: the stars, remaining in their order and courses, fought against Sisara. ²¹ The torrent of Cison dragged their carcasses, the torrent of Cadumim, the torrent of Cison: tread thou, my soul, upon the strong ones. ²² The hoofs of the horses were broken whilst the stoutest of the enemies fled amain, and fell headlong down. ²³ Curse ye the land of Meroz, said the angel of the Lord: curse the inhabitants thereof, because they came not to the help of the Lord, to help his most valiant men. ²⁴ Blessed among women be Jahel, the wife of Haber the

Cinite, and blessed be she in her tent. ²⁵ He asked her water, and she gave him milk, and offered him butter in a dish fit for princes. ²⁶ She put her left hand to the nail, and her right hand to the workman's hammer, and she struck Sisara, seeking in his head a place for the wound, and strongly piercing through his temples. ²⁷ Between her feet he fell: he fainted, and he died: he rolled before her feet, and there he lay lifeless and wretched. ²⁸ His mother looked out at a window, and howled: and she spoke from the dining room: Why is his chariot so long in coming back? Why are the feet of his horses so slow? ²⁹ One that was wiser than the rest of his wives, returned this answer to her mother in law: ³⁰ Perhaps he is now dividing the spoils, and the fairest of the women is chosen out for him: garments of divers colours are given to Sisara for his prey, and furniture of different kinds is heaped together to adorn necks. ³¹ So let all thy enemies perish, O Lord: but let them that love thee shine, as the sun shineth in his rising. ³² And the land rested for forty years.

118. The call of Gedeon

Judges 6:1-40

⁶ ¹ And the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the Lord: and he delivered them into the hand of Madian seven years, ² And they were grievously oppressed by them. And they made themselves dens and caves in the mountains, and strong holds to resist. ³ And when Israel had sown, Madian and Amalec, and the rest of the eastern nations, came up: ⁴ And pitching their tents among them, wasted all things as they were in the blade, even to the entrance of Gaza: and they left nothing at all in Israel for sustenance of life, nor sheep, nor oxen, nor asses. ⁵ For they and all their flocks came with their tents, and like locusts filled all places, an innumerable multitude of men, and of camels, wasting whatsoever they touched. ⁶ And Israel was humbled exceedingly in the sight of Madian.

⁷ And he cried to the Lord, desiring help against the Madianites. ⁸ And he sent unto them a prophet, and he spoke: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: I made you to come up out of Egypt, and brought you out of the house of bondage, ⁹ And delivered you out of the hands of the Egyptians, and of all the enemies that afflicted you: and I cast them out at your coming in, and gave you their land. ¹⁰ And I said: I am the Lord your God, fear not the gods of the Amorrites, in whose land you dwell. And you would not hear my voice.

¹¹ And an angel of the Lord came, and sat under an oak that was in Ephra, and belonged to Joas, the father of the family of Ezri. And when Gedeon, his son, was threshing and cleansing wheat by the winepress, to flee from Madian, ¹² The angel of the Lord appeared to him, and said: The Lord is with thee, O most valiant of men. ¹³ And Gedeon said to him: I beseech thee, my lord, if the Lord be with us, why have these evils fallen upon us? Where are his miracles, which our fathers have told us of, saying: The Lord brought us out of Egypt but now the Lord hath forsaken us, and delivered us into the hand of Madian. ¹⁴ And the Lord looked upon him, and said: Go, in this thy strength, and thou shalt deliver Israel out of the hand of Madian: know that I have sent thee. ¹⁵ He answered, and said: I beseech thee, my lord wherewith shall I deliver Israel? Behold, my family is the meanest in Manasses, and I am the least in my father's house. ¹⁶ And the Lord said to him: I will be with thee: and thou shalt

cut off Madian as one man. ¹⁷ And he said: If I have found grace before thee, give me a sign that it is thou that speakest to me: ¹⁸ And depart not hence, till I return to thee, and bring a sacrifice, and offer it to thee. And he answered: I will wait thy coming.

¹⁹ So Gedeon went in, and boiled a kid, and made unleavened loaves of a measure of flour: and putting the flesh in a basket, and the broth of the flesh into a pot, he carried all under the oak, and presented to him. ²⁰ And the angel of the Lord said to him: Take the flesh and the unleavened loaves, and lay them upon that rock, and pour out the broth thereon. And when he had done so,

²¹ The angel of the Lord put forth the tip of the rod, which he held in his hand, and touched the flesh and the unleavened loaves: and there arose a fire from the rock, and consumed the flesh and the unleavened loaves: and the angel of the Lord vanished out of his sight. ²² And Gedeon seeing that it was the angel of the Lord, said: Alas, my Lord God: for I have seen the angel of the Lord face to face. ²³ And the Lord said to him: Peace be with thee: fear not, thou shalt not die. ²⁴ And Gedeon built there an altar to the Lord, and called it the Lord's peace, until this present day. And when he was yet in Ephra, which is of the family of Ezri,

²⁵ That night the Lord said to him: Take a bullock of thy father's, and another bullock of seven years, and thou shalt destroy the altar of Baal, which is thy father's: and cut down the grove that is about the altar: ²⁶ And thou shalt build an altar to the Lord thy God, in the top of this rock, whereupon thou didst lay the sacrifice before: and thou shalt take the second bullock, and shalt offer a holocaust upon a pile of the wood, which thou shalt cut down out of the grove. ²⁷ Then Gedeon, taking ten men of his servants, did as the Lord had commanded him. But fearing his father's house, and the men of that city, he would not do it by day, but did all by night.

²⁸ And when the men of that town were risen in the morning, they saw the altar of Baal destroyed, and the grove cut down, and the second bullock laid upon the altar, which then was built. ²⁹ And they said one to another: Who hath done this? And when they inquired for the author of the fact, it was said: Gedeon, the son of Joas, did all this. ³⁰ And they said to Joas: Bring out thy son hither, that he may die: because he hath destroyed the altar of Baal, and hath cut down his grove. ³¹ He answered them: Are you the avengers of Baal, that you fight for him? he that is his adversary, let him die before to morrow light appear: if he be a god, let him revenge himself on him that hath cast down his altar. ³² From that day Gedeon was called Jerobaal, because Joas had said: Let Baal revenge himself on him that hath cast down his altar.

³³ Now all Madian, and Amalec, and the eastern people, were gathered together, and passing over the Jordan, camped in the valley of Jezrael. ³⁴ But the spirit of the Lord came upon Gedeon, and he sounded the trumpet, and called together the house of Abiezer, to follow him. ³⁵ And he sent messengers into all Manasses, and they also followed him: and other messengers into Aser and Zabulon, and Nephthali, and they came to meet him.

³⁶ And Gedeon said to God: If thou wilt save Israel by my hand, as thou hast said, ³⁷ I will put this fleece of wool on the floor: if there be dew on the fleece only, and it be dry on all the

ground beside, I shall know that by my hand, as thou hast said, thou wilt deliver Israel. ³⁸ And it was so. And rising before day, wringing the fleece, he filled a vessel with the dew. ³⁹ And he said again to God: Let not thy wrath be kindled against me, if I try once more, seeking a sign in the fleece. I pray that the fleece only may be dry, and all the ground wet with dew. ⁴⁰ And God did that night as he had requested: and it was dry on the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

119. Gedeon and the three hundred

Judges 7:1-25

7 ¹ Then Jerobaal, who is the same as Gedeon, rising up early, and all the people with him, came to the fountain that is called Harad. Now the camp of Madian was in the valley, on the north side of the high hill. ² And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people that are with thee are many, and Madian shall not be delivered into their hands: lest Israel should glory against me, and say: I was delivered by my own strength. ³ Speak to the people, and proclaim in the hearing of all: Whosoever is fearful and timorous, let him return. So two and twenty thousand men went away from Mount Galaad and returned home, and only ten thousand remained. ⁴ And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people are still too many, bring them to the waters, and there I will try them: and of whom I shall say to thee, This shall go with thee, let him go: whom I shall forbid to go, let him return. ⁵ And when the people were come down to the waters, the Lord said to Gedeon: They that shall lap the water with their tongues, as dogs are wont to lap, thou shalt set apart by themselves: but they that shall drink bowing down their knees, shall be on the other side. ⁶ And the number of them that had lapped water; casting it with the hand to their mouth, was three hundred men: and all the rest of the multitude had drunk kneeling. ⁷ And the Lord said to Gedeon: By the three hundred men, that lapped water, I will save you, and deliver Madian into thy hand: but let all the rest of the people return to their place. ⁸ So taking victuals and trumpets according to their number, he ordered all the rest of the multitude to depart to their tents: and he with the three hundred gave himself to the battle. Now the camp of Madia was beneath him in the valley. ⁹ The same night the Lord said to him: Arise, and go down into the camp: because I have delivered them into thy hand. ¹⁰ But if thou be afraid to go alone, let Phara, thy servant, go down with thee. ¹¹ And when thou shalt hear what they are saying, then shall thy hands be strengthened, and thou shalt go down more secure to the enemies' camp. And he went down with Phara his servant, into part of the camp, where was the watch of men in arms. ¹² But Madian and Amalec, and all the eastern people, lay scattered in the valley, as a multitude of locusts: their camels also were innumerable, as the sand that lieth on the sea shore. ¹³ And when Gedeon was come, one told his neighbour a dream: and in this manner related what he had seen: I dreamt a dream, and it seemed to me as if a hearth cake of barley bread rolled and came down into the camp of Madian: and when it was come to a tent, it struck it, and beat it down flat to the ground. ¹⁴ He to whom he spoke, answered: This is nothing else but the sword of Gedeon, the son of Joas, a man of Israel. For the Lord hath delivered Madian, and all their camp into his hand.

¹⁵ And when Gedeon had heard the dream, and the interpretation thereof, he adored: and returned to the camp of Israel, and

said: Arise, for the Lord hath delivered the camp of Madian into our hands.

¹⁶ And he divided the three hundred men into three parts, and gave them trumpets in their hands, and empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers. ¹⁷ And he said to them: What you shall see me do, do you the same: I will go into one part of the camp, and do you as I shall do. ¹⁸ When the trumpet shall sound in my hand, do you also blow the trumpets on every side of the camp, and shout together to the Lord and to Gedeon.

¹⁹ And Gedeon, and the three hundred men that were with him, went into part of the camp, at the beginning of the midnight watch, and the watchmen being alarmed, they began to sound their trumpets, and to clap the pitchers one against another. ²⁰ And when they sounded their trumpets in three places round about the camp, and had broken their pitchers, they held their lamps in their left hands, and with their right hands the trumpets which they blew, and they cried out: The sword of the Lord and of Gedeon: ²¹ Standing every man in his place round about the enemies' camp. So all the camp was troubled, and crying out and howling, they fled away: ²² And the three hundred men nevertheless persisted sounding the trumpets. And the Lord sent the sword into all the camp, and they killed one another, ²³ Fleeing as far as Bethsetta, and the border of Abelmahula, in Tebbath. But the men of Israel, shouting from Nephthali, and Aser, and from all Manasses, pursued after Madian. ²⁴ And Gedeon sent messengers into all Mount Ephraim, saying: Come down to meet Madian, and take the waters before them to Bethbera and the Jordan. And all Ephraim shouted, and took the waters before them and the Jordan as far as Bethbera. ²⁵ And having taken two men of Madian, Oreb and Zeb: Oreb they slew in the rock of Oreb, and Zeb in the winepress of Zeb. And they pursued Madian, carrying the heads of Oreb and Zeb to Gedeon, beyond the waters of the Jordan.

120. Gedeon's victory, and the ephod

Judges 8:1-35

8 ¹ And the men of Ephraim said to him: What is this that thou meanest to do, that thou wouldst not call us, when thou wentest to fight against Madian? And they chid him sharply, and almost offered violence. ² And he answered them: What could I have done like to that which you have done? Is not one bunch of grapes of Ephraim better than the vintages of Abiezer? ³ The Lord hath delivered into your hands the princes of Madian, Oreb and Zeb: what could I have done like to what you have done? And when he had said this, their spirit was appeased, with which they swelled against him.

⁴ And when Gedeon was come to the Jordan, he passed over it with the three hundred men that were with him: who were so weary that they could not pursue after them that fled. ⁵ And he said to the men of Soccoth: Give, I beseech you, bread to the people that is with me, for they are faint: that we may pursue Zebbee, and Salmana, the kings of Madian.

⁶ The princes of Soccoth answered: Peradventure the palms of the hands of Zebbee and Salmana are in thy hand, and therefore thou demandest that we should give bread to thy army. ⁷ And he said to them: When the Lord therefore shall have delivered Zebbee and Salmana into my hands, I will thresh your flesh with the thorns and briers of the desert.

⁸ And going up from thence, he came to Phanuel: and he spoke the like things to the men of that place. And they also answered him, as the men of Soccoth had answered. ⁹ He said, therefore, to them also: When I shall return a conqueror in peace, I will destroy this tower.

¹⁰ But Zebbee and Salmana were resting with all their army. For fifteen thousand men were left of all the troops of the eastern people, and one hundred and twenty thousand warriors that drew the sword were slain. ¹¹ And Gedeon went up by the way of them that dwelt in tents, on the east of Nobe and Jegbaa, and smote the camp of the enemies, who were secure, and suspected no hurt. ¹² And Zebbee and Salmana fled, and Gedeon pursued and took them, all their host being put in confusion. ¹³ And returning from the battle before the sun rising, ¹⁴ He took a boy of the men of Soccoth: and he asked him the names of the princes and ancients of Soccoth, and he described unto him seventy-seven men. ¹⁵ And he came to Soccoth, and said to them: Behold Zebbee, and Salmana, concerning whom you upbraided me, saying: Peradventure the hands of Zebbee and Salmana are in thy hands, and therefore thou demandest that we should give bread to the men that are weary and faint. ¹⁶ So he took the ancients of the city, and thorns and briers of the desert, and tore them with the same, and cut in pieces the men of Soccoth. ¹⁷ And he demolished the tower of Phanuel, and slew the men of the city.

¹⁸ And he said to Zebbee and Salmana: What manner of men were they, whom you slew in Thabor? They answered: They were like thee, and one of them as the son of a king. ¹⁹ He answered them: They were my brethren, the sons of my mother. As the Lord liveth, if you had saved them, I would not kill you. ²⁰ And he said to Jether, his eldest son: Arise, and slay them. But he drew not his sword: for he was afraid, being but yet a boy. ²¹ And Zebbee and Salmana said: Do thou rise and run upon us: because the strength of a man is according to his age: Gedeon rose up, and slew Zebbee and Salmana: and he took the ornaments and bosses, with which the necks of the camels of kings are wont to be adorned.

²² And all the men of Israel said to Gedeon: Rule thou over us, and thy son, and thy son's son: because thou hast delivered us from the hand of Madian. ²³ And he said to them: I will not rule over you, neither shall my son rule over you, but the Lord shall rule over you. ²⁴ And he said to them: I desire one request of you: Give me the earlets of your spoils. For the Ismaelites were accustomed to wear golden earlets. ²⁵ They answered: We will give them most willingly. And spreading a mantle on the ground, they cast upon it the earlets of the spoils. ²⁶ And the weight of the earlets that he requested, was a thousand seven hundred sicles of gold, besides the ornaments, and jewels, and purple raiment, which the kings of Madian were wont to use, and besides the golden chains that were about the camels necks. ²⁷ And Gedeon made an ephod thereof, and put it in his city Ephra. And all Israel committed fornication with it, and it became a ruin to Gedeon, and to all his house. ²⁸ But Madian was humbled before the children of Israel, neither could they any more lift up their heads: but the land rested for forty years, while Gedeon presided.

²⁹ So Jerobaal, the son of Joas, went and dwelt in his own house: ³⁰ And he had seventy sons, who came out of his thigh,

for he had many wives. ³¹ And his concubine, that he had in Sichem, bore him a son, whose name was Abimelech. ³² And Gedeon, the son of Joas died in a good old age, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father, in Ephra, of the family of Ezri. ³³ But after Gedeon was dead, the children of Israel turned again, and committed fornication with Baalim. And they made a covenant with Baal, that he should be their god: ³⁴ And they remembered not the Lord their God, who delivered them out of the hands of all their enemies round about: ³⁵ Neither did they shew mercy to the house of Jerobaal Gedeon, according to all the good things he had done to Israel.

121. Abimelech, and the parable of the trees

Judges 9:1-10:18

9 ¹ And Abimelech, the son of Jerobaal, went to Sichem, to his mother's brethren, and spoke to them, and to all the kindred of his mother's father, saying: ² Speak to all the men of Sichem: whether is better for you that seventy men, all the sons of Jerobaal, should rule over you, or that one man should rule over you? And withal, consider that I am your bone, and your flesh. ³ And his mother's brethren spoke of him to all the men of Sichem, all these words, and they inclined their hearts after Abimelech, saying: He is our brother: ⁴ And they gave him seventy weight of silver out of the temple of Baalberith: wherewith he hired to himself men that were needy, and vagabonds, and they followed him. ⁵ And he came to his father's house in Ephra, and slew his brethren, the sons of Jerobaal, seventy men, upon one stone: and there remained only Joatham, the youngest son of Jerobaal, who was hidden. ⁶ And all the men of Sichem were gathered together, and all the families of the city of Mello: and they went and made Abimelech king, by the oak that stood in Sichem. ⁷ This being told to Joatham, he went, and stood on the top of Mount Garizim: and lifting up his voice, he cried, and said: Hear me, ye men of Sichem, so may God hear you. ⁸ The trees went to anoint a king over them: and they said to the olive tree: Reign thou over us. ⁹ And it answered: Can I leave my fatness, which both gods and men make use of, to come to be promoted among the trees? ¹⁰ And the trees said to the fig tree: Come thou and reign over us. ¹¹ And it answered them: Can I leave my sweetness, and my delicious fruits, and go to be promoted among the other trees? ¹² And the trees said to the vine: Come thou and reign over us. ¹³ And it answered them: Can I forsake my wine, that cheereth God and men, and be promoted among the other trees? ¹⁴ And all the trees said to the bramble: Come thou and reign over us. ¹⁵ And it answered them: If, indeed, you mean to make me king, come ye, and rest under my shadow: but if you mean it not, let fire come out from the bramble, and devour the cedars of Libanus. ¹⁶ Now, therefore, if you have done well, and without sin, in appointing Abimelech king over you, and have dealt well with Jerobaal, and with his house, and have made a suitable return for the benefits of him who fought for you, ¹⁷ And exposed his life to dangers, to deliver you from the hand of Madian, ¹⁸ And you are now risen up against my father's house, and have killed his sons, seventy men, upon one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his handmaid, king over the inhabitants of Sichem, because he is your brother: ¹⁹ If therefore you have dealt well, and without fault, with Jerobaal and his house, rejoice ye, this day, in Abimelech, and may he

rejoice in you. ²⁰ But if unjustly: let fire come out from him, and consume the inhabitants of Sichem, and the town of Mello: and let fire come out from the men of Sichem and from the town of Mello, and devour Abimelech. ²¹ And when he had said thus, he fled, and went into Bera: and dwelt there for fear of Abimelech, his brother.

²² So Abimelech reigned over Israel three years. ²³ And the Lord sent a very evil spirit between Abimelech and the inhabitants of Sichem; who began to detest him, ²⁴ And to lay the crime of the murder of the seventy sons of Jerobaal, and the shedding of their blood, upon Abimelech, their brother, and upon the rest of the princes of the Sichemites, who aided him. ²⁵ And they set an ambush against him on the top of the mountains: and while they waited for his coming, they committed robberies, taking spoils of all that passed by: and it was told Abimelech. ²⁶ And Gaal, the son of Obed, came with his brethren, and went over to Sichem. And the inhabitants of Sichem, taking courage at his coming, ²⁷ Went out into the fields, wasting the vineyards, and treading down the grapes: and singing and dancing, they went into the temple of their god, and in their banquets and cups they cursed Abimelech. ²⁸ And Gaal, the son of Obed, cried: Who is Abimelech, and what is Sichem, that we should serve him? Is he not the son of Jerobaal, and hath made Zebul, his servant, ruler over the men of Emor, the father of Sichem? Why then shall we serve him? ²⁹ Would to God that some man would put this people under my hand, that I might remove Abimelech out of the way. And it was said to Abimelech: Gather together the multitude of an army, and come.

³⁰ For Zebul, the ruler of the city, hearing the words of Gaal, the son of Obed, was very angry, ³¹ And sent messengers privately to Abimelech, saying: Behold, Gaal, the son of Obed, is come into Sichem with his brethren, and endeavoureth to set the city against thee. ³² Arise, therefore, in the night, with the people that is with thee, and lie hid in the field: ³³ And betimes in the morning, at sun rising, set upon the city, and when he shall come out against thee, with his people, do to him what thou shalt be able.

³⁴ Abimelech, therefore, arose with all his army, by night, and laid ambushes near Sichem in four places. ³⁵ And Gaal, the son of Obed, went out, and stood in the entrance of the gate of the city. And Abimelech rose up, and all his army with him, from the places of the ambushes. ³⁶ And when Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul: Behold, a multitude cometh down from the mountains. And he answered him: Thou seest the shadows of the mountains as if they were the heads of men, and this is thy mistake. ³⁷ Again Gaal said: Behold, there cometh people down from the midst of the land, and one troop cometh by the way that looketh towards the oak. ³⁸ And Zebul said to him: Where is now thy mouth, wherewith thou saidst: Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him? Is not this the people which thou didst despise? Go out, and fight against him. ³⁹ So Gaal went out, in the sight of the people of Sichem, and fought against Abimelech, ⁴⁰ Who chased and put him to flight, and drove him to the city: and many were slain of his people, even to the gate of the city: ⁴¹ And Abimelech sat down in Ruma: but Zebul drove Gaal, and his companions, out of the city, and would not suffer them to abide in it. ⁴² So the day following the people went out into the

field. And it was told to Abimelech, ⁴³ And he took his army, and divided it into three companies, and laid ambushes in the fields. And seeing that the people came out of the city, he arose, and set upon them, ⁴⁴ With his own company, assaulting and besieging the city: whilst the two other companies chased the enemies that were scattered about the field. ⁴⁵ And Abimelech assaulted the city all that day: and took it, and killed the inhabitants thereof, and demolished it, so that he sowed salt in it.

⁴⁶ And when they who dwelt in the tower of Sichem, had heard this, they went into the temple of their god Berith, where they had made a covenant with him, and from thence the place had taken its name, and it was exceeding strong. ⁴⁷ Abimelech also hearing that the men of the tower of Sichem were gathered together, ⁴⁸ Went up into mount Selmon, he and all his people with him: and taking an axe, he cut down the bough of a tree, and laying it on his shoulder, and carrying it, he said to his companions: What you see me do, do ye out of hand. ⁴⁹ So they cut down boughs from the trees, every man as fast as he could, and followed their leader. And surrounding the fort, they set it on fire: and so it came to pass, that with the smoke and with the fire a thousand persons were killed, men and women together, of the inhabitants of the town of Sichem. ⁵⁰ Then Abimelech, departing from thence, came to the town of Thebes, which he surrounded and besieged with his army. ⁵¹ And there was in the midst of the city a high tower, to which both the men and the women were fled together, and all the princes of the city, and having shut and strongly barred the gate, they stood upon the battlements of the tower to defend themselves. ⁵² And Abimelech, coming near the tower, fought stoutly: and, approaching to the gate, endeavoured to set fire to it: ⁵³ And behold, a certain woman casting a piece of a millstone from above, dashed it against the head of Abimelech, and broke his skull. ⁵⁴ And he called hastily to his armourbearer, and said to him: Draw thy sword, and kill me: lest it should be said that I was slain by a woman. He did as he was commanded, and slew him. ⁵⁵ And when he was dead all the men of Israel that were with him, returned to their homes. ⁵⁶ And God repaid the evil that Abimelech had done against his father, killing his seventy brethren. ⁵⁷ The Sichemites also were rewarded for what they had done, and the curse of Joatham, the son of Jerobaal, came upon them.

10 ¹ After Abimelech, there arose a ruler in Israel, Thola, son of Phua, the uncle of Abimelech, a man of Issachar, who dwelt in Samir of mount Ephraim: ² And he judged Israel three and twenty years, and he died, and was buried in Samir.

³ To him succeeded Jair, the Galaadite, who judged Israel for two and twenty years, ⁴ Having thirty sons, that rode on thirty ass colts, and were princes of thirty cities, which from his name were called Havoth Jair, that is, the towns of Jair, until this present day, in the land of Galaad. ⁵ And Jair died, and was buried in the place which is called Camon.

⁶ But the children of Israel, adding new sins to their old ones, did evil in the sight of the Lord, and served idols, Baalim and Astaroth, and the gods of Syria, and of Sidon, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines: and they left the Lord, and did not serve him. ⁷ And the Lord being angry with them, delivered them into the hands of the Philistines, and of the children of Ammon. ⁸ And they were afflicted, and grievously op-

pressed for eighteen years, all they that dwelt beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorhite, who is in Galaad: ⁹ Inasmuch that the children of Ammon, passing over the Jordan, wasted Juda, and Benjamin, and Ephraim: and Israel was distressed exceedingly. ¹⁰ And they cried to the Lord, and said, We have sinned against thee, because we have forsaken the Lord our God, and have served Baalim. ¹¹ And the Lord said to them: Did not the Egyptians, and the Amorrites, and the children of Ammon, and the Philistines, ¹² The Sidonians also, and Amalec, and Chanaan, oppress you, and you cried to me, and I delivered you out of their hand? ¹³ And yet you have forsaken me, and have worshipped strange gods: therefore I will deliver you no more: ¹⁴ Go, and call upon the gods which you have chosen: let them deliver you in the time of distress.

¹⁵ And the children of Israel said to the Lord: We have sinned, do thou unto us whatsoever pleaseth thee: only deliver us this time. ¹⁶ And saying these things, they cast away out of their coats all the idols of strange gods, and served the Lord their God: and he was touched with their miseries. ¹⁷ And the children of Ammon shouting together, pitched their tents in Galaad: against whom the children of Israel assembled themselves together, and camped in Maspha. ¹⁸ And the princes of Galaad said one to another: Whosoever of us shall first begin to fight against the children of Ammon, he shall be the leader of the people of Galaad.

122. Jephthe, his vow, and Ephraim

Judges 11:1-12:15

11 ¹ There was at that time Jephthe, the Galaadite, a most valiant man, and a warrior, the son of a woman that was a harlot, and his father was Galaad. ² Now Galaad had a wife of whom he had sons: who, after they were grown up, thrust out Jephthe, saying: Thou canst not inherit in the house of our father, because thou art born of another mother. ³ Then he fled and avoided them, and dwelt in the land of Tob: and there were gathered to him needy men and robbers, and they followed him as their prince.

⁴ In those days the children of Ammon made war against Israel. ⁵ And as they pressed hard upon them, the ancients of Galaad went to fetch Jephthe out of the land of Tob to help them: ⁶ And they said to him: Come thou, and be our prince, and fight against the children of Ammon. ⁷ And he answered them: Are not you the men that hated me, and cast me out of my father's house, and now you are come to me, constrained by necessity? ⁸ And the princes of Galaad said to Jephthe: For this cause we are now come to thee, that thou mayst go with us, and fight against the children of Ammon, and be head over all the inhabitants of Galaad. ⁹ Jephthe also said to them: If you be come to me sincerely, that I should fight for you against the children of Ammon, and the Lord shall deliver them into my hand, shall I be your prince? ¹⁰ They answered him: The Lord, who heareth these things, he himself is mediator and witness that we will do as we have promised. ¹¹ Jephthe therefore went with the princes of Galaad, and all the people made him their prince. And Jephthe spoke all his words before the Lord in Maspha.

¹² And he sent messengers to the king of the children of Ammon, to say in his name: What hast thou to do with me, that thou art come against me, to waste my land? ¹³ And he answered them: Because Israel took away my land, when he came up out of Egypt, from the confines of the Arnon unto the Jaboc and the

Jordan: now, therefore, restore the same peaceably to me. ¹⁴ And Jephthe again sent word by them, and commanded them to say to the king of Ammon: ¹⁵ Thus saith Jephthe: Israel did not take away the land of Moab, nor the land of the children of Ammon: ¹⁶ But when they came up out of Egypt, he walked through the desert to the Red Sea, and came into Cades. ¹⁷ And he sent messengers to the king of Edom, saying: Suffer me to pass through thy land. But he would not condescend to his request. He sent also to the king of Moab, who, likewise, refused to give him passage. He abode, therefore, in Cades, ¹⁸ And went round the land of Edom at the side, and the land of Moab: and came over against the east coast of the land of Moab, and camped on the other side of the Arnon: and he would not enter the bounds of Moab. ¹⁹ So Israel sent messengers to Sehon, king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Hesebon, and they said to him: Suffer me to pass through thy land to the river. ²⁰ But he, also despising the words of Israel, suffered him not to pass through his borders: but gathering an infinite multitude, went out against him to Jasa, and made strong opposition. ²¹ And the Lord delivered him, with all his army, into the hands of Israel, and he slew him, and possessed all the land of the Amorrite, the inhabitant of that country, ²² And all the coasts thereof from the Arnon to the Jaboc, and from the wilderness to the Jordan. ²³ So the Lord, the God of Israel, destroyed the Amorrite, his people of Israel fighting against him, and wilt thou now possess his land? ²⁴ Are not those things which thy god Chamos possesseth, due to thee by right? But what the Lord our God hath obtained by conquest, shall be our possession: ²⁵ Unless, perhaps, thou art better than Balac, the son of Sephor, king of Moab: or canst shew that he strove against Israel, and fought against him, ²⁶ Whereas he hath dwelt in Hesebon, and the villages thereof, and in Aroer, and its villages, and in all the cities near the Jordan, for three hundred years. Why have you for so long a time attempted nothing about this claim? ²⁷ Therefore I do not trespass against thee, but thou wrongest me by declaring an unjust war against me. The Lord be judge, and decide this day, between Israel and the children of Ammon. ²⁸ And the king of the children of Ammon would not hearken to the words of Jephthe, which he sent him by the messengers. ²⁹ Therefore the spirit of the Lord came upon Jephthe, and going round Galaad, and Manasses, and Maspha of Galaad, and passing over from thence to the children of Ammon, ³⁰ He made a vow to the Lord, saying: If thou wilt deliver the children of Ammon into my hands, ³¹ Whosoever shall first come forth out of the doors of my house, and shall meet me, when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, the same will I offer a holocaust to the Lord.

³² And Jephthe passed over to the children of Ammon to fight against them: and the Lord delivered them into his hands. ³³ And he smote them from Aroer till you come to Mennith, twenty cities, and as far as Abel, which is set with vineyards, with a very great slaughter: and the children of Ammon were humbled by the children of Israel.

³⁴ And when Jephthe returned into Maspha, to his house, his only daughter met him with timbrels and with dances: for he had no other children. ³⁵ And when he saw her, he rent his garments, and said: Alas! my daughter, thou hast deceived me, and thou thyself art deceived: for I have opened my mouth to

the Lord, and I can do no other thing. ³⁶ And she answered him: My father, if thou hast opened thy mouth to the Lord, do unto me whatsoever thou hast promised, since the victory hath been granted to thee, and revenge of thy enemies. ³⁷ And she said to her father: Grant me only this, which I desire: Let me go, that I may go about the mountains for two months, and may bewail my virginity with my companions. ³⁸ And he answered her: Go. And he sent her away for two months. And when she was gone with her comrades and companions, she mourned her virginity in the mountains. ³⁹ And the two months being expired, she returned to her father, and he did to her as he had vowed, and she knew no man. From thence came a fashion in Israel, and a custom has been kept: ⁴⁰ That, from year to year, the daughters of Israel assemble together, and lament the daughter of Jephthe the Galaadite, for four days.

12 ¹ But behold there arose a sedition in Ephraim. And passing towards the north, they said to Jephthe: When thou wentest to fight against the children of Ammon, why wouldst thou not call us, that we might go with thee? Therefore we will burn thy house. ² And he answered them: I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon: and I called you to assist me, and you would not do it. ³ And when I saw this, I put my life in my own hands, and passed over against the children of Ammon and the Lord delivered them into my hands. What have I deserved, that you should rise up to fight against me? ⁴ Then calling to him all the men of Galaad, he fought against Ephraim: and the men of Galaad defeated Ephraim, because he had said: Galaad is a fugitive of Ephraim, and dwelleth in the midst of Ephraim and Manasses. ⁵ And the Galaadites secured the fords of the Jordan, by which Ephraim was to return. And when any one of the number of Ephraim came thither in the flight, and said: I beseech you let me pass: the Galaadites said to him: Art thou not an Ephraimite? If he said: I am not: ⁶ They asked him: Say then, Scibboleth, which is interpreted, An ear of corn. But he answered, Sibboleth, not being able to express an ear of corn by the same letter. Then presently they took him and killed him in the very passage of the Jordan. And there fell at that time of Ephraim, two and forty thousand. ⁷ And Jephthe, the Galaadite, judged Israel six years: and he died, and was buried in his city of Galaad.

⁸ After him Abesan of Bethlehem judged Israel: ⁹ He had thirty sons, and as many daughters, whom he sent abroad, and gave to husbands, and took wives for his sons, of the same number, bringing them into his house. And he judged Israel seven years: ¹⁰ And he died, and was buried in Bethlehem.

¹¹ To him succeeded Ahialon, a Zabulonite: and he judged Israel ten years: ¹² And he died, and was buried in Zabulon.

¹³ After him, Abdon, the son of Illel, a Pharathonite, judged Israel: ¹⁴ And he had forty sons, and of them thirty grandsons, mounted upon seventy ass colts, and he judged Israel eight years: ¹⁵ And he died, and was buried in Pharathon, in the land of Ephraim, in the mount of Amalech.

123. The birth of Samson

Judges 13:1-25

13 ¹ And the children of Israel did evil again in the sight of the Lord: and he delivered them into the hands of the Philistines forty years.

² Now there was a certain man of Saraa, and of the race of Dan, whose name was Manue, and his wife was barren. ³ And an angel of the Lord appeared to her, and said: Thou art barren and without children: but thou shalt conceive and bear a son. ⁴ Now therefore beware, and drink no wine nor strong drink, and eat not any unclean thing. ⁵ Because thou shalt conceive, and bear a son, and no razor shall touch his head: for he shall be a Nazarite of God, from his infancy, and from his mother's womb, and he shall begin to deliver Israel from the hands of the Philistines.

⁶ And when she was come to her husband, she said to him: A man of God came to me, having the countenance of an angel, very awful. And when I asked him who he was, and whence he came, and by what name he was called, he would not tell me: ⁷ But he answered thus: Behold thou shalt conceive and bear a son: beware thou drink no wine, nor strong drink, nor eat any unclean thing: for the child shall be a Nazarite of God from his infancy, from his mother's womb until the day of his death.

⁸ Then Manue prayed to the Lord, and said: I beseech thee, O Lord, that the man of God, whom thou didst send, may come again, and teach us what we ought to do concerning the child, that shall be born. ⁹ And the Lord heard the prayer of Manue, and the angel of the Lord appeared again to his wife, as she was sitting in the field. But Manue her husband was not with her. And when she saw the angel, ¹⁰ She made haste, and ran to her husband: and told him, saying: Behold the man hath appeared to me, whom I saw before. ¹¹ He rose up, and followed his wife: and coming to the man, said to him: Art thou he that spoke to the woman? And he answered: I am. ¹² And Manue said to him: When thy word shall come to pass, what wilt thou that the child should do? or from what shall he keep himself? ¹³ And the angel of the Lord said to Manue: From all the things I have spoken of to thy wife, let her refrain herself: ¹⁴ And let her eat nothing that cometh of the vine, neither let her drink wine or strong drink, nor eat any unclean thing: and whatsoever I have commanded her, let her fulfil and observe.

¹⁵ And Manue said to the angel of the Lord: I beseech thee to consent to my request, and let us dress a kid for thee. ¹⁶ And the angel answered him: If thou press me I will not eat of thy bread: but if thou wilt offer a holocaust, offer it to the Lord. And Manue knew not it was the angel of the Lord. ¹⁷ And he said to him: What is thy name, that, if thy word shall come to pass, we may honour thee? ¹⁸ And he answered him: Why askest thou my name, which is wonderful? ¹⁹ Then Manue took a kid of the flocks, and the libations, and put them upon a rock, offering to the Lord, who doth wonderful things: and he and his wife looked on. ²⁰ And when the flame from the altar went up towards heaven, the angel of the Lord ascended also in the flame. And when Manue and his wife saw this, they fell flat on the ground: ²¹ And the angel of the Lord appeared to them no more. And forthwith Manue understood that it was an angel of the Lord, ²² And he said to his wife: We shall certainly die, because we have seen God. ²³ And his wife answered him: If the Lord had a mind to kill us, he would not have received a holocaust and

libations at our hands; neither would he have shewed us all these things, nor have told us the things that are to come. ²⁴ And she bore a son, and called his name Samson. And the child grew, and the Lord blessed him. ²⁵ And the Spirit of the Lord began to be with him in the camp of Dan, between Saraa and Esthaol.

124. The riddle, the foxes and the jawbone

Judges 14:1-15:20

14 ¹ Then Samson went down to Thamnatha, and seeing there a woman of the daughters of the Philistines, ² He came up, and told his father and his mother, saying: I saw a woman in Thamnatha of the daughters of the Philistines: I beseech you, take her for me to wife. ³ And his father and mother said to him: Is there no woman among the daughters of thy brethren, or among all my people, that thou wilt take a wife of the Philistines, who are uncircumcised? And Samson said to his father: Take this woman for me; for she hath pleased my eyes. ⁴ Now his parents knew not that the thing was done by the Lord, and that he sought an occasion against the Philistines: for at that time the Philistines had dominion over Israel.

⁵ Then Samson went down with his father and mother to Thamnatha. And when they were come to the vineyards of the town, behold a young lion met him, raging and roaring. ⁶ And the Spirit of the Lord came upon Samson, and he tore the lion as he would have torn a kid in pieces, having nothing at all in his hand: and he would not tell this to his father and mother. ⁷ And he went down, and spoke to the woman that had pleased his eyes. ⁸ And after some days, returning to take her, he went aside to see the carcass of the lion, and behold there was a swarm of bees in the mouth of the lion, and a honey-comb. ⁹ And when he had taken it in his hands, he went on eating: and coming to his father and mother, he gave them of it, and they ate: but he would not tell them that he had taken the honey from the body of the lion. ¹⁰ So his father went down to the woman, and made a feast for his son Samson: for so the young men used to do. ¹¹ And when the citizens of that place saw him, they brought him thirty companions to be with him.

¹² And Samson said to them: I will propose to you a riddle, which if you declare unto me within the seven days of the feast, I will give you thirty shirts, and as many coats: ¹³ But if you shall not be able to declare it, you shall give me thirty shirts and the same number of coats. They answered him: Put forth the riddle, that we may hear it. ¹⁴ And he said to them: Out of the eater came forth meat, and out of the strong came forth sweetness. And they could not for three days expound the riddle. ¹⁵ And when the seventh day came, they said to the wife of Samson: Sooth thy husband, and persuade him to tell thee what the riddle meaneth. But if thou wilt not do it, we will burn thee, and thy father's house. Have you called us to the wedding on purpose to strip us? ¹⁶ So she wept before Samson and complained, saying: Thou hatest me, and dost not love me: therefore thou wilt not expound to me the riddle, which thou hast proposed to the sons of my people. But he answered: I would not tell it to my father and mother: and how can I tell it to thee? ¹⁷ So she wept before him the seven days of the feast: and, at length, on the seventh day, as she was troublesome to him, he expounded it. And she immediately told her countrymen. ¹⁸ And they, on the seventh day before the sun went down, said to him: What is sweeter than

honey? and what is stronger than a lion? And he said to them: If you had not ploughed with my heifer, you had not found out my riddle.

¹⁹ And the Spirit of the Lord came upon him, and he went down to Ascalon, and slew there thirty men whose garments he took away, and gave to them that had declared the riddle. And being exceedingly angry, he went up to his father's house: ²⁰ But his wife took one of his friends and bridal companions for her husband.

15 ¹ And a while after, when the days of the wheat harvest were at hand, Samson came, meaning to visit his wife, and he brought her a kid of the flock. And when he would have gone into her chamber, as usual, her father would not suffer him, saying: ² I thought thou hadst hated her, and therefore I gave her to thy friend: but she hath a sister, who is younger and fairer than she, take her to wife instead of her.

³ And Samson answered him: From this day I shall be blameless in what I do against the Philistines: for I will do you evils.

⁴ And he went and caught three hundred foxes, and coupled them tail to tail, and fastened torches between the tails: ⁵ And setting them on fire he let the foxes go, that they might run about hither and thither. And they presently went into the standing corn of the Philistines. Which being set on fire, both the corn that was already carried together, and that which was yet standing, was all burnt, insomuch that the flame consumed also the vineyards and the oliveyards.

⁶ Then the Philistines said: Who hath done this thing? And it was answered: Samson, the son in law of the Thamnathite, because he took away his wife, and gave her to another, hath done these things. And the Philistines went up and burnt both the woman and her father.

⁷ But Samson said to them: Although you have done this, yet will I be revenged of you, and then I will be quiet. ⁸ And he made a great slaughter of them, so that in astonishment they laid the calf of the leg upon the thigh. And going down he dwelt in a cavern of the rock Etam. ⁹ Then the Philistines going up into the land of Juda, camped in the place which afterwards was called Lechi, that is, the Jawbone, where their army was spread abroad. ¹⁰ And the men of the tribe of Juda said to them: Why are you come up against us? They answered: We are come to bind Samson, and to pay him for what he hath done against us. ¹¹ Wherefore three thousand men of Juda went down to the cave of the rock Etam, and said to Samson: Knowest thou not that the Philistines rule over us? Why wouldst thou do thus? And he said to them: As they did to me, so have I done to them. ¹² And they said to him: We are come to bind thee, and to deliver thee into the hands of the Philistines. And Samson said to them: Swear to me, and promise me that you will not kill me. ¹³ They said: We will not kill thee: but we will deliver thee up bound. And they bound him with two new cords, and brought him from the rock Etam.

¹⁴ Now when he was come to the place of the Jawbone, and the Philistines shouting went to meet him, the Spirit of the Lord came strongly upon him: and as flax is wont to be consumed at the approach of fire, so the bands with which he was bound were broken and loosed. ¹⁵ And finding a jawbone, even the jawbone of an ass, which lay there, catching it up, he slew therewith a

thousand men. ¹⁶ And he said: With the jawbone of an ass, with the jaw of the colt of asses, I have destroyed them, and have slain a thousand men. ¹⁷ And when he had ended these words, singing, he threw the jawbone out of his hand, and called the name of that place Ramathlechi, which is interpreted the lifting up of the jawbone.

¹⁸ And being very thirsty, he cried to the Lord, and said: Thou hast given this very great deliverance and victory into the hand of thy servant: and behold I die for thirst, and shall fall into the hands of the uncircumcised. ¹⁹ Then the Lord opened a great tooth in the jaw of the ass and waters issued out of it. And when he had drunk them, he refreshed his spirit, and recovered his strength. Therefore the name of that place was called The Spring of him that invoked from the jawbone, until this present day. ²⁰ And he judged Israel, in the days of the Philistines, twenty years.

125. Samson and Dalila

Judges 16:1-31

Judges 17-21, the appendix of Michas and the outrage at Gabaa, is omitted.

16 ¹ He went also into Gaza, and saw there a woman, a harlot, and went in unto her. ² And when the Philistines had heard this, and it was noised about among them, that Samson was come into the city, they surrounded him, setting guards at the gate of the city, and watching there all the night in silence, that in the morning they might kill him as he went out. ³ But Samson slept till midnight, and then rising, he took both the doors of the gate, with the posts thereof and the bolt, and laying them on his shoulders, carried them up to the top of the hill, which looketh towards Hebron.

⁴ After this he loved a woman, who dwelt in the valley of Sorec, and she was called Dalila. ⁵ And the princes of the Philistines came to her, and said: Deceive him, and learn of him wherein his great strength lieth, and how we may be able to overcome him, to bind and afflict him: which if thou shalt do, we will give thee every one of us eleven hundred pieces of silver.

⁶ And Dalila said to Samson: Tell me, I beseech thee, wherein thy greatest strength lieth, and what it is, wherewith if thou wert bound, thou couldst not break loose. ⁷ And Samson answered her: If I shall be bound with seven cords, made of sinews not yet dry, but still moist, I shall be weak like other men. ⁸ And the princes of the Philistines brought unto her seven cords, such as he spoke of, with which she bound him; ⁹ Men lying privately in wait with her, and in the chamber, expecting the event of the thing, and she cried out to him: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And he broke the bands, as a man would break a thread of tow twined with spittle, when it smelleth the fire: so it was not known wherein his strength lay. ¹⁰ And Dalila said to him: Behold thou hast mocked me, and hast told me a false thing: but now at least tell me wherewith thou mayest be bound.

¹¹ And he answered her: If I shall be bound with new ropes, that were never in work, I shall be weak and like other men. ¹² Dalila bound him again with these, and cried out: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson, there being an ambush prepared for him in the chamber. But he broke the bands like threads of webs. ¹³ And Dalila said to him again: How long dost thou deceive me,

and tell me lies? Shew me wherewith thou mayest be bound. And Samson answered her: If thou plattest the seven locks of my head with a lace, and tying them round about a nail, fastenest it in the ground, I shall be weak. ¹⁴ And when Dalila had done this, she said to him: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And awaking out of his sleep, he drew out the nail with the hairs and the lace.

¹⁵ And Dalila said to him: How dost thou say thou lovest me, when thy mind is not with me? Thou hast told me lies these three times, and wouldst not tell me wherein thy greatest strength lieth. ¹⁶ And when she pressed him much, and continually hung upon him for many days, giving him no time to rest, his soul fainted away, and was wearied even unto death. ¹⁷ Then opening the truth of the thing, he said to her: The razor hath never come upon my head, for I am a Nazarite, that is to say, consecrated to God from my mother's womb: If my head be shaven, my strength shall depart from me, and I shall become weak, and shall be like other men.

¹⁸ Then seeing that he had discovered to her all his mind, she sent to the princes of the Philistines, saying: Come up this once more, for now he hath opened his heart to me. And they went up, taking with them the money which they had promised. ¹⁹ But she made him sleep upon her knees, and lay his head in her bosom. And she called a barber and shaved his seven locks, and began to drive him away, and thrust him from her: for immediately his strength departed from him. ²⁰ And she said: The Philistines are upon thee, Samson. And awaking from sleep, he said in his mind: I will go out as I did before, and shake myself, not knowing that the Lord was departed from him.

²¹ Then the Philistines seized upon him, and forthwith pulled out his eyes, and led him bound in chains to Gaza, and shutting him up in prison made him grind. ²² And now his hair began to grow again, ²³ And the princes of the Philistines assembled together, to offer great sacrifices to Dagon their god, and to make merry, saying: Our god hath delivered our enemy Samson into our hands. ²⁴ And the people also seeing this, praised their god, and said the same: Our god hath delivered our adversary into our hands, him that destroyed our country, and killed very many. ²⁵ And rejoicing in their feasts, when they had now taken their good cheer, they commanded that Samson should be called, and should play before them. And being brought out of prison, he played before them; and they made him stand between two pillars. ²⁶ And he said to the lad that guided his steps: Suffer me to touch the pillars which support the whole house, and let me lean upon them, and rest a little. ²⁷ Now the house was full of men and women, and all the princes of the Philistines were there. Moreover about three thousand persons of both sexes, from the roof and the higher part of the house, were beholding Samson's play. ²⁸ But he called upon the Lord, saying: O Lord God remember me, and restore to me now my former strength, O my God, that I may revenge myself on my enemies, and for the loss of my two eyes I may take one revenge. ²⁹ And laying hold on both the pillars on which the house rested, and holding the one with his right hand, and the other with his left, ³⁰ He said: Let me die with the Philistines. And when he had strongly shook the pillars, the house fell upon all the princes, and the rest of the multitude, that was there: and he killed many more at his

death, than he had killed before in his life. ³¹ And his brethren and all his kindred, going down took his body, and buried it between Saraa and Esthaol, in the buryingplace of his father Manue: and he judged Israel twenty years.

126. "Thy people shall be my people"

Ruth 1:1-22

1 ¹ In the days of one of the judges, when the judges ruled, there came a famine in the land. And a certain man of Bethlehem Juda, went to sojourn in the land of Moab with his wife and his two sons. ² He was named Elimelech, and his wife Noemi: and his two sons, the one Mahalon, and the other Chelion, Ephrathites of Bethlehem Juda. And entering into the country of Moab, they abode there. ³ And Elimelech the husband of Noemi died: and she remained with her sons. ⁴ And they took wives of the women of Moab, of which one was called Orpha, and the other Ruth. And they dwelt there ten years, ⁵ And they both died, to wit, Mahalon and Chelion: and the woman was left alone, having lost both her sons and her husband. ⁶ And she arose to go from the land of Moab to her own country, with both her daughters in law: for she had heard that the Lord had looked upon his people, and had given them food. ⁷ Wherefore she went forth out of the place of her sojournment, with both her daughters in law: and being now in the way to return into the land of Juda, ⁸ She said to them: Go ye home to your mothers, the Lord deal mercifully with you, as you have dealt with the dead and with me. ⁹ May he grant you to find rest in the houses of the husbands whom you shall take. And she kissed them. And they lifted up their voice, and began to weep, ¹⁰ And to say: We will go on with thee to thy people. ¹¹ But she answered them: Return, my daughters: why come ye with me? have I any more sons in my womb, that you may hope for husbands of me? ¹² Return again, my daughters, and go your ways: for I am now spent with age, and not fit for wedlock. Although I might conceive this night, and bear children, ¹³ If you would wait till they were grown up, and come to man's estate, you would be old women before you marry. Do not so, my daughters, I beseech you: for I am grieved the more for your distress, and the hand of the Lord is gone out against me. ¹⁴ And they lifted up their voice, and began to weep again: Orpha kissed her mother in law, and returned: Ruth stuck close to her mother in law. ¹⁵ And Noemi said to her: Behold thy kinswoman is returned to her people, and to her gods, go thou with her. ¹⁶ She answered: Be not against me, to desire that I should leave thee and depart: for whithersoever thou shalt go, I will go: and where thou shalt dwell, I also will dwell. Thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God. ¹⁷ The land that shall receive thee dying, in the same will I die: and there will I be buried. The Lord do so and so to me, and add more also, if aught but death part me and thee. ¹⁸ Then Noemi seeing that Ruth was steadfastly determined to go with her, would not be against it, nor persuade her any more to return to her friends:

¹⁹ So they went together, and came to Bethlehem. And when they were come into the city, the report was quickly spread among all: and the women said: This is that Noemi. ²⁰ But she said to them: Call me not Noemi (that is, beautiful,) but call me Mara (that is, bitter), for the Almighty hath quite filled me with bitterness. ²¹ I went out full and the Lord hath brought me back empty. Why then do you call me Noemi, whom the Lord hath

humbled, and the Almighty hath afflicted? ²² So Noemi came with Ruth, the Moabitess, her daughter in law, from the land of her sojournment: and returned into Bethlehem, in the beginning of the barley harvest.

127. Ruth gleans in the field of Booz

Ruth 2:1-23

2 ¹ Now her husband Elimelech had a kinsman, a powerful man, and very rich, whose name was Booz. ² And Ruth, the Moabitess, said to her mother in law: If thou wilt, I will go into the field, and glean the ears of corn that escape the hands of the reapers, wheresoever I shall find grace with a householder, that will be favourable to me. And she answered her: Go, my daughter. ³ She went, therefore, and gleaned the ears of corn after the reapers. And it happened that the owner of that field was Booz, who was of the kindred of Elimelech.

⁴ And behold, he came out of Bethlehem, and said to the reapers: The Lord be with you. And they answered him: The Lord bless thee. ⁵ And Booz said to the young man that was set over the reapers: Whose maid is this? ⁶ And he answered him: This is the Moabitess, who came with Noemi, from the land of Moab, ⁷ And she desired leave to glean the ears of corn that remain, following the steps of the reapers: and she hath been in the field from morning till now, and hath not gone home for one moment. ⁸ And Booz said to Ruth: Hear me, daughter, do not go to glean in any other field, and do not depart from this place: but keep with my maids, ⁹ And follow where they reap. For I have charged my young men, not to molest thee: and if thou art thirsty, go to the vessels, and drink of the waters whereof the servants drink. ¹⁰ She fell on her face, and worshipping upon the ground, said to him: Whence cometh this to me, that I should find grace before thy eyes, and that thou shouldst vouchsafe to take notice of me, a woman of another country? ¹¹ And he answered her: All hath been told me, that thou hast done to thy mother in law after the death of thy husband: and how thou hast left thy parents, and the land wherein thou wast born, and art come to a people which thou knewest not heretofore. ¹² The Lord render unto thee for thy work, and mayst thou receive a full reward of the Lord the God of Israel, to whom thou art come, and under whose wings thou art fled. ¹³ And she said: I have found grace in thy eyes, my lord, who hast comforted me, and hast spoken to the heart of thy handmaid, who am not like to one of thy maids. ¹⁴ And Booz said to her: At mealtime come thou hither, and eat of the bread, and dip thy morsel in the vinegar. So she sat at the side of the reapers, and she heaped to herself frumenty, and ate and was filled, and took the leavings. ¹⁵ And she arose from thence, to glean the ears of corn as before. And Booz commanded his servants, saying: If she would even reap with you, hinder her not: ¹⁶ And let fall some of your handfuls of purpose, and leave them, that she may gather them without shame, and let no man rebuke her when she gathereth them.

¹⁷ She gleaned therefore in the field till evening: and beating out with a rod, and threshing what she had gleaned, she found about the measure of an ephi of barley, that is, three bushels: ¹⁸ Which she took up, and returned into the city, and shewed it to her mother in law: moreover, she brought out, and gave her of the remains of her meat, wherewith she had been filled. ¹⁹ And her mother in law said to her: Where hast thou gleaned

today, and where hast thou wrought? blessed be he that hath had pity on thee. And she told her with whom she had wrought: and she told the man's name, that he was called Booz. ²⁰ And Noemi answered her: Blessed be he of the Lord: because the same kindness which he shewed to the living, he hath kept also to the dead. And again she said: The man is our kinsman. ²¹ And Ruth said: He also charged me, that I should keep close to his reapers, till all the corn should be reaped. ²² And her mother in law said to her: It is better for thee, my daughter, to go out to reap with his maids, lest in another man's field some one may resist thee. ²³ So she kept close to the maids of Booz: and continued to glean with them, till all the barley and the wheat were laid up in the barns.

128. Ruth at the threshing floor

Ruth 3:1-18

3 ¹ After she was returned to her mother in law, Noemi said to her: My daughter, I will seek rest for thee, and will provide that it may be well with thee. ² This Booz, with whose maids thou wast joined in the field, is our near kinsman, and behold this night he winnoweth barley in the threshingfloor. ³ Wash thyself therefore and anoint thee, and put on thy best garments, and go down to the barnfloor: but let not the man see thee, till he shall have done eating and drinking. ⁴ And when he shall go to sleep, mark the place wherein he sleepeth: and thou shalt go in, and lift up the clothes wherewith he is covered towards his feet, and shalt lay thyself down there: and he will tell thee what thou must do. ⁵ She answered: Whatsoever thou shalt command, I will do. ⁶ And she went down to the barnfloor, and did all that her mother in law had bid her. ⁷ And when Booz had eaten, and drunk, and was merry, he went to sleep by the heap of sheaves, and she came softly, and uncovering his feet, laid herself down. ⁸ And behold, when it was now midnight the man was afraid, and troubled: and he saw a woman lying at his feet, ⁹ And he said to her: Who art thou? And she answered: I am Ruth, thy handmaid: spread thy coverlet over thy servant, for thou art a near kinsman. ¹⁰ And he said: Blessed art thou of the Lord, my daughter, and thy latter kindness has surpassed the former: because thou hast not followed young men either poor or rich. ¹¹ Fear not therefore, but whatsoever thou shalt say to me I will do to thee. For all the people that dwell within the gates of my city, know that thou art a virtuous woman. ¹² Neither do I deny myself to be near of kin, but there is another nearer than I. ¹³ Rest thou this night: and when morning is come, if he will take thee by the right of kindred, all is well: but if he will not, I will undoubtedly take thee, as the Lord liveth: sleep till the morning.

¹⁴ So she slept at his feet till the night was going off. And she arose before men could know one another, and Booz said: Beware lest any man know that thou camest hither. ¹⁵ And again he said: Spread thy mantle, wherewith thou art covered, and hold it with both hands. And when she spread it and held it, he measured six measures of barley, and laid it upon her. And she carried it, and went into the city, ¹⁶ And came to her mother in law; who said to her: What hast thou done, daughter? And she told her all that the man had done to her. ¹⁷ And she said: Behold he hath given me six measures of barley: for he said: I will not have thee return empty to thy mother in law. ¹⁸ And

Noemi said: Wait, my daughter, till we see what end the thing will have. For the man will not rest until he have accomplished what he hath said.

129. Booz redeems Ruth

Ruth 4:1-22

The book ends in a genealogy, and it is the one genealogy no abridgement can cut: Phares, Booz, Obed, Isai, David.

4 ¹ Then Booz went up to the gate, and sat there. And when he had seen the kinsman going by, of whom he had spoken before, he said to him, calling him by his name: Turn aside for a little while, and sit down here. He turned aside, and sat down. ² And Booz, taking ten men of the ancients of the city, said to them: Sit ye down here. ³ They sat down, and he spoke to the kinsman: Noemi, who is returned from the country of Moab will sell a parcel of land that belonged to our brother Elimelech. ⁴ I would have thee to understand this, and would tell thee before all that sit here, and before the ancients of my people. If thou wilt take possession of it by the right of kindred: buy it, and possess it: but if it please thee not, tell me so, that I may know what I have to do. For there is no near kinsman besides thee, who art first, and me, who am second. But he answered: I will buy the field. ⁵ And Booz said to him: When thou shalt buy the field at the woman's hand, thou must take also Ruth, the Moabitess, who was the wife of the deceased: to raise up the name of thy kinsman in his inheritance.

⁶ He answered: I yield up my right of next akin: for I must not cut off the posterity of my own family. Do thou make use of my privilege, which I profess I do willingly forego. ⁷ Now this in former times was the manner in Israel between kinsmen, that if at any time one yielded his right to another: that the grant might be sure, the man put off his shoe and gave it to his neighbour; this was a testimony of cession of right in Israel. ⁸ So Booz said to his kinsman: Put off thy shoe. And immediately he took it off from his foot.

⁹ And he said to the ancients, and to all the people: You are witnesses this day, that I have bought all that was Elimelech's, and Chelion's, and Mahalon's, of the hand of Noemi: ¹⁰ And have taken to wife Ruth, the Moabitess, the wife of Mahalon, to raise up the name of the deceased in his inheritance lest his name be cut off, from among his family and his brethren and his people. You, I say, are witnesses of this thing. ¹¹ Then all the people that were in the gate, and the ancients, answered: We are witnesses: The Lord make this woman who cometh into thy house, like Rachel, and Lia, who built up the house of Israel: that she may be an example of virtue in Ephrata, and may have a famous name in Bethlehem: ¹² And that the house may be, as the house of Phares, whom Tamar bore unto Juda, of the seed which the Lord shall give thee of this young woman.

¹³ Booz therefore took Ruth, and married her: and went in unto her, and the Lord gave her to conceive, and to bear a son. ¹⁴ And the women said to Noemi: Blessed be the Lord, who hath not suffered thy family to want a successor: that his name should be preserved in Israel. ¹⁵ And thou shouldst have one to comfort thy soul, and cherish thy old age. For he is born of thy daughter in law: who loveth thee: and is much better to thee, than if thou hadst seven sons. ¹⁶ And Noemi taking the child, laid it in her

bosom, and she carried it, and was a nurse unto it. ¹⁷ And the women, her neighbours, congratulating with her, and saying, There is a son born to Noemi, called his name Obed: he is the father of Isai, the father of David.

¹⁸ These are the generations of Phares: Phares begot Esron, ¹⁹ Esron begot Aram, Aram begot Aminadab, ²⁰ Aminadab begot Nahasson, Nahasson begot Salmon, ²¹ Salmon begot Booz, Booz begot Obed, ²² Obed begot Isai, Isai begot David.

130. Psalm 77

Psalms 77:1-72

Vulgate 77 = Hebrew 78: the desert and the conquest rehearsed as a parable, ending in the choice of David.

77 ¹ Understanding for Asaph. Attend, O my people, to my law: incline your ears to the words of my mouth. ² I will open my mouth in parables: I will utter propositions from the beginning. ³ How great things have we heard and known, and our fathers have told us. ⁴ They have not been hidden from their children, in another generation. Declaring the praises of the Lord, and his powers, and his wonders which he hath done. ⁵ And he set up a testimony in Jacob: and made a law in Israel. How great things he commanded our fathers, that they should make the same known to their children: ⁶ That another generation might know them. The children that should be born and should rise up, and declare them to their children. ⁷ That they may put their hope in God and may not forget the works of God: and may seek his commandments. ⁸ That they may not become like their fathers, a perverse and exasperating generation. A generation that set not their heart aright: and whose spirit was not faithful to God. ⁹ The sons of Ephraim who bend and shoot with the bow: they have turned back in the day of battle. ¹⁰ They kept not the covenant of God: and in his law they would not walk. ¹¹ And they forgot his benefits, and his wonders that he had shewn them. ¹² Wonderful things did he do in the sight of their fathers, in the land of Egypt, in the field of Tanis. ¹³ He divided the sea and brought them through: and he made the waters to stand as in a vessel. ¹⁴ And he conducted them with a cloud by day: and all the night with a light of fire. ¹⁵ He struck the rock in the wilderness: and gave them to drink, as out of the great deep. ¹⁶ He brought forth water out of the rock: and made streams run down as rivers. ¹⁷ And they added yet more sin against him: they provoked the most High to wrath in the place without water. ¹⁸ And they tempted God in their hearts, by asking meat for their desires. ¹⁹ And they spoke ill of God: they said: Can God furnish a table in the wilderness? ²⁰ Because he struck the rock, and the waters gushed out, and the streams overflowed. Can he also give bread, or provide a table for his people? ²¹ Therefore the Lord heard, and was angry: and a fire was kindled against Jacob, and wrath came up against Israel. ²² Because they believed not in God: and trusted not in his salvation. ²³ And he had commanded the clouds from above, and had opened the doors of heaven. ²⁴ And had rained down manna upon them to eat, and had given them the bread of heaven. ²⁵ Man ate the bread of angels: he sent them provisions in abundance. ²⁶ He removed the south wind from heaven: and by his power brought in the south-west wind. ²⁷ And he rained upon them flesh as dust: and feathered fowls like as the sand of the sea. ²⁸ And they fell in the midst of

their camp, round about their pavilions. ²⁹ So they did eat, and were filled exceedingly, and he gave them their desire: ³⁰ they were not defrauded of that which they craved. As yet their meat was in their mouth: ³¹ And the wrath of God came upon them. And he slew the fat ones amongst them, and brought down the chosen men of Israel. ³² In all these things they sinned still: and they believed not for his wondrous works. ³³ And their days were consumed in vanity, and their years in haste. ³⁴ When he slew them, then they sought him: and they returned, and came to him early in the morning. ³⁵ And they remembered that God was their helper: and the most high God their redeemer. ³⁶ And they loved him with their mouth: and with their tongue they lied unto him: ³⁷ But their heart was not right with him: nor were they counted faithful in his covenant. ³⁸ But he is merciful, and will forgive their sins: and will not destroy them. And many a time did he turn away his anger: and did not kindle all his wrath. ³⁹ And he remembered that they are flesh: a wind that goeth and returneth not. ⁴⁰ How often did they provoke him in the desert: and move him to wrath in the place without water? ⁴¹ And they turned back and tempted God: and grieved the holy one of Israel. ⁴² They remembered not his hand, in the day that he redeemed them from the hand of him that afflicted them: ⁴³ How he wrought his signs in Egypt, and his wonders in the field of Tanis. ⁴⁴ And he turned their rivers into blood, and their showers that they might not drink. ⁴⁵ He sent amongst them divers sorts of flies, which devoured them: and frogs which destroyed them. ⁴⁶ And he gave up their fruits to the blast, and their labours to the locust. ⁴⁷ And he destroyed their vineyards with hail, and their mulberry trees with hoarfrost. ⁴⁸ And he gave up their cattle to the hail, and their stock to the fire. ⁴⁹ And he sent upon them the wrath of his indignation: indignation and wrath and trouble, which he sent by evil angels. ⁵⁰ He made a way for a path to his anger: he spared not their souls from death, and their cattle he shut up in death. ⁵¹ And he killed all the firstborn in the land of Egypt: the firstfruits of all their labour in the tabernacles of Cham. ⁵² And he took away his own people as sheep: and guided them in the wilderness like a flock. ⁵³ And he brought them out in hope and they feared not: and the sea overwhelmed their enemies. ⁵⁴ And he brought them into the mountain of his sanctuary: the mountain which his right hand had purchased. And he cast out the Gentiles before them: and by lot divided to them their land by a line of distribution. ⁵⁵ And he made the tribes of Israel to dwell in their tabernacles. ⁵⁶ Yet they tempted, and provoked the most high God: and they kept not his testimonies. ⁵⁷ And they turned away, and kept not the covenant: even like their fathers they were turned aside as a crooked bow. ⁵⁸ They provoked him to anger on their hills: and moved him to jealousy with their graven things. ⁵⁹ God heard, and despised them, and he reduced Israel exceedingly as it were to nothing. ⁶⁰ And he put away the tabernacle of Silo, his tabernacle where he dwelt among men. ⁶¹ And he delivered their strength into captivity: and their beauty into the hands of the enemy. ⁶² And he shut up his people under the sword: and he despised his inheritance. ⁶³ Fire consumed their young men: and their maidens were not lamented. ⁶⁴ Their priests fell by the sword: and their widows did not mourn. ⁶⁵ And the Lord was awaked as one out of sleep, and like a mighty man that hath

been surfeited with wine. ⁶⁶ And he smote his enemies on the hinder parts: he put them to an everlasting reproach. ⁶⁷ And he rejected the tabernacle of Joseph: and chose not the tribe of Ephraim: ⁶⁸ But he chose the tribe of Juda, mount Sion which he loved. ⁶⁹ And he built his sanctuary as of unicorns, in the land which he founded for ever. ⁷⁰ And he chose his servant David, and took him from the flocks of sheep: he brought him from following the ewes great with young. ⁷¹ To feed Jacob his servant and Israel his inheritance. ⁷² And he fed them in the innocence of his heart: and conducted them by the skilfulness of his hands.

THE UNITED MONARCHY

1 and 2 Samuel entire. The Douay-Rheims prints these as the First and Second Books of Kings; this plan uses the modern names, so that Douay 3 and 4 Kings appear in the next period as 1 and 2 Kings. 1 and 2 Paralipomenon (Chronicles) are passed over as a second telling of the same reigns.

131. Anna, and the birth of Samuel

1 Samuel 1:1-28

Douay-Rheims title: the First Book of Samuel, otherwise called the First Book of Kings.

1 ¹ There was a man of Ramathaim-sophim, of Mount Ephraim, and his name was Elcana, the son of Jeroham, the son of Eliu, the son of Thohu, the son of Suph, an Ephraimite: ² And he had two wives, the name of one was Anna, and the name of the other Phenenna. Phenenna had children: but Anna had no children. ³ And this man went up out of his city upon the appointed days, to adore and to offer sacrifice to the Lord of hosts in Silo. And the two sons of Heli, Ophni and Phinees, were there priests of the Lord. ⁴ Now the day came, and Elcana offered sacrifice, and gave to Phenenna, his wife, and to all her sons and daughters, portions: ⁵ But to Anna he gave one portion with sorrow, because he loved Anna. And the Lord had shut up her womb. ⁶ Her rival also afflicted her, and troubled her exceedingly, insomuch that she upbraided her, that the Lord had shut up her womb: ⁷ And thus she did every year, when the time returned, that they went up to the temple of the Lord: and thus she provoked her: but Anna wept, and did not eat. ⁸ Then Elcana, her husband, said to her: Anna, why weepest thou? and why dost thou not eat? and why dost thou afflict thy heart? Am not I better to thee than ten children?

⁹ So Anna arose after she had eaten and drunk in Silo: And Heli, the priest, sitting upon a stool before the door of the temple of the Lord; ¹⁰ As Anna had her heart full of grief, she prayed to the Lord, shedding many tears, ¹¹ And she made a vow, saying: O Lord of hosts, if thou wilt look down on the affliction of thy servant, and wilt be mindful of me, and not forget thy handmaid, and wilt give to thy servant a manchild: I will give him to the Lord all the days of his life, and no razor shall come upon his head. ¹² And it came to pass, as she multiplied prayers before the Lord, that Heli observed her mouth. ¹³ Now Anna spoke in her heart, and only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard at all. Heli therefore thought her to be drunk, ¹⁴ And said to her: How long wilt thou be drunk? digest a little the wine, of which thou hast taken too much. ¹⁵ Anna answering, said: Not

so, my lord: for I am an exceeding unhappy woman, and have drunk neither wine nor any strong drink, but I have poured out my soul before the Lord. ¹⁶ Count not thy handmaid for one of the daughters of Belial: for out of the abundance of my sorrow and grief have I spoken till now. ¹⁷ Then Heli said to her: Go in peace: and the God of Israel grant thee thy petition, which thou hast asked of him. ¹⁸ And she said: Would to God thy handmaid may find grace in thy eyes. So the woman went on her way, and ate, and her countenance was no more changed.

¹⁹ And they rose in the morning, and worshipped before the Lord: and they returned, and came into their house at Ramatha. And Elcana knew Anna his wife: And the Lord remembered her. ²⁰ And it came to pass when the time was come about, Anna conceived and bore a son, and called his name Samuel: because she had asked him of the Lord. ²¹ And Elcana, her husband, went up, and all his house, to offer to the Lord the solemn sacrifice, and his vow. ²² But Anna went not up: for she said to her husband: I will not go till the child be weaned, and till I may carry him, that he may appear before the Lord, and may abide always there. ²³ And Elcana, her husband, said to her: Do what seemeth good to thee, and stay till thou wean him: and I pray that the Lord may fulfil his word. So the woman staid at home, and gave her son suck, till she weaned him.

²⁴ And after she had weaned him, she carried him with her, with three calves, and three bushels of flour, and a bottle of wine, and she brought him to the house of the Lord in Silo. Now the child was as yet very young: ²⁵ And they immolated a calf, and offered the child to Heli. ²⁶ And Anna said: I beseech thee, my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord: I am that woman, who stood before thee here praying to the Lord. ²⁷ For this child did I pray, and the Lord hath granted me my petition, which I asked of him. ²⁸ Therefore I also have lent him to the Lord all the days of his life, he shall be lent to the Lord. And they adored the Lord there. And Anna prayed, and said:

132. The canticle of Anna; the sons of Heli

1 Samuel 2:1-36

The Magnificat answers this canticle; both are read in this plan.

² ¹ My heart hath rejoiced in the Lord, and my horn is exalted in my God: my mouth is enlarged over my enemies: because I have joyed in thy salvation. ² There is none holy as the Lord is: for there is no other beside thee, and there is none strong like our God. ³ Do not multiply to speak lofty things, boasting: let old matters depart from your mouth: for the Lord is a God of all knowledge, and to him are thoughts prepared. ⁴ The bow of the mighty is overcome, and the weak are girt with strength. ⁵ They that were full before, have hired out themselves for bread: and the hungry are filled, so that the barren hath borne many: and she that had many children is weakened. ⁶ The Lord killeth and maketh alive, he bringeth down to hell, and bringeth back again. ⁷ The Lord maketh poor and maketh rich, he humbleth and he exalteth: ⁸ He raiseth up the needy from the dust, and lifteth up the poor from the dunghill: that he may sit with princes, and hold the throne of glory. For the poles of the earth are the Lord's, and upon them he hath set the world. ⁹ He will keep the feet of his saints, and the wicked shall be silent in darkness; because

no man shall prevail by his own strength. ¹⁰ The adversaries of the Lord shall fear him: and upon them shall he thunder in the heavens: The Lord shall judge the ends of the earth, and he shall give empire to his king, and shall exalt the horn of his Christ.

¹¹ And Elcana went to Ramatha, to his house: but the child ministered in the sight of the Lord before the face of Heli the priest.

¹² Now the sons of Heli were children of Belial, not knowing the Lord, ¹³ Nor the office of the priests to the people: but whosoever had offered a sacrifice, the servant of the priest came, while the flesh was in boiling, with a fleshhook of three teeth in his hand, ¹⁴ And thrust it into the kettle, or into the cauldron, or into the pot, or into the pan: and all that the fleshhook brought up, the priest took to himself. Thus did they to all Israel that came to Silo. ¹⁵ Also before they burnt the fat, the servant of the priest came, and said to the man that sacrificed: Give me flesh to boil for the priest: for I will not take of thee sodden flesh, but raw. ¹⁶ And he that sacrificed said to him: Let the fat first be burnt to day, according to the custom, and then take to thee as much as thy soul desireth. But he answered, and said to him: Not so: but thou shalt give it me now, or else I will take it by force. ¹⁷ Wherefore the sin of the young men was exceeding great before the Lord: because they withdrew men from the sacrifice of the Lord. ¹⁸ But Samuel ministered before the face of the Lord: being a child girded with a linen ephod. ¹⁹ And his mother made him a little coat, which she brought to him on the appointed days, when she went up with her husband, to offer the solemn sacrifice. ²⁰ And Heli blessed Elcana and his wife: and he said to him: The Lord give thee seed of this woman, for the loan thou hast lent to the Lord. And they went to their own home. ²¹ And the Lord visited Anna, and she conceived, and bore three sons, and two daughters: and the child Samuel became great before the Lord.

²² Now Heli was very old, and he heard all that his sons did to all Israel: and how they lay with the women that waited at the door of the tabernacle: ²³ And he said to them: Why do ye these kinds of things, which I hear, very wicked things, from all the people? ²⁴ Do not so, my sons: for it is no good report that I hear, that you make the people of the Lord to transgress. ²⁵ If one man shall sin against another, God may be appeased in his behalf: but if a man shall sin against the Lord, who shall pray for him? And they hearkened not to the voice of their father, because the Lord would slay them. ²⁶ But the child Samuel advanced, and grew on, and pleased both the Lord and men.

²⁷ And there came a man of God to Heli, and said to him: Thus saith the Lord: Did I not plainly appear to thy father's house, when they were in Egypt in the house of Pharaoh? ²⁸ And I chose him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to go up to my altar, and burn incense to me, and to wear the ephod before me: and I gave to thy father's house of all the sacrifices of the children of Israel. ²⁹ Why have you kicked away my victims, and my gifts which I commanded to be offered in the temple: and thou hast rather honoured thy sons than me, to eat the firstfruits of every sacrifice of my people Israel? ³⁰ Wherefore thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: I said indeed that thy house, and the house of thy father, should minister in my sight, for ever. But now saith the Lord: Far be this from me: but whosoever shall

glorify me, him will I glorify: but they that despise me, shall be despised. ³¹ Behold the days come: and I will cut off thy arm, and the arm of thy father's house, that there shall not be an old man in thy house. ³² And thou shalt see thy rival in the temple, in all the prosperity of Israel, and there shall not be an old man in thy house for ever. ³³ However, I will not altogether take away a man of thee from my altar: but that thy eyes may faint, and thy soul be spent: and a great part of thy house shall die, when they come to man's estate. ³⁴ And this shall be a sign to thee, that shall come upon thy two sons, Ophni and Phinees: in one day they shall both of them die. ³⁵ And I will raise me up a faithful priest, who shall do according to my heart, and my soul and I will build him a faithful house, and he shall walk all days before my anointed. ³⁶ And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall remain in thy house shall come that he may be prayed for, and shall offer a piece of silver, and a roll of bread, and shall say: Put me, I beseech thee, to somewhat of the priestly office, that I may eat a morsel of bread.

133. The call of Samuel

1 Samuel 3:1-21

3 ¹ Now the child Samuel ministered to the Lord before Heli, and the word of the Lord was precious in those days, there was no manifest vision. ² And it came to pass one day when Heli lay in his place, and his eyes were grown dim, that he could not see: ³ Before the lamp of God went out, Samuel slept in the temple of the Lord, where the ark of God was. ⁴ And the Lord called Samuel. And he answered: Here am I. ⁵ And he ran to Heli, and said: Here am I: for thou didst call me. He said: I did not call: go back and sleep. And he went and slept. ⁶ And the Lord called Samuel again. And Samuel arose and went to Heli, and said: Here am I: for thou calledst me. He answered: I did not call thee, my son: return and sleep. ⁷ Now Samuel did not yet know the Lord, neither had the word of the Lord been revealed to him. ⁸ And the Lord called Samuel again the third time. And he arose up and went to Heli, ⁹ And said: Here am I: for thou didst call me. Then Heli understood that the Lord called the child, and he said to Samuel: Go, and sleep: and if he shall call thee any more, thou shalt say: Speak, Lord, for thy servant heareth. So Samuel went, and slept in his place. ¹⁰ And the Lord came, and stood, and he called, as he had called the other times, Samuel, Samuel. And Samuel said: Speak, Lord, for thy servant heareth.

¹¹ And the Lord said to Samuel: Behold I do a thing in Israel: and whosoever shall hear it, both his ears shall tingle. ¹² In that day I will raise up against Heli all the things I have spoken concerning his house: I will begin, and I will make an end. ¹³ For I have foretold unto him, that I will judge his house for ever, for iniquity, because he knew that his sons did wickedly, and did not chastise them. ¹⁴ Therefore have I sworn to the house of Heli, that the iniquity of his house shall not be expiated with victims nor offerings for ever.

¹⁵ And Samuel slept till morning, and opened the doors of the house of the Lord. And Samuel feared to tell the vision to Heli. ¹⁶ Then Heli called Samuel, and said: Samuel, my son. And he answered: Here am I. ¹⁷ And he asked him: What is the word that the Lord hath spoken to thee? I beseech thee hide it not from me. May God do so and so to thee, and add so and so, if thou hide from me one word of all that were said to thee. ¹⁸ So

Samuel told him all the words, and did not hide them from him. And he answered: It is the Lord: let him do what is good in his sight.

¹⁹ And Samuel grew, and the Lord was with him, and not one of his words fell to the ground. ²⁰ And all Israel, from Dan to Bersabee, knew that Samuel was a faithful prophet of the Lord. ²¹ And the Lord again appeared in Silo, for the Lord revealed himself to Samuel in Silo, according to the word of the Lord. And the word of Samuel came to pass to all Israel.

134. The ark taken; the glory departed

1 Samuel 4:1-22

4 ¹ And it came to pass in those days, that the Philistines gathered themselves together to fight: and Israel went out to war against the Philistines, and camped by the Stone of help. And the Philistines came to Aphec, ² And put their army in array against Israel. And when they had joined battle, Israel turned their backs to the Philistines: and there were slain in that fight, here and there in the fields, about four thousand men. ³ And the people returned to the camp: and the ancients of Israel said: Why hath the Lord defeated us to day before the Philistines? Let us fetch unto us the ark of the covenant of the Lord from Silo, and let it come in the midst of us, that it may save us from the hand of our enemies. ⁴ So the people sent to Silo, and they brought from thence the ark of the covenant of the Lord of hosts, sitting upon the cherubims: and the two sons of Heli, Ophni and Phinees, were with the ark of the covenant of God. ⁵ And when the ark of the covenant of the Lord was come into the camp, all Israel shouted with a great shout, and the earth rang again. ⁶ And the Philistines heard the noise of the shout, and they said: What is this noise of a great shout in the camp of the Hebrews? And they understood that the ark of the Lord was come into the camp. ⁷ And the Philistines were afraid, saying: God is come into the camp. And sighing, they said: ⁸ Woe to us: for there was no such great joy yesterday, and the day before: Woe to us. Who shall deliver us from the hand of these high Gods? these are the Gods that struck Egypt with all the plagues in the desert. ⁹ Take courage, and behave like men, ye Philistines: lest you come to be servants to the Hebrews, as they have served you: take courage and fight. ¹⁰ So the Philistines fought, and Israel was overthrown, and every man fled to his own dwelling: and there was an exceeding great slaughter; for there fell of Israel thirty thousand footmen. ¹¹ And the ark of God was taken: and the two sons of Heli, Ophni and Phinees, were slain.

¹² And there ran a man of Benjamin out of the army, and came to Silo the same day, with his clothes rent, and his head strewed with dust. ¹³ And when he was come, Heli sat upon a stool over against the way, watching. For his heart was fearful for the ark of God. And when the man was come into the city, he told it: and all the city cried out. ¹⁴ And Heli heard the noise of the cry, and he said: What meaneth the noise of this uproar? But he made haste, and came, and told Heli. ¹⁵ Now Heli was ninety and eight years old, and his eyes were dim, and he could not see. ¹⁶ And he said to Heli: I am he that came from the battle, and have fled out of the field this day. And he said to him: What is there done, my son? ¹⁷ And he that brought the news answered, and said: Israel is fled before the Philistines, and there has been a great slaughter of the people: moreover thy two sons, Ophni

and Phinees, are dead: and the ark of God is taken. ¹⁸ And when he had named the ark of God, he fell from his stool backwards by the door, and broke his neck and died. For he was an old man, and far advanced in years: And he judged Israel forty years.

¹⁹ And his daughter in law, the wife of Phinees, was big with child, and near her time: and hearing the news that the ark of God was taken, and her father in law, and her husband, were dead, she bowed herself and fell in labour: for her pains came upon her on a sudden. ²⁰ And when she was upon the point of death, they that stood about her said to her: Fear not, for thou hast borne a son. She answered them not, nor gave heed to them. ²¹ And she called the child Ichabod, saying: The glory is gone from Israel, because the ark of God was taken, and for her father in law, and for her husband: ²² And she said: The glory is departed from Israel, because the ark of God was taken.

135. The ark among the Philistines, and its return

1 Samuel 5:1-6:21

⁵ ¹ And the Philistines took the ark of God, and carried it from the Stone of help into Azotus. ² And the Philistines took the ark of God, and brought it into the temple of Dagon, and set it by Dagon. ³ And when the Azotians arose early the next day, behold Dagon lay upon his face on the ground before the ark of the Lord: and they took Dagon, and set him again in his place. ⁴ And the next day again, when they rose in the morning, they found Dagon lying upon his face on the earth before the ark of the Lord: and the head of Dagon, and both the palms of his hands, were cut off upon the threshold: ⁵ And only the stump of Dagon remained in its place. For this cause neither the priests of Dagon, nor any that go into the temple, tread on the threshold of Dagon in Azotus unto this day. ⁶ And the hand of the Lord was heavy upon the Azotians, and he destroyed them, and afflicted Azotus and the coasts thereof with emerods. And in the villages and fields in the midst of that country, there came forth a multitude of mice, and there was the confusion of a great mortality in the city. ⁷ And the men of Azotus seeing this kind of plague, said: The ark of the God of Israel shall not stay with us: for his hand is heavy upon us, and upon Dagon, our god. ⁸ And sending, they gathered together all the lords of the Philistines to them, and said: What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel? And the Gethites answered: Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried about. And they carried the ark of the God of Israel about. ⁹ And while they were carrying it about, the hand of the Lord came upon every city with an exceeding great slaughter: and he smote the men of every city, both small and great, and they had emerods in their secret parts. And the Gethites consulted together, and made themselves seats of skins. ¹⁰ Therefore they sent the ark of God into Accaron. And when the ark of God was come into Accaron, the Accaronites cried out, saying: They have brought the ark of the God of Israel to us, to kill us and our people. ¹¹ They sent therefore, and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines: and they said: Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let it return into its own place, and not kill us and our people. ¹² For there was the fear of death in every city, and the hand of God was exceeding heavy. The men also that did not die, were afflicted with the emerods: and the cry of every city went up to heaven.

⁶ ¹ Now the ark of God was in the land of the Philistines seven months. ² And the Philistines called for the priests and the diviners, saying: What shall we do with the ark of the Lord? tell us how we are to send it back to its place. And they said: ³ If you send back the ark of the God of Israel, send it not away empty, but render unto him what you owe for sin, and then you shall be healed: and you shall know why his hand departeth not from you. ⁴ They answered: What is it we ought to render unto him for sin? and they answered: ⁵ According to the number of the provinces of the Philistines you shall make five golden emerods, and five golden mice: for the same plague hath been upon you all, and upon your lords. And you shall make the likeness of your emerods, and the likeness of the mice, that have destroyed the land, and you shall give glory to the God of Israel: to see if he will take off his hand from you, and from your gods, and from your land. ⁶ Why do you harden your hearts, as Egypt and Pharaoh hardened their hearts? did not he, after he was struck, then let them go, and they departed? ⁷ Now, therefore, take and make a new cart: and two kine that have calved, on which there hath come no yoke, tie to the cart, and shut up their calves at home. ⁸ And you shall take the ark of the Lord, and lay it on the cart, and the vessels of gold, which you have paid him for sin, you shall put into a little box at the side thereof: and send it away, that it may go. ⁹ And you shall look: and if it go up by the way of his own coasts, towards Bethsames, then he hath done us this great evil: but if not, we shall know that it is not his hand hath touched us, but it hath happened by chance.

¹⁰ They did therefore in this manner: and taking two kine, that had sucking calves, they yoked them to the cart, and shut up their calves at home. ¹¹ And they laid the ark of God upon the cart, and the little box that had in it the golden mice, and the likeness of the emerods. ¹² And the kine took the straight way, that leadeth to Bethsames, and they went along the way, lowing as they went: and turned not aside neither to the right hand nor to the left: and the lords of the Philistines followed them as far as the borders of Bethsames. ¹³ Now the Bethsamites were reaping wheat in the valley: and lifting up their eyes, they saw the ark, and rejoiced to see it. ¹⁴ And the cart came into the field of Josue, a Bethsamite, and stood there. And there was a great stone, and they cut in pieces the wood of the cart, and laid the kine upon it a holocaust to the Lord. ¹⁵ And the Levites took down the ark of God, and the little box that was at the side of it, wherein were the vessels of gold, and they put them upon the great stone. The men also of Bethsames offered holocausts, and sacrificed victims that day to the Lord. ¹⁶ And the five princes of the Philistines saw, and they returned to Accaron the same day. ¹⁷ And these are the golden emerods, which the Philistines returned for sin to the Lord: For Azotus one, for Gaza one, for Ascalon one, for Geth one, for Accaron one: ¹⁸ And the golden mice, according to the number of the cities of the Philistines, of the five provinces, from the fenced city to the village that was without wall, and to the great Abel (the stone) whereon they set down the ark of the Lord, which was till that day in the field of Josue the Bethsamite. ¹⁹ But he slew of the men of Bethsames, because they had seen the ark of the Lord, and he slew of the people seventy men, and fifty thousand of the common people. And the people lamented, because the Lord had smitten the people with a great slaughter.

²⁰ And the men of Bethsames said: Who shall be able to stand before the Lord this holy God? and to whom shall he go up from us?

²¹ And they sent messengers to the inhabitants of Cariathiarim, saying: The Philistines have brought back the ark of the Lord, come ye down and fetch it up to you.

136. Samuel judges Israel at Masphath

1 Samuel 7:1-17

⁷ ¹ And the men of Cariathiarim came, and fetched up the ark of the Lord, and carried it into the house of Abinadab, in Gabaa: and they sanctified Eleazar, his son, to keep the ark of the Lord. ² And it came to pass, that from the day the ark of the Lord abode in Cariathiarim, days were multiplied (for it was now the twentieth year) and all the house of Israel rested, following the Lord. ³ And Samuel spoke to all the house of Israel, saying: If you turn to the Lord with all your heart, put away the strange gods from among you, Baalim and Astaroth: and prepare your hearts unto the Lord, and serve him only, and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines. ⁴ Then the children of Israel put away Baalim and Astaroth, and served the Lord only. ⁵ And Samuel said: Gather all Israel to Masphath, that I may pray to the Lord for you. ⁶ And they gathered together to Masphath, and they drew water, and poured it out before the Lord, and they fasted on that day, and they said there: We have sinned against the Lord. And Samuel judged the children of Israel in Masphath.

⁷ And the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together to Masphath, and the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. And when the children of Israel heard this, they were afraid of the Philistines. ⁸ And they said to Samuel: Cease not to cry to the Lord our God for us, that he may save us out of the hand of the Philistines. ⁹ And Samuel took a sucking lamb, and offered it whole for a holocaust to the Lord: and Samuel cried to the Lord for Israel, and the Lord heard him. ¹⁰ And it came to pass, when Samuel was offering the holocaust, the Philistines began the battle against Israel: but the Lord thundered with a great thunder on that day upon the Philistines, and terrified them, and they were overthrown before the face of Israel. ¹¹ And the men of Israel going out of Masphath, pursued after the Philistines, and made slaughter of them till they came under Bethchar. ¹² And Samuel took a stone, and laid it between Masphath and Sen: and he called the place The stone of help. And he said: Thus far the Lord hath helped us. ¹³ And the Philistines were humbled, and they did not come any more into the borders of Israel. And the hand of the Lord was against the Philistines, all the days of Samuel. ¹⁴ And the cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel, were restored to Israel, from Accaron to Geth, and their borders: and he delivered Israel from the hand of the Philistines, and there was peace between Israel and the Amorrhites. ¹⁵ And Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life: ¹⁶ And he went every year about to Bethel and to Galgal and to Masphath, and he judged Israel in the foresaid places. ¹⁷ And he returned to Ramatha: for there was his house, and there he judged Israel: he built also there an altar to the Lord.

137. "Give us a king"

1 Samuel 8:1-22

The kingdom is granted as a concession; every later reading in this period is coloured by that.

⁸ ¹ And it came to pass, when Samuel was old, that he appointed his sons to be judges over Israel. ² Now the name of his firstborn son was Joel: and the name of the second was Abia, judges in Bersabee. ³ And his sons walked not in his ways: but they turned aside after lucre, and took bribes, and perverted judgment.

⁴ Then all the ancients of Israel being assembled came to Samuel to Ramatha. ⁵ And they said to him: Behold thou art old, and thy sons walk not in thy ways: make us a king, to judge us, as all nations have. ⁶ And the word was displeasing in the eyes of Samuel, that they should say: Give us a king to judge us. And Samuel prayed to the Lord. ⁷ And the Lord said to Samuel: Hearken to the voice of the people in all that they say to thee. For they have not rejected thee, but me, that I should not reign over them. ⁸ According to all their works, they have done from the day that I brought them out of Egypt until this day: as they have forsaken me, and served strange gods, so do they also unto thee. ⁹ Now, therefore, hearken to their voice: but yet testify to them, and foretell them the right of the king, that shall reign over them.

¹⁰ Then Samuel told all the words of the Lord to the people that had desired a king of him, ¹¹ And said: This will be the right of the king that shall reign over you: He will take your sons, and put them in his chariots, and will make them his horsemen, and his running footmen, to run before his chariots, ¹² And he will appoint of them to be his tribunes, and his centurions, and to plough his fields, and to reap his corn, and to make him arms and chariots. ¹³ Your daughters also he will take to make him ointments, and to be his cooks, and bakers. ¹⁴ And he will take your fields, and your vineyards, and your best oliveyards, and give them to his servants. ¹⁵ Moreover he will take the tenth of your corn, and of the revenues of your vineyards, to give to his eunuchs and servants. ¹⁶ Your servants also, and handmaids, and your goodliest young men, and your asses, he will take away, and put them to his work. ¹⁷ Your flocks also he will tithe, and you shall be his servants. ¹⁸ And you shall cry out in that day from the face of the king, whom you have chosen to yourselves: and the Lord will not hear you in that day, because you desired unto yourselves a king.

¹⁹ But the people would not hear the voice of Samuel, and they said, Nay: but there shall be a king over us, ²⁰ And we also will be like all nations: and our king shall judge us, and go out before us, and fight our battles for us. ²¹ And Samuel heard all the words of the people, and rehearsed them in the ears of the Lord. ²² And the Lord said to Samuel: Hearken to their voice, and make them a king. And Samuel said to the men of Israel: Let every man go to his city.

138. Saul sought, anointed, and acclaimed

1 Samuel 9:1-10:27

⁹ ¹ Now there was a man of Benjamin, whose name was Cis, the son of Abiel, the son of Seror, the son of Bechorath, the son of Aphia, the son of a man of Jemini, valiant and strong. ² And he had a son whose name was Saul, a choice and goodly man,

and there was not among the children of Israel a goodlier person than he: from his shoulders and upward he appeared above all the people.

³ And the asses of Cis, Saul's father, were lost: and Cis said to his son Saul: Take one of the servants with thee, and arise, go, and seek the asses. And when they had passed through Mount Ephraim, ⁴ And through the land of Salisa, and had not found them, they passed also through the land of Salim, and they were not there: and through the land of Jemini, and found them not. ⁵ And when they were come to the land of Suph, Saul said to the servant that was with him: Come, let us return, lest perhaps my father forget the asses, and be concerned for us. ⁶ And he said to him: Behold there is a man of God in this city, a famous man: all that he saith, cometh certainly to pass. Now, therefore, let us go thither, perhaps he may tell us of our way, for which we are come. ⁷ And Saul said to his servant: Behold we will go: but what shall we carry to the man of God? the bread is spent in our bags: and we have no present to make to the man of God, nor any thing at all. ⁸ The servant answered Saul again, and said: Behold there is found in my hand the fourth part of a sicle of silver, let us give it to the man of God, that he may tell us our way. ⁹ Now in time past in Israel, when a man went to consult God, he spoke thus: Come, let us go to the seer. For he that is now called a prophet, in time past was called a seer. ¹⁰ And Saul said to his servant: Thy word is very good, come let us go. And they went into the city, where the man of God was. ¹¹ And when they went up the ascent to the city, they found maids coming out to draw water, and they said to them: Is the seer here? ¹² They answered and said to them: He is: behold he is before you, make haste now: for he came to day into the city, for there is a sacrifice of the people to day in the high place. ¹³ As soon as you come into the city, you shall immediately find him, before he go up to the high place to eat: for the people will not eat till he come; because he blesseth the victim, and afterwards they eat that are invited. Now, therefore, go up, for to day you shall find him. ¹⁴ And they went up into the city. And when they were walking in the midst of the city, behold Samuel was coming out over against them, to go up to the high place.

¹⁵ Now the Lord had revealed to the ear of Samuel the day before Saul came, saying: ¹⁶ To morrow about this same hour I will send thee a man of the land of Benjamin, and thou shalt anoint him to be ruler over my people Israel: and he shall save my people out of the hand of the Philistines: for I have looked down upon my people, because their cry is come to me. ¹⁷ And when Samuel saw Saul, the Lord said to him: Behold the man, of whom I spoke to thee, this man shall reign over my people.

¹⁸ And Saul came to Samuel in the midst of the gate, and said: Tell me, I pray thee, where is the house of the seer? ¹⁹ And Samuel answered Saul, saying: I am the seer; go up before me to the high place, that you may eat with me to day, and I will let thee go in the morning: and tell thee all that is in thy heart. ²⁰ And as for the asses, which were lost three days ago, be not solicitous, because they are found. And for whom shall be all the best things of Israel? Shall they not be for thee and for all thy father's house? ²¹ And Saul answering, said: Am not I a son of Jemini of the least tribe of Israel, and my kindred the last among all the families of the tribe of Benjamin? Why then hast thou

spoken this word to me? ²² Then Samuel taking Saul, and his servant, brought them into the parlour, and gave them a place at the head of them that were invited. For there were about thirty men. ²³ And Samuel said to the cook: Bring the portion which I gave thee, and commanded thee to set it apart by thee. ²⁴ And the cook took up the shoulder, and set it before Saul. And Samuel said: Behold what is left, set it before thee, and eat; because it was kept of purpose for thee, when I invited the people. And Saul ate with Samuel that day.

²⁵ And they went down from the high place into the town, and he spoke with Saul upon the top of the house: and he prepared a bed for Saul on the top of the house and he slept. ²⁶ And when they were risen in the morning, and it began now to be light, Samuel called Saul on the top of the house, saying: Arise, that I may let thee go. And Saul arose: and they went out both of them: to wit, he and Samuel. ²⁷ And as they were going down in the end of the city, Samuel said to Saul: Speak to the servant to go before us, and pass on: but stand thou still a while, that I may tell thee the word of the Lord.

10 ¹ And Samuel took a little vial of oil, and poured it upon his head, and kissed him, and said: Behold, the Lord hath anointed thee to be prince over his inheritance, and thou shalt deliver his people out of the hands of their enemies, that are round about them. And this shall be a sign unto thee, that God hath anointed thee to be prince. ² When thou shalt depart from me this day, thou shalt find two men by the sepulchre of Rachel in the borders of Benjamin to the south, and they shall say to thee: The asses are found which thou wentest to seek: and thy father, thinking no more of the asses, is concerned for you, and saith: What shall I do for my son? ³ And when thou shalt depart from thence, and go farther on, and shalt come to the oak of Thabor, there shall meet thee three men going up to God to Bethel, one carrying three kids, and another three loaves of bread, and another carrying a bottle of wine. ⁴ And they will salute thee, and will give thee two loaves, and thou shalt take them at their hand. ⁵ After that thou shalt come to the hill of God, where the garrison of the Philistines is: and when thou shalt be come there into the city, thou shalt meet a company of prophets coming down from the high place, with a psaltery, and a timbrel, and a pipe, and a harp before them, and they shall be prophesying. ⁶ And the Spirit of the Lord shall come upon thee, and thou shalt prophesy with them, and shalt be changed into another man. ⁷ When therefore these signs shall happen to thee, do whatsoever thy hand shall find, for the Lord is with thee. ⁸ And thou shalt go down before me to Galgal, (for I will come down to thee), that thou mayst offer an oblation, and sacrifice victims of peace: seven days shalt thou wait, till I come to thee, and I will shew thee what thou art to do. ⁹ So when he had turned his back to go from Samuel, God gave unto him another heart, and all these things came to pass that day. ¹⁰ And they came to the foresaid hill, and behold a company of prophets met him: and the Spirit of the Lord came upon him, and he prophesied in the midst of them. ¹¹ And all that had known him yesterday and the day before, seeing that he was with the prophets, and prophesied, said to each other: What is this that hath happened to the son of Cis? is Saul also among the prophets? ¹² And one answered another, saying: And who is their father? therefore it became a proverb: Is Saul also among

the prophets? ¹³ And when he had made an end of prophesying, he came to the high place.

¹⁴ And Saul's uncle said to him, and to his servant: Whither went you? They answered: To seek the asses: and not finding them, we went to Samuel. ¹⁵ And his uncle said to him: Tell me what Samuel said to thee. ¹⁶ And Saul said to his uncle: He told us that the asses were found. But of the matter of the kingdom of which Samuel had spoken to him, he told him not.

¹⁷ And Samuel called together the people to the Lord in Maspha: ¹⁸ And he said to the children of Israel: Thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: I brought up Israel out of Egypt, and delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians, and from the hand of all the kings who afflicted you. ¹⁹ But you this day have rejected your God, who only hath saved you out of all your evils and your tribulations: and you have said: Nay: but set a king over us. Now therefore stand before the Lord by your tribes, and by your families. ²⁰ And Samuel brought to him all the tribes of Israel, and the lot fell on the tribe of Benjamin. ²¹ And he brought the tribe of Benjamin and the kindreds thereof, and the lot fell upon the kindred of Metri, and it came to Saul, the son of Cis. They sought him therefore, and he was not found. ²² And after this they consulted the Lord whether he would come thither. And the Lord answered: Behold he is hidden at home. ²³ And they ran and fetched him thence: and he stood in the midst of the people, and he was higher than any of the people from the shoulders and upward. ²⁴ And Samuel said to all the people: Surely you see him whom the Lord hath chosen, that there is none like him among all the people. And all the people cried and said: God save the king. ²⁵ And Samuel told the people the law of the kingdom, and wrote it in a book, and laid it up before the Lord: and Samuel sent away all the people, every one to his own house. ²⁶ Saul also departed to his own house in Gabaa: and there went with him a part of the army, whose hearts God had touched. ²⁷ But the children of Belial said: Shall this fellow be able to save us? And they despised him, and brought him no presents; but he dissembled as though he heard not.

139. *Jabes Galaad delivered; the farewell of Samuel*

1 Samuel 11:1-12:25

11 ¹ And it came to pass about a month after this, that Naas, the Ammonite, came up, and began to fight against Jabes Galaad. And all the men of Jabes said to Naas: Make a covenant with us, and we will serve thee. ² And Naas, the Ammonite, answered them: On this condition will I make a covenant with you, that I may pluck out all your right eyes, and make you a reproach in all Israel. ³ And the ancients of Jabes said to him: Allow us seven days, that we may send messengers to all the coasts of Israel: and if there be no one to defend us, we will come out to thee. ⁴ The messengers therefore came to Gabaa of Saul: and they spoke these words in the hearing of the people: and all the people lifted up their voices, and wept.

⁵ And behold Saul came, following oxen out of the field, and he said: What aileth the people that they weep? And they told him the words of the men of Jabes. ⁶ And the Spirit of the Lord came upon Saul, when he had heard these words, and his anger was exceedingly kindled. ⁷ And taking both the oxen, he cut them in pieces, and sent them into all the coasts of Israel, by messengers, saying: Whosoever shall not come forth, and follow Saul and

Samuel, so shall it be done to his oxen. And the fear of the Lord fell upon the people, and they went out as one man. ⁸ And he numbered them in Bezek: and there were of the children of Israel three hundred thousand: and of the men of Juda thirty thousand. ⁹ And they said to the messengers that came: Thus shall you say to the men of Jabes Galaad: To morrow, when the sun shall be hot, you shall have relief. The messengers therefore came, and told the men of Jabes, and they were glad. ¹⁰ And they said: In the morning we will come out to you: and you shall do what you please with us. ¹¹ And it came to pass, when the morrow was come, that Saul put the people in three companies: and he came into the midst of the camp in the morning watch, and he slew the Ammonites until the day grew hot, and the rest were scattered, so that two of them were not left together.

¹² And the people said to Samuel: Who is he that said: Shall Saul reign over us? Bring the men, and we will kill them. ¹³ And Saul said: No man shall be killed this day: because the Lord this day hath wrought salvation in Israel: ¹⁴ And Samuel said to the people: Come, and let us go to Galgal, and let us renew the kingdom there. ¹⁵ And all the people went to Galgal, and there they made Saul king, before the Lord in Galgal, and they sacrificed there victims of peace before the Lord. And there Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced exceedingly.

12 ¹ And Samuel said to all Israel: Behold I have hearkened to your voice in all that you said to me, and have made a king over you. ² And now the king goeth before you: but I am old and greyheaded: and my sons are with you: having then conversed with you from my youth until this day, behold here I am. ³ Speak of me before the Lord, and before his anointed, whether I have taken any man's ox, or ass: if I have wronged any man, if I have oppressed any man, if I have taken a bribe at any man's hand: and I will despise it this day, and will restore it to you. ⁴ And they said: Thou hast not wronged us, nor oppressed us, nor taken ought at any man's hand. ⁵ And he said to them: The Lord is witness against you, and his anointed is witness this day, that you have not found any thing in my hand. And they said: He is witness.

⁶ And Samuel said to the people: It is the Lord who made Moses and Aaron, and brought our fathers out of the land of Egypt. ⁷ Now, therefore, stand up, that I may plead in judgment against you before the Lord, concerning all the kindness of the Lord, which he hath shewn to you, and to your fathers: ⁸ How Jacob went into Egypt, and your fathers cried to the Lord: and the Lord sent Moses and Aaron, and brought your fathers out of Egypt, and made them dwell in this place. ⁹ And they forgot the Lord their God, and he delivered them into the hands of Sisara, captain of the army of Hasor, and into the hands of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab, and they fought against them. ¹⁰ But afterwards they cried to the Lord, and said: We have sinned, because we have forsaken the Lord, and have served Baalim and Astaroth: but now deliver us from the hand of our enemies, and we will serve thee. ¹¹ And the Lord sent Jerobaal, and Badan, and Jephthe, and Samuel, and delivered you from the hand of your enemies round about, and you dwelt securely. ¹² But seeing that Naas, king of the children of Ammon, was come against you, you said to me: Nay, but a king shall reign over us: whereas the Lord your God was your king. ¹³ Now,

therefore, your king is here, whom you have chosen and desired: Behold the Lord hath given you a king. ¹⁴ If you will fear the Lord, and serve him, and hearken to his voice, and not provoke the mouth of the Lord: then shall both you, and the king who reigneth over you, be followers of the Lord your God. ¹⁵ But if you will not hearken to the voice of the Lord, but will rebel against his words, the hand of the Lord shall be upon you, and upon your fathers.

¹⁶ Now then stand, and see this great thing which the Lord will do in your sight. ¹⁷ Is it not wheat harvest to day? I will call upon the Lord, and he shall send thunder and rain: and you shall know, and see that you yourselves have done a great evil in the sight of the Lord, in desiring a king over you. ¹⁸ And Samuel cried unto the Lord, and the Lord sent thunder and rain that day. ¹⁹ And all the people greatly feared the Lord and Samuel. And all the people said to Samuel: Pray for thy servants to the Lord thy God, that we may not die, for we have added to all our sins this evil, to ask for a king.

²⁰ And Samuel said to the people: Fear not, you have done all this evil: but yet depart not from following the Lord, but serve the Lord with all your heart. ²¹ And turn not aside after vain things, which shall never profit you, nor deliver you, because they are vain. ²² And the Lord will not forsake his people for his great name's sake: because the Lord hath sworn to make you his people. ²³ And far from me be this sin against the Lord, that I should cease to pray for you: and I will teach you the good and right way. ²⁴ Therefore fear the Lord, and serve him in truth, and with your whole heart, for you have seen the great works which he hath done among you. ²⁵ But if you will still do wickedly: both you and your king shall perish together.

140. *Saul's unlawful sacrifice*

1 Samuel 13:1-23

13 ¹ Saul was a child of one year when he began to reign, and he reigned two years over Israel. ² And Saul chose him three thousand men of Israel: and two thousand were with Saul in Machmas, and in mount Bethel: and a thousand with Jonathan in Gabaa of Benjamin: and the rest of the people he sent back every man to their dwellings. ³ And Jonathan smote the garrison of the Philistines which was in Gabaa. And when the Philistines had heard of it, Saul sounded the trumpet over all the land, saying: Let the Hebrews hear. ⁴ And all Israel heard this report: Saul hath smitten the garrison of the Philistines: and Israel took courage against the Philistines. And the people were called together after Saul to Galgal. ⁵ The Philistines also were assembled to fight against Israel, thirty thousand chariots, and six thousand horsemen, and a multitude of people besides, like the sand on the seashore for number. And going up they camped in Machmas, at the east of Bethaven. ⁶ And when the men of Israel saw that they were straitened (for the people were distressed), they hid themselves in caves, and in thickets, and in rocks, and in dens, and in pits. ⁷ And some of the Hebrews passed over the Jordan into the land of Gad and Galaad. And when Saul was yet in Galgal, all the people that followed him were greatly afraid. ⁸ And he waited seven days, according to the appointment of Samuel, and Samuel came not to Galgal, and the people slept away from him. ⁹ Then Saul said: Bring me the holocaust, and the peace offerings. And he offered the holocaust. ¹⁰ And when

he had made an end of offering the holocaust, behold Samuel came: and Saul went forth to meet him and salute him. ¹¹ And Samuel said to him: What hast thou done? Saul answered: Because I saw that the people slept from me, and thou wast not come according to the days appointed, and the Philistines were gathered together in Machmas, ¹² I said: Now will the Philistines come down upon me to Galgal, and I have not appeased the face of the Lord. Forced by necessity, I offered the holocaust. ¹³ And Samuel said to Saul: Thou hast done foolishly, and hast not kept the commandments of the Lord thy God, which he commanded thee. And if thou hadst not done thus, the Lord would now have established thy kingdom over Israel for ever: ¹⁴ But thy kingdom shall not continue. The Lord hath sought him a man according to his own heart: and him hath the Lord commanded to be prince over his people, because thou hast not observed that which the Lord commanded.

¹⁵ And Samuel arose and went up from Galgal to Gabaa of Benjamin. And the rest of the people went up after Saul, to meet the people who fought against them, going from Galgal to Gabaa, in the hill of Benjamin. And Saul numbered the people, that were found with him, about six hundred men. ¹⁶ And Saul, and Jonathan his son, and the people that were present with them, were in Gabaa of Benjamin: But the Philistines encamped in Machmas. ¹⁷ And there went out of the camp of the Philistines three companies to plunder. One company went towards the way of Ephra to the land of Sual; ¹⁸ And another went by the way of Bethoron, and the third turned to the way of the border, above the valley of Seboim towards the desert. ¹⁹ Now there was no smith to be found in all the land of Israel, for the Philistines had taken this precaution, lest the Hebrews should make them swords or spears. ²⁰ So all Israel went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his ploughshare, and his spade, and his axe, and his rake. ²¹ So that their shares, and their spades, and their forks, and their axes, were blunt, even to the goad, which was to be mended. ²² And when the day of battle was come, there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people that were with Saul and Jonathan, except Saul and Jonathan his son. ²³ And the army of the Philistines went out in order to advance further in Machmas.

141. *Jonathan at Machmas; the rash oath*

1 Samuel 14:1-52

14 ¹ Now it came to pass one day that Jonathan, the son of Saul, said to the young man that bore his armour: Come, and let us go over to the garrison of the Philistines, which is on the other side of yonder place. But he told not this to his father. ² And Saul abode in the uttermost part of Gabaa, under the pomegranate tree, which was in Magron: and the people with him were about six hundred men. ³ And Achias, the son of Achitob, brother of Ichabod the son of Phinees, the son of Heli, the priest of the Lord in Silo, wore the ephod. And the people knew not whither Jonathan was gone.

⁴ Now there were between the ascents, by which Jonathan sought to go over to the garrison of the Philistines, rocks standing up on both sides, and steep cliffs like teeth on the one side, and on the other, the name of the one was Boses, and the name of the other was Sene: ⁵ One rock stood out toward the north, over against Machmas, and the other to the south, over against

Gabaa. ⁶ And Jonathan said to the young man that bore his armour: Come, let us go over to the garrison of these uncircumcised, it may be the Lord will do for us: because it is easy for the Lord to save either by many, or by few. ⁷ And his armourbearer said to him: Do all that pleaseth thy mind: go whither thou wilt, and I will be with thee wheresoever thou hast a mind. ⁸ And Jonathan said: Behold we will go over to these men. And when we shall be seen by them, ⁹ If they shall speak thus to us: Stay till we come to you: let us stand still in our place, and not go up to them. ¹⁰ But if they shall say: Come up to us: let us go up, because the Lord hath delivered them into our hands, this shall be a sign unto us. ¹¹ So both of them discovered themselves to the garrison of the Philistines: and the Philistines said: Behold the Hebrews come forth out of the holes wherein they were hid. ¹² And the men of the garrison spoke to Jonathan, and to his armourbearer, and said: Come up to us, and we will shew you a thing. And Jonathan said to his armourbearer: Let us go up, follow me: for the Lord hath delivered them into the hands of Israel. ¹³ And Jonathan went up creeping on his hands and feet, and his armourbearer after him. And some fell before Jonathan, others his armourbearer slew as he followed him. ¹⁴ And the first slaughter which Jonathan and his armourbearer made, was of about twenty men, within half an acre of land, which a yoke of oxen is wont to plough in a day. ¹⁵ And there was a miracle in the camp, in the fields: and all the people of their garrison, who had gone out to plunder, were amazed, and the earth trembled: and it happened as a miracle from God. ¹⁶ And the watchmen of Saul, who were in Gabaa of Benjamin looked, and behold a multitude overthrown, and fleeing this way and that. ¹⁷ And Saul said to the people that were with him: Look, and see who is gone from us. And when they had sought, it was found that Jonathan and his armourbearer were not there. ¹⁸ And Saul said to Achias: Bring the ark of the Lord. (For the ark of God was there that day with the children of Israel.) ¹⁹ And while Saul spoke to the priest, there arose a great uproar in the camp of the Philistines: and it increased by degrees, and was heard more clearly. And Saul said to the priest: Draw in thy hand. ²⁰ Then Saul, and all the people that were with him, shouted together, and they came to the place of the fight: and behold every man's sword was turned upon his neighbour, and there was a very great slaughter. ²¹ Moreover, the Hebrews that had been with the Philistines yesterday and the day before, and went up with them into the camp, returned to be with the Israelites, who were with Saul and Jonathan. ²² And all the Israelites that had hid themselves in mount Ephraim, hearing that the Philistines fled, joined themselves with their countrymen in the fight. And there were with Saul about ten thousand men. ²³ And the Lord saved Israel that day. And the fight went on as far as Bethaven.

²⁴ And the men of Israel were joined together that day: and Saul adjured the people, saying: Cursed be the man that shall eat food till evening, till I be revenged of my enemies. So none of the people tasted any food. ²⁵ And all the common people came into a forest, in which there was honey upon the ground. ²⁶ And when the people came into the forest, behold the honey dropped, but no man put his hand to his mouth. For the people feared the oath. ²⁷ But Jonathan had not heard when his father adjured the people: and he put forth the end of the rod, which he had in his

hand, and dipt it in a honeycomb: and he carried his hand to his mouth, and his eyes were enlightened. ²⁸ And one of the people answering, said: Thy father hath bound the people with an oath, saying: Cursed be the man that shall eat any food this day. (And the people were faint.) ²⁹ And Jonathan said: My father hath troubled the land: you have seen yourselves that my eyes are enlightened, because I tasted a little of this honey: ³⁰ How much more if the people had eaten of the prey of their enemies, which they found? had there not been made a greater slaughter among the Philistines? ³¹ So they smote that day the Philistines, from Machmas to Aialon. And the people were wearied exceedingly. ³² And falling upon the spoils, they took sheep, and oxen, and calves, and slew them on the ground: and the people ate them with the blood. ³³ And they told Saul that the people had sinned against the Lord, eating with the blood. And he said: You have transgressed: roll here to me now a great stone. ³⁴ And Saul said: Disperse yourselves among the people, and tell them to bring me every man his ox and his ram and slay them upon this stone, and eat, and you shall not sin against the Lord, in eating with the blood. So all the people brought every man his ox with him till the night: and slew them there. ³⁵ And Saul built an altar to the Lord: and he then first began to build an altar to the Lord. ³⁶ And Saul said: Let us fall upon the Philistines by night, and destroy them till the morning light, and let us not leave a man of them. And the people said: Do all that seemeth good in thy eyes. And the priest said: Let us draw near hither unto God. ³⁷ And Saul consulted the Lord: Shall I pursue after the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into the hands of Israel? And he answered him not that day. ³⁸ And Saul said: Bring hither all the corners of the people: and know, and see by whom this sin hath happened to day. ³⁹ As the Lord liveth, who is the Saviour of Israel, if it was done by Jonathan, my son, he shall surely die. In this none of the people gainsayed him. ⁴⁰ And he said to all Israel: Be you on one side and I, with Jonathan, my son, will be on the other side. And the people answered Saul: Do what seemeth good in thy eyes. ⁴¹ And Saul said to the Lord: O Lord God of Israel, give a sign, by which we may know, what the meaning is, that thou answerest not thy servant to day: If this iniquity be in me, or in my son Jonathan, give a proof: or if this iniquity be in thy people, give holiness. And Jonathan and Saul were taken, and the people escaped. ⁴² And Saul said: Cast lots between me, and Jonathan, my son. And Jonathan was taken. ⁴³ And Saul said to Jonathan: Tell me what thou hast done. And Jonathan told him, and said: I did but taste a little honey with the end of the rod, which was in my hand, and behold I must die. ⁴⁴ And Saul said: May God do so and so to me, and add still more: for dying thou shalt die, O Jonathan. ⁴⁵ And the people said to Saul: Shall Jonathan then die, who hath wrought this great salvation in Israel? this must not be: As the Lord liveth, there shall not one hair of his head fall to the ground, for he hath wrought with God this day. So the people delivered Jonathan, that he should not die. ⁴⁶ And Saul went back, and did not pursue after the Philistines: and the Philistines went to their own places.

⁴⁷ And Saul having his kingdom established over Israel, fought against all his enemies round about, against Moab, and against the children of Ammon, and Edom, and the kings of Soba, and the Philistines: and whithersoever he turned himself, he overcame.

⁴⁸ And gathering together an army, he defeated Amalec, and delivered Israel from the hand of them that spoiled them. ⁴⁹ And the sons of Saul, were Jonathan, and Jessui, and Melchisua: and the names of his two daughters, the name of the firstborn was Merob, and the name of the younger Michol. ⁵⁰ And the name of Saul's wife was Achinoam, the daughter of Achimaas; and the name of the captain of his army was Abner, the son of Ner, the cousin german of Saul. ⁵¹ For Cis was the father of Saul, and Ner, the father of Abner, was son of Abiel. ⁵² And there was a great war against the Philistines all the days of Saul. For whomsoever Saul saw to be a valiant man, and fit for war, he took him to himself.

142. *Saul rejected*

1 Samuel 15:1-35

"Obedience is better than sacrifices" (15:22).

15 ¹ And Samuel said to Saul: The Lord sent me to anoint thee king over his people Israel: now therefore hearken thou unto the voice of the Lord: ² Thus saith the Lord of hosts: I have reckoned up all that Amalec hath done to Israel: how he opposed them in the way when they came up out of Egypt. ³ Now therefore go, and smite Amalec, and utterly destroy all that he hath: spare him not, nor covet anything that is his: but slay both man and woman, child and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass. ⁴ So Saul commanded the people, and numbered them as lambs: two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand of the men of Juda. ⁵ And when Saul was come to the city of Amalec, he laid ambushes in the torrent. ⁶ And Saul said to the Cinite: Go, depart, and get ye down from Amalec: lest I destroy thee with him. For thou hast shewn kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. And the Cinite departed from the midst of Amalec. ⁷ And Saul smote Amalec from Hevila, until thou comest to Sur, which is over against Egypt. ⁸ And he took Agag, the king of Amalec, alive: but all the common people he slew with the edge of the sword. ⁹ And Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the flocks of sheep, and of the herds, and the garments and the rams, and all that was beautiful, and would not destroy them: but every thing that was vile, and good for nothing, that they destroyed.

¹⁰ And the word of the Lord came to Samuel, saying: ¹¹ It repenteth me that I have made Saul king: for he hath forsaken me, and hath not executed my commandments. And Samuel was grieved, and he cried unto the Lord all night. ¹² And when Samuel rose early, to go to Saul in the morning, it was told Samuel that Saul was come to Carmel, and had erected for himself a triumphant arch, and returning had passed on, and gone down to Galgal. And Samuel came to Saul, and Saul was offering a holocaust to the Lord, out of the choicest of the spoils, which he had brought from Amalec. ¹³ And when Samuel was come to Saul, Saul said to him: Blessed be thou of the Lord, I have fulfilled the word of the Lord. ¹⁴ And Samuel said: What meaneth then this bleating of the flocks, which soundeth in my ears, and the lowing of the herds, which I hear? ¹⁵ And Saul said: They have brought them from Amalec: for the people spared the best of the sheep and of the herds, that they might be sacrificed to the Lord thy God, but the rest we have slain. ¹⁶ And Samuel said to Saul: Suffer me, and I will tell thee what the Lord hath said to

me this night. And he said to him: Speak. ¹⁷ And Samuel said: When thou wast a little one in thy own eyes, wast thou not made the head of the tribes of Israel? And the Lord anointed thee to be king over Israel. ¹⁸ And the Lord sent thee on the way, and said: Go, and kill the sinners of Amalec, and thou shalt fight against them until thou hast utterly destroyed them. ¹⁹ Why then didst thou not hearken to the voice of the Lord: but hast turned to the prey, and hast done evil in the eyes of the Lord? ²⁰ And Saul said to Samuel: Yea, I have hearkened to the voice of the Lord, and have walked in the way by which the Lord sent me, and have brought Agag, the king of Amalec, and Amalec I have slain. ²¹ But the people took of the spoils, sheep and oxen, as the firstfruits of those things that were slain, to offer sacrifice to the Lord their God in Galgal. ²² And Samuel said: Doth the Lord desire holocausts and victims, and not rather that the voice of the Lord should be obeyed? For obedience is better than sacrifices: and to hearken rather than to offer the fat of rams. ²³ Because it is like the sin of witchcraft, to rebel: and like the crime of idolatry, to refuse to obey. Forasmuch, therefore, as thou hast rejected the word of the Lord, the Lord hath also rejected thee from being king.

²⁴ And Saul said to Samuel: I have sinned, because I have transgressed the commandment of the Lord, and thy words, fearing the people, and obeying their voice. ²⁵ But now bear, I beseech thee, my sin, and return with me, that I may adore the Lord. ²⁶ And Samuel said to Saul: I will not return with thee, because thou hast rejected the word of the Lord, and the Lord hath rejected thee from being king over Israel. ²⁷ And Samuel turned about to go away: but he laid hold upon the skirt of his mantle, and it rent. ²⁸ And Samuel said to him: The Lord hath rent the kingdom of Israel from thee this day, and hath given it to thy neighbour who is better than thee. ²⁹ But the triumph in Israel will not spare, and will not be moved to repentance: for he is not a man that he should repent. ³⁰ Then he said: I have sinned: yet honour me now before the ancients of my people, and before Israel, and return with me, that I may adore the Lord thy God. ³¹ So Samuel turned again after Saul: and Saul adored the Lord. ³² And Samuel said: Bring hither to me Agag, the king of Amalec. And Agag was presented to him very fat, and trembling. And Agag said: Doth bitter death separate in this manner? ³³ And Samuel said: As thy sword hath made women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And Samuel hewed him in pieces before the Lord in Galgal.

³⁴ And Samuel departed to Ramatha: but Saul went up to his house in Gabaa. ³⁵ And Samuel saw Saul no more till the day of his death: nevertheless, Samuel mourned for Saul, because the Lord repented that he had made him king over Israel.

143. *David anointed*

1 Samuel 16:1-23

16 ¹ And the Lord said to Samuel: How long wilt thou mourn for Saul, whom I have rejected from reigning over Israel? fill thy horn with oil, and come, that I may send thee to Isai, the Bethlehemite: for I have provided me a king among his sons. ² And Samuel said: How shall I go? for Saul will hear of it, and he will kill me. And the Lord said: Thou shalt take with thee a calf of the herd, and thou shalt say: I am come to sacrifice to the Lord. ³ And thou shalt call Isai to the sacrifice, and I will shew

thee what thou art to do, and thou shalt anoint him whom I shall shew to thee. ⁴ Then Samuel did as the Lord had said to him. And he came to Bethlehem, and the ancients of the city wondered, and meeting him, they said: Is thy coming hither peaceable? ⁵ And he said: It is peaceable: I am come to offer sacrifice to the Lord, be ye sanctified, and come with me to the sacrifice. And he sanctified Isai and his sons, and called them to the sacrifice. ⁶ And when they were come in, he saw Eliab, and said: Is the Lord's anointed before him? ⁷ And the Lord said to Samuel: Look not on his countenance, nor on the height of his stature: because I have rejected him, nor do I judge according to the look of man: for man seeth those things that appear, but the Lord beholdeth the heart. ⁸ And Isai called Abinadab, and brought him before Samuel. And he said: Neither hath the Lord chosen this, ⁹ And Isai brought Samma, and he said of him: Neither hath the Lord chosen this. ¹⁰ Isai therefore brought his seven sons before Samuel: and Samuel said to Isai: The Lord hath not chosen any one of these. ¹¹ And Samuel said to Isai: Are here all thy sons? He answered: There remaineth yet a young one, who keepeth the sheep. And Samuel said to Isai: Send, and fetch him: for we will not sit down till he come hither. ¹² He sent therefore and brought him. Now he was ruddy and beautiful to behold, and of a comely face. And the Lord said: Arise, and anoint him, for this is he. ¹³ Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him in the midst of his brethren: and the Spirit of the Lord came upon David from that day forward: and Samuel rose up, and went to Ramatha. ¹⁴ But the Spirit of the Lord departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the Lord troubled him. ¹⁵ And the servants of Saul said to him: Behold now an evil spirit from God troubleth thee. ¹⁶ Let our lord give orders, and thy servants who are before thee, will seek out a man skilful in playing on the harp, that when the evil spirit from the Lord is upon thee, he may play with his hand, and thou mayst bear it more easily. ¹⁷ And Saul said to his servants: Provide me then some man that can play well, and bring him to me. ¹⁸ And one of the servants answering, said: Behold I have seen a son of Isai, the Bethlehemite, a skilful player, and one of great strength, and a man fit for war, and prudent in his words, and a comely person: and the Lord is with him.

¹⁹ Then Saul sent messengers to Isai, saying: Send me David, thy son, who is in the pastures. ²⁰ And Isai took an ass laden with bread, and a bottle of wine, and a kid of the flock, and sent them by the hand of David, his son, to Saul. ²¹ And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him exceedingly, and made him his armourbearer. ²² And Saul sent to Isai, saying: Let David stand before me: for he hath found favour in my sight. ²³ So whensoever the evil spirit from the Lord was upon Saul, David took his harp, and played with his hand, and Saul was refreshed, and was better, for the evil spirit departed from him.

144. David and Goliath

1 Samuel 17:1-58

17 ¹ Now the Philistines gathering together their troops to battle, assembled at Socho of Juda: and camped between Socho and Azeca, in the borders of Dommim. ² And Saul and the children of Israel being gathered together, came to the valley of Terebinth, and they set the army in array to fight against the Philistines. ³ And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side, and

Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them. ⁴ And there went out a man baseborn from the camp of the Philistines, named Goliath, of Geth, whose height was six cubits and a span: ⁵ And he had a helmet of brass upon his head, and he was clothed with a coat of mail with scales, and the weight of his coat of mail was five thousand sicles of brass: ⁶ And he had greaves of brass on his legs, and a buckler of brass covered his shoulders. ⁷ And the staff of his spear was like a weaver's beam, and the head of his spear weighed six hundred sicles of iron: and his armourbearer went before him. ⁸ And standing, he cried out to the bands of Israel, and said to them: Why are you come out prepared to fight? am not I a Philistine, and you the servants of Saul? Choose out a man of you, and let him come down and fight hand to hand. ⁹ If he be able to fight with me, and kill me, we will be servants to you: but if I prevail against him, and kill him, you shall be servants, and shall serve us. ¹⁰ And the Philistine said: I have defied the bands of Israel this day: give me a man, and let him fight with me hand to hand. ¹¹ And Saul and all the Israelites hearing these words of the Philistine, were dismayed, and greatly afraid. ¹² Now David was the son of that Ephrathite, of Bethlehem Juda, before mentioned, whose name was Isai, who had eight sons, and was an old man in the days of Saul, and of great age among men. ¹³ And his three eldest sons followed Saul to the battle: and the names of his three sons that went to the battle, were Eliab, the firstborn, and the second, Abinadab, and the third Samma: ¹⁴ But David was the youngest. So the three eldest having followed Saul, ¹⁵ David went, and returned from Saul, to feed his father's flock at Bethlehem. ¹⁶ Now the Philistine came out morning and evening, and presented himself forty days. ¹⁷ And Isai said to David, his son: Take for thy brethren an ephi of frumenty, and these ten loaves, and run to the camp to thy brethren, ¹⁸ And carry these ten little cheeses to the tribune: and go see thy brethren, if they are well: and learn with whom they are placed. ¹⁹ But Saul, and they, and all the children of Israel, were in the valley of Terebinth, fighting against the Philistines.

²⁰ David, therefore, arose in the morning, and gave the charge of the flock to the keeper: and went away loaded, as Isai had commanded him. And he came to the place of Magala, and to the army, which was going out to fight, and shouted for the battle. ²¹ For Israel had put themselves in array, and the Philistines who stood against them were prepared. ²² And David leaving the vessels which he had brought, under the care of the keeper of the baggage, ran to the place of the battle, and asked if all things went well with his brethren. ²³ And as he talked with them, that baseborn man, whose name was Goliath, the Philistine, of Geth, shewed himself coming up from the camp of the Philistines: and he spoke according to the same words, and David heard them, ²⁴ And all the Israelites, when they saw the man, fled from his face, fearing him exceedingly. ²⁵ And some one of Israel said: Have you seen this man that is come up, for he is come up to defy Israel. And the man that shall slay him, the king will enrich with great riches, and will give him his daughter, and will make his father's house free from tribute in Israel. ²⁶ And David spoke to the men that stood by him, saying: What shall be given to the man that shall kill this Philistine, and shall take away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine,

that he should defy the armies of the living God? ²⁷ And the people answered him the same words, saying: These things shall be given to the man that shall slay him.

²⁸ Now when Eliab his eldest brother heard this, when he was speaking with others, he was angry with David, and said: Why camest thou hither? and why didst thou leave those few sheep in the desert? I know thy pride, and the wickedness of thy heart: that thou art come down to see the battle. ²⁹ And David said: What have I done? is there not cause to speak? ³⁰ And he turned a little aside from him to another: and said the same word. And the people answered him as before. ³¹ And the words which David spoke were heard, and were rehearsed before Saul. ³² And when he was brought to Saul, he said to him. Let not any man's heart be dismayed in him: I thy servant will go, and will fight against the Philistine. ³³ And Saul said to David: Thou art not able to withstand this Philistine, nor to fight against him: for thou art but a boy, but he is a warrior from his youth. ³⁴ And David said to Saul: Thy servant kept his father's sheep, and there came a lion, or a bear, and took a ram out of the midst of the flock: ³⁵ And I pursued after them, and struck them, and delivered it out of their mouth: and they rose up against me, and I caught them by the throat, and I strangled, and killed them. ³⁶ For I thy servant have killed both a lion and a bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be also as one of them. I will go now, and take away the reproach of the people: for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, who hath dared to curse the army of the living God? ³⁷ And David said: The Lord who delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine. And Saul said to David: Go, and the Lord be with thee.

³⁸ And Saul clothed David with his garments, and put a helmet of brass upon his head, and armed him with a coat of mail. ³⁹ And David having girded his sword upon his armour, began to try if he could walk in armour: for he was not accustomed to it. And David said to Saul: I cannot go thus, for I am not used to it. And he laid them off,

⁴⁰ And he took his staff, which he had always in his hands: and chose him five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them into the shepherd's scrip, which he had with him, and he took a sling in his hand, and went forth against the Philistine. ⁴¹ And the Philistine came on, and drew nigh against David, and his armourbearer went before him. ⁴² And when the Philistine looked, and beheld David, he despised him. For he was a young man, ruddy, and of a comely countenance. ⁴³ And the Philistine said to David: Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with a staff? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. ⁴⁴ And he said to David: Come to me, and I will give thy flesh to the birds of the air, and to the beasts of the earth. ⁴⁵ And David said to the Philistine: Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, which thou hast defied. ⁴⁶ This day, and the Lord will deliver thee into my hand, and I will slay thee, and take away thy head from thee: and I will give the carcasses of the army of the Philistines this day to the birds of the air, and to the beasts of the earth: that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. ⁴⁷ And all this assembly shall know that the

Lord saveth not with sword and spear: for it is his battle, and he will deliver you into our hands.

⁴⁸ And when the Philistine arose, and was coming, and drew nigh to meet David, David made haste, and ran to the fight to meet the Philistine. ⁴⁹ And he put his hand into his scrip, and took a stone, and cast it with the sling, and fetching it about, struck the Philistine in the forehead: and the stone was fixed in his forehead, and he fell on his face upon the earth. ⁵⁰ And David prevailed over the Philistine, with a sling and a stone, and he struck, and slew the Philistine. And as David had no sword in his hand, ⁵¹ He ran, and stood over the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath, and slew him, and cut off his head. And the Philistines seeing that their champion was dead, fled away. ⁵² And the men of Israel and Juda rising up shouted, and pursued after the Philistines till they came to the valley and to the gates of Accaron, and there fell many wounded of the Philistines in the way of Saraim, and as far as Geth, and as far as Accaron. ⁵³ And the children of Israel returning, after they had pursued the Philistines, fell upon their camp. ⁵⁴ And David taking the head of the Philistine, brought it to Jerusalem: but his armour he put in his tent. ⁵⁵ Now at the time that Saul saw David going out against the Philistines, he said to Abner, the captain of the army: Of what family is this young man descended, Abner? And Abner said: As thy soul liveth, O king, I know not. ⁵⁶ And the king said: Inquire thou, whose son this young man is. ⁵⁷ And when David was returned, after the Philistine was slain, Abner took him, and brought him in before Saul, with the head of the Philistine in his hand. ⁵⁸ And Saul said to him: Young man, of what family art thou? And David said: I am the son of thy servant Isai the Bethlehemite.

145. Jonathan's friendship, and Saul's envy

1 Samuel 18:1-30

18 ¹ And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking to Saul, the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul. ² And Saul took him that day, and would not let him return to his father's house. ³ And David and Jonathan made a covenant, for he loved him as his own soul. ⁴ And Jonathan stripped himself of the coat with which he was clothed, and gave it to David, and the rest of his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.

⁵ And David went out to whatsoever business Saul sent him, and he behaved himself prudently: and Saul set him over the soldiers, and he was acceptable in the eyes of all the people, and especially in the eyes of Saul's servants.

⁶ Now when David returned, after he slew the Philistine, the women came out of all the cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet king Saul, with timbrels of joy, and cornets. ⁷ And the women sung as they played, and they said: Saul slew his thousands, and David his ten thousands. ⁸ And Saul was exceeding angry, and this word was displeasing in his eyes, and he said: They have given David ten thousands, and to me they have given but a thousand, what can he have more but the kingdom? ⁹ And Saul did not look on David with a good eye from that day and forward. ¹⁰ And the day after, the evil spirit from God came upon Saul, and he prophesied in the midst of his house. And David played with his hand as at other times. And Saul held a spear in his hand, ¹¹ And threw it, thinking to nail David to

the wall: and David stept aside out of his presence twice. ¹² And Saul feared David, because the Lord was with him, and was departed from himself. ¹³ Therefore Saul removed him from him, and made him a captain over a thousand men, and he went out and came in before the people. ¹⁴ And David behaved wisely in all his ways, and the Lord was with him. ¹⁵ And Saul saw that he was exceeding prudent, and began to beware of him. ¹⁶ But all Israel and Juda loved David, for he came in and went out before them. ¹⁷ And Saul said to David: Behold my elder daughter Merob, her will I give thee to wife: only be a valiant man, and fight the battles of the Lord. Now Saul said within himself: Let not my hand be upon him, but let the hands of the Philistines be upon him. ¹⁸ And David said to Saul: Who am I, or what is my life, or my father's family in Israel, that I should be son in law of the king? ¹⁹ And it came to pass at the time when Merob, the daughter of Saul, should have been given to David, that she was given to Hadriel, the Molathite, to wife. ²⁰ But Michol, the other daughter of Saul, loved David. And it was told Saul, and it pleased him. ²¹ And Saul said: I will give her to him, that she may be a stumblingblock to him, and that the hand of the Philistines may be upon him. And Saul said to David: In two things thou shalt be my son in law this day.

²² And Saul commanded his servants to speak to David privately, saying: Behold, thou pleasest the king, and all his servants love thee. Now, therefore be the king's son in law. ²³ And the servants of Saul spoke all these words in the ears of David. And David said: Doth it seem to you a small matter to be the king's son in law? But I am a poor man, and of small ability. ²⁴ And the servants of Saul told him, saying: Such words as these hath David spoken. ²⁵ And Saul said: Speak thus to David: The king desireth not any dowry, but only a hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be avenged of the king's enemies. Now Saul thought to deliver David into the hands of the Philistines. ²⁶ And when his servants had told David the words that Saul had said, the word was pleasing in the eyes of David to be the king's son in law. ²⁷ And after a few days David rose up, and went with the men that were under him, and he slew of the Philistines two hundred men, and brought their foreskins and numbered them out to the king, that he might be his son in law. Saul therefore gave him Michol, his daughter, to wife. ²⁸ And Saul saw, and understood that the Lord was with David. And Michol, the daughter of Saul, loved him. ²⁹ And Saul began to fear David more: and Saul became David's enemy continually. ³⁰ And the princes of the Philistines went forth: and from the beginning of their going forth, David behaved himself more wisely than all the servants of Saul, and his name became very famous.

146. Michol's stratagem; the covenant with Jonathan

1 Samuel 19:1-20:43

19 ¹ And Saul spoke to Jonathan, his son, and to all his servants, that they should kill David. But Jonathan, the son of Saul, loved David exceedingly. ² And Jonathan told David, saying: Saul, my father, seeketh to kill thee: wherefore look to thyself, I beseech thee, in the morning and thou shalt abide in a secret place, and shalt be hid. ³ And I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where thou art: and I will speak of thee to my father, and whatsoever I shall see, I will tell thee.

⁴ And Jonathan spoke good things of David to Saul, his father: and said to him: Sin not, O king, against thy servant, David, because he hath not sinned against thee, and his works are very good towards thee. ⁵ And he put his life in his hand, and slew the Philistine, and the Lord wrought great salvation for all Israel. Thou sawest it and didst rejoice. Why therefore wilt thou sin against innocent blood, by killing David, who is without fault? ⁶ And when Saul heard this, he was appeased with the words of Jonathan, and swore: As the Lord liveth, he shall not be slain. ⁷ Then Jonathan called David, and told him all these words: and Jonathan brought in David to Saul, and he was before him, as he had been yesterday and the day before.

⁸ And the war began again, and David went out, and fought against the Philistines, and defeated them with a great slaughter, and they fled from his face. ⁹ And the evil spirit from the Lord came upon Saul; and he sat in his house, and held a spear in his hand: and David played with his hand. ¹⁰ And Saul endeavoured to nail David to the wall with his spear. And David slipt away out of the presence of Saul: and the spear missed him, and was fastened in the wall, and David fled, and escaped that night. ¹¹ Saul therefore sent his guards to David's house to watch him, that he might be killed in the morning. And when Michol, David's wife, had told him this, saying: Unless thou save thyself this night, to morrow thou wilt die: ¹² She let him down through a window. And he went and fled away, and escaped. ¹³ And Michol took an image, and laid it on the bed, and put a goat's skin, with the hair at the head of it, and covered it with clothes. ¹⁴ And Saul sent officers to seize David; and it was answered that he was sick. ¹⁵ And again Saul sent to see David, saying: Bring him to me in the bed, that he may be slain. ¹⁶ And when the messengers were come in, they found an image upon the bed, and a goat skin at his head. ¹⁷ And Saul said to Michol: Why hast thou deceived me so, and let my enemy go and flee away? And Michol answered Saul: Because he said to me: Let me go, or else I will kill thee.

¹⁸ But David fled and escaped, and came to Samuel in Ramatha, and told him all that Saul had done to him: and he and Samuel went and dwelt in Najoth. ¹⁹ And it was told Saul by some, saying: Behold David is in Najoth, in Ramatha. ²⁰ So Saul sent officers to take David: and when they saw a company of prophets prophesying, and Samuel presiding over them, the Spirit of the Lord came also upon them, and they likewise began to prophesy. ²¹ And when this was told Saul, he sent other messengers: but they also prophesied. And again Saul sent messengers the third time: and they prophesied also. And Saul being exceeding angry, ²² Went also himself to Ramatha, and came as far as the great cistern, which is in Socho, and he asked, and said: In what place are Samuel and David? And it was told him: Behold they are in Najoth, in Ramatha. ²³ And he went to Najoth, in Ramatha, and the Spirit of the Lord came upon him also, and he went on, and prophesied till he came to Najoth, in Ramatha. ²⁴ And he stripped himself also of his garments, and prophesied with the rest before Samuel, and lay down naked all that day and night. This gave occasion to a proverb: What! is Saul too among the prophets?

20 ¹ But David fled from Najoth, which is in Ramatha, and came and said to Jonathan: What have I done? what is my iniquity, and what is my sin against thy father, that he seeketh my life?

² And he said to him: God forbid, thou shalt not die: for my father will do nothing, great or little, without first telling me: hath then my father hid this word only from me? no, this shall not be. ³ And he swore again to David. And David said: Thy father certainly knoweth that I have found grace in thy sight, and he will say: Let not Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved. But truly as the Lord liveth, and thy soul liveth, there is but one step (as I may say) between me and death. ⁴ And Jonathan said to David: Whatsoever thy soul shall say to me, I will do for thee. ⁵ And David said to Jonathan: Behold to morrow is the new moon, and I, according to custom, am wont to sit beside the king to eat: let me go then that I may be hid in the field till the evening of the third day. ⁶ If thy father look and inquire for me, thou shalt answer him: David asked me that he might run to Bethlehem, his own city: because there are solemn sacrifices there for all of his tribe. ⁷ If he shall say: It is well: thy servant shall have peace: but if he be angry, know that his malice is come to its height. ⁸ Deal mercifully then with thy servant: for thou hast brought me, thy servant, into a covenant of the Lord with thee. But if there be any iniquity in me, do thou kill me, and bring me not in to thy father.

⁹ And Jonathan said: Far be this from thee: for if I should certainly know that evil is determined by my father against thee, I could do no otherwise than tell thee. ¹⁰ And David answered Jonathan: Who shall bring me word, if thy father should answer thee harshly concerning me?

¹¹ And Jonathan said to David: Come, and let us go out into the field. And when they were both of them gone out into the field, ¹² Jonathan said to David: O Lord God of Israel, if I shall discover my father's mind, to morrow, or the day after, and there be any thing good for David, and I send not immediately to thee, and make it known to thee, ¹³ May the Lord do so and so to Jonathan, and add still more. But if my father shall continue in malice against thee, I will discover it to thy ear, and will send thee away, that thou mayst go in peace, and the Lord be with thee, as he hath been with my father. ¹⁴ And if I live, thou shalt shew me the kindness of the Lord: but if I die, ¹⁵ Thou shalt not take away thy kindness from my house for ever, when the Lord shall have rooted out the enemies of David, every one of them from the earth, may he take away Jonathan from his house, and may the Lord require it at the hands of David's enemies. ¹⁶ Jonathan therefore made a covenant with the house of David: and the Lord required it at the hands of David's enemies. ¹⁷ And Jonathan swore again to David, because he loved him: for he loved him as his own soul. ¹⁸ And Jonathan said to him: To morrow is the new moon, and thou wilt be missed: ¹⁹ For thy seat will be empty till after to morrow. So thou shalt go down quickly, and come to the place where thou must be hid, on the day when it is lawful to work, and thou shalt remain beside the stone, which is called Ezel. ²⁰ And I will shoot three arrows near it, and will shoot as if I were exercising myself at a mark. ²¹ And I will send a boy, saying to him: Go and fetch me the arrows. ²² If I shall say to the boy: Behold the arrows are on this side of thee, take them up: come thou to me, because there is peace to thee, and there is no evil, as the Lord liveth. But if I shall speak thus to the boy: Behold the arrows are beyond thee: go in peace, for the Lord hath sent thee away. ²³ And concerning the word

which I and thou have spoken, the Lord be between thee and me forever.

²⁴ So David was hid in the field, and the new moon came, and the king sat down to eat bread. ²⁵ And when the king sat down upon his chair, (according to custom) which was beside the wall, Jonathan arose, and Abner sat by Saul's side, and David's place appeared empty. ²⁶ And Saul said nothing that day, for he thought it might have happened to him, that he was not clean, nor purified. ²⁷ And when the second day after the new moon was come, David's place appeared empty again. And Saul said to Jonathan, his son: Why cometh not the son of Isai to meat neither yesterday, nor to day? ²⁸ And Jonathan answered Saul: He asked leave of me earnestly to go to Bethlehem. ²⁹ And he said: Let me go, for there is a solemn sacrifice in the city, one of my brethren hath sent for me: and now if I have found favour in thy eyes, I will go quickly, and see my brethren. For this cause he came not to the king's table. ³⁰ Then Saul being angry against Jonathan, said to him: Thou son of a woman that is the ravisher of a man, do I not know that thou lovest the son of Isai to thy own confusion, and to the confusion of thy shameless mother? ³¹ For as long as the son of Isai liveth upon earth, thou shalt not be established, nor thy kingdom. Therefore now presently send, and fetch him to me: for he is the son of death. ³² And Jonathan answering Saul, his father, said: Why shall he die? What hath he done? ³³ And Saul caught up a spear to strike him. And Jonathan understood that it was determined by his father to kill David. ³⁴ So Jonathan rose from the table in great anger, and did not eat bread on the second day after the new moon. For he was grieved for David, because his father had put him to confusion.

³⁵ And when the morning came, Jonathan went into the field according to the appointment with David, and a little boy with him. ³⁶ And he said to his boy: Go, and fetch me the arrows which I shoot. And when the boy ran, he shot another arrow beyond the boy. ³⁷ The boy therefore came to the place of the arrow which Jonathan had shot: and Jonathan cried after the boy, and said: Behold the arrow is there further beyond thee. ³⁸ And Jonathan cried again after the boy, saying: Make haste speedily, stand not. And Jonathan's boy gathered up the arrows, and brought them to his master: ³⁹ And he knew not at all what was doing: for only Jonathan and David knew the matter. ⁴⁰ Jonathan therefore gave his arms to the boy, and said to him: Go, and carry them into the city.

⁴¹ And when the boy was gone, David rose out of his place, which was toward the south, and falling on his face to the ground, adored thrice: and kissing one another, they wept together; but David more. ⁴² And Jonathan said to David: Go in peace: and let all stand that we have sworn both of us in the name of the Lord, saying: The Lord be between me and thee, and between my seed and thy seed for ever. ⁴³ And David arose, and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.

147. The loaves of proposition; the priests of Nobe

1 Samuel 21:1-22:23

Christ cites the loaves of proposition against the Pharisees; that passage is read in this plan.

21 ¹ And David came to Nobe, to Achimelech, the priest and Achimelech was astonished at David's coming. And he said to

him: Why art thou alone, and no man with thee? ² And David said to Achimelech, the priest: The king hath commanded me a business, and said: Let no man know the thing for which thou art sent by me, and what manner of commands I have given thee: and I have appointed my servants to such and such a place. ³ Now therefore if thou have any thing at hand, though it were but five loaves, give me, or whatsoever thou canst find. ⁴ And the priest answered David, saying: I have no common bread at hand, but only holy bread, if the young men be clean, especially from women? ⁵ And David answered the priest, and said to him: Truly, as to what concerneth women, we have refrained ourselves from yesterday and the day before, when we came out, and the vessels of the young men were holy. Now this way is defiled, but it shall also be sanctified this day in the vessels. ⁶ The priest therefore gave him hallowed bread: for there was no bread there, but only the loaves of proposition, which had been taken away from before the face of the Lord, that hot loaves might be set up. ⁷ Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, within the tabernacle of the Lord: and his name was Doeg, an Edomite, the chiefest of Saul's herdsmen.

⁸ And David said to Achimelech: Hast thou here at hand a spear, or a sword? for I brought not my own sword, nor my own weapons with me, for the king's business required haste. ⁹ And the priest said: Lo, here is the sword of Goliath, the Philistine, whom thou slewest in the valley of Terebinth, wrapped up in a cloth behind the ephod: if thou wilt take this, take it, for here there is no other but this. And David said: There is none like that, give it me.

¹⁰ And David arose and fled that day from the face of Saul: and came to Achis, the king of Geth: ¹¹ And the servants of Achis, when they saw David, said to him: Is not this David, the king of the land? Did they not sing to him in their dances, saying: Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands? ¹² But David laid up these words in his heart, and was exceedingly afraid at the face of Achis, the king of Geth. ¹³ And he changed his countenance before them, and slipt down between their hands: and he stumbled against the doors of the gate, and his spittle ran down upon his beard. ¹⁴ And Achis said to his servants: You saw the man was mad: why have you brought him to me? ¹⁵ Have we need of mad men, that you have brought in this fellow, to play the madman in my presence? shall this fellow come into my house?

22 ¹ David therefore went from thence, and fled to the cave of Odollam. And when his brethren, and all his father's house, had heard of it, they went down to him thither. ² And all that were in distress, and oppressed with debt, and under affliction of mind, gathered themselves unto him: and he became their prince, and there were with him about four hundred men. ³ And David departed from thence into Maspha of Moab: and he said to the king of Moab: Let my father and my mother tarry with you, I beseech thee, till I know what God will do for me. ⁴ And he left them under the eyes of the king of Moab, and they abode with him all the days that David was in the hold. ⁵ And Gad the prophet said to David: Abide not in the hold, depart, and go into the land of Juda. And David departed, and came into the forest of Haret.

⁶ And Saul heard that David was seen, and the men that were with him. Now whilst Saul abode in Gabaa, and was in the wood, which is by Rama, having his spear in his hand, and all his servants were standing about him, ⁷ He said to his servants that stood about him: Hear me now, ye sons of Jemini: will the son of Isai give every one of you fields, and vineyards, and make you all tribunes, and centurions: ⁸ That all of you have conspired against me, and there is no one to inform me, especially when even my son hath entered into league with the son of Isai? There is not one of you that pitieth my case, nor that giveth me any information: because my son hath raised up my servant against me, plotting against me to this day.

⁹ And Doeg, the Edomite, who stood by, and was the chief among the servants of Saul, answering, said: I saw the son of Isai, in Nobe, with Achimelech, the son of Achitob, the priest. ¹⁰ And he consulted the Lord for him, and gave him victuals, and gave him the sword of Goliath, the Philistine. ¹¹ Then the king sent to call for Achimelech, the priest, the son of Achitob, and all his father's house, the priests that were in Nobe, and they came all of them to the king. ¹² And Saul said to Achimelech: Hear, thou son of Achitob. He answered: Here I am, my lord. ¹³ And Saul said to him: Why have you conspired against me, thou, and the son of Isai, and thou hast given him bread and a sword, and hast consulted the Lord for him, that he should rise up against me, continuing a traitor to this day. ¹⁴ And Achimelech answering the king, said: And who amongst all thy servants is so faithful as David, who is the king's son in law, and goeth forth at thy bidding, and is honourable in thy house? ¹⁵ Did I begin to day to consult the Lord for him? far be this from me: let not the king suspect such a thing against his servant, or any one in all my father's house: for thy servant knew nothing of this matter, either little or great. ¹⁶ And the king said: Dying thou shalt die, Achimelech, thou and all thy father's house. ¹⁷ And the king said to the messengers that stood about him: Turn, and kill the priests of the Lord, for their hand is with David, because they knew that he was fled, and they told it not to me. And the king's servants would not put forth their hands against the priests of the Lord. ¹⁸ And the king said to Doeg: Turn thou, and fall upon the priests. And Doeg, the Edomite, turned, and fell upon the priests, and slew in that day eighty-five men that wore the linen ephod. ¹⁹ And Nobe, the city of the priests, he smote with the edge of the sword, both men and women, children and sucklings, and ox, and ass, and sheep, with the edge of the sword. ²⁰ But one of the sons of Achimelech, the son of Achitob, whose name was Abiathar, escaped, and fled to David, ²¹ And told him that Saul had slain the priests of the Lord. ²² And David said to Abiathar: I knew that day when Doeg, the Edomite, was there, that without doubt he would tell Saul: I have been the occasion of the death of all the souls of thy father's house. ²³ Abide thou with me, fear not: for he that seeketh my life, seeketh thy life also, and with me thou shalt be saved.

148. David in the wilderness of Ziph

1 Samuel 23:1-28

23 ¹ And they told David, saying: Behold the Philistines fight against Ceila, and they rob the barns. ² Therefore David consulted the Lord, saying: Shall I go and smite these Philistines? And the Lord said to David: Go, and thou shalt smite the

Philistines, and shalt save Ceila. ³ And the men that were with David, said to him: Behold we are in fear here in Judea, how much more if we go to Ceila against the bands of the Philistines? ⁴ Therefore David consulted the Lord again. And he answered and said to him: Arise, and go to Ceila: for I will deliver the Philistines into thy hand. ⁵ David, therefore, and his men, went to Ceila, and fought against the Philistines, and brought away their cattle, and made a great slaughter of them: and David saved the inhabitants of Ceila. ⁶ Now at that time, when Abiathar, the son of Achimelech, fled to David, to Ceila, he came down, having an ephod with him.

⁷ And it was told Saul that David was come to Ceila: and Saul said: The Lord hath delivered him into my hands, and he is shut up, being come into a city that hath gates and bars. ⁸ And Saul commanded all the people to go down to fight against Ceila, and to besiege David and his men. ⁹ Now when David understood that Saul secretly prepared evil against him, he said to Abiathar, the priest: Bring hither the ephod. ¹⁰ And David said: O Lord God of Israel, thy servant hath heard a report, that Saul designeth to come to Ceila, to destroy the city for my sake: ¹¹ Will the men of Ceila deliver me into his hands? and will Saul come down, as thy servant hath heard? O Lord God of Israel, tell thy servant. And the Lord said: He will come down. ¹² And David said: Will the men of Ceila deliver me and my men into the hands of Saul? And the Lord said: They will deliver thee up.

¹³ Then David and his men, who were about six hundred, arose, and departing from Ceila, wandered up and down, uncertain where they should stay: and it was told Saul that David was fled from Ceila, and had escaped: wherefore he forbore to go out. ¹⁴ But David abode in the desert in strong holds, and he remained in a mountain of the desert of Ziph, in a woody hill. And Saul sought him always: but the Lord delivered him not into his hands. ¹⁵ And David saw that Saul was come out to seek his life. And David was in the desert of Ziph, in a wood.

¹⁶ And Jonathan, the son of Saul, arose, and went to David, into the wood, and strengthened his hands in God: and he said to him: ¹⁷ Fear not: for the hand of my father, Saul, shall not find thee, and thou shalt reign over Israel, and I shall be next to thee; yea and my father knoweth this. ¹⁸ And they two made a covenant before the Lord: and David abode in the wood: but Jonathan returned to his house.

¹⁹ And the Ziphites went up to Saul, in Gabaa, saying: Lo, doth not David lie hid with us in the strong holds of the wood, in mount Hachila, which is on the right hand of the desert. ²⁰ Now therefore come down, as thy soul hath desired to come down: and it shall be our business to deliver him into the king's hands. ²¹ And Saul said: Blessed be ye of the Lord, for you have pitied my case. ²² Go, therefore, I pray you, and use all diligence, and curiously inquire, and consider the place where his foot is, and who hath seen him there: for he thinketh of me, that I lie craftily in wait for him. ²³ Consider, and see all his lurking holes, wherein he is hid, and return to me with the certainty of the thing, that I may go with you. And if he should even go down into the earth to hide himself, I will search him out in all the thousands of Juda. ²⁴ And they arose, and went to Ziph before Saul: and David and his men were in the desert of Maon, in the plain at the right hand of Jesimon. ²⁵ Then Saul and his men went to

seek him: and it was told David, and forthwith he went down to the rock, and abode in the wilderness of Maon: and when Saul had heard of it, he pursued after David in the wilderness of Maon. ²⁶ And Saul went on this side of the mountain: and David and his men were on the other side of the mountain: and David despaired of being able to escape from the face of Saul: and Saul and his men encompassed David and his men round about, to take them. ²⁷ And a messenger came to Saul, saying: Make haste to come, for the Philistines have poured in themselves upon the land. ²⁸ Wherefore Saul returned, leaving the pursuit of David, and went to meet the Philistines. For this cause they called that place the rock of division.

149. David spares Saul in the cave

1 Samuel 24:1-23

²⁴ ¹ Then David went up from thence, and dwelt in strong holds of Engaddi. ² And when Saul was returned from following the Philistines, they told him, saying: Behold, David is in the desert of Engaddi. ³ Saul, therefore, took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and went out to seek after David and his men, even upon the most craggy rocks, which are accessible only to wild goats. ⁴ And he came to the sheepcotes which were in his way. And there was a cave, into which Saul went, to ease nature: now David and his men lay hid in the inner part of the cave. ⁵ And the servants of David said to him: Behold the day, of which the Lord said to thee: I will deliver thy enemy unto thee, that thou mayst do to him as it shall seem good in thy eyes. Then David arose, and secretly cut off the hem of Saul's robe. ⁶ After which David's heart struck him, because he had cut off the hem of Saul's robe. ⁷ And he said to his men: The Lord be merciful unto me, that I may do no such thing to my master, the Lord's anointed, as to lay my hand upon him, because he is the Lord's anointed. ⁸ And David stopped his men with his words, and suffered them not to rise against Saul: but Saul, rising up out of the cave, went on his way.

⁹ And David also rose up after him: and going out of the cave, cried after Saul, saying: My lord the king. And Saul looked behind him: and David bowing himself down to the ground, worshipped, ¹⁰ And said to Saul: Why dost thou hear the words of men that say: David seeketh thy hurt? ¹¹ Behold this day thy eyes have seen, that the Lord hath delivered thee into my hand, in the cave, and I had a thought to kill thee, but my eye hath spared thee. For I said: I will not put out my hand against my lord, because he is the Lord's anointed. ¹² Moreover, see and know, O my father, the hem of thy robe in my hand, that when I cut off the hem of thy robe, I would not put out my hand against thee. Reflect, and see, that there is no evil in my hand, nor iniquity, neither have I sinned against thee: but thou liest in wait for my life, to take it away. ¹³ The Lord judge between me and thee and the Lord revenge me of thee: but my hand shall not be upon thee. ¹⁴ As also it is said in the old proverb: From the wicked shall wickedness come forth: therefore my hand shall not be upon thee. After whom dost thou come out, O king of Israel? ¹⁵ After whom dost thou pursue? After a dead dog, after a flea.

¹⁶ Be the Lord judge, and judge between me and thee, and see, and judge my cause, and deliver me out of thy hand. ¹⁷ And when David had made an end of speaking these words to Saul, Saul said: Is this thy voice, my son David? And Saul lifted up

his voice, and wept: ¹⁸ And he said to David: Thou art more just than I: for thou hast done good to me, and I have rewarded thee with evil. ¹⁹ And thou hast shewed this day what good things thou hast done to me: how the Lord delivered me into thy hand, and thou hast not killed me. ²⁰ For who when he hath found his enemy, will let him go well away? But the Lord reward thee for this good turn, for what thou hast done to me this day. ²¹ And now as I know that thou shalt surely be king, and have the kingdom of Israel in thy hand: ²² Swear to me by the Lord, that thou wilt not destroy my seed after me, nor take away my name from the house of my father. ²³ And David swore to Saul. So Saul went home: and David and his men went up into safer places.

150. Nabal and Abigail; Saul spared again

1 Samuel 25:1-26:25

25 ¹ And Samuel died, and all Israel was gathered together, and they mourned for him, and buried him in his house in Ramatha. And David rose, and went down into the wilderness of Pharan.

² Now there was a certain man in the wilderness of Maon, and his possessions were in Carmel, and the man was very great: and he had three thousand sheep, and a thousand goats: and it happened that he was shearing his sheep in Carmel. ³ Now the name of the man was Nabal: and the name of his wife was Abigail. And she was a prudent and very comely woman: but her husband was churlish, and very bad and ill natured: and he was of the house of Caleb. ⁴ And when David heard in the wilderness, that Nabal was shearing his sheep, ⁵ He sent ten young men, and said to them: Go up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and salute him in my name with peace. ⁶ And you shall say: Peace be to my brethren, and to thee, and peace to thy house, and peace to all that thou hast. ⁷ I have heard that thy shepherds that were with us in the desert were shearing: we never molested them, neither was there ought missing to them of the flock at any time, all the while they were with us in Carmel. ⁸ Ask thy servants, and they will tell thee. Now therefore let thy servants find favour in thy eyes: for we are come in a good day, whatsoever thy hand shall find give to thy servants, and to thy son David. ⁹ And when David's servants came, they spoke to Nabal all these words in David's name, and then held their peace.

¹⁰ But Nabal answering the servants of David, said: Who is David? and what is the son of Isai? servants are multiplied now days who flee from their masters. ¹¹ Shall I then take my bread, and my water, and the flesh of my cattle, which I have killed for my shearers, and give to men whom I know not whence they are?

¹² So the servants of David went back their way, and returning came and told him all the words that he said. ¹³ Then David said to his young men: Let every man gird on his sword. And they girded on every man his sword. And David also girded on his sword: and there followed David about four hundred men, and two hundred remained with the baggage.

¹⁴ But one of the servants told, Abigail, the wife of Nabal, saying: Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness, to salute our master: and he rejected them. ¹⁵ These men were very good to us, and gave us no trouble: Neither did we ever lose any thing all the time that we conversed with them in the desert. ¹⁶ They were a wall unto us, both by night and day, all

the while we were with them keeping the sheep. ¹⁷ Wherefore consider, and think what thou hast to do: for evil is determined against thy husband, and against thy house, and he is a son of Belial, so that no man can speak to him.

¹⁸ Then Abigail made haste and took two hundred loaves, and two vessels of wine, and five sheep ready dressed, and five measures of parched corn, and a hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of dry figs, and laid them upon asses: ¹⁹ And she said to her servants: Go before me: behold, I will follow after you: but she told not her husband, Nabal. ²⁰ And when she had gotten upon an ass, and was coming down to the foot of the mountain, David and his men came down over against her, and she met them. ²¹ And David said: Truly in vain have I kept all that belonged to this fellow in the wilderness, and nothing was lost of all that pertained unto him: and he hath returned me evil for good. ²² May God do so and so, and add more to the foes of David, if I leave of all that belong to him till the morning, any that pisseth against the wall. ²³ And when Abigail saw David, she made haste and lighted off the ass, and fell before David, on her face, and adored upon the ground. ²⁴ And she fell at his feet, and said: Upon me let this iniquity be, my lord: let thy handmaid speak, I beseech thee, in thy ears, and hear the words of thy servant. ²⁵ Let not my lord the king, I pray thee, regard this naughty man, Nabal: for according to his name, he is a fool, and folly is with him: but I, thy handmaid, did not see thy servants, my lord, whom thou sentest. ²⁶ Now therefore, my lord, the Lord liveth, and thy soul liveth, who hath withholden thee from coming to blood, and hath saved thy hand to thee: and now let thy enemies be as Nabal, and all they that seek evil to my lord. ²⁷ Wherefore receive this blessing, which thy handmaid hath brought to thee, my lord: and give it to the young men that follow thee, my lord. ²⁸ Forgive the iniquity of thy handmaid: for the Lord will surely make for my lord a faithful house, because thou, my lord, fightest the battles of the Lord: let not evil therefore be found in thee all the days of thy life. ²⁹ For if a man at any time shall rise, and persecute thee, and seek thy life, the soul of my lord shall be kept, as in the bundle of the living, with the Lord thy God: but the souls of thy enemies shall be whirled, as with the violence and whirling of a sling. ³⁰ And when the Lord shall have done to thee, my lord, all the good that he hath spoken concerning thee, and shall have made thee prince over Israel, ³¹ This shall not be an occasion of grief to thee, and a scruple of heart to my lord, that thou hast shed innocent blood, or hast revenged thyself: and when the Lord shall have done well by my lord, thou shalt remember thy handmaid.

³² And David said to Abigail: Blessed be the Lord the God of Israel, who sent thee this day to meet me, and blessed be thy speech: ³³ And blessed be thou, who hast kept me to day from coming to blood, and revenging me with my own hand. ³⁴ Otherwise, as the Lord liveth, the God of Israel, who hath withholden me from doing thee any evil, if thou hadst not quickly come to meet me, there had not been left to Nabal by the morning light, any that pisseth against the wall. ³⁵ And David received at her hand all that she had brought him, and said to her: Go in peace into thy house, behold I have heard thy voice, and honoured thy face.

³⁶ And Abigail came to Nabal: and behold he had a feast in his house, like the feast of a king: and Nabal's heart was merry, for he was very drunk: and she told him nothing less or more until morning. ³⁷ But early in the morning, when Nabal had digested his wine, his wife told him these words, and his heart died within him, and he became as a stone. ³⁸ And after ten days had passed, the Lord struck Nabal, and he died. ³⁹ And when David had heard that Nabal was dead, he said: Blessed be the Lord, who hath judged the cause of my reproach, at the hand of Nabal, and hath kept his servant from evil, and the Lord hath returned the wickedness of Nabal upon his head. Then David sent and treated with Abigail, that he might take her to himself for a wife. ⁴⁰ And David's servants came to Abigail, to Carmel, and spoke to her, saying: David hath sent us to thee, to take thee to himself for a wife. ⁴¹ And she arose, and bowed herself down with her face to the earth, and said: Behold, let thy servant be a handmaid, to wash the feet of the servants of my lord. ⁴² And Abigail arose, and made haste, and got upon an ass, and five damsels went with her, her waiting maids, and she followed the messengers of David, and became his wife. ⁴³ Moreover David took also Achinoam of Jezrahel: and they were both of them his wives.

⁴⁴ But Saul gave Michol, his daughter, David's wife, to Phalti, the son of Lais, who was of Gallim.

26 ¹ And the men of Ziph came to Saul in Gabaa, saying: Behold David is hid in the hill of Hachila, which is over against the wilderness. ² And Saul arose, and went down to the wilderness of Ziph having with him three thousand chosen men of Israel, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph. ³ And Saul encamped in Gabaa Hachila, which was over against the wilderness in the way: and David abode in the wilderness. And seeing that Saul was come after him into the wilderness, ⁴ He sent spies, and learned that he was most certainly come thither. ⁵ And David arose secretly, and came to the place where Saul was: and when he had beheld the place, wherein Saul slept, and Abner, the son of Ner, the captain of his army, and Saul sleeping in a tent, and the rest of the multitude round about him,

⁶ David spoke to Achimelech, the Hethite, and Abisai, the son of Sarvia, the brother of Joab, saying: Who will go down with me to Saul into the camp? And Abisai said: I will go with thee. ⁷ So David and Abisai came to the people by night, and found Saul lying and sleeping in the tent, and his spear fixed in the ground at his head: and Abner and the people sleeping round about him. ⁸ And Abisai said to David: God hath shut up thy enemy this day into thy hands: now then I will run him through with my spear, even to the earth at once, and there shall be no need of a second time. ⁹ And David said to Abisai: Kill him not: for who shall put forth his hand against the Lord's anointed, and shall be guiltless? ¹⁰ And David said: As the Lord liveth, unless the Lord shall strike him, or his day shall come to die, or he shall go down to battle, and perish: ¹¹ The Lord be merciful unto me, that I extend not my hand upon the Lord's anointed. But now take the spear, which is at his head, and the cup of water, and let us go. ¹² So David took the spear, and the cup of water which was at Saul's head, and they went away: and no man saw it, or knew it, or awaked, but they were all asleep, for a deep sleep from the Lord was fallen upon them. ¹³ And when David

was gone over to the other side, and stood on the top of the hill afar off, and a good space was between them, ¹⁴ David cried to the people, and to Abner, the son of Ner, saying: Wilt thou not answer, Abner? And Abner answering, said: Who art thou, that criest, and disturbest the king? ¹⁵ And David said to Abner: Art not thou a man? and who is like unto thee in Israel? why then hast thou not kept thy lord the king? for there came one of the people in to kill the king thy lord. ¹⁶ This thing is not good, that thou hast done: as the Lord liveth, you are the sons of death, who have not kept your master, the Lord's anointed. And now where is the king's spear, and the cup of water, which was at his head? ¹⁷ And Saul knew David's voice, and said: Is this thy voice, my son David? And David said: It is my voice, my lord the king. ¹⁸ And he said: Wherefore doth my lord persecute his servant? What have I done? or what evil is there in my hand? ¹⁹ Now therefore hear, I pray thee, my lord the king, the words of thy servant: If the Lord stir thee up against me, let him accept of sacrifice: but if the sons of men, they are cursed in the sight of the Lord, who have cast me out this day, that I should not dwell in the inheritance of the Lord, saying: Go, serve strange gods. ²⁰ And now let not my blood be shed upon the earth before the Lord: for the king of Israel is come out to seek a flea, as the partridge is hunted in the mountains.

²¹ And Saul said: I have sinned; return, my son David, for I will no more do thee harm, because my life hath been precious in thy eyes this day: for it appeareth that I have done foolishly, and have been ignorant in very many things. ²² And David answering, said: Behold the king's spear: let one of the king's servants come over and fetch it. ²³ And the Lord will reward every one according to his justice, and his faithfulness: for the Lord hath delivered thee this day into my hand, and I would not put forth my hand against the Lord's anointed. ²⁴ And as thy life hath been much set by this day in my eyes, so let my life be much set by in the eyes of the Lord, and let him deliver me from all distress. ²⁵ Then Saul said to David: Blessed art thou, my son David: and truly doing thou shalt do, and prevailing thou shalt prevail. And David went on his way, and Saul returned to his place.

151. David among the Philistines; the witch of Endor

1 Samuel 27:1-28:25

27 ¹ And David said in his heart: I shall one day or other fall into the hands of Saul: is it not better for me to flee, and to be saved in the land of the Philistines, that Saul may despair of me, and cease to seek me in all the coasts of Israel? I will flee then out of his hands. ² And David arose, and went away, both he and the six hundred men that were with him, to Achis, the son of Maoch, king of Geth. ³ And David dwelt with Achis at Geth, he and his men; every man with his household, and David with his two wives, Achinoam, the Jezrahelitess, and Abigail, the wife of Nabal of Carmel. ⁴ And it was told Saul that David was fled to Geth, and he sought no more after him.

⁵ And David said to Achis: If I have found favour in thy sight, let a place be given me in one of the cities of this country, that I may dwell there: for why should thy servant dwell in the royal city with thee? ⁶ Then Achis gave him Siceleg that day: for which reason Siceleg belongeth to the kings of Juda unto this day. ⁷ And

the time that David dwelt in the country of the Philistines, was four months.

⁸ And David and his men went up, and pillaged Gessuri, and Gerzi, and the Amalecites: for these were of old the inhabitants of the countries, as men go to Sur, even to the land of Egypt. ⁹ And David wasted all the land, and left neither man nor woman alive: and took away the sheep, and the oxen, and the asses, and the camels, and the apparel, and returned and came to Achis. ¹⁰ And Achis said to him: Whom hast thou gone against to day? David answered: Against the south of Juda, and against the south of Jerameel, and against the south of Ceni. ¹¹ And David saved neither man nor woman, neither brought he any of them to Geth, saying: Lest they should speak against us. So did David, and such was his proceeding all the days that he dwelt in the country of the Philistines. ¹² And Achis believed David, saying: He hath done much harm to his people Israel: Therefore he shall be my servant for ever.

28 ¹ And it came to pass in those days, that the Philistines gathered together their armies, to be prepared for war against Israel: And Achis said to David: Know thou now assuredly, that thou shalt go out with me to the war, thou, and thy men. ² And David said to Achis: Now thou shalt know what thy servant will do. And Achis said to David: And I will appoint thee to guard my life for ever.

³ Now Samuel was dead, and all Israel mourned for him, and buried him in Ramatha, his city. And Saul had put away all the magicians and soothsayers out of the land. ⁴ And the Philistines were gathered together, and came and encamped in Sunam: and Saul also gathered together all Israel, and came to Gelboe. ⁵ And Saul saw the army of the Philistines, and was afraid, and his heart was very much dismayed. ⁶ And he consulted the Lord, and he answered him not, neither by dreams, nor by priests, nor by prophets. ⁷ And Saul said to his servants: Seek me a woman that hath a divining spirit, and I will go to her, and enquire by her. And his servants said to him: There is a woman that hath a divining spirit at Endor. ⁸ Then he disguised himself: and put on other clothes, and he went, and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night, and he said to her: Divine to me by thy divining spirit, and bring me up him whom I shall tell thee. ⁹ And the woman said to him: Behold thou knowest all that Saul hath done, and how he hath rooted out the magicians and soothsayers from the land: why then dost thou lay a snare for my life, to cause me to be put to death? ¹⁰ And Saul swore unto her by the Lord, saying: As the Lord liveth, there shall no evil happen to thee for this thing. ¹¹ And the woman said to him: Whom shall I bring up to thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel. ¹² And when the woman saw Samuel, she cried out with a loud voice, and said to Saul: Why hast thou deceived me? for thou art Saul. ¹³ And the king said to her: Fear not: what hast thou seen? and the woman said to Saul: I saw gods ascending out of the earth. ¹⁴ And he said to her: What form is he of? And she said: An old man cometh up, and he is covered with a mantle. And Saul understood that it was Samuel, and he bowed himself with his face to the ground, and adored.

¹⁵ And Samuel said to Saul: Why hast thou disturbed my rest, that I should be brought up? And Saul said: I am in great distress: for the Philistines fight against me, and God is departed from

me, and would not hear me, neither by the hand of prophets, nor by dreams: therefore I have called thee, that thou mayst shew me what I shall do. ¹⁶ And Samuel said: Why askest thou me, seeing the Lord has departed from thee, and is gone over to thy rival? ¹⁷ For the Lord will do to thee as he spoke by me, and he will rend thy kingdom out of thy hand, and will give it to thy neighbour David: ¹⁸ Because thou didst not obey the voice of the Lord, neither didst thou execute the wrath of his indignation upon Amalec. Therefore hath the Lord done to thee what thou sufferest this day. ¹⁹ And the Lord also will deliver Israel with thee into the hands of the Philistines: and to morrow thou and thy sons shall be with me: and the Lord will also deliver the army of Israel into the hands of the Philistines.

²⁰ And forthwith Saul fell all along on the ground; for he was frightened with the words of Samuel, and there was no strength in him, for he had eaten no bread all that day.

²¹ And the woman came to Saul, (for he was very much troubled) and said to him: Behold thy handmaid hath obeyed thy voice, and I have put my life in my hand: and I hearkened unto the words which thou spakest to me. ²² Now therefore, I pray thee, hearken thou also to the voice of thy handmaid, and let me set before thee a morsel of bread, that thou mayst eat and recover strength, and be able to go on thy journey. ²³ But he refused, and said: I will not eat. But his servants and the woman forced him, and at length hearkening to their voice, he arose from the ground, and sat upon the bed. ²⁴ Now the woman had a fatted calf in the house, and she made haste and killed it: and taking meal, kneaded it, and baked some unleavened bread, ²⁵ And set it before Saul, and before his servants. And when they had eaten they rose up, and walked all that night.

152. Siceleg burned and recovered

1 Samuel 29:1-30:31

29 ¹ Now all the troops of the Philistines were gathered together to Aphec: and Israel also encamped by the fountain, which is in Jezrahel. ² And the lords of the Philistines marched with their hundreds and their thousands: but David and his men were in the rear with Achis. ³ And the princes of the Philistines said to Achis: What mean these Hebrews? And Achis said to the princes of the Philistines: Do you not know David who was the servant of Saul, the king of Israel, and hath been with me many days, or years, and I have found no fault in him, since the day that he fled over to me until this day? ⁴ But the princes of the Philistines were angry with him, and they said to him: Let this man return, and abide in his place, which thou hast appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, lest he be an adversary to us, when we shall begin to fight: for how can he otherwise appease his master, but with our heads? ⁵ Is not this David, to whom they sung in their dances, saying: Saul slew his thousands, and David his ten thousands?

⁶ Then Achis called David, and said to him: As the Lord liveth, thou art upright and good in my sight: and so is thy going out, and thy coming in with me in the army: and I have not found any evil in thee, since the day that thou camest to me unto this day: but thou pleasest not the lords. ⁷ Return therefore, and go in peace, and offend not the eyes of the princes of the Philistines.

⁸ And David said to Achis: But what have I done, or what hast thou found in me thy servant, from the day that I have been

in thy sight until this day, that I may not go and fight against the enemies of my lord the king? ⁹ And Achis answering, said to David: I know that thou art good in my sight, as an angel of God: But the princes of the Philistines have said: He shall not go up with us to the battle. ¹⁰ Therefore arise in the morning, thou, and the servants of thy lord, who came with thee: and when you are up before day, and it shall begin to be light, go on your way. ¹¹ So David and his men arose in the night, that they might set forward in the morning, and returned to the land of the Philistines: and the Philistines went up to Jezrahel.

30 ¹ Now when David and his men were come to Siceleg on the third day, the Amalecites had made an invasion on the south side upon Siceleg, and had smitten Siceleg, and burnt it with fire, ² And had taken the women captives that were in it, both little and great: and they had not killed any person, but had carried them with them, and went on their way. ³ So when David and his men came to the city, and found it burnt with fire, and that their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captives, ⁴ David and the people that were with him, lifted up their voices, and wept till they had no more tears. ⁵ For the two wives also of David were taken captives, Achinoam, the Jezrahelitess, and Abigail, the wife of Nabal of Carmel. ⁶ And David was greatly afflicted: for the people had a mind to stone him, for the soul of every man was bitterly grieved for his sons and daughters: but David took courage in the Lord his God. ⁷ And he said to Abiathar, the priest, the son of Achimelech: Bring me hither the ephod. And Abiathar brought the ephod to David. ⁸ And David consulted the Lord, saying: Shall I pursue after these robbers, and shall I overtake them, or not? And the Lord said to him: Pursue after them: for thou shalt surely overtake them and recover the prey. ⁹ So David went, he and the six hundred men that were with him, and they came to the torrent Besor: and some, being weary, stayed there. ¹⁰ But David pursued, he and four hundred men: for two hundred stayed, who, being weary, could not go over the torrent Besor. ¹¹ And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David: and they gave him bread to eat, and water to drink, ¹² As also a piece of a cake of figs, and two bunches of raisins. And when he had eaten them, his spirit returned, and he was refreshed: for he had not eaten bread, nor drunk water, three days and three nights. ¹³ And David said to him: To whom dost thou belong; or whence dost thou come? and whither art thou going? He said: I am a young man of Egypt, the servant of an Amalecite: and my master left me, because I began to be sick three days ago. ¹⁴ For we made an invasion on the south side of Cerethi, and upon Juda, and upon the south of Caleb, and we burnt Siceleg with fire. ¹⁵ And David said to him: Canst thou bring me to this company? and he said: Swear to me by God, that thou wilt not kill me, nor deliver me into the hands of my master, and I will bring thee to this company. And David swore to him.

¹⁶ And when he had brought him, behold they were lying spread abroad upon all the ground, eating and drinking, and as it were keeping a festival day, for all the prey and the spoils which they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Juda. ¹⁷ And David slew them from the evening unto the evening of the next day, and there escaped not a man of them, but four hundred young men, who had gotten upon camels, and

fled. ¹⁸ So David recovered all that the Amalecites had taken, and he rescued his two wives. ¹⁹ And there was nothing missing small or great, neither of their sons or their daughters, nor of the spoils, and whatsoever they had taken, David recovered all. ²⁰ And he took all the flocks and the herds, and made them go before him: and they said: This is the prey of David.

²¹ And David came to the two hundred men, who, being weary, had stayed, and were not able to follow David, and he had ordered them to abide at the torrent Besor: and they came out to meet David, and the people that were with him. And David coming to the people, saluted them peaceably. ²² Then all the wicked and unjust men, that had gone with David, answering, said: Because they came not with us, we will not give them any thing of the prey which we have recovered: but let every man take his wife, and his children, and be contented with them, and go his way. ²³ But David said: You shall not do so, my brethren, with these things, which the Lord hath given us, who hath kept us, and hath delivered the robbers that invaded us into our hands: ²⁴ And no man shall hearken to you in this matter. But equal shall be the portion of him that went down to battle, and of him that abode at the baggage, and they shall divide alike. ²⁵ And this hath been done from that day forward, and since was made a statute and an ordinance, and as a law in Israel.

²⁶ Then David came to Siceleg, and sent presents of the prey to the ancients of Juda, his neighbours, saying: Receive a blessing of the prey of the enemies of the Lord. ²⁷ To them that were in Bethel, and that were in Ramoth to the south, and to them that were in Jether. ²⁸ And to them that were in Aroer, and that were in Sephamoth, and that were in Esthamo, ²⁹ And that were in Rachal, and that were in the cities of Jerameel, and that were in the cities of Ceni, ³⁰ And that were in Arama, and that were in the lake Asan, and that were in Athach, ³¹ And that were in Hebron, and to the rest that were in those places, in which David had abode with his men.

153. The death of Saul on Gelboe

1 Samuel 31:1-13

31 ¹ And the Philistines fought against Israel, and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain in mount Gelboe. ² And the Philistines fell upon Saul, and upon his sons, and they slew Jonathan, and Abinadab, and Melchisua, the sons of Saul. ³ And the whole weight of the battle was turned upon Saul: and the archers overtook him, and he was grievously wounded by the archers. ⁴ Then Saul said to his armourbearer: Draw thy sword, and kill me: lest these uncircumcised come, and slay me, and mock at me. And his armourbearer would not: for he was struck with exceeding great fear. Then Saul took his sword, and fell upon it. ⁵ And when his armourbearer saw this, to wit, that Saul was dead, he also fell upon his sword and died with him. ⁶ So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armourbearer, and all his men that same day together.

⁷ And the men of Israel, that were beyond the valley, and beyond the Jordan, seeing that the Israelites were fled, and that Saul was dead, and his sons, forsook their cities, and fled: and the Philistines came and dwelt there. ⁸ And on the morrow the Philistines came to strip the slain, and they found Saul and his three sons lying in mount Gelboe. ⁹ And they cut off Saul's head, and stripped him of his armour, and sent into the land of the

Philistines round about, to publish it in the temples of their idols and among their people. ¹⁰ And they put his armour in the temple of Astaroth, but his body they hung on the wall of Bethsan. ¹¹ Now when the inhabitants of Jabes Galaad had heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul, ¹² All the most valiant men arose, and walked all the night, and took the body of Saul, and the bodies of his sons, from the wall of Bethsan: and they came to Jabes Galaad, and burnt them there. ¹³ And they took their bones, and buried them in the wood of Jabes: and fasted seven days.

154. The lament for Saul and Jonathan

2 Samuel 1:1-27

Douay-Rheims title: the Second Book of Samuel, otherwise called the Second Book of Kings.

1 ¹ Now it came to pass, after Saul was dead, that David returned from the slaughter of the Amalecites, and abode two days in Siceleg. ² And on the third day, there appeared a man who came out of Saul's camp, with his garments rent, and dust strewed on his head: and when he came to David, he fell upon his face, and adored. ³ And David said to him: From whence comest thou? And he said to him: I am fled out of the camp of Israel. ⁴ And David said unto him: What is the matter that is come to pass? tell me: He said: The people are fled from the battle, and many of the people are fallen and dead: moreover Saul and Jonathan his son are slain. ⁵ And David said to the young man that told him: How knowest thou that Saul and Jonathan his son, are dead? ⁶ And the young man that told him, said: I came by chance upon mount Gelboe, and Saul leaned upon his spear: and the chariots and horsemen drew nigh unto him, ⁷ And looking behind him, and seeing me, he called me. And I answered, Here am I. ⁸ And he said to me: Who art thou? And I said to him: I am an Amalecite. ⁹ And he said to me: Stand over me, and kill me: for anguish is come upon me, and as yet my whole life is in me. ¹⁰ So standing over him, I killed him: for I knew that he could not live after the fall: and I took the diadem that was on his head, and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them hither to thee, my lord.

¹¹ Then David took hold of his garments and rent them, and likewise all the men that were with him. ¹² And they mourned, and wept, and fasted until evening for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of the Lord, and for the house of Israel, because they were fallen by the sword.

¹³ And David said to the young man that told him: Whence art thou? He answered: I am the son of a stranger of Amalec. ¹⁴ David said to him: Why didst thou not fear to put out thy hand to kill the Lord's anointed? ¹⁵ And David calling one of his servants, said: Go near and fall upon him. And he struck him so that he died. ¹⁶ And David said to him: Thy blood be upon thy own head: for thy own mouth hath spoken against thee, saying: I have slain the Lord's anointed.

¹⁷ And David made this kind of lamentation over Saul, and over Jonathan his son. ¹⁸ (Also he commanded that they should teach the children of Juda the use of the bow, as it is written in the book of the just.) And he said: Consider, O Israel, for them that are dead, wounded on thy high places. ¹⁹ The illustrious of Israel are slain upon thy mountains: how are the valiant fallen?

²⁰ Tell it not in Geth, publish it not in the streets of Ascalon: lest the daughters of the Philistines rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised triumph. ²¹ Ye mountains of Gelboe, let neither dew, nor rain come upon you, neither be they fields of firstfruits: for there was cast away the shield of the valiant, the shield of Saul as though he had not been anointed with oil. ²² From the blood of the slain, from the fat of the valiant, the arrow of Jonathan never turned back, and the sword of Saul did not return empty. ²³ Saul and Jonathan, lovely, and comely in their life, even in death they were not divided: they were swifter than eagles, stronger than lions. ²⁴ Ye daughters of Israel, weep over Saul, who clothed you with scarlet in delights, who gave ornaments of gold for your attire. ²⁵ How are the valiant fallen in battle? Jonathan slain in the high places? ²⁶ I grieve for thee, my brother Jonathan: exceeding beautiful, and amiable to me above the love of women. As the mother loveth her only son, so did I love thee. ²⁷ How are the valiant fallen, and the weapons of war perished?

155. Hebron, Abner, and the murder of Isboseth

2 Samuel 2:1-4:12

2 ¹ And after these things David consulted the Lord, saying: Shall I go up into one of the cities of Juda? And the Lord said to him: Go up. And David said: Whither shall I go up? And he answered him: Into Hebron. ² So David went up, and his two wives Achinoam the Jezrahelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal of Carmel: ³ And the men also that were with him, David brought up every man with his household: and they abode in the towns of Hebron. ⁴ And the men of Juda came, and anointed David there, to be king over the house of Juda. And it was told David that the men of Jabes Galaad had buried Saul. ⁵ David therefore sent messengers to the men of Jabes Galaad, and said to them: Blessed be you to the Lord, who have shewn this mercy to your master Saul, and have buried him. ⁶ And now the Lord surely will render you mercy and truth, and I also will requite you for this good turn, because you have done this thing. ⁷ Let your hands be strengthened, and be ye men of valour: for although your master Saul be dead, yet the house of Juda hath anointed me to be their king.

⁸ But Abner the son of Ner, general of Saul's army, took Isboseth the son of Saul, and led him about through the camp, ⁹ And made him king over Galaad, and over Gessuri, and over Jezrahel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and over all Israel. ¹⁰ Isboseth the son of Saul was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years; and only the house of Juda followed David. ¹¹ And the number of the days that David abode, reigning in Hebron over the house of Juda, was seven years and six months.

¹² And Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Isboseth the son of Saul, went out from the camp to Gabaon. ¹³ And Joab the son of Sarvia, and the servants of David went out, and met them by the pool of Gabaon. And when they were come together, they sat down over against one another: the one on the one side of the pool, and the other on the other side. ¹⁴ And Abner said to Joab: Let the young men rise, and play before us. And Joab answered: Let them rise. ¹⁵ Then there arose and went over twelve in number of Benjamin, of the part of Isboseth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David. ¹⁶ And every one

catching his fellow by the head, thrust his sword into the side of his adversary, and they fell down together: and the name of the place was called: The field of the valiant, in Gabaon. ¹⁷ And there was a very fierce battle that day: and Abner was put to flight, with the men of Israel, by the servants of David. ¹⁸ And there were the three sons of Sarvia there, Joab, and Abisai, and Asael: now Asael was a most swift runner, like one of the roes that abide in the woods. ¹⁹ And Asael pursued after Abner, and turned not to the right hand nor to the left from following Abner. ²⁰ And Abner looked behind him, and said: Art thou Asael? And he answered: I am. ²¹ And Abner said to him: Go to the right hand or to the left, and lay hold on one of the young men and take thee his spoils. But Asael would not leave off following him close. ²² And again Abner said to Asael: Go off, and do not follow me, lest I be obliged to stab thee to the ground, and I shall not be able to hold up my face to Joab thy brother. ²³ But he refused to hearken to him, and would not turn aside: wherefore Abner struck him with his spear with a back stroke in the groin, and thrust him through, and he died upon the spot: and all that came to the place where Asael fell down and died stood still. ²⁴ Now while Joab and Abisai pursued after Abner, the sun went down: and they came as far as the hill of the aqueduct, that lieth over against the valley by the way of the wilderness in Gabaon. ²⁵ And the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together to Abner: and being joined in one body, they stood on the top of a hill. ²⁶ And Abner cried out to Joab, and said: Shall thy sword rage unto utter destruction? knowest thou not that it is dangerous to drive people to despair? how long dost thou defer to bid the people cease from pursuing after their brethren? ²⁷ And Joab said: As the Lord liveth, if thou hadst spoke sooner, even in the morning the people should have retired from pursuing after their brethren. ²⁸ Then Joab sounded the trumpet, and all the army stood still, and did not pursue after Israel any farther, nor fight any more. ²⁹ And Abner and his men walked all that night through the plains: and they passed the Jordan, and having gone through all Beth-horon, came to the camp. ³⁰ And Joab returning, after he had left Abner, assembled all the people: and there were wanting of David's servants nineteen men, beside Asael. ³¹ But the servants of David had killed of Benjamin, and of the men that were with Abner, three hundred and sixty, who all died. ³² And they took Asael, and buried him in the sepulchre of his father in Bethlehem and Joab, and the men that were with him, marched all the night, and they came to Hebron at break of day.

3 ¹ Now there was a long war between the house of Saul and the house of David: David prospering and growing always stronger and stronger, but the house of Saul decaying daily. ² And sons were born to David in Hebron: and his firstborn was Amnon of Achinoam the Jezrahelitess: ³ And his second Cheleab of Abigail the wife of Nabal of Carmel: and the third Absalom the son of Maacha the daughter of Tholmai king of Gessur: ⁴ And the fourth Adonias, the son of Haggith: and the fifth Saphathia the son of Abital: ⁵ And the sixth Jethraam of Egla the wife of David: these were born to David in Hebron.

⁶ Now while there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, Abner the son of Ner ruled the house of Saul. ⁷ And Saul had a concubine named Respha, the daughter of Aia. And Isboseth said to Abner: ⁸ Why didst thou go in to

my father's concubine? And he was exceedingly angry for the words of Isboseth, and said: Am I a dog's head against Juda this day, who have shewn mercy to the house of Saul thy father, and to his brethren and friends, and have not delivered thee into the hands of David, and hast thou sought this day against me to charge me with a matter concerning a woman? ⁹ So do God to Abner, and more also, unless as the Lord hath sworn to David, so I do to him, ¹⁰ That the kingdom be translated from the house of Saul, and the throne of David be set up over Israel, and over Juda from Dan to Bersabee. ¹¹ And he could not answer him a word, because he feared him.

¹² Abner therefore sent messengers to David for himself, saying: Whose is the land? and that they should say: Make a league with me, and my hand shall be with thee: and I will bring all Israel to thee.

¹³ And he said: Very well: I will make a league with thee: but one thing I require of thee, saying: Thou shalt not see my face before thou bring Michol the daughter of Saul: and so thou shalt come, and see me. ¹⁴ And David sent messengers to Isboseth the son of Saul, saying: Restore my wife Michol, whom I espoused to me for a hundred foreskins of the Philistines. ¹⁵ And Isboseth sent, and took her from her husband Phaltiel, the son of Lais. ¹⁶ And her husband followed her, weeping as far as Bahurim: and Abner said to him: Go and return. And he returned.

¹⁷ Abner also spoke to the ancients of Israel, saying: Both yesterday and the day before you sought for David that he might reign over you. ¹⁸ Now then do it: because the Lord hath spoken to David, saying: By the hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel from the hands of the Philistines, and of all their enemies. ¹⁹ And Abner spoke also to Benjamin. And he went to speak to David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel, and to all Benjamin. ²⁰ And he came to David in Hebron with twenty men: and David made a feast for Abner, and his men that came with him. ²¹ And Abner said to David: I will rise, that I may gather all Israel unto thee my lord the king, and may enter into a league with thee, and that thou mayst reign over all as thy soul desireth. Now when David had brought Abner on his way, and he was gone in peace,

²² Immediately, David's servants and Joab came, after having slain the robbers, with an exceeding great booty. And Abner was not with David in Hebron, for he had now sent him away, and he was gone in peace. ²³ And Joab and all the army that was with him, came afterwards: and it was told Joab, that Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he hath sent him away, and he is gone in peace. ²⁴ And Joab went in to the king, and said: What hast thou done? Behold Abner came to thee: Why didst thou send him away, and he is gone and departed? ²⁵ Knowest thou not Abner the son of Ner, that to this end he came to thee, that he might deceive thee, and to know thy going out, and thy coming in, and to know all thou dost? ²⁶ Then Joab going out from David, sent messengers after Abner, and brought him back from the cistern of Sira, David knowing nothing of it. ²⁷ And when Abner was returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside to the middle of the gate, to speak to him treacherously: and he stabbed him there in the groin, and he died, in revenge of the blood of Asael his brother. ²⁸ And when David heard of it, after the thing was now done, he said: I, and my kingdom are innocent before

the Lord for ever of the blood of Abner the son of Ner: ²⁹ And may it come upon the head of Joab, and upon all his father's house: and let there not fail from the house of Joab one that hath an issue of seed, or that is a leper, or that holdeth the distaff, or that falleth by the sword, or that wanteth bread. ³⁰ So Joab and Abisai his brother slew Abner, because he had killed their brother Asael at Gabaon in the battle.

³¹ And David said to Joab, and to all the people that were with him: Rend your garments, and gird yourselves with sackcloths, and mourn before the funeral of Abner. And king David himself followed the bier. ³² And when they had buried Abner in Hebron, king David lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abner: and all the people also wept. ³³ And the king mourning and lamenting over Abner, said: Not as cowards are wont to die, hath Abner died. ³⁴ Thy hands were not bound, nor thy feet laden with fetters: but as men fall before the children of iniquity, so didst thou fall. And all the people repeating it wept over him. ³⁵ And when all the people came to take meat with David, while it was yet broad day, David swore, saying: So do God to me, and more also, if I taste bread or any thing else before sunset. ³⁶ And all the people heard, and they were pleased, and all that the king did seemed good in the sight of all the people. ³⁷ And all the people, and all Israel understood that day that it was not the king's doing, that Abner the son of Ner was slain. ³⁸ The king also said to his servants: Do you not know that a prince and a great man is slain this day in Israel? ³⁹ But I as yet am tender, though anointed king. And these men the sons of Sarvia are too hard for me: the Lord reward him that doth evil according to his wickedness.

4 ¹ And Isboseth the son of Saul heard that Abner was slain in Hebron: and his hands were weakened, and all Israel was troubled. ² Now the son of Saul had two men captains of his bands, the name of the one was Baana, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Remmon a Berothite of the children of Benjamin: for Beroth also was reckoned in Benjamin. ³ And the Berothites fled into Gethaim, and were sojourners there until that time. ⁴ And Jonathan the son of Saul had a son that was lame of his feet: for he was five years old when the tidings came of Saul and Jonathan from Jezrahel. And his nurse took him up and fled: and as she made haste to flee, he fell and became lame: and his name was Miphiboseth. ⁵ And the sons of Remmon the Berothite, Rechab and Baana coming, went into the house of Isboseth in the heat of the day: and he was sleeping upon his bed at noon. And the doorkeeper of the house, who was cleansing wheat, was fallen asleep. ⁶ And they entered into the house secretly taking ears of corn, and Rechab and Baana his brother stabbed him in the groin, and fled away. ⁷ For when they came into the house, he was sleeping upon his bed in a parlour, and they struck him and killed him and taking away his head they went off by the way of the wilderness, walking all night. ⁸ And they brought the head of Isboseth to David to Hebron: and they said to the king: Behold the head of Isboseth the son of Saul thy enemy who sought thy life: and the Lord hath revenged my lord the king this day of Saul, and of his seed.

⁹ But David answered Rechab, and Baana his brother, the sons of Remmon the Berothite, and said to them: As the Lord liveth, who hath delivered my soul out of all distress, ¹⁰ The man that

told me, and said: Saul is dead, who thought he brought good tidings, I apprehended, and slew him in Siceleg, who should have been rewarded for his news. ¹¹ How much more now when wicked men have slain an innocent man in his own house, upon his bed, shall I not require his blood at your hand, and take you away from the earth? ¹² And David commanded his servants and they slew them: and cutting off their hands and feet, hanged them up over the pool in Hebron: but the head of Isboseth they took and buried in the sepulchre of Abner in Hebron.

156. King over all Israel; Jerusalem taken

2 Samuel 5:1-25

5 ¹ Then all the tribes of Israel came to David in Hebron, saying: Behold we are thy bone and thy flesh. ² Moreover yesterday also and the day before, when Saul was king over us, thou wast he that did lead out and bring in Israel: and the Lord said to thee: Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be prince over Israel. ³ The ancients also of Israel came to the king of Hebron, and king David made a league with them in Hebron before the Lord: and they anointed David to be king over Israel.

⁴ David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years. ⁵ In Hebron he reigned over Juda seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned three and thirty years over all Israel and Juda.

⁶ And the king and all the men that were with him went to Jerusalem to the Jebusites the inhabitants of the land: and they said to David: Thou shalt not come in hither unless thou take away the blind and the lame that say: David shall not come in hither. ⁷ But David took the castle of Sion, the same is the city of David. ⁸ For David had offered that day a reward to whosoever should strike the Jebusites and get up to the gutters of the tops of the houses, and take away the blind and the lame that hated the soul of David: therefore it is said in the proverb: The blind and the lame shall not come into the temple. ⁹ And David dwelt in the castle, and called it, The city of David: and built round about from Mello and inwards. ¹⁰ And he went on prospering and growing up, and the Lord God of hosts was with him. ¹¹ And Hiram the king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar trees, and carpenters, and masons for walls: and they built a house for David. ¹² And David knew that the Lord had confirmed him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom over his people Israel.

¹³ And David took more concubines and wives of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron: and there were born to David other sons also and daughters: ¹⁴ And these are the names of them, that were born to him in Jerusalem, Samua, and Sobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, ¹⁵ And Jebahar, and Elisua, and Nepheg, ¹⁶ And Japhia, and Elisama, and Elioda, and Eliphalet.

¹⁷ And the Philistines heard that they had anointed David to be king over Israel: and they all came to seek David: and when David heard of it, he went down to a strong hold. ¹⁸ And the Philistines coming spread themselves in the valley of Raphaim. ¹⁹ And David consulted the Lord, saying: Shall I go up to the Philistines? and wilt thou deliver them into my hand? And the Lord said to David: Go up, for I will surely deliver the Philistines into thy hand. ²⁰ And David came to Baal Pharisim: and defeated them there, and he said, The Lord hath divided my enemies before me, as waters are divided. Therefore the name of the

place was called Baal Pharisim. ²¹ And they left there their idols: which David and his men took away.

²² And the Philistines came up again and spread themselves into the valley of Raphaim. ²³ And David consulted the Lord: Shall I go up against the Philistines, and wilt thou deliver them into my hands? He answered: Go not up against them but fetch a compass behind them, and thou shalt come upon them over against the pear trees. ²⁴ And when thou shalt hear the sound of one going in the tops of the pear trees, then shalt thou join battle: for then will the Lord go out before thy face to strike the army of the Philistines. ²⁵ And David did as the Lord had commanded him, and he smote the Philistines from Gabaa until thou come to Gezer.

157. *The ark brought up*

2 Samuel 6:1-23

6 ¹ And David again gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand. ² And David arose and went, with all the people that were with him of the men of Juda to fetch the ark of God, upon which the name of the Lord of Hosts is invoked, who sitteth over it upon the cherubims. ³ And they laid the ark of God upon a new cart: and took it out of the house of Abinadab, who was in Gabaa, and Oza and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drove the new cart. ⁴ And when they had taken it out of the house of Abinadab, who was in Gabaa, Ahio having care of the ark of God went before the ark. ⁵ But David and all Israel played before the Lord on all manner of instruments made of wood, on harps and lutes and timbrels and cornets and cymbals.

⁶ And when they came to the floor of Nachon, Oza put forth his hand to the ark of God, and took hold of it: because the oxen kicked and made it lean aside. ⁷ And the indignation of the Lord was enkindled against Oza, and he struck him for his rashness: and he died there before the ark of God. ⁸ And David was grieved because the Lord had struck Oza, and the name of that place was called: The striking of Oza, to this day. ⁹ And David was afraid of the Lord that day, saying: How shall the ark of the Lord come to me? ¹⁰ And he would not have the ark of the Lord brought in to himself into the city of David: but he caused it to be carried into the house of Obedom the Gethite. ¹¹ And the ark of the Lord abode in the house of Obedom the Gethite three months: and the Lord blessed Obedom, and all his household. ¹² And it was told king David, that the Lord had blessed Obedom, and all that he had, because of the ark of God. So David went, and brought away the ark of God out of the house of Obedom into the city of David with joy. And there were with David seven choirs, and calves for victims. ¹³ And when they that carried the ark of the Lord had gone six paces, he sacrificed an ox and a ram: ¹⁴ And David danced with all his might before the Lord: and David was girded with a linen ephod. ¹⁵ And David and all the house of Israel brought the ark of the covenant of the Lord with joyful shouting, and with sound of trumpet. ¹⁶ And when the ark of the Lord was come into the city of David, Michol the daughter of Saul, looking out through a window, saw king David leaping and dancing before the Lord: and she despised him in her heart. ¹⁷ And they brought the ark of the Lord, and set it in its place in the midst of the tabernacle, which David had pitched for it: and David offered holocausts, and peace offerings before the Lord. ¹⁸ And when he had made an end of offering holocausts

and peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of the Lord of hosts. ¹⁹ And he distributed to all the multitude of Israel, both men and women, to every one, a cake of bread, and a piece of roasted beef, and fine flour fried with oil: and all the people departed every one to his own house.

²⁰ And David returned to bless his own house: and Michol the daughter of Saul coming out to meet David, said: How glorious was the king of Israel to day, uncovering himself before the handmaids of his servants, and was naked, as if one of the buffoons should be naked. ²¹ And David said to Michol: Before the Lord, who chose me rather than thy father, and than all his house, and commanded me to be ruler over the people of the Lord in Israel, ²² I will both play and make myself meaner than I have done: and I will be little in my own eyes: and with the handmaids of whom thou speakest, I shall appear more glorious. ²³ Therefore Michol the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death.

158. *"Thy house shall be faithful for ever"*

2 Samuel 7:1-29

The Davidic covenant. The angel's words at the Annunciation, read later in this plan, are its direct answer.

7 ¹ And it came to pass when the king sat in his house, and the Lord had given him rest on every side from all his enemies, ² He said to Nathan the prophet: Dost thou see that I dwell in a house of cedar, and the ark of God is lodged within skins? ³ And Nathan said to the king: Go, do all that is in thy heart: because the Lord is with thee.

⁴ But it came to pass that night, that the word of the Lord came to Nathan, saying: ⁵ Go, and say to my servant David: Thus saith the Lord: Shalt thou build me a house to dwell in? ⁶ Whereas I have not dwelt in a house from the day that I brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt even to this day: but have walked in a tabernacle, and in a tent. ⁷ In all the places that I have gone through with all the children of Israel, did ever I speak a word to any one of the tribes of Israel, whom I commanded to feed my people Israel, saying: Why have you not built me a house of cedar? ⁸ And now thus shalt thou speak to my servant David: Thus saith the Lord of hosts: I took thee out of the pastures from following the sheep to be ruler over my people Israel: ⁹ And I have been with thee wheresoever thou hast walked, and have slain all thy enemies from before thy face: and I have made thee a great man, like unto the name of the great ones that are on the earth. ¹⁰ And I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and I will plant them, and they shall dwell therein, and shall be disturbed no more: neither shall the children of iniquity afflict them any more as they did before, ¹¹ From the day that I appointed judges over my people Israel: and I will give thee rest from all thy enemies. And the Lord foretelleth to thee, that the Lord will make thee a house. ¹² And when thy days shall be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will raise up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. ¹³ He shall build a house to my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom for ever. ¹⁴ I will be to him a father, and he shall be to me a son: and if he commit any iniquity, I will correct him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men. ¹⁵ But my mercy I will not

take away from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I removed from before my face. ¹⁶ And thy house shall be faithful, and thy kingdom for ever before thy face, and thy throne shall be firm for ever. ¹⁷ According to all these words and according to all this vision so did Nathan speak to David.

¹⁸ And David went in, and sat before the Lord, and said: Who am I, O Lord God, and what is my house, that thou hast brought me thus far? ¹⁹ But yet this hath seemed little in thy sight, O Lord God, unless thou didst also speak of the house of thy servant for a long time to come: for this is the law of Adam, O Lord God: ²⁰ And what can David say more unto thee? for thou knowest thy servant, O Lord God: ²¹ For thy word's sake, and according to thy own heart thou has done all these great things, so that thou wouldst make it known to thy servant. ²² Therefore thou art magnified, O Lord God, because there is none like to thee, neither is there any God besides thee, in all the things that we have heard with our ears. ²³ And what nation is there upon earth, as thy people Israel, whom God went to redeem for a people to himself, and to make him a name, and to do for them great and terrible things, upon the earth, before the face of thy people, whom thou redeemedst to thyself out of Egypt, from the nations and their gods. ²⁴ For thou hast confirmed to thyself thy people Israel to be an everlasting people: and thou, O Lord God, art become their God. ²⁵ And now, O Lord God, raise up for ever the word that thou hast spoken, concerning thy servant and concerning his house: and do as thou hast spoken, ²⁶ That thy name may be magnified for ever, and it may be said: The Lord of hosts is God over Israel. And the house of thy servant David shall be established before the Lord. ²⁷ Because thou, O Lord of hosts, God of Israel, hast revealed to the ear of thy servant, saying: I will build thee a house: therefore hath thy servant found in his heart to pray this prayer to thee. ²⁸ And now, O Lord God, thou art God, and thy words shall be true: for thou hast spoken to thy servant these good things. ²⁹ And now begin, and bless the house of thy servant, that it may endure for ever before thee: because thou, O Lord God, hast spoken it, and with thy blessing let the house of thy servant be blessed for ever.

159. The wars of David; kindness to Miphiboseth

2 Samuel 8:1-10:19

8 ¹ And it came to pass after this that David defeated the Philistines, and brought them down, and David took the tribute of tribute out of the hand of the Philistines, ² And he defeated Moab, and measured them with a line, casting them down to the earth: and he measured with two lines, one to put to death, and one to save alive: and Moab was made to serve David under tribute.

³ David defeated also Adarezer the son of Rohob king of Soba, when he went to extend his dominion over the river Euphrates.

⁴ And David took from him a thousand and seven hundred horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen, and houghed all the chariot horses: and only reserved of them for one hundred chariots.

⁵ And the Syrians of Damascus came to succour Adarezer the king of Soba: and David slew of the Syrians two and twenty thousand men. ⁶ And David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus: and Syria served David under tribute, and the Lord preserved David in all his enterprises, whithersoever he went. ⁷ And David took the arms of gold, which the servants of Adarezer wore and

brought them to Jerusalem. ⁸ And out of Bete, and out of Beroth, cities of Adarezer, king David took an exceeding great quantity of brass.

⁹ And Thou the king of Emath heard that David had defeated all the forces of Adarezer. ¹⁰ And Thou sent Joram his son to king David, to salute him, and to congratulate with him, and to return him thanks: because he had fought against Adarezer, and had defeated him. For Thou was an enemy to Adarezer, and in his hand were vessels of gold, and vessels of silver, and vessels of brass: ¹¹ And king David dedicated them to the Lord, together with the silver and gold that he had dedicated of all the nations, which he had subdued: ¹² Of Syria, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalec, and of the spoils of Adarezer the son of Rohob king of Soba. ¹³ David also made himself a name, when he returned after taking Syria in the valley of the saltpits, killing eighteen thousand: ¹⁴ And he put guards in Edom, and placed there a garrison: and all Edom was made to serve David: and the Lord preserved David in all enterprises he went about.

¹⁵ And David reigned over all Israel: and David did judgment and justice to all his people. ¹⁶ And Joab the son of Sarvia was over the army: and Josaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder: ¹⁷ And Sadoc the son of Achitob, and Achimelech the son of Abiathar, were the priests: and Saraias was the scribe: ¹⁸ And Banaias the son of Joiada was over the Cerethi and Phelethi: and the sons of David were the princes.

9 ¹ And David said: Is there any one, think you, left of the house of Saul, that I may shew kindness to him for Jonathan's sake? ² Now there was of the house of Saul, a servant named Siba: and when the king had called him to him, he said to him: Art thou Siba? And he answered: I am Siba thy servant. ³ And the king said: Is there any one left of the house of Saul, that I may shew the mercy of God unto him? And Siba said to the king: There is a son of Jonathan left, who is lame of his feet. ⁴ Where is he? said he. And Siba said to the king: Behold he is in the house of Machir the son of Ammiel in Lodabar.

⁵ Then King David sent, and brought him out of the house of Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodabar. ⁶ And when Miphiboseth the son of Jonathan the son of Saul was come to David, he fell on his face and worshipped. And David said: Miphiboseth? And he answered: Behold thy servant.

⁷ And David said to him: Fear not, for I will surely shew thee mercy for Jonathan thy father's sake, and I will restore the lands of Saul thy father, and thou shalt eat bread at my table always.

⁸ He bowed down to him, and said: Who am I thy servant, that thou shouldst look upon such a dead dog as I am?

⁹ Then the King called Siba the servant of Saul, and said to him: All that belonged to Saul, and all his house, I have given to thy master's son. ¹⁰ Thou therefore and thy sons and thy servants shall till the land for him: and thou shalt bring in food for thy master's son, that he may be maintained: and Miphiboseth the son of thy master shall always eat bread at my table. And Siba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. ¹¹ And Siba said to the king: As thou my lord the king hast commanded thy servant, so will thy servant do: and Miphiboseth shall eat at my table, as one of the sons of the King. ¹² And Miphiboseth had a young son whose name was Micha: and all that kindred of the house of

Siba served Miphiboseth. ¹³ But Miphiboseth dwelt in Jerusalem: because he ate always of the king's table: and he was lame of both feet.

10 ¹ And it came to pass after this, that the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanon his son reigned in his stead. ² And David said: I will shew kindness to Hanon the son of Daas, as his father shewed kindness to me. So David sent his servants to comfort him for the death of his father. But when the servants of David were come into the land of the children of Ammon, ³ The princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanon their lord: Thinkest thou that for the honour of thy father, David hath sent comforters to thee, and hath not David rather sent his servants to thee to search, and spy into the city, and overthrow it? ⁴ Wherefore Hanon took the servants of David, and shaved off the one half of their beards, and cut away half of their garments even to the buttocks, and sent them away. ⁵ When this was told David, he sent to meet them: for the men were sadly put to confusion, and David commanded them, saying: Stay at Jericho, till your beards be grown, and then return.

⁶ And the children of Ammon seeing that they had done an injury to David, sent and hired the Syrians of Rohob, and the Syrians of Soba, twenty thousand footmen, and of the king of Maacha a thousand men, and of Istob twelve thousand men. ⁷ And when David heard this, he sent Joab and the whole army of warriors. ⁸ And the children of Ammon came out, and set their men in array at the entering in of the gate: but the Syrians of Soba, and of Rohob, and of Istob, and of Maacha were by themselves in the field. ⁹ Then Joab seeing that the battle was prepared against him, both before and behind, chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians: ¹⁰ And the rest of the people he delivered to Abisai his brother, who set them in array against the children of Ammon. ¹¹ And Joab said: If the Syrians are too strong for me, then thou shalt help me, but if the children of Ammon are too strong for thee, then I will help thee. ¹² Be of good courage, and let us fight for our people, and for the city of our God: and the Lord will do what is good in his sight. ¹³ And Joab and the people that were with him, began to fight against the Syrians: and they immediately fled before him. ¹⁴ And the children of Ammon seeing that the Syrians were fled, they fled also before Abisai, and entered into the city: and Joab returned from the children of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem.

¹⁵ Then the Syrians seeing that they had fallen before Israel, gathered themselves together. ¹⁶ And Adarezer sent and fetched the Syrians, that were beyond the river, and brought over their army: and Sobach, the captain of the host of Adarezer, was their general. ¹⁷ And when this was told David, he gathered all Israel together, and passed over the Jordan, and came to Helam: and the Syrians set themselves in array against David, and fought against him. ¹⁸ And the Syrians fled before Israel, and David slew of the Syrians the men of seven hundred chariots, and forty thousand horsemen: and smote Sobach the captain of the army, who presently died. ¹⁹ And all the kings that were auxiliaries of Adarezer, seeing themselves overcome by Israel, were afraid and fled away, eight and fifty thousand men before Israel. And they made peace with Israel: and served them, and all the Syrians were afraid to help the children of Ammon any more.

160. David and Bethsabee

2 Samuel 11:1-27

11 ¹ And it came to pass at the return of the year, at the time when kings go forth to war, that David sent Joab and his servants with him, and all Israel, and they spoiled the children of Ammon, and besieged Rabba: but David remained in Jerusalem. ² In the mean time it happened that David arose from his bed after noon, and walked upon the roof of the king's house: And he saw from the roof of his house a woman washing herself, over against him: and the woman was very beautiful. ³ And the king sent, and inquired who the woman was. And it was told him, that she was Bethsabee the daughter of Eliam, the wife of Urias the Hethite. ⁴ And David sent messengers, and took her, and she came in to him, and he slept with her: and presently she was purified from her uncleanness: ⁵ And she returned to her house having conceived. And she sent and told David, and said: I have conceived.

⁶ And David sent to Joab, saying: Send me Urias the Hethite. And Joab sent Urias to David. ⁷ And Urias came to David. And David asked how Joab did, and the people, and how the war was carried on. ⁸ And David said to Urias: Go into thy house, and wash thy feet. And Urias went out from the king's house, and there went out after him a mess of meat from the king. ⁹ But Urias slept before the gate of the king's house, with the other servants of his lord, and went not down to his own house. ¹⁰ And it was told David by some that said: Urias went not to his house. And David said to Urias: Didst thou not come from thy journey? why didst thou not go down to thy house? ¹¹ And Urias said to David: The ark of God and Israel and Juda dwell in tents, and my lord Joab and the servants of my lord abide upon the face of the earth: and shall I go into my house, to eat and to drink, and to sleep with my wife? By thy welfare and by the welfare of thy soul I will not do this thing. ¹² Then David said to Urias: Tarry here to day, and to morrow I will send thee away. Urias tarried in Jerusalem that day and the next. ¹³ And David called him to eat and to drink before him, and he made him drunk: and he went out in the evening, and slept on his couch with the servants of his lord, and went not down into his house. ¹⁴ And when the morning was come, David wrote a letter to Joab: and sent it by the hand of Urias, ¹⁵ Writing in the letter: Set ye Urias in the front of the battle, where the fight is strongest: and leave ye him, that he may be wounded and die. ¹⁶ Wherefore as Joab was besieging the city, he put Urias in the place where he knew the bravest men were. ¹⁷ And the men coming out of the city, fought against Joab, and there fell some of the people of the servants of David, and Urias the Hethite was killed also. ¹⁸ Then Joab sent, and told David all things concerning the battle. ¹⁹ And he charged the messenger, saying: When thou hast told all the words of the battle to the king, ²⁰ If thou see him to be angry, and he shall say: Why did you approach so near to the wall to fight? knew you not that many darts are thrown from above off the wall? ²¹ Who killed Abimelech the son of Jerobaal? did not a woman cast a piece of a millstone upon him from the wall and slew him in Thebes? Why did you go near the wall? Thou shalt say: Thy servant Urias the Hethite is also slain.

²² So the messenger departed, and came and told David all that Joab had commanded him. ²³ And the messenger said to

David: The men prevailed against us, and they came out to us into the field: and we vigorously charged and pursued them even to the gate of the city.²⁴ And the archers shot their arrows at thy servants from off the wall above: and some of the king's servants are slain, and thy servant Urias the Hethite is also dead.²⁵ And David said to the messenger: Thus shalt thou say to Joab: Let not this thing discourage thee: for various is the event of war: and sometimes one, sometimes another is consumed by the sword: encourage thy warriors against the city, and exhort them that thou mayest overthrow it.

²⁶ And the wife of Urias heard that Urias her husband was dead, and she mourned for him.²⁷ And the mourning being over, David sent and brought her into his house, and she became his wife, and she bore him a son: and this thing which David had done, was displeasing to the Lord.

161. Nathan's parable

2 Samuel 12:1-31

12 ¹ And the Lord sent Nathan to David: and when he was come to him, he said to him: There were two men in one city, the one rich, and the other poor.² The rich man had exceeding many sheep and oxen.³ But the poor man had nothing at all but one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up, and which had grown up in his house together with his children, eating of his bread, and drinking of his cup, and sleeping in his bosom: and it was unto him as a daughter.⁴ And when a certain stranger was come to the rich man, he spared to take of his own sheep and oxen, to make a feast for that stranger, who was come to him, but took the poor man's ewe, and dressed it for the man that was come to him.⁵ And David's anger being exceedingly kindled against that man, he said to Nathan: As the Lord liveth, the man that hath done this is a child of death.⁶ He shall restore the ewe fourfold, because he did this thing, and had no pity.

⁷ And Nathan said to David: Thou art the man. Thus saith the Lord the God of Israel: I anointed thee king over Israel, and I delivered thee from the hand of Saul,⁸ And gave thee thy master's house and thy master's wives into thy bosom, and gave thee the house of Israel and Juda: and if these things be little, I shall add far greater things unto thee.⁹ Why therefore hast thou despised the word of the Lord, to do evil in my sight? Thou hast killed Urias the Hethite with the sword, and hast taken his wife to be thy wife, and hast slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon.¹⁰ Therefore the sword shall never depart from thy house, because thou hast despised me, and hast taken the wife of Urias the Hethite to be thy wife.¹¹ Thus saith the Lord: Behold, I will raise up evil against thee out of thy own house, and I will take thy wives before thy eyes and give them to thy neighbour, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun.¹² For thou didst it secretly: but I will do this thing in the sight of all Israel, and in the sight of the sun.¹³ And David said to Nathan: I have sinned against the Lord. And Nathan said to David: The Lord also hath taken away thy sin: thou shalt not die.¹⁴ Nevertheless, because thou hast given occasion to the enemies of the Lord to blaspheme, for this thing, the child that is born to thee, shall surely die.¹⁵ And Nathan returned to his house. The Lord also struck the child which the wife of Urias had borne to David, and his life was despaired of.¹⁶ And David besought the Lord for the child: and David kept a fast, and going

in by himself lay upon the ground.¹⁷ And the ancients of his house came, to make him rise from the ground: but he would not, neither did he eat meat with them.¹⁸ And it came to pass on the seventh day that the child died: and the servants of David feared to tell him, that the child was dead. For they said: Behold when the child was yet alive, we spoke to him, and he would not hearken to our voice: how much more will he afflict himself if we tell him that the child is dead?¹⁹ But when David saw his servants whispering, he understood that the child was dead: and he said to his servants: Is the child dead? They answered him He is dead.²⁰ Then David arose from the ground, and washed and anointed himself: and when he had changed his apparel, he went into the house of the Lord: and worshipped, and then he came into his own house, and he called for bread, and ate.²¹ And his servants said to him: What thing is this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, while it was alive, but when the child was dead, thou didst rise up, and eat bread.²² And he said: While the child was yet alive, I fasted and wept for him: for I said: Who knoweth whether the Lord may not give him to me, and the child may live?²³ But now that he is dead, why should I fast? Shall I be able to bring him back any more? I shall go to him rather: but he shall not return to me.

²⁴ And David comforted Bethsabee his wife, and went in unto her, and slept with her: and she bore a son, and he called his name Solomon, and the Lord loved him.²⁵ And he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet, and called his name, Amiable to the Lord, because the Lord loved him.

²⁶ And Joab fought against Rabbath of the children of Ammon, and laid close siege to the royal city.²⁷ And Joab sent messengers to David, saying: I have fought against Rabbath, and the city of waters is about to be taken.²⁸ Now therefore gather thou the rest of the people together, and besiege the city and take it: lest when the city shall be wasted by me, the victory be ascribed to my name.²⁹ Then David gathered all the people together, and went out against Rabbath: and after fighting, he took it.³⁰ And he took the crown of their king from his head, the weight of which was a talent of gold, set with most precious stones, and it was put upon David's head, and the spoils of the city which were very great he carried away.³¹ And bringing forth the people thereof he sawed them, and drove over them chariots armed with iron: and divided them with knives, and made them pass through brickkilns: so did he to all the cities of the children of Ammon: and David returned, with all the army to Jerusalem.

162. Psalm 50

Psalms 50:1-21

Vulgate 50 = Hebrew 51, the Miserere, inscribed to this episode and read here for that reason.

50 ¹ Unto the end, a psalm of David,² When Nathan the prophet came to him, after he had sinned with Bethsabee. [2 Kings 12.]³ Have mercy on me, O God, according to thy great mercy. And according to the multitude of thy tender mercies blot out my iniquity.⁴ Wash me yet more from my iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin.⁵ For I know my iniquity, and my sin is always before me.⁶ To thee only have I sinned, and have done evil before thee: that thou mayst be justified in thy words, and mayst overcome when thou art judged.⁷ For behold I was conceived in

iniquities; and in sins did my mother conceive me. ⁸ For behold thou hast loved truth: the uncertain and hidden things of thy wisdom thou hast made manifest to me. ⁹ Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and I shall be cleansed: thou shalt wash me, and I shall be made whiter than snow. ¹⁰ To my hearing thou shalt give joy and gladness: and the bones that have been humbled shall rejoice. ¹¹ Turn away thy face from my sins, and blot out all my iniquities. ¹² Create a clean heart in me, O God: and renew a right spirit within my bowels. ¹³ Cast me not away from thy face; and take not thy holy spirit from me. ¹⁴ Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation, and strengthen me with a perfect spirit. ¹⁵ I will teach the unjust thy ways: and the wicked shall be converted to thee. ¹⁶ Deliver me from blood, O God, thou God of my salvation: and my tongue shall extol thy justice. ¹⁷ O Lord, thou wilt open my lips: and my mouth shall declare thy praise. ¹⁸ For if thou hadst desired sacrifice, I would indeed have given it: with burnt offerings thou wilt not be delighted. ¹⁹ A sacrifice to God is an afflicted spirit: a contrite and humbled heart, O God, thou wilt not despise. ²⁰ Deal favourably, O Lord, in thy good will with Sion; that the walls of Jerusalem may be built up. ²¹ Then shalt thou accept the sacrifice of justice, oblations and whole burnt offerings: then shall they lay calves upon thy altar.

163. Amnon and Thamar; Absalom recalled

2 Samuel 13:1-14:33

13 ¹ And it came to pass after this that Amnon the son of David loved the sister of Absalom the son of David, who was very beautiful, and her name was Thamar. ² And he was exceedingly fond of her, so that he fell sick for the love of her: for as she was a virgin, he thought it hard to do any thing dishonestly with her. ³ Now Amnon had a friend, named Jonadab the son of Semmaa the brother of David, a very wise man: ⁴ And he said to him: Why dost thou grow so lean from day to day, O son of the king? why dost thou not tell me the reason of it? And Amnon said to him: I am in love with Thamar the sister of my brother Absalom. ⁵ And Jonadab said to him: Lie down upon thy bed, and feign thyself sick: and when thy father shall come to visit thee, say to him: Let my sister Thamar, I pray thee, come to me, to give me to eat, and to make me a mess, that I may eat it at her hand.

⁶ So Amnon lay down, and made as if he were sick: and when the king came to visit him, Amnon said to the king: I pray thee let my sister Thamar come, and make in my sight two little messes, that I may eat at her hand. ⁷ Then David sent home to Thamar, saying: Come to the house of thy brother Amnon, and make him a mess. ⁸ And Thamar came to the house of Amnon her brother: but he was laid down: and she took meal and tempered it: and dissolving it in his sight she made little messes. ⁹ And taking what she had boiled, she poured it out, and set it before him, but he would not eat: and Amnon said: Put out all persons from me. And when they had put all persons out, ¹⁰ Amnon said to Thamar: Bring the mess into the chamber, that I may eat at thy hand. And Thamar took the little messes which she had made, and brought them in to her brother Amnon in the chamber. ¹¹ And when she had presented him the meat, he took hold of her, and said: Come lie with me, my sister. ¹² She answered him: Do not so, my brother, do not force me: for no such thing must be done in Israel. Do not thou this folly. ¹³ For I shall not be able to bear my shame, and thou shalt be as one of the fools in Israel:

but rather speak to the king, and he will not deny me to thee. ¹⁴ But he would not hearken to her prayers, but being stronger overpowered her and lay with her. ¹⁵ Then Amnon hated her with an exceeding great hatred: so that the hatred wherewith he hated her was greater than the love with which he had loved her before. And Amnon said to her: Arise, and get thee gone. ¹⁶ She answered him: This evil which now thou dost against me, in driving me away, is greater than that which thou didst before. And he would not hearken to her: ¹⁷ But calling the servants that ministered to him, he said: Thrust this woman out from me: and shut the door after her. ¹⁸ And she was clothed with a long robe: for the king's daughters that were virgins, used such kind of garments. Then his servant thrust her out: and shut the door after her. ¹⁹ And she put ashes on her head, and rent her long robe and laid her hands upon her head, and went on crying. ²⁰ And Absalom her brother said to her: Hath thy brother Amnon lain with thee? but now, sister, hold thy peace, he is thy brother: and afflict not thy heart for this thing. So Thamar remained pining away in the house of Absalom her brother.

²¹ And when king David heard of these things he was exceedingly grieved: and he would not afflict the spirit of his son Amnon, for he loved him, because he was his firstborn. ²² But Absalom spoke not to Amnon neither good nor evil: for Absalom hated Amnon because he had ravished his sister Thamar.

²³ And it came to pass after two years, that the sheep of Absalom were shorn in Baalhasor, which is near Ephraim: and Absalom invited all the king's sons: ²⁴ And he came to the king, and said to him: Behold thy servant's sheep are shorn. Let the king, I pray, with his servants come to his servant. ²⁵ And the king said to Absalom: Nay, my son, do not ask that we should all come, and be chargeable to thee. And when he pressed him, and he would not go, he blessed him. ²⁶ And Absalom said: If thou wilt not come, at least let my brother Amnon, I beseech thee, come with us. And the king said to him: It is not necessary that he should go with thee. ²⁷ But Absalom pressed him, so that he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him. And Absalom made a feast as it were the feast of a king. ²⁸ And Absalom had commanded his servants, saying: Take notice when Amnon shall be drunk with wine, and when I shall say to you: Strike him, and kill him, fear not: for it is I that command you: take courage, and be valiant men. ²⁹ And the servants of Absalom did to Amnon as Absalom had commanded them. And all the king's sons arose and got up every man upon his mule, and fled.

³⁰ And while they were yet in the way, a rumour came to David, saying: Absalom hath slain all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left. ³¹ Then the king rose up, and rent his garments: and fell upon the ground, and all his servants, that stood about him, rent their garments. ³² But Jonadab the son of Semmaa David's brother answering, said: Let not my lord the king think that all the king's sons are slain: Amnon only is dead, for he was appointed by the mouth of Absalom from the day that he ravished his sister Thamar. ³³ Now therefore let not my lord the king take this thing into his heart, saying: All the king's sons are slain: for Amnon only is dead. ³⁴ But Absalom fled away: and the young man that kept the watch, lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold there came much people by a by-way on the side of the mountain. ³⁵ And Jonadab said to the

king: Behold the king's sons are come: as thy servant said, so it is. ³⁶ And when he made an end of speaking, the king's sons also appeared: and coming in they lifted up their voice, and wept: and the king also and all his servants wept very much.

³⁷ But Absalom fled, and went to Tholomai the son of Ammiud the king of Gessur. And David mourned for his son every day. ³⁸ And Absalom after he was fled, and come into Gessur, was there three years. And king David ceased to pursue after Absalom, because he was comforted concerning the death of Amnon.

14 ¹ And Joab the son of Sarvia, understanding that the king's heart was turned to Absalom, ² Sent to Thecua, and fetched from thence a wise woman: and said to her: Feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on mourning apparel, and be not anointed with oil, that thou mayest be as a woman that had a long time been mourning for one dead. ³ And thou shalt go in to the king, and shalt speak to him in this manner. And Joab put the words in her mouth.

⁴ And when the woman of Thecua was come in to the king, she fell before him upon the ground, and worshipped, and said: Save me, O king. ⁵ And the king said to her: What is the matter with thee? She answered: Alas, I am a widow woman: for my husband is dead. ⁶ And thy handmaid had two sons: and they quarrelled with each other in the field, and there was none to part them: and the one struck the other, and slew him. ⁷ And behold the whole kindred rising against thy handmaid, saith: Deliver him that hath slain his brother, that we may kill him for the life of his brother, whom he slew, and that we may destroy the heir: and they seek to quench my spark which is left, and will leave my husband no name, nor remainder upon the earth.

⁸ And the king said to the woman: Go to thy house, and I will give charge concerning thee. ⁹ And the woman of Thecua said to the king: Upon me, my lord be the iniquity, and upon the house of my father: but may the king and his throne be guiltless. ¹⁰ And the king said: If any one shall say ought against thee, bring him to me, and he shall not touch thee any more. ¹¹ And she said: Let the king remember the Lord his God, that the next of kin be not multiplied to take revenge, and that they may not kill my son. And he said: As the Lord liveth, there shall not one hair of thy son fall to the earth. ¹² Then the woman said: Let thy hand maid speak one word to my lord the king. And he said: Speak. ¹³ And the woman said: Why hast thou thought such a thing against the people of God, and why hath the king spoken this word, to sin, and not bring home again his own exile? ¹⁴ We all die, and like waters that return no more, we fall down into the earth: neither will God have a soul to perish, but recalleth, meaning that he that is cast off should not altogether perish. ¹⁵ Now therefore I am come, to speak this word to my lord the king before the people. And thy handmaid said: I will speak to the king, it maybe the king will perform the request of his handmaid. ¹⁶ And the king hath hearkened to me to deliver his handmaid out of the hand of all that would destroy me and my son together out of the inheritance of God. ¹⁷ Then let thy handmaid say, that the word of the Lord the king be made as a sacrifice. For even as an angel of God, so is my lord the king, that he is neither moved with blessing nor cursing: wherefore the Lord thy God is also with thee. ¹⁸ And the king answering,

said to the woman: Hide not from me the thing that I ask thee. And the woman said to him: Speak, my lord the king. ¹⁹ And the king said: Is not the hand of Joab with thee in all this? The woman answered, and said: By the health of thy soul, my lord, O king, it is neither on the left hand, nor on the right, in all these things which my lord the king hath spoken: for thy servant Joab, he commanded me, and he put all these words into the mouth of thy handmaid. ²⁰ That I should come about with this form of speech, thy servant Joab commanded this: but thou, my lord, O king, art wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to understand all things upon earth.

²¹ And the king said to Joab: Behold I am appeased and have granted thy request: Go therefore and fetch back the boy Absalom. ²² And Joab falling down to the ground upon his face, adored, and blessed the king: and Joab said: This day thy servant hath understood, that I have found grace in thy sight, my lord, O king: for thou hast fulfilled the request of thy servant. ²³ Then Joab arose and went to Gessur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem. ²⁴ But the king said: Let him return into his house, and let him not see my face. So Absalom returned into his house, and saw not the king's face. ²⁵ But in all Israel there was not a man so comely, and so exceedingly beautiful as Absalom: from the sole of the foot to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him. ²⁶ And when he polled his hair (now he was polled once a year, because his hair was burdensome to him) he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred sicles, according to the common weight. ²⁷ And there were born to Absalom three sons: and one daughter, whose name was Tamar, and she was very beautiful. ²⁸ And Absalom dwelt two years in Jerusalem, and saw not the king's face. ²⁹ He sent therefore to Joab, to send him to the king: but he would not come to him. And when he had sent the second time, and he would not come to him, ³⁰ He said to his servants: You know the field of Joab near my field, that hath a crop of barley: go now and set it on fire. So the servants of Absalom set the corn on fire. And Joab's servants coming with their garments rent, said: The servants of Absalom have set part of the field on fire. ³¹ Then Joab arose, and came to Absalom to his house, and said: Why have thy servants set my corn on fire? ³² And Absalom answered Joab: I sent to thee beseeching thee to come to me, that I might send thee to the king, to say to him: Wherefore am I come from Gessur? it had been better for me to be there: I beseech thee therefore that I may see the face of the king: and if he be mindful of my iniquity, let him kill me. ³³ So Joab going in to the king, told him all: and Absalom was called for, and, he went in to the king: and prostrated himself on the ground before him: and the king kissed Absalom.

164. The revolt of Absalom

2 Samuel 15:1-37

15 ¹ Now after these things Absalom made himself chariots, and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him. ² And Absalom rising up early stood by the entrance of the gate, and when any man had business to come to the king's judgment, Absalom called him to him, and said: Of what city art thou? He answered, and said: Thy servant is of such tribe of Israel. ³ And Absalom answered him: Thy words seem to me good and just. But there is no man appointed by the king to hear thee. And Absalom said: ⁴ O that they would make me judge over the land, that all that

have business might come to me, that I might do them justice. ⁵ Moreover when any man came to him to salute him, he put forth his hand, and took him, and kissed him. ⁶ And this he did to all Israel that came for judgment, to be heard by the king, and he enticed the hearts of the men of Israel.

⁷ And after forty years, Absalom said to king David: Let me go, and pay my vows which I have vowed to the Lord in Hebron. ⁸ For thy servant made a vow, when he was in Gessur of Syria, saying: If the Lord shall bring me again into Jerusalem, I will offer sacrifice to the Lord. ⁹ And king David said to him: Go in peace. And he arose, and went to Hebron.

¹⁰ And Absalom sent spies into all the tribes of Israel, saying: As soon as you shall hear the sound of the trumpet, say ye: Absalom reigneth in Hebron. ¹¹ Now there went with Absalom two hundred men out of Jerusalem that were called, going with simplicity of heart, and knowing nothing of the design. ¹² Absalom also sent for Achitophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city Gilo. And while he was offering sacrifices, there was a strong conspiracy, and the people running together increased with Absalom. ¹³ And there came a messenger to David, saying: All Israel with their whole heart followeth Absalom. ¹⁴ And David said to his servants, that were with him in Jerusalem: Arise and let us flee: for we shall not escape else from the face of Absalom: make haste to go out, lest he come and overtake us, and bring ruin upon us, and smite the city with the edge of the sword. ¹⁵ And the king's servants said to him: Whatsoever our lord the king shall command, we thy servants will willingly execute. ¹⁶ And the king went forth, and all his household on foot: and the king left ten women his concubines to keep the house: ¹⁷ And the king going forth and all Israel on foot, stood afar off from the house: ¹⁸ And all his servants walked by him, and the bands of the Cerethi, and the Phelethi, and all the Gethites, valiant warriors, six hundred men who had followed him from Geth on foot, went before the king.

¹⁹ And the king said to Ethai the Gethite: Why comest thou with us: return and dwell with the king, for thou art a stranger, and art come out of thy own place. ²⁰ Yesterday thou camest, and to day shalt thou be forced to go forth with us? but I shall go whither I am going: return thou, and take back thy brethren with thee, and the Lord will shew thee mercy, and truth, because thou hast shewn grace and fidelity. ²¹ And Ethai answered the king, saying: As the Lord liveth, and as my lord the king liveth: in what place soever thou shalt be, my lord, O king, either in death, or in life, there will thy servant be. ²² And David said to Ethai: Come, and pass over. And Ethai the Gethite passed, and all the men that were with him, and the rest of the people. ²³ And they all wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself went over the brook Cedron, and all the people marched towards the way that looketh to the desert. ²⁴ And Sadoc the priest also came, and all the Levites with him carrying the ark of the covenant of God, and they set down the ark of God: and Abiathar went up, till all the people that was come out of the city had done passing. ²⁵ And the king said to Sadoc: Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find grace in the sight of the Lord, he will bring me again, and he will shew me it, and his tabernacle. ²⁶ But if he shall say to me: Thou pleasest me not: I am ready, let him do that which is good before

him. ²⁷ And the king said to Sadoc the priest: O seer, return into the city in peace: and let Achimaas thy son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar, your two sons, be with you. ²⁸ Behold I will lie hid in the plains of the wilderness, till there come word from you to certify me. ²⁹ So Sadoc and Abiathar carried back the ark of God into Jerusalem: and they tarried there. ³⁰ But David went up by the ascent of mount Olivet, going up and weeping, walking barefoot, and with his head covered, and all the people that were with them, went up with their heads covered weeping.

³¹ And it was told David that Achitophel also was in the conspiracy with Absalom, and David said: Infatuate, O Lord, I beseech thee, the counsel of Achitophel.

³² And when David was come to the top of the mountain, where he was about to adore the Lord, behold Chusai the Arachite, came to meet him with his garment rent and his head covered with earth. ³³ And David said to him: If thou come with me, thou wilt be a burden to me: ³⁴ But if thou return into the city, and wilt say to Absalom: I am thy servant, O king: as I have been thy father's servant, so I will be thy servant: thou shalt defeat the counsel of Achitophel. ³⁵ And thou hast with thee Sadoc, and Abiathar the priests: and what thing soever thou shalt hear out of the king's house, thou shalt tell it to Sadoc and Abiathar the priests. ³⁶ And there are with them their two sons Achimaas; the son of Sadoc, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar: and you shall send by them to me every thing that you shall hear. ³⁷ Then Chusai the friend of David went into the city, and Absalom came into Jerusalem.

165. Semei, Achitophel and Chusai

2 Samuel 16:1-17:29

16 ¹ And when David was a little past the top of the hill, behold Siba the servant of Miphiboseth came to meet him with two asses, laden with two hundred loaves of bread, and a hundred bunches of raisins, a hundred cakes of figs, and a vessel of wine. ² And the king said to Siba: What mean these things? And Siba answered: The asses are for the king's household to sit on: and the loaves and the figs for thy servants to eat, and the wine to drink if any man be faint in the desert. ³ And the king said: Where is thy master's son? And Siba answered the king: He remained in Jerusalem, saying: To day, will the house of Israel restore me the kingdom of my father. ⁴ And the king said to Siba: I give thee all that belonged to Miphiboseth. And Siba said: I beseech thee let me find grace before thee, my lord, O king.

⁵ And king David came as far as Bahurim: and behold there came out from thence a man of the kindred of the house of Saul named Semei, the son of Gera, and coming out he cursed as he went on, ⁶ And he threw stones at David, and at all the servants of king David: and all the people, and all the warriors walked on the right, and on the left side of the king. ⁷ And thus said Semei when he cursed the king: Come out, come out, thou man of blood, and thou man of Belial. ⁸ The Lord hath repaid thee for all the blood of the house of Saul: because thou hast usurped the kingdom in his stead, and the Lord hath given the kingdom into the hand of Absalom thy son: and behold thy evils press upon thee, because thou art a man of blood.

⁹ And Abisai the son of Sarvia said to the king: Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? I will go, and cut off his head. ¹⁰ And the king said: What have I to do with you, ye sons

of Sarvia? Let him alone and let him curse: for the Lord hath bid him curse David: and who is he that shall dare say, why hath he done so? ¹¹ And the king said to Abisai, and to all his servants: Behold my son, who came forth from my bowels, seeketh my life: how much more now a son of Jemini? let him alone that he may curse as the Lord hath bidden him. ¹² Perhaps the Lord may look upon my affliction, and the Lord may render me good for the cursing of this day. ¹³ And David and his men with him went by the way. And Semei by the hill's side went over against him, cursing, and casting stones at him, and scattering earth. ¹⁴ And the king and all the people with him came weary, and refreshed themselves there.

¹⁵ But Absalom and all his people came into Jerusalem, and Achitophel was with him. ¹⁶ And when Chusai the Arachite, David's friend, was come to Absalom, he said to him: God save thee, O king, God save thee, O king. ¹⁷ And Absalom said to him, Is this thy kindness to thy friend? Why wentest thou not with thy friend? ¹⁸ And Chusai answered Absalom: Nay: for I will be his, whom the Lord hath chosen, and all this people, and all Israel, and with him will I abide. ¹⁹ Besides this, whom shall I serve? is it not the king's son? as I have served thy father, so will I serve thee also.

²⁰ And Absalom said to Achitophel: Consult what we are to do. ²¹ And Achitophel said to Absalom: Go in to the concubines of thy father, whom he hath left to keep the house: that when all Israel shall hear that thou hast disgraced thy father, their hands may be strengthened with thee. ²² So they spread a tent for Absalom on the top of the house, and he went in to his father's concubines before all Israel. ²³ Now the counsel of Achitophel, which he gave in those days, was as if a man should consult God: so was all the counsel of Achitophel, both when he was with David, and when he was with Absalom.

17 ¹ And Achitophel said to Absalom: I will choose me twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David this night. ² And coming upon him (for he is now weary, and weak handed) I will defeat him: and when all the people is put to flight that is with him, I will kill the king who will be left alone. ³ And I will bring back all the people, as if they were but one man: for thou seekest but one man: and all the people shall be in peace. ⁴ And his saying pleased Absalom, and all the ancients of Israel. ⁵ But Absalom said: Call Chusai the Arachite, and let us hear what he also saith. ⁶ And when Chusai was come to Absalom, Absalom said to him: Achitophel hath spoken after this manner: shall we do it or not? what counsel dost thou give? ⁷ And Chusai said to Absalom: The counsel that Achitophel hath given this time is not good. ⁸ And again Chusai said: Thou knowest thy father, and the men that are with him, that they are very valiant, and bitter in their mind, as a bear raging in the wood when her whelps are taken away: and thy father is a warrior, and will not lodge with the people. ⁹ Perhaps he now lieth hid in pits, or in some other place where he list: and when any one shall fall at the first, every one that heareth it shall say: There is a slaughter among the people that followed Absalom. ¹⁰ And the most valiant man whose heart is as the heart of a lion, shall melt for fear: for all the people of Israel know thy father to be a valiant man, and that all who are with him are valiant. ¹¹ But this seemeth to me to be good counsel: Let all Israel be gathered to thee, from Dan

to Bersabee, as the sand of the sea which cannot be numbered: and thou shalt be in the midst of them. ¹² And we shall come upon him in what place soever he shall be found: and we shall cover him, as the dew falleth upon the ground, and we shall not leave of the men that are with him, not so much as one. ¹³ And if he shall enter into any city, all Israel shall cast ropes round about that city, and we will draw it into the river, so that there shall not be found so much as one small stone thereof. ¹⁴ And Absalom, and all the men of Israel said: The counsel of Chusai the Arachite is better than the counsel of Achitophel: and by the will of the Lord the profitable counsel of Achitophel was defeated, that the Lord might bring evil upon Absalom.

¹⁵ And Chusai said to Sadoc and Abiathar the priests: Thus and thus did Achitophel counsel Absalom, and the ancients of Israel: and thus and thus did I counsel them. ¹⁶ Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying: Tarry not this night in the plains of the wilderness, but without delay pass over: lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people that is with him. ¹⁷ And Jonathan and Achimaas stayed by the fountain Rogel: and there went a maid and told them: and they went forward, to carry the message to king David, for they might not be seen, nor enter into the city. ¹⁸ But a certain boy saw them, and told Absalom: but they making haste went into the house of a certain man in Bahurim, who had a well in his court, and they went down into it. ¹⁹ And a woman took, and spread a covering over the mouth of the well, as it were to dry sodden barley and so the thing was not known. ²⁰ And when Absalom's servants were come into the house, they said to the woman: Where is Achimaas and Jonathan? and the woman answered them: They passed on in haste, after they had tasted a little water. But they that sought them, when they found them not, returned into Jerusalem. ²¹ And when they were gone, they came up out of the well, and going on told king David, and said: Arise, and pass quickly over the river: for this manner of counsel has Achitophel given against you.

²² So David arose, and all the people that were with him, and they passed over the Jordan, until it grew light, and not one of them was left that was not gone over the river.

²³ But Achitophel seeing that his counsel was not followed, saddled his ass, and arose and went home to his house and to his city, and putting his house in order, hanged himself, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father. ²⁴ But David came to the camp, and Absalom passed over the Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him. ²⁵ Now Absalom appointed Amasa in Joab's stead over the army: and Amasa was the son of a man who was called Jethra, of Jezrael, who went in to Abigail the daughter of Naas, the sister of Sarvia who was the mother of Joab. ²⁶ And Israel camped with Absalom in the land of Galaad.

²⁷ And when David was come to the camp, Sobi the son of Naas of Rabbath of the children of Ammon, and Machir the son of Ammiel of Lodabar and Berzellai the Galaadite of Rogelim, ²⁸ Brought him beds, and tapestry, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and meal, and parched corn, and beans, and lentils, and fried pulse, ²⁹ And honey, and butter, and sheep, and fat calves, and they gave to David and the people that were with him, to eat: for they suspected that the people were faint with hunger and thirst in the wilderness.

166. The death of Absalom*2 Samuel 18:1-33*

18 ¹ And David, having reviewed his people, appointed over them captains of thousands and of hundreds, ² And sent forth a third part of the people under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abisai the son of Sarvia Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of Ethai, who was of Geth: and the king said to the people: I also will go forth with you. ³ And the people answered: Thou shalt not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not much mind us: or if half of us should fall, they will not greatly care: for thou alone art accounted for ten thousand: it is better therefore that thou shouldst be in the city to succour us. ⁴ And the king said to them: What seemeth good to you, that will I do. And the king stood by the gate: and all the people went forth by their troops, by hundreds and by thousands. ⁵ And the king commanded Joab, and Abisai, and Ethai, saying: Save me the boy Absalom. And all the people heard the king giving charge to all the princes concerning Absalom.

⁶ So the people went out into the field against Israel, and the battle was fought in the forest of Ephraim. ⁷ And the people of Israel were defeated there by David's army, and a great slaughter was made that day of twenty thousand men. ⁸ And the battle there was scattered over the face of all the country, and there were many more of the people whom the forest consumed, than whom the sword devoured that day.

⁹ And it happened that Absalom met the servants of David, riding on a mule: and as the mule went under a thick and large oak, his head stuck in the oak: and while he hung between the heaven and the earth, the mule on which he rode passed on. ¹⁰ And one saw this and told Joab, saying: I saw Absalom hanging upon an oak. ¹¹ And Joab said to the man that told him: If thou sawest him, why didst thou not stab him to the ground, and I would have given thee ten sicles of silver, and a belt? ¹² And he said to Joab: If thou wouldst have paid down in my hands a thousand pieces of silver, I would not lay my hands upon the king's son for in our hearing the king charged thee, and Abisai, and Ethai, saying: Save me the boy Absalom. ¹³ Yea and if I should have acted boldly against my own life, this could not have been hid from the king, and wouldst thou have stood by me? ¹⁴ And Joab said: Not as thou wilt, but I will set upon him in thy sight. So he took three lances in his hand, and thrust them into the heart of Absalom: and whilst he yet panted for life, sticking on the oak, ¹⁵ Ten young men, armourbearers of Joab, ran up, and striking him slew him. ¹⁶ And Joab sounded the trumpet, and kept back the people from pursuing after Israel in their flight, being willing to spare the multitude. ¹⁷ And they took Absalom, and cast him into a great pit in the forest, and they laid an exceeding great heap of stones upon him: but all Israel fled to their own dwellings.

¹⁸ Now Absalom had reared up for himself, in his lifetime, a pillar, which is in the king's valley: for he said: I have no son, and this shall be the monument of my name. And he called the pillar by his own name, and it is called the hand of Absalom, to this day.

¹⁹ And Achimaas the son of Sadoc said: I will run and tell the king, that the Lord hath done judgment for him from the hand of his enemies. ²⁰ And Joab said to him: Thou shalt not

be the messenger this day, but shalt bear tidings another day: this day I will not have thee bear tidings, because the king's son is dead. ²¹ And Joab said to Chusai: Go, and tell the king what thou hast seen. Chusai bowed down to Joab, and ran. ²² Then Achimaas the son of Sadoc said to Joab again: Why might not I also run after Chusai? And Joab said to him: Why wilt thou run, my son? thou wilt not be the bearer of good tidings. ²³ He answered: But what if I run? And he said to him: Run. Then Achimaas running by a nearer way passed Chusai. ²⁴ And David sat between the two gates: and the watchman that was on the top of the gate upon the wall, lifting up his eyes, saw a man running alone. ²⁵ And crying out he told the king: and the king said: If he be alone, there are good tidings in his mouth. And as he was coming apace, and drawing nearer, ²⁶ The watchman saw another man running, and crying aloud from above, he said: I see another man running alone. And the king said: He also is a good messenger. ²⁷ And the watchman said: The running of the foremost seemeth to me like the running of Achimaas the son of Sadoc. And the king said: He is a good man: and cometh with good news. ²⁸ And Achimaas crying out, said to the king: God save thee, O king. And falling down before the king with his face to the ground, he said: Blessed be the Lord thy God, who hath shut up the men that have lifted up their hands against the lord my king. ²⁹ And the king said: Is the young man Absalom safe? And Achimaas said: I saw a great tumult, O king, when thy servant Joab sent me thy servant: I know nothing else. ³⁰ And the king said to him: Pass, and stand here. ³¹ And when he had passed, and stood still, Chusai appeared and coming up he said: I bring good tidings, my lord, the king, for the Lord hath judged for thee this day from the hand of all that have risen up against thee. ³² And the king said to Chusai: Is the young man Absalom safe? And Chusai answering him, said: Let the enemies of my lord, the king, and all that rise against him unto evil, be as the young man is.

³³ The king therefore being much moved, went up to the high chamber over the gate, and wept. And as he went he spoke in this manner: My son Absalom, Absalom my son: would to God that I might die for thee, Absalom my son, my son Absalom.

167. The return, and the revolt of Seba*2 Samuel 19:1-20:26*

19 ¹ And it was told Joab, that the king wept and mourned for his son: ² And the victory that day was turned into mourning unto all the people: for the people heard say that day: The king grieveth for his son. ³ And the people shunned the going into the city that day as a people would do that hath turned their backs, and fled away from the battle. ⁴ And the king covered his head, and cried with a loud voice: O my son Absalom, O Absalom my son, O my son. ⁵ Then Joab going into the house to the king, said: Thou hast shamed this day the faces of all thy servants, that have saved thy life, and the lives of thy sons, and of thy daughters, and the lives of thy wives, and the lives of thy concubines. ⁶ Thou lovest them that hate thee, and thou hatest them that love thee: and thou hast shewn this day that thou carest not for thy nobles, nor for thy servants: and I now plainly perceive that if Absalom had lived, and all we had been slain, then it would have pleased thee. ⁷ Now therefore arise, and go out, and speak to the satisfaction of thy servants: for I

swear to thee by the Lord, that if thou wilt not go forth, there will not tarry with thee so much as one this night: and that will be worse to thee, than all the evils that have befallen thee from thy youth until now.⁸ Then the king arose and sat in the gate: and it was told to all the people that the king sat in the gate: and all the people came before the king, but Israel fled to their own dwellings.⁹ And all the people were at strife in all the tribes of Israel, saying: The king delivered us out of the hand of our enemies, and he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines: and now he is fled out of the land for Absalom.¹⁰ But Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in the battle: how long are you silent, and bring not back the king?

¹¹ And king David sent to Sadoc, and Abiathar the priests, saying: Speak to the ancients of Juda, saying: Why are you the last to bring the king back to his house? (For the talk of all Israel was come to the king in his house.)¹² You are my brethren, you are my bone, and my flesh, why are you the last to bring back the king?¹³ And say ye to Amasa: Art not thou my bone, and my flesh? So do God to me and add more, if thou be not the chief captain of the army before me always in the place of Joab.¹⁴ And he inclined the heart of all the men of Juda, as it were of one man: and they sent to the king, saying: Return thou, and all thy servants.¹⁵ And the king returned and came as far as the Jordan, and all Juda came as far as Galgal to meet the king, and to bring him over the Jordan.¹⁶ And Semei the son of Gera the son of Jemini of Bahurim, made haste and went down with the men of Juda to meet king David,¹⁷ With a thousand men of Benjamin, and Siba the servant of the house of Saul: and his fifteen sons, and twenty servants were with him: and going over the Jordan,¹⁸ They passed the fords before the king, that they might help over the king's household, and do according to his commandment. And Semei the son of Gera falling down before the king, when he was come over the Jordan,¹⁹ Said to him: Impute not to me, my lord, the iniquity, nor remember the injuries of thy servant on the day that thou, my lord, the king, wentest out of Jerusalem, nor lay it up in thy heart, O king.²⁰ For I thy servant acknowledge my sin: and therefore I am come this day the first of all the house of Joseph, and am come down to meet my lord the king.²¹ But Abisai the son of Sarvia answering, said: Shall Semei for these words not be put to death, because he cursed the Lord's anointed?²² And David said: What have I to do with you, ye sons of Sarvia? why are you a satan this day to me? shall there any man be killed this day in Israel? do not I know that this day I am made king over Israel?²³ And the king said to Semei: Thou shalt not die. And he swore unto him.

²⁴ And Miphiboseth the son of Saul came down to meet the king, and he had neither washed his feet, nor trimmed his beard: nor washed his garments from the day that the king went out, until the day of his return in peace.²⁵ And when he met the king at Jerusalem, the king said to him: Why camest thou not with me, Miphiboseth?²⁶ And he answering, said: My lord, O king, my servant despised me: for I thy servant spoke to him to saddle me an ass, that I might get on and go with the king: for I thy servant am lame.²⁷ Moreover he hath also accused me thy servant to thee, my lord the king: but thou my lord the king art as an angel of God, do what pleaseth thee.²⁸ For all of my father's house were no better than worthy of death before my

lord the king; and thou hast set me thy servant among the guests of thy table: what just complaint therefore have I? or what right to cry any more to the king?²⁹ Then the king said to him: Why speakest thou any more? what I have said is determined: thou and Siba divide the possessions.³⁰ And Miphiboseth answered the king: Yea, let him take all, forasmuch as my lord the king is returned peaceably into his house.

³¹ Berzellai also the Galaadite coming down from Rogelim, brought the king over the Jordan, being ready also to wait on him beyond the river.³² Now Berzellai the Galaadite was of a great age, that is to say, fourscore years old, and he provided the king with sustenance when he abode in the camp: for he was a man exceeding rich.³³ And the king said to Berzellai: Come with me that thou mayest rest secure with me in Jerusalem.³⁴ And Berzellai said to the king: How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem?³⁵ I am this day fourscore years old, are my senses quick to discern sweet and bitter? or can meat or drink delight thy servant? or can I hear any more the voice of singing men and singing women? why should thy servant be a burden to my lord, the king?³⁶ I thy servant will go on a little way from the Jordan with thee: I need not this recompense.³⁷ But I beseech thee let thy servant return, and die in my own city, and be buried by the sepulchre of my father, and of my mother. But there is thy servant Chamaam, let him go with thee, my lord, the king, and do to him whatsoever seemeth good to thee.³⁸ Then the king said to him: Let Chamaam go over with me, and I will do for him whatsoever shall please thee, and all that thou shalt ask of me, thou shalt obtain.³⁹ And when all the people and the king had passed over the Jordan, the king kissed Berzellai, and blessed him: and he returned to his own place.⁴⁰ So the king went on to Galgal, and Chamaam with him. Now all the people of Juda had brought the king over, and only half of the people of Israel were there.⁴¹ Therefore all the men of Israel running together to the king, said to him: Why have our brethren the men of Juda stolen thee away, and have brought the king and his household over the Jordan, and all the men of David with him?⁴² And all the men of Juda answered the men of Israel: Because the king is nearer to me: why art thou angry for this matter? have we eaten any thing of the king's, or have any gifts been given us?⁴³ And the men of Israel answered the men of Juda, and said: I have ten parts in the king more than thou, and David belongeth to me more than to thee: why hast thou done me a wrong, and why was it not told me first, that I might bring back my king? And the men of Juda answered more harshly than the men of Israel.

20 ¹ And there happened to be there a man of Belial, whose name was Seba, the son of Bochri, a man of Jemini: and he sounded the trumpet, and said: We have no part in David, nor inheritance in the son of Isai: return to thy dwellings, O Israel.² And all Israel departed from David, and followed Seba the son of Bochri: but the men of Juda stuck to their king from the Jordan unto Jerusalem.

³ And when the king was come into his house at Jerusalem, he took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them inward, allowing them provisions:

and he went not in unto them, but they were shut up unto the day of their death living in widowhood.

⁴ And the king said to Amasa: Assemble to me all the men of Juda against the third day, and be thou here present. ⁵ So Amasa went to assemble the men of Juda, but he tarried beyond the set time which the king had appointed him. ⁶ And David said to Abisai: Now will Seba the son of Bochri do us more harm than did Absalom: take thou therefore the servants of thy lord, and pursue after him, lest he find fenced cities, and escape us. ⁷ So Joab's men went out with him, and the Cerethi and the Phelethi: and all the valiant men went out of Jerusalem to pursue after Seba the son of Bochri. ⁸ And when they were at the great stone which is in Gabaon, Amasa coming met them. And Joab had on a close coat of equal length with his habit, and over it was girded with a sword hanging down to his flank, in a scabbard, made in such manner as to come out with the least motion and strike. ⁹ And Joab said to Amasa: God save thee, my brother. And he took Amasa by the chin with his right hand to kiss him. ¹⁰ But Amasa did not take notice of the sword, which Joab had, and he struck him in the side, and shed out his bowels to the ground, and gave him not a second wound, and he died. And Joab, and Abisai his brother pursued after Seba the son of Bochri. ¹¹ In the mean time some men of Joab's company stopping at the dead body of Amasa, said: Behold he that would have been in Joab's stead the companion of David. ¹² And Amasa imbrued with blood, lay in the midst of the way. A certain man saw this that all the people stood still to look upon him, so he removed Amasa out of the highway into the field, and covered him with a garment, that they who passed might, not stop on his account. ¹³ And when he was removed out of the way, all the people went on following Joab to pursue after Seba the son of Bochri. ¹⁴ Now he had passed through all the tribes of Israel unto Abela and Bethmaacha: and all the chosen men were gathered together unto him. ¹⁵ And they came, and besieged him in Abela, and in Bethmaacha, and they cast up works round the city, and the city was besieged: and all the people that were with Joab, laboured to throw down the walls.

¹⁶ And a wise woman cried out from the city: Hear, hear, and say to Joab: Come near hither, and I will speak with thee. ¹⁷ And when he was come near to her, she said to him: Art thou Joab? And he answered: I am. And she spoke thus to him: Hear the words of thy handmaid. He answered: I do hear. ¹⁸ And she again said: A saying was used in the old proverb: They that inquire, let them inquire in Abela: and so they made an end. ¹⁹ Am not I she that answer truth in Israel, and thou seekest to destroy the city, and to overthrow a mother in Israel? Why wilt thou throw down the inheritance of the Lord? ²⁰ And Joab answering said: God forbid, God forbid that I should, I do not throw down, nor destroy. ²¹ The matter is not so, but a man of mount Ephraim, Seba the son of Bochri by name, hath lifted up his hand against king David: deliver him only, and we will depart from the city. And the woman said to Joab: Behold his head shall be thrown to thee from the wall. ²² So she went to all the people, and spoke to them wisely: and they cut off the head of Seba the son of Bochri, and cast it out to Joab. And he sounded the trumpet, and they departed from the city, every one to their home: and Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.

²³ So Joab was over all the army of Israel: and Banaias the son of Joiada was over the Cerethites and Phelethites, ²⁴ But Aduram over the tributes: and Josaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder. ²⁵ And Siva was scribe: and Sadoc and Abiathar, priests. ²⁶ And Ira the Jairite was the priest of David.

168. The famine, the song, and the last words of David

2 Samuel 21:1-23:39

21 ¹ And there was a famine in the days of David for three years successively: and David consulted the oracle of the Lord. And the Lord said: It is for Saul, and his bloody house, because he slew the Gabaonites. ² Then the king, calling for the Gabaonites, said to them: (Now the Gabaonites were not of the children of Israel, but the remains of the Amorrites: and the children of Israel had sworn to them, and Saul sought to slay them out of zeal, as it were for the children of Israel and Juda:) ³ David therefore said to the Gabaonites: What shall I do for you? and what shall be the atonement for you, that you may bless the inheritance of the Lord? ⁴ And the Gabaonites said to him: We have no contest about silver and gold, but against Saul and against his house: neither do we desire that any man be slain of Israel. And the king said to them: What will you then that I should do for you? ⁵ And they said to the king: The man that crushed us and oppressed us unjustly, we must destroy in such manner that there be not so much as one left of his stock in all the coasts of Israel. ⁶ Let seven men of his children be delivered unto us, that we may crucify them to the Lord in Gabaa of Saul, once the chosen of the Lord. And the king said: I will give them. ⁷ And the king spared Miphiboseth the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of the oath of the Lord, that had been between David and Jonathan the son of Saul. ⁸ So the king took the two sons of Respha the daughter of Aia, whom she bore to Saul, Armoni, and Miphiboseth: and the five sons of Michol the daughter of Saul, whom she bore to Hadriel the son of Berzellai, that was of Molathi: ⁹ And gave them into the hands of the Gabaonites: and they crucified them on a hill before the Lord: and these seven died together in the first days of the harvest, when the barley began to be reaped.

¹⁰ And Respha the daughter of Aia took haircloth, and spread it under her upon the rock from the beginning of the harvest, till water dropped upon them out of heaven: and suffered neither the birds to tear them by day, nor the beasts by night. ¹¹ And it was told David, what Respha the daughter of Aia, the concubine of Saul, had done. ¹² And David went, and took the bones of Saul, and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabes Galaad, who had stolen them from the street of Bethsan, where the Philistines had hanged them when they had slain Saul in Gelboe. ¹³ And he brought from thence the bones of Saul, and the bones of Jonathan his son, and they gathered up the bones of them that were crucified, ¹⁴ And they buried them with the bones of Saul, and of Jonathan his son in the land of Benjamin, in the side, in the sepulchre of Cis his father: and they did all that the king had commanded, and God shewed mercy again to the land after these things.

¹⁵ And the Philistines made war again against Israel, and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines. And David growing faint, ¹⁶ Jesibeenob, who was of the race of Arapha, the iron of whose spear weighed three

hundred ounces, being girded with a new sword, attempted to kill David. ¹⁷ And Abisai the son of Sarvia rescued him, and striking the Philistine killed him. Then David's men swore unto him saying: Thou shalt go no more out with us to battle, lest thou put out the lamp of Israel. ¹⁸ There was also a second battle in Gob against the Philistines: then Sobochai of Husathi slew Saph of the race of Arapha of the family of the giants. ¹⁹ And there was a third battle in Gob against the Philistines, in which Adeodatus the son of the Forrest an embroiderer of Bethlehem slew Goliath the Gethite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam. ²⁰ A fourth battle was in Geth: where there was a man of great stature, that had six fingers on each hand, and six toes on each foot, four and twenty in all, and he was of the race of Arapha. ²¹ And he reproached Israel: and Jonathan the son of Samae the brother of David slew him. ²² These four were born of Arapha in Geth, and they fell by the hand of David, and of his servants.

22 ¹ And David spoke to the Lord the words of this canticle, in the day that the Lord delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul, ² And he said: The Lord is my rock, and my strength, and my saviour. ³ God is my strong one, in him will I trust: my shield, and the horn of my salvation: he lifteth me up, and is my refuge: my saviour, thou wilt deliver me from iniquity. ⁴ I will call on the Lord who is worthy to be praised: and I shall be saved from my enemies. ⁵ For the pangs of death have surrounded me: the floods of Belial have made me afraid. ⁶ The cords of hell compassed me: the snares of death prevented me. ⁷ In my distress I will call upon the Lord, and I will cry to my God: and he will hear my voice out of his temple, and my cry shall come to his ears. ⁸ The earth shook and trembled, the foundations of the mountains were moved, and shaken, because he was angry with them. ⁹ A smoke went up from his nostrils, and a devouring fire out of his mouth: coals were kindled by it. ¹⁰ He bowed the heavens, and came down: and darkness was under his feet. ¹¹ And he rode upon the cherubims, and flew: and slid upon the wings of the wind. ¹² He made darkness a covering round about him: dropping waters out of the clouds of the heavens. ¹³ By the brightness before him, the coals of fire were kindled. ¹⁴ The Lord shall thunder from heaven: and the most high shall give forth his voice. ¹⁵ He shot arrows and scattered them: lightning, and consumed them. ¹⁶ And the overflowings of the sea appeared, and the foundations of the world were laid open at the rebuke of the Lord, at the blast of the spirit of his wrath. ¹⁷ He sent from on high, and took me, and drew me out of many waters. ¹⁸ He delivered me from my most mighty enemy, and from them that hated me: for they were too strong for me. ¹⁹ He prevented me in the day of my affliction, and the Lord became my stay. ²⁰ And he brought me forth into a large place, he delivered me, because I pleased him. ²¹ The Lord will reward me according to my justice: and according to the cleanness of my hands he will render to me. ²² Because I have kept the ways of the Lord, and have not wickedly departed from my God. ²³ For all his judgments are in my sight: and his precepts I have not removed from me. ²⁴ And I shall be perfect with him: and shall keep myself from my iniquity. ²⁵ And the Lord will recompense me according to my justice: and according to the cleanness of my hands in the sight of his eyes. ²⁶ With

the holy one thou wilt be holy: and with the valiant perfect. ²⁷ With the elect thou wilt be elect: and with the perverse thou wilt be perverted. ²⁸ And the poor people thou wilt save: and with thy eyes thou shalt humble the haughty. ²⁹ For thou art my lamp O Lord: and thou, O Lord, wilt enlighten my darkness. ³⁰ For in thee I will run girded: in my God I will leap over the wall. ³¹ God, his way is immaculate, the word of the Lord is tried by fire: he is the shield of all that trust in him. ³² Who is God but the Lord: and who is strong but our God? ³³ God who hath girded me with strength, and made my way perfect. ³⁴ Making my feet like the feet of harts, and setting me upon my high places. ³⁵ He teacheth my hands to war: and maketh my arms like a bow of brass. ³⁶ Thou hast given me the shield of my salvation: and thy mildness hath multiplied me. ³⁷ Thou shalt enlarge my steps under me: and my ankles shall not fail. ³⁸ I will pursue after my enemies, and crush them: and will not return again till I consume them. ³⁹ I will consume them and break them in pieces, so that they shall not rise: they shall fall under my feet. ⁴⁰ Thou hast girded me with strength to battle: thou hast made them that resisted me to bow under me. ⁴¹ My enemies thou hast made to turn their back to me: them that hated me, and I shall destroy them. ⁴² They shall cry, and there shall be none to save: to the Lord, and he shall not hear them. ⁴³ I shall beat them as small as the dust of the earth: I shall crush them and spread them abroad like the mire of the streets. ⁴⁴ Thou wilt save me from the contradictions of my people: thou wilt keep me to be the head of the Gentiles: the people which I know not, shall serve me, ⁴⁵ The sons of the stranger will resist me, at the hearing of the ear they will obey me. ⁴⁶ The strangers are melted away, and shall be straitened in their distresses. ⁴⁷ The Lord liveth, and my God is blessed: and the strong God of my salvation shall be exalted: ⁴⁸ God who giveth me revenge, and bringest down people under me, ⁴⁹ Who bringest me forth from my enemies, and liftest me up from them that resist me: from the wicked man thou shalt deliver me. ⁵⁰ Therefore will I give thanks to thee, O Lord, among the Gentiles, and will sing to thy name. ⁵¹ Giving great salvation to his king, and shewing mercy to David his anointed, and to his seed for ever.

23 ¹ Now these are David's last words. David the son of Isai said: The man to whom it was appointed concerning the Christ of the God of Jacob, the excellent psalmist of Israel said: ² The spirit of the Lord hath spoken by me and his word by my tongue. ³ The God of Israel said to me, the strong one of Israel spoke, the ruler of men, the just ruler in the fear of God. ⁴ As the light of the morning, when the sun riseth, shineth in the morning without clouds, and as the grass springeth out of the earth by rain. ⁵ Neither is my house so great with God, that he should make with me an eternal covenant, firm in all things and assured. For he is all my salvation, and all my will: neither is there ought thereof that springeth not up. ⁶ But transgressors shall all of them be plucked up as thorns: which are not taken away with hands. ⁷ And if a man will touch them, he must be armed with iron and with the staff of a lance: but they shall be set on fire and burnt to nothing.

⁸ These are the names of the valiant men of David: Jesbaham sitting in the chair was the wisest chief among the three, he was like the most tender little worm of the wood, who killed eight

hundred men at one onset. ⁹ After him was Eleazar the son of Dodo the Ahohite, one of the three valiant men that were with David when they defied the Philistines, and they were there gathered together to battle. ¹⁰ And when the men of Israel were gone away, he stood and smote the Philistines till his hand was weary, and grew stiff with the sword: and the Lord wrought a great victory that day: and the people that were fled away, returned to take spoils of them that were slain. ¹¹ And after him was Semma the son of Age of Arari. And the Philistines were gathered together in a troop: for there was a field full of lentils. And when the people were fled from the face of the Philistines, ¹² He stood in the midst of the field, and defended it, and defeated the Philistines: and the Lord gave a great victory. ¹³ Moreover also before this the three who were princes among the thirty, went down and came to David in the harvest time into the cave of Odollam: and the camp of the Philistines was in the valley of the giants. ¹⁴ And David was then in a hold: and there was a garrison of the Philistines then in Bethlehem. ¹⁵ And David longed, and said: O that some man would get me a drink of the water out of the cistern, that is in Bethlehem, by the gate. ¹⁶ And the three valiant men broke through the camp of the Philistines, and drew water out of the cistern of Bethlehem, that was by the gate, and brought it to David: but he would not drink, but offered it to the Lord, ¹⁷ Saying: The Lord be merciful to me, that I may not do this: shall I drink the blood of these men that went, and the peril of their lives? therefore he would not drink. These things did these three mighty men. ¹⁸ Abisai also the brother of Joab, the son of Sarvia, was chief among three: and he lifted up his spear against three hundred whom he slew, and he was renowned among the three, ¹⁹ And the noblest of three, and was their chief, but to the three first he attained not. ²⁰ And Banaias the son of Joiada a most valiant man, of great deeds, of Cabseel: he slew the two lions of Moab, and he went down, and slew a lion in the midst of a pit, in the time of snow. ²¹ He also slew an Egyptian, a man worthy to be a sight, having a spear in his hand: but he went down to him with a rod, and forced the spear out of the hand of the Egyptian, and slew him with his own spear. ²² These things did Banaias the son of Joiada. ²³ And he was renowned among the three valiant men, who were the most honourable among the thirty: but he attained not to the first three: and David made him of his privy council. ²⁴ Asael the brother of Joab was one of the thirty, Elehanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem. ²⁵ Semma of Harodi, Elica of Harodi, ²⁶ Heles of Phalti, Hira the son of Acces of Thecua, ²⁷ Abiezer of Anathoth, Mobonnai of Husati, ²⁸ Selmon the Ahohite, Maharai the Netophathite, ²⁹ Heled the son of Baana, also a Netophathite, Ithai the son of Ribai of Gabaath of the children of Benjamin, ³⁰ Banaia the Pharathonite, Heddaï of the torrent Gaas, ³¹ Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth of Beromi, ³² Eliaba of Salaboni. The sons of Jassen, Jonathan, ³³ Semma of Oriori, Aliam the son of Sarar the Arorite, ³⁴ Eliphelet the son of Aasbai the son of Machati, Eliam the son of Achiphel the Gelonite, ³⁵ Hesrai of Carmel, Pharai of Arbi, ³⁶ Igaal the son of Nathan of Soba, Bonni of Gadi, ³⁷ Selec of Ammoni, Naharai the Berothite, armourbearer of Joab the son of Sarvia, ³⁸ Ira the Jethrite, Gareb also a Jethrite, ³⁹ Urias the Hethite, thirty and seven in all.

169. The census, the plague, and the threshing floor

2 Samuel 24:1-25

The threshing floor of Areuna is where the temple will stand.

24 ¹ And the anger of the Lord was again kindled against Israel, and stirred up David among them, saying: Go, number Israel and Juda. ² And the king said to Joab the general of his army: Go through all the tribes of Israel from Dan to Bersabee, and number ye the people that I may know the number of them. ³ And Joab said to the king: The Lord thy God increase thy people, and make them as many more as they are now, and again multiply them a hundredfold in the sight of my lord the king: but what meaneth my lord the king by this kind of thing? ⁴ But the king's words prevailed over the words of Joab, and of the captains of the army: and Joab, and the captains of the soldiers went out from the presence of the king, to number the people of Israel. ⁵ And when they had passed the Jordan, they came to Aroer to the right side of the city, which is in the vale of Gad. ⁶ And by Jazer they passed into Galaad, and to the lower land of Hodsi, and they came into the woodlands of Dan. And going about by Sidon, ⁷ They passed near the walls of Tyre, and all the land of the Hevite, and the Chanaanite, and they came to the south of Juda into Bersabee: ⁸ And having gone through the whole land, after nine months and twenty days, they came to Jerusalem. ⁹ And Joab gave up the sum of the number of the people to the king, and there were found of Israel eight hundred thousand valiant men that drew the sword: and of Juda five hundred thousand fighting men.

¹⁰ But David's heart struck him, after the people were numbered: and David said to the Lord: I have sinned very much in what I have done: but I pray thee, O Lord, to take away the iniquity of thy servant, because I have done exceeding foolishly. ¹¹ And David arose in the morning, and the word of the Lord came to Gad the prophet and the seer of David, saying: ¹² Go, and say to David: Thus saith the Lord: I give thee thy choice of three things, choose one of them which thou wilt, that I may do it to thee. ¹³ And when Gad was come to David, he told him, saying: Either seven years of famine shall come to thee in thy land: or thou shalt flee three months before thy adversaries, and they shall pursue thee: or for three days there shall be a pestilence in thy land. Now therefore deliberate, and see what answer I shall return to him that sent me. ¹⁴ And David said to Gad: I am in a great strait: but it is better that I should fall into the hands of the Lord (for his mercies are many) than into the hands of men.

¹⁵ And the Lord sent a pestilence upon Israel, from the morning unto the time appointed, and there died of the people from Dan to Bersabee seventy thousand men. ¹⁶ And when the angel of the Lord had stretched out his hand over Jerusalem to destroy it, the Lord had pity on the affliction, and said to the angel that slew the people: It is enough: now hold thy hand. And the angel of the Lord was by the thrashingfloor of Areuna the Jebusite. ¹⁷ And David said to the Lord, when he saw the angel striking the people: It is I; I am he that have sinned, I have done wickedly: these that are the sheep, what have they done? let thy hand, I beseech thee, be turned against me, and against my father's house.

¹⁸ And Gad came to David that day, and said: Go up, and build an altar to the Lord in the thrashingfloor of Areuna the Jebusite.

¹⁹ And David went up according to the word of Gad which the Lord had commanded him. ²⁰ And Areuna looked, and saw the king and his servants coming towards him: ²¹ And going out he worshipped the king, bowing with his face to the earth, and said: Wherefore is my lord the king come to his servant? And David said to him: To buy the thrashingfloor of thee, and build an altar to the Lord, that the plague, which rageth among the people, may cease. ²² And Areuna said to David: Let my lord the king take, and offer, as it seemeth good to him: thou hast here oxen for a holocaust, and the wain, and the yokes of the oxen for wood. ²³ All these things Areuna as a king gave to the king: and Areuna said to the king: The Lord thy God receive thy vow. ²⁴ And the king answered him, and said: Nay, but I will buy it of thee, at a price, and I will not offer to the Lord my God holocausts free cost. So David bought the floor, and the oxen, for fifty sicles of silver: ²⁵ And David built there an altar to the Lord, and offered holocausts and peace offerings: and the Lord became merciful to the land, and the plague was stayed from Israel.

170. Psalm 22

Psalms 22:1-6

Vulgate 22 = Hebrew 23, "The Lord ruleth me." The numbering convention of this plan in one line: the shepherd psalm is 22, not 23.

22 ¹ A psalm for David. The Lord ruleth me: and I shall want nothing. ² He hath set me in a place of pasture. He hath brought me up, on the water of refreshment: ³ He hath converted my soul. He hath led me on the paths of justice, for his own name's sake. ⁴ For though I should walk in the midst of the shadow of death, I will fear no evils, for thou art with me. Thy rod and thy staff, they have comforted me. ⁵ Thou hast prepared a table before me against them that afflict me. Thou hast anointed my head with oil; and my chalice which inebriateth me, how goodly is it! ⁶ And thy mercy will follow me all the days of my life. And that I may dwell in the house of the Lord unto length of days.

171. Psalm 88

Psalms 88:1-53

Vulgate 88 = Hebrew 89: the oath sworn to David, and the complaint that it appears broken.

88 ¹ Of understanding, for Ethan the Ezrahite. ² The mercies of the Lord I will sing for ever. I will shew forth thy truth with my mouth to generation and generation. ³ For thou hast said: Mercy shall be built up for ever in the heavens: thy truth shall be prepared in them. ⁴ I have made a covenant with my elect: I have sworn to David my servant: ⁵ Thy seed will I settle for ever. And I will build up thy throne unto generation and generation. ⁶ The heavens shall confess thy wonders, O Lord: and thy truth in the church of the saints. ⁷ For who in the clouds can be compared to the Lord: or who among the sons of God shall be like to God? ⁸ God, who is glorified in the assembly of the saints: great and terrible above all them that are about him. ⁹ O Lord God of hosts, who is like to thee? thou art mighty, O Lord, and thy truth is round about thee. ¹⁰ Thou rulest the power of the sea: and appeasest the motion of the waves thereof. ¹¹ Thou hast humbled the proud one, as one that is slain: with the arm of

thy strength thou hast scattered thy enemies. ¹² Thine are the heavens, and thine is the earth: the world and the fulness thereof thou hast founded: ¹³ The north and the sea thou hast created. Thabor and Hermon shall rejoice in thy name: ¹⁴ Thy arm is with might. Let thy hand be strengthened, and thy right hand exalted: ¹⁵ Justice and judgment are the preparation of thy throne. Mercy and truth shall go before thy face: ¹⁶ Blessed is the people that knoweth jubilation. They shall walk, O Lord, in the light of thy countenance: ¹⁷ And in thy name they shall rejoice all the day, and in thy justice they shall be exalted. ¹⁸ For thou art the glory of their strength: and in thy good pleasure shall our horn be exalted. ¹⁹ For our protection is of the Lord, and of our king the holy one of Israel. ²⁰ Then thou spakest in a vision to thy saints, and saidst: I have laid help upon one that is mighty, and have exalted one chosen out of my people. ²¹ I have found David my servant: with my holy oil I have anointed him. ²² For my hand shall help him: and my arm shall strengthen him. ²³ The enemy shall have no advantage over him: nor the son of iniquity have power to hurt him. ²⁴ And I will cut down his enemies before his face; and them that hate him I will put to flight. ²⁵ And my truth and my mercy shall be with him: and in my name shall his horn be exalted. ²⁶ And I will set his hand in the sea; and his right hand in the rivers. ²⁷ He shall cry out to me: Thou art my father: my God, and the support of my salvation. ²⁸ And I will make him my firstborn, high above the kings of the earth. ²⁹ I will keep my mercy for him for ever: and my covenant faithful to him. ³⁰ And I will make his seed to endure for evermore: and his throne as the days of heaven. ³¹ And if his children forsake my law, and walk not in my judgments: ³² If they profane my justices: and keep not my commandments: ³³ I will visit their iniquities with a rod and their sins with stripes. ³⁴ But my mercy I will not take away from him: nor will I suffer my truth to fail. ³⁵ Neither will I profane my covenant: and the words that proceed from my mouth I will not make void. ³⁶ Once have I sworn by my holiness: I will not lie unto David: ³⁷ His seed shall endure for ever. ³⁸ And his throne as the sun before me: and as the moon perfect for ever, and a faithful witness in heaven. ³⁹ But thou hast rejected and despised: thou hast been angry with my anointed. ⁴⁰ Thou hast overthrown the covenant of thy servant: thou hast profaned his sanctuary on the earth. ⁴¹ Thou hast broken down all his hedges: thou hast made his strength fear. ⁴² All that pass by the way have robbed him: he is become a reproach to his neighbours. ⁴³ Thou hast set up the right hand of them that oppress him: thou hast made all his enemies to rejoice. ⁴⁴ Thou hast turned away the help of his sword; and hast not assisted him in battle. ⁴⁵ Thou hast made his purification to cease: and thou hast cast his throne down to the ground. ⁴⁶ Thou hast shortened the days of his time: thou hast covered him with confusion. ⁴⁷ How long, O Lord, turnest thou away unto the end? shall thy anger burn like fire? ⁴⁸ Remember what my substance is: for hast thou made all the children of men in vain? ⁴⁹ Who is the man that shall live, and not see death: that shall deliver his soul from the hand of hell? ⁵⁰ Lord, where are thy ancient mercies, according to what thou didst swear to David in thy truth? ⁵¹ Be mindful, O Lord, of the reproach of thy servants (which I have held in my bosom) of many nations: ⁵² Wherewith thy enemies have reproached,

O Lord; wherewith they have reproached the change of thy anointed. ⁵³ Blessed be the Lord for evermore. So be it. So be it.

THE DIVIDED MONARCHY

1 Kings entire and 2 Kings 1-17 - in the Douay-Rheims, the Third Book of Kings and the Fourth as far as the fall of Samaria. The period runs from Solomon to the deportation of the northern tribes. Isaias 7, 9 and 11 are read here, at the reign of Achaz to whom the first of them was spoken.

172. Adonias; the anointing of Solomon; David's charge

1 Kings 1:1-2:46

TRAP: this is Douay 3 Kings. Every modern 1 Kings citation in this period is Douay 3 Kings.

1 ¹ Now king David was old, and advanced in years: and when he was covered with clothes he was not warm. ² His servants therefore, said to him: Let us seek for our lord the king, a young virgin, and let her stand before the king, and cherish him, and sleep in his bosom and warm our lord the king. ³ So they sought a beautiful young woman, in all the coasts of Israel and they found Abisag, a Sunamitess, and brought her to the king. ⁴ And the damsel was exceedingly beautiful, and she slept with the king, and served him, but the king did not know her.

⁵ And Adonias, the son of Haggith, exalted himself, saying: I will be king. And he made himself chariots and horsemen, and fifty men to run before him. ⁶ Neither did his father rebuke him at any time, saying: Why hast thou done this? And he also was very beautiful, the next in birth after Absalom. ⁷ And he conferred with Joab, the son of Sarvia, and with Abiathar, the priest, who furthered Adonias's side. ⁸ But Sadoc, the priest, and Banaias, the son of Joiada, and Nathan, the prophet, and Semei, and Rei, and the strength of David's army, was not with Adonias. ⁹ And Adonias having slain rams and calves, and all fat cattle, by the stone of Zoheleth, which was near the fountain Rogel, invited all his brethren, the king's sons, and all the men of Juda, the king's servants: ¹⁰ But Nathan, the prophet, and Banaias, and all the valiant men, and Solomon, his brother, he invited not.

¹¹ And Nathan said to Bethsabee, the mother of Solomon: Hast thou not heard that Adonias, the son of Haggith, reigneth, and our lord David knoweth it not? ¹² Now then, come, take my counsel, and save thy life, and the life of thy son Solomon. ¹³ Go, and get thee in to king David, and say to him: Didst not thou, my lord, O king, swear to me, thy handmaid, saying: Solomon, thy son, shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne? why then doth Adonias reign? ¹⁴ And while thou art yet speaking there with the king, I will come in after thee, and will fill up thy words.

¹⁵ So Bethsabee went in to the king into the chamber. Now the king was very old, and Abisag, the Sunamitess, ministered to him. ¹⁶ Bethsabee bowed herself, and worshipped the king. And the king said to her: What is thy will? ¹⁷ She answered, and said: My lord, thou didst swear to thy handmaid, by the Lord thy God, saying: Solomon, thy son, shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne. ¹⁸ And behold, now Adonias reigneth, and thou, my lord the king, knowest nothing of it. ¹⁹ He hath killed oxen, and all fat cattle, and many rams, and invited all the king's sons, and Abiathar, the priest, and Joab, the general of

the army: but Solomon, thy servant, he invited not. ²⁰ And now, my lord, O king, the eyes of all Israel are upon thee, that thou shouldst tell them, who shall sit on thy throne, my lord the king, after thee. ²¹ Otherwise it shall come to pass, when my lord the king sleepeth with his fathers, that I, and my son, Solomon, shall be accounted offenders.

²² As she was yet speaking with the king, Nathan, the prophet, came. ²³ And they told the king, saying: Nathan, the prophet, is here. And when he was come in before the king, and had worshipped, bowing down to the ground, ²⁴ Nathan said: My lord, O king, hast thou said: Let Adonias reign after me, and let him sit upon my throne? ²⁵ Because he is gone down to day, and hath killed oxen, and fatlings, and many rams, and invited all the king's sons, and the captains of the army, and Abiathar the priest: and they are eating and drinking before him, and saying: God save king Adonias: ²⁶ But me, thy servant, and Sadoc, the priest, and Banaias, the son of Joiada, and Solomon, thy servant, he hath not invited. ²⁷ Is this word come out from my lord the king, and hast thou not told me, thy servant, who should sit on the throne of my lord the king after him?

²⁸ And king David answered, and said: Call to me Bethsabee. And when she was come in to the king, and stood before him, ²⁹ The king swore, and said: As the Lord liveth, who hath delivered my soul out of all distress, ³⁰ Even as I swore to thee, by the Lord, the God of Israel, saying: Solomon thy son, shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne in my stead, so will I do this day. ³¹ And Bethsabee, bowing with her face to the earth, worshipped the king, saying: May my lord David live for ever.

³² King David also said: Call me Sadoc, the priest, and Nathan, the prophet, and Banaias, the son of Joiada. And when they were come in before the king, ³³ He said to them: Take with you the servants of your lord, and set my son Solomon upon my mule: and bring him to Gihon: ³⁴ And let Sadoc, the priest, and Nathan, the prophet, anoint him there king over Israel: and you shall sound the trumpet, and shall say: God save king Solomon. ³⁵ And you shall come up after him, and he shall come, and shall sit upon my throne, and he shall reign in my stead: and I will appoint him to be ruler over Israel, and over Juda. ³⁶ And Banaias, the son of Joiada, answered the king, saying: Amen: so say the Lord, the God of my lord the king. ³⁷ As the Lord hath been with my lord the king, so be he with Solomon, and make his throne higher than the throne of my lord king David. ³⁸ So Sadoc, the priest, and Nathan, the prophet, went down, and Banaias, the son of Joiada, and the Cerethi, and Phelethi: and they set Solomon upon the mule of king David, and brought him to Gihon. ³⁹ And Sadoc, the priest, took a horn of oil out of the tabernacle, and anointed Solomon: and they sounded the trumpet, and all the people said: God save king Solomon. ⁴⁰ And all the multitude went up after him, and the people played with pipes, and rejoiced with a great joy, and the earth rang with the noise of their cry. ⁴¹ And Adonias, and all that were invited by him, heard it, and now the feast was at an end. Joab also, hearing the sound of the trumpet, said: What meaneth this noise of the city in an uproar? ⁴² While he yet spoke, Jonathan, the son of Abiathar, the priest, came: and Adonias said to him: Come in, because thou art a valiant man, and bringest good news. ⁴³ And Jonathan answered Adonias: Not so: for our lord, king David,

hath appointed Solomon king; ⁴⁴ And hath sent with him Sadoc, the priest, and Nathan, the prophet, and Banaias, the son of Joiada, and the Cerethi, and the Phelethi, and they have set him upon the king's mule: ⁴⁵ And Sadoc, the priest, and Nathan, the prophet, have anointed him king, in Gihon: and they are gone up from thence rejoicing, so that the city rang again: this is the noise that you have heard. ⁴⁶ Moreover, Solomon sitteth upon the throne of the kingdom. ⁴⁷ And the king's servants going in, have blessed our lord king David, saying: May God make the name of Solomon greater than thy name, and make his throne greater than thy throne. And the king adored in his bed: ⁴⁸ And he said: Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel, who hath given this day one to sit on my throne, my eyes seeing it. ⁴⁹ Then all the guests of Adonias were afraid, and they all arose, and every man went his way. ⁵⁰ And Adonias fearing Solomon, arose and went, and took hold of the horn of the altar. ⁵¹ And they told Solomon, saying: Behold Adonias fearing king Solomon, hath taken hold of the horn of the altar, saying: Let king Solomon swear to me this day, that he will not kill his servant with the sword. ⁵² And Solomon said: If he be a good man, there shall not so much as one hair of his head fall to the ground: but if evil be found in him, he shall die. ⁵³ Then king Solomon sent, and brought him out from the altar: and going in, he worshipped king Solomon: and Solomon said to him: Go to thy house.

2 ¹ And the days of David drew nigh that he should die, and he charged his son Solomon, saying: ² I am going the way of all flesh: take thou courage and shew thyself a man. ³ And keep the charge of the Lord thy God, to walk in his ways, and observe his ceremonies, and his precepts, and judgments, and testimonies, as it is written in the law of Moses: that thou mayst understand all thou dost, and whithersoever thou shalt turn thyself: ⁴ That the Lord may confirm his words, which he hath spoken of me, saying: If thy children shall take heed to their ways, and shall walk before me in truth, with all their heart, and with all their soul, there shall not be taken away from thee a man on the throne of Israel. ⁵ Thou knowest also what Joab, the son of Sarvia, hath done to me, what he did to the two captains of the army of Israel, to Abner, the son of Ner, and to Amasa, the son of Jether: whom he slew, and shed the blood of war in peace, and put the blood of war on his girdle that was about his loins, and in his shoes that were on his feet. ⁶ Do, therefore, according to thy wisdom, and let not his hoary head go down to hell in peace. ⁷ But shew kindness to the sons of Berzellai, the Galaadite, and let them eat at thy table: for they met me when I fled from the face of Absalom, thy brother. ⁸ Thou hast also with thee Semei, the son of Gera, the son of Jemini, of Bahurim, who cursed me with a grievous curse, when I went to the camp: but because he came down to meet me when I passed over the Jordan, and I swore to him by the Lord, saying: I will not kill thee with the sword: ⁹ Do not thou hold him guiltless. But thou art a wise man, and knowest what to do with him, and thou shalt bring down his grey hairs with blood to the grave. ¹⁰ So David slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David. ¹¹ And the days that David reigned in Israel, were forty years: in Hebron he reigned seven years, in Jerusalem thirty-three. ¹² And Solomon sat upon the throne of his father David, and his kingdom was strengthened exceedingly.

¹³ And Adonias, the son of Haggith, came to Bethsabee the mother of Solomon. And she said to him: Is thy coming peaceable? He answered: It is peaceable. ¹⁴ And he added: I have a word to speak with thee. She said to him: Speak. And he said: ¹⁵ Thou knowest that the kingdom was mine, and all Israel had preferred me to be their king: but the kingdom is transferred, and is become my brother's: for it was appointed him by the Lord. ¹⁶ Now therefore, I ask one petition of thee; turn not away my face. And she said to him: Say on. ¹⁷ And he said I pray thee speak to king Solomon (for he cannot deny thee any thing) to give me Abisag, the Sunamitess, to wife. ¹⁸ And Bethsabee said: Well, I will speak for thee to the king.

¹⁹ Then Bethsabee came to king Solomon, to speak to him for Adonias: and the king arose to meet her, and bowed to her, and sat down upon his throne: and a throne was set for the king's mother, and she sat on his right hand. ²⁰ And she said to him: I desire one small petition of thee; do not put me to confusion. And the king said to her: My mother ask, for I must not turn away thy face. ²¹ And she said: Let Abisag, the Sunamitess, be given to Adonias, thy brother, to wife. ²² And king Solomon answered, and said to his mother: Why dost thou ask Abisag, the Sunamitess, for Adonias? ask for him also the kingdom; for he is my elder brother, and hath Abiathar, the priest, and Joab, the son of Sarvia. ²³ Then king Solomon swore by the Lord, saying: So and so may God do to me, and add more, if Adonias hath not spoken this word against his own life. ²⁴ And now, as the Lord liveth, who hath established me, and placed me upon the throne of David, my father, and who hath made me a house, as he promised, Adonias shall be put to death this day. ²⁵ And king Solomon sent by the hand of Banaias, the son of Joiada, who slew him, and he died. ²⁶ And the king said also to Abiathar, the priest: Go to Anathoth, to thy lands, for indeed thou art worthy of death: but I will not at this time put thee to death, because thou didst carry the ark of the Lord God before David, my father, and hast endured trouble in all the troubles my father endured. ²⁷ So Solomon cast out Abiathar from being the priest of the Lord, that the word of the Lord might be fulfilled, which he spoke concerning the house of Heli in Silo.

²⁸ And the news came to Joab, because Joab had turned after Adonias, and had not turned after Solomon: and Joab fled into the tabernacle of the Lord, and took hold on the horn of the altar. ²⁹ And it was told king Solomon, that Joab was fled into the tabernacle of the Lord, and was by the altar: and Solomon sent Banaias, the son of Joiada, saying. Go, kill him. ³⁰ And Banaias came to the tabernacle of the Lord, and said to him: Thus saith the king: Come forth. And he said: I will not come forth, but here I will die. Banaias brought word back to the king, saying: Thus saith Joab, and thus he answered me. ³¹ And the king said to him: Do as he hath said; and kill him, and bury him, and thou shalt remove the innocent blood which hath been shed by Joab, from me, and from the house of my father: ³² And the Lord shall return his blood upon his own head; because he murdered two men, just and better than himself: and slew them with the sword, my father, David, not knowing it; Abner, the son of Ner, general of the army of Israel, and Amasa, the son of Jether general of the army of Juda; ³³ And their blood shall return upon the head of Joab, and upon the head of his seed for ever. But to David

and his seed, and his house, and to his throne, be peace for ever from the Lord. ³⁴ So Banaïas, the son of Joiada, went up, and setting upon him slew him, and he was buried in his house in the desert. ³⁵ And the king appointed Banaïas, the son of Joiada in his room over the army; and Sadoc, the priest, he put in the place of Abiathar.

³⁶ The king also sent, and called for Semei, and said to him: Build thee a house in Jerusalem, and dwell there: and go not out from thence any where. ³⁷ For on what day soever thou shalt go out, and shalt pass over the brook Cedron, know that thou shalt be put to death: thy blood shall be upon thy own head. ³⁸ And Semei said to the king: The saying is good: as my lord the king hath said, so will thy servant do. And Semei dwelt in Jerusalem many days. ³⁹ And it came to pass after three years, that the servants of Semei ran away to Achis, the son of Maacha, the king of Geth: and it was told Semei that his servants were gone to Geth. ⁴⁰ And Semei arose, and saddled his ass, and went to Achis, to Geth, to seek his servants, and he brought them out of Geth. ⁴¹ And it was told Solomon, that Semei had gone from Jerusalem to Geth, and was come back. ⁴² And sending he called for him, and said to him: Did I not protest to thee by the Lord, and tell thee before: On what day soever thou shalt go out and walk abroad any where, know that thou shalt die? And thou answeredst me: The word that I have heard is good. ⁴³ Why then hast thou not kept the oath of the Lord, and the commandment that I laid upon thee? ⁴⁴ And the king said to Semei: Thou knowest all the evil, of which thy heart is conscious, which thou didst to David, my father: the Lord hath returned thy wickedness upon thy own head. ⁴⁵ And king Solomon shall be blessed, and the throne of David shall be established before the Lord for ever. ⁴⁶ So the king commanded Banaïas, the son of Joiada: and he went out and struck him; and he died.

173. The gift of wisdom, and the two mothers

1 Kings 3:1-28

3 ¹ And the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon, and he made affinity with Pharaoh, the king of Egypt: for he took his daughter, and brought her into the city of David: until he had made an end of building his own house, and the house of the Lord, and the wall of Jerusalem round about. ² But yet the people sacrificed in the high places: for there was no temple built to the name of the Lord until that day. ³ And Solomon loved the Lord, walking in the precepts of David, his father; only he sacrificed in the high places, and burnt incense. ⁴ He went therefore to Gabaon, to sacrifice there: for that was the great high place: a thousand victims for holocausts, did Solomon offer upon that altar, in Gabaon. ⁵ And the Lord appeared to Solomon in a dream by night, saying: Ask what thou wilt that I should give thee. ⁶ And Solomon said: Thou hast shewed great mercy to thy servant David, my father, even as he walked before thee in truth, and justice, and an upright heart with thee: and thou hast kept thy great mercy for him, and hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day. ⁷ And now, O Lord God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David, my father: and I am but a child, and know not how to go out and come in; ⁸ And thy servant is in the midst of the people which thou hast chosen, an immense people, which cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude. ⁹ Give therefore to thy servant an

understanding heart, to judge thy people, and discern between good and evil. For who shall be able to judge this people, thy people, which is so numerous? ¹⁰ And the word was pleasing to the Lord, that Solomon had asked such a thing. ¹¹ And the Lord said to Solomon: Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life nor riches, nor the lives of thy enemies, but hast asked for thyself wisdom to discern judgment; ¹² Behold I have done for thee according to thy words, and have given thee a wise and understanding heart, in so much that there hath been no one like thee before thee, nor shall arise after thee. ¹³ Yea, and the things also which thou didst not ask, I have given thee; to wit, riches and glory: so that no one hath been like thee among the kings in all days heretofore. ¹⁴ And if thou wilt walk in my ways, and keep my precepts and my commandments, as thy father walked, I will lengthen thy days. ¹⁵ And Solomon awaked, and perceived that it was a dream: and when he was come to Jerusalem, he stood before the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and offered holocausts, and sacrificed victims of peace offerings, and made a great feast for all his servants.

¹⁶ Then there came two women that were harlots, to the king, and stood before him. ¹⁷ And one of them said: I beseech thee, my lord, I and this woman dwelt in one house, and I was delivered of a child with her in the chamber. ¹⁸ And the third day after I was delivered, she also was delivered; and we were together, and no other person with us in the house; only we two. ¹⁹ And this woman's child died in the night: for in her sleep she overlaid him. ²⁰ And rising in the dead time of the night, she took my child from my side, while I, thy handmaid, was asleep, and laid it in her bosom: and laid her dead child in my bosom. ²¹ And when I arose in the morning, to give my child suck, behold it was dead: but considering him more diligently, when it was clear day, I found that it was not mine which I bore. ²² And the other woman answered: It is not so as thou sayest, but thy child is dead, and mine is alive. On the contrary, she said; Thou liest: for my child liveth, and thy child is dead. And in this manner they strove before the king. ²³ Then said the king: The one saith, My child is alive, and thy child is dead. And the other answereth: Nay; but thy child is dead, and mine liveth. ²⁴ The king therefore said: Bring me a sword. And when they had brought a sword before the king, ²⁵ Divide, said he, the living child in two, and give half to the one and half to the other. ²⁶ But the woman, whose child was alive, said to the king; (for her bowels were moved upon her child) I beseech thee, my lord, give her the child alive, and do not kill it. But the other said: Let it be neither mine nor thine; but divide it. ²⁷ The king answered, and said: Give the living child to this woman, and let it not be killed; for she is the mother thereof. ²⁸ And all Israel heard the judgment which the king had judged, and they feared the king, seeing that the wisdom of God was in him to do judgment.

174. Psalm 71

Psalms 71:1-20

Vulgate 71 = Hebrew 72, inscribed "a psalm on Solomon": the king's son, and a reign of peace to the ends of the earth.

71 ¹ A psalm on Solomon. ² Give to the king thy judgment, O God, and to the king's son thy justice: To judge thy people with justice, and thy poor with judgment. ³ Let the mountains receive

peace for the people: and the hills justice. ⁴ He shall judge the poor of the people, and he shall save the children of the poor: and he shall humble the oppressor. ⁵ And he shall continue with the sun and before the moon, throughout all generations. ⁶ He shall come down like rain upon the fleece; and as showers falling gently upon the earth. ⁷ In his days shall justice spring up, and abundance of peace, till the moon be taken away. ⁸ And he shall rule from sea to sea, and from the river unto the ends of the earth. ⁹ Before him the Ethiopians shall fall down: and his enemies shall lick the ground. ¹⁰ The kings of Tharsis and the islands shall offer presents: the kings of the Arabians and of Saba shall bring gifts: ¹¹ And all kings of the earth shall adore him: all nations shall serve him. ¹² For he shall deliver the poor from the mighty: and the needy that had no helper. ¹³ He shall spare the poor and needy: and he shall save the souls of the poor. ¹⁴ He shall redeem their souls from usuries and iniquity: and their names shall be honourable in his sight. ¹⁵ And he shall live, and to him shall be given of the gold of Arabia, for him they shall always adore: they shall bless him all the day. ¹⁶ And there shall be a firmament on the earth on the tops of mountains, above Libanus shall the fruit thereof be exalted: and they of the city shall flourish like the grass of the earth. ¹⁷ Let his name be blessed for evermore: his name continueth before the sun. And in him shall all the tribes of the earth be blessed: all nations shall magnify him. ¹⁸ Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel, who alone doth wonderful things. ¹⁹ And blessed be the name of his majesty for ever: and the whole earth shall be filled with his majesty. So be it. So be it. ²⁰ The praises of David, the son of Jesse, are ended.

175. The glory of the reign; preparation for the temple

1 Kings 4:1-5:18

⁴ ¹ And king Solomon reigned over all Israel: ² And these were the princes which he had: Azarias, the son of Sadoc, the priest: ³ Elihoreph, and Ahia, the sons of Sisa, scribes: Josaphat, the son of Ahilud, recorder: ⁴ Banaias, the son of Joiada, over the army: and Sadoc, and Abiathar, priests. ⁵ Azarias, the son of Nathan, over them that were about the king: Zabud, the son of Nathan, the priest, the king's friend: ⁶ And Ahisar, governor of the house: and Adoniram, the son of Abda, over the tribute.

⁷ And Solomon had twelve governors over all Israel, who provided victuals for the king and for his house hold: for every one provided necessities, each man his month in the year. ⁸ And these are their names: Benhur, in mount Ephraim. ⁹ Bendecar, in Maccas, and in Salebim, and in Bethsames, and in Elon, and in Bethanan. ¹⁰ Benhesed, in Aruboth: his was Socho, and all the land of Ephraim. ¹¹ Benabinadab, to whom belonged all Nephthad: he had Tapheth, the daughter of Solomon, to wife. ¹² Bana, the son of Ahilud, who governed Thanac, and Mageddo, and all Bethsan, which is by Sarthana, beneath Jezrael, from Bethsan unto Abelmehula, over against Jecmaan. ¹³ Bengaber, in Ramoth Galaad: he had the town of Jair, the son of Manasses, in Galaad: he was chief in all the country of Argob, which is in Basan, threescore great cities with walls, and brazen bolts. ¹⁴ Ahinadab, the son of Addo, was chief in Manaim. ¹⁵ Achimaas, in Nephthali: he also had Basemath, the daughter of Solomon, to wife. ¹⁶ Baana, the son of Husi, in Aser, and in Baloth. ¹⁷ Josaphat, the son of Pharue, in Issachar. ¹⁸ Semei, the son of Ela, in Benjamin. ¹⁹ Gaber, the son of Uri, in the land of Galaad, in the land of

Sehon, the king of the Amorrhites, and of Og, the king of Basan, over all that were in that land.

²⁰ Juda and Israel were innumerable, as the sand of the sea in multitude; eating and drinking, and rejoicing. ²¹ And Solomon had under him all the kingdoms, from the river to the land of the Philistines, even to the border of Egypt: and they brought him presents, and served him all the days of his life. ²² And the provision of Solomon, for each day, was thirty measures of fine flour, and threescore measures of meal; ²³ Ten fat oxen, and twenty out of the pastures, and a hundred rams; besides venison of harts, roes, and buffles, and fatted fowls. ²⁴ For he had all the country which was beyond the river, from Thaphsa to Gazan, and all the kings of those countries: and he had peace on every side round about. ²⁵ And Juda, and Israel, dwelt without any fear, every one under his vine, and under his fig tree, from Dan to Bersabee, all the days of Solomon. ²⁶ And Solomon had forty thousand stalls of chariot horses, and twelve thousand for the saddle. ²⁷ And the foresaid governors of the king fed them; and they furnished the necessities also for king Solomon's table, with great care, in their time. ²⁸ They brought barley also, and straw for the horses and beasts, to the place where the king was, according as it was appointed them. ²⁹ And God gave to Solomon wisdom, and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart, as the sand that is on the sea shore. ³⁰ And the wisdom of Solomon surpassed the wisdom of all the Orientals, and of the Egyptians; ³¹ And he was wiser than all men: wiser than Ethan, the Ezrahite, and Heman, and Chalcol, and Dorda, the sons of Mahol, and he was renowned in all nations round about. ³² Solomon also spoke three thousand parables: and his poems were a thousand and five. ³³ And he treated about trees, from the cedar that is in Libanus, unto the hyssop that cometh out of the wall: and he discoursed of beasts, and of fowls, and of creeping things, and of fishes. ³⁴ And they came from all nations to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and from all the kings of the earth, who heard of his wisdom.

⁵ ¹ And Hiram, king of Tyre, sent his servants to Solomon: for he heard that they had anointed him king in the room of his father: for Hiram had always been David's friend. ² And Solomon sent to Hiram, saying: ³ Thou knowest the will of David, my father, and that he could not build a house to the name of the Lord his God, because of the wars that were round about him, until the Lord put them under the soles of his feet. ⁴ But now the Lord my God hath given me rest round about; and there is no adversary nor evil occurrence. ⁵ Wherefore I purpose to build a temple to the name of the Lord my God, as the Lord spoke to David my father, saying: Thy son, whom I will set upon the throne, in thy place, he shall build a house to my name. ⁶ Give orders, therefore, that thy servants cut me down cedar trees, out of Libanus, and let my servants be with thy servants: and I will give thee the hire of thy servants whatsoever thou wilt ask: for thou knowest how there is not among my people a man that has skill to hew wood like to the Sidonians.

⁷ Now when Hiram had heard the words of Solomon, he rejoiced exceedingly, and said: Blessed be the Lord God this day, who hath given to David a very wise son over this numerous people. ⁸ And Hiram sent to Solomon, saying: I have heard all thou hast desired of me; and I will do all thy desire concern-

ing cedar trees, and fir trees. ⁹ My servants shall bring them down from Libanus to the sea: and I will put them together in floats, on the sea, and convey them to the place, which thou shalt signify to me, and will land them there, and thou shalt receive them: and thou shalt allow me necessities to furnish food for my household.

¹⁰ So Hiram gave Solomon cedar trees, and fir trees, according to all his desire. ¹¹ And Solomon allowed Hiram twenty thousand measures of wheat, for provision for his house, and twenty measures of the purest oil: thus gave Solomon to Hiram every year. ¹² And the Lord gave wisdom to Solomon, as he promised him: and there was peace between Hiram and Solomon, and they two made a league together.

¹³ And king Solomon chose workmen out of all Israel, and the levy was of thirty thousand men. ¹⁴ And he sent them to Libanus, ten thousand every month, by turns, so that two months they were at home: and Adoniram was over this levy. ¹⁵ And Solomon had seventy thousand to carry burdens, and eighty thousand to hew stones in the mountain: ¹⁶ Besides the overseers who were over every work, in number three thousand and three hundred, that ruled over the people, and them that did the work. ¹⁷ And the king commanded that they should bring great stones, costly stones, for the foundation of the temple, and should square them: ¹⁸ And the masons of Solomon, and the masons of Hiram, hewed them: and the Giblians prepared timber and stones to build the house.

176. The temple built and furnished

1 Kings 6:1-7:51

6 ¹ And it came to pass in the four hundred and eightieth year after the children of Israel came out of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of the reign of Solomon over Israel, in the month Zio, (the same is the second month) he began to build a house to the Lord. ² And the house, which king Solomon built to the Lord, was threescore cubits in length, and twenty cubits in breadth, and thirty cubits in height. ³ And there was a porch before the temple, of twenty cubits in length, according to the measure of the breadth of the temple: and it was ten cubits in breadth, before the face of the temple. ⁴ And he made in the temple oblique windows. ⁵ And upon the wall of the temple, he built floors round about, in the walls of the house, round about the temple and the oracle, and he made chambers in the sides round about. ⁶ The floor that was underneath was five cubits in breadth, and the middle floor was six cubits in breadth, and the third floor was seven cubits in breadth. And he put beams in the house round about on the outside, that they might not be fastened in the walls of the temple. ⁷ And the house, when it was in building, was built of stones, hewed and made ready: so that there was neither hammer nor axe, nor any tool of iron heard in the house when it was in building. ⁸ The door, for the middle side, was on the right hand of the house: and by winding stairs they went up to the middle room, and from the middle to the third. ⁹ So he built the house, and finished it: and he covered the house with roofs of cedar. ¹⁰ And he built a floor over all the house, five cubits in height, and he covered the house with timber of cedar.

¹¹ And the word of the Lord came to Solomon, saying: ¹² As for this house, which thou art building, if thou wilt walk in my

statutes, and execute my judgments, and keep all my commandments, walking in them, I will fulfil my word to thee, which I spoke to David thy father. ¹³ And I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel, and I will not forsake my people Israel. ¹⁴ So Solomon built the house, and finished it. ¹⁵ And he built the walls of the house on the inside, with boards of cedar, from the floor of the house to the top of the walls, and to the roofs, he covered it with boards of cedar on the inside: and he covered the floor of the house with planks of fir. ¹⁶ And he built up twenty cubits with boards of cedar at the hinder part of the temple, from the floor to the top: and made the inner house of the oracle to be the holy of holies. ¹⁷ And the temple itself, before the doors of the oracle, was forty cubits long. ¹⁸ And all the house was covered within with cedar, having the turnings, and the joints thereof artfully wrought, and carvings projecting out: all was covered with boards of cedar: and no stone could be seen in the wall at all. ¹⁹ And he made the oracle in the midst of the house, in the inner part, to set there the ark of the covenant of the Lord. ²⁰ Now the oracle was twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits in breadth, and twenty cubits in height. And he covered it, and overlaid it with most pure gold. And the altar also he covered with cedar. ²¹ And the house before the oracle he overlaid with most pure gold, and fastened on the plates with nails of gold. ²² And there was nothing in the temple that was not covered with gold: the whole altar of the oracle he covered also with gold.

²³ And he made in the oracle two cherubims of olive tree, of ten cubits in height. ²⁴ One wing of the cherub was five cubits, and the other wing of the cherub was five cubits: that is, in all ten cubits, from the extremity of one wing to the extremity of the other wing. ²⁵ The second cherub also was ten cubits: and the measure, and the work was the same in both the cherubims: ²⁶ That is to say, one cherub was ten cubits high, and in like manner the other cherub. ²⁷ And he set the cherubims in the midst of the inner temple: and the cherubims stretched forth their wings, and the wing of the one touched one wall, and the wing of the other cherub touched the other wall: and the other wings in the midst of the temple touched one another. ²⁸ And he overlaid the cherubims with gold. ²⁹ And all the walls of the temple round about he carved with divers figures and carvings: and he made in them cherubims and palm trees, and divers representations, as it were standing out, and coming forth from the wall. ³⁰ And the floor of the house he also overlaid with gold within and without. ³¹ And in the entrance of the oracle, he made little doors of olive tree, and posts of five corners, ³² And two doors of olive tree: and he carved upon them figures of cherubims, and figures of palm trees, and carvings very much projecting; and he overlaid them with gold: and he covered both the cherubims and the palm trees, and the other things, with gold. ³³ And he made in the entrance of the temple posts of olive tree foursquare: ³⁴ And two doors of fir tree, one of each side: and each door was double, and so opened with folding leaves. ³⁵ And he carved cherubims, and palm trees, and carved work standing very much out: and he overlaid all with golden plates in square work by rule. ³⁶ And he built the inner court with three rows of polished stones, and one row of beams of cedar.

³⁷ In the fourth year was the house of the Lord founded, in the month Zio: ³⁸ And in the eleventh year, in the month Bul. (which is the eighth month) the house was finished in all the works thereof, and in all the appurtenances thereof: and he was seven years in building it.

7 ¹ And Solomon built his own house in thirteen years, and brought it to perfection. ² He built also the house of the forest of Libanus; the length of it was a hundred cubits, and the breadth fifty cubits, and the height thirty cubits: and four galleries between pillars of cedar: for he had cut cedar trees into pillars. ³ And he covered the whole vault with boards of cedar, and it was held up with five and forty pillars. And one row had fifteen pillars, ⁴ Set one against another, ⁵ And looking one upon another, with equal space between the pillars, and over the pillars were square beams in all things equal. ⁶ And he made a porch of pillars of fifty cubits in length, and thirty cubits in breadth: and another porch before the greater porch, and pillars, and chapiters upon the pillars. ⁷ He made also the porch of the throne wherein is the seat of judgment; and covered it with cedar wood from the floor to the top. ⁸ And in the midst of the porch, was a small house, where he sat in judgment of the like work. He made also a house for the daughter of Pharaoh (whom Solomon had taken to wife) of the same work, as this porch; ⁹ All of costly stones, which were sawed by a certain rule and measure, both within and without: from the foundation to the top of the walls, and without, unto the great court. ¹⁰ And the foundations were of costly stones, great stones of ten cubits or eight cubits. ¹¹ And above there were costly stones of equal measure hewed, and in like manner planks of cedar. ¹² And the great court was made round with three rows of hewed stones, and one row of planks of cedar, which also was observed in the inner court of the house of the Lord, and in the porch of the house.

¹³ And king Solomon sent, and brought Hiram from Tyre, ¹⁴ The son of a widow woman, of the tribe of Nephthali, whose father was a Tyrian, an artificer in brass, and full of wisdom, and understanding, and skill to work all work in brass. And when he was come to king Solomon, he wrought all his work. ¹⁵ And he cast two pillars in brass, each pillar was eighteen cubits high: and a line of twelve cubits compassed both the pillars. ¹⁶ He made also two chapiters of molten brass, to be set upon the tops of the pillars: the height of one chapter was five cubits, and the height of the other chapter was five cubits: ¹⁷ And a kind of network, and chain work wreathed together with wonderful art. Both the chapiters of the pillars were cast: seven rows of nets were on one chapter, and seven nets on the other chapter. ¹⁸ And he made the pillars, and two rows round about each network to cover the chapiters, that were upon the top, with pomegranates: and in like manner did he to the other chapter. ¹⁹ And the chapiters that were upon the top of the pillars, were of lily work, in the porch of four cubits. ²⁰ And again there were other chapiters on the top of the pillars above, according to the measure of the pillar over against the network: and of pomegranates there were two hundred, in rows round about the other chapter. ²¹ And he set up the two pillars in the porch of the temple: and when he had set up the pillar on the right hand, he called the name thereof Jachin: in like manner he set up the second pillar, and

called the name thereof Booz. ²² And upon the tops of the pillars he made lily work: so the work of the pillars was finished.

²³ He made also a molten sea, of ten cubits, from brim to brim, round all about; the height of it was five cubits, and a line of thirty cubits compassed it round about. ²⁴ And a graven work, under the brim of it, compassed it for ten cubits going about the sea: there were two rows cast of chamfered sculptures. ²⁵ And it stood upon twelve oxen, of which three looked towards the north, and three towards the west, and three towards the south, and three towards the east: and the sea was above upon them, and their hinder parts were all hid within. ²⁶ And the laver was a hand breadth thick: and the brim thereof was like the brim of a cup, or the leaf of a crisped lily: it contained two thousand bates.

²⁷ And he made ten bases of brass, every base was four cubits in length, and four cubits in breadth, and three cubits high. ²⁸ And the work itself of the bases, was intergraven: and there were gravings between the joinings. ²⁹ And between the little crowns and the ledges, were lions, and oxen, and cherubims; and in the joinings likewise above: and under the lions and oxen, as it were bands of brass hanging down. ³⁰ And every base had four wheels, and axletrees of brass: and at the four sides were undersetters, under the laver molten, looking one against another. ³¹ The mouth also of the laver within, was in the top of the chapter: and that which appeared without, was of one cubit all round, and together it was one cubit and a half: and in the corners of the pillars were divers engravings: and the spaces between the pillars were square, not round. ³² And the four wheels, which were at the four corners of the base, were joined one to another under the base: the height of a wheel was a cubit and a half. ³³ And they were such wheels as are used to be made in a chariot: and their axletrees, and spokes, and strakes, and naves, were all cast. ³⁴ And the four undersetters, that were at every corner of each base, were of the base itself, cast and joined together. ³⁵ And on the top of the base, there was a round compass of half a cubit, so wrought that the laver might be set thereon, having its gravings, and divers sculptures of itself. ³⁶ He engraved also in those plates, which were of brass, and in the corners, cherubims, and lions, and palm trees, in likeness of a man standing, so that they seemed not to be engraven, but added round about. ³⁷ After this manner, he made ten bases, of one casting and measure, and the like graving. ³⁸ He made also ten lavers of brass: one laver contained four bases, and was of four cubits: and upon every base, in all ten, he put as many lavers. ³⁹ And he set the ten bases, five on the right side of the temple, and five on the left: and the sea he put on the right side of the temple, over against the east southward.

⁴⁰ And Hiram made cauldrons, and shovels, and basins, and finished all the work of king Solomon in the temple of the Lord. ⁴¹ The two pillars and the two cords of the chapiters, upon the chapiters of the pillars: and the two networks, to cover the two cords, that were upon the top of the pillars. ⁴² And four hundred pomegranates for the two networks: two rows of pomegranates for each network, to cover the cords of the chapiters, which were upon the tops of the pillars. ⁴³ And the ten bases, and the ten lavers on the bases. ⁴⁴ And one sea, and twelve oxen under the sea. ⁴⁵ And the cauldrons, and the shovels, and the basins. All

the vessels that Hiram made for king Solomon, for the house of the Lord, were of fine brass. ⁴⁶ In the plains of the Jordan, did the king cast them in a clay ground, between Socoth and Sartham. ⁴⁷ And Solomon placed all the vessels: but for its exceeding great multitude the brass could not be weighed.

⁴⁸ And Solomon made all the vessels for the house of the Lord: the altar of gold, and the table of gold, upon which the loaves of proposition should be set: ⁴⁹ And the golden candlesticks, five on the right hand, and five on the left, over against the oracle, of pure gold: and the flowers like lilies, and the lamps over them of gold: and golden snuffers, ⁵⁰ And pots, and fleshhooks, and bowls, and mortars, and censers, of most pure gold: and the hinges for the doors of the inner house of the holy of holies, and for the doors of the house of the temple, were of gold. ⁵¹ And Solomon finished all the work that he made in the house of the Lord, and brought in the things that David, his father, had dedicated, the silver and the gold, and the vessels, and laid them up in the treasures of the house of the Lord.

177. The dedication of the temple

1 Kings 8:1-66

8 ¹ Then all the ancients of Israel, with the princes of the tribes, and the heads of the families of the children of Israel, were assembled to king Solomon, in Jerusalem: that they might carry the ark of the covenant of the Lord, out of the city of David, that is, out of Sion. ² And all Israel assembled themselves to king Solomon, on the festival day, in the month of Ethanim, the same is the seventh month. ³ And all the ancients of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark, ⁴ And carried the ark of the Lord, and the tabernacle of the covenant, and all the vessels of the sanctuary, that were in the tabernacle: and the priests and the Levites carried them. ⁵ And king Solomon, and all the multitude of Israel, that were assembled unto him, went with him before the ark, and they sacrificed sheep and oxen, that could not be counted or numbered. ⁶ And the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the Lord into its place, into the oracle of the temple, into the holy of holies, under the wings of the cherubims. ⁷ For the cherubims spread forth their wings over the place of the ark, and covered the ark, and the staves thereof above. ⁸ And whereas the staves stood out, the ends of them were seen without, in the sanctuary before the oracle, but were not seen farther out, and there they have been unto this day. ⁹ Now in the ark there was nothing else but the two tables of stone, which Moses put there at Horeb, when the Lord made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt. ¹⁰ And it came to pass, when the priests were come out of the sanctuary, that a cloud filled the house of the Lord, ¹¹ And the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud: for the glory of the Lord had filled the house of the Lord.

¹² Then Solomon said: The Lord said that he would dwell in a cloud. ¹³ Building, I have built a house for thy dwelling, to be thy most firm throne for ever. ¹⁴ And the king turned his face, and blessed all the assembly of Israel: for all the assembly of Israel stood. ¹⁵ And Solomon said: Blessed be the Lord the God of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to David, my father, and with his own hands hath accomplished it, saying: ¹⁶ Since the day that I brought my people Israel, out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel, for a house to be built, that my name

might be there: but I chose David to be over my people Israel. ¹⁷ And David, my father, would have built a house to the name of the Lord, the God of Israel: ¹⁸ And the Lord said to David, my father: Whereas, thou hast thought in thy heart to build a house to my name, thou hast done well in having this same thing in thy mind. ¹⁹ Nevertheless, thou shalt not build me a house, but thy son, that shall come forth out of thy loins, he shall build a house to my name. ²⁰ The Lord hath performed his word which he spoke. And I stand in the room of David, my father, and sit upon the throne of Israel, as the Lord promised: and have built a house to the name of the Lord, the God of Israel. ²¹ And I have set there a place for the ark, wherein is the covenant of the Lord, which he made with our fathers, when they came out of the land of Egypt.

²² And Solomon stood before the altar of the Lord, in the sight of the assembly of Israel, and spread forth his hands towards heaven, ²³ And said: Lord God of Israel, there is no God like thee, in heaven above, or on the earth beneath: who keepest covenant and mercy with thy servants, that have walked before thee with all their heart: ²⁴ Who hast kept with thy servant David, my father, what thou hast promised him: with thy mouth thou didst speak, and with thy hands thou hast performed, as this day proveth. ²⁵ Now, therefore, O Lord God of Israel, keep with thy servant David, my father, what thou hast spoken to him, saying: There shall not be taken away of thee a man in my sight, to sit on the throne of Israel: yet so that thy children take heed to their way, that they walk before me as thou hast walked in my sight. ²⁶ And now, Lord God of Israel, let thy words be established, which thou hast spoken to thy servant David, my father. ²⁷ Is it then to be thought that God should indeed dwell upon earth? for if heaven, and the heavens of heavens, cannot contain thee, how much less this house which I have built? ²⁸ But have regard to the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplications, O Lord, my God: hear the hymn and the prayer, which thy servant prayeth before thee this day: ²⁹ That thy eyes may be open upon this house, night and day: upon the house of which thou hast said: My name shall be there: that thou mayst hearken to the prayer which thy servant prayeth, in this place to thee: ³⁰ That thou mayst hearken to the supplication of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, whatsoever they shall pray for in this place, and hear them in the place of thy dwelling in heaven; and when thou hearest, shew them mercy.

³¹ If any man trespass against his neighbour, and have an oath upon him, wherewith he is bound, and come, because of the oath, before thy altar, to thy house, ³² Then hear thou in heaven: and do and judge thy servants, condemning the wicked, and bringing his way upon his own head, and justifying the just, and rewarding him according to his justice.

³³ If thy people Israel shall fly before their enemies (because they will sin against thee) and doing penance, and confessing to thy name, shall come and pray, and make supplications to thee in this house: ³⁴ Then hear thou in heaven, and forgive the sin of thy people Israel, and bring them back to the land which thou gavest to their fathers.

³⁵ If heaven shall be shut up, and there shall be no rain, because of their sins, and they, praying in this place, shall do penance to thy name, and shall be converted from their sins, by occasion of

their afflictions: ³⁶ Then hear thou them in heaven, and forgive the sins of thy servants, and of thy people Israel: and shew them the good way wherein they should walk, and give rain upon thy land, which thou hast given to thy people in possession.

³⁷ If a famine arise in the land, or a pestilence, or corrupt air, or blasting, or locust, or mildew; if their enemy afflict them, besieging the gates, whatsoever plague, whatsoever infirmity, ³⁸ Whatsoever curse or imprecation shall happen to any man of thy people Israel: when a man shall know the wound of his own heart, and shall spread forth his hands in this house; ³⁹ Then hear thou in heaven, in the place of thy dwelling, and forgive, and do so as to give to every one according to his ways, as thou shalt see his heart (for thou only knowest the heart of all the children of men) ⁴⁰ That they may fear thee all the days that they live upon the face of the land, which thou hast given to our fathers. ⁴¹ Moreover also the stranger, who is not of thy people Israel, when he shall come out of a far country for thy name's sake, (for they shall hear every where of thy great name, and thy mighty hand, ⁴² And thy stretched out arm) so when he shall come, and shall pray in this place, ⁴³ Then hear thou in heaven, in the firmament of thy dwelling place, and do all those things, for which that stranger shall call upon thee: that all the people of the earth may learn to fear thy name, as do thy people Israel, and may prove that thy name is called upon on this house, which I have built.

⁴⁴ If thy people go out to war against their enemies, by what way soever thou shalt send them, they shall pray to thee towards the way of the city, which thou hast chosen, and towards the house, which I have built to thy name: ⁴⁵ And then hear thou in heaven their prayers, and their supplications, and do judgment for them. ⁴⁶ But if they sin against thee, (for there is no man who sinneth not) and thou being angry, deliver them up to their enemies, so that they be led away captives into the land of their enemies, far or near; ⁴⁷ Then if they do penance in their heart, in the place of captivity, and being converted, make supplication to thee in their captivity, saying: We have sinned, we have done unjustly, we have committed wickedness: ⁴⁸ And return to thee with all their heart, and all their soul, in the land of their enemies, to which they have been led captives: and pray to thee towards the way of their land, which thou gavest to their fathers, and of the city which thou hast chosen, and of the temple which I have built to thy name: ⁴⁹ Then hear thou in heaven, in the firmament of thy throne, their prayers, and their supplications, and do judgment for them: ⁵⁰ And forgive thy people, that have sinned against thee, and all their iniquities, by which they have transgressed against thee: and give them mercy before them that have made them captives, that they may have compassion on them. ⁵¹ For they are thy people, and thy inheritance, whom thou hast brought out of the land of Egypt, from the midst of the furnace of iron. ⁵² That thy eyes may be open to the supplication of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, to hear them in all things for which they shall call upon thee. ⁵³ For thou hast separated them to thyself for an inheritance, from amongst all the people of the earth, as thou hast spoken by Moses, thy servant, when thou broughtest our fathers out of Egypt, O Lord God.

⁵⁴ And it came to pass, when Solomon had made an end of praying all this prayer and supplication to the Lord, that he rose

from before the altar of the Lord: for he had fixed both knees on the ground, and had spread his hands towards heaven. ⁵⁵ And he stood, and blessed all the assembly of Israel with a loud voice, saying: ⁵⁶ Blessed be the Lord, who hath given rest to his people Israel, according to all that he promised: there hath not failed so much as one word of all the good things that he promised by his servant Moses. ⁵⁷ The Lord our God be with us, as he was with our fathers, and not leave us, nor cast us off: ⁵⁸ But may he incline our hearts to himself, that we may walk in all his ways, and keep his commandments, and his ceremonies, and all his judgments, which he commanded our fathers. ⁵⁹ And let these my words, wherewith I have prayed before the Lord, be nigh unto the Lord our God day and night, that he may do judgment for his servant, and for his people Israel, day by day: ⁶⁰ That all the people of the earth may know, that the Lord he is God, and there is no other besides him. ⁶¹ Let our hearts also be perfect with the Lord our God, that we may walk in his statutes, and keep his commandments, as at this day.

⁶² And the king, and all Israel with him, offered victims before the Lord. ⁶³ And Solomon slew victims of peace offerings, which he sacrificed to the Lord, two and twenty thousand oxen, and a hundred and twenty thousand sheep so the king, and all the children of Israel, dedicated the temple of the Lord. ⁶⁴ In that day the king sanctified the middle of the court, that was before the house of the Lord for there he offered the holocaust, and sacrifice, and the fat of the peace offerings: because the brazen altar that was before the Lord, was too little to receive the holocaust, and sacrifice, and the fat of the peace offerings. ⁶⁵ And Solomon made at the same time a solemn feast, and all Israel with him, a great multitude, from the entrance of Emath to the river of Egypt, before the Lord our God, seven days and seven days, that is, fourteen days. ⁶⁶ And on the eighth day, he sent away the people: and they blessed the king, and went to their dwellings, rejoicing, and glad in heart, for all the good things that the Lord had done for David, his servant, and for Israel, his people.

178. The second appearing, the condition, and the queen of Saba

1 Kings 9:1-10:29

9 ¹ And it came to pass when Solomon had finished the building of the house of the Lord, and the king's house, and all that he desired and was pleased to do, ² That the Lord appeared to him the second time, as he had appeared to him in Gabaon. ³ And the Lord said to him: I have heard thy prayer and thy supplication, which thou hast made before me: I have sanctified this house, which thou hast built, to put my name there for ever; and my eyes, and my heart, shall be there always. ⁴ And if thou wilt walk before me, as thy father walked, in simplicity of heart, and in uprightness: and wilt do all that I have commanded thee, and wilt keep my ordinances, and my judgments, ⁵ I will establish the throne of thy kingdom over Israel for ever, as I promised David, thy father, saying: There shall not fail a man of thy race upon the throne of Israel. ⁶ But if you and your children, revolting, shall turn away from following me, and will not keep my commandments, and my ceremonies, which I have set before you, but will go and worship strange gods, and adore them: ⁷ I will take away Israel from the face of the land which I have given them; and the temple which I have sanctified to my name, I will

cast out of my sight; and Israel shall be a proverb, and a byword among all people. ⁸ And this house shall be made an example of: every one that shall pass by it, shall be astonished, and shall hiss, and say: Why hath the Lord done thus to this land, and to this house? ⁹ And they shall answer: Because they forsook the Lord their God, who brought their fathers out of the land of Egypt, and followed strange gods, and adored them, and worshipped them: therefore hath the Lord brought upon them all this evil.

¹⁰ And when twenty years were ended, after Solomon had built the two houses; that is, the house of the Lord, and the house of the king, ¹¹ (Hiram, the king of Tyre, furnishing Solomon with cedar trees, and fir trees, and gold, according to all he had need of) then Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee. ¹² And Hiram came out of Tyre, to see the towns which Solomon had given him, and they pleased him not; ¹³ And he said: Are these the cities which thou hast given me, brother? And he called them the land of Chabul, unto this day. ¹⁴ And Hiram sent to king Solomon a hundred and twenty talents of gold.

¹⁵ This is the sum of the expenses, which king Solomon offered to build the house of the Lord, and his own house, and Mello, and the wall of Jerusalem, and Hesar, and Mageddo, and Gazer. ¹⁶ Pharaon, the king of Egypt, came up and took Gazer, and burnt it with fire: and slew the Chanaanite that dwelt in the city, and gave it for a dowry to his daughter, Solomon's wife. ¹⁷ So Solomon built Gazer, and Bethhoron the nether, ¹⁸ And Baalath, and Palmira, in the land of the wilderness. ¹⁹ And all the towns that belonged to himself, and were not walled, he fortified; the cities also of the chariots, and the cities of the horsemen, and whatsoever he had a mind to build in Jerusalem, and in Libanus, and in all the land of his dominion. ²⁰ All the people that were left of the Amorrhites, and Hethites, and Pherezites, and Hevites, and Jebusites, that are not of the children of Israel: ²¹ Their children, that were left in the land; to wit, such as the children of Israel had not been able to destroy, Solomon made tributary unto this day. ²² But of the children of Israel, Solomon made not any to be bondmen, but they were warriors, and his servants, and his princes, and captains, and overseers of the chariots and horses. ²³ And there were five hundred and fifty chief officers set over all the works of Solomon, and they had people under them, and had charge over the appointed works.

²⁴ And the daughter of Pharaon came up out of the city of David to her house, which Solomon had built for her: then did he build Mello.

²⁵ Solomon also offered three times every year holocausts, and victims of peace offerings, upon the altar which he had built to the Lord, and he burnt incense before the Lord: and the temple was finished.

²⁶ And king Solomon made a fleet in Asiongaber, which is by Ailath, on the shore of the Red Sea, in the land of Edom. ²⁷ And Hiram sent his servants in the fleet, sailors that had knowledge of the sea, with the servants of Solomon. ²⁸ And they came to Ophir; and they brought from thence to king Solomon four hundred and twenty talents of gold.

10 ¹ And the queen of Saba having heard of the fame of Solomon in the name of the Lord, came to try him with hard questions.

² And entering into Jerusalem with a great train, and riches, and camels that carried spices, and an immense quantity of gold, and

precious stones, she came to king Solomon, and spoke to him all that she had in her heart. ³ And Solomon informed her of all the things she proposed to him: there was not any word the king was ignorant of, and which he could not answer her. ⁴ And when the queen of Saba saw all the wisdom of Solomon, and the house which he had built, ⁵ And the meat of his table, and the apartments of his servants, and the order of his ministers, and their apparel, and the cupbearers, and the holocausts, which he offered in the house of the Lord, she had no longer any spirit in her; ⁶ And she said to the king: The report is true, which I heard in my own country, ⁷ Concerning thy words, and concerning thy wisdom. And I did not believe them that told me, till I came myself, and saw with my own eyes, and have found that the half hath not been told me: thy wisdom and thy works exceed the fame which I heard. ⁸ Blessed are thy men, and blessed are thy servants, who stand before thee always, and hear thy wisdom. ⁹ Blessed be the Lord thy God, whom thou hast pleased, and who hath set thee upon the throne of Israel, because the Lord hath loved Israel for ever, and hath appointed thee king, to do judgment and justice. ¹⁰ And she gave the king a hundred and twenty talents of gold, and of spices a very great store, and precious stones: there was brought no more such abundance of spices as these which the queen of Saba gave to king Solomon. ¹¹ (The navy also of Hiram, which brought gold from Ophir, brought from Ophir great plenty of thyine trees, and precious stones. ¹² And the king made of the thyine trees the rails of the house of the Lord, and of the king's house: and citterns and harps for singers: there were no such thyine trees as these brought nor seen unto this day.) ¹³ And king Solomon gave the queen of Saba all that she desired, and asked of him: besides what he offered her of himself of his royal bounty. And she returned, and went to her own country, with her servants.

¹⁴ And the weight of the gold that was brought to Solomon every year, was six hundred and sixty-six talents of gold: ¹⁵ Besides that which the men brought him that were over the tributes, and the merchants, and they that sold by retail, and all the kings of Arabia, and the governors of the country. ¹⁶ And Solomon made two hundred shields of the purest gold: he allowed six hundred sicles of gold for the plates of one shield. ¹⁷ And three hundred targets of fine gold: three hundred pounds of gold covered one target: and the king put them in the house of the forest of Libanus. ¹⁸ King Solomon also made a great throne of ivory: and overlaid it with the finest gold. ¹⁹ It had six steps: and the top of the throne was round behind: and there were two hands on either side holding the seat: and two lions stood, one at each hand, ²⁰ And twelve little lions stood upon the six steps, on the one side and on the other: there was no such work made in any kingdom. ²¹ Moreover, all the vessels out of which king Solomon drank, were of gold: and all the furniture of the house of the forest of Libanus was of most pure gold: there was no silver, nor was any account made of it in the days of Solomon: ²² For the king's navy, once in three years, went with the navy of Hiram by sea to Tharsis, and brought from thence gold, and silver, and elephants' teeth, and apes, and peacocks. ²³ And king Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom. ²⁴ And all the earth desired to see Solomon's face, to hear his wisdom, which God had given in his heart. ²⁵ And every one brought him

presents, vessels of silver and of gold, garments, and armour, and spices, and horses, and mules, every year.

²⁶ And Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen, and he had a thousand four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen: and he bestowed them in fenced cities, and with the king in Jerusalem. ²⁷ And he made silver to be as plentiful in Jerusalem as stones: and cedars to be as common as sycamores which grow in the plains. ²⁸ And horses were brought for Solomon out of Egypt, and Coa: for the king's merchants bought them out of Coa, and brought them at a set price. ²⁹ And a chariot of four horses came out of Egypt, for six hundred sicles of silver, and a horse for a hundred and fifty. And after this manner did all the kings of the Hethites, and of Syria, sell horses.

179. Solomon's wives, and the sentence

1 Kings 11:1-43

11 ¹ And king Solomon loved many strange women, besides the daughter of Pharaoh, and women of Moab, and of Ammon, and of Edom, and of Sidon, and of the Hethites: ² Of the nations concerning which the Lord said to the children of Israel: You shall not go in unto them, neither shall any of them come into yours: for they will most certainly turn away your hearts to follow their gods. And to these was Solomon joined with a most ardent love. ³ And he had seven hundred wives as queens, and three hundred concubines: and the women turned away his heart. ⁴ And when he was now old, his heart was turned away by women to follow strange gods: and his heart was not perfect with the Lord his God, as was the heart of David, his father. ⁵ But Solomon worshipped Astarthe, the goddess of the Sidonians, and Moloch, the idol of the Ammonites. ⁶ And Solomon did that which was not pleasing before the Lord, and did not fully follow the Lord, as David, his father. ⁷ Then Solomon built a temple for Chamos, the idol of Moab, on the hill that is over against Jerusalem, and for Moloch, the idol of the children of Ammon. ⁸ And he did in this manner for all his wives that were strangers, who burnt incense, and offered sacrifice to their gods. ⁹ And the Lord was angry with Solomon, because his mind was turned away from the Lord, the God of Israel, who had appeared to him twice; ¹⁰ And had commanded him concerning this thing, that he should not follow strange gods: but he kept not the things which the Lord commanded him. ¹¹ The Lord therefore said to Solomon: Because thou hast done this, and hast not kept my covenant, and my precepts, which I have commanded thee, I will divide and rend thy kingdom, and will give it to thy servant. ¹² Nevertheless, in thy days I will not do it, for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son. ¹³ Neither will I take away the whole kingdom; but I will give one tribe to thy son, for the sake of David, my servant, and Jerusalem, which I have chosen.

¹⁴ And the Lord raised up an adversary to Solomon, Adad, the Edomite, of the king's seed, in Edom. ¹⁵ For when David was in Edom, and Joab, the general of the army, was gone up to bury them that were slain, and had killed every male in Edom, ¹⁶ (For Joab remained there six months with all Israel, till he had slain every male in Edom,) ¹⁷ Then Adad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants, with him, to go into Egypt: and Adad was then a little boy. ¹⁸ And they arose out of Madian, and came into Pharan, and they took men with them from Pharan,

and went into Egypt, to Pharaoh, the king of Egypt: who gave him a house, and appointed him victuals, and assigned him land. ¹⁹ And Adad found great favour before Pharaoh, insomuch that he gave him to wife the own sister of his wife, Taphnes, the queen. ²⁰ And the sister of Taphnes bore him his son, Genubath; and Taphnes brought him up in the house of Pharaoh: and Genubath dwelt with Pharaoh among his children. ²¹ And when Adad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab, the general of the army, was dead, he said to Pharaoh: Let me depart, that I may go to my own country. ²² And Pharaoh said to him: Why, what is wanting to thee with me, that thou seekest to go to thy own country? But he answered: Nothing; yet I beseech thee to let me go.

²³ God also raised up against him an adversary, Razon, the son of Eliada, who had fled from his master, Adarezer, the king of Soba. ²⁴ And he gathered men against him, and he became a captain of robbers, when David slew them of Soba: and they went to Damascus, and dwelt there, and they made him king in Damascus. ²⁵ And he was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon: and this is the evil of Adad, and his hatred against Israel; and he reigned in Syria.

²⁶ Jeroboam also, the son of Nabat, an Ephrathite, of Sareda, a servant of Solomon, whose mother was named Sarua, a widow woman, lifted up his hand against the king. ²⁷ And this is the cause of his rebellion against him; for Solomon built Mello, and filled up the breach of the city of David, his father. ²⁸ And Jeroboam was a valiant and mighty man: and Solomon seeing him a young man ingenious and industrious, made him chief over the tributes of all the house of Joseph. ²⁹ So it came to pass at that time, that Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, and the prophet Ahias, the Silonite, clad with a new garment, found him in the way: and they two were alone in the field. ³⁰ And Ahias taking his new garment, wherewith he was clad, divided it into twelve parts: ³¹ And he said to Jeroboam: Take to thee ten pieces: for thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon, and will give thee ten tribes. ³² But one tribe shall remain to him for the sake of my servant, David, and Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel: ³³ Because he hath forsaken me, and hath adored Astarthe, the goddess of the Sidonians, and Chamos, the god of Moab, and Moloch, the god of the children of Ammon: and hath not walked in my ways, to do justice before me, and to keep my precepts, and judgments, as did David, his father. ³⁴ Yet I will not take away all the kingdom out of his hand, but I will make him prince all the days of his life, for David my servant's sake, whom I chose, who kept my commandments, and my precepts. ³⁵ But I will take away the kingdom out of his son's hand, and will give thee ten tribes: ³⁶ And to his son I will give one tribe, that there may remain a lamp for my servant, David, before me always in Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen, that my name might be there. ³⁷ And I will take thee, and thou shalt reign over all that thy soul desireth, and thou shalt be king over Israel. ³⁸ If then thou wilt hearken to all that I shall command thee, and wilt walk in my ways, and do what is right before me, keeping my commandments and my precepts, as David, my servant, did: I will be with thee, and will build thee up a faithful house, as I built a house for David, and I will deliver

Israel to thee: ³⁹ And I will for this afflict the seed of David, but yet not for ever. ⁴⁰ Solomon, therefore, sought to kill Jeroboam: but he arose, and fled into Egypt, to Sesac, the king of Egypt, and was in Egypt till the death of Solomon.

⁴¹ And the rest of the words of Solomon, and all that he did and his wisdom: behold they are all written in the book of the words of the days of Solomon. ⁴² And the days that Solomon reigned in Jerusalem, over all Israel, were forty years. ⁴³ And Solomon slept with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David, his father; and Roboam, his son, reigned in his stead.

180. The kingdom torn in two

1 Kings 12:1-33

12 ¹ And Roboam went to Sichem: for thither were all Israel come together to make him king. ² But Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who was yet in Egypt, a fugitive from the face of king Solomon, hearing of his death, returned out of Egypt. ³ And they sent and called him: and Jeroboam came, and all the multitude of Israel, and they spoke to Roboam, saying: ⁴ Thy father laid a grievous yoke upon us: now, therefore, do thou take off a little of the grievous service of thy father, and of his most heavy yoke, which he put upon us, and we will serve thee. ⁵ And he said to them: Go till the third day, and come to me again. And when the people was gone,

⁶ King Roboam took counsel with the old men, that stood before Solomon, his father, while he yet lived, and he said: What counsel do you give me, that I may answer this people? ⁷ They said to him: If thou wilt yield to this people to day, and condescend to them, and grant their petition, and wilt speak gentle words to them, they will be thy servants always. ⁸ But he left the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, and consulted with the young men that had been brought up with him, and stood before him. ⁹ And he said to them: What counsel do you give me, that I may answer this people, who have said to me: Make the yoke, which thy father put upon us, lighter? ¹⁰ And the young men that had been brought up with him, said: Thus shalt thou speak to this people, who have spoken to thee, saying: Thy father made our yoke heavy, do thou ease us. Thou shalt say to them: My little finger is thicker than the back of my father. ¹¹ And now my father put a heavy yoke upon you, but I will add to your yoke: my father beat you with whips, but I will beat you with scorpions.

¹² So Jeroboam, and all the people, came to Roboam the third day, as the king had appointed, saying: Come to me again the third day. ¹³ And the king answered the people roughly, leaving the counsel of the old men, which they had given him, ¹⁴ And he spoke to them according to the counsel of the young men, saying: My father made your yoke heavy, but I will add to your yoke: My father beat you with whips, but I will beat you with scorpions. ¹⁵ And the king condescended not to the people: for the Lord was turned away from him, to make good his word, which he had spoken in the hand of Ahias, the Silonite, to Jeroboam, the son of Nabat. ¹⁶ Then the people, seeing that the king would not hearken to them, answered him, saying: What portion have we in David? or what inheritance in the son of Isai? Go home to thy dwellings, O Israel: now, David, look to thy own house. So Israel departed to their dwellings. ¹⁷ But as for all the children of Israel that dwelt in the cities of Juda, Roboam reigned over

them. ¹⁸ Then king Roboam sent Aduram, who was over the tribute: and all Israel stoned him, and he died. Wherefore king Roboam made haste to get him up into his chariot, and he fled to Jerusalem: ¹⁹ And Israel revolted from the house of David, unto this day. ²⁰ And it came to pass when all Israel heard that Jeroboam was come again, that they gathered an assembly, and sent and called him, and made him king over all Israel, and there was none that followed the house of David but the tribe of Juda only.

²¹ And Roboam came to Jerusalem, and gathered together all the house of Juda, and the tribe of Benjamin, a hundred fourscore thousand chosen men for war, to fight against the house of Israel, and to bring the kingdom again under Roboam, the son of Solomon. ²² But the word of the Lord came to Semeias, the man of God, saying: ²³ Speak to Roboam, the son of Solomon, the king of Juda, and to all the house of Juda, and Benjamin, and the rest of the people, saying: ²⁴ Thus saith the Lord: You shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren, the children of Israel: let every man return to his house, for this thing is from me. They hearkened to the word of the Lord, and returned from their journey, as the Lord had commanded them.

²⁵ And Jeroboam built Sichem in mount Ephraim, and dwelt there, and going out from thence, he built Phanael. ²⁶ And Jeroboam said in his heart: Now shall the kingdom return to the house of David, ²⁷ If this people go up to offer sacrifices in the house of the Lord at Jerusalem: and the heart of this people will turn to their lord Roboam, the king of Juda, and they will kill me, and return to him. ²⁸ And finding out a device, he made two golden calves, and said to them: Go ye up no more to Jerusalem: Behold thy gods, O Israel, who brought thee out of the land of Egypt. ²⁹ And he set the one in Bethel, and the other in Dan: ³⁰ And this thing became an occasion of sin: for the people went to adore the calf as far as Dan. ³¹ And he made temples in the high places, and priests of the lowest of the people, who were not of the sons of Levi. ³² And he appointed a feast in the eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the month, after the manner of the feast that was celebrated in Juda. And going up to the altar, he did in like manner in Bethel, to sacrifice to the calves, which he had made: and he placed in Bethel priests of the high places, which he had made. ³³ And he went up to the altar, which he had built in Bethel, on the fifteenth day of the eighth month, which he had devised of his own heart: and he ordained a feast to the children of Israel, and went up on the altar to burn incense.

181. The man of God out of Juda; Jeroboam condemned

1 Kings 13:1-14:31

13 ¹ And behold there came a man of God out of Juda, by the word of the Lord, to Bethel, when Jeroboam was standing upon the altar, and burning incense. ² And he cried out against the altar in the word of the Lord, and said: O altar, altar, thus saith the Lord: Behold a child shall be born to the house of David, Josias by name, and he shall immolate upon thee the priests of the high places, who now burn incense upon thee, and he shall burn men's bones upon thee. ³ And he gave a sign the same day, saying: This shall be the sign, that the Lord hath spoken: Behold the altar shall be rent, and the ashes that are upon it, shall be poured out. ⁴ And when the king had heard the word of the man of God, which he had cried out against the altar in Bethel, he

stretched forth his hand from the altar, saying: Lay hold on him. And his hand which he stretched forth against him, withered: and he was not able to draw it back again to him. ⁵ The altar also was rent, and the ashes were poured out from the altar, according to the sign which the man of God had given before in the word of the Lord. ⁶ And the king said to the man of God: Entreat the face of the Lord thy God, and pray for me, that my hand may be restored to me. And the man of God besought the face of the Lord, and the king's hand was restored to him, and it became as it was before. ⁷ And the king said to the man of God: Come home with me to dine, and I will make thee presents. ⁸ And the man of God answered the king: If thou wouldst give me half thy house, I will not go with thee, nor eat bread, nor drink water in this place: ⁹ For so it was enjoined me by the word of the Lord commanding me: Thou shalt not eat bread, nor drink water, nor return by the same way that thou camest. ¹⁰ So he departed by another way, and returned not by the way that he came into Bethel.

¹¹ Now a certain old prophet dwelt in Bethel, and his sons came to him, and told him all the works that the man of God had done that day in Bethel: and they told their father the words which he had spoken to the king. ¹² And their father said to them: What way went he? His sons shewed him the way by which the man of God went, who came out of Juda. ¹³ And he said to his sons: Saddle me the ass. And when they had saddled it, he got up, ¹⁴ And went after the man of God, and found him sitting under a turpentine tree: and he said to him: Art thou the man of God who camest from Juda? He answered: I am. ¹⁵ And he said to him: Come home with me to eat bread. ¹⁶ But he said: I must not return, nor go with thee, neither will I eat bread, or drink water in this place: ¹⁷ Because the Lord spoke to me, in the word of the Lord, saying: Thou shalt not eat bread, and thou shalt not drink water there, nor return by the way thou wentest. ¹⁸ He said to him: I also am a prophet like unto thee: and an angel spoke to me, in the word of the Lord, saying: Bring him back with thee into thy house, that he may eat bread, and drink water. He deceived him, ¹⁹ And brought him back with him: so he ate bread, and drank water in his house. ²⁰ And as they sat at table, the word of the Lord came to the prophet that brought him back: ²¹ And he cried out to the man of God who came out of Juda, saying: Thus saith the Lord: Because thou hast not been obedient to the Lord, and hast not kept the commandment which the Lord thy God commanded thee, ²² And hast returned, and eaten bread, and drunk water in the place wherein he commanded thee that thou shouldst not eat bread, nor drink water, thy dead body shall not be brought into the sepulchre of thy fathers.

²³ And when he had eaten and drunk, he saddled his ass for the prophet, whom he had brought back. ²⁴ And when he was gone, a lion found him in the way, and killed him, and his body was cast in the way: and the ass stood by him, and the lion stood by the dead body. ²⁵ And behold, men passing by, saw the dead body cast in the way, and the lion standing by the body. And they came and told it in the city, wherein that old prophet dwelt. ²⁶ And when that prophet, who had brought him back out of the way, heard of it, he said: It is the man of God, that was disobedient to the mouth of the Lord, and the Lord hath delivered him to the lion, and he hath torn him, and killed him,

according to the word of the Lord, which he spoke to him. ²⁷ And he said to his sons: Saddle me an ass. And when they had saddled it, ²⁸ And he was gone, he found the dead body cast in the way, and the ass and the lion standing by the carcass: the lion had not eaten of the dead body, nor hurt the ass. ²⁹ And the prophet took up the body of the man of God, and laid it upon the ass, and going back brought it into the city of the old prophet, to mourn for him. ³⁰ And he laid his dead body in his own sepulchre: and they mourned over him, saying: Alas! alas, my brother. ³¹ And when they had mourned over him, he said to his sons: When I am dead, bury me in the sepulchre wherein the man of God is buried: lay my bones beside his bones. ³² For assuredly the word shall come to pass which he hath foretold in the word of the Lord, against the altar that is in Bethel: and against all the temples of the high places, that are in the cities of Samaria.

³³ After these words, Jeroboam came not back from his wicked way: but on the contrary, he made of the meanest of the people priests of the high places: whosoever would, he filled his hand, and he was made a priest of the high places. ³⁴ And for this cause did the house of Jeroboam sin, and was cut off, and destroyed from the face of the earth.

14 ¹ At that time Abia, the son of Jeroboam, fell sick. ² And Jeroboam said to his wife: Arise, and change thy dress, that thou be not known to be the wife of Jeroboam, and go to Silo, where Ahias, the prophet is, who told me that I should reign over this people. ³ Take also with thee ten loaves, and cracknels, and a pot of honey, and go to him: for he will tell thee what will become of this child. ⁴ Jeroboam's wife did as he told her: and rising up, went to Silo, and came to the house of Ahias; but he could not see, for his eyes were dim by reason of his age. ⁵ And the Lord said to Ahias: Behold the wife of Jeroboam cometh in, to consult thee concerning her son, that is sick: thus and thus shalt thou speak to her. So when she was coming in, and made as if she were another woman, ⁶ Ahias heard the sound of her feet, coming in at the door, and said: Come in, thou wife of Jeroboam: why dost thou feign thyself to be another? But I am sent to thee with heavy tidings. ⁷ Go, and tell Jeroboam: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: For as much as I exalted thee from among the people, and made thee prince over my people Israel; ⁸ And rent the kingdom away from the house of David, and gave it to thee, and thou hast not been as my servant, David, who kept my commandments, and followed me with all his heart, doing that which was well pleasing in my sight: ⁹ But hast done evil above all that were before thee, and hast made thee strange gods, and molten gods, to provoke me to anger, and hast cast me behind thy back: ¹⁰ Therefore, behold I will bring evils upon the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off from Jeroboam him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up, and the last in Israel: and I will sweep away the remnant of the house of Jeroboam, as dung is swept away till all be clean. ¹¹ Them that shall die of Jeroboam in the city, the dogs shall eat: and them that shall die in the field, the birds of the air shall devour: for the Lord hath spoken it. ¹² Arise thou, therefore, and go to thy house: and when thy feet shall be entering into the city, the child shall die, ¹³ And all Israel shall mourn for him, and shall bury him: for he only of Jeroboam shall be laid in a sepulchre, because in his regard there is found a good word from the Lord, the God of Israel, in the

house of Jeroboam. ¹⁴ And the Lord hath appointed himself a king over Israel, who shall cut off the house of Jeroboam in this day, and in this time: ¹⁵ And the Lord God shall strike Israel as a reed is shaken in the water: and he shall root up Israel out of this good land, which he gave to their fathers, and shall scatter them beyond the river: because they have made to themselves groves, to provoke the Lord. ¹⁶ And the Lord shall give up Israel for the sins of Jeroboam, who hath sinned, and made Israel to sin.

¹⁷ And the wife of Jeroboam arose, and departed, and came to Thersa: and when she was coming in to the threshold of the house, the child died, ¹⁸ And they buried him. And all Israel mourned for him, according to the word of the Lord, which he spoke by the hand of his servant Ahias, the prophet. ¹⁹ And the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how he fought, and how he reigned, behold they are written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel. ²⁰ And the days that Jeroboam reigned, were two and twenty years: and he slept with his fathers: and Nadab, his son, reigned in his stead.

²¹ And Roboam, the son of Solomon, reigned in Juda: Roboam was one and forty years old when he began to reign: and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the Lord chose out of all the tribes of Israel to put his name there. And his mother's name was Naama, an Ammonitess. ²² And Juda did evil in the sight of the Lord, and provoked him above all that their fathers had done, in their sins which they committed. ²³ For they also built them altars, and statues, and groves, upon every high hill, and under every green tree: ²⁴ There were also the effeminate in the land, and they did according to all the abominations of the people, whom the Lord had destroyed before the face of the children of Israel.

²⁵ And in the fifth year of the reign of Roboam, Sesac, king of Egypt, came up against Jerusalem. ²⁶ And he took away the treasures of the house of the Lord, and the king's treasures, and carried all off: as also the shields of gold which Solomon had made: ²⁷ And Roboam made shields of brass instead of them, and delivered them into the hand of the captains of the shieldbearers, and of them that kept watch before the gate of the king's house. ²⁸ And when the king went into the house of the Lord, they whose office it was to go before him, carried them: and afterwards they brought them back to the armoury of the shieldbearers.

²⁹ Now the rest of the acts of Roboam, and all that he did, behold they are written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda. ³⁰ And there was war between Roboam and Jeroboam always. ³¹ And Roboam slept with his fathers, and was buried with them, in the city of David: and his mother's name was Naama, an Ammonitess: and Abiam, his son, reigned in his stead.

182. The dynasties of Israel; Achab and Jezabel

1 Kings 15:1-16:34

15 ¹ Now in the eighteenth year of the reign of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, Abiam reigned over Juda. ² He reigned three years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Maacha, the daughter of Abessalom. ³ And he walked in all the sins of his father, which he had done before him: and his heart was not perfect with the Lord his God, as was the heart of David, his father. ⁴ But for

David's sake the Lord his God gave him a lamp in Jerusalem, to set up his son after him, and to establish Jerusalem: ⁵ Because David had done that which was right in the eyes of the Lord, and had not turned aside from any thing that he commanded him, all the days of his life, except the matter of Urias, the Hethite. ⁶ But there was war between Roboam and Jeroboam all the time of his life. ⁷ And the rest of the words of Abiam, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? And there was war between Abiam and Jeroboam. ⁸ And Abiam slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David: and Asa, his son, reigned in his stead.

⁹ So in the twentieth year of Jeroboam, king of Israel, reigned Asa, king of Juda, ¹⁰ And he reigned one and forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Maacha, the daughter of Abessalom. ¹¹ And Asa did that which was right in the sight of the Lord, as did David, his father: ¹² And he took away the effeminate out of the land, and removed all the filth of the idols, which his fathers had made. ¹³ Moreover, he also removed his mother, Maacha, from being the princess in the sacrifices of Priapus, and in the grove which she had consecrated to him: and he destroyed her den, and broke in pieces the filthy idol, and burnt it by the torrent Cedron: ¹⁴ But the high places he did not take away. Nevertheless, the heart of Asa was perfect with the Lord all his days: ¹⁵ And he brought in the things which his father had dedicated, and he had vowed, into the house of the Lord, silver and gold, and vessels.

¹⁶ And there was war between Asa, and Baasa, king of Israel, all their days. ¹⁷ And Baasa, king of Israel, went up against Juda, and built Rama, that no man might go out or come in of the side of Asa, king of Juda. ¹⁸ Then Asa took all the silver and gold that remained in the treasures of the house of the Lord, and in the treasures of the king's house, and delivered it into the hands of his servants: and sent them to Benadad, son of Tabremon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, who dwelt in Damascus, saying: ¹⁹ There is a league between me and thee, and between my father and thy father: therefore I have sent thee presents of silver and gold: and I desire thee to come, and break thy league with Baasa, king of Israel, that he may depart from me. ²⁰ Benadad, hearkening to king Asa, sent the captains of his army against the cities of Israel, and they smote Ahion, and Dan, and Abeldomum Maacha, and all Cenneroth; that is all the land of Nephthali. ²¹ And when Baasa had heard this, he left off building Rama, and returned into Thersa. ²² But king Asa sent word into all Juda, saying: Let no man be excused: and they took away the stones from Rama, and the timber thereof, wherewith Baasa had been building, and with them king Asa built Gabaa of Benjamin, and Maspha. ²³ But the rest of all the acts of Asa, and all his strength, and all that he did, and the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? But in the time of his old age he was diseased in his feet. ²⁴ And he slept with his fathers, and was buried with them in the city of David, his father. And Josaphat, his son, reigned in his place.

²⁵ But Nadab, the son of Jeroboam, reigned over Israel the second year of Asa, king of Juda: and he reigned over Israel two years. ²⁶ And he did evil in the sight of the Lord, and walked in the ways of his father, and in his sins, wherewith he made Israel to sin. ²⁷ And Baasa, the son of Ahias, of the house of

Issachar, conspired against him, and slew him in Gebbethon, which is a city of the Philistines: for Nadab and all Israel besieged Gebbethon. ²⁸ So Baasa slew him in the third year of Asa, king of Juda, and reigned in his place. ²⁹ And when he was king, he cut off all the house of Jeroboam: he left not so much as one soul of his seed, till he had utterly destroyed him, according to the word of the Lord, which he had spoken in the hand of Ahias, the Silonite: ³⁰ Because of the sin of Jeroboam, which he had sinned, and wherewith he had made Israel to sin, and for the offence wherewith he provoked the Lord, the God of Israel.

³¹ But the rest of the acts of Nadab, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ³² And there was war between Asa and Baasa, the king of Israel, all their days. ³³ In the third year of Asa, king of Juda, Baasa, the son of Ahias, reigned over all Israel, in Thersa, four and twenty years. ³⁴ And he did evil before the Lord, and walked in the ways of Jeroboam, and in his sins, wherewith he made Israel to sin.

16 ¹ Then the word of the Lord came to Jehu, the son of Hanani, against Baasa, saying: ² For as much as I have exalted thee out of the dust and made thee prince over my people Israel, and thou hast walked in the way of Jeroboam, and hast made my people Israel to sin, to provoke me to anger with their sins: ³ Behold I will cut down the posterity of Baasa, and the posterity of his house, and I will make thy house as the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat. ⁴ Him that dieth of Baasa, in the city, the dogs shall eat: and him that dieth of his in the country, the fowls of the air shall devour. ⁵ But the rest of the acts of Baasa, and all that he did, and his battles, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ⁶ So Baasa slept with his fathers, and was buried in Thersa: and Ela, his son, reigned in his stead. ⁷ And when the word of the Lord came in the hand of Jehu, the son of Hanani, the prophet, against Baasa, and against his house, and against all the evil that he had done before the Lord, to provoke him to anger by the works of his hands, to become as the house of Jeroboam: for this cause he slew him; that is to say, Jehu, the son of Hanani, the prophet.

⁸ In the six and twentieth year of Asa, king of Juda, Ela, the son of Baasa, reigned over Israel, in Thersa, two years. ⁹ And his servant Zambri, who was captain of half the horsemen, rebelled against him: now Ela was drinking in Thersa, and drunk in the house of Arsa, the governor of Thersa. ¹⁰ And Zambri rushing in, struck him, and slew him, in the seven and twentieth year of Asa, king of Juda and he reigned in his stead.

¹¹ And when he was king, and sat upon his throne, he slew all the house of Baasa, and he left not one thereof to piss against a wall and all his kinsfolks and friends. ¹² And Zambri destroyed all the house of Baasa, according to the word of the Lord, that he had spoken to Baasa, in the hand of Jehu, the prophet, ¹³ For all the sins of Baasa, and the sins of Ela, his son, who sinned, and made Israel to sin, provoking the Lord, the God of Israel, with their vanities. ¹⁴ But the rest of the acts of Ela, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

¹⁵ In the seven and twentieth year of Asa, king of Juda, Zambri reigned seven days in Thersa: now the army was besieging Gebbethon, a city of the Philistines. ¹⁶ And when they heard

that Zambri had rebelled, and slain the king, all Israel made Amri their king, who was general over Israel in the camp that day. ¹⁷ And Amri went up, and all Israel with him, from Gebbethon, and they besieged Thersa. ¹⁸ And Zambri, seeing that the city was about to be taken, went into the palace, and burnt himself with the king's house: and he died. ¹⁹ In his sins, which he had sinned, doing evil before the Lord, and walking in the way of Jeroboam, and in his sin, wherewith he made Israel to sin. ²⁰ But the rest of the acts of Zambri, and of his conspiracy and tyranny, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

²¹ Then were the people of Israel divided into two parts: one half of the people followed Thebni, the son of Gineth, to make him king: and one half followed Amri. ²² But the people that were with Amri, prevailed over the people that followed Thebni, the son of Gineth: and Thebni died, and Amri reigned. ²³ In the one and thirtieth year of Asa, king of Juda, Amri reigned over Israel twelve years: in Thersa he reigned six years. ²⁴ And he bought the hill of Samaria of Semer, for two talents of silver: and he built upon it, and he called the city which he built Samaria, after the name of Semer, the owner of the hill. ²⁵ And Amri did evil in the sight of the Lord, and acted wickedly above all that were before him. ²⁶ And he walked in all the way of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, and in his sins, wherewith he made Israel to sin: to provoke the Lord, the God of Israel, to anger with their vanities. ²⁷ Now the rest of the acts of Amri, and the battles he fought, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ²⁸ And Amri slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria, and Achab, his son, reigned in his stead.

²⁹ Now Achab, the son of Amri, reigned over Israel in the eight and thirtieth year of Asa, king of Juda. And Achab, the son of Amri, reigned over Israel in Samaria two and twenty years. ³⁰ And Achab, the son of Amri, did evil in the sight of the Lord above all that were before him. ³¹ Nor was it enough for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat: but he also took to wife Jezabel, daughter of Ethbaal, king of the Sidonians. And he went, and served Baal, and adored him. ³² And he set up an altar for Baal, in the temple of Baal, which he had built in Samaria; ³³ And he planted a grove: and Achab did more to provoke the Lord, the God of Israel, than all the kings of Israel that were before him. ³⁴ In his days Hiel, of Bethel, built Jericho: in Abiram, his firstborn, he laid its foundations: and in his youngest son, Segub, he set up the gates thereof: according to the word of the Lord, which he spoke in the hand of Josue, the son of Nun.

183. Elias, the drought, and the widow of Sarephta

1 Kings 17:1-24

17 ¹ And Elias the Thesbite, of the inhabitants of Galaad, said to Achab: As the Lord liveth, the God of Israel, in whose sight I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to the words of my mouth. ² And the word of the Lord came to him, saying: ³ Get thee hence, and go towards the east, and hide thyself by the torrent of Carith, which is over against the Jordan; ⁴ And there thou shalt drink of the torrent: and I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there. ⁵ So he went, and did according to the word of the Lord: and going, he dwelt by the torrent Carith, which is over against the Jordan. ⁶ And the

ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening; and he drank of the torrent. ⁷ But after some time the torrent was dried up: for it had not rained upon the earth.

⁸ Then the word of the Lord came to him, saying: ⁹ Arise, and go to Sarephta of the Sidonians, and dwell there: for I have commanded a widow woman there to feed thee. ¹⁰ He arose, and went to Sarephta. And when he was come to the gate of the city, he saw the widow woman gathering sticks, and he called her, and said to her: Give me a little water in a vessel, that I may drink. ¹¹ And when she was going to fetch it, he called after her, saying: Bring me also, I beseech thee, a morsel of bread in thy hand. ¹² And she answered: As the Lord thy God liveth, I have no bread, but only a handful of meal in a pot, and a little oil in a cruise: behold I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it, for me and my son, that we may eat it and die. ¹³ And Elias said to her: Fear not; but go, and do as thou hast said but first make for me of the same meal a little hearth cake, and bring it to me, and after make for thyself and thy son. ¹⁴ For thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: The pot of meal shall not waste, nor the cruise of oil be diminished, until the day wherein the Lord will give rain upon the face of the earth. ¹⁵ She went, and did according to the word of Elias: and he ate, and she, and her house: and from that day ¹⁶ The pot of meal wasted not, and the cruise of oil was not diminished according to the word of the Lord, which he spoke in the hand of Elias.

¹⁷ And it came to pass after this, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick, and the sickness was very grievous, so that there was no breath left in him. ¹⁸ And she said to Elias: What have I to do with thee, thou man of God? art thou come to me, that my iniquities should be remembered, and that thou shouldst kill my son? ¹⁹ And Elias said to her: Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him into the upper chamber where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed. ²⁰ And he cried to the Lord, and said: O Lord, my God, hast thou afflicted also the widow, with whom I am after a sort maintained, so as to kill her son? ²¹ And he stretched, and measured himself upon the child three times, and cried to the Lord, and said: O Lord, my God, let the soul of this child, I beseech thee, return into his body. ²² And the Lord heard the voice of Elias: and the soul of the child returned into him, and he revived. ²³ And Elias took the child, and brought him down from the upper chamber to the house below, and delivered him to his mother, and said to her: Behold thy son liveth.

²⁴ And the woman said to Elias: Now by this I know that thou art a man of God, and the word of the Lord in thy mouth is true.

184. *Elias on Carmel*

1 Kings 18:1-46

18 ¹ After many days, the word of the Lord came to Elias, in the third year, saying: Go, and shew thyself to Achab, that I may give rain upon the face of the earth. ² And Elias went to shew himself to Achab, and there was a grievous famine in Samaria. ³ And Achab called Abdias the governor of his house: now Abdias feared the Lord very much. ⁴ For when Jezabel killed the prophets of the Lord, he took a hundred prophets, and hid them by fifty and fifty in caves, and fed them with bread and water. ⁵ And Achab said to Abdias: Go into the land unto all

fountains of waters, and into all valleys, to see if we can find grass, and save the horses and mules, that the beasts may not utterly perish. ⁶ And they divided the countries between them, that they might go round about them: Achab went one way, and Abdias another way by himself. ⁷ And as Abdias was in the way, Elias met him: and he knew him, and fell on his face, and said: Art thou my lord Elias? ⁸ And he answered: I am. Go, and tell thy master: Elias is here. ⁹ And he said: What have I sinned, that thou wouldst deliver me, thy servant, into the hand of Achab, that he should kill me? ¹⁰ As the Lord thy God liveth, there is no nation or kingdom, whither my lord hath not sent to seek thee: and when all answered: He is not here: he took an oath of every kingdom and nation, because thou wast not found. ¹¹ And now thou sayest to me: Go and tell thy master: Elias is here. ¹² And when I am gone from thee, the Spirit of the Lord will carry thee into a place that I know not: and I shall go in and tell Achab; and he, not finding thee, will kill me: but thy servant feareth the Lord from his infancy. ¹³ Hath it not been told thee, my lord, what I did when Jezabel killed the prophets of the Lord; how I hid a hundred men of the prophets of the Lord, by fifty and fifty in caves, and fed them with bread and water? ¹⁴ And now thou sayest: Go and tell thy master: Elias is here: that he may kill me. ¹⁵ And Elias said: As the Lord of hosts liveth, before whose face I stand, this day I will shew myself unto him. ¹⁶ Abdias therefore went to meet Achab, and told him: and Achab came to meet Elias.

¹⁷ And when he had seen him, he said: Art thou he that troublest Israel? ¹⁸ And he said: I have not troubled Israel, but thou and thy father's house, who have forsaken the commandments of the Lord, and have followed Baalim. ¹⁹ Nevertheless send now, and gather unto me all Israel, unto Mount Carmel, and the prophets of Baal four hundred and fifty, and the prophets of the groves four hundred, who eat at Jezabel's table. ²⁰ Achab sent to all the children of Israel, and gathered together the prophets unto mount Carmel. ²¹ And Elias coming to all the people, said: How long do you halt between two sides? If the Lord be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him. And the people did not answer him a word. ²² And Elias said again to the people: I only remain a prophet of the Lord: but the prophets of Baal are four hundred and fifty men. ²³ Let two bullocks be given us, and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it upon wood, but put no fire under: and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under it. ²⁴ Call ye on the names of your gods, and I will call on the name of my Lord: and the God that shall answer by fire, let him be God. And all the people answering, said: A very good proposal. ²⁵ Then Elias said to the prophets of Baal: Choose you one bullock and dress it first, because you are many: and call on the names of your gods; but put no fire under. ²⁶ And they took the bullock, which he gave them, and dressed it: and they called on the name of Baal from morning even until noon, saying: O Baal, hear us. But there was no voice, nor any that answered: and they leaped over the altar that they had made. ²⁷ And when it was now noon, Elias jested at them, saying: Cry with a louder voice: for he is a god; and perhaps he is talking, or is in an inn, or on a journey; or perhaps he is asleep, and must be awaked. ²⁸ So they cried with a loud voice, and cut themselves after their manner with knives

and lancets, till they were all covered with blood. ²⁹ And after midday was past, and while they were prophesying, the time was come of offering sacrifice, and there was no voice heard, nor did any one answer, nor regard them as they prayed. ³⁰ Elias said to all the people: Come ye unto me. And the people coming near unto him, he repaired the altar of the Lord, that was broken down: ³¹ And he took twelve stones, according to the number of the tribes of the sons of Jacob to whom the word of the Lord came, saying: Israel shall be thy name. ³² And he built with the stones an altar to the name of the Lord: and he made a trench for water, of the breadth of two furrows, round about the altar. ³³ And he laid the wood in order, and cut the bullock in pieces, and laid it upon the wood. ³⁴ And he said: Fill four buckets with water, and pour it upon the burnt offering, and upon the wood. And again he said: Do the same the second time. And when they had done it the second time, he said: Do the same also the third time. And they did so the third time. ³⁵ And the water run round about the altar, and the trench was filled with water. ³⁶ And when it was now time to offer the holocaust, Elias, the prophet, came near and said: O Lord God of Abraham, and Isaac, and Israel, shew this day that thou art the God of Israel, and I thy servant, and that according to thy commandment I have done all these things. ³⁷ Hear me, O Lord, hear me: that this people may learn that thou art the Lord God, and that thou hast turned their heart again. ³⁸ Then the fire of the Lord fell, and consumed the holocaust, and the wood, and the stones, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench. ³⁹ And when all the people saw this, they fell on their faces, and they said: The Lord, he is God; the Lord, he is God. ⁴⁰ And Elias said to them: Take the prophets of Baal, and let not one of them escape. And when they had taken them, Elias brought them down to the torrent Cison, and killed them there.

⁴¹ And Elias said to Achab: Go up, eat and drink: for there is a sound of abundance of rain. ⁴² Achab went up to eat and drink: and Elias went up to the top of Carmel, and casting himself down upon the earth, put his face between his knees, ⁴³ And he said to his servant: Go up, and look towards the sea. And he went up, and looked, and said: There is nothing. And again he said to him: Return seven times. ⁴⁴ And at the seventh time: Behold a little cloud arose out of the sea like a man's foot. And he said: Go up, and say to Achab: Prepare thy chariot, and go down, lest the rain prevent thee. ⁴⁵ And while he turned himself this way and that way, behold the heavens grew dark, with clouds and wind, and there fell a great rain. And Achab getting up, went away to Jezrahel: ⁴⁶ And the hand of the Lord was upon Elias, and he girded up his loins, and ran before Achab, till he came to Jezrahel.

185. The whistling of a gentle air

1 Kings 19:1-21

Horeb again, and the call of Eliseus.

19 ¹ And Achab told Jezabel all that Elias had done, and how he had slain all the prophets with the sword. ² And Jezabel sent a messenger to Elias, saying: Such and such things may the gods do to me, and add still more, if by this hour to morrow I make not thy life as the life of one of them. ³ Then Elias was afraid, and rising up, he went whithersoever he had a mind: and he

came to Bersabee of Juda, and left his servant there, ⁴ And he went forward, one day's journey into the desert. And when he was there, and sat under a juniper tree, he requested for his soul that he might die, and said: It is enough for me, Lord; take away my soul: for I am no better than my fathers. ⁵ And he cast himself down, and slept in the shadow of the juniper tree: and behold an angel of the Lord touched him, and said to him: Arise and eat. ⁶ He looked, and behold there was at his head a hearth cake, and a vessel of water: and he ate and drank, and he fell asleep again. ⁷ And the angel of the Lord came again the second time, and touched him, and said to him: Arise, eat: for thou hast yet a great way to go. ⁸ And he arose, and ate and drank, and walked in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights, unto the mount of God, Horeb. ⁹ And when he was come thither, he abode in a cave: and behold the word of the Lord came unto him, and he said to him: What dost thou here, Elias? ¹⁰ And he answered: With zeal have I been zealous for the Lord God of hosts: for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant: they have thrown down thy altars, they have slain thy prophets with the sword, and I alone am left, and they seek my life to take it away. ¹¹ And he said to him: Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the Lord: and behold the Lord passeth, and a great and strong wind before the Lord, overthrowing the mountains, and breaking the rocks in pieces: but the Lord is not in the wind. And after the wind, an earthquake: but the Lord is not in the earthquake. ¹² And after the earthquake, a fire: but the Lord is not in the fire. And after the fire, a whistling of a gentle air. ¹³ And when Elias heard it, he covered his face with his mantle, and coming forth, stood in the entering in of the cave, and behold a voice unto him, saying: What dost thou here, Elias? And he answered: ¹⁴ With zeal have I been zealous for the Lord God of hosts: because the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant: they have destroyed thy altars, they have slain thy prophets with the sword; and I alone am left, and they seek my life to take it away. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: Go, and return on thy way, through the desert, to Damascus: and when thou art come thither, thou shalt anoint Hazael to be king over Syria; ¹⁶ And thou shalt anoint Jehu, the son of Namsi, to be king over Israel: and Eliseus, the son of Saphat, of Abelmeula, thou shalt anoint to be prophet in thy room. ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall escape the sword of Hazael, shall be slain by Jehu: and whosoever shall escape the sword of Jehu, shall be slain by Eliseus. ¹⁸ And I will leave me seven thousand men in Israel, whose knees have not been bowed before Baal, and every mouth that hath not worshipped him, kissing the hands.

¹⁹ And Elias departing from thence, found Eliseus, the son of Saphat, ploughing with twelve yoke of oxen: and he was one of them that were ploughing with, twelve yoke of oxen: and when Elias came up to him, he cast his mantle upon him. ²⁰ And he forthwith left the oxen, and ran after Elias, and said: Let me, I pray thee, kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow thee. And he said to him: Go, and return back: for that which was my part, I have done to thee. ²¹ And returning back from him, he took a yoke of oxen, and killed them, and boiled the flesh with the plough of the oxen, and gave to the people, and they ate: and rising up, he went away, and followed Elias, and ministered to him.

186. The Syrian wars*1 Kings 20:1-43*

20 ¹ And Benadad, king of Syria, gathered together all his host, and there were two and thirty kings with him, and horses, and chariots: and going up, he fought against Samaria, and besieged it. ² And sending messengers to Achab, king of Israel, into the city, ³ He said: Thus saith Benadad: Thy silver and thy gold is mine: and thy wives and thy goodliest children are mine. ⁴ And the king of Israel answered: According to thy word, my lord, O king, I am thine, and all that I have. ⁵ And the messengers came again, and said: Thus saith Benadad, who sent us unto thee: Thy silver and thy gold, and thy wives and thy children, thou shalt deliver up to me. ⁶ To morrow, therefore, at this same hour, I will send my servants to thee, and they shall search thy house, and the houses of thy servants: and all that pleaseth them, they shall put in their hands, and take away. ⁷ And the king of Israel called all the ancients of the land, and said: Mark, and see that he layeth snares for us. For he sent to me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver and gold: and I said not nay. ⁸ And all the ancients, and all the people said to him: Harken not to him, nor consent to him. ⁹ Wherefore he answered the messengers of Benadad: Tell my lord, the king: All that thou didst send for to me, thy servant at first, I will do: but this thing I cannot do. ¹⁰ And the messengers returning brought him word. And he sent again, and said: Such and such things may the gods do to me, and more may they add, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for handfuls for all the people that follow me. ¹¹ And the king of Israel answering, said: Tell him: Let not the girded boast himself as the ungirded.

¹² And it came to pass, when Benadad heard this word, that he and the kings were drinking in pavilions, and he said to his servants: Beset the city. And they beset it.

¹³ And behold a prophet coming to Achab, king of Israel, said to him: Thus saith the Lord: Hast thou seen all this exceeding great multitude? behold I will deliver them into thy hand this day: that thou mayst know that I am the Lord. ¹⁴ And Achab said: By whom? And he said to him: Thus saith the Lord: By the servants of the princes of the provinces. And he said: Who shall begin to fight? And he said: Thou. ¹⁵ So he mustered the servants of the princes of the provinces, and he found the number of two hundred and thirty-two: and he mustered after them the people, all the children of Israel, seven thousand: ¹⁶ And they went out at noon. But Benadad was drinking himself drunk in his pavilion, and the two and thirty kings with him, who were come to help him. ¹⁷ And the servants of the princes of the provinces went out first. And Benadad sent. And they told him, saying: There are men come out of Samaria. ¹⁸ And he said: Whether they come for peace, take them alive: or whether they come to fight, take them alive. ¹⁹ So the servants of the princes of the provinces went out, and the rest of the army followed: ²⁰ And every one slew the man that came against him: and the Syrians fled, and Israel pursued after them. And Benadad, king of Syria, fled away on horseback with his horsemen. ²¹ But the king of Israel going out overthrew the horses and chariots, and slew the Syrians with a great slaughter. ²² (And a prophet coming to the king of Israel, said to him: Go, and strengthen thyself, and know, and see what thou dost: for the next year the king of Syria will come up

against thee.) ²³ But the servants of the king of Syria said to him: Their gods are gods of the hills, therefore they have overcome us: but it is better that we should fight against them in the plains, and we shall overcome them. ²⁴ Do thou, therefore, this thing: Remove all the kings from thy army, and put captains in their stead: ²⁵ And make up the number of soldiers that have been slain of thine, and horses, according to the former horses, and chariots, according to the chariots which thou hadst before: and we will fight against them in the plains, and thou shalt see that we shall overcome them. He believed their counsel, and did so. ²⁶ Wherefore, at the return of the year, Benadad mustered the Syrians, and went up to Aphec, to fight against Israel. ²⁷ And the children of Israel were mustered, and taking victuals, went out on the other side, and encamped over against them, like two little flocks of goats: but the Syrians filled the land. ²⁸ (And a man of God coming, said to the king of Israel: Thus saith the Lord: Because the Syrians have said: The Lord is God of the hills, but is not God of the valleys: I will deliver all this great multitude into thy hand, and you shall know that I am the Lord.) ²⁹ And both sides set their armies in array one against the other seven days, and on the seventh day the battle was fought: and the children of Israel slew, of the Syrians, a hundred thousand footmen in one day. ³⁰ And they that remained fled to Aphec, into the city: and the wall fell upon seven and twenty thousand men, that were left. And Benadad fleeing, went into the city, into a chamber that was within a chamber. ³¹ And his servants said to him: Behold, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful; so let us put sackcloths on our loins, and ropes on our heads, and go out to the king of Israel: perhaps he will save our lives. ³² So they girded sackcloths on their loins, and put ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said to him: Thy servant, Benadad, saith: I beseech thee let me have my life. And he said: If he be yet alive, he is my brother. ³³ The men took this for good luck: and in haste caught the word out of his mouth, and said: Thy brother Benadad. And he said to them: Go, and bring him to me. Then Benadad came out to him, and he lifted him up into his chariot. ³⁴ And he said to him: The cities which my father took from thy father, I will restore: and do thou make thee streets in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria and having made a league, I will depart from thee. So he made a league with him, and let him go.

³⁵ Then a certain man of the sons of the prophets, said to his companion, in the word of the Lord: Strike me. But he would not strike. ³⁶ Then he said to him: Because thou wouldst not hearken to the word of the Lord, behold thou shalt depart from me, and a lion shall slay thee. And when he was gone a little from him, a lion found him, and slew him. ³⁷ Then he found another man, and said to him: Strike me. And he struck him and wounded him. ³⁸ So the prophet went, and met the king in the way, and disguised himself by sprinkling dust on his face and his eyes. ³⁹ And as the king passed by, he cried to the king, and said: Thy servant went out to fight hand to hand: and when a certain man was run away, one brought him to me, and said: Keep this man: and if he shall slip away, thy life shall be for his life, or thou shalt pay a talent of silver. ⁴⁰ And whilst I, in the hurry, turned this way and that, on a sudden he was not to be seen. And the king of Israel said to him: This is thy judgment,

which thyself hast decreed. ⁴¹ But he forthwith wiped off the dust from his face, and the king of Israel knew him, that he was one of the prophets. ⁴² And he said to him: Thus saith the Lord. Because thou hast let go out of thy hand a man worthy of death, thy life shall be for his life, and thy people for his people. ⁴³ And the king of Israel returned to his house, slighting to hear, and raging came into Samaria.

187. Naboth's vineyard

1 Kings 21:1-29

21 ¹ And after these things, Naboth the Jezrahelite, who was in Jezrahel, had at that time a vineyard, near the palace of Achab, king of Samaria. ² And Achab spoke to Naboth, saying: Give me thy vineyard, that I may make me a garden of herbs, because it is nigh, and adjoining to my house; and I will give thee for it a better vineyard: or if thou think it more convenient for thee, I will give thee the worth of it in money. ³ Naboth answered him: The Lord be merciful to me, and not let me give thee the inheritance of my fathers. ⁴ And Achab came into his house angry and fretting, because of the word that Naboth, the Jezrahelite, had spoken to him, saying: I will not give thee the inheritance of my fathers. And casting himself upon his bed, he turned away his face to the wall, and would eat no bread. ⁵ And Jezabel, his wife, went in to him, and said to him: What is the matter that thy soul is so grieved? and why eatest thou no bread? ⁶ And he answered her: I spoke to Naboth, the Jezrahelite, and said to him: Give me thy vineyard, and take money for it: or if it please thee, I will give thee a better vineyard for it. And he said: I will not give thee my vineyard. ⁷ Then Jezabel, his wife, said to him. Thou art of great authority indeed, and governest well the kingdom of Israel. Arise, and eat bread, and be of good cheer; I will give thee the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite. ⁸ So she wrote letters in Achab's name, and sealed them with his ring, and sent them to the ancients, and the chief men that were in his city, and that dwelt with Naboth. ⁹ And this was the tenor of the letters: Proclaim a fast, and make Naboth sit among the chief of the people; ¹⁰ And suborn two men, sons of Belial, against him, and let them bear false witness; that he hath blasphemed God and the king: and then carry him out, and stone him, and so let him die. ¹¹ And the men of his city, the ancients and nobles, that dwelt with him in the city, did as Jezabel had commanded them, and as it was written in the letters which she had sent to them; ¹² They proclaimed a fast, and made Naboth sit among the chief of the people. ¹³ And bringing two men, sons of the devil, they made them sit against him: and they, like men of the devil, bore witness against him before the people: saying: Naboth hath blasphemed God and the king. Wherefore they brought him forth without the city, and stoned him to death. ¹⁴ And they sent to Jezabel, saying: Naboth is stoned, and is dead.

¹⁵ And it came to pass, when Jezabel heard that Naboth was stoned, and dead, that she said to Achab: Arise, and take possession of the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite, who would not agree with thee, and give it thee for money: for Naboth is not alive, but dead. ¹⁶ And when Achab heard this, to wit, that Naboth was dead, he arose, and went down into the vineyard of Naboth, the Jezrahelite, to take possession of it.

¹⁷ And the word of the Lord came to Elias, the Thesbite, saying:

¹⁸ Arise, and go down to meet Achab, king of Israel, who is in

Samaria: behold he is going down to the vineyard of Naboth, to take possession of it: ¹⁹ And thou shalt speak to him, saying: Thus saith the Lord: Thou hast slain: moreover also thou hast taken possession. And after these words thou shalt add: Thus saith the Lord: In this place, wherein the dogs have licked the blood of Naboth, they shall lick thy blood also. ²⁰ And Achab said to Elias: Hast thou found me thy enemy? He said: I have found thee because thou art sold, to do evil in the sight of the Lord. ²¹ Behold I will bring evil upon thee, and I will cut down thy posterity, and I will kill of Achab him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up, and the last in Israel. ²² And I will make thy house like the house of Jeroboam the son of Nabat, and like the house of Baasa the son of Ahias: for what thou hast done to provoke me to anger, and for making Israel to sin. ²³ And of Jezabel also, the Lord spoke, saying: The dogs shall eat Jezabel in the field of Jezrahel. ²⁴ If Achab die in the city, the dogs shall eat him: but if he die in the field, the birds of the air shall eat him.

²⁵ Now, there was not such another as Achab, who was sold to do evil in the sight of the Lord: for his wife, Jezabel, set him on, ²⁶ And he became abominable, insomuch that he followed the idols which the Amorrites had made, whom the Lord destroyed before the face of the children of Israel. ²⁷ And when Achab had heard these words, he rent his garments, and put haircloth upon his flesh, and fasted, and slept in sackcloth, and walked with his head cast down. ²⁸ And the word of the Lord came to Elias, the Thesbite, saying: ²⁹ Hast thou not seen Achab humbled before me? therefore, because he hath humbled himself, for my sake, I will not bring the evil in his days, but in his son's days will I bring the evil upon his house.

188. Micheas the prophet; the death of Achab

1 Kings 22:1-54

22 ¹ And there passed three years without war between Syria and Israel. ² And in the third year, Josaphat, king of Juda, came down to the king of Israel. ³ (And the king of Israel said to his servants: Know ye not that Ramoth Galaad is ours, and we neglect to take it out of the hand of the king of Syria?) ⁴ And he said to Josaphat: Wilt thou come with me to battle to Ramoth Galaad? ⁵ And Josaphat said to the king of Israel: As I am, so art thou: my people and thy people are one: and my horsemen are thy horsemen. And Josaphat said to the king of Israel: Inquire, I beseech thee, this day the word of the Lord. ⁶ Then the king of Israel assembled the prophets, about four hundred men, and he said to them: Shall I go to Ramoth Galaad to fight, or shall I forbear? They answered: Go up, and the Lord will deliver it into the hand of the king. ⁷ And Josaphat said: Is there not here some prophet of the Lord, that we may inquire by him? ⁸ And the king of Israel said to Josaphat. There is one man left, by whom we may inquire of the Lord; Micheas, the son of Jemla: but I hate him, for he doth not prophecy good to me, but evil. And Josaphat said: Speak not so, O king. ⁹ Then the king of Israel called an eunuch, and said to him: Make haste, and bring hither Micheas, the son of Jemla. ¹⁰ And the king of Israel, and Josaphat, king of Juda, sat each on his throne, clothed with royal robes, in a court, by the entrance of the gate of Samaria, and all the prophets prophesied before them. ¹¹ And Sedecias, the son of Chanaana, made himself horns of iron, and said: Thus saith the Lord: With

these shalt thou push Syria, till thou destroy it. ¹² And all the prophets prophesied in like manner, saying: Go up to Ramoth Galaad, and prosper, for the Lord will deliver it into the king's hands. ¹³ And the messenger that went to call Micheas, spoke to him, saying: Behold the words of the prophets with one mouth declare good things to the king: let thy word, therefore, be like to theirs, and speak that which is good. ¹⁴ But Micheas said to him: As the Lord liveth, whatsoever the Lord shall say to me, that will I speak.

¹⁵ So he came to the king, and the king said to him: Micheas, shall we go to Ramoth Galaad to battle, or shall we forbear? He answered him: Go up, and prosper, and the Lord shall deliver it into the king's hands. ¹⁶ But the king said to him: I adjure thee again and again, that thou tell me nothing but that which is true, in the name of the Lord. ¹⁷ And he said: I saw all Israel scattered upon the hills, like sheep that have no shepherd; and the Lord said: These have no master: let every man of them return to his house in peace. ¹⁸ (Then the king of Israel said to Josaphat: Did I not tell thee, that he prophesieth no good to me, but always evil?) ¹⁹ And he added and said: Hear thou, therefore, the word of the Lord: I saw the Lord sitting on his throne, and all the army of heaven standing by him on the right hand and on the left. ²⁰ And the Lord said: Who shall deceive Achab, king of Israel, that he may go up, and fall at Ramoth Galaad? And one spoke words of this manner, and another otherwise. ²¹ And there came forth a spirit, and stood before the Lord, and said: I will deceive him. And the Lord said to him: By what means? ²² And he said: I will go forth, and be a lying spirit, in the mouth of all his prophets. And the Lord said: Thou shalt deceive him, and shalt prevail: go forth, and do so. ²³ Now, therefore, behold the Lord hath given a lying spirit in the mouth of all thy prophets that are here, and the Lord hath spoken evil against thee. ²⁴ And Sedecias, the son of Chanaana, came, and struck Micheas on the cheek, and said: Hath then the spirit of the Lord left me, and spoken to thee? ²⁵ And Micheas said: Thou shalt see in the day when thou shalt go into a chamber within a chamber to hide thyself. ²⁶ And the king of Israel said: Take Micheas and let him abide with Amon, the governor of the city, and with Joas, the son of Amalech; ²⁷ And tell them: Thus saith the king: Put this man in prison, and feed him with bread of affliction, and water of distress till I return in peace. ²⁸ And Micheas said: If thou return in peace, the Lord hath not spoken by me. And he said: Hear, all ye people.

²⁹ So the king of Israel, and Josaphat, king of Juda, went up to Ramoth-Galaad. ³⁰ And the king of Israel said to Josaphat: Take thy armour, and go into the battle, and put on thy own garments. But the king of Israel changed his dress, and went into the battle. ³¹ And the king of Syria had commanded the two and thirty captains of the chariots, saying: You shall not fight against any, small or great, but against the king of Israel only. ³² So when the captains of the chariots saw Josaphat, they suspected that he was the king of Israel, and making a violent assault, they fought against him: and Josaphat cried out. ³³ And the captains of the chariots perceived that he was not the king of Israel, and they turned away from him. ³⁴ And a certain man bent his bow, shooting at a venture, and chanced to strike the king of Israel, between the lungs and the stomach. But he said

to the driver of his chariot: Turn thy hand, and carry me out of the army, for I am grievously wounded. ³⁵ And the battle was fought that day, and the king of Israel stood in his chariot against the Syrians, and he died in the evening: and the blood ran out of the wound into the midst of the chariot. ³⁶ And the herald proclaimed through all the army, before the sun set, saying: Let every man return to his own city, and to his own country.

³⁷ And the king died, and was carried into Samaria: and they buried the king in Samaria. ³⁸ And they washed his chariot in the pool of Samaria and the dogs licked up his blood, and they washed the reins according to the word of the Lord which he had spoken. ³⁹ But the rest of the acts of Achab, and all that he did, and the house of ivory that he made, and all the cities that he built, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ⁴⁰ So Achab slept with his fathers; and Ochozias, his son, reigned in his stead.

⁴¹ But Josaphat, the son of Asa, began to reign over Juda, in the fourth year of Achab, king of Israel. ⁴² He was five and thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned five and twenty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Azuba, the daughter of Salai. ⁴³ And he walked in all the way of Asa, his father, and he declined not from it: and he did that which was right in the sight of the Lord. ⁴⁴ Nevertheless, he took not away the high places for as yet the people offered sacrifice, and burnt incense in the high places. ⁴⁵ And Josaphat had peace with the king of Israel. ⁴⁶ But the rest of the acts of Josaphat, and his works which he did, and his battles, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ⁴⁷ And the remnant also of the effeminate, who remained in the days of Asa, his father, he took out of the land. ⁴⁸ And there was then no king appointed in Edom. ⁴⁹ But king Josaphat made navies on the sea, to sail into Ophir for gold: but they could not go, for the ships were broken in Asiongaber. ⁵⁰ Then Ochozias, the son of Achab, said to Josaphat: Let my servants go with thy servants in the ships. And Josaphat would not.

⁵¹ And Josaphat slept with his fathers, and was buried with them in the city of David, his father: and Joram, his son, reigned in his stead. ⁵² And Ochozias, the son of Achab, began to reign over Israel, in Samaria, in the seventeenth year of Josaphat, king of Juda, and he reigned over Israel two years. ⁵³ And he did evil in the sight of the Lord, and walked in the way of his father and his mother, and in the way of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin. ⁵⁴ He served also Baal, and worshipped him, and provoked the Lord, the God of Israel, according to all that his father had done.

189. Ochozias, and the fire from heaven

2 Kings 1:1-18

TRAP: this is Douay 4 Kings.

1 ¹ And Moab rebelled against Israel, after the death of Achab.

² And Ochozias fell through the lattices of his upper chamber, which he had in Samaria, and was sick: and he sent messengers, saying to them: Go, consult Beelzebub, the god of Accaron, whether I shall recover of this my illness. ³ And an angel of the Lord spoke to Elias, the Thesbite, saying: Arise, and go up to meet the messengers of the king of Samaria, and say to them: Is there not a God in Israel, that ye go to consult Beelzebub, the

god of Accaron? ⁴ Wherefore, thus saith the Lord: From the bed, on which thou art gone up, thou shalt not come down, but thou shalt surely die. And Elias went away.

⁵ And the messengers turned back to Ochozias. And he said to them: Why are you come back? ⁶ But they answered him: A man met us, and said to us: Go, and return to the king, that sent you, and you shall say to him: Thus saith the Lord: Is it because there was no God in Israel, that thou sendest to Beelzebub, the god of Accaron? Therefore thou shalt not come down from the bed, on which thou art gone up, but thou shalt surely die. ⁷ And he said to them: What manner of man was he who met you, and spoke these words? ⁸ But they said: A hairy man, with a girdle of leather about his loins. And he said: It is Elias, the Thesbite.

⁹ And he sent to him a captain of fifty, and the fifty men that were under him. And he went up to him, and as he was sitting on the top of a hill, he said to him: Man of God, the king hath commanded that thou come down. ¹⁰ And Elias answering, said to the captain of fifty: If I be a man of God, let fire come down from heaven and consume thee, and thy fifty. And there came down fire from heaven and consumed him, and the fifty that were with him. ¹¹ And he again sent to him another captain of fifty men, and his fifty with him. And he said to him: Man of God: Thus saith the king: Make haste and come down. ¹² Elias answering, said: If I be a man of God, let fire come down from heaven, and consume thee, and thy fifty. And fire came down from heaven, and consumed him and his fifty.

¹³ Again he sent a third captain of fifty men, and the fifty that were with him. And when he was come, he fell upon his knees before Elias, and besought him, and said: Man of God, despise not my life, and the lives of thy servants that are with me. ¹⁴ Behold fire came down from heaven, and consumed the two first captains of fifty men, and the fifties that were with them: but now I beseech thee to spare my life. ¹⁵ And the angel of the Lord spoke to Elias, saying: Go down with him, fear not. He arose therefore, and went down with him to the king. ¹⁶ And said to him: Thus saith the Lord: Because thou hast sent messengers to consult Beelzebub, the god of Accaron, as though there were not a God in Israel, of whom thou mightest inquire the word; therefore, from the bed on which thou art gone up, thou shalt not come down, but thou shalt surely die.

¹⁷ So he died, according to the word of the Lord, which Elias spoke; and Joram, his brother, reigned in his stead, in the second year of Joram, the son of Josaphat, king of Juda, because he had no son. ¹⁸ But the rest of the acts of Ochozias, which he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

190. *Elias taken up; the mantle of Eliseus*

2 Kings 2:1-25

2 ¹ And it came to pass, when the Lord would take up Elias, into heaven, by a whirlwind, that Elias and Eliseus were going from Galgal. ² And Elias said to Eliseus: Stay thou here, because the Lord hath sent me as far as Bethel. And Eliseus said to him: As the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And when they were come down to Bethel, ³ The sons of the prophets, that were at Bethel, came forth to Eliseus, and said to him: Dost thou know that, this day, the Lord will take away thy master from thee? And he answered: I also know it: hold

your peace. ⁴ And Elias said to Eliseus: Stay here, because the Lord hath sent me to Jericho. And he said: As the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And when they were come to Jericho, ⁵ The sons of the prophets, that were at Jericho, came to Eliseus, and said to him: Dost thou know that, this day, the Lord will take away thy master from thee? And he said: I also know it: hold your peace. ⁶ And Elias said to him: Stay here, because the Lord hath sent me as far as the Jordan. And he said: as the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. And they two went on together. ⁷ And fifty men, of the sons of the prophets, followed them, and stood in sight, at a distance: but they two stood by the Jordan. ⁸ And Elias took his mantle, and folded it together, and struck the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, and they both passed over on dry ground. ⁹ And when they were gone over, Elias said to Eliseus: Ask what thou wilt have me to do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Eliseus said: I beseech thee, that in me may be thy double spirit. ¹⁰ And he answered: Thou hast asked a hard thing; nevertheless, if thou see me when I am taken from thee, thou shalt have what thou hast asked: but if thou see me not, thou shalt not have it. ¹¹ And as they went on, walking and talking together, behold, a fiery chariot and fiery horses parted them both asunder: and Elias went up by a whirlwind into heaven. ¹² And Eliseus saw him, and cried: My father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the driver thereof. And he saw him no more: and he took hold of his own garments, and rent them in two pieces.

¹³ And he took up the mantle of Elias, that fell from him: and going back, he stood on the bank of the Jordan; ¹⁴ And he struck the waters with the mantle of Elias, that had fallen from him, and they were not divided. And he said: Where is now the God of Elias? And he struck the waters, and they were divided hither and thither, and Eliseus passed over. ¹⁵ And the sons of the prophets, at Jericho, who were over against him, seeing it, said: The spirit of Elias hath rested upon Eliseus. And coming to meet him, they worshipped him, falling to the ground. ¹⁶ And they said to him: Behold, there are with thy servants, fifty strong men, that can go, and seek thy master, lest, perhaps, the spirit of the Lord, hath taken him up and cast him upon some mountain, or into some valley. And he said: Do not send. ¹⁷ But they pressed him, till he consented, and said: Send. And they sent fifty men: and they sought three days, but found him not. ¹⁸ And they came back to him: for he abode at Jericho, and he said to them: Did I not say to you? Do not send.

¹⁹ And the men of the city, said to Eliseus: Behold the situation of this city is very good, as thou, my lord, seest: but the waters are very bad, and the ground barren. ²⁰ And he said: Bring me a new vessel, and put salt into it. And when they had brought it, ²¹ He went out to the spring of the waters, and cast the salt into it, and said: Thus saith the Lord: I have healed these waters, and there shall be no more in them death or barrenness. ²² And the waters were healed unto this day, according to the word of Eliseus, which he spoke.

²³ And he went up from thence to Bethel: and as he was going up by the way, little boys came out of the city and mocked him, saying: Go up, thou bald head, go up, thou bald head. ²⁴ And looking back, he saw them, and cursed them in the name of the

Lord: and there came forth two bears out of the forest, and tore of them, two and forty boys. ²⁵ And from thence he went to mount Carmel, and from thence he returned to Samaria.

191. The campaign against Moab

2 Kings 3:1-27

3 ¹ And Joram the son of Achab, reigned over Israel, in Samaria, in the eighteenth year of Josaphat, king of Juda. And he reigned twelve years. ² And he did evil before the Lord, but not like his father and his mother: for he took away the statues of Baal, which his father had made. ³ Nevertheless, he stuck to the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin, nor did he depart from them.

⁴ Now Mesa, king of Moab, nourished many sheep, and he paid to the king of Israel a hundred thousand lambs, and a hundred thousand rams, with their fleeces. ⁵ And when Achab was dead, he broke the league which he had made with the king of Israel. ⁶ And king Joram went out that day from Samaria, and mustered all Israel. ⁷ And he sent to Josaphat; king of Juda, saying: The king of Moab is revolted from me: come with me against him to battle. And he answered: I will come up: he that is mine, is thine: my people are thy people: and my horses, thy horses. ⁸ And he said: Which way shall we go up? But he answered: By the desert of Edom. ⁹ So the king of Israel, and the king of Juda, and the king of Edom, went, and they fetched a compass of seven days journey, and there was no water for the army, and for the beasts, that followed them. ¹⁰ And the king of Israel said: Alas, alas, the Lord hath gathered us three kings together, to deliver us into the hands of Moab. ¹¹ And Josaphat said: Is there not here a prophet of the Lord, that we may beseech the Lord by him? And one of the servants of the king of Israel answered: Here is Eliseus, the son of Saphat, who poured water on the hands of Elias. ¹² And Josaphat said: The word of the Lord is with him. And the king of Israel, and Josaphat, king of Juda, and the king of Edom, went down to him. ¹³ And Eliseus said to the king of Israel: What have I to do with thee? go to the prophets of thy father, and thy mother. And the king of Israel said to him: Why hath the Lord gathered together these three kings, to deliver them into the hands of Moab? ¹⁴ And Eliseus said to him: As the Lord of hosts liveth, in whose sight I stand, if I did not reverence the face of Josaphat, king of Juda, I would not have hearkened to thee, nor looked on thee. ¹⁵ But now bring me hither a minstrel. And when the minstrel played, the hand of the Lord came upon him, and he said: ¹⁶ Thus saith the Lord: Make the channel of this torrent full of ditches. ¹⁷ For thus saith the Lord: You shall not see wind, nor rain: and yet this channel shall be filled with waters, and you shall drink, you and your families, and your beasts. ¹⁸ And this is a small thing in the sight of the Lord: moreover, he will deliver, also, Moab into your hands. ¹⁹ And you shall destroy every fenced city, and every choice city, and shall cut down every fruitful tree, and shall stop up all the springs of waters, and every goodly field you shall cover with stones.

²⁰ And it came to pass, in the morning, when the sacrifices used to be offered, that behold, water came by the way of Edom, and the country was filled with water.

²¹ And all the Moabites hearing that the kings were come up to fight against them, gathered together all that were girded with

a belt upon them, and stood in the borders. ²² And they rose early in the morning, and the sun being now up, and shining upon the waters, the Moabites saw the waters over against them red, like blood, ²³ And they said: It is the blood of the sword: the kings have fought among themselves, and they have killed one another: go now, Moab, to the spoils. ²⁴ And they went into the camp of Israel: but Israel rising up, defeated Moab, who fled before them. And they being conquerors, went and smote Moab. ²⁵ And they destroyed the cities: and they filled every goodly field, every man casting his stone: and they stopt up all the springs of waters: and cut down all the trees that bore fruit, so that brick walls only remained: and the city was beset by the slingers, and a great part thereof destroyed. ²⁶ And when the king of Moab saw this, to wit, that the enemies had prevailed, he took with him seven hundred men that drew the sword, to break in upon the king of Edom: but they could not. ²⁷ Then he took his eldest son, that should have reigned in his stead, and offered him for a burnt offering upon the wall: and there was great indignation in Israel, and presently they departed from him, and returned into their own country.

192. The widow's oil, and the Sunamitess

2 Kings 4:1-44

4 ¹ Now a certain woman of the wives of the prophets, cried to Eliseus, saying: Thy servant, my husband, is dead, and thou knowest that thy servant was one that feared God, and behold the creditor is come to take away my two sons to serve him. ² And Eliseus said to her: What wilt thou have me do for thee? Tell me, what hast thou in thy house? And she answered: I, thy handmaid, have nothing in my house but a little oil, to anoint me. ³ And he said to her: Go, borrow of all thy neighbours empty vessels, not a few. ⁴ And go in, and shut thy door, when thou art within, and thy sons: and pour out thereof into all those vessels: and when they are full, take them away. ⁵ So the woman went, and shut the door upon her, and upon her sons: they brought her the vessels, and she poured in. ⁶ And when the vessels were full, she said to her son: Bring me yet a vessel. And he answered: I have no more. And the oil stood. ⁷ And she came, and told the man of God. And he said: Go, sell the oil, and pay thy creditor: and thou and thy sons live of the rest.

⁸ And there was a day when Eliseus passed by Sunam: now there was a great woman there, who detained him to eat bread: and as he passed often that way, he turned into her house to eat bread. ⁹ And she said to her husband: I perceive that this is a holy man of God, who often passeth by us. ¹⁰ Let us, therefore, make him a little chamber, and put a little bed in it for him, and a table, and a stool, and a candlestick, that when he cometh to us he may abide there. ¹¹ Now, there was a certain day, when he came, and turned into the chamber, and rested there. ¹² And he said to Giezi, his servant: Call this Sunamitess. And when he had called her, and she stood before him, ¹³ He said to his servant: Say to her: Behold, thou hast diligently served us in all things; what wilt thou have me to do for thee? Hast thou any business, and wilt thou, that I speak to the king, or to the general of the army? And she answered: I dwell in the midst of my own people. ¹⁴ And he said: What will she then that I do for her? And Giezi said: Do not ask, for she hath no son, and her husband is old. ¹⁵ Then he bid him call her. And when she

was called, and stood before the door, ¹⁶ He said to her: At this time, and this same hour, if life be in company, thou shalt have a son in thy womb. But she answered: Do not, I beseech thee, my lord, thou man of God, do not lie to thy handmaid. ¹⁷ And the woman conceived, and brought forth a son in the time, and at the same hour that Eliseus had said. ¹⁸ And the child grew. And on a certain day, when he went out to his father to the reapers, ¹⁹ He said to his father: My head acheth, my head acheth. But he said to his servant. Take him, and carry him to his mother. ²⁰ And when he had taken him, and brought him to his mother, she sat him on her knees, until noon, and then he died. ²¹ And she went up, and laid him upon the bed of the man of God, and shut the door: and going out, ²² She called her husband, and said: Send with me, I beseech thee, one of thy servants, and an ass, that I may run to the man of God, and come again. ²³ And he said to her: Why dost thou go to him? to day is neither new moon nor sabbath. She answered: I will go. ²⁴ And she saddled an ass, and commanded her servant: Drive, and make haste, make no stay in going: And do that which I bid thee. ²⁵ So she went forward, and came to the man of God, to mount Carmel: and when the man of God saw her coming towards, he said to Giezi, his servant: Behold that Sunamitess. ²⁶ Go, therefore, to meet her, and say to her: Is all well with thee, and with thy husband, and with thy son? And she answered: Well. ²⁷ And when she came to the man of God, to the mount, she caught hold on his feet: and Giezi came to remove her. And the man of God said: Let her alone for her soul is in anguish, and the Lord hath hid it from me, and hath not told me. ²⁸ And she said to him: Did I ask a son of my lord? did I not say to thee: Do not deceive me? ²⁹ Then he said to Giezi: Gird up thy loins, and take my staff in thy hand, and go. If any man meet thee, salute him not: and if any man salute thee, answer him not: and lay my staff upon the face of the child. ³⁰ But the mother of the child said: As the Lord liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not leave thee. He arose, therefore, and followed her. ³¹ But Giezi was gone before them, and laid the staff upon the face of the child, and there was no voice nor sense: and he returned to meet him, and told him, saying: The child is not risen. ³² Eliseus, therefore, went into the house, and behold the child lay dead on his bed: ³³ And going in, he shut the door upon him, and upon the child, and prayed to the Lord. ³⁴ And he went up, and lay upon the child: and put his mouth upon his mouth, and his eyes upon his eyes, and his hands upon his hands: and he bowed himself upon him, and the child's flesh grew warm. ³⁵ Then he returned and walked in the house, once to and fro: and he went up, and lay upon him: and the child gaped seven times, and opened his eyes. ³⁶ And he called Giezi, and said to him: Call this Sunamitess. And she being called, went in to him: and he said: Take up thy son. ³⁷ She came and fell at his feet, and worshipped upon the ground: and took up her son, and went out.

³⁸ And Eliseus returned to Galgal, and there was a famine in the land, and the sons of the prophets dwelt before him: And he said to one of his servants: Set on the great pot, and boil pottage for the sons of the prophets. ³⁹ And one went out into the field to gather wild herbs: and he found something like a wild vine, and gathered of it wild gourds of the field, and filled his mantle, and coming back, he shred them into the pot of pottage; for he knew

not what it was. ⁴⁰ And they poured it out for their companions to eat: and when they had tasted of the pottage, they cried out, saying: Death is in the pot, O man of God. And they could not eat thereof. ⁴¹ But he said: Bring some meal. And when they had brought it, he cast it into the pot, and said: Pour out for the people, that they may eat. And there was now no bitterness in the pot.

⁴² And a certain man came from Baalsalisa, bringing to the man of God, bread of the firstfruits, twenty loaves of barley, and new corn in his scrip. And he said: Give to the people, that they may eat. ⁴³ And his servant answered him: How much is this, that I should set it before a hundred men? He said again: Give to the people, that they may eat: for thus saith the Lord: They shall eat, and there shall be left. ⁴⁴ So he set it before them: and they ate, and there was left, according to the word of the Lord.

193. Naaman the Syrian

2 Kings 5:1-27

Cited by Christ at Nazareth, read later in this plan.

5 ¹ Naaman, general of the army, of the king of Syria, was a great man with his master, and honourable: for by him the Lord gave deliverance to Syria: and he was a valiant man, and rich, but a leper. ² Now there had gone out robbers from Syria, and had led away captive out of the land of Israel, a little maid, and she waited upon Naaman's wife. ³ And she said to her mistress: I wish my master had been with the prophet that is in Samaria: he would certainly have healed him of the leprosy which he hath. ⁴ Then Naaman went in to his lord, and told him, saying: Thus and thus said the girl from the land of Israel. ⁵ And the king of Syria said to him: Go; and I will send a letter to the king of Israel. And he departed, and took with him ten talents of silver, and six thousand pieces of gold, and ten changes of raiment; ⁶ And brought the letter to the king of Israel, in these words: When thou shalt receive this letter, know that I have sent to thee Naaman, my servant, that thou mayst heal him of his leprosy. ⁷ And when the king of Israel had read the letter, he rent his garments, and said: Am I God, to be able to kill and give life, that this man hath sent to me to heal a man of his leprosy? mark, and see how he seeketh occasions against me.

⁸ And when Eliseus, the man of God, had heard this, to wit, that the king of Israel had rent his garments, he sent to him, saying: Why hast thou rent thy garments? let him come to me, and let him know that there is a prophet in Israel.

⁹ So Naaman came with his horses and chariots, and stood at the door of the house of Eliseus: ¹⁰ And Eliseus sent a messenger to him, saying: Go, and wash seven times in the Jordan, and thy flesh shall recover health, and thou shalt be clean. ¹¹ Naaman was angry, and went away, saying: I thought he would have come out to me, and standing, would have invoked the name of the Lord his God, and touched with his hand the place of the leprosy, and healed me. ¹² Are not the Abana, and the Parphar, rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel, that I may wash in them, and be made clean? So as he turned, and was going away with indignation, ¹³ His servants came to him, and said to him: Father, if the prophet had bid thee do some great thing, surely thou shouldst have done it: how much rather what he now hath said to thee: Wash, and thou shalt be clean?

¹⁴ Then he went down, and washed in the Jordan seven times, according to the word of the man of God; and his flesh was restored, like the flesh of a little child: and he was made clean. ¹⁵ And returning to the man of God, with all his train, he came, and stood before him, and said: In truth, I know there is no other God, in all the earth, but only in Israel: I beseech thee, therefore, take a blessing of thy servant. ¹⁶ But he answered: As the Lord liveth, before whom I stand, I will receive none. And when he pressed him, he still refused. ¹⁷ And Naaman said: As thou wilt: but I beseech thee, grant to me, thy servant, to take from hence two mules' burden of earth: for thy servant will not henceforth offer holocaust, or victim, to other gods, but to the Lord. ¹⁸ But there is only this, for which thou shalt entreat the Lord for thy servant; when my master goeth into the temple of Remmon, to worship there, and he leaneth on my hand: if I bow down in the temple of Remmon, when he boweth down in the same place, that the Lord pardon me, thy servant, for this thing. ¹⁹ And he said to him: Go in peace. So he departed from him, in the spring time of the earth.

²⁰ But Giezi, the servant of the man of God, said: My master hath spared Naaman this Syrian, in not receiving of him that which he brought: as the Lord liveth, I will run after him, and take something of him. ²¹ And Giezi followed after Naaman: and when he saw him running after him, he leapt down from his chariot to meet him, and said: Is all well? ²² And he said: Well: my master hath sent me to thee, saying: Just now there are come to me from mount Ephraim, two young men of the sons of the prophets: give them a talent of silver, and two changes of garments. ²³ And Naaman said: It is better that thou take two talents. And he forced him, and bound two talents of silver in two bags, and two changes of garments, and laid them upon two of his servants, and they carried them before him. ²⁴ And when he was come, and now it was the evening, he took them from their hands, and laid them up in the house, and sent the men away, and they departed. ²⁵ But he went in, and stood before his master. And Eliseus said: Whence comest thou, Giezi? He answered: Thy servant went no whither. ²⁶ But he said: Was not my heart present, when the man turned back, from his chariot, to meet thee? So now thou hast received money, and received garments, to buy oliveyards and vineyards, and sheep, and oxen, and men-servants, and maid-servants. ²⁷ But the leprosy of Naaman, shall also stick to thee, and to thy seed for ever. And he went out from him a leper, as white as snow.

194. *The floating iron; the blinded army; the siege lifted*

2 Kings 6:1-7:20

6 ¹ And the sons of the prophets said to Eliseus: Behold, the place where we dwell with thee is too strait for us. ² Let us go as far as the Jordan, and take out of the wood every man a piece of timber, that we may build us there a place to dwell in. And he said: Go. ³ And one of them said: But come thou also with thy servants. He answered: I will come. ⁴ So he went with them. And when they were come to the Jordan, they cut down wood. ⁵ And it happened, as one was felling some timber, that the head of the ax fell into the water: and he cried out, and said: Alas, alas, my lord, for this same was borrowed. ⁶ And the man of God said: Where did it fall? and he shewed him the place: Then he

cut off a piece of wood, and cast it in thither: and the iron swam. ⁷ And he said: Take it up. And he put out his hand, and took it.

⁸ And the king of Syria warred against Israel, and took counsel with his servants, saying: In such and such a place, let us lay an ambush. ⁹ And the man of God sent to the king of Israel, saying: Beware that thou pass not to such a place: for the Syrians are there in ambush. ¹⁰ And the king of Israel, sent to the place which the man of God had told him, and prevented him, and looked well to himself there not once nor twice. ¹¹ And the heart of the king of Syria, was troubled for this thing. And calling together his servants, he said: Why do you not tell me who it is that betrays me to the king of Israel? ¹² And one of his servants said: No one, my lord, O king: but Eliseus, the prophet, that is in Israel, telleth the king of Israel all the words, that thou speakest in thy privy chamber.

¹³ And he said to them: Go, and see where he is: that I may send and take him. And they told him: saying: Behold he is in Dothan. ¹⁴ Therefore, he sent thither horses, and chariots, and the strength of an army: and they came by night, and beset the city. ¹⁵ And the servant of the man of God, rising early went out, and saw an army round about the city, and horses and chariots: and he told him, saying: Alas, alas, alas, my lord, what shall we do? ¹⁶ But he answered: Fear not: for there are more with us than with them. ¹⁷ And Eliseus prayed, and said: Lord, open his eyes, that he may see. And the Lord opened the eyes of the servant, and he saw: and behold, the mountain was full of horses, and chariots of fire round about Eliseus. ¹⁸ And the enemies came down to him: but Eliseus prayed to the Lord, saying: Strike, I beseech thee, this people with blindness: and the Lord struck them with blindness, according to the word of Eliseus.

¹⁹ And Eliseus said to them: This is not the way, neither is this the city: follow me, and I will shew you the man whom you seek. So he led them into Samaria. ²⁰ And when they were come into Samaria, Eliseus said: Lord, open the eyes of these men, that they may see. And the Lord opened their eyes, and they saw themselves to be in the midst of Samaria. ²¹ And the king of Israel said to Eliseus, when he saw them: My father, shall I kill them? ²² And he said: Thou shalt not kill them: for thou didst not take them with thy sword, or thy bow, that thou mayst kill them: but set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, and go to their master. ²³ And a great provision of meats was set before them, and they ate and drank; and he let them go: and they went away to their master: and the robbers of Syria came no more into the land of Israel.

²⁴ And it came to pass, after these things, that Benadad, king of Syria, gathered together all his army, and went up and besieged Samaria. ²⁵ And there was a great famine in Samaria: and so long did the siege continue, till the head of an ass was sold for fourscore pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a cake of pigeons' dung, for five pieces of silver. ²⁶ And as the king of Israel was passing by the wall, a certain woman cried out to him, saying: Save me, my lord, O king. ²⁷ And he said: If the Lord doth not save thee, how can I save thee? out of the barnfloor, or out of the winepress? And the king said to her: What aileth thee? And she answered: ²⁸ This woman said to me: Give thy son, that we may eat him today, and we will eat my son tomorrow. ²⁹ So we

boiled my son, and ate him. And I said to her on the next day: Give thy son, that we may eat him. And she hath hid her son.

³⁰ When the king heard this, he rent his garments, and passed by upon the wall. And all the people saw the haircloth which he wore within next to his flesh. ³¹ And the king said: May God do so and so to me, and may he add more, if the head of Eliseus, the son of Saphat, shall stand on him this day. ³² But Eliseus sat in his house, and the ancients sat with him. So he sent a man before: and before that messenger came, he said to the ancients: Do you know that this son of a murderer hath sent to cut off my head? Look then when the messenger shall come, shut the door, and suffer him not to come in: for behold the sound of his master's feet is behind him. ³³ While he was yet speaking to them, the messenger appeared, who was coming to him. And he said: Behold, so great an evil is from the Lord: what shall I look for more from the Lord?

7 ¹ And Eliseus said: Hear ye the word of the Lord: Thus saith the Lord: Tomorrow, about this time, a bushel of fine flour shall be sold for a stater, and two bushels of barley for a stater, in the gate of Samaria. ² Then one of the lords, upon whose hand the king leaned, answering the man of God, said: If the Lord should make flood-gates in heaven, can that possibly be which thou sayest? And he said: Thou shalt see it with thy eyes, but shalt not eat thereof.

³ Now there were four lepers, at the entering in of the gate: and they said one to another: What mean we to stay here till we die? ⁴ If we will enter into the city, we shall die with the famine: and if we will remain here, we must also die: come therefore, and let us run over to the camp of the Syrians. If they spare us, we shall live: but if they kill us, we shall but die. ⁵ So they arose in the evening, to go to the Syrian camp. And when they were come to the first part of the camp of the Syrians, they found no man there. ⁶ For the Lord had made them hear, in the camp of Syria, the noise of chariots, and of horses, and of a very great army: and they said one to another: Behold, the king of Israel hath hired against us the kings of the Hethites, and of the Egyptians; and they are come upon us. ⁷ Wherefore they arose, and fled away in the dark, and left their tents, and their horses and asses in the camp, and fled, desiring to save their lives. ⁸ So when these lepers were come to the beginning of the camp, they went into one tent, and ate and drank: and they took from thence silver, and gold, and raiment, and went, and hid it: and they came again, and went into another tent, and carried from thence in like manner, and hid it. ⁹ Then they said one to another: We do not well: for this is a day of good tidings. If we hold our peace, and do not tell it till the morning, we shall be charged with a crime: come, let us go, and tell it in the king's court. ¹⁰ So they came to the gate of the city, and told them, saying: We went to the camp of the Syrians, and we found no man there, but horses, and asses tied, and the tents standing. ¹¹ Then the guards of the gate went, and told it within in the king's palace.

¹² And he arose in the night, and said to his servants: I tell you what the Syrians have done to us: They know that we suffer great famine, and therefore they are gone out of the camp, and lie hid in the fields, saying: When they come out of the city, we shall take them alive, and then we may get into the city. ¹³ And one of his servants answered: Let us take the five horses that are

remaining in the city (because there are no more in the whole multitude of Israel, for the rest are consumed), and let us send and see. ¹⁴ They brought therefore two horses, and the king sent into the camp of the Syrians, saying: Go, and see. ¹⁵ And they went after them, as far as the Jordan: and behold, all the way was full of garments, and vessels, which the Syrians had cast away, in their fright, and the messengers returned, and told the king. ¹⁶ And the people going out, pillaged the camp of the Syrians: and a bushel of fine flour was sold for a stater, and two bushels of barley for a stater, according to the word of the Lord. ¹⁷ And the king appointed that lord on whose hand he leaned, to stand at the gate: and the people trod upon him in the entrance of the gate; and he died, as the man of God had said, when the king came down to him. ¹⁸ And it came to pass, according to the word of the man of God, which he spoke to the king, when he said: Two bushels of barley shall be for a stater, and a bushel of fine flour for a stater, at this very time tomorrow, in the gate of Samaria. ¹⁹ When that lord answered the man of God, and said: Although the Lord should make flood-gates in heaven, could this come to pass which thou sayest? And he said to him: Thou shalt see it with thy eyes, and shalt not eat thereof. ²⁰ And so it fell out to him, as it was foretold, and the people trod upon him in the gate, and he died.

195. Hazael, and the anointing of Jehu

2 Kings 8:1-9:37

8 ¹ And Eliseus spoke to the woman, whose son he had restored to life, saying: Arise, and go thou, and thy household, and sojourn wheresoever thou canst find: for the Lord hath called a famine, and it shall come upon the land seven years. ² And she arose, and did according to the word of the man of God: and going with her household, she sojourned in the land of the Philistines many days. ³ And when the seven years were ended, the woman returned out of the land of the Philistines, and she went forth to speak to the king for her house and for her lands. ⁴ And the king talked with Giezi, the servant of the man of God, saying: Tell me all the great things that Eliseus hath done. ⁵ And when he was telling the king how he had raised one dead to life, the woman appeared, whose son he had restored to life, crying to the king for her house, and her lands. And Giezi said: My lord, O king, this is the woman, and this is her son, whom Eliseus raised to life. ⁶ And the king asked the woman: and she told him. And the king appointed her an eunuch, saying: Restore her all that is hers, and all the revenues of the lands, from the day that she left the land to this present.

⁷ Eliseus also came to Damascus, and Benadad, king of Syria was sick; and they told him, saying: The man of God is come hither. ⁸ And the king said to Hazael: Take with thee presents, and go to meet the man of God, and consult the Lord by him, saying: Can I recover of this my illness? ⁹ And Hazael went to meet him, taking with him presents, and all the good things of Damascus, the burdens of forty camels. And when he stood before him, he said: Thy son, Benadad, the king of Syria, hath sent me to thee, saying: Can I recover of this my illness? ¹⁰ And Eliseus said to him: Go tell him: Thou shalt recover: but the Lord hath shewed me that he shall surely die. ¹¹ And he stood with him, and was troubled so far as to blush: and the man of God wept. ¹² And Hazael said to him: Why doth my lord weep? And

he said: Because I know the evil that thou wilt do to the children of Israel. Their strong cities thou wilt burn with fire, and their young men thou wilt kill with the sword, and thou wilt dash their children, and rip up their pregnant women. ¹³ And Hazeal said: But what am I, thy servant, a dog, that I should do this great thing? And Eliseus said: The Lord hath shewed me that thou shalt be king of Syria. ¹⁴ And when he was departed from Eliseus he came to his master, who said to him: What said Eliseus to thee? And he answered: He told me: Thou shalt recover. ¹⁵ And on the next day, he took a blanket, and poured water on it, and spread it upon his face: and he died, and Hazeal reigned in his stead.

¹⁶ In the fifth year of Joram, son of Achab, king of Israel, and of Josaphat, king of Juda, reigned Joram, son of Josaphat, king of Juda. ¹⁷ He was two and thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem. ¹⁸ And he walked in the ways of the kings of Israel, as the house of Achab had walked: for the daughter of Achab was his wife: and he did that which was evil in the sight of the Lord. ¹⁹ But the Lord would not destroy Juda, for David his servant's sake, as he had promised him, to give him a light, and to his children always.

²⁰ In his days Edom revolted from being under Juda, and made themselves a king. ²¹ And Joram came to Seira, and all the chariots with him: and he arose in the night, and defeated the Edomites that had surrounded him, and the captains of the chariots, but the people fled into their tents. ²² So Edom revolted from being under Juda, unto this day. Then Lobna also revolted at the same time. ²³ But the rest of the acts of Joram, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁴ And Joram slept with his fathers, and was buried with them in the city of David, and Ochozias, his son, reigned in his stead.

²⁵ In the twelfth year of Joram, the son of Achab, king of Israel, reigned Ochozias, son of Joram, king of Juda. ²⁶ Ochozias was two and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Athalia the daughter of Amri king of Israel. ²⁷ And he walked in the ways of the house of Achab: and he did evil before the Lord, as did the house of Achab: for he was the son in law of the house of Achab.

²⁸ He went also with Joram, son of Achab, to fight against Hazeal, king of Syria, in Ramoth Galaad, and the Syrians wounded Joram: ²⁹ And he went back to be healed, in Jezrahel: because the Syrians had wounded him in Ramoth, when he fought against Hazeal, king of Syria And Ochozias, the son of Joram, king of Juda, went down to visit Joram, the son of Achab, in Jezrahel, because he was sick there.

9 ¹ And Eliseus the prophet, called one of the sons of the prophets, and said to him: Gird up thy loins, and take this little bottle of oil in thy hand, and go to Ramoth Galaad. ² And when thou art come thither, thou shalt see Jehu the son of Josaphat the son of Namsi: and going in, thou shalt make him rise up from amongst his brethren, and carry him into an inner chamber. ³ Then taking the little bottle of oil, thou shalt pour it on his head, and shalt say: Thus saith the Lord: I have anointed thee king over Israel. And thou shalt open the door and flee, and shalt not stay there.

⁴ So the young man, the servant of the prophet, went away to Ramoth Galaad, ⁵ And went in thither: and behold, the captains of the army were sitting, and he said: I have a word to thee, O prince. And Jehu said: Unto whom of us all? And he said: To thee, O prince. ⁶ And he arose, and went into the chamber: and he poured the oil upon his head, and said: Thus saith the Lord God of Israel: I have anointed thee king over Israel, the people of the Lord. ⁷ And thou shalt cut off the house of Achab, thy master, and I will revenge the blood of my servants, the prophets, and the blood of all the servants of the Lord, at the hand of Jezabel. ⁸ And I will destroy all the house of Achab, and I will cut off from Achab, him that pisseth against the wall, and him that is shut up, and the meanest in Israel. ⁹ And I will make the house of Achab, like the house of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, and like the house of Baasa, the son of Ahias. ¹⁰ And the dogs shall eat Jezabel, in the field of Jezrahel, and there shall be no one to bury her. And he opened the door and fled.

¹¹ Then Jehu went forth to the servants of his lord: and they said to him: Are all things well? why came this madman to thee? And he said to them: You know the man, and what he said. ¹² But they answered: It is false; but rather do thou tell us. And he said to them: Thus and thus did he speak to me: and he said: Thus saith the Lord: I have anointed thee king over Israel. ¹³ Then they made haste, and taking every man his garment, laid it under his feet, after the manner of a judgment seat, and they sounded the trumpet, and said: Jehu is king. ¹⁴ So Jehu, the son of Josaphat, the son of Namsi, conspired against Joram. Now Joram had besieged Ramoth Galaad, he, and all Israel, fighting with Hazeal, king of Syria: ¹⁵ And was returned to be healed in Jezrahel of his wounds; for the Syrians had wounded him, when he fought with Hazeal, king of Syria. And Jehu said: If it please you, let no man go forth or flee out of the city, lest he go, and tell in Jezrahel. ¹⁶ And he got up, and went into Jezrahel for Joram was sick there, and Ochozias king of Juda, was come down to visit Joram. ¹⁷ The watchman therefore, that stood upon the tower of Jezrahel, saw the troop of Jehu coming, and said: I see a troop. And Joram said: Take a chariot, and send to meet them, and let him that goeth say: Is all well? ¹⁸ So there went one in a chariot to meet him, and said: Thus saith the king: Are all things peaceable? And Jehu said: What hast thou to do with peace? go behind and follow me. And the watchman told, saying: The messenger came to them, but he returneth not. ¹⁹ And he sent a second chariot of horses: and he came to them, and said: Thus saith the king: Is there peace? And Jehu said: What hast thou to do with peace? pass, and follow me. ²⁰ And the watchman told, saying: He came even to them, but returneth not: and the driving is like the driving of Jehu, the son of Namsi; for he drives furiously. ²¹ And Joram said: Make ready the chariot. And they made ready his chariot: and Joram, king of Israel, and Ochozias, king of Juda, went out, each in his chariot, and they went out to meet Jehu, and met him in the field of Naboth, the Jezrahelite. ²² And when Joram saw Jehu, he said: Is there peace, Jehu? And he answered: What peace? so long as the fornications of Jezabel, thy mother, and her many sorceries, are in their vigour. ²³ And Joram turned his hand, and fleeing, said to Ochozias: There is treachery, Ochozias. ²⁴ But Jehu bent his bow with his hand, and shot Joram between the shoulders: and the arrow went out

through his heart, and immediately he fell in his chariot. ²⁵ And Jehu said to Badacer, his captain: Take him, and cast him into the field of Naboth, the Jezrahelite: for I remember, when I and thou, sitting in a chariot, followed Achab, this man's father, that the Lord laid this burden upon him, saying: ²⁶ If I do not requite thee in this field, saith the Lord, for the blood of Naboth, and for the blood of his children, which I saw yesterday, saith the Lord. So now take him, and cast him into the field, according to the word of the Lord.

²⁷ But Ochozias, king of Juda, seeing this, fled by the way of the garden house: and Jehu pursued him, and said: Strike him also in his chariot. And they struck him in the going up to Gaver, which is by Jebllaam: and he fled into Mageddo, and died there. ²⁸ And his servants laid him upon his chariot, and carried him to Jerusalem: and they buried him in his sepulchre with his fathers, in the city of David. ²⁹ In the eleventh year of Joram, the son of Achab, Ochozias reigned over Juda;

³⁰ And Jehu came into Jezrahel. But Jezabel, hearing of his coming in, painted her face with stibic stone, and adorned her head, and looked out of a window. ³¹ At Jehu coming in at the gate, and said: Can there be peace for Zambri, that hath killed his master? ³² And Jehu lifted up his face to the window, and said: Who is this? And two or three eunuchs bowed down to him. ³³ And he said to them: Throw her down headlong; And they threw her down, and the wall was sprinkled with her blood, and the hoofs of the horses trod upon her. ³⁴ And when he was come in to eat, and to drink, he said: Go, and see after that cursed woman, and bury her; because she is a king's daughter. ³⁵ And when they went to bury her, they found nothing but the skull, and the feet, and the extremities of her hands. ³⁶ And coming back they told him. And Jehu said: It is the word of the Lord, which he spoke by his servant Elias, the Thesbite, saying: In the field of Jezrahel the dogs shall eat the flesh of Jezabel. ³⁷ And the flesh of Jezabel shall be as dung upon the face of the earth in the field of Jezrahel; so that they who pass by shall say: Is this that same Jezabel?

196. The house of Achab destroyed

2 Kings 10:1-36

10 ¹ And Achab had seventy sons in Samaria: so Jehu wrote letters, and sent to Samaria, to the chief men of the city, and to the ancients, and to them that brought up Achab's children, saying: ² As soon as you receive these letters, ye that have your master's sons, and chariots, and horses, and fenced cities, and armour, ³ Choose the best, and him that shall please you most of your master's sons, and set him on his father's throne, and fight for the house of your master. ⁴ But they were exceedingly afraid, and said: Behold two kings could not stand before him, and how shall we be able to resist? ⁵ Therefore they that were over the king's house, and the rulers of the city, and the ancients, and the bringers up of the children, sent to Jehu, saying: We are thy servants: whatsoever thou shalt command us we will do; we will not make us any king: do thou all that pleaseth thee. ⁶ And he wrote letters the second time to them, saying: If you be mine, and will obey me, take the heads of the sons of your master, and come to me to Jezrahel by tomorrow at this time. Now the king's sons, being seventy men, were brought up with the chief men of the city. ⁷ And when the letters came to them,

they took the king's sons, and slew seventy persons, and put their heads in baskets, and sent them to him to Jezrahel. ⁸ And a messenger came, and told him, saying: They have brought the heads of the king's sons. And he said: Lay ye them in two heaps by the entering in of the gate until the morning. ⁹ And when it was light, he went out, and standing, said to all the people: You are just: if I conspired against my master, and slew him; who hath slain all these? ¹⁰ See therefore now that there hath not fallen to the ground any of the words of the Lord, which the Lord spoke concerning the house of Achab, and the Lord hath done that which he spoke in the hand of his servant Elias. ¹¹ So Jehu slew all that were left of the house of Achab in Jezrahel, and all his chief men, and his friends, and his priests, till there were no remains left of him.

¹² And he arose, and went to Samaria: and when he was come to the shepherds' cabin in the way, ¹³ He met with the brethren of Ochozias, king of Juda, and he said to them: Who are you? And they answered: We are the brethren of Ochozias, and are come down to salute the sons of the king, and the sons of the queen. ¹⁴ And he said: Take them alive. And they took them alive, and killed them at the pit by the cabin, two and forty men, and he left not any of them.

¹⁵ And when he was departed thence, he found Jonadab, the son of Rechab, coming to meet him, and he blessed him. And he said to him: Is thy heart right as my heart is with thy heart? And Jonadab said: It is. If it be, said he, give me thy hand. He gave him his hand. And he lifted him up to him into the chariot, ¹⁶ And said to him: Come with me, and see my zeal for the Lord. So he made him ride in his chariot, ¹⁷ And brought him into Samaria. And he slew all that were left of Achab, in Samaria, to a man, according to the word of the Lord which he spoke by Elias.

¹⁸ And Jehu gathered together all the people, and said to them: Achab worshipped Baal a little, but I will worship him more. ¹⁹ Now therefore call to me all the prophets of Baal, and all his servants, and all his priests: let none be wanting, for I have a great sacrifice to offer to Baal: whosoever shall be wanting, shall not live. Now Jehu did this craftily, that he might destroy the worshippers of Baal. ²⁰ And he said: Proclaim a festival for Baal. And he called, ²¹ And he sent into all the borders of Israel; and all the servants of Baal came: there was not one left that did not come. And they went into the temple of Baal: and the house of Baal was filled, from one end to the other. ²² And he said to them that were over the wardrobe: Bring forth garments for all the servants of Baal. And they brought them forth garments. ²³ And Jehu, and Jonadab, the son of Rechab, went to the temple of Baal, and said to the worshippers of Baal: Search, and see that there be not any with you of the servants of the Lord, but that there be the servants of Baal only. ²⁴ And they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings: but Jehu had prepared him fourscore men without, and said to them: If any of the men escape, whom I have brought into your hands, he that letteth him go, shall answer life for life. ²⁵ And it came to pass, when the burnt offering was ended, that Jehu commanded his soldiers and captains, saying: Go in, and kill them: let none escape. And the soldiers and captains slew them with the edge of the sword, and cast them out: and they went into the city of the temple of

Baal, ²⁶ And brought the statue out of Baal's temple, and burnt it, ²⁷ And broke it in pieces. They destroyed also the temple of Baal, and made a jakes in its place unto this day. ²⁸ So Jehu destroyed Baal out of Israel:

²⁹ But yet he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin, nor did he forsake the golden calves that were in Bethel, and Dan. ³⁰ And the Lord said to Jehu: because thou hast diligently executed that which was right and pleasing in my eyes, and hast done to the house of Achab according to all that was in my heart: thy children shall sit upon the throne of Israel to the fourth generation. ³¹ But Jehu took no heed to walk in the law of the Lord, the God of Israel, with all his heart: for he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, who had made Israel to sin.

³² In those days the Lord began to be weary of Israel: and Hazael ravaged them in all the coasts of Israel, ³³ From the Jordan eastward, all the land of Galaad, and Gad, and Ruben, and Manasses, from Aroer, which is upon the torrent Arnon, and Galaad, and Basan. ³⁴ But the rest of the acts of Jehu, and all that he did, and his strength, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ³⁵ And Jehu slept with his fathers, and they buried him in Samaria: and Joachaz, his son, reigned in his stead. ³⁶ And the time that Jehu reigned over Israel, in Samaria, was eight and twenty years.

197. *Athalia, the boy king Joas, and the temple repaired*

2 Kings 11:1-12:21

11 ¹ Now Athalia, the mother of Ochozias, seeing that her son was dead, arose and slew all the royal seed. ² But Josaba the daughter of king Joram, sister of Ochozias, took Joas, the son of Ochozias, and stole him from among the king's sons that were slain, out of the bedchamber with his nurse: and hid him from the face of Athalia; so that he was not slain. ³ And he was with her six years, hid in the house of the Lord. And Athalia reigned over the land.

⁴ And in the seventh year Joiada sent, and taking the centurions and soldiers, brought them in to him into the temple of the Lord, and made a covenant with them: and taking an oath of them in the house of the Lord, shewed them the king's son: ⁵ And he commanded them, saying: This is the thing that you must do. ⁶ Let a third part of you go in on the sabbath, and keep the watch of the king's house. And let a third part be at the gate of Sur; and let a third part be at the gate behind the dwelling of the shieldbearers; and you shall keep the watch of the house of Messa. ⁷ But let two parts of you all that go forth on the sabbath, keep the watch of the house of the Lord about the king. ⁸ And you shall compass him round about, having weapons in your hands: and if any man shall enter the precinct of the temple, let him be slain: and you shall be with the king, coming in and going out. ⁹ And the centurions did according to all things that Joiada the priest, had commanded them: and taking every one their men, that went in on the sabbath, with them that went out in the sabbath, came to Joiada, the priest. ¹⁰ And he gave them the spears, and the arms of king David, which were in the house of the Lord. ¹¹ And they stood, having every one their weapons in their hands, from the right side of the temple, unto the left side of the altar, and of the temple, about the king. ¹² And he brought forth the king's son, and put the diadem upon him, and

the testimony: and they made him king, and anointed him: and clapping their hands, they said: God save the king.

¹³ And Athalia heard the noise of the people running: and going in to the people into the temple of the Lord, ¹⁴ She saw the king standing upon a tribunal, as the manner was, and the singers, and the trumpets near him, and all the people of the land rejoicing, and sounding the trumpets: and she rent her garments, and cried: A conspiracy, a conspiracy. ¹⁵ But Joiada commanded the centurions that were over the army, and said to them: Have her forth without the precinct of the temple, and whosoever shall follow her, let him be slain with the sword. For the priest had said: Let her not be slain in the temple of the Lord. ¹⁶ And they laid hands on her: and thrust her out by the way by which the horses go in, by the palace, and she was slain there.

¹⁷ And Joiada made a covenant between the Lord, and the king, and the people, that they should be the people of the Lord; and between the king and the people. ¹⁸ And all the people of the land went into the temple of Baal, and broke down his altars, and his images they broke in pieces thoroughly: they slew also Mathan the priest of Baal before the altar. And the priest set guards in the house of the Lord. ¹⁹ And he took the centurions, and the bands of the Cerethi, and the Phelethi, and all the people of the land, and they brought the king from the house of the Lord: and they came by the way of the gate of the shieldbearers into the palace, and he sat on the throne of the kings. ²⁰ And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet: but Athalia was slain with the sword in the king's house. ²¹ Now Joas was seven years old when he began to reign.

12 ¹ In the seventh year of Jehu, Joas began to reign: and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. The name of his mother was Sebia, of Bersabee. ² And Joas did that which was right before the Lord all the days that Joiada, the priest, taught him. ³ But yet he took not away the high places: for the people still sacrificed and burnt incense in the high places.

⁴ And Joas said to the priests: all the money of the sanctified things, which is brought into the temple of the Lord by those that pass, which is offered for the price of a soul, and which of their own accord, and of their own free heart, they bring into the temple of the Lord: ⁵ Let the priests take it according to their order and repair the house, wheresoever they shall see any thing that wanteth repairing. ⁶ Now till the three and twentieth year of king Joas the priests did not make the repairs of the temple. ⁷ And king Joas called Joiada, the high priest, and the priests, saying to them: Why do you not repair the temple? Take you, therefore, money no more according to your order, but restore it for the repairing of the temple. ⁸ And the priests were forbidden to take any more money of the people, and to make the repairs of the house. ⁹ And Joiada, the high priest, took a chest, and bored a hole in the top, and set it by the altar at the right hand of them that came into the house of the Lord; and the priests that kept the doors, put therein all the money that was brought to the temple of the Lord. ¹⁰ And when they saw that there was very much money in the chest, the king's scribe, and the high priest, came up, and poured it out, and counted the money that was found in the house of the Lord. ¹¹ And they gave it out by number and measure into the hands of them that were over the builders of the house of the Lord: and they laid it out to the carpenters, and

the masons, that wrought in the house of the Lord, ¹² And made the repairs: and to them that cut stones, and to buy timber, and stones to be hewed, that the repairs of the house of the Lord might be completely finished, and wheresoever there was need of expenses to uphold the house. ¹³ But there were not made of the same money for the temple of the Lord, bowls, or fleshhooks, or censers, or trumpets, or any vessel of gold and silver, of the money that was brought into the temple of the Lord: ¹⁴ For it was given to them that did the work, that the temple of the Lord might be repaired. ¹⁵ And they reckoned not with the men that received the money to distribute it to the workmen, but they bestowed it faithfully. ¹⁶ But the money for trespass, and the money for sins, they brought not into the temple of the Lord, because it was for the priests.

¹⁷ Then Hazael, king of Syria, went up, and fought against Geth, and took it, and set his face to go up to Jerusalem. ¹⁸ Wherefore Joas, king of Juda, took all the sanctified things, which Josaphat, and Joram, and Ochozias, his fathers, the kings of Juda, had dedicated to holy uses, and which he himself had offered: and all the silver that could be found in the treasures of the temple of the Lord, and in the king's palace: and sent it to Hazael, king of Syria, and he went off from Jerusalem.

¹⁹ And the rest of the acts of Joas, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁰ And his servants arose, and conspired among themselves, and slew Joas, in the house of Mello, in the descent of Sella. ²¹ For Josachar the son of Semaath, and Jozabad the son of Somer his servant, struck him, and he died: and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David; and Amasias, his son, reigned in his stead.

198. Joachaz, Joas, the death of Eliseus, and Amasias

2 Kings 13:1-14:29

13 ¹ In the three and twentieth year of Joas son of Ochozias, king of Juda, Joachaz, the son of Jehu, reigned over Israel, in Samaria, seventeen years. ² And he did evil before the Lord, and followed the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin; and he departed not from them. ³ And the wrath of the Lord was kindled against Israel, and he delivered them into the hand of Hazael, the king of Syria, and into the hand of Benadad, the son of Hazael, all days. ⁴ But Joachaz besought the face of the Lord, and the Lord heard him: for he saw the distress of Israel, because the king of Syria had oppressed them: ⁵ And the Lord gave Israel a saviour, and they were delivered out of the hand of the king of Syria: and the children of Israel dwelt in their pavilions as yesterday and the day before. ⁶ But yet they departed not from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, who made Israel to sin, but walked in them: and there still remained a grove also in Samaria. ⁷ And Joachaz had no more left of the people than fifty horsemen, and ten chariots, and ten thousand footmen: for the king of Syria had slain them, and had brought them low as dust by threshing in the barnfloor. ⁸ But the rest of the acts of Joachaz, and all that he did, and his valour, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ⁹ And Joachaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in Samaria: and Joas, his son, reigned in his stead.

¹⁰ In the seven and thirtieth year of Joas, king of Juda, Joas the son of Joachaz reigned over Israel, in Samaria, sixteen years.

¹¹ And he did that which is evil in the sight of the Lord: he departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin; but he walked in them. ¹² But the rest of the acts of Joas, and all that he did, and his valour wherewith he fought against Amasias, king of Juda, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ¹³ And Joas slept with his fathers; and Jeroboam sat upon his throne. But Joas was buried in Samaria, with the kings of Israel.

¹⁴ Now Eliseus was sick of the illness whereof he died: and Joas, king of Israel, went down to him, and wept before him, and said: O my father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the guider thereof. ¹⁵ And Eliseus said to him: Bring a bow and arrows. And when he had brought him a bow and arrows, ¹⁶ He said to the king of Israel: Put thy hand upon the bow. And when he had put his hand, Eliseus put his hands over the king's hands, ¹⁷ And said: Open the window to the east. And when he had opened it, Eliseus said: Shoot an arrow. And he shot. And Eliseus said: The arrow of the Lord's deliverance, and the arrow of the deliverance from Syria: and thou shalt strike the Syrians in Aphec, till thou consume them. ¹⁸ And he said: Take the arrows. And when he had taken them, he said to him: Strike with an arrow upon the ground. And he struck three times, and stood still. ¹⁹ And the man of God was angry with him, and said: If thou hadst smitten five or six or seven times, thou hadst smitten Syria even to utter destruction: but now three times shalt thou smite it.

²⁰ And Eliseus died, and they buried him. And the rovers from Moab came into the land the same year. ²¹ And some that were burying a man, saw the rovers, and cast the body into the sepulchre of Eliseus. And when it had touched the bones of Eliseus, the man came to life and stood upon his feet.

²² Now Hazael, king of Syria, afflicted Israel all the days of Joachaz. ²³ And the Lord had mercy on them, and returned to them, because of his covenant, which he had made with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob: and he would not destroy them, nor utterly cast them away, unto this present time. ²⁴ And Hazael, king of Syria, died; and Benadad, his son, reigned in his stead. ²⁵ Now Joas the son of Joachaz, took the cities out of the hand of Benadad, the son of Hazael, which he had taken out of the hand of Joachaz, his father, by war; three times did Joas beat him, and he restored the cities to Israel.

14 ¹ In the second year of Joas son of Joachaz, king of Israel, reigned Amasias son of Joas, king of Juda. ² He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign; and nine and twenty years he reigned in Jerusalem; the name of his mother was Joadan, of Jerusalem. ³ And he did that which was right before the Lord, but yet not like David his father. He did according to all things that Joas his father, did: ⁴ But this only, that he took not away the high places; for yet the people sacrificed, and burnt incense in the high places: ⁵ And when he had possession of the kingdom, he put his servants to death that had slain the king, his father. ⁶ But the children of the murderers he did not put to death, according to that which is written in the book of the law of Moses, wherein the Lord commanded, saying: The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers: but every man shall die for his own sin. ⁷ He slew of Edom in the valley of the Saltpits, ten thousand men, and took the rock by war, and called the name

thereof Jectehel, unto this day.⁸ Then Amasias sent messengers to Joas, son of Joachaz, son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying: Come, let us see one another.⁹ And Joas, king of Israel, sent again to Amasias, king of Juda, saying: A thistle of Libanus sent to a cedar tree, which is in Libanus, saying: Give thy daughter to my son to wife. And the beasts of the forest, that are in Libanus, passed, and trod down the thistle.¹⁰ Thou hast beaten and prevailed over Edom, and thy heart hath lifted thee up; be content with this glory, and sit at home; why provokest thou evil, that thou shouldst fall, and Juda with thee?¹¹ But Amasias did not rest satisfied. So Joas, king of Israel, went up; and he and Amasias, king of Juda, saw one another in Bethsames, a town in Juda.¹² And Juda was put to the worse before Israel, and they fled every man to their dwellings.¹³ But Joas, king of Israel, took Amasias, king of Juda, the son of Joas, the son of Ochozias, in Bethsames, and brought him into Jerusalem; and he broke down the wall of Jerusalem, from the gate of Ephraim to the gate of the corner, four hundred cubits.¹⁴ And he took all the gold and silver, and all the vessels that were found in the house of the Lord, and in the king's treasures, and hostages, and returned to Samaria.

¹⁵ But the rest of the acts of Joas, which he did, and his valour, wherewith he fought against Amasias, king of Juda, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ¹⁶ And Joas slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria, with the kings of Israel: and Jeroboam, his son, reigned in his stead.

¹⁷ And Amasias, the son of Joas, king of Juda, lived after the death of Joas, son of Joachaz, king of Israel, fifteen years.¹⁸ And the rest of the acts of Amasias, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ¹⁹ Now they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem: and he fled to Lachis. And they sent after him to Lachis, and killed him there.²⁰ And they brought him away upon horses, and he was buried in Jerusalem with his fathers, in the city of David.

²¹ And all the people of Juda took Azarias, who was sixteen years old, and made him king instead of his father, Amasias.²² He built Elath, and restored it to Juda, after that the king slept with his fathers.

²³ In the fifteenth year of Amasias, son of Joas, king of Juda, reigned Jeroboam, the son of Joas, king of Israel, in Samaria, one and forty years:²⁴ And he did that which is evil before the Lord. He departed not from all the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin.²⁵ He restored the borders of Israel from the entrance of Emath, unto the sea of the wilderness, according to the word of the Lord, the God of Israel, which he spoke by his servant, Jonas, the son of Amathi, the prophet, who was of Geth, which is in Opher.²⁶ For the Lord saw the affliction of Israel, that it was exceedingly bitter, and that they were consumed even to them that were shut up in prison, and the lowest persons, and that there was no one to help Israel.²⁷ And the Lord did not say that he would blot out the name of Israel from under heaven; but he saved them by the hand of Jeroboam, the son of Joas.²⁸ But the rest of the acts of Jeroboam, and all that he did, and his valour, wherewith he fought, and how he restored Damascus and Emath to Juda, in Israel, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ²⁹ And Jeroboam

slept with his fathers, the kings of Israel; and Zacharias, his son, reigned in his stead.

199. *The kings hasten to the end; Achaz and the altar of Damascus*

2 Kings 15:1-16:20

15 ¹ In the seven and twentieth year of Jeroboam, king of Israel, reigned Azarias, son of Amasias, king of Juda.² He was sixteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned two and fifty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Jechelia, of Jerusalem.³ And he did that which was pleasing before the Lord, according to all that his father, Amasias, had done.⁴ But the high places he did not destroy, for the people sacrificed, and burnt incense in the high places.⁵ And the Lord struck the king, so that he was a leper unto the day of his death, and he dwelt in a free house apart: but Joatham, the king's son, governed the palace, and judged the people of the land.⁶ And the rest of the acts of Azarias, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ⁷ And Azarias slept with his fathers: and they buried him with his ancestors in the city of David, and Joatham, his son, reigned in his stead.

⁸ In the eight and thirtieth year of Azarias, king of Juda, reigned Zacharias, son of Jeroboam, over Israel, in Samaria, six months:⁹ And he did that which is evil before the Lord, as his fathers had done: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin.¹⁰ And Sellum, the son of Jabes, conspired against him: and struck him publicly, and killed him, and reigned in his place.¹¹ Now the rest of the acts of Zacharias, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ¹² This was the word of the Lord, which he spoke to Jehu, saying: Thy children, to the fourth generation, shall sit upon the throne of Israel. And so it came to pass.

¹³ Sellum, the son of Jabes, began to reign in the nine and thirtieth year of Azarias, king of Juda: and reigned one month in Samaria.¹⁴ And Manahem, the son of Gadi, went up from Thersa, and he came into Samaria, and struck Sellum, the son of Jabes, in Samaria, and slew him, and reigned in his stead.¹⁵ And the rest of the acts of Sellum, and his conspiracy which he made, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

¹⁶ Then Manahem destroyed Thapsa and all that were in it, and the borders thereof from Thersa, because they would not open to him: and he slew all the women thereof that were with child, and ripped them up.¹⁷ In the nine and thirtieth year of Azarias, king of Juda, reigned Manahem, son of Gadi, over Israel, ten years, in Samaria.¹⁸ And he did that which was evil before the Lord: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin, all his days.¹⁹ And Phul, king of the Assyrians, came into the land, and Manahem gave Phul a thousand talents of silver to aid him and to establish him in the kingdom.²⁰ And Manahem laid a tax upon Israel, on all that were mighty and rich, to give the king of the Assyrians, each man fifty sicles of silver: so the king of the Assyrians turned back, and did not stay in the land.²¹ And the rest of the acts of Manahem, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel? ²² And Manahem slept with his fathers: and Phaceia, his son, reigned in his stead.

²³ In the fiftieth year of Azarias, king of Juda, reigned Phaceia, the son of Manahem, over Israel, in Samaria, two years. ²⁴ And he did that which was evil before the Lord: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin. ²⁵ And Phacee the son of Romelia, his captain, conspired against him, and smote him in Samaria, in the tower of the king's house, near Argob, and near Arie, and with him fifty men of the sons of the Galaadites, and he slew him, and reigned in his stead. ²⁶ And the rest of the acts of Phaceia, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

²⁷ In the two and fiftieth year of Azarias, king of Juda, reigned Phacee, the son of Romelia, over Israel, in Samaria, twenty years. ²⁸ And he did that which was evil before the Lord: he departed not from the sins of Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin. ²⁹ In the days of Phacee, king of Israel, came Theglathphalasar, king of Assyria, and took Aion, and Abel Domum Maacha, and Janoe, and Cedec, and Asor, and Galaad, and Galilee, and all the land of Nephthali: and carried them captives into Assyria. ³⁰ Now Osee, son of Ela, conspired, and formed a plot against Phacee, the son of Romelia, and struck him, and slew him: and reigned in his stead in the twentieth year of Joatham, the son of Ozias. ³¹ But the rest of the acts of Phacee, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

³² In the second year of Phacee, the son of Romelia king of Israel, reigned Joatham, son of Ozias, king of Juda. ³³ He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Jerusa, the daughter of Sadoc. ³⁴ And he did that which was right before the Lord: according to all that his father Ozias had done, so did he. ³⁵ But the high places he took not away: the people still sacrificed, and burnt incense in the high places: he built the highest gate of the house of the Lord. ³⁶ But the rest of the acts of Joatham, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ³⁷ In those days the Lord began to send into Juda, Rasin king of Syria, and Phacee the son of Romelia. ³⁸ And Joatham slept with his fathers, and was buried with them in the city of David, his father; and Achaz, his son, reigned in his stead.

16 ¹ In the seventeenth year of Phacee, the son of Romelia reigned Achaz, the son of Joatham, king of Juda. ² Achaz was twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem: he did not that which was pleasing in the sight of the Lord, his God, as David, his father. ³ But he walked in the way of the kings of Israel: moreover, he consecrated also his son, making him pass through the fire, according to the idols of the nations which the Lord destroyed before the children of Israel. ⁴ He sacrificed also, and burnt incense in the high places, and on the hills, and under every green tree.

⁵ Then Rasin, king of Syria, and Phacee, son of Romelia, king of Israel, came up to Jerusalem to fight: and they besieged Achaz, but were not able to overcome him. ⁶ At that time Rasin, king of Syria, restored Aila to Syria, and drove the men of Juda out of Aila: and the Edomites came into Aila, and dwelt there unto this day. ⁷ And Achaz sent messengers to Theglathphalasar, king of the Assyrians, saying: I am thy servant, and thy son: come up,

and save me out of the hand of the king of Syria, and out of the hand of the king of Israel, who are risen up together against me. ⁸ And when he had gathered together the silver and gold that could be found in the house of the Lord, and in the king's treasures, he sent it for a present to the king of the Assyrians. ⁹ And he agreed to his desire: for the king of the Assyrians went up against Damascus, and laid it waste: and he carried away the inhabitants thereof to Cyrene; but Rasin he slew.

¹⁰ And king Achaz went to Damascus to meet Theglathphalasar, king of the Assyrians, and when he had seen the altar of Damascus, king Achaz sent to Urias, the priest, a pattern of it, and its likeness, according to all the work thereof. ¹¹ And Urias, the priest, built an altar according to all that king Achaz had commanded from Damascus so did Urias, the priest, until king Achaz came from Damascus. ¹² And when the king was come from Damascus, he saw the altar and worshipped it: and went up and offered holocausts, and his own sacrifice; ¹³ And he offered libations, and poured the blood of the peace offerings, which he had offered, upon the altar. ¹⁴ But the altar of brass that was before the Lord, he removed from the face of the temple, and from the place of the altar, and from the place of the temple of the Lord: and he set it at the side of the altar towards the north. ¹⁵ And king Achaz commanded Urias, the priest, saying: Upon the great altar offer the morning holocaust, and the evening sacrifice, and the king's holocaust, and his sacrifice, and the holocaust of the whole people of the land, and their sacrifices, and their libations: and all the blood of the holocaust, and all the blood of the victim, thou shalt pour out upon it: but the altar of brass shall be ready at my pleasure. ¹⁶ So Urias, the priest, did according to all that king Achaz had commanded him.

¹⁷ And king Achaz took away the graven bases, and the laver that was upon them: and he took down the sea from the brazen oxen that held it up, and put it upon a pavement of stone. ¹⁸ The Musach also for the sabbath, which he had built in the temple, and the king's entry from without, he turned into the temple of the Lord, because of the king of the Assyrians. ¹⁹ Now the rest of the acts of Achaz which he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁰ And Achaz slept with his fathers, and was buried with them in the city of David, and Ezechias, his son, reigned in his stead.

200. Emmanuel promised to Achaz

Isaiah 7:1-17

Read at the reign in which it was spoken. One of four passages of Isaias in this plan; the remaining sixty-two chapters are not read.

7 ¹ And it came to pass in the days of Achaz the son of Joathan, the son of Ozias, king of Juda, that Rasin king of Syria and Phacee the son of Romelia king of Israel, came up to Jerusalem, to fight against it: but they could not prevail over it. ² And they told the house of David, saying: Syria hath rested upon Ephraim, and his heart was moved, and the heart of his people, as the trees of the woods are moved with the wind. ³ And the Lord said to Isaias: Go forth to meet Achaz, thou and Jasub thy son that is left, to the conduit of the upper pool in the way of the fuller's field. ⁴ And thou shalt say to him: See thou be quiet: fear not, and let not thy heart be afraid of the two tails of these firebrands, smoking

with the wrath of the fury of Rasin king of Syria, and of the son of Romelia. ⁵ Because Syria hath taken counsel against thee, unto the evil of Ephraim and the son of Romelia, saying: ⁶ Let us go up to Juda, and rouse it up, and draw it away to us, and make the son of Tabeel king in the midst thereof. ⁷ Thus saith the Lord God: It shall not stand, and this shall not be. ⁸ But the head of Syria is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is Rasin: and within threescore and five years, Ephraim shall cease to be a people: ⁹ And the head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is the son of Romelia. If you will not believe, you shall not continue.

¹⁰ And the Lord spoke again to Achaz, saying: ¹¹ Ask thee a sign of the Lord thy God, either unto the depth of hell, or unto the height above. ¹² And Achaz said: I will not ask, and I will not tempt the Lord. ¹³ And he said: Hear ye therefore, O house of David: Is it a small thing for you to be grievous to men, that you are grievous to my God also? ¹⁴ Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign. Behold a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son and his name shall be called Emmanuel. ¹⁵ He shall eat butter and honey, that he may know to refuse the evil, and to choose the good. ¹⁶ For before the child know to refuse the evil and to choose the good, the land which thou abhorrest shall be forsaken of the face of her two kings. ¹⁷ The Lord shall bring upon thee, and upon thy people, and upon the house of thy father, days that have not come since the time of the separation of Ephraim from Juda with the king of the Assyrians.

201. "A child is born to us"

Isaiah 9:1-7

9 ¹ At the first time the land of Zabulon, and the land of Nephtali was lightly touched: and at the last the way of the sea beyond the Jordan of the Galilee of the Gentiles was heavily loaded. ² The people that walked in darkness, have seen a great light: to them that dwelt in the region of the shadow of death, light is risen. ³ Thou hast multiplied the nation, and hast not increased the joy. They shall rejoice before thee, as they that rejoice in the harvest, as conquerors rejoice after taking a prey, when they divide the spoils. ⁴ For the yoke of their burden, and the rod of their shoulder, and the sceptre of their oppressor thou hast overcome, as in the day of Madian. ⁵ For every violent taking of spoils, with tumult, and garment mingled with blood, shall be burnt, and be fuel for the fire. ⁶ For a CHILD IS BORN to us, and a son is given to us, and the government is upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, God the Mighty, the Father of the world to come, the Prince of Peace. ⁷ His empire shall be multiplied, and there shall be no end of peace: he shall sit upon the throne of David, and upon his kingdom; to establish it and strengthen it with judgment and with justice, from henceforth and for ever: the zeal of the Lord of hosts will perform this.

202. "A rod out of the root of Jesse"

Isaiah 11:1-10

11 ¹ And there shall come forth a rod out of the root of Jesse, and a flower shall rise up out of his root. ² And the spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him: the spirit of wisdom, and of understanding, the spirit of counsel, and of fortitude, the spirit of knowledge,

and of godliness. ³ And he shall be filled with the spirit of the fear of the Lord, He shall not judge according to the sight of the eyes, nor reprove according to the hearing of the ears. ⁴ But he shall judge the poor with justice, and shall reprove with equity for the meek of the earth: and he shall strike the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips he shall slay the wicked. ⁵ And justice shall be the girdle of his loins: and faith the girdle of his reins. ⁶ The wolf shall dwell with the lamb: and the leopard shall lie down with the kid: the calf and the lion, and the sheep shall abide together, and a little child shall lead them. ⁷ The calf and the bear shall feed: their young ones shall rest together: and the lion shall eat straw like the ox. ⁸ And the sucking child shall play on the hole of the asp: and the weaned child shall thrust his hand into the den of the basilisk. ⁹ They shall not hurt, nor shall they kill in all my holy mountain, for the earth is filled with the knowledge of the Lord, as the covering waters of the sea.

¹⁰ In that day the root of Jesse, who standeth for an ensign of the people, him the Gentiles shall beseech, and his sepulchre shall be glorious.

203. The fall of Samaria

2 Kings 17:1-41

The chapter states why the northern kingdom ended, and is the plan's explanation of everything that follows it.

17 ¹ In the twelfth year of Achaz king of Juda, Osee the son of Ela reigned in Samaria, over Israel, nine years. ² And he did evil before the Lord: but not as the kings of Israel that had been before him. ³ Against him came up Salmanasar, king of the Assyrians; and Osee became his servant, and paid him tribute. ⁴ And when the king of the Assyrians found that Osee, endeavouring to rebel, had sent messengers to Sua, the king of Egypt, that he might not pay tribute to the king of the Assyrians, as he had done every year, he besieged him, bound him, and cast him into prison. ⁵ And he went through all the land: and going up to Samaria, he besieged it three years. ⁶ And in the ninth year of Osee, the king of the Assyrians took Samaria, and carried Israel away to Assyria: and he placed them in Hala, and Habor, by the river of Gozan, in the cities of the Medes.

⁷ For so it was that the children of Israel had sinned against the Lord, their God, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, from under the hand of Pharaoh, king of Egypt; and they worshipped strange gods. ⁸ And they walked according to the way of the nations which the Lord had destroyed in the sight of the children of Israel, and of the kings of Israel: because they had done in like manner. ⁹ And the children of Israel offended the Lord, their God, with things that were not right: and built them high places in all their cities, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city. ¹⁰ And they made them statues and groves on every high hill, and under every shady tree: ¹¹ And they burnt incense there upon altars, after the manner of the nations which the Lord had removed from their face: and they did wicked things, provoking the Lord. ¹² And they worshipped abominations, concerning which the Lord had commanded them that they should not do this thing. ¹³ And the Lord testified to them in Israel, and in Juda, by the hand of all the prophets and seers, saying: Return from your wicked ways, and keep my precepts, and ceremonies,

according to all the law which I commanded your fathers: and as I have sent to you in the hand of my servants the prophets. ¹⁴ And they hearkened not, but hardened their necks like to the neck of their fathers, who would not obey the Lord, their God. ¹⁵ And they rejected his ordinances, and the covenant that he made with their fathers, and the testimonies which he testified against them: and they followed vanities, and acted vainly: and they followed the nations that were round about them, concerning which the Lord had commanded them that they should not do as they did. ¹⁶ And they forsook all the precepts of the Lord, their God: and made to themselves two molten calves, and groves, and adored all the host of heaven: and they served Baal, ¹⁷ And consecrated their sons, and their daughters, through fire: and they gave themselves to divinations, and soothsayings: and they delivered themselves up to do evil before the Lord, to provoke him. ¹⁸ And the Lord was very angry with Israel, and removed them from his sight, and there remained only the tribe of Juda. ¹⁹ But neither did Juda itself keep the commandments of the Lord, their God: but they walked in the errors of Israel, which they had wrought. ²⁰ And the Lord cast off all the seed of Israel, and afflicted them, and delivered them into the hand of spoilers, till he cast them away from his face: ²¹ Even from that time, when Israel was rent from the house of David, and made Jeroboam, son of Nabat, their king: for Jeroboam separated Israel from the Lord, and made them commit a great sin. ²² And the children of Israel walked in all the sins of Jeroboam, which he had done: and they departed not from them, ²³ Till the Lord removed Israel from his face, as he had spoken in the hand of all his servants, the prophets: and Israel was carried away out of their land to Assyria, unto this day.

²⁴ And the king of the Assyrians brought people from Babylon, and from Cutha, and from Avah, and from Emath, and from Sepharvaim: and placed them in the cities of Samaria instead of the children of Israel: and they possessed Samaria, and dwelt in the cities thereof. ²⁵ And when they began to dwell there, they feared not the Lord: and the Lord sent lions among them, which killed them. ²⁶ And it was told the king of the Assyrians, and it was said: The nations which thou hast removed, and made to dwell in the cities of Samaria, know not the ordinances of the God of the land: and the Lord hath sent lions among them: and behold they kill them, because they know not the manner of the God of the land. ²⁷ And the king of the Assyrians commanded, saying: Carry thither one of the priests whom you brought from thence captive, and let him go, and dwell with them: and let him teach them the ordinances of the God of the land. ²⁸ So one of the priests, who had been carried away captive from Samaria, came and dwelt in Bethel, and taught them how they should worship the Lord. ²⁹ And every nation made gods of their own and put them in the temples of the high places, which the Samaritans had made, every nation in their cities where they dwelt. ³⁰ For the men of Babylon made Sochothbenoth: and the Cuthites made Nergel: and the men of Emath made Asima. ³¹ And the Hevites made Nebahaz, and Tharthac. And they that were of Sepharvaim burnt their children in fire, to Adramelech and Anamelech, the gods of Sepharvaim. ³² And nevertheless they worshipped the Lord. And they made to themselves, of the lowest of the people, priests of the high places, and they

placed them in the temples of the high places. ³³ And when they worshipped the Lord, they served also their own gods, according to the custom of the nations out of which they were brought to Samaria: ³⁴ Unto this day they follow the old manner: they fear not the Lord, neither do they keep his ceremonies, and judgments, and law, and the commandment, which the Lord commanded the children of Jacob, whom he surnamed Israel: ³⁵ With whom he made a covenant, and charged them, saying: You shall not fear strange gods, nor shall you adore them, nor worship them, nor sacrifice to them. ³⁶ But the Lord, your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, with great power, and a stretched out arm, him shall you fear, and him shall you adore, and to him shall you sacrifice. ³⁷ And the ceremonies, and judgments, and law, and the commandment, which he wrote for you, you shall observe to do them always: and you shall not fear strange gods. ³⁸ And the covenant that he made with you, you shall not forget: neither shall ye worship strange gods, ³⁹ But fear the Lord, your God, and he shall deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies. ⁴⁰ But they did not hearken to them, but did according to their old custom. ⁴¹ So these nations feared the Lord, but nevertheless served also their idols: their children also, and grandchildren, as their fathers did, so do they unto this day.

EXILE

2 Kings 18-25: Juda alone, from Ezechias to the burning of the temple, with the prophetic and deuterocanonical material the exile requires. Ezechias and Josias stand here rather than in the Divided Kingdom because their reigns are the last reprieve before the deportation, and the book treats them so.

204. Ezechias reforms; Sennacherib invades

2 Kings 18:1-37

18 ¹ In the third year of Osee, the son of Ela, king of Israel, reigned Ezechias, the son of Achaz, king of Juda. ² He was five and twenty years old when he began to reign: and he reigned nine and twenty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Abi, the daughter of Zacharias. ³ And he did that which was good before the Lord, according to all that David, his father, had done. ⁴ He destroyed the high places, and broke the statues in pieces, and cut down the groves, and broke the brazen serpent, which Moses had made: for till that time the children of Israel burnt incense to it: and he called its name Nohestan. ⁵ He trusted in the Lord, the God of Israel: so that after him there was none like him among all the kings of Juda, nor any of them that were before him: ⁶ And he stuck to the Lord, and departed not from his steps, but kept his commandments, which the Lord commanded Moses. ⁷ Wherefore the Lord also was with him, and in all things, to which he went forth, he behaved himself wisely. And he rebelled against the king of the Assyrians, and served him not. ⁸ He smote the Philistines as far as Gaza, and all their borders, from the tower of the watchmen to the fenced city.

⁹ In the fourth year of king Ezechias, which was the seventh year of Osee, the son of Ela, king of Israel, Salmanasar, king of the Assyrians, came up to Samaria, and besieged it, ¹⁰ And took it. For after three years, in the sixth year of Ezechias, that is, in the ninth year of Osee, king of Israel, Samaria was taken: ¹¹ And the king of the Assyrians carried away Israel into Assyria, and

placed them in Hala, and in Habor, by the rivers of Gozan, in the cities of the Medes. ¹² Because they hearkened not to the voice of the Lord, their God, but transgressed his covenant: all that Moses, the servant of the Lord, commanded, they would not hear, nor do.

¹³ In the fourteenth year of king Ezechias, Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians, came up against the fenced cities of Juda, and took them. ¹⁴ Then Ezechias, king of Juda, sent messengers to the king of the Assyrians, to Lachis, saying: I have offended, depart from me: and all that thou shalt put upon me, I will bear. And the king of the Assyrians put a tax upon Ezechias, king of Juda, of three hundred talents of silver, and thirty talents of gold. ¹⁵ And Ezechias gave all the silver that was found in the house of the Lord, and in the king's treasures. ¹⁶ At that time Ezechias broke the doors of the temple of the Lord, and the plates of gold which he had fastened on them, and gave them to the king of the Assyrians.

¹⁷ And the king of the Assyrians sent Tharthan, and Rabsaris, and Rabsaces, from Lachis, to king Ezechias, with a strong army, to Jerusalem: and they went up and came to Jerusalem, and they stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the way of the fuller's field. ¹⁸ And they called for the king: and there went out to them Eliacim, the son of Helcias, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and Joahe, the son of Asaph, the recorder. ¹⁹ And Rabsaces said to them: Speak to Ezechias: Thus saith the great king, the king of the Assyrians: What is this confidence, wherein thou trustest? ²⁰ Perhaps thou hast taken counsel, to prepare thyself for battle. On whom dost thou trust, that thou darest to rebel? ²¹ Dost thou trust in Egypt a staff of a broken reed, upon which if a man lean, it will break and go into his hand, and pierce it? so is Pharaoh, king of Egypt, to all that trust in him. ²² But if you say to me: We trust in the Lord, our God: is it not he, whose high places and altars Ezechias hath taken away: and hath commanded Juda and Jerusalem: You shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem? ²³ Now therefore come over to my master, the king of the Assyrians, and I will give you two thousand horses, and see whether you be able to have riders for them. ²⁴ And how can you stand against one lord of the least of my master's servants? Dost thou trust in Egypt for chariots and for horsemen? ²⁵ Is it without the will of the Lord that I am come up to this place to destroy it? The Lord said to me: Go up to this land, and destroy it. ²⁶ Then Eliacim, the son of Helcias, and Sobna, and Joahe, said to Rabsaces: We pray thee, speak to us, thy servants, in Syriac: for we understand that tongue: and speak not to us in the Jews' language, in the hearing of the people that are upon the wall. ²⁷ And Rabsaces answered them, saying: Hath my master sent me to thy master, and to thee, to speak these words, and not rather to the men that sit upon the wall, that they may eat their own dung, and drink their urine with you? ²⁸ Then Rabsaces stood, and cried out with a loud voice in the Jews' language, and said: Hear the word of the great king, the king of the Assyrians. ²⁹ Thus saith the king: Let not Ezechias deceive you: for he shall not be able to deliver you out of my hand. ³⁰ Neither let him make you trust in the Lord, saying: The Lord will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be given into the hand of the king of the Assyrians. ³¹ Do not hearken to Ezechias. For thus saith the king of the Assyrians:

Do with me that which is for your advantage, and come out to me: and every man of you shall eat of his own vineyard, and of his own fig tree: and you shall drink water of your own cisterns, ³² Till I come, and take you away, to a land, like to your own land, a fruitful land, and plentiful in wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olives, and oil, and honey, and you shall live, and not die. Hearken not to Ezechias, who deceiveth you, saying: The Lord will deliver us. ³³ Have any of the gods of the nations delivered their land from the hand of the king of Assyria? ³⁴ Where is the god of Emath, and of Arphad? where is the god of Sepharvaim, of Ana, and of Ava? have they delivered Samaria out of my hand? ³⁵ Who are they among all the gods of the nations that have delivered their country out of my hand, that the Lord may deliver Jerusalem out of my hand? ³⁶ But the people held their peace, and answered him not a word: for they had received commandment from the king that they should not answer him. ³⁷ And Eliacim, the son of Helcias, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and Joahe, the son of Asaph, the recorder, came to Ezechias, with their garments rent, and told him the words of Rabsaces.

205. The angel of the Lord before Jerusalem

2 Kings 19:1-37

19 ¹ And when king Ezechias heard these words, he rent his garments, and covered himself with sackcloth, and went into the house of the Lord. ² And he sent Eliacim, who was over the house, and Sobna, the scribe, and the ancients of the priests, covered with sackcloths, to Isaia, the prophet, the son of Amos. ³ And they said to him: Thus saith Ezechias: This day is a day of tribulation, and of rebuke, and of blasphemy: the children are come to the birth, and the woman in travail hath not strength. ⁴ It may be the Lord, thy God, will hear all the words of Rabsaces, whom the king of the Assyrians, his master, hath sent to reproach the living God, and to reprove with words, which the Lord, thy God, hath heard: and do thou offer prayer for the remnants that are found. ⁵ So the servants of king Ezechias came to Isaia. ⁶ And Isaia said to them: Thus shall you say to your master: Thus saith the Lord: Be not afraid for the words which thou hast heard, with which the servants of the king of the Assyrians have blasphemed me. ⁷ Behold I will send a spirit upon him, and he shall hear a message, and shall return into his own country, and I will make him fall by the sword in his own country.

⁸ And Rabsaces returned, and found the king of the Assyrians besieging Lobna: for he had heard that he was departed from Lachis. ⁹ And when he heard of Tharaca, king of Ethiopia: Behold, he is come out to fight with thee: and was going against him, he sent messengers to Ezechias, saying: ¹⁰ Thus shall you say to Ezechias, king of Juda: Let not thy God deceive thee, in whom thou trustest: and do not say: Jerusalem shall not be delivered into the hands of the king of the Assyrians. ¹¹ Behold, thou hast heard what the kings of the Assyrians have done to all countries, how they have laid them waste: and canst thou alone be delivered? ¹² Have the gods of the nations delivered any of them, whom my fathers have destroyed, to wit, Gozan, and Haran, and Reseph, and the children of Eden, that were in The-lassar? ¹³ Where is the king of Emath, and the king of Arphad, and the king of the city of Sepharvaim, and of Ana, and of Ava?

¹⁴ And when Ezechias had received the letter of the hand of the messengers, and had read it, he went up to the house of the Lord, and spread it before the Lord, ¹⁵ And he prayed in his sight, saying: O Lord God of Israel, who sittest upon the cherubims, thou alone art the God of all the kings of the earth: thou madest heaven and earth: ¹⁶ Incline thy ear, and hear: open, O Lord, thy eyes and see: and hear all the words of Sennacherib, who hath sent to upbraid unto us the living God. ¹⁷ Of a truth, O Lord, the kings of the Assyrians have destroyed nations, and the lands of them all. ¹⁸ And they have cast their gods into the fire: for they were not gods, but the work of men's hands, of wood and stone, and they destroyed them. ¹⁹ Now therefore, O Lord our God, save us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the Lord, the only God.

²⁰ And Isaias, the son of Amos, sent to Ezechias, saying: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: I have heard the prayer thou hast made to me concerning Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians. ²¹ This is the word that the Lord hath spoken of him: The virgin, the daughter of Sion, hath despised thee, and laughed thee to scorn: the daughter of Jerusalem hath wagged her head behind thy back. ²² Whom hast thou reproached, and whom hast thou blasphemed? against whom hast thou exalted thy voice, and lifted up thy eyes on high? against the holy one of Israel. ²³ By the hand of thy servants thou hast reproached the Lord, and hast said: With the multitude of my chariots I have gone up to the height of the mountains, to the top of Libanus, and have cut down its tall cedars, and its choice fir trees. And I have entered into the furthest parts thereof, and the forest of its Carmel. ²⁴ I have cut down, and I have drunk strange waters, and have dried up with the soles of my feet all the shut up waters. ²⁵ Hast thou not heard what I have done from the beginning? from the days of old I have formed it, and now I have brought it to effect: that fenced cities of fighting men should be turned to heaps of ruins: ²⁶ And the inhabitants of them were weak of hand, they trembled and were confounded, they became like the grass of the field, and the green herb on the tops of houses, which withered before it came to maturity. ²⁷ Thy dwelling, and thy going out, and thy coming in, and thy way I knew before, and thy rage against me. ²⁸ Thou hast been mad against me, and thy pride hath come up to my ears: therefore I will put a ring in thy nose, and a bit between thy lips, and I will turn thee back by the way by which thou camest. ²⁹ And to thee, O Ezechias, this shall be a sign: Eat this year what thou shalt find: and in the second year, such things as spring of themselves: but in the third year sow and reap: plant vineyards, and eat the fruit of them. ³⁰ And whatsoever shall be left of the house of Juda, shall take root downward, and bear fruit upward. ³¹ For out of Jerusalem shall go forth a remnant, and that which shall be saved out of mount Sion: the zeal of the Lord of hosts shall do this. ³² Wherefore thus saith the Lord concerning the king of the Assyrians: He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow into it, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a trench about it. ³³ By the way that he came he shall return: and into this city he shall not come, saith the Lord. ³⁴ And I will protect this city, and will save it for my own sake, and for David, my servant's sake.

³⁵ And it came to pass that night, that an angel of the Lord came, and slew in the camp of the Assyrians a hundred and

eighty-five thousand. And when he arose early in the morning, he saw all the bodies of the dead. ³⁶ And Sennacherib, king of the Assyrians, departing, went away, and he returned and abode in Ninive. ³⁷ And as he was worshipping in the temple of Nes-roch, his god, Adramelech and Sarasar, his sons, slew him with the sword, and they fled into the land of the Armenians, and Asarhaddon, his son, reigned in his stead.

206. The envoys of Babylon; Manasses fills Jerusalem with blood

2 Kings 20:1-21:26

20 ¹ In those days Ezechias was sick unto death: and Isaias, the son of Amos, the prophet, came and said to him: Thus saith the Lord God: Give charge concerning thy house, for thou shalt die, and not live. ² And he turned his face to the wall, and prayed to the Lord, saying: ³ I beseech thee, O Lord, remember how I have walked before thee in truth, and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is pleasing before thee. And Ezechias wept with much weeping. ⁴ And before Isaias was gone out of the middle of the court, the word of the Lord came to him, saying: ⁵ Go back, and tell Ezechias, the captain of my people: Thus saith the Lord, the God of David, thy father: I have heard thy prayer, and I have seen thy tears: and behold I have healed thee: on the third day thou shalt go up to the temple of the Lord. ⁶ And I will add to thy days fifteen years: and I will deliver thee and this city out of the hand of the king of the Assyrians, and I will protect this city for my own sake, and for David, my servant's sake. ⁷ And Isaias said: Bring me a lump of figs. And when they had brought it, and laid it upon his boil, he was healed.

⁸ And Ezechias had said to Isaias: What shall be the sign that the Lord will heal me, and that I will go up to the temple of the Lord the third day? ⁹ And Isaias said to him: This shall be the sign from the Lord, that the Lord will do the word which he hath spoken: Wilt thou that the shadow go forward ten lines, or that it go back so many degrees? ¹⁰ And Ezechias said: It is an easy matter for the shadow to go forward ten lines: and I do not desire that this be done, but let it return back ten degrees. ¹¹ And Isaias, the prophet, called upon the Lord, and he brought the shadow ten degrees backwards by the lines, by which it had already gone down on the dial of Achaz.

¹² At that time Berodach Baladan, the son of Baladan, king of the Babylonians, sent letters and presents to Ezechias: for he had heard that Ezechias had been sick. ¹³ And Ezechias rejoiced at their coming, and he shewed them the house of his aromatical spices, and the gold, and the silver, and divers precious odours, and ointments, and the house of his vessels, and all that he had in his treasures. There was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominions, that Ezechias shewed them not.

¹⁴ And Isaias, the prophet, came to king Ezechias, and said to him: What said these men? or from whence came they to thee? And Ezechias said to him: From a far country, they came to me out of Babylon. ¹⁵ And he said: What did they see in thy house? Ezechias said: They saw all the things that are in my house: There is nothing among my treasures that I have not shewed them. ¹⁶ And Isaias said to Ezechias: Hear the word of the Lord. ¹⁷ Behold the days shall come, that all that is in thy house, and that thy fathers have laid up in store unto this day, shall be carried into Babylon: nothing shall be left, saith the Lord.

¹⁸ And of thy sons also that shall issue from thee, whom thou shalt beget, they shall take away, and they shall be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon. ¹⁹ Ezechias said to Isaia: The word of the Lord, which thou hast spoken, is good: let peace and truth be in my days.

²⁰ And the rest of the acts of Ezechias, and all his might, and how he made a pool, and a conduit, and brought waters into the city, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²¹ And Ezechias slept with his fathers, and Manasses, his son reigned in his stead.

21 ¹ Manasses was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned five and fifty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Haphsiba. ² And he did evil in the sight of the Lord, according to the idols of the nations, which the Lord destroyed from before the face of the children of Israel. ³ And he turned, and built up the high places, which Ezechias, his father, had destroyed: and he set up altars to Baal, and made groves, as Achab, the king of Israel, had done: and he adored all the host of heaven, and served them. ⁴ And he built altars in the house of the Lord, of which the Lord said: In Jerusalem I will put my name. ⁵ And he built altars for all the host of heaven, in the two courts of the temple of the Lord. ⁶ And he made his son pass through fire: and he used divinations, and observed omens, and appointed pythons, and multiplied soothsayers, to do evil before the Lord, and to provoke him. ⁷ He set also an idol of the grove, which he had made, in the temple of the Lord: concerning which the Lord said to David, and to Solomon his son: In this temple, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name for ever. ⁸ And I will no more make the feet of Israel to be moved out of the land, which I gave to their fathers: only if they will observe to do all that I have commanded them, according to the law which my servant Moses commanded them. ⁹ But they hearkened not: but were seduced by Manasses, to do evil more than the nations which the Lord destroyed before the children of Israel.

¹⁰ And the Lord spoke in the hand of his servants, the prophets, saying: ¹¹ Because Manasses, king of Juda, hath done these most wicked abominations, beyond all that the Amorrites did before him, and hath made Juda also to sin with his filthy doings: ¹² Therefore thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I will bring on evils upon Jerusalem and Juda: that whosoever shall hear of them, both his ears shall tingle. ¹³ And I will stretch over Jerusalem the line of Samaria, and the weight of the house of Achab: and I will efface Jerusalem, as writings tables are wont to be effaced, and I will erase and turn it, and draw the pencil often over the face thereof. ¹⁴ And I will leave the remnants of my inheritance, and will deliver them into the hands of their enemies: and they shall become a prey, and a spoil to all their enemies. ¹⁵ Because they have done evil before me, and have continued to provoke me, from the day that their fathers came out of Egypt, even unto this day. ¹⁶ Moreover, Manasses shed also very much innocent blood, till he filled Jerusalem up to the mouth: besides his sins, wherewith he made Juda to sin, to do evil before the Lord.

¹⁷ Now the rest of the acts of Manasses, and all that he did, and his sin, which he sinned, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ¹⁸ And Manasses

slept with his fathers, and was buried in the garden of his own house, in the garden of Oza: and Amon, his son, reigned in his stead.

¹⁹ Two and twenty years old was Amon when he began to reign, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Messalemeth, the daughter of Harus, of Jeteba. ²⁰ And he did evil in the sight of the Lord, as Manasses, his father, had done. ²¹ And he walked in all the way in which his father had walked: and he served the abominations which his father had served, and he adored them. ²² And forsook the Lord, the God of his fathers, and walked not in the way of the Lord. ²³ And his servants plotted against him, and slew the king in his own house. ²⁴ But the people of the land slew all them that had conspired against king Amon: and made Josias, his son, their king in his stead. ²⁵ But the rest of the acts of Amon, which he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁶ And they buried him in his sepulchre, in the garden of Oza: and his son, Josias, reigned in his stead.

207. The book of the law found

2 Kings 22:1-20

22 ¹ Josias was eight years old when he began to reign: he reigned one and thirty years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Idida, the daughter of Hadaia, of Besecath. ² And he did that which was right in the sight of the Lord, and walked in all the ways of David, his father: he turned not aside to the right hand, or to the left.

³ And in the eighteenth year of king Josias, the king sent Saphan, the son of Assia, the son of Messulam, the scribe of the temple of the Lord, saying to him: ⁴ Go to Helcias, the high priest, that the money may be put together which is brought into the temple of the Lord, which the doorkeepers of the temple have gathered of the people. ⁵ And let it be given to the workmen by the overseers of the house of the Lord: and let them distribute it to those that work in the temple of the Lord, to repair the temple: ⁶ That is, to carpenters and masons, and to such as mend breaches: and that timber may be bought, and stones out of the quarries, to repair the temple of the Lord. ⁷ But let there be no reckoning made with them of the money which they receive, but let them have it in their power, and in their trust.

⁸ And Helcias, the high priest, said to Saphan, the scribe: I have found the book of the law in the house of the Lord: and Helcias gave the book to Saphan, and he read it. ⁹ And Saphan, the scribe, came to the king, and brought him word again concerning that which he had commanded, and said: Thy servants have gathered together the money that was found in the house of the Lord: and they have given it to be distributed to the workmen, by the overseers of the works of the temple of the Lord. ¹⁰ And Saphan, the scribe, told the king, saying: Helcias, the priest, hath delivered to me a book. And when Saphan had read it before the king,

¹¹ And the king had heard the words of the law of the Lord, he rent his garments. ¹² And he commanded Helcias, the priest, and Ahicam, the son of Saphan, and Achobor, the son of Micha, and Saphan, the scribe, and Asaia, the king's servant, saying: ¹³ Go and consult the Lord for me, and for the people, and for all Juda, concerning the words of this book which is found: for the great wrath of the Lord is kindled against us, because our

fathers have not hearkened to the words of this book, to do all that is written for us. ¹⁴ So Helcias, the priest, and Ahicam, and Achobor, and Saphan, and Asaia, went to Holda, the prophetess, the wife of Sellum, the son of Thecua, the son of Araas, keeper of the wardrobe, who dwelt in Jerusalem, in the Second: and they spoke to her. ¹⁵ And she said to them: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: Tell the man that sent you to me: ¹⁶ Thus saith the Lord: Behold, I will bring evils upon this place, and upon the inhabitants thereof, all the words of the law which the king of Juda hath read: ¹⁷ Because they have forsaken me, and have sacrificed to strange gods, provoking me by all the works of their hands: therefore my indignation shall be kindled against this place, and shall not be quenched. ¹⁸ But to the king of Juda, who sent you to consult the Lord, thus shall you say: Thus saith the Lord, the God of Israel: for as much as thou hast heard the words of the book, ¹⁹ And thy heart hath been moved to fear, and thou hast humbled thyself before the Lord, hearing the words against this place, and the inhabitants thereof, to wit, that they should become a wonder and a curse: and thou hast rent thy garments, and wept before me; I also have heard thee; saith the Lord. ²⁰ Therefore I will gather thee to thy fathers, and thou shalt be gathered to thy sepulchre in peace; that thy eyes may not see all the evils which I will bring upon this place.

208. The reform and the death of Josias

2 Kings 23:1-37

23 ¹ And they brought the king word again what she had said. And he sent: and all the ancients of Juda and Jerusalem were assembled to him. ² And the king went up to the temple of the Lord, and all the men of Juda, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, the priests, and the prophets, and all the people, both little and great: and in the hearing of them all he read all the words of the book of the covenant, which was found in the house of the Lord. ³ And the king stood upon the step: and he made a covenant with the Lord, to walk after the Lord, and to keep his commandments, and his testimonies, and his ceremonies, with all their heart, and with all their soul, and to perform the words of this covenant, which were written in that book: and the people agreed to the covenant.

⁴ And the king commanded Helcias, the high priest, and the priests of the second order, and the doorkeepers, to cast out of the temple of the Lord all the vessels that had been made for Baal, and for the grove, and for all the host of heaven: and he burnt them without Jerusalem, in the valley of Cedron, and he carried the ashes of them to Bethel. ⁵ And he destroyed the soothsayers, whom the kings of Juda had appointed to sacrifice in the high places in the cities of Juda, and round about Jerusalem: them also that burnt incense to Baal, and to the sun, and to the moon, and to the twelve signs, and to all the host of heaven. ⁶ And he caused the grove to be carried out from the house of the Lord, without Jerusalem, to the valley of Cedron, and he burnt it there, and reduced it to dust, and cast the dust upon the graves of the common people. ⁷ He destroyed also the pavilions of the effeminate, which were in the house of the Lord, for which the women wove as it were little dwellings for the grove. ⁸ And he gathered together all the priests out of the cities of Juda: and he defiled the high places, where the priests offered sacrifice, from Gabaa to Bersabee: and he broke down the altars of the

gates that were in the entering in of the gate of Josue, governor of the city, which was on the left hand of the gate of the city. ⁹ However, the priests of the high places came not up to the altar of the Lord, in Jerusalem: but only ate of the unleavened bread among their brethren. ¹⁰ And he defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the son of Ennom: that no man should consecrate there his son, or his daughter, through fire, to Moloch. ¹¹ And he took away the horses which the kings of Juda had given to the sun, at the entering in of the temple of the Lord, near the chamber of Nathanmelech the eunuch, who was in Pharurim: and he burnt the chariots of the sun with fire. ¹² And the altars that were upon the top of the upper chamber of Achaz, which the kings of Juda had made, and the altars which Manasses had made in the two courts of the temple of the Lord, the king broke down: and he ran from thence, and cast the ashes of them into the torrent Cedron. ¹³ The high places also that were at Jerusalem, on the right side of the Mount of Offence, which Solomon, king of Israel, had built to Astaroth, the idol of the Sidonians, and to Chamos, the scandal of Moab, and to Melchom, the abomination of the children of Ammon, the king defiled. ¹⁴ And he broke in pieces the statues, and cut down the groves: and he filled their places with the bones of dead men.

¹⁵ Moreover, the altar also that was at Bethel, and the high place, which Jeroboam, the son of Nabat, who made Israel to sin, had made: both the altar, and the high place, he broke down and burnt, and reduced to powder, and burnt the grove. ¹⁶ And as Josias turned himself, he saw there the sepulchres that were in the mount: and he sent and took the bones out of the sepulchres, and burnt them upon the altar, and defiled it according to the word of the Lord, which the man of God spoke, who had foretold these things. ¹⁷ And he said: What is that monument which I see? And the men of that city answered: It is the sepulchre of the man of God, who came from Juda, and foretold these things which thou hast done upon the altar of Bethel. ¹⁸ And he said: Let him alone, let no man move his bones. So his bones were left untouched with the bones of the prophet, that came out of Samaria. ¹⁹ Moreover all the temples of the high places which were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke the Lord, Josias took away: and he did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Bethel. ²⁰ And he slew all the priests of the high places, that were there, upon the altars; and he burnt men's bones upon them: and returned to Jerusalem.

²¹ And he commanded all the people, saying: Keep the Phase to the Lord your God, according as it is written in the book of this covenant. ²² Now there was no such a Phase kept from the days of the judges, who judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, and of the kings of Juda, ²³ As was this Phase, that was kept to the Lord in Jerusalem, in the eighteenth year of king Josias.

²⁴ Moreover the diviners by spirits, and soothsayers, and the figures of idols, and the uncleannesses, and the abominations, that had been in the land of Juda and Jerusalem, Josias took away: that he might perform the words of the law, that were written in the book, which Helcias the priest had found in the temple of the Lord. ²⁵ There was no king before him like unto him, that returned to the Lord with all his heart, and with all his

soul, and with all his strength, according to all the law of Moses: neither after him did there arise any like unto him. ²⁶ But yet the Lord turned not away from the wrath of his great indignation, wherewith his anger was kindled against Juda: because of the provocations, wherewith Manasses had provoked him. ²⁷ And the Lord said: I will remove Juda also from before my face, as I have removed Israel: and I will cast off this city Jerusalem, which I chose, and the house, of which I said: My name shall be there. ²⁸ Now the rest of the acts of Josias, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? ²⁹ In his days Pharao Nechao, king of Egypt, went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates: and king Josias went to meet him: and was slain at Mageddo, when he had seen him. ³⁰ And his servants carried him dead from Mageddo: and they brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own sepulchre. And the people of the land took Joachaz, the son of Josias: and they anointed him, and made him king in his father's stead.

³¹ Joachaz was three and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Amital, the daughter of Jeremias, of Lobna. ³² And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that his fathers had done. ³³ And Pharao Nechao bound him at Rebla, which is in the land of Emath, that he should not reign in Jerusalem: and he set a fine upon the land, of a hundred talents of silver, and a talent of gold. ³⁴ And Pharao Nechao made Eliacim, the son of Josias, king in the room of Josias his father: and turned his name to Joakim. And he took Joachaz away and carried him into Egypt, and he died there. ³⁵ And Joakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharao, after he had taxed the land for every man, to contribute according to the commandment of Pharao: and he exacted both the silver and the gold of the people of the land, of every man according to his ability: to give to Pharao Nechao. ³⁶ Joakim was five and twenty years old when he began to reign: and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Zebida, the daughter of Phadaia, of Ruma. ³⁷ And he did evil before the Lord according to all that his fathers had done.

209. The first deportation

2 Kings 24:1-20

24 ¹ In his days Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon came up, and Joakim became his servant three years: then again he rebelled against him. ² And the Lord sent against him the rovers of the Chaldees, and the rovers of Syria, and the rovers of Moab, and the rovers of the children of Ammon: and he sent them against Juda, to destroy it, according to the word of the Lord, which he had spoken by his servants, the prophets. ³ And this came by the word of the Lord against Juda, to remove them from before him for all the sins of Manasses which he did; ⁴ And for the innocent blood that he shed, filling Jerusalem with innocent blood: and therefore the Lord would not be appeased. ⁵ But the rest of the acts of Joakim, and all that he did, are they not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Juda? And Joakim slept with his fathers: ⁶ And Joachin, his son, reigned in his stead. ⁷ And the king of Egypt came not again any more out of his own country: for the king of Babylon had taken all that had belonged to the king of Egypt, from the river of Egypt, unto the river Euphrates.

⁸ Joachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Nohesta, the daughter of Elnathan, of Jerusalem. ⁹ And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that his father had done. ¹⁰ At that time the servants of Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came up against Jerusalem, and the city was surrounded with their forts. ¹¹ And Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came to the city, with his servants, to assault it. ¹² And Joachin, king of Juda, went out to the king of Babylon, he, and his mother, and his servants, and his nobles, and his eunuchs: and the king of Babylon received him in the eighth year of his reign. ¹³ And he brought out from thence all the treasures of the house of the Lord, and the treasures of the king's house: and he cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon, king of Israel, had made in the temple of the Lord, according to the word of the Lord. ¹⁴ And he carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the valiant men of the army, to the number of ten thousand, into captivity: and every artificer and smith: and none were left, but the poor sort of the people of the land. ¹⁵ And he carried away Joachin into Babylon, and the king's mother, and the king's wives, and his eunuchs: and the judges of the land he carried into captivity, from Jerusalem, into Babylon. ¹⁶ And all the strong men, seven thousand, and the artificers, and the smiths, a thousand, all that were valiant men, and fit for war: and the king of Babylon led them captives into Babylon. ¹⁷ And he appointed Matthanias, his uncle, in his stead: and called his name Sedecias. ¹⁸ Sedecias was one and twenty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem: the name of his mother was Amital, the daughter of Jeremias, of Lobna. ¹⁹ And he did evil before the Lord, according to all that Joakim had done. ²⁰ For the Lord was angry against Jerusalem and against Juda, till he cast them out from his face: and Sedecias revolted from the king of Babylon.

210. The fall of Jerusalem

2 Kings 25:1-30

The temple is burned. The lowest point of the plan, and the ground of everything the prophets afterwards say.

25 ¹ And it came to pass in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, the tenth day of the month, that Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem: and they surrounded it: and raised works round about it. ² And the city was shut up and besieged till the eleventh year of king Sedecias, ³ The ninth day of the month: and a famine prevailed in the city, and there was no bread for the people of the land. ⁴ And a breach was made into the city: and all the men of war fled in the night between the two walls by the king's garden (now the Chaldees besieged the city round about), and Sedecias fled by the way that leadeth to the plains of the wilderness. ⁵ And the army of the Chaldees pursued after the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho: and all the warriors that were with him were scattered, and left him: ⁶ So they took the king, and brought him to the king of Babylon, to Reblatha, and he gave judgment upon him. ⁷ And he slew the sons of Sedecias before his face, and he put out his eyes, and bound him with chains, and brought him to Babylon.

⁸ In the fifth month, the seventh day of the month, the same is the nineteenth year of the king of Babylon, came Nabuzardan, commander of the army, a servant of the king of Babylon, into Jerusalem. ⁹ And he burnt the house of the Lord, and the king's house, and the houses of Jerusalem, and every house he burnt with fire. ¹⁰ And all the army of the Chaldees, which was with the commander of the troops, broke down the walls of Jerusalem round about. ¹¹ And Nabuzardan, the commander of the army, carried away the rest of the people, that remained in the city, and the fugitives, that had gone over to the king of Babylon, and the remnant of the common people. ¹² But of the poor of the land he left some dressers of vines and husbandmen. ¹³ And the pillars of brass that were in the temple of the Lord, and the bases, and the sea of brass, which was in the house of the Lord, the Chaldees broke in pieces, and carried all the brass of them to Babylon. ¹⁴ They took away also the pots of brass, and the mazers, and the forks, and the cups, and the mortars, and all the vessels of brass, with which they ministered. ¹⁵ Moreover also the censers, and the bowls, such as were of gold in gold: and such as were of silver in silver, the general of the army took away. ¹⁶ That is, two pillars, one sea, and the bases which Solomon had made in the temple of the Lord: the brass of all these vessels was without weight. ¹⁷ One pillar was eighteen cubits high: and the chapter of brass, which was upon it, was three cubits high: and the network, and the pomegranates that were upon the chapter of the pillar, were all of brass: and the second pillar had the like adorning.

¹⁸ And the general of the army took Seraias, the chief priest, and Sophonias, the second priest, and three doorkeepers: ¹⁹ And out of the city one eunuch, who was captain over the men of war: and five men of them who had stood before the king, whom he found in the city, and Sopher, the captain of the army, who exercised the young soldiers of the people of the land: and three-score men of the common people, who were found in the city: ²⁰ These Nabuzardan, the general of the army, took away, and carried them to the king of Babylon, to Reblatha. ²¹ And the king of Babylon smote them, and slew them at Reblatha, in the land of Emath: so Juda was carried away out of their land.

²² But over the people that remained in the land of Juda, which Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, had left, he gave the government to Godolias, the son of Ahicam, the son of Saphan. ²³ And when all the captains of the soldiers had heard this, they and the men that were with them, to wit, that the king of Babylon had made Godolias governor they came to Godolias to Maspha, Ismael, the son of Nathanas, and Johanan, the son of Caree, and Saraia, the son of Thanehumeth, the Netophathite, and Jezonias, the son of Maachathi, they and their men. ²⁴ And Godolias swore to them and to their men, saying: Be not afraid to serve the Chaldees: stay in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it shall be well with you. ²⁵ But it came to pass in the seventh month, that Ismael, the son of Nathanas, the son of Elisama, of the seed royal came, and ten men with him, and smote Godolias; so that he died: and also the Jews and the Chaldees that were with him in Maspha. ²⁶ And all the people, both little and great, and the captains of the soldiers, rising up, went to Egypt, fearing the Chaldees. ²⁷ And it came to pass in the seven and thirtieth year of the captivity of Joachin, king of Juda, in the twelfth

month, the seven and twentieth day of the month: Evilmerodach, king of Babylon, in the year that he began to reign, lifted up the head of Joachin, king of Juda, out of prison. ²⁸ And he spoke kindly to him: and he set his throne above the throne of the kings that were with him in Babylon. ²⁹ And he changed his garments which he had in prison, and he ate bread always before him, all the days of his life. ³⁰ And he appointed him a continual allowance, which was also given him by the king, day by day, all the days of his life.

211. *Jeremias: the burnt roll, and the cistern*

Jeremiah 36:1-32; 38:1-13 — here Jeremiah 36:1-38:13

Two of the three passages of Jeremias in this plan; the prophecy entire is not read.

36 ¹ And it came to pass in the fourth year of Joakim the son of Josias king of Juda, that this word came to Jeremias by the Lord, saying: ² Take thee a roll of a book, and thou shalt write in it all the words that I have spoken to thee against Israel and Juda, and against all the nations from the day that I spoke to thee, from the days of Josias even to this day. ³ If so be, when the house of Juda shall hear all the evils that I purpose to do unto them, that they may return every man from his wicked way: and I will forgive their iniquity, and their sin. ⁴ So Jeremias called Baruch the son of Nerias: and Baruch wrote from the mouth of Jeremias all the words of the Lord, which he spoke to him, upon the roll of a book. ⁵ And Jeremias commanded Baruch, saying: I am shut up, and cannot go into the house of the Lord. ⁶ Go thou in therefore, and read out of the volume, which thou hast written from my mouth, the words of the Lord, in the hearing of all the people in the house of the Lord on the fasting day: and also thou shalt read them in the hearing of all Juda that come out of their cities: ⁷ If so be they may present their supplication before the Lord, and may return every one from his wicked way: for great is the wrath and indignation which the Lord hath pronounced against this people. ⁸ And Baruch the son of Nerias did according to all that Jeremias the prophet had commanded him, reading out of the volume the words of the Lord in the house of the Lord. ⁹ And it came to pass in the fifth year of Joakim the son of Josias king of Juda, in the ninth month, that they proclaimed a fast before the Lord to all the people in Jerusalem, and to all the people that were come together out of the cities of Juda to Jerusalem. ¹⁰ And Baruch read out of the volume the words of Jeremias in the house of the Lord, in the treasury of Gamarias the son of Saphan the scribe, in the upper court, in the entry of the new gate of the house of the Lord, in the hearing of all the people.

¹¹ And when Micheas the son of Gamarias the son of Saphan had heard out of the book all the words of the Lord, ¹² He went down into the king's house to the secretary's chamber: and behold all the princes sat there, Elisama the scribe, and Dalaiahs the son of Semeias, and Elnathan the son of Achobor, and Gamarias the son of Saphan, and Sedecias the son of Hananias, and all the princes. ¹³ And Micheas told them all the words that he had heard when Baruch read out of the volume in the hearing of the people. ¹⁴ Therefore all the princes sent Judi the son of Nathanas, the son of Selemias, the son of Chusi, to Baruch, saying: Take in thy hand the volume in which thou hast read in the hearing of the people, and come. So Baruch the son of Nerias

took the volume in his hand, and came to them. ¹⁵ And they said to him: Sit down and read these things in our hearing. And Baruch read in their hearing. ¹⁶ And when they had heard all the words, they looked upon one another with astonishment, and they said to Baruch: We must tell the king all these words. ¹⁷ And they asked him, saying: Tell us how didst thou write all these words from his mouth. ¹⁸ And Baruch said to them: With his mouth he pronounced all these words as if he were reading to me: and I wrote in a volume with ink. ¹⁹ And the princes said to Baruch: Go, and hide thee, both thou and Jeremias, and let no man know where you are.

²⁰ And they went in to the king into the court: but they laid up the volume in the chamber of Elisama the scribe: and they told all the words in the hearing of the king. ²¹ And the king sent Judi that he should take the volume: who bringing it out of the chamber of Elisama the scribe, read it in the hearing of the king, and of all the princes that stood about the king. ²² Now the king sat in the winter house, in the ninth month: and there was a hearth before him full of burning coals. ²³ And when Judi had read three or four pages, he cut it with the penknife, and he cast it into the fire, that was upon the hearth, till all the volume was consumed with the fire that was on the hearth. ²⁴ And the king and all his servants that heard all these words were not afraid, nor did they rend their garments. ²⁵ But yet Elnathan, and Dalaías, and Gamarias spoke to the king, not to burn the book: and he heard them not. ²⁶ And the king commanded Jeremiel the son of Amelech, and Saraías the son of Ezriel, and Selemias the son of Abdeel, to take up Baruch the scribe, and Jeremias the prophet: but the Lord hid them.

²⁷ And the word of the Lord came to Jeremias the prophet, after that the king had burnt the volume, and the words that Baruch had written from the mouth of Jeremias, saying: ²⁸ Take thee again another volume: and write in it all the former words that were in the first volume which Joakim the king of Juda hath burnt. ²⁹ And thou shalt say to Joakim the king of Juda: Thus saith the Lord: Thou hast burnt that volume, saying: Why hast thou written therein, and said: The king of Babylon shall come speedily, and shall lay waste this land: and shall cause to cease from thence man and beast? ³⁰ Therefore thus saith the Lord against Joakim the king of Juda: He shall have none to sit upon the throne of David: and his dead body shall be cast out to the heat by day, and to the frost by night. ³¹ And I will punish him, and his seed and his servants, for their iniquities, and I will bring upon them, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and upon the men of Juda all the evil that I have pronounced against them, but they have not heard.

³² And Jeremias took another volume, and gave it to Baruch the son of Nerias the scribe: who wrote in it from the mouth of Jeremias all the words of the book which Joakim the king of Juda had burnt with fire: and there were added besides many more words than had been before.

38 ¹ Now Saphatias the son of Mathan, and Gedelias the son of Phassur, and Juchal the son of Selemias, and Phassur the son of Melchias heard the words that Jeremias spoke to all the people, saying: ² Thus saith the Lord: Whosoever shall remain in this city, shall die by the sword, and by famine, and by pestilence: but he that shall go forth to the Chaldeans, shall live, and his

life shall be safe, and he shall live. ³ Thus saith the Lord: This city shall surely be delivered into the hand of the army of the king of Babylon, and he shall take it. ⁴ And the princes said to the king. We beseech thee that this man may be put to death: for on purpose he weakeneth the hands of the men of war, that remain in this city, and the hands of the people, speaking to them according to these words: for this man seeketh not peace to this people, but evil. ⁵ And king Sedecias said: Behold he is in your hands: for it is not lawful for the king to deny you any thing. ⁶ Then they took Jeremias and cast him into the dungeon of Melchias the son of Amelech, which was in the entry of the prison: and they let down Jeremias by ropes into the dungeon, wherein there was no water, but mire. And Jeremias sunk into the mire.

⁷ Now Abdemelech the Ethiopian, an eunuch that was in the king's house, heard that they had put Jeremias in the dungeon: but the king was sitting in the gate of Benjamin. ⁸ And Abdemelech went out of the king's house, and spoke to the king, saying: ⁹ My lord the king, these men have done evil in all that they have done against Jeremias the prophet, casting him into the dungeon to die there with hunger, for there is no more bread in the city. ¹⁰ Then the king commanded Abdemelech the Ethiopian, saying: Take from hence thirty men with thee, and draw up Jeremias the prophet out of the dungeon, before he die. ¹¹ So Abdemelech taking the men with him, went into the king's house that was under the storehouse: and he took from thence old rags, and old rotten things, and he let them down by cords to Jeremias into the dungeon. ¹² And Abdemelech the Ethiopian said to Jeremias: Put these old rags and these rent and rotten things under thy arms, and upon the cords: and Jeremias did so. ¹³ And they drew up Jeremias with the cords, and brought him forth out of the dungeon. And Jeremias remained in the entry of the prison.

212. The new covenant

Jeremiah 31:31-40

Read out of book order, after the fall it interprets. Cited at the Last Supper, and in Hebrews, which this plan does not read.

31 ³¹ Behold the days shall come, saith the Lord, and I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Juda: ³² Not according to the covenant which I made with their fathers, in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt, the covenant which they made void, and I had dominion over them, saith the Lord. ³³ But this shall be the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel, after those days, saith the Lord: I will give my law in their bowels, and I will write it in their heart: and I will be their God, and they shall be my people. ³⁴ And they shall teach no more every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying: Know the Lord: for all shall know me from the least of them even to the greatest, saith the Lord: for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more. ³⁵ Thus saith the Lord, who giveth the sun for the light of the day, the order of the moon and of the stars, for the light of the night: who stirreth up the sea, and the waves thereof roar, the Lord of hosts is his name. ³⁶ If these ordinances shall fail before me, saith the Lord: then also the seed of Israel shall fail, so as not to be a nation before me for ever. ³⁷ Thus saith the Lord: If the heavens above can be measured,

and the foundations of the earth searched out beneath, I also will cast away all the seed of Israel, for all that they have done, saith the Lord.

³⁸ Behold the days come, saith the Lord, that the city shall be built to the Lord from the tower of Hanameel even to the gate of the corner. ³⁹ And the measuring line shall go out farther in his sight upon the hill Gareb: and it shall compass Goatha, ⁴⁰ And the whole valley of dead bodies, and of ashes, and all the country of death, even to the torrent Cedron, and to the corner of the horse gate towards the east, the Holy of the Lord: it shall not be plucked up, and it shall not be destroyed any more for ever.

213. The suffering servant

Isaiah 52:13-53:12

52 ¹³ Behold my servant shall understand, he shall be exalted, and extolled, and shall be exceeding high. ¹⁴ As many have been astonished at thee, so shall his visage be inglorious among men, and his form among the sons of men. ¹⁵ He shall sprinkle many nations, kings shall shut their mouth at him: for they to whom it was not told of him, have seen: and they that heard not, have beheld.

53 ¹ Who hath believed our report? and to whom is the arm of the Lord revealed? ² And he shall grow up as a tender plant before him, and as a root out of a thirsty ground: there is no beauty in him, nor comeliness: and we have seen him, and there was no sightliness, that we should be desirous of him: ³ Despised, and the most abject of men, a man of sorrows, and acquainted with infirmity: and his look was as it were hidden and despised, whereupon we esteemed him not. ⁴ Surely he hath borne our infirmities and carried our sorrows: and we have thought him as it were a leper, and as one struck by God and afflicted. ⁵ But he was wounded for our iniquities, he was bruised for our sins: the chastisement of our peace was upon him, and by his bruises we are healed. ⁶ All we like sheep have gone astray, every one hath turned aside into his own way: and the Lord hath laid on him the iniquity of us all. ⁷ He was offered because it was his own will, and he opened not his mouth: he shall be led as a sheep to the slaughter, and shall be dumb as a lamb before his shearer, and he shall not open his mouth. ⁸ He was taken away from distress, and from judgment: who shall declare his generation? because he is cut off out of the land of the living: for the wickedness of my people have I struck him. ⁹ And he shall give the ungodly for his burial, and the rich for his death: because he hath done no iniquity, neither was there deceit in his mouth. ¹⁰ And the Lord was pleased to bruise him in infirmity: if he shall lay down his life for sin, he shall see a longlived seed, and the will of the Lord shall be prosperous in his hand. ¹¹ Because his soul hath laboured, he shall see and be filled: by his knowledge shall this my just servant justify many, and he shall bear their iniquities. ¹² Therefore will I distribute to him very many, and he shall divide the spoils of the strong, because he hath delivered his soul unto death, and was reputed with the wicked: and he hath borne the sins of many, and hath prayed for the transgressors.

214. "Thy Maker shall rule over thee"

Isaiah 54:5-14

A lesson of the Easter Vigil, whose range this reading reproduces exactly.

54 ⁵ For he that made thee shall rule over thee, the Lord of hosts is his name: and thy Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel, shall be called the God of all the earth. ⁶ For the Lord hath called thee as a woman forsaken and mourning in spirit, and as a wife cast off from her youth, said thy God. ⁷ For a small moment have I forsaken thee, but with great mercies will I gather thee. ⁸ In a moment of indignation have I hid my face a little while from thee, but with everlasting kindness have I had mercy on thee, said the Lord thy Redeemer. ⁹ This thing is to me as in the days of Noe, to whom I swore, that I would no more bring in the waters of Noe upon the earth: so have I sworn not to be angry with thee, and not to rebuke thee. ¹⁰ For the mountains shall be moved, and the hills shall tremble; but my mercy shall not depart from thee, and the covenant of my peace shall not be moved: said the Lord that hath mercy on thee. ¹¹ O poor little one, tossed with tempest, without all comfort, behold I will lay thy stones in order, and will lay thy foundations with sapphires, ¹² And I will make thy bulwarks of jasper: and thy gates of graven stones, and all thy borders of desirable stones. ¹³ All thy children shall be taught of the Lord: and great shall be the peace of thy children. ¹⁴ And thou shalt be founded in justice: depart far from oppression, for thou shalt not fear; and from terror, for it shall not come near thee.

215. "All you that thirst, come to the waters"

Isaiah 55:1-11

A lesson of the Easter Vigil, whose range this reading reproduces exactly.

55 ¹ All you that thirst, come to the waters: and you that have no money make haste, buy, and eat: come ye, buy wine and milk without money, and without any price. ² Why do you spend money for that which is not bread, and your labour for that which doth not satisfy you? Harken diligently to me, and eat that which is good, and your soul shall be delighted in fatness. ³ Incline your ear and come to me: hear and your soul shall live, and I will make an everlasting covenant with you, the faithful mercies of David. ⁴ Behold I have given him for a witness to the people, for a leader and a master to the Gentiles. ⁵ Behold thou shalt call a nation, which thou knewest not: and the nations that knew not thee shall run to thee, because of the Lord thy God, and for the Holy One of Israel, for he hath glorified thee. ⁶ Seek ye the Lord, while he may be found: call upon him, while he is near. ⁷ Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unjust man his thoughts, and let him return to the Lord, and he will have mercy on him, and to our God: for he is bountiful to forgive. ⁸ For my thoughts are not your thoughts: nor your ways my ways, saith the Lord. ⁹ For as the heavens are exalted above the earth, so are my ways exalted above your ways, and my thoughts above your thoughts. ¹⁰ And as the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and return no more thither, but soak the earth, and water it, and make it to spring, and give seed to the sower, and bread to the eater: ¹¹ So shall my word be, which shall go forth from my

mouth: it shall not return to me void, but it shall do whatsoever I please, and shall prosper in the things for which I sent it.

216. "Hear, O Israel, the commandments of life"

Baruch 3:9-15; 3:32-4:4 — here Baruch 3:9-4:4

A lesson of the Easter Vigil, read in the Vigil's own two parts: 3:9-15 and 3:32-4:4. Baruch is deuterocanonical and stands in the 73-book canon this plan follows.

3 ⁹ Hear, O Israel, the commandments of life: give ear, that thou mayst learn wisdom. ¹⁰ How happeneth it, O Israel, that thou art in thy enemies' land? ¹¹ Thou art grown old in a strange country, thou art defiled with the dead: thou art counted with them that go down into hell. ¹² Thou hast forsaken the fountain of wisdom: ¹³ For if thou hadst walked in the way of God, thou hadst surely dwelt in peace for ever. ¹⁴ Learn where is wisdom, where is strength, where is understanding: that thou mayst know also where is length of days and life, where is the light of the eyes, and peace. ¹⁵ Who hath found out her place? and who hath gone in to her treasures? ³² But he that knoweth all things, knoweth her, and hath found her out with his understanding: he that prepared the earth for evermore, and filled it with cattle and fourfooted beasts: ³³ He that sendeth forth the light, and it goeth: and hath called it, and it obeyeth him with trembling. ³⁴ And the stars have given light in their watches, and rejoiced: ³⁵ They were called, and they said: Here we are: and with cheerfulness they have shined forth to him that made them. ³⁶ This is our God, and there shall no other be accounted of in comparison of him. ³⁷ He found out all the way of knowledge, and gave it to Jacob his servant, and to Israel his beloved. ³⁸ Afterwards he was seen upon earth, and conversed with men.

4 ¹ This is the book of the commandments of God, and the law, that is for ever: all they that keep it, shall come to life: but they that have forsaken it, to death. ² Return, O Jacob, and take hold of it, walk in the way by its brightness, in the presence of the light thereof. ³ Give not thy honour to another, nor thy dignity to a strange nation. ⁴ We are happy, O Israel: because the things that are pleasing to God, are made known to us.

217. The shepherds of Israel

Ezekiel 34:1-31

The one shepherd promised here is claimed in St. John 10, read later in this plan.

34 ¹ And the word of the Lord came to me, saying: ² Son of man, prophesy concerning the shepherds of Israel: prophesy, and say to the shepherds: Thus saith the Lord God: Woe to the shepherds of Israel, that fed themselves: should not the flocks be fed by the shepherds? ³ You ate the milk, and you clothed yourselves with the wool, and you killed that which was fat: but my flock you did not feed. ⁴ The weak you have not strengthened, and that which was sick you have not healed, that which was broken you have not bound up, and that which was driven away you have not brought again, neither have you sought that which was lost: but you ruled over them with rigour, and with a high hand. ⁵ And my sheep were scattered, because there was no shepherd and they became the prey of all the beasts of the field, and were scattered. ⁶ My sheep have wandered in every mountain, and in every high hill: and my flocks were scattered upon the face

of the earth, and there was none that sought them, there was none, I say, that sought them.

⁷ Therefore, ye shepherds, hear the word of the Lord: ⁸ As I live, saith the Lord God, forasmuch as my flocks have been made a spoil, and my sheep are become a prey to all the beasts of the field, because there was no shepherd: for my shepherds did not seek after my flock, but the shepherds fed themselves, and fed not my flocks: ⁹ Therefore, ye shepherds, hear the word of the Lord: ¹⁰ Thus saith the Lord God: Behold I myself come upon the shepherds, I will require my flock at their hand, and I will cause them to cease from feeding the flock any more, neither shall the shepherds feed themselves any more: and I will deliver my flock from their mouth, and it shall no more be meat for them.

¹¹ For thus saith the Lord God: Behold I myself will seek my sheep, and will visit them. ¹² As the shepherd visiteth his flock in the day when he shall be in the midst of his sheep that were scattered, so will I visit my sheep, and will deliver them out of all the places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day. ¹³ And I will bring them out from the peoples, and will gather them out of the countries, and will bring them to their own land: and I will feed them in the mountains of Israel, by the rivers, and in all the habitations of the land. ¹⁴ I will feed them in the most fruitful pastures, and their pastures shall be in the high mountains of Israel: there shall they rest on the green grass, and be fed in fat pastures upon the mountains of Israel. ¹⁵ I will feed my sheep: and I will cause them to lie down, saith the Lord God. ¹⁶ I will seek that which was lost: and that which was driven away, I will bring again: and I will bind up that which was broken, and I will strengthen that which was weak, and that which was fat and strong I will preserve, and I will feed them in judgment.

¹⁷ And as for you, O my flocks, thus saith the Lord God: Behold I judge between cattle and cattle, of rams and of he goats. ¹⁸ Was it not enough for you to feed upon good pastures? but you must also tread down with your feet the residue of your pastures: and when you drank the clearest water, you troubled the rest with your feet. ¹⁹ And my sheep were fed with that which you had trodden with your feet: and they drank what your feet had troubled.

²⁰ Therefore thus saith the Lord God to you: Behold, I myself will judge between the fat cattle and the lean. ²¹ Because you thrust with sides and shoulders, and struck all the weak cattle with your horns, till they were scattered abroad: ²² I will save my flock, and it shall be no more a spoil, and I will judge between cattle and cattle. ²³ And I WILL SET UP ONE SHEPHERD OVER THEM, and he shall feed them, even my servant David: he shall feed them, and he shall be their shepherd. ²⁴ And I the Lord will be their God: and my servant David the prince in the midst of them: I the Lord have spoken it. ²⁵ And I will make a covenant of peace with them, and will cause the evil beasts to cease out of the land: and they that dwell in the wilderness shall sleep secure in the forests. ²⁶ And I will make them a blessing round about my hill: and I will send down the rain in its season, there shall be showers of blessing. ²⁷ And the tree of the field shall yield its fruit, and the earth shall yield her increase, and they shall be in their land without fear: and they shall know that I am the Lord, when I shall have broken the bonds of their yoke, and shall

have delivered them out of the hand of those that rule over them. ²⁸ And they shall be no more for a spoil to the nations, neither shall the beasts of the earth devour them: but they shall dwell securely without, any terror. ²⁹ And I will raise up for them a bud of renown: and they shall be no more consumed with famine in the land, neither shall they bear any more the reproach of the Gentiles. ³⁰ And they shall know that I the Lord their God am with them, and that they are my people the house of Israel: saith the Lord God. ³¹ And you my flocks, the flocks of my pasture are men: and I am the Lord your God, saith the Lord God.

218. "A new heart, and a new spirit"

Ezekiel 36:16-28

A lesson of the Easter Vigil, whose range this reading reproduces exactly.

36 ¹⁶ And the word of the Lord came to me, saying: ¹⁷ Son of man, when the house of Israel dwelt in their own land, they defiled it with their ways, and with their doings: their way was before me like the uncleanness of a menstruous woman. ¹⁸ And I poured out my indignation upon them for the blood which they had shed upon the land, and with their idols they defiled it. ¹⁹ And I scattered them among the nations, and they are dispersed through the countries: I have judged them according to their ways, and their devices. ²⁰ And when they entered among the nations whither they went, they profaned my holy name, when it was said of them: This is the people of the Lord, and they are come forth out of his land. ²¹ And I have regarded my own holy name, which the house of Israel hath profaned among the nations to which they went in. ²² Therefore thou shalt say to the house of Israel: Thus saith the Lord God: It is not for your sake that I will do this, O house of Israel, but for my holy name's sake, which you have profaned among the nations whither you went. ²³ And I will sanctify my great name, which was profaned among the Gentiles, which you have profaned in the midst of them: that the Gentiles may know that I am the Lord, saith the Lord of hosts, when I shall be sanctified in you before their eyes. ²⁴ For I will take you from among the Gentiles, and will gather you together out of all the countries, and will bring you into your own land. ²⁵ And I will pour upon you clean water, and you shall be cleansed from all your filthiness, and I will cleanse you from all your idols. ²⁶ And I will give you a new heart, and put a new spirit within you: and I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and will give you a heart of flesh. ²⁷ And I will put my spirit in the midst of you: and I will cause you to walk in my commandments, and to keep my judgments, and do them. ²⁸ And you shall dwell in the land which I gave to your fathers, and you shall be my people, and I will be your God.

219. The dry bones

Ezekiel 37:1-14

37 ¹ The hand of the Lord was upon me, and brought me forth in the spirit of the Lord: and set me down in the midst of a plain that was full of bones. ² And he led me about through them on every side: now they were very many upon the face of the plain, and they were exceeding dry. ³ And he said to me: Son of man, dost thou think these bones shall live? And I answered: O Lord God, thou knowest. ⁴ And he said to me: Prophecy concerning

these bones; and say to them: Ye dry bones, hear the word of the Lord. ⁵ Thus saith the Lord God to these bones: Behold, I will send spirit into you, and you shall live. ⁶ And I will lay sinews upon you, and will cause flesh to grow over you, and will cover you with skin: and I will give you spirit and you shall live, and you shall know that I am the Lord. ⁷ And I prophesied as he had commanded me: and as I prophesied there was a noise, and behold a commotion: and the bones came together, each one, its joint. ⁸ And I saw, and behold the sinews, and the flesh came up upon them: and the skin was stretched out over them, but there was no spirit in them. ⁹ And he said to me: Prophecy to the spirit, prophesy, O son of man, and say to the spirit: Thus saith the Lord God: Come, spirit, from the four winds, and blow upon these slain, and let them live again. ¹⁰ And I prophesied as he had commanded me: and the spirit came into them, and they lived: and they stood up upon their feet, an exceeding great army.

¹¹ And he said to me: Son of man: All these bones are the house of Israel: they say: Our bones are dried up, and our hope is lost, and we are cut off. ¹² Therefore prophesy, and say to them: Thus saith the Lord God: Behold I will open your graves, and will bring you out of your sepulchres, O my people: and will bring you into the land of Israel. ¹³ And you shall know that I am the Lord, when I shall have opened your sepulchres, and shall have brought you out of your graves, O my people: ¹⁴ And shall have put my spirit in you, and you shall live, and I shall make you rest upon your own land: and you shall know that I the Lord have spoken, and done it, saith the Lord God:

220. "The mercies of the Lord that we are not consumed"

Lamentations 3:19-33

3 ¹⁹ Zain. Remember my poverty, and transgression, the worm-wood and the gall. ²⁰ Zain. I will be mindful and remember, and my soul shall languish within me. ²¹ Zain. These things I shall think over in my heart, therefore will I hope. ²² Heth. The mercies of the Lord that we are not consumed: because his commiserations have not failed. ²³ Heth. They are new every morning, great is thy faithfulness. ²⁴ Heth. The Lord is my portion, said my soul: therefore will I wait for him. ²⁵ Teth. The Lord is good to them that hope in him, to the soul that seeketh him. ²⁶ Teth. It is good to wait with silence for the salvation of God. ²⁷ Teth. It is good for a man, when he hath borne the yoke from his youth. ²⁸ Jod. He shall sit solitary, and hold his peace: because he hath taken it up upon himself. ²⁹ Jod. He shall put his mouth in the dust, if so be there may be hope. ³⁰ Jod. He shall give his cheek to him that striketh him, he shall be filled with reproaches. ³¹ Caph. For the Lord will not cast off for ever. ³² Caph. For if he hath cast off, he will also have mercy, according to the multitude of his mercies. ³³ Caph. For he hath not willingly afflicted, nor cast off the children of men.

221. Psalm 136

Psalms 136:1-9

Vulgate 136 = Hebrew 137: "Upon the rivers of Babylon."

136 ¹ Upon the rivers of Babylon, there we sat and wept: when we remembered Sion: ² On the willows in the midst thereof we hung up our instruments. ³ For there they that led us into cap-

tivity required of us the words of songs. And they that carried us away, said: Sing ye to us a hymn of the songs of Sion. ⁴ How shall we sing the song of the Lord in a strange land? ⁵ If I forget thee, O Jerusalem, let my right hand be forgotten. ⁶ Let my tongue cleave to my jaws, if I do not remember thee: If I make not Jerusalem the beginning of my joy. ⁷ Remember, O Lord, the children of Edom, in the day of Jerusalem: Who say: Rase it, rase it, even to the foundation thereof. ⁸ O daughter of Babylon, miserable: blessed shall he be who shall repay thee thy payment which thou hast paid us. ⁹ Blessed be he that shall take and dash thy little ones against the rock.

222. Daniel and his companions at the king's table

Daniel 1:1-21

1 ¹ In the third year of the reign of Joakim, king of Juda, Nabuchodonosor, king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem, and besieged it. ² And the Lord delivered into his hands Joakim, the king of Juda, and part of the vessels of the house of God: and he carried them away into the land of Sennaar, to the house of his god, and the vessels he brought into the treasure house of his god.

³ And the king spoke to Asphenez, the master of the eunuchs, that he should bring in some of the children of Israel, and of the king's seed, and of the princes, ⁴ Children in whom there was no blemish, well favoured, and skilful in all wisdom, acute in knowledge, and instructed in science, and such as might stand in the king's palace, that he might teach them the learning, and tongue of the Chaldeans. ⁵ And the king appointed them a daily provision, of his own meat, and of the wine of which he drank himself, that being nourished three years, afterwards they might stand before the king. ⁶ Now there were among them of the children of Juda, Daniel, Ananias, Misael, and Azarias. ⁷ And the master of the eunuchs gave them names: to Daniel, Baltassar: to Ananias, Sidrach: to Misael, Misach: and to Azarias, Abdenago.

⁸ But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not be defiled with the king's table, nor with the wine which he drank: and he requested the master of the eunuchs that he might not be defiled. ⁹ And God gave to Daniel grace and mercy in the sight of the prince of the eunuchs. ¹⁰ And the prince of the eunuchs said to Daniel: I fear my lord, the king, who hath appointed you meat and drink: who if he should see your faces leaner than those of the other youths, your equals, you shall endanger my head to the king. ¹¹ And Daniel said to Malasar, whom the prince of the eunuchs had appointed over Daniel, Ananias, Misael, and Azarias: ¹² Try, I beseech thee, thy servants for ten days, and let pulse be given us to eat, and water to drink: ¹³ And look upon our faces, and the faces of the children that eat of the king's meat: and as thou shalt see, deal with thy servants. ¹⁴ And when he had heard these words, he tried them for ten days. ¹⁵ And after ten days, their faces appeared fairer and fatter than all the children that ate of the king's meat. ¹⁶ So Malasar took their portions, and the wine that they should drink: and he gave them pulse.

¹⁷ And to these children God gave knowledge, and understanding in every book, and wisdom: but to Daniel the understanding also of all visions and dreams. ¹⁸ And when the days were ended, after which the king had ordered they should be brought in: the prince of the eunuchs brought them in before Nabuchodonosor. ¹⁹ And when the king had spoken to them, there were not found

among them all such as Daniel, Ananias, Misael, and Azarias: and they stood in the king's presence. ²⁰ And in all matters of wisdom and understanding, that the king inquired of them, he found them ten times better than all the diviners, and wise men, that were in all his kingdom. ²¹ And Daniel continued even to the first year of king Cyrus.

223. The dream of the statue

Daniel 2:1-49

The stone cut without hands, which becomes a mountain.

2 ¹ In the second year of the reign of Nabuchodonosor, Nabuchodonosor had a dream, and his spirit was terrified, and his dream went out of his mind. ² Then the king commanded to call together the diviners and the wise men, and the magicians, and the Chaldeans: to declare to the king his dreams: so they came and stood before the king. ³ And the king said to them: I saw a dream: and being troubled in mind I know not what I saw. ⁴ And the Chaldeans answered the king in Syriac: O king, live for ever: tell to thy servants thy dream, and we will declare the interpretation thereof. ⁵ And the king, answering, said to the Chaldeans: The thing is gone out of my mind: unless you tell me the dream, and the meaning thereof, you shall be put to death, and your houses shall be confiscated. ⁶ but if you tell the dream, and the meaning of it, you shall receive of me rewards, and gifts, and great honour: therefore, tell me the dream, and the interpretation thereof. ⁷ They answered again and said: Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will declare the interpretation of it. ⁸ The king answered and said: I know for certain, that you seek to gain time, since you know that the thing is gone from me. ⁹ If, therefore, you tell me not the dream, there is one sentence concerning you, that you have also framed a lying interpretation, and full of deceit, to speak before me till the time pass away. Tell me, therefore, the dream, that I may know that you also give a true interpretation thereof.

¹⁰ Then the Chaldeans answered before the king, and said: There is no man upon earth, that can accomplish thy word, O king; neither doth any king, though great and mighty, ask such a thing of any diviner, or wise man, or Chaldean. ¹¹ For the thing that thou askest, O king, is difficult: nor can any one be found that can shew it before the king, except the gods, whose conversation is not with men. ¹² Upon hearing this, the king in fury, and in great wrath, commanded that all the wise men of Babylon should be put to death. ¹³ And the decree being gone forth, the wise men were slain: and Daniel and his companions were sought for, to be put to death.

¹⁴ Then Daniel inquired concerning the law and the sentence, of Arioch, the general of the king's army, who was gone forth to kill the wise men of Babylon. ¹⁵ And he asked him that had received the orders of the king, why so cruel a sentence was gone forth from the face of the king. And when Arioch had told the matter to Daniel, ¹⁶ Daniel went in, and desired of the king, that he would give him time to resolve the question, and declare it to the king. ¹⁷ And he went into his house, and told the matter to Ananias, and Misael, and Azarias, his companions: ¹⁸ To the end that they should ask mercy at the face of the God of heaven, concerning this secret, and that Daniel and his companions might not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.

¹⁹ Then was the mystery revealed to Daniel by a vision in the night: and Daniel blessed the God of heaven, ²⁰ And speaking, he said: Blessed be the name of the Lord from eternity and for evermore: for wisdom and fortitude are his. ²¹ And he changeth times and ages: taketh away kingdoms, and establisheth them: giveth wisdom to the wise, and knowledge to them that have understanding: ²² He revealeth deep and hidden things, and knoweth what is in darkness: and light is with him. ²³ To thee, O God of our fathers, I give thanks, and I praise thee: because thou hast given me wisdom and strength: and now thou hast shewn me what we desired of thee, for thou hast made known to us the king's discourse.

²⁴ After this Daniel went in to Arioch, to whom the king had given orders to destroy the wise men of Babylon, and he spoke thus to him: Destroy not the wise men of Babylon: bring me in before the king, and I will tell the solution to the king. ²⁵ Then Arioch in haste brought in Daniel to the king, and said to him: I have found a man of the children of the captivity of Juda, that will resolve the question to the king. ²⁶ The king answered, and said to Daniel, whose name was Baltassar: Thinkest thou indeed that thou canst tell me the dream that I saw, and the interpretation thereof? ²⁷ And Daniel made answer before the king, and said: The secret that the king desireth to know, none of the wise men, or the philosophers, or the diviners, or the soothsayers, can declare to the king. ²⁸ But there is a God in heaven that revealeth mysteries, who hath shewn to thee, O king Nabuchodonosor, what is to come to pass in the latter times. Thy dream, and the visions of thy head upon thy bed, are these: ²⁹ Thou, O king, didst begin to think in thy bed, what should come to pass hereafter: and he that revealeth mysteries shewed thee what shall come to pass. ³⁰ To me also this secret is revealed, not by any wisdom that I have more than all men alive: but that the interpretation might be made manifest to the king, and thou mightest know the thoughts of thy mind.

³¹ Thou, O king, sawest, and behold there was as it were a great statue: this statue, which was great and high, tall of stature, stood before thee, and the look thereof was terrible. ³² The head of this statue was of fine gold, but the breast and the arms of silver, and the belly and the thighs of brass. ³³ And the legs of iron, the feet part of iron and part of clay. ³⁴ Thus thou sawest, till a stone was cut out of a mountain without hands: and it struck the statue upon the feet thereof that were of iron and clay, and broke them in pieces. ³⁵ Then was the iron, the clay, the brass, the silver, and the gold broken to pieces together, and became like the chaff of a summer's threshing floor, and they were carried away by the wind: and there was no place found for them: but the stone that struck the statue became a great mountain, and filled the whole earth.

³⁶ This is the dream: we will also tell the interpretation thereof before thee, O king. ³⁷ Thou art a king of kings: and the God of heaven hath given thee a kingdom, and strength, and power, and glory: ³⁸ And all places wherein the children of men, and the beasts of the field do dwell: he hath also given the birds of the air into thy hand, and hath put all things under thy power: thou, therefore, art the head of gold. ³⁹ And after thee shall rise up another kingdom, inferior to thee, of silver: and another third kingdom of brass, which shall rule over all the world. ⁴⁰ And the

fourth kingdom shall be as iron. As iron breaketh into pieces, and subdueth all things, so shall that break, and destroy all these. ⁴¹ And whereas thou sawest the feet, and the toes, part of potter's clay, and part of iron: the kingdom shall be divided, but yet it shall take its origin from the iron, according as thou sawest the iron mixed with the miry clay. ⁴² And as the toes of the feet were part of iron, and part of clay: the kingdom shall be partly strong, and partly broken. ⁴³ And whereas thou sawest the iron mixed with miry clay, they shall be mingled indeed together with the seed of man, but they shall not stick fast one to another, as iron cannot be mixed with clay. ⁴⁴ But in the days of those kingdoms, the God of heaven will set up a kingdom that shall never be destroyed, and his kingdom shall not be delivered up to another people: and it shall break in pieces, and shall consume all these kingdoms: and itself shall stand for ever. ⁴⁵ According as thou sawest, that the stone was cut out of the mountain without hands, and broke in pieces the clay and the iron, and the brass, and the silver, and the gold, the great God hath shewn the king what shall come to pass hereafter, and the dream is true, and the interpretation thereof is faithful.

⁴⁶ Then king Nabuchodonosor fell on his face, and worshipped Daniel, and commanded that they should offer in sacrifice to him victims and incense. ⁴⁷ And the king spoke to Daniel, and said: Verily, your God is the God of gods, and Lord of kings, and a revealer of hidden things: seeing thou couldst discover this secret. ⁴⁸ Then the king advanced Daniel to a high station, and gave him many and great gifts: and he made him governor over all the provinces of Babylon: and chief of the magistrates over all the wise men of Babylon. ⁴⁹ And Daniel requested of the king, and he appointed Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, over the works of the province of Babylon: but Daniel himself was in the king's palace.

224. *The furnace, and the canticle of the three children*

Daniel 3:1-100

The canticle stands inline at 3:24-90 in the Vulgate; modern versions print it separately or omit it.

3 ¹ King Nabuchodonosor made a statue of gold, of sixty cubits high, and six cubits broad, and he set it up in the plain of Dura, of the province of Babylon. ² Then Nabuchodonosor, the king, sent to call together the nobles, the magistrates, and the judges, the captains, the rulers, and governors, and all the chief men of the provinces, to come to the dedication of the statue which king Nabuchodonosor had set up. ³ Then the nobles, the magistrates, and the judges, the captains, and rulers, and the great men that were placed in authority, and all the princes of the provinces, were gathered together to come to the dedication of the statue, which king Nabuchodonosor had set up. And they stood before the statue which king Nabuchodonosor had set up. ⁴ Then a herald cried with a strong voice: To you it is commanded, O nations, tribes and languages: ⁵ That in the hour that you shall hear the sound of the trumpet, and of the flute, and of the harp, of the sackbut, and of the psaltery, and of the symphony, and of all kind of music, ye fall down and adore the golden statue which king Nabuchodonosor hath set up. ⁶ But if any man shall not fall down and adore, he shall the same hour be cast into a furnace of burning fire. ⁷ Upon this, therefore, at the time when

all the people heard the sound of the trumpet, the flute, and the harp, of the sackbut, and the psaltery, of the symphony, and of all kind of music, all the nations, tribes, and languages fell down and adored the golden statue which king Nabuchodonosor had set up.

⁸ And presently at that very time some Chaldeans came and accused the Jews, ⁹ And said to king Nabuchodonosor: O king, live for ever: ¹⁰ Thou, O king, hast made a decree, that every man that shall hear the sound of the trumpet, the flute, and the harp, of the sackbut, and the psaltery, of the symphony, and of all kind of music, shall prostrate himself, and adore the golden statue: ¹¹ And that if any man shall not fall down and adore, he should be cast into a furnace of burning fire. ¹² Now there are certain Jews, whom thou hast set over the works of the province of Babylon, Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago: these men, O king, have slighted thy decree: they worship not thy gods, nor do they adore the golden statue which thou hast set up.

¹³ Then Nabuchodonosor in fury, and in wrath, commanded that Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago should be brought: who immediately were brought before the king. ¹⁴ And Nabuchodonosor, the king, spoke to them, and said: Is it true, O Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, that you do not worship my gods, nor adore the golden statue that I have set up? ¹⁵ Now, therefore, if you be ready, at what hour soever, you shall hear the sound of the trumpet, flute, harp, sackbut, and psaltery, and symphony, and of all kind of music, prostrate yourselves, and adore the statue which I have made: but if you do not adore, you shall be cast the same hour into the furnace of burning fire: and who is the God that shall deliver you out of my hand? ¹⁶ Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, answered, and said to king Nabuchodonosor: We have no occasion to answer thee concerning this matter. ¹⁷ For behold our God, whom we worship, is able to save us from the furnace of burning fire, and to deliver us out of thy hands, O king. ¹⁸ But if he will not, be it known to thee, O king, that we will not worship thy gods, nor adore the golden statue which thou hast set up.

¹⁹ Then was Nabuchodonosor filled with fury: and the countenance of his face was changed against Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, and he commanded that the furnace should be heated seven times more than it had been accustomed to be heated. ²⁰ And he commanded the strongest men that were in his army, to bind the feet of Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, and to cast them into the furnace of burning fire. ²¹ And immediately these men were bound, and were cast into the furnace of burning fire, with their coats, and their caps, and their shoes, and their garments. ²² For the king's commandment was urgent, and the furnace was heated exceedingly. And the flame of the fire slew those men that had cast in Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago. ²³ But these three men, that is, Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, fell down bound in the midst of the furnace of burning fire. ²⁴ And they walked in the midst of the flame, praising God, and blessing the Lord. ²⁵ Then Azarias standing up, prayed in this manner, and opening his mouth in the midst of the fire, he said: ²⁶ Blessed art thou, O Lord, the God of our fathers, and thy name is worthy of praise, and glorious for ever: ²⁷ For thou art just in all that thou hast done to us, and all thy works are true, and thy ways right, and all thy judgments true. ²⁸ For thou hast executed true

judgments in all the things that thou hast brought upon us, and upon Jerusalem, the holy city of our fathers: for according to truth and judgment, thou hast brought all these things upon us for our sins. ²⁹ For we have sinned, and committed iniquity, departing from thee: and we have trespassed in all things: ³⁰ And we have not hearkened to thy commandments, nor have we observed nor done as thou hadst commanded us, that it might go well with us. ³¹ Wherefore, all that thou hast brought upon us, and every thing that thou hast done to us, thou hast done in true judgment: ³² And thou hast delivered us into the hands of our enemies that are unjust, and most wicked, and prevaricators, and to a king unjust, and most wicked beyond all that are upon the earth. ³³ And now we cannot open our mouths: we are become a shame, and a reproach to thy servants, and to them that worship thee. ³⁴ Deliver us not up for ever, we beseech thee, for thy name's sake, and abolish not thy covenant. ³⁵ And take not away thy mercy from us, for the sake of Abraham, thy beloved, and Isaac, thy servant, and Israel, thy holy one: ³⁶ To whom thou hast spoken, promising that thou wouldst multiply their seed as the stars of heaven, and as the sand that is on the sea shore. ³⁷ For we, O Lord, are diminished more than any nation, and are brought low in all the earth this day for our sins. ³⁸ Neither is there at this time prince, or leader, or prophet, or holocaust, or sacrifice, or oblation, or incense, or place of first fruits before thee, ³⁹ That we may find thy mercy: nevertheless, in a contrite heart and humble spirit let us be accepted. ⁴⁰ As in holocausts of rams, and bullocks, and as in thousands of fat lambs: so let our sacrifice be made in thy sight this day, that it may please thee: for there is no confusion to them that trust in thee. ⁴¹ And now we follow thee with all our heart, and we fear thee, and seek thy face. ⁴² Put us not to confusion, but deal with us according to thy meekness, and according to the multitude of thy mercies. ⁴³ And deliver us, according to thy wonderful works, and give glory to thy name, O Lord: ⁴⁴ And let all them be confounded that shew evils to thy servants, let them be confounded in all thy might, and let their strength be broken: ⁴⁵ And let them know that thou art the Lord, the only God, and glorious over all the world. ⁴⁶ Now the king's servants that had cast them in, ceased not to heat the furnace with brimstone and tow, and pitch, and dry sticks, ⁴⁷ And the flame mounted up above the furnace nine and forty cubits: ⁴⁸ And it broke forth, and burnt such of the Chaldeans as it found near the furnace. ⁴⁹ But the angel of the Lord went down with Azarias and his companions into the furnace: and he drove the flame of the fire out of the furnace, ⁵⁰ And made the midst of the furnace like the blowing of a wind bringing dew, and the fire touched them not at all, nor troubled them, nor did them any harm. ⁵¹ Then these three, as with one mouth, praised and glorified and blessed God, in the furnace, saying: ⁵² Blessed art thou, O Lord, the God of our fathers; and worthy to be praised, and glorified, and exalted above all for ever: and blessed is the holy name of thy glory: and worthy to be praised and exalted above all, in all ages. ⁵³ Blessed art thou in the holy temple of thy glory: and exceedingly to be praised and exalted above all for ever. ⁵⁴ Blessed art thou on the throne of thy kingdom, and exceedingly to be praised and exalted above all for ever. ⁵⁵ Blessed art thou that beholdest the depths, and sittest upon the cherubims: and worthy to be praised and exalted

above all for ever. ⁵⁶ Blessed art thou in the firmament of heaven: and worthy of praise, and glorious for ever. ⁵⁷ All ye works of the Lord, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁵⁸ O ye angels of the Lord, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁵⁹ O ye heavens, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁰ O all ye waters that are above the heavens, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶¹ O all ye powers of the Lord, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶² O ye sun and moon, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶³ O ye stars of heaven, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁴ O every shower and dew, bless ye the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁵ O all ye spirits of God, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁶ O ye fire and heat, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁷ O ye cold and heat, bless the Lord, praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁸ O ye dews and hoar frost, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁶⁹ O ye frost and cold, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁰ O ye ice and snow, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷¹ O ye nights and days, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷² O ye light and darkness, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷³ O ye lightnings and clouds, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁴ O let the earth bless the Lord: let it praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁵ O ye mountains and hills, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁶ O all ye things that spring up in the earth, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁷ O ye fountains, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁸ O ye seas and rivers, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁷⁹ O ye whales, and all that move in the waters, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁰ O all ye fowls of the air, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸¹ O all ye beasts and cattle, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸² O ye sons of men, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸³ O let Israel bless the Lord: let them praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁴ O ye priests of the Lord, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁵ O ye servants of the Lord, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁶ O ye spirits and souls of the just, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁷ O ye holy and humble of heart, bless the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. ⁸⁸ O Ananias, Azarias, and Misael, bless ye the Lord: praise and exalt him above all for ever. For he hath delivered us from hell, and saved us out of the hand of death, and delivered us out of the midst of the burning flame, and saved us out of the midst of the fire. ⁸⁹ O give thanks to the Lord, because he is good: because his mercy endureth for ever and ever. ⁹⁰ O all ye religious, bless the Lord, the God of gods: praise him, and give him thanks, because his mercy endureth for ever and ever. ⁹¹ Then Nabuchodonosor, the king, was astonished, and rose up in haste, and said to his nobles: Did we not cast three men bound into the midst of the fire? They answered the king, and said: True, O king. ⁹² He answered, and said: Behold, I see four men loose, and walking in the midst of the fire, and there is no hurt in them, and the form of the fourth is like the son of God.

⁹³ Then Nabuchodonosor came to the door of the burning fiery furnace, and said: Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, ye servants of the most high God, go ye forth, and come. And immediately Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, went out from the midst of the fire. ⁹⁴ And the nobles, and the magistrates, and the judges, and the great men of the king, being gathered together, considered these men, that the fire had no power on their bodies, and that not a hair of their head had been singed, nor their garments altered, nor the smell of the fire had passed on them.

⁹⁵ Then Nabuchodonosor breaking forth, said: Blessed be the God of them, to wit, of Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, who hath sent his angel, and delivered his servants that believed in him: and they changed the king's word, and delivered up their bodies, that they might not serve nor adore any god except their own God. ⁹⁶ By me, therefore, this decree is made: That every people, tribe, and tongue, which shall speak blasphemy against the God of Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, shall be destroyed, and their houses laid waste: for there is no other God that can save in this manner. ⁹⁷ Then the king promoted Sidrach, Misach, and Abdenago, in the province of Babylon. ⁹⁸ Nabuchodonosor, the king, to all peoples, nations, and tongues, that dwell in all the earth, peace be multiplied unto you. ⁹⁹ The most high God hath wrought signs and wonders towards me. It hath seemed good to me, therefore, to publish ¹⁰⁰ His signs, because they are great: and his wonders, because they are mighty: and his kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his power to all generations.

225. *The madness of Nabuchodonosor; the writing on the wall*

Daniel 4:1-5:31

¹ I, Nabuchodonosor, was at rest in my house, and flourishing in my palace: ² I saw a dream that affrighted me: and my thoughts in my bed, and the visions of my head, troubled me. ³ Then I set forth a decree, that all the wise men of Babylon should be brought in before me, and that they should shew me the interpretation of the dream. ⁴ Then came in the diviners, the wise men, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers, and I told the dream before them: but they did not shew me the interpretation thereof. ⁵ Till their colleague, Daniel, came in before me, whose name is Baltassar, according to the name of my god, who hath in him the spirit of the holy gods: and I told the dream before him. ⁶ Baltassar, prince of the diviners, because I know that thou hast in thee the spirit of the holy gods, and that no secret is impossible to thee, tell me the visions of my dreams that I have seen, and the interpretation of them. ⁷ This was the vision of my head in my bed: I saw, and behold a tree in the midst of the earth, and the height thereof was exceeding great. ⁸ The tree was great and strong, and the height thereof reached unto heaven: the sight thereof was even to the ends of all the earth. ⁹ Its leaves were most beautiful, and its fruit exceeding much: and in it was food for all: under it dwelt cattle and beasts, and in the branches thereof the fowls of the air had their abode: and all flesh did eat of it. ¹⁰ I saw in the vision of my head upon my bed, and behold a watcher, and a holy one came down from heaven. ¹¹ He cried aloud, and said thus: Cut down the tree, and chop off the branches thereof: shake off its leaves, and scatter its fruits: let the beasts fly away that are under it, and the birds from its branches. ¹² Nevertheless, leave the stump of its roots

in the earth, and let it be tied with a band of iron and of brass, among the grass, that is without, and let it be wet with the dew of heaven, and let its portion be with the wild beasts in the grass of the earth. ¹³ Let his heart be changed from man's, and let a beast's heart be given him: and let seven times pass over him. ¹⁴ This is the decree by the sentence of the watchers, and the word and demand of the holy ones: till the living know, that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men: and he will give it to whomsoever it shall please him, and he will appoint the basest man over it. ¹⁵ I, king Nabuchodonosor, saw this dream: thou, therefore, O Baltassar, tell me quickly the interpretation: for all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to declare the meaning of it to me: but thou art able, because the spirit of the holy gods is in thee.

¹⁶ Then Daniel, whose name was Baltassar, began silently to think within himself for about one hour: and his thought troubled him. But the king answering, said: Baltassar, let not the dream and the interpretation thereof trouble thee. Baltassar answered, and said: My lord, the dream be to them that hate thee, and the interpretation thereof to thy enemies. ¹⁷ The tree which thou sawest, which was high and strong, whose height reached to the skies, and the sight thereof into all the earth: ¹⁸ And the branches thereof were most beautiful, and its fruit exceeding much, and in it was food for all, under which the beasts of the field dwelt, and the birds of the air had their abode in its branches. ¹⁹ It is thou, O king, who art grown great, and become mighty: for thy greatness hath grown, and hath reached to heaven, and thy power unto the ends of the earth. ²⁰ And whereas the king saw a watcher, and a holy one come down from heaven, and say: Cut down the tree, and destroy it, but leave the stump of the roots thereof in the earth, and let it be bound with iron and brass, among the grass without, and let it be sprinkled with the dew of heaven, and let his feeding be with the wild beasts, till seven times pass over him. ²¹ This is the interpretation of the sentence of the most High, which is come upon my lord, the king. ²² They shall cast thee out from among men, and thy dwelling shall be with cattle, and with wild beasts, and thou shalt eat grass, as an ox, and shalt be wet with the dew of heaven: and seven times shall pass over thee, till thou know that the most High ruleth over the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will. ²³ But whereas he commanded, that the stump of the roots thereof, that is, of the tree, should be left: thy kingdom shall remain to thee, after thou shalt have known that power is from heaven. ²⁴ Wherefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable to thee, and redeem thou thy sins with alms, and thy iniquities with works of mercy to the poor: perhaps he will forgive thy offences.

²⁵ All these things came upon king Nabuchodonosor. ²⁶ At the end of twelve months he was walking in the palace of Babylon. ²⁷ And the king answered, and said: Is not this the great Babylon, which I have built, to be the seat of the kingdom, by the strength of my power, and in the glory of my excellence? ²⁸ And while the word was yet in the king's mouth, a voice came down from heaven: To thee, O king Nabuchodonosor, it is said: Thy kingdom shall pass from thee. ²⁹ And they shall cast thee out from among men, and thy dwelling shall be with cattle and wild beasts: thou shalt eat grass like an ox, and seven times shall pass over thee,

till thou know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will. ³⁰ The same hour the word was fulfilled upon Nabuchodonosor, and he was driven away from among men, and did eat grass, like an ox, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven: till his hairs grew like the feathers of eagles, and his nails like birds' claws.

³¹ Now at the end of the days, I, Nabuchodonosor, lifted up my eyes to heaven, and my sense was restored to me: and I blessed the most High, and I praised and glorified him that liveth for ever: for his power is an everlasting power, and his kingdom is to all generations. ³² And all the inhabitants of the earth are reputed as nothing before him: for he doth according to his will, as well with the powers of heaven, as among the inhabitants of the earth: and there is none that can resist his hand, and say to him: Why hast thou done it? ³³ At the same time my sense returned to me, and I came to the honour and glory of my kingdom: and my shape returned to me: and my nobles, and my magistrates, sought for me, and I was restored to my kingdom: and greater majesty was added to me. ³⁴ Therefore I, Nabuchodonosor, do now praise, and magnify, and glorify the King of heaven: because all his works are true, and his ways judgments, and them that walk in pride he is able to abase.

5 ¹ Baltasar, the king, made a great feast for a thousand of his nobles: and every one drank according to his age. ² And being now drunk, he commanded that they should bring the vessels of gold and silver, which Nabuchodonosor, his father, had brought away out of the temple, that was in Jerusalem, that the king and his nobles, and his wives, and his concubines, might drink in them. ³ Then were the golden and silver vessels brought, which he had brought away out of the temple that was in Jerusalem: and the king and his nobles, his wives, and his concubines, drank in them. ⁴ They drank wine, and praised their gods of gold, and of silver, of brass, of iron, and of wood, and of stone.

⁵ In the same hour there appeared fingers, as it were of the hand of a man, writing over against the candlestick, upon the surface of the wall of the king's palace: and the king beheld the joints of the hand that wrote. ⁶ Then was the king's countenance changed, and his thoughts troubled him: and the joints of his loins were loosed, and his knees struck one against the other. ⁷ And the king cried out aloud to bring in the wise men, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers. And the king spoke, and said to the wise men of Babylon: Whosoever shall read this writing, and shall make known to me the interpretation thereof, shall be clothed with purple, and shall have a golden chain on his neck, and shall be the third man in my kingdom. ⁸ Then came in all the king's wise men, but they could neither read the writing, nor declare the interpretation to the king. ⁹ Wherewith king Baltasar was much troubled, and his countenance was changed: and his nobles also were troubled.

¹⁰ Then the queen, on occasion of what had happened to the king, and his nobles, came into the banquet-house: and she spoke, and said: O king, live for ever: let not thy thoughts trouble thee, neither let thy countenance be changed. ¹¹ There is a man in thy kingdom that hath the spirit of the holy gods in him: and in the days of thy father knowledge and wisdom were found in him: for king Nabuchodonosor, thy father, appointed him prince of the wise men, enchanter, Chaldeans, and soothsayers, thy father,

I say, O king: ¹² Because a greater spirit, and knowledge, and understanding, and interpretation of dreams, and shewing of secrets, and resolving of difficult things, were found in him, that is, in Daniel: whom the king named Baltassar. Now, therefore, let Daniel be called for, and he will tell the interpretation. ¹³ Then Daniel was brought in before the king. And the king spoke, and said to him: Art thou Daniel, of the children of the captivity of Juda, whom my father, the king, brought out of Judea? ¹⁴ I have heard of thee, that thou hast the spirit of the gods, and excellent knowledge, and understanding, and wisdom are found in thee. ¹⁵ And now the wise men, the magicians, have come in before me, to read this writing, and shew me the interpretation thereof; and they could not declare to me the meaning of this writing. ¹⁶ But I have heard of thee, that thou canst interpret obscure things, and resolve difficult things: now if thou art able to read the writing, and to shew me the interpretation thereof, thou shalt be clothed with purple, and shalt have a chain of gold about thy neck, and shalt be the third prince in my kingdom.

¹⁷ To which Daniel made answer, and said before the king: thy rewards be to thyself, and the gifts of thy house give to another: but the writing I will read to thee, O king, and shew thee the interpretation thereof. ¹⁸ O king, the most high God gave to Nabuchodonosor, thy father, a kingdom, and greatness, and glory, and honour. ¹⁹ And for the greatness that he gave to him, all people, tribes, and languages trembled, and were afraid of him: whom he would, he slew: and whom he would, he destroyed: and whom he would, he set up: and whom he would, he brought down. ²⁰ But when his heart was lifted up, and his spirit hardened unto pride, he was put down from the throne of his kingdom, and his glory was taken away. ²¹ And he was driven out from the sons of men, and his heart was made like the beasts, and his dwelling was with the wild asses, and he did eat grass like an ox, and his body was wet with the dew of heaven: till he knew that the most High ruled in the kingdom of men, and that he will set over it whomsoever it shall please him. ²² Thou also, his son, O Baltasar, hast not humbled thy heart, whereas thou knewest all these things: ²³ But hast lifted thyself up against the Lord of heaven: and the vessels of his house have been brought before thee: and thou, and thy nobles, and thy wives, and thy concubines, have drunk wine in them: and thou hast praised the gods of silver, and of gold, and of brass, of iron, and of wood, and of stone, that neither see, nor hear, nor feel: but the God who hath thy breath in his hand, and all thy ways, thou hast not glorified. ²⁴ Wherefore, he hath sent the part of the hand which hath written this that is set down.

²⁵ And this is the writing that is written: MANE, THECEL, PHARES. ²⁶ And this is the interpretation of the word. MANE: God hath numbered thy kingdom, and hath finished it. ²⁷ THECEL: thou art weighed in the balance, and art found wanting. ²⁸ PHARES: thy kingdom is divided, and is given to the Medes and Persians. ²⁹ Then by the king's command, Daniel was clothed with purple, and a chain of gold was put about his neck: and it was proclaimed of him that he had power as the third man in the kingdom.

³⁰ The same night Baltasar, the Chaldean king, was slain. ³¹ And Darius, the Mede, succeeded to the kingdom, being three-score and two years old.

226. The lions' den

Daniel 6:1-28

Daniel 7-12, the visions, are not read.

6 ¹ It seemed good to Darius, and he appointed over the kingdom a hundred and twenty governors, to be over his whole kingdom. ² And three princes over them of whom Daniel was one: that the governors might give an account to them, and the king might have no trouble. ³ And Daniel excelled all the princes, and governors: because a greater spirit of God was in him.

⁴ And the king thought to set him over all the kingdom; whereupon the princes, and the governors, sought to find occasion against Daniel, with regard to the king: and they could find no cause, nor suspicion, because he was faithful, and no fault, nor suspicion was found in him. ⁵ Then these men said: We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, unless perhaps concerning the law of his God.

⁶ Then the princes, and the governors, craftily suggested to the king, and spoke thus unto him: King Darius, live for ever: ⁷ All the princes of the kingdom, the magistrates, and governors, the senators, and judges, have consulted together, that an imperial decree, and an edict be published: That whosoever shall ask any petition of any god, or man, for thirty days, but of thee, O king, shall be cast into the den of the lions. ⁸ Now, therefore, O king, confirm the sentence, and sign the decree: that what is decreed by the Medes and Persians may not be altered, nor any man be allowed to transgress it. ⁹ So king Darius set forth the decree, and established it.

¹⁰ Now, when Daniel knew this, that is to say, that the law was made, he went into his house: and opening the windows in his upper chamber towards Jerusalem, he knelt down three times a day, and adored and gave thanks before his God, as he had been accustomed to do before. ¹¹ Wherefore those men carefully watching him, found Daniel praying and making supplication to his God. ¹² And they came and spoke to the king concerning the edict: O king, hast thou not decreed, that every man that should make a request to any of the gods, or men, for thirty days, but to thyself, O king, should be cast into the den of the lions? And the king answered them, saying: The word is true, according to the decree of the Medes and Persians, which it is not lawful to violate. ¹³ Then they answered, and said before the king: Daniel, who is of the children of the captivity of Juda, hath not regarded thy law, nor the decree that thou hast made: but three times a day he maketh his prayer. ¹⁴ Now when the king had heard these words, he was very much grieved, and in behalf of Daniel he set his heart to deliver him, and even till sunset he laboured to save him. ¹⁵ But those men perceiving the king's design, said to him: Know thou, O king, that the law of the Medes and Persians is, that no decree which the king hath made, may be altered. ¹⁶ Then the king commanded, and they brought Daniel, and cast him into the den of the lions. And the king said to Daniel: Thy God, whom thou always servest, he will deliver thee. ¹⁷ And a stone was brought, and laid upon the mouth of the den: which the king sealed with his own ring, and with the ring of his nobles, that nothing should be done against Daniel. ¹⁸ And the king went away to his house, and laid himself down without taking supper, and meat was not set before him, and even sleep departed from him. ¹⁹ Then the king rising very early

in the morning, went in haste to the lions' den: ²⁰ And coming near to the den, cried with a lamentable voice to Daniel, and said to him: Daniel, servant of the living God, hath thy God, whom thou servest always, been able, thinkest thou, to deliver thee from the lions? ²¹ And Daniel answering the king, said: O king, live for ever: ²² My God hath sent his angel, and hath shut up the mouths of the lions, and they have not hurt me: forasmuch as before him justice hath been found in me: yea, and before thee, O king, I have done no offence. ²³ Then was the king exceeding glad for him, and he commanded that Daniel should be taken out of the den: and Daniel was taken out of the den, and no hurt was found in him, because he believed in his God.

²⁴ And by the king's commandment, those men were brought that had accused Daniel: and they were cast into the lions' den, they and their children, and their wives: and they did not reach the bottom of the den, before the lions caught them, and broke all their bones in pieces.

²⁵ Then king Darius wrote to all people, tribes, and languages, dwelling in the whole earth: PEACE be multiplied unto you. ²⁶ It is decreed by me, that in all my empire and my kingdom, all men dread and fear the God of Daniel. For he is the living and eternal God for ever: and his kingdom shall not be destroyed, and his power shall be for ever. ²⁷ He is the deliverer, and saviour, doing signs and wonders in heaven, and in earth: who hath delivered Daniel out of the lions' den. ²⁸ Now Daniel continued unto the reign of Darius, and the reign of Cyrus, the Persian.

227. *Susanna*

Daniel 13:1-65

Vulgate chapter 13; modern versions print it as an addition.

13 ¹ Now there was a man that dwelt in Babylon, and his name was Joakim: ² And he took a wife, whose name was Susanna, the daughter of Helcias, a very beautiful woman, and one that feared God. ³ For her parents being just, had instructed their daughter according to the law of Moses. ⁴ Now Joakim was very rich, and had an orchard near his house: and the Jews resorted to him, because he was the most honourable of them all. ⁵ And there were two of the ancients of the people appointed judges that year, of whom the Lord said: That iniquity came out from Babylon, from the ancient judges, that seemed to govern the people. ⁶ These men frequented the house of Joakim, and all that had any matters of judgment came to them. ⁷ And when the people departed away at noon, Susanna went in, and walked in her husband's orchard. ⁸ And the old men saw her going in every day, and walking: and they were inflamed with lust towards her: ⁹ And they perverted their own mind, and turned away their eyes, that they might not look unto heaven, nor remember just judgments. ¹⁰ So they were both wounded with the love of her, yet they did not make known their grief one to the other. ¹¹ For they were ashamed to declare to one another their lust, being desirous to have to do with her: ¹² And they watched carefully every day to see her. And one said to the other: ¹³ Let us now go home, for it is dinner time. So going out, they departed one from another. ¹⁴ And turning back again, they came both to the same place: and asking one another the cause, they acknowledged their lust: and then they agreed together upon a time, when they might find her alone. ¹⁵ And it fell out, as they watched a fit day,

she went in on a time, as yesterday and the day before, with two maids only, and was desirous to wash herself in the orchard: for it was hot weather. ¹⁶ And there was nobody there, but the two old men that had hid themselves, and were beholding her. ¹⁷ So she said to the maids: Bring me oil, and washing balls, and shut the doors of the orchard, that I may wash me. ¹⁸ And they did as she bade them: and they shut the doors of the orchard, and went out by a back door to fetch what she had commanded them, and they knew not that the elders were hid within. ¹⁹ Now when the maids were gone forth, the two elders arose, and ran to her, and said: ²⁰ Behold the doors of the orchard are shut, and nobody seeth us, and we are in love with thee: wherefore consent to us, and lie with us. ²¹ But if thou wilt not, we will bear witness against thee, that a young man was with thee, and therefore thou didst send away thy maids from thee. ²² Susanna sighed, and said: I am straitened on every side: for if I do this thing, it is death to me: and if I do it not, I shall not escape your hands. ²³ But it is better for me to fall into your hands without doing it, than to sin in the sight of the Lord. ²⁴ With that Susanna cried out with a loud voice: and the elders also cried out against her. ²⁵ And one of them ran to the door of the orchard, and opened it. ²⁶ So when the servants of the house heard the cry in the orchard, they rushed in by the back door, to see what was the matter. ²⁷ But after the old men had spoken, the servants were greatly ashamed: for never had there been any such word said of Susanna. And on the next day, ²⁸ When the people were come to Joakim, her husband, the two elders also came full of wicked device against Susanna, to put her to death. ²⁹ And they said before the people: Send to Susanna, daughter of Helcias, the wife of Joakim. And presently they sent. ³⁰ And she came with her parents, and children and all her kindred. ³¹ Now Susanna was exceeding delicate, and beautiful to behold. ³² But those wicked men commanded that her face should be uncovered, (for she was covered) that so at least they might be satisfied with her beauty. ³³ Therefore her friends, and all her acquaintance wept. ³⁴ But the two elders rising up in the midst of the people, laid their hands upon her head. ³⁵ And she weeping, looked up to heaven, for her heart had confidence in the Lord. ³⁶ And the elders said: As we walked in the orchard alone, this woman came in with two maids, and shut the doors of the orchard, and sent away the maids from her. ³⁷ Then a young man that was there hid came to her, and lay with her. ³⁸ But we that were in a corner of the orchard, seeing this wickedness, ran up to them, and we saw them lie together. ³⁹ And him indeed we could not take, because he was stronger than us, and opening the doors, he leaped out: ⁴⁰ But having taken this woman, we asked who the young man was, but she would not tell us: of this thing we are witnesses. ⁴¹ The multitude believed them, as being the elders, and the judges of the people, and they condemned her to death. ⁴² Then Susanna cried out with a loud voice, and said: O eternal God, who knowest hidden things, who knowest all things before they come to pass, ⁴³ Thou knowest that they have borne false witness against me: and behold I must die, whereas I have done none of these things, which these men have maliciously forged against me. ⁴⁴ And the Lord heard her voice. ⁴⁵ And when she was led to be put to death, the Lord raised up the holy spirit of a young boy, whose name was Daniel: ⁴⁶ And

he cried out with a loud voice: I am clear from the blood of this woman. ⁴⁷ Then all the people turning themselves towards him, said: What meaneth this word that thou hast spoken? ⁴⁸ But he standing in the midst of them, said: Are ye so foolish, ye children of Israel, that without examination or knowledge of the truth, you have condemned a daughter of Israel? ⁴⁹ Return to judgment, for they have borne false witness against her. ⁵⁰ So all the people turned again in haste, and the old men said to him: Come, and sit thou down among us, and shew it us: seeing God hath given thee the honour of old age. ⁵¹ And Daniel said to the people: Separate these two far from one another, and I will examine them. ⁵² So when they were put asunder one from the other, he called one of them, and said to him: O thou that art grown old in evil days, now are thy sins come out, which thou hast committed before: ⁵³ In judging unjust judgments, oppressing the innocent, and letting the guilty to go free, whereas the Lord saith: The innocent and the just thou shalt not kill. ⁵⁴ Now then if thou sawest her, tell me under what tree thou sawest them conversing together: He said: Under a mastic tree. ⁵⁵ And Daniel said: Well hast thou lied against thy own head: for behold the angel of God having received the sentence of him, shall cut thee in two. ⁵⁶ And having put him aside, he commanded that the other should come, and he said to him: O thou seed of Chanaan, and not of Juda, beauty hath deceived thee, and lust hath perverted thy heart: ⁵⁷ Thus did you do to the daughters of Israel, and they for fear conversed with you: but a daughter of Juda would not abide your wickedness. ⁵⁸ Now, therefore, tell me, under what tree didst thou take them conversing together. And he answered: Under a holm tree. ⁵⁹ And Daniel said to him: Well hast thou also lied against thy own head: for the angel of the Lord waiteth with a sword to cut thee in two, and to destroy you. ⁶⁰ With that all the assembly cried out with a loud voice, and they blessed God, who saveth them that trust in him. ⁶¹ And they rose up against the two elders, (for Daniel had convicted them of false witness by their own mouth) and they did to them as they had maliciously dealt against their neighbour, ⁶² To fulfil the law of Moses: and they put them to death, and innocent blood was saved in that day. ⁶³ But Helcias, and his wife, praised God, for their daughter, Susanna, with Joakim, her husband, and all her kindred, because there was no dishonesty found in her. ⁶⁴ And Daniel became great in the sight of the people from that day, and thence forward. ⁶⁵ And king Astyages was gathered to his fathers; and Cyrus, the Persian, received his kingdom.

228. *Bel and the dragon*

Daniel 14:1-42

Vulgate chapter 14.

14 ¹ And Daniel was the king's guest, and was honoured above all his friends. ² Now the Babylonians had an idol called Bel: and there was spent upon him every day twelve great measures of fine flour, and forty sheep, and six vessels of wine. ³ The king also worshipped him, and went every day to adore him: but Daniel adored his God. And the king said to him: Why dost thou not adore Bel? ⁴ And he answered, and said to him: Because I do not worship idols made with hands, but the living God, that created heaven and earth, and hath power over all flesh. ⁵ And the king said to him: Doth not Bel seem to thee

to be a living god? Seest thou not how much he eateth and drinketh every day? ⁶ Then Daniel smiled, and said: O king, be not deceived: for this is but clay within, and brass without, neither hath he eaten at any time. ⁷ And the king being angry, called for his priests, and said to them: If you tell me not who it is that eateth up these expenses, you shall die. ⁸ But if you can shew that Bel eateth these things, Daniel shall die, because he hath blasphemed against Bel. And Daniel said to the king: Be it done according to thy word. ⁹ Now the priests of Bel were seventy, besides their wives, and little ones, and children. And the king went with Daniel into the temple of Bel. ¹⁰ And the priests of Bel said: Behold, we go out: and do thou, O king, set on the meats, and make ready the wine, and shut the door fast, and seal it with thy own ring: ¹¹ And when thou comest in the morning, if thou findest not that Bel hath eaten up all, we will suffer death, or else Daniel, that hath lied against us. ¹² And they little regarded it, because they had made under the table a secret entrance, and they always came in by it, and consumed those things. ¹³ So it came to pass after they were gone out, the king set the meats before Bel: and Daniel commanded his servants, and they brought ashes, and he sifted them all over the temple before the king: and going forth, they shut the door, and having sealed it with the king's ring, they departed. ¹⁴ But the priests went in by night, according to their custom, with their wives, and their children: and they ate and drank up all. ¹⁵ And the king arose early in the morning, and Daniel with him. ¹⁶ And the king said: Are the seals whole, Daniel? And he answered: They are whole, O king. ¹⁷ And as soon as he had opened the door, the king looked upon the table, and cried out with a loud voice: Great art thou, O Bel, and there is not any deceit with thee. ¹⁸ And Daniel laughed: and he held the king, that he should not go in: and he said: Behold the pavement, mark whose footsteps these are. ¹⁹ And the king said: I see the footsteps of men, and women, and children. And the king was angry. ²⁰ Then he took the priests, and their wives, and their children: and they shewed him the private doors by which they came in, and consumed the things that were on the table. ²¹ The king, therefore, put them to death, and delivered Bel into the power of Daniel: who destroyed him and his temple. ²² And there was a great dragon in that place, and the Babylonians worshipped him. ²³ And the king said to Daniel: Behold, thou canst not say now, that this is not a living god: adore him, therefore. ²⁴ And Daniel said: I adore the Lord, my God: for he is the living God: but that is no living god. ²⁵ But give me leave, O king, and I will kill this dragon without sword or club. And the king said, I give thee leave. ²⁶ Then Daniel took pitch, and fat, and hair, and boiled them together: and he made lumps, and put them into the dragon's mouth, and the dragon burst asunder. And he said: Behold him whom you worship. ²⁷ And when the Babylonians had heard this, they took great indignation: and being gathered together against the king, they said: The king is become a Jew. He hath destroyed Bel, he hath killed the dragon, and he hath put the priests to death. ²⁸ And they came to the king, and said: Deliver us Daniel, or else we will destroy thee and thy house. ²⁹ And the king saw that they pressed upon him violently: and being constrained by necessity: he delivered Daniel to them. ³⁰ And they cast him into the den of lions, and he was there six days. ³¹ And in the den there were

seven lions, and they had given to them two carcasses every day, and two sheep: but then they were not given unto them, that they might devour Daniel. ³² Now there was in Judea a prophet called Habacuc, and he had boiled pottage, and had broken bread in a bowl: and was going into the field, to carry it to the reapers. ³³ And the angel of the Lord said to Habacuc: Carry the dinner which thou hast into Babylon, to Daniel, who is in the lions' den. ³⁴ And Habacuc said: Lord, I never saw Babylon, nor do I know the den. ³⁵ And the angel of the Lord took him by the top of his head, and carried him by the hair of his head, and set him in Babylon, over the den, in the force of his spirit. ³⁶ And Habacuc cried, saying: O Daniel, thou servant of God, take the dinner that God hath sent thee. ³⁷ And Daniel said, Thou hast remembered me, O God, and thou hast not forsaken them that love thee. ³⁸ And Daniel arose, and ate. And the angel of the Lord presently set Habacuc again in his own place. ³⁹ And upon the seventh day the king came to bewail Daniel: and he came to the den, and looked in, and behold Daniel was sitting in the midst of the lions. ⁴⁰ And the king cried out with a loud voice, saying: Great art thou, O Lord, the God of Daniel. And he drew him out of the lions' den. ⁴¹ But those that had been the cause of his destruction, he cast into the den, and they were devoured in a moment before him. ⁴² Then the king said: Let all the inhabitants of the whole earth fear the God of Daniel: for he is the Saviour, working signs, and wonders in the earth: who hath delivered Daniel out of the lions' den.

229. Tobias in exile, and his blindness

Tobit 1:1-2:23

The Douay-Rheims follows the Vulgate text of Tobias, whose chapter and verse division differs from the Greek used by most modern versions; these references will not always transfer to a modern Bible.

1 ¹ Tobias of the tribe and city of Nephtali, (which is in the upper parts of Galilee above Naasson, beyond the way that leadeth to the west, having on the right hand the city of Sephet,) ² When he was made captive in the days of Salmanasar king of the Assyrians, even in his captivity, forsook not the way of truth, ³ But every day gave all he could get to his brethren his fellow captives, that were of his kindred. ⁴ And when he was younger than any of the tribe of Nephtali, yet did he no childish thing in his work. ⁵ Moreover when all went to the golden calves which Jeroboam king of Israel had made, he alone fled the company of all, ⁶ And went to Jerusalem to the temple of the Lord, and there adored the Lord God of Israel, offering faithfully all his firstfruits, and his tithes, ⁷ So that in the third year he gave all his tithes to the proselytes, and strangers. ⁸ These and such like things did he observe when but a boy according to the law of God. ⁹ But when he was a man, he took to wife Anna of his own tribe, and had a son by her, whom he called after his own name, ¹⁰ And from his infancy he taught him to fear God, and to abstain from all sin. ¹¹ And when by the captivity he with his wife and his son and all his tribe was come to the city of Nineve, ¹² (When all ate of the meats of the Gentiles) he kept his soul and never was defiled with their meats. ¹³ And because he was mindful of the Lord with all his heart, God gave him favour in the sight of Salmanasar the king. ¹⁴ And he gave him leave

to go whithersoever he would, with liberty to do whatever he had a mind. ¹⁵ He therefore went to all that were in captivity, and gave them wholesome admonitions. ¹⁶ And when he was come to Rages a city of the Medes, and had ten talents of silver of that with which he had been honoured by the king: ¹⁷ And when amongst a great multitude of his kindred, he saw Gabelus in want, who was one of his tribe, taking a note of his hand he gave him the aforesaid sum of money. ¹⁸ But after a long time, Salmanasar the king being dead, when Sennacherib his son, who reigned in his place, had a hatred for the children of Israel: ¹⁹ Tobias daily went among all his kindred and comforted them, and distributed to every one as he was able, out of his goods: ²⁰ He fed the hungry, and gave clothes to the naked, and was careful to bury the dead, and they that were slain. ²¹ And when king Sennacherib was come back, fleeing from Judea by reason of the slaughter that God had made about him for his blasphemy, and being angry slew many of the children of Israel, Tobias buried their bodies. ²² But when it was told the king, he commanded him to be slain, and took away all his substance. ²³ But Tobias fleeing naked away with his son and with his wife, lay concealed, for many loved him. ²⁴ But after forty-five days, the king was killed by his own sons. ²⁵ And Tobias returned to his house, and all his substance was restored to him.

2 ¹ But after this, when there was a festival of the Lord, and a good dinner was prepared in Tobias's house, ² He said to his son: Go, and bring some of our tribe that fear God, to feast with us. ³ And when he had gone, returning he told him, that one of the children of Israel lay slain in the street. And he forthwith leaped up from his place at the table, and left his dinner, and came fasting to the body. ⁴ And taking it up carried it privately to his house, that after the sun was down, he might bury him cautiously. ⁵ And when he had hid the body, he ate bread with mourning and fear, ⁶ Remembering the word which the Lord spoke by Amos the prophet: Your festival days shall be turned into lamentation and mourning. ⁷ So when the sun was down, he went and buried him. ⁸ Now all his neighbours blamed him, saying: once already commandment was given for thee to be slain because of this matter, and thou didst scarce escape the sentence of death, and dost thou again bury the dead? ⁹ But Tobias fearing God more than the king, carried off the bodies of them that were slain, and hid them in his house, and at midnight buried them. ¹⁰ Now it happened one day that being wearied with burying, he came to his house, and cast himself down by the wall and slept, ¹¹ And as he was sleeping, hot dung out of a swallow's nest fell upon his eyes, and he was made blind. ¹² Now this trial the Lord therefore permitted to happen to him, that an example might be given to posterity of his patience, as also of holy Job. ¹³ For whereas he had always feared God from his infancy, and kept his commandments, he repined not against God because the evil of blindness had befallen him, ¹⁴ But continued immoveable in the fear of God, giving thanks to God all the days of his life. ¹⁵ For as the kings insulted over holy Job: so his relations and kinsmen mocked at his life, saying: ¹⁶ Where is thy hope, for which thou gavest alms, and buriedst the dead? ¹⁷ But Tobias rebuked them, saying: Speak not so: ¹⁸ For we are the children of saints, and look for that life which God will give to those that never change their faith from him. ¹⁹ Now Anna

his wife went daily to weaving work, and she brought home what she could get for their living by the labour of her hands. ²⁰ Whereby it came to pass, that she received a young kid, and brought it home: ²¹ And when her husband heard it bleating, he said: Take heed, lest perhaps it be stolen: restore ye it to its owners, for it is not lawful for us either to eat or to touch any thing that cometh by theft. ²² At these words his wife being angry answered: It is evident thy hope is come to nothing, and thy alms now appear. ²³ And with these and other, such like words she upbraided him.

230. Two prayers heard in one hour

Tobit 3:1-25

3 ¹ Then Tobias sighed, and began to pray with tears, ² Saying, Thou art just, O Lord, and all thy judgments are just, and all thy ways mercy, and truth, and judgment: ³ And now, O Lord, think of me, and take not revenge of my sins, neither remember my offences, nor those of my parents. ⁴ For we have not obeyed thy commandments, therefore are we delivered to spoil and to captivity, and death, and are made a fable, and a reproach to all nations, amongst which thou hast scattered us. ⁵ And now, O Lord, great are thy judgments, because we have not done according to thy precepts, and have not walked sincerely before thee. ⁶ And now, O Lord, do with me according to thy will, and command my spirit to be received in peace: for it is better for me to die, than to live. ⁷ Now it happened on the same day, that Sara daughter of Raguel, in Rages a city of the Medes, received a reproach from one of her father's servant maids, ⁸ Because she had been given to seven husbands and a devil named Asmodeus had killed them, at their first going in unto her. ⁹ So when she reproved the maid for her fault, she answered her, saying: May we never see son, or daughter of thee upon the earth, thou murderer of thy husbands. ¹⁰ Wilt thou kill me also, as thou hast already killed seven husbands? At these words, she went into an upper chamber of her house: and for three days and three nights did neither eat nor drink: ¹¹ But continuing in prayer with tears besought God, that he would deliver her from this reproach. ¹² And it came to pass on the third day when she was making an end of her prayer, blessing the Lord, ¹³ She said: Blessed is thy name, O God of our fathers, who when thou hast been angry, wilt shew mercy, and in the time of tribulation forgivest the sins of them that call upon thee. ¹⁴ To thee, O Lord, I turn my face, to thee I direct my eyes. ¹⁵ I beg, O Lord, that thou loose me from the bond of this reproach, or else take me away from the earth. ¹⁶ Thou knowest, O Lord, that I never coveted a husband, and have kept my soul clean from all lust. ¹⁷ Never have I joined myself with them that play: neither have I made myself partaker with them that walk in lightness. ¹⁸ But a husband I consented to take, with thy fear, not with my lust. ¹⁹ And either I was unworthy of them, or they perhaps were not worthy of me: because perhaps thou hast kept me for another man, ²⁰ For thy counsel is not in man's power. ²¹ But this every one is sure of that worshippeth thee, that his life, if it be under trial, shall be crowned and if it be under tribulation, it shall be delivered: and if it be under correction, it shall be allowed to come to thy mercy. ²² For thou art not delighted in our being lost, because after a storm thou makest a calm, and after tears and weeping thou pourest in joyfulness. ²³ Be thy name, O God

of Israel, blessed for ever, ²⁴ At that time the prayers of them both were heard in the sight of the glory of the most high God: ²⁵ And the holy angel of the Lord, Raphael was sent to heal them both, whose prayers at one time were rehearsed in the sight of the Lord.

231. The charge to the son, and the guide

Tobit 4:1-5:28

4 ¹ Therefore when Tobias thought that his prayer was heard that he might die, he called to him Tobias his son, ² And said to him: Hear, my son, the words of my mouth, and lay them as a foundation in thy heart. ³ When God shall take my soul, thou shalt bury my body: and thou shalt honour thy mother all the days of her life: ⁴ For thou must be mindful what and how great perils she suffered for thee in her womb. ⁵ And when she also shall have ended the time of her life, bury her by me. ⁶ And all the days of thy life have God in thy mind: and take heed thou never consent to sin, nor transgress the commandments of the Lord our God. ⁷ Give alms out of thy substance, and turn not away thy face from any poor person: for so it shall come to pass that the face of the Lord shall not be turned from thee. ⁸ According to thy ability be merciful. ⁹ If thou have much give abundantly: if thou have little, take care even so to bestow willingly a little. ¹⁰ For thus thou storest up to thyself a good reward for the day of necessity. ¹¹ For alms deliver from all sin, and from death, and will not suffer the soul to go into darkness. ¹² Alms shall be a great confidence before the most high God, to all them that give it. ¹³ Take heed to keep thyself, my son, from all fornication, and beside thy wife never endure to know a crime. ¹⁴ Never suffer pride to reign in thy mind, or in thy words: for from it all perdition took its beginning. ¹⁵ If any man hath done any work for thee, immediately pay him his hire, and let not the wages of thy hired servant stay with thee at all. ¹⁶ See thou never do to another what thou wouldst hate to have done to thee by another. ¹⁷ Eat thy bread with the hungry and the needy, and with thy garments cover the naked, ¹⁸ Lay out thy bread, and thy wine upon the burial of a just man, and do not eat and drink thereof with the wicked. ¹⁹ Seek counsel always of a wise man. ²⁰ Bless God at all times: and desire of him to direct thy ways, and that all thy counsels may abide in him. ²¹ I tell thee also, my son, that I lent ten talents of silver, while thou wast yet a child, to Gabelus, in Rages a city of the Medes, and I have a note of his hand with me: ²² Now therefore inquire how thou mayst go to him, and receive of him the foresaid sum of money, and restore to him the note of his hand. ²³ Fear not, my son: we lead indeed a poor life, but we shall have many good things if we fear God, and depart from all sin, and do that which is good.

5 ¹ Then Tobias answered his father, and said: I will do all things, father, which thou hast commanded me. ² But how I shall get this money, I cannot tell; he knoweth not me, and I know not him: what token shall I give him? nor did I ever know the way which leadeth thither. ³ Then his father answered him, and said: I have a note of his hand with me, which when thou shalt shew him, he will presently pay it. ⁴ But go now, and seek thee out some faithful man, to go with thee for his hire: that thou mayst receive it, while I yet live. ⁵ Then Tobias going forth, found a beautiful young man, standing girded, and as it were ready to

walk. ⁶ And not knowing that he was an angel of God, he saluted him, and said: From whence art thou, good young man? ⁷ But he answered: Of the children of Israel. And Tobias said to him: Knowest thou the way that leadeth to the country of the Medes? ⁸ And he answered: I know it: and I have often walked through all the ways thereof, and I have abode with Gabelus our brother, who dwelleth at Rages a city of the Medes, which is situate in the mount of Ecbatana. ⁹ And Tobias said to him: Stay for me, I beseech thee, till I tell these same things to my father. ¹⁰ Then Tobias going in told all these things to his father. Upon which his father being in admiration, desired that he would come in unto him. ¹¹ So going in he saluted him, and said: Joy be to thee always. ¹² And Tobias said: What manner of joy shall be to me, who sit in darkness and see not the light of heaven? ¹³ And the young man said to him: Be of good courage, thy cure from God is at hand. ¹⁴ And Tobias said to him: Canst thou conduct my son to Gabelus at Rages, a city of the Medes? and when thou shalt return, I will pay thee thy hire. ¹⁵ And the angel said to him: I will conduct him thither, and bring him back to thee. ¹⁶ And Tobias said to him: I pray thee, tell me, of what family, or what tribe art thou? ¹⁷ And Raphael the angel answered: Dost thou seek the family of him thou hirest, or the hired servant himself to go with thy son? ¹⁸ But lest I should make thee uneasy, I am Azarias the son of the great Ananias. ¹⁹ And Tobias answered: Thou art of a great family. But I pray thee be not angry that I desired to know thy family. ²⁰ And the angel said to him: I will lead thy son safe, and bring him to thee again safe. ²¹ And Tobias answering, said: May you have a good journey, and God be with you in your way, and his angel accompany you. ²² Then all things being ready, that were to be carried in their journey, Tobias bade his father and his mother farewell, and they set out both together. ²³ And when they were departed, his mother began to weep, and to say: Thou hast taken the staff of our old age, and sent him away from us. ²⁴ I wish the money for which thou hast sent him, had never been. ²⁵ For our poverty was sufficient for us, that we might account it as riches, that we saw our son. ²⁶ And Tobias said to her: Weep not, our son will arrive thither safe, and will return safe to us, and thy eyes shall see him. ²⁷ For I believe that the good angel of God doth accompany him, and doth order all things well that are done about him, so that he shall return to us with joy. ²⁸ At these words his mother ceased weeping, and held her peace.

232. The fish, and the house of Raguel

Tobit 6:1-7:20

6 ¹ And Tobias went forward, and the dog followed him, and he lodged the first night by the river of Tigris. ² And he went out to wash his feet, and behold a monstrous fish came up to devour him. ³ And Tobias being afraid of him, cried out with a loud voice, saying: Sir, he cometh upon me. ⁴ And the angel said to him: Take him by the gill, and draw him to thee. And when he had done so, he drew him out upon the land, and he began to pant before his feet. ⁵ Then the angel said to him: Take out the entrails of this fish, and lay up his heart, and his gall, and his liver for thee: for these are necessary for useful medicines. ⁶ And when he had done so, he roasted the flesh thereof, and they took it with them in the way: the rest they salted as much as might serve them, till they came to Rages the city of the Medes. ⁷ Then

Tobias asked the angel, and said to him: I beseech thee, brother Azarias, tell me what remedies are these things good for, which thou hast bid me keep of the fish? ⁸ And the angel, answering, said to him: If thou put a little piece of its heart upon coals, the smoke thereof driveth away all kind of devils, either from man or from woman, so that they come no more to them. ⁹ And the gall is good for anointing the eyes, in which there is a white speck, and they shall be cured. ¹⁰ And Tobias said to him: Where wilt thou that we lodge? ¹¹ And the angel answering, said: Here is one whose name is Raguel, a near kinsman of thy tribe, and he hath a daughter named Sara, but he hath no son nor any other daughter beside her. ¹² All his substance is due to thee, and thou must take her to wife. ¹³ Ask her therefore of her father, and he will give her thee to wife. ¹⁴ Then Tobias answered, and said: I hear that she hath been given to seven husbands, and they all died: moreover I have heard, that a devil killed them. ¹⁵ Now I am afraid, lest the same thing should happen to me also: and whereas I am the only child of my parents, I should bring down their old age with sorrow to hell. ¹⁶ Then the angel Raphael said to him: Hear me, and I will shew thee who they are, over whom the devil can prevail. ¹⁷ For they who in such manner receive matrimony, as to shut out God from themselves, and from their mind, and to give themselves to their lust, as the horse and mule, which have not understanding, over them the devil hath power. ¹⁸ But thou when thou shalt take her, go into the chamber, and for three days keep thyself continent from her, and give thyself to nothing else but to prayers with her. ¹⁹ And on that night lay the liver of the fish on the fire, and the devil shall be driven away. ²⁰ But the second night thou shalt be admitted into the society of the holy Patriarchs. ²¹ And the third night thou shalt obtain a blessing that sound children may be born of you. ²² And when the third night is past, thou shalt take the virgin with the fear of the Lord, moved rather for love of children than for lust, that in the seed of Abraham thou mayst obtain a blessing in children.

7 ¹ And they went in to Raguel, and Raguel received them with joy. ² And Raguel looking upon Tobias, said to Anna his wife: How like is this young man to my cousin? ³ And when he had spoken these words, he said: Whence are ye young men our brethren? ⁴ But they said: We are of the tribe of Nephtali, of the captivity of Ninive. ⁵ And Raguel said to them: Do you know Tobias my brother? And they said: We know him. ⁶ And when he was speaking many good things of him, the angel said to Raguel: Tobias concerning whom thou inquirest is this young man's father. ⁷ And Raguel went to him, and kissed him with tears and weeping upon his neck, said: A blessing be upon thee, my son, because thou art the son of a good and most virtuous man. ⁸ And Anna his wife, and Sara their daughter wept. ⁹ And after they had spoken, Raguel commanded a sheep to be killed, and a feast to be prepared. And when he desired them to sit down to dinner, ¹⁰ Tobias said: I will not eat nor drink here this day, unless thou first grant me my petition, and promise to give me Sara thy daughter. ¹¹ Now when Raguel heard this he was afraid, knowing what had happened to those seven husbands, that went in unto her: and he began to fear lest it might happen to him also in like manner: and as he was in suspense, and gave no answer to his petition, ¹² The angel said to him: Be not afraid to give her to this man, for to him who feareth God is thy

daughter due to be his wife: therefore another could not have her. ¹³ Then Raguel said: I doubt not but God hath regarded my prayers and tears in his sight. ¹⁴ And I believe he hath therefore made you come to me, that this maid might be married to one of her own kindred, according to the law of Moses: and now doubt not but I will give her to thee. ¹⁵ And taking the right hand of his daughter, he gave it into the right hand of Tobias, saying: The God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob be with you, and may he join you together, and fulfil his blessing in you. ¹⁶ And taking paper they made a writing of the marriage. ¹⁷ And afterwards they made merry, blessing God. ¹⁸ And Raguel called to him Anna his wife, and bade her to prepare another chamber. ¹⁹ And she brought Sara her daughter in thither, and she wept. ²⁰ And she said to her: Be of good cheer, my daughter: the Lord of heaven give thee joy for the trouble thou hast undergone.

233. The marriage, the return, and Raphael made known

Tobit 8:1-12:22

8 ¹ And after they had supped, they brought in the young man to her. ² And Tobias remembering the angel's word, took out of his bag part of the liver, and laid it upon burning coals. ³ Then the angel Raphael took the devil, and bound him in the desert of upper Egypt. ⁴ Then Tobias exhorted the virgin, and said to her: Sara, arise, and let us pray to God to day, and to morrow, and the next day: because for these three nights we are joined to God: and when the third night is over, we will be in our own wedlock. ⁵ For we are the children of saints, and we must not be joined together like heathens that know not God. ⁶ So they both arose, and prayed earnestly both together that health might be given them. ⁷ And Tobias said: Lord God of our fathers, may the heavens and the earth, and the sea, and the fountains, and the rivers, and all thy creatures that are in them, bless thee. ⁸ Thou madest Adam of the slime of the earth, and gavest him Eve for a helper. ⁹ And now, Lord, thou knowest, that not for fleshly lust do I take my sister to wife, but only for the love of posterity, in which thy name may be blessed for ever and ever. ¹⁰ Sara also said: Have mercy on us, O Lord, have mercy on us, and let us grow old both together in health. ¹¹ And it came to pass about the cockcrowing, Raguel ordered his servants to be called for, and they went with him together to dig a grave. ¹² For he said: Lest perhaps it may have happened to him, in like manner as it did to the other seven husbands, that went in unto her. ¹³ And when they had prepared the pit, Raguel went back to his wife, and said to her: ¹⁴ Send one of thy maids, and let her see if he be dead, that I may bury him before it be day. ¹⁵ So she sent one of her maidservants, who went into the chamber, and found them safe and sound, sleeping both together. ¹⁶ And returning she brought the good news: and Raguel and Anna his wife blessed the Lord. ¹⁷ And said: We bless thee, O Lord God of Israel, because it hath not happened as we suspected. ¹⁸ For thou hast shewn thy mercy to us, and hast shut out from us the enemy that persecuted us. ¹⁹ And thou hast taken pity upon two only children. Make them, O Lord, bless thee more fully: and to offer up to thee a sacrifice of thy praise, and of their health, that all nations may know, that thou alone art God in all the earth. ²⁰ And immediately Raguel commanded his servants, to fill up the pit they had made, before it was day. ²¹ And he spoke to his

wife to make ready a feast, and prepare all kind of provisions that are necessary for such as go a journey. ²² He caused also two fat kine, and four wethers to be killed, and a banquet to be prepared for all his neighbours, and all his friends. ²³ And Raguel adjured Tobias, to abide with him two weeks. ²⁴ And of all things which Raguel possessed, he gave one half to Tobias, and made a writing, that the half that remained should after their decease come also to Tobias.

9 ¹ Then Tobias called the angel to him, whom he took to be a man, and said to him: Brother Azarias, I pray thee hearken to my words: ² If I should give myself to be thy servant I should not make a worthy return for thy care. ³ However, I beseech thee, to take with thee beasts and servants, and to go to Gabelus to Rages the city of the Medes: and to restore to him his note of hand, and receive of him the money, and desire him to come to my wedding. ⁴ For thou knowest that my father numbereth the days: and if I stay one day more, his soul will be afflicted. ⁵ And indeed thou seest how Raguel hath adjured me, whose adjuring I cannot despise. ⁶ Then Raphael took four of Raguel's servants, and two camels, and went to Rages the city of the Medes: and finding Gabelus, gave him his note of hand, and received of him all the money. ⁷ And he told him concerning Tobias the son of Tobias, all that had been done: and made him come with him to the wedding. ⁸ And when he was come into Raguel's house he found Tobias sitting at the table: and he leaped up, and they kissed each other: and Gabelus wept, and blessed God. ⁹ And said: The God of Israel bless thee, because thou art the son of a very good and just man, and that feareth God, and doth almsdeeds: ¹⁰ And may a blessing come upon thy wife and upon your parents. ¹¹ And may you see your children, and your children's children, unto the third and fourth generation: and may your seed be blessed by the God of Israel, who reigneth for ever and ever. ¹² And when all had said, Amen, they went to the feast: but the marriage feast they celebrated also with the fear of the Lord.

10 ¹ But as Tobias made longer stay upon occasion of the marriage, Tobias his father was solicitous, saying: Why thinkest thou doth my son tarry, or why is he detained there? ² Is Gabelus dead, thinkest thou, and no man will pay him the money? ³ And he began to be exceeding sad, both he and Anna his wife with him: and they began both to weep together, because their son did not return to them on the day appointed. ⁴ But his mother wept and was quite disconsolate, and said: Woe, woe is me, my son; why did we send thee to go to a strange country, the light of our eyes, the staff of our old age, the comfort of our life, the hope of our posterity? ⁵ We having all things together in thee alone, ought not to have let thee go from us. ⁶ And Tobias said to her: Hold thy peace, and be not troubled, our son is safe: that man with whom we sent him is very trusty. ⁷ But she could by no means be comforted, but daily running out looked round about, and went into all the ways by which there seemed any hope he might return, that she might if possible see him coming afar off. ⁸ But Raguel said to his son in law: Stay here, and I will send a messenger to Tobias thy father, that thou art in health. ⁹ And Tobias said to him: I know that my father and mother now count the days, and their spirit is grievously afflicted within them. ¹⁰ And when Raguel had pressed Tobias with many words, and he by no

means would hearken to him, he delivered Sara unto him, and half of all his substance in menservants, and womenservants, in cattle, in camels, and in kine, and in much money, and sent him away safe and joyful from him, ¹¹ Saying: The holy angel of the Lord be with you in your journey, and bring you through safe, and that you may find all things well about your parents, and my eyes may see your children before I die. ¹² And the parents taking their daughter kissed her, and let her go: ¹³ Admonishing her to honour her father and mother in law, to love her husband, to take care of the family, to govern the house, and to behave herself irreprehensibly.

11 ¹ And as they were returning they came to Charan, which is in the midway to Ninive, the eleventh day. ² And the angel said: Brother Tobias, thou knowest how thou didst leave thy father. ³ If it please thee therefore, let us go before, and let the family follow softly after us, together with thy wife, and with the beasts. ⁴ And as this their going pleased him, Raphael said to Tobias: Take with thee of the gall of the fish, for it will be necessary. So Tobias took some of that gall and departed. ⁵ But Anna sat beside the way daily, on the top of a hill, from whence she might see afar off. ⁶ And while she watched his coming from that place, she saw him afar off, and presently perceived it was her son coming: and returning she told her husband, saying: Behold thy son cometh. ⁷ And Raphael said to Tobias: As soon as thou shalt come into thy house, forthwith adore the Lord thy God: and giving thanks to him, go to thy father, and kiss him. ⁸ And immediately anoint his eyes with this gall of the fish, which thou carriest with thee. For be assured that his eyes shall be presently opened, and thy father shall see the light of heaven, and shall rejoice in the sight of thee. ⁹ Then the dog, which had been with them in the way, ran before, and coming as if he had brought the news, shewed his joy by his fawning and wagging his tail. ¹⁰ And his father that was blind, rising up, began to run stumbling with his feet: and giving a servant his hand, went to meet his son. ¹¹ And receiving him kissed him, as did also his wife, and they began to weep for joy. ¹² And when they had adored God, and given him thanks, they sat down together. ¹³ Then Tobias taking of the gall of the fish, anointed his father's eyes. ¹⁴ And he stayed about half an hour: and a white skin began to come out of his eyes, like the skin of an egg. ¹⁵ And Tobias took hold of it, and drew it from his eyes, and immediately he recovered his sight. ¹⁶ And they glorified God, both he and his wife and all that knew him. ¹⁷ And Tobias said: I bless thee, O Lord God of Israel, because thou hast chastised me, and thou hast saved me and behold I see Tobias my son. ¹⁸ And after seven days Sara his son's wife and all the family arrived safe, and the cattle, and the camels, and an abundance of money of his wife's: and that money also which he had received of Gabelus, ¹⁹ And he told his parents all the benefits of God, which he had done to him by the man that conducted him. ²⁰ And Achior and Nabath the kinsmen of Tobias came, rejoicing for Tobias, and congratulating with him for all the good things that God had done for him. ²¹ And for seven days they feasted and rejoiced all with great joy.

12 ¹ Then Tobias called to him his son and said to him: What can we give to this holy man, that is come with thee? ² Tobias answering, said to his father: Father, what wages shall we give him? or what can be worthy of his benefits? ³ He conducted me

and brought me safe again, he received the money of Gabelus, he caused me to have my wife, and he chased from her the evil spirit, he gave joy to her parents, myself he delivered from being devoured by the fish, thee also he hath made to see the light of heaven, and we are filled with all good things through him. What can we give him sufficient for these things? ⁴ But I beseech thee, my father, to desire him, that he would vouchsafe to accept of one half of all things that have been brought. ⁵ So the father and the son calling him, took him aside: and began to desire him that he would vouchsafe to accept of half of all things that they had brought, ⁶ Then he said to them secretly, Bless ye the God of heaven, give glory to him in the sight of all that live, because he hath shewn his mercy to you. ⁷ For it is good to hide the secret of a king: but honourable to reveal and confess the works of God. ⁸ Prayer is good with fasting and alms more than to lay up treasures of gold. ⁹ For alms delivereth from death, and the same is that which purgeth away sins, and maketh to find mercy and life everlasting. ¹⁰ But they that commit sin and iniquity, are enemies to their own soul. ¹¹ I discover then the truth unto you, and I will not hide the secret from you. ¹² When thou didst pray with tears, and didst bury the dead, and didst leave thy dinner, and hide the dead by day in thy house, and bury them by night, I offered thy prayer to the Lord. ¹³ And because thou wast acceptable to God, it was necessary that temptation should prove thee. ¹⁴ And now the Lord hath sent me to heal thee, and to deliver Sara thy son's wife from the devil. ¹⁵ For I am the angel Raphael, one of the seven, who stand before the Lord. ¹⁶ And when they had heard these things, they were troubled, and being seized with fear they fell upon the ground on their face. ¹⁷ And the angel said to them: Peace be to you, fear not. ¹⁸ For when I was with you, I was there by the will of God: bless ye him, and sing praises to him. ¹⁹ I seemed indeed to eat and to drink with you but I use an invisible meat and drink, which cannot be seen by men. ²⁰ It is time therefore that I return to him that sent me: but bless ye God, and publish all his wonderful works. ²¹ And when he had said these things, he was taken from their sight, and they could see him no more. ²² Then they lying prostrate for three hours upon their face, blessed God, and rising up, they told all his wonderful works.

234. The canticle of Tobias, and his death

Tobit 13:1-14:17

13 ¹ And Tobias the elder opening his mouth, blessed the Lord, and said: Thou art great O Lord, for ever, and thy kingdom is unto all ages. ² For thou scourgest, and thou savest: thou leadest down to hell, and bringest up again: and there is none that can escape thy hand. ³ Give glory to the Lord, ye children of Israel, and praise him in the sight of the Gentiles: ⁴ Because he hath therefore scattered you among the Gentiles, who know not him, that you may declare his wonderful works, and make them know that there is no other almighty God besides him. ⁵ He hath chastised us for our iniquities: and he will save us for his own mercy. ⁶ See then what he hath done with us, and with fear and trembling give ye glory to him: and extol the eternal King of worlds in your works. ⁷ As for me, I will praise him in the land of my captivity: because he hath shewn his majesty toward a sinful nation, ⁸ Be converted therefore, ye sinners, and do justice before God, believing that he will shew his mercy to you. ⁹ And

I and my soul will rejoice in him. ¹⁰ Bless ye the Lord, all his elect, keep days of joy, and give glory to him. ¹¹ Jerusalem, city of God, the Lord hath chastised thee for the works of thy hands. ¹² Give glory to the Lord for thy good things, and bless the God eternal that he may rebuild his tabernacle in thee, and may call back all the captives to thee, and thou mayst rejoice for ever and ever. ¹³ Thou shalt shine with a glorious light: and all the ends of the earth shall worship thee, ¹⁴ Nations from afar shall come to thee: and shall bring gifts, and shall adore the Lord in thee, and shall esteem thy land as holy. ¹⁵ For they shall call upon the great name in thee, ¹⁶ They shall be cursed that shall despise thee: and they shall be condemned that shall blaspheme thee: and blessed shall they be that shall build thee up, ¹⁷ But thou shalt rejoice in thy children, because they shall all be blessed, and shall be gathered together to the Lord. ¹⁸ Blessed are all they that love thee, and that rejoice in thy peace, ¹⁹ My soul, bless thou the Lord, because the Lord our God hath delivered Jerusalem his city from all her troubles. ²⁰ Happy shall I be if there shall remain of my seed, to see the glory of Jerusalem. ²¹ The gates of Jerusalem shall be built of sapphire, and of emerald, and all the walls thereof round about of precious stones. ²² All its streets shall be paved with white and clean stones: and Alleluia shall be sung in its streets, ²³ Blessed be the Lord, who hath exalted it, and may he reign over it for ever and ever, Amen.

14 ¹ And the words of Tobias were ended. And after Tobias was restored to his sight, he lived two and forty years, and saw the children of his grandchildren. ² And after he had lived a hundred and two years, he was buried honorably in Ninive. ³ For he was six and fifty years old when he lost the sight of his eyes, and sixty when he recovered it again. ⁴ And the rest of his life was in joy, and with great increase of the fear of God he departed in peace. ⁵ And at the hour of his death he called unto him his son Tobias and his children, seven young men, his grandsons, and said to them: ⁶ The destruction of Ninive is at hand: for the word of the Lord must be fulfilled: and our brethren, that are scattered abroad from the land of Israel, shall return to it. ⁷ And all the land thereof that is desert shall be filled with people, and the house of God which is burnt in it, shall again be rebuilt: and all that fear God shall return thither. ⁸ And the Gentiles shall leave their idols, and shall come into Jerusalem, and shall dwell in it. ⁹ And all the kings of the earth shall rejoice in it, adoring the King of Israel. ¹⁰ Hearken therefore, my children, to your father: serve the Lord in truth, and seek to do the things that please him: ¹¹ And command your children that they do justice and almsdeeds, and that they be mindful of God, and bless him at all times in truth, and with all their power. ¹² And now, children, hear me, and do not stay here: but as soon as you shall bury your mother by me in one sepulchre, without delay direct your steps to depart hence: ¹³ For I see that its iniquity will bring it to destruction. ¹⁴ And it came to pass that after the death of his mother, Tobias departed out of Ninive with his wife, and children, and children's children, and returned to his father and mother in law. ¹⁵ And he found them in health in a good old age: and he took care of them, and he closed their eyes: and all the inheritance of Raguel's house came to him: and he saw his children's children to the fifth generation. ¹⁶ And after he had lived ninety-nine years in the fear of the Lord, with joy

they buried him. ¹⁷ And all his kindred, and all his generation continued in good life, and in holy conversation, so that they were acceptable both to God, and to men, and to all that dwelt in the land.

RETURN AND RESTORATION

Esdras (Ezra) and Nehemias entire but for their registers, with Esther and Judith. The Douay-Rheims prints the first two as the First and Second Books of Esdras. Esdras 2, Nehemias 3 and Nehemias 7 are lists of names and are passed over on the same rule that omits Genesis 5, 10 and 36.

235. The decree of Cyrus

Ezra 1:1-11

Douay-Rheims title: the First Book of Esdras. Esdras 2, the register of those who returned, is omitted.

1 ¹ In the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, that the word of the Lord by the mouth of Jeremias might be fulfilled, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians: and he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and in writing also, saying: ² Thus saith Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord the God of heaven hath given to me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he hath charged me to build him a house in Jerusalem, which is in Judea. ³ Who is there among you of all his people? His God be with him. Let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judea, and build the house of the Lord the God of Israel: he is the God that is in Jerusalem. ⁴ And let all the rest in all places wheresoever they dwell, help him every man from his place, with silver and gold, and goods, and cattle, besides that which they offer freely to the temple of God, which is in Jerusalem.

⁵ Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Juda and Benjamin, and the priests, and Levites, and every one whose spirit God had raised up, to go up to build the temple of the Lord, which was in Jerusalem. ⁶ And all they that were round about, helped their hands with vessels of silver, and gold, with goods, and with beasts, and with furniture, besides what they had offered on their own accord. ⁷ And king Cyrus brought forth the vessels of the temple of the Lord, which Nabuchodonosor had taken from Jerusalem, and had put them in the temple of his god. ⁸ Now Cyrus king of Persia brought them forth by the hand of Mithridates the son of Gazabar, and numbered them to Sassabasar the prince of Juda. ⁹ And this is the number of them: thirty bowls of gold, a thousand bowls of silver, nine and twenty knives, thirty cups of gold, ¹⁰ Silver cups of a second sort, four hundred and ten: other vessels a thousand. ¹¹ All the vessels of gold and silver, five thousand four hundred: all these Sassabasar brought with them that came up from the captivity of Babylon to Jerusalem.

236. The altar, and the foundation laid

Ezra 3:1-13

3 ¹ And now the seventh month was come, and the children of Israel were in their cities: and the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem. ² And Josue the son of Josedec rose up, and his brethren the priests, and Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and his brethren, and they built the altar of the God of Israel that they might offer holocausts upon it, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God. ³ And they set the

altar of God upon its bases, while the people of the lands round about put them in fear, and they offered upon it a holocaust to the Lord morning and evening. ⁴ And they kept the feast of tabernacles, as it is written, and offered the holocaust every day orderly according to the commandment, the duty of the day in its day. ⁵ And afterwards the continual holocaust, both on the new moons, and on all the solemnities of the Lord, that were consecrated, and on all in which a freewill offering was made to the Lord. ⁶ From the first day of the seventh month they began to offer holocausts to the Lord: but the temple of God was not yet founded. ⁷ And they gave money to hewers of stones and to masons: and meat and drink, and oil to the Sidonians and Tyrians, to bring cedar trees from Libanus to the sea of Joppe, according to the orders which Cyrus king of the Persians had given them.

⁸ And in the second year of their coming to the temple of God in Jerusalem, the second month, Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and Josue the son of Josedec, and the rest of their brethren the priests, and the Levites, and all that were come from the captivity to Jerusalem began, and they appointed Levites from twenty years old and upward, to hasten forward the work of the Lord. ⁹ Then Josue and his sons and his brethren, Cedmihel, and his sons, and the children of Juda, as one man, stood to hasten them that did the work in the temple of God: the sons of Henadad, and their sons, and their brethren the Levites. ¹⁰ And when the masons laid the foundations of the temple of the Lord, the priests stood in their ornaments with trumpets: and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise God by the hands of David king of Israel. ¹¹ And they sung together hymns, and praise to the Lord: because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever towards Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, praising the Lord, because the foundations of the temple of the Lord were laid. ¹² But many of the priests and the Levites, and the chief of the fathers and the ancients that had seen the former temple; when they had the foundation of this temple before their eyes, wept with a loud voice: and many shouting for joy, lifted up their voice. ¹³ So that one could not distinguish the voice of the shout of joy, from the noise of the weeping of the people: for one with another the people shouted with a loud shout, and the voice was heard afar off.

237. The work stopped

Ezra 4:1-24

4 ¹ Now the enemies of Juda and Benjamin heard that the children of the captivity were building a temple to the Lord the God of Israel. ² And they came to Zorobabel, and the chief of the fathers, and said to them: Let us build with you, for we seek your God as ye do: behold we have sacrificed to him, since the days of Asor Haddan king of Assyria, who brought us hither. ³ But Zorobabel, and Josue, and the rest of the chief of the fathers of Israel said to them: You have nothing to do with us to build a house to our God, but we ourselves alone will build to the Lord our God, as Cyrus king of the Persians hath commanded us. ⁴ Then the people of the land hindered the hands of the people of Juda, and troubled them in building. ⁵ And they hired counsellors against them, to frustrate their design all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of the Persians. ⁶ And in the reign of Assuerus, in the beginning

of his reign, they wrote an accusation against the inhabitants of Juda and Jerusalem.

⁷ And in the days of Artaxerxes, Beselam, Mithridates, and Thabeel, and the rest that were in the council wrote to Artaxerxes king of the Persians: and the letter of accusation was written in Syrian, and was read in the Syrian tongue. ⁸ Reum Beelteem, and Samsai the scribe wrote a letter from Jerusalem to king Artaxerxes, in this manner: ⁹ Reum Beelteem, and Samsai the scribe and the rest of their counsellors, the Dinities, and the Apharsathacites, the Therphalites, the Apharsites, the Erchuities, the Babylonians, the Susanechites, the Dievites, and the Elamites, ¹⁰ And the rest of the nations, whom the great and glorious Asenaphar brought over: and made to dwell in the cities of Samaria and in the rest of the countries of this side of the river in peace.

¹¹ (This is the copy of the letter, which they sent to him:) To Artaxerxes the king, thy servants, the men that are on this side of the river, send greeting. ¹² Be it known to the king, that the Jews, who came up from thee to us, are come to Jerusalem a rebellious and wicked city, which they are building, setting up the ramparts thereof and repairing the walls. ¹³ And now be it known to the king, that if this city be built up, and the walls thereof repaired, they will not pay tribute nor toll, nor yearly revenues, and this loss will fall upon the kings. ¹⁴ But we remembering the salt that we have eaten in the palace, and because we count it a crime to see the king wronged, have therefore sent and certified the king, ¹⁵ That search may be made in the books of the histories of thy fathers, and thou shalt find written in the records: and shalt know that this city is a rebellious city, and hurtful to the kings and provinces, and that wars were raised therein of old time: for which cause also the city was destroyed. ¹⁶ We certify the king, that if this city be built, and the walls thereof repaired, thou shalt have no possession on this side of the river.

¹⁷ The king sent word to Reum Beelteem and Samsai the scribe, and to the rest that were in their council, inhabitants of Samaria, and to the rest beyond the river, sending greeting and peace. ¹⁸ The accusation, which you have sent to us, hath been plainly read before me, ¹⁹ And I commanded: and search hath been made, and it is found, that this city of old time hath rebelled against kings, and seditions and wars have been raised therein. ²⁰ For there have been powerful kings in Jerusalem, who have had dominion over all the country that is beyond the river: and have received tribute, and toll and revenues. ²¹ Now therefore hear the sentence: Hinder those men, that this city be not built, till further orders be given by me. ²² See that you be not negligent in executing this, lest by little and little the evil grow to the hurt of the kings.

²³ Now the copy of the edict of king Artaxerxes was read before Reum Beelteem, and Samsai the scribe, and their counsellors: and they went up in haste to Jerusalem to the Jews, and hindered them with arm and power. ²⁴ Then the work of the house of the Lord in Jerusalem was interrupted, and ceased till the second year of the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

238. The temple finished and dedicated*Ezra 5:1-6:22*

5 ¹ Now Aggeus the prophet, and Zacharias the son of Addo, prophesied to the Jews that were in Judea and Jerusalem, in the name of the God of Israel. ² Then rose up Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and Josue the son of Josedec, and began to build the temple of God in Jerusalem, and with them were the prophets of God helping them.

³ And at the same time came to them Thathanai, who was governor beyond the river, and Stharbuzanai, and their counsellors: and said thus to them: Who hath given you counsel to build this house, and to repair the walls thereof? ⁴ In answer to which we gave them the names of the men who were the promoters of that building. ⁵ But the eye of their God was upon the ancients of the Jews, and they could not hinder them. And it was agreed that the matter should be referred to Darius, and then they should give satisfaction concerning that accusation.

⁶ The copy of the letter that Thathanai governor of the country beyond the river, and Stharbuzanai, and his counsellors the Arphasachites, who dwelt beyond the river, sent to Darius the king. ⁷ The letter which they sent him, was written thus: To Darius the king all peace. ⁸ Be it known to the king, that we went to the province of Judea, to the house of the great God, which they are building with unpolished stones, and timber is laid in the walls: and this work is carried on diligently and advanceth in their hands. ⁹ And we asked those ancients, and said to them thus: Who hath given you authority to build this house, and to repair these walls? ¹⁰ We asked also of them their names, that we might give thee notice: and we have written the names of the men that are the chief among them. ¹¹ And they answered us in these words, saying: We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and we are building a temple that was built these many years ago, and which a great king of Israel built and set up. ¹² But after that our fathers had provoked the God of heaven to wrath, he delivered them into the hands of Nabuchodonosor the king of Babylon the Chaldean: and he destroyed this house, and carried away the people to Babylon. ¹³ But in the first year of Cyrus the king of Babylon, king Cyrus set forth a decree, that this house of God should be built. ¹⁴ And the vessels also of gold and silver of the temple of God, which Nabuchodonosor had taken out of the temple, that was in Jerusalem, and had brought them to the temple of Babylon, king Cyrus brought out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered to one Sassabasar, whom also he appointed governor, ¹⁵ And said to him: Take these vessels, and go, and put them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be built in its place. ¹⁶ Then came this same Sassabasar, and laid the foundations of the temple of God in Jerusalem, and from that time until now it is in building, and is not yet finished. ¹⁷ Now therefore if it seem good to the king, let him search in the king's library, which is in Babylon, whether it hath been decreed by Cyrus the king, that the house of God in Jerusalem should be built, and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.

6 ¹ Then king Darius gave orders, and they searched in the library of the books that were laid up in Babylon, ² And there was found in Ecbatana, which is a castle in the province of Media, a book in which this record was written. ³ In the first

year of Cyrus the king: Cyrus the king decreed, that the house of God should be built, which is in Jerusalem, in the place where they may offer sacrifices, and that they lay the foundations that may support the height of threescore cubits, and the breadth of threescore cubits, ⁴ Three rows of unpolished stones, and so rows of new timber: and the charges shall be given out of the king's house. ⁵ And also let the golden and silver vessels of the temple of God, which Nabuchodonosor took out of the temple of Jerusalem, and brought to Babylon, be restored, and carried back to the temple of Jerusalem to their place, which also were placed in the temple of God. ⁶ Now therefore Thathanai, governor of the country beyond the river, Stharbuzanai, and your counsellors the Aphasachites, who are beyond the river, depart far from them, ⁷ And let that temple of God be built by the governor of the Jews, and by their ancients, that they may build that house of God in its place. ⁸ I also have commanded what must be done by those ancients of the Jews, that the house of God may be built, to wit, that of the king's chest, that is, of the tribute that is paid out of the country beyond the river, the charges be diligently given to those men, lest the work be hindered. ⁹ And if it shall be necessary, let calves also, and lambs, and kids, for holocausts to the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the custom of the priests that are in Jerusalem, be given them day by day, that there be no complaint in any thing. ¹⁰ And let them offer oblations to the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king, and of his children. ¹¹ And I have made a decree: That if any whosoever, shall alter this commandment, a beam be taken from his house, and set up, and he be nailed upon it, and his house be confiscated. ¹² And may the God, that hath caused his name to dwell there, destroy all kingdoms, and the people that shall put out their hand to resist, and to destroy the house of God, that is in Jerusalem. I Darius have made the decree, which I will have diligently complied with.

¹³ So then Thathanai, governor of the country beyond the river, and Stharbuzanai, and his counsellors diligently executed what Darius the king had commanded. ¹⁴ And the ancients of the Jews built, and prospered according to the prophecy of Aggeus the prophet, and of Zacharias the son of Addo: and they built and finished, by the commandment of the God of Israel, and by the commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes kings of the Persians. ¹⁵ And they were finishing this house of God, until the third day of the month of Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of king Darius.

¹⁶ And the children of Israel, the priests and the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity kept the dedication of the house of God with joy. ¹⁷ And they offered at the dedication of the house of God, a hundred calves, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs, and for a sin offering for all Israel twelve he goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel. ¹⁸ And they set the priests in their divisions, and the Levites in their courses over the works of God in Jerusalem, as it is written in the book of Moses. ¹⁹ And the children of Israel of the captivity kept the phase, on the fourteenth day of the first month. ²⁰ For all the priests and the Levites were purified as one man: all were clean to kill the phase for all the children of the captivity, and for their brethren the priests, and themselves. ²¹ And the children of Israel that were returned from captivity, and all that

had separated themselves from the filthiness of the nations of the earth to them, to seek the Lord the God of Israel, did eat.²² And they kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy, for the Lord had made them joyful, and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria to them, that he should help their hands in the work of the house of the Lord the God of Israel.

239. Esdras comes up from Babylon

Ezra 7:1-8:36

7 ¹ Now after these things in the reign of Artaxerxes king of the Persians, Esdras the son of Saraïas, the son of Azarias, the son of Helcias, ² The son of Sellum, the son of Sadoc, the son of Achitob, ³ The son of Amarias, the son of Azarias, the son of Maraïoth, ⁴ The son of Zarahias, the son of Ozi, the son of Bocci, ⁵ The son of Abisue, the son of Phinees, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, the priest from the beginning. ⁶ This Esdras went up from Babylon, and he was a ready scribe in the law of Moses, which the Lord God had given to Israel: and the king granted him all his request, according to the hand of the Lord his God upon him. ⁷ And there went up some of the children of Israel, and of the children of the priests, and of the children of the Levites, and of the singing men, and of the porters, and of the Nathinites to Jerusalem in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king. ⁸ And they came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, in the seventh year of the king. ⁹ For upon the first day of the first month he began to go up from Babylon, and on the first day of the fifth month he came to Jerusalem according to the good hand of his God upon him. ¹⁰ For Esdras had prepared his heart to seek the law of the Lord, and to do and to teach in Israel the commandments and judgment.

¹¹ And this is the copy of the letter of the edict, which king Artaxerxes gave to Esdras the priest, the scribe instructed in the words and commandments of the Lord, and his ceremonies in Israel. ¹² Artaxerxes king of kings to Esdras the priest, the most learned scribe of the law of the God of heaven, greeting. ¹³ It is decreed by me, that all they of the people of Israel, and of the priests and of the Levites in my realm, that are minded to go into Jerusalem, should go with thee. ¹⁴ For thou art sent from before the king, and his seven counsellors, to visit Judea and Jerusalem according to the law of thy God, which is in thy hand. ¹⁵ And to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counsellors have freely offered to the God of Israel, whose tabernacle is in Jerusalem. ¹⁶ And all the silver and gold that thou shalt find in all the province of Babylon, and that the people is willing to offer, and that the priests shall offer of their own accord to the house of their God, which is in Jerusalem, ¹⁷ Take freely, and buy diligently with this money, calves, rams, lambs, with the sacrifices and libations of them, and offer them upon the altar of the temple of your God, that is in Jerusalem. ¹⁸ And if it seem good to thee, and to thy brethren to do any thing with the rest of the silver and gold, do it according to the will of your God. ¹⁹ The vessels also, that are given thee for the sacrifice of the house of thy God, deliver thou in the sight of God in Jerusalem. ²⁰ And whatsoever more there shall be need of for the house of thy God, how much soever thou shalt have occasion to spend, it shall be given out of the treasury, and the king's exchequer, and by me. ²¹ I Artaxerxes the king have ordered and decreed to all the keepers of the public chest, that are beyond the river, that

whatsoever Esdras the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, shall require of you, you give it without delay, ²² Unto a hundred talents of silver, and unto a hundred cores of wheat, and unto a hundred bates of wine, and unto a hundred bates of oil, and salt without measure. ²³ All that belongeth to the rites of the God of heaven, let it be given diligently in the house of the God of heaven: lest his wrath should be enkindled against the realm of the king, and of his sons. ²⁴ We give you also to understand concerning all the priests, and the Levites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nathinites, and ministers of the house of this God, that you have no authority to impose toll or tribute, or custom upon them. ²⁵ And thou Esdras according to the wisdom of thy God, which is in thy hand, appoint judges and magistrates, that may judge all the people, that is beyond the river, that is, for them who know the law of thy God, yea and the ignorant teach ye freely. ²⁶ And whosoever will not do the law of thy God, and the law of the king diligently, judgment shall be executed upon him, either unto death, or unto banishment, or to the confiscation of goods, or at least to prison.

²⁷ Blessed be the Lord the God of our fathers, who hath put this in the king's heart, to glorify the house of the Lord, which is in Jerusalem, ²⁸ And hath inclined his mercy toward me before the king and his counsellors, and all the mighty princes of the king: and I being strengthened by the hand of the Lord my God, which was upon me, gathered together out of Israel chief men to go up with me.

8 ¹ Now these are the chiefs of families, and the genealogy of them, who came up with me from Babylon in the reign of Artaxerxes the king. ² Of the sons of Phinees, Gersom. Of the sons of Ithamar, Daniel. Of the sons of David, Hattus. ³ Of the sons of Sechenias, the son of Pharos, Zacharias, and with him were numbered a hundred and fifty men. ⁴ Of the sons of Phahath Moab, Eleoenai the son of Zareha, and with him two hundred men. ⁵ Of the sons of Sechenias, the son of Ezechiel, and with him three hundred men. ⁶ Of the sons of Adan, Abed the son of Jonathan, and with him fifty men. ⁷ Of the sons of Alam, Isaïas the son of Athalias, and with him seventy men. ⁸ Of the sons of Saphatïa: Zebodia the son of Michael, and with him eighty men. ⁹ Of the sons of Joab, Obedia the son of Jahiel, and with him two hundred and eighteen men. ¹⁰ Of the sons of Selomith, the son of Josphia, and with him a hundred and sixty men. ¹¹ Of the sons of Bebai, Zacharias the son of Bebai: and with him eight and twenty men. ¹² Of the sons of Azgad, Joanan the son of Eccetan, and with him a hundred and ten men. ¹³ Of the sons of Adonicam, who were the last: and these are their names: Eliphelet, and Jehiel, and Samaïas, and with them sixty men. ¹⁴ Of the sons of Begui, Uthai and Zachur, and with them seventy men.

¹⁵ And I gathered them together to the river, which runneth down to Ahava, and we stayed there three days: and I sought among the people and among the priests for the sons of Levi, and found none there. ¹⁶ So I sent Eliezer, and Ariel, and Semeias, and Elnathan, and Jarib, and another Elnathan, and Nathan, and Zacharias, and Mosollam, chief men: and Joarib, and Elnathan, wise men. ¹⁷ And I sent them to Eddo, who is chief in the place of Chasphia, and I put in their mouth the words that they should speak to Eddo, and his brethren the Nathinites in the place of Chasphia, that they should bring us ministers of the house of our

God.¹⁸ And by the good hand of our God upon us, they brought us a most learned man of the sons of Moholi the son of Levi the son of Israel, and Sarabias and his sons, and his brethren eighteen,¹⁹ And Hasabias, and with him Isaias of the sons of Merari, and his brethren, and his sons twenty.²⁰ And of the Nathinites, whom David, and the princes gave for the service of the Levites, Nathinites two hundred and twenty: all these were called by their names.

²¹ And I proclaimed there a fast by the river Ahava, that we might afflict ourselves before the Lord our God, and might ask of him a right way for us and for our children, and for all our substance.²² For I was ashamed to ask the king for aid and for horsemen, to defend us from the enemy in the way: because we had said to the king: The hand of our God is upon all them that seek him in goodness: and his power and strength, and wrath upon all them that forsake him.²³ And we fasted, and besought our God for this: and it fell out prosperously unto us.

²⁴ And I separated twelve of the chief of the priests, Sarabias, and Hasabias, and with them ten of their brethren,²⁵ And I weighed unto them the silver and gold, and the vessels consecrated for the house of our God, which the king and his counselors, and his princes, and all Israel, that were found had offered.²⁶ And I weighed to their hands six hundred and fifty talents of silver, and a hundred vessels of silver, and a hundred talents of gold,²⁷ And twenty cups of gold, of a thousand solids, and two vessels of the best shining brass, beautiful as gold.²⁸ And I said to them: You are the holy ones of the Lord, and the vessels are holy, and the silver and gold, that is freely offered to the Lord the God of our fathers.²⁹ Watch ye and keep them, till you deliver them by weight before the chief of the priests, and of the Levites, and the heads of the families of Israel in Jerusalem, into the treasure of the house of the Lord.³⁰ And the priests and the Levites received the weight of the silver and gold, and the vessels, to carry them to Jerusalem to the house of our God.

³¹ Then we set forward from the river Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month to go to Jerusalem: and the hand of our God was upon us, and delivered us from the hand of the enemy, and of such as lay in wait by the way.³² And we came to Jerusalem, and we stayed there three days.³³ And on the fourth day the silver and the gold, and the vessels were weighed in the house of our God by the hand of Meremoth the son of Urias the priest, and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinees, and with them Jozabad the son of Josue, and Nodaia the son of Benoi, Levites.³⁴ According to the number and weight of everything: and all the weight was written at that time.³⁵ Moreover the children of them that had been carried away that were come out of the captivity, offered holocausts to the God of Israel, twelve calves for all the people of Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, and twelve he goats for sin: all for a holocaust to the Lord.³⁶ And they gave the king's edicts to the lords that were from the king's court, and the governors beyond the river, and they furthered the people and the house of God.

240. The prayer of Esdras, and the separation

Ezra 9:1-10:44

9 ¹ And after these things were accomplished, the princes came to me, saying: The people of Israel, and the priests and Levites have not separated themselves from the people of the lands,

and from their abominations, namely, of the Chanaanites, and the Hethites, and the Pherezites, and the Jebusites, and the Ammonites, and the Moabites, and the Egyptians, and the Amorrites.² For they have taken of their daughters for themselves and for their sons, and they have mingled the holy seed with the people of the lands. And the hand of the princes and magistrates hath been first in this transgression.³ And when I had heard this word, I rent my mantle and my coat, and plucked off the hairs of my head and my beard, and I sat down mourning.⁴ And there were assembled to me all that feared the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that were come from the captivity, and I sat sorrowful, until the evening sacrifice.

⁵ And at the evening sacrifice I rose up from my affliction, and having rent my mantle and my garment, I fell upon my knees, and spread out my hands to the Lord my God,⁶ And said: My God I am confounded and ashamed to lift up my face to thee: for our iniquities are multiplied over our heads, and our sins are grown up even unto heaven,⁷ From the days of our fathers: and we ourselves also have sinned grievously unto this day, and for our iniquities we and our kings, and our priests have been delivered into the hands of the kings of the lands, and to the sword, and to captivity, and to spoil, and to confusion of face, as it is at this day.⁸ And now as a little, and for a moment has our prayer been made before the Lord our God, to leave us a remnant, and give us a pin in his holy place, and that our God would enlighten our eyes, and would give us a little life in our bondage.⁹ For we are bondmen, and in our bondage our God hath not forsaken us, but hath extended mercy upon us before the king of the Persians, to give us life, and to set up the house of our God, and to rebuild the desolations thereof, and to give us a fence in Juda and Jerusalem.¹⁰ And now, O our God, what shall we say after this? for we have forsaken thy commandments,¹¹ Which thou hast commanded by the hand of thy servants the prophets, saying: The land which you go to possess, is an unclean land, according to the uncleanness of the people, and of other lands, with their abominations, who have filled it from mouth to mouth with their filth.¹² Now therefore give not your daughters to their sons, and take not their daughters for your sons, and seek not their peace, nor their prosperity for ever: that you may be strengthened, and may eat the good things of the land, and may have your children your heirs for ever.¹³ And after all that is come upon us, for our most wicked deeds, and our great sin, seeing that thou our God hast saved us from our iniquity, and hast given us a deliverance as at this day,¹⁴ That we should not turn away, nor break thy commandments, nor join in marriage with the people of these abominations. Art thou angry with us unto utter destruction, not to leave us a remnant to be saved?¹⁵ O Lord God of Israel, thou art just: for we remain yet to be saved as at this day. Behold we are before thee in our sin, for there can be no standing before thee in this matter.

10 ¹ Now when Esdras was thus praying, and beseeching, and weeping, and lying before the temple of God, there was gathered to him of Israel an exceeding great assembly of men and women and children, and the people wept with much lamentation.² And Sechenias the son of Jehiel of the sons of Elam answered, and said to Esdras: We have sinned against our God, and have taken strange wives of the people of the land: and now if there be

repentance in Israel concerning this, ³ Let us make a covenant with the Lord our God, to put away all the wives, and such as are born of them, according to the will of the Lord, and of them that fear the commandment of the Lord our God: let it be done according to the law. ⁴ Arise, it is thy part to give orders, and we will be with thee: take courage, and do it. ⁵ So Esdras arose, and made the chiefs of the priests and of the Levites, and all Israel, to swear that they would do according to this word, and they swore. ⁶ And Esdras rose up from before the house of God, and went to the chamber of Johanan the son of Eliasib, and entered in thither: he ate no bread, and drank no water: for he mourned for the transgression of them that were come out of the captivity. ⁷ And proclamation was made in Juda and Jerusalem to all the children of the captivity, that they should assemble together into Jerusalem. ⁸ And that whosoever would not come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the ancients, all his substance should be taken away, and he should be cast out of the company of them that were returned from captivity.

⁹ Then all the men of Juda, and Benjamin gathered themselves together to Jerusalem within three days, in the ninth month, the twentieth day of the month: and all the people sat in the street of the house of God, trembling because of the sin, and the rain. ¹⁰ And Esdras the priest stood up, and said to them: You have transgressed, and taken strange wives, to add to the sins of Israel. ¹¹ And now make confession to the Lord the God of your fathers, and do his pleasure, and separate yourselves from the people of the land, and from your strange wives. ¹² And all the multitude answered and said with a loud voice: According to thy word unto us, so be it done. ¹³ But as the people are many, and it is time of rain, and we are not able to stand without, and it is not a work of one day or two, (for we have exceedingly sinned in this matter,) ¹⁴ Let rulers be appointed in all the multitude: and in all our cities, let them that have taken strange wives come at the times appointed, and with them the ancients and the judges of every city, until the wrath of our God be turned away from us for this sin.

¹⁵ Then Jonathan the son of Azahel, and Jaasia the son of Thecua were appointed over this, and Mesollam and Sebethai, Levites, helped them: ¹⁶ And the children of the captivity did so. And Esdras the priest, and the men heads of the families in the houses of their fathers, and all by their names, went and sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter. ¹⁷ And they made an end with all the men that had taken strange wives by the first day of the first month.

¹⁸ And there were found among the sons of the priests that had taken strange wives: Of the sons of Josue the son of Josedec, and his brethren, Maasia, and Eliezer, and Jarib, and Godolia. ¹⁹ And they gave their hands to put away their wives, and to offer for their offence a ram of the flock. ²⁰ And of the sons of Emmer, Hanani, and Zebedia. ²¹ And of the sons of Harim, Maasia, and Elia, and Semeia, and Jehiel, and Ozias. ²² And of the sons of Pheshur, Elioenai, Maasia, Ismael, Nathanael, Jozabed, and Elasa. ²³ And of the sons of the Levites, Jozabed, and Semei, and Celaia, the same is Calita, Phataia, Juda, and Eliezer. ²⁴ And of the singing men, Elisiab: and of the porters, Sellum, and Telem, and Uri. ²⁵ And of Israel, of the sons of Pharos, Remeia, and Jezia, and Melchia, and Miamin, and Eliezer, and Melchia, and Banea.

²⁶ And of the sons of Elam, Mathania, Zacharias, and Jehiel, and Abdi, and Jerimoth, and Elia. ²⁷ And of the sons of Zethua, Elioenai, Eliasib, Mathania, Jerimoth, and Zabad, and Aziaza. ²⁸ And of the sons of Babai, Johanan, Hanania, Zabbai, Athalai: ²⁹ And of the sons of Bani, Mosollam, and Melluch, and Adaia, Jasub, and Saal, and Ramoth. ³⁰ And of the sons of Phahath, Moab, Edna, and Chalal, Banaia, and Maasias, Mathanias, Beseleel, Bennui, and Manasse. ³¹ And of the sons of Herem, Eliezer, Josue, Melchias, Semeias, Simeon, ³² Benjamin, Maloch, Samarias. ³³ And of the sons of Hasom, Mathanai, Mathatha, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jermai, Manasse, Semei. ³⁴ Of the sons of Bani, Maaddi, Amram, and Uel, ³⁵ Baneas, and Badaias, Cheliau, ³⁶ Vania, Marimuth, and Eliasib, ³⁷ Mathanias, Mathania, and Jasi, ³⁸ And Bani, and Bennui, Semei, ³⁹ And Salmias, and Nathan, and Adaias, ⁴⁰ And Mechnedebai, Sisai, Sarai, ⁴¹ Ezrel, and Selemiau, Semeria, ⁴² Sellum, Amaria, Joseph. ⁴³ Of the sons of Nebo, Jehiel, Mathathias, Zabad, Zabina, Jeddu, and Joel, and Banaia. ⁴⁴ All these had taken strange wives, and there were among them women that had borne children.

241. Nehemias hears of the ruined walls

Nehemiah 1:1-11

Douay-Rheims title: the Book of Nehemias, which is called the Second of Esdras.

1 ¹ The words of Nehemias the son of Helchias. And it came to pass in the month of Casleu, in the twentieth year, as I was in the castle of Susa, ² That Hanani one of my brethren came, he and some men of Juda; and I asked them concerning the Jews, that remained and were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem. ³ And they said to me: They that have remained, and are left of the captivity there in the province, are in great affliction, and reproach: and the wall of Jerusalem is broken down, and the gates thereof are burnt with fire.

⁴ And when I had heard these words, I sat down, and wept, and mourned for many days: and I fasted, and prayed before the face of the God of heaven. ⁵ And I said: I beseech thee, O Lord God of heaven, strong, great, and terrible, who keepest covenant and mercy with those that love thee, and keep thy commandments: ⁶ Let thy ears be attentive, and thy eyes open, to hear the prayer of thy servant, which I pray before thee now, night and day, for the children of Israel thy servants: and I confess the sins of the children of Israel, by which they have sinned against thee: I and my father's house have sinned. ⁷ We have been seduced by vanity, and have not kept thy commandments, and ceremonies and judgments, which thou hast commanded thy servant Moses. ⁸ Remember the word that thou commandedst to Moses thy servant, saying: If you shall transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations: ⁹ But if you return to me, and keep my commandments, and do them, though you should be led away to the uttermost parts of the world, I will gather you from thence, and bring you back to the place which I have chosen for my name to dwell there. ¹⁰ And these are thy servants, and thy people: whom thou hast redeemed by thy great strength, and by thy mighty hand. ¹¹ I beseech thee, O Lord, let thy ear be attentive to the prayer of thy servant, and to the prayer of thy servants who desire to fear thy name: and direct thy servant this day, and give him mercy before this man. For I was the king's cupbearer.

242. The night ride, and the king's leave*Nehemiah 2:1-20*

Nehemias 3, the register of the builders, is omitted.

2 ¹ And it came to pass in the month of Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king: that wine was before him, and I took up the wine, and gave it to the king: and I was as one languishing away before his face. ² And the king said to me: Why is thy countenance sad, seeing thou dost not appear to be sick? this is not without cause, but some evil, I know not what, is in thy heart. And I was seized with an exceeding great fear: ³ And I said to the king: O king, live for ever: why should not my countenance be sorrowful, seeing the city of the place of the sepulchres of my fathers is desolate, and the gates thereof are burnt with fire? ⁴ Then the king said to me: For what dost thou make request? And I prayed to the God of heaven, ⁵ And I said to the king: If it seem good to the king, and if thy servant hath found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldst send me into Judea to the city of the sepulchre of my father, and I will build it. ⁶ And the king said to me, and the queen that sat by him: For how long shall thy journey be, and when wilt thou return? And it pleased the king, and he sent me: and I fixed him a time. ⁷ And I said to the king: If it seem good to the king, let him give me letters to the governors of the country beyond the river, that they convey me over, till I come into Judea: ⁸ And a letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, to give me timber that I may cover the gates of the tower of the house, and the walls of the city, and the house that I shall enter into. And the king gave me according to the good hand of my God with me.

⁹ And I came to the governors of the country beyond the river, and gave them the king's letters. And the king had sent with me captains of soldiers, and horsemen. ¹⁰ And Sanaballat the Horonite, and Tobias the servant, the Ammonite, heard it, and it grieved them exceedingly, that a man was come, who sought the prosperity of the children of Israel. ¹¹ And I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days. ¹² And I arose in the night, I and some few men with me, and I told not any man what God had put in my heart to do in Jerusalem, and there was no beast with me, but the beast that I rode upon. ¹³ And I went out by night by the gate of the valley, and before the dragon fountain, and to the dung gate, and I viewed the wall of Jerusalem which was broken down, and the gates thereof which were consumed with fire. ¹⁴ And I passed to the gate of the fountain, and to the king's aqueduct, and there was no place for the beast on which I rode to pass. ¹⁵ And I went up in the night by the torrent, and viewed the wall, and going back I came to the gate of the valley, and returned. ¹⁶ But the magistrates knew not whither I went, or what I did: neither had I as yet told any thing to the Jews, or to the priests, or to the nobles, or to the magistrates, or to the rest that did the work.

¹⁷ Then I said to them: You know the affliction wherein we are, because Jerusalem is desolate, and the gates thereof are consumed with fire: come, and let us build up the walls of Jerusalem, and let us be no longer a reproach. ¹⁸ And I shewed them how the hand of my God was good with me, and the king's words, which he had spoken to me, and I said: Let us rise up, and build. And their hands were strengthened in good. ¹⁹ But Sanaballat the Horonite, and Tobias the servant, the Ammonite, and Gossem

the Arabian heard of it, and they scoffed at us, and despised us, and said: What is this thing that you do? are you going to rebel against the king? ²⁰ And I answered them, and said to them: The God of heaven he helpeth us, and we are his servants: let us rise up and build: but you have no part, nor justice, nor remembrance in Jerusalem.

243. Sword and trowel; the usury of the nobles*Nehemiah 4:1-5:19*

4 ¹ And it came to pass, that when Sanaballat heard that we were building the wall he was angry: and being moved exceedingly he scoffed at the Jews. ² And said before his brethren, and the multitude of the Samaritans: What are the silly Jews doing? Will the Gentiles let them alone? will they sacrifice and make an end in a day? are they able to raise stones out of the heaps of the rubbish, which are burnt? ³ Tobias also the Ammonite who was by him said: Let them build: if a fox go up, he will leap over their stone wall. ⁴ Hear thou our God, for we are despised: turn their reproach upon their own head, and give them to be despised in a land of captivity. ⁵ Cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from before thy face, because they have mocked thy builders. ⁶ So we built the wall, and joined it all together unto the half thereof: and the heart of the people was excited to work.

⁷ And it came to pass, when Sanaballat, and Tobias, and the Arabians, and the Ammonites, and the Azotians heard that the walls of Jerusalem were made up, and the breaches began to be closed, that they were exceedingly angry. ⁸ And they all assembled themselves together, to come, and to fight against Jerusalem, and to prepare ambushes. ⁹ And we prayed to our God, and set watchmen upon the wall day and night against them. ¹⁰ And Juda said: The strength of the bearer of burdens is decayed, and the rubbish is very much, and we shall not be able to build the wall. ¹¹ And our enemies said: Let them not know, nor understand, till we come in the midst of them, and kill them, and cause the work to cease. ¹² And it came to pass, that when the Jews that dwelt by them came and told us ten times, out of all the places from whence they came to us,

¹³ I set the people in the place behind the wall round about in order, with their swords, and spears, and bows. ¹⁴ And I looked and rose up: and I said to the chief men and the magistrates, and to the rest of the common people: be not afraid of them. Remember the Lord who is great and terrible, and fight for your brethren, your sons, and your daughters, and your wives, and your houses. ¹⁵ And it came to pass, when our enemies heard that the thing had been told us, that God defeated their counsel. And we returned all of us to the walls, every man to his work. ¹⁶ And it came to pass from that day forward, that half of their young men did the work, and half were ready for to fight, with spears, and shields, and bows, and coats of mail, and the rulers were behind them in all the house of Juda. ¹⁷ Of them that built on the wall and that carried burdens, and that laded: with one of his hands he did the work, and with the other he held a sword. ¹⁸ For every one of the builders was girded with a sword about his reins. And they built, and sounded with a trumpet by me. ¹⁹ And I said to the nobles, and to the magistrates, and to the rest of the common people: The work is great and wide, and we are separated on the wall one far from another: ²⁰ In what place

soever you shall hear the sound of the trumpet, run all thither unto us: our God will fight for us.²¹ And let us do the work: and let one half of us hold our spears from the rising of the morning, till the stars appear.²² At that time also I said to the people: Let every one with his servant stay in the midst of Jerusalem, and let us take our turns in the night, and by day, to work.²³ Now I and my brethren, and my servants, and the watchmen that followed me, did not put off our clothes: only every man stripped himself when he was to be washed.

5 ¹ Now there was a great cry of the people, and of their wives against their brethren the Jews.² And there were some that said: Our sons and our daughters are very many: let us take up corn for the price of them, and let us eat and live.³ And there were some that said: Let us mortgage our lands, and our vineyards, and our houses, and let us take corn because of the famine.⁴ And others said: Let us borrow money for the king's tribute, and let us give up our fields and vineyards:⁵ And now our flesh is as the flesh of our brethren: and our children as their children. Behold we bring into bondage our sons and our daughters, and some of our daughters are bondwomen already, neither have we wherewith to redeem them, and our fields and our vineyards other men possess.

⁶ And I was exceedingly angry when I heard their cry according to these words.⁷ And my heart thought with myself: and I rebuked the nobles and magistrates, and said to them: Do you every one exact usury of your brethren? And I gathered together a great assembly against them,⁸ And I said to them: We, as you know, have redeemed according to our ability our brethren the Jews, that were sold to the Gentiles: and will you then sell your brethren, for us to redeem them? And they held their peace, and found not what to answer.⁹ And I said to them: The thing you do is not good: why walk you not in the fear of our God, that we be not exposed to the reproaches of the Gentiles our enemies?¹⁰ Both I and my brethren, and my servants, have lent money and corn to many: let us all agree not to call for it again; let us forgive the debt that is owing to us.¹¹ Restore ye to them this day their fields, and their vineyards, and their oliveyards, and their houses: and the hundredth part of the money, and of the corn, the wine, and the oil, which you were wont to exact of them, give it rather for them.¹² And they said: We will restore, and we will require nothing of them: and we will do as thou sayest. And I called the priests and took an oath of them, to do according to what I had said.¹³ Moreover I shook my lap, and said: So may God shake every man that shall not accomplish this word, out of his house, and out of his labours, thus may he be shaken out, and become empty. And all the multitude said: Amen. And they praised God. And the people did according to what was said.

¹⁴ And from the day, in which the king commanded me to be governor in the land of Juda, from the twentieth year even to the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes the king, for twelve years, I and my brethren did not eat the yearly allowance that was due to the governors.¹⁵ But the former governors that had been before me, were chargeable to the people, and took of them in bread, and wine, and in money every day forty sicles: and their officers also oppressed the people. But I did not so for the fear of God.¹⁶ Moreover I built in the work of the wall, and I

bought no land, and all my servants were gathered together to the work.¹⁷ The Jews also and the magistrates to the number of one hundred and fifty men, were at my table, besides them that came to us from among the nations that were round about us.¹⁸ And there was prepared for me day by day one ox, and six choice rams, besides fowls, and once in ten days I gave store of divers wines, and many other things: yet I did not require my yearly allowance as governor: for the people were very much impoverished.¹⁹ Remember me, O my God, for good according to all that I have done for this people.

244. The wall finished in fifty-two days

Nehemiah 6:1-19

Nehemias 7, the census of the returned, is omitted.

6 ¹ And it came to pass, when Sanaballat, and Tobias, and Gossem the Arabian, and the rest of our enemies, heard that I had built the wall, and that there was no breach left in it, (though at that time I had not set up the doors in the gates,) ² Sanaballat and Gossem sent to me, saying: Come, and let us make a league together in the villages, in the plain of Ono. But they thought to do me mischief.³ And I sent messengers to them, saying: I am doing a great work, and I cannot come down, lest it be neglected whilst I come, and go down to you.⁴ And they sent to me according to this word, four times: and I answered them after the same manner.⁵ And Sanaballat sent his servant to me the fifth time according to the former word, and he had a letter in his hand written in this manner: ⁶ It is reported amongst the Gentiles, and Gossem hath said it, that thou and the Jews think to rebel, and therefore thou buildest the wall, and hast a mind to set thyself king over them: for which end ⁷ Thou hast also set up prophets, to preach of thee at Jerusalem, saying: There is a king in Judea. The king will hear of these things: therefore come now, that we may take counsel together.⁸ And I sent to them, saying: There is no such thing done as thou sayest: but thou feignest these things out of thy own heart.⁹ For all these men thought to frighten us, thinking that our hands would cease from the work, and that we would leave off. Wherefore I strengthened my hands the more:

¹⁰ And I went into the house of Samaia the son of Delaia, the son of Metabeel privately. And he said: Let us consult together in the house of God in the midst of the temple: and let us shut the doors of the temple, for they will come to kill thee, and in the night they will come to slay thee.¹¹ And I said: Should such a man as I flee? and who is there that being as I am, would go into the temple, to save his life? I will not go in.¹² And I understood that God had not sent him, but that he had spoken to me as if he had been prophesying, and Tobias, and Sanaballat had hired him.¹³ For he had taken money, that I being afraid should do this thing, and sin, and they might have some evil to upbraid me withal.¹⁴ Remember me, O Lord, for Tobias and Sanaballat, according to their works of this kind: and Nodias the prophet, and the rest of the prophets that would have put me in fear.

¹⁵ But the wall was finished the five and twentieth day of the month of Elul, in two and fifty days.¹⁶ And it came to pass when all our enemies heard of it, that all nations which were round about us, were afraid, and were cast down within themselves, for they perceived that this work was the work of God.¹⁷ Moreover

in those days many letters were sent by the principal men of the Jews to Tobias, and from Tobias there came letters to them. ¹⁸ For there were many in Judea sworn to him, because he was the son in law of Sechenias the son of Area, and Johanan his son had taken to wife the daughter of Mosollam the son of Barachias. ¹⁹ And they praised him also before me, and they related my words to him: And Tobias sent letters to put me in fear.

245. Esdras reads the law

Nehemiah 8:1-18

"The joy of the Lord is our strength." The people hear the law they had lost, and the restored community is constituted around it.

8 ¹ And the seventh month came: and the children of Israel were in their cities. And all the people were gathered together as one man to the street which is before the water gate, and they spoke to Esdras the scribe, to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the Lord had commanded to Israel. ² Then Esdras the priest brought the law before the multitude of men and women, and all those that could understand, in the first day of the seventh month. ³ And he read it plainly in the street that was before the water gate, from the morning until midday, before the men, and the women, and all those that could understand: and the ears of all the people were attentive to the book. ⁴ And Esdras the scribe stood upon a step of wood, which he had made to speak upon, and there stood by him Mathathias, and Semeia, and Ania, and Uriah, and Helcia, and Maasia, on his right hand: and on the left, Phadaia, Misael, and Melchia, and Hasum, and Hasbadana, Zacharia and Mosollam. ⁵ And Esdras opened the book before all the people: for he was above all the people: and when he had opened it, all the people stood. ⁶ And Esdras blessed the Lord the great God: and all the people answered, Amen, amen: lifting up their hands: and they bowed down, and adored God with their faces to the ground. ⁷ Now Josue, and Bani, and Serebia, Jamin, Accub, Sephtai, Odia, Maasia, Celtia, Azarias, Jozabed, Hanan, Phalaia, the Levites, made silence among the people to hear the law: and the people stood in their place. ⁸ And they read in the book of the law of God distinctly and plainly to be understood: and they understood when it was read.

⁹ And Nehemias (he is Athersatha) and Esdras the priest and scribe, and the Levites who interpreted to all the people, said: This is a holy day to the Lord our God: do not mourn, nor weep: for all the people wept, when they heard the words of the law. ¹⁰ And he said to them: Go, eat fat meats, and drink sweet wine, and send portions to them that have not prepared for themselves: because it is the holy day of the Lord, and be not sad: for the joy of the Lord is our strength. ¹¹ And the Levites stilled all the people, saying: Hold your peace, for the day is holy, and be not sorrowful. ¹² So all the people went to eat and drink, and to send portions, and to make great mirth: because they understood the words that he had taught them.

¹³ And on the second day the chiefs of the families of all the people, the priests, and the Levites were gathered together to Esdras the scribe, that he should interpret to them the words of the law. ¹⁴ And they found written in the law, that the Lord had commanded by the hand of Moses, that the children of Israel should dwell in tabernacles, on the feast, in the seventh month:

¹⁵ And that they should proclaim and publish the word in all their cities, and in Jerusalem, saying: Go forth to the mount, and fetch branches of olive, and branches of beautiful wood, branches of myrtle, and branches of palm, and branches of thick trees, to make tabernacles, as it is written.

¹⁶ And the people went forth, and brought. And they made themselves tabernacles every man on the top of his house, and in their courts, and in the courts of the house of God, and in the street of the water gate, and in the street of the gate of Ephraim. ¹⁷ And all the assembly of them that were returned from the captivity, made tabernacles, and dwelt in tabernacles: for since the days of Josue the son of Nun the children of Israel had not done so, until that day: and there was exceeding great joy. ¹⁸ And he read in the book of the law of God day by day, from the first day till the last, and they kept the solemnity seven days, and in the eighth day a solemn assembly according to the manner.

246. The great confession

Nehemiah 9:1-38

The whole of salvation history to this point, recited by the people themselves - the nearest thing in scripture to this plan's own table of contents.

9 ¹ And in the four and twentieth day of the month the children of Israel came together with fasting and with sackcloth, and earth upon them. ² And the seed of the children of Israel separated themselves from every stranger: and they stood, and confessed their sins, and the iniquities of their fathers. ³ And they rose up to stand: and they read in the book of the law of the Lord their God, four times in the day, and four times they confessed, and adored the Lord their God. ⁴ And there stood up upon the step of the Levites, Josue, and Bani, and Cedmihel, Sabania, Bonni, Sarebias, Bani, and Chanani: and they cried with a loud voice to the Lord their God. ⁵ And the Levites Josue and Cedmihel, Bonni, Hasebnia, Serebia, Oduia, Sebnia, and Phathahia, said: Arise, bless the Lord your God from eternity to eternity: and blessed be the high name of thy glory with all blessing and praise. ⁶ Thou thyself, O Lord alone, thou hast made heaven, and the heaven of heavens, and all the host thereof: the earth and all things that are in it: the seas and all that are therein: and thou givest life to all these things, and the host of heaven adoreth thee. ⁷ Thou O Lord God, art he who chocest Abram, and broughtest him forth out of the fire of the Chaldeans, and gavest him the name of Abraham. ⁸ And thou didst find his heart faithful before thee: and thou madest a covenant with him, to give him the land of the Chanaanite, of the Hethite, and of the Amorrite, and of the Pherezite, and of the Jebusite, and of the Gergezite, to give it to his seed: and thou hast fulfilled thy words, because thou art just. ⁹ And thou sawest the affliction of our fathers in Egypt: and thou didst hear their cry by the Red Sea. ¹⁰ And thou shewedst signs and wonders upon Pharaoh, and upon all his servants, and upon the people of his land: for thou knewest that they dealt proudly against them: and thou madest thyself a name, as it is at this day. ¹¹ And thou didst divide the sea before them, and they passed through the midst of the sea on dry land: but their persecutors thou threwest into the depth, as a stone into mighty waters. ¹² And in a pillar of a cloud thou wast their leader by day, and in a pillar of fire by night, that they might see the way

by which they went. ¹³ Thou camest down also to mount Sinai, and didst speak with them from heaven, and thou gavest them right judgments, and the law of truth, ceremonies, and good precepts. ¹⁴ Thou madest known to them thy holy sabbath, and didst prescribe to them commandments, and ceremonies, and the law by the hand of Moses thy servant. ¹⁵ And thou gavest them bread from heaven in their hunger, and broughtest forth water for them out of the rock in their thirst, and thou saidst to them that they should go in, and possess the land, upon which thou hadst lifted up thy hand to give it them. ¹⁶ But they and our fathers dealt proudly, and hardened their necks and hearkened not to thy commandments. ¹⁷ And they would not hear, and they remembered not thy wonders which thou hadst done for them. And they hardened their necks, and gave the head to return to their bondage, as it were by contention. But thou, a forgiving God, gracious, and merciful, longsuffering, and full of compassion, didst not forsake them. ¹⁸ Yea when they had made also to themselves a molten calf, and had said: This is thy God, that brought thee out of Egypt: and had committed great blasphemies: ¹⁹ Yet thou, in thy many mercies, didst not leave them in the desert: the pillar of the cloud departed not from them by day to lead them in the way, and the pillar of fire by night to shew them the way by which they should go. ²⁰ And thou gavest them thy good Spirit to teach them, and thy manna thou didst not withhold from their mouth, and thou gavest them water for their thirst. ²¹ Forty years didst thou feed them in the desert, and nothing was wanting to them: their garments did not grow old, and their feet were not worn. ²² And thou gavest them kingdoms, and nations, and didst divide lots for them: and they possessed the land of Sehon, and the land of the king of Hesebon, and the land of Og king of Basan. ²³ And thou didst multiply their children as the stars of heaven, and broughtest them to the land concerning which thou hadst said to their fathers, that they should go in and possess it. ²⁴ And the children came and possessed the land, and thou didst humble before them the inhabitants of the land, the Chanaanites, and gavest them into their hands, with their kings, and the people of the land, that they might do with them as it pleased them. ²⁵ And they took strong cities and a fat land, and possessed houses full of all goods: cisterns made by others, vineyards, and oliveyards, and fruit trees in abundance: and they ate, and were filled, and became fat, and abounded with delight in thy great goodness. ²⁶ But they provoked thee to wrath, and departed from thee, and threw thy law behind their backs: and they killed thy prophets, who admonished them earnestly to return to thee: and they were guilty of great blasphemies. ²⁷ And thou gavest them into the hands of their enemies, and they afflicted them. And in the time of their tribulation they cried to thee, and thou heardest from heaven, and according to the multitude of thy tender mercies thou gavest them saviours, to save them from the hands of their enemies. ²⁸ But after they had rest, they returned to do evil in thy sight: and thou leftest them in the hand of their enemies, and they had dominion over them. Then they returned, and cried to thee: and thou heardest from heaven, and deliveredst them many times in thy mercies. ²⁹ And thou didst admonish them to return to thy law. But they dealt proudly, and hearkened not to thy commandments, but sinned against

thy judgments, which if a man do, he shall live in them: and they withdrew the shoulder, and hardened their neck, and would not hear. ³⁰ And thou didst forbear with them for many years, and didst testify against them by thy spirit by the hand of thy prophets: and they heard not, and thou didst deliver them into the hand of the people of the lands. ³¹ Yet in thy very many mercies thou didst not utterly consume them, nor forsake them: because thou art a merciful and gracious God. ³² Now therefore our God, great, strong, and terrible, who keepest covenant and mercy, turn not away from thy face all the labour which hath come upon us, upon our kings, and our princes, and our priests, and our prophets, and our fathers, and all the people from the days of the king of Assur, until this day. ³³ And thou art just in all things that have come upon us: because thou hast done truth, but we have done wickedly. ³⁴ Our kings, our princes, our priests, and our fathers have not kept thy law, and have not minded thy commandments, and thy testimonies which thou hast testified among them. ³⁵ And they have not served thee in their kingdoms, and in thy manifold goodness, which thou gavest them, and in the large and fat land, which thou deliveredst before them, nor did they return from their most wicked devices. ³⁶ Behold we ourselves this day are bondmen: and the land, which thou gavest our fathers, to eat the bread thereof, and the good things thereof, and we ourselves are servants in it. ³⁷ And the fruits thereof grow up for the kings, whom thou hast set over us for our sins, and they have dominion over our bodies, and over our beasts, according to their will, and we are in great tribulation. ³⁸ And because of all this we ourselves make a covenant, and write it, and our princes, our Levites, and our priests sign it.

247. The covenant subscribed; Jerusalem repeople

Nehemiah 10:1-11:36

10 ¹ And the subscribers were Nehemias, Athersatha the son of Hachelai, and Sedecias, ² Saraia, Azarias, Jeremias, ³ Pheshur, Amarias, Melchias, ⁴ Hattus, Sebenia, Melluch, ⁵ Harem, Merimuth, Obdias, ⁶ Daniel, Genthon, Baruch, ⁷ Mosollam, Abia, Miamin, ⁸ Maazia, Belgia, Semeia: these were priests. ⁹ And the Levites, Josue the son of Azanias, Bennui of the sons of Henadad, Cedmihel, ¹⁰ And their brethren, Sebenia, Oduia, Celita, Phalaia, Hanan, ¹¹ Micha, Rohob, Hasebia, ¹² Zachur, Serebia, Sabania, ¹³ Odaia, Bani, Baninu. ¹⁴ The heads of the people, Pharos, Phahath Moab, Elam, Zethu, Bani, ¹⁵ Bonni, Azgad, Bebai, ¹⁶ Adonia, Begoai, Adin, ¹⁷ Ater, Hezecia, Azur, ¹⁸ Odaia, Hasum, Besai, ¹⁹ Hareph, Anathoth, Nebai, ²⁰ Megphias, Mosollam, Hazir, ²¹ Mesizabel, Sadoc, Jeddua, ²² Pheltia, Hanan, Anaia, ²³ Osee, Hanania, Hasub, ²⁴ Alohes, Phalea, Sobec, ²⁵ Rehum, Hasebna, Maasia, ²⁶ Echaia, Hanan, Anan, ²⁷ Melluch, Haran, Baana:

²⁸ And the rest of the people, priests, Levites, porters, and singing men, Nathinites, and all that had separated themselves from the people of the lands to the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters. ²⁹ All that could understand, promising for their brethren, with their chief men, and they came to promise, and swear that they would walk in the law of God, which he gave in the hand of Moses the servant of God, that they would do and keep all the commandments of the Lord our God, and his judgments and his ceremonies. ³⁰ And that we would not give our daughters to the people of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons. ³¹ And if the people of the land

bring in things to sell, or any things for use, to sell them on the sabbath day, that we would not buy them on the sabbath, or on the holy day. And that we would leave the seventh year, and the exaction of every hand.

³² And we made ordinances for ourselves, to give the third part of a sicle every year for the work of the house of our God, ³³ For the loaves of proposition, and for the continual sacrifice, and for a continual holocaust on the sabbaths, on the new moons, on the set feasts, and for the holy things, and for the sin offering: that atonement might be made for Israel, and for every use of the house of our God. ³⁴ And we cast lots among the priests, and the Levites, and the people for the offering of wood, that it might be brought into the house of our God by the houses of our fathers at set times, from year to year: to burn upon the altar of the Lord our God, as it is written in the law of Moses: ³⁵ And that we would bring the firstfruits of our land, and the firstfruits of all fruit of every tree, from year to year, in the house of our Lord. ³⁶ And the firstborn of our sons, and of our cattle, as it is written in the law, and the firstlings of our oxen, and of our sheep, to be offered in the house of our God, to the priests who minister in the house of our God. ³⁷ And that we would bring the firstfruits of our meats, and of our libations, and the fruit of every tree, of the vintage also and of oil to the priests, to the storehouse of our God, and the tithes of our ground to the Levites. The Levites also shall receive the tithes of our works out of all the cities. ³⁸ And the priest the son of Aaron shall be with the Levites in the tithes of the Levites, and the Levites shall offer the tithe of their tithes in the house of our God, to the storeroom into the treasure house. ³⁹ For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall carry to the treasury the firstfruits of corn, of wine, and of oil: and the sanctified vessels shall be there, and the priests, and the singing men, and the porters, and ministers, and we will not forsake the house of our God.

11 ¹ And the princes of the people dwelt at Jerusalem: but the rest of the people cast lots, to take one part in ten to dwell in Jerusalem the holy city, and nine parts in the other cities. ² And the people blessed all the men that willingly offered themselves to dwell in Jerusalem.

³ These therefore are the chief men of the province, who dwelt in Jerusalem, and in the cities of Juda. And every one dwelt in his possession, in their cities: Israel, the priests, the Levites, the Nathinites, and the children of the servants of Solomon. ⁴ And in Jerusalem there dwelt some of the children of Juda, and some of the children of Benjamin: of the children of Juda, Athaias the son of Aziam, the son of Zacharias, the son of Amarias, the son of Saphatias, the son of Malaleel: of the sons of Phares, ⁵ Maasia the son of Baruch, the son of Cholhoza, the son of Hazia, the son of Adaia, the son of Joiarib, the son of Zacharias, the son of the Silonite: ⁶ All these the sons of Phares, who dwelt in Jerusalem, were four hundred sixty-eight valiant men. ⁷ And these are the children of Benjamin: Sellum the son of Mosollam, the son of Joed, the son of Phadaia, the son of Colaia, the son of Masia, the son of Etheel, the son of Isaia. ⁸ And after him Gebbai, Sellai, nine hundred twenty-eight. ⁹ And Joel the son of Zechri their ruler, and Judas the son of Senua was second over the city. ¹⁰ And of the priests Idaia the son of Joarib, Jachin, ¹¹ Saraia the son of Helcias, the son of Mosollam, the son of Sadoc, the son of

Meraioth, the son of Achitob the prince of the house of God, ¹² And their brethren that do the works of the temple: eight hundred twenty-two. And Adaia the son of Jeroham, the son of Phelelia, the son of Amsi, the son of Zacharias, the son of Pheshur, the son of Melchias, ¹³ And his brethren the chiefs of the fathers: two hundred forty-two. And Amassai the son of Azreel, the son of Ahazi, the son of Mosollamoth, the son of Emmer, ¹⁴ And their brethren who were very mighty, a hundred twenty-eight: and their ruler Zabdiel son of the mighty. ¹⁵ And of the Levites Semeia the son of Hasub, the son of Azaricam, the son of Hasabia, the son of Boni, ¹⁶ And Sabathai and Jozabed, who were over all the outward business of the house of God, of the princes of the Levites, ¹⁷ And Mathania the son of Micha, the son of Zebedei, the son of Asaph, was the principal man to praise, and to give glory in prayer, and Becbecia, the second, one of his brethren, and Abda the son of Samua, the son of Galal, the son of Idithun. ¹⁸ All the Levites in the holy city were two hundred eighty-four. ¹⁹ And the porters, Accub, Telmon, and their brethren, who kept the doors: a hundred seventy-two. ²⁰ And the rest of Israel, the priests and the Levites were in all the cities of Juda, every man in his possession. ²¹ And the Nathinites, that dwelt in Ophel, and Siaha, and Gaspha of the Nathinites. ²² And the overseer of the Levites in Jerusalem, was Azzi the son of Bani, the son of Hasabia, the son of Mathania, the son of Micha. Of the sons of Asaph, were the singing men in the ministry of the house of God. ²³ For the king's commandment was concerning them, and an order among the singing men day by day. ²⁴ And Phathahia the son of Mesezebel of the children of Zara the son of Juda was at the hand of the king, in all matters concerning the people, ²⁵ And in the houses through all their countries. Of the children of Juda some dwelt at Cariath-Arbe, and in the villages thereof: and at Dibon, and in the villages thereof: and at Cabseel, and in the villages thereof. ²⁶ And at Jesue, and at Molada, and at Bethphaleth, ²⁷ And at Hasersual, and at Bersabee, and in the villages thereof, ²⁸ And at Siceleg, and at Mochona, and in the villages thereof, ²⁹ And at Remmon, and at Saraa, and at Jerimuth, ³⁰ Zanoa, Odollam, and in their villages, at Lachis and its dependencies, and at Azeca and the villages thereof. And they dwelt from Bersabee unto the valley of Ennom. ³¹ And the children of Benjamin, from Geba, at Mechmas, and at Hai, and at Bethel, and in the villages thereof, ³² At Anathoth, Nob, Anania, ³³ Asor, Rama, Gethaim, ³⁴ Hadid, Seboim, and Neballat, Lod, ³⁵ And Ono the valley of craftsmen. ³⁶ And of the Levites were portions of Juda and Benjamin.

248. The dedication of the wall

Nehemiah 12:1-46

12 ¹ Now these are the priests and the Levites, that went up with Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and Josue: Saraia, Jeremias, Esdras, ² Amaria, Melluch, Hattus, ³ Sebenias, Rheum, Merimuth, ⁴ Addo, Genthon, Abia, ⁵ Miamin, Madia, Belga, ⁶ Semeia, and Joiarib, Idaia, Sellum Amoc, Helcias, ⁷ Idaia. These were the chief of the priests, and of their brethren in the days of Josue. ⁸ And the Levites, Jesua, Bennui, Cedmihel, Sarebia, Juda, Mathanias, they and their brethren were over the hymns: ⁹ And Becbecia, and Hanni, and their brethren every one in his office. ¹⁰ And Josue begot Joacim, and Joacim begot Eliasib, and Eliasib begot Joiada, ¹¹ And Joiada begot Jonathan and Jonathan begot Jeddoa. ¹² And

in the days of Joacim the priests and heads of the families were: Of Saraia, Maraia: of Jeremias, Hanania: ¹³ Of Esdras, Mosollam: and of Amaria, Johanan: ¹⁴ Of Milicho, Jonathan: of Sebenia, Joseph: ¹⁵ Of Haram, Edna: of Maraioth, Helci: ¹⁶ Of Adaia, Zacharia: of Genthon, Mosollam: ¹⁷ Of Abia, Zechri: of Miamin and Moadia, Phelti: ¹⁸ Of Belga, Sammua of Semaia, Jonathan: ¹⁹ Of Joiarib, Mathanai: of Jodaia, Azzi: ²⁰ Of Sellai, Celai: of Amoc, Heber: ²¹ Of Helcias, Hasebia: of Idaia, Nathanael.

²² The Levites the chiefs of the families in the days of Eliasib, and Joiada, and Johanan, and Jeddoa, were recorded, and the priests in the reign of Darius the Persian. ²³ The sons of Levi, heads of the families were written in the book of Chronicles, even unto the days of Jonathan the son of Eliasib. ²⁴ Now the chief of the Levites were Hasebia, Serebia, and Josue the son of Cedmihel: and their brethren by their courses, to praise and to give thanks according to the commandment of David the man of God, and to wait equally in order. ²⁵ Mathania, and Becbecia, Obedia, and Mosollam, Telmon, Accub, were keepers of the gates and of the entrances before the gates. ²⁶ These were in the days of Joacim the son of Josue, the son of Josedec, and in the days of Nehemias the governor, and of Esdras the priest and scribe.

²⁷ And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites out of all their places, to bring them to Jerusalem, and to keep the dedication, and to rejoice with thanksgiving, and with singing, and with cymbals, and psalteries and harps. ²⁸ And the sons of the singing men were gathered together out of the plain country about Jerusalem, and out of the villages of Nethuphati, ²⁹ And from the house of Galgal, and from the countries of Geba and Azmaveth: for the singing men had built themselves villages round about Jerusalem. ³⁰ And the priests and the Levites were purified, and they purified the people, and the gates, and the wall. ³¹ And I made the princes of Juda go up upon the wall, and I appointed two great choirs to give praise. And they went on the right hand upon the wall toward the dung gate. ³² And after them went Osaia, and half of the princes of Juda, ³³ And Azarias, Esdras, and Mosollam, Judas, and Benjamin, and Semeia, and Jeremias. ³⁴ And of the sons of the priests with trumpets, Zacharias the son of Jonathan, the son of Semeia, the son of Mathania, the son of Michaia, the son of Zechur, the son of Asaph, ³⁵ And his brethren Semeia, and Azareel, Malalai, Galalai, Maai, Nathanael, and Judas, and Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God: and Esdras the scribe before them at the fountain gate. ³⁶ And they went up over against them by the stairs of the city of David, at the going up of the wall of the house of David, and to the water gate eastward: ³⁷ And the second choir of them that gave thanks went on the opposite side, and I after them, and the half of the people upon the wall, and upon the tower of the furnaces, even to the broad wall, ³⁸ And above the gate of Ephraim, and above the old gate, and above the fish gate and the tower of Hananeel, and the tower of Emath, and even to the flock gate: and they stood still in the watch gate. ³⁹ And the two choirs of them that gave praise stood still at the house of God, and I and the half of the magistrates with me. ⁴⁰ And the priests, Eliachim, Maasia, Miamin, Michea, Elioenai, Zacharia, Hanania with trumpets, ⁴¹ And Maasia, and Semeia, and Eleazar, and Azzi, and Johanan, and Melchia, and Elam, and Ezer. And the singers sung loud, and Jezraia was their overseer: ⁴² And they

sacrificed on that day great sacrifices, and they rejoiced: for God had made them joyful with great joy: their wives also and their children rejoiced, and the joy of Jerusalem was heard afar off. ⁴³ They appointed also in that day men over the storehouses of the treasure, for the libations, and for the firstfruits, and for the tithes, that the rulers of the city might bring them in by them in honour of thanksgiving, for the priests and Levites: for Juda was joyful in the priests and Levites that assisted.

⁴⁴ And they kept the watch of their God, and the observance of expiation, and the singing men, and the porters, according to the commandment of David, and of Solomon his son. ⁴⁵ For in the days of David and Asaph from the beginning there were chief singers appointed, to praise with canticles, and give thanks to God. ⁴⁶ And all Israel, in the days of Zorobabel, and in the days of Nehemias gave portions to the singing men, and to the porters, day by day, and they sanctified the Levites, and the Levites sanctified the sons of Aaron.

249. The last reforms of Nehemias

Nehemiah 13:1-31

Aggeus, Zacharias and Malachias belong to this period and are not read.

13 ¹ And on that day they read in the book of Moses in the hearing of the people: and therein was found written, that the Ammonites and the Moabites should not come in to the church of God for ever: ² Because they met not the children of Israel with bread and water: and they hired against them Balaam, to curse them, and our God turned the curse into blessing. ³ And it came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated every stranger from Israel.

⁴ And over this thing was Eliasib the priest, who was set over the treasury of the house of our God, and was near akin to Tobias. ⁵ And he made him a great storeroom, where before him they laid up gifts, and frankincense, and vessels, and the tithes of the corn, of the wine, and of the oil, the portions of the Levites, and of the singing men, and of the porters, and the firstfruits of the priests. ⁶ But in all this time I was not in Jerusalem, because in the two and thirtieth year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon, I went to the king, and after certain days I asked the king: ⁷ And I came to Jerusalem, and I understood the evil that Eliasib had done for Tobias, to make him a storehouse in the courts of the house of God. ⁸ And it seemed to me exceeding evil. And I cast forth the vessels of the house of Tobias out of the storehouse. ⁹ And I commanded and they cleansed the storehouses: and I brought thither again the vessels of the house of God, the sacrifice, and the frankincense.

¹⁰ And I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them: and that the Levites, and the singing men, and they that ministered were fled away every man to his own country: ¹¹ And I pleaded the matter against the magistrates, and said: Why have we forsaken the house of God? And I gathered them together, and I made them to stand in their places. ¹² And all Juda brought the tithe of the corn, and the wine, and the oil into the storehouses. ¹³ And we set over the storehouses Selemias the priest, and Sadoc the scribe, and of the Levites Phadaia, and next to them Hanan the son of Zachur, the son of Mathania: for they were approved as faithful, and to them were committed

the portions of their brethren. ¹⁴ Remember me, O my God, for this thing, and wipe not out my kindnesses, which I have done relating to the house of my God and his ceremonies.

¹⁵ In those days I saw in Juda some treading the presses on the sabbath, and carrying sheaves, and lading asses with wine, and grapes, and figs, and all manner of burthens, and bringing them into Jerusalem on the sabbath day. And I charged them that they should sell on a day on which it was lawful to sell. ¹⁶ Some Tyrians also dwelt there, who brought fish, and all manner of wares: and they sold them on the sabbaths to the children of Juda in Jerusalem. ¹⁷ And I rebuked the chief men of Juda, and said to them: What is this evil thing that you are doing, profaning the sabbath day: ¹⁸ Did not our fathers do these things, and our God brought all this evil upon us, and upon this city? And you bring more wrath upon Israel by violating the sabbath. ¹⁹ And it came to pass, that when the gates of Jerusalem were at rest on the sabbath day, I spoke: and they shut the gates, and I commanded that they should not open them till after the sabbath: and I set some of my servants at the gates, that none should bring in burthens on the sabbath day. ²⁰ So the merchants, and they that sold all kinds of wares, stayed without Jerusalem, once or twice. ²¹ And I charged them, and I said to them: Why stay you before the wall? if you do so another time, I will lay hands on you. And from that time they came no more on the sabbath. ²² I spoke also to the Levites that they should be purified, and should come to keep the gates, and to sanctify the sabbath day: for this also remember me, O my God, and spare me according to the multitude of thy tender mercies.

²³ In those days also I saw Jews that married wives, women of Azotus, and of Ammon, and of Moab. ²⁴ And their children spoke half in the speech of Azotus, and could not speak the Jews' language, but they spoke according to the language of this and that people. ²⁵ And I chid them, and laid my curse upon them. And I beat some of them, and shaved off their hair, and made them swear by God that they would not give their daughters to their sons, nor take their daughters for their sons, nor for themselves, saying: ²⁶ Did not Solomon king of Israel sin in this kind of thing: and surely among many nations, there was not a king like him, and he was beloved of his God, and God made him king over all Israel: and yet women of other countries brought even him to sin. ²⁷ And shall we also be disobedient and do all this great evil to transgress against our God, and marry strange women: ²⁸ And one of the sons of Joiada the son of Eliasib the high priest, was son in law to Sanaballat the Horonite, and I drove him from me. ²⁹ Remember them, O Lord my God, that defile the priesthood, and the law of priests and Levites. ³⁰ So I separated from them all strangers, and I appointed the courses of the priests and the Levites, every man in his ministry: ³¹ And for the offering of wood at times appointed, and for the firstfruits: remember me, O my God, unto good. Amen.

250. *Vasthi deposed; Esther made queen*

Esther 1:1-2:23

1 ¹ In the days of Assuerus, who reigned from India to Ethiopia over a hundred and twenty seven provinces: ² When he sat on the throne of his kingdom, the city Susan was the capital of his kingdom. ³ Now in the third year of his reign he made a great feast for all the princes, and for his servants, for the most mighty

of the Persians, and the nobles of the Medes, and the governors of the provinces in his sight, ⁴ That he might shew the riches of the glory of his kingdom, and the greatness, and boasting of his power, for a long time, to wit, for a hundred and fourscore days. ⁵ And when the days of the feast were expired, he invited all the people that were found in Susan, from the greatest to the least: and commanded a feast to be made seven days in the court of the garden, and of the wood, which was planted by the care and the hand of the king. ⁶ And there were hung up on every side sky coloured, and green, and violet hangings, fastened with cords of silk, and of purple, which were put into rings of ivory, and were held up with marble pillars. The beds also were of gold and silver, placed in order upon a floor paved with porphyry and white marble: which was embellished with painting of wonderful variety. ⁷ And they that were invited, drank in golden cups, and the meats were brought in divers vessels one after another. Wine also in abundance and of the best was presented, as was worthy of a king's magnificence. ⁸ Neither was there any one to compel them to drink that were not willing, but as the king had appointed, who set over every table one of his nobles, that every man might take what he would. ⁹ Also Vasthi the queen made a feast for the women in the palace, where king Assuerus was used to dwell. ¹⁰ Now on the seventh day, when the king was merry, and after very much drinking was well warmed with wine, he commanded Mauman, and Bazatha, and Harbona, and Bagatha, and Abgatha, and Zethar, and Charcas, the seven eunuchs that served in his presence, ¹¹ To bring in queen Vasthi before the king, with the crown set upon her head, to shew her beauty to all the people and the princes: for she was exceeding beautiful. ¹² But she refused, and would not come at the king's commandment, which he had signified to her by the eunuchs. Whereupon the king, being angry, and inflamed with a very great fury, ¹³ Asked the wise men, who according to the custom of the kings, were always near his person, and all he did was by their counsel, who knew the laws, and judgments of their forefathers: ¹⁴ (Now the chief and nearest him were, Charsena, and Sethar, and Admatha, and Tharsis, and Mares, and Marsana, and Mamuchan, seven princes of the Persians and of the Medes, who saw the face of the king, and were used to sit first after him:) ¹⁵ What sentence ought to pass upon Vasthi the queen, who had refused to obey the commandment of king Assuerus, which he had sent to her by the eunuchs? ¹⁶ And Mamuchan answered, in the hearing of the king and the princes: Queen Vasthi hath not only injured the king, but also all the people and princes that are in all the provinces of king Assuerus. ¹⁷ For this deed of the queen will go abroad to all women, so that they will despise their husbands, and will say: King Assuerus commanded that queen Vasthi should come in to him, and she would not. ¹⁸ And by this example all the wives of the princes of the Persians and the Medes will slight the commandments of their husbands: wherefore the king's indignation is just. ¹⁹ If it please thee, let an edict go out from thy presence, and let it be written according to the law of the Persians and of the Medes, which must not be altered, that Vasthi come in no more to the king, but another, that is better than her, be made queen in her place. ²⁰ And let this be published through all the provinces of thy empire, (which is very wide,) and let all wives, as well of the greater as of the

lesser, give honour to their husbands. ²¹ His counsel pleased the king, and the princes: and the king did according to the counsel of Mamuchan. ²² And he sent letters to all the provinces of his kingdom, as every nation could hear and read, in divers languages and characters, that the husbands should be rulers and masters in their houses: and that this should be published to every people.

2 ¹ After this, when the wrath of king Assuerus was appeased, he remembered Vasthi, and what she had done and what she had suffered: ² And the king's servants and his officers said: Let young women be sought for the king, virgins and beautiful, ³ And let some persons be sent through all the provinces to look for beautiful maidens and virgins: and let them bring them to the city of Susan, and put them into the house of the women under the hand of Egeus the eunuch, who is the overseer and keeper of the king's women: and let them receive women's ornaments, and other things necessary for their use. ⁴ And whosoever among them all shall please the king's eyes, let her be queen instead of Vasthi. The word pleased the king: and he commanded it should be done as they had suggested.

⁵ There was a man in the city of Susan, a Jew, named Mardochai, the son of Jair, the son of Semei, the son of Cis, of the race of Jemini, ⁶ Who had been carried away from Jerusalem at the time that Nabuchodonosor king of Babylon carried away Jeconias king of Juda, ⁷ And he had brought up his brother's daughter Edissa, who by another name was called Esther: now she had lost both her parents: and was exceeding fair and beautiful. And her father and mother being dead, Mardochai adopted her for his daughter. ⁸ And when the king's ordinance was noised abroad, and according to his commandment many beautiful virgins were brought to Susan, and were delivered to Egeus the eunuch: Esther also among the rest of the maidens was delivered to him to be kept in the number of the women. ⁹ And she pleased him, and found favour in his sight. And he commanded the eunuch to hasten the women's ornaments, and to deliver to her her part, and seven of the most beautiful maidens of the king's house, and to adorn and deck out both her and her waiting maids. ¹⁰ And she would not tell him her people nor her country. For Mardochai had charged her to say nothing at all of that: ¹¹ And he walked every day before the court of the house, in which the chosen virgins were kept, having a care for Esther's welfare, and desiring to know what would befall her.

¹² Now when every virgin's turn came to go in to the king, after all had been done for setting them off to advantage, it was the twelfth month: so that for six months they were anointed with oil of myrrh, and for other six months they used certain perfumes and sweet spices. ¹³ And when they were going in to the king, whatsoever they asked to adorn themselves they received: and being decked out, as it pleased them, they passed from the chamber of the women to the king's chamber. ¹⁴ And she that went in at evening, came out in the morning, and from thence she was conducted to the second house, that was under the hand of Susagaz the eunuch, who had the charge over the king's concubines: neither could she return any more to the king, unless the king desired it, and had ordered her by name to come. ¹⁵ And as the time came orderly about, the day was at hand, when Esther, the daughter of Abihail the brother of Mardochai,

whom he had adopted for his daughter, was to go in to the king. But she sought not women's ornaments, but whatsoever Egeus the eunuch the keeper of the virgins had a mind, he gave her to adorn her. For she was exceeding fair, and her incredible beauty made her appear agreeable and amiable in the eyes of all. ¹⁶ So she was brought to the chamber of king Assuerus the tenth month, which is called Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign. ¹⁷ And the king loved her more than all the women, and she had favour and kindness before him above all the women, and he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vasthi. ¹⁸ And he commanded a magnificent feast to be prepared for all the princes, and for his servants, for the marriage and wedding of Esther, And he gave rest to all the provinces, and bestowed gifts according to princely magnificence. ¹⁹ And when the virgins were sought the second time, and gathered together, Mardochai stayed at the king's gate, ²⁰ Neither had Esther as yet declared her country and people, according to his commandment. For whatsoever he commanded, Esther observed: and she did all things in the same manner as she was wont at that time when he brought her up a little one.

²¹ At that time, therefore, when Mardochai abode at the king's gate, Bagathan and Thares, two of the king's eunuchs, who were porters, and presided in the first entry of the palace, were angry: and they designed to rise up against the king, and to kill him. ²² And Mardochai had notice of it, and immediately he told it to queen Esther: and she to the king in Mardochai's name, who had reported the thing unto her. ²³ It was inquired into, and found out: and they were both hanged on a gibbet. And it was put in the histories, and recorded in the chronicles before the king.

251. The decree of Aman; "who knoweth whether thou art come for such a time"

Esther 3:1-4:17

3 ¹ After these things, king Assuerus advanced Aman, the son of Amadathi, who was of the race of Agag: and he set his throne above all the princes that were with him. ² And all the king's servants, that were at the doors of the palace, bent their knees, and worshipped Aman: for so the emperor had commanded them, only Mardochai did not bend his knee, nor worship him. ³ And the king's servants that were chief at the doors of the palace, said to him: Why dost thou alone not observe the king's commandment? ⁴ And when they were saying this often, and he would not hearken to them, they told Aman, desirous to know whether he would continue in his resolution: for he had told them that he was a Jew. ⁵ Now when Aman had heard this, and had proved by experience that Mardochai did not bend his knee to him, nor worship him, he was exceeding angry. ⁶ And he counted it nothing to lay his hands upon Mardochai alone: for he had heard that he was of the nation of the Jews, and he chose rather to destroy all the nation of the Jews that were in the kingdom of Assuerus.

⁷ In the first month (which is called Nisan) in the twelfth year of the reign of Assuerus, the lot was cast into an urn, which in Hebrew is called Phur, before Aman, on what day and what month the nation of the Jews should be destroyed: and there came out the twelfth month, which is called Adar. ⁸ And Aman said to king Assuerus: There is a people scattered through all the provinces of thy kingdom, and separated one from another,

that use new laws and ceremonies, and moreover despise the king's ordinances: and thou knowest very well that it is not expedient for thy kingdom that they should grow insolent by impunity. ⁹ If it please thee, decree that they may be destroyed, and I will pay ten thousand talents to thy treasurers. ¹⁰ And the king took the ring that he used, from his own hand, and gave it to Aman, the son of Amadathi of the race of Agag, the enemy of the Jews, ¹¹ And he said to him: As to the money which thou promisest, keep it for thyself: and as to the people, do with them as seemeth good to thee. ¹² And the king's scribes were called in the first month Nisan, on the thirteenth day of the same month: and they wrote, as Aman had commanded, to all the king's lieutenants, and to the judges of the provinces, and of divers nations, as every nation could read, and hear according to their different languages, in the name of king Assuerus: and the letters, sealed with his ring, ¹³ Were sent by the king's messengers to all provinces, to kill and destroy all the Jews, both young and old, little children, and women, in one day, that is, on the thirteenth of the twelfth month, which is called Adar, and to make a spoil of their goods. ¹⁴ And the contents of the letters were to this effect, that all provinces might know and be ready against that day. ¹⁵ The couriers that were sent made haste to fulfil the king's commandment. And immediately the edict was hung up in Susan, the king and Aman feasting together, and all the Jews that were in the city weeping.

4 ¹ Now when Mardochai had heard these things, he rent his garments, and put on sackcloth, strewing ashes on his head and he cried with a loud voice in the street in the midst of the city, shewing the anguish of his mind. ² And he came lamenting in this manner even to the gate of the palace: for no one clothed with sackcloth might enter the king's court. ³ And in all provinces, towns, and places, to which the king's cruel edict was come, there was great mourning among the Jews, with fasting, wailing, and weeping, many using sackcloth and ashes for their bed. ⁴ Then Esther's maids and her eunuchs went in, and told her. And when she heard it she was in a consternation and she sent a garment, to clothe him, and to take away the sackcloth: but he would not receive it. ⁵ And she called for Athach the eunuch, whom the king had appointed to attend upon her, and she commanded him to go to Mardochai, and learn of him why he did this. ⁶ And Athach going out went to Mardochai, who was standing in the street of the city, before the palace gate: ⁷ And Mardochai told him all that had happened, how Aman had promised to pay money into the king's treasures, to have the Jews destroyed. ⁸ He gave him also a copy of the edict which was hanging up in Susan, that he should shew it to the queen, and admonish her to go in to the king, and to entreat him for her people. ⁹ And Athach went back and told Esther all that Mardochai had said. ¹⁰ She answered him, and bade him say to Mardochai: ¹¹ All the king's servants, and all the provinces that are under his dominion, know, that whosoever, whether man or woman, cometh into the king's inner court, who is not called for, is immediately to be put to death without any delay: except the king shall hold out the golden sceptre to him, in token of clemency, that so he may live. How then can I go in to the king, who for these thirty days now have not been called unto him?

¹² And when Mardochai had heard this, ¹³ He sent word to Es-

ther again, saying: Think not that thou mayst save thy life only, because thou art in the king's house, more than all the Jews: ¹⁴ For if thou wilt now hold thy peace, the Jews shall be delivered by some other occasion: and thou, and thy father's house shall perish. And who knoweth whether thou art not therefore come to the kingdom, that thou mightest be ready in such a time as this?

¹⁵ And again Esther sent to Mardochai in these words: ¹⁶ Go, and gather together all the Jews whom thou shalt find in Susan, and pray ye for me. Neither eat nor drink for three days and three nights: and I with my handmaids will fast in like manner, and then I will go in to the king, against the law, not being called, and expose myself to death and to danger. ¹⁷ So Mardochai went, and did all that Esther had commanded him.

252. Esther before the king; the night without sleep

Esther 5:1-6:14

5 ¹ And on the third day Esther put on her royal apparel, and stood in the inner court of the king's house, over against the king's hall: now he sat upon his throne in the hall of the palace, over against the door of the house. ² And when he saw Esther the queen standing, she pleased his eyes, and he held out toward her the golden sceptre, which he held in his hand and she drew near, and kissed the top of his sceptre. ³ And the king said to her: What wilt thou, queen Esther? what is thy request? if thou shouldst even ask one half of the kingdom, it shall be given to thee. ⁴ But she answered: If it please the king, I beseech thee to come to me this day, and Aman with thee to the banquet which I have prepared. ⁵ And the king said forthwith: Call ye Aman quickly, that he may obey Esther's will. So the king and Aman came to the banquet which the queen had prepared for them. ⁶ And the king said to her, after he had drunk wine plentifully: What dost thou desire should be given thee? and for what thing askest thou? although thou shouldst ask the half of my kingdom, thou shalt have it. ⁷ And Esther answered: My petition and request is this: ⁸ If I have found favour in the king's sight, and if it please the king to give me what I ask, and to fulfil my petition: let the king and Aman come to the banquet which I have prepared them, and to morrow I will open my mind to the king.

⁹ So Aman went out that day joyful and merry. And when he saw Mardochai sitting before the gate of the palace, and that he not only did not rise up to honour him, but did not so much as move from the place where he sat, he was exceedingly angry: ¹⁰ But dissembling his anger, and returning into his house, he called together to him his friends, and Zares his wife: ¹¹ And he declared to them the greatness of his riches, and the multitude of his children, and with how great glory the king had advanced him above all his princes and servants. ¹² And after this he said: Queen Esther also hath invited no other to the banquet with the king, but me: and with her I am also to dine to morrow with the king: ¹³ And whereas I have all these things, I think I have nothing, so long as I see Mardochai the Jew sitting before the king's gate.

¹⁴ Then Zares his wife, and the rest of his friends answered him: Order a great beam to be prepared, fifty cubits high, and in the morning speak to the king, that Mardochai may be hanged upon it, and so thou shalt go full of joy with the king to the

banquet. The counsel pleased him, and he commanded a high gibbet to be prepared.

6 ¹ That night the king passed without sleep, and he commanded the histories and chronicles of former times to be brought him. And when they were reading them before him, ² They came to that place where it was written, how Mardochai had discovered the treason of Bagathan and Thares the eunuchs, who sought to kill king Assuerus. ³ And when the king heard this, he said: What honour and reward hath Mardochai received for this fidelity? His servants and ministers said to him: He hath received no reward at all.

⁴ And the king said immediately: Who is in the court? for Aman was coming in to the inner court of the king's house, to speak to the king, that he might order Mardochai to be hanged upon the gibbet, which was prepared for him. ⁵ The servants answered: Aman standeth in the court, and the king said: Let him come in. ⁶ And when he was come in, he said to him: What ought to be done to the man whom the king is desirous to honour? But Aman thinking in his heart, and supposing that the king would honour no other but himself, ⁷ Answered: The man whom the king desireth to honour, ⁸ Ought to be clothed with the king's apparel, and to be set upon the horse that the king rideth upon, and to have the royal crown upon his head, ⁹ And let the first of the king's princes and nobles hold his horse, and going through the street of the city, proclaim before him and say: Thus shall he be honoured, whom the king hath a mind to honour. ¹⁰ And the king said to him: Make haste and take the robe and the horse, and do as thou hast spoken to Mardochai the Jew, who sitteth before the gates of the palace. Beware thou pass over any of those things which thou hast spoken. ¹¹ So Aman took the robe and the horse, and arraying Mardochai in the street of the city, and setting him on the horse, went before him, and proclaimed: This honour is he worthy of, whom the king hath a mind to honour. ¹² But Mardochai returned to the palace gate: and Aman made haste to go to his house, mourning and having his head covered: ¹³ And he told Zares his wife, and his friends, all that had befallen him. And the wise men whom he had in counsel, and his wife answered him: If Mardochai be of the seed of the Jews, before whom thou hast begun to fall, thou canst not resist him, but thou shalt fall in his sight. ¹⁴ As they were yet speaking, the king's eunuchs came, and compelled him to go quickly to the banquet which the queen had prepared.

253. Aman hanged; the decree reversed

Esther 7:1-8:17

7 ¹ So the king and Aman went in, to drink with the queen. ² And the king said to her again the second day, after he was warm with wine: What is thy petition, Esther, that it may be granted thee? and what wilt thou have done: although thou ask the half of my kingdom, thou shalt have it. ³ Then she answered: If I have found favour in thy sight, O king, and if it please thee, give me my life for which I ask, and my people for which I request. ⁴ For we are given up, I and my people, to be destroyed, to be slain, and to perish. And would God we were sold for bondmen and bondwomen: the evil might be borne with, and I would have mourned in silence: but now we have an enemy, whose cruelty redoundeth upon the king.

⁵ And king Assuerus answered and said: Who is this, and of what power, that he should do these things? ⁶ And Esther said: It is this Aman that is our adversary and most wicked enemy. Aman hearing this was forthwith astonished, not being able to bear the countenance of the king and of the queen.

⁷ But the king being angry rose up, and went from the place of the banquet into the garden set with trees. Aman also rose up to entreat Esther the queen for his life, for he understood that evil was prepared for him by the king. ⁸ And when the king came back out of the garden set with trees, and entered into the place of the banquet, he found Aman was fallen upon the bed on which Esther lay, and he said: He will force the queen also in my presence, in my own house. The word was not yet gone out of the king's mouth, and immediately they covered his face. ⁹ And Harbona, one of the eunuchs that stood waiting on the king, said: Behold the gibbet which he hath prepared for Mardochai, who spoke for the king, standeth in Aman's house, being fifty cubits high. And the king said to him: Hang him upon it. ¹⁰ So Aman was hanged on the gibbet, which he had prepared for Mardochai: and the king's wrath ceased.

8 ¹ On that day king Assuerus gave the house of Aman, the Jews' enemy, to queen Esther, and Mardochai came in before the king. For Esther had confessed to him that he was her uncle. ² And the king took the ring which he had commanded to be taken again from Aman, and gave it to Mardochai. And Esther set Mardochai over her house. ³ And not content with these things, she fell down at the king's feet and wept, and speaking to him besought him, that he would give orders that the malice of Aman the Agagite, and his most wicked devices which he had invented against the Jews, should be of no effect. ⁴ But he, as the manner was, held out the golden sceptre with his hand, which was the sign of clemency: and she arose up and stood before him, ⁵ And said: If it please the king, and if I have found favour in his sight, and my request be not disagreeable to him, I beseech thee, that the former letters of Aman the traitor and enemy of the Jews, by which he commanded that they should be destroyed in all the king's provinces, may be reversed by new letters. ⁶ For how can I endure the murdering and slaughter of my people?

⁷ And king Assuerus answered Esther the queen, and Mardochai the Jew: I have given Aman's house to Esther, and I have commanded him to be hanged on a gibbet, because he durst lay hands on the Jews. ⁸ Write ye therefore to the Jews, as it pleaseth you in the king's name, and seal the letters with my ring. For this was the custom, that no man durst gainsay the letters which were sent in the king's name, and were sealed with his ring. ⁹ Then the king's scribes and secretaries were called for (now it was the time of the third month which is called Sibani) the three and twentieth day of the month, and letters were written, as Mardochai had a mind, to the Jews, and to the governors, and to the deputies, and to the judges, who were rulers over the hundred and twenty-seven provinces, from India even to Ethiopia: to province and province, to people and people, according to their languages and characters, and to the Jews, according as they could read and hear. ¹⁰ And these letters which were sent in the king's name, were sealed with his ring, and sent by posts: who were to run through all the provinces, to prevent the

former letters with new messages. ¹¹ And the king gave orders to them, to speak to the Jews in every city, and to command them to gather themselves together, and to stand for their lives, and to kill and destroy all their enemies with their wives and children and all their houses, and to take their spoil. ¹² And one day of revenge was appointed through all the provinces, to wit, the thirteenth of the twelfth month Adar. ¹³ And this was the content of the letter, that it should be notified in all lands and peoples that were subject to the empire of king Assuerus, that the Jews were ready to be revenged of their enemies. ¹⁴ So the swift posts went out carrying the messages, and the king's edict was hung up in Susan.

¹⁵ And Mardochai going forth out of the palace, and from the king's presence, shone in royal apparel, to wit, of violet and sky colour, wearing a golden crown on his head, and clothed with a cloak of silk and purple. And all the city rejoiced, and was glad. ¹⁶ But to the Jews, a new light seemed to rise, joy, honour, and dancing. ¹⁷ And in all peoples, cities, and provinces, whithersoever the king's commandments came, there was wonderful rejoicing, feasts and banquets, and keeping holy day: Inasmuch that many of other nations and religion, joined themselves to their worship and ceremonies. For a great dread of the name of the Jews had fallen upon all.

254. The feast of Phurim

Esther 9:1-10:3

9 ¹ So on the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which as we have said above is called Adar, when all the Jews were designed to be massacred, and their enemies were greedy after their blood, the case being altered, the Jews began to have the upper hand, and to revenge themselves of their adversaries. ² And they gathered themselves together in every city, and town, and place, to lay their hands on their enemies, and their persecutors. And no one durst withstand them, for the fear of their power had gone through every people. ³ And the judges of the provinces, and the governors, and lieutenants, and every one in dignity, that presided over every place and work, extolled the Jews for fear of Mardochai: ⁴ For they knew him to be prince of the palace, and to have great power: and the fame of his name increased daily, and was spread abroad through all men's mouths. ⁵ So the Jews made a great slaughter of their enemies, and killed them, repaying according to what they had prepared to do to them: ⁶ Inasmuch that even in Susan they killed five hundred men, besides the ten sons of Aman the Agagite, the enemy of the Jews: whose names are these: ⁷ Pharsandatha, and Delphon, and Esphatha ⁸ And Phoratha, and Adalia, and Aridatha, ⁹ And Phermesta, and Arisai, and Aridai, and Jezatha. ¹⁰ And when they had slain them, they would not touch the spoils of their goods. ¹¹ And presently the number of them that were killed in Susan was brought to the king.

¹² And he said to the queen: The Jews have killed five hundred men in the city of Susan, besides the ten sons of Aman: how many dost thou think they have slain in all the provinces? What askest thou more, and what wilt thou have me to command to be done? ¹³ And she answered: If it please the king, let it be granted to the Jews, to do to morrow in Susan as they have done to day, and that the ten sons of Aman may be hanged upon gibbets. ¹⁴ And the king commanded that it should be so done. And

forthwith the edict was hung up in Susan, and the ten sons of Aman were hanged. ¹⁵ And on the fourteenth day of the month Adar the Jews gathered themselves together, and they killed in Susan three hundred men: but they took not their substance. ¹⁶ Moreover through all the provinces which were subject to the king's dominion the Jews stood for their lives, and slew their enemies and persecutors: insomuch that the number of them that were killed amounted to seventy-five thousand, and no man took any of their goods. ¹⁷ Now the thirteenth day of the month Adar was the first day with them all of the slaughter, and on the fourteenth day they left off. Which they ordained to be kept holy day, so that all times hereafter they should celebrate it with feasting, joy, and banquets. ¹⁸ But they that were killing in the city of Susan, were employed in the slaughter on the thirteenth and fourteenth day of the same month: and on the fifteenth day they rested. And therefore they appointed that day to be a holy day of feasting and gladness. ¹⁹ But those Jews that dwelt in towns not walled and in villages, appointed the fourteenth day of the month Adar for banquets and gladness, so as to rejoice on that day, and send one another portions of their banquets and meats.

²⁰ And Mardochai wrote all these things, and sent them comprised in letters to the Jews that abode in all the king's provinces, both those that lay near and those afar off, ²¹ That they should receive the fourteenth and fifteenth day of the month Adar for holy days, and always at the return of the year should celebrate them with solemn honour: ²² Because on those days the Jews revenged themselves of their enemies, and their mourning and sorrow were turned into mirth and joy, and that these should be days of feasting and gladness, in which they should send one to another portions of meats, and should give gifts to the poor. ²³ And the Jews undertook to observe with solemnity all they had begun to do at that time, which Mardochai by letters had commanded to be done. ²⁴ For Aman, the son of Amadathi of the race of Agag, the enemy and adversary of the Jews, had devised evil against them, to kill them and destroy them; and had cast Phur, that is, the lot. ²⁵ And afterwards Esther went in to the king, beseeching him that his endeavours might be made void by the king's letters: and the evil that he had intended against the Jews, might return upon his own head. And so both he and his sons were hanged upon gibbets. ²⁶ And since that time these days are called Phurim, that is, of lots: because Phur, that is, the lot, was cast into the urn. And all things that were done, are contained in the volume of this epistle, that is, of this book: ²⁷ And the things that they suffered, and that were afterwards changed, the Jews took upon themselves and their seed, and upon all that had a mind to be joined to their religion, so that it should be lawful for none to pass these days without solemnity: which the writing testifieth, and certain times require, as the years continually succeed one another. ²⁸ These are the days which shall never be forgot: and which all provinces in the whole world shall celebrate throughout all generations: neither is there any city wherein the days of Phurim, that is, of lots, must not be observed by the Jews, and by their posterity, which is bound to these ceremonies. ²⁹ And Esther the queen, the daughter of Abihail, and Mardochai the Jew, wrote also a second epistle, that with all diligence this day should be established a festival for

the time to come.³⁰ And they sent to all the Jews that were in the hundred and twenty-seven provinces of king Assuerus, that they should have peace, and receive truth,³¹ And observe the days of lots, and celebrate them with joy in their proper time: as Mardochai and Esther had appointed, and they undertook them to be observed by themselves and by their seed, fasts, and cries, and the days of lots,³² And all things which are contained in the history of this book, which is called Esther.

10 ¹ And king Assuerus made all the land, and all the islands of the sea tributary. ² And his strength and his empire, and the dignity and greatness wherewith he exalted Mardochai, are written in the books of the Medes, and of the Persians: ³ And how Mardochai of the race of the Jews, was next after king Assuerus: and great among the Jews, and acceptable to the people of his brethren, seeking the good of his people, and speaking those things which were for the welfare of his seed.

255. The Vulgate additions to Esther

Esther 10:4-16:24

St. Jerome removed these portions from their Greek places and set them at the end of the book; the Douay-Rheims prints them so. Modern versions print them inline or as Greek Esther A-F, so these references do not transfer.

10 ⁴ Then Mardochai said: God hath done these things. ⁵ I remember a dream that I saw, which signified these same things: and nothing thereof hath failed. ⁶ The little fountain which grew into a river, and was turned into a light, and into the sun, and abounded into many waters, is Esther, whom the king married, and made queen. ⁷ But the two dragons are I and Aman. ⁸ The nations that were assembled are they that endeavoured to destroy the name of the Jews. ⁹ And my nation is Israel, who cried to the Lord, and the Lord saved his people: and he delivered us from all evils, and hath wrought great signs and wonders among the nations: ¹⁰ And he commanded that there should be two lots, one of the people of God, and the other of all the nations. ¹¹ And both lots came to the day appointed already from that time before God to all nations: ¹² And the Lord remembered his people, and had mercy on his inheritance. ¹³ And these days shall be observed in the month of Adar on the fourteenth, and fifteenth day of the same month, with all diligence, and joy of the people gathered into one assembly, throughout all the generations hereafter of the people of Israel.

11 ¹ In the fourth year of the reign of Ptolemy and Cleopatra, Dositheus, who said he was a priest, and of the Levitical race, and Ptolemy his son brought this epistle of Phurim, which they said Lysimachus the son of Ptolemy had interpreted in Jerusalem. ² In the second year of the reign of Artaxerxes the great, in the first day of the month Nisan, Mardochai the son of Jair, the son of Semei, the son of Cis, of the tribe of Benjamin: ³ A Jew who dwelt in the city of Susan, a great man and among the first of the king's court, had a dream. ⁴ Now he was of the number of the captives, whom Nabuchodonosor king of Babylon had carried away from Jerusalem with Jechonias king of Juda: ⁵ And this was his dream: Behold there were voices, and tumults, and thunders, and earthquakes, and a disturbance upon the earth. ⁶ And behold two great dragons came forth ready to fight one against another. ⁷ And at their cry all nations were stirred up to fight against the

nation of the just. ⁸ And that was a day of darkness and danger, of tribulation and distress, and great fear upon the earth. ⁹ And the nation of the just was troubled fearing their own evils, and was prepared for death. ¹⁰ And they cried to God: and as they were crying, a little fountain grew into a very great river, and abounded into many waters. ¹¹ The light and the sun rose up, and the humble were exalted, and they devoured the glorious. ¹² And when Mardochai had seen this, and arose out of his bed, he was thinking what God would do: and he kept it fixed in his mind, desirous to know what the dream should signify.

12 ¹ And he abode at that time in the king's court with Bagatha and Thara the king's eunuchs, who were porters of the palace. ² And when he understood their designs, and had diligently searched into their projects, he learned that they went about to lay violent hands on king Artaxerxes, and he told the king thereof. ³ Then the king had them both examined, and after they had confessed, commanded them to be put to death. ⁴ But the king made a record of what was done: and Mardochai also committed the memory of the thing to writing. ⁵ And the king commanded him, to abide in the court of the palace, and gave him presents for the information. ⁶ But Aman the son of Amadathi the Bugite was in great honour with the king, and sought to hurt Mardochai and his people, because of the two eunuchs of the king who were put to death.

13 ¹ And this was the copy of the letter: Artaxerxes the great king who reigneth from India to Ethiopia, to the princes and governors of the hundred and twenty-seven provinces, that are subject to his empire, greeting. ² Whereas I reigned over many nations, and had brought all the world under my dominion, I was not willing to abuse the greatness of my power, but to govern my subjects with clemency and that they might live quietly without any terror, and might enjoy peace, which is desired by all men, ³ But when I asked my counsellors how this might be accomplished, one that excelled the rest in wisdom and fidelity, and was second after the king, Aman by name, ⁴ Told me that there was a people scattered through the whole world, which used new laws, and acted against the customs of all nations, despised the commandments of kings, and violated by their opposition the concord of all nations. ⁵ Wherefore having learned this, and seeing one nation in opposition to all mankind using perverse laws, and going against our commandments, and disturbing the peace and concord of the provinces subject to us, ⁶ We have commanded that all whom Aman shall mark out, who is chief over all the provinces, and second after the king, and whom we honour as a father, shall be utterly destroyed by their enemies, with their wives and children, and that none shall have pity on them, on the fourteenth day of the twelfth month Adar of this present year: ⁷ That these wicked men going down to hell in one day, may restore to our empire the peace which they had disturbed. ⁸ But Mardochai besought the Lord, remembering all his works, ⁹ And said: O Lord, Lord, almighty king, for all things are in thy power, and there is none that can resist thy will, if thou determine to save Israel. ¹⁰ Thou hast made heaven and earth and all things that are under the cope of heaven. ¹¹ Thou art Lord of all, and there is none that can resist thy majesty. ¹² Thou knowest all things, and thou knowest that it was not out of pride and or any desire of glory, that I refused to worship

the proud Aman, ¹³ (For I would willingly and readily for the salvation of Israel have kissed even the steps of his feet,) ¹⁴ But I feared lest I should transfer the honour of my God to a man, and lest I should adore any one except my God. ¹⁵ And now, O Lord, O king, O God of Abraham, have mercy on thy people, because our enemies resolve to destroy us, and extinguish thy inheritance. ¹⁶ Despise not thy portion, which thou hast redeemed for thyself out of Egypt. ¹⁷ Hear my supplication, and be merciful to thy lot and inheritance, and turn our mourning into joy, that we may live and praise thy name, O Lord, and shut not the mouths of them that sing to thee. ¹⁸ And all Israel with like mind and supplication cried to the Lord, because they saw certain death hanging over their heads.

14 ¹ Queen Esther also, fearing the danger that was at hand, had recourse to the Lord. ² And when she had laid away her royal apparel, she put on garments suitable for weeping and mourning: instead of divers precious ointments, she covered her head with ashes and dung, and she humbled her body with fasts: and all the places in which before she was accustomed to rejoice, she filled with her torn hair. ³ And she prayed to the Lord the God of Israel, saying: O my Lord, who alone art our king, help me a desolate woman, and who have no other helper but thee. ⁴ My danger is in my hands. ⁵ I have heard of my father that thou, O Lord, didst take Israel from among all nations, and our fathers from all their predecessors, to possess them as an everlasting inheritance, and thou hast done to them as thou hast promised. ⁶ We have sinned in thy sight, and therefore thou hast delivered us into the hands of our enemies: ⁷ For we have worshipped their gods. Thou art just, O Lord. ⁸ And now they are not content to oppress us with most hard bondage, but attributing the strength of their hands to the power of their idols. ⁹ They design to change thy promises, and destroy thy inheritance, and shut the mouths of them that praise thee, and extinguish the glory of thy temple and altar, ¹⁰ That they may open the mouths of Gentiles, and praise the strength of idols, and magnify for ever a carnal king. ¹¹ Give not, O Lord, thy sceptre to them that are not, lest they laugh at our ruin: but turn their counsel upon themselves, and destroy him that hath begun to rage against us. ¹² Remember, O Lord, and shew thyself to us in the time of our tribulation, and give me boldness, O Lord, king of gods, and of all power: ¹³ Give me a well ordered speech in my mouth in the presence of the lion, and turn his heart to the hatred of our enemy, that both he himself may perish, and the rest that consent to him. ¹⁴ But deliver us by thy hand, and help me, who have no other helper, but thee, O Lord, who hast the knowledge of all things. ¹⁵ And thou knowest that I hate the glory of the wicked, and abhor the bed of the uncircumcised, and of every stranger. ¹⁶ Thou knowest my necessity, that I abominate the sign of my pride and glory, which is upon my head in the days of my public appearance, and detest it as a menstruous rag, and wear it not in the days of my silence, ¹⁷ And that I have not eaten at Aman's table, nor hath the king's banquet pleased me, and that I have not drunk the wine of the drink offerings: ¹⁸ And that thy handmaid hath never rejoiced, since I was brought hither unto this day but in thee, O Lord, the God of Abraham. ¹⁹ O God, who art mighty above all, hear the voice of them, that have no other hope, and

deliver us from the hand of the wicked, and deliver me from my fear.

15 ¹ And he commanded her (no doubt but he was Mardochai) to go to the king, and petition for her people, and for her country. ² Remember, (said he,) the days of thy low estate, how thou wast brought up by my hand, because Aman the second after the king hath spoken against us unto death. ³ And do thou call upon the Lord, and speak to the king for us, and deliver us from death. ⁴ And on the third day she laid away the garments she wore, and put on her glorious apparel. ⁵ And glittering in royal robes, after she had called upon God the ruler and Saviour of all, she took two maids with her, ⁶ And upon one of them she leaned, as if for delicateness and overmuch tenderness she were not able to bear up her own body. ⁷ And the other maid followed her lady, bearing up her train flowing on the ground. ⁸ But she with a rosy colour in her face, and with gracious and bright eyes hid a mind full of anguish, and exceeding great fear. ⁹ So going in she passed through all doors in order, and stood before the king, where he sat upon his royal throne, clothed with his royal robes, and glittering with gold, and precious stones, and he was terrible to behold. ¹⁰ And when he had lifted up his countenance, and with burning eyes had shewn the wrath of his heart, the queen sunk down, and her colour turned pale, and she rested her weary head upon her handmaid. ¹¹ And God changed the king's spirit into mildness, and all in haste and in fear he leaped from his throne, and holding her up in his arms, till she came to herself, caressed her with these words: ¹² What is the matter, Esther? I am thy brother, fear not. ¹³ Thou shalt not die: for this law is not made for thee, but for all others. ¹⁴ Come near then, and touch the sceptre. ¹⁵ And as she held her peace, he took the golden sceptre, and laid it upon her neck, and kissed her, and said: Why dost thou not speak to me? ¹⁶ She answered: I saw thee, my lord, as an angel of God, and my heart was troubled for fear of thy majesty. ¹⁷ For thou, my lord, art very admirable, and thy face is full of graces. ¹⁸ And while she was speaking, she fell down again, and was almost in a swoon. ¹⁹ But the king was troubled, and all his servants comforted her.

16 ¹ The great king Artaxerxes, from India to Ethiopia, to the governors and princes of a hundred and twenty-seven provinces, which obey our command, sendeth greeting. ² Many have abused unto pride the goodness of princes, and the honour that hath been bestowed upon them: ³ And not only endeavour to oppress the king's subjects, but not bearing the glory that is given them, take in hand, to practise also against them that gave it. ⁴ Neither are they content not to return thanks for benefits received, and to violate in themselves the laws of humanity, but they think they can also escape the justice of God who seeth all things. ⁵ And they break out into so great madness, as to endeavour to undermine by lies such as observe diligently the offices committed to them, and do all things in such manner as to be worthy of all men's praise, ⁶ While with crafty fraud they deceive the ears of princes that are well meaning, and judge of others by their own nature. ⁷ Now this is proved both from ancient histories, and by the things which are done daily, how the good designs of kings are depraved by the evil suggestions of certain men. ⁸ Wherefore we must provide for the peace of all provinces. ⁹ Neither must you think, if we command different things, that

it cometh of the levity of our mind, but that we give sentence according to the quality and necessity of times, as the profit of the commonwealth requireth. ¹⁰ Now that you may more plainly understand what we say, Aman the son of Amadathi, a Macedonian both in mind and country, and having nothing of the Persian blood, but with his cruelty staining our goodness, was received being a stranger by us: ¹¹ And found our humanity so great towards him, that he was called our father, and was worshipped by all as the next man after the king: ¹² But he was so far puffed up with arrogancy, as to go about to deprive us of our kingdom and life. ¹³ For with certain new and unheard of devices he hath sought the destruction of Mardochai, by whose fidelity and good services our life was saved, and of Esther the partner of our kingdom with all their nation: ¹⁴ Thinking that after they were slain, he might work treason against us left alone without friends, and might transfer the kingdom of the Persians to the Macedonians. ¹⁵ But we have found that the Jews, who were by that most wicked man appointed to be slain, are in no fault at all, but contrariwise, use just laws, ¹⁶ And are the children of the highest and the greatest, and the ever living God, by whose benefit the kingdom was given both to our fathers and to us, and is kept unto this day. ¹⁷ Wherefore know ye that those letters which he sent in our name, are void and of no effect. ¹⁸ For which crime both he himself that devised it, and all his kindred hang on gibbets, before the gates of this city Susan: not we, but God repaying him as he deserved. ¹⁹ But this edict, which we now send, shall be published in all cities, that the Jews may freely follow their own laws. ²⁰ And you shall aid them that they may kill those who had prepared themselves to kill them, on the thirteenth day of the twelfth month, which is called Adar. ²¹ For the almighty God hath turned this day of sadness and mourning into joy to them. ²² Wherefore you shall also count this day among other festival days, and celebrate it with all joy, that it may be known also in times to come, ²³ That all they who faithfully obey the Persians, receive a worthy reward for their fidelity: but they that are traitors to their kingdom, are destroyed for their wickedness. ²⁴ And let every province and city, that will not be partaker of this solemnity, perish by the sword and by fire, and be destroyed in such manner as to be made unpassable, both to men and beasts, for an example of contempt, and disobedience.

256. Nabuchodonosor and Holofernes

Judith 1:1-3:15

The Vulgate division of Judith differs from the Greek; as with Tobias, these references do not transfer to a modern Bible unchanged.

1 ¹ Now Arphaxad king of the Medes had brought many nations under his dominions, and he built a very strong city, which he called Ecbatana, ² Of stones squared and hewed: he made the walls thereof seventy cubits broad, and thirty cubits high, and the towers thereof he made a hundred cubits high. But on the square of them, each side was extended the space of twenty feet. ³ And he made the gates thereof according to the height of the towers: ⁴ And he gloried as a mighty one in the force of his army and in the glory of his chariots. ⁵ Now in the twelfth year of his reign, Nabuchodonosor king of the Assyrians,

who reigned in Ninive the great city, fought against Arphaxad and overcame him, ⁶ In the great plain which is called Ragua, about the Euphrates, and the Tigris, and the Jadason, in the plain of Erioch the king of the Elicians. ⁷ Then was the kingdom of Nabuchodonosor exalted, and his heart was elevated: and he sent to all that dwelt in Cilicia and Damascus, and Libanus, ⁸ And to the nations that are in Carmelus, and Cedar, and to the inhabitants of Galilee in the great plain of Asdrelon, ⁹ And to all that were in Samaria, and beyond the river Jordan even to Jerusalem, and all the land of Jesse till you come to the borders of Ethiopia. ¹⁰ To all these Nabuchodonosor king of the Assyrians, sent messengers: ¹¹ But they all with one mind refused, and sent them back empty, and rejected them without honour. ¹² Then king Nabuchodonosor being angry against all that land, swore by his throne and kingdom that he would revenge himself of all those countries.

2 ¹ In the thirteenth year of the reign of Nabuchodonosor, the two and twentieth day of the first month, the word was given out in the house of Nabuchodonosor king of the Assyrians, that he would revenge himself. ² And he called all the ancients, and all the governors, and his officers of war, and communicated to them the secret of his counsel: ³ And he said that his thoughts were to bring all the earth under his empire. ⁴ And when this saying pleased them all, Nabuchodonosor, the king, called Holofernes the general of his armies, ⁵ And said to him: Go out against all the kingdoms of the west, and against them especially that despised my commandment. ⁶ Thy eye shall not spare any kingdom, and all the strong cities thou shalt bring under my yoke. ⁷ Then Holofernes called the captains, and officers of the power of the Assyrians: and he mustered men for the expedition, as the king commanded him, a hundred and twenty thousand fighting men on foot, and twelve thousand archers, horsemen. ⁸ And he made all his warlike preparations to go before with a multitude of innumerable camels, with all provisions sufficient for the armies in abundance, and herds of oxen, and flocks of sheep, without number. ⁹ He appointed corn to be prepared out of all Syria in his passage. ¹⁰ But gold and silver he took out of the king's house in great abundance. ¹¹ And he went forth he and all the army, with the chariots, and horsemen, and archers, who covered the face of the earth, like locusts. ¹² And when he had passed through the borders of the Assyrians, he came to the great mountains of Ange, which are on the left of Cilicia: and he went up to all their castles, and took all the strong places. ¹³ And he took by assault the renowned city of Melothus, and pillaged all the children of Tharsis, and the children of Ismahel, who were over against the face of the desert, and on the south of the land of Cellon. ¹⁴ And he passed over the Euphrates and came into Mesopotamia: and he forced all the stately cities that were there, from the torrent of Mambre, till one comes to the sea: ¹⁵ And he took the borders thereof, from Cilicia to the coasts of Japheth, which are towards the south. ¹⁶ And he carried away all the children of Madian, and stripped them of all their riches, and all that resisted him he slew with the edge of the sword. ¹⁷ And after these things he went down into the plains of Damascus in the days of the harvest, and he set all the corn on fire, and he caused all the trees and vineyards to be cut down. ¹⁸ And the fear of them fell upon all the inhabitants of the land.

3 ¹ Then the kings and the princes of all the cities and provinces, of Syria, Mesopotamia, and Syria Sobal, and Libya, and Cilicia sent their ambassadors, who coming to Holofernes, said: ² Let thy indignation towards us cease, for it is better for us to live and serve Nabuchodonosor the great king, and be subject to thee, than to die and to perish, or suffer the miseries of slavery. ³ All our cities and our possessions, all mountains and hills, and fields, and herds of oxen, and flocks of sheep, and goats, and horses, and camels, and all our goods, and families are in thy sight: ⁴ Let all we have be subject to thy law, ⁵ Both we and our children are thy servants. ⁶ Come to us a peaceable lord, and use our service as it shall please thee, ⁷ Then he came down from the mountains with horsemen, in great power, and made himself master of every city, and all the inhabitants of the land. ⁸ And from all the cities he took auxiliaries valiant men, and chosen for war, ⁹ And so great a fear lay upon all those provinces, that the inhabitants of all the cities, both princes and nobles, as well as the people, went out to meet him at his coming. ¹⁰ And received him with garlands, and lights, and dances, and timbrels, and flutes. ¹¹ And though they did these things, they could not for all that mitigate the fierceness of his heart: ¹² For he both destroyed their cities, and cut down their groves. ¹³ For Nabuchodonosor the king had commanded him to destroy all the gods of the earth, that he only might be called God by those nations which could be brought under him by the power of Holofernes. ¹⁴ And when he had passed through all Syria Sobal, and all Apamea, and all Mesopotamia, he came to the Idumeans into the land of Gabaa, ¹⁵ And he took possession of their cities, and stayed there for thirty days, in which days he commanded all the troops of his army to be united.

257. *Israel prepares; the warning of Achior*

Judith 4:1-6:21

4 ¹ Then the children of Israel, who dwelt in the land of Juda, hearing these things, were exceedingly afraid of him. ² Dread and horror seized upon their minds, lest he should do the same to Jerusalem and to the temple of the Lord, that he had done to other cities and their temples. ³ And they sent into all Samaria round about, as far as Jericho, and seized upon all the tops of the mountains: ⁴ And they compassed their towns with walls and gathered together corn for provision for war. ⁵ And Eliachim the priest wrote to all that were over against Esdrelon, which faceth the great plain near Dothain, and to all by whom there might be a passage of way, that they should take possession of the ascents of the mountains, by which there might be any way to Jerusalem, and should keep watch where the way was narrow between the mountains. ⁶ And the children of Israel did as the priest of the Lord Eliachim had appointed them. ⁷ And all the people cried to the Lord with great earnestness, and they humbled their souls in fastings, and prayers, both they and their wives. ⁸ And the priests put on haircloths, and they caused the little children to lie prostrate before the temple of the Lord, and the altar of the Lord they covered with haircloth. ⁹ And they cried to the Lord the God of Israel with one accord, that their children might not be made a prey, and their wives carried off, and their cities destroyed, and their holy things profaned, and that they might not be made a reproach to the Gentiles. ¹⁰ Then Eliachim the high priest of the Lord went about all Israel and spoke to them, ¹¹ Saying: Know

ye that the Lord will hear your prayers, if you continue with perseverance in fastings and prayers in the sight of the Lord. ¹² Remember Moses the servant of the Lord overcame Amalec that trusted in his own strength, and in his power, and in his army, and in his shields, and in his chariots, and in his horsemen, not by fighting with the sword, but by holy prayers: ¹³ So all the enemies of Israel be, if you persevere in this work which you have begun. ¹⁴ So they being moved by this exhortation of his, prayed to the Lord, and continued in the sight of the Lord. ¹⁵ So that even they who offered the holocausts to the Lord, offered the sacrifices to the Lord girded with haircloths, and with ashes upon their head. ¹⁶ And they all begged of God with all their heart, that he would visit his people Israel.

5 ¹ And it was told Holofernes the general of the army of the Assyrians, that the children of Israel prepared themselves to resist, and had shut up the ways of the mountains. ² And he was transported with exceeding great fury and indignation, and he called all the princes of Moab and the leaders of Ammon. ³ And he said to them: Tell me what is this people that besetteth the mountains: or what are their cities, and of what sort, and how great: also what is their power, or what is their multitude: or who is the king over their warfare: ⁴ And why they above all that dwell in the east, have despised us, and have not come out to meet us, that they might receive us with peace? ⁵ Then Achior captain of all the children of Ammon answering, said: If thou vouchsafe, my lord, to hear, I will tell the truth in thy sight concerning this people, that dwelleth in the mountains, and there shall not a false word come out of my mouth. ⁶ This people is of the offspring of the Chaldeans. ⁷ They dwelt first in Mesopotamia, because they would not follow the gods of their fathers, who were in the land of the Chaldeans. ⁸ Wherefore forsaking the ceremonies of their fathers, which consisted in the worship of many gods, ⁹ They worshipped one God of heaven, who also commanded them to depart from thence, and to dwell in Charan. And when there was a famine over all the land, they went down into Egypt, and there for four hundred years were so multiplied, that the army of them could not be numbered. ¹⁰ And when the king of Egypt oppressed them, and made slaves of them to labour in clay and brick, in the building of his cities, they cried to their Lord, and he struck the whole land of Egypt with divers plagues. ¹¹ And when the Egyptians had cast them out from them, and the plague had ceased from them, and they had a mind to take them again, and bring them back to their service, ¹² The God of heaven opened the sea to them in their flight, so that the waters were made to stand firm as a wall on either side, and they walked through the bottom of the sea and passed it dry foot. ¹³ And when an innumerable army of the Egyptians pursued after them in that place, they were so overwhelmed with the waters, that there was not one left, to tell what had happened to posterity. ¹⁴ After they came out of the Red Sea, they abode in the deserts of mount Sina, in which never man could dwell, or son of man rested. ¹⁵ There bitter fountains were made sweet for them to drink, and for forty years they received food from heaven. ¹⁶ Wheresoever they went in without bow and arrow, and without shield and sword, their God fought for them and overcame. ¹⁷ And there was no one that triumphed over this people, but when they departed from

the worship of the Lord their God. ¹⁸ But as often as beside their own God, they worshipped any other, they were given to spoil and to the sword, and to reproach. ¹⁹ And as often as they were penitent for having revolted from the worship of their God, the God of heaven gave them power to resist. ²⁰ So they overthrew the king of the Chanaanites, and of the Jebusites, and of the Pherezites, and of the Hethites, and of the Hevites, and of the Amorrhites, and all the mighty ones in Hesebon, and they possessed their lands, and their cities: ²¹ And as long as they sinned not in the sight of their God, it was well with them: for their God hateth iniquity. ²² And even some years ago when they had revolted from the way which God had given them to walk therein, they were destroyed in battles by many nations and very many of them were led away captive into a strange land. ²³ But of late returning to the Lord their God, from the different places wherein they were scattered, they are come together and are gone up into all these mountains, and possess Jerusalem again, where their holies are. ²⁴ Now therefore, my lord, search if there be any iniquity of theirs in the sight of their God: let us go up to them, because their God will surely deliver them to thee, and they shall be brought under the yoke of thy power: ²⁵ But if there be no offence of this people in the sight of their God, we cannot resist them because their God will defend them: and we shall be a reproach to the whole earth. ²⁶ And it came to pass, when Achior had ceased to speak these words, all the great men of Holofernes were angry, and they had a mind to kill him, saying to each other: ²⁷ Who is this, that saith the children of Israel can resist king Nabuchodonosor, and his armies, men unarmed, and without force, and without skill in the art of war? ²⁸ That Achior therefore may know that he deceiveth us, let us go up into the mountains: and when the bravest of them shall be taken, then shall he with them be stabbed with the sword, ²⁹ That every nation may know that Nabuchodonosor is god of the earth, and besides him there is no other.

6 ¹ And it came to pass when they had left off speaking, that Holofernes being in a violent passion, said to Achior: ² Because thou hast prophesied unto us, saying: That the nation of Israel is defended by their God, to shew thee that there is no God, but Nabuchodonosor: ³ When we shall slay them all as one man, then thou also shalt die with them by the sword of the Assyrians, and all Israel shall perish with thee: ⁴ And thou shalt find that Nabuchodonosor is lord of the whole earth: and then the sword of my soldiers shall pass through thy sides, and thou shalt be stabbed and fall among the wounded of Israel, and thou shalt breathe no more till thou be destroyed with them. ⁵ But if thou think thy prophecy true, let not thy countenance sink, and let the paleness that is in thy face, depart from thee, if thou imaginest these my words cannot be accomplished. ⁶ And that thou mayst know that thou shalt experience these things together with them, behold from this hour thou shalt be associated to their people, that when they shall receive the punishment they deserve from my sword, thou mayst fall under the same vengeance. ⁷ Then Holofernes commanded his servants to take Achior, and to lead him to Bethulia, and to deliver him into the hands of the children of Israel. ⁸ And the servants of Holofernes taking him, went through the plains: but when they came near the mountains, the slingers came out against them. ⁹ Then turning out of the way

by the side of the mountain, they tied Achior to a tree hand and foot, and so left him bound with ropes, and returned to their master. ¹⁰ And the children of Israel coming down from Bethulia, came to him, and loosing him they brought him to Bethulia, and setting him in the midst of the people, asked him what was the matter that the Assyrians had left him bound. ¹¹ In those days the rulers there, were Ozias the son of Micha of the tribe of Simeon, and Charmi, called also Gothoniell. ¹² And Achior related in the midst of the ancients, and in the presence of all the people, all that he had said being asked by Holofernes: and how the people of Holofernes would have killed him for this word, ¹³ And how Holofernes himself being angry had commanded him to be delivered for this cause to the Israelites: that when he should overcome the children of Israel, then he might command Achior also himself to be put to death by diverse torments, for having said: The God of heaven is their defender. ¹⁴ And when Achior had declared all these things, all the people fell upon their faces, adoring the Lord, and all of them together mourning and weeping poured out their prayers with one accord to the Lord, ¹⁵ Saying: O Lord God of heaven and earth, behold their pride, and look on our low condition, and have regard to the face of thy saints, and shew that thou forsakest not them that trust on thee, and that thou humblest them that presume of themselves, and glory in their own strength. ¹⁶ So when their weeping was ended, and the people's prayer, in which they continued all the day, was concluded, they comforted Achior, ¹⁷ Saying: The God of our fathers, whose power thou hast set forth, will make this return to thee, that thou rather shalt see their destruction. ¹⁸ And when the Lord our God shall give this liberty to his servants, let God be with thee also in the midst of us: that as it shall please thee, so thou with all thine mayst converse with us. ¹⁹ Then Ozias, after the assembly was broken up, received him into his house, and made him a great supper. ²⁰ And all the ancients were invited, and they refreshed themselves together after their fast was over. ²¹ And afterwards all the people were called together, and they prayed all the night long within the church, desiring help of the God of Israel.

258. The siege of Bethulia

Judith 7:1-25

7 ¹ But Holofernes on the next day gave orders to his army, to go up against Bethulia. ² Now there were in his troops a hundred and twenty thousand footmen, and two and twenty thousand horsemen, besides the preparations of those men who had been taken, and who had been brought away out of the provinces and cities of all the youth. ³ All these prepared themselves together to fight against the children of Israel, and they came by the hillside to the top, which looketh toward Dothain, from the place which is called Belma, unto Chelmon, which is over against Esdrelon. ⁴ But the children of Israel, when they saw the multitude of them, prostrated themselves upon the ground, putting ashes upon their heads, praying with one accord, that the God of Israel would shew his mercy upon his people. ⁵ And taking their arms of war, they posted themselves at the places, which by a narrow pathway lead directly between the mountains, and they guarded them all day and night. ⁶ Now Holofernes, in going round about, found that the fountain which supplied them with water, ran through an aqueduct without the city on the south side: and he

commanded their aqueduct to be cut off. ⁷ Nevertheless there were springs not far from the walls, out of which they were seen secretly to draw water, to refresh themselves a little rather than to drink their fill. ⁸ But the children of Ammon and Moab came to Holofernes, saying: The children of Israel trust not in their spears, nor in their arrows, but the mountains are their defence, and the steep hills and precipices guard them. ⁹ Wherefore that thou mayst overcome them without joining battle, set guards at the springs that they may not draw water out of them, and thou shalt destroy them without sword, or at least being wearied out they will yield up their city, which they suppose, because it is situate in the mountains, to be impregnable. ¹⁰ And these words pleased Holofernes, and his officers, and he placed all round about a hundred men at every spring. ¹¹ And when they had kept this watch for full twenty days, the cisterns, and the reserve of waters failed among all the inhabitants of Bethulia, so that there was not within the city, enough to satisfy them, no not for one day, for water was daily given out to the people by measure. ¹² Then all the men and women, young men, and children, gathering themselves together to Ozias, all together with one voice, ¹³ Said: God be judge between us and thee, for thou hast done evil against us, in that thou wouldst not speak peaceably with the Assyrians, and for this cause God hath sold us into their hands. ¹⁴ And therefore there is no one to help us, while we are cast down before their eyes in thirst, and sad destruction. ¹⁵ And now assemble ye all that are in the city, that we may of our own accord yield ourselves all up to the people of Holofernes. ¹⁶ For it is better, that being captives we should live and bless the Lord, than that we should die, and be a reproach to all flesh, after we have seen our wives and our infants die before our eyes. ¹⁷ We call to witness this day heaven and earth, and the God of our fathers, who taketh vengeance upon us according to our sins, conjuring you to deliver now the city into the hand of the army of Holofernes, that our end may be short by the edge of the sword, which is made longer by the drought of thirst. ¹⁸ And when they had said these things, there was great weeping and lamentation of all in the assembly, and for many hours with one voice they cried to God, saying: ¹⁹ We have sinned with our fathers, we have done unjustly, we have committed iniquity: ²⁰ Have thou mercy on us, because thou art good, or punish our iniquities by chastising us thyself, and deliver not them that trust in thee to a people that knoweth not thee, ²¹ That they may not say among the Gentiles: Where is their God? ²² And when being wearied with these cries, and tired with these weepings, they held their peace, ²³ Ozias rising up all in tears, said: Be of good courage, my brethren, and let us wait these five days for mercy from the Lord. ²⁴ For perhaps he will put a stop to his indignation, and will give glory to his own name. ²⁵ But if after five days be past there come no aid, we will do the things which you have spoken.

259. *The counsel and the prayer of Judith*

Judith 8:1-9:19

8 ¹ Now it came to pass, when Judith a widow had heard these words, who was the daughter of Merari, the son of Idox, the son of Joseph, the son of Ozias, the son of Elai, the son of Jamnor, the son of Gedeon, the son of Raphaim, the son of Achitob, the son of Melchias, the son of Enan, the son of Nathanas, the

son of Salathiel, the son of Simeon, the son of Ruben: ² And her husband was Manasses, who died in the time of the barley harvest: ³ For he was standing over them that bound sheaves in the field; and the heat came upon his head, and he died in Bethulia his own city, and was buried there with his fathers. ⁴ And Judith his relict was a widow now three years and six months. ⁵ And she made herself a private chamber in the upper part of her house, in which she abode shut up with her maids. ⁶ And she wore haircloth upon her loins, and fasted all the days of her life, except the sabbaths, and new moons, and the feasts of the house of Israel. ⁷ And she was exceedingly beautiful, and her husband left her great riches, and very many servants, and large possessions of herds of oxen, and flocks of sheep. ⁸ And she was greatly renowned among all, because she feared the Lord very much, neither was there any one that spoke an ill word of her. ⁹ When therefore she had heard that Ozias had promised that he would deliver up the city after the fifth day, she sent to the ancients Chabri and Charmi. ¹⁰ And they came to her, and she said to them: What is this word, by which Ozias hath consented to give up the city to the Assyrians, if within five days there come no aid to us? ¹¹ And who are you that tempt the Lord? ¹² This is not a word that may draw down mercy, but rather that may stir up wrath, and enkindle indignation. ¹³ You have set a time for the mercy of the Lord, and you have appointed him a day, according to your pleasure. ¹⁴ But forasmuch as the Lord is patient, let us be penitent for this same thing, and with many tears let us beg his pardon: ¹⁵ For God will not threaten like man, nor be inflamed to anger like the son of man. ¹⁶ And therefore let us humble our souls before him, and continuing in an humble spirit, in his service: ¹⁷ Let us ask the Lord with tears, that according to his will so he would shew his mercy to us: that as our heart is troubled by their pride, so also we may glorify in our humility. ¹⁸ For we have not followed the sins of our fathers, who forsook their God, and worshipped strange gods. ¹⁹ For which crime they were given up to their enemies, to the sword, and to pillage, and to confusion: but we know no other God but him. ²⁰ Let us humbly wait for his consolation, and the Lord our God will require our blood of the afflictions of our enemies, and he will humble all the nations that shall rise up against us, and bring them to disgrace. ²¹ And now, brethren, as you are the ancients among the people of God, and their very soul resteth upon you: comfort their hearts by your speech, that they may be mindful how our fathers were tempted that they might be proved, whether they worshipped their God truly. ²² They must remember how our father Abraham was tempted, and being proved by many tribulations, was made the friend of God. ²³ So Isaac, so Jacob, so Moses, and all that have pleased God, passed through many tribulations, remaining faithful. ²⁴ But they that did not receive the trials with the fear of the Lord, but uttered their impatience and the reproach of their murmuring against the Lord, ²⁵ Were destroyed by the destroyer, and perished by serpents. ²⁶ As for us therefore let us not revenge ourselves for these things which we suffer. ²⁷ But esteeming these very punishments to be less than our sins deserve, let us believe that these scourges of the Lord, with which like servants we are chastised, have happened for our amendment, and not for our destruction. ²⁸ And Ozias and the ancients said to her: All

things which thou hast spoken are true, and there is nothing to be reprehended in thy words. ²⁹ Now therefore pray for us, for thou art a holy woman, and one fearing God. ³⁰ And Judith said to them: As you know that what I have been able to say is of God: ³¹ So that which I intend to do prove ye if it be of God, and pray that God may strengthen my design. ³² You shall stand at the gate this night, and I will go out with my maidservant: and pray ye, that as you have said, in five days the Lord may look down upon his people Israel. ³³ But I desire that you search not into what I am doing, and till I bring you word let nothing else be done but to pray for me to the Lord our God. ³⁴ And Ozias the prince of Juda said to her: Go in peace, and the Lord be with thee to take revenge of our enemies. So returning they departed.

9 ¹ And when they were gone, Judith went into her oratory: and putting on haircloth, laid ashes on her head: and falling down prostrate before the Lord, she cried to the Lord, saying: ² Lord God of my father Simeon, who gavest him a sword to execute vengeance against strangers, who had defiled by their uncleanness, and uncovered the virgin unto confusion: ³ And who gavest their wives to be made a prey, and their daughters into captivity: and all their spoils to be divided to the servants, who were zealous with thy zeal: assist, I beseech thee, O Lord God, me a widow. ⁴ For thou hast done the things of old, and hast devised one thing after another: and what thou hast designed hath been done. ⁵ For all thy ways are prepared, and in thy providence thou hast placed thy judgments. ⁶ Look upon the camp of the Assyrians now, as thou wast pleased to look upon the camp of the Egyptians, when they pursued armed after thy servants, trusting in their chariots, and in their horsemen, and in a multitude of warriors. ⁷ But thou lookedst over their camp, and darkness wearied them. ⁸ The deep held their feet, and the waters overwhelmed them. ⁹ So may it be with these also, O Lord, who trust in their multitude, and in their chariots, and in their pikes, and in their shields, and in their arrows, and glory in their spears, ¹⁰ And know not that thou art our God, who destroyest wars from the beginning, and the Lord is thy name. ¹¹ Lift up thy arm as from the beginning, and crush their power with thy power: let their power fall in their wrath, who promise themselves to violate thy sanctuary, and defile the dwelling place of thy name, and to beat down with their sword the horn of thy altar. ¹² Bring to pass, O Lord, that his pride may be cut off with his own sword. ¹³ Let him be caught in the net of his own eyes in my regard, and do thou strike him by the graces of the words of my lips. ¹⁴ Give me constancy in my mind, that I may despise him: and fortitude that I may overthrow him. ¹⁵ For this will be a glorious monument for thy name, when he shall fall by the hand of a woman. ¹⁶ For thy power, O Lord, is not in a multitude, nor is thy pleasure in the strength of horses, nor from the beginning have the proud been acceptable to thee: but the prayer of the humble and the meek hath always pleased thee. ¹⁷ O God of the heavens, creator of the waters, and Lord of the whole creation, hear me a poor wretch, making supplication to thee, and presuming of thy mercy. ¹⁸ Remember, O Lord, thy covenant, and put thou words in my mouth, and strengthen the resolution in my heart, that thy house may continue in thy holiness: ¹⁹ And all nations may acknowledge that thou art God, and there is no other besides thee.

260. Judith in the camp

Judith 10:1-13:31

10 ¹ And it came to pass, when she had ceased to cry to the Lord, that she rose from the place wherein she lay prostrate before the Lord. ² And she called her maid, and going down into her house she took off her haircloth, and put away the garments of her widowhood, ³ And she washed her body, and anointed herself with the best ointment, and plaited the hair of her head, and put a bonnet upon her head, and clothed herself with the garments of her gladness, and put sandals on her feet, and took her bracelets, and lilies, and earlets, and rings, and adorned herself with all her ornaments. ⁴ And the Lord also gave her more beauty: because all this dressing up did not proceed from sensuality, but from virtue: and therefore the Lord increased this her beauty, so that she appeared to all men's eyes incomparably lovely. ⁵ And she gave to her maid a bottle of wine to carry, and a vessel of oil, and parched corn, and dry figs, and bread and cheese, and went out. ⁶ And when they came to the gate of the city, they found Ozias, and the ancients of the city waiting. ⁷ And when they saw her they were astonished, and admired her beauty exceedingly. ⁸ But they asked her no question, only they let her pass, saying: The God of our fathers give thee grace, and may he strengthen all the counsel of thy heart with his power, that Jerusalem may glory in thee, and thy name may be in the number of the holy and just. ⁹ And they that were there said, all with one voice: So be it, so be it. ¹⁰ But Judith praying to the Lord, passed through the gates, she and her maid. ¹¹ And it came to pass, when she went down the hill, about break of day, that the watchmen of the Assyrians met her, and stopped her, saying: Whence comest thou or whither goest thou? ¹² And she answered: I am a daughter of the Hebrews, and I am fled from them, because I knew they would be made a prey to you, because they despised you, and would not of their own accord yield themselves, that they might find mercy in your sight. ¹³ For this reason I thought with myself, saying: I will go to the presence of the prince Holofernes, that I may tell him their secrets, and shew him by what way he may take them, without the loss of one man of his army. ¹⁴ And when the men had heard her words, they beheld her face, and their eyes were amazed, for they wondered exceedingly at her beauty. ¹⁵ And they said to her: Thou hast saved thy life by taking this resolution, to come down to our lord. ¹⁶ And be assured of this, that when thou shalt stand before him, he will treat thee well, and thou wilt be most acceptable to his heart. And they brought her to the tent of Holofernes, telling him of her. ¹⁷ And when she was come into his presence, forthwith Holofernes was caught by his eyes. ¹⁸ And his officers said to him: Who can despise the people of the Hebrews, who have such beautiful women, that we should not think it worth our while for their sakes to fight against them? ¹⁹ And Judith seeing Holofernes sitting under a canopy, which was woven of purple and gold, with emeralds and precious stones: ²⁰ After she had looked on his face, bowed down to him, prostrating herself to the ground. And the servants of Holofernes lifted her up, by the command of their master.

11 ¹ Then Holofernes said to her: Be of good comfort, and fear not in thy heart: for I have never hurt a man that was willing to serve Nabuchodonosor the king. ² And if thy people had not despised me, I would never have lifted up my spear against them.

³ But now tell me, for what cause hast thou left them, and why it hath pleased thee to come to us? ⁴ And Judith said to him: Receive the words of thy handmaid, for if thou wilt follow the words of thy handmaid, the Lord will do with thee a perfect thing. ⁵ For as Nabuchodonosor the king of the earth liveth, and his power liveth which is in thee for chastising of all straying souls: not only men serve him through thee, but also the beasts of the field obey him. ⁶ For the industry of thy mind is spoken of among all nations, and it is told through the whole world, that thou only art excellent, and mighty in all his kingdom, and thy discipline is cried up in all provinces. ⁷ It is known also what Achior said, nor are we ignorant of what thou hast commanded to be done to him. ⁸ For it is certain that our God is so offended with sins, that he hath sent word by his prophets to the people, that he will deliver them up for their sins. ⁹ And because the children of Israel know they have offended their God, thy dread is upon them. ¹⁰ Moreover also a famine hath come upon them, and for drought of water they are already to be counted among the dead. ¹¹ And they have a design even to kill their cattle, and to drink the blood of them. ¹² And the consecrated things of the Lord their God which God forbade them to touch, in corn, wine, and oil, these have they purposed to make use of, and they design to consume the things which they ought not to touch with their hands: therefore because they do these things, it is certain they will be given up to destruction. ¹³ And I thy handmaid knowing this, am fled from them, and the Lord hath sent me to tell thee these very things. ¹⁴ For I thy handmaid worship God even now that I am with thee, and thy handmaid will go out, and I will pray to God, ¹⁵ And he will tell me when he will repay them for their sins, and I will come and tell thee, so that I may bring thee through the midst of Jerusalem, and thou shalt have all the people of Israel, as sheep that have no shepherd, and there shall not so much as one dog bark against thee: ¹⁶ Because these things are told me by the providence of God. ¹⁷ And because God is angry with them, I am sent to tell these very things to thee. ¹⁸ And all these words pleased Holofernes, and his servants, and they admired her wisdom, and they said one to another: ¹⁹ There is not such another woman upon earth in look, in beauty, and in sense of words. ²⁰ And Holofernes said to her: God hath done well who sent thee before the people, that thou mightest give them into our hands: ²¹ And because thy promise is good, if thy God shall do this for me, he shall also be my God, and thou shalt be great in the house of Nabuchodonosor, and thy name shall be renowned through all the earth.

12 ¹ Then he ordered that she should go in where his treasures were laid up, and bade her tarry there, and he appointed what should be given her from his own table. ² And Judith answered him and said: Now I cannot eat of these things which thou commandest to be given me, lest sin come upon me: but I will eat of the things which I have brought. ³ And Holofernes said to her: If these things which thou hast brought with thee fail thee, what shall we do for thee? ⁴ And Judith said: As thy soul liveth, my lord, thy handmaid shall not spend all these things till God do by my hand that which I have purposed. And his servants brought her into the tent which he had commanded. ⁵ And when she was going in, she desired that she might have liberty to go out at night and before day to prayer, and to beseech the Lord.

⁶ And he commanded his chamberlains, that she might go out and in, to adore her God as she pleased, for three days. ⁷ And she went out in the nights into the valley of Bethulia, and washed herself in a fountain of water. ⁸ And as she came up, she prayed to the Lord the God of Israel, that he would direct her way to the deliverance of his people. ⁹ And going in, she remained pure in the tent, until she took her own meat in the evening. ¹⁰ And it came to pass on the fourth day, that Holofernes made a supper for his servants, and said to Vagao his eunuch: Go, and persuade that Hebrew woman, to consent of her own accord to dwell with me. ¹¹ For it is looked upon as shameful among the Assyrians, if a woman mock a man, by doing so as to pass free from him. ¹² Then Vagao went in to Judith, and said: Let not my good maid be afraid to go in to my lord, that she may be honoured before his face, that she may eat with him and drink wine and be merry. ¹³ And Judith answered him: Who am I, that I should gainsay my lord? ¹⁴ All that shall be good and best before his eyes, I will do. And whatsoever shall please him, that shall be best to me all the days of my life. ¹⁵ And she arose and dressed herself out with her garments, and going in she stood before his face. ¹⁶ And the heart of Holofernes was smitten, for he was burning with the desire of her. ¹⁷ And Holofernes said to her: Drink now, and sit down and be merry; for thou hast found favour before me. ¹⁸ And Judith said: I will drink my lord, because my life is magnified this day above all my days. ¹⁹ And she took and ate and drank before him what her maid had prepared for her. ²⁰ And Holofernes was made merry on her occasion, and drank exceeding much wine, so much as he had never drunk in his life.

13 ¹ And when it was grown late, his servants made haste to their lodgings, and Vagao shut the chamber doors, and went his way. ² And they were all overcharged with wine. ³ And Judith was alone in the chamber. ⁴ But Holofernes lay on his bed, fast asleep, being exceedingly drunk. ⁵ And Judith spoke to her maid to stand without before the chamber, and to watch: ⁶ And Judith stood before the bed praying with tears, and the motion of her lips in silence, ⁷ Saying: Strengthen me, O Lord God of Israel, and in this hour look on the works of my hands, that as thou hast promised, thou mayst raise up Jerusalem thy city: and that I may bring to pass that which I have purposed, having a belief that it might be done by thee. ⁸ And when she had said this, she went to the pillar that was at his bed's head, and loosed his sword that hung tied upon it. ⁹ And when she had drawn it out, she took him by the hair of his head, and said: Strengthen me, O Lord God, at this hour. ¹⁰ And she struck twice upon his neck, and cut off his head, and took off his canopy from the pillars, and rolled away his headless body. ¹¹ And after a while she went out, and delivered the head of Holofernes to her maid, and bade her put it into her wallet. ¹² And they two went out according to their custom, as it were to prayer, and they passed the camp, and having compassed the valley, they came to the gate of the city. ¹³ And Judith from afar off cried to the watchmen upon the walls: Open the gates for God is with us, who hath shewn his power in Israel. ¹⁴ And it came to pass, when the men had heard her voice, that they called the ancients of the city. ¹⁵ And all ran to meet her from the least to the greatest: for they now had no hopes that she would come. ¹⁶ And lighting up lights they all gathered round about her: and she went up to a higher place,

and commanded silence to be made. And when all had held their peace, ¹⁷ Judith said: Praise ye the Lord our God, who hath not forsaken them that hope in him. ¹⁸ And by me his handmaid he hath fulfilled his mercy, which he promised to the house of Israel: and he hath killed the enemy of his people by my hand this night. ¹⁹ Then she brought forth the head of Holofernes out of the wallet, and shewed it them, saying: Behold the head of Holofernes the general of the army of the Assyrians, and behold his canopy, wherein he lay in his drunkenness, where the Lord our God slew him by the hand of a woman. ²⁰ But as the same Lord liveth, his angel hath been my keeper both going hence, and abiding there, and returning from thence hither: and the Lord hath not suffered me his handmaid to be defiled, but hath brought me back to you without pollution of sin, rejoicing for his victory, for my escape, and for your deliverance. ²¹ Give all of you glory to him, because he is good, because his mercy endureth for ever. ²² And they all adored the Lord, and said to her: The Lord hath blessed thee by his power, because by thee he hath brought our enemies to nought. ²³ And Ozias the prince of the people of Israel, said to her: Blessed art thou, O daughter, by the Lord the most high God, above all women upon the earth. ²⁴ Blessed be the Lord who made heaven and earth, who hath directed thee to the cutting off the head of the prince of our enemies. ²⁵ Because he hath so magnified thy name this day, that thy praise shall not depart out of the mouth of men who shall be mindful of the power of the Lord for ever, for that thou hast not spared thy life, by reason of the distress and tribulation of thy people, but hast prevented our ruin in the presence of our God. ²⁶ And all the people said: So be it, so be it. ²⁷ And Achior being called for came, and Judith said to him: The God of Israel, to whom thou gavest testimony, that he revengeth himself of his enemies, he hath cut off the head of all the unbelievers this night by my hand. ²⁸ And that thou mayst find that it is so, behold the head of Holofernes, who in the contempt of his pride despised the God of Israel: and threatened them with death, saying: When the people of Israel shall be taken, I will command thy sides to be pierced with a sword. ²⁹ Then Achior seeing the head of Holofernes, being seized with a great fear he fell on his face upon the earth, and his soul swooned away. ³⁰ But after he had recovered his spirits he fell down at her feet, and revered her, and said: ³¹ Blessed art thou by thy God in every tabernacle of Jacob, for in every nation which shall hear thy name, the God of Israel shall be magnified on occasion of thee.

261. The rout, and the canticle of Judith

Judith 14:1-16:31

14 ¹ And Judith said to all the people: Hear me, my brethren, hang ye up this head upon our walls. ² And as soon as the sun shall rise, let every man take his arms, and rush ye out, not as going down beneath, but as making an assault. ³ Then the watchmen must needs run to awake their prince for the battle. ⁴ And when the captains of them shall run to the tent of Holofernes, and shall find him without his head wallowing in his blood, fear shall fall upon them. ⁵ And when you shall know that they are fleeing, go after them securely, for the Lord will destroy them under your feet. ⁶ Then Achior seeing the power that the God of Israel had wrought, leaving the religion of the Gentiles, he believed God, and circumcised the flesh of his foreskin, and was

joined to the people of Israel, with all the succession of his kindred until this present day. ⁷ And immediately at break of day, they hung up the head of Holofernes upon the walls, and every man took his arms, and they went out with a great noise and shouting. ⁸ And the watchmen seeing this, ran to the tent of Holofernes. ⁹ And they that were in the tent came, and made a noise, before the door of the chamber to awake him, endeavouring by art to break his rest, that Holofernes might awake, not by their calling him, but by their noise. ¹⁰ For no man durst knock, or open and go into the chamber of the general of the Assyrians. ¹¹ But when his captains and tribunes were come, and all the chiefs of the army of the king of the Assyrians, they said to the chamberlains: ¹² Go in, and awake him, for the mice, coming out of their holes, have presumed to challenge us to fight. ¹³ Then Vagao going into his chamber, stood before the curtain, and made a clapping with his hands: for he thought that he was sleeping with Judith. ¹⁴ But when with hearkening, he perceived no motion of one lying, he came near to the curtain, and lifting it up, and seeing the body of Holofernes, lying upon the ground, without the head, weltering in his blood, he cried out with a loud voice, with weeping, and rent his garments. ¹⁵ And he went into the tent of Judith, and not finding her, he ran out to the people, ¹⁶ And said: One Hebrew woman hath made confusion in the house of king Nabuchodonosor: for behold Holofernes lieth upon the ground, and his head is not upon him. ¹⁷ Now when the chiefs of the army of the Assyrians had heard this, they all rent their garments, and an intolerable fear and dread fell upon them, and their minds were troubled exceedingly. ¹⁸ And there was a very great cry in the midst of their camp.

15 ¹ And when all the army heard that Holofernes was beheaded, courage and counsel fled from them, and being seized with trembling and fear they thought only to save themselves by flight. ² So that no one spoke to his neighbour, but hanging down the head, leaving all things behind, they made haste to escape from the Hebrews, who, as they heard, were coming armed upon them, and fled by the ways of the fields, and the paths of the hills. ³ So the children of Israel seeing them fleeing, followed after them. And they went down sounding with trumpets and shouting after them. ⁴ And because the Assyrians were not united together, they went without order in their flight; but the children of Israel pursuing in one body, defeated all that they could find. ⁵ And Ozias sent messengers through all the cities and countries of Israel. ⁶ And every country, and every city, sent their chosen young men armed after them, and they pursued them with the edge of the sword until they came to the extremities of their confines. ⁷ And the rest that were in Bethulia went into the camp of the Assyrians, and took away the spoils which the Assyrians in their flight had left behind them, and they were laden exceedingly, ⁸ But they that returned conquerors to Bethulia, brought with them all things that were theirs, so that there was no numbering of their cattle, and beasts, and all their moveables, insomuch that from the least to the greatest all were made rich by their spoils. ⁹ And Joachim the high priest came from Jerusalem to Bethulia with all his ancients to see Judith. ¹⁰ And when she was come out to him, they all blessed her with one voice, saying: Thou art the glory of Jerusalem, thou art the joy of Israel, thou art the honour of our people: ¹¹ For thou hast

done manfully, and thy heart has been strengthened, because thou hast loved chastity, and after thy husband hast not known any other: therefore also the hand of the Lord hath strengthened thee, and therefore thou shalt be blessed for ever. ¹² And all the people said: So be it, so be it. ¹³ And thirty days were scarce sufficient for the people of Israel to gather up the spoils of the Assyrians. ¹⁴ But all those things that were proved to be the peculiar goods of Holofernes, they gave to Judith in gold, and silver, and garments and precious stones, and all household stuff, and they all were delivered to her by the people. ¹⁵ And all the people rejoiced, with the women, and virgins, and young men, playing on instruments and harps.

16 ¹ Then Judith sung this canticle to the Lord, saying: ² Begin ye to the Lord with timbrels, sing ye to the Lord with cymbals, tune unto him a new psalm, extol and call upon his name. ³ The Lord putteth an end to wars, the Lord is his name. ⁴ He hath set his camp in the midst of his people, to deliver us from the hand of all our enemies. ⁵ The Assyrian came out of the mountains from the north in the multitude of his strength: his multitude stopped up the torrents, and their horses covered the valleys. ⁶ He bragged that he would set my borders on fire, and kill my young men with the sword, to make my infants a prey, and my virgins captives. ⁷ But the almighty Lord hath struck him, and hath delivered him into the hands of a woman, and hath slain him. ⁸ For their mighty one did not fall by young men, neither did the sons of Titan strike him, nor tall giants oppose themselves to him, but Judith the daughter of Merari weakened him with the beauty of her face. ⁹ For she put off her the garments of widowhood, and put on her the garments of joy, to give joy to the children of Israel. ¹⁰ She anointed her face with ointment, and bound up her locks with a crown, she took a new robe to deceive him. ¹¹ Her sandals ravished his eyes, her beauty made his soul her captive, with a sword she cut off his head. ¹² The Persians quaked at her constancy, and the Medes at her boldness. ¹³ Then the camp of the Assyrians howled, when my lowly ones appeared, parched with thirst. ¹⁴ The sons of the damsels have pierced them through, and they have killed them like children fleeing away: they perished in battle before the face of the Lord my God. ¹⁵ Let us sing a hymn to the Lord, let us sing a new hymn to our God. ¹⁶ O Adonai, Lord, great art thou, and glorious in thy power, and no one can overcome thee. ¹⁷ Let all thy creatures serve thee: because thou hast spoken, and they were made: thou didst send forth thy spirit, and they were created, and there is no one that can resist thy voice. ¹⁸ The mountains shall be moved from the foundations with the waters: the rocks shall melt as wax before thy face. ¹⁹ But they that fear thee, shall be great with thee in all things. ²⁰ Woe be to the nation that riseth up against my people: for the Lord almighty will take revenge on them, in the day of judgment he will visit them. ²¹ For he will give fire, and worms into their flesh, that they may burn, and may feel for ever. ²² And it came to pass after these things, that all the people, after the victory, came to Jerusalem to adore the Lord: and as soon as they were purified, they all offered holocausts, and vows, and their promises. ²³ And Judith offered for an anathema of oblivion all the arms of Holofernes, which the people gave her, and the canopy that she had taken away out of his chamber. ²⁴ And the people were joyful in the sight

of the sanctuary, and for three months the joy of this victory was celebrated with Judith. ²⁵ And after those days every man returned to his house, and Judith was made great in Bethulia, and she was most renowned in all the land of Israel. ²⁶ And chastity was joined to her virtue, so that she knew no man all the days of her life, after the death of Manasses her husband. ²⁷ And on festival days she came forth with great glory. ²⁸ And she abode in her husband's house a hundred and five years, and made her handmaid free, and she died, and was buried with her husband in Bethulia. ²⁹ And all the people mourned for seven days. ³⁰ And all the time of her life there was none that troubled Israel, nor many years after her death. ³¹ But the day of the festivity of this victory is received by the Hebrews in the number of holy days, and is religiously observed by the Jews from that time until this day.

262. Psalm 125

Psalms 125:1-7

Vulgate 125 = Hebrew 126: "When the Lord brought back the captivity of Sion."

125 ¹ When the Lord brought back the captivity of Sion, we became like men comforted. ² Then was our mouth filled with gladness; and our tongue with joy. Then shall they say among the Gentiles: The Lord hath done great things for them. ³ The Lord hath done great things for us: we are become joyful. ⁴ Turn again our captivity, O Lord, as a stream in the south. ⁵ They that sow in tears shall reap in joy. ⁶ Going they went and wept, casting their seeds. ⁷ But coming they shall come with joyfulness, carrying their sheaves.

MACCABEAN REVOLT

1 Machabees entire, with the two martyr chapters of 2 Machabees. Both books are deuterocanonical and belong to the 73-book canon; an abridgement built on a 66-book canon has no period here at all, and the centuries before Christ go silent.

263. The desolation of the sanctuary

1 Maccabees 1:1-67

The Greek kingdoms, and the abomination set upon the altar. Deuterocanonical.

1 ¹ Now it came to pass, after that Alexander the son of Philip the Macedonian, who first reigned in Greece, coming out of the land of Cethim, had overthrown Darius, king of the Persians and Medes: ² He fought many battles, and took the strong holds of all, and slew the kings of the earth: ³ And he went through even to the ends of the earth: and took the spoils of many nations: and the earth was quiet before him. ⁴ And he gathered a power, and a very strong army: and his heart was exalted and lifted up: ⁵ And he subdued countries of nations, and princes; and they became tributaries to him. ⁶ And after these things, he fell down upon his bed, and knew that he should die. ⁷ And he called his servants, the nobles that were brought up with him from his youth: and he divided his kingdom among them, while he was yet alive. ⁸ And Alexander reigned twelve years, and he died. ⁹ And his servants made themselves kings, every one in his place: ¹⁰ And they all put crowns upon themselves after his death, and their sons after

them, many years; and evils were multiplied in the earth. ¹¹ And there came out of them a wicked root, Antiochus the Illustrious, the son of king Antiochus, who had been a hostage at Rome: and he reigned in the hundred and thirty-seventh year of the kingdom of the Greeks. ¹² In those days there went out of Israel wicked men, and they persuaded many, saying: Let us go and make a covenant with the heathens that are round about us: for since we departed from them, many evils have befallen us. ¹³ And the word seemed good in their eyes. ¹⁴ And some of the people determined to do this, and went to the king: and he gave them license to do after the ordinances of the heathens. ¹⁵ And they built a place of exercise in Jerusalem, according to the laws of the nations: ¹⁶ And they made themselves prepuces, and departed from the holy covenant, and joined themselves to the heathens, and were sold to do evil: ¹⁷ And the kingdom was established before Antiochus, and he had a mind to reign over the land of Egypt, that he might reign over two kingdoms. ¹⁸ And he entered into Egypt with a great multitude, with chariots, and elephants, and horsemen, and a great number of ships: ¹⁹ And he made war against Ptolemee king of Egypt; but Ptolemee was afraid at his presence and fled, and many were wounded unto death. ²⁰ And he took the strong cities in the land of Egypt: and he took the spoils of the land of Egypt. ²¹ And after Antiochus had ravaged Egypt, in the hundred and forty-third year, he returned and went up against Israel. ²² And he went up to Jerusalem, with a great multitude. ²³ And he proudly entered into the sanctuary, and took away the golden altar, and the candlestick of light, and all the vessels thereof, and the table of proposition, and the pouring vessels, and the vials, and the little mortars of gold, and the veil, and the crowns, and the golden ornament that was before the temple: and he broke them all in pieces. ²⁴ And he took the silver and gold, and the precious vessels: and he took the hidden treasures, which he found: and when he had taken all away, he departed into his own country. ²⁵ And he made a great slaughter of men, and spoke very proudly. ²⁶ And there was great mourning in Israel, and in every place where they were: ²⁷ And the princes, and the ancients mourned, and the virgins and the young men were made feeble, and the beauty of the women was changed. ²⁸ Every bridegroom took up lamentation: and the bride that sat in the marriage bed, mourned: ²⁹ And the land was moved for the inhabitants thereof, and all the house of Jacob was covered with confusion. ³⁰ And after two full years, the king sent the chief collector of his tributes to the cities of Juda, and he came to Jerusalem with a great multitude. ³¹ And he spoke to them peaceable words in deceit; and they believed him. ³² And he fell upon the city suddenly, and struck it with a great slaughter, and destroyed much people in Israel. ³³ And he took the spoils of the city, and burnt it with fire, and threw down the houses thereof, and the walls thereof round about: ³⁴ And they took the women captive, and the children, and the cattle they possessed. ³⁵ And they built the city of David with a great and strong wall, and with strong towers, and made it a fortress for them: ³⁶ And they placed there a sinful nation, wicked men, and they fortified themselves therein: and they stored up armour and victuals, and gathered together the spoils of Jerusalem; ³⁷ And laid them up there: and they became a great snare. ³⁸ And this was a place to lie in wait against the sanctuary, and an evil

devil in Israel. ³⁹ And they shed innocent blood round about the sanctuary, and defiled the holy place. ⁴⁰ And the inhabitants of Jerusalem fled away by reason of them and the city was made the habitation of strangers, and she became a stranger to her own seed, and her children forsook her. ⁴¹ Her sanctuary was desolate like a wilderness, her festival days were turned into mourning, her sabbaths into reproach, her honours were brought to nothing. ⁴² Her dishonour was increased according to her glory, and her excellency was turned into mourning. ⁴³ And king Antiochus wrote to all his kingdom, that all the people should be one: and every one should leave his own law. ⁴⁴ And all nations consented, according to the word of king Antiochus. ⁴⁵ And many of Israel consented to his service, and they sacrificed to idols, and profaned the sabbath. ⁴⁶ And the king sent letters by the hands of messengers to Jerusalem, and to all the cities of Juda; that they should follow the law of the nations of the earth. ⁴⁷ And should forbid holocausts and sacrifices, and atonements to be made in the temple of God. ⁴⁸ And should prohibit the sabbath, and the festival days to be celebrated. ⁴⁹ And he commanded the holy places to be profaned, and the holy people of Israel. ⁵⁰ And he commanded altars to be built, and temples, and idols, and swine's flesh to be immolated, and unclean beasts, ⁵¹ And that they should leave their children uncircumcised, and let their souls be defiled with all uncleannesses, and abominations, to the end that they should forget the law, and should change all the justifications of God. ⁵² And that whosoever would not do according to the word of king Antiochus, should be put to death. ⁵³ According to all these words he wrote to his whole kingdom: and he appointed rulers over the people that should force them to do these things. ⁵⁴ And they commanded the cities of Juda to sacrifice. ⁵⁵ Then many of the people were gathered to them that had forsaken the law of the Lord: and they committed evils in the land: ⁵⁶ And they drove away the people of Israel into lurking holes, and into the secret places of fugitives. ⁵⁷ On the fifteenth day of the month, Casleu, in the hundred and forty-fifth year, king Antiochus set up the abominable idol of desolation upon the altar of God, and they built altars throughout all the cities of Juda round about: ⁵⁸ And they burnt incense, and sacrificed at the doors of the houses and in the streets. ⁵⁹ And they cut in pieces, and burnt with fire the books of the law of God: ⁶⁰ And every one with whom the books of the testament of the Lord were found, and whosoever observed the law of the Lord, they put to death, according to the edict of the king. ⁶¹ Thus by their power did they deal with the people of Israel, that were found in the cities month after month. ⁶² And on the five and twentieth day of the month they sacrificed upon the altar of the idol that was over against the altar of God. ⁶³ Now the women that circumcised their children were slain according to the commandment of king Antiochus, ⁶⁴ And they hanged the children about their necks in all their houses: and those that had circumcised them, they put to death. ⁶⁵ And many of the people of Israel determined with themselves, that they would not eat unclean things: and they chose rather to die, than to be defiled with unclean meats: ⁶⁶ And they would not break the holy law of God and they were put to death: ⁶⁷ And there was very great wrath upon the people.

264. Mathathias, and the beginning of the revolt*1 Maccabees 2:1-70*

2 ¹ In those days arose Mathathias, the son of John, the son of Simeon, a priest of the sons of Joarib, from Jerusalem, and he abode in the mountain of Modin: ² And he had five sons: John, who was surnamed Gaddis: ³ And Simon, who was surnamed Thasi; ⁴ And Judas, who was called Machabeus; ⁵ And Eleazar, who was surnamed Abaron; and Jonathan, who was surnamed Apphus. ⁶ These saw the evils that were done in the people of Juda, and in Jerusalem. ⁷ And Mathathias said: Woe is me, wherefore was I born to see the ruin of my people, and the ruin of the holy city, and to dwell there, when it is given into the hands of the enemies? ⁸ The holy places are come into the hands of strangers her temple is become as a man without honour. ⁹ The vessels of her glory are carried away captive; her old men are murdered in the streets, and her young men are fallen by the sword of the enemies. ¹⁰ What nation hath not inherited her kingdom, and gotten of her spoils? ¹¹ All her ornaments are taken away. She that was free is made a slave. ¹² And behold our sanctuary, and our beauty, and our glory is laid waste, and the Gentiles have defiled them. ¹³ To what end then should we live any longer? ¹⁴ And Mathathias and his sons rent their garments, and they covered themselves with haircloth, and made great lamentation. ¹⁵ And they that were sent from king Antiochus, came thither, to compel them that were fled into the city of Modin, to sacrifice, and to burn incense, and to depart from the law of God. ¹⁶ And many of the people of Israel consented and came to them: but Mathathias and his sons stood firm. ¹⁷ And they that were sent from Antiochus, answering, said to Mathathias: Thou art a ruler, and an honourable, and great man in this city, and adorned with sons, and brethren. ¹⁸ Therefore, come thou first, and obey the king's commandment, as all nations have done, and the men of Juda, and they that remain in Jerusalem: and thou, and thy sons shall be in the number of the king's friends, and enriched with gold, and silver, and many presents. ¹⁹ Then Mathathias answered, and said with a loud voice: Although all nations obey king Antiochus, so as to depart every man from the service of the law of his fathers, and consent to his commandments: ²⁰ I and my sons, and my brethren will obey the law of our fathers. ²¹ God be merciful unto us: it is not profitable for us to forsake the law, and the justices of God: ²² We will not hearken to the words of king Antiochus, neither will we sacrifice and transgress the commandments of our law, to go another way. ²³ Now as he left off speaking these words, there came a certain Jew in the sight of all to sacrifice to the idols upon the altar in the city of Modin, according to the king's commandment. ²⁴ And Mathathias saw, and was grieved, and his reins trembled, and his wrath was kindled according to the judgment of the law, and running upon him he slew him upon the altar: ²⁵ Moreover the man whom king Antiochus had sent, who compelled them to sacrifice, he slew at the same time, and pulled down the altar, ²⁶ And shewed zeal for the law, as Phinees did by Zamri, the son of Salomi. ²⁷ And Mathathias cried out in the city with a loud voice, saying: Every one that hath zeal for the law, and maintaineth the testament, let him follow me. ²⁸ So he and his sons fled into the mountains, and left all that they had in the city. ²⁹ Then many that sought after judgment, and justice, went

down into the desert: ³⁰ And they abode there, they and their children, and their wives, and their cattle: because afflictions increased upon them. ³¹ And it was told to the king's men, and to the army that was in Jerusalem, in the city of David, that certain men, who had broken the king's commandment, were gone away into the secret places in the wilderness, and that many were gone after them. ³² And forthwith they went out towards them, and made war against them on the sabbath day. ³³ And they said to them: Do you still resist? come forth, and do according to the edict of king Antiochus, and you shall live. ³⁴ And they said: We will not come forth, neither will we obey the king's edict, to profane the sabbath day. ³⁵ And they made haste to give them battle. ³⁶ But they answered them not, neither did they cast a stone at them, nor stopped up the secret places, ³⁷ Saying: Let us all die in our innocency: and heaven and earth shall be witnesses for us, that you put us to death wrongfully. ³⁸ So they gave them battle on the sabbath: and they were slain, with their wives, and their children, and their cattle, to the number of a thousand persons. ³⁹ And Mathathias and his friends heard of it, and they mourned for them exceedingly. ⁴⁰ And every man said to his neighbour: If we shall all do as our brethren have done, and not fight against the heathens for our lives, and our justifications, they will now quickly root us out of the earth. ⁴¹ And they determined in that day, saying: Whosoever shall come up against us to fight on the sabbath day, we will fight against him: and we will not all die, as our brethren that were slain in the secret places. ⁴² Then was assembled to them the congregation of the Assideans, the stoutest of Israel, every one that had a good will for the law. ⁴³ And all they that fled from the evils, joined themselves to them, and were a support to them. ⁴⁴ And they gathered an army, and slew the sinners in their wrath, and the wicked men in their indignation: and the rest fled to the nations for safety. ⁴⁵ And Mathathias and his friends went round about, and they threw down the altars: ⁴⁶ And they circumcised all the children whom they found in the confines of Israel that were uncircumcised: and they did valiantly. ⁴⁷ And they pursued after the children of pride, and the work prospered in their hands: ⁴⁸ And they recovered the law out of the hands of the nations, and out of the hands of the kings: and they yielded not the horn to the sinner. ⁴⁹ Now the days drew near that Mathathias should die, and he said to his sons: Now hath pride and chastisement gotten strength, and the time of destruction, and the wrath of indignation: ⁵⁰ Now, therefore, O my sons, be ye zealous for the law, and give your lives for the covenant of your fathers. ⁵¹ And call to remembrance the works of the fathers, which they have done in their generations: and you shall receive great glory, and an everlasting name. ⁵² Was not Abraham found faithful in temptation, and it was reputed to him unto justice? ⁵³ Joseph, in the time of his distress, kept the commandment, and he was made lord of Egypt. ⁵⁴ Phinees, our father, by being fervent in the zeal of God, received the covenant of an everlasting priesthood. ⁵⁵ Jesus, whilst he fulfilled the word, was made ruler in Israel. ⁵⁶ Caleb, for bearing witness before the congregation, received an inheritance. ⁵⁷ David, by his mercy, obtained the throne of an everlasting kingdom. ⁵⁸ Elias, while he is full of zeal for the law, was taken up into heaven. ⁵⁹ Ananias and Azarias and Misael, by believing, were delivered out of the flame. ⁶⁰ Daniel, in his

innocency, was delivered out of the mouth of the lions. ⁶¹ And thus consider, through all generations: that none that trust in him, fail in strength. ⁶² And fear not the words of a sinful man, for his glory is dung and worms: ⁶³ Today he is lifted up, and tomorrow he shall not be found, because he is returned into his earth and his thought is come to nothing. ⁶⁴ You, therefore, my sons, take courage, and behave manfully in the law: for by it you shall be glorious. ⁶⁵ And behold, I know that your brother Simon is a man of counsel: give ear to him always, and he shall be a father to you. ⁶⁶ And Judas Machabeus, who is valiant and strong from his youth up, let him be the leader of your army, and he shall manage the war of the people. ⁶⁷ And you shall take to you all that observe the law: and revenge ye the wrong of your people. ⁶⁸ Render to the Gentiles their reward, and take heed to the precepts of the law. ⁶⁹ And he blessed them, and was joined to his fathers. ⁷⁰ And he died in the hundred and forty-sixth year: and he was buried by his sons in the sepulchres of his fathers, in Modin, and all Israel mourned for him with great mourning.

265. Judas Machabeus takes the lead

1 Maccabees 3:1-60

3 ¹ Then his son Judas, called Machabeus, rose up in his stead. ² And all his brethren helped him, and all they that had joined themselves to his father, and they fought with cheerfulness the battle of Israel. ³ And he got his people great honour, and put on a breastplate as a giant, and girt his warlike armour about him in battles, and protected the camp with his sword. ⁴ In his acts he was like a lion, and like a lion's whelp roaring for his prey. ⁵ And he pursued the wicked and sought them out, and them that troubled his people he burnt with fire: ⁶ And his enemies were driven away for fear of him, and all the workers of iniquity were troubled: and salvation prospered in his hand. ⁷ And he grieved many kings, and made Jacob glad with his works, and his memory is blessed for ever. ⁸ And he went through the cities of Juda, and destroyed the wicked out of them, and turned away wrath from Israel. ⁹ And he was renowned even to the utmost part of the earth, and he gathered them that were perishing. ¹⁰ And Apollonius gathered together the Gentiles, and a numerous and great army from Samaria, to make war against Israel. ¹¹ And Judas understood it, and went forth to meet him: and he overthrew him, and killed him: and many fell down slain, and the rest fled away. ¹² And he took their spoils, and Judas took the sword of Apollonius, and fought with it all his lifetime. ¹³ And Seron, captain of the army of Syria, heard that Judas had assembled a company of the faithful, and a congregation with him, ¹⁴ And he said I will get me a name, and will be glorified in the kingdom, and will overthrow Judas, and those that are with him, that have despised the edict of the king. ¹⁵ And he made himself ready; and the host of the wicked went up with him, strong succours, to be revenged of the children of Israel. ¹⁶ And they approached even as far as Bethoron: and Judas went forth to meet him, with a small company. ¹⁷ But when they saw the army coming to meet them, they said to Judas: How shall we, being few, be able to fight against so great a multitude, and so strong, and we are ready to faint with fasting today? ¹⁸ And Judas said: It is an easy matter for many to be shut up in the hands of a few: and there is no difference in the sight of the God of heaven to deliver with a great multitude, or with a small

company: ¹⁹ For the success of war is not in the multitude of the army, but strength cometh from heaven. ²⁰ They come against us with an insolent multitude, and with pride, to destroy us, and our wives, and our children, and to take our spoils. ²¹ But we will fight for our lives, and our laws: ²² And the Lord himself will overthrow them before our face, but as for you, fear them not. ²³ And as soon as he had made an end of speaking, he rushed suddenly upon them: and Seron, and his host were overthrown before him: ²⁴ And he pursued him by the descent of Bethoron, even to the plain, and there fell of them eight hundred men, and the rest fled into the land of the Philistines. ²⁵ And the fear of Judas, and of his brethren, and the dread of them, fell upon all the nations round about them. ²⁶ And his fame came to the king, and all nations told of the battles of Judas. ²⁷ Now when king Antiochus heard these words, he was angry in his mind: and he sent, and gathered the forces of all his kingdom, an exceeding strong army. ²⁸ And he opened his treasury, and gave out pay to the army for a year: and he commanded them, that they should be ready for all things. ²⁹ And he perceived that the money of his treasures failed, and that the tributes of the country were small, because of the dissension, and the evil that he had brought upon the land, that he might take away the laws of old times: ³⁰ And he feared that he should not have as formerly enough for charges and gifts, which he had given before with a liberal hand: for he had abounded more than the kings that had been before him. ³¹ And he was greatly perplexed in mind, and purposed to go into Persia, and to take tributes of the countries, and to gather much money. ³² And he left Lysias, a nobleman of the blood royal to oversee the affairs of the kingdom from the river Euphrates even to the river of Egypt: ³³ And to bring up his son, Antiochus, till he came again. ³⁴ And he delivered to him half the army, and the elephants: and he gave him charge concerning all that he would have done, and concerning the inhabitants of Judea, and Jerusalem. ³⁵ And that he should send an army against them to destroy and root out the strength of Israel, and the remnant of Jerusalem, and to take away the memory of them from that place. ³⁶ And that he should settle strangers, to dwell in all their coasts, and divide their land by lot. ³⁷ So the king took the half of the army that remained, and went forth from Antioch, the chief city of his kingdom, in the hundred and forty-seventh year: and he passed over the river Euphrates, and went through the higher countries. ³⁸ Then Lysias chose Ptolemee, the son of Dorymenus, and Nicanor, and Gorgias, mighty men of the king's friends. ³⁹ And he sent with them forty thousand men, and seven thousand horsemen: to go into the land of Juda, and to destroy it, according to the king's orders. ⁴⁰ So they went forth with all their power, and came, and pitched near Emmaus, in the plain country. ⁴¹ And the merchants of the countries heard the fame of them: and they took silver and gold in abundance, and servants: and they came into the camp, to buy the children of Israel for slaves: and there were joined to them the forces of Syria, and of the land of the strangers. ⁴² And Judas, and his brethren, saw that evils were multiplied, and that the armies approached to their borders: and they knew the orders the king had given to destroy the people, and utterly abolish them. ⁴³ And they said, every man to his neighbour: Let us raise up the low condition of our people, and let us fight for our people, and our

sanctuary. ⁴⁴ And the assembly was gathered, that they might be ready for battle, and that they might pray, and ask mercy and compassion. ⁴⁵ Now Jerusalem was not inhabited, but was like a desert: there was none of her children that went in or out: and the sanctuary was trodden down: and the children of strangers were in the castle, there was the habitation of the Gentiles: and joy was taken away from Jacob, and the pipe and harp ceased there. ⁴⁶ And they assembled together, and came to Maspha, over against Jerusalem: for in Maspha was a place of prayer heretofore in Israel. ⁴⁷ And they fasted that day, and put on haircloth, and put ashes upon their heads: and they rent their garments: ⁴⁸ And they laid open the books of the law, in which the Gentiles searched for the likeness of their idols: ⁴⁹ And they brought the priestly ornaments, and the first fruits and tithes, and stirred up the Nazarites that had fulfilled their days: ⁵⁰ And they cried with a loud voice toward heaven, saying: What shall we do with these, and whither shall we carry them? ⁵¹ For thy holies are trodden down, and are profaned, and thy priests are in mourning, and are brought low. ⁵² And behold the nations are come together against us, to destroy us: thou knowest what they intend against us. ⁵³ How shall we be able to stand before their face, unless thou, O God, help us? ⁵⁴ Then they sounded with trumpets, and cried out with a loud voice. ⁵⁵ And after this, Judas appointed captains over the people, over thousands, and over hundreds, and over fifties, and over tens. ⁵⁶ And he said to them that were building houses, or had betrothed wives, or were planting vineyards, or were fearful, that they should return every man to his house, according to the law. ⁵⁷ So they removed the camp, and pitched on the south side of Emmaus. ⁵⁸ And Judas said: Gird yourselves, and be valiant men, and be ready against the morning, that you may fight with these nations that are assembled against us to destroy us and our sanctuary. ⁵⁹ For it is better for us to die in battle, than to see the evils of our nation, and of the holies: ⁶⁰ Nevertheless, as it shall be the will of God in heaven, so be it done.

266. Emmaus and Bethsura

1 Maccabees 4:1-35

4 ¹ Then Gorgias took five thousand men, and a thousand of the best horsemen; and they removed out of the camp by night. ² That they might come upon the camp of the Jews and strike them suddenly: and the men that were of the castle were their guides. ³ And Judas heard of it, and rose up, he and the valiant men, to attack the king's forces that were in Emmaus. ⁴ For as yet the army was dispersed from the camp. ⁵ And Gorgias came by night into the camp of Judas, and found no man; and he sought them in the mountains: for he said: These men flee from us. ⁶ And when it was day, Judas shewed himself in the plain with three thousand men only, who neither had armour nor swords: ⁷ And they saw the camp of the Gentiles that it was strong, and the men in breastplates, and the horsemen round about them, and these were trained up to war. ⁸ And Judas said to the men that were with him: Fear ye not their multitude, neither be ye afraid of their assault. ⁹ Remember in what manner our fathers were saved in the Red Sea, when Pharaoh pursued them with a great army. ¹⁰ And now let us cry to heaven, and the Lord will have mercy on us, and will remember the covenant of our fathers, and will destroy this army before our face this day:

¹¹ And all nations shall know that there is one that redeemeth and delivereth Israel. ¹² And the strangers lifted up their eyes, and saw them coming against them. ¹³ And they went out of the camp to battle, and they that were with Judas sounded the trumpet. ¹⁴ And they joined battle: and the Gentiles were routed, and fled into the plain. ¹⁵ But all the hindmost of them fell by the sword and they pursued them as far as Gezeron, and even to the plains of Idumea, and of Azotus, and of Jamnia: and there fell of them to the number of three thousand men. ¹⁶ And Judas returned again with his army that followed him. ¹⁷ And he said to the people: Be not greedy of the spoils; for there is war before us: ¹⁸ And Gorgias and his army are near us in the mountain: but stand ye now against our enemies, and overthrow them, and you shall take the spoils afterwards with safety. ¹⁹ And as Judas was speaking these words, behold part of them appeared, looking forth from the mountain. ²⁰ And Gorgias saw that his men were put to flight, and that they had set fire to the camp: for the smoke that was seen declared what was done. ²¹ And when they had seen this, they were seized with great fear, seeing at the same time Judas and his army in the plain ready to fight. ²² So they all fled away into the land of the strangers. ²³ And Judas returned to take the spoils of the camp, and they got much gold, and silver, and blue silk, and purple of the sea, and great riches. ²⁴ And returning home, they sung a hymn, and blessed God in heaven, because he is good, because his mercy endureth for ever. ²⁵ So Israel had a great deliverance that day. ²⁶ And such of the strangers as escaped, went and told Lysias all that had happened. ²⁷ And when he heard these things, he was amazed and discouraged: because things had not succeeded in Israel according to his mind, and as the king had commanded. ²⁸ So the year following, Lysias gathered together threescore thousand chosen men, and five thousand horsemen, that he might subdue them. ²⁹ And they came into Judea, and pitched their tents in Bethoron, and Judas met them with ten thousand men. ³⁰ And they saw that the army was strong, and he prayed and said: Blessed art thou, O Saviour of Israel, who didst break the violence of the mighty by the hand of thy servant David, and didst deliver up the camp of the strangers into the hands of Jonathan the son of Saul, and of his armour bearer. ³¹ Shut up this army in the hands of thy people Israel, and let them be confounded in their host and their horsemen. ³² Strike them with fear, and cause the boldness of their strength to languish, and let them quake at their own destruction. ³³ Cast them down with the sword of them that love thee: and let all that know thy name praise thee with hymns. ³⁴ And they joined battle: and there fell of the army of Lysias five thousand men. ³⁵ And when Lysias saw that his men were put to flight, and how bold the Jews were, and that they were ready either to live, or to die manfully, he went to Antioch, and chose soldiers, that they might come again into Judea with greater numbers.

267. The sanctuary cleansed

1 Maccabees 4:36-61

The dedication kept afterwards as a feast, and named in St. John 10:22, which this plan reads.

4 ³⁶ Then Judas, and his brethren said: Behold our enemies are discomfited: let us go up now to cleanse the holy places, and

to repair them. ³⁷ And all the army assembled together, and they went up into Mount Sion. ³⁸ And they saw the sanctuary desolate, and the altar profaned, and the gates burnt, and shrubs growing up in the courts as in a forest, or on the mountains, and the chambers joining to the temple thrown down. ³⁹ And they rent their garments, and made great lamentation, and put ashes on their heads: ⁴⁰ And they fell down to the ground on their faces, and they sounded with the trumpets of alarm, and they cried towards heaven. ⁴¹ Then Judas appointed men to fight against them that were in the castle, till they had cleansed the holy places, ⁴² And he chose priests without blemish, whose will was set upon the law of God. ⁴³ And they cleansed the holy places, and took away the stones that had been defiled into an unclean place. ⁴⁴ And he considered about the altar of holocausts that had been profaned, what he should do with it. ⁴⁵ And a good counsel came into their minds, to pull it down: lest it should be a reproach to them, because the Gentiles had defiled it; so they threw it down. ⁴⁶ And they laid up the stones in the mountain of the temple, in a convenient place, till there should come a prophet, and give answer concerning them. ⁴⁷ Then they took whole stones, according to the law and built a new altar, according to the former: ⁴⁸ And they built up the holy places, and the things that were within the temple: and they sanctified the temple and the courts. ⁴⁹ And they made new holy vessels, and brought in the candlestick, and the altar of incense, and the table, into the temple. ⁵⁰ And they put incense upon the altar, and lighted up the lamps that were upon the candlestick, and they gave light in the temple. ⁵¹ And they set the loaves upon the table, and hung up the veils, and finished all the works that they had begun to make. ⁵² And they arose before the morning on the five and twentieth day of the ninth month, (which is the month of Casleu) in the hundred and forty-eighth year. ⁵³ And they offered sacrifice, according to the law, upon the new altar of holocausts which they had made. ⁵⁴ According to the time, and according to the day wherein the heathens had defiled it, in the same was it dedicated anew with canticles, and harps, and lutes, and cymbals. ⁵⁵ And all the people fell upon their faces, and adored, and blessed up to heaven, him that had prospered them. ⁵⁶ And they kept the dedication of the altar eight days, and they offered holocausts with joy, and sacrifices of salvation, and of praise. ⁵⁷ And they adorned the front of the temple with crowns of gold, and escutcheons, and they renewed the gates, and the chambers, and hanged doors upon them. ⁵⁸ And there was exceeding great joy among the people, and the reproach of the Gentiles was turned away. ⁵⁹ And Judas, and his brethren, and all the church of Israel decreed, that the day of the dedication of the altar should be kept in its season from year to year for eight days, from the five and twentieth day of the month of Casleu, with joy and gladness. ⁶⁰ They built up also at that time Mount Sion, with high walls, and strong towers round about, lest the Gentiles should at any time come, and tread it down, as they did before. ⁶¹ And he placed a garrison there, to keep it, and he fortified it, to secure Bethsura, that the people might have a defence against Idumea.

268. The campaigns round about

1 Maccabees 5:1-68

5 ¹ Now it came to pass, when the nations round about heard that the altar and the sanctuary were built up, as before, that they were exceeding angry. ² And they thought to destroy the generation of Jacob that were among them, and they began to kill some of the people, and to persecute them. ³ Then Judas fought against the children of Esau in Idumea, and them that were in Acrobathane: because they beset the Israelites round about, and he made a great slaughter of them. ⁴ And he remembered the malice of the children of Ben: who were a snare and a stumblingblock to the people, by lying in wait for them in the way. ⁵ And they were shut up by him in towers, and he set upon them, and devoted them to utter destruction, and burnt their towers with fire, and all that were in them. ⁶ Then he passed over to the children of Ammon, where he found a mighty power, and much people, and Timotheus was their captain: ⁷ And he fought many battles with them, and they were discomfited in their sight, and he smote them: ⁸ And he took the city of Gazer and her towns, and returned into Judea. ⁹ And the Gentiles that were in Galaad, assembled themselves together against the Israelites that were in their quarters, to destroy them: and they fled into the fortress of Datheman. ¹⁰ And they sent letters to Judas, and his brethren, saying: The heathens that are round about are gathered together against us to destroy us: ¹¹ And they are preparing to come, and to take the fortress into which we are fled: and Timotheus is the captain of their host. ¹² Now therefore come, and deliver us out of their hands, for many of us are slain. ¹³ And all our brethren that were in the places of Tubin, are killed: and they have carried away their wives, and their children, captives, and taken their spoils, and they have slain there almost a thousand men. ¹⁴ And while they were yet reading these letters, behold there came other messengers out of Galilee with their garments rent, who related according to these words: ¹⁵ Saying, that they of Ptolemais, and of Tyre, and of Sidon, were assembled against them, and all Galilee is filled with strangers, in order to consume us. ¹⁶ Now when Judas and the people heard these words, a great assembly met together to consider what they should do for their brethren that were in trouble, and were assaulted by them. ¹⁷ And Judas said to Simon, his brother: Choose thee men, and go, and deliver thy brethren in Galilee: and I, and my brother Jonathan, will go into the country of Galaad: ¹⁸ And he left Joseph, the son of Zacharias, and Azarias, captains of the people, with the remnant of the army in Judea, to keep it: ¹⁹ And he commanded them, saying: Take ye the charge of this people; but make no war against the heathens, till we return. ²⁰ Now three thousand men were allotted to Simon, to go into Galilee: and eight thousand to Judas, to go into the land of Galaad. ²¹ And Simon went into Galilee, and fought many battles with the heathens: and the heathens were discomfited before his face, and he pursued them even to the gate of Ptolemais. ²² And there fell of the heathens almost three thousand men, and he took the spoils of them. ²³ And he took with him those that were in Galilee and in Arbatis, with their wives, and children, and all that they had, and he brought them into Judea with great joy. ²⁴ And Judas Machabeus, and Jonathan, his brother, passed over the Jordan, and went three

days' journey through the desert. ²⁵ And the Nabutheans met them, and received them in a peaceable manner, and told them all that happened to their brethren in the land of Galaad, ²⁶ And that many of them were shut up in Barasa, and in Bosor, and in Alima, and in Casphor, and in Mageth, and in Carnaim; all these strong and great cities. ²⁷ Yea, and that they were kept shut up in the rest of the cities of Galaad, and that they had appointed to bring their army on the morrow near to these cities, and to take them, and to destroy them all in one day. ²⁸ Then Judas and his army suddenly turned their march into the desert, to Bosor, and took the city: and he slew every male by the edge of the sword, and took all their spoils, and burnt it with fire. ²⁹ And they removed from thence by night, and went till they came to the fortress. ³⁰ And it came to pass that early in the morning, when they lifted up their eyes, behold there were people without number, carrying ladders and engines to take the fortress, and assault them. ³¹ And Judas saw that the fight was begun, and the cry of the battle went up to heaven like a trumpet, and a great cry out of the city: ³² And he said to his host: Fight ye today for your brethren. ³³ And he came with three companies behind them, and they sounded their trumpets, and cried out in prayer. ³⁴ And the host of Timotheus understood that it was Machabeus, and they fled away before his face and they made a great slaughter of them, and there fell of them in that day almost eight thousand men. ³⁵ And Judas turned aside to Maspha, and assaulted, and took it, and he slew every male thereof, and took the spoils thereof, and burnt it with fire. ³⁶ From thence he marched, and took Casbon, and Mageth, and Bosor, and the rest of the cities of Galaad. ³⁷ But after this Timotheus gathered another army, and camped over against Raphon, beyond the torrent. ³⁸ And Judas sent men to view the army: and they brought him word, saying: All the nations, that are round about us, are assembled unto him an army exceeding great: ³⁹ And they have hired the Arabians to help them, and they have pitched their tents beyond the torrent, ready to come to fight against thee. And Judas went to meet them. ⁴⁰ And Timotheus said to the captains of his army: When Judas and his army come near the torrent of water, if he pass over unto us first, we shall not be able to withstand him: for he will certainly prevail over us. ⁴¹ But if he be afraid to pass over, and camp on the other side of the river, we will pass over to them, and shall prevail against him. ⁴² Now when Judas came near the torrent of water, he set the scribes of the people by the torrent, and commanded them, saying: Suffer no man to stay behind: but let all come to the battle. ⁴³ And he passed over to them first, and all the people after him, and all the heathens were discomfited before them, and they threw away their weapons, and fled to the temple that was in Carnaim. ⁴⁴ And he took that city, and the temple he burnt with fire, with all things that were therein: and Carnaim was subdued, and could not stand against the face of Judas. ⁴⁵ And Judas gathered together all the Israelites that were in the land of Galaad, from the least even to the greatest, and their wives and children, and an army exceeding great, to come into the land of Juda. ⁴⁶ And they came as far as Ephron: now this was a great city, situate in the way, strongly fortified, and there was no means to turn from it on the right hand or on the left, but the way was through the midst of it. ⁴⁷ And they that were in the city shut themselves in,

and stopped up the gates with stones: and Judas sent to them with peaceable words, ⁴⁸ Saying: Let us pass through your land, to go into our own country, and no man shall hurt you; we will only pass through on foot. But they would not open to them. ⁴⁹ Then Judas commanded proclamation to be made in the camp, that they should make an assault, every man in the place where he was. ⁵⁰ And the men of the army drew near, and he assaulted that city all the day, and all the night; and the city was delivered into his hands: ⁵¹ And they slew every male with the edge of the sword, and he razed the city, and took the spoils thereof, and passed through all the city over them that were slain. ⁵² Then they passed over the Jordan to the great plain that is over against Bethsan. ⁵³ And Judas gathered together the hindmost, and he exhorted the people, all the way through, till they came into the land of Juda. ⁵⁴ And they went up to mount Sion with joy and gladness, and offered holocausts, because not one of them was slain, till they had returned in peace. ⁵⁵ Now in the days that Judas and Jonathan were in the land of Galaad, and Simon his brother in Galilee, before Ptolemais, ⁵⁶ Joseph, the son of Zacharias, and Azarias, captain of the soldiers, heard of the good success, and the battles that were fought, ⁵⁷ And he said: Let us also get us a name, and let us go fight against the Gentiles that are round about us. ⁵⁸ And he gave charge to them that were in his army, and they went towards Jamnia. ⁵⁹ And Gorgias and his men went out of the city, to give them battle. ⁶⁰ And Joseph and Azarias were put to flight, and were pursued unto the borders of Judea: and there fell on that day, of the people of Israel, about two thousand men, and there was a great overthrow of the people: ⁶¹ Because they did not hearken to Judas and his brethren, thinking that they should do manfully. ⁶² But they were not of the seed of those men by whom salvation was brought to Israel. ⁶³ And the men of Juda were magnified exceedingly in the sight of all Israel, and of all the nations where their name was heard. ⁶⁴ And the people assembled to them with joyful acclamations. ⁶⁵ Then Judas and his brethren went forth and attacked the children of Esau, in the land towards the south, and he took Chebron and her towns: and he burnt the walls thereof, and the towers all round it. ⁶⁶ And he removed his camp to go into the land of the aliens, and he went through Samaria. ⁶⁷ In that day some priests fell in battle, while desiring to do manfully they went out unadvisedly to fight. ⁶⁸ And Judas turned to Azotus, into the land of the strangers, and he threw down their altars, and he burnt the statues of their gods with fire: and he took the spoils of the cities, and returned into the land of Juda.

269. *The death of Antiochus; Eleazar and the elephant*

1 Maccabees 6:1-63

6 ¹ Now king Antiochus was going through the higher countries, and he heard that the city of Elymais in Persia, was greatly renowned, and abounding in silver and gold, ² And that there was in it a temple exceeding rich; and coverings of gold, and breastplates, and shields, which king Alexander, son of Philip, the Macedonian, that reigned first in Greece, had left there. ³ So he came, and sought to take the city and to pillage it; but he was not able, because the design was known to them that were in the city. ⁴ And they rose up against him in battle, and he fled away from thence, and departed with great sadness, and returned towards Babylonia. ⁵ And whilst he was in Persia there

came one that told him how the armies that were in the land of Juda were put to flight: ⁶ And that Lysias went with a very great power, and was put to flight before the face of the Jews, and that they were grown strong by the armour, and power, and store of spoils which they had gotten out of the camps which they had destroyed: ⁷ And that they had thrown down the abomination which he had set up upon the altar in Jerusalem, and that they had compassed about the sanctuary with high walls as before, and Bethsura also, his city. ⁸ And it came to pass, when the king heard these words, that he was struck with fear, and exceedingly moved: and he laid himself down upon his bed, and fell sick for grief, because it had not fallen out to him as he imagined. ⁹ And he remained there many days: for great grief came more and more upon him, and he made account that he should die. ¹⁰ And he called for all his friends, and said to them: Sleep is gone from my eyes, and I am fallen away, and my heart is cast down for anxiety: ¹¹ And I said in my heart: Into how much tribulation am I come, and into what floods of sorrow wherein now I am: I that was pleasant and beloved in my power! ¹² But now I remember the evils that I have done in Jerusalem, from whence also I took away all the spoils of gold, and of silver, that were in it, and I sent to destroy the inhabitants of Juda without cause. ¹³ I know, therefore, that for this cause these evils have found me: and behold I perish with great grief in a strange land. ¹⁴ Then he called Philip, one of his friends, and he made him regent over all his kingdom. ¹⁵ And he gave him the crown, and his robe, and his ring, that he should go to Antiochus, his son, and should bring him up for the kingdom. ¹⁶ So king Antiochus died there in the year one hundred and forty-nine. ¹⁷ And Lysias understood that the king was dead, and he set up Antiochus, his son, to reign, whom he had brought up young: and he called his name Eupator. ¹⁸ Now they that were in the castle, had shut up the Israelites round about the holy places: and they were continually seeking their hurt, and to strengthen the Gentiles. ¹⁹ And Judas purposed to destroy them: and he called together all the people, to besiege them. ²⁰ And they came together, and besieged them in the year one hundred and fifty, and they made battering slings and engines. ²¹ And some of the besieged got out: and some wicked men of Israel joined themselves unto them. ²² And they went to the king, and said: How long dost thou delay to execute judgment, and to revenge our brethren? ²³ We determined to serve thy father, and to do according to his orders, and obey his edicts: ²⁴ And for this they of our nation are alienated from us, and have slain as many of us as they could find, and have spoiled our inheritances. ²⁵ Neither have they put forth their hand against us only, but also against all our borders. ²⁶ And behold they have approached this day to the castle of Jerusalem to take it, and they have fortified the strong hold of Bethsura: ²⁷ And unless thou speedily prevent them, they will do greater things than these, and thou shalt not be able to subdue them. ²⁸ Now when the king heard this, he was angry: and he called together all his friends, and the captains of his army, and them that were over the horsemen. ²⁹ There came also to him from other realms, and from the islands of the sea, hired troops. ³⁰ And the number of his army was an hundred thousand footmen, and twenty thousand horsemen, and thirty-two elephants trained to battle. ³¹ And they went through Idumea, and

approached to Bethsura, and fought many days, and they made engines: but they sallied forth, and burnt them with fire, and fought manfully. ³² And Judas departed from the castle, and removed the camp to Bethzacharam, over against the king's camp. ³³ And the king rose before it was light, and made his troops march on fiercely towards the way of Bethzacharam: and the armies made themselves ready for the battle, and they sounded the trumpets: ³⁴ And they shewed the elephants the blood of grapes, and mulberries, to provoke them to fight. ³⁵ And they distributed the beasts by the legions: and there stood by every elephant a thousand men in coats of mail, and with helmets of brass on their heads: and five hundred horsemen set in order were chosen for every beast. ³⁶ These before the time wheresoever the beast was they were there: and whithersoever it went, they went, and they departed not from it. ³⁷ And upon the beast, there were strong wooden towers which covered every one of them: and engines upon them, and upon every one thirty-two valiant men, who fought from above: and an Indian to rule the beast. ³⁸ And the rest of the horsemen he placed on this side and on that side, at the two wings, with trumpets to stir up the army, and to hasten them forward that stood thick together in the legions thereof. ³⁹ Now when the sun shone upon the shields of gold, and of brass, the mountains glittered therewith, and they shone like lamps of fire. ⁴⁰ And part of the king's army was distinguished by the high mountains, and the other part by the low places: and they marched on warily and orderly. ⁴¹ And all the inhabitants of the land were moved at the noise of their multitude, and the marching of the company, and the rattling of the armour, for the army was exceeding great and strong. ⁴² And Judas and his army drew near for battle: and there fell of the king's army six hundred men. ⁴³ And Eleazar, the son of Saura, saw one of the beasts harnessed with the king's harness: and it was higher than the other beasts; and it seemed to him that the king was on it: ⁴⁴ And he exposed himself to deliver his people, and to get himself an everlasting name. ⁴⁵ And he ran up to it boldly in the midst of the legion, killing on the right hand, and on the left, and they fell by him on this side and that side. ⁴⁶ And he went between the feet of the elephant, and put himself under it: and slew it, and it fell to the ground upon him, and he died there. ⁴⁷ Then they seeing the strength of the king and the fierceness of his army, turned away from them. ⁴⁸ But the king's army went up against them to Jerusalem: and the king's army pitched their tents against Judea and Mount Sion. ⁴⁹ And he made peace with them that were in Bethsura: and they came forth out of the city, because they had no victuals, being shut up there, for it was the year of rest to the land. ⁵⁰ And the king took Bethsura: and he placed there a garrison to keep it. ⁵¹ And he turned his army against the sanctuary for many days: and he set up there battering slings, and engines, and instruments to cast fire, and engines to cast stones and javelins, and pieces to shoot arrows, and slings. ⁵² And they also made engines against their engines, and they fought for many days. ⁵³ But there were no victuals in the city, because it was the seventh year: and such as had stayed in Judea of them that came from among the nations, had eaten the residue of all that which had been stored up. ⁵⁴ And there remained in the holy places but a few, for the famine had prevailed over them: and they were dispersed every

man to his own place. ⁵⁵ Now Lysias heard that Philip; whom king Antiochus while he lived had appointed to bring up his son, Antiochus, and to reign, ⁵⁶ Was returned from Persia, and Media, with the army that went with him and that he sought to take upon him the affairs of the kingdom: ⁵⁷ Wherefore he made haste to go, and say to the king and to the captains of the army: We decay daily, and our provision of victuals is small, and the place that we lay siege to is strong, and it lieth upon us to take order for the affairs of the kingdom. ⁵⁸ Now, therefore, let us come to an agreement with these men, and make peace with them and with all their nation. ⁵⁹ And let us covenant with them, that they may live according to their own laws, as before. For because of our despising their laws, they have been provoked, and have done all these things. ⁶⁰ And the proposal was acceptable in the sight of the king, and of the princes: and he sent to them to make peace: and they accepted of it. ⁶¹ And the king and the princes swore to them: and they came out of the strong hold. ⁶² Then the king entered into Mount Sion, and saw the strength of the place: and he quickly broke the oath that he had taken, and gave commandment to throw down the wall round about. ⁶³ And he departed in haste and returned to Antioch, where he found Philip master of the city: and he fought against him, and took the city.

270. Nicanor

1 Maccabees 7:1-50

7 ¹ In the hundred and fifty-first year, Demetrius, the son of Seleucus, departed from the city of Rome, and came up with few men into a city of the sea coast, and reigned there. ² And it came to pass as he entered into the house of the kingdom of his fathers, that the army seized upon Antiochus, and Lysias, to bring them unto him. ³ And when he knew it, he said: Let me not see their face. ⁴ So the army slew them. And Demetrius sat upon the throne of his kingdom: ⁵ And there came to him the wicked and ungodly men of Israel: and Alcimus was at the head of them, who desired to be made high priest. ⁶ And they accused the people to the king, saying: Judas and his brethren have destroyed all thy friends, and he hath driven us out of our land. ⁷ Now, therefore, send some men whom thou trustest, and let him go, and see all the havoc he hath made amongst us, and in the king's lands: and let him punish all his friends and their helpers. ⁸ Then the king chose Bacchides, one of his friends, that ruled beyond the great river in the kingdom, and was faithful to the king: and he sent him, ⁹ To see the havoc that Judas had made: and the wicked Alcimus he made high priest, and commanded him to take revenge upon the children of Israel. ¹⁰ And they arose, and came with a great army into the land of Juda: and they sent messengers, and spoke to Judas and his brethren with peaceable words, deceitfully. ¹¹ But they gave no heed to their words: for they saw that they were come with a great army. ¹² Then there assembled to Alcimus and Bacchides a company of the scribes, to require things that are just: ¹³ And first the Assideans, that were among the children of Israel, and they sought peace of them. ¹⁴ For they said: One that is a priest of the seed of Aaron is come, he will not deceive us. ¹⁵ And he spoke to them peaceably: and he swore to them, saying: We will do you no harm, nor your friends. ¹⁶ And they believed him. And he took threescore of them, and slew them in one day,

according to the word that is written: ¹⁷ The flesh of thy saints, and the blood of them they have shed round about Jerusalem, and there was none to bury them. ¹⁸ Then fear and trembling fell upon all the people: for they said: There is no truth, nor justice among them: for they have broken the covenant, and the oath which they made. ¹⁹ And Bacchides removed the camp from Jerusalem, and pitched in Bethzecha: and he sent, and took many of them that were fled away from him, and some of the people he killed, and threw them into a great pit. ²⁰ Then he committed the country to Alcimus, and left with him troops to help him. So Bacchides went away to the king. ²¹ But Alcimus did what he could to maintain his chief priesthood. ²² And they that disturbed the people resorted to him, and they got the land of Juda into their power, and did much hurt in Israel. ²³ And Judas saw all the evils that Alcimus, and they that were with him, did to the children of Israel, much more than the Gentiles. ²⁴ And he went out into all the coasts of Judea round about, and took vengeance upon the men that had revolted, and they ceased to go forth any more into the country. ²⁵ And Alcimus saw that Judas and they that were with him, prevailed: and he knew that he could not stand against them, and he went back to the king, and accused them of many crimes. ²⁶ And the king sent Nicanor, one of his principal lords, who was a great enemy to Israel: and he commanded him to destroy the people. ²⁷ And Nicanor came to Jerusalem with a great army, and he sent to Judas and to his brethren deceitfully, with friendly words, ²⁸ Saying: Let there be no fighting between me and you: I will come with a few men, to see your faces with peace. ²⁹ And he came to Judas, and they saluted one another peaceably: and the enemies were prepared to take away Judas by force. ³⁰ And the thing was known to Judas that he was come to him with deceit: and he was much afraid of him, and would not see his face any more. ³¹ And Nicanor knew that his counsel was discovered: and he went out to fight against Judas, near Capharsalama. ³² And there fell of Nicanor's army almost five thousand men, and they fled into the city of David. ³³ And after this Nicanor went up into mount Sion: and some of the priests and the people came out to salute him peaceably, and to shew him the holocausts that were offered for the king. ³⁴ But he mocked and despised them, and abused them: and he spoke proudly, ³⁵ And swore in anger, saying: Unless Judas and his army be delivered into my hands, as soon as ever I return in peace, I will burn this house. And he went out in a great rage. ³⁶ And the priests went in, and stood before the face of the altar and the temple: and weeping, they said: ³⁷ Thou, O Lord, hast chosen this house for thy name to be called upon therein, that it might be a house of prayer and supplication for thy people. ³⁸ Be avenged of this man, and his army, and let them fall by the sword: remember their blasphemies, and suffer them not to continue any longer. ³⁹ Then Nicanor went out from Jerusalem, and encamped near to Bethoron: and an army of Syria joined him. ⁴⁰ But Judas pitched in Adarsa with three thousand men: and Judas prayed, and said: ⁴¹ O Lord, when they that were sent by king Sennacherib blasphemed thee, an angel went out, and slew of them a hundred and eighty-five thousand: ⁴² Even so destroy this army in our sight today and let the rest know that he hath spoken ill against thy sanctuary: and judge thou him according to his wickedness. ⁴³ And the armies joined battle on

the thirteenth day of the month, Adar: and the army of Nicanor was defeated, and he himself was first slain in the battle. ⁴⁴ And when his army saw that Nicanor was slain they threw away their weapons, and fled: ⁴⁵ And they pursued after them one day's journey from Adazer, even till ye come to Gazara, and they sounded the trumpets after them with signals. ⁴⁶ And they went forth out of all the towns of Judea round about, and they pushed them with the horns, and they turned again to them, and they were all slain with the sword, and there was not left of them so much as one. ⁴⁷ And they took the spoils of them for a booty, and they cut off Nicanor's head, and his right hand, which he had proudly stretched out, and they brought it, and hung it up over against Jerusalem. ⁴⁸ And the people rejoiced exceedingly, and they spent that day with great joy. ⁴⁹ And he ordained that this day should be kept every year, being the thirteenth of the month of Adar. ⁵⁰ And the land of Juda was quiet for a short time.

271. The league with the Romans

1 Maccabees 8:1-32

8 ¹ Now Judas heard of the fame of the Romans, that they are powerful and strong, and willingly agree to all things that are requested of them: and that whosoever have come to them, they have made amity with them, and that they are mighty in power. ² And they heard of their battles, and their noble acts which they had done in Galatia, how they had conquered them, and brought them under tribute: ³ And how great things they had done in the land of Spain, and that they had brought under their power the mines of silver and of gold that are there, and had gotten possession of all the place by their counsel and patience: ⁴ And had conquered places that were very far off from them, and kings that came against them from the ends of the earth, and had overthrown them with great slaughter: and the rest pay them tribute every year. ⁵ And that they had defeated in battle Philip and Perses the king of the Ceteans, and the rest that had borne arms against them, and had conquered them: ⁶ And how Antiochus, the great king of Asia, who went to fight against them, having a hundred and twenty elephants, with horsemen, and chariots, and a very great army, was routed by them. ⁷ And how they took him alive, and appointed to him, that both he and they that should reign after him, should pay a great tribute, and that he should give hostages, and that which was agreed upon, ⁸ And the country of the Indians, and of the Medes, and of the Lydians, some of their best provinces: and those which they had taken from them, they gave to king Eumenes. ⁹ And that they who were in Greece, had a mind to go and to destroy them: and they had knowledge thereof, ¹⁰ And they sent a general against them, and fought with them, and many of them were slain, and they carried away their wives, and their children captives, and spoiled them, and took possession of their land, and threw down their walls, and brought them to be their servants unto this day. ¹¹ And the other kingdoms, and islands, that at any time had resisted them, they had destroyed and brought under their power. ¹² But with their friends, and such as relied upon them, they kept amity, and had conquered kingdoms that were near, and that were far off: for all that heard their name, were afraid of them. ¹³ That whom they had a mind to help to a kingdom, those reigned: and whom they would, they deposed from the kingdom:

and they were greatly exalted. ¹⁴ And none of all these wore a crown, or was clothed in purple, to be magnified thereby. ¹⁵ And that they had made themselves a senate house, and consulted daily three hundred and twenty men, that sat in council always for the people, that they might do the things that were right: ¹⁶ And that they committed their government to one man every year, to rule over all their country, and they all obey one, and there is no envy nor jealousy amongst them. ¹⁷ So Judas chose Eupolemus, the son of John, the son of Jacob, and Jason, the son of Eleazar, and he sent them to Rome to make a league of amity and confederacy with them: ¹⁸ And that they might take off from them the yoke of the Grecians, for they saw that they oppressed the kingdom of Israel with servitude. ¹⁹ And they went to Rome, a very long journey, and they entered into the senate house, and said: ²⁰ Judas Machabeus, and his brethren, and the people of the Jews, have sent us to you to make alliance and peace with you, and that we may be registered your confederates and friends. ²¹ And the proposal was pleasing in their sight. ²² And this is the copy of the writing that they wrote back again, graven in tables of brass, and sent to Jerusalem, that it might be with them there for a memorial of the peace, and alliance. ²³ GOOD SUCCESS BE TO THE ROMANS, and to the people of the Jews by sea, and by land, for ever: and far be the sword and enemy from them. ²⁴ But if there come first any war upon the Romans, or any of their confederates, in all their dominions: ²⁵ The nation of the Jews shall help them according as the time shall direct, with all their heart: ²⁶ Neither shall they give them, whilst they are fighting, or furnish them with wheat, or arms, or money, or ships, as it hath seemed good to the Romans: and they shall obey their orders, without taking any thing of them. ²⁷ In like manner also if war shall come first upon the nation of the Jews, the Romans shall help them with all their heart, according as the time shall permit them: ²⁸ And there shall not be given to them that come to their aid, either wheat, or arms, or money, or ships, as it hath seemed good to the Romans: and they shall observe their orders without deceit. ²⁹ According to these articles did the Romans covenant with the people of the Jews. ³⁰ And, if after this, one party or the other shall have a mind to add to these articles, or take away any thing, they may do it at their pleasure: and whatsoever they shall add, or take away, shall be ratified. ³¹ Moreover, concerning the evils that Demetrius, the king, hath done against them, we have written to him, saying: Why hast thou made thy yoke heavy upon our friends and allies, the Jews? ³² If, therefore, they come again to us complaining of thee, we will do them justice, and will make war against thee by sea and land.

272. The death of Judas; Jonathan succeeds

1 Maccabees 9:1-73

9 ¹ In the mean time, when Demetrius heard that Nicanor and his army were fallen in battle, he sent again Bacchides and Alcimus into Judea; and the right wing of his army with them. ² And they took the road that leadeth to Galgal, and they camped in Masaloth, which is in Arabella: and they made themselves masters of it, and slew many people. ³ In the first month of the hundred and fifty-second year they brought the army to Jerusalem: ⁴ And they arose and went to Berea, with twenty thousand men, and two thousand horsemen. ⁵ Now Judas had

pitched his tents in Laiza, and three thousand chosen men with him: ⁶ And they saw the multitude of the army that they were many, and they were seized with great fear: and many withdrew themselves out of the camp, and there remained of them no more than eight hundred men. ⁷ And Judas saw that his army slipped away, and the battle pressed upon him, and his heart was cast down: because he had not time to gather them together, and he was discouraged. ⁸ Then he said to them that remained: Let us arise, and go against our enemies, if we may be able to fight against them. ⁹ But they dissuaded him, saying: We shall not be able, but let us save our lives now, and return to our brethren, and then we will fight against them: for we are but few. ¹⁰ Then Judas said: God forbid we should do this thing, and flee away from them: but if our time be come, let us die manfully for our brethren, and let us not stain our glory. ¹¹ And the army removed out of the camp, and they stood over against them: and the horsemen were divided into two troops, and the slingers, and the archers, went before the army, and they that were in the front were all men of valour. ¹² And Bacchides was in the right wing, and the legion drew near on two sides, and they sounded the trumpets: ¹³ And they also that were on Judas's side, even they also cried out, and the earth shook at the noise of the armies: and the battle was fought from morning even unto the evening. ¹⁴ And Judas perceived that the stronger part of the army of Bacchides was on the right side, and all the stout of heart came together with him: ¹⁵ And the right wing was discomfited by them, and he pursued them even to the mount Azotus. ¹⁶ And they that were in the left wing saw that the right wing was discomfited, and they followed after Judas, and them that were with him, at their back: ¹⁷ And the battle was hard fought, and there fell many wounded of the one side and of the other. ¹⁸ And Judas was slain, and the rest fled away. ¹⁹ And Jonathan and Simon took Judas, their brother, and buried him in the sepulchre of their fathers, in the city of Modin. ²⁰ And all the people of Israel bewailed him with great lamentation, and they mourned for him many days. ²¹ And said: How is the mighty man fallen, that saved the people of Israel! ²² But the rest of the words of the wars of Judas, and of the noble acts that he did, and of his greatness, are not written: for they were very many. ²³ And it came to pass, after the death of Judas, that the wicked began to put forth their heads in all the confines of Israel, and all the workers of iniquity rose up. ²⁴ In those days there was a very great famine, and they and all their country yielded to Bacchides. ²⁵ And Bacchides chose the wicked men, and made them lords of the country: ²⁶ And they sought out, and made diligent search after the friends of Judas, and brought them to Bacchides, and he took vengeance of them, and abused them. ²⁷ And there was a great tribulation in Israel, such as was not since the day, that there was no prophet seen in Israel. ²⁸ And all the friends of Judas came together, and said to Jonathan: ²⁹ Since thy brother Judas died there is not a man like him to go forth against our enemies, Bacchides, and them that are the enemies of our nation. ³⁰ Now, therefore, we have chosen thee this day to be our prince, and captain, in his stead, to fight our battles. ³¹ So Jonathan took upon him the government at that time, and rose up in the place of Judas, his brother. ³² And Bacchides had knowledge of it, and sought to kill him. ³³ And Jonathan, and Simon, his brother, knew

it, and all that were with them: and they fled into the desert of Thecua, and they pitched by the water of the lake Asphar, ³⁴ And Bacchides understood it, and he came himself, with all his army, over the Jordan, on the sabbath day. ³⁵ And Jonathan sent his brother, a captain of the people, to desire the Nabutheans his friends, that they would lend them their equipage, which was copious. ³⁶ And the children of Jambri came forth out of Madaba, and took John, and all that he had, and went away with them. ³⁷ After this it was told Jonathan, and Simon, his brother, that the children of Jambri made a great marriage, and were bringing the bride out of Madaba, the daughter of one of the great princes of Chanaan, with great pomp. ³⁸ And they remembered the blood of John, their brother: and they went up, and hid themselves under the covert of the mountain. ³⁹ And they lifted up their eyes, and saw: and behold a tumult, and great preparation: and the bridegroom came forth, and his friends, and his brethren to meet them with timbrels, and musical instruments and many weapons. ⁴⁰ And they rose up against them from the place where they lay in ambush, and slew them, and there fell many wounded, and the rest fled into the mountains, and they took all their spoils: ⁴¹ And the marriage was turned into mourning, and the noise of their musical instruments into lamentation. ⁴² And they took revenge for the blood of their brother: and they returned to the bank of the Jordan. ⁴³ And Bacchides heard it, and he came on the sabbath day even to the bank of the Jordan, with a great power. ⁴⁴ And Jonathan said to his company: Let us arise, and fight against our enemies: for it is not now as yesterday, and the day before. ⁴⁵ For behold the battle is before us, and the water of the Jordan on this side and on that side, and banks, and marshes, and woods: and there is no place for us to turn aside. ⁴⁶ Now, therefore, cry ye to heaven, that ye may be delivered from the hand of your enemies. And they joined battle. ⁴⁷ And Jonathan stretched forth his hand to strike Bacchides, but he turned away from him backwards. ⁴⁸ And Jonathan, and they that were with him, leapt into the Jordan, and swam over the Jordan to them. ⁴⁹ And there fell of Bacchides' side that day a thousand men: and they returned to Jerusalem, ⁵⁰ And they built strong cities in Judea, the fortress that was in Jericho, and in Ammaus, and in Bethoron, and in Bethel, and Thamnata, and Phara, and Thopo, with high walls, and gates, and bars. ⁵¹ And he placed garrisons in them, that they might wage war against Israel: ⁵² And he fortified the city of Bethsura, and Gazara, and the castle, and set garrisons in them, and provisions of victuals: ⁵³ And he took the sons of the chief men of the country for hostages, and put them in the castle in Jerusalem in custody. ⁵⁴ Now in the year one hundred and fifty-three, the second month, Alcimus commanded the walls of the inner court of the sanctuary to be thrown down, and the works of the prophets to be destroyed: and he began to destroy. ⁵⁵ At that time Alcimus was struck: and his works were hindered, and his mouth was stopped, and he was taken with a palsy, so that he could no more speak a word, nor give order concerning his house. ⁵⁶ And Alcimus died at that time in great torment. ⁵⁷ And Bacchides saw that Alcimus was dead: and he returned to the king, and the land was quiet for two years. ⁵⁸ And all the wicked held a council, saying: Behold Jonathan, and they that are with him, dwell at ease and without fear: now, therefore, let us bring Bacchides hither, and he shall take them

all in one night. ⁵⁹ So they went, and gave him counsel. ⁶⁰ And he arose to come with a great army: and he sent secretly letters to his adherents that were in Judea to seize upon Jonathan, and them that were with him: but they could not, for their design was known to them. ⁶¹ And he apprehended of the men of the country, that were the principal authors of the mischief, fifty men, and he slew them. ⁶² And Jonathan, and Simon, and they that were with him, retired into Bethbessen, which is in the desert: and he repaired the breaches thereof, and they fortified it. ⁶³ And when Bacchides knew it, he gathered together all his multitude: and sent word to them that were of Judea. ⁶⁴ And he came, and camped above Bethbessen, and fought against it many days, and made engines. ⁶⁵ But Jonathan left his brother, Simon, in the city and went forth into the country, and came with a number of men, ⁶⁶ And struck Odares, and his brethren, and the children of Phaseron, in their tents, and he began to slay, and to increase in forces. ⁶⁷ But Simon, and they that were with him, sallied out of the city, and burnt the engines, ⁶⁸ And they fought against Bacchides, and he was discomfited by them: and they afflicted him exceedingly, for his counsel, and his enterprise was in vain. ⁶⁹ And he was angry with the wicked men that had given him counsel to come into their country, and he slew many of them: and he purposed to return with the rest into their country. ⁷⁰ And Jonathan had knowledge of it, and he sent ambassadors to him to make peace with him, and to restore to him the prisoners. ⁷¹ And he accepted it willingly, and did according to his words, and swore that he would do him no harm all the days of his life. ⁷² And he restored to him the prisoners which he before had taken out of the land of Juda: and he returned, and went away into his own country, and he came no more into their borders. ⁷³ So the sword ceased from Israel: and Jonathan dwelt in Machmas, and Jonathan began there to judge the people, and he destroyed the wicked out of Israel.

273. Jonathan made high priest

1 Maccabees 10:1-89

10 ¹ Now in the hundred and sixtieth year, Alexander, the son of Antiochus, surnamed the Illustrious, came up and took Ptolemais, and they received him, and he reigned there. ² And king Demetrius heard of it, and gathered together an exceeding great army, and went forth against him to fight. ³ And Demetrius sent a letter to Jonathan, with peaceable words, to magnify him. ⁴ For he said: Let us first make a peace with him, before he make one with Alexander against us. ⁵ For he will remember all the evils that we have done against him, and against his brother, and against his nation. ⁶ And he gave him authority to gather together an army, and to make arms, and that he should be his confederate: and the hostages that were in the castle, he commanded to be delivered to him. ⁷ And Jonathan came to Jerusalem, and read the letters in the hearing of all the people, and of them that were in the castle. ⁸ And they were struck with great fear, because they heard that the king had given him authority to gather together an army. ⁹ And the hostages were delivered to Jonathan, and he restored them to their parents. ¹⁰ And Jonathan dwelt in Jerusalem, and began to build, and to repair the city. ¹¹ And he ordered workmen to build the walls, and mount Sion round about with square stones for fortification: and so they did. ¹² And the strangers that were in the strong

holds, which Bacchides had built, fled away. ¹³ And every man left his place, and departed into his own country: ¹⁴ Only in Bethsura there remained some of them, that had forsaken the law, and the commandments of God: for this was a place of refuge for them. ¹⁵ And king Alexander heard of the promises that Demetrius had made Jonathan: and they told him of the battles, and the worthy acts that he and his brethren had done, and the labours that they had endured. ¹⁶ And he said: Shall we find such another man? now, therefore, we will make him our friend and our confederate. ¹⁷ So he wrote a letter, and sent it to him according to these words, saying: ¹⁸ King Alexander to his brother, Jonathan, greetings. ¹⁹ We have heard of thee, that thou art a man of great power, and fit to be our friend: ²⁰ Now therefore, we make thee this day high priest of thy nation, and that thou be called the king's friend, (and he sent him a purple robe, and a crown of gold) and that thou be of one mind with us in our affairs, and keep friendship with us. ²¹ Then Jonathan put on the holy vestment in the seventh month, in the year one hundred and threescore, at the feast day of the tabernacles: and he gathered together an army, and made a great number of arms. ²² And Demetrius heard these words, and was exceeding sorry, and said: ²³ What is this that we have done, that Alexander hath prevented us to gain the friendship of the Jews to strengthen himself? ²⁴ I also will write to them words of request, and offer dignities, and gifts: that they may be with me to aid me. ²⁵ And he wrote to them in these words: King Demetrius to the nation of the Jews, greeting. ²⁶ Whereas you have kept covenant with us, and have continued in our friendship, and have not joined with our enemies, we have heard of it, and are glad. ²⁷ Wherefore now continue still to keep fidelity towards us, and we will reward you with good things, for what you have done in our behalf. ²⁸ And we will remit to you many charges, and will give you gifts. ²⁹ And now I free you, and all the Jews, from tributes, and I release you from the customs of salt, and remit the crowns, and the thirds of the seed: ³⁰ And the half of the fruit of trees, which is my share, I leave to you from this day forward, so that it shall not be taken of the land of Juda, and of the three cities that are added thereto out of Samaria and Galilee, from this day forth, and for ever: ³¹ And let Jerusalem be holy and free, with the borders thereof: and let the tenths, and tributes be for itself. ³² I yield up also the power of the castle that is in Jerusalem, and I give it to the high priest, to place therein such men as he shall choose, to keep it. ³³ And every soul of the Jews that hath been carried captive from the land of Juda in all my kingdom, I set at liberty freely, that all be discharged from tributes, even of their cattle. ³⁴ And I will that all the feasts, and the sabbaths, and the new moons, and the days appointed, and three days before the solemn day, and three days after the solemn day, be all days of immunity and freedom, for all the Jews that are in my kingdom: ³⁵ And no man shall have power to do any thing against them, or to molest any of them, in any cause. ³⁶ And let there be enrolled in the king's army to the number of thirty thousand of the Jews: and allowance shall be made them, as is due to all the king's forces and certain of them shall be appointed to be in the fortresses of the great king: ³⁷ And some of them shall be set over the affairs of the kingdom, that are of trust, and let the governors be taken from among themselves, and let them

walk in their own laws, as the king hath commanded in the land of Juda. ³⁸ And the three cities that are added to Judea, out of the country of Samaria, let them be accounted with Judea: that they may be under one, and obey no other authority but that of the high priest: ³⁹ Ptolemais and the confines thereof, I give as a free gift to the holy places that are in Jerusalem, for the necessary charges of the holy things. ⁴⁰ And I give every year fifteen thousand sickles of silver out of the king's accounts, of what belongs to me: ⁴¹ And all that is above, which they that were over the affairs the years before, had not paid, from this time they shall give it to the works of the house. ⁴² Moreover, the five thousand sickles of silver, which they received from the account of the holy places, every year, shall also belong to the priests that execute the ministry. ⁴³ And whosoever shall flee into the temple that is in Jerusalem, and in all the borders thereof, being indebted to the king for any matter, let them be set at liberty, and all that they have in my kingdom, let them have it free. ⁴⁴ For the building also, or repairing the works of the holy places, the charges shall be given out of the king's revenues: ⁴⁵ For the building also of the walls of Jerusalem, and the fortifying thereof round about, the charges shall be given out of the king's account, as also for the building of the walls in Judea. ⁴⁶ Now when Jonathan and the people heard these words, they gave no credit to them, nor received them because they remembered the great evil that he had done in Israel, for he had afflicted them exceedingly. ⁴⁷ And their inclinations were towards Alexander, because he had been the chief promoter of peace in their regard, and him they always helped. ⁴⁸ And king Alexander gathered together a great army, and moved his camp near to Demetrius. ⁴⁹ And the two kings joined battle, and the army of Demetrius fled away, and Alexander pursued after him, and pressed them close. ⁵⁰ And the battle was hard fought, till the sun went down: and Demetrius was slain that day. ⁵¹ And Alexander sent ambassadors to Ptolemee king of Egypt, with words to this effect, saying: ⁵² Forasmuch as I am returned into my kingdom and am set in the throne of my ancestors, and have gotten the dominion, and have overthrown Demetrius and possessed our country, ⁵³ And have joined battle with him, and both he and his army have been destroyed by us, and we are placed in the throne of his kingdom: ⁵⁴ Now, therefore, let us make friendship one with another: and give me now thy daughter to wife, and I will be thy son in law, and I will give both thee and her gifts worthy of thee. ⁵⁵ And king Ptolemee answered, saying: Happy is the day wherein thou didst return to the land of thy fathers, and satest in the throne of their kingdom. ⁵⁶ And now I will do to thee as thou hast written but meet me at Ptolemais, that we may see one another, and I may give her to thee as thou hast said. ⁵⁷ So Ptolemee went out of Egypt, with Cleopatra his daughter, and he came to Ptolemais, in the hundred and sixty-second year. ⁵⁸ And king Alexander met him, and he gave him his daughter, Cleopatra: and he celebrated her marriage at Ptolemais with great glory, after the manner of kings. ⁵⁹ And king Alexander wrote to Jonathan, that he should come and meet him. ⁶⁰ And he went honourably to Ptolemais, and he met there the two kings, and he gave them much silver, and gold, and presents: and he found favour in their sight. ⁶¹ And some pestilent men of Israel, men of a wicked life, assembled themselves against

him, to accuse him: and the king gave no heed to them. ⁶² And he commanded that Jonathan's garments should be taken off, and that he should be clothed with purple: and they did so. And the king made him sit by himself. ⁶³ And he said to his princes: Go out with him into the midst of the city, and make proclamation, that no man complain against him of any matter, and that no man trouble him for any manner of cause. ⁶⁴ So when his accusers saw his glory proclaimed, and him clothed with purple, they all fled away. ⁶⁵ And the king magnified him, and enrolled him amongst his chief friends, and made him governor, and partaker of his dominion. ⁶⁶ And Jonathan returned into Jerusalem with peace and joy. ⁶⁷ In the year one hundred and sixty-five, Demetrius, the son of Demetrius, came from Crete into the land of his fathers. ⁶⁸ And king Alexander heard of it, and was much troubled, and returned to Antioch. ⁶⁹ And king Demetrius made Apollonius his general, who was governor of Celesyria: and he gathered together a great army, and came to Jamnia: and he sent to Jonathan, the high priest, ⁷⁰ Saying: Thou alone standest against us, and I am laughed at and reproached, because thou shewest thy power against us in the mountains. ⁷¹ Now, therefore, if thou trustest in thy forces, come down to us into the plain, and there let us try one another: for with me is the strength of war. ⁷² Ask, and learn who I am, and the rest that help me, who also say that your foot cannot stand before our face, for thy fathers have twice been put to flight in their own land: ⁷³ And now how wilt thou be able to abide the horsemen, and so great an army in the plain, where there is no stone, nor rock, nor place to flee to? ⁷⁴ Now when Jonathan heard the words of Apollonius, he was moved in his mind: and he chose ten thousand men, and went out of Jerusalem, and Simon, his brother, met him to help him. ⁷⁵ And they pitched their tents near Joppe, but they shut him out of the city: because a garrison of Apollonius was in Joppe, and he laid siege to it. ⁷⁶ And they that were in the city being affrighted, opened the gates to him: so Jonathan took Joppe. ⁷⁷ And Apollonius heard of it, and he took three thousand horsemen, and a great army. ⁷⁸ And he went to Azotus, as one that was making a journey, and immediately he went forth into the plain: because he had a great number of horsemen, and he trusted in them. And Jonathan followed after him to Azotus, and they joined battle. ⁷⁹ And Apollonius left privately in the camp a thousand horsemen behind them. ⁸⁰ And Jonathan knew that there was an ambush behind him, and they surrounded his army, and cast darts at the people from morning till evening. ⁸¹ But the people stood still, as Jonathan had commanded them: and so their horses were fatigued. ⁸² Then Simon drew forth his army, and attacked the legion: for the horsemen were wearied: and they were discomfited by him, and fled. ⁸³ And they that were scattered about the plain fled into Azotus, and went into Bethdagon, their idol's temple, there to save themselves. ⁸⁴ But Jonathan set fire to Azotus, and the cities that were round about it, and took the spoils of them and the temple of Dagon: and all them that were fled into it, he burnt with fire. ⁸⁵ So they that were slain by the sword, with them that were burnt, were almost eight thousand men. ⁸⁶ And Jonathan, removed his army from thence and camped against Ascalon: and they went out of the city to meet him with great honour. ⁸⁷ And Jonathan returned into Jerusalem with his people, having many spoils. ⁸⁸ And it

came to pass, when Alexander the king heard these words, that he honoured Jonathan yet more.⁸⁹ And he sent him a buckle of gold, as the custom is, to be given to such as are of the royal blood. And he gave him Accaron, and all the borders thereof, in possession.

274. The shifting kings of Syria

1 Maccabees 11:1-74

11 ¹ And the king of Egypt gathered together an army, like the sand that lieth upon the sea shore, and many ships: and he sought to get the kingdom of Alexander by deceit, and join it to his own kingdom. ² And he went out into Syria with peaceable words and they opened to him the cities, and met him: for king Alexander had ordered them to go forth to meet him, because he was his father in law. ³ Now when Ptolemee entered into the cities, he put garrisons of soldiers in every city. ⁴ And when he came near to Azotus, they shewed him the temple of Dagon that was burnt with fire, and Azotus, and the suburbs thereof, that were destroyed, and the bodies that were cast abroad, and the graves of them that were slain in the battle, which they had made near the way. ⁵ And they told the king that Jonathan had done these things, to make him odious: but the king held his peace. ⁶ And Jonathan came to meet the king at Joppe with glory, and they saluted one another, and they lodged there. ⁷ And Jonathan went with the king as far as the river, called Eleutherus: and he returned into Jerusalem. ⁸ And king Ptolemee got the dominion of the cities by the sea side, even to Seleucia, and he devised evil designs against Alexander. ⁹ And he sent ambassadors to Demetrius, saying: Come, let us make a league between us, and I will give thee my daughter whom Alexander hath, and thou shalt reign in the kingdom of thy father. ¹⁰ For I repent that I have given him my daughter: for he hath sought to kill me. ¹¹ And he slandered him, because he coveted his kingdom, ¹² And he took away his daughter, and gave her to Demetrius, and alienated himself from Alexander, and his enmities were made manifest. ¹³ And Ptolemee entered into Antioch, and set two crowns upon his head, that of Egypt, and that of Asia. ¹⁴ Now king Alexander was in Cilicia at that time: because they that were in those places had rebelled. ¹⁵ And when Alexander heard of it, he came to give him battle: and king Ptolemee brought forth his army, and met him with a strong power, and put him to flight. ¹⁶ And Alexander fled into Arabia, there to be protected: and king Ptolemee was exalted. ¹⁷ And Zabdiel the Arabian took off Alexander's head, and sent it to Ptolemee. ¹⁸ And king Ptolemee died the third day after: and they that were in the strong holds were destroyed by them that were within the camp. ¹⁹ And Demetrius reigned in the hundred and sixty-seventh year. ²⁰ In those days Jonathan gathered together them that were in Judea, to take the castle that was in Jerusalem: and they made many engines of war against it. ²¹ Then some wicked men that hated their own nation, went away to king Demetrius, and told him that Jonathan was besieging the castle. ²² And when he heard it, he was angry: and forthwith he came to Ptolemais, and wrote to Jonathan that he should not besiege the castle, but should come to him in haste, and speak to him. ²³ But when Jonathan heard this, he bade them besiege it still: and he chose some of the ancients of Israel, and of the priests, and put himself in danger. ²⁴ And he took gold, and silver, and raiment, and many other presents, and went to the

king to Ptolemais and he found favour in his sight. ²⁵ And certain wicked men of his nation made complaints against him. ²⁶ And the king treated him as his predecessors had done before: and he exalted him in the sight of all his friends. ²⁷ And he confirmed him in the high priesthood and all the honours he had before, and he made him the chief of his friends. ²⁸ And Jonathan requested of the king that he would make Judea free from tribute, and the three governments, and Samaria, and the confines thereof: and he promised him three hundred talents. ²⁹ And the king consented: and he wrote letters to Jonathan of all these things, to this effect. ³⁰ King Demetrius to his brother, Jonathan, and to the nation of the Jews, greeting. ³¹ We send you here a copy of the letter which we have written to Lasthenes, our parent, concerning you, that you might know it. ³² King Demetrius to Lasthenes, his parent, greetings. ³³ We have determined to do good to the nation of the Jews, who are our friends, and keep the things that are just with us, for their good will which they bear towards us. ³⁴ We have ratified, therefore, unto them all the borders of Judea, and the three cities, Apherema, Lydda, and Ramatha, which are added to Judea, out of Samaria, and all their confines, to be set apart to all them that sacrifice in Jerusalem, instead of the payments which the king received of them every year, and for the fruits of the land, and of the trees. ³⁵ And as for other things that belonged to us of the tithes, and of the tributes, from this time we discharge them of them: the salt pans also, and the crowns that were presented to us. ³⁶ We give all to them, and nothing hereof shall be revoked from this time forth and for ever. ³⁷ Now, therefore, see that thou make a copy of these things, and let it be given to Jonathan, and set upon the holy mountain, in a conspicuous place. ³⁸ And king Demetrius, seeing that the land was quiet before him, and nothing resisted him, sent away all his forces, every man to his own place, except the foreign army, which he had drawn together from the islands of the nations: so all the troops of his fathers hated him. ³⁹ Now there was one Tryphon who had been of Alexander's party before: who seeing that all the army murmured against Demetrius, went to Emalchuel, the Arabian, who brought up Antiochus, the son of Alexander: ⁴⁰ And he pressed him much to deliver him to him, that he might be king in his father's place: and he told him all that Demetrius had done, and how his soldiers hated him. And he remained there many days. ⁴¹ And Jonathan sent to king Demetrius, desiring that he would cast out them that were in the castle in Jerusalem, and those that were in the strong holds: because they fought against Israel. ⁴² And Demetrius sent to Jonathan, saying: I will not only do this for thee, and for thy people, but I will greatly honour thee, and thy nation, when opportunity shall serve. ⁴³ Now, therefore, thou shalt do well if thou send me men to help me: for all my army is gone from me. ⁴⁴ And Jonathan sent him three thousand valiant men to Antioch: and they came to the king, and the king was very glad of their coming. ⁴⁵ And they that were of the city assembled themselves together, to the number of a hundred and twenty thousand men, and would have killed the king. ⁴⁶ And the king fled into the palace: and they of the city kept the passages of the city, and began to fight. ⁴⁷ And the king called the Jews to his assistance: and they came to him all at once, and they all dispersed themselves through the city. ⁴⁸ And they slew in that

day a hundred thousand men, and they set fire to the city, and got many spoils that day, and delivered the king. ⁴⁹ And they that were of the city saw that the Jews had got the city as they would: and they were discouraged in their mind, and cried to the king, making supplication, and saying: ⁵⁰ Grant us peace, and let the Jews cease from assaulting us, and the city. ⁵¹ And they threw down their arms, and made peace, and the Jews were glorified in the sight of the king, and in the sight of all that were in his realm, and were renowned throughout the kingdom, and returned to Jerusalem with many spoils. ⁵² So king Demetrius sat in the throne of his kingdom: and the land was quiet before him. ⁵³ And he falsified all whatsoever he had said, and alienated himself from Jonathan, and did not reward him according to the benefits he had received from him, but gave him great trouble. ⁵⁴ And after this Tryphon returned, and with him Antiochus, the young boy, who was made king, and put on the diadem. ⁵⁵ And there assembled unto him all the hands which Demetrius had sent away, and they fought against Demetrius who turned his back and fled. ⁵⁶ And Tryphon took the elephants, and made himself master of Antioch. ⁵⁷ And young Antiochus wrote to Jonathan, saying: I confirm thee in the high priesthood, and I appoint thee ruler over the four cities, and to be one of the king's friends. ⁵⁸ And he sent him vessels of gold for his service, and he gave him leave to drink in gold, and to be clothed in purple, and to wear a golden buckle: ⁵⁹ And he made his brother, Simon, governor, from the borders of Tyre even to the confines of Egypt. ⁶⁰ Then Jonathan went forth, and passed through the cities beyond the river, and all the forces of Syria gathered themselves to him to help him, and he came to Ascalon, and they met him honourably out of the city. ⁶¹ And he went from thence to Gaza: and they that were in Gaza shut him out: and he besieged it, and burnt all the suburbs round about, and took the spoils. ⁶² And the men of Gaza made supplication to Jonathan, and he gave them the right hand: and he took their sons for hostages, and sent them to Jerusalem: and he went through the country, as far as Damascus. ⁶³ And Jonathan heard that the generals of Demetrius were come treacherously to Cades, which is in Galilee, with a great army, purposing to remove him from the affairs of the kingdom. ⁶⁴ And he went against them: but left his brother, Simon, in the country. ⁶⁵ And Simon encamped against Bethsura, and assaulted it many days, and shut them up. ⁶⁶ And they desired him to make peace, and he granted it them: and he cast them out from thence, and took the city, and placed a garrison in it. ⁶⁷ And Jonathan and his army encamped by the water of Genesar, and before it was light they were ready in the plain of Asor. ⁶⁸ And behold the army of the strangers met him in the plain, and they laid an ambush for him in the mountains: but he went out against them. ⁶⁹ And they that lay in ambush rose out of their places, and joined battle. ⁷⁰ And all that were on Jonathan's side fled, and none was left of them, but Mathathias, the son of Absalom, and Judas, the son of Calphi, chief captain of the army. ⁷¹ And Jonathan rent his garments, and cast earth upon his head, and prayed. ⁷² And Jonathan turned again to them to battle, and he put them to flight, and they fought. ⁷³ And they of his part that fled saw this, and they turned again to him, and they all with him pursued the enemies, even to Cades, to their own camp, and they came even

thither. ⁷⁴ And there fell of the aliens in that day three thousand men: and Jonathan returned to Jerusalem.

275. *Jonathan's embassies, and his capture*

1 Maccabees 12:1-54

12 ¹ And Jonathan saw that the time served him, and he chose certain men, and sent them to Rome, to confirm and to renew the amity with them: ² And he sent letters to the Spartans, and to other places, according to the same form. ³ And they went to Rome, and entered into the senate house, and said: Jonathan, the high priest, and the nation of the Jews, have sent us to renew the amity, and alliance, as it was before. ⁴ And they gave them letters to their governors in every place, to conduct them into the land of Juda with peace. ⁵ And this is a copy of the letters which Jonathan wrote to the Spartans: ⁶ Jonathan, the high priest, and the ancients of the nation, and the priests, and the rest of the people of the Jews, to the Spartans, their brethren, greeting. ⁷ There were letters sent long ago to Onias the high priest, from Arius, who reigned then among you to signify that you are our brethren, as the copy here underwritten doth specify. ⁸ And Onias received the ambassador with honour and received the letters, wherein there was mention made of the alliance, and amity. ⁹ We, though we needed none of these things having for our comfort the holy books that are in our hands, ¹⁰ Chose rather to send to you to renew the brotherhood and friendship, lest we should become strangers to you altogether: for there is a long time passed since you sent to us. ¹¹ We, therefore, at all times without ceasing, both in our festivals, and other days wherein it is convenient, remember you in the sacrifices that we offer, and in our observances, as it is meet and becoming to remember brethren. ¹² And we rejoice at your glory. ¹³ But we have had many troubles and wars on every side; and the kings that are round about us have fought against us. ¹⁴ But we would not be troublesome to you, nor to the rest of our allies and friends, in these wars. ¹⁵ For we have had help from heaven, and we have been delivered, and our enemies are humbled. ¹⁶ We have chosen, therefore, Numenius the son of Antiochus, and Antipater, the son of Jason, and have sent them to the Romans, to renew with them the former amity and alliance. ¹⁷ And we have commanded them to go also to you, and salute you, and to deliver you our letters, concerning the renewing of our brotherhood. ¹⁸ And now you shall do well to give us an answer hereto. ¹⁹ And this is the copy of the letter which he had sent to Onias: ²⁰ Arius, king of the Spartans, to Onias, the high priest, greeting. ²¹ It is found in writing concerning the Spartans, and the Jews, that they are brethren, and that they are of the stock of Abraham. ²² And now since this is come to our knowledge, you do well to write to us of your prosperity. ²³ And we also have written back to you, That our cattle, and our possessions, are yours: and yours, ours. We, therefore, have commanded that these things should be told you. ²⁴ Now Jonathan heard that the generals of Demetrius were come again with a greater army than before to fight against him. ²⁵ So he went out from Jerusalem, and met them in the land of Amath: for he gave them no time to enter into his country. ²⁶ And he sent spies into their camp, and they came back, and brought him word that they designed to come upon them in the night. ²⁷ And when the sun was set, Jonathan commanded his men to watch, and to be in arms all night long ready to fight,

and he set sentinels round about the camp.²⁸ And the enemies heard that Jonathan and his men were ready for battle: and they were struck with fear and dread in their heart: and they kindled fires in their camp.²⁹ But Jonathan, and they that were with him, knew it not till the morning: for they saw the lights burning.³⁰ And Jonathan pursued after them, but overtook them not: for they had passed the river Eleutherus.³¹ And Jonathan turned upon the Arabians, that are called Zabadeans: and he defeated them, and took the spoils of them.³² And he went forward, and came to Damascus, and passed through all that country.³³ Simon also went forth, and came as far as Ascalon, and the neighbouring fortresses, and he turned aside to Joppe, and took possession of it,³⁴ (For he heard that they designed to deliver the hold to them that took part with Demetrius) and he put a garrison there to keep it.³⁵ And Jonathan came back, and called together the ancients of the people; and he took a resolution with them to build fortresses in Judea,³⁶ And to build up walls in Jerusalem, and raise a mount between the castle and the city, to separate it from the city, that so it might have no communication, and that they might neither buy nor sell.³⁷ And they came together to build up the city: for the wall that was upon the brook, towards the east, was broken down, and he repaired that which is called Caphetetha:³⁸ And Simon built Adiada in Sephela, and fortified it, and set up gates and bars.³⁹ Now when Tryphon had conceived a design to make himself king of Asia and to take the crown, and to stretch out his hand against king Antiochus:⁴⁰ Fearing lest Jonathan would not suffer him, but would fight against him: he sought to seize upon him, and to kill him. So he rose up and came to Bethsan.⁴¹ And Jonathan went out to meet him with forty thousand men chosen for battle, and came to Bethsan.⁴² Now when Tryphon saw that Jonathan came with a great army, he durst not stretch forth his hand against him.⁴³ But received him with honour, and commended him to all his friends, and gave him presents: and he commanded his troops to obey him, as himself.⁴⁴ And he said to Jonathan: Why hast thou troubled all the people, whereas we have no war?⁴⁵ Now, therefore, send them back to their own houses: and choose thee a few men that may be with thee, and come with me to Ptolemais, and I will deliver it to thee, and the rest of the strong holds, and the army, and all that have any charge, and I will return and go away: for this is the cause of my coming.⁴⁶ And Jonathan believed him, and did as he said: and sent away his army, and they departed into the land of Juda:⁴⁷ But he kept with him three thousand men: of whom he sent two thousand into Galilee, and one thousand went with him.⁴⁸ Now as soon as Jonathan entered into Ptolemais, they of Ptolemais shut the gates of the city, and took him: and all them that came in with him they slew with the sword.⁴⁹ Then Tryphon sent an army and horsemen into Galilee, and into the great plain, to destroy all Jonathan's company.⁵⁰ But they, when they understood that Jonathan, and all that were with him, were taken and slain, encouraged one another, and went out ready for battle.⁵¹ Then they that had come after them, seeing that they stood for their lives, returned back.⁵² Whereupon they all came peaceably into the land of Juda and they bewailed Jonathan, and them that had been with him, exceedingly: and Israel mourned with great lamentation.⁵³ Then all the heathens that were round

about them, sought to destroy them. For they said:⁵⁴ They have no prince, nor any to help them: now therefore, let us make war upon them, and take away the memory of them from amongst men.

276. *Simon, and the freedom of Israel*

1 Maccabees 13:1-54

13 ¹ Now Simon heard that Tryphon was gathering together a very great army to invade the land of Juda, and to destroy it.² And seeing that the people was in dread and in fear, he went up to Jerusalem, and assembled the people,³ And exhorted them, saying: You know what great battles I and my brethren, and the house of my father, have fought for the laws, and the sanctuary, and the distresses that we have seen:⁴ By reason whereof all my brethren have lost their lives for Israel's sake, and I am left alone.⁵ And now far be it from me to spare my life in any time of trouble: for I am not better than my brethren.⁶ I will avenge then my nation and the sanctuary, and our children, and wives: for all the heathens are gathered together to destroy us out of mere malice.⁷ And the spirit of the people was enkindled as soon as they heard these words:⁸ And they answered with a loud voice, saying: Thou art our leader in the place of Judas, and Jonathan, thy brother:⁹ Fight thou our battles, and we will do whatsoever thou shalt say to us.¹⁰ So gathering together all the men of war, he made haste to finish all the walls of Jerusalem, and he fortified it round about.¹¹ And he sent Jonathan, the son of Absalom, and with him a new army, into Joppe, and he cast out them that were in it, and himself remained there.¹² And Tryphon removed from Ptolemais with a great army, to invade the land of Juda, and Jonathan was with him in custody.¹³ But Simon pitched in Addus, over against the plain.¹⁴ And when Tryphon understood that Simon was risen up in the place of his brother, Jonathan, and that he meant to join battle with him, he sent messengers to him,¹⁵ Saying: We have detained thy brother, Jonathan, for the money that he owed in the king's account, by reason of the affairs which he had the management of.¹⁶ But now send a hundred talents of silver, and his two sons for hostages, that when he is set at liberty he may not revolt from us, and we will release him.¹⁷ Now Simon knew that he spoke deceitfully to him; nevertheless, he ordered the money and the children to be sent, lest he should bring upon himself a great hatred of the people of Israel, who might have said:¹⁸ Because he sent not the money and the children therefore is he lost.¹⁹ So he sent the children and the hundred talents and he lied, and did not let Jonathan go.²⁰ And after this, Tryphon entered within the country, to destroy it: and they went about by the way that leadeth to Ador: and Simon and his army marched to every place whithersoever they went.²¹ And they that were in the castle, sent messengers to Tryphon, that he should make haste to come through the desert, and send them victuals.²² And Tryphon made ready all his horsemen to come that night; but there fell a very great snow, and he came not into the country of Galaad.²³ And when he approached to Bascama, he slew Jonathan and his sons there.²⁴ And Tryphon returned, and went into his own country.²⁵ And Simon sent, and took the bones of Jonathan, his brother, and buried them in Modin, the city of his fathers.²⁶ And all Israel bewailed him with great lamentation: and they mourned for him many days.²⁷ And Simon built over

the sepulchre of his father and of his brethren, a building lofty to the sight, of polished stone, behind and before: ²⁸ And he set up seven pyramids, one against another, for his father, and his mother, and his four brethren: ²⁹ And round about these he set great pillars; and upon the pillars, arms, for a perpetual memory; and by the arms, ships carved, which might be seen by all that sailed on the sea. ³⁰ This is the sepulchre that he made in Modin, even unto this day. ³¹ But Tryphon, when he was upon a journey with the young king, Antiochus, treacherously slew him. ³² And he reigned in his place, and put on the crown of Asia: and brought great evils upon the land. ³³ And Simon built up the strong holds of Judea, fortifying them with high towers, and great walls, and gates and bars: and he stored up victuals in the fortresses. ³⁴ And Simon chose men, and sent to king Demetrius, to the end that he should grant an immunity to the land; for all that Tryphon did, was to spoil. ³⁵ And king Demetrius, in answer to this request, wrote a letter in this manner: ³⁶ King Demetrius to Simon, the high priest, and friend of kings, and to the ancients, and to the nation of the Jews, greeting: ³⁷ The golden crown, and the palm, which you sent, we have received: and we are ready to make a firm peace with you, and to write to the king's chief officers to release you the things that we have released. ³⁸ For all that we have decreed in your favour shall stand in force. The strong holds that you have built, shall be your own. ³⁹ And as for any oversight or fault committed unto this day, we forgive it: and the crown which you owed: and if any other thing were taxed in Jerusalem, now let it not be taxed. ⁴⁰ And if any of you be fit to be enrolled among ours, let them be enrolled, and let there be peace between us. ⁴¹ In the year one hundred and seventy, the yoke of the Gentiles was taken off from Israel. ⁴² And the people of Israel began to write in the instruments, and public records, The first year under Simon, the high priest, the great captain, and prince of the Jews. ⁴³ In those days Simon besieged Gaza, and camped round about it, and he made engines, and set them to the city, and he struck one tower, and took it. ⁴⁴ And they that were within the engine leapt into the city: and there was a great uproar in the city. ⁴⁵ And they that were in the city went up, with their wives and children, upon the wall, with their garments rent, and they cried with a loud voice, beseeching Simon to grant them peace. ⁴⁶ And they said: Deal not with us according to our evil deeds, but according to thy mercy. ⁴⁷ And Simon being moved, did not destroy them but yet he cast them out of the city, and cleansed the houses wherein there had been idols, and then he entered into it with hymns, blessing the Lord: ⁴⁸ And having cast out of it all uncleanness, he placed in it men that should observe the law: and he fortified it, and made it his habitation. ⁴⁹ But they that were in the castle of Jerusalem were hindered from going out and coming into the country, and from buying and selling: and they were straitened with hunger, and many of them perished through famine. ⁵⁰ And they cried to Simon for peace, and he granted it to them: and he cast them out from thence and cleansed the castle from uncleannesses. ⁵¹ And they entered into it the three and twentieth day of the second month, in the year one hundred and seventy-one, with thanksgiving, and branches of palm trees, and harps, and cymbals, and psalteries, and hymns, and canticles, because the great enemy was destroyed out of Israel. ⁵² And he ordained that these days should be kept every year with gladness.

⁵³ And he fortified the mountain of the temple that was near the castle, and he dwelt there himself, and they that were with him. ⁵⁴ And Simon saw that John, his son, was a valiant man for war: and he made him captain of all the forces: and he dwelt in Gazara.

277. *The praise of Simon*

1 Maccabees 14:1-49

14 ¹ In the year one hundred and seventy-two king Demetrius assembled his army, and went into Media to get him succours to fight against Tryphon. ² And Arsaces, the king of Persia and Media, heard that Demetrius was entered within his borders, and he sent one of his princes to take him alive, and bring him to him. ³ And he went, and defeated the army of Demetrius: and took him, and brought him to Arsaces, and he put him into custody. ⁴ And all the land of Juda was at rest all the days of Simon, and he sought the good of his nation: and his power, and his glory pleased them well all his days. ⁵ And with all his glory he took Joppe for a haven, and made an entrance to the isles of the sea. ⁶ And he enlarged the bounds of his nation, and made himself master of the country. ⁷ And he gathered together a great number of captives, and had the dominion of Gazara, and of Bethsura, and of the castle: and took away all uncleanness out of it, and there was none that resisted him. ⁸ And every man tilled his land with peace, and the land of Juda yielded her increase, and the trees of the fields their fruit. ⁹ The ancient men sat all in the streets, and treated together of the good things of the land, and the young men put on them glory, and the robes of war. ¹⁰ And he provided victuals for the cities, and he appointed that they should be furnished with ammunition, so that the fame of his glory was renowned even to the end of the earth. ¹¹ He made peace in the land, and Israel rejoiced with great joy. ¹² And every man sat under his vine, and under his fig tree: and there was none to make them afraid. ¹³ There was none left in the land to fight against them: kings were discomfited in those days. ¹⁴ And he strengthened all those of his people that were brought low, and he sought the law, and took away every unjust and wicked man. ¹⁵ He glorified the sanctuary, and multiplied the vessels of the holy places. ¹⁶ And it was heard at Rome, and as far as Sparta, that Jonathan was dead: and they were very sorry. ¹⁷ But when they heard that Simon, his brother, was made high priest in his place, and was possessed of all the country, and the cities therein: ¹⁸ They wrote to him in tables of brass, to renew the friendship and alliance which they had made with Judas and with Jonathan, his brethren. ¹⁹ And they were read before the assembly in Jerusalem. And this is the copy of the letters that the Spartans sent. ²⁰ The princes and the cities of the Spartans, to Simon, the high priest, and to the ancients, and the priests, and the rest of the people of the Jews, their brethren, greeting. ²¹ The ambassadors that were sent to our people, have told us of your glory, and honour, and joy: and we rejoiced at their coming. ²² And we registered what was said by them in the councils of the people, in this manner: Numenius, the son of Antiochus, and Antipater, the son of Jason, ambassadors of the Jews, came to us to renew the former friendship with us. ²³ And it pleased the people to receive the men honourably, and to put a copy of their words in the public records, to be a memorial to the people of the Spartans. And we have written a copy of them to Simon,

the high priest.²⁴ And after this Simon sent Numenius to Rome, with a great shield of gold, of the weight of a thousand pounds, to confirm the league with them. And when the people of Rome had heard²⁵ These words, they said: What thanks shall we give to Simon, and his sons?²⁶ For he hath restored his brethren, and hath driven away in fight the enemies of Israel from them: and they decreed him liberty, and registered it in tables of brass, and set it upon pillars in mount Sion.²⁷ And this is a copy of the writing. The eighteenth day of the month Elul, in the year one hundred and seventy-two, being the third year under Simon, the high priest, at Asaramel,²⁸ In a great assembly of the priests, and of the people, and the princes of the nation, and the ancients of the country, these things were notified: Forasmuch as there have often been wars in our country,²⁹ And Simon, the son of Mathathias, of the children of Jarib, and his brethren, have put themselves in danger, and resisted the enemies of their nation, for the maintenance of their holy places, and the law: and have raised their nation to great glory.³⁰ And Jonathan gathered together his nation, and was made their high priest, and he was laid to his people.³¹ And their enemies desired to tread down and destroy their country, and to stretch forth their hands against their holy places.³² Then Simon resisted and fought for his nation, and laid out much of his money, and armed the valiant men of his nation, and gave them wages.³³ And he fortified the cities of Judea and Bethsura that lieth in the borders of Judea, where the armour of the enemies was before: and he placed there a garrison of Jews.³⁴ And he fortified Joppe, which lieth by the sea: and Gazara, which bordereth upon Azotus, wherein the enemies dwelt before, and he placed Jews here: and furnished them with all things convenient for their reparation.³⁵ And the people seeing the acts of Simon, and to what glory he meant to bring his nation, made him their prince and high priest, because he had done all these things, and for the justice and faith which he kept to his nation, and for that he sought by all means to advance his people.³⁶ And in his days things prospered in his hands, so that the heathens were taken away out of their country, and they also that were in the city of David, in Jerusalem, in the castle, out of which they issued forth, and profaned all places round about the sanctuary, and did much evil to purity.³⁷ And he placed therein Jews for the defence of the country, and of the city, and he raised up the walls of Jerusalem.³⁸ And king Demetrius confirmed him in the high priesthood.³⁹ According to these things he made him his friend, and glorified him with great glory.⁴⁰ For he had heard that the Romans had called the Jews their friends, and confederates, and brethren, and that they had received Simon's ambassadors with honour:⁴¹ And that the Jews, and their priests, had consented that he should be their prince and high priest for ever, till there should arise a faithful prophet:⁴² And that he should be chief over them, and that he should have the charge of the sanctuary, and that he should appoint rulers over their works, and over the country, and over the armour, and over the strong holds;⁴³ And that he should have care of the holy places; and that he should be obeyed by all, and that all the writings in the country should be made in his name; and that he should be clothed with purple and gold:⁴⁴ And that it should not be lawful for any of the people, or of the priests, to disannul any of these things, or to gainsay his

words, or to call together an assembly in the country without him: or to be clothed with purple, or to wear a buckle of gold.⁴⁵ And whosoever shall do otherwise, or shall make void any of these things, shall be punished.⁴⁶ And it pleased all the people to establish Simon, and to do according to these words.⁴⁷ And Simon accepted thereof, and was well pleased to execute the office of the high priesthood, and to be captain, and prince of the nation of the Jews, and of the priests, and to be chief over all.⁴⁸ And they commanded that this writing should be put in tables of brass, and that they should be set up within the compass of the sanctuary, in a conspicuous place:⁴⁹ And that a copy thereof should be put in the treasury, that Simon, and his sons, may have it.

278. Antiochus turns; the death of Simon

1 Maccabees 15:1-16:24

15 ¹ And king Antiochus, the son of Demetrius, sent letters from the isles of the sea to Simon, the priest, and prince of the nation of the Jews, and to all the people: ² And the contents were these: King Antiochus to Simon, the high priest, and to the nation of the Jews, greeting. ³ Forasmuch as certain pestilent men have usurped the kingdom of our fathers, and my purpose is to challenge the kingdom, and to restore it to its former estate; and I have chosen a great army, and have built ships of war. ⁴ And I design to go through the country, that I may take revenge of them that have destroyed our country, and that have made many cities desolate in my realm. ⁵ Now, therefore, I confirm unto thee all the oblations which all the kings before me remitted to thee, and what other gifts soever they remitted to thee: ⁶ And I give thee leave to coin thy own money in thy country: ⁷ And let Jerusalem be holy and free, and all the armour that hath been made, and the fortresses which thou hast built, and which thou keepest in thy hands, let them remain to thee. ⁸ And all that is due to the king, and what should be the king's hereafter, from this present and for ever, is forgiven thee. ⁹ And when we shall have recovered our kingdom, we will glorify thee, and thy nation, and the temple, with great glory, so that your glory shall be made manifest in all the earth. ¹⁰ In the year one hundred and seventy-four, Antiochus entered into the land of his fathers, and all the forces assembled to him, so that few were left with Tryphon. ¹¹ And king Antiochus pursued after him, and he fled along by the sea coast and came to Dora. ¹² For he perceived that evils were gathered together upon him, and his troops had forsaken him. ¹³ And Antiochus camped above Dora with a hundred and twenty thousand men of war, and eight thousand horsemen: ¹⁴ And he invested the city, and the ships drew near by sea: and they annoyed the city by land, and by sea, and suffered none to come in, or to go out. ¹⁵ And Numenius, and they that had been with him, came from the city of Rome, having letters written to the kings, and countries, the contents whereof were these: ¹⁶ Lucius, the consul of the Romans, to king Ptolemee, greeting. ¹⁷ The ambassadors of the Jews, our friends, came to us, to renew the former friendship and alliance, being sent from Simon, the high priest, and the people of the Jews. ¹⁸ And they brought also a shield of gold of a thousand pounds. ¹⁹ It hath seemed good therefore to us, to write to the kings and countries, that they should do them no harm, nor fight against them, their cities, or countries: and that they should give no aid to them that fight

against them. ²⁰ And it hath seemed good to us to receive the shield of them. ²¹ If, therefore, any pestilent men are fled out of their country to you, deliver them to Simon, the high priest, that he may punish them according to their law. ²² These same things were written to king Demetrius, and to Attalus, and to Ariarathes, and to Arsaces, ²³ And to all the countries: and to Lampsacus and to the Spartans, and to Delus, and Myndus, and Sicyon, and Caria, and Samus, and Pamphylia, and Lycia, and Alicarnassus, and Cos, and Side, and Aradus, and Rhodes, and Phaselis, and Gortyna, and Gnidus, and Cyprus, and Cyrene. ²⁴ And they wrote a copy thereof to Simon, the high priest, and to the people of the Jews. ²⁵ But king Antiochus moved his camp to Dora the second time, assaulting it continually, and making engines: and he shut up Tryphon, that he could not go out. ²⁶ And Simon sent to him two thousand chosen men to aid him, silver also, and gold, and abundance of furniture. ²⁷ And he would not receive them, but broke all the covenant that he had made with him before, and alienated himself from him. ²⁸ And he sent to him Athenobius, one of his friends, to treat with him, saying: You hold Joppe and Gazara, and the castle that is in Jerusalem, which are cities of my kingdom: ²⁹ Their borders you have wasted, and you have made great havoc in the land, and have got the dominion of many places in my kingdom. ³⁰ Now, therefore, deliver up the cities that you have taken, and the tributes of the places whereof you have gotten the dominion without the borders of Judea. ³¹ But if not, give me for them five hundred talents of silver, and for the havoc that you have made, and the tributes of the cities, other five hundred talents: or else we will come and fight against you. ³² So Athenobius, the king's friend came to Jerusalem, and saw the glory of Simon and his magnificence in gold, and silver, and his great equipage, and he was astonished, and told him the king's words. ³³ And Simon answered him, and said to him: We have neither taken other men's land, neither do we hold that which is other men's, but the inheritance of our fathers, which was for some time unjustly possessed by our enemies. ³⁴ But we having opportunity, claim the inheritance of our fathers. ³⁵ And as to thy complaints concerning Joppe and Gazara, they did great harm to the people, and to our country: yet for these we will give a hundred talents. And Athenobius answered him not a word. ³⁶ But returning in a rage to the king, made report to him of these words, and of the glory of Simon, and of all that he had seen, and the king was exceeding angry. ³⁷ And Tryphon fled away by ship to Orthosias. ³⁸ And the king appointed Cendebeus captain of the sea coast, and gave him an army of footmen and horsemen. ³⁹ And he commanded him to march with his army towards Judea: and he commanded him to build up Gedor, and to fortify the gates of the city, and to war against the people. But the king himself pursued after Tryphon. ⁴⁰ And Cendebeus came to Jamnia, and began to provoke the people, and to ravage Judea, and to take the people prisoners, and to kill, and to build Gedor. ⁴¹ And he placed there horsemen, and an army: that they might issue forth, and make incursions upon the ways of Judea, as the king had commanded him.

16 ¹ Then John came up from Gazara, and told Simon, his father, what Cendebeus had done against their people. ² And Simon called his two eldest sons, Judas and John, and said to them: I and my brethren, and my father's house, have fought against the

enemies of Israel from our youth even to this day: and things have prospered so well in our hands, that we have delivered Israel oftentimes. ³ And now I am old, but be you instead of me, and my brethren, and go out, and fight for our nation: and the help from heaven be with you. ⁴ Then he chose out of the country twenty thousand fighting men, and horsemen, and they went forth against Cendebeus: and they rested in Modin. ⁵ And they arose in the morning, and went into the plain: and behold a very great army of footmen and horsemen came against them, and there was a running river between them. ⁶ And he and his people pitched their camp over against them, and he saw that the people were afraid to go over the river, so he went over first: then the men seeing him, passed over after him. ⁷ And he divided the people, and set the horsemen in the midst of the footmen: but the horsemen of the enemies were very numerous. ⁸ And they sounded the holy trumpets: and Cendebeus and his army were put to flight: and there fell many of them wounded, and the rest fled into the strong hold. ⁹ At that time, Judas, John's brother, was wounded: but John pursued after them, till he came to Cedron, which he had built: ¹⁰ And they fled even to the towers that were in the fields of Azotus, and he burnt them with fire. And there fell of them two thousand men, and he returned into Judea in peace. ¹¹ Now Ptolemee, the son of Abobus, was appointed captain in the plain of Jericho, and he had abundance of silver and gold. ¹² For he was son in law of the high priest. ¹³ And his heart was lifted up, and he designed to make himself master of the country, and he purposed treachery against Simon and his sons, to destroy them. ¹⁴ Now Simon, as he was going through the cities that were in the country of Judea, and taking care for the good ordering of them, went down to Jericho, he and Mathathias and Judas, his sons, in the year one hundred and seventy-seven, the eleventh month: the same is the month Sabath. ¹⁵ And the son of Abobus received them deceitfully into a little fortress, that is called Doch, which he had built: and he made them a great feast, and hid men there. ¹⁶ And when Simon and his sons had drunk plentifully, Ptolemee and his men rose up, and took their weapons, and entered into the banqueting place, and slew him, and his two sons, and some of his servants. ¹⁷ And he committed a great treachery in Israel, and rendered evil for good. ¹⁸ And Ptolemee wrote these things, and sent to the king that he should send him an army to aid him, and he would deliver him the country, and their cities, and tributes. ¹⁹ And he sent others to Gazara to kill John: and to the tribunes he sent letters to come to him, and that he would give them silver, and gold, and gifts. ²⁰ And he sent others to take Jerusalem, and the mountain of the temple. ²¹ Now one running before, told John in Gazara, that his father and his brethren were slain, and that he hath sent men to kill thee also. ²² But when he heard it, he was exceedingly afraid: and he apprehended the men that came to kill him, and he put them to death: for he knew that they sought to make him away. ²³ And as concerning the rest of the acts of John, and his wars, and the worthy deeds, which he bravely achieved, and the building of the walls, which he made, and the things that he did: ²⁴ Behold, these are written in the book of the days of his priesthood, from the time that he was made high priest after his father.

279. The martyrdom of Eleazar*2 Maccabees 6:1-31*

6 ¹ But not long after the king sent a certain old man of Antioch, to compel the Jews to depart from the laws of their fathers and of God: ² And to defile the temple that was in Jerusalem, and to call it the temple of Jupiter Olympius: and that in Garazim of Jupiter Hospitalis, according as they were that inhabited the place. ³ And very bad was this invasion of evils, and grievous to all. ⁴ For the temple was full of the riot and revellings of the Gentiles: and of men lying with lewd women. And women thrust themselves of their accord into the holy places, and brought in things that were not lawful. ⁵ The altar also was filled with unlawful things, which were forbidden by the laws. ⁶ And neither were the sabbaths kept, nor the solemn days of the fathers observed, neither did any man plainly profess himself to be a Jew. ⁷ But they were led by bitter constraint on the king's birthday to the sacrifices: and when the feast of Bacchus was kept, they were compelled to go about crowned with ivy in honour of Bacchus. ⁸ And there went out a decree into the neighbouring cities of the Gentiles, by the suggestion of the Ptolemeans, that they also should act in like manner against the Jews, to oblige them to sacrifice: ⁹ And whosoever would not conform themselves to the ways of the Gentiles, should be put to death: then was misery to be seen. ¹⁰ For two women were accused to have circumcised their children: whom, when they had openly led about through the city, with the infants hanging at their breasts, they threw down headlong from the walls. ¹¹ And others that had met together in caves that were near, and were keeping the sabbath day privately, being discovered by Philip, were burnt with fire, because they made a conscience to help themselves with their hands, by reason of the religious observance of the day. ¹² Now I beseech those that shall read this book, that they be not shocked at these calamities, but that they consider the things that happened, not as being for the destruction, but for the correction of our nation. ¹³ For it is a token of great goodness, when sinners are not suffered to go on in their ways for a long time, but are presently punished. ¹⁴ For, not as with other nations, (whom the Lord patiently expecteth, that when the day of judgment shall come, he may punish them in the fulness of their sins:) ¹⁵ Doth he also deal with us, so as to suffer our sins to come to their height, and then take vengeance on us. ¹⁶ And therefore he never withdraweth his mercy from us: but though he chastise his people with adversity he forsaketh them not. ¹⁷ But let this suffice in a few words for a warning to the readers. And now we must come to the narration. ¹⁸ Eleazar one of the chief of the scribes, a man advanced in years, and of a comely countenance, was pressed to open his mouth to eat swine's flesh. ¹⁹ But he, choosing rather a most glorious death than a hateful life, went forward voluntarily to the torment. ²⁰ And considering in what manner he was to come to it, patiently bearing, he determined not to do any unlawful things for the love of life. ²¹ But they that stood by, being moved with wicked pity, for the old friendship they had with the man, taking him aside, desired that flesh might be brought which it was lawful for him to eat, that he might make as if he had eaten, as the king had commanded, of the flesh of the sacrifice: ²² That by so doing he might be delivered from death; and for the sake of their old

friendship with the man, they did him this courtesy. ²³ But he began to consider the dignity of his age, and his ancient years, and the inbred honour of his grey head, and his good life and conversation from a child; and he answered without delay, according to the ordinances of the holy law made by God, saying, that he would rather be sent into the other world. ²⁴ For it doth not become our age, said he, to dissemble: whereby many young persons might think that Eleazar, at the age of fourscore and ten years, was gone over to the life of the heathens: ²⁵ And so they, through my dissimulation, and for a little time of a corruptible life, should be deceived, and hereby I should bring a stain and a curse upon my old age. ²⁶ For though, for the present time, I should be delivered from the punishments of men, yet should I not escape the hand of the Almighty neither alive nor dead. ²⁷ Wherefore, by departing manfully out of this life, I shall shew myself worthy of my old age: ²⁸ And I shall leave an example of fortitude to young men, if with a ready mind and constancy I suffer an honourable death, for the most venerable and most holy laws. And having spoken thus, he was forthwith carried to execution. ²⁹ And they that led him, and had been a little before more mild, were changed to wrath for the words he had spoken, which they thought were uttered out of arrogancy. ³⁰ But when he was now ready to die with the stripes, he groaned: and said: O Lord, who hast the holy knowledge, thou knowest manifestly that whereas I might be delivered from death, I suffer grievous pains in body: but in soul am well content to suffer these things, because I fear thee. ³¹ Thus did this man die, leaving not only to young men, but also to the whole nation, the memory of his death, for an example of virtue and fortitude.

280. The mother and her seven sons*2 Maccabees 7:1-42*

The clearest statement of the resurrection in the Old Testament, and the reason these two chapters are read though the rest of 2 Machabees is not.

7 ¹ It came to pass also, that seven brethren, together with their mother, were apprehended, and compelled by the king to eat swine's flesh against the law, for which end they were tormented with whips and scourges. ² But one of them, who was the eldest, said thus: What wouldst thou ask, or learn of us? we are ready to die, rather than to transgress the laws of God, received from our fathers. ³ Then the king being angry, commanded fryingpans and brazen caldrons to be made hot: which forthwith being heated, ⁴ He commanded to cut out the tongue of him that had spoken first: and the skin of his head being drawn off, to chop off also the extremities of his hands and feet, the rest of his brethren and his mother looking on. ⁵ And when he was now maimed in all parts, he commanded him, being yet alive, to be brought to the fire, and to be fried in the fryingpan: and while he was suffering therein long torments, the rest, together with the mother, exhorted one another to die manfully, ⁶ Saying: The Lord God will look upon the truth, and will take pleasure in us, as Moses declared in the profession of the canticle; And in his servants he will take pleasure. ⁷ So when the first was dead after this manner, they brought the next to make him a mocking stock: and when they had pulled off the skin of his head with the hair, they asked him if he would eat, before he were punished throughout the whole

body in every limb. ⁸ But he answered in his own language, and said: I will not do it. Wherefore he also, in the next place, received the torments of the first: ⁹ And when he was at the last gasp, he said thus: Thou indeed, O most wicked man, destroyest us out of this present life: but the King of the world will raise us up, who die for his laws, in the resurrection of eternal life. ¹⁰ After him the third was made a mocking-stock, and when he was required, he quickly put forth his tongue, and courageously stretched out his hands: ¹¹ And said with confidence: These I have from heaven, but for the laws of God I now despise them, because I hope to receive them again from him. ¹² So that the king, and they that were with him, wondered at the young man's courage, because he esteemed the torments as nothing. ¹³ And after he was thus dead, they tormented the fourth in the like manner. ¹⁴ And when he was now ready to die, he spoke thus: It is better, being put to death by men, to look for hope from God, to be raised up again by him; for, as to thee, thou shalt have no resurrection unto life. ¹⁵ And when they had brought the fifth, they tormented him. But he, looking upon the king, ¹⁶ Said: Whereas thou hast power among men though thou art corruptible, thou dost what thou wilt but think not that our nation is forsaken by God. ¹⁷ But stay patiently a while, and thou shalt see his great power, in what manner he will torment thee and thy seed. ¹⁸ After him they brought the sixth, and he being ready to die, spoke thus: Be not deceived without cause: for we suffer these things for ourselves, having sinned against our God, and things worthy of admiration are done to us: ¹⁹ But do not think that thou shalt escape unpunished, for that thou hast attempted to fight against God. ²⁰ Now the mother was to be admired above measure, and worthy to be remembered by good men, who beheld her seven sons slain in the space of one day, and bore it with a good courage, for the hope that she had in God: ²¹ And she bravely exhorted every one of them in her own language, being filled with wisdom; and joining a man's heart to a woman's thought, ²² She said to them: I know not how you were formed in my womb; for I neither gave you breath, nor soul, nor life, neither did I frame the limbs of every one of you. ²³ But the Creator of the world, that formed the nativity of man, and that found out the origin of all, he will restore to you again, in his mercy, both breath and life, as now you despise yourselves for the sake of his laws. ²⁴ Now Antiochus, thinking himself despised, and withal despising the voice of the upbraider, when the youngest was yet alive, did not only exhort him by words, but also assured him with an oath, that he would make him a rich and a happy man, and, if he would turn from the laws of his fathers, would take him for a friend, and furnish him with things necessary. ²⁵ But when the young man was not moved with these things, the king called the mother, and counselled her to deal with the young man to save his life. ²⁶ And when he had exhorted her with many words she promised that she would counsel her son. ²⁷ So bending herself towards him, mocking the cruel tyrant, she said in her own language: My son have pity upon me, that bore thee nine months in my womb, and gave thee suck three years, and nourished thee, and brought thee up unto this age. ²⁸ I beseech thee, my son, look upon heaven and earth, and all that is in them, and consider that God made them out of nothing, and mankind also: ²⁹ So thou shalt not fear this

tormentor, but being made a worthy partner with thy brethren, receive death, that in that mercy I may receive thee again with thy brethren. ³⁰ While she was yet speaking these words, the young man said: For whom do you stay? I will not obey the commandment of the king, but the commandment of the law which was given us by Moses. ³¹ But thou that hast been the author of all mischief against the Hebrews, shalt not escape the hand of God. ³² For we suffer thus for our sins. ³³ And though the Lord, our God, is angry with us a little while, for our chastisement and correction, yet he will be reconciled again to his servants. ³⁴ But thou, O wicked, and of all men most flagitious, be not lifted up without cause with vain hopes, whilst thou art raging against his servants. ³⁵ For thou hast not yet escaped the judgment of the Almighty God, who beholdeth all things. ³⁶ For my brethren having now undergone a short pain, are under the covenant of eternal life: but thou, by the judgment of God, shalt receive just punishment for thy pride. ³⁷ But I, like my brethren, offer up my life and my body for the laws of our fathers: calling upon God to be speedily merciful to our nation, and that thou by torments and stripes mayst confess that he alone is God. ³⁸ But in me, and in my brethren, the wrath of the Almighty, which hath justly been brought upon all our nation, shall cease. ³⁹ Then the king being incensed with anger, raged against him more cruelly than all the rest, taking it grievously that he was mocked. ⁴⁰ So this man also died undefiled, wholly trusting in the Lord. ⁴¹ And last of all, after the sons, the mother also was consumed. ⁴² But now there is enough said of the sacrifices and of the excessive cruelties.

THE LIFE OF CHRIST

St. Luke entire is the spine of this period: it is the gospel written as a continuous narrative, and it carries the infancy, the journey to Jerusalem, and the resurrection appearances. St. Matthew, St. Mark and St. John enter at the year tier only, and only where they give what St. Luke does not.

281. Zachary in the temple

Luke 1:1-25

¹ ¹ Forasmuch as many have taken in hand to set forth in order a narration of the things that have been accomplished among us, ² According as they have delivered them unto us, who from the beginning were eyewitnesses and ministers of the word: ³ It seemed good to me also, having diligently attained to all things from the beginning, to write to thee in order, most excellent Theophilus, ⁴ That thou mayest know the verity of those words in which thou hast been instructed.

⁵ There was in the days of Herod, the king of Judea, a certain priest named Zachary, of the course of Abia: and his wife was of the daughters of Aaron, and her name Elizabeth. ⁶ And they were both just before God, walking in all the commandments and justifications of the Lord without blame. ⁷ And they had no son, for that Elizabeth was barren: and they both were well advanced in years. ⁸ And it came to pass, when he executed the priestly function in the order of his course before God, ⁹ According to the custom of the priestly office, it was his lot to offer incense, going into the temple of the Lord. ¹⁰ And all the multitude of the people was praying without, at the hour of incense. ¹¹ And

there appeared to him an angel of the Lord, standing on the right side of the altar of incense. ¹² And Zachary seeing him, was troubled: and fear fell upon him. ¹³ But the angel said to him: Fear not, Zachary, for thy prayer is heard: and thy wife Elizabeth shall bear thee a son. And thou shalt call his name John. ¹⁴ And thou shalt have joy and gladness: and many shall rejoice in his nativity. ¹⁵ For he shall be great before the Lord and shall drink no wine nor strong drink: and he shall be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from his mother's womb. ¹⁶ And he shall convert many of the children of Israel to the Lord their God. ¹⁷ And he shall go before him in the spirit and power of Elias: that he may turn the hearts of the fathers unto the children and the incredulous to the wisdom of the just, to prepare unto the Lord a perfect people. ¹⁸ And Zachary said to the angel: Whereby shall I know this? For I am an old man, and my wife is advanced in years. ¹⁹ And the angel answering, said to him: I am Gabriel, who stand before God and am sent to speak to thee and to bring thee these good tidings. ²⁰ And behold, thou shalt be dumb and shalt not be able to speak until the day wherein these things shall come to pass: because thou hast not believed my words, which shall be fulfilled in their time. ²¹ And the people were waiting for Zachary: and they wondered that he tarried so long in the temple. ²² And when he came out, he could not speak to them: and they understood that he had seen a vision in the temple. And he made signs to them and remained dumb. ²³ And it came to pass, after the days of his office were accomplished, he departed to his own house. ²⁴ And after those days, Elizabeth his wife conceived and hid herself five months, saying: ²⁵ Thus hath the Lord dealt with me in the days wherein he hath had regard to take away my reproach among men.

282. The Annunciation and the Nativity

Luke 1:26-38; 2:1-20 — here Luke 1:26-2:20

Read as one sitting from two places in St. Luke. The angel's promise of a throne and a kingdom without end answers 2 Samuel 7, read earlier in this plan.

1 ²⁶ And in the sixth month, the angel Gabriel was sent from God into a city of Galilee, called Nazareth, ²⁷ To a virgin espoused to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David: and the virgin's name was Mary. ²⁸ And the angel being come in, said unto her: Hail, full of grace, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women. ²⁹ Who having heard, was troubled at his saying and thought with herself what manner of salutation this should be. ³⁰ And the angel said to her: Fear not, Mary, for thou hast found grace with God. ³¹ Behold thou shalt conceive in thy womb and shalt bring forth a son: and thou shalt call his name Jesus. ³² He shall be great and shall be called the Son of the Most High. And the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of David his father: and he shall reign in the house of Jacob for ever. ³³ And of his kingdom there shall be no end. ³⁴ And Mary said to the angel: How shall this be done, because I know not man? ³⁵ And the angel answering, said to her: The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee and the power of the Most High shall overshadow thee. And therefore also the Holy which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God. ³⁶ And behold thy cousin Elizabeth, she also hath conceived a son in her old age: and this is the sixth month with her that is called barren.

³⁷ Because no word shall be impossible with God. ³⁸ And Mary said: Behold the handmaid of the Lord: be it done to me according to thy word. And the angel departed from her.

2 ¹ And it came to pass that in those days there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus that the whole world should be enrolled. ² This enrolling was first made by Cyrinus, the governor of Syria. ³ And all went to be enrolled, every one into his own city. ⁴ And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judea, to the city of David, which is called Bethlehem: because he was of the house and family of David. ⁵ To be enrolled with Mary his espoused wife, who was with child. ⁶ And it came to pass that when they were there, her days were accomplished that she should be delivered. ⁷ And she brought forth her first born son and wrapped him up in swaddling clothes and laid him in a manger: because there was no room for them in the inn. ⁸ And there were in the same country shepherds watching and keeping the night watches over their flock. ⁹ And behold an angel of the Lord stood by them and the brightness of God shone round about them: and they feared with a great fear. ¹⁰ And the angel said to them: Fear not; for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy that shall be to all the people: ¹¹ For, this day is born to you a Saviour, who is Christ the Lord, in the city of David. ¹² And this shall be a sign unto you. You shall find the infant wrapped in swaddling clothes and laid in a manger. ¹³ And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly army, praising God and saying: ¹⁴ Glory to God in the highest: and on earth peace to men of good will. ¹⁵ And it came to pass, after the angels departed from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another: Let us go over to Bethlehem and let us see this word that is come to pass, which the Lord hath shewed to us. ¹⁶ And they came with haste: and they found Mary and Joseph, and the infant lying in the manger. ¹⁷ And seeing, they understood of the word that had been spoken to them concerning this child. ¹⁸ And all that heard wondered: and at those things that were told them by the shepherds. ¹⁹ But Mary kept all these words, pondering them in her heart. ²⁰ And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things they had heard and seen, as it was told unto them.

283. The Visitation, and the Magnificat

Luke 1:39-56

The canticle answers Anna's in 1 Samuel 2.

1 ³⁹ And Mary rising up in those days, went into the hill country with haste into a city of Juda. ⁴⁰ And she entered into the house of Zachary and saluted Elizabeth. ⁴¹ And it came to pass that when Elizabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the infant leaped in her womb. And Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost. ⁴² And she cried out with a loud voice and said: Blessed art thou among women and blessed is the fruit of thy womb. ⁴³ And whence is this to me that the mother of my Lord should come to me? ⁴⁴ For behold as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in my ears, the infant in my womb leaped for joy. ⁴⁵ And blessed art thou that hast believed, because those things shall be accomplished that were spoken to thee by the Lord. ⁴⁶ And Mary said: My soul doth magnify the Lord. ⁴⁷ And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour. ⁴⁸ Because he hath regarded the humility of his handmaid: for behold from henceforth all generations shall

call me blessed. ⁴⁹ Because he that is mighty hath done great things to me: and holy is his name. ⁵⁰ And his mercy is from generation unto generations, to them that fear him. ⁵¹ He hath shewed might in his arm: he hath scattered the proud in the conceit of their heart. ⁵² He hath put down the mighty from their seat and hath exalted the humble. ⁵³ He hath filled the hungry with good things: and the rich he hath sent empty away. ⁵⁴ He hath received Israel his servant, being mindful of his mercy. ⁵⁵ As he spoke to our fathers: to Abraham and to his seed for ever. ⁵⁶ And Mary abode with her about three months. And she returned to her own house.

284. The birth of John, and the Benedictus

Luke 1:57-80

1 ⁵⁷ Now Elizabeth's full time of being delivered was come: and she brought forth a son. ⁵⁸ And her neighbors and kinsfolks heard that the Lord had shewed his great mercy towards her: and they congratulated with her. ⁵⁹ And it came to pass that on the eighth day they came to circumcise the child: and they called him by his father's name Zachary. ⁶⁰ And his mother answering, said: Not so. But he shall be called John. ⁶¹ And they said to her: There is none of thy kindred that is called by this name. ⁶² And they made signs to his father, how he would have him called. ⁶³ And demanding a writing table, he wrote, saying: John is his name. And they all wondered. ⁶⁴ And immediately his mouth was opened and his tongue loosed: and he spoke, blessing God. ⁶⁵ And fear came upon all their neighbours: and all these things were noised abroad over all the hill country of Judea. ⁶⁶ And all they that had heard them laid them up in their heart, saying: What an one, think ye, shall this child be? For the hand of the Lord was with him. ⁶⁷ And Zachary his father was filled with the Holy Ghost. And he prophesied, saying: ⁶⁸ Blessed be the Lord God of Israel: because he hath visited and wrought the redemption of his people. ⁶⁹ And hath raised up an horn of salvation to us, in the house of David his servant. ⁷⁰ As he spoke by the mouth of his holy prophets, who are from the beginning. ⁷¹ Salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all that hate us. ⁷² To perform mercy to our fathers and to remember his holy testament. ⁷³ The oath, which he swore to Abraham our father, that he would grant to us. ⁷⁴ That being delivered from the hand of our enemies, we may serve him without fear: ⁷⁵ In holiness and justice before him, all our days. ⁷⁶ And thou, child, shalt be called the prophet of the Highest: for thou shalt, go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways: ⁷⁷ To give knowledge of salvation to his people, unto the remission of their sins. ⁷⁸ Through the bowels of the mercy of our God, in which the Orient from on high hath visited us: ⁷⁹ To enlighten them that sit in darkness and in the shadow of death: to direct our feet into the way of peace. ⁸⁰ And the child grew and was strengthened in spirit: and was in the deserts until the day of his manifestation to Israel.

285. The presentation, and the finding in the temple

Luke 2:21-52

2 ²¹ And after eight days were accomplished, that the child should be circumcised, his name was called JESUS, which was called by the angel before he was conceived in the womb. ²² And

after the days of her purification, according to the law of Moses, were accomplished, they carried him to Jerusalem, to present him to the Lord: ²³ As it is written in the law of the Lord: Every male opening the womb shall be called holy to the Lord: ²⁴ And to offer a sacrifice, according as it is written in the law of the Lord, a pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons: ²⁵ And behold there was a man in Jerusalem named Simeon: and this man was just and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel. And the Holy Ghost was in him. ²⁶ And he had received an answer from the Holy Ghost, that he should not see death before he had seen the Christ of the Lord. ²⁷ And he came by the Spirit into the temple. And when his parents brought in the child Jesus, to do for him according to the custom of the law, ²⁸ He also took him into his arms and blessed God and said ²⁹ Now thou dost dismiss thy servant, O Lord, according to thy word in peace: ³⁰ Because my eyes have seen thy salvation, ³¹ Which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples: ³² A light to the revelation of the Gentiles and the glory of thy people Israel. ³³ And his father and mother were wondering at those things which were spoken concerning him. ³⁴ And Simeon blessed them and said to Mary his mother: Behold this child is set for the fall and for the resurrection of many in Israel and for a sign which shall be contradicted. ³⁵ And thy own soul a sword shall pierce, that, out of many hearts thoughts may be revealed. ³⁶ And there was one Anna, a prophetess, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Aser. She was far advanced in years and had lived with her husband seven years from her virginity. ³⁷ And she was a widow until fourscore and four years: who departed not from the temple, by fastings and prayers serving night and day. ³⁸ Now she, at the same hour, coming in, confessed to the Lord: and spoke of him to all that looked for the redemption of Israel. ³⁹ And after they had performed all things according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their city Nazareth. ⁴⁰ And the child grew and waxed strong, full of wisdom: and the grace of God was in him. ⁴¹ And his parents went every year to Jerusalem, at the solemn day of the pasch. ⁴² And when he was twelve years old, they going up into Jerusalem, according to the custom of the feast, ⁴³ And having fulfilled the days, when they returned, the child Jesus remained in Jerusalem. And his parents knew it not. ⁴⁴ And thinking that he was in the company, they came a day's journey and sought him among their kinsfolks and acquaintance. ⁴⁵ And not finding him, they returned into Jerusalem, seeking him. ⁴⁶ And it came to pass, that, after three days, they found him in the temple, sitting in the midst of the doctors, hearing them and asking them questions. ⁴⁷ And all that heard him were astonished at his wisdom and his answers. ⁴⁸ And seeing him, they wondered. And his mother said to him: Son, why hast thou done so to us? Behold thy father and I have sought thee sorrowing. ⁴⁹ And he said to them: How is it that you sought me? Did you not know that I must be about my father's business? ⁵⁰ And they understood not the word that he spoke unto them. ⁵¹ And he went down with them and came to Nazareth and was subject to them. And his mother kept all these words in her heart. ⁵² And Jesus advanced in wisdom and age and grace with God and men.

286. The genealogy according to St. Matthew*Matthew 1:1-25*

The one New Testament genealogy this plan reads: it gathers Abraham, David, Tamar, Rahab, Ruth and the exile, all read above.

1 ¹ The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham: ² Abraham begot Isaac. And Isaac begot Jacob. And Jacob begot Judas and his brethren. ³ And Judas begot Phares and Zara of Tamar. And Phares begot Esron. And Esron begot Aram. ⁴ And Aram begot Aminadab. And Aminadab begot Naasson. And Naasson begot Salmon. ⁵ And Salmon begot Booz of Rahab. And Booz begot Obed of Ruth. And Obed begot Jesse. ⁶ And Jesse begot David the king. And David the king begot Solomon, of her that had been the wife of Urias. ⁷ And Solomon begot Roboam. And Roboam begot Abia. And Abia begot Asa. ⁸ And Asa begot Josaphat. And Josaphat begot Joram. And Joram begot Ozias. ⁹ And Ozias begot Joatham. And Joatham begot Achaz. And Achaz begot Ezechias. ¹⁰ And Ezechias begot Manasses. And Manasses begot Amon. And Amon begot Josias. ¹¹ And Josias begot Jechonias and his brethren in the transmigration of Babylon. ¹² And after the transmigration of Babylon, Jechonias begot Salathiel. And Salathiel begot Zorobabel. ¹³ And Zorobabel begot Abiud. And Abiud begot Eliacim. And Eliacim begot Azor. ¹⁴ And Azor begot Sadoc. And Sadoc begot Achim. And Achim begot Eliud. ¹⁵ And Eliud begot Eleazar. And Eleazar begot Mathan. And Mathan begot Jacob. ¹⁶ And Jacob begot Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ. ¹⁷ So all the generations from Abraham to David, are fourteen generations. And from David to the transmigration of Babylon, are fourteen generations: and from the transmigration of Babylon to Christ are fourteen generations.

¹⁸ Now the generation of Christ was in this wise. When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child, of the Holy Ghost. ¹⁹ Whereupon Joseph her husband, being a just man, and not willing publicly to expose her, was minded to put her away privately. ²⁰ But while he thought on these things, behold the Angel of the Lord appeared to him in his sleep, saying: Joseph, son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife, for that which is conceived in her, is of the Holy Ghost. ²¹ And she shall bring forth a son: and thou shalt call his name Jesus. For he shall save his people from their sins. ²² Now all this was done that it might be fulfilled which the Lord spoke by the prophet, saying: ²³ Behold a virgin shall be with child, and bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us. ²⁴ And Joseph rising up from sleep, did as the angel of the Lord had commanded him, and took unto him his wife. ²⁵ And he knew her not till she brought forth her first born son: and he called his name Jesus.

287. The magi, and the flight into Egypt*Matthew 2:1-23*

2 ¹ When Jesus therefore was born in Bethlehem of Juda, in the days of king Herod, behold, there came wise men from the East to Jerusalem, ² Saying: Where is he that is born king of the Jews? For we have seen his star in the East, and are come to adore him. ³ And king Herod hearing this, was troubled, and all Jerusalem

with him. ⁴ And assembling together all the chief priests and the scribes of the people, he inquired of them where Christ should be born. ⁵ But they said to him: In Bethlehem of Juda. For so it is written by the prophet: ⁶ And thou Bethlehem the land of Juda art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come forth the captain that shall rule my people Israel. ⁷ Then Herod, privately calling the wise men learned diligently of them the time of the star which appeared to them; ⁸ And sending them into Bethlehem, said: Go and diligently inquire after the child, and when you have found him, bring me word again, that I also may come and adore him. ⁹ Who having heard the king, went their way; and behold the star which they had seen in the East, went before them, until it came and stood over where the child was. ¹⁰ And seeing the star they rejoiced with exceeding great joy. ¹¹ And entering into the house, they found the child with Mary his mother, and falling down they adored him: and opening their treasures, they offered him gifts; gold, frankincense, and myrrh. ¹² And having received an answer in sleep that they should not return to Herod, they went back another way into their country. ¹³ And after they were departed, behold an angel of the Lord appeared in sleep to Joseph, saying: Arise, and take the child and his mother, and fly into Egypt: and be there until I shall tell thee. For it will come to pass that Herod will seek the child to destroy him. ¹⁴ Who arose, and took the child and his mother by night, and retired into Egypt: and he was there until the death of Herod: ¹⁵ That it might be fulfilled which the Lord spoke by the prophet, saying: Out of Egypt have I called my son.

¹⁶ Then Herod perceiving that he was deluded by the wise men, was exceeding angry: and sending killed all the menchildren that were in Bethlehem, and in all the borders thereof, from two years old and under, according to the time which he had diligently inquired of the wise men. ¹⁷ Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremias the prophet, saying: ¹⁸ A voice in Rama was heard, lamentation and great mourning; Rachel bewailing her children, and would not be comforted, because they are not.

¹⁹ But when Herod was dead, behold an angel of the Lord appeared in sleep to Joseph in Egypt, ²⁰ Saying: Arise, and take the child and his mother, and go into the land of Israel. For they are dead that sought the life of the child. ²¹ Who arose, and took the child and his mother, and came into the land of Israel. ²² But hearing that Archelaus reigned in Judea in the room of Herod his father, he was afraid to go thither: and being warned in sleep retired into the quarters of Galilee. ²³ And coming he dwelt in a city called Nazareth: that it might be fulfilled which was said by the prophets: That he shall be called a Nazarene.

288. John the Baptist, and the baptism of Christ*Luke 3:1-38*

3 ¹ Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being governor of Judea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and Philip his brother tetrarch of Iturea and the country of Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilina: ² Under the high priests Annas and Caiphas: the word of the Lord was made unto John, the son of Zachary, in the desert. ³ And he came into all the country about the Jordan, preaching the baptism of penance for the remission of sins. ⁴ As it was written in the book of the sayings of Isaias the prophet: A voice of one crying in the

wilderness: Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make straight his paths. ⁵ Every valley shall be filled and every mountain and hill shall be brought low: and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough ways plain. ⁶ And all flesh shall see the salvation of God. ⁷ He said therefore to the multitudes that went forth to be baptized by him: Ye offspring of vipers, who hath shewed you to flee from the wrath to come? ⁸ Bring forth therefore fruits worthy of penance: and do not begin to say, We have Abraham for our father. For I say unto you that God is able of these stones, to raise up children to Abraham. ⁹ For now the axe is laid to the root of the trees. Every tree therefore that bringeth not forth good fruit shall be cut down and cast into the fire. ¹⁰ And the people asked him, saying: What then shall we do? ¹¹ And he answering, said to them: He that hath two coats, let him give to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do in like manner. ¹² And the publicans also came to be baptized and said to him: Master, what shall we do? ¹³ But he said to them: Do nothing more than that which is appointed you. ¹⁴ And the soldiers also asked him, saying: And what shall we do? And he said to them: Do violence to no man, neither calumniate any man; and be content with your pay. ¹⁵ And as the people were of opinion, and all were thinking in their hearts of John, that perhaps he might be the Christ: ¹⁶ John answered, saying unto all: I indeed baptize you with water: but there shall come one mightier than I, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to loose. He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire; ¹⁷ Whose fan is in his hand: and he will purge his floor and will gather the wheat into his barn: but the chaff he will burn with unquenchable fire. ¹⁸ And many other things exhorting did he preach to the people. ¹⁹ But Herod the tetrarch, when he was reproved by him for Herodias, his brother's wife, and for all the evils which Herod had done: ²⁰ He added this also above all and shut up John in prison. ²¹ Now it came to pass, when all the people were baptized, that Jesus also being baptized and praying, heaven was opened. ²² And the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape, as a dove, upon him. And a voice came from heaven: Thou art my beloved Son. In thee I am well pleased. ²³ And Jesus himself was beginning about the age of thirty years: being (as it was supposed) the son of Joseph, who was of Heli, who was of Mathat, ²⁴ Who was of Levi, who was of Melchi, who was of Janne, who was of Joseph, ²⁵ Who was of Mathathias, who was of Amos, who was of Nahum, who was of Hesli, who was of Nagge, ²⁶ Who was of Mahath, who was of Mathathias, who was of Semei, who was of Joseph, who was of Juda, ²⁷ Who was of Joanna, who was of Reza, who was of Zorobabel, who was of Salathiel, who was of Neri, ²⁸ Who was of Melchi, who was of Addi, who was of Cosan, who was of Helmadan, who was of Her, ²⁹ Who was of Jesus, who was of Eliezer, who was of Jorim, who was of Mathat, who was of Levi, ³⁰ Who was of Simeon, who was of Judas, who was of Joseph, who was of Jona, who was of Eliakim, ³¹ Who was of Melea, who was of Menna, who was of Mathatha, who was of Nathan, who was of David, ³² Who was of Jesse, who was of Obed, who was of Booz, who was of Salmon, who was of Naasson, ³³ Who was of Aminadab, who was of Aram, who was of Esron, who was of Phares, who was of Judas, ³⁴ Who was of Jacob, who was of Isaac, who was of Abraham, who was of Thare, who was of Nachor, ³⁵ Who was of

Sarug, who was of Ragau, who was of Phaleg, who was of Heber, who was of Sale, ³⁶ Who was of Cainan, who was of Arphaxad, who was of Sem, who was of Noe, who was of Lamech, ³⁷ Who was of Mathusale, who was of Enoch, who was of Jared, who was of Malaleel, who was of Cainan, ³⁸ Who was of Henos, who was of Seth, who was of Adam, who was of God.

289. The temptation

Luke 4:1-13

Christ answers out of Deuteronomy 6 and 8, both read in this plan.

4 ¹ And Jesus being full of the Holy Ghost, returned from the Jordan and was led by the spirit into the desert, ² For the space of forty days, and was tempted by the devil. And he ate nothing in those days. And when they were ended, he was hungry. ³ And the devil said to him: If thou be the Son of God, say to this stone that it be made bread. ⁴ And Jesus answered him: It is written that Man liveth not by bread alone, but by every word of God. ⁵ And the devil led him into a high mountain and shewed him all the kingdoms of the world in a moment of time. ⁶ And he said to him: To thee will I give all this power and the glory of them. For to me they are delivered: and to whom I will, I give them. ⁷ If thou therefore wilt adore before me, all shall be thine. ⁸ And Jesus answering said to him. It is written: Thou shalt adore the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve. ⁹ And he brought him to Jerusalem and set him on a pinnacle of the temple and said to him: If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself from hence. ¹⁰ For it is written that He hath given his angels charge over thee that they keep thee. ¹¹ And that in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest perhaps thou dash thy foot against a stone. ¹² And Jesus answering, said to him: It is said: Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God. ¹³ And all the temptation being ended, the devil departed from him for a time.

290. "This day is fulfilled this scripture"

Luke 4:14-44

Nazareth. The widow of Sarephtha and Naaman, cited here, were read in the Divided Kingdom.

4 ¹⁴ And Jesus returned in the power of the spirit, into Galilee: and the fame of him went out through the whole country. ¹⁵ And he taught in their synagogues and was magnified by all.

¹⁶ And he came to Nazareth, where he was brought up: and he went into the synagogue, according to his custom, on the sabbath day: and he rose up to read. ¹⁷ And the book of Isaias the prophet was delivered unto him. And as he unfolded the book, he found the place where it was written: ¹⁸ The spirit of the Lord is upon me. Wherefore he hath anointed me to preach the gospel to the poor, he hath sent me to heal the contrite of heart, ¹⁹ To preach deliverance to the captives and sight to the blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised, to preach the acceptable year of the Lord and the day of reward. ²⁰ And when he had folded the book, he restored it to the minister and sat down. And the eyes of all in the synagogue were fixed on him. ²¹ And he began to say to them: This day is fulfilled this scripture in your ears. ²² And all gave testimony to him. And they wondered at the words of grace that proceeded from his mouth. And they said: Is not this the son of Joseph? ²³ And he said to them: Doubtless

you will say to me this similitude: Physician, heal thyself. As great things as we have heard done in Capharnaum, do also here in thy own country. ²⁴ And he said: Amen I say to you that no prophet is accepted in his own country. ²⁵ In truth I say to you, there were many widows in the days of Elias in Israel, when heaven was shut up three years and six months, when there was a great famine throughout all the earth. ²⁶ And to none of them was Elias sent, but to Sarepta of Sidon, to a widow woman. ²⁷ And there were many lepers in Israel in the time of Eliseus the prophet: and none of them was cleansed but Naaman the Syrian. ²⁸ And all they in the synagogue, hearing these things, were filled with anger. ²⁹ And they rose up and thrust him out of the city: and they brought him to the brow of the hill whereon their city was built, that they might cast him down headlong. ³⁰ But he passing through the midst of them, went his way. ³¹ And he went down into Capharnaum, a city of Galilee: and there he taught them on the sabbath days. ³² And they were astonished at his doctrine: for his speech was with power. ³³ And in the synagogue there was a man who had an unclean devil: and he cried out with a loud voice, ³⁴ Saying: Let us alone. What have we to do with thee, Jesus of Nazareth? Art thou come to destroy us? I know thee who thou art, the holy one of God. ³⁵ And Jesus rebuked him, saying: Hold thy peace and go out of him. And when the devil had thrown him into the midst, he went out of him and hurt him not at all. ³⁶ And there came fear upon all; and they talked among themselves, saying: What word is this, for with authority and power he commandeth the unclean spirits, and they go out? ³⁷ And the fame of him was published into every place of the country.

³⁸ And Jesus rising up out of the synagogue, went into Simon's house. And Simon's wife's mother was taken with a great fever: and they besought him for her. ³⁹ And standing over her, he commanded the fever: and it left her. And immediately rising, she ministered to them. ⁴⁰ And when the sun was down, all they that had any sick with divers diseases brought them to him. But he, laying his hands on every one of them, healed them. ⁴¹ And devils went out from many, crying out and saying: Thou art the son of God. And rebuking them he suffered them not to speak; for they knew that he was Christ. ⁴² And when it was day, going out he went into a desert place: and the multitudes sought him, and came unto him. And they stayed him that he should not depart from them. ⁴³ To whom he said: To other cities also I must preach the kingdom of God: for therefore am I sent. ⁴⁴ And he was preaching in the synagogues of Galilee.

291. The beginning of the gospel

Mark 1:1-20

1 ¹ The beginning of the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God. ² As it is written in Isaias the prophet: Behold I send my angel before thy face, who shall prepare the way before thee. ³ A voice of one crying in the desert: Prepare ye the way of the Lord; make straight his paths. ⁴ John was in the desert, baptizing and preaching the baptism of penance, unto remission of sins. ⁵ And there went out to him all the country of Judea and all they of Jerusalem and were baptized by him in the river of Jordan, confessing their sins. ⁶ And John was clothed with camel's hair, and a leathern girdle about his loins: and he ate locusts and wild honey. ⁷ And he preached, saying: There cometh after me one

mightier than I, the latchet of whose shoes I am not worthy to stoop down and loose. ⁸ I have baptized you with water: but he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost. ⁹ And it came to pass, in those days, Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee and was baptized by John in the Jordan. ¹⁰ And forthwith coming up out of the water, he saw the heavens opened, and the Spirit as a dove descending and remaining on him. ¹¹ And there came a voice from heaven: Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased. ¹² And immediately the Spirit drove him out into the desert. ¹³ And he was in the desert forty days and forty nights, and was tempted by Satan. And he was with beasts: and the angels ministered to him. ¹⁴ And after that John was delivered up, Jesus came into Galilee, preaching the gospel of the kingdom of God, ¹⁵ And saying: The time is accomplished and the kingdom of God is at hand. Repent and believe the gospel: ¹⁶ And passing by the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother, casting nets into the sea for they were fishermen. ¹⁷ And Jesus said to them: Come after me; and I will make you to become fishers of men. ¹⁸ And immediately leaving their nets, they followed him. ¹⁹ And going on from thence a little farther, he saw James the son of Zebedee and John his brother, who also were mending their nets in the ship: ²⁰ And forthwith he called them. And leaving their father Zebedee in the ship with his hired men, they followed him.

292. The prologue

John 1:1-18

1 ¹ In the beginning was the Word: and the Word was with God: and the Word was God. ² The same was in the beginning with God. ³ All things were made by him: and without him was made nothing that was made. ⁴ In him was life: and the life was the light of men. ⁵ And the light shineth in darkness: and the darkness did not comprehend it.

⁶ There was a man sent from God, whose name was John. ⁷ This man came for a witness, to give testimony of the light, that all men might believe through him. ⁸ He was not the light, but was to give testimony of the light. ⁹ That was the true light, which enlighteneth every man that cometh into this world. ¹⁰ He was in the world: and the world was made by him: and the world knew him not. ¹¹ He came unto his own: and his own received him not. ¹² But as many as received him, he gave them power to be made the sons of God, to them that believe in his name. ¹³ Who are born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh and dwelt among us (and we saw his glory, the glory as it were of the only begotten of the Father), full of grace and truth. ¹⁵ John beareth witness of him and crieth out, saying: This was he of whom I spoke: He that shall come after me is preferred before me: because he was before me. ¹⁶ And of his fulness we all have received: and grace for grace. ¹⁷ For the law was given by Moses: grace and truth came by Jesus Christ. ¹⁸ No man hath seen God at any time: the only begotten Son who is in the Bosom of the Father, he hath declared him.

293. "Behold the Lamb of God"*John 1:19-51*

1 ¹⁹ And this is the testimony of John, when the Jews sent from Jerusalem priests and Levites to him, to ask him: Who art thou? ²⁰ And he confessed and did not deny: and he confessed: I am not the Christ. ²¹ And they asked him: What then? Art thou Elias? And he said: I am not. Art thou the prophet? And he answered: No. ²² They said therefore unto him: Who art thou, that we may give an answer to them that sent us? What sayest thou of thyself? ²³ He said: I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Isaias. ²⁴ And they that were sent were of the Pharisees. ²⁵ And they asked him and said to him: Why then dost thou baptize, if thou be not Christ, nor Elias, nor the prophet? ²⁶ John answered them, saying: I baptize with water: but there hath stood one in the midst of you, whom you know not. ²⁷ The same is he that shall come after me, who is preferred before me: the latchet of whose shoe I am not worthy to loose. ²⁸ These things were done in Bethania, beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

²⁹ The next day, John saw Jesus coming to him; and he saith: Behold the Lamb of God. Behold him who taketh away the sin of the world. ³⁰ This is he of whom I said: After me there cometh a man, who is preferred before me: because he was before me. ³¹ And I knew him not: but that he may be made manifest in Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water. ³² And John gave testimony, saying: I saw the Spirit coming down, as a dove from heaven; and he remained upon him. ³³ And I knew him not: but he who sent me to baptize with water said to me: He upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending and remaining upon him, he it is that baptizeth with the Holy Ghost. ³⁴ And I saw: and I gave testimony that this is the Son of God.

³⁵ The next day again John stood and two of his disciples. ³⁶ And beholding Jesus walking, he saith: Behold the Lamb of God. ³⁷ And the two disciples heard him speak: and they followed Jesus. ³⁸ And Jesus turning and seeing them following him, saith to them: What seek you? Who said to him: Rabbi (which is to say, being interpreted, Master), where dwellest thou? ³⁹ He saith to them: Come and see. They came and saw where he abode: and they stayed with him that day. Now it was about the tenth hour. ⁴⁰ And Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, was one of the two who had heard of John and followed him. ⁴¹ He findeth first his brother Simon and saith to him: We have found the Messiah, which is, being interpreted, the Christ. ⁴² And he brought him to Jesus. And Jesus looking upon him, said: Thou art Simon the son of Jona. Thou shalt be called Cephas, which is interpreted Peter.

⁴³ On the following day, he would go forth into Galilee: and he findeth Philip, And Jesus saith to him: follow me. ⁴⁴ Now Philip was of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter. ⁴⁵ Philip findeth Nathanael and saith to him: We have found him of whom Moses, in the law and the prophets did write, Jesus the son of Joseph of Nazareth. ⁴⁶ And Nathanael said to him: Can any thing of good come from Nazareth? Philip saith to him: Come and see. ⁴⁷ Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him and he saith of him: Behold an Israelite indeed, in whom there is no guile. ⁴⁸ Nathanael saith to him: Whence knowest thou me? Jesus answered and said to him: Before that Philip called thee, when thou wast under the

fig tree, I saw thee. ⁴⁹ Nathanael answered him and said: Rabbi: Thou art the Son of God. Thou art the King of Israel. ⁵⁰ Jesus answered and said to him: Because I said unto thee, I saw thee under the fig tree, thou believest: greater things than these shalt thou see. ⁵¹ And he saith to him: Amen, amen, I say to you, you shall see the heaven opened and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of man.

294. Cana, the temple, and Nicodemus*John 2:1-3:36*

"As Moses lifted up the serpent in the desert" - Numbers 21, read in the Desert Wanderings.

2 ¹ And the third day, there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee: and the mother of Jesus was there. ² And Jesus also was invited, and his disciples, to the marriage. ³ And the wine failing, the mother of Jesus saith to him: They have no wine. ⁴ And Jesus saith to her: Woman, what is that to me and to thee? My hour is not yet come. ⁵ His mother saith to the waiters: Whatsoever he shall say to you, do ye. ⁶ Now there were set there six waterpots of stone, according to the manner of the purifying of the Jews, containing two or three measures apiece. ⁷ Jesus saith to them: Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim. ⁸ And Jesus saith to them: Draw out now and carry to the chief steward of the feast. And they carried it. ⁹ And when the chief steward had tasted the water made wine and knew not whence it was, but the waiters knew who had drawn the water: the chief steward calleth the bridegroom, ¹⁰ And saith to him: Every man at first setteth forth good wine, and when men have well drunk, then that which is worse. But thou hast kept the good wine until now. ¹¹ This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana of Galilee and manifested his glory. And his disciples believed in him.

¹² After this, he went down to Capharnaum, he and his mother and his brethren and his disciples: and they remained there not many days.

¹³ And the pasch of the Jews was at hand: and Jesus went up to Jerusalem. ¹⁴ And he found in the temple them that sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the changers of money sitting. ¹⁵ And when he had made, as it were, a scourge of little cords, he drove them all out of the temple, the sheep also and the oxen: and the money of the changers he poured out, and the tables he overthrew. ¹⁶ And to them that sold doves he said: Take these things hence, and make not the house of my Father a house of traffic. ¹⁷ And his disciples remembered, that it was written: The zeal of thy house hath eaten me up.

¹⁸ The Jews, therefore, answered, and said to him: What sign dost thou shew unto us, seeing thou dost these things? ¹⁹ Jesus answered and said to them: Destroy this temple; and in three days I will raise it up. ²⁰ The Jews then said: Six and forty years was this temple in building; and wilt thou raise it up in three days? ²¹ But he spoke of the temple of his body. ²² When therefore he was risen again from the dead, his disciples remembered that he had said this: and they believed the scripture and the word that Jesus had said.

²³ Now when he was at Jerusalem, at the pasch, upon the festival day, many believed in his name, seeing his signs which he did. ²⁴ But Jesus did not trust himself unto them: for that he

knew all men,²⁵ And because he needed not that any should give testimony of man: for he knew what was in man.

3 ¹ And there was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews. ² This man came to Jesus by night and said to him: Rabbi, we know that thou art come a teacher from God; for no man can do these signs which thou dost, unless God be with him. ³ Jesus answered and said to him: Amen, amen, I say to thee, unless a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God. ⁴ Nicodemus saith to him: How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother's womb and be born again? ⁵ Jesus answered: Amen, amen, I say to thee, unless a man be born again of water and the Holy Ghost, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God. ⁶ That which is born of the flesh is flesh: and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit. ⁷ Wonder not that I said to thee: You must be born again. ⁸ The Spirit breatheth where he will and thou hearest his voice: but thou knowest not whence he cometh and whither he goeth. So is every one that is born of the Spirit. ⁹ Nicodemus answered and said to him: How can these things be done? ¹⁰ Jesus answered and said to him: Art thou a master in Israel, and knowest not these things? ¹¹ Amen, amen, I say to thee that we speak what we know and we testify what we have seen: and you receive not our testimony. ¹² If I have spoken to you earthly things, and you believe not: how will you believe, if I shall speak to you heavenly things? ¹³ And no man hath ascended into heaven, but he that descended from heaven, the Son of man who is in heaven. ¹⁴ And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the desert, so must the Son of man be lifted up: ¹⁵ That whosoever believeth in him may not perish, but may have life everlasting. ¹⁶ For God so loved the world, as to give his only begotten Son: that whosoever believeth in him may not perish, but may have life everlasting. ¹⁷ For God sent not his Son into the world, to judge the world: but that the world may be saved by him. ¹⁸ He that believeth in him is not judged. But he that doth not believe is already judged: because he believeth not in the name of the only begotten Son of God. ¹⁹ And this is the judgment: Because the light is come into the world and men loved darkness rather than the light: for their works were evil. ²⁰ For every one that doth evil hateth the light and cometh not to the light, that his works may not be reproved. ²¹ But he that doth truth cometh to the light, that his works may be made manifest: because they are done in God.

²² After these things, Jesus and his disciples came into the land of Judea: and there he abode with them and baptized. ²³ And John also was baptizing in Ennon near Salim: because there was much water there. And they came and were baptized. ²⁴ For John was not yet cast into prison. ²⁵ And there arose a question between some of John's disciples and the Jews, concerning purification. ²⁶ And they came to John and said to him: Rabbi, he that was with thee beyond the Jordan, to whom thou gavest testimony: behold, he baptizeth and all men come to him. ²⁷ John answered and said: A man cannot receive any thing, unless it be given him from heaven. ²⁸ You yourselves do bear me witness that I said, I am not Christ, but that I am sent before him. ²⁹ He that hath the bride is the bridegroom: but the friend of the bridegroom, who standeth and heareth Him, rejoiceth with joy because of the bridegroom's voice. This my joy therefore is fulfilled. ³⁰ He must increase: but I must decrease. ³¹ He that cometh from above

is above all. He that is of the earth, of the earth he is, and of the earth he speaketh. He that cometh from heaven is above all. ³² And what he hath seen and heard, that he testifieth: and no man receiveth his testimony. ³³ He that hath received his testimony hath set to his seal that God is true. ³⁴ For he whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God: for God doth not give the Spirit by measure. ³⁵ The Father loveth the Son: and he hath given all things into his hand. ³⁶ He that believeth in the Son hath life everlasting: but he that believeth not the Son shall not see life: but the wrath of God abideth on him.

295. The woman at the well

John 4:1-54

4 ¹ When Jesus therefore understood that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus maketh more disciples and baptizeth more than John, ² (Though Jesus himself did not baptize, but his disciples), ³ He left Judea and went again into Galilee. ⁴ And he was of necessity to pass through Samaria. ⁵ He cometh therefore to a city of Samaria, which is called Sichar, near the land which Jacob gave to his son Joseph. ⁶ Now Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore, being wearied with his journey, sat thus on the well. It was about the sixth hour. ⁷ There cometh a woman of Samaria, to draw water. Jesus saith to her: Give me to drink. ⁸ For his disciples were gone into the city to buy meats. ⁹ Then that Samaritan woman saith to him: How dost thou, being a Jew; ask of me to drink, who am a Samaritan woman? For the Jews do not communicate with the Samaritans. ¹⁰ Jesus answered and said to her: If thou didst know the gift of God and who he is that saith to thee: Give me to drink; thou perhaps wouldst have asked of him, and he would have given thee living water. ¹¹ The woman saith to him: Sir, thou hast nothing wherein to draw, and the well is deep. From whence then hast thou living water? ¹² Art thou greater than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank thereof, himself and his children and his cattle? ¹³ Jesus answered and said to her: Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again: but he that shall drink of the water that I will give him shall not thirst for ever. ¹⁴ But the water that I will give him shall become in him a fountain of water, springing up into life everlasting. ¹⁵ The woman said to him: Sir, give me this water, that I may not thirst, nor come hither to draw. ¹⁶ Jesus saith to her: Go, call thy husband, and come hither. ¹⁷ The woman answered and said: I have no husband. Jesus said to her: Thou hast said well: I have no husband. ¹⁸ For thou hast had five husbands: and he whom thou now hast is not thy husband. This, thou hast said truly. ¹⁹ The woman saith to him: Sir, I perceive that thou art a prophet. ²⁰ Our fathers adored on this mountain: and you say that at Jerusalem is the place where men must adore. ²¹ Jesus saith to her: Woman, believe me that the hour cometh, when you shall neither on this mountain, nor in Jerusalem, adore the Father. ²² You adore that which you know not: we adore that which we know. For salvation is of the Jews. ²³ But the hour cometh and now is, when the true adorers shall adore the Father in spirit and in truth. For the Father also seeketh such to adore him. ²⁴ God is a spirit: and they that adore him must adore him in spirit and in truth. ²⁵ The woman saith to him: I know that the Messias cometh (who is called Christ): therefore, when he is come, he will tell us all things. ²⁶ Jesus saith to her: I am he, who am speaking with thee.

²⁷ And immediately his disciples came. And they wondered that he talked with the woman. Yet no man said: What seekest thou? Or: Why talkest thou with her? ²⁸ The woman therefore left her waterpot and went her way into the city and saith to the men there: ²⁹ Come, and see a man who has told me all things whatsoever I have done. Is not he the Christ? ³⁰ They went therefore out of the city and came unto him.

³¹ In the mean time, the disciples prayed him, saying: Rabbi, eat. ³² But he said to them: I have meat to eat which you know not. ³³ The disciples therefore said one to another: Hath any man brought him to eat? ³⁴ Jesus saith to them: My meat is to do the will of him that sent me, that I may perfect his work. ³⁵ Do not you say: There are yet four months, and then the harvest cometh? Behold, I say to you, lift up your eyes, and see the countries. For they are white already to harvest. ³⁶ And he that reapeth receiveth wages and gathereth fruit unto life everlasting: that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together. ³⁷ For in this is the saying true: That it is one man that soweth, and it is another that reapeth. ³⁸ I have sent you to reap that in which you did not labour. Others have laboured: and you have entered into their labours.

³⁹ Now of that city many of the Samaritans believed in him, for the word of the woman giving testimony: He told me all things whatsoever I have done. ⁴⁰ So when the Samaritans were come to him, they desired that he would tarry there. And he abode there two days. ⁴¹ And many more believed in him, because of his own word. ⁴² And they said to the woman: We now believe, not for thy saying: for we ourselves have heard him and know that this is indeed the Saviour of the world.

⁴³ Now after two days, he departed thence and went into Galilee. ⁴⁴ For Jesus himself gave testimony that a prophet hath no honour in his own country. ⁴⁵ And when he was come into Galilee, the Galileans received him, having seen all the things he had done at Jerusalem on the festival day: for they also went to the festival day. ⁴⁶ He came again therefore into Cana of Galilee, where he made the water wine. And there was a certain ruler, whose son was sick at Capharnaum. ⁴⁷ He having heard that Jesus was come from Judea into Galilee, went to him and prayed him to come down and heal his son: for he was at the point of death. ⁴⁸ Jesus therefore said to him: Unless you see signs and wonders, you believe not. ⁴⁹ The ruler saith to him: Lord, come down before that my son die. ⁵⁰ Jesus saith to him: Go thy way. Thy son liveth. The man believed the word which Jesus said to him and went his way. ⁵¹ And as he was going down, his servants met him: and they brought word, saying, that his son lived. ⁵² He asked therefore of them the hour wherein he grew better. And they said to him: Yesterday at the seventh hour, the fever left him. ⁵³ The father therefore knew that it was at the same hour that Jesus said to him: Thy son liveth. And himself believed, and his whole house. ⁵⁴ This is again the second miracle that Jesus did, when he was come out of Judea into Galilee.

296. *The first disciples; the leper and the paralytic*

Luke 5:1-39

5 ¹ And it came to pass, that when the multitudes pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he stood by the lake of Genesareth, ² And saw two ships standing by the lake: but the fishermen were gone out of them and were washing their nets. ³ And going into

one of the ships that was Simon's, he desired him to draw back a little from the land. And sitting, he taught the multitudes out of the ship. ⁴ Now when he had ceased to speak, he said to Simon: Launch out into the deep and let down your nets for a draught. ⁵ And Simon answering said to him: Master, we have laboured all the night and have taken nothing: but at thy word I will let down the net. ⁶ And when they had done this, they enclosed a very great multitude of fishes: and their net broke. ⁷ And they beckoned to their partners that were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came and filled both the ships, so that they were almost sinking. ⁸ Which when Simon Peter saw, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying: Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, O Lord. ⁹ For he was wholly astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken. ¹⁰ And so were also James and John, the sons of Zebedee, who were Simon's partners. And Jesus saith to Simon: Fear not: from henceforth thou shalt catch men. ¹¹ And having brought their ships to land, leaving all things, they followed him.

¹² And it came to pass, when he was in a certain city, behold a man full of leprosy who, seeing Jesus and falling on his face, besought him saying: Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean. ¹³ And stretching forth his hand, he touched him, saying: I will. Be thou cleansed. And immediately the leprosy departed from him. ¹⁴ And he charged him that he should tell no man, but: Go, shew thyself to the priest and offer for thy cleansing according as Moses commanded, for a testimony to them. ¹⁵ But the fame of him went abroad the more: and great multitudes came together to hear and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ And he retired into the desert; and prayed. ¹⁷ And it came to pass on a certain day, as he sat teaching, that there were also Pharisees and doctors of the law sitting by, that were come out of every town of Galilee and Judea and Jerusalem: and the power of the Lord was to heal them. ¹⁸ And behold, men brought in a bed a man who had the palsy: and they sought means to bring him in and to lay him before him. ¹⁹ And when they could not find by what way they might bring him in, because of the multitude, they went up upon the roof and let him down through the tiles with his bed into the midst before Jesus. ²⁰ Whose faith when he saw, he said: Man, thy sins are forgiven thee. ²¹ And the scribes and Pharisees began to think, saying: Who is this who speaketh blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone? ²² And when Jesus knew their thoughts, answering he said to them: What is it you think in your hearts? ²³ Which is easier to say: Thy sins are forgiven thee; or to say: Arise and walk? ²⁴ But that you may know that the Son of man hath the power on earth to forgive sins (he saith to the sick of the palsy), I say to thee, Arise, take up thy bed and go into thy house. ²⁵ And immediately rising up before them, he took up the bed on which he lay: and he went away to his own house, glorifying God. ²⁶ And all were astonished: and they glorified God. And they were filled with fear, saying: We have seen wonderful things to-day.

²⁷ And after these things, he went forth and saw a publican named Levi, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he said to him: Follow me. ²⁸ And leaving all things, he rose up and followed him. ²⁹ And Levi made him a great feast in his own house: And there was a great company of publicans and of others that were at table with them. ³⁰ But the Pharisees and scribes murmured,

saying to his disciples: Why do you eat and drink with publicans and sinners? ³¹ And Jesus answering, said to them: They that are whole need not the physician: but they that are sick. ³² I came not to call the just, but sinners to penance.

³³ And they said to him: Why do the disciples of John fast often and make prayers, and the disciples of the Pharisees in like manner; but thine eat and drink? ³⁴ To whom he said: Can you make the children of the bridegroom fast whilst the bridegroom is with them? ³⁵ But the days will come when the bridegroom shall be taken away from them: then shall they fast in those days.

³⁶ And he spoke also a similitude to them: That no man putteth a piece from a new garment upon an old garment: otherwise he both rendeth the new, and the piece taken from the new agreeth not with the old. ³⁷ And no man putteth new wine into old bottles: otherwise the new wine will break the bottles; and it will be spilled and the bottles will be lost. ³⁸ But new wine must be put into new bottles: and both are preserved. ³⁹ And no man drinking old hath presently a mind to new: for he saith: The old is better.

297. The twelve, and the sermon on the plain

Luke 6:1-49

6 ¹ And it came to pass on the second first sabbath that, as he went through the corn fields, his disciples plucked the ears and did eat, rubbing them in their hands. ² And some of the Pharisees said to them: Why do you that which is not lawful on the sabbath days? ³ And Jesus answering them, said: Have you not read so much as this, what David did, when himself was hungry and they that were with him: ⁴ How he went into the house of God and took and ate the bread of proposition and gave to them that were with him, which is not lawful to eat but only for the priests? ⁵ And he said to them: The Son of man is Lord also of the sabbath. ⁶ And it came to pass also, on another sabbath, that he entered into the synagogue and taught. And there was a man whose right hand was withered. ⁷ And the scribes and Pharisees watched if he would heal on the sabbath: that they might find an accusation against him. ⁸ But he knew their thoughts and said to the man who had the withered hand: Arise and stand forth in the midst. And rising he stood forth. ⁹ Then Jesus said to them: I ask you, if it be lawful on the sabbath days to do good or to do evil? To save life or to destroy? ¹⁰ And looking round about on them all, he said to the man: Stretch forth thy hand. And he stretched it forth. And his hand was restored. ¹¹ And they were filled with madness: and they talked one with another, what they might do to Jesus. ¹² And it came to pass in those days, that he went out into a mountain to pray: and he passed the whole night in the prayer of God. ¹³ And when day was come, he called unto him his disciples: and he chose twelve of them (whom also he named apostles): ¹⁴ Simon, whom he surnamed Peter, and Andrew his brother, James and John, Philip and Bartholomew, ¹⁵ Matthew and Thomas, James the son of Alpheus, and Simon who is called Zelotes, ¹⁶ And Jude the brother of James, and Judas Iscariot, who was the traitor.

¹⁷ And coming down with them, he stood in a plain place: and the company of his disciples and a very great multitude of people from all Judea and Jerusalem and the sea coast, both of Tyre and Sidon, ¹⁸ Who were come to hear him and to be healed of their

diseases. And they that were troubled with unclean spirits were cured. ¹⁹ And all the multitude sought to touch him: for virtue went out from him and healed all.

²⁰ And he, lifting up his eyes on his disciples, said: Blessed are ye poor: for yours is the kingdom of God. ²¹ Blessed are ye that hunger now: for you shall be filled. Blessed are ye that weep now: for you shall laugh. ²² Blessed shall you be when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you and shall reproach you and cast out your name as evil, for the Son of man's sake. ²³ Be glad in that day and rejoice: for behold, your reward is great in heaven, For according to these things did their fathers to the prophets. ²⁴ But woe to you that are rich: for you have your consolation. ²⁵ Woe to you that are filled: for you shall hunger. Woe to you that now laugh: for you shall mourn and weep. ²⁶ Woe to you when men shall bless you: for according to these things did their fathers to the false prophets.

²⁷ But I say to you that hear: Love your enemies. Do good to them that hate you. ²⁸ Bless them that curse you and pray for them that calumniate you. ²⁹ And to him that striketh thee on the one cheek, offer also the other. And him that taketh away from thee thy cloak, forbid not to take thy coat also. ³⁰ Give to every one that asketh thee: and of him that taketh away thy goods, ask them not again. ³¹ And as you would that men should do to you, do you also to them in like manner. ³² And if you love them that love you, what thanks are to you? For sinners also love those that love them. ³³ And if you do good to them who do good to you, what thanks are to you? For sinners also do this. ³⁴ And if you lend to them of whom you hope to receive, what thanks are to you? For sinners also lend to sinners, for to receive as much. ³⁵ But love ye your enemies: do good, and lend, hoping for nothing thereby: and your reward shall be great, and you shall be the sons of the Highest. For he is kind to the unthankful and to the evil. ³⁶ Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful. ³⁷ Judge not: and you shall not be judged. Condemn not: and you shall not be condemned. Forgive: and you shall be forgiven. ³⁸ Give: and it shall be given to you: good measure and pressed down and shaken together and running over shall they give into your bosom. For with the same measure that you shall mete withal, it shall be measured to you again. ³⁹ And he spoke also to them a similitude: Can the blind lead the blind? Do they not both fall into the ditch? ⁴⁰ The disciple is not above his master: but every one shall be perfect, if he be as his master. ⁴¹ And why seest thou the mote in thy brother's eye: but the beam that is in thy own eye thou considerest not? ⁴² Or how canst thou say to thy brother: Brother, let me pull the mote out of thy eye, when thou thyself seest not the beam in thy own eye? Hypocrite, cast first the beam out of thy own eye: and then shalt thou see clearly to take out the mote from thy brother's eye. ⁴³ For there is no good tree that bringeth forth evil fruit: nor an evil tree that bringeth forth good fruit. ⁴⁴ For every tree is known by its fruit. For men do not gather figs from thorns: nor from a bramble bush do they gather the grape. ⁴⁵ A good man out of the good treasure of his heart bringeth forth that which is good: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth that which is evil. For out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh.

⁴⁶ And why call you me, Lord, Lord; and do not the things which I say? ⁴⁷ Every one that cometh to me and heareth my words and doth them, I will shew you to whom he is like. ⁴⁸ He is like to a man building a house, who digged deep and laid the foundation upon a rock. And when a flood came, the stream beat vehemently upon that house: and it could not shake it: for it was founded on a rock. ⁴⁹ But he that heareth and doth not is like to a man building his house upon the earth without a foundation: against which the stream beat vehemently. And immediately it fell: and the ruin of that house was great.

298. The beatitudes

Matthew 5:1-48

5 ¹ And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain, and when he was set down, his disciples came unto him. ² And opening his mouth he taught them, saying: ³ Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. ⁴ Blessed are the meek: for they shall possess the land. ⁵ Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted. ⁶ Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after justice: for they shall have their fill. ⁷ Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy. ⁸ Blessed are the clean of heart: for they shall see God. ⁹ Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God. ¹⁰ Blessed are they that suffer persecution for justice' sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. ¹¹ Blessed are ye when they shall revile you, and persecute you, and speak all that is evil against you, untruly, for my sake: ¹² Be glad and rejoice for your reward is very great in heaven. For so they persecuted the prophets that were before you.

¹³ You are the salt of the earth. But if the salt lose its savour, wherewith shall it be salted? It is good for nothing anymore but to be cast out, and to be trodden on by men. ¹⁴ You are the light of the world. A city seated on a mountain cannot be hid. ¹⁵ Neither do men light a candle and put it under a bushel, but upon a candlestick, that it may shine to all that are in the house. ¹⁶ So let your light shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father who is in heaven.

¹⁷ Do not think that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets. I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil. ¹⁸ For amen I say unto you, till heaven and earth pass, one jot, or one tittle shall not pass of the law, till all be fulfilled. ¹⁹ He therefore that shall break one of these least commandments, and shall so teach men shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven. But he that shall do and teach, he shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven. ²⁰ For I tell you, that unless your justice abound more than that of the scribes and Pharisees, you shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.

²¹ You have heard that it was said to them of old: Thou shalt not kill. And whosoever shall kill, shall be in danger of the judgment. ²² But I say to you, that whosoever is angry with his brother, shall be in danger of the judgment. And whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council. And whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire. ²³ If therefore thou offer thy gift at the altar, and there thou remember that thy brother hath anything against thee; ²⁴ Leave there thy offering before the altar, and go first to be reconciled to thy brother, and then coming thou shalt offer thy gift. ²⁵ Be at agreement with thy adversary betimes, whilst thou art in the

way with him: lest perhaps the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison. ²⁶ Amen I say to thee, thou shalt not go out from thence till thou repay the last farthing.

²⁷ You have heard that it was said to them of old: Thou shalt not commit adultery. ²⁸ But I say to you, that whosoever shall look on a woman to lust after her, hath already committed adultery with her in his heart. ²⁹ And if thy right eye scandalize thee, pluck it out and cast it from thee. For it is expedient for thee that one of thy members should perish, rather than thy whole body be cast into hell. ³⁰ And if thy right hand scandalize thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is expedient for thee that one of thy members should perish, rather than that thy whole body go into hell. ³¹ And it hath been said, Whosoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a bill of divorce. ³² But I say to you, that whosoever shall put away his wife, excepting for the cause of fornication, maketh her to commit adultery: and he that shall marry her that is put away, committeth adultery.

³³ Again you have heard that it was said to them of old, thou shalt not forswear thyself: but thou shalt perform thy oaths to the Lord. ³⁴ But I say to you not to swear at all, neither by heaven for it is the throne of God: ³⁵ Nor by the earth, for it is his footstool: nor by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great king: ³⁶ Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black. ³⁷ But let your speech be yea, yea: no, no: and that which is over and above these, is of evil.

³⁸ You have heard that it hath been said: An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth. ³⁹ But I say to you not to resist evil: but if one strike thee on thy right cheek, turn to him also the other: ⁴⁰ And if a man will contend with thee in judgment, and take away thy coat, let go thy cloak also unto him. ⁴¹ And whosoever will force thee one mile, go with him other two. ⁴² Give to him that asketh of thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn not away.

⁴³ You have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thy enemy. ⁴⁴ But I say to you, Love your enemies: do good to them that hate you: and pray for them that persecute and calumniate you: ⁴⁵ That you may be the children of your Father who is in heaven, who maketh his sun to rise upon the good, and bad, and raineth upon the just and the unjust. ⁴⁶ For if you love them that love you, what reward shall you have? do not even the publicans this? ⁴⁷ And if you salute your brethren only, what do you more? do not also the heathens this? ⁴⁸ Be you therefore perfect, as also your heavenly Father is perfect.

299. The Our Father, and the two ways

Matthew 6:1-7:29

6 ¹ Take heed that you do not your justice before men, to be seen by them: otherwise you shall not have a reward of your Father who is in heaven. ² Therefore when thou dost an alms-deed, sound not a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may be honoured by men. Amen I say to you, they have received their reward. ³ But when thou dost alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doth. ⁴ That thy alms may be in secret, and thy Father who seeth in secret will repay thee.

⁵ And when ye pray, you shall not be as the hypocrites, that love to stand and pray in the synagogues and corners of the

streets, that they may be seen by men: Amen I say to you, they have received their reward. ⁶ But thou when thou shalt pray, enter into thy chamber, and having shut the door, pray to thy Father in secret, and thy father who seeth in secret will repay thee. ⁷ And when you are praying, speak not much, as the heathens. For they think that in their much speaking they may be heard. ⁸ Be not you therefore like to them for your Father knoweth what is needful for you, before you ask him. ⁹ Thus therefore shall you pray: Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. ¹⁰ Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. ¹¹ Give us this day our supersubstantial bread. ¹² And forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors. ¹³ And lead us not into temptation. But deliver us from evil. Amen. ¹⁴ For if you will forgive men their offences, your heavenly Father will forgive you also your offences. ¹⁵ But if you will not forgive men, neither will your Father forgive you your offences.

¹⁶ And when you fast, be not as the hypocrites, sad. For they disfigure their faces, that they may appear unto men to fast. Amen I say to you, they have received their reward. ¹⁷ But thou, when thou fastest anoint thy head, and wash thy face; ¹⁸ That thou appear not to men to fast, but to thy Father who is in secret: and thy Father who seeth in secret, will repay thee.

¹⁹ Lay not up to yourselves treasures on earth: where the rust, and moth consume, and where thieves break through, and steal. ²⁰ But lay up to yourselves treasures in heaven: where neither the rust nor moth doth consume, and where thieves do not break through, nor steal. ²¹ For where thy treasure is, there is thy heart also. ²² The light of thy body is thy eye. If thy eye be single, thy whole body shall be lightsome. ²³ But if thy eye be evil thy whole body shall be darksome. If then the light that is in thee, be darkness: the darkness itself how great shall it be!

²⁴ No man can serve two masters. For either he will hate the one, and love the other: or he will sustain the one, and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon. ²⁵ Therefore I say to you, be not solicitous for your life, what you shall eat, nor for your body, what you shall put on. Is not the life more than the meat: and the body more than the raiment? ²⁶ Behold the birds of the air, for they neither sow, nor do they reap, nor gather into barns: and your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are not you of much more value than they? ²⁷ And which of you by taking thought, can add to his stature one cubit? ²⁸ And for raiment why are you solicitous? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow: they labour not, neither do they spin. ²⁹ But I say to you, that not even Solomon in all his glory was arrayed as one of these. ³⁰ And if the grass of the field, which is to day, and to morrow is cast into the oven, God doth so clothe: how much more you, O ye of little faith? ³¹ Be not solicitous therefore, saying: What shall we eat: or what shall we drink, or wherewith shall we be clothed? ³² For after all these things do the heathens seek. For your Father knoweth that you have need of all these things. ³³ Seek ye therefore first the kingdom of God, and his justice, and all these things shall be added unto you. ³⁴ Be not therefore solicitous for to morrow; for the morrow will be solicitous for itself. Sufficient for the day is the evil thereof.

⁷ ¹ Judge not, that you may not be judged. ² For with what judgment you judge, you shall be judged: and with what measure you mete, it shall be measured to you again. ³ And why seest

thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye; and seest not the beam that is in thy own eye? ⁴ Or how sayest thou to thy brother: Let me cast the mote out of thy eye; and behold a beam is in thy own eye? ⁵ Thou hypocrite, cast out first the beam out of thy own eye, and then shalt thou see to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.

⁶ Give not that which is holy to dogs; neither cast ye your pearls before swine, lest perhaps they trample them under their feet, and turning upon you, they tear you.

⁷ Ask, and it shall be given you: seek, and you shall find: knock, and it shall be opened to you. ⁸ For every one that asketh, receiveth: and he that seeketh, findeth: and to him that knocketh, it shall be opened. ⁹ Or what man is there among you, of whom if his son shall ask bread, will he reach him a stone? ¹⁰ Or if he shall ask him a fish, will he reach him a serpent? ¹¹ If you then being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children: how much more will your Father who is in heaven, give good things to them that ask him? ¹² All things therefore whatsoever you would that men should do to you, do you also to them. For this is the law and the prophets.

¹³ Enter ye in at the narrow gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way that leadeth to destruction, and many there are who go in thereat. ¹⁴ How narrow is the gate, and strait is the way that leadeth to life: and few there are that find it!

¹⁵ Beware of false prophets, who come to you in the clothing of sheep, but inwardly they are ravening wolves. ¹⁶ By their fruits you shall know them. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles? ¹⁷ Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit, and the evil tree bringeth forth evil fruit. ¹⁸ A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can an evil tree bring forth good fruit. ¹⁹ Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit, shall be cut down, and shall be cast into the fire. ²⁰ Wherefore by their fruits you shall know them.

²¹ Not every one that saith to me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven: but he that doth the will of my Father who is in heaven, he shall enter into the kingdom of heaven.

²² Many will say to me in that day: Lord, Lord, have not we prophesied in thy name, and cast out devils in thy name, and done many miracles in thy name? ²³ And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, you that work iniquity.

²⁴ Every one therefore that heareth these my words, and doth them, shall be likened to a wise man that built his house upon a rock, ²⁵ And the rain fell, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and they beat upon that house, and it fell not, for it was founded on a rock. ²⁶ And every one that heareth these my words and doth them not, shall be like a foolish man that built his house upon the sand, ²⁷ And the rain fell, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and they beat upon that house, and it fell, and great was the fall thereof. ²⁸ And it came to pass when Jesus had fully ended these words, the people were in admiration at his doctrine. ²⁹ For he was teaching them as one having power, and not as the scribes and Pharisees.

300. The centurion, the widow of Naim, the sinful woman, the sower and Jairus

Luke 7:1-8:56

7 ¹ And when he had finished all his words in the hearing of the people, he entered into Capharnaum. ² And the servant of a certain centurion who was dear to him, being sick, was ready to die. ³ And when he had heard of Jesus, he sent unto him the ancients of the Jews, desiring him to come and heal his servant. ⁴ And when they came to Jesus, they besought him earnestly, saying to him: He is worthy that thou shouldest do this for him. ⁵ For he loveth our nation: and he hath built us a synagogue. ⁶ And Jesus went with them. And when he was now not far from the house, the centurion sent his friends to him, saying: Lord, trouble not thyself; for I am not worthy that thou shouldst enter under my roof. ⁷ For which cause neither did I think myself worthy to come to thee: but say the word, and my servant shall be healed. ⁸ For I also am a man subject to authority, having under me soldiers: and I say to one, Go, and he goeth: and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doth it. ⁹ Which Jesus hearing, marvelled: and turning about to the multitude that followed him, he said: Amen I say to you, I have not found so great faith, not even in Israel. ¹⁰ And they who were sent, being returned to the house, found the servant whole who had been sick.

¹¹ And it came to pass afterwards that he went into a city that is called Naim: and there went with him his disciples and a great multitude. ¹² And when he came nigh to the gate of the city, behold a dead man was carried out, the only son of his mother: and she was a widow. And a great multitude of the city was with her. ¹³ Whom when the Lord had seen, being moved with mercy towards her, he said to her: Weep not. ¹⁴ And he came near and touched the bier. And they that carried it stood still. And he said: Young man, I say to thee, arise. ¹⁵ And he that was dead sat up and began to speak. And he gave him to his mother. ¹⁶ And there came a fear upon them all: and they glorified God saying: A great prophet is risen up among us: and, God hath visited his people. ¹⁷ And this rumour of him went forth throughout all Judea and throughout all the country round about. ¹⁸ And John's disciples told him of all these things. ¹⁹ And John called to him two of his disciples and sent them to Jesus, saying: Art thou he that art to come? Or look we for another? ²⁰ And when the men were come unto him, they said: John the Baptist hath sent us to thee, saying: Art thou he that art to come? Or look we for another? ²¹ (And in that same hour, he cured many of their diseases and hurts and evil spirits: and to many that were blind he gave sight.) ²² And answering, he said to them: Go and relate to John what you have heard and seen: the blind see, the lame walk, the lepers are made clean, the deaf hear, the dead rise again, to the poor the gospel is preached. ²³ And blessed is he whosoever shall not be scandalized in me.

²⁴ And when the messengers of John were departed, he began to speak to the multitudes concerning John. What went ye out into the desert to see? A reed shaken with the wind? ²⁵ But what went you out to see? A man clothed in soft garments? Behold they that are in costly apparel and live delicately are in the houses of kings. ²⁶ But what went you out to see? A prophet? Yea, I say to you, and more than a prophet. ²⁷ This is he of whom it is written: Behold I send my angel before thy face, who shall prepare thy way before thee. ²⁸ For I say to you: Amongst those that are born of women, there is not a greater prophet than John

the Baptist. But he that is the lesser in the kingdom of God is greater than he. ²⁹ And all the people hearing, and the publicans, justified God, being baptized with John's baptism. ³⁰ But the Pharisees and the lawyers despised the counsel of God against themselves, being not baptized by him.

³¹ And the Lord said: Whereunto then shall I liken the men of this generation? And to what are they like? ³² They are like to children sitting in the marketplace and speaking one to another and saying: We have piped to you, and you have not danced: we have mourned, and you have not wept. ³³ For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine. And you say: He hath a devil. ³⁴ The Son of man is come eating and drinking. And you say: Behold a man that is a glutton and a drinker of wine, a friend of publicans and sinners. ³⁵ And wisdom is justified by all her children.

³⁶ And one of the Pharisees desired him to eat with him. And he went into the house of the Pharisee and sat down to meat. ³⁷ And behold a woman that was in the city, a sinner, when she knew that he sat at meat in the Pharisee's house, brought an alabaster box of ointment. ³⁸ And standing behind at his feet, she began to wash his feet with tears and wiped them with the hairs of her head and kissed his feet and anointed them with the ointment. ³⁹ And the Pharisee, who had invited him, seeing it, spoke within himself, saying: This man, if he were if a prophet, would know surely who and what manner of woman this is that toucheth him, that she is a sinner. ⁴⁰ And Jesus answering, said to him: Simon, I have somewhat to say to thee. But he said: Master, say it. ⁴¹ A certain creditor had two debtors: the one owed five hundred pence and the other fifty. ⁴² And whereas they had not wherewith to pay, he forgave them both. Which therefore of the two loveth him most? ⁴³ Simon answering, said: I suppose that he to whom he forgave most. And he said to him: Thou hast judged rightly. ⁴⁴ And turning to the woman, he said unto Simon: Dost thou see this woman? I entered into thy house: thou gavest me no water for my feet. But she with tears hath washed my feet; and with her hairs hath wiped them. ⁴⁵ Thou gavest me no kiss. But she, since she came in, hath not ceased to kiss my feet. ⁴⁶ My head with oil thou didst not anoint. But she with ointment hath anointed my feet. ⁴⁷ Wherefore, I say to thee: Many sins are forgiven her, because she hath loved much. But to whom less is forgiven, he loveth less. ⁴⁸ And he said to her: Thy sins are forgiven thee. ⁴⁹ And they that sat at meat with him began to say within themselves: Who is this that forgiveth sins also? ⁵⁰ And he said to the woman: Thy faith hath made thee safe. Go in peace.

8 ¹ And it came to pass afterwards, that he travelled through the cities and towns, preaching and evangelizing the kingdom of God: and the twelve with him: ² And certain women who had been healed of evil spirits and infirmities: Mary who is called Magdalen, out of whom seven devils were gone forth, ³ And Joanna the wife of Chusa, Herod's steward, and Susanna and many others who ministered unto him of their substance. ⁴ And when a very great multitude was gathered together and hastened out of the cities, unto him, he spoke by a similitude. ⁵ The sower went out to sow his seed. And as he sowed, some fell by the way side. And it was trodden down: and the fowls of the air devoured it. ⁶ And other some fell upon a rock. And as soon as

it was sprung up, it withered away, because it had no moisture. ⁷ And other some fell among thorns. And the thorns growing up with it, choked it. ⁸ And other some fell upon good ground and, being sprung up, yielded fruit a hundredfold. Saying these things, he cried out: He that hath ears to hear, let him hear. ⁹ And his disciples asked him what this parable might be. ¹⁰ To whom he said: To you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God; but to the rest in parables, that seeing they may not see and hearing may not understand. ¹¹ Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God. ¹² And they by the way side are they that hear: then the devil cometh and taketh the word out of their heart, lest believing they should be saved. ¹³ Now they upon the rock are they who when they hear receive the word with joy: and these have no roots: for they believe for a while and in time of temptation they fall away. ¹⁴ And that which fell among thorns are they who have heard and, going their way, are choked with the cares and riches and pleasures of this life and yield no fruit. ¹⁵ But that on the good ground are they who in a good and perfect heart, hearing the word, keep it and bring forth fruit in patience.

¹⁶ Now no man lighting a candle covereth it with a vessel or putteth it under a bed: but setteth it upon a candlestick, that they who come in may see the light. ¹⁷ For there is not any thing secret that shall not be made manifest, nor hidden that shall not be known and come abroad. ¹⁸ Take heed therefore how you hear. For whosoever hath, to him shall be given: and whosoever hath not, that also which he thinketh he hath shall be taken away from him.

¹⁹ And his mother and brethren came unto him: and they could not come at him for the crowd. ²⁰ And it was told him: Thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to see thee. ²¹ Who answering, said to them: My mother and my brethren are they who hear the word of God and do it.

²² And it came to pass on a certain day that he went into a little ship with his disciples. And he said to them: Let us go over to the other side of the lake. And they launched forth. ²³ And when they were sailing, he slept. And there came down a storm of wind upon the lake: and they were filled and were in danger. ²⁴ And they came and awaked him, saying: Master, we perish. But he arising, rebuked the wind and the rage of the water. And it ceased: and there was a calm. ²⁵ And he said to them: Where is your faith? Who being afraid, wondered, saying one to another: Who is this (think you), that he commandeth both the winds and the sea: and they obey him?

²⁶ And they sailed to the country of the Gerasens, which is over against Galilee. ²⁷ And when he was come forth to the land, there met him a certain man who had a devil now a very long time. And he wore no clothes: neither did he abide in a house, but in the sepulchres. ²⁸ And when he saw Jesus, he fell down before him. And crying out with a loud voice, he said: What have I to do with thee, Jesus, Son of the most high God? I beseech thee, do not torment me. ²⁹ For he commanded the unclean spirit to go out of the man. For many times it seized him: and he was bound with chains and kept in fetters: and breaking the bonds, he was driven by the devil into the deserts. ³⁰ And Jesus asked him, saying: What is thy name? But he said: Legion. Because many devils were entered into him. ³¹ And they besought him

that he would not command them to go into the abyss. ³² And there was there a herd of many swine feeding on the mountain: and they besought him that he would suffer them to enter into them. And he suffered them. ³³ The devils therefore went out of the man and entered into the swine. And the herd ran violently down a steep place into the lake and were stifled. ³⁴ Which when they that fed them saw done, they fled away and told it in the city and in the villages. ³⁵ And they went out to see what was done. And they came to Jesus and found the man out of whom the devils were departed, sitting at his feet, clothed and in his right mind. And they were afraid. ³⁶ And they also that had seen told them how he had been healed from the legion. ³⁷ And all the multitude of the country of the Gerasens besought him to depart from them: for they were taken with great fear. And he, going up into the ship, returned back again. ³⁸ Now the man out of whom the devils were departed besought him that he might be with him. But Jesus sent him away, saying: ³⁹ Return to thy house and tell how great things God hath done to thee. And he went through the whole city, publishing how great things Jesus had done to him. ⁴⁰ And it came to pass that when Jesus was returned, the multitude received him: for they were all waiting for him. ⁴¹ And behold there came a man whose name was Jairus: and he was a ruler of the synagogue. And he fell down at the feet of Jesus, beseeching him that he would come into his house: ⁴² For he had an only daughter, almost twelve years old, and she was dying. And it happened as he went that he was thronged by the multitudes. ⁴³ And there was a certain woman having an issue of blood twelve years, who had bestowed all her substance on physicians and could not be healed by any. ⁴⁴ She came behind him and touched the hem of his garment: and immediately the issue of her blood stopped. ⁴⁵ And Jesus said: Who is it that touched me? And all denying, Peter and they that were with him said: Master, the multitudes throng and press thee; and dost thou say, who touched me? ⁴⁶ And Jesus said: Somebody hath touched me; for I know that virtue is gone out from me. ⁴⁷ And the woman seeing that she was not hid, came trembling and fell down before his feet and declared before all the people for what cause she had touched him, and how she was immediately healed. ⁴⁸ But he said to her: Daughter, thy faith hath made thee whole. Go thy way in peace.

⁴⁹ As he was yet speaking, there cometh one to the ruler of the synagogue, saying to him: Thy daughter is dead: trouble him not. ⁵⁰ And Jesus hearing this word, answered the father of the maid: Fear not. Believe only: and she shall be safe. ⁵¹ And when he was come to the house, he suffered not any man to go in with him, but Peter and James and John, and the father and mother of the maiden. ⁵² And all wept and mourned for her. But he said: Weep not. The maid is not dead, but sleepeth. ⁵³ And they laughed him to scorn, knowing that she was dead. ⁵⁴ But he taking her by the hand, cried out, saying: Maid, arise. ⁵⁵ And her spirit returned: and she arose immediately. And he bid them give her to eat. ⁵⁶ And her parents were astonished, whom he charged to tell no man what was done.

301. The storm, the Gerasene, Jairus, and what defiles a man*Mark 4:35-5:43; 7:1-23 — here Mark 4:35-7:23*

4 ³⁵ And he saith to them that day, when evening was come: Let us pass over to the other side. ³⁶ And sending away the multitude, they take him even as he was in the ship: and there were other ships with him. ³⁷ And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that the ship was filled. ³⁸ And he was in the hinder part of the ship, sleeping upon a pillow; and they awake him, and say to him: Master, doth, it not concern thee that we perish? ³⁹ And rising up, he rebuked the wind, and said to the sea: Peace, be still. And the wind ceased: and there was made a great calm. ⁴⁰ And he said to them: Why are you fearful? have you not faith yet? And they feared exceedingly: and they said one to another: Who is this (thinkest thou) that both wind and sea obey him?

5 ¹ And they came over the strait of the sea, into the country of the Gerasens. ² And as he went out of the ship, immediately there met him out of the monuments a man with an unclean spirit, ³ Who had his dwelling in the tombs, and no man now could bind him, not even with chains. ⁴ For having been often bound with fetters and chains, he had burst the chains, and broken the fetters in pieces, and no one could tame him. ⁵ And he was always day and night in the monuments and in the mountains, crying and cutting himself with stones. ⁶ And seeing Jesus afar off, he ran and adored him. ⁷ And crying with a loud voice, he said: What have I to do with thee, Jesus the Son of the most high God? I adjure thee by God that thou torment me not. ⁸ For he said unto him: Go out of the man, thou unclean spirit. ⁹ And he asked him: What is thy name? And he saith to him: My name is Legion, for we are many. ¹⁰ And he besought him much, that he would not drive him away out of the country. ¹¹ And there was there near the mountain a great herd of swine, feeding. ¹² And the spirits besought him, saying: Send us into the swine, that we may enter into them. ¹³ And Jesus immediately gave them leave. And the unclean spirits going out, entered into the swine: and the herd with great violence was carried headlong into the sea, being about two thousand, and were stifled in the sea. ¹⁴ And they that fed them fled, and told it in the city and in the fields. And they went out to see what was done: ¹⁵ And they came to Jesus, and they see him that was troubled with the devil, sitting, clothed, and well in his wits, and they were afraid. ¹⁶ And they that had seen it, told them, in what manner he had been dealt with who had the devil; and concerning the swine. ¹⁷ And they began to pray him that he would depart from their coasts. ¹⁸ And when he went up into the ship, he that had been troubled with the devil, began to beseech him that he might be with him. ¹⁹ And he admitted him not, but saith to him: Go into thy house to thy friends, and tell them how great things the Lord hath done for thee, and hath had mercy on thee. ²⁰ And he went his way, and began to publish in Decapolis how great things Jesus had done for him: and all men wondered. ²¹ And when Jesus had passed again in the ship over the strait, a great multitude assembled together unto him, and he was nigh unto the sea. ²² And there cometh one of the rulers of the synagogue named Jairus: and seeing him, falleth down at his feet. ²³ And he besought him much, saying: My daughter is at the point

of death, come, lay thy hand upon her, that she may be safe, and may live. ²⁴ And he went with him, and a great multitude followed him, and they thronged him. ²⁵ And a woman who was under an issue of blood twelve years, ²⁶ And had suffered many things from many physicians; and had spent all that she had, and was nothing the better, but rather worse, ²⁷ When she had heard of Jesus, came in the crowd behind him, and touched his garment. ²⁸ For she said: If I shall touch but his garment, I shall be whole. ²⁹ And forthwith the fountain of her blood was dried up, and she felt in her body that she was healed of the evil. ³⁰ And immediately Jesus knowing in himself the virtue that had proceeded from him, turning to the multitude, said: Who hath touched my garments? ³¹ And his disciples said to him: Thou seest the multitude thronging thee, and sayest thou who hath touched me? ³² And he looked about to see her who had done this. ³³ But the woman fearing and trembling, knowing what was done in her, came and fell down before him, and told him all the truth. ³⁴ And he said to her: Daughter, thy faith hath made thee whole: go in peace, and be thou whole of thy disease. ³⁵ While he was yet speaking, some come from the ruler of the synagogue's house, saying: Thy daughter is dead: why dost thou trouble the master any further? ³⁶ But Jesus having heard the word that was spoken, saith to the ruler of the synagogue: Fear not, only believe. ³⁷ And he admitted not any man to follow him, but Peter, and James, and John the brother of James. ³⁸ And they come to the house of the ruler of the synagogue; and he seeth a tumult, and people weeping and wailing much. ³⁹ And going in, he saith to them Why make you this ado, and weep? the damsel is not dead, but sleepeth. ⁴⁰ And they laughed him to scorn. But he having put them all out, taketh the father and the mother of the damsel, and them that were with him, and entereth in where the damsel was lying. ⁴¹ And taking the damsel by the hand, he saith to her: Talitha cumi, which is, being interpreted: Damsel (I say to thee) arise. ⁴² And immediately the damsel rose up, and walked: and she was twelve years old: and they were astonished with a great astonishment. ⁴³ And he charged them strictly that no man should know it: and commanded that something should be given her to eat.

7 ¹ And there assembled together unto him the Pharisees and some of the scribes, coming from Jerusalem. ² And when they had seen some of his disciples eat bread with common, that is, with unwashed hands, they found fault. ³ For the Pharisees and all the Jews eat not without often washing their hands, holding the tradition of the ancients. ⁴ And when they come from the market, unless they be washed, they eat not: and many other things there are that have been delivered to them to observe, the washings of cups and of pots and of brazen vessels and of beds. ⁵ And the Pharisees and scribes asked him: Why do not thy disciples walk according to the tradition of the ancients, but they eat bread with common hands? ⁶ But he answering, said to them: Well did Isaias prophesy of you hypocrites, as it is written: This people honoureth me with their lips, but their heart is far from me. ⁷ And in vain do they worship me, teaching doctrines and precepts of men. ⁸ For leaving the commandment of God, you hold the tradition of men, the washing of pots and of cups: and many other things you do like to these. ⁹ And he said to them: Well do you make void the commandment of God, that

you may keep your own tradition. ¹⁰ For Moses said: Honour thy father and thy mother. And He that shall curse father or mother, dying let him die. ¹¹ But you say: If a man shall say to his father or mother, Corban (which is a gift) whatsoever is from me shall profit thee. ¹² And further you suffer him not to do any thing for his father or mother, ¹³ Making void the word of God by your own tradition, which you have given forth. And many other such like things you do.

¹⁴ And calling again the multitude unto him, he said to them: Hear ye me all and understand. ¹⁵ There is nothing from without a man that entering into him can defile him. But the things which come from a man, those are they that defile a man. ¹⁶ If any man have ears to hear, let him hear. ¹⁷ And when he was come into the house from the multitude, his disciples asked him the parable. ¹⁸ And he saith to them: So are you also without knowledge? Understand you not that every thing from without entering into a man cannot defile him: ¹⁹ Because it entereth not into his heart, but goeth into the belly, and goeth out into the privy, purging all meats? ²⁰ But he said that the things which come out from a man, they defile a man. ²¹ For from within, out of the heart of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, fornications, murders, ²² Thefts, covetousness, wickedness, deceit, lasciviousness, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, foolishness. ²³ All these evil things come from within and defile a man.

302. The mission of the twelve, and the loaves

Luke 9:1-17

⁹ ¹ Then calling together the twelve apostles, he gave them power and authority over all devils and to cure diseases. ² And he sent them to preach the kingdom of God and to heal the sick. ³ And he said to them: Take nothing for your journey, neither staff, nor scrip, nor bread, nor money; neither have two coats. ⁴ And whatsoever house you shall enter into, abide there and depart not from thence. ⁵ And whosoever will not receive you, when ye go out of that city, shake off even the dust of your feet, for a testimony against them. ⁶ And going out, they went about through the towns, preaching the gospel and healing every where.

⁷ Now Herod, the tetrarch, heard of all things that were done by him. And he was in a doubt, because it was said ⁸ By some that John was risen from the dead: but by other some, that Elias had appeared: and by others, that one of the old prophets was risen again. ⁹ And Herod said: John I have beheaded. But who is this of whom I hear such things? And he sought to see him.

¹⁰ And the apostles, when they were returned, told him all they had done. And taking them, he went aside into a desert place, apart, which belongeth to Bethsaida. ¹¹ Which when the people knew, they followed him: and he received them and spoke to them of the kingdom of God and healed them who had need of healing. ¹² Now the day began to decline. And the twelve came and said to him: Send away the multitude, that, going into the towns and villages round about, they may lodge and get victuals; for we are here in a desert place. ¹³ But he said to them: Give you them to eat. And they said: We have no more than five loaves and two fishes; unless perhaps, we should go and buy food for all this multitude. ¹⁴ Now there were about five thousand men. And he said to his disciples: Make them sit down by fifties in a company. ¹⁵ And they did so and made them all sit

down. ¹⁶ And taking the five loaves and the two fishes, he looked up to heaven and blessed them: and he broke and distributed to his disciples, to set before the multitude. ¹⁷ And they did all eat and were filled. And there were taken up of fragments that remained to them, twelve baskets.

303. The bread of life

John 6:1-72

⁶ ¹ After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is that of Tiberias. ² And a great multitude followed him, because they saw the miracles which he did on them that were diseased. ³ Jesus therefore went up into a mountain: and there he sat with his disciples. ⁴ Now the pasch, the festival day of the Jews, was near at hand. ⁵ When Jesus therefore had lifted up his eyes and seen that a very great multitude cometh to him, he said to Philip: Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat? ⁶ And this he said to try him: for he himself knew what he would do. ⁷ Philip answered him: Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them that every one may take a little. ⁸ One of his disciples, Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, saith to him: ⁹ There is a boy here that hath five barley loaves and two fishes. But what are these among so many? ¹⁰ Then Jesus said: Make the men sit down. Now, there was much grass in the place. The men therefore sat down, in number about five thousand. ¹¹ And Jesus took the loaves: and when he had given thanks, he distributed to them that were set down. In like manner also of the fishes, as much as they would. ¹² And when they were filled, he said to his disciples: gather up the fragments that remain, lest they be lost. ¹³ They gathered up therefore and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves which remained over and above to them that had eaten. ¹⁴ Now those men, when they had seen what a miracle Jesus had done, said: This is of a truth the prophet that is to come into the world. ¹⁵ Jesus therefore, when he knew that they would come to take him by force and make him king, fled again into the mountain himself alone. ¹⁶ And when evening was come, his disciples went down to the sea. ¹⁷ And when they had gone up into a ship, they went over the sea to Capharnaum. And it was now dark: and Jesus was not come unto them. ¹⁸ And the sea arose, by reason of a great wind that blew. ¹⁹ When they had rowed therefore about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, they see Jesus walking upon the sea and drawing nigh to the ship. And they were afraid. ²⁰ But he saith to them: It is I. Be not afraid. ²¹ They were willing therefore to take him into the ship. And presently the ship was at the land to which they were going.

²² The next day, the multitude that stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was no other ship there but one: and that Jesus had not entered into the ship with his disciples, but that his disciples were gone away alone. ²³ But other ships came in from Tiberias, nigh unto the place where they had eaten the bread, the Lord giving thanks. ²⁴ When therefore the multitude saw that Jesus was not there, nor his disciples, they took shipping and came to Capharnaum, seeking for Jesus. ²⁵ And when they had found him on the other side of the sea, they said to him: Rabbi, when camest thou hither? ²⁶ Jesus answered them and said: Amen, amen, I say to you, you seek me, not because you have seen miracles, but because you did eat of the loaves and were filled. ²⁷ Labour not for the meat which perisheth, but for

that which endureth unto life everlasting, which the Son of man will give you. For him hath God, the Father, sealed.²⁸ They said therefore unto him: What shall we do, that we may work the works of God?²⁹ Jesus answered and said to them: This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he hath sent.³⁰ They said therefore to him: What sign therefore dost thou shew that we may see and may believe thee? What dost thou work?³¹ Our fathers did eat manna in the desert, as it is written: He gave them bread from heaven to eat.³² Then Jesus said to them: Amen, amen, I say to you; Moses gave you not bread from heaven, but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven.³³ For the bread of God is that which cometh down from heaven and giveth life to the world.³⁴ They said therefore unto him: Lord, give us always this bread.³⁵ And Jesus said to them: I am the bread of life. He that cometh to me shall not hunger: and he that believeth in me shall never thirst.³⁶ But I said unto you that you also have seen me, and you believe not.³⁷ All that the Father giveth to me shall come to me: and him that cometh to me, I will not cast out.³⁸ Because I came down from heaven, not to do my own will but the will of him that sent me.³⁹ Now this is the will of the Father who sent me: that of all that he hath given me, I should lose nothing; but should raise it up again in the last day.⁴⁰ And this is the will of my Father that sent me: that every one who seeth the Son and believeth in him may have life everlasting. And I will raise him up in the last day.⁴¹ The Jews therefore murmured at him, because he had said: I am the living bread which came down from heaven.⁴² And they said: Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How then saith he: I came down from heaven?⁴³ Jesus therefore answered and said to them: Murmur not among yourselves.⁴⁴ No man can come to me, except the Father, who hath sent me, draw him. And I will raise him up in the last day.⁴⁵ It is written in the prophets: And they shall all be taught of God. Every one that hath heard of the Father and hath learned cometh to me.⁴⁶ Not that any man hath seen the Father: but he who is of God, he hath seen the Father.⁴⁷ Amen, amen, I say unto you: He that believeth in me hath everlasting life.⁴⁸ I am the bread of life.⁴⁹ Your fathers did eat manna in the desert: and are dead.⁵⁰ This is the bread which cometh down from heaven: that if any man eat of it, he may not die.⁵¹ I am the living bread which came down from heaven.⁵² If any man eat of this bread, he shall live for ever: and the bread that I will give is my flesh, for the life of the world.⁵³ The Jews therefore strove among themselves, saying: How can this man give us his flesh to eat?⁵⁴ Then Jesus said to them: Amen, amen, I say unto you: except you eat the flesh of the Son of man and drink his blood, you shall not have life in you.⁵⁵ He that eateth my flesh and drinketh my blood hath everlasting life: and I will raise him up in the last day.⁵⁶ For my flesh is meat indeed: and my blood is drink indeed.⁵⁷ He that eateth my flesh and drinketh my blood abideth in me: and I in him.⁵⁸ As the living Father hath sent me and I live by the Father: so he that eateth me, the same also shall live by me.⁵⁹ This is the bread that came down from heaven. Not as your fathers did eat manna and are dead. He that eateth this bread shall live for ever.⁶⁰ These things he said, teaching in the synagogue, in Capharnaum.⁶¹ Many therefore of his disciples, hearing it, said: This saying is hard; and who can hear it?⁶² But Jesus, knowing in himself that his

disciples murmured at this, said to them: Doth this scandalize you?⁶³ If then you shall see the Son of man ascend up where he was before?⁶⁴ It is the spirit that quickeneth: the flesh profiteth nothing. The words that I have spoken to you are spirit and life.⁶⁵ But there are some of you that believe not. For Jesus knew from the beginning who they were that did not believe and who he was that would betray him.

⁶⁶ And he said: Therefore did I say to you that no man can come to me, unless it be given him by my Father.⁶⁷ After this, many of his disciples went back and walked no more with him.⁶⁸ Then Jesus said to the twelve: Will you also go away?⁶⁹ And Simon Peter answered him: Lord, to whom shall we go? Thou hast the words of eternal life.⁷⁰ And we have believed and have known that thou art the Christ, the Son of God.⁷¹ Jesus answered them: Have not I chosen you twelve? And one of you is a devil.⁷² Now he meant Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon: for this same was about to betray him, whereas he was one of the twelve.

304. *The confession of Peter, and the Transfiguration*

Luke 9:18-36

Moses and Elias, read in this plan at Sinai and at Carmel, stand with him.

9 ¹⁸ And it came to pass, as he was alone praying, his disciples also were with him: and he asked them, saying: Whom do the people say that I am? ¹⁹ But they answered and said: John the Baptist; but some say Elias: and others say that one of the former prophets is risen again.²⁰ And he said to them: But whom do you say that I am? Simon Peter answering, said: The Christ of God.²¹ But he strictly charging them, commanded they should tell this to no man.²² Saying: The Son of man must suffer many things and be rejected by the ancients and chief priests and scribes and be killed and the third day rise again.

²³ And he said to all: If any man will come after me, let him deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow me.²⁴ For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: for he that shall lose his life for my sake shall save it.²⁵ For what is a man advantaged, if he gain the whole world and lose himself and cast away himself?²⁶ For he that shall be ashamed of me and of my words, of him the Son of man shall be ashamed, when he shall come in his majesty and that of his Father and of the holy angels.²⁷ But I tell you of a truth: There are some standing here that shall not taste death till they see the kingdom of God.

²⁸ And it came to pass, about eight days after these words, that he took Peter and James and John and went up into a mountain to pray.²⁹ And whilst he prayed, the shape of his countenance was altered and his raiment became white and glittering.³⁰ And behold two men were talking with him. And they were Moses and Elias,³¹ Appearing in majesty. And they spoke of his decease that he should accomplish in Jerusalem.³² But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with sleep. And waking, they saw his glory and the two men that stood with him.³³ And it came to pass that, as they were departing from him, Peter saith to Jesus: Master, it is good for us to be here: and let us make three tabernacles, one for thee, and one for Moses; and one for Elias: not knowing what he said.³⁴ And as he spoke these things, there came a cloud and overshadowed them. And they were afraid when they entered into the cloud.³⁵ And a voice came out of the

cloud; saying: This is my beloved son. Hear him. ³⁶ And whilst the voice was uttered Jesus was found alone. And they held their peace and told no man in those days any of these things which they had seen.

305. "Thou art Peter"

Matthew 16:13-28

16 ¹³ And Jesus came into the quarters of Cesarea Philippi: and he asked his disciples, saying: Whom do men say that the Son of man is? ¹⁴ But they said: Some John the Baptist, and other some Elias, and others Jeremias, or one of the prophets. ¹⁵ Jesus saith to them: But whom do you say that I am? ¹⁶ Simon Peter answered and said: Thou art Christ, the Son of the living God. ¹⁷ And Jesus answering said to him: Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-Jona: because flesh and blood hath not revealed it to thee, but my Father who is in heaven. ¹⁸ And I say to thee: That thou art Peter; and upon this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. ¹⁹ And I will give to thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven. And whatsoever thou shalt bind upon earth, it shall be bound also in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth, it shall be loosed also in heaven. ²⁰ Then he commanded his disciples, that they should tell no one that he was Jesus the Christ.

²¹ From that time Jesus began to shew to his disciples, that he must go to Jerusalem, and suffer many things from the ancients and scribes and chief priests, and be put to death, and the third day rise again. ²² And Peter taking him, began to rebuke him, saying: Lord, be it far from thee, this shall not be unto thee. ²³ Who turning, said to Peter: Go behind me, Satan, thou art a scandal unto me: because thou savourest not the things that are of God, but the things that are of men.

²⁴ Then Jesus said to his disciples: If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me. ²⁵ For he that will save his life, shall lose it: and he that shall lose his life for my sake, shall find it. ²⁶ For what doth it profit a man, if he gain the whole world and suffer the loss of his own soul? Or what exchange shall a man give for his soul? ²⁷ For the Son of man shall come in the glory of his Father with his angels: and then will he render to every man according to his works. ²⁸ Amen I say to you, there are some of them that stand here, that shall not taste death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.

306. Blind Bartimeus, and the ransom for many

Mark 10:32-52

10 ³² And they were in the way going up to Jerusalem: and Jesus went before them. And they were astonished and following were afraid. And taking again the twelve, he began to tell them the things that should befall him. ³³ Saying: Behold we go up to Jerusalem, and the Son of man shall be betrayed to the chief priests and to the scribes and ancients. And they shall condemn him to death and shall deliver him to the Gentiles. ³⁴ And they shall mock him and spit on him and scourge him and kill him: and the third day he shall rise again.

³⁵ And James and John, the sons of Zebedee, come to him, saying: Master, we desire that whatsoever we shall ask, thou wouldst do it for us. ³⁶ But he said to them: What would you

that I should do for you? ³⁷ And they said: Grant to us that we may sit, one on thy right hand and the other on thy left hand, in thy glory. ³⁸ And Jesus said to them: You know not what you ask. Can you drink of the chalice that I drink of or be baptized with the baptism wherewith I am baptized? ³⁹ But they said to him: We can. And Jesus saith to them: You shall indeed drink of the chalice that I drink of; and with the baptism wherewith I am baptized you shall be baptized. ⁴⁰ But to sit on my right hand or on my left is not mine to give to you, but to them for whom it is prepared. ⁴¹ And the ten, hearing it, began to be much displeased at James and John. ⁴² But Jesus calling them, saith to them: You know that they who seem to rule over the Gentiles lord it over them: and their princes have power over them. ⁴³ But it is not so among you: but whosoever will be greater shall be your minister. ⁴⁴ And whosoever will be first among you shall be the servant of all. ⁴⁵ For the Son of man also is not come to be ministered unto: but to minister and to give his life a redemption for many.

⁴⁶ And they came to Jericho. And as he went out of Jericho with his disciples and a very great multitude, Bartimeus the blind man, the son of Timeus, sat by the way side begging. ⁴⁷ Who when he had heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, began to cry out and to say: Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me. ⁴⁸ And many rebuked him, that he might hold his peace; but he cried a great deal the more: Son of David, have mercy on me. ⁴⁹ And Jesus, standing still, commanded him to be called. And they call the blind man, saying to him: Be of better comfort. Arise, he calleth thee. ⁵⁰ Who casting off his garment leaped up and came to him. ⁵¹ And Jesus answering, said to him: What wilt thou that I should do to thee? And the blind man said to him: Rabboni. That I may see. ⁵² And Jesus saith to him: Go thy way. Thy faith hath made thee whole. And immediately he saw and followed him in the way.

307. The road to Jerusalem

Luke 9:37-62

9 ³⁷ And it came to pass the day following, when they came down from the mountain, there met him a great multitude. ³⁸ And behold a man among the crowd cried out, saying: Master, I beseech thee, look upon my son, because he is my only one. ³⁹ And lo, a spirit seizeth him, and he suddenly crieth out, and he throweth him down and teareth him, so that he foameth; and bruising him, he hardly departeth from him. ⁴⁰ And I desired thy disciples to cast him out: and they could not. ⁴¹ And Jesus, answering, said: O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you and suffer you? Bring hither thy son. ⁴² And as he was coming to him, the devil threw him down and tore him. ⁴³ And Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit and cured the boy and restored him to his father. ⁴⁴ And all were astonished at the mighty power of God. But while all wondered at all the things he did, he said to his disciples: Lay you up in your hearts these words, for it shall come to pass that the Son of man shall be delivered into the hands of men. ⁴⁵ But they understood not this word: and it was hid from them, so that they perceived it not. And they were afraid to ask him concerning this word.

⁴⁶ And there entered a thought into them, which of them should be greater. ⁴⁷ But Jesus seeing the thoughts of their hearts, took a child and set him by him, ⁴⁸ And said to them: Whosoever shall receive this child in my name receiveth me; and whosoever

shall receive me receiveth him that sent me. For he that is the lesser among you all, he is the greater.

⁴⁹ And John, answering, said: Master, we saw a certain man casting out devils in thy name: and we forbade him, because he followeth not with us. ⁵⁰ And Jesus said to him: Forbid him not: for he that is not against you is for you.

⁵¹ And it came to pass, when the days of his assumption were accomplishing, that he steadfastly set his face to go to Jerusalem.

⁵² And he sent messengers before his face: and going, they entered into a city of the Samaritans, to prepare for him. ⁵³ And they received him not, because his face was of one going to Jerusalem. ⁵⁴ And when his disciples, James and John, had seen this, they said: Lord, wilt thou that we command fire to come down from heaven and consume them? ⁵⁵ And turning, he rebuked them, saying: you know not of what spirit you are. ⁵⁶ The Son of man came not to destroy souls, but to save. And they went into another town.

⁵⁷ And it came to pass, as they walked in the way, that a certain man said to him: I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.

⁵⁸ Jesus said to him: The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air nests: but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head. ⁵⁹ But he said to another: Follow me. And he said: Lord, suffer me first to go and to bury my father. ⁶⁰ And Jesus said to him: Let the dead bury their dead: but go thou and preach the kingdom of God. ⁶¹ And another said: I will follow thee, Lord; but let me first take my leave of them that are at my house. ⁶² Jesus said to him: No man putting his hand to the plough and looking back is fit for the kingdom of God.

308. The seventy-two, the good Samaritan, Martha and Mary

Luke 10:1-42

10 ¹ And after these things, the Lord appointed also other seventy-two. And he sent them two and two before his face into every city and place whither he himself was to come. ² And he said to them: The harvest indeed is great, but the labourers are few. Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest that he send labourers into his harvest. ³ Go: Behold I send you as lambs among wolves. ⁴ Carry neither purse, nor scrip, nor shoes: and salute no man by the way. ⁵ Into whatever house you enter, first say: Peace be to this house. ⁶ And if the son of peace be there, your peace shall rest upon him: but if not, it shall return to you. ⁷ And in the same house, remain, eating and drinking such things as they have: for the labourer is worthy of his hire. Remove not from house to house. ⁸ And into what city soever you enter, and they receive you, eat such things as are set before you. ⁹ And heal the sick that are therein and say to them: The kingdom of God is come nigh unto you. ¹⁰ But into whatsoever city you enter, and they receive you not, going forth into the streets thereof, say: ¹¹ Even the very dust of your city that cleaveth to us, we wipe off against you. Yet know this, that the kingdom of God is at hand. ¹² I say to you, it shall be more tolerable at that day for Sodom than for that city. ¹³ Woe to thee, Corozain! Woe to thee, Bethsaida! For if in Tyre and Sidon had been wrought the mighty works that have been wrought in you, they would have done penance long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes. ¹⁴ But it shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment than for you. ¹⁵ And thou, Capharnaum, which art exalted unto

heaven, thou shalt be thrust down to hell. ¹⁶ He that heareth you heareth me: and he that despiseth you despiseth me: and he that despiseth me despiseth him that sent me.

¹⁷ And the seventy-two returned with joy, saying: Lord, the devils also are subject to us in thy name. ¹⁸ And he said to them: I saw Satan like lightning falling from heaven. ¹⁹ Behold, I have given you power to tread upon serpents and scorpions and upon all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall hurt you. ²⁰ But yet rejoice not in this, that spirits are subject unto you: but rejoice in this, that your names are written in heaven.

²¹ In that same hour, he rejoiced in the Holy Ghost and said: I confess to thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hidden these things from the wise and prudent and hast revealed them to little ones. Yea, Father, for so it hath seemed good in thy sight. ²² All things are delivered to me by my Father. And no one knoweth who the Son is, but the Father: and who the Father is, but the Son and to whom the Son will reveal him.

²³ And turning to his disciples, he said: Blessed are the eyes that see the things which you see. ²⁴ For I say to you that many prophets and kings have desired to see the things that you see and have not seen them; and to hear the things that you hear and have not heard them.

²⁵ And behold a certain lawyer stood up, tempting him and saying, Master, what must I do to possess eternal life? ²⁶ But he said to him: What is written in the law? How readest thou?

²⁷ He answering, said: Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with thy whole heart and with thy whole soul and with all thy strength and with all thy mind: and thy neighbour as thyself. ²⁸ And he said to him: Thou hast answered right. This do: and thou shalt live. ²⁹ But he willing to justify himself, said to Jesus: And who is my neighbour? ³⁰ And Jesus answering, said: A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho and fell among robbers, who also stripped him and having wounded him went away, leaving him half dead. ³¹ And it chanced, that a certain priest went down the same way: and seeing him, passed by. ³² In like manner also a Levite, when he was near the place and saw him, passed by. ³³ But a certain Samaritan, being on his journey, came near him: and seeing him, was moved with compassion: ³⁴ And going up to him, bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine: and setting him upon his own beast, brought him to an inn and took care of him. ³⁵ And the next day he took out two pence and gave to the host and said: Take care of him; and whatsoever thou shalt spend over and above, I, at my return, will repay thee. ³⁶ Which of these three, in thy opinion, was neighbour to him that fell among the robbers? ³⁷ But he said: He that shewed mercy to him. And Jesus said to him: Go, and do thou in like manner.

³⁸ Now it came to pass, as they went, that he entered into a certain town: and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house. ³⁹ And she had a sister called Mary, who, sitting also at the Lord's feet, heard his word. ⁴⁰ But Martha was busy about much serving. Who stood and said: Lord, hast thou no care that my sister hath left me alone to serve? Speak to her therefore, that she help me. ⁴¹ And the Lord answering, said to her: Martha, Martha, thou art careful and art troubled about many things: ⁴² But one thing is necessary. Mary hath chosen the best part, which shall not be taken away from her.

309. The Our Father, the strong man, and "fear not, little flock"*Luke 11:1-12:59*

11 ¹ And it came to pass that as he was in a certain place praying, when he ceased, one of his disciples said to him: Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples. ² And he said to them: When you pray, say: Father, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. ³ Give us this day our daily bread. ⁴ And forgive us our sins, for we also forgive every one that is indebted to us. And lead us not into temptation. ⁵ And he said to them: Which of you shall have a friend and shall go to him at midnight and shall say to him: Friend, lend me three loaves, ⁶ Because a friend of mine is come off his journey to me and I have not what to set before him. ⁷ And he from within should answer and say: Trouble me not; the door is now shut, and my children are with me in bed. I cannot rise and give thee. ⁸ Yet if he shall continue knocking, I say to you, although he will not rise and give him because he is his friend; yet, because of his importunity, he will rise and give him as many as he needeth. ⁹ And I say to you: Ask, and it shall be given you: seek, and you shall find: knock, and it shall be opened to you. ¹⁰ For every one that asketh receiveth: and he that seeketh findeth: and to him that knocketh it shall be opened: ¹¹ And which of you, if he ask his father bread, will he give him a stone? Or a fish, will he for a fish give him a serpent? ¹² Or if he shall ask an egg, will he reach him a scorpion? ¹³ If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father from heaven give the good Spirit to them that ask him?

¹⁴ And he was casting out a devil: and the same was dumb. And when he had cast out the devil, the dumb spoke: and the multitudes, were in admiration at it. ¹⁵ But some of them said: He casteth out devils by Beelzebub, the prince of devils. ¹⁶ And others tempting, asked of him a sign from heaven. ¹⁷ But he seeing their thoughts, said to them: Every kingdom divided against itself shall be brought to desolation; and house upon house shall fall. ¹⁸ And if Satan also be divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand? Because you say that through Beelzebub I cast out devils. ¹⁹ Now if I cast out devils by Beelzebub, by whom do your children cast them out? Therefore, they shall be your judges. ²⁰ But if I by the finger of God cast out devils, doubtless the kingdom of God is come upon you. ²¹ When a strong man armed keepeth his court, those things are in peace which he possesseth. ²² But if a stronger than he come upon him and overcome him, he will take away all his armour wherein he trusted and will distribute his spoils. ²³ He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth not with me scattereth. ²⁴ When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through places without water, seeking rest: and not finding, he saith: I will return into my house whence I came out. ²⁵ And when he is come, he findeth it swept and garnished. ²⁶ Then he goeth and taketh with him seven other spirits more wicked than himself: and entering in they dwell there. And the last state of that man becomes worse than the first.

²⁷ And it came to pass, as he spoke these things, a certain woman from the crowd, lifting up her voice, said to him: Blessed is the womb that bore thee and the paps that gave thee suck.

²⁸ But he said: Yea rather, blessed are they who hear the word of God and keep it.

²⁹ And the multitudes running together, he began to say: This generation is a wicked generation. It asketh a sign: and a sign shall not be given it, but the sign of Jonas the prophet. ³⁰ For as Jonas was a sign to the Ninivites; so shall the Son of man also be to this generation. ³¹ The queen of the south shall rise in the judgment with the men of this generation and shall condemn them: because she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon. And behold more than Solomon here. ³² The men of Ninive shall rise in the judgment with this generation and shall condemn it; Because they did penance at the preaching of Jonas. And behold more than Jonas here. ³³ No man lighteth a candle and putteth it in a hidden place, nor under a bushel: but upon a candlestick, that they that come in may see the light. ³⁴ The light of thy body is thy eye. If thy eye be single, thy whole body will be lightsome: but if it be evil, thy body also will be darksome. ³⁵ Take heed therefore that the light which is in thee be not darkness. ³⁶ If then thy whole body be lightsome, having no part of darkness: the whole shall be lightsome and, as a bright lamp, shall enlighten thee.

³⁷ And as he was speaking, a certain Pharisee prayed him that he would dine with him. And he going in, sat down to eat. ³⁸ And the Pharisee began to say, thinking within himself, why he was not washed before dinner. ³⁹ And the Lord said to him: Now you, Pharisees, make clean the outside of the cup and of the platter: but your inside is full of rapine and iniquity. ⁴⁰ Ye fools, did not he that made that which is without make also that which is within? ⁴¹ But yet that which remaineth, give alms: and behold, all things are clean unto you. ⁴² But woe to you, Pharisees, because you tithe mint and rue and every herb and pass over judgment and the charity of God. Now these things you ought to have done, and not to leave the other undone. ⁴³ Woe to you, Pharisees, because you love the uppermost seats in the synagogues and salutations in the marketplace. ⁴⁴ Woe to you, because you are as sepulchres that appear not: and men that walk over are not aware.

⁴⁵ And one of the lawyers answering, saith to him: Master, in saying these things, thou reproachest us also. ⁴⁶ But he said: Woe to you lawyers also, because you load men with burdens which they cannot bear and you yourselves touch not the packs with one of your fingers. ⁴⁷ Woe to you who build the monuments of the prophets: and your fathers killed them. ⁴⁸ Truly you bear witness that you consent to the doings of your fathers. For they indeed killed them: and you build their sepulchres. ⁴⁹ For this cause also the wisdom of God said: I will send to them prophets and apostles: and some of them they will kill and persecute. ⁵⁰ That the blood of all the prophets which was shed from the foundation of the world may be required of this generation, ⁵¹ From the blood of Abel unto the blood of Zacharias, who was slain between the altar and the temple. Yea I say to you: It shall be required of this generation. ⁵² Woe to you lawyers, for you have taken away the key of knowledge. You yourselves have not entered in: and those that were entering in, you have hindered. ⁵³ And as he was saying these things to them, the Pharisees and the lawyers began violently to urge him and to oppress his

mouth about many things,⁵⁴ Lying in wait for him and seeking to catch something from his mouth, that they might accuse him.

12 ¹ And when great multitudes stood about him, so that they trod one upon another, he began to say to his disciples: Beware ye of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy. ² For there is nothing covered that shall not be revealed: nor hidden that shall not be known. ³ For whatsoever things you have spoken in darkness shall be published in the light: and that which you have spoken in the ear in the chambers shall be preached on the housetops. ⁴ And I say to you, my friends: Be not afraid of them who kill the body and after that have no more that they can do. ⁵ But I will shew you whom you shall fear: Fear ye him who, after he hath killed, hath power to cast into hell. Yea, I say to you: Fear him. ⁶ Are not five sparrows sold for two farthings, and not one of them is forgotten before God? ⁷ Yea, the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Fear not therefore: you are of more value than many sparrows. ⁸ And I say to you: Whosoever shall confess me before men, him shall the Son of man also confess before the angels of God. ⁹ But he that shall deny me before men shall be denied before the angels of God. ¹⁰ And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but to him that shall blaspheme against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven. ¹¹ And when they shall bring you into the synagogues and to magistrates and powers, be not solicitous how or what you shall answer, or what you shall say. ¹² For the Holy Ghost shall teach you in the same hour what you must say.

¹³ And one of the multitude said to him: Master, speak to my brother that he divide the inheritance with me. ¹⁴ But he said to him: Man, who hath appointed me judge or divider over you? ¹⁵ And he said to them: Take heed and beware of all covetousness: for a man's life doth not consist in the abundance of things which he possesseth. ¹⁶ And he spoke a similitude to them, saying: The land of a certain rich man brought forth plenty of fruits. ¹⁷ And he thought within himself, saying: What shall I do, because I have no room where to bestow my fruits? ¹⁸ And he said: This will I do: I will pull down my barns and will build greater: and into them will I gather all things that are grown to me and my goods. ¹⁹ And I will say to my soul: Soul, thou hast much goods laid up for many years. Take thy rest: eat, drink, make good cheer. ²⁰ But God said to him: Thou fool, this night do they require thy soul of thee. And whose shall those things be which thou hast provided? ²¹ So is he that layeth up treasure for himself and is not rich towards God.

²² And he said to his disciples: Therefore I say to you: Be not solicitous for your life, what you shall eat, nor for your body, what you shall put on. ²³ The life is more than the meat: and the body is more than the raiment. ²⁴ Consider the ravens, for they sow not, neither do they reap, neither have they storehouse nor barn, and God feedeth them. How much are you more valuable than they? ²⁵ And which of you by taking thought can add to his stature one cubit? ²⁶ If then ye be not able to do so much as the least thing, why are you solicitous for the rest? ²⁷ Consider the lilies, how they grow: they labour not, neither do they spin. But I say to you, not even Solomon in all his glory was clothed like one of these. ²⁸ Now, if God clothe in this manner the grass that is to-day in the field and to-morrow is cast into the oven: how much more you, O ye of little faith? ²⁹ And seek not what

you shall eat or what you shall drink: and be not lifted up on high. ³⁰ For all these things do the nations of the world seek. But your Father knoweth that you have need of these things. ³¹ But seek ye first the kingdom of God and his justice: and all these things shall be added unto you. ³² Fear not, little flock, for it hath pleased your Father to give you a kingdom. ³³ Sell what you possess and give alms. Make to yourselves bags which grow not old, a treasure in heaven which faileth not: where no thief approacheth, nor moth corrupteth. ³⁴ For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also. ³⁵ Let your loins be girt and lamps burning in your hands. ³⁶ And you yourselves like to men who wait for their lord, when he shall return from the wedding; that when he cometh and knocketh, they may open to him immediately. ³⁷ Blessed are those servants whom the Lord, when he cometh, shall find watching. Amen I say to you that he will gird himself and make them sit down to meat and passing will minister unto them. ³⁸ And if he shall come in the second watch or come in the third watch and find them so, blessed are those servants. ³⁹ But this know ye, that if the householder did know at what hour the thief would come, he would surely watch and would not suffer his house to be broken open. ⁴⁰ Be you then also ready: for at what hour you think not the Son of man will come.

⁴¹ And Peter said to him: Lord, dost thou speak this parable to us, or likewise to all? ⁴² And the Lord said: Who thinkest thou is the faithful and wise steward, whom his lord setteth over his family, to give them their measure of wheat in due season? ⁴³ Blessed is that servant whom, when his lord shall come, he shall find so doing. ⁴⁴ Verily I say to you, he will set him over all that he possesseth. ⁴⁵ But if that servant shall say in his heart: My lord is long a coming; and shall begin to strike the men-servants and maid-servants, and to eat and to drink and be drunk: ⁴⁶ The lord of that servant will come in the day that he hopeth not, and at the hour that he knoweth not: and shall separate him and shall appoint him his portion with unbelievers. ⁴⁷ And that servant, who knew the will of his lord and prepared not himself and did not according to his will, shall be beaten with many stripes. ⁴⁸ But he that knew not and did things worthy of stripes shall be beaten with few stripes. And unto whomsoever much is given, of him much shall be required: and to whom they have committed much, of him they will demand the more.

⁴⁹ I am come to cast fire on the earth. And what will I, but that it be kindled? ⁵⁰ And I have a baptism wherewith I am to be baptized. And how am I straitened until it be accomplished? ⁵¹ Think ye, that I am come to give peace on earth? I tell you, no; but separation. ⁵² For there shall be from henceforth five in one house divided: three against two, and two against three. ⁵³ The father shall be divided against the son and the son against his father: the mother against the daughter and the daughter against her mother: the mother-in-law against the daughter-in-law and the daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law.

⁵⁴ And he said also to the multitudes: When you see a cloud rising from the west, presently you say: A shower is coming. And so it happeneth. ⁵⁵ And when ye see the south wind blow, you say: There will be heat. And it cometh to pass. ⁵⁶ You hypocrites, you know how to discern the face of the heaven and of the earth: but how is it that you do not discern this time? ⁵⁷ And why, even

of yourselves, do you not judge that which is just? ⁵⁸ And when thou goest with thy adversary to the prince, whilst thou art in the way, endeavour to be delivered from him: lest perhaps he draw thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the exacter, and the exacter cast thee into prison. ⁵⁹ I say to thee, thou shalt not go out thence until thou pay the very last mite.

310. The narrow gate, the lament over Jerusalem, and the great supper

Luke 13:1-14:35

13 ¹ And there were present, at that very time, some that told him of the Galileans, whose blood Pilate had mingled with their sacrifices. ² And he answering, said to them: Think you that these Galileans were sinners above all the men of Galilee, because they suffered such things? ³ No, I say to you: but unless you shall do penance, you shall all likewise perish. ⁴ Or those eighteen upon whom the tower fell in Siloe and slew them: think you that they also were debtors above all the men that dwelt in Jerusalem? ⁵ No, I say to you: but except you do penance, you shall all likewise perish.

⁶ He spoke also this parable: A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard: and he came seeking fruit on it and found none. ⁷ And he said to the dresser of the vineyard: Behold, for these three years I come seeking fruit on this fig tree and I find none. Cut it down therefore. Why cumbereth it the ground? ⁸ But he answering, said to him: Lord, let it alone this year also, until I dig about it and dung it. ⁹ And if happily it bear fruit: but if not, then after that thou shalt cut it down. ¹⁰ And he was teaching in their synagogue on their sabbath. ¹¹ And behold there was a woman who had a spirit of infirmity eighteen years. And she was bowed together: neither could she look upwards at all. ¹² Whom when Jesus saw, he called her unto him and said to her: Woman, thou art delivered from thy infirmity. ¹³ And he laid his hands upon her: and immediately she was made straight and glorified God. ¹⁴ And the ruler of the synagogue being angry that Jesus had healed on the sabbath answering, said to the multitude: Six days there are wherein you ought to work. In them therefore come and be healed: and not on the sabbath day. ¹⁵ And the Lord answering him, said: Ye hypocrites, doth not every one of you, on the sabbath day, loose his ox or his ass from the manger and lead them to water? ¹⁶ And ought not this daughter of Abraham, whom Satan hath bound, lo, these eighteen years, be loosed from this bond on the sabbath day? ¹⁷ And when he said these things, all his adversaries were ashamed: and all the people rejoiced for all the things that were gloriously done by him.

¹⁸ He said therefore: To what is the kingdom of God like, and whereunto shall I resemble it? ¹⁹ It is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took and cast into his garden: and it grew and became a great tree, and the birds of the air lodged in the branches thereof. ²⁰ And again he said: Whereunto shall I esteem the kingdom of God to be like? ²¹ It is like to leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened. ²² And he went through the cities and towns teaching and making his journey to Jerusalem. ²³ And a certain man said to him: Lord, are they few that are saved? But he said to them:

²⁴ Strive to enter by the narrow gate: for many, I say to you, shall seek to enter and shall not be able. ²⁵ But when the master of the house shall be gone in and shall shut the door, you shall

begin to stand without; and knock at the door, saying: Lord, open to us. And he answering, shall say to you: I know you not, whence you are. ²⁶ Then you shall begin to say: We have eaten and drunk in thy presence: and thou hast taught in our streets. ²⁷ And he shall say to you: I know you not, whence you are. Depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity. ²⁸ There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth; when you shall see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets, in the kingdom of God: and you yourselves thrust out. ²⁹ And there shall come from the east and the west and the north and the south: and shall sit down in the kingdom of God. ³⁰ And behold, they are last that shall be first: and they are first that shall be last.

³¹ The same day, there came some of the Pharisees, saying to him: Depart, and get thee hence, for Herod hath a mind to kill thee. ³² And he said to them: Go and tell that fox: Behold, I cast out devils and do cures, to-day and to-morrow, and the third day I am consummated. ³³ Nevertheless, I must walk to-day and to-morrow and the day following, because it cannot be that a prophet perish, out of Jerusalem. ³⁴ Jerusalem, Jerusalem, that killest the prophets; and stonest them that are sent to thee, how often would I have gathered thy children as the bird doth her brood under her wings, and thou wouldest not? ³⁵ Behold your house shall be left to you desolate. And I say to you that you shall not see me till the time come when you shall say: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

14 ¹ And it came to pass, when Jesus went into the house of one of the chief of the Pharisees, on the sabbath day, to eat bread, that they watched him. ² And behold, there was a certain man before him that had the dropsy. ³ And Jesus answering, spoke to the lawyers and Pharisees, saying: Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath day? ⁴ But they held their peace. But he taking him, healed him and sent him away. ⁵ And answering them, he said: Which of you shall have an ass or an ox fall into a pit and will not immediately draw him out, on the sabbath day? ⁶ And they could not answer him to these things.

⁷ And he spoke a parable also to them that were invited, marking how they chose the first seats at the table, saying to them: ⁸ When thou art invited to a wedding, sit not down in the first place, lest perhaps one more honourable than thou be invited by him: ⁹ And he that invited thee and him, come and say to thee: Give this man place. And then thou begin with shame to take the lowest place. ¹⁰ But when thou art invited, go, sit down in the lowest place; that when he who invited thee cometh, he may say to thee: Friend, go up higher. Then shalt thou have glory before them that sit at table with thee. ¹¹ Because every one that exalteth himself shall be humbled: and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted.

¹² And he said to him also that had invited him: When thou make a dinner or a supper, call not thy friends nor thy brethren nor thy kinsmen nor thy neighbours who are rich; lest perhaps they also invite thee again, and a recompense be made to thee. ¹³ But when thou makest a feast, call the poor, the maimed, the lame and the blind. ¹⁴ And thou shalt be blessed, because they have not wherewith to make thee recompense: for recompense shall be made thee at the resurrection of the just.

¹⁵ When one of them that sat at table with him had heard these things, he said to him: Blessed is he that shall eat bread in

the kingdom of God. ¹⁶ But he said to him: A certain man made a great supper and invited many. ¹⁷ And he sent his servant at the hour of supper to say to them that were invited, that they should come: for now all things are ready. ¹⁸ And they began all at once to make excuse. The first said to him: I have bought a farm and I must needs go out and see it. I pray thee, hold me excused. ¹⁹ And another said: I have bought five yoke of oxen and I go to try them. I pray thee, hold me excused. ²⁰ And another said: I have married a wife; and therefore I cannot come. ²¹ And the servant returning, told these things to his lord. Then the master of the house, being angry, said to his servant: Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city; and bring in hither the poor and the feeble and the blind and the lame. ²² And the servant said: Lord, it is done as thou hast commanded; and yet there is room. ²³ And the Lord said to the servant: Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled. ²⁴ But I say unto you that none of those men that were invited shall taste of my supper.

²⁵ And there went great multitudes with him. And turning, he said to them: ²⁶ If any man come to me, and hate not his father and mother and wife and children and brethren and sisters, yea and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple. ²⁷ And whosoever doth not carry his cross and come after me cannot be my disciple. ²⁸ For which of you, having a mind to build a tower, doth not first sit down and reckon the charges that are necessary, whether he have wherewithal to finish it: ²⁹ Lest, after he hath laid the foundation and is not able to finish it, all that see it begin to mock him, ³⁰ Saying: This man began to build and was not able to finish. ³¹ Or, what king, about to go to make war against another king, doth not first sit down and think whether he be able, with ten thousand, to meet him that, with twenty thousand, cometh against him? ³² Or else, while the other is yet afar off, sending an embassy, he desireth conditions of peace. ³³ So likewise every one of you that doth not renounce all that he possesseth cannot be my disciple.

³⁴ Salt is good. But if the salt shall lose its savour, wherewith shall it be seasoned? ³⁵ It is neither profitable for the land nor for the dunghill: but shall be cast out. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

311. *The lost sheep, the lost groat, the prodigal son*

Luke 15:1-32

15 ¹ Now the publicans and sinners drew near unto him to hear him. ² And the Pharisees and the scribes murmured, saying: This man receiveth sinners and eateth with them.

³ And he spoke to them this parable, saying: ⁴ What man of you that hath an hundred sheep, and if he shall lose one of them, doth he not leave the ninety-nine in the desert and go after that which was lost, until he find it? ⁵ And when he hath found it, lay it upon his shoulders, rejoicing? ⁶ And coming home, call together his friends and neighbours, saying to them: Rejoice with me, because I have found my sheep that was lost? ⁷ I say to you that even so there shall be joy in heaven upon one sinner that doth penance, more than upon ninety-nine just who need not penance.

⁸ Or what woman having ten groats, if she lose one groat, doth not light a candle and sweep the house and seek diligently until she find it? ⁹ And when she hath found it, call together her

friends and neighbours, saying: Rejoice with me, because I have found the groat which I had lost. ¹⁰ So I say to you, there shall be joy before the angels of God upon one sinner doing penance.

¹¹ And he said: A certain man had two sons. ¹² And the younger of them said to his father: Father, give me the portion of substance that falleth to me. And he divided unto them his substance. ¹³ And not many days after, the younger son, gathering all together, went abroad into a far country: and there wasted his substance, living riotously. ¹⁴ And after he had spent all, there came a mighty famine in that country: and he began to be in want. ¹⁵ And he went and cleaved to one of the citizens of that country. And he sent him into his farm to feed swine. ¹⁶ And he would fain have filled his belly with the husks the swine did eat: and no man gave unto him. ¹⁷ And returning to himself, he said: How many hired servants in my father's house abound with bread, and I here perish with hunger! ¹⁸ I will arise and will go to my father and say to him: Father, I have sinned against heaven and before thee. ¹⁹ I am not worthy to be called thy son: make me as one of thy hired servants. ²⁰ And rising up, he came to his father. And when he was yet a great way off, his father saw him and was moved with compassion and running to him fell upon his neck and kissed him. ²¹ And the son said to him: Father: I have sinned against heaven and before thee I am not now worthy to be called thy son. ²² And the father said to his servants: Bring forth quickly the first robe and put it on him: and put a ring on his hand and shoes on his feet. ²³ And bring hither the fatted calf, and kill it: and let us eat and make merry: ²⁴ Because this my son was dead and is come to life again, was lost and is found. And they began to be merry. ²⁵ Now his elder son was in the field and when he came and drew nigh to the house, he heard music and dancing. ²⁶ And he called one of the servants, and asked what these things meant. ²⁷ And he said to him: Thy brother is come and thy father hath killed the fatted calf, because he hath received him safe. ²⁸ And he was angry and would not go in. His father therefore coming out began to entreat him. ²⁹ And he answering, said to his father: Behold, for so many years do I serve thee and I have never transgressed thy commandment: and yet thou hast never given me a kid to make merry with my friends. ³⁰ But as soon as this thy son is come, who hath devoured his substance with harlots, thou hast killed for him the fatted calf. ³¹ But he said to him: Son, thou art always with me; and all I have is thine. ³² But it was fit that we should make merry and be glad: for this thy brother was dead and is come to life again; he was lost, and is found.

312. *Dives and Lazarus; the ten lepers*

Luke 16:1-17:37

16 ¹ And he said also to his disciples: There was a certain rich man who had a steward: and the same was accused unto him, that he had wasted his goods. ² And he called him and said to him: How is it that I hear this of thee? Give an account of thy stewardship: for now thou canst be steward no longer. ³ And the steward said within himself: What shall I do, because my lord taketh away from me the stewardship? To dig I am not able; to beg I am ashamed. ⁴ I know what I will do, that when I shall be removed from the stewardship, they may receive me into their houses. ⁵ Therefore, calling together every one of his lord's debtors, he said to the first: How much dost thou owe my

lord? ⁶ But he said: An hundred barrels of oil. And he said to him: Take thy bill and sit down quickly and write fifty. ⁷ Then he said to another: And how much dost thou owe? Who said: An hundred quarters of wheat. He said to him: Take thy bill and write eighty. ⁸ And the lord commended the unjust steward, forasmuch as he had done wisely: for the children of this world are wiser in their generation than the children of light. ⁹ And I say to you: Make unto you friends of the mammon of iniquity: that when you shall fail, they may receive you into everlasting dwellings. ¹⁰ He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in that which is greater: and he that is unjust in that which is little is unjust also in that which is greater. ¹¹ If then you have not been faithful in the unjust mammon, who will trust you with that which is the true? ¹² And if you have not been faithful in that which is another's, who will give you that which is your own? ¹³ No servant can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one and love the other: or he will hold to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon. ¹⁴ Now the Pharisees, who were covetous, heard all these things: and they derided him. ¹⁵ And he said to them: you are they who justify yourselves before men, but God knoweth your hearts. For that which is high to men is an abomination before God. ¹⁶ The law and the prophets were until John. From that time the kingdom of God is preached: and every one useth violence towards it. ¹⁷ And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass than one tittle of the law to fall. ¹⁸ Every one that putteth away his wife and marrieth another committeth adultery: and he that marrieth her that is put away from her husband committeth adultery.

¹⁹ There was a certain rich man who was clothed in purple and fine linen and feasted sumptuously every day. ²⁰ And there was a certain beggar, named Lazarus, who lay at his gate, full of sores, ²¹ Desiring to be filled with the crumbs that fell from the rich man's table. And no one did give him: moreover the dogs came and licked his sores. ²² And it came to pass that the beggar died and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom. And the rich man also died: and he was buried in hell. ²³ And lifting up his eyes when he was in torments, he saw Abraham afar off and Lazarus in his bosom: ²⁴ And he cried and said: Father Abraham, have mercy on me and send Lazarus, that he may dip the tip of his finger in water to cool my tongue: for I am tormented in this flame. ²⁵ And Abraham said to him: Son, remember that thou didst receive good things in thy lifetime, and likewise Lazarus evil things: but now he is comforted and thou art tormented. ²⁶ And besides all this, between us and you, there is fixed a great chaos: so that they who would pass from hence to you cannot, nor from thence come hither. ²⁷ And he said: Then, father, I beseech thee that thou wouldst send him to my father's house, for I have five brethren, ²⁸ That he may testify unto them, lest they also come into this place of torments. ²⁹ And Abraham said to him: They have Moses and the prophets. Let them hear them. ³⁰ But he said: No, father Abraham: but if one went to them from the dead, they will do penance. ³¹ And he said to him: If they hear not Moses and the prophets, neither will they believe, if one rise again from the dead.

17 ¹ And he said to his disciples: It is impossible that scandals should not come. But woe to him through whom they come!

² It were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck and he cast into the sea, than that he should scandalize one of these little ones. ³ Take heed to yourselves. If thy brother sin against thee, reprove him: and if he do penance, forgive him. ⁴ And if he sin against thee seven times in a day, and seven times in a day be converted unto thee, saying: I repent: forgive him. ⁵ And the apostles said to the Lord: Increase our faith. ⁶ And the Lord said: If you had faith like to a grain of mustard seed, you might say to this mulberry tree: Be thou rooted up and be thou transplanted into the sea. And it would obey you. ⁷ But which of you, having a servant ploughing or feeding cattle, will say to him, when he is come from the field: Immediately go. Sit down to meat. ⁸ And will not rather say to him: Make ready my supper and gird thyself and serve me, whilst I eat and drink; and afterwards thou shalt eat and drink? ⁹ Doth he thank that servant for doing the things which he commanded him? ¹⁰ I think not. So you also, when you shall have done all these things that are commanded you, say: We are unprofitable servants; we have done that which we ought to do.

¹¹ And it came to pass, as he was going to Jerusalem, he passed through the midst of Samaria and Galilee. ¹² And as he entered into a certain town, there met him ten men that were lepers, who stood afar off. ¹³ And lifted up their voice, saying: Jesus, Master, have mercy on us. ¹⁴ Whom when he saw, he said: Go, shew yourselves to the priests. And it came to pass, as they went, they were made clean. ¹⁵ And one of them, when he saw that he was made clean, went back, with a loud voice glorifying God. ¹⁶ And he fell on his face before his feet, giving thanks. And this was a Samaritan. ¹⁷ And Jesus answering, said: Were not ten made clean? And where are the nine? ¹⁸ There is no one found to return and give glory to God, but this stranger. ¹⁹ And he said to him: Arise, go thy way; for thy faith hath made thee whole.

²⁰ And being asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God should come, he answered them and said: The kingdom of God cometh not with observation. ²¹ Neither shall they say: Behold here, or behold there. For lo, the kingdom of God is within you. ²² And he said to his disciples: The days will come when you shall desire to see one day of the Son of man. And you shall not see it. ²³ And they will say to you: See here, and see there. Go ye not after, nor follow them. ²⁴ For as the lightning that lighteneth from under heaven shineth unto the parts that are under heaven, so shall the Son of man be in his day. ²⁵ But first he must suffer many things and be rejected by this generation. ²⁶ And as it came to pass in the days of Noe, so shall it be also in the days of the Son of man. ²⁷ They did eat and drink, they married wives and were given in marriage, until the day that Noe entered into the ark and the flood came and destroyed them all. ²⁸ Likewise as it came to pass in the days of Lot. They did eat and drink, they bought and sold, they planted and built. ²⁹ And in the day that Lot went out of Sodom, it rained fire and brimstone from heaven and destroyed them all. ³⁰ Even thus shall it be in the day when the Son of man shall be revealed. ³¹ In that hour, he that shall be on the housetop, and his goods in the house, let him not go down to take them away: and he that shall be in the field, in like manner, let him not return back. ³² Remember Lot's wife. ³³ Whosoever shall seek to save his life shall lose it: and whosoever shall lose it shall preserve it. ³⁴ I say to you: In

that night there shall be two men in one bed. The one shall be taken and the other shall be left.³⁵ Two women shall be grinding together. The one shall be taken and the other shall be left. Two men shall be in the field. The one shall be taken and the other shall be left.³⁶ They answering, say to him: Where, Lord?³⁷ Who said to them: Wheresoever the body shall be, thither will the eagles also be gathered together.

313. The widow, the publican, and the rich ruler

Luke 18:1-43

18 ¹ And he spoke also a parable to them, that we ought always to pray and not to faint, ² Saying: There was a judge in a certain city, who feared not God nor regarded man. ³ And there was a certain widow in that city; and she came to him, saying: Avenge me of my adversary. ⁴ And he would not for a long time. But afterwards he said within himself: Although I fear not God nor regard man, ⁵ Yet because this widow is troublesome to me, I will avenge her, lest continually coming she weary me. ⁶ And the Lord said: Hear what the unjust judge saith. ⁷ And will not God revenge his elect who cry to him day and night? And will he have patience in their regard? ⁸ I say to you that he will quickly revenge them. But yet the Son of man, when he cometh, shall he find, think you, faith on earth? ⁹ And to some who trusted in themselves as just and despised others, he spoke also this parable: ¹⁰ Two men went up into the temple to pray: the one a Pharisee and the other a publican. ¹¹ The Pharisee standing, prayed thus with himself: O God, I give thee thanks that I am not as the rest of men, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, as also is this publican. ¹² I fast twice in a week: I give tithes of all that I possess. ¹³ And the publican, standing afar off, would not so much as lift up his eyes towards heaven; but struck his breast, saying: O God, be merciful to me a sinner. ¹⁴ I say to you, this man went down into his house justified rather than the other: because every one that exalteth himself shall be humbled: and he that humbleth himself shall be exalted. ¹⁵ And they brought unto him also infants, that he might touch them. Which when the disciples saw, they rebuked them. ¹⁶ But Jesus, calling them together, said: Suffer children to come to me and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God. ¹⁷ Amen, I say to you: Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a child shall not enter into it. ¹⁸ And a certain ruler asked him, saying: Good master, what shall I do to possess everlasting life? ¹⁹ And Jesus said to him: Why dost thou call me good? None is good but God alone. ²⁰ Thou knowest the commandments: Thou shalt not kill. Thou shalt not commit adultery: Thou shalt not steal: Thou shalt not bear false witness: Honour thy father and mother. ²¹ Who said: All these things have I kept from my youth. ²² Which when Jesus had heard, he said to him: Yet one thing is wanting to thee. Sell all whatever thou hast and give to the poor: and thou shalt have treasure in heaven. And come, follow me. ²³ He having heard these things, became sorrowful: for he was very rich. ²⁴ And Jesus seeing him become sorrowful, said: How hardly shall they that have riches enter into the kingdom of God! ²⁵ For it is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God. ²⁶ And they that heard it said: Who then can be saved? ²⁷ He said to them: The things that are impossible with men are possible with God. ²⁸ Then Peter said: Behold, we have left all things and have followed

thee. ²⁹ Who said to them: Amen, I say to you, there is no man that hath left home or parents or brethren or wife or children, for the kingdom of God's sake, ³⁰ Who shall not receive much more in this present time, and in the world to come life everlasting.

³¹ Then Jesus took unto him the twelve and said to them: Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and all things shall be accomplished which were written by the prophets concerning the Son of man. ³² For he shall be delivered to the Gentiles and shall be mocked and scourged and spit upon. ³³ And after they have scourged him, they will put him to death. And the third day he shall rise again. ³⁴ And they understood none of these things, and this word was hid from them: and they understood not the things that were said.

³⁵ Now it came to pass, when he drew nigh to Jericho, that a certain blind man sat by the way side, begging. ³⁶ And when he heard the multitude passing by, he asked what this meant. ³⁷ And they told him that Jesus of Nazareth was passing by. ³⁸ And he cried out, saying: Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me. ³⁹ And they that went before rebuked him, that he should hold his peace: but he cried out much more: Son of David, have mercy on me. ⁴⁰ And Jesus standing, commanded him to be brought unto him. And when he was come near, he asked him, ⁴¹ Saying: What wilt thou that I do to thee? But he said: Lord, that I may see. ⁴² And Jesus said to him: Receive thy sight: thy faith hath made thee whole. ⁴³ And immediately he saw and followed him, glorifying God. And all the people, when they saw it, gave praise to God.

314. The parables of the kingdom

Matthew 13:1-58

13 ¹ The same day Jesus going out of the house, sat by the sea side. ² And great multitudes were gathered together unto him, so that he went up into a boat and sat: and all the multitude stood on the shore. ³ And he spoke to them many things in parables, saying: Behold the sower went forth to sow. ⁴ And whilst he soweth some fell by the way side, and the birds of the air came and ate them up. ⁵ And other some fell upon stony ground, where they had not much earth: and they sprung up immediately, because they had no deepness of earth. ⁶ And when the sun was up they were scorched: and because they had not root, they withered away. ⁷ And others fell among thorns: and the thorns grew up and choked them. ⁸ And others fell upon good ground: and they brought forth fruit, some an hundred fold, some sixty fold, and some thirty fold. ⁹ He that hath ears to hear, let him hear. ¹⁰ And his disciples came and said to him: Why speakest thou to them in parables? ¹¹ Who answered and said to them: Because to you it is given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven: but to them it is not given. ¹² For he that hath, to him shall be given, and he shall abound: but he that hath not, from him shall be taken away that also which he hath. ¹³ Therefore do I speak to them in parables: because seeing they see not, and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand. ¹⁴ And the prophecy of Isaias is fulfilled in them, who saith: By hearing you shall hear, and shall not understand: and seeing you shall see, and shall not perceive. ¹⁵ For the heart of this people is grown gross, and with their ears they have been dull of hearing, and their eyes they have shut: lest at any time they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and understand with their heart, and be converted, and I should heal them. ¹⁶ But

blessed are your eyes, because they see, and your ears, because they hear. ¹⁷ For, amen, I say to you, many prophets and just men have desired to see the things that you see, and have not seen them: and to hear the things that you hear and have not heard them.

¹⁸ Hear you therefore the parable of the sower. ¹⁹ When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, there cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart: this is he that received the seed by the way side. ²⁰ And he that received the seed upon stony ground, is he that heareth the word, and immediately receiveth it with joy. ²¹ Yet hath he not root in himself, but is only for a time: and when there ariseth tribulation and persecution because of the word, he is presently scandalized. ²² And he that received the seed among thorns, is he that heareth the word, and the care of this world and the deceitfulness of riches choketh up the word, and he becometh fruitless. ²³ But he that received the seed upon good ground, is he that heareth the word, and understandeth, and beareth fruit, and yieldeth the one an hundredfold, and another sixty, and another thirty.

²⁴ Another parable he proposed to them, saying: The kingdom of heaven is likened to a man that sowed good seed in his field. ²⁵ But while men were asleep, his enemy came and oversowed cockle among the wheat and went his way. ²⁶ And when the blade was sprung up, and had brought forth fruit, then appeared also the cockle. ²⁷ And the servants of the good man of the house coming said to him. Sir, didst thou not sow good seed in thy field? Whence then hath it cockle? ²⁸ And he said to them: An enemy hath done this. And the servants said to him: Wilt thou that we go and gather it up? ²⁹ And he said: No, lest perhaps gathering up the cockle, you root up the wheat also together with it. ³⁰ Suffer both to grow until the harvest, and in the time of the harvest I will say to the reapers: Gather up first the cockle, and bind it into bundles to burn, but the wheat gather ye into my barn.

³¹ Another parable he proposed unto them, saying: The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took and sowed in his field. ³² Which is the least indeed of all seeds; but when it is grown up, it is greater than all herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come, and dwell in the branches thereof.

³³ Another parable he spoke to them: The kingdom of heaven is like to leaven, which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, until the whole was leavened. ³⁴ All these things Jesus spoke in parables to the multitudes: and without parables he did not speak to them. ³⁵ That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying: I will open my mouth in parables, I will utter things hidden from the foundation of the world. ³⁶ Then having sent away the multitudes, he came into the house, and his disciples came to him, saying: Expound to us the parable of the cockle of the field. ³⁷ Who made answer and said to them: He that soweth the good seed is the Son of man. ³⁸ And the field is the world. And the good seed are the children of the kingdom. And the cockle are the children of the wicked one. ³⁹ And the enemy that sowed them, is the devil. But the harvest is the end of the world. And the reapers are the angels. ⁴⁰ Even as cockle therefore is gathered up, and burnt with fire: so shall it be at

the end of the world. ⁴¹ The Son of man shall send his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all scandals, and them that work iniquity. ⁴² And shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth. ⁴³ Then shall the just shine as the sun, in the kingdom of their Father. He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

⁴⁴ The kingdom of heaven is like unto a treasure hidden in a field. Which a man having found, hid it, and for joy thereof goeth, and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.

⁴⁵ Again the kingdom of heaven is like to a merchant seeking good pearls. ⁴⁶ Who when he had found one pearl of great price, went his way, and sold all that he had, and bought it.

⁴⁷ Again the kingdom of heaven is like to a net cast into the sea, and gathering together of all kinds of fishes. ⁴⁸ Which, when it was filled, they drew out, and sitting by the shore, they chose out the good into vessels, but the bad they cast forth. ⁴⁹ So shall it be at the end of the world. The angels shall go out, and shall separate the wicked from among the just. ⁵⁰ And shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth. ⁵¹ Have ye understood all these things? They say to him: Yes. ⁵² He said unto them: Therefore every scribe instructed in the kingdom of heaven, is like to a man that is a householder, who bringeth forth out of his treasure new things and old.

⁵³ And it came to pass: when Jesus had finished these parables, he passed from thence. ⁵⁴ And coming into his own country, he taught them in their synagogues, so that they wondered and said: How came this man by this wisdom and miracles? ⁵⁵ Is not this the carpenter's son? Is not his mother called Mary, and his brethren James, and Joseph, and Simon, and Jude: ⁵⁶ And his sisters, are they not all with us? Whence therefore hath he all these things? ⁵⁷ And they were scandalized in his regard. But Jesus said to them: A prophet is not without honour, save in his own country, and in his own house. ⁵⁸ And he wrought not many miracles there, because of their unbelief.

315. *The church, and forgiveness without number*

Matthew 18:1-35

18 ¹ At that hour the disciples came to Jesus, saying: Who, thinkest thou, is the greater in the kingdom of heaven? ² And Jesus, calling unto him a little child, set him in the midst of them. ³ And said: amen I say to you, unless you be converted, and become as little children, you shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven. ⁴ Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, he is the greater in the kingdom of heaven. ⁵ And he that shall receive one such little child in my name, receiveth me. ⁶ But he that shall scandalize one of these little ones that believe in me, it were better for him that a millstone should be hanged about his neck, and that he should be drowned in the depth of the sea.

⁷ Woe to the world because of scandals. For it must needs be that scandals come: but nevertheless woe to that man by whom the scandal cometh. ⁸ And if thy hand, or thy foot, scandalize thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee. It is better for thee to go into life maimed or lame, than having two hands or two feet, to be cast into everlasting fire. ⁹ And if thy eye scandalize thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee. It is better for thee having one eye to enter into life, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire. ¹⁰ See that you despise not one of these little ones: for I say to you, that their angels in heaven always see the face

of my Father who is in heaven. ¹¹ For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost. ¹² What think you? If a man have an hundred sheep, and one of them should go astray: doth he not leave the ninety-nine in the mountains, and go to seek that which is gone astray? ¹³ And if it so be that he find it: Amen I say to you, he rejoiceth more for that, than for the ninety-nine that went not astray. ¹⁴ Even so it is not the will of your Father, who is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.

¹⁵ But if thy brother shall offend against thee, go, and rebuke him between thee and him alone. If he shall hear thee, thou shalt gain thy brother. ¹⁶ And if he will not hear thee, take with thee one or two more: that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may stand. ¹⁷ And if he will not hear them: tell the church. And if he will not hear the church, let him be to thee as the heathen and publican. ¹⁸ Amen I say to you, whatsoever you shall bind upon earth, shall be bound also in heaven: and whatsoever you shall loose upon earth, shall be loosed also in heaven. ¹⁹ Again I say to you, that if two of you shall consent upon earth, concerning anything whatsoever they shall ask, it shall be done to them by my Father who is in heaven. ²⁰ For where there are two or three gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.

²¹ Then came Peter unto him and said: Lord, how often shall my brother offend against me, and I forgive him? till seven times? ²² Jesus saith to him: I say not to thee, till seven times; but till seventy times seven times. ²³ Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened to a king, who would take an account of his servants. ²⁴ And when he had begun to take the account, one was brought to him, that owed him ten thousand talents. ²⁵ And as he had not wherewith to pay it, his lord commanded that he should be sold, and his wife and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made. ²⁶ But that servant falling down, besought him, saying: Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all. ²⁷ And the lord of that servant being moved with pity, let him go and forgave him the debt. ²⁸ But when that servant was gone out, he found one of his fellow-servants that owed him an hundred pence: and laying hold of him, he throttled him, saying: Pay what thou owest. ²⁹ And his fellow-servant falling down, besought him, saying: Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all. ³⁰ And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he paid the debt. ³¹ Now his fellow servants seeing what was done, were very much grieved, and they came, and told their lord all that was done. ³² Then his lord called him: and said to him: Thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all the debt, because thou besoughtest me: ³³ Shouldst not thou then have had compassion also on thy fellow servant, even as I had compassion on thee? ³⁴ And his lord being angry, delivered him to the torturers until he paid all the debt. ³⁵ So also shall my heavenly Father do to you, if you forgive not every one his brother from your hearts.

316. "I am the light of the world"; the man born blind

John 8:12-9:41

8 ¹² Again therefore, Jesus spoke to: them, saying: I am the light of the world. He that followeth me walketh not in darkness, but shall have the light of life. ¹³ The Pharisees therefore said to him: Thou givest testimony of thyself. Thy testimony is not true. ¹⁴ Jesus answered and said to them: Although I give testimony of myself, my testimony is true: for I know whence I

came, and whither I go: but you know not whence I come, or whither I go. ¹⁵ You judge according to the flesh: I judge not any man. ¹⁶ And if I do judge, my judgment is true: because I am not alone, but I and the Father that sent me. ¹⁷ And in your law it is written that the testimony of two men is true. ¹⁸ I am one that give testimony of myself: and the Father that sent me giveth testimony of me. ¹⁹ They said therefore to him: Where is thy Father? Jesus answered: Neither me do you know, nor my Father. If you did know me, perhaps you would know my Father also. ²⁰ These words Jesus spoke in the treasury, teaching in the temple: and no man laid hands on him, because his hour was not yet come. ²¹ Again therefore Jesus said to them: I go: and you shall seek me. And you shall die in your sin. Whither I go, you cannot come. ²² The Jews therefore said: Will he kill himself, because he said: Whither I go you cannot come? ²³ And he said to them: You are from beneath: I am from above. You are of this world: I am not of this world. ²⁴ Therefore I said to you that you shall die in your sins. For if you believe not that I am he, you shall die in your sin. ²⁵ They said therefore to him: Who art thou? Jesus said to them: The beginning, who also speak unto you. ²⁶ Many things I have to speak and to judge of you. But he that sent me, is true: and the things I have heard of him, these same I speak in the world. ²⁷ And they understood not that he called God his Father. ²⁸ Jesus therefore said to them: When you shall have lifted up, the Son of man, then shall you know that I am he and that I do nothing of myself. But as the Father hath taught me, these things I speak. ²⁹ And he that sent me is with me: and he hath not left me alone. For I do always the things that please him. ³⁰ When he spoke these things, many believed in him. ³¹ Then Jesus said to those Jews who believed him: If you continue in my word, you shall be my disciples indeed. ³² And you shall know the truth: and the truth shall make you free.

³³ They answered him: We are the seed of Abraham: and we have never been slaves to any man. How sayest thou: You shall be free? ³⁴ Jesus answered them: Amen, amen, I say unto you that whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin. ³⁵ Now the servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the son abideth for ever. ³⁶ If therefore the son shall make you free, you shall be free indeed. ³⁷ I know that you are the children of Abraham: but you seek to kill me, because my word hath no place in you. ³⁸ I speak that which I have seen with my Father: and you do the things that you have seen with your father. ³⁹ They answered and said to him: Abraham is our father. Jesus saith to them: If you be the children of Abraham, do the works of Abraham. ⁴⁰ But now you seek to kill me, a man who have spoken the truth to you, which I have heard of God. This Abraham did not. ⁴¹ You do the works of your father. They said therefore to him: We are not born of fornication: we have one Father, even God. ⁴² Jesus therefore said to them: If God were your Father, you would indeed love me. For from God I proceeded and came. For I came not of myself: but he sent me. ⁴³ Why do you not know my speech? Because you cannot hear my word. ⁴⁴ You are of your father the devil: and the desires of your father you will do. He was a murderer from the beginning: and he stood not in the truth, because truth is not in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father thereof. ⁴⁵ But if I say the truth, you believe me not. ⁴⁶ Which of you shall convince me of sin? If

I say the truth to you, why do you not believe me: ⁴⁷ He that is of God heareth the words of God. Therefore you hear them not, because you are not of God. ⁴⁸ The Jews therefore answered and said to him: Do not we say well that thou art a Samaritan and hast a devil? ⁴⁹ Jesus answered: I have not a devil: but I honour my Father. And you have dishonoured me. ⁵⁰ But I seek not my own glory: there is one that seeketh and judgeth. ⁵¹ Amen, amen, I say to you: If any man keep my word, he shall not see death for ever. ⁵² The Jews therefore said: Now we know that thou hast a devil. Abraham is dead, and the prophets: and thou sayest: If any man keep my word, he shall not taste death for ever. ⁵³ Art thou greater than our father Abraham who is dead? And the prophets are dead. Whom dost thou make thyself? ⁵⁴ Jesus answered: If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father that glorifieth me, of whom you say that he is your God. ⁵⁵ And you have not known him: but I know him. And if I shall say that I know him not, I shall be like to you, a liar. But I do know him and do keep his word. ⁵⁶ Abraham your father rejoiced that he might see my day: he saw it and was glad. ⁵⁷ The Jews therefore said to him: Thou art not yet fifty years old. And hast thou seen Abraham? ⁵⁸ Jesus said to them: Amen, amen, I say to you, before Abraham was made, I AM. ⁵⁹ They took up stones therefore to cast at him. But Jesus hid himself and went out of the temple.

9 ¹ And Jesus passing by, saw a man who was blind from his birth. ² And his disciples asked him: Rabbi, who hath sinned, this man or his parents, that he should be born blind? ³ Jesus answered: Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents; but that the works of God should be made manifest in him. ⁴ I must work the works of him that sent me, whilst it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work. ⁵ As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world. ⁶ When he had said these things, he spat on the ground and made clay of the spittle and spread the clay upon his eyes, ⁷ And said to him: Go, wash in the pool of Siloe, which is interpreted, Sent. He went therefore and washed: and he came seeing.

⁸ The neighbours, therefore, and they who had seen him before that he was a beggar, said: Is not this he that sat and begged? Some said: This is he. ⁹ But others said: No, but he is like him. But he said: I am he. ¹⁰ They said therefore to him: How were thy eyes opened? ¹¹ He answered: That man that is called Jesus made clay and anointed my eyes and said to me: Go to the pool of Siloe and wash. And I went: I washed: and I see. ¹² And they said to him: Where is he? He saith: I know not.

¹³ They bring him that had been blind to the Pharisees. ¹⁴ Now it was the sabbath, when Jesus made the clay and opened his eyes. ¹⁵ Again therefore the Pharisees asked him how he had received his sight. But he said to them: He put clay upon my eyes: and I washed: and I see. ¹⁶ Some therefore of the Pharisees said: This man is not of God, who keepeth not the sabbath. But others said: How can a man that is a sinner do such miracles? And there was a division among them. ¹⁷ They say therefore to the blind man again: What sayest thou of him that hath opened thy eyes? And he said: He is a prophet. ¹⁸ The Jews then did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind and had received his sight, until they called the parents of him that had received his sight, ¹⁹ And asked them, saying: Is this your son, who you say was born blind? How then doth he now see? ²⁰ His parents

answered them and said: We know that this is our son and that he was born blind: ²¹ But how he now seeth, we know not: or who hath opened his eyes, we know not. Ask himself: he is of age: Let him speak for himself. ²² These things his parents said, because they feared the Jews: for the Jews had already agreed among themselves that if any man should confess him to be Christ, he should be put out of the synagogue. ²³ Therefore did his parents say: He is of age. Ask himself. ²⁴ They therefore called the man again that had been blind and said to him: Give glory to God. We know that this man is a sinner. ²⁵ He said therefore to them: If he be a sinner, I know not. One thing I know, that whereas I was blind, now I see. ²⁶ They said then to him: What did he to thee? How did he open thy eyes? ²⁷ He answered them: I have told you already, and you have heard. Why would you hear it again? Will you also become his disciples? ²⁸ They reviled him therefore and said: Be thou his disciple; but we are the disciples of Moses. ²⁹ We know that God spoke to Moses: but as to this man, we know not from whence he is. ³⁰ The man answered and said to them: why, herein is a wonderful thing, that you know not from whence he is, and he hath opened my eyes. ³¹ Now we know that God doth not hear sinners: but if a man be a server of God and doth his will, him he heareth. ³² From the beginning of the world it hath not been heard, that any man hath opened the eyes of one born blind. ³³ Unless this man were of God, he could not do anything. ³⁴ They answered and said to him: Thou wast wholly born in sins; and dost thou teach us? And they cast him out. ³⁵ Jesus heard that they had cast him out. And when he had found him, he said to him: Dost thou believe in the Son of God? ³⁶ He answered, and said: Who is he, Lord, that I may believe in him? ³⁷ And Jesus said to him: Thou hast both seen him; and it is he that talketh with thee. ³⁸ And he said: I believe, Lord. And falling down, he adored him.

³⁹ And Jesus said: For judgment I am come into this world: that they who see not may see; and they who see may become blind. ⁴⁰ And some of the Pharisees, who were with him, heard: and they said unto him: Are we also blind? ⁴¹ Jesus said to them: If you were blind, you should not have sin: but now you say: We see. Your sin remaineth.

317. The good shepherd

John 10:1-42

Answers Ezekiel 34, read in the Exile.

10 ¹ Amen, amen, I say to you: He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold but climbeth up another way, the same is a thief and a robber. ² But he that entereth in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep. ³ To him the porter openeth: and the sheep hear his voice. And he calleth his own sheep by name and leadeth them out. ⁴ And when he hath let out his own sheep, he goeth before them: and the sheep follow him, because they know his voice. ⁵ But a stranger they follow not, but fly from him, because they know not the voice of strangers. ⁶ This proverb Jesus spoke to them. But they understood not what he spoke to them. ⁷ Jesus therefore said to them again: Amen, amen, I say to you, I am the door of the sheep. ⁸ All others, as many as have come, are thieves and robbers: and the sheep heard them not. ⁹ I am the door. By me, if any man enter in, he shall be saved: and he shall go in and go out, and shall find pastures. ¹⁰ The thief

cometh not, but for to steal and to kill and to destroy. I am come that they may have life and may have it more abundantly. ¹¹ I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd giveth his life for his sheep. ¹² But the hireling and he that is not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming and leaveth the sheep and flieth: and the wolf catcheth and scattereth the sheep. ¹³ And the hireling flieth, because he is a hireling: and he hath no care for the sheep. ¹⁴ I am the good shepherd: and I know mine, and mine know me. ¹⁵ As the Father knoweth me, and I know the Father: and I lay down my life for my sheep. ¹⁶ And other sheep I have that are not of this fold: them also I must bring. And they shall hear my voice: And there shall be one fold and one shepherd. ¹⁷ Therefore doth the Father love me: because I lay down my life, that I may take it again. ¹⁸ No man taketh it away from me: but I lay it down of myself. And I have power to lay it down: and I have power to take it up again. This commandment have I received of my Father.

¹⁹ A dissension rose again among the Jews for these words. ²⁰ And many of them said: He hath a devil and is mad. Why hear you him? ²¹ Others said: These are not the words of one that hath a devil. Can a devil open the eyes of the blind?

²² And it was the feast of the dedication at Jerusalem: and it was winter. ²³ And Jesus walked in the temple, in Solomon's porch. ²⁴ The Jews therefore came round about him and said to him: How long dost thou hold our souls in suspense? If thou be the Christ, tell us plainly. ²⁵ Jesus answered them: I speak to you, and you believe not: the works that I do in the name of my Father, they give testimony of me. ²⁶ But you do not believe, because you are not of my sheep. ²⁷ My sheep hear my voice. And I know them: and they follow me. ²⁸ And I give them life everlasting: and they shall not perish for ever. And no man shall pluck them out of my hand. ²⁹ That which my Father hath given me is greater than all: and no one can snatch them out of the hand of my Father. ³⁰ I and the Father are one. ³¹ The Jews then took up stones to stone him. ³² Jesus answered them: Many good works I have shewed you from my Father. For which of those works do you stone me? ³³ The Jews answered him: For a good work we stone thee not, but for blasphemy: and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God. ³⁴ Jesus answered them: Is it not written in your law: I said, you are gods? ³⁵ If he called them gods to whom the word of God was spoken; and the scripture cannot be broken: ³⁶ Do you say of him whom the Father hath sanctified and sent into the world: Thou blasphemest; because I said: I am the Son of God? ³⁷ If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not. ³⁸ But if I do, though you will not believe me, believe the works: that you may know and believe that the Father is in me and I in the Father. ³⁹ They sought therefore to take him: and he escaped out of their hands. ⁴⁰ And he went again beyond the Jordan, into that place where John was baptizing first. And there he abode. ⁴¹ And many resorted to him: and they said: John indeed did no sign. ⁴² But all things whatsoever John said of this man were true. And many believed in him.

318. *Lazarus*

John 11:1-56

11 ¹ Now there was a certain man sick, named Lazarus, of Bethania, of the town of Mary and of Martha her sister. ² (And Mary was she that anointed the Lord with ointment and wiped his

feet with her hair: whose brother Lazarus was sick.) ³ His sisters therefore sent to him, saying: Lord, behold, he whom thou lovest is sick. ⁴ And Jesus hearing it, said to them: This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God: that the Son of God may be glorified by it. ⁵ Now Jesus loved Martha and her sister Mary and Lazarus. ⁶ When he had heard therefore that he was sick, he still remained in the same place two days. ⁷ Then after that, he said to his disciples: Let us go into Judea again. ⁸ The disciples say to him: Rabbi, the Jews but now sought to stone thee. And goest thou thither again? ⁹ Jesus answered: Are there not twelve hours of the day? If a man walk in the day he stumbleth not, because he seeth the light of this world: ¹⁰ But if he walk in the night, he stumbleth, because the light is not in him. ¹¹ These things he said; and after that he said to them: Lazarus our friend sleepeth: but I go that I may awake him out of sleep. ¹² His disciples therefore said: Lord, if he sleep, he shall do well. ¹³ But Jesus spoke of his death: and they thought that he spoke of the repose of sleep. ¹⁴ Then therefore Jesus said to them plainly: Lazarus is dead. ¹⁵ And I am glad, for your sakes; that I was not there, that you may believe. But, let us go to him. ¹⁶ Thomas therefore, who is called Didymus, said to his fellow disciples: Let us also go, that we may die with him. ¹⁷ Jesus therefore came: and found that he had been four days already in the grave. ¹⁸ (Now Bethania was near Jerusalem, about fifteen furlongs off.) ¹⁹ And many of the Jews were come to Martha and Mary, to comfort them concerning their brother. ²⁰ Martha therefore, as soon as she heard that Jesus was come, went to meet him: but Mary sat at home. ²¹ Martha therefore said to Jesus: Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died. ²² But now also I know that whatsoever thou wilt ask of God, God will give it thee. ²³ Jesus saith to her: Thy brother shall rise again. ²⁴ Martha saith to him: I know that he shall rise again, in the resurrection at the last day. ²⁵ Jesus said to her: I am the resurrection and the life: he that believeth in me, although he be dead, shall live: ²⁶ And every one that liveth and believeth in me shall not die for ever. Believest thou this? ²⁷ She saith to him: Yea, Lord, I have believed that thou art Christ, the Son of the living God, who art come into this world. ²⁸ And when she had said these things, she went and called her sister Mary secretly, saying: The master is come and calleth for thee. ²⁹ She, as soon as she heard this, riseth quickly and cometh to him. ³⁰ For Jesus was not yet come into the town: but he was still in that place where Martha had met him. ³¹ The Jews therefore, who were with her in the house and comforted her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up speedily and went out, followed her, saying: She goeth to the grave to weep there. ³² When Mary therefore was come where Jesus was, seeing him, she fell down at his feet and saith to him. Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died. ³³ Jesus, therefore, when he saw her weeping, and the Jews that were come with her weeping, groaned in the spirit and troubled himself, ³⁴ And said: Where have you laid him? They say to him: Lord, come and see. ³⁵ And Jesus wept. ³⁶ The Jews therefore said: Behold how he loved him. ³⁷ But some of them said: Could not he that opened the eyes of the man born blind have caused that this man should not die? ³⁸ Jesus therefore again groaning in himself, cometh to the sepulchre. Now it was a cave; and a stone was laid over it. ³⁹ Jesus saith: Take away the stone. Martha, the sister of him

that was dead, saith to him: Lord, by this time he stinketh, for he is now of four days. ⁴⁰ Jesus saith to her: Did not I say to thee that if thou believe, thou shalt see the glory of God? ⁴¹ They took therefore the stone away. And Jesus lifting up his eyes, said: Father, I give thee thanks that thou hast heard me. ⁴² And I knew that thou hearest me always: but because of the people who stand about have I said it, that they may believe that thou hast sent me. ⁴³ When he had said these things, he cried with a loud voice: Lazarus, come forth. ⁴⁴ And presently he that had been dead came forth, bound feet and hands with winding bands. And his face was bound about with a napkin. Jesus said to them: Loose him and let him go. ⁴⁵ Many therefore of the Jews, who were come to Mary and Martha and had seen the things that Jesus did, believed in him. ⁴⁶ But some of them went to the Pharisees and told them the things that Jesus had done. ⁴⁷ The chief priests, therefore, and the Pharisees gathered a council and said: What do we, for this man doth many miracles? ⁴⁸ If we let him alone so, all will believe in him; and the Romans will come, and take away our place and nation. ⁴⁹ But one of them, named Caiphas, being the high priest that year, said to them: You know nothing. ⁵⁰ Neither do you consider that it is expedient for you that one man should die for the people and that the whole nation perish not. ⁵¹ And this he spoke not of himself: but being the high priest of that year, he prophesied that Jesus should die for the nation. ⁵² And not only for the nation, but to gather together in one the children of God that were dispersed. ⁵³ From that day therefore they devised to put him to death. ⁵⁴ Wherefore Jesus walked no more openly among the Jews: but he went into a country near the desert, unto a city that is called Ephrem. And there he abode with his disciples.

⁵⁵ And the pasch of the Jews was at hand: and many from the country went up to Jerusalem, before the pasch, to purify themselves. ⁵⁶ They sought therefore for Jesus; and they discoursed one with another, standing in the temple: What think you that he is not come to the festival day? And the chief priests and Pharisees had given a commandment that, if any man knew where he was, he should tell, that they might apprehend him.

319. Zacheus, and the entry into Jerusalem

Luke 19:1-48

19 ¹ And entering he walked through Jericho. ² And behold, there was a man named Zacheus, who was the chief of the publicans: and he was rich. ³ And he sought to see Jesus who he was: and he could not for the crowd, because he was low of stature. ⁴ And running before, he climbed up into a sycamore tree, that he might see him: for he was to pass that way. ⁵ And when Jesus was come to the place, looking up, he saw him and said to him: Zacheus, make haste and come down: for this day I must abide in thy house. ⁶ And he made haste and came down and received him with joy. ⁷ And when all saw it, they murmured, saying, that he was gone to be a guest with a man that was a sinner. ⁸ But Zacheus standing, said to the Lord: Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have wronged any man of any thing, I restore him fourfold. ⁹ Jesus said to him: This day is salvation come to this house, because he also is a son of Abraham. ¹⁰ For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost. ¹¹ As they were hearing these things, he added and spoke a parable, because he was nigh to Jerusalem

and because they thought that the kingdom of God should immediately be manifested. ¹² He said therefore: a certain nobleman went into a far country, to receive for himself a kingdom and to return. ¹³ And calling his ten servants, he gave them ten pounds and said to them: Trade till I come. ¹⁴ But his citizens hated him and they sent an embassy after him, saying: We will not have this man to reign over us. ¹⁵ And it came to pass that he returned, having received the kingdom: and he commanded his servants to be called, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading, ¹⁶ And the first came saying: Lord, thy pound hath gained ten pounds. ¹⁷ And he said to him: Well done, thou good servant, because thou hast been faithful in a little, thou shalt have power over ten cities. ¹⁸ And the second came, saying: Lord, thy pound hath gained five pounds. ¹⁹ And he said to him: Be thou also over five cities. ²⁰ And another came, saying: Lord, behold here is thy pound, which I have kept laid up in a napkin. ²¹ For I feared thee, because thou art an austere man: thou takest up what thou didst not lay down: and thou reapest that which thou didst not sow. ²² He saith to him: Out of thy own mouth I judge thee, thou wicked servant. Thou knewest that I was an austere man, taking up what I laid not down and reaping that which I did not sow. ²³ And why then didst thou not give my money into the bank, that at my coming I might have exacted it with usury? ²⁴ And he said to them that stood by: Take the pound away from him and give it to him that hath ten pounds. ²⁵ And they said to him: Lord, he hath ten pounds. ²⁶ But I say to you that to every one that hath shall be given, and he shall abound: and from him that hath not, even that which he hath shall be taken from him. ²⁷ But as for those my enemies, who would not have me reign over them, bring them hither and kill them before me. ²⁸ And having said these things, he went before, going up to Jerusalem. ²⁹ And it came to pass, when he was come nigh to Bethphage and Bethania, unto the mount called Olivet, he sent two of his disciples, ³⁰ Saying: Go into the town which is over against you, at your entering into which you shall find the colt of an ass tied, on which no man ever hath sitten: loose him and bring him hither. ³¹ And if any man shall ask you: Why do you loose him? You shall say thus unto him: Because the Lord hath need of his service. ³² And they that were sent went their way and found the colt standing, as he had said unto them. ³³ And as they were loosing the colt, the owners thereof said to them: Why loose you the colt? ³⁴ But they said: Because the Lord hath need of him. ³⁵ And they brought him to Jesus. And casting their garments on the colt, they set Jesus thereon. ³⁶ And as he went, they spread their clothes underneath in the way. ³⁷ And when he was now coming near the descent of Mount Olivet, the whole multitude of his disciples began with joy to praise God with a loud voice, for all the mighty works they had seen, ³⁸ Saying: Blessed be the king who cometh in the name of the Lord! Peace in heaven and glory on high! ³⁹ And some of the Pharisees, from amongst the multitude, said to him: Master, rebuke thy disciples. ⁴⁰ To whom he said: I say to you that if these shall hold their peace, the stones will cry out.

⁴¹ And when he drew near, seeing the city, he wept over it, saying: ⁴² If thou also hadst known, and that in this thy day, the things that are to thy peace: but now they are hidden from thy

eyes.⁴³ For the days shall come upon thee: and thy enemies shall cast a trench about thee and compass thee round and straiten thee on every side,⁴⁴ And beat thee flat to the ground, and thy children who are in thee. And they shall not leave in thee a stone upon a stone: because thou hast not known the time of thy visitation.⁴⁵ And entering into the temple, he began to cast out them that sold therein and them that bought.⁴⁶ Saying to them: It is written: My house is the house of prayer. But you have made it a den of thieves.⁴⁷ And he was teaching daily in the temple. And the chief priests and the scribes and the rulers of the people sought to destroy him.⁴⁸ And they found not what to do to him: for all the people were very attentive to hear him.

320. The temple disputes, and the discourse on the end

Luke 20:1-21:38

20¹ And it came to pass that on one of the days, as he was teaching the people in the temple and preaching the gospel, the chief priests and the scribes, with the ancients, met together,² And spoke to him, saying: Tell us, by what authority dost thou these things? Or, who is he that hath given thee this authority?³ And Jesus answering, said to them: I will also ask you one thing. Answer me: ⁴ The baptism of John, was it from heaven, or of men? ⁵ But they thought within themselves, saying: If we shall say, From heaven: he will say: Why then did you not believe in him? ⁶ But if we say, of men: the whole people will stone us. For they are persuaded that John was a prophet. ⁷ And they answered that they knew not whence it was. ⁸ And Jesus said to them: Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.⁹ And he began to speak to the people this parable: A certain man planted a vineyard and let it out to husbandmen: and he was abroad for a long time. ¹⁰ And at the season he sent a servant to the husbandmen, that they should give him of the fruit of the vineyard. Who, beating him, sent him away empty. ¹¹ And again he sent another servant. But they beat him also and, treating him reproachfully, sent him away empty. ¹² And again he sent the third: and they wounded him also and cast him out. ¹³ Then the lord of the vineyard said: What shall I do? I will send my beloved son. It may be, when they see him, they will reverence him. ¹⁴ Whom, when the husbandmen saw, they thought within themselves, saying: This is the heir. Let us kill him, that the inheritance may be ours. ¹⁵ So casting him out of the vineyard, they killed him. What therefore will the lord of the vineyard do to them? ¹⁶ He will come and will destroy these husbandmen and will give the vineyard to others. Which they hearing, said to him: God forbid. ¹⁷ But he looking on them, said: What is this then that is written, The stone, which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner? ¹⁸ Whosoever shall fall upon that stone shall be bruised: and upon whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.

¹⁹ And the chief priests and the scribes sought to lay hands on him the same hour: but they feared the people, for they knew that he spoke this parable to them. ²⁰ And being upon the watch, they sent spies, who should feign themselves just, that they might take hold of him in his words, that they might deliver him up to the authority and power of the governor. ²¹ And they asked him, saying: Master, we know that thou speakest and teachest rightly: and thou dost not respect any person, but teachest the way of God in truth. ²² Is it lawful for us to give tribute to Caesar, or

no? ²³ But he, considering their guile, said to them: Why tempt you me? ²⁴ Shew me a penny. Whose image and inscription hath it? They answering, said to him: Caesar's. ²⁵ And he said to them: Render therefore to Caesar the things, that are Caesar's: and to God the things that are God's. ²⁶ And they could not reprehend his word before the people: and wondering at his answer, they held their peace. ²⁷ And there came to him some of the Sadducees, who deny that there is any resurrection: and they asked him, ²⁸ Saying: Master, Moses wrote unto us: If any man's brother die, having a wife, and he leave no children, that his brother should take her to wife and raise up seed unto his brother. ²⁹ There were therefore seven brethren: and the first took a wife and died without children. ³⁰ And the next took her to wife: and he also died childless. ³¹ And the third took her. And in like manner, all the seven: and they left no children and died. ³² Last of all the woman died also. ³³ In the resurrection therefore, whose wife of them shall she be? For all the seven had her to wife. ³⁴ And Jesus said to them: The children of this world marry and are given in marriage: ³⁵ But they that shall be accounted worthy of that world and of the resurrection from the dead shall neither be married nor take wives. ³⁶ Neither can they die any more for they are equal to the angels and are the children of God, being the children of the resurrection. ³⁷ Now that the dead rise again, Moses also shewed at the bush, when he called the Lord: The God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob. ³⁸ For he is not the God of the dead, but of the living: for all live to him.

³⁹ And some of the scribes answering, said to him: Master, thou hast said well. ⁴⁰ And after that they durst not ask him any more questions. ⁴¹ But he said to them: How say they that Christ is the son of David? ⁴² And David himself saith in the book of Psalms: The Lord said to my Lord, sit thou on my right hand, ⁴³ Till I make thy enemies thy footstool. ⁴⁴ David then calleth him Lord. And how is he his son?

⁴⁵ And in the hearing of all the people, he said to his disciples: ⁴⁶ Beware of the scribes, who desire to walk in long robes and love salutations in the market place and the first chairs in the synagogues and the chief rooms at feasts: ⁴⁷ Who devour the houses of widows, feigning long prayer. These shall receive greater damnation.

21¹ And looking on, he saw the rich men cast their gifts into the treasury. ² And he saw also a certain poor widow casting in two brass mites. ³ And he said: Verily, I say to you that this poor widow hath cast in more than they all. ⁴ For all these have of their abundance cast into the offerings of God: but she of her want hath cast in all the living that she had.

⁵ And some saying of the temple that it was adorned with goodly stones and gifts, he said: ⁶ These things which you see, the days will come in which there shall not be left a stone upon a stone that shall not be thrown down. ⁷ And they asked him, saying: Master, when shall these things be? And what shall be the sign when they shall begin to come to pass? ⁸ Who said: Take heed you be not seduced: for many will come in my name, saying: I am he and the time is at hand. Go ye not therefore after them. ⁹ And when you shall hear of wars and seditions, be not terrified. These things must first come to pass: but the end is not yet presently. ¹⁰ Then he said to them: Nation shall

rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. ¹¹ And there shall be great earthquakes in divers places and pestilences and famines and terrors from heaven: and there shall be great signs. ¹² But before all these things, they will lay their hands on you and persecute you, delivering you up to the synagogues and into prisons, dragging you before kings and governors, for my name's sake. ¹³ And it shall happen unto you for a testimony. ¹⁴ Lay it up therefore in your hearts, not to meditate before how you shall answer: ¹⁵ For I will give you a mouth and wisdom, which all your adversaries shall not be able to resist and gainsay. ¹⁶ And you shall be betrayed by your parents and brethren and kinsmen and friends: and some of you they will put to death. ¹⁷ And you shall be hated by all men for my name's sake. ¹⁸ But a hair of your head shall not perish. ¹⁹ In your patience you shall possess your souls. ²⁰ And when you shall see Jerusalem compassed about with an army, then know that the desolation thereof is at hand. ²¹ Then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains: and those who are in the midst thereof depart out: and those who are in the countries not enter into it. ²² For these are the days of vengeance, that all things may be fulfilled, that are written. ²³ But woe to them that are with child and give suck in those days: for there shall be great distress in the land and wrath upon this people. ²⁴ And they shall fall by the edge of the sword and shall be led away captives into all nations: and Jerusalem shall be trodden down by the Gentiles till the times of the nations be fulfilled.

²⁵ And there shall be signs in the sun and in the moon and in the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations, by reason of the confusion of the roaring of the sea, and of the waves: ²⁶ Men withering away for fear and expectation of what shall come upon the whole world. For the powers of heaven shall be moved. ²⁷ And then they shall see the Son of man coming in a cloud, with great power and majesty. ²⁸ But when these things begin to come to pass, look up and lift up your heads, because your redemption is at hand. ²⁹ And he spoke to them a similitude. See the fig tree and all the trees: ³⁰ When they now shoot forth their fruit, you know that summer is nigh; ³¹ So you also, when you shall see these things come to pass, know that the kingdom of God is at hand. ³² Amen, I say to you, this generation shall not pass away till all things be fulfilled. ³³ Heaven and earth shall pass away: but my words shall not pass away.

³⁴ And take heed to yourselves, lest perhaps your hearts be overcharged with surfeiting and drunkenness and the cares of this life: and that day come upon you suddenly. ³⁵ For as a snare shall it come upon all that sit upon the face of the whole earth. ³⁶ Watch ye, therefore, praying at all times, that you may be accounted worthy to escape all these things that are to come and to stand before the Son of man. ³⁷ And in the daytime, he was teaching in the temple: but at night going out, he abode in the mount that is called Olivet. ³⁸ And all the people came early in the morning to him in the temple, to hear him.

321. The last judgment

Matthew 25:1-46

25 ¹ Then shall the kingdom of heaven be like to ten virgins, who taking their lamps went out to meet the bridegroom and the bride. ² And five of them were foolish and five wise. ³ But the five foolish, having taken their lamps, did not take oil with

them. ⁴ But the wise took oil in their vessels with the lamps. ⁵ And the bridegroom tarrying, they all slumbered and slept. ⁶ And at midnight there was a cry made: Behold the bridegroom cometh. Go ye forth to meet him. ⁷ Then all those virgins arose and trimmed their lamps. ⁸ And the foolish said to the wise: Give us of your oil, for our lamps are gone out. ⁹ The wise answered, saying: Lest perhaps there be not enough for us and for you, go ye rather to them that sell and buy for yourselves. ¹⁰ Now whilst they went to buy the bridegroom came: and they that were ready went in with him to the marriage. And the door was shut. ¹¹ But at last came also the other virgins, saying: Lord, Lord, open to us. ¹² But he answering said: Amen I say to you, I know you not. ¹³ Watch ye therefore, because you know not the day nor the hour.

¹⁴ For even as a man going into a far country called his servants and delivered to them his goods; ¹⁵ And to one he gave five talents, and to another two, and to another one, to every one according to his proper ability: and immediately he took his journey. ¹⁶ And he that had received the five talents went his way and traded with the same and gained other five. ¹⁷ And in like manner he that had received the two gained other two. ¹⁸ But he that had received the one, going his way, digged into the earth and hid his lord's money. ¹⁹ But after a long time the lord of those servants came and reckoned with them. ²⁰ And he that had received the five talents coming, brought other five talents, saying: Lord, thou didst deliver to me five talents. Behold I have gained other five over and above. ²¹ His lord said to him: Well done, good and faithful servant, because thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will place thee over many things. Enter thou into the joy of thy lord. ²² And he also that had received the two talents came and said: Lord, thou deliveredst two talents to me. Behold I have gained other two. ²³ His lord said to him: Well done, good and faithful servant: because thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will place thee over many things. Enter thou into the joy of thy lord. ²⁴ But he that had received the one talent, came and said: Lord, I know that thou art a hard man; thou reapest where thou hast not sown and gatherest where thou hast not strewed. ²⁵ And being afraid, I went and hid thy talent in the earth. Behold here thou hast that which is thine. ²⁶ And his lord answering, said to him: Wicked and slothful servant, thou knewest that I reap where I sow not and gather where I have not strewed. ²⁷ Thou oughtest therefore to have committed my money to the bankers: and at my coming I should have received my own with usury. ²⁸ Take ye away therefore the talent from him and give it him that hath ten talents. ²⁹ For to every one that hath shall be given, and he shall abound: but from him that hath not, that also which he seemeth to have shall be taken away. ³⁰ And the unprofitable servant, cast ye out into the exterior darkness. There shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

³¹ And when the Son of man shall come in his majesty, and all the angels with him, then shall he sit upon the seat of his majesty. ³² And all nations shall be gathered together before him: and he shall separate them one from another, as the shepherd separateth the sheep from the goats: ³³ And he shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on his left. ³⁴ Then shall the king say to them that shall be on his right hand: Come, ye blessed of

my Father, possess you the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world. ³⁵ For I was hungry, and you gave me to eat: I was thirsty, and you gave me to drink: I was a stranger, and you took me in: ³⁶ Naked, and you covered me: sick, and you visited me: I was in prison, and you came to me. ³⁷ Then shall the just answer him, saying: Lord, when did we see thee hungry and fed thee: thirsty and gave thee drink? ³⁸ Or when did we see thee a stranger and took thee in? Or naked and covered thee? ³⁹ Or when did we see thee sick or in prison and came to thee? ⁴⁰ And the king answering shall say to them: Amen I say to you, as long as you did it to one of these my least brethren, you did it to me. ⁴¹ Then he shall say to them also that shall be on his left hand: Depart from me, you cursed, into everlasting fire, which was prepared for the devil and his angels. ⁴² For I was hungry and you gave me not to eat: I was thirsty and you gave me not to drink. ⁴³ I was a stranger and you took me not in: naked and you covered me not: sick and in prison and you did not visit me. ⁴⁴ Then they also shall answer him, saying: Lord, when did we see thee hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison and did not minister to thee? ⁴⁵ Then he shall answer them, saying: Amen: I say to you, as long as you did it not to one of these least, neither did you do it to me. ⁴⁶ And these shall go into everlasting punishment: but the just, into life everlasting.

322. *The washing of the feet*

John 13:1-38

13 ¹ Before the festival day of the pasch, Jesus knowing that his hour was come, that he should pass out of this world to the Father: having loved his own who were in the world, he loved them unto the end. ² And when supper was done (the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon, to betray him), ³ Knowing that the Father had given him all things into his hands and that he came from God and goeth to God, ⁴ He riseth from supper and layeth aside his garments and, having taken a towel, girded himself. ⁵ After that, he putteth water into a basin and began to wash the feet of the disciples and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded. ⁶ He cometh therefore to Simon Peter. And Peter saith to him: Lord, dost thou wash my feet? ⁷ Jesus answered and said to him: What I do, thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter. ⁸ Peter saith to him: Thou shalt never wash my feet, Jesus answered him: If I wash thee not, thou shalt have no part with me. ⁹ Simon Peter saith to him: Lord, not only my feet, but also my hands and my head. ¹⁰ Jesus saith to him: He that is washed needeth not but to wash his feet, but is clean wholly. And you are clean, but not all. ¹¹ For he knew who he was that would betray him; therefore he said: You are not all clean. ¹² Then after he had washed their feet and taken his garments, being set down again, he said to them: Know you what I have done to you? ¹³ You call me Master and Lord. And you say well: for so I am. ¹⁴ If then I being your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; you also ought to wash one another's feet. ¹⁵ For I have given you an example, that as I have done to you, so you do also. ¹⁶ Amen, amen, I say to you: The servant is not greater than his lord: neither is the apostle greater than he that sent him. ¹⁷ If you know these things, you shall be blessed if you do them. ¹⁸ I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen. But that the scripture may be fulfilled: He that eateth bread with me shall lift up his

heel against me, ¹⁹ At present I tell you, before it come to pass: that when it shall come to pass, you may believe that I am he. ²⁰ Amen, amen, I say to you, he that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth me: and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me. ²¹ When Jesus had said these things, he was troubled in spirit; and he testified, and said: Amen, amen, I say to you, one of you shall betray me. ²² The disciples therefore looked one upon another, doubting of whom he spoke. ²³ Now there was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved. ²⁴ Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him and said to him: Who is it of whom he speaketh? ²⁵ He therefore, leaning on the breast of Jesus, saith to him: Lord, who is it? ²⁶ Jesus answered: He it is to whom I shall reach bread dipped. And when he had dipped the bread, he gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon. ²⁷ And after the morsel, Satan entered into him. And Jesus said to him: That which thou dost, do quickly. ²⁸ Now no man at the table knew to what purpose he said this unto him. ²⁹ For some thought, because Judas had the purse, that Jesus had said to him: Buy those things which we have need of for the festival day: or that he should give something to the poor. ³⁰ He therefore, having received the morsel, went out immediately. And it was night.

³¹ When he therefore was gone out, Jesus said: Now is the Son of man glorified; and God is glorified in him. ³² If God be glorified in him, God also will glorify him in himself: and immediately will he glorify him. ³³ Little children, yet a little while I am with you. You shall seek me. And as I said to the Jews: Whither I go you cannot come; so I say to you now. ³⁴ A new commandment I give unto you: That you love one another, as I have loved you, that you also love one another. ³⁵ By this shall all men know that you are my disciples, if you have love one for another.

³⁶ Simon Peter saith to him: Lord, whither goest thou? Jesus answered: Whither I go, thou canst not follow me now: but thou shalt follow hereafter. ³⁷ Peter saith to him: Why cannot I follow thee now? I will lay down my life for thee. ³⁸ Jesus answered him: Wilt thou lay down thy life for me? Amen, amen, I say to thee, the cock shall not crow, till thou deny me thrice.

323. *The last discourse, and the priestly prayer*

John 14:1-17:26

14 ¹ Let not your heart be troubled. You believe in God: believe also in me. ² In my Father's house there are many mansions. If not, I would have told you: because I go to prepare a place for you. ³ And if I shall go and prepare a place for you, I will come again and will take you to myself: that where I am, you also may be. ⁴ And whither I go you know: and the way you know. ⁵ Thomas saith to him: Lord, we know not whither thou goest. And how can we know the way? ⁶ Jesus saith to him: I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No man cometh to the Father, but by me. ⁷ If you had known me, you would without doubt have known my Father also: and from henceforth you shall know him. And you have seen him. ⁸ Philip saith to him: Lord, shew us the Father; and it is enough for us. ⁹ Jesus saith to him: Have I been so long a time with you and have you not known me? Philip, he that seeth me seeth the Father also. How sayest thou: Shew us the Father? ¹⁰ Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father in me? The words that I speak to you, I speak not of myself. But the Father who abideth in me,

he doth the works. ¹¹ Believe you not that I am in the Father and the Father in me? ¹² Otherwise believe for the very works' sake. Amen, amen, I say to you, he that believeth in me, the works that I do, he also shall do: and greater than these shall he do. ¹³ Because I go to the Father: and whatsoever you shall ask the Father in my name, that will I do: that the Father may be glorified in the Son. ¹⁴ If you shall ask me any thing in my name, that I will do. ¹⁵ If you love me, keep my commandments. ¹⁶ And I will ask the Father: and he shall give you another Paraclete, that he may abide with you for ever: ¹⁷ The spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, nor knoweth him. But you shall know him; because he shall abide with you and shall be in you. ¹⁸ I will not leave you orphans: I will come to you. ¹⁹ Yet a little while and the world seeth me no more. But you see me: because I live, and you shall live. ²⁰ In that day you shall know that I am in my Father: and you in me, and I in you. ²¹ He that hath my commandments and keepeth them; he it is that loveth me. And he that loveth me shall be loved of my Father: and I will love him and will manifest myself to him. ²² Judas saith to him, not the Iscariot: Lord, how is it that thou wilt manifest thyself to us, and not to the world? ²³ Jesus answered and said to him: If any one love me, he will keep my word. And my Father will love him and we will come to him and will make our abode with him. ²⁴ He that loveth me not keepeth not my words. And the word which you have heard is not mine; but the Father's who sent me. ²⁵ These things have I spoken to you, abiding with you. ²⁶ But the Paraclete, the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things and bring all things to your mind, whatsoever I shall have said to you. ²⁷ Peace I leave with you: my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, do I give unto you. Let not your heart be troubled: nor let it be afraid. ²⁸ You have heard that I said to you: I go away, and I come unto you. If you loved me you would indeed be glad, because I go to the Father: for the Father is greater than I. ²⁹ And now I have told you before it come to pass: that when it shall come to pass, you may believe. ³⁰ I will not now speak many things with you. For the prince of this world: cometh: and in me he hath not any thing. ³¹ But that the world may know that I love the Father: and as the Father hath given me commandment, so do I. Arise, let us go hence.

15 ¹ I am the true vine: and my Father is the husbandman. ² Every branch in me that beareth not fruit, he will take away: and every one that beareth fruit, he will purge it, that it may bring forth more fruit. ³ Now you are clean, by reason of the word which I have spoken to you. ⁴ Abide in me: and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abide in the vine, so neither can you, unless you abide in me. ⁵ I am the vine: you the branches. He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same beareth much fruit: for without me you can do nothing. ⁶ If any one abide not in me, he shall be cast forth as a branch and shall wither: and they shall gather him up and cast him into the fire: and he burneth. ⁷ If you abide in me and my words abide in you, you shall ask whatever you will: and it shall be done unto you. ⁸ In this is my Father glorified: that you bring forth very much fruit and become my disciples. ⁹ As the Father hath loved me, I also have loved you. Abide in my love. ¹⁰ If you keep my commandments, you shall abide in my love: as I also have kept

my Father's commandments and do abide in his love. ¹¹ These things I have spoken to you, that my joy may be in you, and your joy may be filled. ¹² This is my commandment, that you love one another, as I have loved you. ¹³ Greater love than this no man hath, that a man lay down his life for his friends. ¹⁴ You are my friends, if you do the things that I command you. ¹⁵ I will not now call you servants: for the servant knoweth not what his lord doth. But I have called you friends: because all things, whatsoever I have heard of my Father, I have made known to you. ¹⁶ You have not chosen me: but I have chosen you; and have appointed you, that you should go and should bring forth fruit; and your fruit should remain: that whatsoever you shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you. ¹⁷ These things I command you, that you love one another. ¹⁸ If the world hate you, know ye that it hath hated me before you. ¹⁹ If you had been of the world, the world would love its own: but because you are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hateth you. ²⁰ Remember my word that I said to you: The servant is not greater than his master. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you. If they have kept my word, they will keep yours also. ²¹ But all these things they will do to you for my name's sake: because they know not him that sent me. ²² If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have sin: but now they have no excuse for their sin. ²³ He that hateth me hateth my Father also. ²⁴ If I had not done among them the works that no other man hath done, they would not have sin: but now they have both seen and hated both me and my Father. ²⁵ But that the word may be fulfilled which is written in their law: they hated me without cause. ²⁶ But when the Paraclete cometh, whom I will send you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceedeth from the Father, he shall give testimony of me. ²⁷ And you shall give testimony, because you are with me from the beginning.

16 ¹ These things have I spoken to you, that you may not be scandalized. ² They will put you out of the synagogues: yea, the hour cometh, that whosoever killeth you will think that he doth a service to God. ³ And these things will they do to you; because they have not known the Father nor me. ⁴ But these things I have told you, that when the hour shall come, you may remember that I told you of them. ⁵ But I told you not these things from the beginning, because I was with you. And now I go to him that sent me, and none of you asketh me: Whither goest thou? ⁶ But because I have spoken these things to you, sorrow hath filled your heart. ⁷ But I tell you the truth: it is expedient to you that I go. For if I go not, the Paraclete will not come to you: but if I go, I will send him to you. ⁸ And when he is come, he will convince the world of sin and of justice and of judgment. ⁹ Of sin: because they believed not in me. ¹⁰ And of justice: because I go to the Father: and you shall see me no longer. ¹¹ And of judgment: because the prince of this world is already judged. ¹² I have yet many things to say to you: but you cannot bear them now. ¹³ But when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will teach you all truth. For he shall not speak of himself: but what things soever he shall hear, he shall speak. And the things that are to come, he shall shew you. ¹⁴ He shall glorify me: because he shall receive of mine and shall shew it to you. ¹⁵ All things whatsoever the Father hath are mine. Therefore I said that he

shall receive of me and shew it to you. ¹⁶ A little while, and now you shall not see me: and again a little while, and you shall see me: because I go to the Father. ¹⁷ Then some of his disciples said one to another: What is this that he saith to us: A little while, and you shall not see me: and again a little while, and you shall see me, and, Because I go to the Father? ¹⁸ They said therefore: What is this that he saith, A little while? We know not what he speaketh. ¹⁹ And Jesus knew that they had a mind to ask him. And he said to them: Of this do you inquire among yourselves, because I said: A little while, and you shall not see me; and again a little while, and you shall see me? ²⁰ Amen, amen, I say to you, that you shall lament and weep, but the world shall rejoice: and you shall be made sorrowful, but your sorrow shall be turned into joy. ²¹ A woman, when she is in labour, hath sorrow, because her hour is come; but when she hath brought forth the child, she remembereth no more the anguish, for joy that a man is born into the world. ²² So also you now indeed have sorrow: but I will see you again and your heart shall rejoice. And your joy no man shall take from you. ²³ And in that day you shall not ask me any thing. Amen, amen, I say to you: if you ask the Father any thing in my name, he will give it you. ²⁴ Hitherto, you have not asked any thing in my name. Ask, and you shall receive; that your joy may be full. ²⁵ These things I have spoken to you in proverbs. The hour cometh when I will no longer speak to you in proverbs, but will shew you plainly of the Father. ²⁶ In that day, you shall ask in my name: and I say not to you that I will ask the Father for you. ²⁷ For the Father himself loveth you, because you have loved me and have believed that I came out from God. ²⁸ I came forth from the Father and am come into the world: again I leave the world and I go to the Father. ²⁹ His disciples say to him: Behold, now thou speakest plainly and speakest no proverb. ³⁰ Now we know that thou knowest all things and thou needest not that any man should ask thee. By this we believe that thou camest forth from God. ³¹ Jesus answered them: Do you now believe? ³² Behold, the hour cometh, and it is now come, that you shall be scattered every man to his own and shall leave me alone. And yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me. ³³ These things I have spoken to you, that in me you may have peace. In the world you shall have distress. But have confidence. I have overcome the world.

17 ¹ These things Jesus spoke: and lifting up his eyes to heaven, he said: Father, the hour is come. Glorify thy Son, that thy Son may glorify thee. ² As thou hast given him power over all flesh, that he may give eternal life to all whom thou hast given him. ³ Now this is eternal life: That they may know thee, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom thou hast sent. ⁴ I have glorified thee on the earth; I have finished the work which thou gavest me to do. ⁵ And now glorify thou me, O Father, with thyself, with the glory which I had, before the world was, with thee. ⁶ I have manifested thy name to the men whom thou hast given me out of the world. Thine they were: and to me thou gavest them. And they have kept thy word. ⁷ Now they have known that all things which thou hast given me are from thee: ⁸ Because the words which thou gavest me, I have given to them. And they have received them and have known in very deed that I came out from thee: and they have believed that thou didst send me. ⁹ I pray for them. I pray not for the world, but for them whom

thou hast given me: because they are thine. ¹⁰ And all my things are thine, and thine are mine: and I am glorified in them. ¹¹ And now I am not in the world, and these are in the world, and I come to thee. Holy Father, keep them in thy name whom thou hast given me: that they may be one, as we also are. ¹² While I was with them, I kept them in thy name. Those whom thou gavest me have I kept: and none of them is lost, but the son of perdition: that the scripture may be fulfilled. ¹³ And now I come to thee: and these things I speak in the world, that they may have my joy filled in themselves. ¹⁴ I have given them thy word, and the world hath hated them: because they are not of the world, as I also am not of the world. ¹⁵ I pray not that thou shouldst take them out of the world, but that thou shouldst keep them from evil. ¹⁶ They are not of the world, as I also am not of the world. ¹⁷ Sanctify them in truth. Thy word is truth. ¹⁸ As thou hast sent me into the world, I also have sent them into the world. ¹⁹ And for them do I sanctify myself, that they also may be sanctified in truth. ²⁰ And not for them only do I pray, but for them also who through their word shall believe in me. ²¹ That they all may be one, as thou, Father, in me, and I in thee; that they also may be one in us: that the world may believe that thou hast sent me. ²² And the glory which thou hast given me, I have given to them: that, they may be one, as we also are one. ²³ I in them, and thou in me: that they may be made perfect in one: and the world may know that thou hast sent me and hast loved them, as thou hast also loved me. ²⁴ Father, I will that where I am, they also whom thou hast given me may be with me: that they may see my glory which thou hast given me, because thou hast loved me before the creation of the world. ²⁵ Just Father, the world hath not known thee: but I have known thee. And these have known that thou hast sent me. ²⁶ And I have made known thy name to them and will make it known: that the love wherewith thou hast loved me may be in them, and I in them.

324. The supper, Gethsemani, and the arrest

Luke 22:1-71

22 ¹ Now the feast of unleavened bread, which is called the pasch, was at hand. ² And the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might put Jesus to death: but they feared the people.

³ And Satan entered into Judas, who was surnamed Iscariot, one of the twelve. ⁴ And he went and discoursed with the chief priests and the magistrates, how he might betray him to them. ⁵ And they were glad and covenanted to give him money. ⁶ And he promised. And he sought opportunity to betray him in the absence of the multitude.

⁷ And the day of the unleavened bread came, on which it was necessary that the pasch should be killed. ⁸ And he sent Peter and John, saying: Go, and prepare for us the pasch, that we may eat. ⁹ But they said: Where wilt thou that we prepare? ¹⁰ And he said to them: Behold, as you go into the city, there shall meet you a man carrying a pitcher of water: follow him into the house where he entereth in. ¹¹ And you shall say to the goodman of the house: The master saith to thee: Where is the guest chamber, where I may eat the pasch with my disciples? ¹² And he will shew you a large dining room, furnished. And there prepare. ¹³ And they going, found as he had said to them and made ready the pasch. ¹⁴ And when the hour was come, he sat down: and the twelve apostles with him. ¹⁵ And he said to them: With desire I

have desired to eat this pasch with you, before I suffer. ¹⁶ For I say to you that from this time I will not eat it, till it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God. ¹⁷ And having taken the chalice, he gave thanks and said: Take and divide it among you. ¹⁸ For I say to you that I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, till the kingdom of God come.

¹⁹ And taking bread, he gave thanks and brake and gave to them, saying: This is my body, which is given for you. Do this for a commemoration of me. ²⁰ In like manner, the chalice also, after he had supped, saying: This is the chalice, the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you. ²¹ But yet behold: the hand of him that betrayeth me is with me on the table. ²² And the Son of man indeed goeth, according to that which is determined: but yet, woe to that man by whom he shall be betrayed. ²³ And they began to inquire among themselves, which of them it was that should do this thing.

²⁴ And there was also a strife amongst them, which of them should seem to be the greater. ²⁵ And he said to them: The kings of the Gentiles lord it over them; and they that have power over them are called beneficent. ²⁶ But you not so: but he that is the greater among you, let him become as the younger: and he that is the leader, as he that serveth. ²⁷ For which is greater, he that sitteth at table or he that serveth? Is not he that sitteth at table? But I am in the midst of you, as he that serveth. ²⁸ And you are they who have continued with me in my temptations: ²⁹ And I dispose to you, as my Father hath disposed to me, a kingdom; ³⁰ That you may eat and drink at my table, in my kingdom: and may sit upon thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

³¹ And the Lord said: Simon, Simon, behold Satan hath desired to have you, that he may sift you as wheat. ³² But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and thou, being once converted, confirm thy brethren. ³³ Who said to him: Lord, I am ready to go with thee, both into prison and to death. ³⁴ And he said: I say to thee, Peter, the cock shall not crow this day, till thou thrice deniest that thou knowest me. And he said to them: ³⁵ When I sent you without purse and scrip and shoes, did you want anything? ³⁶ But they said: Nothing. Then said he unto them: But now he that hath a purse, let him take it, and likewise a scrip: and he that hath not, let him sell his coat and buy a sword. ³⁷ For I say to you that this that is written must yet be fulfilled in me. And with the wicked was he reckoned. For the things concerning me have an end. ³⁸ But they said: Lord, behold, here are two swords. And he said to them: It is enough.

³⁹ And going out, he went, according to his custom, to the Mount of Olives. And his disciples also followed him. ⁴⁰ And when he was come to the place, he said to them: Pray, lest ye enter into temptation. ⁴¹ And he was withdrawn away from them a stone's cast. And kneeling down, he prayed. ⁴² Saying: Father, if thou wilt, remove this chalice from me: but yet not my will, but thine be done. ⁴³ And there appeared to him an angel from heaven, strengthening him. And being in an agony, he prayed the longer. ⁴⁴ And his sweat became as drops of blood, trickling down upon the ground. ⁴⁵ And when he rose up from prayer and was come to the disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Why sleep you? Arise: pray: lest you enter into temptation.

⁴⁷ As he was yet speaking, behold a multitude; and he that was called Judas, one of the twelve, went before them and drew near to Jesus, for to kiss him. ⁴⁸ And Jesus said to him: Judas, dost thou betray the Son of man with a kiss? ⁴⁹ And they that were about him, seeing what would follow, said to him: Lord, shall we strike with the sword? ⁵⁰ And one of them struck the servant of the high priest and cut off his right ear. ⁵¹ But Jesus answering, said: Suffer ye thus far. And when he had touched his ear, he healed him. ⁵² And Jesus said to the chief priests and magistrates of the temple and the ancients, that were come unto him: Are ye come out, as it were against a thief, with swords and clubs? ⁵³ When I was daily with you in the temple, you did not stretch forth your hands against me: but this is your hour and the power of darkness.

⁵⁴ And apprehending him, they led him to the high priest's house. But Peter followed afar off. ⁵⁵ And when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the hall and were sitting about it, Peter was in the midst of them. ⁵⁶ Whom when a certain servant maid had seen sitting at the light and had earnestly beheld him, she said: This man also was with him. ⁵⁷ But he denied him, saying: Woman, I know him not. ⁵⁸ And after a little while, another seeing him, said: Thou also art one of them. But Peter said: O man, I am not. ⁵⁹ And after the space, as it were of one hour, another certain man affirmed, saying: Of a truth, this man was also with him: for he is also a Galilean. ⁶⁰ And Peter said: Man, I know not what thou sayest. And immediately, as he was yet speaking, the cock crew. ⁶¹ And the Lord turning looked on Peter. And Peter remembered the word of the Lord, as he had said: Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice. ⁶² And Peter going out, wept bitterly.

⁶³ And the men that held him mocked him and struck him. ⁶⁴ And they blindfolded him and smote his face. And they asked him saying: Prophecy: Who is it that struck thee? ⁶⁵ And blaspheming, many other things they said against him.

⁶⁶ And as soon as it was day, the ancients of the people and the chief priests and scribes came together. And they brought him into their council saying: If thou be the Christ, tell us. ⁶⁷ And he saith to them: If I shall tell you, you will not believe me. ⁶⁸ And if I shall also ask you, you will not answer me, nor let me go. ⁶⁹ But hereafter the Son of man shall be sitting on the right hand of the power of God. ⁷⁰ Then said they all: Art thou then the Son of God? Who said: You say that I am. ⁷¹ And they said: What need we any further testimony? For we ourselves have heard it from his own mouth.

325. *The Passion*

Luke 23:1-56

23 ¹ And the whole multitude of them, rising up, led him to Pilate. ² And they began to accuse him, saying: We have found this man perverting our nation and forbidding to give tribute to Caesar and saying that he is Christ the king. ³ And Pilate asked him, saying: Art thou the king of the Jews? But he answering, said: Thou sayest it. ⁴ And Pilate said to the chief priests and to the multitudes: I find no cause in this man. ⁵ But they were more earnest, saying: He stirreth up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee to this place. ⁶ But Pilate hearing Galilee, asked if the man were of Galilee? ⁷ And when

he understood that he was of Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him away to Herod, who was also himself at Jerusalem in those days.

⁸ And Herod seeing Jesus, was very glad: for he was desirous of a long time to see him, because he had heard many things of him; and he hoped to see some sign wrought by him. ⁹ And he questioned him in many words. But he answered him nothing. ¹⁰ And the chief priests and the scribes stood by, earnestly accusing him. ¹¹ And Herod with his army set him at nought and mocked him, putting on him a white garment: and sent him back to Pilate. ¹² And Herod and Pilate were made friends, that same day: for before they were enemies one to another.

¹³ And Pilate, calling together the chief priests and the magistrates and the people, ¹⁴ Said to them: You have presented unto me this man as one that perverteth the people. And behold I, having examined him before you, find no cause in this man, in those things wherein you accuse him. ¹⁵ No, nor Herod neither. For, I sent you to him: and behold, nothing worthy of death is done to him. ¹⁶ I will chastise him therefore and release him. ¹⁷ Now of necessity he was to release unto them one upon the feast day. ¹⁸ But the whole multitude together cried out, saying: Away with this man, and release unto us Barabbas: ¹⁹ Who, for a certain sedition made in the city and for a murder, was cast into prison. ²⁰ And Pilate again spoke to them, desiring to release Jesus. ²¹ But they cried again, saying: Crucify him, Crucify him. ²² And he said to them the third time: Why, what evil hath this man done? I find no cause of death in him. I will chastise him therefore and let him go. ²³ But they were instant with loud voices, requiring that he might be crucified. And their voices prevailed. ²⁴ And Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they required. ²⁵ And he released unto them him who for murder and sedition had been cast into prison, whom they had desired. But Jesus he delivered up to their will. ²⁶ And as they led him away, they laid hold of one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country; and they laid the cross on him to carry after Jesus. ²⁷ And there followed him a great multitude of people and of women, who bewailed and lamented him. ²⁸ But Jesus turning to them, said: Daughters of Jerusalem, weep not over me; but weep for yourselves and for your children. ²⁹ For behold, the days shall come, wherein they will say: Blessed are the barren and the wombs that have not borne and the paps that have not given suck. ³⁰ Then shall they begin to say to the mountains: Fall upon us. And to the hills: Cover us. ³¹ For if in the green wood they do these things, what shall be done in the dry? ³² And there were also two other malefactors led with him to be put to death. ³³ And when they were come to the place which is called Calvary, they crucified him there: and the robbers, one on the right hand, and the other on the left.

³⁴ And Jesus said: Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do. But they, dividing his garments, cast lots. ³⁵ And the people stood beholding. And the rulers with them derided him, saying: He saved others: let him save himself, if he be Christ, the elect of God. ³⁶ And the soldiers also mocked him, coming to him and offering him vinegar, ³⁷ And saying: If thou be the king of the Jews, save thyself. ³⁸ And there was also a superscription written over him in letters of Greek and Latin and Hebrew THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.

³⁹ And one of those robbers who were hanged blasphemed him, saying: If thou be Christ, save thyself and us. ⁴⁰ But the other answering, rebuked him, saying: Neither dost thou fear God, seeing; thou art under the same condemnation? ⁴¹ And we indeed justly: for we receive the due reward of our deeds. But this man hath done no evil. ⁴² And he said to Jesus: Lord, remember me when thou shalt come into thy kingdom. ⁴³ And Jesus said to him: Amen I say to thee: This day thou shalt be with me in paradise. ⁴⁴ And it was almost the sixth hour: and there was darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour. ⁴⁵ And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was rent in the midst. ⁴⁶ And Jesus crying with a loud voice, said: Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit. And saying this, he gave up the ghost. ⁴⁷ Now, the centurion, seeing what was done, glorified God, saying: Indeed this was a just man. ⁴⁸ And all the multitude of them that were come together to that sight and saw the things that were done returned, striking their breasts. ⁴⁹ And all his acquaintance and the women that had followed him from Galilee stood afar off, beholding these things.

⁵⁰ And behold there was a man named Joseph who was a counsellor, a good and a just man, ⁵¹ (The same had not consented to their counsel and doings) of Arimathea, a city of Judea: who also himself looked for the kingdom of God. ⁵² This man went to Pilate and begged the body of Jesus. ⁵³ And taking him down, he wrapped him in fine linen and laid him in a sepulchre that was hewed in stone, wherein never yet any man had been laid. ⁵⁴ And it was the day of the Paraseve: and the sabbath drew on. ⁵⁵ And the women that were come with him from Galilee, following after, saw the sepulchre and how his body was laid. ⁵⁶ And returning, they prepared spices and ointments: and on the sabbath day they rested, according to the commandment.

326. Psalm 21

Psalms 21:1-32

Vulgate 21 = Hebrew 22: "O God my God, look upon me: why hast thou forsaken me?" - the psalm Christ speaks from the cross.

21 ¹ Unto the end, for the morning protection, a psalm for David. ² O God my God, look upon me: why hast thou forsaken me? Far from my salvation are the words of my sins. ³ O my God, I shall cry by day, and thou wilt not hear: and by night, and it shall not be reputed as folly in me. ⁴ But thou dwellest in the holy place, the praise of Israel. ⁵ In thee have our fathers hoped: they have hoped, and thou hast delivered them. ⁶ They cried to thee, and they were saved: they trusted in thee, and were not confounded. ⁷ But I am a worm, and no man: the reproach of men, and the outcast of the people. ⁸ All they that saw me have laughed me to scorn: they have spoken with the lips, and wagged the head. ⁹ He hoped in the Lord, let him deliver him: let him save him, seeing he delighteth in him. ¹⁰ For thou art he that hast drawn me out of the womb: my hope from the breasts of my mother. ¹¹ I was cast upon thee from the womb. From my mother's womb thou art my God, ¹² Depart not from me. For tribulation is very near: for there is none to help me. ¹³ Many calves have surrounded me: fat bulls have besieged me. ¹⁴ They have opened their mouths against me, as a lion ravening and roaring. ¹⁵ I am poured out like water; and all my bones are scattered. My heart is become

like wax melting in the midst of my bowels. ¹⁶ My strength is dried up like a potsherd, and my tongue hath cleaved to my jaws: and thou hast brought me down into the dust of death. ¹⁷ For many dogs have encompassed me: the council of the malignant hath besieged me. They have dug my hands and feet. ¹⁸ They have numbered all my bones. And they have looked and stared upon me. ¹⁹ They parted my garments amongst them; and upon my vesture they cast lots. ²⁰ But thou, O Lord, remove not thy help to a distance from me; look towards my defence. ²¹ Deliver, O God, my soul from the sword: my only one from the hand of the dog. ²² Save me from the lion's mouth; and my lowness from the horns of the unicorns. ²³ I will declare thy name to my brethren: in the midst of the church will I praise thee. ²⁴ Ye that fear the Lord, praise him: all ye the seed of Jacob, glorify him. ²⁵ Let all the seed of Israel fear him: because he hath not slighted nor despised the supplication of the poor man. Neither hath he turned away his face from me: and when I cried to him he heard me. ²⁶ With thee is my praise in a great church: I will pay my vows in the sight of them that fear him. ²⁷ The poor shall eat and shall be filled: and they shall praise the Lord that seek him: their hearts shall live for ever and ever. ²⁸ All the ends of the earth shall remember, and shall be converted to the Lord: And all the kindreds of the Gentiles shall adore in his sight. ²⁹ For the kingdom is the Lord's; and he shall have dominion over the nations. ³⁰ All the fat ones of the earth have eaten and have adored: all they that go down to the earth shall fall before him. ³¹ And to him my soul shall live: and my seed shall serve him. ³² There shall be declared to the Lord a generation to come: and the heavens shall shew forth his justice to a people that shall be born, which the Lord hath made.

327. The pierced side

John 19:25-37

19 ²⁵ Now there stood by the cross of Jesus, his mother and his mother's sister, Mary of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalen. ²⁶ When Jesus therefore had seen his mother and the disciple standing whom he loved, he saith to his mother: Woman, behold thy son. ²⁷ After that, he saith to the disciple: Behold thy mother. And from that hour, the disciple took her to his own.

²⁸ Afterwards, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, said: I thirst. ²⁹ Now there was a vessel set there, full of vinegar. And they, putting a sponge full of vinegar about hyssop, put it to his mouth. ³⁰ Jesus therefore, when he had taken the vinegar, said: It is consummated. And bowing his head, he gave up the ghost. ³¹ Then the Jews (because it was the parasceve), that the bodies might not remain upon the cross on the sabbath day (for that was a great sabbath day), besought Pilate that their legs might be broken: and that they might be taken away. ³² The soldiers therefore came: and they broke the legs of the first, and of the other that was crucified with him. ³³ But after they were come to Jesus, when they saw that he was already dead, they did not break his legs. ³⁴ But one of the soldiers with a spear opened his side: and immediately there came out blood and water. ³⁵ And he that saw it hath given testimony: and his testimony is true. And he knoweth that he saith true: that you also may believe. ³⁶ For these things were done that the scripture might be fulfilled: You

shall not break a bone of him. ³⁷ And again another scripture saith: They shall look on him whom they pierced.

328. The resurrection, and the road to Emmaus

Luke 24:1-53

24 ¹ And on the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they came to the sepulchre, bringing the spices which they had prepared. ² And they found the stone rolled back from the sepulchre. ³ And going in, they found not the body of the Lord Jesus. ⁴ And it came to pass, as they were astonished in their mind at this, behold, two men stood by them, in shining apparel. ⁵ And as they were afraid and bowed down their countenance towards the ground, they said unto them: Why seek you the living with the dead? ⁶ He is not here, but is risen. Remember how he spoke unto you, when he was yet in Galilee, ⁷ Saying: The Son of man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men and be crucified and the third day rise again. ⁸ And they remembered his words. ⁹ And going back from the sepulchre, they told all these things to the eleven and to all the rest. ¹⁰ And it was Mary Magdalen and Joanna and Mary of James and the other women that were with them, who told these things to the apostles. ¹¹ And these words seemed to them as idle tales: and they did not believe them. ¹² But Peter rising up, ran to the sepulchre and, stooping down, he saw the linen cloths laid by themselves: and went away wondering in himself at that which was come to pass.

¹³ And behold, two of them went, the same day, to a town which was sixty furlongs from Jerusalem, named Emmaus. ¹⁴ And they talked together of all these things which had happened. ¹⁵ And it came to pass that while they talked and reasoned with themselves, Jesus himself also, drawing near, went with them. ¹⁶ But their eyes were held, that they should not know him. ¹⁷ And he said to them: What are these discourses that you hold one with another as you walk and are sad? ¹⁸ And the one of them, whose name was Cleophas, answering, said to him: Art thou only a stranger in Jerusalem, and hast not known the things that have been done there in these days? ¹⁹ To whom he said: What things? And they said: Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, who was a prophet, mighty in work and word before God and all the people. ²⁰ And how our chief priests and princes delivered him to be condemned to death and crucified him. ²¹ But we hoped that it was he that should have redeemed Israel. And now besides all this, to-day is the third day since these things were done. ²² Yea and certain women also of our company affrighted us who, before it was light, were at the sepulchre, ²³ And not finding his body, came, saying that they had also seen a vision of angels, who say that he is alive. ²⁴ And some of our people went to the sepulchre and found it so as the women had said: but him they found not. ²⁵ Then he said to them: O foolish and slow of heart to believe in all things, Which the prophets have spoken. ²⁶ Ought not Christ to have suffered these things and so, to enter into his glory? ²⁷ And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded to them in all the scriptures the things that were concerning him. ²⁸ And they drew nigh to the town whither they were going: and he made as though he would go farther. ²⁹ But they constrained him, saying: Stay with us, because it is towards evening and the day is now far spent. And he went in with them. ³⁰ And it came to pass, whilst he was at table with them, he took bread and blessed and brake and gave

to them. ³¹ And their eyes were opened: and they knew him. And he vanished out of their sight. ³² And they said one to the other: Was not our heart burning within us, whilst he spoke in the way and opened to us the scriptures? ³³ And rising up, the same hour, they went back to Jerusalem: and they found the eleven gathered together, and those that were with them, ³⁴ Saying: The Lord is risen indeed and hath appeared to Simon. ³⁵ And they told what things were done in the way: and how they knew him in the breaking of bread.

³⁶ Now, whilst they were speaking these things, Jesus stood in the midst of them and saith to them: Peace be to you. It is I: Fear not. ³⁷ But they being troubled and frightened, supposed that they saw a spirit. ³⁸ And he said to them: Why are you troubled, and why do thoughts arise in your hearts? ³⁹ See my hands and feet, that it is I myself. Handle, and see: for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as you see me to have. ⁴⁰ And when he had said this, he shewed them his hands and feet. ⁴¹ But while they yet believed not and wondered for joy, he said: Have you here any thing to eat? ⁴² And they offered him a piece of a broiled fish and a honeycomb. ⁴³ And when he had eaten before them, taking the remains, he gave to them. ⁴⁴ And he said to them: These are the words which I spoke to you while I was yet with you, that all things must needs be fulfilled which are written in the law of Moses and in the prophets and in the psalms, concerning me. ⁴⁵ Then he opened their understanding, that they might understand the scriptures. ⁴⁶ And he said to them: Thus it is written, and thus it behoved Christ to suffer and to rise again from the dead, the third day: ⁴⁷ And that penance and remission of sins should be preached in his name, unto all nations, beginning at Jerusalem. ⁴⁸ And you are witnesses of these things. ⁴⁹ And I send the promise of my Father upon you: but stay you in the city till you be endued with power from on high.

⁵⁰ And he led them out as far as Bethania: and lifting up his hands, he blessed them. ⁵¹ And it came to pass, whilst he blessed them, he departed from them and was carried up to heaven. ⁵² And they adoring went back into Jerusalem with great joy. ⁵³ And they were always in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

329. The empty tomb, and the ending of St. Mark

Mark 16:1-20

16 ¹ And when the sabbath was past, Mary Magdalen and Mary the mother of James and Salome bought sweet spices, that coming, they might anoint Jesus. ² And very early in the morning, the first day of the week, they come to the sepulchre, the sun being now risen. ³ And they said one to another: Who shall roll us back the stone from the door of the sepulchre? ⁴ And looking, they saw the stone rolled back. For it was very great. ⁵ And entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting on the right side, clothed with a white robe: and they were astonished. ⁶ Who saith to them: Be not affrighted; you seek Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified. He is risen: he is not here. Behold the place where they laid him. ⁷ But go, tell his disciples and Peter that he goeth before you into Galilee. There you shall see him, as he told you. ⁸ But they going out, fled from the sepulchre: for a trembling and fear had seized them. And they said nothing to any man: for they were afraid.

⁹ But he rising early the first day of the week, appeared first to Mary Magdalen; out of whom he had cast seven devils. ¹⁰ She went and told them that had been with him, who were mourning and weeping. ¹¹ And they hearing that he was alive and had been seen by her, did not believe.

¹² And after that he appeared in another shape to two of them walking, as they were going into the country. ¹³ And they going told it to the rest: neither did they believe them.

¹⁴ At length he appeared to the eleven as they were at table: and he upbraided them with their incredulity and hardness of heart, because they did not believe them who had seen him after he was risen again. ¹⁵ And he said to them: Go ye into the whole world and preach the gospel to every creature. ¹⁶ He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved: but he that believeth not shall be condemned. ¹⁷ And these signs shall follow them that believe: In my name they shall cast out devils. They shall speak with new tongues. ¹⁸ They shall take up serpents: and if they shall drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them. They shall lay their hand upon the sick: and they shall recover.

¹⁹ And the Lord Jesus, after he had spoken to them, was taken up into heaven and sitteth on the right hand of God. ²⁰ But they going forth preached every where: the Lord working withal, and confirming the word with signs that followed.

330. The risen Lord, and the charge to Peter

John 20:1-21:25

20 ¹ And on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalen cometh early, when it was yet dark, unto the sepulchre: and she saw the stone taken away from the sepulchre. ² She ran therefore and cometh to Simon Peter and to the other disciple whom Jesus loved and saith to them: They have taken away the Lord out of the sepulchre: and we know not where they have laid him. ³ Peter therefore went out, and that other disciple: and they came to the sepulchre. ⁴ And they both ran together: and that other disciple did outrun Peter and came first to the sepulchre. ⁵ And when he stooped down, he saw the linen cloths lying: but yet he went not in. ⁶ Then cometh Simon Peter, following him, and went into the sepulchre: and saw the linen cloths lying, ⁷ And the napkin that had been about his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but apart, wrapped up into one place. ⁸ Then that other disciple also went in, who came first to the sepulchre: and he saw and believed. ⁹ For as yet they knew not the scripture, that he must rise again from the dead. ¹⁰ The disciples therefore departed again to their home.

¹¹ But Mary stood at the sepulchre without, weeping. Now as she was weeping, she stooped down and looked into the sepulchre, ¹² And she saw two angels in white, sitting, one at the head, and one at the feet, where the body of Jesus had been laid. ¹³ They say to her: Woman, why weepest thou? She saith to them: Because they have taken away my Lord: and I know not where they have laid him. ¹⁴ When she had thus said, she turned herself back and saw Jesus standing: and she knew not that it was Jesus. ¹⁵ Jesus saith to her: Woman, why weepest thou? Whom seekest thou? She, thinking that it was the gardener, saith to him: Sir, if thou hast taken him hence, tell me where thou hast laid him: and I will take him away. ¹⁶ Jesus saith to her: Mary. She turning, saith to him: Rabboni (which is to say, Master). ¹⁷ Jesus saith to her: Do not touch me: for I am not yet ascended to my

Father. But go to my brethren and say to them: I ascend to my Father and to your Father, to my God and to your God. ¹⁸ Mary Magdalen cometh and telleth the disciples: I have seen the Lord; and these things he said to me. ¹⁹ Now when it was late the same day, the first of the week, and the doors were shut, where the disciples were gathered together, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood in the midst and said to them: Peace be to you. ²⁰ And when he had said this, he shewed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore were glad, when they saw the Lord. ²¹ He said therefore to them again: Peace be to you. As the Father hath sent me, I also send you. ²² When he had said this, he breathed on them; and he said to them: Receive ye the Holy Ghost. ²³ Whose sins you shall forgive, they are forgiven them: and whose sins you shall retain, they are retained.

²⁴ Now Thomas, one of the twelve, who is called Didymus, was not with them when Jesus came. ²⁵ The other disciples therefore said to him: We have seen the Lord. But he said to them: Except I shall see in his hands the print of the nails and put my finger into the place of the nails and put my hand into his side, I will not believe.

²⁶ And after eight days, again his disciples were within, and Thomas with them. Jesus cometh, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst and said: Peace be to you. ²⁷ Then he said to Thomas: Put in thy finger hither and see my hands. And bring hither thy hand and put it into my side. And be not faithless, but believing. ²⁸ Thomas answered and said to him: My Lord and my God. ²⁹ Jesus saith to him: Because thou hast seen me, Thomas, thou hast believed: blessed are they that have not seen and have believed.

³⁰ Many other signs also did Jesus in the sight of his disciples, which are not written in this book. ³¹ But these are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God: and that believing, you may have life in his name.

21 ¹ After this, Jesus shewed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias. And he shewed himself after this manner.

² There were together: Simon Peter and Thomas, who is called Didymus, and Nathanael, who was of Cana of Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee and two others of his disciples. ³ Simon Peter saith to them: I go a fishing. They say to him: We also come with thee. And they went forth and entered into the ship: and that night they caught nothing. ⁴ But when the morning was come, Jesus stood on the shore: yet the disciples knew not that it was Jesus. ⁵ Jesus therefore said to them: Children, have you any meat? They answered him: No. ⁶ He saith to them: Cast the net on the right side of the ship; and you shall find. They cast therefore: and now they were not able to draw it, for the multitude of fishes. ⁷ That disciple therefore whom Jesus loved said to Peter: It is the Lord. Simon Peter, when he heard that it was the Lord, girt his coat about him (for he was naked) and cast himself into the sea. ⁸ But the other disciples came in the ship (for they were not far from the land, but as it were two hundred cubits) dragging the net with fishes. ⁹ As soon then as they came to land they saw hot coals lying, and a fish laid thereon, and bread. ¹⁰ Jesus saith to them: Bring hither of the fishes which you have now caught. ¹¹ Simon Peter went up and drew the net to land, full of great fishes, one hundred and fifty-three. And although there were so many, the net was not broken. ¹² Jesus

saith to them: Come and dine. And none of them who were at meat, durst ask him: Who art thou? Knowing that it was the Lord. ¹³ And Jesus cometh and taketh bread and giveth them: and fish in like manner. ¹⁴ This is now the third time that Jesus was manifested to his disciples, after he was risen from the dead. ¹⁵ When therefore they had dined, Jesus saith to Simon Peter: Simon, son of John, lovest thou me more than these? He saith to him: Yea, Lord, thou knowest that I love thee. He saith to him: Feed my lambs. ¹⁶ He saith to him again: Simon, son of John, lovest thou me? He saith to him: yea, Lord, thou knowest that I love thee. He saith to him: Feed my lambs. ¹⁷ He said to him the third time: Simon, son of John, lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he had said to him the third time: Lovest thou me? And he said to him: Lord, thou knowest all things: thou knowest that I love thee. He said to him: Feed my sheep. ¹⁸ Amen, amen, I say to thee, When thou wast younger, thou didst gird thyself and didst walk where thou wouldst. But when thou shalt be old, thou shalt stretch forth thy hands, and another shall gird thee and lead thee whither thou wouldst not. ¹⁹ And this he said, signifying by what death he should glorify God. And when he had said this, he saith to him: Follow me. ²⁰ Peter turning about, saw that disciple whom Jesus loved following, who also leaned on his breast at supper and said: Lord, who is he that shall betray thee? ²¹ Him therefore when Peter had seen, he saith to Jesus: Lord, and what shall this man do? ²² Jesus saith to him: So I will have him to remain till I come, what is it to thee? Follow thou me. ²³ This saying therefore went abroad among the brethren, that that disciple should not die. And Jesus did not say to him: He should not die; but: So I will have him to remain till I come, what is it to thee? ²⁴ This is that disciple who giveth testimony of these things and hath written these things: and we know that his testimony is true. ²⁵ But there are also many other things which Jesus did which, if they were written every one, the world itself. I think, would not be able to contain the books that should be written.

331. The great commission

Matthew 28:16-20

28 ¹⁶ And the eleven disciples went into Galilee, unto the mountain where Jesus had appointed them. ¹⁷ And seeing him they adored: but some doubted. ¹⁸ And Jesus coming, spoke to them, saying: All power is given to me in heaven and in earth. ¹⁹ Going therefore, teach ye all nations: baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. ²⁰ Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you. And behold I am with you all days, even to the consummation of the world.

332. Psalm 109

Psalms 109:1-7

Vulgate 109 = Hebrew 110: "The Lord said to my Lord" - the psalm Christ turns on the Pharisees, and the one St. Peter preaches at Pentecost.

109 ¹ A psalm for David. The Lord said to my Lord: Sit thou at my right hand: Until I make thy enemies thy footstool. ² The Lord will send forth the sceptre of thy power out of Sion: rule thou in the midst of thy enemies. ³ With thee is the principality

in the day of thy strength: in the brightness of the saints: from the womb before the day star I begot thee. ⁴ The Lord hath sworn, and he will not repent: Thou art a priest for ever according to the order of Melchisedech. ⁵ The Lord at thy right hand hath broken kings in the day of his wrath. ⁶ He shall judge among nations, he shall fill ruins: he shall crush the heads in the land of many. ⁷ He shall drink of the torrent in the way: therefore shall he lift up the head.

THE APOSTOLIC CHURCH

The Acts of the Apostles entire, from the Ascension to Rome, with three psalms the apostles preach from, and one passage of the Apocalypse to close the arc opened in Genesis 1. The epistles are not read; see the omissions.

333. The Ascension, and the choosing of Matthias

Acts 1:1-26

1 ¹ The former treatise I made, O Theophilus, of all things which Jesus began to do and to teach, ² Until the day on which, giving commandments by the Holy Ghost to the apostles whom he had chosen, he was taken up. ³ To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion, by many proofs, for forty days appearing to them, and speaking of the kingdom of God. ⁴ And eating together with them, he commanded them, that they should not depart from Jerusalem, but should wait for the promise of the Father, which you have heard (saith he) by my mouth. ⁵ For John indeed baptized with water: but you shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost, not many days hence. ⁶ They therefore who were come together, asked him, saying: Lord, wilt thou at this time restore again the kingdom of Israel? ⁷ But he said to them: It is not for you to know the times or moments, which the Father hath put in his own power: ⁸ But you shall receive the power of the Holy Ghost coming upon you, and you shall be witnesses unto me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea, and Samaria, and even to the uttermost part of the earth. ⁹ And when he had said these things, while they looked on, he was raised up: and a cloud received him out of their sight. ¹⁰ And while they were beholding him going up to heaven, behold two men stood by them in white garments. ¹¹ Who also said: Ye men of Galilee, why stand you looking up to heaven? This Jesus who is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come as you have seen him going into heaven. ¹² Then they returned to Jerusalem from the mount that is called Olivet, which is nigh Jerusalem, within a sabbath day's journey. ¹³ And when they were come in, they went up into an upper room, where abode Peter and John, James and Andrew, Philip and Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James of Alpheus and Simon Zelotes and Jude the brother of James. ¹⁴ All these were persevering with one mind in prayer with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brethren.

¹⁵ In those days Peter rising up in the midst of the brethren, said (now the number of persons together was about an hundred and twenty): ¹⁶ Men, brethren, the scripture must needs be fulfilled, which the Holy Ghost spoke before by the mouth of David concerning Judas, who was the leader of them that apprehended Jesus: ¹⁷ Who was numbered with us, and had obtained part of this ministry. ¹⁸ And he indeed hath possessed a field of the reward of iniquity, and being hanged, burst asunder in the

midst: and all his bowels gushed out. ¹⁹ And it became known to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem: so that the same field was called in their tongue, Haceldama, that is to say, The field of blood. ²⁰ For it is written in the book of Psalms: Let their habitation become desolate, and let there be none to dwell therein. And his bishopric let another take. ²¹ Wherefore of these men who have companied with us, all the time that the Lord Jesus came in and went out among us, ²² Beginning from the baptism of John, until the day wherein he was taken up from us, one of these must be made a witness with us of his resurrection. ²³ And they appointed two, Joseph, called Barsabas, who was surnamed Justus, and Matthias. ²⁴ And praying, they said: Thou, Lord, who knowest the heart of all men, shew whether of these two thou hast chosen, ²⁵ To take the place of this ministry and apostleship, from which Judas hath by transgression fallen, that he might go to his own place. ²⁶ And they gave them lots, and the lot fell upon Matthias, and he was numbered with the eleven apostles.

334. Pentecost

Acts 2:1-47

Babel, read in the Early World, is answered here. St. Peter preaches from Joel and from Psalms 15 and 109.

2 ¹ And when the days of the Pentecost were accomplished, they were all together in one place: ² And suddenly there came a sound from heaven, as of a mighty wind coming: and it filled the whole house where they were sitting. ³ And there appeared to them parted tongues, as it were of fire: and it sat upon every one of them. ⁴ And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost: and they began to speak with divers tongues, according as the Holy Ghost gave them to speak. ⁵ Now there were dwelling at Jerusalem, Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven. ⁶ And when this was noised abroad, the multitude came together, and were confounded in mind, because that every man heard them speak in his own tongue. ⁷ And they were all amazed, and wondered, saying: Behold, are not all these that speak Galileans? ⁸ And how have we heard, every man our own tongue wherein we were born? ⁹ Parthians and Medes and Elamites and inhabitants of Mesopotamia, Judea, and Cappadocia, Pontus and Asia, ¹⁰ Phrygia and Pamphylia, Egypt and the parts of Libya about Cyrene, and strangers of Rome, ¹¹ Jews also, and proselytes, Cretes, and Arabians: we have heard them speak in our own tongues the wonderful works of God. ¹² And they were all astonished, and wondered, saying one to another: What meaneth this? ¹³ But others mocking, said: These men are full of new wine.

¹⁴ But Peter standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and spoke to them: Ye men of Judea, and all you that dwell in Jerusalem, be this known to you and with your ears receive my words. ¹⁵ For these are not drunk, as you suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day: ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken of by the prophet Joel: ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass, in the last days, (saith the Lord), I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy: and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams. ¹⁸ And upon my servants indeed and upon my handmaids will I pour out in those days of my spirit: and they shall prophesy. ¹⁹ And I will shew wonders in the heaven above, and signs on the

earth beneath: blood and fire, and vapour of smoke. ²⁰ The sun shall be turned into darkness and the moon into blood, before the great and manifest day of the Lord shall come. ²¹ And it shall come to pass, that whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved. ²² Ye men of Israel, hear these words: Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs, which God did by him, in the midst of you, as you also know: ²³ This same being delivered up, by the determinate counsel and foreknowledge of God, you by the hands of wicked men have crucified and slain. ²⁴ Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the sorrows of hell, as it was impossible that he should be holden by it. ²⁵ For David saith concerning him: I foresaw the Lord before my face: because he is at my right hand, that I may not be moved. ²⁶ For this my heart hath been glad, and my tongue hath rejoiced: moreover my flesh also shall rest in hope. ²⁷ Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell: nor suffer thy Holy One to see corruption. ²⁸ Thou hast made known to me the ways of life: thou shalt make me full of joy with thy countenance. ²⁹ Ye men, brethren, let me freely speak to you of the patriarch David: that he died and was buried; and his sepulchre is with us to this present day. ³⁰ Whereas therefore he was a prophet and knew that God hath sworn to him with an oath, that of the fruit of his loins one should sit upon his throne. ³¹ Foreseeing this, he spoke of the resurrection of Christ. For neither was he left in hell: neither did his flesh see corruption. ³² This Jesus hath God raised again, whereof all we are witnesses. ³³ Being exalted therefore by the right hand of God and having received of the Father the promise of the Holy Ghost, he hath poured forth this which you see and hear. ³⁴ For David ascended not into heaven; but he himself said: The Lord said to my Lord: Sit thou on my right hand. ³⁵ Until I make thy enemies thy footstool. ³⁶ Therefore let all the house of Israel know most certainly that God hath made both Lord and Christ, this same Jesus, whom you have crucified.

³⁷ Now when they had heard these things, they had compunction in their heart and said to Peter and to the rest of the apostles: What shall we do, men and brethren? ³⁸ But Peter said to them: Do penance: and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ, for the remission of your sins. And you shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost. ³⁹ For the promise is to you and to your children and to all that are far off, whomsoever the Lord our God shall call. ⁴⁰ And with very many other words did he testify and exhort them, saying: Save yourselves from this perverse generation.

⁴¹ They therefore that received his word were baptized: and there were added in that day about three thousand souls. ⁴² And they were persevering in the doctrine of the apostles and in the communication of the breaking of bread and in prayers. ⁴³ And fear came upon every soul. Many wonders also and signs were done by the apostles in Jerusalem: and there was great fear in all. ⁴⁴ And all they that believed were together and had all things common. ⁴⁵ Their possessions and goods they sold and divided them to all, according as every one had need. ⁴⁶ And continuing daily with one accord in the temple and breaking bread from house to house, they took their meat with gladness and simplicity of heart: ⁴⁷ Praising God and having favour with

all the people. And the Lord increased daily together such as should be saved.

335. Psalm 15

Psalms 15:1-11

Vulgate 15 = Hebrew 16: "Thou wilt not leave my soul in hell" - quoted in Acts 2.

15 ¹ The inscription of a title to David himself. Preserve me, O Lord, for I have put my trust in thee. ² I have said to the Lord, thou art my God, for thou hast no need of my goods. ³ To the saints, who are in his land, he hath made wonderful all my desires in them. ⁴ Their infirmities were multiplied: afterwards they made haste. I will not gather together their meetings for bloodofferings: nor will I be mindful of their names by my lips. ⁵ The Lord is the portion of my inheritance and of my cup: it is thou that wilt restore my inheritance to me. ⁶ The lines are fallen unto me in goodly places: for my inheritance is goodly to me. ⁷ I will bless the Lord, who hath given me understanding: moreover, my reins also have corrected me even till night. ⁸ I set the Lord always in my sight: for he is at my right hand, that I be not moved. ⁹ Therefore my heart hath been glad, and my tongue hath rejoiced: moreover, my flesh also shall rest in hope. ¹⁰ Because thou wilt not leave my soul in hell; nor wilt thou give thy holy one to see corruption. ¹¹ Thou hast made known to me the ways of life, thou shalt fill me with joy with thy countenance: at thy right hand are delights even to the end.

336. The lame man at the Beautiful gate

Acts 3:1-26

3 ¹ Now Peter and John went up into the temple at the ninth hour of prayer. ² And a certain man who was lame from his mother's womb was carried: whom they laid every day at the gate of the temple, which is called Beautiful, that he might ask alms of them that went into the temple. ³ He, when he had seen Peter and John, about to go into the temple, asked to receive an alms. ⁴ But Peter with John, fastening his eyes upon him, said: Look upon us. ⁵ But he looked earnestly upon them, hoping that he should receive something of them. ⁶ But Peter said: Silver and gold I have none; but what I have, I give thee. In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, arise and walk. ⁷ And taking him by the right hand, he lifted him up: and forthwith his feet and soles received strength. ⁸ And he leaping up, stood and walked and went in with them into the temple, walking and leaping and praising God. ⁹ And all the people saw him walking and praising God. ¹⁰ And they knew him, that it was he who sat begging alms at the Beautiful gate of the temple: and they were filled with wonder and amazement at that which had happened to him. ¹¹ And as he held Peter and John, all the people ran to them, to the porch which is called Solomon's, greatly wondering.

¹² But Peter seeing, made answer to the people: Ye men of Israel, why wonder you at this? Or why look you upon us, as if by our strength or power we had made this man to walk?

¹³ The God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, the God of our fathers, hath glorified his Son Jesus, whom you indeed delivered up and denied before the face of Pilate, when he judged he should be released. ¹⁴ But you denied the Holy One and the Just: and desired a murderer to be granted

unto you. ¹⁵ But the author of life you killed, whom God hath raised from the dead: of which we are witnesses. ¹⁶ And in the faith of his name, this man, whom you have seen and known, hath his name strengthened. And the faith which is by him hath given this perfect soundness in the sight of you all. ¹⁷ And now, brethren, I know that you did it through ignorance: as did also your rulers. ¹⁸ But those things which God before had shewed by the mouth of all the prophets, that his Christ should suffer, he hath so fulfilled.

¹⁹ Be penitent, therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out. ²⁰ That when the times of refreshment shall come from the presence of the Lord, and he shall send him who hath been preached unto you, Jesus Christ. ²¹ Whom heaven indeed must receive, until the times of the restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of his holy prophets, from the beginning of the world. ²² For Moses said: A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me: him you shall hear according to all things whatsoever he shall speak to you. ²³ And it shall be, that every soul which will not hear that prophet shall be destroyed from among the people. ²⁴ And all the prophets, from Samuel and afterwards, who have spoken, have told of these days. ²⁵ You are the children of the prophets and of the testament which God made to our fathers, saying to Abraham: And in thy seed shall all the kindreds of the earth be blessed. ²⁶ To you first, God, raising up his Son, hath sent him to bless you: that every one may convert himself from his wickedness.

337. Peter and John before the council

Acts 4:1-37

4 ¹ And as they were speaking to the people the priests and the officer of the temple and the Sadducees came upon them, ² Being grieved that they taught the people and preached in Jesus the resurrection from the dead: ³ And they laid hands upon them and put them in hold till the next day: for it was now evening. ⁴ But many of them who had heard the word believed: and the number of the men was made five thousand.

⁵ And it came to pass on the morrow, that their princes and ancients and scribes were gathered together in Jerusalem. ⁶ And Annas the high priest and Caiphas and John and Alexander: and as many as were of the kindred of the high priest. ⁷ And setting them in the midst, they asked: By what power or by what name, have you done this? ⁸ Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said to them: Ye princes of the people and ancients, hear. ⁹ If we this day are examined concerning the good deed done to the infirm man, by what means he hath been made whole: ¹⁰ Be it known to you all and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of our Lord Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom you crucified, whom God hath raised from the dead, even by him, this man standeth here before you, whole. ¹¹ This is the stone which was rejected by you the builders, which is become the head of the corner. ¹² Neither is there salvation in any other. For there is no other name under heaven given to men, whereby we must be saved.

¹³ Now seeing the constancy of Peter and of John, understanding that they were illiterate and ignorant men, they wondered: and they knew them that they had been with Jesus. ¹⁴ Seeing the man also who had been healed, standing with them, they

could say nothing against it. ¹⁵ But they commanded them to go aside out of the council: and they conferred among themselves, ¹⁶ Saying: What shall we do to these men? For indeed a miracle hath been done by them, known to all the inhabitants of Jerusalem. It is manifest: and we cannot deny it. ¹⁷ But that it may be no farther spread among the people, let us threaten them that they speak no more in this name to any man. ¹⁸ And calling them, they charged them not to speak at all, nor teach in the name of Jesus. ¹⁹ But Peter and John answering, said to them: If it be just, in the sight of God, to hear you rather than God, judge ye. ²⁰ For we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard. ²¹ But they, threatening, sent them away, not finding how they might punish them, because of the people: for all men glorified what had been done, in that which had come to pass. ²² For the man was above forty years old, in whom that miraculous cure had been wrought.

²³ And being let go, they came to their own company and related all that the chief priests and ancients had said to them. ²⁴ Who having heard it, with one accord lifted up their voice to God and said: Lord, thou art he that didst make heaven and earth, the sea and all things that are in them. ²⁵ Who, by the Holy Ghost, by the mouth of our father David, thy servant, hast said: Why did the Gentiles rage: and the people meditate vain things? ²⁶ The kings of the earth stood up: and the princes assembled together against the Lord and his Christ. ²⁷ For of a truth there assembled together in this city against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles and the people of Israel, ²⁸ To do what thy hand and thy counsel decreed to be done. ²⁹ And now, Lord, behold their threatenings: and grant unto thy servants that with all confidence they may speak thy word, ³⁰ By stretching forth thy hand to cures and signs and wonders, to be done by the name of thy holy Son, Jesus.

³¹ And when they had prayed, the place was moved wherein they were assembled: and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost: and they spoke the word of God with confidence. ³² And the multitude of believers had but one heart and one soul. Neither did any one say that aught of the things which he possessed was his own: but all things were common unto them. ³³ And with great power did the Apostles give testimony of the resurrection of Jesus Christ our Lord: and great grace was in them all. ³⁴ For neither was there any one needy among them. For as many as were owners of lands or houses sold them and brought the price of the things they sold, ³⁵ And laid it down before the feet of the apostles. And distribution was made to every one, according as he had need. ³⁶ And Joseph, who, by the apostles, was surnamed Barnabas (which is, by interpretation, The son of consolation), a Levite, a Cyprian born, ³⁷ Having land, sold it and brought the price and laid it at the feet of the Apostles.

338. Psalm 2

Psalms 2:1-13

Vulgate 2 = Hebrew 2: "Why have the Gentiles raged" - prayed by the Church in Acts 4.

2 ¹ Why have the Gentiles raged, and the people devised vain things? ² The kings of the earth stood up, and the princes met together, against the Lord, and against his Christ. ³ Let us break

their bonds asunder: and let us cast away their yoke from us. ⁴ He that dwelleth in heaven shall laugh at them: and the Lord shall deride them. ⁵ Then shall he speak to them in his anger, and trouble them in his rage. ⁶ But I am appointed king by him over Sion, his holy mountain, preaching his commandment. ⁷ The Lord hath said to me: Thou art my son, this day have I begotten thee. ⁸ Ask of me, and I will give thee the Gentiles for thy inheritance, and the utmost parts of the earth for thy possession. ⁹ Thou shalt rule them with a rod of iron, and shalt break them in pieces like a potter's vessel. ¹⁰ And now, O ye kings, understand: receive instruction, you that judge the earth. ¹¹ Serve ye the Lord with fear: and rejoice unto him with trembling. ¹² Embrace discipline, lest at any time the Lord be angry, and you perish from the just way. ¹³ When his wrath shall be kindled in a short time, blessed are all they that trust in him.

339. Ananias and Saphira; the apostles imprisoned

Acts 5:1-42

⁵ ¹ But a certain man named Ananias, with Saphira his wife, sold a piece of land, ² And by fraud kept back part of the price of the land, his wife being privy thereunto: and bringing a certain part of it, laid it at the feet of the apostles. ³ But Peter said: Ananias, why hath Satan tempted thy heart, that thou shouldst lie to the Holy Ghost and by fraud keep part of the price of the land? ⁴ Whilst it remained, did it not remain to thee? And after it was sold, was it not in thy power? Why hast thou conceived this thing in thy heart? Thou hast not lied to men, but to God. ⁵ And Ananias, hearing these words, fell down and gave up the ghost. And there came great fear upon all that heard it. ⁶ And the young men rising up, removed him, and carrying him out, buried him. ⁷ And it was about the space of three hours after, when his wife, not knowing what had happened, came in. ⁸ And Peter said to her: Tell me, woman, whether you sold the land for so much? And she said: Yea, for so much. ⁹ And Peter said unto her: Why have you agreed together to tempt the spirit of the Lord? Behold the feet of them who have buried thy husband are at the door: and they shall carry thee out, ¹⁰ Immediately, she fell down before his feet and gave up the ghost. And the young men coming in found her dead: and carried her out and buried her by her husband. ¹¹ And there came great fear upon the whole church and upon all that heard these things.

¹² And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people. And they were all with one accord in Solomon's porch. ¹³ But of the rest no man durst join himself unto them: but the people magnified them. ¹⁴ And the multitude of men and women who believed in the Lord was more increased: ¹⁵ Insomuch that they brought forth the sick into the streets and laid them on beds and couches, that, when Peter came, his shadow at the least might overshadow any of them and they might be delivered from their infirmities. ¹⁶ And there came also together to Jerusalem a multitude out of the neighbouring cities, bringing sick persons and such as were troubled with unclean spirits: who were all healed.

¹⁷ Then the high priest rising up, and all they that were with him (which is the heresy of the Sadducees) were filled with envy. ¹⁸ And they laid hands on the apostles and put them in the common prison. ¹⁹ But an angel of the Lord by night, opening the doors of the prison and leading them out, said: ²⁰ Go, and

standing speak in the temple to the people all the words of this life. ²¹ Who having heard this, early in the morning, entered into the temple and taught. And the high priest coming, and they that were with him, called together the council and all the ancients of the children of Israel: and they sent to the prison to have them brought. ²² But when the ministers came and opening the prison found them not there, they returned and told, ²³ Saying: The prison indeed we found shut with all diligence, and the keepers standing before the doors; but opening it, we found no man within. ²⁴ Now when the officer of the temple and the chief priests heard these words, they were in doubt concerning them, what would come to pass. ²⁵ But one came and told them: Behold, the men whom you put in prison are in the temple, standing and teaching the people. ²⁶ Then went the officer with the ministers and brought them without violence: for they feared the people, lest they should be stoned. ²⁷ And when they had brought them, they set them before the council. And the high priest asked them, ²⁸ Saying: Commanding, we commanded you that you should not teach in this name. And behold, you have filled Jerusalem with your doctrine: and you have a mind to bring the blood of this man upon us.

²⁹ But Peter and the apostles answering, said: We ought to obey God rather than men. ³⁰ The God of our fathers hath raised up Jesus, whom you put to death, hanging him upon a tree. ³¹ Him hath God exalted with his right hand, to be Prince and Saviour, to give repentance to Israel and remission of sins. ³² And we are witnesses of these things: and the Holy Ghost, whom God hath given to all that obey him.

³³ When they had heard these things, they were cut to the heart: and they thought to put them to death. ³⁴ But one in the council rising up, a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law, respected by all the people, commanded the men to be put forth a little while. ³⁵ And he said to them: Ye men of Israel, take heed to yourselves what you intend to do, as touching these men. ³⁶ For before these days rose up Theodas, affirming himself to be somebody, to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves. Who was slain: and all that believed him were scattered and brought to nothing. ³⁷ After this man, rose up Judas of Galilee, in the days of the enrolling, and drew away the people after him. He also perished: and all, even as many as consented to him, were dispersed. ³⁸ And now, therefore, I say to you: Refrain from these men and let them alone. For if this council or this work be of men, it will come to nought: ³⁹ But if it be of God, you cannot overthrow it, lest perhaps you be found even to fight against God. And they consented to him. ⁴⁰ And calling in the apostles, after they had scourged them, they charged them that they should not speak at all in the name of Jesus. And they dismissed them. ⁴¹ And they indeed went from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were accounted worthy to suffer reproach for the name of Jesus. ⁴² And every day they ceased not, in the temple and from house to house, to teach and preach Christ Jesus.

340. Stephen

Acts 6:1-7:59

Stephen's speech is the salvation history of this plan, told in one breath before his death.

6 ¹ And in those days, the number of the disciples increasing, there arose a murmuring of the Greeks against the Hebrews, for that their widows were neglected in the daily ministration. ² Then the twelve, calling together the multitude of the disciples, said: It is not reason that we should leave the word of God and serve tables. ³ Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of good reputation, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business. ⁴ But we will give ourselves continually to prayer and to the ministry of the word.

⁵ And the saying was liked by all the multitude. And they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip and Prochorus and Nicanor, and Timon and Parmenas and Nicolas, a proselyte of Antioch. ⁶ These they set before the apostles: and they praying, imposed hands upon them. ⁷ And the word of the Lord increased: and the number of the disciples was multiplied in Jerusalem exceedingly. A great multitude also of the priests obeyed the faith. ⁸ And Stephen, full of grace and fortitude, did great wonders and signs among the people. ⁹ Now there arose some, of that which is called the synagogue of the Libertines and of the Cyrenians and of the Alexandrians and of them that were of Cilicia and Asia, disputing with Stephen. ¹⁰ And they were not able to resist the wisdom and the spirit that spoke. ¹¹ Then they suborned men to say they had heard him speak words of blasphemy against Moses and against God. ¹² And they stirred up the people and the ancients and the scribes. And running together, they took him and brought him to the council. ¹³ And they set up false witnesses, who said: This man ceaseth not to speak words against the holy place and the law. ¹⁴ For we have heard him say that this Jesus of Nazareth shall destroy this place and shall change the traditions which Moses delivered unto us. ¹⁵ And all that sat in the council, looking on him, saw his face as if it had been the face of an angel.

7 ¹ Then the high priest said: Are these things so? ² Who said: Ye men, brethren and fathers, hear. The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham, when he was in Mesopotamia, before he dwelt in Charan. ³ And said to him: Go forth out of thy country and from thy kindred: and come into the land which I shall shew thee. ⁴ Then he went out of the land of the Chaldeans and dwelt in Charan. And from thence, after his father was dead, he removed him into this land, wherein you now dwell. ⁵ And he gave him no inheritance in it: no, not the pace of a foot. But he promised to give it him in possession, and to his seed after him, when as yet he had no child. ⁶ And God said to him: That his seed should sojourn in a strange country, and that they should bring them under bondage and treat them evil four hundred years. ⁷ And the nation which they shall serve will I judge (said the Lord): and after these things they shall go out and shall serve me in this place. ⁸ And he gave him the covenant of circumcision. And so he begot Isaac and circumcised him the eighth day: and Isaac begot Jacob: and Jacob, the twelve patriarchs. ⁹ And the patriarchs, through envy, sold Joseph into Egypt. And God was with him, ¹⁰ And delivered him out of all his tribulations: and he gave him favour and wisdom in the sight of Pharao, the king of Egypt. And he appointed him governor over Egypt and over all his house. ¹¹ Now there came a famine upon all Egypt and Chanaan, and great tribulation: and our fathers found no food. ¹² But when Jacob had heard that there was corn in Egypt, he sent

our fathers first. ¹³ And at the second time, Joseph was known by his brethren: and his kindred was made known to Pharao. ¹⁴ And Joseph sending, called thither Jacob, his father, and all his kindred, seventy-five souls. ¹⁵ So Jacob went down into Egypt. And he died, and our fathers. ¹⁶ And they were translated into Sichem and were laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought for a sum of money of the sons of Hemor, the son of Sichem. ¹⁷ And when the time of the promise drew near, which God had promised to Abraham, the people increased and were multiplied in Egypt. ¹⁸ Till another king arose in Egypt, who knew not Joseph. ¹⁹ This same, dealing craftily with our race, afflicted our fathers, that they should expose their children, to the end they might not be kept alive. ²⁰ At the same time was Moses born: and he was acceptable to God. Who was nourished three months in his father's house. ²¹ And when he was exposed, Pharao's daughter took him up and nourished him for her own son. ²² And Moses was instructed in all the wisdom of the Egyptians: and he was mighty in his words and in his deeds. ²³ And when he was full forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brethren, the children of Israel. ²⁴ And when he had seen one of them suffer wrong, he defended him: and striking the Egyptian, he avenged him who suffered the injury. ²⁵ And he thought that his brethren understood that God by his hand would save them. But they understood it not. ²⁶ And the day following, he shewed himself to them when they were at strife and would have reconciled them in peace, saying: Men, ye are brethren. Why hurt you one another? ²⁷ But he that did the injury to his neighbour thrust him away, saying: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge over us? ²⁸ What! Wilt thou kill me, as thou didst yesterday kill the Egyptian? ²⁹ And Moses fled upon this word: and was a stranger in the land of Madian, where he begot two sons. ³⁰ And when forty years were expired, there appeared to him, in the desert of mount Sina, an angel in a flame of fire in a bush. ³¹ And Moses seeing it wondered at the sight. And as he drew near to view it, the voice of the Lord came unto him, saying: ³² I am the God of thy fathers: the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob. And Moses being terrified durst not behold. ³³ And the Lord said to him: Loose the shoes from thy feet: for the place wherein thou standest is holy ground. ³⁴ Seeing, I have seen the affliction of my people which is in Egypt: and I have heard their groaning and am come down to deliver them. And now come: and I will send thee into Egypt. ³⁵ This Moses, whom they refused, saying: Who hath appointed thee prince and judge? Him God sent to be prince and redeemer, by the hand of the angel who appeared to him in the bush. ³⁶ He brought them out, doing wonders and signs in the land of Egypt and in the Red Sea and in the desert, forty years. ³⁷ This is that Moses who said to the children of Israel: A prophet shall God raise up to you of your own brethren, as myself. Him shall you hear. ³⁸ This is he that was in the church in the wilderness, with the angel who spoke to him on Mount Sina and with our fathers. Who received the words of life to give unto us. ³⁹ Whom our fathers would not obey: but thrust him away and in their hearts turned back into Egypt, ⁴⁰ Saying to Aaron: Make us gods to go before us. For as for this Moses, who brought us out of the land of Egypt, we know not what is become of him. ⁴¹ And they made a calf in those days and offered sacrifices to the idol and rejoiced in the

works of their own hands. ⁴² And God turned and gave them up to serve the host of heaven, as it is written in the books of the prophets: Did you offer victims and sacrifices to me for forty years, in the desert, O house of Israel? ⁴³ And you took unto you the tabernacle of Moloch and the star of your god Rempham, figures which you made to adore them. And I will carry you away beyond Babylon. ⁴⁴ The tabernacle of the testimony was with our fathers in the desert, as God ordained for them, speaking to Moses, that he should make it according to the form which he had seen. ⁴⁵ Which also our fathers receiving, brought in with Jesus, into the possession of the Gentiles: whom God drove out before the face of our fathers, unto the days of David, ⁴⁶ Who found grace before God and desired to find a tabernacle for the God of Jacob. ⁴⁷ But Solomon built him a house, ⁴⁸ Yet the most High dwelleth not in houses made by hands, as the prophet saith: ⁴⁹ Heaven is my throne and the earth my footstool. What house will you build me (saith the Lord)? Or what is the place of my resting? ⁵⁰ Hath not my hand made all these things?

⁵¹ You stiffnecked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Ghost. As your fathers did, so do you also. ⁵² Which of the prophets have not your fathers persecuted? And they have slain them who foretold of the coming of the Just One: of whom you have been now the betrayers and murderers. ⁵³ Who have received the law by the disposition of angels and have not kept it.

⁵⁴ Now hearing these things, they were cut to the heart: and they gnashed with their teeth at him. ⁵⁵ But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looking up steadfastly to heaven, saw the glory of God and Jesus standing on the right hand of God. And he said: Behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God. ⁵⁶ And they, crying out with a loud voice, stopped their ears and with one accord ran violently upon him. ⁵⁷ And casting him forth without the city, they stoned him. And the witnesses laid down their garments at the feet of a young man, whose name was Saul. ⁵⁸ And they stoned Stephen, invoking and saying: Lord Jesus, receive my spirit. ⁵⁹ And falling on his knees, he cried with a loud voice, saying: Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep in the Lord. And Saul was consenting to his death.

341. Philip in Samaria, and on the road to Gaza

Acts 8:1-40

The eunuch is reading Isaia 53, which this plan reads in the Exile.

⁸ ¹ And at that time, there was raised a great persecution against the church which was at Jerusalem. And they were all dispersed through the countries of Judea, and Samaria, except the apostles. ² And devout men took order for Stephen's funeral and made great mourning over him. ³ But Saul made havock of the church, entering in from house to house: and dragging away men and women, committed them to prison. ⁴ They therefore that were dispersed went about preaching the word of God. ⁵ And Philip, going down to the city of Samaria, preached Christ unto them. ⁶ And the people with one accord were attentive to those things which were said by Philip, hearing, and seeing the miracles which he did. ⁷ For many of them who had unclean spirits, crying with a loud voice, went out. ⁸ And many, taken with the

palsy, and that were lame, were healed. ⁹ There was therefore great joy in that city. Now there was a certain man named Simon who before had been a magician in that city, seducing the people of Samaria, giving out that he was some great one: ¹⁰ To whom they all gave ear, from the least to the greatest, saying: This man is the power of God, which is called great. ¹¹ And they were attentive to him, because, for a long time, he had bewitched them with his magical practices. ¹² But when they had believed Philip preaching of the kingdom of God, in the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women. ¹³ Then Simon himself believed also and, being baptized, he adhered to Philip. And being astonished, wondered to see the signs and exceeding great miracles which were done. ¹⁴ Now, when the apostles, who were in Jerusalem, had heard that Samaria had received the word of God, they sent unto them Peter and John. ¹⁵ Who, when they were come, prayed for them that they might receive the Holy Ghost. ¹⁶ For he was not as yet come upon any of them: but they were only baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus. ¹⁷ Then they laid their hands upon them: and they received the Holy Ghost. ¹⁸ And when Simon saw that, by the imposition of the hands of the apostles, the Holy Ghost was given, he offered them money, ¹⁹ Saying: Give me also this power, that on whomsoever I shall lay my hands, he may receive the Holy Ghost. But Peter said to him: ²⁰ Keep thy money to thyself, to perish with thee: because thou hast thought that the gift of God may be purchased with money. ²¹ Thou hast no part nor lot in this matter. For thy heart is not right in the sight of God. ²² Do penance therefore for this thy wickedness: and pray to God, that perhaps this thought of thy heart may be forgiven thee. ²³ For I see thou art in the gall of bitterness and in the bonds of iniquity. ²⁴ Then Simon answering, said: Pray you for me to the Lord that none of these things which you have spoken may come upon me. ²⁵ And they indeed, having testified and preached the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem: and preached the gospel to many countries of the Samaritans. ²⁶ Now an angel of the Lord spoke to Philip, saying: Arise, go towards the south, to the way that goeth down from Jerusalem into Gaza: this is desert. ²⁷ And rising up, he went. And behold, a man of Ethiopia, an eunuch, of great authority under Candace the queen of the Ethiopians, who had charge over all her treasures, had come to Jerusalem to adore. ²⁸ And he was returning, sitting in his chariot and reading Isaia the prophet. ²⁹ And the Spirit said to Philip: Go near and join thyself to this chariot. ³⁰ And Philip running thither, heard him reading the prophet Isaia. And he said: Thinkest thou that thou understandest what thou readest? ³¹ Who said: And how can I, unless some man shew me? And he desired Philip that he would come up and sit with him. ³² And the place of the scripture which he was reading was this: He was led as a sheep to the slaughter: and like a lamb without voice before his shearer, so openeth he not his mouth. ³³ In humility his judgment was taken away. His generation who shall declare, for his life shall be taken from the earth? ³⁴ And the eunuch answering Philip, said: I beseech thee, of whom doth the prophet speak this? Of himself, or of some other man? ³⁵ Then Philip, opening his mouth and beginning at this scripture, preached unto him Jesus. ³⁶ And as they went on their way, they came to a certain water. And the eunuch said: See, here is water: What doth hinder me from being

baptized? ³⁷ And Philip said: If thou believest with all thy heart, thou mayest. And he answering, said: I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God. ³⁸ And he commanded the chariot to stand still. And they went down into the water, both Philip and the eunuch. And he baptized him. ³⁹ And when they were come up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord took away Philip: and the eunuch saw him no more. And he went on his way rejoicing. ⁴⁰ But Philip was found in Azotus: and passing through, he preached the gospel to all the cities, till he came to Cæsarea.

342. The conversion of Saul

Acts 9:1-31

9 ¹ And Saul, as yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest ² And asked of him letters to Damascus, to the synagogues: that if he found any men and women of this way, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem. ³ And as he went on his journey, it came to pass that he drew nigh to Damascus. And suddenly a light from heaven shined round about him. ⁴ And falling on the ground, he heard a voice saying to him: Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? ⁵ Who said: Who art thou, Lord? And he: I am Jesus whom thou persecutest. It is hard for thee to kick against the goad. ⁶ And he, trembling and astonished, said: Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? ⁷ And the Lord said to him: Arise and go into the city; and there it shall be told thee what thou must do. Now the men who went in company with him stood amazed, hearing indeed a voice but seeing no man. ⁸ And Saul arose from the ground: and when his eyes were opened, he saw nothing. But they, leading him by the hands, brought him to Damascus. ⁹ And he was there three days without sight: and he did neither eat nor drink.

¹⁰ Now there was a certain disciple at Damascus, named Ananias. And the Lord said to him in a vision: Ananias, And he said: Behold I am here, Lord. ¹¹ And the Lord said to him: Arise and go into the street that is called Strait and seek in the house of Judas, one named Saul of Tarsus. For behold he prayeth. ¹² (And he saw a man named Ananias coming in and putting his hands upon him, that he might receive his sight.) ¹³ But Ananias answered: Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints in Jerusalem. ¹⁴ And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that invoke thy name. ¹⁵ And the Lord said to him: Go thy way: for this man is to me a vessel of election, to carry my name before the Gentiles and kings and the children of Israel. ¹⁶ For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake. ¹⁷ And Ananias went his way and entered into the house. And laying his hands upon him, he said: Brother Saul, the Lord Jesus hath sent me, he that appeared to thee in the way as thou camest, that thou mayest receive thy sight and be filled with the Holy Ghost. ¹⁸ And immediately there fell from his eyes as it were scales: and he received his sight. And rising up, he was baptized. ¹⁹ And when he had taken meat, he was strengthened. And he was with the disciples that were at Damascus, for some days. ²⁰ And immediately he preached Jesus in the synagogues, that he is the son of God. ²¹ And all that heard him were astonished and said: Is not this he who persecuted in Jerusalem those that called upon this name and came hither for that intent, that he might carry them bound to the chief priests? ²² But Saul increased much more in strength

and confounded the Jews who dwelt at Damascus, affirming that this is the Christ. ²³ And when many days were passed, the Jews consulted together to kill him. ²⁴ But their lying in wait was made known to Saul. And they watched the gates also day and night, that they might kill him. ²⁵ But the disciples, taking him in the night, conveyed him away by the wall, letting him down in a basket. ²⁶ And when he was come into Jerusalem, he essayed to join himself to the disciples: and they all were afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple. ²⁷ But Barnabas took him and brought him to the apostles and told them how he had seen the Lord, and that he had spoken to him: and how in Damascus he had dealt confidently in the name of Jesus. ²⁸ And he was with them, coming in and going out in Jerusalem and dealing confidently in the name of the Lord. ²⁹ He spoke also to the Gentiles and disputed with the Greeks. But they sought to kill him. ³⁰ Which when the brethren had known, they brought him down to Cæsarea and sent him away to Tarsus. ³¹ Now, the church had peace throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria: and was edified, walking in the fear of the Lord: and was filled with the consolation of the Holy Ghost.

343. Cornelius, and the door opened to the Gentiles

Acts 9:32-11:18

9 ³² And it came to pass that Peter, as he passed through, visiting all, came to the saints who dwelt at Lydda. ³³ And he found there a certain man named Eneas, who had kept his bed for eight years, who was ill of the palsy. ³⁴ And Peter said to him: Eneas, the Lord Jesus Christ healeth thee. Arise and make thy bed. And immediately he arose. ³⁵ And all that dwelt at Lydda and Saron saw him: who were converted to the Lord.

³⁶ And in Joppe there was a certain disciple named Tabitha, which by interpretation is called Dorcas. This woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did. ³⁷ And it came to pass in those days that she was sick and died. Whom when they had washed, they laid her in an upper chamber. ³⁸ And forasmuch as Lydda was nigh to Joppe, the disciples, hearing that Peter was there, sent unto him two men, desiring him that he would not be slack to come unto them. ³⁹ And Peter rising up went with them. And when he was come, they brought him into the upper chamber. And all the widows stood about him, weeping and shewing him the coats and garments which Dorcas made them. ⁴⁰ And they all being put forth, Peter, kneeling down, prayed. And turning to the body, he said: Tabitha, arise. And she opened her eyes and, seeing Peter, sat up. ⁴¹ And giving her his hand, he lifted her up. And when he had called the saints and the widows, he presented her alive. ⁴² And it was made known throughout all Joppe. And many believed in the Lord. ⁴³ And it came to pass that he abode many days in Joppe, with one Simon a tanner.

10 ¹ And there was a certain man in Cæsarea, named Cornelius, a centurion of that which is called the Italian band: ² A religious man, and fearing God with all his house, giving much alms to the people and always praying to God. ³ This man saw in a vision manifestly, about the ninth hour of the day, an angel of God coming in unto him and saying to him: Cornelius. ⁴ And he, beholding him, being seized with fear, said: What is it, Lord? And he said to him: Thy prayers and thy alms are ascended for a memorial in the sight of God. ⁵ And now send men to Joppe:

and call hither one Simon, who is surnamed Peter. ⁶ He lodgeth with one Simon a tanner, whose house is by the sea side. He will tell thee what thou must do. ⁷ And when the angel who spoke to him was departed, he called two of his household servants and a soldier who feared the Lord, of them that were under him. ⁸ To whom when he had related all, he sent them to Joppe.

⁹ And on the next day, whilst they were going on their journey and drawing nigh to the city, Peter went up to the higher parts of the house to pray, about the sixth hour. ¹⁰ And being hungry, he was desirous to taste somewhat. And as they were preparing, there came upon him an ecstasy of mind. ¹¹ And he saw the heaven opened and a certain vessel descending, as it were a great linen sheet let down by the four corners from heaven to the earth: ¹² Wherein were all manner of four-footed beasts and creeping things of the earth and fowls of the air. ¹³ And there came a voice to him: Arise, Peter. Kill and eat. ¹⁴ But Peter said: Far be it from me. For I never did eat any thing that is common and unclean. ¹⁵ And the voice spoke to him again the second time: That which God hath cleansed, do not thou call common. ¹⁶ And this was done thrice. And presently the vessel was taken up into heaven. ¹⁷ Now, whilst Peter was doubting within himself what the vision that he had seen should mean, behold the men who were sent from Cornelius, inquiring for Simon's house, stood at the gate. ¹⁸ And when they had called, they asked if Simon, who is surnamed Peter, were lodged there. ¹⁹ And as Peter was thinking of the vision, the Spirit said to him: Behold three men seek thee. ²⁰ Arise, therefore: get thee down and go with them, doubting nothing: for I have sent them. ²¹ Then Peter, going down to the men, said: Behold, I am he whom you seek. What is the cause for which you are come? ²² Who said: Cornelius, a centurion, a just man and one that feareth God, and having good testimony from all the nation of the Jews, received an answer of an holy angel, to send for thee into his house And to hear words of thee. ²³ Then bringing them in, he lodged them. And the day following, he arose and went with them: and some of the brethren from Joppe accompanied him. ²⁴ And the morrow after, he entered into Cæsarea. And Cornelius waited for them, having called together his kinsmen and special friends. ²⁵ And it came to pass that when Peter was come in, Cornelius came to meet him and falling at his feet adored. ²⁶ But Peter lifted him up, saying: Arise: I myself also am a man. ²⁷ And talking with him, he went in and found many that were come together. ²⁸ And he said to them: you know how abominable it is for a man that is a Jew to keep company or to come unto one of another nation: but God hath shewed to me, to call no man common or unclean. ²⁹ For which cause, making no doubt, I came when I was sent for. I ask, therefore, for what cause you have sent for me? ³⁰ And Cornelius said: Four days ago, unto this hour, I was praying in my house, at the ninth hour and behold a man stood before me in white apparel and said: ³¹ Cornelius, thy prayer is heard and thy alms are had in remembrance in the sight of God. ³² Send therefore to Joppe: and call hither Simon, who is surnamed Peter. He lodgeth in the house of Simon a tanner, by the sea side. ³³ Immediately therefore I sent to thee: and thou hast done well in coming. Now, therefore, all we are present in thy sight to hear all things whatsoever are commanded thee by the Lord.

³⁴ And Peter opening his mouth, said: in very deed I perceive that God is not a respecter of persons. ³⁵ But in every nation, he that feareth him and worketh justice is acceptable to him. ³⁶ God sent the word to the children of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ (He is Lord of all). ³⁷ You know the word which hath been published through all Judea: for it began from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached. ³⁸ Jesus of Nazareth: how God anointed him with the Holy Ghost and with power, who went about doing good and healing all that were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him. ³⁹ And we are witnesses of all things that he did in the land of the Jews and in Jerusalem: whom they killed, hanging him upon a tree. ⁴⁰ Him God raised up the third day and gave him to be made manifest, ⁴¹ Not to all the people, but to witnesses preordained by God, even to us, who did eat and drink with him, after he arose again from the dead. ⁴² And he commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that it is he who was appointed by God to be judge of the living and of the dead. ⁴³ To him all the prophets give testimony, that by his name all receive remission of sins, who believe in him.

⁴⁴ While Peter was yet speaking these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all them that heard the word. ⁴⁵ And the faithful of the circumcision, who came with Peter, were astonished for that the grace of the Holy Ghost was poured out upon the Gentiles also. ⁴⁶ For they heard them speaking with tongues and magnifying God. ⁴⁷ Then Peter answered: Can any man forbid water, that these should not be baptized, who have received the Holy Ghost, as well as we? ⁴⁸ And he commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ. Then they desired him to tarry with them some days.

11 ¹ And the apostles and brethren, who were in Judea, heard that the Gentiles also had received the word of God. ² And when Peter was come up to Jerusalem, they that were of the circumcision contended with him, ³ Saying: Why didst thou go in to men uncircumcised and didst eat with them? ⁴ But Peter began and declared to them the matter in order, saying: ⁵ I was in the city of Joppe praying: and I saw in an ecstasy of mind a vision, a certain vessel descending, as it were a great sheet let down from heaven by four corners. And it came even unto me. ⁶ Into which looking, I considered and saw fourfooted creatures of the earth and beasts and creeping things and fowls of the air. ⁷ And I heard also a voice saying to me: Arise, Peter. Kill and eat. ⁸ And I said: Not so, Lord: for nothing common or unclean hath ever entered into my mouth. ⁹ And the voice answered again from heaven: What God hath made clean, do not thou call common. ¹⁰ And this was done three times. And all were taken up again into heaven. ¹¹ And behold, immediately there were three men come to the house wherein I was, sent to me from Cæsarea. ¹² And the Spirit said to me that I should go with them, nothing doubting. And these six brethren went with me also: and we entered into the man's house. ¹³ And he told us how he had seen an angel in his house, standing and saying to him: Send to Joppe and call hither Simon, who is surnamed Peter, ¹⁴ Who shall speak to thee words whereby thou shalt be saved, and all thy house. ¹⁵ And when I had begun to speak, the Holy Ghost fell upon them, as upon us also in the beginning. ¹⁶ And I remembered the word of the Lord, how that he said: John indeed baptized with water but

you shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost. ¹⁷ If then God gave them the same grace as to us also who believed in the Lord Jesus Christ: who was I, that could withstand God? ¹⁸ Having heard these things, they held their peace and glorified God, saying: God then hath also to the Gentiles given repentance, unto life.

344. Antioch; Herod; the deliverance of Peter

Acts 11:19-12:25

11 ¹⁹ Now they who had been dispersed by the persecution that arose on occasion of Stephen went about as far as Phenice and Cyprus and Antioch, speaking the word to none, but to the Jews only. ²⁰ But some of them were men of Cyprus and Cyrene, who, when they were entered into Antioch, spoke also to the Greeks, preaching the Lord Jesus. ²¹ And the hand of he Lord was with them: and a great number believing, were converted to the Lord. ²² And the tidings came to the ears of the church that was at Jerusalem, touching these things: and they sent Barnabas as far as Antioch. ²³ Who, when he was come and had seen the grace of God, rejoiced. And he exhorted them all with purpose of heart to continue in the Lord. ²⁴ For he was a good man and full of the Holy Ghost and of faith. And a great multitude was added to the Lord. ²⁵ And Barnabas went to Tarsus to seek Saul: whom, when he had found, he brought to Antioch. ²⁶ And they conversed there in the church a whole year: and they taught a great multitude, so that at Antioch the disciples were first named Christians.

²⁷ And in these days there came prophets from Jerusalem to Antioch. ²⁸ And one of them named Agabus, rising up, signified by the Spirit that there should be a great famine over the whole world, which came to pass under Claudius. ²⁹ And the disciples, every man according to his ability, purposed to send relief to the brethren who dwelt in Judea. ³⁰ Which also they did, sending it to the ancients, by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

12 ¹ And at the same time, Herod the king stretched forth his hands, to afflict some of the church. ² And he killed James, the brother of John, With the sword. ³ And seeing that it pleased the Jews, he proceeded to take up Peter also. Now it was in the days of the Azymes. ⁴ And when he had apprehended him, he cast him into prison, delivering him to four files of soldiers, to be kept, intending, after the pasch, to bring him forth to the people. ⁵ Peter therefore was kept in prison. But prayer was made without ceasing by the church unto God for him. ⁶ And when Herod would have brought him forth, the same night, Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains: and the keepers before the door kept the prison. ⁷ And behold an angel of the Lord stood by him and a light shined in the room. And he, striking Peter on the side, raised him up, saying: Arise quickly. And the chains fell off from his hands. ⁸ And the angel said to him: Gird thyself and put on thy sandals. And he did so. And he said to him: Cast thy garment about thee and follow me, ⁹ And going out, he followed him. And he knew not that it was true which was done by the angel: but thought he saw a vision. ¹⁰ And passing through the first and the second ward, they came to the iron gate that leadeth to the city which of itself opened to them. And going out, they passed on through one street. And immediately the angel departed from him. ¹¹ And Peter coming to himself, said: Now I know in very deed that the

Lord hath sent his angel and hath delivered me out of the hand of Herod and from all the expectation of the people of the Jews. ¹² And considering, he came to the house of Mary the mother of John, who was surnamed Mark, where many were gathered together and praying. ¹³ And when he knocked at the door of the gate, a damsel came to hearken, whose name was Rhode. ¹⁴ And as soon as she knew Peter's voice, she opened not the gate for joy: but running in she told that Peter stood before the gate. ¹⁵ But they said to her: Thou art mad. But she affirmed that it was so. Then said they: It is his angel. ¹⁶ But Peter continued knocking. And when they had opened, they saw him and were astonished. ¹⁷ But he, beckoning to them with his hand to hold their peace, told how the Lord had brought him out of prison. And he said: Tell these things to James and to the brethren. And going out, he went into another place. ¹⁸ Now when day was come, there was no small stir among the soldiers, what was become of Peter. ¹⁹ And when Herod had sought for him and found him not, having examined the keepers, he commanded they should be put to death. And going down from Judea to Cæsarea, he abode there.

²⁰ And he was angry with the Tyrians and the Sidonians. But they with one accord came to him: and, having gained Blastus who was the king's chamberlain, they desired peace, because their countries were nourished by him. ²¹ And upon a day appointed, Herod being arrayed in kingly apparel, sat in the judgment seat and made an oration to them. ²² And the people made acclamation, saying: It is the voice of a god, and not of a man. ²³ And forthwith an angel of the Lord struck him, because he had not given the honour to God: and, being eaten up by worms, he gave up the ghost.

²⁴ But the word of the Lord increased and multiplied. ²⁵ And Barnabas and Saul, returned from Jerusalem, having fulfilled their ministry, taking with them John who was surnamed Mark.

345. The first mission

Acts 13:1-52

13 ¹ Now there were in the church which was at Antioch prophets and doctors, among whom was Barnabas and Simon who was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene and Manahen who was the foster brother of Herod the tetrarch, and Saul. ² And as they were ministering to the Lord and fasting, the Holy Ghost said to them: Separate me Saul and Barnabas, for the work whereunto I have taken them. ³ Then they fasting and praying and imposing their hands upon them, sent them away. ⁴ So they, being sent by the Holy Ghost, went to Seleucia: and from thence they sailed to Cyprus. ⁵ And when they were come to Salamina, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews. And they had John also in the ministry. ⁶ And when they had gone through the whole island, as far as Paphos, they found a certain man, a magician, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Bar-Jesu: ⁷ Who was with the proconsul Sergius Paulus, a prudent man. He, sending for Barnabas and Saul, desired to hear the word of God. ⁸ But Elymas the magician (for so his name is interpreted) withstood them, seeking to turn away the proconsul from the faith. ⁹ Then Saul, otherwise Paul, filled with the Holy Ghost, looking upon him, ¹⁰ Said: O full of all guile and of all deceit, child of the devil, enemy of all justice, thou ceasest not to pervert the right ways of the Lord. ¹¹ And now

behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee: and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a time. And immediately there fell a mist and darkness upon him: and going about, he sought some one to lead him by the hand. ¹² Then the proconsul, when he had seen what was done, believed, admiring at the doctrine of the Lord. ¹³ Now when Paul and they that were with him had sailed from Paphos, they came to Perge in Pamphylia. And John departing from them, returned to Jerusalem. ¹⁴ But they, passing through Perge, came to Antioch in Pisidia: and, entering into the Synagogue on the sabbath day, they sat down. ¹⁵ And after the reading of the law and the prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent to them, saying: Ye men, brethren, if you have any word of exhortation to make to the people, speak. ¹⁶ Then Paul rising up and with his hand bespeaking silence, said: Ye men of Israel and you that fear God, give ear. ¹⁷ The God of the people of Israel chose our fathers and exalted the people when they were sojourners in the land of Egypt: And with an high arm brought them out from thence: ¹⁸ And for the space of forty years endured their manners in the desert: ¹⁹ And, destroying seven nations in the land of Chanaan, divided their land among them by lot. ²⁰ As it were, after four hundred and fifty years. And after these things, he gave unto them judges, until Samuel the prophet. ²¹ And after that they desired a king: and God gave them Saul the son of Cis, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, forty years. ²² And when he had removed him, he raised them up David to be king: to whom giving testimony, he said: I have found David, the son of Jesse, a man according to my own heart, who shall do all my wills. ²³ Of this man's seed, God, according to his promise, hath raised up to Israel a Saviour Jesus: ²⁴ John first preaching, before his coming, the baptism of penance to all the people of Israel. ²⁵ And when John was fulfilling his course, he said: I am not he whom you think me to be. But behold, there cometh one after me, whose shoes of his feet I am not worthy to loose. ²⁶ Men, brethren, children of the stock of Abraham, and whosoever among you fear God: to you the word of this salvation is sent. ²⁷ For they that inhabited Jerusalem and the rulers thereof, not knowing him, nor the voices of the prophets which are read every sabbath, judging him, have fulfilled them. ²⁸ And finding no cause of death in him, they desired of Pilate that they might kill him. ²⁹ And when they had fulfilled all things that were written of him, taking him down from the tree, they laid him in a sepulchre. ³⁰ But God raised him up from the dead the third day. ³¹ Who was seen for many days by them who came up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who to this present are his witnesses to the people. ³² And we declare unto you that the promise which was made to our fathers, ³³ This same God hath fulfilled to our children, raising up Jesus, as in the second psalm also is written: Thou art my Son: this day have I begotten thee. ³⁴ And to shew that he raised him up from the dead, not to return now any more to corruption, he said thus: I will give you the holy things of David, faithful. ³⁵ And therefore, in another place also, he saith: Thou shalt not suffer thy holy one to see corruption. ³⁶ For David, when he had served in his generation, according to the will of God, slept: and was laid unto his fathers and saw corruption. ³⁷ But he whom God hath raised from the dead saw no corruption. ³⁸ Be it known therefore to you, men, brethren, that through him forgiveness of sins is preached to

you: and from all the things from which you could not be justified by the law of Moses. ³⁹ In him every one that believeth is justified. ⁴⁰ Beware, therefore, lest that come upon you which is spoken in the prophets: ⁴¹ Behold, ye despisers, and wonder and perish: for I work a work in your days, a work which you will not believe, if any man shall tell it you. ⁴² And as they went out, they desired them that on the next sabbath they would speak unto them these words. ⁴³ And when the synagogue was broken up, many of the Jews and of the strangers who served God followed Paul and Barnabas: who, speaking to them, persuaded them to continue in the grace of God.

⁴⁴ But the next sabbath day, the whole city almost came together, to hear the word of God. ⁴⁵ And the Jews, seeing the multitudes, were filled with envy and contradicted those things which were said by Paul, blaspheming. ⁴⁶ Then Paul and Barnabas said boldly: To you it behoved us first to speak the word of God: but because you reject it and judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life, behold we turn to the Gentiles. ⁴⁷ For so the Lord hath commanded us: I have set thee to be the light of the Gentiles: that thou mayest be for salvation unto the utmost part of the earth. ⁴⁸ And the Gentiles hearing it were glad and glorified the word of the Lord: and as many as were ordained to life everlasting believed. ⁴⁹ And the word of the Lord was published throughout the whole country. ⁵⁰ But the Jews stirred up religious and honourable women and the chief men of the city: and raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas: and cast them out of their coasts. ⁵¹ But they, shaking off the dust of their feet against them, came to Iconium. ⁵² And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Ghost.

346. *Lystra and Derbe*

Acts 14:1-27

14 ¹ And it came to pass in Iconium that they entered together into the synagogue of the Jews and so spoke that a very great multitude both of the Jews and of the Greeks did believe. ² But the unbelieving Jews stirred up and incensed the minds of the Gentiles against the brethren. ³ A long time therefore they abode there, dealing confidently in the Lord, who gave testimony to the word of his grace, granting signs and wonders to be done by their hands. ⁴ And the multitude of the city was divided. And some of them indeed held with the Jews, but some with the apostles. ⁵ And when there was an assault made by the Gentiles and the Jews with their rulers, to use them contumeliously and to stone them: ⁶ They, understanding it, fled to Lystra and Derbe, cities of Lycaonia, and to the whole country round about: and were there preaching the gospel. ⁷ And there sat a certain man at Lystra, impotent in his feet, a cripple from his mother's womb, who never had walked.

⁸ This same heard Paul speaking. Who looking upon him and seeing that he had faith to be healed, ⁹ Said with a loud voice: Stand upright on thy feet. And he leaped up and walked. ¹⁰ And when the multitudes had seen what Paul had done, they lifted up their voice in the Lycaonian tongue, saying: The gods are come down to us in the likeness of men. ¹¹ And they called Barnabas, Jupiter: but Paul, Mercury: because he was chief speaker. ¹² The priest also of Jupiter that was before the city, bringing oxen and garlands before the gate, would have offered sacrifice with the people. ¹³ Which, when the apostles Barnabas and Paul

had heard, rending their clothes, they leaped out among the people, crying, ¹⁴ And saying: Ye men, why do ye these things? We also are mortals, men like unto you, preaching to you to be converted from these vain things to the living God, who made the heaven and the earth and the sea and all things that are in them: ¹⁵ Who in times past, suffered all nations to walk in their own ways. ¹⁶ Nevertheless he left not himself without testimony, doing good from heaven, giving rains and fruitful Seasons, filling our hearts with food and gladness. ¹⁷ And speaking these things, they scarce restrained the people from sacrificing to them. ¹⁸ Now there came thither certain Jews from Antioch and Iconium: and, persuading the multitude and stoning Paul, drew him out of the city, thinking him to be dead. ¹⁹ But as the disciples stood round about him, he rose up and entered into the city: and the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe. ²⁰ And when they had preached the gospel to that city and had taught many, they returned again to Lystra and to Iconium and to Antioch: ²¹ Confirming the souls of the disciples and exhorting them to continue in the faith: and that through many tribulations we must enter into the kingdom of God. ²² And when they had ordained to them priests in every church and had prayed with fasting, they commended them to the Lord, in whom they believed. ²³ And passing through Pisidia, they came into Pamphylia. ²⁴ And having spoken the word of the Lord in Perge, they went down into Attalia. ²⁵ And thence they sailed to Antioch, from whence they had been delivered to the grace of God, unto the work which they accomplished. ²⁶ And when they were come and had assembled the church, they related what great things God had done with them and how he had opened the door of faith to the Gentiles. ²⁷ And they abode no small time with the disciples.

347. The council of Jerusalem

Acts 15:1-41

15 ¹ And some, coming down from Judea, taught the brethren: That, except you be circumcised after the manner of Moses, you cannot be saved. ² And when Paul and Barnabas had no small contest with them, they determined that Paul and Barnabas and certain others of the other side should go up to the apostles and priests to Jerusalem, about this question. ³ They therefore, being brought on their way by the church, passed through Phenice and Samaria, relating the conversion of the Gentiles. And they caused great joy to all the brethren. ⁴ And when they were come to Jerusalem, they were received by the church and by the apostles and ancients, declaring how great things God had done with them. ⁵ But there arose of the sect of the Pharisees some that believed, saying: They must be circumcised and be commanded to observe the law of Moses.

⁶ And the apostles and ancients assembled to consider of this matter. ⁷ And when there had been much disputing, Peter, rising up, said to them: Men, brethren, you know that in former days God made choice among us, that by my mouth the Gentiles should hear the word of the gospel and believe. ⁸ And God, who knoweth the hearts, gave testimony, giving unto them the Holy Ghost, as well as to us: ⁹ And put no difference between us and them, purifying their hearts by faith. ¹⁰ Now therefore, why tempt you God to put a yoke upon the necks of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we have been able to bear? ¹¹ But

by the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, we believe to be saved, in like manner as they also.

¹² And all the multitude held their peace: and they heard Barnabas and Paul telling what great signs and wonders God had wrought among the Gentiles by them. ¹³ And after they had held their peace, James answered, saying: Men, brethren, hear me. ¹⁴ Simon hath related how God first visited to take of the Gentiles, a people to his name. ¹⁵ And to this agree the words of the prophets, as it is written: ¹⁶ After these things I will return and will rebuild the tabernacle of David, which is fallen down: and the ruins thereof I will rebuild. And I will set it up: ¹⁷ That the residue of men may seek after the Lord, and all nations upon whom my name is invoked, saith the Lord, who doth these things. ¹⁸ To the Lord was his own work known from the beginning of the world. ¹⁹ For which cause I judge that they who from among the Gentiles are converted to God are not to be disquieted: ²⁰ But that we write unto them, that they refrain themselves from the pollutions of idols and from fornication and from things strangled and from blood. ²¹ For Moses of old time hath in every city them that preach him in the synagogues, where he is read every sabbath. ²² Then it pleased the apostles and ancients, with the whole church, to choose men of their own company and to send to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas, namely, Judas, who was surnamed Barsabas, and Silas, chief men among the brethren. ²³ Writing by their hands: The apostles and ancients, brethren, to the brethren of the Gentiles that are at Antioch and in Syria and Cilicia, greeting. ²⁴ Forasmuch as we have heard that some going out from us have troubled you with words, subverting your souls, to whom we gave no commandment: ²⁵ It hath seemed good to us, being assembled together, to choose out men and to send them unto you, with our well beloved Barnabas and Paul: ²⁶ Men that have given their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. ²⁷ We have sent therefore Judas and Silas, who themselves also will, by word of mouth, tell you the same things. ²⁸ For it hath seemed good to the Holy Ghost and to us to lay no further burden upon you than these necessary things: ²⁹ That you abstain from things sacrificed to idols and from blood and from things strangled and from fornication: from which things keeping yourselves, you shall do well. Fare ye well. ³⁰ They therefore, being dismissed, went down to Antioch and, gathering together the multitude, delivered the epistle. ³¹ Which when they had read, they rejoiced for the consolation. ³² But Judas and Silas, being prophets also themselves, with many words comforted the brethren and confirmed them. ³³ And after they had spent some time there, they were let go with peace by the brethren unto them that had sent them. ³⁴ But it seemed good unto Silas to remain there: and Judas alone departed to Jerusalem. ³⁵ And Paul and Barnabas continued at Antioch, teaching and preaching, with many others, the word of the Lord.

³⁶ And after some days, Paul said to Barnabas: Let us return and visit our brethren in all the cities wherein we have preached the word of the Lord, to see how they do. ³⁷ And Barnabas would have taken with them John also, that was surnamed Mark. ³⁸ But Paul desired that he (as having departed from them out of Pamphylia and not gone with them to the work) might not be received. ³⁹ And there arose a dissension so that they departed

one from another. And Barnabas indeed, taking Mark, sailed to Cyprus. ⁴⁰ But Paul, choosing Silas, departed, being delivered by the brethren to the grace of God. ⁴¹ And he went through Syria and Cilicia, confirming the churches, commanding them to keep the precepts of the apostles and the ancients.

348. Macedonia: Lydia, and the jailer

Acts 16:1-40

16 ¹ And he came to Derbe and Lystra. And behold, there was a certain disciple there named Timothy, the son of a Jewish woman that believed: but his father was a Gentile. ² To this man the brethren that were in Lystra and Iconium gave a good testimony. ³ Him Paul would have to go along with him: and taking him, he circumcised him, because of the Jews who were in those places. For they all knew that his father was a Gentile. ⁴ And as they passed through the cities, they delivered unto them the decrees for to keep, that were decreed by the apostles and ancients who were at Jerusalem. ⁵ And the churches were confirmed in faith and increased in number daily. ⁶ And when they had passed through Phrygia and the country of Galatia, they were forbidden by the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia. ⁷ And when they were come into Mysia, they attempted to go into Bithynia: and the Spirit of Jesus suffered them not. ⁸ And when they had passed through Mysia, they went down to Troas. ⁹ And a vision was shewed to Paul in the night, which was a man of Macedonia standing and beseeching him and saying: Pass over into Macedonia and help us. ¹⁰ And as soon as he had seen the vision, immediately we sought to go into Macedonia: being assured that God had called us to preach the gospel to them. ¹¹ And sailing from Troas, we came with a straight course to Samothracia, and the day following to Neapolis. ¹² And from thence to Philippi, which is the chief city of part of Macedonia, a colony. And we were in this city some days conferring together. ¹³ And upon the Sabbath day, we went forth without the gate by a river side, where it seemed that there was prayer: and sitting down, we spoke to the women that were assembled. ¹⁴ And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, one that worshipped God, did hear: whose heart the Lord opened to attend to those things which were said by Paul. ¹⁵ And when she was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying: If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and abide there. And she constrained us.

¹⁶ And it came to pass, as we went to prayer, a certain girl having a pythonical spirit met us, who brought to her masters much gain by divining. ¹⁷ This same following Paul and us, cried out, saying: These men are the servants of the Most High God, who preach unto you the way of salvation. ¹⁸ And this she did many days. But Paul being grieved, turned and said to the spirit: I command thee, in the name of Jesus Christ, to go out from her. And he went out the same hour.

¹⁹ But her masters, seeing that the hope of their gain was gone, apprehending Paul and Silas, brought them into the market place to the rulers. ²⁰ And presenting them to the magistrates, they said: These men disturb our city, being Jews: ²¹ And preach a fashion which it is not lawful for us to receive nor observe, being Romans. ²² And the people ran together against them: and the magistrates, rending off their clothes, commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³ And when they had laid many stripes upon

them, they cast them into prison, charging the gaoler to keep them diligently. ²⁴ Who having received such a charge, thrust them into the inner prison and made their feet fast in the stocks.

²⁵ And at midnight, Paul and Silas, praying, praised God. And they that were in prison heard them. ²⁶ And suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken. And immediately all the doors were opened and the bands of all were loosed. ²⁷ And the keeper of the prison, awakening out of his sleep and seeing the doors of the prison open, drawing his sword, would have killed himself, supposing that the prisoners had been fled. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying: Do thyself no harm, for we all are here. ²⁹ Then calling for a light, he went in: and trembling, fell down at the feet of Paul and Silas. ³⁰ And bringing them out, he said: Masters, what must I do, that I may be saved? ³¹ But they said: believe in the Lord Jesus: and thou shalt be saved, and thy house. ³² And they preached the word of the Lord to him and to all that were in his house. ³³ And he, taking them the same hour of the night, washed their stripes: and himself was baptized, and all his house immediately. ³⁴ And when he had brought them into his own house, he laid the table for them: and rejoiced with all his house, believing God. ³⁵ And when the day was come, the magistrates sent the serjeants, saying: Let those men go. ³⁶ And the keeper of the prison told these words to Paul: The magistrates have sent to let you go. Now therefore depart. And go in peace. ³⁷ But Paul said to them: They have beaten us publicly, uncondemned, men that are Romans, and have cast us into prison. And now do they thrust us out privately? Not so: but let them come. ³⁸ And let us out ourselves. And the serjeants told these words to the magistrates. And they were afraid: hearing that they were Romans. ³⁹ And coming, they besought them: and bringing them out, they desired them to depart out of the city. ⁴⁰ And they went out of the prison and entered into the house of Lydia: and having seen the brethren, they comforted them and departed.

349. Athens, and the unknown God

Acts 17:1-34

17 ¹ And when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where there was a synagogue of the Jews. ² And Paul, according to his custom, went in unto them. And for three sabbath days he reasoned with them out of the scriptures: ³ Declaring and insinuating that the Christ was to suffer and to rise again from the dead; and that this is Jesus Christ, whom I preach to you. ⁴ And some of them believed and were associated to Paul and Silas: and of those that served God and of the Gentiles a great multitude: and of noble women not a few. ⁵ But the Jews, moved with envy and taking unto them some wicked men of the vulgar sort and making a tumult, set the city in an uproar: and besetting Jason's house, sought to bring them out unto the people. ⁶ And not finding them, they drew Jason and certain brethren to the rulers of the city, crying: They that set the city in an uproar are come hither also: ⁷ Whom Jason hath received. And these all do contrary to the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king, Jesus. ⁸ And they stirred up the people: and the rulers of the city, hearing these things, ⁹ And having taken satisfaction of Jason and of the rest, they let them go.

¹⁰ But the brethren immediately sent away Paul and Silas by night unto Berea. Who, when they were come thither, went into the synagogue of the Jews. ¹¹ Now these were more noble than those in Thessalonica, who received the word with all eagerness, daily searching the scriptures, whether these things were so. ¹² And many indeed of them believed: and of honourable women that were Gentiles and of men, not a few. ¹³ And when the Jews of Thessalonica had knowledge that the word of God was also preached by Paul at Berea, they came thither also, stirring up and troubling the multitude. ¹⁴ And then immediately the brethren sent away Paul, to go unto the sea: but Silas and Timothy remained there. ¹⁵ And they that conducted Paul brought him as far as Athens: and receiving a commandment from him to Silas and Timothy, that they should come to him with all speed, they departed.

¹⁶ Now whilst Paul waited for them at Athens, his spirit was stirred within him, seeing the city wholly given to idolatry. ¹⁷ He disputed, therefore, in the synagogue with the Jews and with them that served God: and in the market place, every day, with them that were there. ¹⁸ And certain philosophers of the Epicureans and of the Stoics disputed with him. And some said: What is it that this word sower would say? But others: He seemeth to be a setter forth of new gods. Because he preached to them Jesus and the resurrection. ¹⁹ And taking him, they brought him to the Areopagus, saying: May we know what this new doctrine is, which thou speakest of? ²⁰ For thou bringest in certain new things to our ears. We would know therefore what these things mean. ²¹ (Now all the Athenians and strangers that were there employed themselves in nothing else, but either in telling or in hearing some new thing.)

²² But Paul, standing in the midst of the Areopagus, said: Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things you are too superstitious. ²³ For passing by and seeing your idols, I found an altar also, on which was written: To the Unknown God. What therefore you worship without knowing it, that I preach to you: ²⁴ God, who made the world and all things therein, he being Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands. ²⁵ Neither is he served with men's hands, as though he needed any thing: seeing it is he who giveth to all life and breath and all things: ²⁶ And hath made of one, all mankind, to dwell upon the whole face of the earth, determining appointed times and the limits of their habitation. ²⁷ That they should seek God, if haply they may feel after him or find him, although he be not far from every one of us. ²⁸ For in him we live and move and are: as some also of your own poets said: For we are also his offspring. ²⁹ Being therefore the offspring of God, we must not suppose the divinity to be like unto gold or silver or stone, the graving of art and device of man. ³⁰ And God indeed having winked at the times of this ignorance, now declareth unto men that all should every where do penance. ³¹ Because he hath appointed a day wherein he will judge the world in equity, by the man whom he hath appointed: giving faith to all, by raising him up from the dead.

³² And when they had heard of the resurrection of the dead, some indeed mocked. But others said: We will hear thee again concerning this matter. ³³ So Paul went out from among them.

³⁴ But certain men, adhering to him, did believe: among whom

was also Dionysius the Areopagite and a woman named Damaris and others with them.

350. *Corinth and Ephesus*

Acts 18:1-19:40

18 ¹ After these things, departing from Athens, he came to Corinth. ² And finding a certain Jew, named Aquila, born in Pontus, lately come from Italy, with Priscilla his wife (because that Claudius had commanded all Jews to depart from Rome), he came to them. ³ And because he was of the same trade, he remained with them and wrought. (Now they were tentmakers by trade.) ⁴ And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, bringing in the name of the Lord Jesus. And he persuaded the Jews and the Greeks. ⁵ And when Silas and Timothy were come from Macedonia, Paul was earnest in preaching, testifying to the Jews that Jesus is the Christ. ⁶ But they gainsaying and blaspheming, he shook his garments and said to them: Your blood be upon your own heads: I am clean. From henceforth I will go unto the Gentiles.

⁷ And departing thence, he entered into the house of a certain man, named Titus Justus, one that worshipped God, whose house was adjoining to the synagogue. ⁸ And Crispus, the ruler of the synagogue, believed in the Lord, with all his house. And many of the Corinthians hearing, believed and were baptized. ⁹ And the Lord said to Paul in the night, by a vision: Do not fear, but speak. And hold not thy peace, ¹⁰ Because I am with thee and no man shall set upon thee, to hurt thee. For I have much people in this city. ¹¹ And he stayed there a year and six months, teaching among them the word of God. ¹² But when Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews with one accord rose up against Paul and brought him to the judgment seat, ¹³ Saying: This man persuadeth men to worship God contrary to the law. ¹⁴ And when Paul was beginning to open his mouth, Gallio said to the Jews: If it were some matter of injustice or an heinous deed, O Jews, I should with reason bear with you. ¹⁵ But if they be questions of word and names and of your law, look you to it. I will not be judge of such things. ¹⁶ And he drove them from the judgment seat. ¹⁷ And all laying hold on Sosthenes, the ruler of the synagogue, beat him before the judgment seat. And Gallio cared for none of those things.

¹⁸ But Paul, when he had stayed yet many days, taking his leave of the brethren, sailed thence into Syria (and with him Priscilla and Aquila), having shorn his head in Cenchrae. For he had a vow. ¹⁹ And he came to Ephesus and left them there. But he himself, entering into the synagogue, disputed with the Jews. ²⁰ And when they desired him that he would tarry a longer time, he consented not: ²¹ But taking his leave and saying: I will return to you again, God willing, he departed from Ephesus. ²² And going down to Cæsarea, he went up to Jerusalem and saluted the church: and so came down to Antioch. ²³ And after he had spent some time there, he departed and went through the country of Galatia and Phrygia, in order, confirming all the disciples. ²⁴ Now a certain Jew, named Apollo, born at Alexandria, an eloquent man, came to Ephesus, one mighty in the scriptures. ²⁵ This man was instructed in the way of the Lord: and being fervent in spirit, spoke and taught diligently the things that are of Jesus, knowing only the baptism of John. ²⁶ This man therefore began to speak boldly in the synagogue. Whom when Priscilla and Aquila had

heard, they took him to them and expounded to him the way of the Lord more diligently.²⁷ And whereas he was desirous to go to Achaia, the brethren exhorting wrote to the disciples to receive him. Who, when he was come, helped them much who had believed.²⁸ For with much vigour he convinced the Jews openly, shewing by the scriptures that Jesus is the Christ.

19¹ And it came to pass, while Apollo was at Corinth, that Paul, having passed through the upper coasts, came to Ephesus and found certain disciples.² And he said to them: Have you received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? But they said to him: We have not so much as heard whether there be a Holy Ghost.³ And he said: In what then were you baptized? Who said: In John's baptism.⁴ Then Paul said: John baptized the people with the baptism of penance saying: That they should believe in him, who was to come after him, that is to say, in Jesus.⁵ Having heard these things, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.⁶ And when Paul had imposed his hands on them, the Holy Ghost came upon them: and they spoke with tongues and prophesied.⁷ And all the men were about twelve.⁸ And entering into the synagogue, he spoke boldly for the space of three months, disputing and exhorting concerning the kingdom of God.⁹ But when some were hardened and believed not, speaking evil of the way of the Lord before the multitude, departing from them, he separated the disciples, disputing daily in the school of one Tyrannus.¹⁰ And this continued for the space of two years, so that all who dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord, both Jews and Gentiles.¹¹ And God wrought by the hand of Paul more than common miracles.¹² So that even there were brought from his body to the sick, handkerchiefs and aprons: and the diseases departed from them: and the wicked spirits went out of them.¹³ Now some also of the Jewish exorcists, who went about, attempted to invoke over them that had evil spirits the name of the Lord Jesus, saying: I conjure you by Jesus, whom Paul preacheth.¹⁴ And there were certain men, seven sons of Sceva, a Jew, a chief priest, that did this.¹⁵ But the wicked spirit, answering, said to them: Jesus I know: and Paul I know. But who are you?¹⁶ And the man in whom the wicked spirit was, leaping upon them and mastering them both, prevailed against them, so that they fled out of that house naked and wounded.¹⁷ And this became known to all the Jews and the Gentiles that dwelt at Ephesus. And fear fell on them all: and the name of the Lord Jesus was magnified.¹⁸ And many of them that believed came, confessing and declaring their deeds.¹⁹ And many of them who had followed curious arts brought together their books and burnt them before all. And, counting the price of them, they found the money to be fifty thousand pieces of silver.²⁰ So mightily grew the word of God and was confirmed.

²¹ And when these things were ended, Paul purposed in the spirit, when he had passed through Macedonia and Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying: After I have been there, I must see Rome also.²² And sending into Macedonia two of them that ministered to him, Timothy and Erastus, he himself remained for a time in Asia.²³ Now at that time there arose no small disturbance about the way of the Lord.²⁴ For a certain man named Demetrius, a silversmith, who made silver temples for Diana, brought no small gain to the craftsmen.²⁵ Whom he calling together with the workmen of like occupation, said: Sirs, you know that our

gain is by this trade.²⁶ And you see and hear that this Paul, by persuasion hath drawn away a great multitude, not only of Ephesus, but almost of all Asia, saying: they are not gods which are made by hands.²⁷ So that not only this our craft is in danger to be set at nought, but also the temple of great Diana shall be reputed for nothing! Yea, and her majesty shall begin to be destroyed, whom all Asia and the world worshippeth.²⁸ Having heard these things, they were full of anger and cried out, saying: Great is Diana of the Ephesians!²⁹ And the whole city was filled with confusion. And having caught Gaius and Aristarchus, men of Macedonia, Paul's companions, they rushed with one accord into the theatre.³⁰ And when Paul would have entered in unto the people, the disciples suffered him not.³¹ And some also of the rulers of Asia, who were his friends, sent unto him, desiring that he would not venture himself into the theatre.³² Now some cried one thing, some another. For the assembly was confused: and the greater part knew not for what cause they were come together.³³ And they drew forth Alexander out of the multitude, the Jews thrusting him forward. And Alexander, beckoning with his hand for silence, would have given the people satisfaction,³⁴ But as soon as they perceived him to be a Jew, all with one voice, for the space of about two, hours, cried out: Great is Diana of the Ephesians!³⁵ And when the town clerk had appeased the multitudes, he said: Ye men of Ephesus, what man is there that knoweth not that the city of the Ephesians is a worshipper of the great Diana and of Jupiter's offspring?³⁶ For as much therefore as these things cannot be contradicted, you ought to be quiet and to do nothing rashly.³⁷ For you have brought hither these men, who are neither guilty of sacrilege nor of blasphemy against your goddess.³⁸ But if Demetrius and the craftsmen that are with him have a matter against any man, the courts of justice are open: and there are proconsuls. Let them accuse one another.³⁹ And if you inquire after any other matter, it may be decided in a lawful assembly.⁴⁰ For we are even in danger to be called in question for this day's uproar, there being no man guilty (of whom we may give account) of this concourse. And when he had said these things, he dismissed the assembly.

351. The farewell at Miletus

Acts 20:1-38

20¹ And after the tumult was ceased, Paul calling to him the disciples and exhorting them, took his leave and set forward to go into Macedonia.² And when he had gone over those parts and had exhorted them with many words, he came into Greece:³ Where, when he had spent three months, the Jews laid wait for him, as he was about to sail into Syria. So he took a resolution to return through Macedonia.⁴ And there accompanied him Sopater, the son of Pyrrhus, of Berea: and of the Thessalonians, Aristarchus and Secundus: and Gaius of Derbe and Timothy: and of Asia, Tychicus and Trophimus.⁵ These, going before, stayed for us at Troas.⁶ But we sailed from Philippi after the days of the azymes and came to them to Troas in five days, where we abode seven days.⁷ And on the first day of the week, when we were assembled to break bread, Paul discoursed with them, being to depart on the morrow. And he continued his speech until midnight.⁸ And there were a great number of lamps in the upper chamber where we were assembled.⁹ And a certain young man named Eutychus, sitting on the window, being oppressed

with a deep sleep (as Paul was long preaching), by occasion of his sleep fell from the third loft down and was taken up dead. ¹⁰ To whom, when Paul had gone down, he laid himself upon him and, embracing him, said: Be not troubled, for his soul is in him. ¹¹ Then going up and breaking bread and tasting and having talked a long time to them, until daylight, so he departed. ¹² And they brought the youth alive and were not a little comforted.

¹³ But we going aboard the ship, sailed to Assos, being there to take in Paul. For so he had appointed, himself purposing to travel by land. ¹⁴ And when he had met with us at Assos, we took him in and came to Mitylene. ¹⁵ And sailing thence, the day following we came over against Chios: and the next day we arrived at Samos: and the day following we came to Miletus. ¹⁶ For Paul had determined to sail by Ephesus, lest he should be stayed any time in Asia. For he hastened, if it were possible for him, to keep the day of Pentecost at Jerusalem.

¹⁷ And sending from Miletus to Ephesus, he called the ancients of the church. ¹⁸ And when they were come to him and were together, he said to them: You know from the first day that I came into Asia, in what manner I have been with you, for all the time. ¹⁹ Serving the Lord with all humility and with tears and temptations which befell me by the conspiracies of the Jews: ²⁰ How I have kept back nothing that was profitable to you, but have preached it to you, and taught you publicly, and from house to house, ²¹ Testifying both to Jews and Gentiles penance towards God and faith in our Lord Jesus Christ. ²² And now, behold, being bound in the spirit, I go to Jerusalem: not knowing the things which shall befall me there: ²³ Save that the Holy Ghost in every city witnesseth to me, saying: That bands and afflictions wait for me at Jerusalem. ²⁴ But I fear none of these things, neither do I count my life more precious than myself, so that I may consummate my course and the ministry of the word which I received from the Lord Jesus, to testify the gospel of the grace of God. ²⁵ And now behold, I know that all you, among whom I have gone preaching the kingdom of God, shall see my face no more. ²⁶ Wherefore I take you to witness this day that I am clear from the blood of all men. ²⁷ For I have not spared to declare unto you all, the counsel of God. ²⁸ Take heed to yourselves and to the whole flock, wherein the Holy Ghost hath placed you bishops, to rule the Church of God which he hath purchased with his own blood. ²⁹ I know that after my departure ravaging wolves will enter in among you, not sparing the flock. ³⁰ And of your own selves shall arise men speaking perverse things, to draw away disciples after them. ³¹ Therefore watch, keeping in memory that for three years I ceased not with tears to admonish every one of you, night and day. ³² And now I commend you to God and to the word of his grace, who is able to build up and to give an inheritance among all the sanctified. ³³ I have not coveted any man's silver, gold or apparel, as ³⁴ You yourselves know. For such things as were needful for me and them that are with me, these hands have furnished. ³⁵ I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring you ought to support the weak and to remember the word of the Lord Jesus, how he said: It is a more blessed thing to give, rather than to receive.

³⁶ And when he had said these things, kneeling down, he prayed with them all. ³⁷ And there was much weeping among

them all. And falling on the neck of Paul, they kissed him, ³⁸ Being grieved most of all for the word which he had said, that they should see his face no more. And they brought him on his way to the ship.

352. *Jerusalem, the arrest, the defence, and the plot*

Acts 21:1-23:35

21 ¹ And when it came to pass that, being parted from them, we set sail, we came with a straight course to Coos, and the day following to Rhodes: and from thence to Patara. ² And when we had found a ship sailing over to Phenice, we went aboard and set forth. ³ And when we had discovered Cyprus, leaving it on the left hand, we sailed into Syria, and came to Tyre: for there the ship was to unlade her burden. ⁴ And finding disciples, we tarried there seven days: who said to Paul, through the Spirit, that he should not go up to Jerusalem. ⁵ And the days being expired, departing we went forward, they all bringing us on our way, with their wives and children, till we were out of the city. And we kneeled down on the shore: and we prayed. ⁶ And when we had bid one another farewell, we took ship. And they returned home. ⁷ But we, having finished the voyage by sea, from Tyre came down to Ptolemais: and saluting the brethren, we abode one day with them. ⁸ And the next day departing, we came to Cæsarea. And entering into the house of Philip the evangelist, who was one of the seven, we abode with him. ⁹ And he had four daughters, virgins, who did prophesy. ¹⁰ And as we tarried there for some days, there came from Judea a certain prophet, named Agabus. ¹¹ Who, when he was come to us, took Paul's girdle: and binding his own feet and hands, he said: Thus saith the Holy Ghost: The man whose girdle this is, the Jews shall bind in this manner in Jerusalem and shall deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles. ¹² Which when we had heard, both we and they that were of that place desired him that he would not go up to Jerusalem. ¹³ Then Paul answered and said: What do you mean, weeping and afflicting my heart? For I am ready not only to be bound, but to die also in Jerusalem, for the name of the Lord Jesus. ¹⁴ And when we could not persuade him, we ceased, saying: The will of the Lord be done.

¹⁵ And after those days, being prepared, we went up to Jerusalem. ¹⁶ And there went also with us some of the disciples from Cæsarea, bringing with them one Mnason a Cyprian, an old disciple, with whom we should lodge. ¹⁷ And when we were come to Jerusalem, the brethren received us gladly. ¹⁸ And the day following, Paul went in with us unto James: and all the ancients were assembled. ¹⁹ Whom when he had saluted, he related particularly what things God had wrought among the Gentiles by his ministry. ²⁰ But they hearing it, glorified God and said to him: Thou seest, brother, how many thousands there are among the Jews that have believed: and they are all zealous for the law. ²¹ Now they have heard of thee that thou teachest those Jews, who are among the Gentiles to depart from Moses: saying that they ought not to circumcise their children, nor walk according to the custom. ²² What is it therefore? The multitude must needs come together: for they will hear that thou art come. ²³ Do therefore this that we say to thee. We have four men, who have a vow on them. ²⁴ Take these and sanctify thyself with them: and bestow on them, that they may shave their heads. And all will know that the things which they have heard of thee

are false: but that thou thyself also walkest keeping the law. ²⁵ But, as touching the Gentiles that believe, we have written, decreeing that they should only refrain themselves from that which has been offered to idols and from blood and from things strangled and from fornication. ²⁶ Then Paul took the men and, the next day being purified with them, entered into the temple, giving notice of the accomplishment of the days of purification, until an oblation should be offered for every one of them. ²⁷ But when the seven days were drawing to an end, those Jews that were of Asia, when they saw him in the temple, stirred up all the people and laid hands upon him, crying out: ²⁸ Men of Israel, help: This is the man that teacheth all men every where against the people and the law and this place; and moreover hath brought in Gentiles into the temple and hath violated this holy place. ²⁹ (For they had seen Trophimus the Ephesian in the city with him, whom they supposed that Paul had brought into the temple.) ³⁰ And the whole city was in an uproar: and the people ran together. And taking Paul, they drew him out of the temple: and immediately the doors were shut. ³¹ And as they went about to kill him, it was told the tribune of the band that all Jerusalem was in confusion. ³² Who, forthwith taking with him soldiers and centurions, ran down to them. And when they saw the tribune and the soldiers, they left off beating Paul. ³³ Then the tribune, coming near, took him and commanded him to be bound with two chains: and demanded who he was and what he had done. ³⁴ And some cried one thing, some another, among the multitude. And when he could not know the certainty for the tumult, he commanded him to be carried into the castle. ³⁵ And when he was come to the stairs, it fell out that he was carried by the soldiers, because of the violence of the people. ³⁶ For the multitude of the people followed after, crying: Away with him! ³⁷ And as Paul was about to be brought into the castle, he saith to the tribune: May I speak something to thee? Who said: Canst thou speak Greek? ³⁸ Art not thou that Egyptian who before these days didst raise a tumult and didst lead forth into the desert four thousand men that were murderers? ³⁹ But Paul said to him: I am a Jew of Tarsus in Cilicia, a citizen of no mean city. And I beseech thee, suffer me to speak to the people. ⁴⁰ And when he had given him leave, Paul standing on the stairs, beckoned with his hand to the people. And a great silence being made, he spoke unto them in the Hebrew tongue, saying:

22 ¹ Men, brethren and fathers, hear ye the account which I now give unto you. ² (And when they heard that he spoke to them in the Hebrew tongue, they kept the more silence.) ³ And he saith: I am a Jew, born at Tarsus in Cilicia, but brought up in this city, at the feet of Gamaliel, taught according to the truth of the law of the fathers, zealous for the law, as also all you are this day: ⁴ Who persecuted this way unto death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women, ⁵ As the high priest doth bear me witness and all the ancients. From whom also receiving letters to the brethren, I went to Damascus, that I might bring them bound from thence to Jerusalem to be punished. ⁶ And it came to pass, as I was going and drawing nigh to Damascus, at mid-day, that suddenly from heaven there shone round about me a great light: ⁷ And falling on the ground, I heard a voice saying to me: Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? ⁸ And I answered: Who art thou, Lord? And he said to me: I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom

thou persecutest. ⁹ And they that were with me saw indeed the light: but they heard not the voice of him that spoke with me. ¹⁰ And I said: What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said to me: Arise and go to Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things that thou must do. ¹¹ And whereas I did not see for the brightness of that light, being led by the hand by my companions, I came to Damascus, ¹² And one Ananias, a man according to the law, having testimony of all the Jews who dwelt there, ¹³ Coming to me and standing by me, said to me: Brother Saul, look up. And I, the same hour, looked upon him. ¹⁴ But he said: The God of our fathers hath preordained thee that thou shouldst know his will and see the Just One and shouldst hear the voice from his mouth. ¹⁵ For thou shalt be his witness to all men of those things which thou hast seen and heard. ¹⁶ And now why tarriest thou? Rise up and be baptized and wash away thy sins, invoking his name. ¹⁷ And it came to pass, when I was come again to Jerusalem and was praying in the temple, that I was in a trance, ¹⁸ And saw him saying unto me: Make haste and get thee quickly out of Jerusalem: because they will not receive thy testimony concerning me. ¹⁹ And I said: Lord, they know that I cast into prison and beat in every synagogue them that believed in thee. ²⁰ And when the blood of Stephen thy witness was shed, I stood by and consented: and kept the garments of them that killed him. ²¹ And he said to me: Go, for unto the Gentiles afar off will I send thee. ²² And they heard him until this word and then lifted up their voice, saying: Away with such an one from the earth. For it is not fit that he should live. ²³ And as they cried out and threw off their garments and cast dust into the air, ²⁴ The tribune commanded him to be brought into the castle, and that he should be scourged and tortured: to know for what cause they did so cry out against him. ²⁵ And when they had bound him with thongs, Paul saith to the centurion that stood by him: Is it lawful for you to scourge a man that is a Roman and uncondemned? ²⁶ Which the centurion hearing, went to the tribune and told him, saying: What art thou about to do? For this man is a Roman citizen. ²⁷ And the tribune coming, said to him: Tell me. Art thou a Roman? But he said: Yea. ²⁸ And the tribune answered: I obtained the being free of this city with a great sum. And Paul said: But I was born so. ²⁹ Immediately therefore they departed from him that were about to torture him. The tribune also was afraid after he understood that he was a Roman citizen and because he had bound him. ³⁰ But on the next day, meaning to know more diligently for what cause he was accused by the Jews, he loosed him and commanded the priests to come together and all the council: and, bringing forth Paul, he set him before them.

23 ¹ And Paul, looking upon the council, said: Men, brethren, I have conversed with all good conscience before God until this present day. ² And the high priest, Ananias, commanded them that stood by him to strike him on the mouth. ³ Then Paul said to him: God shall strike thee, thou whited wall. For, sittest thou to judge me according to the law and, contrary to the law, commandest me to be struck? ⁴ And they that stood by said: Dost thou revile the high priest of God? ⁵ And Paul said: I knew not, brethren, that he is the high priest. For it is written: Thou shalt not speak evil of the prince of thy people. ⁶ And Paul, knowing that the one part were Sadducees and the other Pharisees, cried

out in the council: Men, brethren, I am a Pharisee, the son of Pharisees: concerning the hope and resurrection of the dead I am called in question. ⁷ And when he had so said, there arose a dissension between the Pharisees and the Sadducees. And the multitude was divided. ⁸ For the Sadducees say that there is no resurrection, neither angel, nor spirit: but the Pharisees confess both. ⁹ And there arose a great cry. And some of the Pharisees rising up, strove, saying: We find no evil in this man. What if a spirit hath spoken to him, or an angel? ¹⁰ And when there arose a great dissension, the tribune, fearing lest Paul should be pulled in pieces by them, commanded the soldiers to go down and to take him by force from among them and to bring him into the castle. ¹¹ And the night following, the Lord standing by him, said: Be constant: for as thou hast testified of me in Jerusalem, so must thou bear witness also at Rome. ¹² And when day was come, some of the Jews gathered together and bound themselves under a curse, saying that they would neither eat nor drink till they killed Paul. ¹³ And they were more than forty men that had made this conspiracy. ¹⁴ Who came to the chief priests and the ancients and said: We have bound ourselves under a great curse that we will eat nothing till we have slain Paul. ¹⁵ Now therefore do you with the council signify to the tribune, that he bring him forth to you, as if you meant to know something more certain touching him. And we, before he come near, are ready to kill him. ¹⁶ Which when Paul's sister's son had heard, of their lying in wait, he came and entered into the castle and told Paul. ¹⁷ And Paul, calling to him one of the centurions, said: Bring this young man to the tribune: for he hath some thing to tell him. ¹⁸ And he, taking him, brought him to the tribune and said: Paul, the prisoner, desired me to bring this young man unto thee, who hath some thing to say to thee. ¹⁹ And the tribune, taking him by the hand, went aside with him privately and asked him: What is it that thou hast to tell me? ²⁰ And he said: The Jews have agreed to desire thee that thou wouldst bring forth Paul to-morrow into the council, as if they meant to inquire some thing more certain touching him. ²¹ But do not thou give credit to them: for there lie in wait for him more than forty men of them, who have bound themselves by oath neither to eat nor to drink, till they have killed him. And they are now ready, looking for a promise from thee. ²² The tribune therefore dismissed the young man, charging him that he should tell no man that he had made known these things unto him. ²³ Then having called two centurions, he said to them: Make ready two hundred soldiers to go as far as Cæsarea: and seventy horsemen and two hundred spearmen, for the third hour of the night. ²⁴ And provide beasts, that they may set Paul on and bring him safe to Felix the governor. ²⁵ (For he feared lest perhaps the Jews might take him away by force and kill him: and he should afterwards be slandered, as if he was to take money.) And he wrote a letter after this manner: ²⁶ Claudius Lysias to the most excellent governor, Felix, greeting: ²⁷ This man, being taken by the Jews and ready to be killed by them, I rescued, coming in with an army, understanding that he is a Roman. ²⁸ And meaning to know the cause which they objected unto him, I brought him forth into their council. ²⁹ Whom I found to be accused concerning questions of their law; but having nothing laid to his charge worthy of death or of bands. ³⁰ And when I was told of ambushes that they had prepared for him, I sent

him to thee, signifying also to his accusers to plead before thee. Farewell. ³¹ Then the soldiers, according as it was commanded them, taking Paul, brought him by night to Antipatris. ³² And the next day, leaving the horsemen to go with him, they returned to the castle. ³³ Who, when they were come to Cæsarea and had delivered the letter to the governor, did also present Paul before him. ³⁴ And when he had read it and had asked of what province he was and understood that he was of Cilicia: ³⁵ I will hear thee, said he, when thy accusers come. And he commanded him to be kept in Herod's judgment hall.

353. *Felix, Festus, the appeal to Caesar, and Agrippa*

Acts 24:1-26:32

24 ¹ And after five days, the high priest, Ananias, came down with some ancients and one Tertullus, an orator, who went to the governor against Paul. ² And Paul being called for, Tertullus began to accuse him, saying: Whereas, through thee we live in much peace and many things are rectified by thy providence, ³ We accept it always and in all places, most excellent Felix, with all thanksgiving. ⁴ But that I be no further tedious to thee, I desire thee of thy clemency to hear us in a few words. ⁵ We have found this to be a pestilent man and raising seditions among all the Jews throughout the world: and author of the sedition of the sect of the Nazarenes. ⁶ Who also hath gone about to profane the temple: whom, we having apprehended, would also have judged according to our law. ⁷ But Lysias the tribune, coming upon us with great violence, took him away out of our hands; ⁸ Commanding his accusers to come to thee. Of whom thou mayest thyself, by examination, have knowledge of all these things whereof we accuse him. ⁹ And the Jews also added and said that these things were so. ¹⁰ Then Paul answered (the governor making a sign to him to speak): Knowing that for many years thou hast been judge over this nation, I will with good courage answer for myself. ¹¹ For thou mayest understand that there are yet but twelve days since I went up to adore in Jerusalem: ¹² And neither in the temple did they find me disputing with any man or causing any concourse of the people: neither in the synagogues, nor in the city. ¹³ Neither can they prove unto thee the things whereof they now accuse me. ¹⁴ But this I confess to thee that according to the way which they call a heresy, so do I serve the Father and my God, believing all things which are written in the law and the prophets: ¹⁵ Having hope in God, which these also themselves look for, that there shall be a resurrection of the just and unjust. ¹⁶ And herein do I endeavour to have always a conscience without offence, towards God and towards men. ¹⁷ Now after many years, I came to bring alms to my nation and offerings and vows. ¹⁸ In which I was found purified in the temple: neither with multitude nor with tumult. ¹⁹ But certain Jews of Asia, who ought to be present before thee and to accuse, if they had anything against me: ²⁰ Or let these men themselves say if they found in me any iniquity, when standing before the council, ²¹ Except it be for this one voice only that I cried, standing among them: Concerning the resurrection of the dead am I judged this day by you.

²² And Felix put them off, having most certain knowledge of this way, saying: When Lysias the tribune shall come down, I will hear you. ²³ And he commanded a centurion to keep him:

and that he should be easy and that he should not prohibit any of his friends to minister unto him.

²⁴ And after some days, Felix, coming with Drusilla his wife, who was a Jew, sent for Paul and heard of him the faith that is in Christ Jesus. ²⁵ And as he treated of justice and chastity and of the judgment to come, Felix, being terrified, answered: For this time, go thy way: but when I have a convenient time, I will send for thee. ²⁶ Hoping also withal that money should be given him by Paul: for which cause also oftentimes sending for him, he spoke with him. ²⁷ But when two years were ended, Felix had for successor Portius Festus. And Felix being willing to shew the Jews a pleasure, left Paul bound.

25 ¹ Now when Festus was come into the province, after three days, he went up to Jerusalem from Cæsarea. ² And the chief priests and principal men of the Jews went unto him against Paul: and they besought him. ³ Requesting favour against him, that he would command him to be brought to Jerusalem, laying wait to kill him in the way. ⁴ But Festus answered: That Paul was kept in Cæsarea: and that he himself would very shortly depart thither. ⁵ Let them, therefore, saith he, among you that are able, go down with me and accuse him, if there be any crime in the man. ⁶ And having tarried among them no more than eight or ten days, he went down to Cæsarea. And the next day, he sat in the judgment seat and commanded Paul to be brought. ⁷ Who being brought, the Jews stood about him, who were come down from Jerusalem, objecting many and grievous causes, which they could not prove: ⁸ Paul making answer for himself: Neither against the law of the Jews, nor against the temple, nor against Caesar, have I offended in any thing. ⁹ But Festus, willing to shew the Jews a pleasure, answering Paul, said: Wilt thou go up to Jerusalem and there be judged of these things before me? ¹⁰ Then Paul said: I stand at Caesar's judgment seat, where I ought to be judged. To the Jews I have done no injury, as thou very well knowest. ¹¹ For if I have injured them or have committed any thing worthy of death, I refuse not to die. But if there be none of these things whereof they accuse me, no man may deliver me to them. I appeal to Caesar. ¹² Then Festus, having conferred with the council, answered: Hast thou appealed to Caesar? To Caesar shalt thou go.

¹³ And after some days, king Agrippa and Bernice came down to Cæsarea, to salute Festus. ¹⁴ And as they tarried there many days, Festus told the king of Paul, saying: A certain man was left prisoner by Felix. ¹⁵ About whom, when I was at Jerusalem, the chief priests and the ancients of the Jews came unto me, desiring condemnation against him. ¹⁶ To whom I answered: it is not the custom of the Romans to condemn any man, before that he who is accused have his accusers present and have liberty to make his answer, to clear himself of the things laid to his charge. ¹⁷ When therefore they were come hither, without any delay, on the day following, sitting in the judgment seat, I commanded the man to be brought. ¹⁸ Against whom, when the accusers stood up, they brought no accusation of this which I thought ill of: ¹⁹ But had certain questions of their own superstition against him, and of one Jesus deceased, whom Paul affirmed to be alive. ²⁰ I therefore being in a doubt of this manner of question, asked him whether he would go to Jerusalem and there be judged of these things. ²¹ But Paul, appealing to be reserved unto the hearing

of Augustus, I commanded him to be kept, till I might send him to Caesar. ²² And Agrippa said to Festus: I would also hear the man, myself. To-morrow, said he, thou shalt hear him.

²³ And on the next day, when Agrippa and Bernice were come with great pomp and had entered into the hall of audience with the tribunes and principal men of the city, at Festus' commandment, Paul was brought forth. ²⁴ And Festus saith: King Agrippa and all ye men who are here present with us, you see this man, about whom all the multitude of the Jews dealt with me at Jerusalem, requesting and crying out that he ought not to live any longer. ²⁵ Yet have I found nothing that he hath committed worthy of death. But forasmuch as he himself hath appealed to Augustus, I have determined to send him. ²⁶ Of whom I have nothing certain to write to my lord. For which cause, I have brought him forth before you, and especially before thee, O king Agrippa, that, examination being made, I may have what to write. ²⁷ For it seemeth to me unreasonable to send a prisoner and not to signify the things laid to his charge.

26 ¹ Then Agrippa said to Paul: Thou art permitted to speak for thyself. Then Paul, stretching forth his hand, began to make his answer. ² I think myself happy, O king Agrippa, that I am to answer for myself this day before thee, touching all the things whereof I am accused by the Jews. ³ Especially as thou knowest all, both customs and questions, that are among the Jews. Wherefore I beseech thee to hear me patiently. ⁴ And my life indeed from my youth, which was from the beginning among my own nation in Jerusalem, all the Jews do know: ⁵ Having known me from the beginning (if they will give testimony) that according to the most sure sect of our religion I lived, a Pharisee. ⁶ And now for the hope of the promise that was made by God to the fathers, do I stand subject to judgment: ⁷ Unto which, our twelve tribes, serving night and day, hope to come. For which hope, O king, I am accused by the Jews. ⁸ Why should it be thought a thing incredible that God should raise the dead? ⁹ And I indeed did formerly think that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth. ¹⁰ Which also I did at Jerusalem: and many of the saints did I shut up in prison, having received authority of the chief priests. And when they were put to death, I brought the sentence. ¹¹ And oftentimes punishing them, in every synagogue, I compelled them to blaspheme: and being yet more mad against them, I persecuted them even unto foreign cities. ¹² Whereupon, when I was going to Damascus with authority and permission of the chief priest, ¹³ At midday, O king, I saw in the way a light from heaven, above the brightness of the sun, shining round about me and them that were in company with me. ¹⁴ And when we were all fallen down on the ground, I heard a voice speaking to me in the Hebrew tongue: Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? It is hard for thee to kick against the goad. ¹⁵ And I said: Who art thou, Lord? And the Lord answered: I am Jesus whom thou persecutest. ¹⁶ But rise up and stand upon thy feet: for to this end have I appeared to thee, that I may make thee a minister and a witness of those things which thou hast seen and of those things wherein I will appear to thee, ¹⁷ Delivering thee from the people and from the nations unto which now I send thee: ¹⁸ To open their eyes, that they may be converted from darkness to light and from the power of Satan to God, that they may receive forgiveness of sins and a

lot among the saints, by the faith that is in me. ¹⁹ Whereupon, O king Agrippa, I was not incredulous to the heavenly vision. ²⁰ But to them first that are at Damascus and at Jerusalem, and unto all the country of Judea, and to the Gentiles did I preach, that they should do penance and turn to God, doing works worthy of penance. ²¹ For this cause, the Jews, when I was in the temple, having apprehended me, went about to kill me. ²² But being aided by the help of God, I stand unto this day, witnessing both to small and great, saying no other thing than those which the prophets and Moses did say should come to pass: ²³ That Christ should suffer and that he should be the first that should rise from the dead and should shew light to the people and to the Gentiles.

²⁴ As he spoke these things and made his answer, Festus said with a loud voice: Paul, thou art beside thyself: much learning doth make thee mad. ²⁵ And Paul said: I am not mad, most excellent Festus, but I speak words of truth and soberness. ²⁶ For the king knoweth of these things, to whom also I speak with confidence. For I am persuaded that none of these things are hidden from him. For neither was any of these things done in a corner. ²⁷ Believest thou the prophets, O king Agrippa? I know that thou believest. ²⁸ And Agrippa said to Paul: In a little thou persuadest me to become a Christian. ²⁹ And Paul said: I would to God that both in a little and in much, not only thou, but also all that hear me this day, should become such as I also am, except these bands. ³⁰ And the king rose up, and the governor and Bernice and they that sat with them. ³¹ And when they were gone aside, they spoke among themselves, saying: This man hath done nothing worthy of death or of bands. ³² And Agrippa said to Festus: This man might have been set at liberty, if he had not appealed to Caesar.

354. The shipwreck

Acts 27:1-44

27 ¹ And when it was determined that he should sail into Italy and that Paul, with the other prisoners, should be delivered to a centurion, named Julius, of the band Augusta, ² Going on board a ship of Adrumetum, we launched, meaning to sail by the coasts of Asia, Aristarchus, the Macedonian of Thessalonica, continuing with us. ³ And the day following, we came to Sidon. And Julius, treating Paul courteously, permitted him to go to his friends and to take care of himself. ⁴ And when we had launched from thence, we sailed under Cyprus, because the winds were contrary. ⁵ And sailing over the sea of Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came to Lystra, which is in Lycia. ⁶ And there, the centurion, finding a ship of Alexandria sailing into Italy, removed us into it. ⁷ And when for many days we had sailed slowly and were scarce come over against Gnidus, the wind not suffering us, we sailed near Crete by Salmone. ⁸ And with much ado sailing by it, we came into a certain place, which is called Good-havens, nigh to which was the city of Thalassa.

⁹ And when much time was spent and when sailing now was dangerous, because the fast was now past, Paul comforted them, ¹⁰ Saying to them: Ye men, I see that the voyage beginneth to be with injury and much damage, not only of the lading and ship, but also of our lives. ¹¹ But the centurion believed the pilot and the master of the ship, more than those things which were said by Paul. ¹² And whereas it was not a commodious haven

to winter in, the greatest part gave counsel to sail thence, if by any means they might reach Phenice, to winter there, which is a haven of Crete, looking towards the south-west and north-west. ¹³ And the south wind gently blowing, thinking that they had obtained their purpose, when they had loosed from Asson, they sailed close by Crete. ¹⁴ But not long after, there arose against it a tempestuous wind, called Euroaquilo. ¹⁵ And when the ship was caught and could not bear up against the wind, giving up the ship to the winds, we were driven. ¹⁶ And running under a certain island that is called Cauda, we had much work to come by the boat. ¹⁷ Which being taken up, they used helps, undergirding the ship: and fearing lest they should fall into the quicksands, they let down the sail yard and so were driven. ¹⁸ And we, being mightily tossed with the tempest, the next day they lightened the ship. ¹⁹ And the third day they cast out with their own hands the tackling of the ship. ²⁰ And when neither sun nor stars appeared for many days and no small storm lay on us, all hope of our being saved was now taken away. ²¹ And after they had fasted a long time, Paul standing forth in the midst of them, said: You should indeed, O ye men, have hearkened unto me and not have loosed from Crete and have gained this harm and loss. ²² And now I exhort you to be of good cheer. For there shall be no loss of any man's life among you, but only of the ship. ²³ For an angel of God, whose I am and whom I serve, stood by me this night, ²⁴ Saying: Fear not, Paul, thou must be brought before Caesar; and behold, God hath given thee all them that sail with thee. ²⁵ Wherefore, sirs, be of good cheer: for I believe God, that it shall so be, as it hath been told me. ²⁶ And we must come unto a certain island. ²⁷ But after the fourteenth night was come, as we were sailing in Adria, about midnight, the shipmen deemed that they discovered some country. ²⁸ Who also sounding, found twenty fathoms: and going on a little further, they found fifteen fathoms. ²⁹ Then fearing lest we should fall upon rough places, they cast four anchors out of the stern: and wished for the day. ³⁰ But as the shipmen sought to fly out of the ship, having let down the boat into the sea, under colour, as though they would have cast anchors out of the forepart of the ship, ³¹ Paul said to the centurion and to the soldiers: Except these stay in the ship, you cannot be saved. ³² Then the soldiers cut off the ropes of the boat and let her fall off. ³³ And when it began to be light, Paul besought them all to take meat, saying: This day is the fourteenth day that you have waited and continued fasting, taking nothing. ³⁴ Wherefore, I pray you to take some meat for your health's sake: for there shall not an hair of the head of any of you perish. ³⁵ And when he had said these things, taking bread, he gave thanks to God in the sight of them all. And when he had broken it, he began to eat. ³⁶ Then were they all of better cheer: and they also took some meat. ³⁷ And we were in all in the ship two hundred threescore and sixteen souls. ³⁸ And when they had eaten enough, they lightened the ship, casting the wheat into the sea. ³⁹ And when it was day, they knew not the land. But they discovered a certain creek that had a shore, into which they minded, if they could, to thrust in the ship. ⁴⁰ And when they had taken up the anchors, they committed themselves to the sea, loosing withal the rudder bands. And hoisting up the mainsail to the wind, they made towards shore. ⁴¹ And when we were fallen into a place where two seas met, they run the ship aground. And

the forepart indeed, sticking fast, remained unmoveable: but the hinder part was broken with the violence of the sea. ⁴² And the soldiers' counsel was that they should kill the prisoners, lest any of them, swimming out should escape. ⁴³ But the centurion, willing to save Paul, forbade it to be done. And he commanded that they who could swim should cast themselves first into the sea and save themselves and get to land. ⁴⁴ And the rest, some they carried on boards and some on those things that belonged to the ship. And so it came to pass that every soul got safe to land.

355. Rome

Acts 28:1-31

"Preaching the kingdom of God... without prohibition." The book stops rather than ends, and so does the period.

28 ¹ And when we had escaped, then we knew that the island was called Melita. But the barbarians shewed us no small courtesy. ² For kindling a fire, they refreshed us all, because of the present rain and of the cold. ³ And when Paul had gathered together a bundle of sticks and had laid them on the fire, a viper, coming out of the heat, fastened on his hand. ⁴ And when the barbarians saw the beast hanging on his hand, they said one to another: Undoubtedly this man is a murderer, who, though he hath escaped the sea, yet vengeance doth not suffer him to live. ⁵ And he indeed, shaking off the beast into the fire, suffered no harm. ⁶ But they supposed that he would begin to swell up and that he would suddenly fall down and die. But expecting long and seeing that there came no harm to him, changing their minds, they said that he was a god.

⁷ Now in these places were possessions of the chief man of the island, named Publius: who, receiving us for three days, entertained us courteously. ⁸ And it happened that the father of Publius lay sick of a fever and of a bloody flux. To whom Paul entered in. And when he had prayed and laid his hands on him, he healed him. ⁹ Which being done, all that had diseases in the island came and were healed. ¹⁰ Who also honoured us with many honours: and when we were to set sail, they laded us with such things as were necessary.

¹¹ And after three months, we sailed in a ship of Alexandria, that had wintered in the island, whose sign was the Castors. ¹² And when we were come to Syracuse, we tarried there three days. ¹³ From thence, compassing by the shore, we came to Rhegium: and after one day, the south wind blowing, we came the second day to Puteoli: ¹⁴ Where, finding brethren, we were desired to tarry with them seven days. And so we went to Rome. ¹⁵ And from thence, when the brethren had heard of us, they came to meet us as far as Appii Forum and the Three Taverns. Whom when Paul saw, he gave thanks to God and took courage. ¹⁶ And when we were come to Rome, Paul was suffered to dwell by himself, with a soldier that kept him.

¹⁷ And after the third day, he called together the chief of the Jews. And when they were assembled, he said to them: Men, brethren, I, having done nothing against the people or the custom of our fathers, was delivered prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans. ¹⁸ Who, when they had examined me, would have released me, for that there was no cause of death in me. ¹⁹ But the Jews contradicting it, I was constrained to appeal

unto Caesar: not that I had anything to accuse my nation of. ²⁰ For this cause therefore I desired to see you and to speak to you. Because that for the hope of Israel, I am bound with this chain. ²¹ But they said to him: We neither received letters concerning thee from Judea: neither did any of the brethren that came hither relate or speak any evil of thee. ²² But we desire to hear of thee what thou thinkest: for as concerning this sect, we know that it is every where contradicted. ²³ And when they had appointed him a day, there came very many to him unto his lodgings. To whom he expounded, testifying the kingdom of God and persuading them concerning Jesus, out of the law of Moses and the prophets, from morning until evening. ²⁴ And some believed the things that were said: but some believed not. ²⁵ And when they agreed not among themselves, they departed, Paul speaking this one word: Well did the Holy Ghost speak to our fathers by Isaias the prophet, ²⁶ Saying: Go to this people and say to them: With the ear you shall hear and shall not understand: and seeing you shall see and shall not perceive. ²⁷ For the heart of this people is grown gross, and with their ears have they heard heavily and their eyes they have shut, lest perhaps they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and should be converted: and I should heal them. ²⁸ Be it known therefore to you that this salvation of God is sent to the Gentiles: and they will hear it. ²⁹ And when he had said these things, the Jews went out from him, having much reasoning among themselves.

³⁰ And he remained two whole years in his own hired lodging: and he received all that came in to him, ³¹ Preaching the kingdom of God and teaching the things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ, with all confidence, without prohibition.

356. Psalm 117

Psalms 117:1-29

Vulgate 117 = Hebrew 118: "The stone which the builders rejected" - quoted by Christ and by St. Peter before the council.

117 ¹ Give praise to the Lord, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever. ² Let Israel now say, that he is good: that his mercy endureth for ever. ³ Let the house of Aaron now say, that his mercy endureth for ever. ⁴ Let them that fear the Lord now say, that his mercy endureth for ever. ⁵ In my trouble I called upon the Lord: and the Lord heard me, and enlarged me. ⁶ The Lord is my helper: I will not fear what man can do unto me. ⁷ The Lord is my helper: and I will look over my enemies. ⁸ It is good to confide in the Lord, rather than to have confidence in man. ⁹ It is good to trust in the Lord, rather than to trust in princes. ¹⁰ All nations compassed me about; and, in the name of the Lord I have been revenged on them. ¹¹ Surrounding me they compassed me about: and in the name of the Lord I have been revenged on them. ¹² They surrounded me like bees, and they burned like fire among thorns: and in the name of the Lord I was revenged on them. ¹³ Being pushed I was overturned that I might fall: but the Lord supported me. ¹⁴ The Lord is my strength and my praise: and he is become my salvation. ¹⁵ The voice of rejoicing and of salvation is in the tabernacles of the just. ¹⁶ The right hand of the Lord hath wrought strength: the right hand of the Lord hath exalted me: the right hand of the Lord hath wrought strength. ¹⁷ I shall not die, but live: and shall declare

the works of the Lord. ¹⁸ The Lord chastising hath chastised me: but he hath not delivered me over to death. ¹⁹ Open ye to me the gates of justice: I will go in to them, and give praise to the Lord. ²⁰ This is the gate of the Lord, the just shall enter into it. ²¹ I will give glory to thee because thou hast heard me: and art become my salvation. ²² The stone which the builders rejected; the same is become the head of the corner. ²³ This is the Lord's doing, and it is wonderful in our eyes. ²⁴ This is the day which the Lord hath made: let us be glad and rejoice therein. ²⁵ O Lord, save me: O Lord, give good success. ²⁶ Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. We have blessed you out of the house of the Lord. ²⁷ The Lord is God, and he hath shone upon us. Appoint a solemn day, with shady boughs, even to the horn of the altar. ²⁸ Thou art my God, and I will praise thee: thou art my God, and I will exalt thee. I will praise thee, because thou hast heard me, and art become my salvation. ²⁹ O praise ye the Lord, for he is good: for his mercy endureth for ever.

357. A new heaven and a new earth

Revelation 21:1-22:5

Douay-Rheims title: the Apocalypse of St. John. The one passage of the Apocalypse in this plan, read so that the arc opened in Genesis 1 closes: a garden, a river, and the tree of life, with no sea and no night.

21 ¹ And I saw a new heaven and a new earth. For the first heaven and the first earth was gone: and the sea is now no more. ² And I, John, saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. ³ And I heard a great voice from the throne, saying: Behold the tabernacle of God with men: and he will dwell with them. And they shall be his people: and God himself with them shall be their God. ⁴ And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes: and death shall be no more. Nor mourning, nor crying, nor sorrow shall be any more, for the former things are passed away. ⁵ And he that sat on the throne, said: Behold, I make all things new. And he said to me: Write. For these words are most faithful and true. ⁶ And he said to me: It is done. I am Alpha and Omega: the Beginning and the End. To him that thirsteth, I will give of the fountain of the water of life, freely. ⁷ He that shall overcome shall possess these things. And I will be his God: and he shall be my son. ⁸ But the fearful and unbelieving and the abominable and murderers and whoremongers and sorcerers and idolaters and all liars, they shall have their portion in the pool burning with fire and brimstone, which is the second death.

⁹ And there came one of the seven angels, who had the vials full of the seven last plagues, and spoke with me, saying: Come and I will shew thee the bride, the wife of the Lamb. ¹⁰ And he took me up in spirit to a great and high mountain: and he shewed me the holy city Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, ¹¹ Having the glory of God, and the light thereof was like to a precious stone, as to the jasper stone even as crystal. ¹² And it had a wall great and high, having twelve gates, and in the gates twelve angels, and names written thereon, which are the names of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel. ¹³ On the east, three gates: and on the north, three gates: and on the south, three gates: and on the west, three gates. ¹⁴ And the wall of the city had twelve foundations: And in them, the twelve names

of the twelve apostles of the Lamb, ¹⁵ And he that spoke with me had a measure of a reed of gold, to measure the city and the gates thereof and the wall. ¹⁶ And the city lieth in a four-square: and the length thereof is as great as the breadth. And he measured the city with the golden reed for twelve thousand furlongs: and the length and the height and the breadth thereof are equal. ¹⁷ And he measured the wall thereof an hundred forty-four cubits, the measure of a man, which is of an angel. ¹⁸ And the building of the wall thereof was of jasper stone: but the city itself pure gold like to clear glass. ¹⁹ And the foundations of the wall of the city were adorned with all manner of precious stones. The first foundation was jasper: the second, sapphire: the third; a chalcedony: the fourth, an emerald: ²⁰ The fifth, sardonyx: the sixth, sardius: the seventh, chrysolite: the eighth, beryl: the ninth, a topaz: the tenth, a chrysoprasus: the eleventh, a jacinth: the twelfth, an amethyst. ²¹ And the twelve gates are twelve pearls, one to each: and every several gate was of one several pearl. And the street of the city was pure gold, as it were, transparent glass. ²² And I saw no temple therein. For the Lord God Almighty is the temple thereof, and the Lamb. ²³ And the city hath no need of the sun, nor of the moon, to shine in it. For the glory of God hath enlightened it: and the Lamb is the lamp thereof. ²⁴ And the nations shall walk in the light of it: and the kings of the earth shall bring their glory and honour into it. ²⁵ And the gates thereof shall not be shut by day: for there shall be no night there. ²⁶ And they shall bring the glory and honour of the nations into it. ²⁷ There shall not enter into it any thing defiled or that worketh abomination or maketh a lie: but they that are written in the book of life of the Lamb.

22 ¹ And he shewed me a river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding from the throne of God and of the Lamb. ² In the midst of the street thereof, and on both sides of the river, was the tree of life, bearing twelve fruits, yielding its fruits every month: and the leaves of the tree for the healing of the nations. ³ And there shall be no curse any more: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it. And his servants shall serve him. ⁴ And they shall see his face: and his name shall be on their foreheads. ⁵ And night shall be no more. And they shall not need the light of the lamp, nor the light of the sun, because the Lord God shall enlighten them. And they shall reign for ever and ever.

Appendices

The apparatus of this volume. It stands at the back so that the readings can stand at the front; nothing has been shortened to put it here.

A. This edition

Registered as. douay-rheims

Source record. edition.english-college-of-douay.douay-rheims-bible.challoner-gutenberg-1581

Publication. Project Gutenberg eBook 1581, released 1 December 1998, most recently updated 23 September 2023; produced by Dennis McCarthy and Tad Book from a text originally published by Catholic Software

Date. 1749

Language. en

Chapter and verse numbering. vulgate

Psalter. gallican

Psalms inscriptions. numbered

B. Rights

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Jurisdiction. United States

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The sequence is `src/sources/reading-plans/narrative-spine.yaml`, read at its full-account tier. The tiers nest: every reading carries the tier at which it first appears and appears at no other, so a tier is read by taking every reading at that tier or above, in order. The text is the tracked per-book verse files of this edition under `src/sources/works/english-college-of-douay/douay-rheims-bible/editions/challoner-gutenberg-1581/artifacts`. Nothing was retrieved, corrected or supplied while typesetting.

Numbering. The plan cites in vulgate numbering and this edition prints vulgate. Where the two differ a reading is converted through the tracked verse-level psalm concordance, and the reference this edition carries is printed beside the one the plan cites. Where no correspondence is recorded the reading is refused and says so, because a psalm reference that resolves to a real verse of the wrong psalm cannot be told from a correct one.

Paragraphs. 1054 paragraph breaks are set in this volume, and not one of them was chosen while typesetting. The tracked verse files of every edition in this library are one verse per row and carry no paragraph structure at all; the markers their sources carried were dropped when the text was derived. Where a break is printed here it comes from one of two places, and both are tracked tables that can be read, counted and regenerated.

1054 projected. No paragraph mark survives for this edition there, so the break is projected from witnesses that have one, under a rule rather than by hand: it is set only where every witness able to carry that verse opens a paragraph at it, and at least two do. The witnesses are king-james-version and world-english-bible-catholic. Where they disagree nothing is printed — and they disagree often, concurring at 2239 of the 8661 places where any of them breaks, which is 25.9%. That refusal is deliberate. A break resting on one witness alone would read as this edition's own paragraphing, and it would not be.

Set `--no-paragraphs` to remove every break and set the text exactly as the stored verse files hold it, each chapter running on as one paragraph. A mechanical review of this edition should use it: with the projection on, what is under review is partly this projection. It removes the paragraphing and nothing else: the verses set, their order and their wording are identical either way. The pilcrows go with the breaks, being paragraph marks themselves.

Digest. Of the verse rows set, in the order set (SHA-256): eacac3f8325033555af39d0f77d7acd7848be9c3159862758baa69d52bef3590

D. What this edition cannot carry

Every reading of this track resolves in this edition.

E. Colophon

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